

The Basis of Minor Vinaya Matters

Vinayakṣudraka-vastu · Toh 6 · Derge Kangyur

འདུལ་བ་པ་ལྟ་ཆགས་ཀྱི་གྲིལ་

Toh 6 in the Kangyur is the Vinayakṣudraka-vastu, known in Tibetan as the Dul wa trantsek kyi zhi (འདུལ་བ་པ་ལྟ་ཆགས་ཀྱི་གྲིལ་), rendered in English as The Basis of Minor Vinaya Matters. It is a canonical Vinaya text belonging to the Mūlasarvāstivāda monastic code and deals with a wide range of minor rules and practical regulations governing the daily life of Buddhist monastics, covering topics as varied as tooth-scrapers, robes, bowls, water-strainers, and personal adornments. As the title suggests, it collects miscellaneous disciplinary matters that do not fit neatly into the major categories of the Vinaya but are nonetheless considered authoritative guidance for monastic conduct. This text forms part of the Vinaya section of the Kangyur, the collection of canonical scriptures attributed to the Buddha himself, and opens with the scene of the Buddha residing at Vaiśālī, establishing the narrative frame from which the individual rules and their origins are expounded.

In the language of India: Vinayakṣudraka-vastu. In the Tibetan language: The Basis of Minor Vinaya Matters. The first section.

Homage to the Omniscient One.

A summary verse of the Basis of Minor Matters:

A tooth-scraper, a monastic robe,
a measuring rod, an elder's body-wash,
an investigation, remorse, and its removal —
these are rightly taught as the basis of minor matters.

A condensed summary verse:

A tooth-scraper, trimming the nails,
a bowl's parts, a mirror-born matter,
a bypath, a water-strainer, pulse soup,
washing the feet, and a knot on the robe.

A summary verse:

A tooth-scraper and white earth,
a fish-scale, a fragrant hand-stamp,
two pillars and two threads,

a wrist ornament, and a ring impression.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Vaiśālī, in the Monkey Pond Hall, the many-storied pavilion. The group of six monks, early in the morning, having divided up their lower robes and their outer monastic robes, and taking their bowls, entered Vaiśālī for the sake of alms. Now, in the interval between Vaiśālī and the many-storied pavilion, the pleasure groves of the Licchavīs of Vaiśālī were filled with flowers and fruit and water in abundance, and with various birds singing — a delightful grove like a pleasure park. Within those groves there were also various implements of sport, of dance, of song, of music, and of bathing set out, and the sounds of all manner of performance were there as well.

The group of six said to one another: "Friends, dear friends — the Blessed One has cited the Licchavīs of Vaiśālī and their pleasure groves as an example for the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three. Let us go for a while and look at those pleasure groves to see what they are like." And having agreed on this, they entered the pleasure groves. There they saw implements for sport: large arrows and straight ones, various throwing-stones, and various implements for dance, song, and music — lutes, flutes, clay drums, hand drums, beautiful-sounding instruments and many others — and also bathing implements: tooth-scrapers, cleansing powder, various kinds of āmalaka for washing the hair. When they saw all of this, they said to one another: "Friends, dear friends, since there are so many excellent implements here of every kind, should we not do some sport, or dance, or sing, or make music, or bathe?" Some said: "Let us bathe long — the more washing the better." And having agreed, they began rubbing themselves with the tooth-scrapers and set about bathing. Those who were skilled in crafts and in practical arts commenced their bathing, and from those who entered the water there arose a most pleasing sound — like a five-branched melody skillfully played by an accomplished musician.

The great mass of people going along the road heard this sound, and pricking up their ears, they stopped for a moment and said: "O wise ones, let us go to the pleasure groves of the Licchavīs of Vaiśālī where the dancers are dancing!" And those who were attracted by the spectacle quickly set off and entered the pleasure groves. There they came upon the group of six, who had just come out. The group of six said to those people: "Noble ones, in which direction are the dancers dancing?" The people replied: "Wretch, you make no distinction —

would a sound like this arise where dancers are dancing? Noble ones, then whose sound was this?" "Wise ones, we were scrubbing our bodies and bathing." "Noble ones, do you contemptible monks torment yourselves with sensual pleasures? You are pressed down by the round of your throat, and you contemptible monks torment yourselves with sensual pleasures. Are you teaching us your way? Say nothing more — we will do you harm." And having threatened them, they set off ahead, entered Vaiśālī, and along the main road and the lanes,

they began to mock them at the crossroads and the lane-junctions. When the monks heard what had happened, they reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One considered the matter. Whatever fault had arisen came about because the monks were scrubbing their bodies with pumice stones while bathing. Therefore a monk shall not scrub his body with a pumice stone while bathing. If he does scrub in that way, it becomes an offence of wrongdoing. When the Blessed One had declared that a monk shall not scrub his body with a pumice stone while bathing, monks who had cracked heels and went on their alms round in a foul-smelling condition were seen by brahmins and householders, who said: "Noble ones, your feet are cracked and you smell — why do you not cleanse the filth away?" They replied: "Friends, the Blessed One has not permitted it." "Can it be, noble ones, that you will be purified by being mired in filth?" The monks said nothing and, having completed their alms round, they returned to the monastery. Then the monks reported the matter in full to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, what came before was a rule. This is now permitted. Therefore a monk is permitted to scrub his feet with a pumice stone — but not the rest of the body; if he scrubs the rest of the body it becomes an offence of wrongdoing."

The Blessed One was dwelling in Vaiśālī, in the Gabled Hall on the bank of the Monkey Pool. In the morning the monks dressed in their lower robes and outer robes, took up their bowls, and entered Vaiśālī on alms round. They saw a brahmin who had smeared three finger-lines of white clay on himself and was wandering about begging, and he was obtaining a great deal in the way of offerings. The group of six said: "Ananda, Upānanda, this is a good method — let us do the same." And so the next day they smeared three finger-lines of white clay on themselves and went on alms round. Those without faith, seeing this, mocked them and spoke with contempt, saying: "Speak with contempt!" And when the group of six heard this they said: "Wretches, do you not even know to whom respectful address is owed and to whom homage is owed?"

Those who replied said: "What do you expect of this? Elderly brahmins deserve respectful address, and monks deserve homage — so why do you offer respectful address to monks rather than homage?" The group of six said: "Noble ones, we take you to be brahmins, not monks. That being so, we have not paid homage — please forgive us." And with that, those people said nothing more.

When the monks heard of this they reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One considered the matter. Whatever fault had arisen came about because the monks were drawing three finger-lines. Therefore a monk shall not draw three finger-lines. If a monk draws three finger-lines, it becomes an offence of wrongdoing. When the Blessed One had declared that a monk shall not smear three finger-lines on himself, there was then an occasion when monks, though instructed by a physician, could not get medicine to be absorbed by their bodies. The monks reported this to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, what came before was a rule. This is now permitted. Therefore what is prescribed by a physician is excepted."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling in Śrāvastī, in Prince Jeta's Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. One morning the group of six dressed in their lower robes and outer robes, took up their bowls, and entered Śrāvastī on alms round, when —

They saw a brahmin performing the gestures of Gīti Wanggi Thig Le, surrounded by a great crowd of ordinary people who were singing his praises at a festival. The members of the group of six said to one another: "Friend, dear friend, this is a fine method — let us do likewise." Agreeing that they would indeed do so, the very next day they adorned themselves with the marks of Gīti Wanggi Thig Le and went out on alms round. Brahmins and householders who saw them mocked them and said: "Speak respectfully! Speak respectfully!" The group of six replied: "You poor wretch — do you not even know to whom respectful address is owed and to whom obeisance is due?" The brahmins and householders said: "What do we want from this? Aged brahmins are the ones to whom respectful address is owed, and monks are the ones to whom obeisance is due. So why do you monks receive respectful address but not obeisance? Noble ones, we take you to be brahmins, not monks. That is why we did not make obeisance to you. Please pardon us." And with that, both sides fell silent.

The monks then reported this matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One considered it and declared: "Whatever fault has arisen, monks, has come about through adorning oneself with the marks of Gīti Wanggi Thig Le. Therefore monks are not to adorn themselves with those marks. If one does so, it becomes an offense entailing a penalty."

After the Blessed One had declared that monks are not to adorn themselves with the marks of Gīti Wanggi Thig Le, a monk who had suddenly sustained a wound went to a physician and said: "Good sir, please show me a medicine." The physician replied: "Noble one, anoint the wound with Gīti Wang, and you will recover." The monk said: "The Blessed One has not permitted it." The physician said: "Noble one, your Teacher is compassionate — he will permit it." The monks then reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, what a physician prescribes is excepted."

After the Blessed One had declared that monks are not to scrape their bodies with a toothed scraper, the monks began scraping themselves with a fish-scale scraper. The Blessed One declared: "One is not to scrape with a fish-scale scraper. If one does so, it becomes an offense entailing a penalty."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling in Śrāvastī, in Prince Jeta's Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The group of six anointed themselves with perfume, then went among the young men and said: "Young men, how does our fragrance smell?" The young men said: "Elders, have you anointed yourselves with perfume?" "We have." "Elders, is it fitting for you to anoint yourselves with perfume?" "Fitting or not fitting, we have done it." The young men mocked and ridiculed them. The monks then reported this to the Blessed One. The Blessed One considered it and declared: "Whatever fault has arisen has come about through anointing with perfume. Therefore monks are not to anoint themselves with perfume. If one does so, it becomes an offense entailing a penalty."

After the Blessed One had declared that monks are not to anoint themselves with perfume, a sick monk went to a physician and said: "Good sir, please show me a medicine." The physician said: "Noble one, if you anoint yourself with perfume, you will recover." The monk said: "Good sir, is that something I may do as I please?" The physician said: "Noble one, this is your medicine — no other treatment will cure you." The monks then reported this to the Blessed One,

The Blessed One declared: "Then it is permitted — one may anoint oneself with perfume on a physician's prescription." But when monks had anointed themselves with perfume and were sitting within the Saṅgha, they would teach the Dharma to brahmins and householders who came to visit, and they would also go to the homes of brahmins and householders. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "I shall lay down a rule of conduct for monks who carry perfume. A monk who carries perfume shall not, after anointing himself, sit within the Saṅgha; he shall not teach the Dharma to brahmins and householders who come to visit; and he shall not go to the homes of brahmins and householders. But when he has recovered, he shall wash and become free of the scent, and then he may sit within the Saṅgha, teach the Dharma to brahmins and householders who come, and go to their homes. If a monk who carries perfume does not properly observe the rule of conduct as laid down, it becomes an offense entailing a penalty."

Now when faithful brahmins and householders offered perfume to the monks, the monks felt scrupulous and would not accept it. Those donors said: "Noble ones, before the awakened Blessed One appeared in the world, the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) were the worthy recipients of offerings. Now that the Blessed One has appeared in the world, you are the worthy recipients. If you will not accept, how shall we from this world accrue merit for the next? Please accept out of compassion for us." They then said: "We shall appeal to the Blessed One." The monks accordingly reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "You may accept it." The monks accepted and then threw the perfume down before those donors. The donors said: "Noble ones, did we not buy this at a fair price? You accepted it and then threw it away!" The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "You should not accept and then discard it; rather, you may apply it as handprint designs on the stūpas of the Tathāgata." The monks took it and applied handprint designs with the perfume on stūpas of hair and nail relics. The donors said: "Noble ones, did you not see the stūpa? We offered it to you alone — we had already made offerings to the stūpas of hair and nail relics before." The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Accept it and apply it to the residence halls." The monks applied it to the doors of the residence halls, and the donors, thinking these were fragrant bath-houses, were making prostrations. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Apply it to the interior." The

monks applied it directly on the walls, and the same problem arose again. The Blessed One then declared: "Apply it near the joints and near the feet of the columns, and all pleasant fragrances that are beneficial to the eyes may be carried about from time to time — there is no need to be scrupulous about this."

The awakened Blessed One was dwelling in the forest of the Fearsome-Looking Grove on the hill of the Jīvaka's Children's Killing — the grove that strikes terror into the heart. At that time a young prince had the handsome Lotus-Decorated Palace decorated and invited the Blessed One, together with his retinue of śrāvaka monks, at midday. The Blessed One was seated on a prepared throne in the upper hall of the Lotus-Decorated Palace. The beloved Ānanda, while eating his meal, leaned a hand against a pillar,

and the Lotus-Decorated Palace shook and swayed. Those who were questioning him said: "Noble one, the young prince Rtogs-byed had the Lotus-Decorated Palace decorated with a hundred and one colors — have you demolished it?" Ānanda replied: "Poor Rtogs-byed became deeply attached to this place and, when he died, was reborn without a fixed destination. And you too, through deep attachment to this place, will die and be reborn among the hungry ghosts with goiters." While these words were being exchanged, the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One, having reflected, said: "Whatever fault has arisen has come about through a monk leaning his hand against a pillar. Therefore monks must not lean their hands against pillars. If one does so, it becomes an offense entailing a meeting of the community." Having declared that monks must not lean their hands against pillars, the Group of Six thereupon began leaning against walls, the ground, and others — pressing with fists, elbows, shoulders, the head, the side of the ribs, the back, the waist, the thighs, the knees, the forearms, the feet, staffs, and sticks, and also pressing against others — thereby bringing about that very same fault. The Blessed One then declared: "No one must lean against anything in any such manner." The Group of Six then leaned against walls and the ground and pressed against others, and the Blessed One declared: "One must not lean against others either, in any manner. If one does so, it becomes an offense entailing a meeting of the community."

The awakened Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The Group of Six, having entered Śrāvastī in the morning for alms-rounds, saw a brahmin wearing the brahminical cord and wandering about begging, obtaining a great quantity of

food and provisions. The Group of Six said among themselves: "Friends, this is an excellent method — let us do likewise." The next day they put on the brahminical cord and went on their alms-rounds. Those of little faith who saw them mocked them and addressed them with derisive politeness — saying, "Speak politely, speak politely!" The Group of Six retorted: "Poor wretches, do you not know to whom one should speak politely and to whom one should bow? They replied: "What do you seek from us? Old brahmins are those to whom one speaks politely, and monks are those one bows to — so why do you monks address others with polite speech rather than bowing? Noble ones, we recognize you as brahmins, not as monks. This being so, we did not bow — please forgive us." And those monks fell silent, saying nothing. When the monks there heard of this, they reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One, having reflected, said: "Whatever fault has arisen has come about through monks wearing the brahminical cord. Therefore monks must not put on the brahminical cord. If one does so, it becomes an offense entailing a meeting of the community."

The awakened Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The Group of Six, having put on their lower robes and outer robes in the morning and taken their alms-bowls, entered Śrāvastī for alms-rounds. They saw a brahmin adorned with fragrant substances and flowers, his wrists bound with five-colored cords, who had eaten at a festival, his senses satisfied, and was departing from a house. They said among themselves: "Friends, this is an excellent method — let us do likewise." The next day they bound their wrists with five-colored cords and went on their alms-rounds.

When the brahmins and householders saw them, they mocked them and spoke with disdain. When they said "with disdain," the Group of Six replied: "You wretched ones — do you not even know who is to be addressed respectfully and who is to be venerated? The answer is this: elderly brahmins are those to be addressed respectfully, and monks are those to be venerated." They replied: "Then why do you address the monks respectfully rather than venerating them?" The Group of Six said: "Noble ones, we regard you as brahmins — not as monks. That being so, forgive us for not having venerated you." At that, the others fell silent.

At that time, the monks heard of this and reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One reflected, and saw that whatever fault had arisen had come about from monks binding their wrists with five-colored cords. Therefore, he

declared: "Monks shall not bind their wrists with five-colored cords. If one does so, it becomes an offense."

After the Blessed One had proclaimed that monks shall not bind their wrists with five-colored cords, a certain sick monk went to a physician and said: "Good sir, I have developed such and such an illness — please prescribe a remedy." The physician said: "Noble one, if a cord is recited over with sacred mantras and bound around your wrist, you will recover." The monk replied: "Good sir, the Blessed One has not permitted this." The physician said: "Noble one, your Teacher is compassionate — he will permit it."

At that time, the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, it is permitted to bind a cord on a physician's authority." After the Blessed One declared that a cord may be bound on a physician's authority, the monks bound it at the tip of the right hand — and the very same fault arose again. The Blessed One declared: "Monks shall not bind it at the tip of the right hand." They then bound it at the upper arm of the right hand — and that same fault arose again. The Blessed One declared: "It shall not be bound at the upper arm of the right hand." They then bound it at the tip of the left hand — and that same fault arose again. The Blessed One declared: "It shall not be bound at the tip of the left hand. However, it may be bound at the upper arm of the left hand."

When the monks had recovered from their illness, they discarded the cords carelessly, and non-humans mocked them, saying: "Noble ones, after we cured you, now you show no regard!" At that time the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "They shall not be discarded carelessly. If the illness has not cleared, bind it to the hem of the monastic robe or to a strap. But if one has fully recovered in every respect, place it in a pillar's joint or a crack in the wall."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The Group of Six, having put on their lower robes and outer robes in the morning and taken their alms-bowls, entered Śrāvastī for alms-rounds. The brahmins and householders had placed ornaments inside offering trays, and the Group of Six took up foot ornaments and arm ornaments and said: "Friend! Dear friend! How beautiful!" The brahmins and householders said: "Noble ones, your heads are shaved and your armpits are unshaven — what bodily beauty is there? Without a doubt, you monks have been overcome by the qualities of sensual desire."

They all remained silent. When the monks heard about this, they reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One reflected that whatever fault had arisen had come from monks adorning themselves with arm ornaments and foot ornaments. Therefore, a monk should not adorn himself with arm ornaments and foot ornaments. If he does so, it constitutes an offense.

The Blessed One was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. Those who take what has not been given them broke into the Saṅgha's storehouses and the monks' individual dwelling cells in the monastery, and stole from them. When other monks noticed that even one item was missing, they said: "We did not notice how much was taken from us." At that time the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, permission is granted to keep locks." Once the Blessed One had declared that locks were permitted, the Group of Six fastened locks made of gold, silver, lapis lazuli, and crystal, adorned with various ring-shaped seal ornaments. Then brahmins and householders, seeing this, reached out their hands and said: "Greetings! Good health to you, good health!" Those monks replied: "Noble ones, what is this?" And those laypeople mocked and ridiculed them, saying that the sons of the Śākya ascetic had fallen away from the conduct of an ascetic and from the conduct of a holy life — that right now these monks were attaching labels to locks and adorning themselves with ornaments. At that time the monks heard about this and reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "A monk should not keep locks made of gold, silver, lapis lazuli, or crystal, nor should he keep ring-shaped seal ornaments. However, the five kinds of lock — those made of iron, copper, cane, bone, and horn — are permitted."

The Group of Six painted figures of men and women sleeping together on their locks. Brahmins and householders said: "Noble ones, are you who are ascetics tormented by the qualities of sensual desire?" At that time the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "There are two kinds of lock: one belonging to the Saṅgha and one belonging to an individual. On the Saṅgha's lock, a wheel should be drawn in the center, and on the two sides, below deer figures, the name of the owner of the monastery should be written. On an individual's lock, a skeleton or a skull should be drawn."

A summary verse:

Cutting nails, dental cleaning,
āmra fruit and myrobalan,

the eight alms-bowls that were forbidden,
and the two things that were permitted.

The Blessed One was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At the time when the householder Anāthapiṇḍada offered the Jeta Grove to the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha, he said to the barber: "Good man, go to the Jeta Grove and shave the heads and faces of the noble ones." That man went to the Jeta Grove, and the habitual conduct of the Group of Six was such that at any given moment one member or another of the Group of Six would be at the gate of the Jeta Grove without fail. The venerable Ānanda was walking and sitting within the Jeta Grove, and when he saw that man approaching from a distance, he said: "Welcome! Welcome!"

"You have been gone a long while, like the moon when it disappears. Where have you come from?" The man replied: "The noble householder sent me here to shave the heads and faces of the noble ones." Ānanda asked: "Do you know how to trim nails well?" "This very craft is my trade, noble one." Ānanda looked over, and as the man drew near, Ānanda stretched out his hand. The barber asked: "How shall I trim them, noble one?" "Trim them like the tip of a grain." When the man had trimmed them like the tip of a grain, Ānanda said: "Now make them like the ledge of a fence, like the edge of a razor, like a crescent, and like the first sliver of the new moon." The man did exactly as he was directed in each case. At the end Ānanda said: "Wretch, you know not even the slightest thing! Go and make them exactly even in just this way." And so Ānanda kept the man there until sunset without releasing him.

After sunset the man went to the householder Anāthapiṇḍada, and Anāthapiṇḍada said: "Good man, how many noble ones' heads and faces have you shaved?" "How could I have shaved the heads and faces of the noble ones? That idle monk Ānanda detained me and had me do every manner of thing with the nails — like the tip of a grain, like the ledge of a fence, like the edge of a razor, like a crescent, and like the first sliver of the new moon — and then said: 'Wretch, you know not even the slightest thing! Go and make them exactly even in just this way,' and now that he has only just let me go, what am I to do?" The householder Anāthapiṇḍada then began to reproach those who had gone forth into the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, saying: "It seems that those who have gone forth show no restraint whatsoever."

At that time the monks heard this and reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One considered the matter. Whatever fault has arisen has come about through monks trimming their nails. Therefore a monk must not trim his nails. If he does so, it becomes an offense with consequences.

After the Blessed One had declared that a monk must not trim his nails, the monks kept their nails very long, and when the brahmins and householders saw this they said: "Why do the noble ones let their nails grow so very long? The Blessed One has not permitted it, noble ones. Can you purify yourselves by growing long nails?" At that time the monks heard this and reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "The former rule was a prohibition. This now is a permission. Therefore it is permitted: nails are to be trimmed in both ways — like the edge of a razor and like a crescent."

The Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At the time when the householder Anāthapiṇḍada offered the Jeta Grove to the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha — everything is exactly as before up to the point: "Do you know how to care for nails, noble one?" "How shall I do it, noble one?" "Make them yellow, red, white, and like the color of gold" — and the man did all of this in every manner. Then Ānanda said: "Wretch, you know not even the slightest thing! Go and make them exactly even in just this way," and now that he has only just let him go, what was there to do? The householder Anāthapiṇḍada then began to reproach those who had gone forth into the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, saying: "It seems that those who have gone forth show no restraint whatsoever." At that time the monks heard this and reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One considered the matter.

Whatever fault had arisen came from the monks trimming their nails. Therefore a monk must not trim his nails. If he does, it becomes an offense. The Blessed One declared: "A monk must not trim his nails."

Now, when the Blessed One had given this ruling, those monks who worked with dyes and those who worked with the begging bowl began to get grime under their nails, and their nails became dirty and discolored. They would go out on alms round with their nails in just that state. Brahmins and householders, seeing this, said: "Noble ones, why are your nails so filthy and discolored?" When the monks were questioned in this way, they replied: "Noble ones, why should we clean the filth away? The Blessed One has not permitted it." The brahmins and householders said: "Noble ones, will you be

purified by being mired in filth?" At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "In order to remove filth, nails may be filed."

The Blessed One, the buddha and Blessed One, was dwelling at Rājagṛha in the Kalandaka Bamboo Grove of Veḷuvana. Now King Bimbisāra's regular practice was this: whatever new-season grain or fruit of any kind first appeared, he would offer it first to the Saṅgha, and only after that would he eat it himself. His ministers then presented him with a crop of mango fruits from the trees, and he said: "Go and offer them to the noble ones." When those fruits were eaten up, he said: "Wise ones, what is there to laugh about?" They replied: "Sire, did you not intend to offer them first to the noble ones? But we had already offered them to the noble ones before." He said: "If that is so, I have given the noble ones a garden of a thousand mango trees." The ministers said: "Excellent, Sire — we rejoice in this." He donated a garden of a thousand mango trees for the sake of the Saṅgha of monks from the four directions, and he also established a seasonal festival there. And just as the crowds of people living in the land of Magadha who came to watch the festival were satisfied by the ripened fruits of the mango trees, so the trees became laden with abundant fruit. When the monks were told to offer this to the Saṅgha, they ate the mango fruits while they were still unripened.

Some time later, a certain border king needed mangoes, and he sent a messenger to King Bimbisāra saying: "Friend, I am in need of mangoes — please send some." Bimbisāra said to the messenger: "Go, ask the noble Saṅgha for however many mangoes are needed." The messenger went to Veḷuvana, but the Group of Six monks, whose regular custom was always to keep the gates of the garden full, were there. The venerable Ānanda was walking about and sitting at the gate of Veḷuvana. The messenger approached him, paid homage, and said: "A certain great king has sent me here on account of mangoes — would you please provide some mangoes for that purpose?" Ānanda replied: "Go, fellow, and take as many mangoes as are needed." The messenger went and looked around the bases of the mango trees, but nothing was visible. He returned and said: "Noble one, there are none." Ānanda took him inside and they went through the entire garden. After they had gone all around the garden, Ānanda said: "Fellow, climb up into this tree." He climbed up but saw nothing. Ānanda said: "Fellow, go along the eastern branches — go along the southern and western branches." He went in all directions, and having done so he came down in dismay and said: "Noble

one, did this garden produce no fruit this year?"

"Good fellow, just as the garden bears fruit year after year, so too did it bear fruit this year. Noble one, was it carried off by wind or rain?" "Good fellow, wind and rain did not carry it off. Rather, we ourselves made the mango fruits unripe." He then returned and reported to King Śreṇiya Bimbisāra: "Sire, the noble ones said with their own mouths, 'We ourselves made the mango fruits unripe.'" The king said: "Very well — I need to enjoy them myself," and that man went away.

In due course, when the time of a festival arrived, the crowd of people dwelling in the land of Magadha assembled, and they said: "Noble ones, did the Ānanda Garden produce no fruit this year?" "Good fellows, just as the garden bears fruit year after year, so too did it bear fruit. However, we ourselves made the mango fruits unripe." "Noble ones, all the people of Magadha might have been satisfied with ripe mangoes, yet you made the fruits unripe alone, and in doing so you harmed us — that was not well done." One of the monks replied: "The king did not give this garden to the crowd of people dwelling in Magadha. Rather, it was offered to the community of monks, and therefore we ate as we wished. What business is it of yours?" And those people began to abuse and revile them.

At that time the monks heard of this and reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One reflected: "Whatever fault has arisen comes from the monks' eating the mangoes. Therefore monks shall not eat mangoes. If a monk eats mangoes, he commits an offense." The Blessed One declared: "Monks shall not eat mangoes."

Then, when faithful brahmin householders presented monks with the fruits of the sahakāra tree, the monks said: "The Blessed One has not permitted this." Those householders said: "Noble ones, when the awakened Blessed One had not yet appeared in the world" — and so forth, as before, down to — "or please accept them and may you go from this world to the next world." Then the monks heard this and reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore it is permitted — provided the distinguishing mark is established — and they may be eaten. There is no transgression in this." The distinguishing mark is this: those in which a core has formed.

Other faithful brahmin householders, when presenting monks with ripe fruits of the mango tree — and so forth as before, down to — "or please come from this world to the next, and accept them." Then the monks reported this to the

Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore it is permitted — provided the distinguishing mark is differentiated — and they may be eaten. The distinguishing mark that is differentiated is this: those in which flesh has formed."

The awakened Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At Śrāvastī, a sick monk went to a physician and said: "Good fellow, I am afflicted with such-and-such an illness — please prescribe medicine." The physician said: "Noble one, drink clarified butter, and I will give you a purgative to grease you inside and cleanse you." He drank the clarified butter, but it caused him harm through thirst. The physician came and asked: "Noble one, are you comfortable?" He replied: "Good fellow, thirst is causing me distress." The physician said: "Take some myrobalan fruit," and the monk took some in his hand and sat there.

The physician came again and asked: "Noble one, are you free from thirst?" He replied: "Good fellow, I am not yet free." The physician said: "Noble one, did you not hold the myrobalan fruit in your mouth?" "Good fellow, I am holding it — here it is." "Noble one, chew it." "Good fellow, the Blessed One has not permitted it." "Noble one, your Teacher is compassionate — he will permit it." At the words "at that occasion," the Blessed One declared as far as "one should hold it in the mouth." So he put it in his mouth and sat there.

The physician came yet again and asked: "Noble one, are you free from thirst?" He replied: "Good fellow, I am still not free." The physician said: "Noble one, did you not hold the myrobalan in your mouth?" "Good fellow, I have been holding it — here I still am." The physician said: "Noble one, chew it up. Otherwise you will not be free from thirst." He replied: "Good fellow, the Blessed One has not permitted it." "Noble one, your Teacher is compassionate — he will permit it."

At that point the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One should chew it up." He chewed it but then spit it out without swallowing it, and his thirst grew worse.

The physician came again and asked: "Noble one, are you free from thirst?" He replied: "Good fellow, it is causing great harm." The physician said: "Noble one, did you not chew the myrobalan?" "Good fellow, I chewed it and then spit it out." "Noble one, why did you not swallow it?" "Good fellow, the Blessed One has forbidden eating at the wrong time." "Noble one, you are a sick man, and your Teacher is compassionate — he will permit it."

At that point the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, monks, I permit it: the five fruits may be eaten whether at the right time or at the wrong time, whether one is sick or not sick. One should not feel remorse over this." The Blessed One having declared that the five fruits may be eaten whether at the right time or at the wrong time, whether one is sick or not sick, the monks did not know which fruits were the five. The Blessed One then declared: "They are myrobalan (Skt. *harītakī*), āmalaka (Skt. *āmalakī*), bibhītaka (Skt. *vibhītaka*), long pepper (Skt. *pippalī*), and black pepper (Skt. *marica*)."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Rājagṛha in the Kalandaka Bamboo Grove. In the city of Rājagṛha there lived a householder named Shintu Zangpo who was wealthy, of great means, possessed of abundant riches and extensive resources, and who was a devoted follower of the Nirgrantha ascetics (the naked ones). He took a wife from a family of equal rank, and together with her he made merry, enjoyed himself, and reveled in pleasure. While they were thus making merry, enjoying themselves, and reveling in pleasure, there came a time when a being entered his wife's womb.

The Blessed One, one morning, put on his lower robe and outer robe, took up his alms bowl, and set out into Rājagṛha for alms. As he was going about for alms through Rājagṛha, he turned toward the house of the householder Shintu Zangpo. The householder Shintu Zangpo saw the Blessed One from a distance. On seeing him, he took his wife by the hand, went to where the Blessed One was, and when he arrived he addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, this companion of mine has a being that has entered her womb — what manner of child will she bear?"

The Blessed One declared: "She will give birth to a son. He will bring luster to the family line, experience the splendors of gods and humans, go forth into my teaching, abandon all afflictions, and directly realize arhatship."

He filled the Blessed One's begging bowl with pure and excellent food and drink and offered it. The Blessed One said, "May you be free of illness," received the alms, and departed.

Not far from there, a naked ascetic was sitting. He thought to himself: "The one household that used to give us alms has now been turned away by the ascetic Gautama. Let me go and see what prophecy the ascetic Gautama has spoken."

He went there and said, "Householder, has the ascetic Gautama come? Has he been?" The householder replied, "He has come." The naked ascetic then asked, "And what prophecy did he give?" The householder said, "Noble one, I showed him my wife and asked what kind of child she would bear." The naked ascetic asked further, "And what did he say?" The householder replied, "He said she would bear a son, who would bring luster to the family line, experience the splendors of gods and humans, go forth into my teaching, abandon all afflictions, and directly realize arhatship."

Now that naked ascetic was skilled in calculation. He took up a white stone pebble and reckoned with it. When he had done so, he saw that everything the Blessed One had prophesied was exactly so. He then thought to himself: "If I praise this fully, the householder will come to have even greater faith in the ascetic Gautama. Therefore I should praise it somewhat and disparage it somewhat." With that thought, he turned away waving his hand sideways.

The householder Shintu Zangpo said, "Noble one, why do you wave your hand sideways like that?" The naked ascetic replied, "Householder, in this prophecy there is some truth and some falsehood." The householder asked, "Noble one, which part is true and which is false?" The naked ascetic answered: "Householder, what he said — that she will bear a son — that is true. What he said — that the son will bring luster to the family line — that is also true, but as for luster: 'luster' is another name for fire. This being of poor fortune will, the very moment he is born, cause the house to burn down. What he said — that the child will experience the splendors of gods and humans — that is false. Householder, have you ever seen or heard of any human being who has experienced the splendors of gods and humans? What he said — that the child will go forth into my teaching — that is true, for when there is nothing to eat and nothing to wear, he will inevitably go forth to the ascetic Gautama. What he said — that the child will abandon all afflictions and directly realize arhatship — that is false. For even now, the ascetic Gautama himself has no arhat who has abandoned all afflictions. To say nothing of his hearers."

The householder Shintu Zangpo became displeased and said, "Noble one, how am I to verify this for myself?" The naked ascetic said, "Householder, we are renouncers who have taken on precepts — you yourself will come to know." Having said this, he departed.

Shintu Zangpo thought, "This too should be discarded," and began to administer something that was not medicine. But because the being in the

womb was one in his final existence, even what was not medicine became medicine for him. When Shintu Zangpo began to massage his wife's left flank, the one in the womb moved to the right flank. When Shintu Zangpo began to massage the right flank, the being moved to the left flank. For a being in his final existence, it is simply impossible and out of the question that, before attaining the exhaustion of all defilements, he should perish and be cut off in the intermediate state.

When Shintu Zangpo's wife began to cry from the rubbing of her flanks, the neighbors heard it and came running from all directions, asking: "Learned one, why is the householder's wife crying?" Shintu Zangpo said:

"Without any doubt, the time has come for her to give birth." At that, they went away.

Shintu Zangpo thought to himself: "I cannot kill him here. I will take him out to a deserted place." He led him out to a remote wilderness and tried every means possible to bring about his death, but concealed the fact that he had failed and carried him home. Then he spoke to his friends, relatives, brothers, and neighbors: "Good people, my wife has died." They began to weep and wail, and wrapping the body in blue, yellow, red, and white garments, they carried it to the Cool Grove charnel ground.

When the naked wanderers (Nirgrantha ascetics) heard this news, they were overjoyed, and raising parasols, victory banners, and pennants, they went about the main roads, lanes, crossroads, and intersections of the city of Rājagṛha, proclaiming: "Good people, hear this! The ascetic Gautama predicted of the wife of the householder Shintu Zangpo that she would give birth to a son, that she would illuminate the lineage, that she would enjoy the splendor of gods and men, and that after going forth into his teaching, abandoning all afflictions, she would directly realize arhathood. That very one is now dead and has been carried to the Cool Grove charnel ground. How could branches, leaves, and foliage ever appear on a tree that has no root at all? In a situation such as this, could it be that the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, do not know, do not see, are not aware, or are in any way ignorant?"

But the Blessed One, the Buddha — who had entered into great compassion for the benefit of the world, the sole protector, uniquely courageous, matchless and beyond all duality of speech, abiding in calm abiding and insight, well trained in the three trainings, skilled in the three bases of Vinaya, one who has crossed the four rivers, one whose feet rest firmly on the four

bases of miraculous power, one who has long been habituated to the four means of attraction, undaunted by the four fearlessnesses, one who has abandoned the five limbs, one who has truly passed beyond the five destinies, possessed of the six limbs, fully complete in the six perfections, ever abiding in the six, rich with the flowers of the seven limbs of awakening, who teaches the noble eightfold path, skilled in the nine successive meditative absorptions, possessed of the power of the ten powers, whose fame pervades the ten directions, supremely exalted above those who rule over thousands — such Blessed Ones, by the very nature of Dharma, survey the world three times by day and three times by night with the buddha's eye, seeing who is declining and who is flourishing, who has become wretched, who has fallen into misfortune, who has been harmed, who is wretched and fallen into misfortune and harmed, who is inclined toward lower rebirths, who has fallen into lower rebirths, who is falling into lower rebirths — and then draws them from lower rebirths to place them in higher states, liberation, and the fruit. And for whomever the root of virtue has not yet arisen, he causes it to arise; for whomever it has arisen, he causes it to ripen fully; and for whomever it has ripened, he causes it to be liberated. Thus he sets his wisdom-vision into motion.

And again it was said:

The ocean where sea-monsters dwell
may by chance be crossed with the waves of time,
but from the disciples who are to be tamed,
a buddha never lets the moment pass.

Just as a mother watching over her only beloved child
guards even that child's very life,
so too the Tathāgata watches over those beings who are to be tamed,
and likewise guards the continuity of their existence.

Abiding in the cause of omniscience,
the staff of compassion, like a cowherd who has lost a calf,
searches without weariness
for the disciples — those wandering lost on the white road of existence.

The Vinaya: Minor Matters, Volume Two.

Then the Blessed One smiled in a certain direction.

It is the very nature of reality that whenever the blessed buddhas smile, from their mouths there issue rays of light — blue, yellow, red, and white. Some of these go downward, and some go upward.

Those that go downward descend into the hells: Reviving, Black Thread, Crushing, Crying, Great Crying, Hot, Very Hot, Torment Without Respite, Blister, Burst Blister, Gnashing Teeth, Groaning, Lamenting, Split Like a Blue Lotus, Split Like a Lotus, and Split Like a Great Lotus. Into whichever of these are hot hells, the rays arrive having become cool; into whichever are cold hells, the rays arrive having become warm. By this, the particular intensity of those beings' suffering is cut off, and they think to themselves: "O wise ones! Have we died and passed on from here, or have we been born elsewhere?" In order to generate faith in them, the Blessed One sends forth an emanation. When those beings see that emanation, they think and say to one another: "O wise ones! We have neither died and passed on from here, nor been born elsewhere; rather, this is a being we have never seen before, and by his power our particular intense suffering has been cut off." With their minds turned in full devotion toward the emanation, they exhaust the karma that would lead to the experience of hell. They then take up an intermediate-state connection and are reborn among gods or humans who are fit vessels.

Those rays that go upward travel into the realms of the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Free from Strife, the Joyful, the Delighting in Creation, the Wielding Others' Creations, the Brahma Heaven, the Brahma Retinue, the Great Brahma, the Minor Light, the Boundless Light, the Radiant Light, the Minor Virtue, the Boundless Virtue, the Abundant Virtue, the Cloudless, the Merit-Increasing, the Great Fruit, the Not Great, the Not Afflicted, the Clear-Seeing, the Graceful Appearance, and Akaniṣṭha — and there they proclaim: impermanence, suffering, emptiness, and selflessness. They also proclaim these two verses:

Rouse yourself and arise!
Strive in the teaching of the buddhas.
Like a great elephant in a house of mud,
vanquish the army of the Lord of Death.
Whoever lives with vigilance
in this Dharma and discipline
shall utterly abandon the wandering of birth
and make an end of all suffering.

Then those rays of light, having circled the great trichiliocosm, follow and trail behind the Blessed One himself. If the Blessed One intends to prophesy the past, the rays dissolve into his back. If he intends to prophesy the future, they dissolve in front of him. If he intends to prophesy rebirth in hell, they dissolve into the soles of his feet. If he intends to prophesy rebirth as an animal, they dissolve into his heel. If he intends to prophesy rebirth as a hungry ghost, they dissolve into the big toe of his foot. If he intends to prophesy rebirth as a human, they dissolve into his knees. If he intends to prophesy a powerful wheel-turning kingship, they dissolve into the palm of his left hand. If he intends to prophesy a wheel-turning kingship, they dissolve into the palm of his right hand. If he intends to prophesy rebirth as a god, they dissolve into his navel.

If he intends to prophesy awakening as a śrāvaka, they dissolve into his mouth. If he intends to prophesy awakening as a pratyekabuddha, they dissolve into his hair-pores. If he intends to prophesy unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, they dissolve into his crown protrusion.

Then those rays of light circle the great trichiliocosm of world-systems three times, circumambulate the Blessed One three times, and dissolve into the mouth of the Blessed One.

Then the venerable Ānanda joined his palms together and addressed the Blessed One with these words:

From his face there issued forth a thousand rays
of brilliant and manifold, many-coloured light,
illuminating all directions round about
just as the risen sun spreads forth its light.

And he continued with these verses:

The buddha, free from wildness, free from dullness and from pride,
the Victor who has tamed all foes, the wanderer supreme,
does not display, without cause, the lotus-petal smile
and lips as white and radiant as a conch.

Therefore, knowing the moment through his own steady wisdom,
for those who earnestly desire to hear the mighty Victor's words,
may the doubts that have arisen be dispelled, I pray,
by the sublime, good, and steadfast speech of the Sage, the highest of the born.

The perfectly awakened buddha, firm as Mount Meru,
does not display a sudden, causeless smile.
O Protector, for what reason have you smiled?
This assembly of beings earnestly wishes to hear.

The Blessed One then declared: "Ānanda, it is indeed so, it is indeed so. Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas do not smile without cause or condition.

"Ānanda, go and inform the monks: 'The Tathāgata intends to walk through the charnel ground. Whoever among you wishes to walk and go to the charnel ground together with the Tathāgata should take his own robe and come.'"

The venerable Ānanda replied, "As you command, Blessed One," and, having listened to the Blessed One, went to where the monks were staying. Arriving there, he informed them: "The Tathāgata intends to walk through the charnel ground. Whoever among you wishes to walk and go to the charnel ground together with the Tathāgata should take his own robe and come." All the monks gathered together and came into the presence of the Blessed One.

Then the Blessed One — disciplined, with a retinue that was disciplined; peaceful, with a retinue that was peaceful; liberated, with a retinue that was liberated; relieved, with a retinue that was relieved; fully tamed, with a retinue that was fully tamed; arhats surrounded by arhats; free from attachment, with a retinue free from attachment; beautiful, with a retinue that was beautiful — like a noble bull surrounded by a herd of bulls, like a great elephant surrounded by a company of young elephants, like a lion with fangs surrounded by a pride of lions, like a king of swans surrounded by a flock of swans, like a garuḍa surrounded by a flock of garuḍas, like a brahmin surrounded by a company of brahmin students, like a physician surrounded by a company of patients, like a hero surrounded by a company of warriors, like a landowner surrounded by a company of guests, like a merchant caravan-leader surrounded by a company of traders, like a guild-master surrounded by his retinue, like a regional king surrounded by a company of ministers, like a wheel-turning monarch surrounded by a thousand sons, like the moon surrounded by a host of stars, like the sun surrounded by a thousand rays of light, like Dhṛtarāṣṭra surrounded by a company of gandharvas, like a noble man surrounded by a company of kumbhāṇḍas —

like Virūpākṣa surrounded by a company of nāgas, like Vaiśravaṇa surrounded by a company of yakṣas, like Virūḍhaka surrounded by a company of asuras,

like Śakra (Indra) surrounded by the company of the Thirty-Three, like Brahmā surrounded by the company of the Brahma gods, like an unmoving ocean, like a cloud laden with water, like the great elephant-king possessed of no pride, moving with deportment undimmed by his thoroughly tamed faculties, his body adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being, made beautiful by the eighty minor marks, his body haloed in light extending a full fathom around him, his radiance surpassing a thousand suns, good in every aspect like a golden mountain on the move —

he who is endowed with the ten powers, the four fearlessnesses, the three bases of mindfulness exclusive to him, and great compassion — proceeded to the charnel ground of the Cool Grove, accompanied by many of the great śrāvakas, all of them learned: Kauṇḍinya, Aśvajit, Vāṣpa, Mahānāman, Bhadrīka, Śāriputra, Maudgalyāyana, Kāśyapa, Yaśas, Gavāmpati, and many other members of the monastic Saṅgha, surrounded by a great multitude of living beings numbering in the hundreds of thousands.

When the Buddha arrived, there were eighteen benefits. What are those eighteen? There is no fear of fire. There is no fear of water. There is no fear of lions. There is no fear of tigers. There is no fear of leopards. There is no fear of the assembled armies of an enemy. There is no fear of thieves. There is no fear of carnivorous beasts. There is no fear of shipwreck. There is no fear of lightning. There is no fear of a false accusation. There is no fear of humans. There is no fear of non-humans. At recurring times one will behold beautiful forms. One will hear pleasant sounds. One will see great light. One will hear those who are omniscient give prophecies. One will be endowed with the enjoyment of Dharma and with the enjoyment of material wealth.

Because the Buddha's arrival causes little harm, many hundreds of thousands of gods and humans followed in the wake of the Blessed One. Breezes also arose from the Cool Grove.

A young man of the warrior caste and two young brahmin boys came out from Rājagṛha and were at play nearby. Of the two, the young man of the warrior caste was a man of faith, whereas the brahmin boy was not. The brahmin boy said to the young man of the warrior caste: "Friend, the Blessed One has prophesied that the son born of the wife of the excellent householder Supriya will become a child of noble lineage, will experience the glory of gods and humans, will go forth into renunciation under my teaching, and, abandoning all afflictions, will directly realize arhathood. Now that that child has died, they

are taking him to the charnel ground of the Cool Grove." The Blessed One declared: "It shall not be otherwise." Then the young man of the warrior caste spoke these verses:

The moon together with her host of stars may yet fall to the earth.

This earth together with its mountains and its forests may yet pass into the sky.

The waters of the great ocean may yet run dry —

but it cannot be that the great sage should speak what is untrue.

The brahmin boy said: "Friend, then let us go and visit the charnel ground of the Cool Grove." And as the two of them went, they saw the Blessed One departing from Rājagṛha. The young man of the warrior caste, seeing the Blessed One even from a great distance, again spoke these verses:

The Sage, free of doubt, possessing no agitation —

proclaiming the finest of roars like the lion, king of beasts,

not intimidated by others who speak against him, free of doubt —

thus he goes, surrounded by a multitude of people.

Like a gathering of snowclouds in the direction of the Cool Grove,

a cool and fragrant breeze has arisen —

this is certain to be a great host of gods who have come from their abodes

to investigate the miraculous powers of Śākyamuni.

The king who was Rūpasāra received a prophecy from the Blessed One: "Householder, you will be reborn as the son of the good householder Supriya's wife, your family lineage will blaze forth, you will enjoy divine and human splendors, and then, going forth into my teaching, you will abandon all afflictions and directly realize the state of an arhat." After receiving this prophecy, when the hour of his death arrived, he was carried out to the charnel ground of the Cool Grove. The Blessed One too was heard to have gone together with the community of śrāvaka monks to the charnel ground of the Cool Grove.

On hearing this, the young man of the warrior caste thought to himself: "The Blessed One does not go to the charnel ground of the Cool Grove without purpose, so surely the Blessed One is going there to perform some great act of taming in connection with the wife of the good householder Supriya — let me follow along and see." And so, accompanied by the queen, the young attendants, the ministers, the palace retinue, and the people of the countryside, he departed from Rājagṛha. When the young man of the warrior

caste saw King Rūpasāra from a great distance, he again spoke these verses:

This lord and chief among the kings who rules over Magadha,
departing thus from Rājagṛha together with his retinue —
at the sight of this gathering's manifold and excellent wealth,
a feeling of certainty has arisen in my heart.

After the multitude of people watched the Blessed One depart, they parted to make way, and the Blessed One smiled and remained in the midst of the assembled people. When the naked ascetics (Nirgrantha) saw the Blessed One smiling, they thought: "Since the renunciant Gautama smiles in this way and remains in the midst of the many people, this sentient being is surely not going to die." And one of them said to the good householder Supriya: "Householder, this unfortunate sentient being has not died."

He replied: "Noble one, if that is so, what is to be done now in this situation?"

The naked ascetic said: "Householder, I myself have properly taken the precepts of training — you yourself should know what to do."

Then he gathered firewood and placed it within the pyre of the wife's corpse and set it alight. When the entire body was consumed, the womb-vessel remained just as it was. Then the womb-vessel burst open and a lotus emerged. From the heart of that lotus there appeared a fair-formed youth, beautiful and lovely to behold. When hundreds and thousands of living creatures saw him, the utmost wonder arose in them, and the arrogance, pride, and conceit of the naked ascetics were deflated.

Then the Blessed One said to the good householder Supriya: "Householder, take the youth." He looked toward the face of the naked ascetic, who said: "Householder, if one enters into the midst of a blazing conflagration, does one not get burned in every way from every direction?" Having said this, he himself did not take the child.

Then the Blessed One summoned the young physician Jīvaka and said: "Young Jīvaka, take the child." Jīvaka thought: "Since the Blessed One has not appointed me at an improper time or an improper occasion, I will take him." And without hesitation he entered into the midst of the blazing fire and took the child.

By the Victor's command he had entered the mass of fire,
and when he took the child from within the flames,
by the Victor's power the fire was entirely quelled

and in that very instant became cool as a cluster of snowflakes.

Then the Blessed One said to the young physician Jīvaka: "Jīvaka, have you suffered any harm or injury?" He replied: "Venerable one, though I was born in a royal palace and grew up in a royal palace, through the blessing of the Blessed One the mass of fire became cool like the finest sandalwood ground — such a thing as this I had never experienced before."

At that time the Blessed One said to the householder Supriya: "Householder, take the child." He turned away to look in the wrong direction and for a moment made no move to take him, instead looking toward the face of that naked ascetic. The naked ascetic said: "Householder, why say so much? Fire burns everything — that this child of such very poor fortune was not burned goes without saying, but if you bring him to your home, your home will certainly burn and your life too will certainly be cut short." Thinking "there is none dearer to me than myself," he did not take the child.

Then at that time the Blessed One said to Bimbisāra, king of Magadha: "Great King, take the child." With respectful attentiveness the king stretched out his arms, took the child, examined him carefully, and said: "Blessed One, what name shall be given to this boy?" The Blessed One declared: "Great King, since this boy was born from within fire, therefore let this boy's name be given as Agnijāta — Born of Fire."

Then the Blessed One, having understood the dispositions, latent tendencies, constitutions, and natures of that great assembly of ordinary people, taught the Dharma in such a way that those many hundreds of sentient beings, upon hearing it, would each find what was fitting for them. Some directly realized the fruit of stream-entry; some the fruit of once-returning; some the fruit of non-returning; some went forth into renunciation, and by abandoning all afflictions directly realized arhatship. Some engendered roots of virtue that had become warm; some developed the highest intensity of those roots; some developed lesser and middling patience. Some generated the awakening mind of a śrāvaka; some of a pratyekabuddha; and some generated the mind of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. Some took refuge and properly undertook the bases of training, and the greater part of that assembly came to rely upon the Buddha, to incline toward the Dharma, and to be supported by the Saṅgha.

Then King Bimbisāra entrusted the boy Agnijāta to eight nurses: two who would carry him and sustain his life, two who would suckle him at the breast, two who would cleanse his impurities, and two who would be his playmates. Those eight nurses nourished and raised him with milk, yogurt, butter, clarified butter, the essence of butter, and also with the very finest of all other requisites, and caused him to grow swiftly like a lotus dwelling in a pond.

Now, his maternal uncle had taken up his belongings and departed for another region. He had come to know that a being had entered into his sister in the manner that the Blessed One had predicted — that the child would be born, that the family lineage would blaze forth, and that the splendor of gods and humans would be experienced.

"He will go forth into my Teaching, abandon all afflictions, and directly realize arhathood" — having heard this prophecy, the maternal uncle packed up his goods, collected his price, and traveled to Rājagṛha. There he heard the news that his sister had reached the time of her death. Upon hearing this, he reflected: "The Blessed One had prophesied that the being who entered into my sister would be born as a boy, that the family lineage would blaze forth, that the splendor of gods and humans would be experienced, and that he would then go forth into my Teaching, abandon all afflictions, and directly realize arhathood. Could the Blessed One's word be false?" And so he asked the members of the household: "I have heard that the Blessed One prophesied of the being who entered into my sister that he would be born as a boy, that the family lineage would blaze forth, that the splendor of gods and humans would be experienced, and that he would go forth into my Teaching, abandon all afflictions, and directly realize arhathood. I heard that and was filled with joy throughout — and now I hear that she too has reached the time of her death." The Blessed One declared: "Could that be false?"

They then spoke these verses:

The moon together with its host of stars may yet fall to the earth,
this earth with all its mountains and forests may yet travel through the sky,
the waters of the great ocean may yet run dry —
but that the Great Sage should speak falsely can never come to pass.

The word of the Blessed One cannot be false. Indeed, the householder had caused her to die in whatever manner she was to die, and at the time appointed for her death she passed away. But the boy born of her, a mighty one of great power who was cast into fire yet was not burned, is even now

being raised in the royal palace."

Upon hearing this, the maternal uncle went to the householder Śin-tu Bzang-po and said: "Householder, you have done something that is not right." "What have I done?" "Deceived by a naked ascetic, you caused my sister — into whom a being had entered — to die in whatever manner she was to die. As for that mighty boy of great power who was cast into fire yet was not burned, who is even now being raised in the royal palace — for the moment there is nothing at all to be done about that. Now, if you take that youth, well and good. But if you do not take him, I will no longer regard you as a kinsman; I will cast aside the genealogical records; and along the highways, at crossroads of three ways, and at crossroads of four ways, I will proclaim the ill-report that the householder Śin-tu Bzang-po killed my sister — that this wife-killer is one with whom no one should consort — and I will also set the king's harm upon you."

Having heard this, the householder was frightened, and thinking, "Given what he has said, he will certainly do this to me," he went to the king, prostrated at his two feet, and said: "O lord, on behalf of my kinsman I would report: if you were now to give that youth, it would be well. But if you do not give him, I will no longer regard you as a kinsman; I will cast aside the genealogical records; and along the highways, at crossroads of three ways, and at crossroads of four ways, I will proclaim the ill-report that the householder Śin-tu Bzang-po killed my sister — that this wife-killer is one with whom no one should consort — and I will also set the king's harm upon you." It was for this reason that the lord gave the youth Meskyes to me.

The king replied: "Householder, it is not I who took the youth Meskyes for you.

The Blessed One entrusted him to me, so if you need the youth, first make a request to the Blessed One on the youth's behalf." And so she went into the presence of the Blessed One, bowed at his two feet, and spoke these words: "Blessed One, my kinsman's message is this: 'If even now you were to give that youth, it would be well. But if you do not give him, I will no longer regard you as a kinsman; I will cast aside the genealogical records; and along the highways, at crossroads of three ways, and at crossroads of four ways, I will proclaim the ill-report that the householder Śin-tu Bzang-po killed my sister — that this wife-killer is one with whom no one should consort — and I will also set the king's harm upon you.' It was for this reason that the lord gave the youth Meskyes to me. Blessed One, if the householder Śin-tu Bzang-po were

not to obtain the youth Meskyes, there would arise a situation in which he would vomit hot blood and meet his time of death." Seeing that such a situation indeed existed, the Blessed One addressed the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, go to King Bimbisāra and convey my instruction, saying 'Aroga,' and say this: 'Great King, give the youth Meskyes to the householder Śin-tu Bzang-po. If the householder Śin-tu Bzang-po does not obtain the youth Meskyes, there will arise a situation in which he will vomit hot blood and meet his time of death.' Deliver this message as well."

The venerable Ānanda replied, "Reverend one, I will carry out the command," and having listened to the Blessed One's word, he went directly to King Bimbisāra and spoke to him thus: "The Blessed One addresses you, Great King, with the word 'Aroga,' and declares: 'Great King, give the youth Meskyes to the householder Śin-tu Bzang-po. If the householder Śin-tu Bzang-po does not obtain the youth Meskyes, there will arise a situation in which he will vomit hot blood and meet his time of death.'"

The king said: "Venerable Ānanda, I pay homage to the Blessed One. It shall be done exactly as the Blessed One has commanded." The venerable Ānanda said "Great King, Aroga," and departed.

The king then spoke: "Householder, I have raised this youth and he is dear and pleasing to me, so I shall give him under a binding pledge — on condition that each and every day, three times in each of the three periods of the day, you send him back so that I may see him." The householder replied: "Your Majesty, if I do not send him into your royal presence, into whose presence would I send him? I will send him." And the king adorned the youth with every ornament, placed him upon an elephant, and sent him forth.

Now it is the custom among people of the world that so long as a father is alive, the name of a son is not proclaimed. After some time had passed, the householder Śin-tu Bzang-po met his time of death, and the youth Meskyes came to dwell in his father's house. He developed trust in the Buddha, trust in the Dharma and the Saṅgha, and took refuge in the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha.

He had a temple built in the direction where his mother had not been killed, furnished it fully with all necessary requisites, offered it to the Saṅgha of the four directions, and thereafter the elders appended to the sūtras the phrase: "The Blessed One was dwelling in Rājagṛha, in the Kalandakanivāpa grove."

The servants of the householder Śin-tu Bzang-po who had gone to earn their livelihood in another region learned that the householder Śin-tu Bzang-po had come to his time of death and that the youth Meskyes was now dwelling in his own home.

They heard that he had developed faith in the Buddha, faith in the Dharma and the Saṅgha, and had gone for refuge to the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha. Upon hearing this, those servants filled an alms bowl of finest sandalwood with precious jewels and sent it as a gift to the householder Meskyes.

He hung it at the top of a tall pole and had it publicly announced in these words: "No one is to take this by ladder, by hook, or by grappling device. But if there is among the ascetics (śramaṇas) or brahmins any who has great supernatural power or great might, let one of them take it — whoever does so may carry it off as they please."

Now, certain non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) who had risen early in the morning and were going to the riverbanks to perform their ablutions saw this. They came to the householder Meskyes and said: "Householder, what is this?" He explained it to them in full. They said: "Householder, the ascetics who are disciples of the Śākya clan will take it out of devotion to them," and then they went away.

Then, in due course, the elder monks who had entered Rājagṛha for alms rounds saw this. They too came to the householder Meskyes and said: "Householder, what is this?" He explained the matter to them exactly as it was. They said: "Householder, the Blessed One has instructed that monks should make their good qualities known and proclaim their faults — but should one truly display oneself merely for the sake of an alms bowl?" And with that they went away.

Then, in due course, the venerable Kāśyapa of the Ten Powers came to that place. He said to the householder: "Householder, what is this?" The householder told him how things stood. The venerable Kāśyapa of the Ten Powers thought to himself: "If I were to cast off, abandon, and purify the mass of afflictions I have accumulated since beginningless time, the householder would have me compete with the non-Buddhists in supernatural feats — and so for his sake I should please his mind." With that, he stretched forth his arm like an elephant's trunk, took the alms bowl, carried it away, and went to the temple.

The monks said to him: "Elder, how did you come by this alms bowl of finest sandalwood?" He recounted what had happened. The monks said: "Elder, was it fitting for you to display supernatural power before a layman merely for the sake of an alms bowl?" He replied: "Whether it was fitting or not, venerable ones, it is already done — there is nothing to be done about it now."

At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "A monk must not display supernatural power before a layman. To do so incurs a serious offense."

Furthermore, regarding the four kinds of alms bowl made of gold, silver, beryl, and crystal, and the four kinds made of iron, bronze, copper, and wood: of these, the first four — none of them already obtained is to be kept, and any that have been obtained are to be given up. The last four — none of them not yet obtained is to be obtained; but if one has been obtained, it may be used as a medicine vessel and utilized accordingly.

As for an alms bowl of iron and one of clay — these two are suitable to be consecrated by blessing.

Then, at a later time, the householder Meskyes came to enjoy the splendor of both gods and humans.

Between Rājagṛha and Campā there was a place where dice were played. The keeper of that dice-house came to the hour of death and was reborn as a fierce yakṣa. He then appeared in a dream to his son and spoke these words: "Son, have a yakṣa shrine erected at this place, and hang a bell there and ring it. Whenever anyone who has come to play dice there tries to leave without paying the dice-fee, at that moment let the bell sound, and when they turn back the dice-fee will be collected." With this he made known his instructions.

The son recounted the dream to his friends and companions, his relatives and family members, and when a favorable day arrived — auspicious in terms of the sun, the date, the time of day, the day of the week, the lunar mansion, and the season — he had a yakṣa shrine erected at that place, hung a bell there, and tied it in position.

In the city of Campā, a brahmin had taken a wife from among his own caste. The brahmin's wife reflected: "My brahmin husband, having acquired wealth by this and that means, sits about spending it, doing no work whatsoever — that is not in keeping with my nature." So she went to the market, purchased fine wool, combed and carded it thoroughly, and engaged a skilled weaver,

commissioning him to weave one pair of cloth worth a thousand kārṣāpaṇas. She then said to the brahmin: "This pair of cloth is worth a thousand kārṣāpaṇas. Go to the market, and to whoever pays a thousand kārṣāpaṇas, give it to them. If no one pays that price, announce 'This is no marketplace!' and go elsewhere."

He took it and went to the market, but there was no one who would buy it for a thousand kārṣāpaṇas. So he announced "This is no marketplace!" tucked the pair of cloth inside the fold of his sunshade, and set off for Rājagṛha together with some traveling companions.

In due course they arrived at the dice-house. The dice-keeper cut off the road for those travelers and demanded the dice-fee. They paid what was owed and went on their way. But then the bell began to sound, and the dice-keepers said: "Good sirs, the bell is ringing like this, which means that among you travelers, not all have paid the dice-fee properly — someone has slipped away without paying. Collect the dice-fee again!" So they called the travelers back and searched, but there was no one who had not paid. When the travelers departed again, the bell rang once more. Again the dice-keepers called them back and searched, and again there was no one who had not paid. Then the dice-keepers scolded the travelers, saying: "Travelers, are you intending to cheat us today? Why do you keep being called back again and again?"

The dice-keepers then divided the travelers into two groups and separated them. The group that did not include that brahmin departed as they were. When the other group set off, the bell rang just the same. They too were divided and separated into two groups time and again, until in the end the brahmin alone remained behind, and they seized him. He said: "Search me — I have nothing at all." They searched him and found nothing, and let him go — yet the bell rang again. They called the brahmin back once more and said: "Brahmin, the divine blessing of the deity is thus — speak the truth, and we will not collect any dice-fee from you." He replied: "If I speak the truth, will you not take it?" They answered: "We will not take it." He then drew out from inside the fold of his sunshade that pair of cloth and showed it to them. They all cried out in amazement: "So this is how the divine blessing of the deity manifests!" Full of wonder, they unfolded one end of his cloth and displayed it before the deity. The brahmin said: "You were saying you would not collect the dice-fee — yet now are you taking everything?" They replied: "Brahmin, we are not taking it from you."

"Since the deity has displayed such divine blessing, we are merely showing it to the deity — now take it and go." He took it, placed it once more inside the fold of his sunshade, and departed, traveling to the city of Rājagṛha. When he spread out that pair of cloth in the marketplace there, again no one would buy it for a thousand kārṣāpaṇas, and so he declared: "The marketplace of Rājagṛha is no marketplace at all."

Now at that time the young man Agnidatta was riding upon an elephant, having come out from the royal palace, and was making his way through the marketplace toward his own home. When he heard this, he had his attendants summon the brahmin and ask him why he was proclaiming the marketplace to be no marketplace. They called him over, and Agnidatta spoke: "Brahmin, why do you proclaim this marketplace to be no marketplace?" He replied: "Householder, because there is no one who will buy this pair of cloth for a thousand kārṣāpaṇas." Agnidatta said: "Bring it and let me see it." The brahmin held it out for him to examine.

Agnidatta said: "Brahmin, that much is indeed fine in appearance, yet of the two pieces of cloth, one has been used and one has not. The unused one is worth five hundred kārṣāpaṇas, and the used one is worth two hundred and fifty." The brahmin asked: "Can it truly be so?" Agnidatta said: "Brahmin, let me show you right before your own eyes." And with that he threw the unused piece up into the open sky — it stretched out and hung there suspended. When he threw the used piece, it immediately fell back down. The brahmin was filled with amazement and said: "Householder, you are a man of great miraculous power and great might."

Agnidatta said: "Look again," and threw the unused one onto a thornbush — it passed over without catching. When he threw the other one, it caught on the thorns. The brahmin was overcome with great wonder, his faith arose, and he said: "Householder, you are a man of great miraculous power and great might — therefore please take it at whatever price you wish." Agnidatta replied: "Brahmin, you are a guest, and so for the sake of honoring you I shall give you a thousand kārṣāpaṇas." He gave him the thousand kārṣāpaṇas, the brahmin took them and departed.

Of the two pieces, Agnidatta gave the used one to a young boy, and made the unused one into a bathing cloth. Then, at another time, King Rūpavanta was sitting atop the upper chamber of his palace, surrounded by an assembly of ministers, when Agnidatta's bathing cloth, which had been set out to dry on

top of the building, was carried up into the sky by the wind and fell upon King Rūpavanta. The king said: "Wise ones, from where has this come — such a garment as befits a king?" They replied: "Your Majesty the king, we have heard that when Agnidatta was born from his mother's womb a shower of jewels fell for seven days. If it rains even an ordinary shower upon the king, before long a rain of jewels will fall." The king said: "The Blessed One (the Buddha) prophesied that the householder Agnidatta would experience the splendor of both gods and men. This has come from the sky like a divine garment — when it arrives, make an offering of it." Even as they were saying these words, Agnidatta himself arrived, and the king said: "Young man, the Blessed One prophesied that you would experience the splendor of both gods and men, and here I have this — a divine garment that fell from the sky. Take it with you."

Agnidatta stretched out his hand and thought: "Let me examine it by touching it — perhaps the king will give it to me." When he did so, he perceived at once that it was indeed his own bathing cloth. He smiled slightly and said: "Your Majesty, this is my bathing cloth — the wind has carried it here." The king said:

"Young man, have you now experienced the splendor of both gods and men?" "Your Majesty, I have experienced the splendor of the gods." "Young man, if that is so, why did you not invite me? Your Majesty, I do invite you now." "Go and prepare a feast of yogurt and the like. Whatever feast is proper to offer one who has experienced the splendor of both gods and men — I myself shall come to provide it." The king went to Agnidatta's house and, seeing a group of women assembled on the outside, turned his senses away. Agnidatta said: "Your Majesty, why did you avert your senses?" He replied: "Young man, I did so because of the bride." Agnidatta said: "Your Majesty, she is not the bride — those are the outer retinue of women." This struck the king as utterly astonishing, and when he looked again and still saw that the inner retinue of women was absent, he turned his senses away once more. Agnidatta asked him in the same way, and the king answered in the same way. Agnidatta said: "Your Majesty, those too are not the bride — those are the inner retinue of women." The king's astonishment grew even greater.

The king then saw, before the entrance, an array of mechanical contrivances arranged so as to resemble a pond filled with water and full of swimming fish, all fashioned from the substance of precious gems. Wishing to enter inside, he began to remove his shoes. Agnidatta said: "Your Majesty, why are you removing your footwear?" He replied: "Young man, I intend to step into the water." Agnidatta said: "Your Majesty, this is not water — what appears to be

water is in fact a floor of precious gems." He said: "Young man, I see fish swimming there like so." Agnidatta replied: "Your Majesty, those appear to move by means of the mechanical devices." The king was not convinced, and when he tossed a finger-ring, it made a ringing sound and bounced across the surface of the precious-gem floor. The king was struck with wonder, went inside, and took his seat on the lion throne. Then the brides came to bow at his feet, and tears came to their eyes. The king said: "Young man, why are these brides weeping?" He replied: "Your Majesty, they are not weeping — it is that the smell of wood-smoke clings to Your Majesty's divine garment, and it has caused their eyes to water."

"Your Majesty, as you enjoy these divine and human splendors and do not wish to depart, the royal duties and activities have fallen entirely into disarray." Then the young man's ministers said to Māra: "Young man, Your Majesty has gone to Agnidatta's house and appears to have settled there — please rise and return. It has been reported by the ministers that the royal duties and activities have fallen entirely into disarray." He replied: "Young man, can you not manage to conduct the royal business for even a single day?" He said: "Your Majesty, I reckon the heavens to be seven high, yet Your Majesty knows them to be only one." The king looked closely at Agnidatta's face and said: "Young man, is that true?" Agnidatta replied: "Your Majesty, it is indeed only seven." "Then how do you tell day from night?" "Your Majesty, one can tell by whether the flowers open and bloom, by whether the jewels blaze with light or do not blaze, and by whether the birds cry out or fall silent. Some flowers open toward the sky and droop under a canopy; others open under a canopy and droop toward the sky. Some gems blaze toward the sky and do not blaze under a canopy; others blaze under a canopy and do not blaze toward the sky. Some birds cry out toward the sky and fall silent under a canopy; others cry out under a canopy and fall silent toward the sky."

The king was filled with wonder and said:

"Young man, the Blessed One speaks only what is unerring, and things have turned out exactly as the Blessed One prophesied concerning you — no differently." Having said these words, the king departed from Agni's house and left.

The young man Ajātaśatru stole a gem from Agni's house and handed it to a boy, who then went back and sat in the very spot from which it had been taken. Ajātaśatru said, "Boy, take a look at that gem and bring it here." The

boy opened a chest and said, "Young master, I do not know where it is." Ajātaśatru began to beat him, and Agni said, "Young man, why are you beating him? Householder, I myself am a thief — but this one is a greater thief still. The gem of yours that I stole was itself stolen by him." The boy said, "Young master, you did not steal it, and he did not steal it either — for he went back and sat in the very spot from which he had taken it." Then he said, "Still, young master, this is your own house, so take as many gems as you need, and as for other goods and valuables, whatever you need, take them freely."

Ajātaśatru thought to himself: "One day, when my father passes away and I become king, I shall take them then." But in time, Ajātaśatru was deceived by Devadatta and, after separating his father — the righteous Dharma-king who ruled in accordance with the Dharma — from his life, he bound the royal crown upon his own head and took the throne. Then he summoned Agni and said, "Householder, since you and I are like brothers, let us divide the houses." Agni thought: "This man has killed such a father as that — the righteous Dharma-king who ruled in accordance with the Dharma — and himself bound the crown on his head and taken the throne. If I defy him, he will kill me too. Yet though he intends to despoil my home, I should give it freely and with a pure heart." Having thought this, he said, "Your Majesty, since this is your domain, what portion do you want? I shall come to your residence; pray come to mine." Ajātaśatru said, "Very well, let it be so." And so Ajātaśatru moved into Agni's home, while Agni moved into Ajātaśatru's home. That glorious mansion vanished from sight, and in its very place there appeared where Agni stood. Seven times in succession it vanished and reappeared, and Ajātaśatru thought: "I have been unable to despoil Agni's gems in this way — I must try another method." He appointed a band of thieves and ordered them: "Go today and steal the gems from Agni's house." They began to climb using ladders, poles, and scaffolding. Now, the wives and attendants of the household were stationed at the base of the upper chambers and saw them, and they raised the cry: "Thieves! Thieves!" When Agni heard this, both in his mind and aloud he said: "May the thieves be frozen in place." And at that very spot, in whatever manner they had climbed, they were fixed there just as they were. When the night had passed and morning came, the assembled multitude of ordinary people saw them and said: "Wise ones, this wicked king has deprived his own father — the righteous Dharma-king who ruled in accordance with the Dharma — of his life, and now he would also destroy our homes. Why should we tolerate this?" Ajātaśatru sent a messenger to Agni saying, "This will

bring blame upon me — release them." Agni thought in his mind and said aloud: "May these thieves depart." And they went. Then Agni thought: "He who has done this — who has deprived the righteous Dharma-king, his own father, of his life — will without fail kill me too."

He thought to himself: "The Blessed One has prophesied that I will go forth under his teaching, abandon all afflictions, and directly realize arhathood." And so, intent on doing exactly this in every way, he gave away all his wealth to those in destitution, to the unprotected, to the poor, and to the sick, leaving those who had been without wealth now endowed with it. Then the householder Agni, turning his face away from friends, kinsmen, relatives, and siblings, went directly to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, prostrated with his head at the Blessed One's two feet and sat to one side. Seated to one side, the householder Agni addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Reverend sir, if it please you, I wish to go forth into the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, receive full ordination, and attain the state of a monk, and to live the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One." At this the Blessed One declared, "Come, monk; live the holy life." The very moment these words were spoken, his head was shaved, he was robed in patched cloth, his hands held an alms bowl and a water vessel, his hair and beard were as though trimmed seven days past, and he carried himself in every way like a monk who had been fully ordained for a hundred years.

When the Tathāgata spoke the word "Come,"
He stood there, body clad in shaved head and patched robe,
And in that very moment his faculties became profoundly stilled —
By the Buddha's intention his bodily form was covered.

The Blessed One then pronounced a prophecy over him, and through his striving, effort, and exertion, he moved and then stilled the five-spoked wheel of saṃsāric existence, coming to know it directly. Struck down by the very nature of all formations — that they decline, fall, scatter, and disintegrate — he abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhathood. As an arhat, he was free from attachment to the three realms, regarding a clod of earth and gold with equal indifference, his mind as even as the sky and the palm of a hand, as even toward a thorn-bush and sandalwood. Through direct knowing he burst open the egg-shell of ignorance, and he attained knowledge, superknowledge, and individual perfect understanding. He turned his back on continued existence, on gain from desire, and on reverence; and the gods, together with Indra and his retinue, came to honor, revere, and speak

respectfully of him.

The monks, having arisen in doubt, put all their doubts to the awakened Blessed One to be resolved: "Reverend sir, what action did the venerable Agni perform, such that through the ripening of that karma he was burned together with his mother in a funeral pyre, yet also experienced the splendor of gods and men, and then, going forth under the Blessed One's teaching, abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhathood?" The Blessed One declared: "Monks, the noble son Agni himself had assembled, fully transformed the conditions for, and brought to full proximity karma that would without fail come to arise — just like a lamp. Could any other person experience individually the karma that Agni himself had done and accumulated? Monks, karma that has been done and accumulated does not ripen in the external element of earth, nor in the element of water, nor in the element of fire, nor in the element of wind. Rather, it is thus: virtuous and non-virtuous karma that has been done and accumulated ripens in the aggregates, elements, and sense bases that one has taken up. For:

Even across a hundred aeons,
The karma one has done will not perish;
When the time and conditions are met,
It will bear fruit for embodied beings."

Monks, ninety-one aeons ago in the past, there appeared in this world the Teacher, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha named Vipāśyin — endowed with knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, the Blessed One. Traveling through the countryside together with a retinue of sixty-two thousand monks, he came to the royal palace of Mūlāga and dwelt in the grove of Mūlāga.

At that time in the royal palace of Mūlāga there reigned a king named Bandhumān, a righteous dharma-king who governed justly, whose kingdom was prosperous, flourishing, happy, blessed with good harvests, and filled with many people and townsfolk; a king who caused strife, fighting, quarrels, discord, foreign enemies, domestic disturbances, bandits, famine, and disease to be entirely pacified, and who caused grain, sugarcane, cattle, and buffalo to be brought to full abundance.

Now in that place there lived a householder named Anāparin, who was wealthy, of great possessions and extensive resources, with holdings both vast

and wide, possessed of the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling Vaiśravaṇa himself in riches. He thought to himself: "Many times I have invited the perfectly complete Buddha Vipāśyin to my home and offered him a meal, but I have never once provided him with all requisites for a full three months. Now let me provide the perfectly complete Buddha Vipāśyin with all requisites for three months."

Having formed this thought, he went to where the perfectly complete Buddha Vipāśyin was, and upon arriving he bowed his head at the feet of the perfectly complete Buddha Vipāśyin and sat to one side. Seated to one side, the householder Anāparin received from the perfectly complete Buddha Vipāśyin a discourse rightly endowed with Dharma — being rightly instructed, rightly encouraged, and rightly gladdened. In many ways Vipāśyin rightly taught a discourse endowed with Dharma, rightly instructed him, rightly encouraged him, and rightly gladdened him, and then remained silent.

Then the householder Anāparin rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, joined his palms in the direction of the perfectly complete Buddha Vipāśyin, and addressed the perfectly complete Buddha Vipāśyin with these words: "Blessed One, may it please you to accept, together with the Saṅgha of monks, my offering of robes, food, lodging, medicine for the sick, and medicinal supplies for three months." The perfectly complete Buddha Vipāśyin granted this to the householder Anāparin by remaining silent.

Then the householder Anāparin, understanding from the perfectly complete Buddha Vipāśyin's silence that he had granted consent, bowed his head at the feet of the perfectly complete Buddha Vipāśyin, rose from his seat, and departed.

Now King Bandhumān heard that the perfectly complete Buddha Vipāśyin, traveling through the countryside with a retinue of sixty-two thousand monks, had come to the royal palace of Mūlāga and was dwelling in the grove of Mūlāga. Upon hearing this he thought to himself: "Many times I have invited the perfectly complete Buddha Vipāśyin to the palace and offered him a meal, but never for three full months with all requisites. Now I shall provide the perfectly complete Buddha Vipāśyin with all requisites for three full months." With that thought, he went to where the perfectly complete Buddha Vipāśyin was, arrived, bowed his head at the feet of the perfectly complete Buddha Vipāśyin, and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the perfectly complete Buddha Vipāśyin taught King Bandhumān a true and proper Dharma discourse,

established him in right understanding, praised him rightly, and made him rejoice completely. Having in many ways taught a true and proper Dharma discourse, established him in right understanding, praised him rightly, and made him rejoice completely, he then remained in silence.

The Minor Matters of the Vinaya. The Third Fascicle.

Then King Bandhumān rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, turned with joined palms toward the perfectly complete Buddha Vipassīyā, bowed, and spoke thus to the perfectly complete Buddha Vipassīyā: "Blessed One, would you please grant me leave to offer to you, together with the Saṅgha of monks, robes, food, lodgings, medicinal provisions, and medical supplies for three months? Great King, the householder Anāpārin has already invited me first." "Blessed One, if you grant me permission, then however you grant it, I shall follow it in dealing with the householder Anāpārin." The Blessed One declared: "Great King, if you would summon the householder Anāpārin, then I shall grant it in that same way."

King Bandhumān bowed his head at the feet of the perfectly complete Buddha Vipassīyā, rose from his seat, went to his own residence, arrived there, and then had the householder Anāpārin summoned by a messenger. He said to him: "Householder, you should know this. From the very first day, I have been offering the perfectly complete Buddha Vipassīyā the midday meal; would it be any hardship to you if after that you were to offer the perfectly complete Buddha Vipassīyā the midday meal?" The householder replied: "Your Majesty, since I was the one who first invited the perfectly complete Buddha Vipassīyā, it is I who wish to offer the midday meal." The King said: "Householder, even if that is so, since you are residing in my territory, it is fitting that I should offer the midday meal first." The householder replied: "Your Majesty, even though I am indeed residing in your territory, it would not be right for a king to obstruct the one who made the first invitation from offering the midday meal. Householder, do not insist on winning the dispute. Rather, let you and the king invite the perfectly complete Buddha Vipassīyā by drawing lots, and whichever of you draws the better lot shall offer the midday meal first, while the one who does not succeed shall offer the midday meal afterward."

The householder Anāpārin agreed, saying "I shall do as you say," and that very evening he prepared pure and wholesome food and drink. Rising early the next morning, he spread many seats and set out water vessels. He then sent an invitation to the perfectly complete Buddha Vipassīyā at the time of the

midday meal, saying: "Blessed One, please be so gracious as to accept the midday meal. May the Venerable One be pleased to consider that the hour has come." The perfectly complete Buddha Vipāśyin then dressed in the forenoon, took his bowl and Dharma robes, and, surrounded by the assembly of the Saṅgha of monks, with them going before him, set out for the residence of the householder Anāparin, arrived there, and took his seat on the seat that had been prepared, in the midst of the Saṅgha of monks.

Then the householder Anāparin, perceiving that the Buddha and the rest of the Saṅgha of monks were comfortably seated, served them with his own hands with clean, excellent food and drink and satisfied them. Having many times over served them with his own hands with clean, excellent food and drink and satisfied them, and having perceived that the Blessed One had finished eating and had rinsed his bowl and set it aside, he took a seat lower than that of the others and sat down before the perfectly complete Buddha Vipāśyin in order to hear the Dharma. Then the perfectly complete Buddha Vipāśyin gave a true and proper teaching grounded in the Dharma to the householder Anāparin, led him to a true and proper grasp of it, gave him true and proper encouragement, and gladdened him truly and completely. Many times over he gave a true and proper teaching grounded in the Dharma, led him to a true and proper grasp of it, gave him true and proper encouragement, and gladdened him truly and completely — and then departed.

King Bandhumant, for his part, should be understood as having made an offering of a canopy in the same extensive way as described above. The canopy-offering of the king and of the householder was similarly splendid, yet since there had been neither victory nor defeat in the matter, King Bandhumant sat brooding, absorbed in thought. His ministers asked him: "Majesty, why do you sit thus, brooding and absorbed in thought?" He replied: "Learned ones, if even the townsfolk who dwell in my realm could not surpass the other's canopy-offering in excellence, how could I not sit brooding and absorbed in thought?" They replied: "Majesty, prohibit the sale of timber. The wood of that householder will then run out." The king said: "Learned ones, let those who dwell in my realm not sell timber. Let those who sell timber not remain in my realm" — and the proclamation was made. Accordingly, the householder Anāparin set the canopy in motion with incense-wood, and began to steam cloths soaked in fragrant sesame oil. The entire city of Bandhumatī was filled with delightful fragrance. King Bandhumant asked: "Learned ones, from where does such a delightful fragrance come?" They explained it to him

at length. He said: "Am I then without resources? I too shall do likewise." The ministers replied: "Majesty, it would not be fitting for you to do so. This householder has no son; it will not be long before his time of death arrives, and all his wealth will become yours. Majesty, please allow the sale of timber." Thereupon the king permitted the sale of timber.

When the householder Anāparin heard that the king had at first not permitted the sale of timber, he was greatly agitated and uttered harsh words, saying: "With this timber, it would be quite permissible for me to burn even that king Bandhumant together with his mother in a great pyre." The king then sat brooding, absorbed in thought. His ministers asked: "Majesty, why do you sit thus, brooding and absorbed in thought?" He explained it to them in full. They said: "Majesty, do not be displeased. We shall find a way for Your Majesty to get the better of the householder Anāparin."

And so the next day the ministers cleared the stones, gravel, and rubbish from the city of King Bandhumant, sprinkled it with sandalwood water, and placed vessels filled with the most delightful fragrances, hung bunches of silk along with victory banners and pennants, scattered flowers of every variety, and adorned the surrounding courtyard so beautifully that it resembled a pleasure grove — making it fit to be compared with such. Then, on a seat-base adorned with various precious substances, along with a throne of precious materials, cushions, and

splendidly adorned with fine cloths — they arranged abundant food and drink, varied in every way, superbly fragrant, complete with pickled delicacies, and as pleasing as the food of the gods, fit for the Teacher of the three worlds. Having laid out this food and these enjoyments, they addressed King Bandhumant: "We have prepared a city such as this, along with food and amenities such as these — may Your Majesty be pleased." King Bandhumant looked upon it all and was filled with great wonder, and in a mind-stream suffused with that wonder he beheld the perfectly enlightened buddha Namaparīkṣit and then issued an invitation for the noon hour, saying: "Blessed One, we request that you accept our noon-hour offering. Venerable One, please consider that the time has now come." Then the perfectly enlightened buddha Namaparīkṣit put on his robes in the morning, took up his bowl and Dharma-robe, and, fully surrounded by the assembly of monks with the Saṅgha going before him, made his way to the place where King Bandhumant had requested his presence. He arrived and took his seat on the prepared throne in the midst of the assembly of monks. Above the head of the perfectly

enlightened buddha Namaparīkṣit, King Bandhumant himself caused the chief of the royal consecration elephants — one bearing a parasol with a hundred spokes — to hold the parasol aloft. Above the monks as well, other elephants were caused to hold other parasols. Over the perfectly enlightened buddha Namaparīkṣit, King Bandhumant's own principal queen was caused to fan him with a fan whose handle was made of gold and jewels. Over the monks too, other members of the queen's retinue were caused to fan them with other fans.

The householder Anāparin appointed a certain man of great discernment and sent him inside, instructing him: "Go in there — observe carefully what kind of noon-hour offering King Bandhumant has presented to the Blessed One and the assembly of monks, and understand it." The man went and looked, and upon seeing such abundance he was filled with great wonder, and his mind, overcome with astonishment, remained right there on the spot. In the same way a second and a third were sent, and they too went and remained right there. Then the householder Anāparin himself went and looked, and upon seeing all that abundance he was filled with great wonder. He thought to himself: "While others can manage such abundance — how could I possibly match the elephants and the queen's retinue?" Realizing this, he returned home, called his gatekeeper, and said: "Hey, gatekeeper — do not turn away any beggars or wanderers who come; give them whatever they desire, but do not let them inside." Having given this instruction, he entered the house of mourning, sat down in a huddled posture, and remained there, the thought gnawing within his mind.

Now the awareness and perception of Śakra, lord of the gods (Indra), naturally extend downward, and so he thought to himself: "Among all objects of veneration in the world, the most supreme is the perfectly enlightened buddha Namaparīkṣit, and among all donors, the most supreme is the householder Anāparin — I should go to his aid." With that he transformed himself into a brahmin of the Kauśika clan and went to the dwelling of the householder Anāparin. Arriving there, he called to the gatekeeper and said: "Ho, gatekeeper — go and tell the householder Anāparin that a brahmin of the Kauśika clan has come to the door and wishes to see him." The gatekeeper said: "Brahmin, the householder has instructed me that any beggars or wanderers who come are to be given whatever they desire and not shown inside. What would the householder do for you? Take whatever you need and go." The brahmin said:

"Ho, gatekeeper — I have no other need whatsoever. I simply wish to see the householder himself. Go and tell him."

The gatekeeper went to the householder Anāparin and said: "Sir, a brahmin of the Kauśika clan has come to the door and wishes to see you."

The householder replied: "What? Gatekeeper, did I not instruct you beforehand that if any beggars or wanderers came, you were to give them whatever they desired and not let them inside? What would I do if he came in? Give him whatever he wants and send him on his way. That is what I told you."

"Sir, I told him exactly that, but he said he has no other need whatsoever — he simply wishes to see the householder himself."

The householder said: "Very well, gatekeeper — go and let him in."

The gatekeeper let the brahmin in, and the brahmin said: "Householder, why have you entered the chamber of grief, sitting in anguish with your knees drawn up, your heart sunken within you?"

The householder spoke in verse:

One who cannot dispel my sorrow
should not be told of it.

One who is able to dispel my sorrow —
to that person it is right to speak.

Śakra (Indra, king of the gods) said: "Householder, tell me what your sorrow is, and I will dispel it."

The householder then told him at length. After he had done so, Śakra, lord of the gods, caused the brahmin form of the Kauśika clan to vanish and sat in his own true nature, saying: "Householder, I shall send the divine son Lasthamsadpa to be your companion." And with that he departed.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, went among the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three and summoned the divine son Lasthamsadpa, saying: "Divine son Lasthamsadpa, go and be a companion to the householder Anāparin."

The divine son replied: "Kauśika, excellent!" And heeding the words of Śakra, lord of the gods, he caused cities to appear that were more beautiful and supremely wondrous than those before. He arranged the halls and thrones of the gods' retinue, and the divine foods were brought forth. Over the head of the perfectly and fully awakened buddha Namapar Zikyi he caused Sāśruṅ — the prince of elephants who had served in the pleasure gardens of Śakra, lord

of the gods — to hold a parasol with a hundred spokes. Over the monks he caused other divine elephants to hold other parasols. For the perfectly and fully awakened buddha Namapar Zikyi, Śakra's principal queen, the goddess Bde and others, fanned him with divine fans whose handles were made of gold and jewels. For the monks as well, other assemblies of divine queens fanned them with other fans.

King Nyendan appointed a man of great discernment and commanded him: "Go inside at once, and find out what kind of parasol the householder Anāparin has offered to the Blessed One and the monastic Saṅgha of monks." When this man looked and saw such splendor, he was seized with great amazement, and so struck with wonder did he remain right there on the spot. The king sent ministers, and they too went and remained right there on the spot. He sent a young attendant, and that one too went and remained right there on the spot.

Then King Nyendan himself went there and stood at the door. The perfectly and fully awakened buddha Namapar Zikyi declared: "Householder, you spoke harsh words to King Nyendan, who has realized the truth. He is standing at this door — go and ask his forgiveness."

The householder went to him, asked his forgiveness, and said: "Great King, please come inside and be pleased to perform the serving with your own hands."

When the king entered inside and looked, he saw a divine abundance, and great wonder arose in him. He then said: "The Saṅgha of monks led by the Buddha is not something I alone — a mere householder — should be serving with a canopy."

The householder Nyemé then fully satisfied the perfectly and fully awakened buddha Namapar Zik with food befitting such abundance, bowed at his feet, and made this aspiration: "By the root of virtue produced through my having served such a worthy field of merit in this way, may I be born into a lineage that is wealthy, with great riches and abundant enjoyment; may I experience the splendor of gods and humans; may I attain the Dharma in a form such as this; and may I come to please a Teacher such as this, and never displease him."

Monks, the one who at that time and on that occasion was the householder Nyemé — he is this householder Mekye. Because of the karmic maturation of the harsh words that noble son spoke to King Nyendan, who had realized the truth, he was burned in a mass of fire together with his mother for five

hundred lifetimes, and he has been burned in a mass of fire again here in this very life. Yet because of the karmic maturation of having served and made aspiration to the Tathāgata Namapar Zik, he was born into a lineage that is wealthy, with great riches and abundant enjoyment; he experienced the splendor of gods and humans; he went forth in my teaching as well; and by abandoning all afflictions he directly realized arhathood. Equal in vigor, equal in strength, and equal in diligent effort to the perfectly and fully awakened buddha Namapar Zik — matching him in every respect — he has pleased me, his Teacher, and has not displeased me.

Monks, therefore the maturation of karma that is purely dark is purely dark; the maturation of karma that is purely bright is purely bright; and the maturation of mixed karma is mixed. Monks, therefore abandon karma that is purely dark and mixed karma, and strive for karma that is purely bright. Monks, you should train accordingly.

Having spoken these words, the monks rejoiced at what the Blessed One had declared.

Summary verse:

Cracked bowls repaired, things used and worn,
small knives and needles, needle-cases too,
seated cushions, and many other things —
all were permitted by the Great Sage.

The setting is Śrāvastī.

At Śrāvastī, the alms bowl of a certain monk cracked, and he took it to a blacksmith's workshop and said: "Good man, please repair this cracked bowl of mine." The blacksmith thought: "These monks press one into unpaid labor but give no wages — no matter what, if I put this off and leave it for a long time, he will eventually come back himself and take it away." So he said: "Noble one, please go and come back tomorrow or whenever — you may come in the morning, or at midday, or in the afternoon," and he began putting him off. Every day the monk went there and grew weary of it. A friend of his saw him and said: "Venerable, since you go there every day like this, is it the house of a relative of yours, or the house of a donor?" The monk replied: "Venerable, it is neither the house of a relative of mine nor the house of a donor. The thing is, my alms bowl cracked and I left it there for repair, and because he keeps putting me off, I go there for that reason." His friend said: "Venerable, have you not heard the saying that craftsmen who tell the truth are rare?"

When the craftsman said, "I do know the craft, but the Blessed One has not permitted it," the monks heard this and reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Therefore, if there are monks who are craftsmen, I permit them to repair an alms bowl in a secluded place."

That monk went to the craftsman and said: "Venerable, the Blessed One has given permission — please repair this alms bowl." The craftsman replied: "Venerable, this cannot be repaired by bare hands alone; smithing tools are also needed." The monks then reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "I permit smithing tools to be kept for the use of the Saṅgha."

The setting is Śrāvastī.

When the robes of monks needed to be sewn, and they tore them apart by hand, causing damage, the Blessed One declared: "They are not to be torn by hand; they are to be cut with a small knife." When the Blessed One had declared that a small knife was to be used, a certain monk whose robe needed cutting borrowed a knife from a householder, cut the robe with it, and then returned it to that householder. The householder said: "Venerable, keep it — it is yours." The monk replied: "Good sir, the Blessed One has not permitted this." The monks then reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, I permit a monk to carry a small knife."

When the Blessed One had declared that a small knife was to be carried, the group of six monks carried knives with handles polished smooth, made of gold, silver, lapis lazuli, and crystal. Brahmins and householders said: "Venerable ones, what is this?" They replied: "The Blessed One has permitted knives." The brahmins and householders then said: "You ascetics are tormented by the pleasures of the senses!" At that, the monks fell silent out of embarrassment and said nothing. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "A monk is not to carry a knife with a variegated or ornamented handle made of gold, silver, lapis lazuli, or crystal. He is to carry an iron small-knife."

When the Blessed One had declared that an iron small-knife was to be carried, the monks carried knives that were far too large. Brahmins and householders said: "Venerable ones, what is this?" "Good sirs, it is a small knife." "Venerable ones, that is a knife — it is not a small knife." The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Knives that are far too large are not to be carried." When monks carried knives that were far too small, they

could not accomplish any task. The Blessed One then declared: "Three sizes of small knife are to be carried: large, medium, and small. The large one is six finger-widths. The small one is four finger-widths. What falls between these two is the medium."

The setting is Śrāvastī.

When the robes of monks needed to be sewn, the monks tried to sew them using bamboo splints and the quill-shafts of birds' feathers, and these split and frayed. The Blessed One declared: "A needle is to be carried." When a certain monk's robe needed sewing and he borrowed a needle from a householder and sewed it, then returned the needle to that householder, the householder said: "Venerable, keep it — it is yours." The monk replied: "Good sir, the Blessed One has not permitted this." The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, I permit a monk to carry a needle."

When the Blessed One declared that a monk may carry a needle, the Group of Six began carrying needles made of gold, silver, lapis lazuli, and crystal. When brahmins and householders saw this, they asked: "Noble ones, what is this?" The monks replied: "The Blessed One has permitted needles." The brahmins and householders said: "Noble ones, you śramaṇas are surely afflicted by sensual pleasures." At that, the Group of Six fell silent and said nothing. The monks then reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "A monk shall not carry needles made of gold, silver, lapis lazuli, or crystal. Rather, a monk shall carry needles of these four kinds: made of horn, copper, bamboo, or iron."

When the Blessed One declared that a monk shall carry needles of these four kinds, the monks set them down here and there, and the needles became embedded in the ground. The Blessed One then declared: "A needle case shall be carried." The monks did not know what kind of needle case to carry, so the Blessed One declared: "There are two kinds of needle case: one with a hollow tube, and one like a container with a stopper."

When the monks put a small knife into a needle case of the stopper type and it split, the Blessed One declared: "The small knife shall be made in two shapes: like a crow's beak, and like the wing of a white-tailed bird."

The occasion for this rule was at Śrāvastī.

When the Blessed One declared that monks shall patch their Dharma robes, the monks stretched the robes out flat on the ground to even them, and the robes became soiled with dust and were damaged by insects. The Blessed One then declared: "Do not lay them on the ground to even them; instead, use a frame." The monks did not know how to make a frame, so the Blessed One declared: "There are two kinds of frame: those made square from wood, and those made square from bamboo."

When the monks pressed them with pegs and the frames split, the Blessed One declared: "Make holes and press them down with wooden pins."

The occasion for this rule was at Śrāvastī.

When the Blessed One declared that robes are of three sizes — large, medium, and small — it was found that a frame used for stretching a large robe was not suitable for stretching a medium or small one. The Blessed One therefore declared: "Make several frames."

A summary verse:

Mirror and water,
likewise tooth-wood and the two cleaning sticks,
the topknot and long hair,
the warm gown and the great fever.

The occasion for this rule was at Śrāvastī.

The Group of Six, having put on their lower robes in the morning and taken up their bowls and outer robes, entered Śrāvastī for alms. They saw mirrors and other grooming implements that brahmins and householders had placed on a cloth for sweeping and cleaning. The Group of Six picked up those mirrors, examined their faces in them, and said: "Friend, dear friend — do we not look fine?" The brahmins and householders said: "Noble ones, your heads are shaved and your armpits are ragged — how could your faces be handsome? These śramaṇas are surely afflicted by sensual pleasures." The Group of Six said nothing in reply. The monks heard about this, reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, a monk shall not examine his face in a mirror. If he does, he commits a serious offense."

When the Blessed One had declared that a monk shall not examine his face in a mirror, the monks then began examining their faces in water. The Blessed One declared:

"A monk shall not examine his face in water either." When the Blessed One had declared that a monk shall not examine his face in water, the monks happened to be examining the water, and upon seeing their own faces reflected there they felt remorse. The Blessed One then declared: "There is no transgression in looking at water, a wound, a wrinkle, or a sign of aging, or in examining the state of the body before and after."

The setting for this rule is Śrāvastī.

The Group of Six, having put on their lower robes and taken up their bowls and outer robes early in the morning, set out on alms-round in Śrāvastī. They saw some combs and hairbrushes that the brahmins and householders had placed on top of their clothing bundles. The Group of Six took their combs and combed their hair, then said: "Dear friend, dear friend — how do we look? Are we handsome?" The brahmins and householders said: "Noble ones, your heads are shaved and your armpits are ragged — how could your hair be beautiful? These śramaṇas are surely afflicted by sensual pleasures." The Group of Six said nothing in reply. The monks heard about this, reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, a monk shall not comb his hair with a comb. If he does, he commits a serious offense." The setting for this rule is Śrāvastī.

When the Blessed One had declared that a monk shall not comb his hair with a comb, the Group of Six then began combing their hair with a bamboo comb. The Blessed One declared: "One shall not comb with a bamboo comb either. If one does, he commits a serious offense." The setting for this rule is Śrāvastī.

When the Blessed One had declared that a monk shall not comb his hair with a bamboo comb, they then made one side into a toothed comb and the other side into a bamboo comb and used it to comb their hair. The Blessed One declared: "One shall not comb the hair with both a comb and a bamboo comb." The setting for this rule is Śrāvastī.

Now, at the time when the householder Anāthapiṇḍada offered the Jeta Grove to the community of monks, the buddha and so forth — the rest of this account proceeds just as it was told before, including the one called the sweeper and so on. Ānanda said: "O handsome one, do you know how to arrange a topknot? That noble one is from my own household. Let him try. Noble one, how shall it be arranged?" "Large," he replied. The man arranged a great topknot. Ānanda said: "Cut one side." He cut one side. Then Ānanda said, "The second, the third" — and so on up to "Cut the seventh side" — and he cut up to the

seventh side. Ānanda said: "You poor fool, you know nothing at all — do it just as it was before and go," and so on, the rest proceeding just as told before.

The Blessed One declared: "Therefore, a monk shall not arrange a topknot. If he does, he commits a serious offense." The setting for this rule is Śrāvastī.

The venerable Vakkha was staying in Kauśāmbī, surrounded by a river, in the wild-boar's cave of the pleasure grove belonging to King Udayana. Then, on another occasion, when the spring season had arrived and the trees were in full bloom, and geese, cranes, peacocks, parrots, grouse, cuckoos, and kalavinka birds were calling out in the grove, King Udayana summoned the caretaker of the pleasure grove and said: "Housekeeper, come here. Let us go to the pleasure grove. Clear away all the stones, gravel, and thorns from the ground around the river-encircled perimeter, lay out the pathways, and have the enclosures cleaned. Also drive away any predatory animals."

The caretaker of the pleasure grove replied to King Udayana, saying, "As Your Majesty commands." He cleared away all the stones, gravel, and thorns from the river-encircled perimeter, laid out the pathways, inspected the grove, and drove away the predatory animals. He then went to where King Udayana was and, having arrived, said to him: "May Your Majesty please take note. All the stones, gravel, and thorns have been cleared from the river-encircled ground, the pathways have been laid out, the grove has been inspected, and the predatory animals have been driven away. May Your Majesty know that the time has now come."

Then King Udayana, surrounded by his retinue of queens, went to the pleasure grove, where he experienced delight, sport, and festivity. After a while, he fell asleep.

Now, it is the nature of women to be fond of flowers and fruit, and so the queens' retinue wandered freely through the pleasure grove as they pleased. At that time, the Venerable Piṇḍola Bhāradvāja was sitting leaning against a tree, his hair and beard grown long, wearing an old monastic robe and a tattered lower garment.

The queens' retinue saw him sitting there with his hair and beard grown long, wearing an old monastic robe and a tattered lower garment. Upon seeing him, they cried out in alarm: "Oh gods! There is a demon here! Oh gods! There is a demon here!" With that cry of fright, the Venerable Piṇḍola Bhāradvāja rose from where he sat and walked slowly and deliberately into the wild-boar's cave.

The noise awoke the king, who drew his sword and rushed forward, asking the women, "Where is the demon?" They replied, "Your Majesty, it has gone into the wild-boar's cave." King Udayana then took up his weapon, stood at the entrance to the wild-boar's cave, and called out: "Hey, who are you, spirit?"

The reply came: "Your Majesty, I am a renunciant."

"Whose renunciant are you?"

"I am a renunciant of the sons of the Śākya."

"Are you an arhat?"

"Your Majesty, I am not."

"Then are you a non-returner, a once-returner, or a stream-enterer?"

"Your Majesty, I am not."

"Then have you attained the fourth meditative concentration?"

"Your Majesty, I have not."

"Then have you attained the third, the second, or the first meditative concentration?"

"Your Majesty, I have not."

At this, the king, already further inflamed by jealousy toward the queens' retinue, became furious and said to his ministers: "Hey, wise ones! This ordinary renunciant has behaved improperly with my queens' retinue. Quickly gather a large number of sows here, and have them fill this cave and kill this renunciant."

Now, a deity who dwelt naturally in the wild-boar's cave thought to himself: "It would be wrong if this fierce king were to slay this blameless, faultless renunciant who has come to me for refuge. I must strive to find a means of saving him." With that thought, the deity manifested its own form as that of a great sow and emerged from the cave at the entrance.

The king, delighted by this sight, said to a man nearby: "Go and fetch my horse and bow and arrow." The man brought the king his horse and bow and arrow. The sow then came out from within the pleasure grove and began to run, and as the king chased after it, it led him far away.

Then the retinue of the queen's attendants said to the venerable Vālanasin: "Noble one, this king is fierce, and if he were to slay you it would be most

unfortunate. You must leave quickly." The venerable Vālanasin swiftly took up his bowl and robes and departed from that pleasure grove, making his way to Śrāvastī.

When he arrived at Śrāvastī, the monks who saw him said: "Welcome, venerable one, welcome! You have been wandering long, long, like the moon moving through the sky. Where have you come from?" "From Kauśāmbī," he replied. "How has the venerable one fared? How have the venerable ones been keeping?" "The king of Vatsa, Udayana, struck and killed my pupil." "Why so?" And as he was explaining the matter in full, the monks reported it to the Blessed One.

The Blessed One then said to one of the monks: "Monk, come here. Go to where the monk Vālanasin is and tell him this: 'The Teacher has said: come into my presence.'" That monk replied, "As you command, venerable one," and obeying the Blessed One's instruction, went to where the venerable Vālanasin was and said to him: "The Teacher has said: come into his presence."

The venerable Vālanasin replied to the monk, "As you command, venerable one," and heeding those words, went to where the Blessed One was. He arrived and bowed his head to the Blessed One's feet, then sat to one side. Seated to one side, the Blessed One said to the venerable Vālanasin: "Monk, why did the king of Vatsa, Udayana, strike and kill your pupil?" Vālanasin then explained the matter to the Blessed One in full.

The Blessed One said: "It is because you, foolish man, were excessively attached to that cave that you have come to dwell in such great suffering." And Vālanasin sat in silence.

Then the Blessed One, knowing that a minor fault had arisen among the monks — namely that of allowing hair to grow long — declared: "Therefore, monks shall not let their hair grow long. If they do, it becomes an offense." And when the Blessed One had declared that monks shall not let their hair grow long, the monks who dwelt in hermitages, finding no one to shave them, abandoned their hermitage lodgings and took up lodgings on the outskirts of villages.

The blessed buddhas know while appearing not to know. So the Blessed One asked the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, why have the monks who dwell in hermitages abandoned their hermitage lodgings and taken up lodgings on the outskirts of villages?" Ānanda then explained the matter fully to the Blessed One.

The Blessed One said: "Therefore, for monks dwelling in hermitages, hair up to the length of two finger-breadths is permitted. For those dwelling on the outskirts of villages, it must be shorter than that."

The origin of this rule was at Śrāvastī. While at Śrāvastī, a sick monk went to a physician and said: "Good sir, please prescribe medicine for me." The physician said: "Noble one, sun yourself and warm your body, and you will recover." The monk said: "Good sir, am I to do whatever I please? Noble one, your medicine — this is the prescription, yet it will not sustain life through any other means." While this exchange was taking place, the monks reported it to the Blessed One.

The Blessed One declared: "If the physician says, 'Monk, your medicine is this, and you will not recover by any other means,' then the monk should use the sweat-bath as prescribed."

When the Blessed One had declared that the monk should use the sweat-bath, the monks asked that physician: "Good sir, now that the Blessed One has permitted it, tell us what exactly a sweat-bath is." He replied: "Noble ones, I have read the medical treatise of the wheel-turning king, and the word sweat-bath does appear there, but I have not yet ascertained precisely what kind of sweat-bath it is. Your own Teacher is omniscient — he himself knows it." Thereupon the monks reported this to the Blessed One.

The Blessed One declared: "Build a round sweat-bath house." When the windows of those houses did not fit, the Blessed One declared: "Install windows." When the windows were made wide on the outside and narrow on the inside, the Blessed One declared: "Make them narrow on the outside and wide on the inside, in the shape of a sea." When the monks set them too high and it became dark inside, the Blessed One declared: "Do not set them too high." When the monks set them too low and the smoke could not escape, the Blessed One declared: "Do not set them too low." When the monks did not know where to set them, the Blessed One declared: "Set them in the middle."

When sparrows and pigeons entered through the windows, the Blessed One declared: "Fit the windows with lattice screens." When wind and rain-spray came inside, the Blessed One declared: "Fit the windows with shutters." When the wind moved the shutters so that one could not sit comfortably, the Blessed One declared: "Insert pivot-fittings, ceiling pegs, and crossbars."

When the monks were troubled by drafts and the noise of the shutters opening and closing, the Blessed One declared: "Place a dry wooden stick nearby." When the door would not accept a door panel, the Blessed One declared: "Fit a door panel and also a door frame, and fit them with a peephole and a hand-rest as well."

When water was placed on the low side and it became cold, the Blessed One declared: "Build a raised platform inside and place the water vessels on it." When a fire was lit on the ground floor and it cracked and became unsuitable, the Blessed One declared: "Spread out a layer of brick tiles." When the monks spread out the fire and it died, the Blessed One declared: "Once spread out, do not discard it but rake it and let it rest." When the monks did not know how to rake it, the Blessed One declared: "Make an iron rake and use that to rake it."

When the monks entered while the fire was still blazing and became scorched, the Blessed One declared: "Do not enter while the fire is still blazing." When the monks entered and became drunk from the smoke of the fire, collapsing to the ground in a stupor, the Blessed One declared: "Mix flour with mustard oil and pour it onto the fire." When the smell became unpleasant, the Blessed One declared: "Pour incense onto the fire." When smoke caused the monks' eyes to water, the Blessed One declared: "Rinse the eyes with a wash of barley-beer." When they still watered, the Blessed One declared: "Rinse with a wash of āmalaka berry-beer."

When there were no seats and the monks took their own seats away with them, and those seats became smeared with oil, the Blessed One declared: "Place bundles of grass there." When their feet were soiled with dust from being placed on the ground, the Blessed One declared: "Spread grass on the floor."

When dry grass bundles were placed there and caught fire from sparks, the Blessed One declared: "Lay down fresh green grass." When green grass could not be found, the Blessed One declared: "Sweep with water and then lay it down."

When the monks became smeared with grain oil and chaff and husks stuck to their bodies and caused sores, the Blessed One declared: "Use an iron scraper." When the scraper was placed just anywhere and became unsuitable, the Blessed One declared: "Make a hole in the wall, fit a peg, and hang the scraper on it, keeping it away from contact with damp things."

When the scraper became greasy and the monks cleaned it again and again, the Blessed One declared: "Season it with fire." When the monks bathed there and it became muddy and soiled, the Blessed One declared: "Do not bathe there; build a bathhouse and bathe in it."

When those who bathed were troubled by the water, the Blessed One declared: "Dig a bathing pit, heat it with stones, and whoever bathes shall enter the pit while whoever pours the bath water sits at the edge and pours it in." When the pit filled with water, the Blessed One declared: "Make a drain-hole."

When the monks, after bathing, went to the monastery to fetch tooth-cleaning powder, cow dung, and tooth-sticks, the Blessed One declared: "Place baskets filled with tooth-cleaning powder, cow dung, and tooth-sticks in that very place."

When the monks were weakened by the heat of the fire, the Blessed One declared: "Have a boy blow on it." When their hands were scalded from blowing with their mouths, the Blessed One declared: "Use a bellows." When one monk found porridge from the boy's blowing to be far too hot, the Blessed One declared: "Drink it through the bellows tube." When a dressing of salt and leaves was needed and none could be found, the Blessed One declared: "Carry a salt pouch."

When the Blessed One declared that a sweeping task should be done in the bathhouse, the monks did not know who was to do the sweeping, and the Blessed One declared: "Those who lodge together and the attendants shall do it, each one for the other." Thus the bathhouse together with its requisites was approved.

The occasion for the preceding rules was at Śrāvastī.

At that time there was in Vaiśālī a great Licchavi named Mahāsenā who was without deceit or cunning and was by nature straightforward and honest. Each day he would go to pay homage at the feet of the Blessed One. Once, as he was going into the presence of the Blessed One, a monk who was a dear friend of his — who though born of the earth still wandered about the countryside — arrived in Vaiśālī, and the two of them saw each other on the road. The two said: "Great one, where are you going?" He replied: "Noble ones, I am going to pay homage at the feet of the Blessed One." The two said that they knew the venerable Jātanora well, having been with him life after life, and then they said: "Great one, one is to bring a gift of words to the buddha, the Blessed One

— do you have some small gift of words?" He replied: "Noble ones, I have none." "Great one, come here. Go to where the Blessed One is, and when you arrive say to the Blessed One: 'Venerable one, it is unsightly and improper that the noble Jātanora should have committed a defeat by engaging in unchaste conduct with my attendant.' And the Blessed One will be pleased with you." He agreed to do exactly as the two asked, and then —

He went to where the Blessed One was, and upon arriving he bowed his head at the Blessed One's two feet. He then said to the Blessed One: "Venerable one, it is unsightly and improper that the noble Jātanora should have committed a defeat by engaging in unchaste conduct with my attendant." Having said this, he departed.

Then the Blessed One addressed the monks: "Monks, the bowl-overturning ceremony is to be performed against the great Licchavī, and likewise against anyone else of that kind. The ceremony is to be performed as follows: having set out seats, the wooden sounding board is struck, and the monks are properly informed by way of the words of inquiry. When the entire Saṅgha is assembled and in harmony, a single monk, by a motion alone, shall perform the act: 'May the venerable ones of the Saṅgha please hear. Since the great Licchavī has falsely accused the venerable Jātanora, if it is the proper time for the Saṅgha and the Saṅgha consents, the Saṅgha shall perform the bowl-overturning ceremony against the great Licchavī. This is the motion.' Against the one upon whom the Saṅgha has performed the bowl-overturning ceremony, monks shall not go to his house, shall not make use of his seats, shall not accept alms from him, and shall not teach him the Dharma."

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, go and inform the great Licchavī with these words: 'The Saṅgha has performed the bowl-overturning ceremony against you.'" The venerable Ānanda replied "As you wish, venerable one," and having heeded the Blessed One's command, he went to where the great Licchavī's house was.

At that time the great Licchavī had gone out on some business. Ānanda spoke to his wife: "Sister, where has the great Licchavī gone?" She replied: "Noble one, he has gone out." "Sister, know this: the Saṅgha has performed the bowl-overturning ceremony against you." She said: "Venerable Ānanda, what is called the bowl-overturning ceremony?" "Sister, against the one upon whom the bowl-overturning ceremony has been performed, monks do not go to his house, do not make use of his seats, do not accept alms from him, and do not

teach the Dharma. Noble Ānanda, by some stratagem the Saṅgha has cast aside my husband's good name — what offense have we committed against the Saṅgha that on account of it the bowl-overturning ceremony has been performed?" "Sister, your husband went to where the Blessed One was, and upon arriving said to the Blessed One: 'Venerable one, it is unsightly and improper that the noble Jātanora should have committed a defeat by engaging in unchaste conduct with my attendant.' On account of that he became ashamed and entered the house, and then the venerable Ānanda departed."

When the great Licchavī arrived home, his wife said: "My lord's son, the Saṅgha has performed the bowl-overturning ceremony against you." He said: "Good woman, the bowl-overturning ceremony has been well performed. The bowl-overturning ceremony has been rightly performed. My lord's son, the bowl-overturning ceremony has been well performed. The bowl-overturning ceremony has been rightly performed." Then she asked: "Do you know what the bowl-overturning ceremony is?" "I do not know." "My lord's son, against the one upon whom the bowl-overturning ceremony has been performed, monks do not come to his house, do not make use of his seats, do not accept alms from him, and do not teach the Dharma. My lord's son, did you see the noble Jātanora together with me?" "Good woman, I did not see him." "Then why have you made a false accusation against the noble one?"

"If I likewise seek the forbearance of the Blessed One and the Saṅgha of monks, then well and good. But if I do not, you will not allow me into her house." Hearing this, he took it to heart and thought: "Since what she has said will come to pass just as she has spoken, I will go and seek forbearance." So he went before the Blessed One, and upon arriving he prostrated with his head at his feet and spoke these words: "Blessed One, my conduct has been like a single umbrella — I arose early as a Buddhist, and have come to pay reverence at the feet of the Blessed One. At the urging of a friendly monk and of the two earth-born ones, the great one has come here. You went to where the Blessed One was." Then, from that point all the way through "I committed unchaste conduct with my attending woman and incurred a defeat," everything was recited just as before. He then addressed the venerable one: "I ask that you bear with whatever fault I have committed."

Thereupon the Blessed One addressed the monks: "Monks, toward the great Licchavī, and toward anyone else similarly situated, the bowl-overturning ceremony is to be reversed. The reversal is to be performed as follows. Having set out the seats, the bell is struck, and the monks are properly informed with

the words of the motion. Then, once the entire Saṅgha is seated and in harmony, the great Licchavī, having paid reverence, is to sit cross-legged at the edge of the elders' side and, with palms joined, is to say these words: 'May the venerable Saṅgha please hear me. I, the great Licchavī, was deceived by a companion of bad conduct, and I falsely slandered the noble Jātanora. The Saṅgha performed the bowl-overturning ceremony against me. Now that the bowl has been overturned against me, I request the Saṅgha to reverse the bowl-overturning. May the venerable Saṅgha, out of compassion, reverse the bowl-overturning for the great Licchavī, out of compassion for me.' This is to be repeated a second and third time. Then the great Licchavī is to be moved from the range of hearing into the range of sight, and a single monk is to perform the act by means of a single motion alone. It is to be done thus: 'May the venerable Saṅgha please hear me. This great Licchavī, who was deceived by a companion of bad conduct, falsely slandered the venerable Jātanora. The Saṅgha performed the bowl-overturning ceremony against him. The great Licchavī upon whom the bowl has been overturned now requests that the bowl-overturning be reversed by the Saṅgha. If it is the appropriate time for the Saṅgha, and the Saṅgha consents, may the Saṅgha grant it, and may the Saṅgha reverse the bowl-overturning for the great Licchavī.' This is the motion. To the one toward whom the bowl-overturning has been reversed, monks may go to his house, may make use of his seats, may accept alms, and may teach the Dharma."

Summary verse:

The limb-forms like a mirror,
dance and song and music's sound,
granting applause and tribute of speech —
together with the four concerning the bowl.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling in Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time a certain ascetic monk was residing in Śrāvastī. One day, when he was sitting cross-legged and settled, his limbs became fit for service. On another occasion, having made his round for alms and finished the meal, returning from the subsequent alms-round for food, he set down his bowl and robe, washed both feet, sat cross-legged at the foot of a tree, and entered upon mental application. Again his limbs became fit for service, and he acted in whatever way would bring about their pacification.

Because the mind changes quickly, when it was distracted, his limbs again and again became fit for service. Then, when he was utterly gripped by

attachment, great aversion also arose in him, and he placed his member upon a stone and struck it with another stone. Tormented by a feeling of pain, he thought to himself: "While I am tormented by painful feelings, how strange it would be if the Blessed One took no notice." Thereupon the Blessed One, by the power of great compassion, came to that place and spoke: "Monk, what is the matter?" The monk explained what had occurred, and the Blessed One declared: "Monk, did I not say that the antidote to attachment is the meditation on the unattractive? The one who should be struck is the deluded one within you, yet you have struck another. What should be beaten is something else, and you have beaten something else." The monk sat in silence. Then the Blessed One addressed the monks: "Monks, I guarantee that if you cultivate this one thing, you will become non-returners — and that is mindfulness directed toward the body. Monks, cultivate mindfulness directed toward the body, and I guarantee you will become non-returners. Therefore a monk should beat what should be beaten, and not beat what should not be beaten. If one beats the wrong thing, it becomes a serious offense." The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling in Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time there was in Śrāvastī a certain householder who had taken a wife from a family of equal rank, and he played with her, rejoiced with her, and made love with her. Through that play, joy, and lovemaking, a being entered into his wife's womb. Eight or nine months passed, and from the birth there came a boy of beautiful form, handsome and lovely to behold. Later, at another time, having gone forth into the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, he was residing for a short time in a district, carrying his alms-bowl and robe, wandering through the region. While he was wandering about the district, a growth appeared on his face, and he had a physician cauterize it. His face then became unattractive. Later, at another time, he went to Śrāvastī, and a certain monk did not grant him entry. He went to another monk and said: "Venerable, do you not know me?" The monk replied: "If I do not know you, fair-faced one, who are you?" He said: "My name is such-and-such. I am the son of a certain great householder. I went forth right there, and came here from that district." The monk said: "Venerable, you have a fair face and a lovely complexion — why then has your face become unattractive?" When he explained all that had happened, the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "A monk's face is like a mirror, therefore a monk should not have a physician cauterize his face. If he does so, it becomes a serious offense." When the Blessed One had declared that a monk should not have a physician cauterize his face, if monks then had

need of lancing due to swelling of blood, the monks refrained from lancing. The Blessed One declared: "Lancing may be done — one should have no remorse about this." The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling in Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time in Śrāvastī there were two festive assemblies: the merchants' festive assembly and the soldiers' festive assembly. Of these two, the merchants' festive assembly would defeat the soldiers' festive assembly with dance, song, and the sound of music; and the soldiers' festive assembly would defeat the merchants' festive assembly by means of weapons.

Then on another occasion the soldiers' festive assembly said amongst themselves: "Friends, these merchants have defeated us with dance, song, and the sound of music, while we have defeated them by means of weapons. By what means, then, might we also defeat them with dance, song, and the sound of music?" Some among them said: "Just so — we too should train in dance, song, and the sound of music." Others said: "Excellent! But from whom should we train?" And those replied: "The noble group of six are skilled in dance, song, and the sound of music — we should train from them. Since those monks are given to sensual pleasures, if we offer them even a small payment they will surely teach us." The others agreed: "Excellent! Let us give it just so." They went to where the group of six was staying, prostrated at their feet, and said: "Noble ones, please teach us dance, song, and the sound of music." Those monks replied: "Friends, if you give us our customary fee, we will teach you." The soldiers said: "Noble ones, we are poor — we offer you only a physician's fee." And those monks taught them dance, song, and the sound of music.

When the training was complete, the soldiers' assembly defeated the merchants' festive assembly both by means of weapons and with dance, song, and the sound of music. The merchants then said: "Good sirs, formerly you defeated us by weapons, and we defeated you with dance, song, and the sound of music. Now you have defeated us on both counts — what technique have you used?" They replied: "We have now trained." "Trained from whom?" "From the noble group of six." The merchants then said: "The conduct of the śramaṇas, the sons of the Śākya — it is a mockery. The conduct of the brahmins — it is a mockery. They teach even dance, song, and the sound of music!" And they derided them, they ridiculed them, and they spread slander about them.

At that juncture the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One, knowing that whatever fault had arisen among the monks had come about through their teaching dance, song, and the sound of music, declared: "Therefore a monk must not teach dance, song, and the sound of music. If one does so, it will constitute a serious offence."

When the Blessed One had declared that monks must not teach dance, song, and the sound of music, those festive assemblies forgot this ruling and went once again to the group of six, saying: "Noble ones, even though we are unworthy, please teach us again." Those monks replied: "Friends, the Blessed One has laid down a rule of training that monks must not teach dance, song, and the sound of music — we will not teach you." The soldiers said: "Noble ones, if you will not teach us, then at least come and rehearse along with us." Those monks replied: "Friends, very well — we will come." They went there and rehearsed with them, and the soldiers again defeated the merchants. Then once more — from "the conduct of the śramaṇas, the sons of the Śākya — it is a mockery, the conduct of the brahmins — it is a mockery" all the way through "they derided them, they ridiculed them, and they spread slander about them" — exactly as before.

At that juncture the monks again reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One, knowing that whatever fault had arisen among the monks had come about through their rehearsing dance, song, and the sound of music, declared: "Therefore a monk must not rehearse dance, song, and the sound of music. If one does so, it will constitute a serious offence." When the Blessed One had declared that monks must not rehearse dance, song, and the sound of music —

— rehearsing dance, song, and the sound of music — the good monks again forgot, and they went once more to the group of six monks and spoke accordingly. The group of six replied: "Good fellows, the Blessed One has forbidden it, so we will not rehearse." The group of six then said: "Noble ones, if you would just come and watch, that alone will defeat us." Thinking, "If that is so, let us go," the good monks went there, and the mere sight of those performances filled them with shame. The group of six then derided them, saying: "So much for the monks' way of a wandering ascetic (śramaṇa) in the sons of the Śākyas — the word 'monk' is all it is. So much for the brāhmin's way — the word is all it is. To think they would even come to watch dance, song, and the sound of music!" They mocked them, they ridiculed them, and they spread slander about them.

At that juncture the monks again reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One, knowing that whatever fault had arisen among the monks had come about through their going to watch dance, song, and the sound of music, declared: "Therefore a monk must not perform dance, must not take up song, must not make the sound of music, must not rehearse dance, song, and the sound of music, and must not go to watch them. Monks, if a monk studies dance, or studies song, or studies the sound of music, or rehearses dance, song, and the sound of music, or goes to watch them, it will constitute a serious offence."

The Minor Rules of Vinaya. The Fourth Fascicle.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time in Kauśāmbī there lived a householder named Supriya who possessed faith and had good and virtuous intentions. He took a wife from among his equals in lineage, and with her he played, took delight, and made merry. As they played and delighted and made merry together, after some time had passed a being entered the womb of his wife.

The venerable Śāriputra, perceiving that this being was ready to be trained, went to the householder's house, established the good-natured householder Supriya in the going for refuge and in the training precepts, and from time to time visited him. Now after some time had passed, the venerable Śāriputra went alone one day, without an attendant monk. The householder said: "Noble one, do you have no attendant monk?" He replied: "Good fellow, would an attendant monk come to me from a thicket of kāśa grass or a thicket of kuśa grass? Those who prove worthy of someone like you — they alone will become my attendant monks." The householder said: "Noble one, if that is so, then if the being who has entered my attendant's womb gives birth to a boy, I will offer that boy to the noble one as an attendant monk." "Good fellow, may you be free from illness," Śāriputra said, and departed.

In time the householder's wife carried the child for nine full months and gave birth, and the boy who was born had an unfortunate complexion and a small body, yet a beautiful voice. His relatives gathered and assembled, and on the twenty-first day after the birth they held a great birth celebration and set about naming the boy. The relatives said: "Although this boy has an unfortunate complexion and a small body, he is the son of Householder Supriya, and he has a beautiful voice; therefore let this boy's name be Supriya, after the beautiful." And so he was given the name Supriya, meaning "the

beautiful." He was cared for and raised and grew to be grown.

Then the venerable Śāriputra dressed himself in his lower robe in the early morning, took up his alms-bowl and his Dharma robe, and entered Kauśāmbī for alms. As he went about collecting alms in Kauśāmbī he came to the home of the householder Supriya, and the householder Supriya, pronouncing the words of welcome, "How good that the noble one has come," greeted him and bowed at his feet. Supriya's wife then filled the alms-bowl with clean and wholesome cooked food and offered it to him. The boy looked into the face of the venerable Śāriputra, and Śāriputra made a gesture to the householder Supriya, whereupon Supriya said to the boy: "My son, even before you were born I had already offered you as a personal attendant to the noble Śāriputra. Go now and accompany the noble one." The being who was in his last existence, following along behind him, was then by Śāriputra given the going-forth and granted full ordination. He received scriptural instruction and, through effort, exertion, and striving, came to know directly that this very wheel of cyclic existence, with its five spokes, whether in motion or at rest, is of a nature in which all formations decay, fall away, scatter apart, and disintegrate. Overwhelmed by this realization, and having abandoned every affliction, he actualized arhatship directly. As an arhat freed from attachment in the three realms, he abided with a mind like a stone of equal weight set against bronze and gold, like space and the palm of the hand in their evenness, like sandalwood soaked and placed aside. He split open the shell of the cave of his rebirth-door, attained the higher knowledges, the superknowledges, and the individual analytical knowledges. He turned his back on gain and honor bound up with existence and desire. He became one worthy of offering, of worship, and of reverent address by the gods together with Indra (Śakra) and their attendants.

Whenever he taught the Dharma with the resonance of his voice, it pervaded everything as far down as the world of Brahmā, and in the streams of many sentient beings it produced virtuous roots conducive to liberation. Indeed, even those sentient beings who belonged to the realm of animal rebirth would prick up their ears and listen to that beautiful sound.

Then the Blessed One addressed the monks: "Among my śrāvaka monks of beautiful voice, this monk, Supriya of the beautiful voice, is the foremost. Such is the pleasing quality of his voice and the beauty of his delivery that monks who had not yet parted from attachment would abandon their own affairs and go to listen to him every single day."

Now, at a certain other time, the king of Kosala, Prasenajit, was riding upon a single great white-lotus elephant, his chief elephant, with the mahout Śrīvarddhana guiding it, and in the early morning hours the two went out to a rocky cliff. At that moment the venerable Supriya of the beautiful voice began to teach the Dharma with the resonance of his voice, and the chief white-lotus elephant heard it. Upon hearing the resonant voice of the venerable Supriya of the beautiful voice, the elephant pricked up its ears and stood utterly motionless. The mahout Śrīvarddhana flapped his hands and feet repeatedly from both sides to urge it on, but still it would not move. The king said: "Śrīvarddhana, the elephant won't come even when struck — what is the reason for this? I cannot fathom it." The king said: "Leave it be; let us see which way it will go." He left it as it pleased, and it turned away from the Jeta Grove and went step by step right to the Jeta Grove, and there at the gate of the Jeta Grove it stood with its ears pricked, listening. When the venerable Supriya of the beautiful voice had finished teaching the Dharma with the resonance of his voice,

Whatever beings have gathered here, whether dwelling on the earth or in the intermediate sky, may they always cherish loving-kindness toward all sentient beings, and may they practice the Dharma by day and by night.

With this complete dedication having been made, the chief among the great elephants, the one with a single white lotus mark, knew that the venerable Supriya of the Beautiful Voice had come to the end of teaching the Dharma with the resonance of his voice, and so it went wherever its mind inclined, moving here and there as it pleased.

The king said: "Śrīvarddhana, why does it go wherever it pleases like this?" He replied: "Your Majesty, I beg your pardon — this elephant heard the sounds of a noble one teaching the Dharma with the resonance of his voice, and its mind was captivated; it has lost all self-control." The king said: "Śrīvarddhana, bring the elephant back, seek out that noble one, offer him a robe, and tomorrow morning go to the rocky cliffs." He replied: "As Your Majesty commands." He turned back and went home. The queen Mālyavatī asked him: "My lord, why have you returned?" He told her what had happened, and then said: "Mālyavatī, give me a robe — I will go and offer it to that noble one." She thought to herself: "To think that the noble Supriya of the Beautiful Voice taught the Dharma with the resonance of his voice — he is of unsightly complexion and small of body, and this king is drawn to the grand and

magnificent. If the king were to see him, there is a possibility he might lose his faith. I must employ some skillful means." So she said: "Your Majesty, please go to the rocky cliffs. I myself will offer the robe to that noble one." He replied: "Mālyavati, you too should offer another robe. Would a single robe from both of us impoverish the palace of Kosala?" She said nothing and remained silent, and the king took a robe befitting a great one and went to the Jeta Grove.

At that time the venerable Ānanda was walking back and forth and sitting at the gate of the Jeta Grove. When the king had dismounted from the elephant and prostrated at his feet with both knees, he said: "Noble one, where is the noble one who was teaching the Dharma with the resonance of his voice earlier tonight?" He replied: "Great king, why do you seek him? You wish to offer him a robe." He thought: "If the venerable Supriya of the Beautiful Voice has been teaching the Dharma with the resonance of his voice — he is of unsightly complexion and small of body, and this king is drawn to the grand and magnificent. If the king were to see him, there is a possibility he might lose his faith. I must employ some skillful means." So he said: "Great king, give it to me, and I will offer it to him on your behalf." The king replied: "Noble one, the Blessed One has praised giving with one's own hand — so please show me him, that I may offer it with my own hand."

At that time the venerable Supriya of the Beautiful Voice was resting in the shade of a tree for his daytime abiding. Then the venerable Ānanda said: "Great king, he is resting there in the shade of a tree — please go." The king went to where he was and looked, and in that moment he saw that he was exceedingly unattractive. Disbelief arose in him; displeased, he turned his face away, threw down the robe, and left.

At that moment the venerable Supriya of the Beautiful Voice spoke these verses:

Those who look upon my form
and follow along after my voice,
those people, governed by desire,
shall not truly see me.

But one who knows inwardly
and does not look to outer things,
one who sees the inner fruit —
that one will be led by the voice alone.

If one knows inwardly,

and sees outward things,
and sees the outward fruit —
that one too will be led by the voice alone.

But if one knows neither inwardly
nor sees outward things at all,
those children utterly bewildered —
they too will be led by the voice alone.

Yet one who knows inwardly
and likewise sees outward things,
that one, firm and inclined toward wisdom,
will not be led by the voice at all.

At that moment the monks were seized by doubt, and they asked the Blessed One, the buddha, to cut through all their doubts: "Venerable one, what karma did the elder, the venerable Supriya of the Beautiful Voice, perform, such that through its ripening he came to have an ugly complexion and a small body yet a beautiful voice?"

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, know that the son of good family, Supriya of the Beautiful Voice himself, found a collection of karma, gathered conditions like a flame drawing close, and caused things that were inevitably going to arise to be performed and accumulated. Who else but Supriya of the Beautiful Voice himself would experience individually what he has done and accumulated? Monks, karma that has been performed and accumulated does not ripen in the external element of earth, nor in the element of water, nor in the element of fire, nor in the element of wind. Rather, virtuous and non-virtuous karma that has been performed and accumulated ripens in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

Actions do not decay even across a hundred aeons;
when the gathering and the time arrive,
their fruits will come to be
for those who bear a body.

Monks, long ago in a time that has passed, in this very good aeon, when the lifespan of beings was forty thousand years, there arose in the world a Teacher — a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, a knower of the world, an unsurpassed guide who tames persons, a teacher of gods and humans, a Blessed One, a

buddha — known as Saṃvartanīya. Having performed all the deeds of a buddha, he passed into nirvāṇa in the realm of nirvāṇa without remainder of aggregates, like a fire gone out when the fuel is exhausted.

King Bhadra then made extensive offerings to the body of that Blessed One, the buddha Saṃvartanīya, and set about having stūpas built encircling the area, each one a league in circumference, and two and a half leagues high. To carry out this work he appointed a certain labourer — a man of different faith but good disposition, of virtuous intention, and diligent in his labor. There was also another labourer who, upon seeing that such a very great stūpa was being built, began to mock the work, saying to those of discerning eye: "I do not know when this king will ever finish building such an enormous stūpa." At that, the labourer whose wages were being paid said: "Hey, fellow! Why do you mock? If it cannot be done, leave the work alone." The mocker fell silent, and the paid labourer then began to drive him away from the site. The mocker begged his pardon and resumed his work. But the stūpa was not yet complete when the mocker again began to mock, and the paid labourer drove him off again. He then begged pardon very earnestly, resumed his work once more, and in the end there was completed a stūpa so magnificent and inexhaustible to behold that it captivated the eyes and minds of many hundreds of thousands of creatures.

Then the paid labourer, seeing what had been accomplished, felt remorse arise within him, thinking: "While this work was being done, I acted badly toward him by mocking him." He resolved to honour that one in every way, and so from the wages he himself had received he had a golden bell made and, with a mind filled with sincere devotion, hung it upon that stūpa.

Monks, the one who at that time was the paid labourer is none other than this very monk Suvarṇabhadra. And because of the karmic ripening of his having mocked the work done on the stūpa of a perfectly awakened buddha that destroys cyclic existence, he was born with a dull complexion and a small body. And because of the karmic ripening of his having, once faith arose in him, caused a golden bell to be made and hung it upon the stūpa, he came to possess a beautiful voice.

Then the monks again gave rise to doubt, and they put their question to the awakened Blessed One, the cutter of all doubt: "Venerable One, what deed did the long-lived Suvarṇabhadra perform such that his voice filled everything down from the Brahmā world?"

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, from the point at which this son of good family, Suvarṇabhadrā himself, obtained the accumulation of karma, onward through to the point of becoming those results — all of that is just as before.

"Monks, long ago in a time now past, in this very auspicious aeon, when the lifespan of beings was twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world the Teacher, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly awakened buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, the knower of the world, the guide of persons to be tamed, the unsurpassed one, the Teacher of gods and humans — the awakened Blessed One Kāśyapa. He was dwelling near Vārāṇasī, in the Deer Park of the sage who speaks truth, residing there in dependence upon that place.

"Between Vārāṇasī and the grove of the sage who speaks truth there stood a mango tree, and in that tree dwelt a male cuckoo bird. At the time when the awakened Blessed One Kāśyapa was going into Vārāṇasī for alms, the bird, regarding him with great attention, let forth a distinctly beautiful and pleasing call, and looked upon him again and again in just that way. Growing satisfied in mind, faith arose in him.

"On another occasion, while giving voice to its call, the bird circumambulated the perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa three times, and joy and happiness arose in it, and it then settled once more in that same mango tree. The very moment it alighted, a hawk snatched away its life, and at the moment of death it died and was born as a brahmin skilled in the six branches of learning.

"Monks, the one who at that time was that cuckoo bird is none other than this very monk Suvarṇabhadrā. And because of the karmic ripening of his having let forth a beautiful call and performed circumambulation before the perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa, his voice came to fill everything down from the Brahmā world."

Then the monks again gave rise to doubt, and they put their question to the awakened Blessed One, the cutter of all doubt: "Venerable One, what deed did the long-lived Suvarṇabhadrā perform such that through the karmic ripening of that deed he went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One, abandoned all afflictions, and directly realized arhathood — and was declared supreme among those with beautiful, resounding voices by the Blessed One?"

The Blessed One declared: "That was by the power of aspiration. Where was that aspiration made? In the very teaching of the perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa there was a monk who had gone forth, and him the Blessed One

Kāśyapa declared supreme among those with beautiful, resounding voices."

Yet in that life, having practiced the holy life for as long as he lived without attaining any accumulation of virtuous qualities, when he came to die he spoke thus: "In the presence of the Blessed One, the perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa, I practiced the holy life for as long as I lived without attaining any accumulation of virtuous qualities. By this root of virtue of mine — since the Blessed One, the perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa, gave a prophecy to the brahmin youth Blama saying, 'O brahmin youth, in a future age, when human lives span a hundred years, there will appear a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly awakened buddha named Śākyamuni' — may I go forth in the teaching of that one whose prophecy was given, and by abandoning all afflictions directly realize arhathood. And just as this preceptor of mine was declared by the Blessed One, the perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa, to be supreme among those with beautiful, resounding voices, so too may I be declared by that Blessed One to be supreme among those with beautiful, resounding voices." By the power of that aspiration so made, he has now gone forth in my teaching, and by abandoning all afflictions has directly realized arhathood. And I have declared this monk to be supreme among those with beautiful, resounding voices.

Monks, therefore the karmic maturation of deeds that are purely dark — from "purely dark" all the way through to "monks, you should train in this way" — is as before.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada.

Now it happened that when the monks were reciting the Dharma, they recited it scattering the words about like a shower of pine seeds, while the non-Buddhists recited their texts in a melodious, resonant voice.

The householder Anāthapiṇḍada was in the habit of rising early each morning and going to pay homage at the feet of the Blessed One. One morning, as he was on his way, he heard the non-Buddhists reciting their texts in a melodious, resonant voice. He thought to himself: "The Dharma and discipline of the non-Buddhists is wrongly spoken — and yet they recite their texts in a melodious, resonant voice. My noble ones, on the other hand, when they recite they scatter the words like a shower of pine seeds. This is a matter I must address."

He went to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived he touched his head to the Blessed One's two feet and sat down to one side. Sitting to one side, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada addressed the Blessed One thus: "Venerable One, the Dharma and discipline of the non-Buddhists is wrongly spoken — and yet they recite their texts in a melodious, resonant voice. The noble ones, when they recite, scatter the words about like a shower of pine seeds. If the Blessed One would therefore permit the noble ones also to recite the texts in a melodious, resonant voice, that would be excellent."

The Blessed One said nothing, and by his silence gave consent. Understanding from the Blessed One's silence that consent had been given, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada touched his head to the Blessed One's two feet and departed from the presence of the Blessed One.

Then the Blessed One addressed the monks and declared: "Monks, you are therefore permitted to recite the Dharma in a melodious, resonant voice."

When the Blessed One had declared that the Dharma was to be recited in a melodious, resonant voice, the monks proceeded to recite, chant, and intone the scriptures in melodious, resonant voices, repeating and rehearsing them fully.

Now, when the householder Anāthapiṇḍada went to the Jeta Grove, he heard this and said: "Noble ones, what is this — have you set up a musician's lodge in this temple of yours?"

At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks are not to recite scriptures, chant, intone, or rehearse them in a melodious, resonant voice. However, the proper proclamation of the Teacher's qualities and the chanting of texts set to three melodic modes are to be chanted in a melodious, resonant voice."

When the Blessed One had declared that those should be chanted in a melodious, resonant voice, a certain young monk, not knowing how to produce a melodious, resonant voice, proceeded to teach the texts in such a way that, as he taught, it was like scattering a heap of pine cones — all in a jumble. The monks said to him: "Venerable one, the Blessed One has permitted the melodious voice; please let it come forth in a melodious voice." He replied: "Venerable ones, I do not know how to produce a melodious, resonant voice."

At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One should train in the melodious, resonant voice."

When the Blessed One had declared that one should train in the melodious, resonant voice, the monks were practicing the melodious tones in the cloisters, the dwelling halls, and the gateway chambers. The householder Anāthapiṇḍada came to the temple and, having heard this, said: "Noble ones, if this temple is not a musician's lodge, have you still not dismissed the musicians?"

At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One should train in the melodious, resonant voice in a secluded place."

The Blessed One, the buddha Bhagavān, was dwelling in Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada.

A monk was standing and bringing out his alms bowl, and the other monks said to him: "Venerable one, do not bring out the alms bowl while standing." He replied: "What is wrong with it?" They said: "The bowl may break — but what else is wrong?" He fell silent, and at that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "A monk should not bring out the alms bowl while standing. And likewise, for placing it in water, washing it, and drying it — these are to be elaborated upon in full."

Summary verse:

A narrow path, and the three vessels,
not to be placed in a net-like manner,
and the canopy, and the inseparable —
these the Great Sage permitted.

The Blessed One, the buddha Bhagavān, was dwelling among the sons of Śākyamuni, on a frightful forested mountain, the haunt of wild beasts, in the land of crocodiles, in the place of the slaughter of children.

At the time when Prince Youthful Rtogs Idan had a fine mansion called Lotus Palace painted with a hundred and one colors, and had long-fringed cotton cloths spread out in abundance, and invited the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas for midday, the Blessed One, intending to go to the Lotus Palace, had not yet gone. Prince Youthful Rtogs Idan said: "Blessed One, please come." Yet the Blessed One still had not gone.

When Prince Youthful Rtogs Idan gathered up the cloths, the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) heard of this and said among themselves: "Wise ones, the renunciant Gautama is not worthy of such honor."

At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, if faithful brahmins and householders have laid down long-fringed cotton cloths even on narrow paths and say, 'Noble ones, please come out of compassion for us,' then, in order to overwhelm the non-Buddhists, one should go, bearing in mind impermanence so as to overwhelm them. There is no remorse in this."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Aṅgaspoṇ (Aṅga's Shore), on a mountain infested with crocodiles, a frightening forested hillside and habitat of wild beasts. A monk was walking along carrying his alms bowl in his hand when he turned aside in another direction, and the bowl fell to the ground and broke, thereby becoming an impediment to him. The monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore a monk should not carry his alms bowl in his bare hand, but should place it in a bowl-bag and carry it thus."

After the Blessed One had declared that a monk should not carry his alms bowl in the bare hand but should place it in a bowl-bag and carry it, the monks put their bowls in bowl-bags and walked along carrying them in their very hands, and that same fault arose again. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One should not carry the bowl-bag in the hand; one should attach a strap and carry it under the arm."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The monks were wandering through the countryside together with like-minded companions. At a certain point a brahmin who was ill went to a physician and said: "Great master, please prescribe medicine for an illness of such and such a kind." The physician said: "Sir, eat āruṇa fruit and you will recover." The brahmin said: "Where is āruṇa to be found along this road?" The physician said: "These renunciants who are sons of the Śākya are learned; if you ask them, they are likely to have some."

The brahmin went to the monks and asked: "Noble ones, do you happen to have any āruṇa?" They said: "Brahmin, if we do, what is it for?" He replied: "A physician has told me to seek āruṇa. If you have any, I humbly request that you give it to me." One of the monks opened his bowl-bag before the brahmin, and right there was some young bamboo, and right there was a small knife, and right there were cords, and right there were various medicines. The brahmin, seeing this, said: "Noble ones, your way of life is impure! It would be better for me to die than to eat something so impure — eating what is impure

is not like that at all!" At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Three kinds of receptacle are to be maintained: the alms-bowl bag, the medicine bag, and the miscellaneous-articles bag."

When the monks attached equal-length straps to all of these, the straps bruised their armpits, and when the Blessed One had declared: "Attach wide straps," they attached wide straps but these chafed them. Then the Blessed One declared: "Fasten a cushioning pad to them, and rub them from time to time with crow-foot grease to make them supple."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. A monk found a piece of cloth and thought to himself: "The Blessed One has declared that the three robes are to be cut and stitched." So he took a small knife and needle and went to the foot of a leafy tree. The Blessed One also proceeded in that direction, saw him, and asked: "Monk, what are you doing?"

He replied: "Venerable Blessed One, since you declared that monks are to cut and stitch the three robes, I found this piece of cloth and it seemed suitable for a robe."

Thereupon the Blessed One spoke words of praise for reverence toward the training, and declared to the monks: "Therefore, monks, the following five things are not to be woven into cloth: all wool from a young animal, all goat hair, all plain raw cloth, all hemp fiber, and all coarse jute fiber."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. A certain monk had gone to another monastery on some business, and he was caught there by nightfall. The one in charge of lodgings said to him: "Venerable one, please take a sleeping place." He replied: "I have brought my mat and will not be needing one." The one in charge of lodgings said: "In that case, please take a bed with a frame." He took the framed bed and lay down, but during the night he fell ill, having been afflicted by the suffering of cold. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore a monk must not travel without a sleeping mat. If he does, he commits an offense."

After the Blessed One had declared that a monk must not travel without a sleeping mat, the monks, wishing to return that very same day, would go to other monasteries nearby, go for their daily walking rounds, and go to other villages, and when they brought their mats along on those journeys, the

elderly senior monks who were aged and frail, and the sick who could not endure the exertion, became exhausted. Then, in circumstances where it was recorded that even for those journeys where one intends to return the very same day, going without a mat was not permitted, the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, when a monk goes to the vicinity or goes on his daily round, he need not carry a mat. When going to another village intending to return the same day, he also need not carry one. When other monks who have no mat go to another village intending to return the same day and circumstances of that nature arise, and night overtakes them there, those who are respectful of the training may borrow a mat for the night from fellow celibates. If one is found, excellent. If none is found, one should fold the upper robe into four layers, lay it down, and pass the night lying on it briefly, but not for a prolonged time."

A certain monk borrowed a mat from another monk, and that monk suffered a nocturnal emission in it and it became defiled. When the same monk then began to return the mat and the owner was unwilling to accept it, the procedure from that point onward is the same as before. The Blessed One declared: "It should be washed and then returned." When that monk washed it and returned it, but the owner still refused to accept it, the procedure up to that point is likewise as before. The Blessed One declared: "Give him the price of cleaning it, or satisfy him in some way."

Monks, other monasteries and

other villages, intending to return that very day, had set out without their three robes, and those who had gone there found themselves in such circumstances that they were forced to spend the night. When, out of respect for the training, they went out at night, they encountered lions, tigers, bandits, and deceivers. On that occasion the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "If those who set out with such an intention are then compelled to spend the night there, they should remain in that place and borrow robes from fellow practitioners of the holy life, then have them consecrated. If those monks do not know how to consecrate borrowed robes, the Blessed One declared: "Consecrate them by means of the mental act of one who previously took them out." These five are accomplished by mental resolve alone: the restoration ceremony, the invitation ceremony, the consecration of robes, the removing of robes, and the inviting of a person as a guest.

When those monks found robes that were worn and unfaded, the Blessed One declared: "If worn and unfaded robes are found, consecrate those worn and unfaded robes. If robes that are unfaded and unworn are found, dye and treat them as appropriate, then consecrate them. If such can be found, well and good. If they cannot be found, consecrate them as they are. Even a layperson's garment may be consecrated, and in doing so one should feel no remorse."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. Two monks who had paid homage at the feet of the Blessed One set out for Śrāvastī from the south road. On the way their water ran out, and tormented by the suffering of thirst, they went to the edge of a small pond. One of the two said to the other: "Venerable, you quickly examine the water and drink it." He began to examine it, and when he found that the water was impure, he spoke this verse:

For a thousand hundred thousand aeons
one so rarely comes to see the Guide.
Let me drink of this water now,
and then behold the one who leads.

The other then spoke this verse:

He who feels in his heart compassion for all sentient beings,
who has utterly abandoned all attachment to existence,
by training in this supreme teaching of his
one gives up one's own life, but does not take the life of living creatures.

Then the one who drank the water departed. The one who did not drink roused his diligence and sat down at the foot of a great tree. For as long as his bodily strength remained, he engaged in wholesome deeds, and when at last his bodily strength was exhausted and the moment of death arrived, he was born among the gods of the four great kings. He became a son of the gods, or —

It is the nature of a divine daughter that, not long after she is born, three things arise in her mind: from where she passed away, where she was born, and by what karma she was born. That one saw that she had passed away from among human beings, been born among the gods of the four great kings, and been born there through the mind of manifest faith in the Blessed One.

Then the former monk, now a son of the gods, thought to himself: "It would not accord with my station to attend to my settled dwelling and go near the

Blessed One in order to look upon him and pay him homage; I will go near the Blessed One without attending to any settled dwelling, in order merely to look upon him and pay him homage."

So the former monk, now a son of the gods, with his earrings and ear ornaments swaying and spotless, his body adorned with garlands and bracelets, filled his robe with divine flowers — blue lotuses, red lotuses, white night-lotuses, white lotuses, and māṇḍārava blossoms — and with a radiance exceedingly brilliant, in the depths of the night, went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, he showered the Blessed One with flowers, bowed his head at the two feet of the Blessed One, paid homage, and sat down to one side. And it was such that through the shining power of that former monk's radiance, the entire Jeta Grove was suffused with a vast brilliance.

Then the Blessed One, having understood with his mind the former monk's aspiration, his underlying tendencies, his temperament, and his character, and having heard what he had heard, taught Dharma to him as he sat right there on that seat — teaching that causes one to thoroughly and individually realize the four noble truths, just as, by the vajra of gnosis, the twenty-peak mountain of the view of the transitory collection (the view that apprehends the self among the aggregates) is shattered while one sits, and the fruit of stream-entry is directly attained.

He then saw the truth, and said aloud three times this solemn declaration to the Blessed One: "This that the revered Blessed One has done for me — not even my father did it for me, not my mother, not a king, not the gods, not my ancestors of former times, not ascetics and brahmins, not the assembly of friends, close companions, and kinsmen. He has dried up the ocean of blood and tears; he has freed me from mountains of bones; he has closed the doors of the lower realms; he has opened the doors of the higher realms and liberation; he has lifted my feet out of the hells, the animal realm, and the realm of hungry ghosts; and he has established me among gods and humans."

Then he also spoke in verse:

By your power I, brimming with pride and laden with many faults,
have had the track to the lower realms blocked and, richly endowed with merit,
have had the path to the higher realms opened — and I myself
have come to reach the further shore of nirvāṇa as well.

Relying on you, supremely pure, today I myself
have obtained a flawless and pure eye,
and rejoicing, have reached the noble, peaceful state of liberation —
I have crossed beyond the ocean of suffering.

You, a sage venerated by beings — asuras, humans, and gods —
freed from birth, aging, sickness, and death,
who sees existence as empty — a rarity supreme —
today there is fruit in my having seen you.

Then, with his robe-end streaming and his garlands hanging free,
he bowed at your feet and joy arose within him,
and circumambulating to the right — the Subduer of Foes —
he rose into the sky, toward the divine world before him.

Then that former monk, the son of the gods, became like a merchant who has
found a great profit, like a farmer whose crops have come to fullness, like a
hero who has conquered in battle, like a sick man who has been freed from
every illness — and in the very same attire in which he had come before the
Blessed One, he departed for his own abode.

As for the other monk, he too went straightway to Śrāvastī.

Then, having set down the bowl and robe, he washed his feet and went to
where the Blessed One was. Arriving there, he bowed his head at the Blessed
One's two feet and sat down to one side.

It is the very nature of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, to gladden with
genuine gladness a monk who has arrived unexpectedly, saying: "Monk, where
have you just come from? Where did you spend the rains retreat?" And so the
Blessed One gladdened that monk with genuine gladness, asking him: "Monk,
where have you come from? Where did you spend the rains retreat?"

The monk replied: "Venerable One, I have just now come from the south. I
spent the rains retreat in the south."

The Blessed One said: "Monk, do you have a fellow monk as a companion?"

"Blessed One, yes."

"Where has he gone? Tell me what happened to him."

Then, at that moment, the Blessed One spoke this verse:

Whoever holds no reverence for my Teaching —
what benefit is it to them to see me?

Even if they look upon me with their eyes,
they neither truly see me nor make true offering.

But the monk who trains in what I teach —
that monk truly sees me.

You, whose wisdom is shallow,
have not seen the Buddha face to face.

Then the Blessed One parted the upper robe from his own body and spoke yet another verse:

Look at this body, monk —
pure, with the color of gold,
born of the ripening of former karma
and arising from father and mother.

One who has not seen the nature of reality
has not seen the fully awakened buddha.
One who has seen the nature of reality
has seen the Great Sage.

Furthermore, one who is steadfast, possessed of a wholesome mind,
and who carefully guards the training —
such a one sees me first
in the form body and in the dharmakāya.

The great being Kāśyapa,
who had transgressed the bounds of training in times past —
even now the ālā leaf has not freed him
from the birthplaces of the nāgas.

The Blessed One then reflected: whatever fault had arisen was due to monks not keeping water filters with them. Therefore monks should keep water filters at hand.

When the Blessed One had spoken the rule that monks should keep water filters at hand, the monks did not know how many kinds of water filters there were. The Blessed One then declared: "There are five kinds of water filters: the triangular water filter, the pot filter with a spout, the ball-shaped filter with a foot, the hanging filter, and the straining filter."

The Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At Śrāvastī, two monks who were on bad terms with each

other were walking about on tour together. Of these two, one had a water filter and the other did not. The one who had it drew up water and drank, and the one who had none said: "Venerable one, lend me your water filter." The other did not give it, and at that point the second monk was left without. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, therefore a monk should not go on tour together with one with whom he is on bad terms. If such a circumstance does arise, they should ask forbearance of each other and proceed."

The Miscellaneous Matters of the Vinaya, the fifth fascicle.

The Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At Śrāvastī two monks were walking about on tour together. Of these two, one had a water filter and the other did not. The one without asked the other: "Do you have a water filter?" The other replied: "I do." But he did not say whether he would lend it or not. Of the two, the one who had the filter drank the water, and the one without said: "Venerable one, lend me your water filter." The other replied:

"Venerable one, you asked me whether I had a water filter, but you did not ask whether I would lend it or not. Since you showed no respect, why should I give you my water filter? I will not give it. Be on your way."

Because he did not give it to him, the other monk was left in difficulty. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "A monk who wishes to travel and who has no water filter should ask his fellow monk: 'Do you have a water filter or not?' If the other says 'I do,' he should say: 'Will you lend it to me or not?' If the other says 'I will lend it,' he may proceed on his journey; otherwise he should not go."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At Śrāvastī two monks set out together on tour. Of the two, one had a water filter and the other did not. The one without asked the other: "Do you have a water filter or not?" The other replied: "I do." "Will you lend it to me or not?" "I will lend it."

They set out, and after some time, while they were on the road, some travellers came along. The business for which the monk with the water filter needed it was accomplished by those very travellers. He then began to turn back, and the other monk said to him: "Venerable one, you promised me the water filter — hand it over." The other replied: "Well, if that is so, I gave it to you for straining water — I did not give it to you for absolutely everything and

in every circumstance." Since he did not give it, the other was left in difficulty. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared:

"A monk who has no water filter should ask his fellow monk: 'Do you have a water filter or not?' If the other says 'I do,' he should ask: 'Will you lend it to me or not?' If the other says 'I will lend it,' he should ask: 'If you should turn back or go elsewhere, will you lend it or not?' If the other says 'I will,' he may proceed on his journey; otherwise he should not go."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time the venerable Upavāna asked the Blessed One: "Venerable one, is it permitted to go to another monastery or another village without a water filter?" Upavāna replied on his own behalf: "It is not permitted." "If one goes there and will not be left in difficulty, it is permitted."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time the venerable Upavāna asked the Blessed One: "Venerable one, is it permitted for two monks to travel on tour with a single water filter between them?" Upavāna replied on his own behalf: "If they go there and will not be left in difficulty, it is permitted." "Venerable one, is it permitted for many monks, or for members of the Saṅgha, to travel on tour with a single water filter?" Upavāna replied: "If they go there and will not be left in difficulty, it is permitted."

"Venerable one, is it permitted to travel along the bank of a river without a water filter?" Upavāna replied: "It is permitted. For a swift-flowing river, one should examine the water at each league to check that it has not mixed with other water. If it has mixed with other water, one should examine it at whatever point one draws it. For a slow-flowing river, one should examine it bank by bank."

"In this context, a swift river is one whose current runs quickly. A slow river is one whose current runs sluggishly."

"Venerable one, what is the vicinity of the bank?" Upavāna replied: "It is exactly one fathom all around."

"Venerable one, is it permitted to go seeking water that has not been strained and has not been examined?" Upavāna replied: "It is not permitted."

"Venerable one, is it permitted to go seeking water that has not been strained but has been examined?" Upavāna replied: "It is permitted, on the

understanding that it is pure to the eye."

"Venerable one, is it permitted to go seeking water that has been strained and examined?" Upavāna replied: "It is permitted in the vicinity, all around."

"However, there are five kinds of permissible water: water permitted by the Saṅgha, water permitted by an individual, water permitted by a water-strainer, water permitted by a spring, and water permitted by a well.

Of these, water permitted by the Saṅgha is water that has been strained by a monk appointed by the unanimous consent of the Saṅgha. Such water permitted by the Saṅgha is to be used by monks.

Water permitted by an individual is water that has been rendered completely pure by a monk whose moral discipline is unimpaired, whose view is unimpaired, whose conduct is unimpaired, and whose livelihood is unimpaired. Such water permitted by an individual is to be used by monks.

Water permitted by a water-strainer is water strained through a strainer that has never been impure. Such water is to be drunk.

Water permitted by a spring is water that flows naturally.

Water permitted by a well is water from a well whose water is pure, drawn after sunset and drinkable until the following sunrise. Such water permitted by a well is to be drunk."

When the monks grew confused from examining water for too long, the Blessed One declared: "Examine it only as much as one trusts — just enough to fill a cart of six oxen loaded with bamboo."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the Garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the monastery given by the prince Jeta. When faithful brahmins and householders came to offer fingerbowls to the monks, the monks would not accept them. Those donors said: "Noble ones, in the time before the Blessed One, the Buddha, arose in the world, the non-Buddhists were the worthy recipients. Now that the Blessed One, the Buddha, has arisen in the world, you are the worthy recipients. If you will not accept, must we die passing from this world to the next without having made provisions along the good path?" At that point, the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Fingerbowls are to be accepted for the sake of the Saṅgha." When the Blessed One had declared that fingerbowls were to be accepted for the sake of the Saṅgha, the monks accepted them, placed them in storage, and ate from them as usual in their begging bowls. When the

faithful brahmins and householders saw this, they said: "Noble ones, is there no sign of the fingerbowls we offered?" The monks replied: "Good people, they are in storage." Those donors said: "Noble ones, is there no dwelling place in our homes? We offered them to you — if you were to fully use what we gave, it would become the merit arising from the cause of us having fully given them. Yet you have put them in storage." At that point, the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "The fingerbowls given by the donors are to be fully used." When the Blessed One had declared that the fingerbowls given by the donors were to be fully used, the monks began to fully use them.

When other brahmins and householders devoted to the Great Vehicle offered large quantities of fingerbowls, and the senior monks — the elder monks — grew weary from washing them, the Blessed One declared: "A fingerbowl attendant is to be appointed." When the Blessed One had declared that a fingerbowl attendant was to be appointed, they were appointed without distinction. Then the Blessed One declared: "A fingerbowl attendant who lacks five qualities is not to be appointed, and one who has been appointed is to be removed. What are the five? Going out of desire, going out of aversion,

going out of delusion, and going out of fear, and not knowing what is and is not proper conduct in the community. A fingerbowl attendant who possesses five qualities is to be appointed, and one who has been appointed is not to be removed. What are the five? Not going out of desire, not going out of aversion, not going out of delusion, not going out of fear, and knowing what is and is not proper conduct in the community."

The appointment is to be carried out as follows. Having assembled in the sitting area, and having struck the wooden sounding board (*gaṇḍī*), the matter is to be announced to the Saṅgha by means of a question, and when the entire Saṅgha has assembled and is seated, first a motion is to be made: "Does it please the Saṅgha to appoint the one called such-and-such as fingerbowl attendant for the Saṅgha? If it pleases, say: 'It pleases.'" Then a single monk is to make the formal motion and carry out the act: "May the venerable Saṅgha hear me. This monk, called such-and-such, is willing to serve as fingerbowl attendant for the Saṅgha. If the moment is right for the Saṅgha and it consents, may the Saṅgha grant approval: the Saṅgha appoints the one called such-and-such as fingerbowl attendant, and the one called such-and-such, appointed as fingerbowl attendant, will properly manage the fingerbowls for the Saṅgha." This is the motion. The formal act is then to be carried out thus:

"May the venerable Saṅgha hear me. This monk, called such-and-such, is willing to properly manage the fingerbowls for the Saṅgha. To that end, the Saṅgha appoints the one called such-and-such as fingerbowl attendant, and the one called such-and-such, appointed as fingerbowl attendant, will properly manage the fingerbowls for the Saṅgha. Those venerable ones who consent to appointing the one called such-and-such as fingerbowl attendant are to remain silent; those who do not consent are to speak." The Saṅgha having consented and approved, the one called such-and-such, appointed as fingerbowl attendant, will properly manage the fingerbowls for the Saṅgha. This is how it is held, by reason of their silence.

When the monks had eaten and gave the leftovers and scrapings directly to the fingerbowl attendant himself, the Blessed One declared: "Those who have leftovers and scrapings are to store them together, and the attendants are to wash them." When the Blessed One had declared that those with leftovers and scrapings were to store them together and the attendants were to wash them, there were other monks who had no attendants and washed the bowls themselves. The Blessed One declared: "Those bowls are to be washed by the fingerbowl attendants alone, and they in turn are to be given the bowls."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The group of six began eating together out of a single black bowl, all six plunging their hands in at once. The bowl caught on their hands and was left dangling. They said to the venerable monks: "Look at the ones doing miracles with the black bowl!" Then they pulled their hands back, it fell and broke. The monks saw them beating it with horse dung and said: "Venerable ones, having done something so unsightly, do you sit there in embarrassment? Look at you laughing!" Those monks replied: "What of it? Have we been drinking ale or eating everything together? So what? Did we not break the black bowl? What violation is there in this? Did the potter die? Is there no clay? It is just something else to be made." They then sat there in silence.

At that time the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One reflected: "Whatever fault has arisen has come about through the monks eating together. Therefore monks must not eat together. If they do so, it shall constitute an offence."

When the Blessed One had declared that monks must not eat together, some monks who were travelling — companions who had set out together — began

to eat their rice in one place. Because all of those monks had no individual eating utensils, it took each one a very long time to eat in turn, and by the time they had finished the travellers were exhausted, and some thieves fell upon them and robbed them.

At that time the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "When one is on the road, if individual eating utensils cannot be found, one may eat together, but each person must put their hand in and take their portion in turn — not all at once."

When the Blessed One had declared that on the road, if individual eating utensils cannot be found, one may eat together, some novices who were present in that place ate together with the monks, and the very same fault arose. The Blessed One declared: "Take a bowl and eat together with them."

There were some others who prepared the food. When they were eating the rice they became separated from the travellers, and the very same fault arose. The Blessed One declared: "Make it into a ball and give it to them."

Some other monks went to the homes of relatives. Their relatives said: "It has been a long time since we ate together; do eat with us." Those monks replied: "You are lay people; we are those who have gone forth into homelessness — it is not fitting for us to eat thus." Those monks, unhappy at this, sat with tears streaming down their faces.

At that time the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "If one is invited repeatedly and persistently, one must know the appropriate moment, and wherever it will not appear unseemly in the eyes of others, one may take up the eating utensils and eat there. One need have no regret in doing so."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in Prince Jeta's park. The group of six monks, wearing a single robe, were seen eating alms food by brahmins and householders, who asked: "Wise ones, who are these people eating rice?" Others replied: "They are ascetics, sons of the Śākya." Those who saw them mocked them and said: "Wise ones — a teacher such as yours possesses conscience and has shame. How can there be followers of his like these, who are utterly devoid of shame and modesty?"

At that time the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One reflected: "Whatever fault has arisen has come about through the monks

wearing a single robe. Therefore monks must not eat rice while wearing a single robe. If they do so, it shall constitute an offence."

When the Blessed One had declared that monks must not eat rice while wearing only a single robe, some who were very elderly and frail, and some who were ill and too weak to endure the effort, were unable to eat their rice while wearing their robes. The Blessed One declared: "Those ones may eat rice that has been softened and moistened. One need have no regret in this."

However, there were some others who still could not manage even this. The Blessed One declared: "Those ones may eat in a secluded spot. One need have no regret in this."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in Prince Jeta's park. The group of six monks were bathing naked in the flooded river. Brahmins and householders who saw them asked:

"Who are these ones bathing naked?" Others replied: "They are monks, sons of the Śākya." People mocked them, saying: "The Teacher himself is endowed with a sense of shame — how can there be those among his followers who are so utterly devoid of shame and modesty?" When the monks reported this to the Blessed One, the Blessed One reflected and saw that whatever fault had arisen had come from monks bathing naked. Therefore he declared: "A monk must not bathe naked. If one does so, it becomes a serious transgression. One must hold a bathing cloth." When the Blessed One declared that a bathing cloth must be held, the monks wore two lengths joined together. The Blessed One then declared: "It should be a single layer. Whoever has a two-layered one should check the water and wash it clean." Some monks, thinking the three Dharma robes to be unsuitable, did not wear them. The Blessed One declared: "Even those ones may consecrate and hold them." Some others could not find a bathing cloth. The Blessed One declared: "Those who cannot find a bathing cloth should cover themselves front and back with leaves, and bathe in a secluded spot where others will not see and become displeased in faith." When some monks wrung out the bathing cloth, they felt regret. The Blessed One declared: "There are no living creatures in a single layer of cloth, but even so, one should spread out the cloth and then wring it. There is no need for regret in this."

The summary verse:

The bean-sprout dish, what is unsuitable,
the earth, and eating what has been vomited,
eating food that has been selected,
regret, and the greasy-lipped bowl.

The buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in Prince Jeta's park. The venerable Nāgita was one who ate anything mixed with broth, so he came to be known by the name Nāgita-of-the-broth, or Broth-Nāgita. Then on another occasion he entered the latrine pit, and there he saw the remnant of a bean-sprout dish and an improper thought arose in him: "I have done something improper regarding the rule about seeds." Once, on another occasion, when food made from bean sprouts had been prepared for the Saṅgha, he would not eat it but sat with his bowl covered. Those who were dwelling with him, and his attendants, said: "Preceptor, food made from bean sprouts has come for the Saṅgha — why do you not eat?" He said: "Friends, I have done something improper regarding the rule about seeds." They asked: "Preceptor, what exactly did you do?" He told them what had happened. They too then began not to eat. Their companions and friends asked: "Why are you not eating?" They told them what had happened, and since Nāgita had many followers, the entire Saṅgha ended up not eating on account of him. The monks then reported this to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, there is something called dyeing with seed-varieties. If steam has arisen, it counts as having been dyed, and it may then be eaten. There is no need for regret in this."

The buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in Prince Jeta's park. The venerable Upananda asked the Blessed One: "Venerable One, if fruit falls in a suitable place from a tree growing in an unsuitable place, may we make full use of it or not?" The Blessed One declared: "Upananda, you may not make full use of it." "Venerable One, then for now — if fruit falls in an unsuitable place from a tree growing in an unsuitable place, may we make full use of it or not?"

"Upananda, you may not make full use of it." "Venerable One, then for now — if fruit falls in an unsuitable place from a tree growing in a suitable place, may we make full use of it or not?" "Upananda, if it has not remained there overnight, you may make full use of it." "Venerable One, then for now — if fruit falls in a suitable place from a tree growing in a suitable place, may we make full use of it or not?" "Upananda, you may make full use of it."

The buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in Prince Jeta's park. A brahmin living at Śrāvastī went begging and obtained a bull. After that he obtained a cow. After that he obtained another bull. And after that he obtained another cow, and in this way his herd of cattle grew large. This brahmin, upon first obtaining the bull, felt it to be auspicious and so let that bull go free. Then at another time, that bull grew old and feeble and infirm, and wanting water it went to the bank of the river Dṛkṣā and wandered into the mud. The venerable Śāriputra also happened to be travelling that road, and seeing the bull he thought: "Does this bull have even a little root of virtue?" And he saw that it did. He then thought: "On whom does it depend?" and concluded: "On me alone." So he pulled it out of the mud and wiped it clean with his hands. Then the venerable one spoke thus: "All formations are impermanent. All phenomena are without self. Nirvāṇa is peace." Having taught these three words of Dharma, he said: "Place your faith in me. If you do so, you will be freed from attachment and released from this birth among animals," and then he departed. Wolves then ate the bull. As it was being eaten by the wolves, it thought: "If this noble one had not come here, I would not have come to such an end." And so, with a mind of pure devotion toward the venerable Śāriputra, it passed from that life and was reborn at Śrāvastī in the family of a brahmin who was diligent in the six duties.

The venerable Śāriputra reflected on what the condition of that bull had been, and he saw the very moment it had passed away. He also reflected on where it had been reborn, and seeing that it had been reborn at Śrāvastī itself in the family of a brahmin who was diligent in the six duties, he went again and again to that household. He established that brahmin together with his wife in taking refuge and in the bases of training. Then at another time he went without a novice attendant following behind him, and the brahmin said: "Noble one, do you not have a novice attendant?" Śāriputra replied: "Good brahmin, are the novice attendants who follow behind me obtained from kuśa grass, or do they arise from kuśa grass? Whatever is obtained from one such as you becomes my novice attendant who follows behind me. Noble one, there is a sentient being in my attendant's womb — if she gives birth to a boy, he shall be your novice attendant who follows behind me." "Venerable one, so be it," said the brahmin, and Śāriputra departed.

Eight or nine months later, she gave birth to a boy with a body like a lump of beef. His relatives gathered and assembled, and on the twenty-first day — being three sets of seven days — after the birth they held a great birth

celebration and proceeded to give him a name. What name would they give the boy? The relatives said: "Since this boy has a body like a young bull, let us name him Vatsadāsa," and so he was named Vatsadāsa. He was raised and nurtured, and when he had grown up,

Then the venerable Śāriputra, in the early morning, robed himself and took up his bowl, and went into Śrāvastī for alms. While walking through Śrāvastī collecting alms, he came to that brahmin's house. The brahmin employed the customary greeting of welcome and prostrated at his feet. His wife too offered him clean and well-prepared food and drink, filling his bowl and presenting it to him.

The boy looked up at the face of the venerable Śāriputra, and Śāriputra made a sign to the brahmin. The brahmin then said to the boy: "My son, from before you were born I offered you to the noble Śāriputra to be the novice attendant who follows behind him. Go now with the noble one." That being was one in his final existence. The boy followed after him, and Śāriputra gave him the going forth, conferred full ordination upon him, and gave him instructions. Through diligent and sustained effort, he realized this very fact — that the wheel of cyclic existence moves, yet in this fifth aspect it does not move — and he cultivated the understanding that all formations, by their very nature as reality, are subject to disintegration, to falling apart, to utter destruction. Having abandoned all afflictions, he directly actualized arhathood: freed from attachment and desire in all three realms, his mind like refined and burnished gold, like sandalwood and camphor, equal to the sky and the palm of the hand, having shattered the hollow door-post of ignorance, he attained clear knowledge, the superknowledges, and the individual perfect insights. Turning his back on attachment to existence and gain, and on esteem, he became an arhat worthy of offerings, of prostrations, and of reverent address by the gods of the sense faculties and their attendant deities.

Now this monk had two throats that had arisen from karmic maturation: from one he would vomit, and from the other he would swallow. In the time before the Blessed One had established the training rule regarding eating at wrong times, he would vomit and then swallow again. But after the rule had been established, he would vomit and discard what came up, and as a result his body became emaciated, weakened, scrawny, and his complexion deteriorated.

The awakened Blessed Ones, though they know, still inquire, so the Blessed One asked the venerable Vatsadāsa: "Vatsadāsa, why has your body become emaciated, weakened, scrawny, and your complexion deteriorated?" When Vatsadāsa explained what had happened, the Blessed One declared: "Vatsadāsa, one who has two throats arising from karmic maturation may vomit two or three times, rinse his mouth, and then swallow what remains. He need have no remorse about this." And when other monks ate and then vomited and felt remorse, the Blessed One declared: "If another monk eats and then vomits, he may rinse his mouth. He need have no remorse about this."

At the time when the venerable Vatsadāsa went forth, brahmins and householders began to mock, ridicule, and slander, saying: "The conduct of the ascetics who are sons of the Śākya is degenerate, their celibate conduct is ruined — and now even those of frightful appearance such as Vatsadāsa and the like are being ordained." When the monks reported this to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "Great hearers who are like Mount Meru cause the great mass of ordinary people to lose faith. Therefore, thinking that Vatsadāsa should not be permitted to reside in the central region, he addressed the venerable Vatsadāsa: "Vatsadāsa, from this day forward you shall not reside in the central region but shall instead make use of dwellings and lodgings in the border regions."

"As you wish, Venerable One," said the venerable Vatsadāsa, and having heeded the Blessed One's command, he departed from Śrāvastī and was seen no more. He dwelt in an empty hall of the Śākyas at Śiṃśapā forest.

Then the Blessed One addressed the monks: "Among my śrāvaka monks, monks, the foremost in their fondness for dwellings and lodgings in the border regions is none other than the monk Vatsadāsa."

Doubt arose among the monks, and wishing to have all their doubts cut through, they put their question to the Blessed Buddha: "Venerable One, what karma did the venerable Vatsadāsa perform, such that through its karmic maturation he came to have the body of a bull?"

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, the karmas that Vatsadāsa himself performed and accumulated, gathered the requisite conditions, saw those conditions fully come together, and — abiding close like a river — are certain to be experienced. Who else would experience the karmas that Vatsadāsa himself performed? Monks, karmas that have been performed and

accumulated do not ripen in the external element of earth, nor in the element of water, nor in the element of fire, nor in the element of wind. Rather, the virtuous and non-virtuous karmas that have been performed and accumulated ripen in nothing other than the aggregates, sense bases, and elements that have been seized upon.

Over hundreds of aeons
karma does not perish;
when the conditions and the time come together,
it ripens as a fruit for embodied beings.

Monks, long ago, in this very excellent aeon, when the human lifespan was twenty thousand years, a fully and perfectly awakened buddha named Kāśyapa arose in the world — accomplished in knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, Teacher of gods and humans, a Blessed Buddha. Under his teaching, a certain one went forth into homelessness. The monk who ordained him was elderly, bent, and frail. One day, while washing that elder's begging bowl, the ordained one heard another monk reciting texts in the distance. Captivated by that recitation, he stole food from his preceptor. Then, at another time, after eating his own food, he washed his own begging bowl and went to where his preceptor was. Seeing that his preceptor was still eating, he accosted him angrily and said: 'Preceptor, are you just sitting there gorging yourself like an old ox?' The elder thought: 'This one is so agitated and quarrelsome that if I say even a little now, it will only stir up greater conflict. I will wait until he is calmer and then speak to him.' So he waited until the other had settled down and then said: 'Venerable one, what did you say?' The other replied: 'I said: are you gorging yourself like an old ox?' — and repeated those same words. Then the elder said: 'Venerable one, do you know who I am? Know well that you, too, went forth under the scriptural dispensation of the fully and perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa, and I too went forth under that very same dispensation.' The other replied: 'That is so, it is true — and yet I have done whatever is to be done and whatever is being done by one who has gone forth, and therefore I am free from all bondage. You are bound by every fetter. And yet you have spoken this harsh verbal karma. Now you must confess this wrongdoing, that this karma of yours may be fully cut off, fully exhausted, and fully done away with. Confess it as a wrongdoing.' And he confessed it as a wrongdoing."

Through the karmic maturation of the deed of habitually applying the expression "old ox" to an arhat monk, he was born in the existence of an ox for five hundred lifetimes. And through the remaining residue of that very karma, he has now been born as a flesh-and-blood ox as he appears today.

The monks then put a question to the Blessed One, the buddha: "Venerable one, what action did the long-lived Ox perform such that, through the karmic maturation of that action, the Blessed One has declared him the foremost among those devoted to remote lodgings?"

The Blessed One declared: "It was through the power of an aspiration. And where was this aspiration made?"

"Under the very scriptural dispensation of the fully and perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa, this one went forth. Having gone forth, he practiced the holy life for one lifetime and yet did not attain even the slightest accumulation of good qualities. Yet it was the very one under whose dispensation he went forth — the Blessed One Kāśyapa — who declared him the foremost among those devoted to remote lodgings. And so he made this aspiration: 'Though I have practiced the holy life for one lifetime under the Blessed One, the fully and perfectly awakened unsurpassable field of offering, Kāśyapa, and have not attained even the slightest accumulation of good qualities — by this root of virtue, may I go forth under the scriptural dispensation of the one whom the Blessed One, the fully and perfectly awakened Kāśyapa, prophesied to the brahmin youth, his preceptor, saying: "Brahmin youth, in the human lifespan of one hundred years, there will arise a Tathāgata, arhat, fully and perfectly awakened buddha named Śākyamuni" — and having gone forth, may I abandon all afflictions and directly actualize arhatship. And just as my preceptor, the Blessed One, the fully and perfectly awakened Kāśyapa, was declared the foremost among those devoted to remote lodgings, so too may I be declared the foremost among those devoted to remote lodgings by Śākyamuni, the king of the Śākyas.' Through the power of that aspiration, he has now been declared by the Tathāgata to be the foremost among those devoted to remote lodgings."

"Therefore, monks, the karmic maturation of actions that are purely dark is purely dark; the maturation of actions that are purely bright is purely bright; and the maturation of mixed actions is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon actions that are purely dark and mixed, and strive for actions that are purely bright. This, monks, is how you should train."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in Prince Jeta's Grove. The group of six monks were saying "Give this here," "Give from this," picking and choosing as they ate, and their food-taking became quarrelsome and contentious. On that occasion the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks must not pick and choose what they eat. If they do so, it will become an offense entailing a formal proceeding."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. When monks were eating, a bowl that was being held fell onto the base of another bowl; a bowl-base that was being held fell into a bowl. Being troubled by this, they refrained from eating, and on that occasion the monks reported this to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, if a bowl that is being held falls onto the surface of a bowl-base, that is to be called a received gift. If a bowl-base that is being held falls into the interior of a bowl, that too is to be called a received gift."

If a bowl that is being held falls into the interior of another bowl, that too is to be called a received gift. If a bowl-base that is being held falls into the interior of another bowl-base, that too is to be called a received gift. Nevertheless, the intention to receive must be present.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The venerable Ānanda went to a metal-smith who worked with tin and said to him: "Good man, can you make a tin bowl?" The smith replied: "Noble one, if you yourself will provide the measurements, I will craft it to whatever size you specify." "Make it large." "Noble one, what do you want with a large tin bowl? Do you think that because you are a mendicant I will make it for nothing? Pay the price for it." The smith thought: "What tin work should I put into this?" and so he made him a large tin bowl. Then the smith said: "Make something else too that will fit inside it." He made another, and in the same way continued until the seventh had been made. Ānanda then had a novice carry them, had a net woven from five-colored thread, placed the bowls inside it, arranged them in order, and sent them off balanced on the novice's head — the novice was to go wherever he was invited as a guest. He arrived and spread them out and sat down. The householders and brahmins said: "Noble one, have you spread out a tin-smith's shop?" He replied: "Poor folk, what do you know? Here, take some flour. Here are oil-provisions. Here are cooked rice grains. From the others, take condiments." They said: "Noble one, if it is so, then in a few of the bowls a great quantity of condiment will

come — other things too must be set out in the others." But he said nothing. On that occasion the monks reported this to the Blessed One. The Blessed One reflected: "Whatever fault has arisen has come about because of monks carrying tin bowls." Therefore a monk must not carry a tin bowl. If he does carry one, it becomes an offense. Excepted are a scraper, a salt-pouch, and an offered drinking cup.

Summary verse: The washing of feet was prohibited; copper foot-scrapers were permitted; likewise a fan and fanning away flies with it.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The place where monks washed their feet repeatedly became filled with insects. When brahmins and householders came to the monastery and saw this, they said: "Noble ones, what is this place that is swarming with buzzing insects?" The monks replied: "We have been washing our feet here." Those people mocked them, saying: "The ascetics (śramaṇas) who are sons of the Śākyas have no sense of cleanliness — they wash their feet again and again in the same spot." On that occasion the monks reported this to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Do not wash the feet repeatedly in the same spot. Rather, designate a foot-washing place at the southeast corner of the residential building." When the Blessed One had declared that a foot-washing place was to be designated, the monks did not know how to make it. The Blessed One declared: "Make it like a tortoise-shell." When they made it very smooth, the Blessed One declared: "Make it rough." When elderly monks who were frail and infirm were unable to go to that place, the Blessed One declared: "Set out a basin for them." When the monks washed in the basin and it broke and became unusable, the Blessed One declared:

"Set out a copper basin." When the Blessed One had declared that a copper basin was to be set out, the group of six monks set out basins made of gold, silver, lapis lazuli, and crystal. When brahmins and householders saw this, they said: "Noble ones, what is this?" The monks replied: "Good sirs, the Blessed One has permitted a basin." The brahmins and householders said: "Noble ones, does your ascetic life not hinder you from indulging in pleasures?" And they replied: "It is crushing your throats with a stone." When those monks were thus mocked, the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Basins made of gold, silver, crystal, and lapis lazuli are not to be set out. Instead, a basin made of clay is to be set out." When they set one out in the shape of a drum, it tipped over, and the Blessed One declared: "Make it in the shape of an elephant's foot, with a raised ornament in the

center like a fine flower." When they made it very smooth, the Blessed One declared: "Make it rough." When the monks set basins down one after another in a disorderly way, the Blessed One declared: "For the Saṅgha's building, set them out under an awning. For individual residences, set them at the back of the door."

The Blessed One was dwelling in the land of Kauśāmbī, in the pleasure grove of Ghositā. When the hot season arrived, the monks suffered from the heat. They became pale and emaciated, and grew thin, wretched, infested with lice, and haggard. When householders and brahmins saw them, they said: "Noble ones, why have you become pale and emaciated, thin, wretched, infested with lice, and haggard?" When the monks explained how things had come to be, those people said: "Noble ones, do you not carry a fan?" The monks replied: "Good sirs, the Blessed One has not permitted it." The people said: "Noble ones, your Teacher is compassionate, so he will grant it." On that occasion the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Very well then, I permit you to carry a fan." When the Blessed One had declared that fans were to be carried, the group of six monks carried fans with handles polished, ornamented, and finely ornamented with gold, silver, crystal, and lapis lazuli. Then, from the point beginning with "brahmins and householders" up through "it is crushing your throats with a stone," the account proceeds as before. When those monks were mocked on that occasion, the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Fans with handles polished or finely polished with gold, silver, lapis lazuli, and crystal are not to be used. Instead, both types of fans — one made of grass roots and one made from palmyra leaves — may be carried." Then, from the point beginning with "faithful brahmins and householders offering the monks fans of various kinds" up to that point, the account proceeds as before, and the Blessed One declared: "Very well then, I permit you to carry fans on behalf of the Saṅgha."

The Blessed One was dwelling at Vaiśālī, in the Gabled Hall by the Monkey Pool. Mosquitoes were biting the monks, and their bodies became covered with welts from the mosquito bites. As they were repeatedly scratching, brahmins and householders said to them: "Noble ones, why are your bodies covered with welts like this?" When the monks explained how things had come to be, those people said: "Noble ones, do you not carry a mosquito-whisk?" The monks replied: "Good sirs, the Blessed One has not permitted it."

"Noble ones, your Teacher is compassionate, so he will permit it." On that occasion the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Very well then, I permit you to carry mosquito-whisks." Once the Blessed One had declared that mosquito-whisks were to be carried, the group of six monks kept whisks with handles made of gold, silver, lapis lazuli, and crystal, and with handles made of tail-hair. As for the brahmins and householders — the rest follows as before. The permitted mosquito-whisks are five in kind: those made of wool, those made of hemp fiber, those made of cotton-wool, those made of cotton cloth, and those made of layered leaves.

The summary verse:

With knotted cloth and body, ladder,
a staff, a net to carry —
shallots were forbidden,
but permitted for the sick.

The Blessed Buddha was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The Blessed One had declared that the monks should sweep. Now at that time, a monk was climbing a ladder, and below him a woodworker was sitting. The woodworker saw the monk's groin and genitals exposed and said: "Noble one, since you are possessed of a man's faculties, I would like to salute you as a male." The monk was embarrassed and sat without speaking. On that occasion the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One reflected: "Whatever slight fault has arisen has come about from monks climbing ladders without having tucked in their robes. Therefore, when a monk sweeps, he should be made to tuck in his robes before sweeping." Reflecting thus, he declared to the monks: "Monks, therefore, when a monk sweeps, he should tuck in his robes before sweeping." Once the Blessed One had declared that a monk doing the sweeping should tuck in his robes, the monks tucked in their robes before sweeping. Those without faith mocked them, saying: "Noble ones, are you about to wrestle?" The monks replied: "Good friends, we are sweeping." Those people fell silent. On that occasion the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Those who are climbing the ladder are the ones who should tuck in their robes — not others."

The Blessed Buddha was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The group of six monks carried loads on their bodies, and brahmins and householders mocked them, saying: "Noble ones, we for our

part bear loads on our backs for the sake of our parents, our children, and our wives — but for whose sake do you carry loads on your bodies?" The monks replied: "Good friends, we too have the making of offerings to the Teacher, the feeding of the Saṅgha, the tending of the sick, and many such duties to perform." Those people fell silent. On that occasion the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, monks must not carry loads on their bodies. If they do, it will constitute an offence."

The Blessed Buddha was dwelling at Rājagṛha, on Vulture Peak Mountain. When monks were climbing up and descending Vulture Peak Mountain, they slipped and fell, striking themselves and becoming injured. On that occasion the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, monks are to carry staffs." Once the Blessed One had declared that monks were to carry staffs, the group of six monks polished staffs made of gold, silver, lapis lazuli, and crystal, and carried ones that were ornamented with elaborate decoration. When brahmins and householders saw this and mocked them, on that occasion the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and —

the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, monks, staffs are to be carried by two categories only — those who are old and frail on account of age, and those who are sick and unable to manage."

Once the Blessed One had declared that staffs were to be carried by those two categories — those who are old and frail on account of age, and those who are sick and unable to bear the exertion — those who counted as elderly and those who counted as sick then also took to carrying staffs. The Blessed One then declared: "Those who are old and those who are sick are to request the vow of the staff from the Saṅgha, and whoever has been granted the vow of the staff by the Saṅgha may carry a staff."

The request is to be made as follows. The seat is to be prepared, the gong struck, and the monks informed by means of the words of inquiry. When the entire Saṅgha has assembled and is gathered, the elderly monk who is old and frail on account of age, or who is sick and unable to bear the exertion, is to sit quietly at the end of the row of elders, press his palms together, and speak these words:

"May the venerable Saṅgha please hear me. I, the monk who am old and frail on account of age, or sick and unable to bear the exertion, called so-and-so, request from the Saṅgha the vow of the staff. May the venerable Saṅgha,

being compassionate, out of compassion grant to me, the monk who am old and frail on account of age, or sick and unable to bear the exertion, called so-and-so, the vow of the staff."

This is to be repeated a second and third time in the same way.

After that, one monk is to make the request and perform the formal act:

"May the venerable Saṅgha please hear me. This monk, who is old and frail on account of age, or sick and unable to bear the exertion, called so-and-so, has requested from the Saṅgha the vow of the staff. If it is the right time for the Saṅgha and the Saṅgha consents, let the Saṅgha grant it. The Saṅgha has granted the vow of the staff to the monk who is old and frail on account of age, or sick and unable to bear the exertion, called so-and-so."

This is the request. The formal act is to be performed as follows:

"May the venerable Saṅgha please hear me. This monk, who is old and frail on account of age, or sick and unable to bear the exertion, called so-and-so, has requested from the Saṅgha the vow of the staff. On that account, if the Saṅgha grants the vow of the staff to the monk who is old and frail on account of age, or sick and unable to bear the exertion, called so-and-so, then those venerable ones who consent to granting the vow of the staff to the monk who is old and frail on account of age, or sick and unable to bear the exertion, called so-and-so, should remain silent; those who do not consent should speak. The Saṅgha has consented and granted, and has given the vow of the staff to the monk who is old and frail on account of age, or sick and unable to bear the exertion, called so-and-so. Since no one has spoken, it is held to be so."

Whoever has been granted the vow of the staff by the Saṅgha may carry a staff, and in this matter there is to be no regret.

The Vinaya of Minor Matters, the sixth fascicle.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Rājagṛha on Vulture Peak Mountain. Elder monks — the elders — and those suffering from wind-illness (a humoral disorder), when climbing and descending Vulture Peak Mountain, slipped and fell, striking themselves and becoming injured. Their water pots, clay vessels, and broad-mouthed pitchers also broke. On that occasion the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, monks are to carry nets." Once the Blessed One had declared that monks were to carry nets —

The group of six monks carried nets made from cords of five different colors, and brahmins and householders, upon seeing this, mocked and derided them. On that occasion the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One must not carry a net made from cords of five different colors; it is to be made from a single color." Once the Blessed One had declared that nets made from a single color were to be carried, elderly and frail monks and those suffering from wind-illness also began carrying nets. The Blessed One then declared: "Even elderly monks and those suffering from wind-illness must request from the Saṅgha the vow pertaining to the net, and whoever has been granted the vow pertaining to the net by the Saṅgha may carry a net."

The request is to be made as follows. A seat is prepared, the wooden sounding board is struck, and the monks are assembled by means of the inquiry formula, so that the entire Saṅgha is convened and seated. The elderly monk — one who is old and frail, or who suffers from wind-illness — sits respectfully at the end of the row of elder monks, joins his palms together, and speaks these words:

"May the venerable Saṅgha please hear me. I, the elderly monk who is old and frail, or who suffers from wind-illness, named so-and-so, request from the Saṅgha the vow pertaining to the net. May the venerable Saṅgha, out of compassion, take me under their compassionate care and grant the vow pertaining to the net to me, the elderly monk who is old and frail, or who suffers from wind-illness, named so-and-so."

This is repeated a second and third time.

After that, a single monk makes the motion and performs the formal act. "May the venerable Saṅgha please hear me. This elderly monk who is old and frail, or who suffers from wind-illness, named so-and-so, requests from the Saṅgha the vow pertaining to the net. If it is the right time for the Saṅgha and they consent, may the Saṅgha approve it, and may the Saṅgha grant the vow pertaining to the net to the elderly monk who is old and frail, or who suffers from wind-illness, named so-and-so. This is the motion."

The formal act then proceeds as follows. "May the venerable Saṅgha please hear me. The elderly monk who is old and frail, or who suffers from wind-illness, named so-and-so, has requested from the Saṅgha the vow pertaining to the net. Therefore, if the Saṅgha grants the vow pertaining to the net to the elderly monk who is old and frail, or who suffers from wind-illness,

named so-and-so, then those venerable ones who consent to granting the vow pertaining to the net to the elderly monk who is old and frail, or who suffers from wind-illness, named so-and-so, should remain silent; those who do not consent should speak."

The Saṅgha having consented and approved, the Saṅgha has granted the vow pertaining to the net to the elderly monk who is old and frail, or who suffers from wind-illness, named so-and-so. It is thus held, by reason of the silence. Whoever has been granted the vow pertaining to the net by the Saṅgha may carry a net, and in this regard there is no ground for regret.

As for certain other monks who needed both a staff and a net, the monks gave them the vow pertaining to the staff and the vow pertaining to the net separately. The Blessed One then declared: "The vow pertaining to the staff and the vow pertaining to the net are to be granted together at the same time, as before."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. A certain monk who was staying at Śrāvastī ate garlic, then went to where the Blessed One was, approached him, and having prostrated at the Blessed One's feet with his head, sat to one side. The Blessed One then spoke to that monk:

"Monk, monk, lend your ear to the teaching of Dharma and listen well." That monk prostrated at the Blessed One's feet with his head and sat to one side. The Blessed One then began to teach him Dharma. Yet the more the Blessed One taught that monk, the more the monk thought, "It would not be right for me to ask the Blessed One a question and trouble him," and so he looked away to one side. A second and a third time the Blessed One said to that monk: "Monk, monk, lend your ear to the teaching of Dharma and listen well." Yet that monk, a second and a third time, looked away in the other direction, then prostrated at the Blessed One's feet with his head and departed from the Blessed One's presence.

Now, since the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, are fully aware yet feign ignorance, the Buddha, the Blessed One, asked the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, why does that monk look away in the other direction no matter how I teach him Dharma?" Ānanda replied: "Reverend One, that monk ate garlic." The Blessed One then said: "Ānanda, monks who eat garlic create an obstruction to the Noble Truths. So it is, Blessed One. Ānanda, if this monk had not eaten garlic today, then today itself he could have shattered the twenty peak-summits of

the mountain of the view of the transitory collection with the vajra of wisdom, and directly realized the fruit of stream-entry. Therefore, from this day forward monks shall not make full use of garlic, or shallots, or chives. If they do make use of them, it shall be a serious offense."

At that time the venerable Śāriputra was gathered in that very assembly and was sitting there. He thought: "If this monk does not see the Noble Truths today, perhaps he will see them tomorrow," and so he entered into a state of mind considering this — yet he did not see it. Śāriputra then examined through the fourth dhyāna of the pinnacle of existence how much time must pass before the monk would see them, and also entered into that state of mind to consider it — yet still he did not see it. The venerable Śāriputra then arose from that meditative absorption and spoke in verse:

Having abandoned this supreme leisure here in this very place,
this one will never in this life ever see
the Noble Truths here — there is a state
from which there is no seeing them again.

The Blessed One then, knowing the venerable Śāriputra's mind through his own mind, said to the venerable Śāriputra: "Śāriputra, do not venture into the domain of a buddha. This is a time beyond the domain of the wisdom of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. At a future time there will arise a Teacher, a Tathāgata, an arhat, a fully and perfectly awakened buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, a knower of the world, an unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, a Teacher of gods and humans, a buddha and Blessed One known as 'One Who Overwhelms All.' Under that one's teaching, this monk will go forth, abandon all afflictions, and directly realize arhatship." Having said this, the Blessed One reflected: "Whatever slight fault has arisen has arisen from the monk's eating of garlic. Therefore monks shall not eat garlic. If they do eat it, it shall be a serious offense."

Having declared that monks shall not eat garlic, a certain monk who was ill went to a physician and, after requesting treatment, said: "Good sir, I have contracted such-and-such an illness — please prescribe medicine for it." The physician said: "Noble one, take garlic and you will recover." The monk replied: "Good sir, the Blessed One has not permitted it." The physician replied: "Noble one, this is your medicine — no other remedy can cure you." At that point the monk spoke to his fellow monks, and the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "If a physician says to you, 'Monk, this

is your medicine — no other remedy can cure you,' then you may eat it, and you need feel no remorse in doing so."

When the Blessed One had declared that an ill monk might eat garlic on a physician's authority, the ill monk, having eaten the garlic, continued to make full use of the monastery — the dwelling places and the bathrooms — and entered there as before. He went among the Saṅgha. He taught the Dharma to brahmins and householders who came to visit. He made prostrations at the stūpa. He went on alms rounds to the homes of brahmins and householders. He sat in gardens, assembly halls, temples, and other public places crowded with people. The brahmins and householders, catching the smell, criticized and reproached him, saying: "The monks, sons of the Śākya, have fallen away from the conduct of wanderers and from the conduct of the pure — now even those who have gone forth eat garlic."

When the monks reported this to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "I shall establish a code of conduct for a monk who eats garlic. A monk who eats garlic must not, while still eating it, make full use of the monastery, nor the dwelling places, nor enter the bathroom area, nor go among the Saṅgha, nor teach the Dharma to brahmins and householders who come to visit, nor make prostrations at the stūpa, nor go on alms rounds to the homes of brahmins and householders, nor remain in gardens, assembly halls, temples, or other public places crowded with people. He shall eat it in some remote direction where, if others see him, no lack of faith will arise. When the task is finished, he shall stay in that same place for seven days. For a sore on the face, three days. For a cold sore, one day. After that he shall bathe, wash his robes as well, and fumigate them with incense. Only then, when the smell is gone, may he enter the monastery and do whatever else was previously permitted."

A monk who eats garlic and properly undertakes the code of conduct thus established — if he does not abide by it, he incurs a serious offense.

Here ends the first section of the minor offenses.

The summary verse is:

With heated water, a razor, an umbrella,
cotton cloth, and ornamental trimmings —
accepting, assembly, bathing,
urine, and moving through a doorway.

The summary verse:

With heated water, a razor, and wrapping cloth,
and likewise giving itself,
a seat and a single grass mat,
residing in a house, and not sharing.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, belonging to Prince Jeta. At the time when the householder Anāthapiṇḍada offered the Jeta Grove to the Saṅgha of the four directions, he sent a barber with the instruction to shave the hair and beards of the noble ones — and what follows is as before up to that point.

Ānanda said: "Good sir, do you know how to shave hair with heated water?" The man replied: "Noble one, that is precisely my trade." Ānanda said: "Good sir, if that is so, come here and shave it." The man shaved with the heated water. Ānanda said: "Shave it again." The man shaved again. Then he said:

"Shave it again." He shaved it again. And so, continuing in this way until the sun set without letting the man go, Ānanda then said: "You poor fellow, you know nothing at all — just do it evenly as it is and be off," and so on, just as before up to that point.

The Blessed One declared: "A monk must not shave with hair-scissors. If a monk shaves with hair-scissors, it becomes an offense." After the Blessed One had declared that a monk must not shave with hair-scissors, some monks sustained wounds on their heads, and when the razor touched them during the course of treating those wounds, the monks reported this to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Around the wound one may shave with hair-scissors, and the remainder is to be shaved with a razor."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. Then the householder Anāthapiṇḍada again sent a barber, and so on, just as before up to that point. Ānanda said: "Good sir, do you know how to shave the hair around the private parts?" The man replied: "Noble one, that is precisely my trade." Ānanda said: "If that is so, come here and shave it." The man said: "Noble one, how shall I shave it?" Ānanda said: "Good sir, shave it neatly." The man began to shave, and Ānanda said: "Good sir, do it like this." The man did so. Then Ānanda said: "Now do it like this as well," and kept the man without letting him go until the sun set. People condemned, sneered, and disparaged them, saying: "The conduct of the ascetics, the sons of the Śākya, is degraded; their brahminical conduct is

degraded — now they even have the hair around their private parts shaved." The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore a monk must not shave the hair of the private parts. If a monk shaves the hair of the private parts, it becomes an offense."

After the Blessed One had declared that a monk must not shave the hair of the private parts, some monks developed wounds in the private area, and those monks, feeling remorse, did not shave the hair. Other monks developed parasites, and because of the harm from these, they were unable to perform virtuous activities. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "A monk may show the affected area to elder monks, and for the sake of a wound or parasites one may shave the hair of the private parts — one need not feel remorse about this."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. Then the householder Anāthapiṇḍada again sent a barber, and so on, just as before up to that point. Ānanda said: "Good sir, do you know how to shave the armpit hair?" The man replied: "Noble one, that is precisely my trade." Ānanda said: "If that is so, come here and shave it." The man said: "Noble one, how shall I shave it?" Ānanda said: "Good sir, shave it neatly." The man began to shave, and Ānanda said: "Good sir, do it like this." The man did so, and Ānanda said: "Now do it like this as well." The man was kept without being let go until nightfall. The householder Anāthapiṇḍada asked him about it, and so on, just as before up to that point. The man reported what had happened, and while people were condemning them, the monks reported this to the Blessed One.

The Blessed One declared: "Therefore, monks must not shave the hair of a layman's body. If a monk does so, it becomes an offense."

The Blessed Buddha was then dwelling at Vaiśālī in the Gabled Hall beside the Monkey Pool. After the Blessed One had declared that monks must not shave the hair of a layman's body, wounds appeared on the thighs of some monks, and other monks were afflicted with insects, so that because of these conditions they were unable to engage in virtuous activity. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "For the sake of a wound, or for the sake of insects, the hair of the body may be shaved. One need feel no remorse regarding this."

The Blessed Buddha was then dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. The Six Group monks were lying together on a single couch,

and lying there they made noise, played, chattered, laughed, jostled one another, and struck each other on the body. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One reflected: "Whatever faults have arisen have come about from monks lying on a single couch together. Therefore I shall not allow a monk to lie on the same couch with another monk." Having thus reflected, he declared to the monks: "Monks, from this day forward a monk must not lie on a single couch together with another monk. If one does so, it becomes an offense."

After the Blessed One had declared that a monk must not lie on a single couch with another monk, a large number of monks went wandering through the countryside and set out on a journey. They went to a certain rocky hillside, and when they arrived there they found couches. They gave up the couches to one another, saying: "These are too few. Bring more as well." The others said: "Noble ones, we have many people sleeping on each single couch of ours. Please take turns on yours, and let two or three sleep on each one." Those monks replied: "If the Blessed One has not permitted two or three to lie on a single couch, how may we do so?" The others said: "Noble ones, there are no other couches here." When they said this, the monks fell silent, unable to speak. The monks then reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Those monks who are conscientious, who feel remorse, and who desire training shall establish mindfulness and, placing a folded robe or the bowl as a divider in the middle of the couch, sleep thereon. One need feel no remorse regarding this. As for a grass mat in place of a couch, and other such things, the same rule applies."

The Blessed Buddha was then dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. A large number of monks went wandering through the countryside and set out on a journey. They went to a certain rocky hillside, and there they received lodging from a householder. The cold season having arrived, they obtained robes. The brahmins and householders, thinking "These are monastics," took pity on them and gave them robes. Each one wore what he had received and slept, while other monks were afflicted by the cold. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One must not keep what each has obtained for oneself alone; rather, all must share together. Whatever single item is found should be spread over all of them in order of seniority, as much as can be covered."

At some point they went to another rocky hillside, and there they found a single robe and spread it over themselves. A close friend among them put it on

and went for a walk. The monks, suffering from the cold, said to him: "Venerable Ānanda, we are suffering from the cold, yet you alone wear it and walk about?" He replied: "Did I forbid you? Why don't you walk as well?" When the monks had passed the night suffering from the cold, they reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Whoever is walking must distribute the robe among the persons present and then walk. If others walk wearing it without sharing, it becomes an offence."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The cold season having arrived, the monks were huddled together, overcome by the affliction of the cold. At one point a householder, the benefactor Anāthapiṇḍada, came to the monastery. Seeing them, he said: "Noble ones, why do you huddle together, abandoning your diligent recitation of scripture and the practice of virtue?" They replied: "Householder, those who are at ease can attend to Dharma, but we are suffering greatly from the cold." He then went home and sent five hundred bolts of fine cloth. The monks divided up these household robes and went outside, and brahmins and householders who saw them exclaimed in surprise: "Noble ones, what has happened to you?" They replied: "We were cold and divided the cloth among ourselves. Venerable sirs, please say nothing of this." When those people began to mock them, the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks must not divide household robes as they are. If such a circumstance arises, one must first cover them with a layer of saffron-coloured robe cloth and then distribute them." The Saṅgha did likewise in wearing them, and then the Blessed One declared: "For the Saṅgha, one must place the cloth underneath and cover it from above and then distribute it. Otherwise it becomes an offence."

The summary verse:

An umbrella, a worldly javelin throw,
joining and stitching, likewise forest fire,
paths without a dwelling-place,
and sharing shares — one does not walk in these.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At Śrāvastī there was a brahmin who dealt in robes, making and selling cloth. On one occasion he came to obtain a great quantity of robes, and he thought: "What means could I use so that I might gain merit and yet also accomplish what I need?" Being a man of

faith, the thought arose in him: he would invite the buddha and the monastic Saṅgha of monks, spread robes as seat-coverings, and offer a midday meal. He reasoned that in this way the robes would be fully used, and by fully using the robes and fully enjoying the meal, he would gain great merit. Thinking thus, he invited the buddha and the monastic Saṅgha of monks to his home for the midday meal, set out pure and excellent food, and placed robes upon the seats. When the meal was arranged and the Blessed One was invited by the invitation, the monastic Saṅgha of monks went, but the Blessed One remained in the monastery and received alms-food. Now, the Blessed Buddhas remain in the monastery and receive alms-food for five reasons. What are those five?

to settle into proper meditation indoors, to teach the Dharma to the gods, to visit the sick, to inspect the lodgings, and to establish a rule of training in the Vinaya for the śrāvakas. In this particular instance, the Blessed One, the buddha, wishing to establish a rule of training in the Vinaya for the śrāvakas, remained in the monastery and received alms-food.

Now, as the monks were walking along the road, rain fell, and their robes became soaked and clung to them as they stood there. Seeing how each monk's robe clung to him in just that way, producing a kind of transparent outlining of the body, the brahmin was disturbed and said: "You have rendered my gifts unfit to be gifts. Take these robes and just share them among yourselves." When this happened, the monks reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, since that brahmin gave them in a state of faithlessness, they must not be accepted." Then, once he had calmed down and again offered the robes with a mind of faith, the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, now that the brahmin has offered them with a mind of faith, they may be accepted. Having accepted them, make them proper and distribute them."

When the monks had accepted them, the brahmin said: "Well done, noble ones — it is worthy of a lineage that wields a canopy!" At that point the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "If that is so, I permit it: monks may carry a canopy."

When the Blessed One had declared that monks might carry a canopy, the group of six monks had canopy shafts made of gold, silver, lapis lazuli (vaiḍūrya), and crystal, and others made of variegated and polished materials, while the canopy itself was made of white cloth and peacock feathers. When brahmins and householders saw this, they said: "Noble ones, what is this? The

Blessed One has permitted a canopy. Noble ones, you ascetics (śramaṇas) — are you afflicted by a craving for the pleasures you desire? Why do you carry canopies like these?" They replied: "We crush the throats of our enemies underfoot and are indeed afflicted by the desire for pleasures." When people were thus insulting them, the monks reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Such canopies as those must not be carried. However, two kinds of canopy may be carried: one made of grass and one made of leaves."

When the Blessed One had declared that two kinds of canopy might be carried, the group of six monks made extremely long canopy shafts, raised those shafts upright, and went into the town. Brahmins and householders, seeing them, rose and looked about wondering: "Is some wealthy man coming, or a merchant chief, or a caravan leader, or who?" Some craned their necks, and when they actually saw who it was, they became faithless. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Canopy shafts must not be made extremely long. Rather, a shaft of just the canopy's own measure may be fitted, and one must not go into a village carrying a canopy."

When the Blessed One had declared that one must not go into a village carrying a canopy, it came to pass that a considerable number of monks were traveling together through the countryside on a shared errand, and their road happened to pass through a village. They thought: "The Blessed One has declared that one must not go into a village carrying a canopy, so we should bypass the village." And so they set the village aside.

Being separated from his companions, he was distressed and overcome. At that point, the monks reported this matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "If the road happens to pass through the middle of a village, one may tilt the canopy to the side and proceed. There is no need to feel regret about this."

Those who were on alms rounds had entered upon their rounds when rain fell and their robes were soaked through with rainwater. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One on alms rounds may fit the canopy shaft to an appropriate length and then set out. Once out, if the rain stops, one must leave the canopy at the first house one comes to, then proceed onward, and later retrieve it and go on one's way."

The awakened Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the park of Prince Jeta.

Now, from the southern lands there came a wandering debater named Bright World-Hurler, who traveled about the countryside and arrived at Śrāvastī. He rested, then went to the venerable Kauṇḍinya and, having arrived, said: "Monk, I possess certain letters received from my teachers, and for that reason I wish to hold a discussion with you." Kauṇḍinya said to him: "Brahmin, I am not one who seeks out discourse. Be on your way."

Then the venerable Aśvajit, Bhadrīka, Vāṣpa, Mahānāman, Bhadrājit, Vimala, and Gavāṃpati went to that place, and each of them said the very same thing.

Next, the venerable Śāriputra went to that place and, having arrived, said: "Monk, I possess certain letters received from my teacher, and for that reason I wish to hold a discussion with you." The venerable Śāriputra reflected: "Does this wanderer have even a little root of virtue, or does he not?" He saw that he did. He then considered: "On whom does this depend?" And he saw that it depended on himself. "By my speaking, is there somewhat of the Dharma-Vinaya that can tame him?" He saw that there was. "In how many days could the assembly gather?" Knowing that it could be convened within seven days, he said: "Very well, let it be so. But where shall the debate take place?" "In a large open space," said the wanderer. Having agreed to the terms of the debate, they established which side would speak first and which second, and who would present the opening position and who would present the opposing view.

The venerable Śāriputra said: "Since you are the one who has come unexpectedly, you yourself should take the first position." The wanderer stated the first position, and the venerable Śāriputra, having listened and repeated it back, declared: "That argument of yours is improper. It is not sound. It does not hold." He leveled these criticisms. The wanderer stated it again, and each time the venerable Śāriputra left it without conceding.

Now that wandering debater from the southern lands named Bright World-Hurler had come to Śrāvastī and entered into debate with the venerable Śāriputra, and when it was announced all around that seven days had now passed, many hundreds of living beings gathered — some out of amazement, and others assembled urged by roots of virtue from former lives. The venerable Śāriputra reflected: "Have those who can be tamed by my speaking gathered?" He saw that they had gathered. Then the venerable Śāriputra

spoke the teaching in full, and that wandering debater was utterly defeated. He then became filled with faith and said: "Venerable Śāriputra, if I may obtain the going forth and the full ordination as a monk in the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, I shall practice the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One."

Then the venerable Śāriputra granted him the going forth and the full ordination, and gave him instruction. Through his striving, effort, and exertion, the rest follows as before, from "knowing this very wheel of saṃsāra in its fifth part, moving and unmoving" down to "he came to speak with reverence."

Then those in the assembly were filled with great amazement, saying: "The noble Śāriputra has defeated such a great debater as this."

Then the venerable Śāriputra, having understood the aspirations, latent tendencies, elements, and natures of those in the assembly, taught the Dharma in accord with them. Many hundreds of thousands of sentient beings, upon hearing it, attained a great and distinguished realization — as follows: some directly realized the fruit of stream-entry; some the fruit of once-returning; some the fruit of non-returning — and so the passage continues as before, down to "they inclined toward the Saṅgha."

At that point the monks reported this to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, in all cases no one will become like the monk Śāriputra, or even comparable to him. Therefore, permit it — monks may study the treatises of outsiders such as worldly logic and debate. The Blessed One has declared that monks may study the treatises of outsiders such as worldly logic and debate." When the Blessed One had declared this, even monks who were childish, confused, or unclear all studied without distinction. The Blessed One then declared: "Those who are able to defeat the arguments of opponents may study the treatises of outsiders such as worldly logic and debate — but not those who are childish, confused, unclear, or unskilled." Those among them who were capable then applied themselves with diligence. The Blessed One declared: "Divide the day into three parts. In two of the three, read the scriptural words of the Buddha; in the third, study the treatises of outsiders." When the Blessed One had declared "divide it into three parts," the monks then studied by the measure of years and months. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, since life is but a moment, it was not with years and months in mind that I spoke — rather, divide a single day into three parts." The monks then recited the treatises of outsiders during the bright period, and during the other

periods recited the scriptural words of the Buddha. The Blessed One declared: "During the bright period, recite the scriptural words of the Buddha — not the treatises of outsiders."

The Blessed One, the buddha Śākyamuni, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in Prince Jeta's Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The venerable Śāriputra had given the going forth to two brahmin youths, Devadatta and Vālendriya, and had set them to reciting sūtras. At some point, they went wandering through the countryside, made their way to a certain rocky cliff, and there great offerings and great honor came to them, and the two settled there. Through the force of their former habituation, they composed the scriptural words of the Buddha with metrical arrangement, words, and order, and recited them as a chant. One of the two died. The other forgot the text, and since no offerings came from his recitation, he wandered from place to place and eventually returned to Śrāvastī. Having rested and recovered, he went to where the venerable Kauṇḍinya of complete knowledge resided, paid homage, and said:

He asked the venerable elder, "Please lend me the recitation."

The elder said, "Good, my son — learn the recitation just so," and began to chant together with him. After reciting a short portion he said, "Elder, you have made an error by not reciting at length."

The monk replied, "My son, I have learned it just as it is."

The young monk prostrated with his head at the elder's feet, then went to where the venerables Aśva, Bhadra, Revatī, Mahānāman, Yaśas, Pūrṇa, Vimala, Gavāmpati, and the noble Hastaka were staying. He arrived, prostrated at their feet, and said, "Elder, please lend me the recitation."

Each one replied, "Good, my son — learn the recitation just so," and each in turn began to chant together with him. After each had recited a short portion he said, "Elder, you have made an error in your recitation."

Each replied, "My son, I have learned it just as it is."

He prostrated at each one's feet, then made his way to where the venerable Śāriputra was staying. He arrived, prostrated at the venerable Śāriputra's feet, and addressed him thus: "Preceptor, please lend me the recitation."

He replied, "Good, my son — learn the recitation just so." They began to chant together, and as they recited at length, the venerable Śāriputra also recited at length. Then the young monk said, "Preceptor — all those monks made errors, but you alone recited without fault."

The venerable Śāriputra replied, "You foolish one — you yourself recited incorrectly; the monks recited without fault." Having said this to him, he fell silent and said nothing more.

At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One reflected: whatever slight fault has arisen here has come about because of monks reciting the scriptures of the Buddha with metrical arrangement, words, and set order. Therefore monks shall not recite the scriptures of the Buddha with metrical arrangement, words, and set order. If a monk recites the scriptures of the Buddha with metrical arrangement, words, and set order, it becomes a serious offence. If the established words are those of the region, the established words of the language, or the established words of the district, there is no transgression.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was residing in Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The Group of Six, even in their old age, continued to behave recklessly and with levity. The monks said, "Venerable ones, even with your grey hair you still will not let go of this levity?" Without a word they drew together to one side and said, "Ānanda and Upānanda — these black-bowled, rope-belted paupers should be made unwelcome." While they were thus busying themselves looking for an opportunity, the elder monks and the senior monks went off to the monastery quarters and commenced their meditation and recitation.

Then the Group of Six set fire to the forest from three sides and gathered together on one side. As the monks came to harm from the forest fire, they began to flee as far as their legs would carry them. The Group of Six called out, "Elders, why are you hurrying away like that? Venerable ones, can you not see the forest fire?" And they engaged them in a bit of conversation, saying, "Elders, did the Blessed One teach the Vinaya only for pleasant conditions?"

Thereupon the others said, "Venerable ones, surely you did not deliberately harm us? You wretches — you told us to make ourselves unwelcome!" When the monks reported this to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "Monks shall not set fire to a forest. If one does so, it becomes a grave offence."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At Śrāvastī an elder monk and a junior monk were traveling together on a journey. The elder had many vessels and many possessions, while the junior was unknown and had nothing beyond his three robes. The elder said, "Venerable one, I am tired — please carry my

robe bundle for a while and come along." The junior replied, "Elder, if it would not be an imposition, may I make a small request for a moment? Venerable one, please scold me on this point. Elder, do you not see the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha? What use is this foolish load of possessions? Good sir, if disrespect is acceptable for a moment, I would ask you this: are you my preceptor or my teacher? For what reason do you guide me?" The elder said nothing, and the elder thought to himself, "I should make this poor fellow unwelcome."

When the two of them arrived at the monastery, there was a rule in place that one was not to spend even a single night there without arranging lodging in advance. The one in charge of lodging told them to look for sleeping places, and the elder accepted one. The junior said, "Venerable one, since I have not arranged lodging, I request lodging," and he went to the elder of the Saṅgha, bowed at his feet, and said, "Elder, please provide me with lodging." The elder asked, "Good sir, with whom did you come?" "Elder, with a certain senior monk." "Good sir, that senior elder of the Saṅgha said that he has dismissed me from his company — go back to him and request lodging from that very one." So the junior went to the others, but they all refused him in the same way. And so it was that when morning came, he went to that elder's own door and knocked, saying, "Elder, homage to you. I am he who is called such-and-such a name. May you be free of illness. Elder, since there is a rule established that one may not stay here even a single night in this monastery, please provide me with lodging." The good man replied, "It is well that the Saṅgha has established such a rule. Had they not done so, I would have had a plan: I have many vessels and many possessions, and am I not the elder? Even if you have shown disrespect, it is proper that you stay, and one who offers lodging — you should pay him your respects." The junior was left speechless and said nothing.

When his lodging had thus been cut off, the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One shall not travel on a journey without arranging lodging. A monk shall not be fierce like a lion. And the Saṅgha shall not establish rules that would harm the monks. For if a monk travels without having arranged lodging, or acts fierce like a lion, or the Saṅgha establishes such a rule, all of it becomes an offense."

The Blessed One, accompanied by his attendant the venerable Nāgapāla, traveled through the country of Magadha and arrived at the city of Śāketa, where he took up residence at Śāketa in the dwelling of the yakṣa Bakula.

Then one night toward dawn, while it was dark and drops of rain were falling here and there and lightning was flashing, the Blessed One was walking on a walking path that had no roof over it. By the nature of things, attendant monks of Blessed Buddhas do not enter inside to settle down for as long as the Blessed Buddhas themselves are not inside and properly settled. The awareness and perception of Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, extends downward, and so he thought to himself —

The Blessed One, the buddha, was residing at Śāketa, in the dwelling of the yakṣa Bakula on the hill of Śāketa. One night toward dawn, while it was dark and drops of rain were falling here and there and lightning was flashing, he was walking on a walking path that had no roof over it. Venerable Nāgapāla, perceiving that he himself ought to go to the Blessed One there, manifested a fragrant chamber made of lapis lazuli, went to where the Blessed One was, and sat walking behind the Blessed One's feet as he walked on his walking path. At that time, the people of the land of Magadha would frighten crying boys and girls by invoking the name of the yakṣa Bakula. Then Venerable Nāgapāla thought to himself: "Alas, the Blessed One has been walking for so long on a walking path with no roof over it — he must have been frightened by the yakṣa Bakula into doing so." Realizing this, he reversed his robe and, having wrapped it differently, sat at the side of the walking path, and addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Bakula, Bakula! Ascetic, I am the yakṣa Bakula." Thereupon the Blessed One said to Venerable Nāgapāla: "You foolish man — can you really think to frighten a Tathāgata with the yakṣa Bakula? Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas are free from fright and shame. There is nothing by which a Tathāgata could be made to flinch, shrink, or have the hair of his body stand on end." At that, Śakra, lord of the gods, became displeased, and addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Venerable one, can there really exist a person of this kind in this Dharma-Vinaya?" The Blessed One replied: "Kauśika, stay where you are. The Gautama lineage is vast — this one too will in time become one who possesses the fully purified Dharma." The Blessed One then reflected and, knowing that whatever fault had arisen had come about for the monks through the reversing and rewrapping of the robe, he addressed the monks: "Monks, the foolish Nāgapāla reversed and rewrapped his robe and said to the Tathāgata: 'Bakula, Bakula! Ascetic, I am the yakṣa Bakula.' Therefore, monks must not reverse and rewrap the robe. If one wears it so, it incurs a serious offense." The Blessed One declared: "Monks must not reverse and rewrap the robe. If

one wears it so, it incurs a serious offense." And when he had so declared, the monks who were staying at Valgu came upon some reversed-robe wrappings there, and lice got into them. In the situation where the monks fell ill from eating lice, the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One may sit with the robe reversed and rewrapped, and one may lie down in it; but one must not tear it apart."

Summary verse:

A strip of wool cloth, and a robe,
and likewise the finest of robes,
a buckle-eye, a buckle-support, a knot,
and waistbands — these make three.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. Then the Blessed One addressed the monks: "Monks, if a wool-strip garment has been completed, it is permitted both for the Saṅgha and for an individual." The Blessed One, the buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, as before, and declared: "If a robe has been completed, it is permitted both for the Saṅgha and for an individual." The Blessed One, the buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, as before, and declared: "If a finest robe has been completed, it is permitted both for the Saṅgha and for an individual."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. Now at that time there was a monk in Śrāvastī who was an alms-round practitioner. One morning he put on his lower robe and his outer robe, took up his bowl, and entered Śrāvastī to go on alms round. As he was walking about on alms round, his outer robe became loose. He quickly set his bowl down on the ground, adjusted it, and tucked it back in. The brahmins and householders who saw this mocked him, saying: "The monks, sons of the Śākya, have no sense of decorum — they set their bowls down just anywhere." When the monks reported this to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "A monk must not set his bowl down just anywhere. If a monk sets his bowl down just anywhere, it becomes an offense. However, in order to protect the outer robe, a robe-loop should be attached." The monks attached one, but the robe then wore out. The Blessed One declared: "Run the strap through the loop and hang it from the shoulder." The monks ran the strap through and attached it, but because there was no robe-knot it would not stay

fixed and became a source of fault. The Blessed One declared: "A knot should be made."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. Now at that time there was a monk in Śrāvastī who was an alms-round practitioner. One morning he put on his lower robe and outer robe, took up his bowl, and entered Śrāvastī to go on alms round. As he was walking about on alms round, his lower robe came unwrapped. He quickly set his bowl down on the ground and readjusted it. The brahmins and householders who saw this — and what followed — is as stated before. The Blessed One declared: "In order to protect the outer robe, three kinds of belt should be worn: a plain sash, a cord sash, and one with a stick-fastener."

This is the Vinaya: Minor Bases, the Seventh Fascicle.

Summary verse:

The Teacher was dwelling at the Śākya seat;
ornamental trim and dangling fringe,
crescent shapes and gold thread —
all variegated patterns were prohibited.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was residing at the Nyagrodha Grove pleasure garden in the Śākya seat. At that time, the household steward of the great man Śākya passed away, and a group of people dwelling in the rocky hills went to the great man Śākya and said: "Lord, your household steward has died — please appoint another steward." Now there was a brahmin youth sitting near him, and the great man Śākya said to him: "Brahmin youth, go for now; when another steward has been sent, I will let you know." That youth went and, having administered affairs properly and in accordance with custom, he offered a great abundance of tribute and extra gifts. The great man Śākya then said: "Brahmin youth, in gathering this tribute and these extra gifts in such abundance, you surely did not harm the people?" The youth replied: "Lord, this tribute and these extra gifts were obtained by legitimate means; I did no harm to the people." The great man Śākya then said to the group of people dwelling in the rocky hills: "Good people, surely this brahmin youth did no harm to any of you? The tribute and extra gifts were obtained by legitimate means — he harmed no one." And so he installed that youth as steward of the rocky hills region. Now, since the world desires prosperity and is averse to hardship, another brahmin gave his daughter to him in marriage, and that man, together with her, began to track the days, the lunar dates, and —

the seasons — and after a short while he took her as his wife. Together with her he played, rejoiced, and made merry. From their playing, rejoicing, and merrymaking, a baby boy was born. When the boy was born, they held a great birth-celebration and gave him a name befitting his lineage. Again, from their playing, rejoicing, and merrymaking, a baby girl was born. For her birth-celebration too they made great festivities and gave her the name Candravatī. They raised and nurtured her until she grew up, and she became so accomplished, well-mannered, graceful in her gait and bearing, that she was pleasing to all the people dwelling in the rocky hills.

Then, some time later, that brahmin youth fell ill. Though he was treated with medicines of roots, trunks, leaves, flowers, and fruits, the illness did not subside. The steward of the rocky hills spent everything that had been paid to him as tribute and given as extra gifts, and he took out further loans — yet he did not recover, and he died there on the spot. The people dwelling in the rocky hills came to that great man Śākya and said: "Sir, the steward has passed away." He said to them: "Wise ones, was there tribute and extra gifts paid to him?" "Sir, a great deal was paid to him, but he spent it all on remedies for his illness, and when he still did not recover, he also took on other debts." "Whatever small remainder there may be, let the son pay off that debt." "Sir, there is nothing at all remaining; as for his household, there is his wife, his son, and his daughter, and his daughter is accomplished, well-mannered, and graceful in her gait and bearing, so that she is pleasing to all the people dwelling in the rocky hills."

The great man said: "Wise ones, let his wife and son go wherever they please, and bring that daughter here." And so they released his wife and son to go wherever they pleased, and brought the daughter to the great man's residence. Now, there was an elderly wife of the great man Śākya whose two tasks were preparing food and gathering flowers, and she said: "Master, I am very old now and can no longer manage these two tasks. Please appoint this Candravatī as my companion in service." And so he appointed her as her companion. The old woman said to her: "Candravatī, you go to the pleasure grove and gather flowers. I will prepare the food." Candravatī went to the pleasure grove, gathered flowers, wove them carefully into a garland, and went to the great man's residence. When he saw her, he was delighted and said: "Excellent! Set it down." Then he said this to the elderly wife: "Why were there few flowers before, yet so many today?" She replied: "Before, when your kinsmen came and asked me for some, I gave them to those people; this one

gives to no one. But I am old and my eyes are dim, whereas she has sharp eyes and is skilled at gathering." He said: "If that is so, let her stay in that pleasure grove and live there." So he had her established there in that very pleasure grove, and because she was always weaving fine garlands of flowers, she became known as Mālyavatī, "the Garlanded One."

On another occasion, she had taken her meal from the house and gone to the pleasure grove, and the Blessed One was also going on his alms round. She saw the Blessed One and found she could not look her fill at him; filled with great ease and profound joy, she contemplated and thought: "It is certain that because I did not serve such a truly worthy recipient of offerings, I have come to be in such a condition as this. Therefore, if only the Blessed One would accept alms from me —"

"I shall offer alms to the Blessed One," she thought. And at such a moment, the awakened buddhas, the Blessed Ones, know nothing that is unknown to them, see nothing that is unseen by them, are aware of nothing that is unrecognized by them, and have nothing whatsoever of which they are unaware. Thus, beginning from "because the awakened buddhas, the Blessed Ones, by the very nature of reality..." down to "ripens as a fruit for embodied beings," all of that is as before.

Then the Blessed One, in order to take her under his care, held out his alms bowl and declared: "Sister, if you have anything to give, place it in this bowl." With very great faith she offered her alms to the Blessed One, prostrated at his two feet, and made this aspiration prayer: "By this root of virtue, may I never again become a slave or one who is poor."

Now it happened that a brahmin astrologer who was a friend of her father saw her and said: "Girl, where have you come from?" "From that very cliff," she replied. "Whose household are you staying with?" He said: "You are dwelling in a place of little fortune — you have been made a slave of the householder Mingchen." "Where did your father go?" "He died." "And where did your mother and brothers go?" "I do not know where they have gone." He said: "Mālyavatī, you are not fit to be a slave. Stretch out your hand and let me look." She stretched out her hand, and he looked, and then he spoke this verse:

She upon whose palms
the mark of the iron wheel is found —
though born into the lineage of slaves,

she shall be taken as a queen's consort.

She whose face is full and bright,
with the bearing of the lord of swans —
though born into the lineage of slaves,
she shall be taken as a queen's consort.

She upon whose soles
the marks of a city's gate and a horse's descent are found —
though born into the lineage of slaves,
she shall be taken as a queen's consort.

"Do not be downcast — go on your way. You will not remain a slave; you will become a queen."

From there she went to a pleasure grove. Prasenjit, the king of the realm of Kosala, had gone out in pursuit of game, and his horse had bolted, carrying him off alone to a place among the yellow-robe wearers. Wandering here and there, he arrived at the pleasure garden of the householder Mingchen. He asked the girl: "Whose pleasure garden is this?" She replied: "It belongs to the householder Mingchen, a divine patron." He dismounted from his horse and said: "Girl, bring water so I may wash my feet." She went very swiftly to the pond and fetched water that had been warmed by the rays of the sun. He washed his feet and sat for a short while, then said: "Girl, bring water so I may wash my face." She skimmed the surface of the water with her hand, took water that was neither too warm nor too cold, and with it he washed his face. He said again: "Girl, I am thirsty — bring water to drink." She stirred the water and took it in a vessel made of cool leaves, and the king drank it and said: "Girl, are there three ponds in this pleasure garden? You have brought water of three kinds." She replied: "Divine patron, there is only one pond here; there are not three." He said: "Then how did you bring water of three different kinds?" She explained what she had done, and the king said: "Very well, I should ask you about this: why did you bring water of three different kinds?" She replied: "Divine patron, the first time I sought warm water: it was in order to bathe your royal feet and ease them. The second time I sought water that was neither too warm nor too cold: it was because both heat and cold are harmful to the eyes. Having stirred the water and sought what was very cool, I brought it in order to free you, divine patron, from thirst." He thought to himself: "This girl is clever," and recognizing this, he said: "Girl, you are

capable and skillful. Since I need my feet massaged, rest here a while."

She massaged his feet, and because his body was endowed with a pleasing tactile quality, the moment she touched them he fell asleep. When he had fallen asleep, she thought to herself: "This king has many enemies. If while he is sleeping someone were to harm him, it would certainly bring disgrace upon my master." And so she barred the door and sat keeping watch.

After some time, word passed from one to another, and the four-limbed host of the army arrived at that pleasure grove and called out for the door to be opened. She did not open it. The king was awakened by the noise of the commotion and said: "Girl, what is that?" She replied: "Divine patron, some people are calling out asking that the door be opened, and they have named your title as well." He said: "Girl, who barred this door?" "Divine patron, I barred it." "Why did you bar it?" "Divine patron, it occurred to me: this king has many enemies, and if while he lay sleeping someone were to harm him, it would certainly bring disgrace upon my master. For that reason I barred the door." He said: "Wise girl, I wish to ask you about this matter I am uncertain of. First, tell me — what is your relationship to the great Śākya clan chief?"

She replied: "I am a maidservant sent in service by him." He said: "You are not a maidservant sent in service by him. You are surely his own daughter. Speak truthfully." She remained silent and said nothing. The king then said: "Girl, go to the great Śākya chief's quarters and say to him: 'King Prasenajit, the king of Kośala, is staying in your pleasure grove.'"

She went quickly, and said: "Lord, the king of Kośala, King Prasenajit, is staying in your pleasure grove." When the great Śākya chief heard this, he had food and drink and perfumes and garlands prepared, and surrounded by a great number of people he went to the pleasure grove. There they exchanged the pleasantries of greeting with words of "Welcome," making one another fully glad. Then the king bathed and ate, they conversed, and after sitting together for a little while, he said: "Great Śākya chief, what is this girl's relation to you?" "Divine patron, she is a maidservant sent in service by me." "She is not a maidservant sent in service by you. She is your own daughter. Give her to me." He replied: "Divine patron, there are other Śākya daughters more distinguished than she. Please take one of those. Why would you want her?" The king said: "It is this very one I need. Give her to me." He replied: "Divine patron, if that is truly so, I will present her to you in the proper manner." "Then do so."

The great Śākya chief then had the city adorned, and having decked the girl with every ornament, he set her upon an elephant and had a proclamation announced at the main roads, the market streets, the crossroads, and the intersections, where the citizens of the city had gathered and crowds of people had come from various regions — calling out: "Know all who have understanding: the daughter of the great Śākya chief, the garland-wearing Phreng-Idan-ma, has been presented as chief queen to King Prasenajit of Kośala." And thus the general populace came to know that she had been presented as chief queen to King Prasenajit of Kośala.

Then King Prasenajit of Kośala took her with great splendor and magnificence and led her to Śrāvastī. When her father heard that "my son has taken a maidservant as his junior wife," jealousy arose in him and he thought: "Either she is truly not that man's daughter, or else I have been deceived into thinking so, and it has turned out that she was born of a slave-woman's union."

He brooded over this, keeping it within himself. Then the king spoke to Phreng-Idan-ma: "Phreng-Idan-ma, go and bow at the feet of the maidservant." She went and took hold of that woman's two feet. Now, that woman possessed a most exquisite touch, and from the mere contact of Phreng-Idan-ma's hands she stirred in her sleep and awoke, thinking: "From such a touch as this, belonging to the daughter of a woman who eats grain, the lineage of Kośala will flourish and grow great."

At that time King Prasenajit of Kośala had two chief queens: Gyal-rik Yar-tsul-ma, of royal lineage, and Phreng-Idan-ma. Whenever the king was together with Phreng-Idan-ma, she would praise Gyal-rik Yar-tsul-ma, saying, "Such a one as she is truly beautiful." And Yar-tsul-ma would say, "O lord, when shall I be able to see her?" The king replied, "Wait but a little while; it will not be long before you see her." And so she remained, full of longing. Likewise, whenever the king was together with Gyal-rik Yar-tsul-ma, she too would praise Phreng-Idan-ma, saying, "Phreng-Idan-ma also possesses such an exquisite touch." And Yar-tsul-ma would say, "O lord, when shall I be able to see her?" The king replied, "Wait but a little while; it will not be long before you see her." Thus, the more the king stirred their wonder, the more each of them grew eager to meet the other.

Then, some time later, the season of spring arrived. The trees in the groves burst into bloom, and in those garden parks filled with the calls of geese, cranes, peacocks, parrots, red-legged partridges, cuckoos, and

shang-shang-teu birds, the king set out surrounded by his retinue of queens. Since women delight in flowers and fruit, they began to wander through those various garden parks. Gyal-rik Yar-tsul-ma grew tired and weary, and leaned against an aśoka tree to rest there. Then Phreng-Idan-ma caught sight of her. Seeing how beautiful she was, Phreng-Idan-ma took her for a tree goddess and immediately bowed at her feet. The very moment Phreng-Idan-ma's hand touched her, she fell asleep.

Then, when the king began praising Phreng-Idan-ma to Yar-tsul-ma, Yar-tsul-ma said, "O lord, when shall I be able to see her?" The king replied, "You have already seen her." "O lord, I do not remember." "I shall remind you. Well then — do you remember the one who took hold of your feet with both hands?" "O lord, was that the goddess Phreng-Idan-ma?" "It was." "O lord, for you to have left behind a queen possessed of such exquisite touch and to have come to me — truly you love me and hold me dear."

Likewise, when the king began praising Yar-tsul-ma to Phreng-Idan-ma, she said, "O lord, when shall I be able to see her?" The king replied, "You have already seen her." "O lord, I do not remember." "I shall remind you. Do you remember the one before whom you bowed as she leaned against the aśoka tree?" "O lord, was that Yar-tsul-ma?" "It was." "O lord, for you to have left behind a queen of such beauty and to have come to me — truly you love me and hold me dear."

At that time King Prasenajit of Kośala had those two chief queens, Gyal-rik Yar-tsul-ma and Phreng-Idan-ma. Of these two, one was proclaimed the supreme among those possessed of beauty of form, and the other was proclaimed the supreme among those possessed of exquisite touch, and this report spread in all directions. The monks were seized by doubt, and they put their doubt before the Blessed One, the Buddha, the dispeller of all doubts:

"What was it that Phreng-Idan-ma and Yar-tsul-ma had done, such that through the karmic maturation of those deeds one became supreme among those possessed of exquisite touch, and the other became supreme among those possessed of beauty of form?"

The Blessed One declared: "O monks, it is they themselves who accumulated the collections of karma, who thoroughly transformed the conditions, who performed and gathered deeds that will inevitably arise, abiding like a flame. Could anyone other than themselves experience individually what they themselves have done and accumulated? O monks, karma that has been

performed and accumulated does not ripen in the element of earth, nor in the element of water, nor in the element of fire, nor in the element of wind. Yet wholesome and unwholesome karma that has been performed and accumulated does ripen in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

Even across a hundred aeons,
karma does not perish.

When conditions are assembled and the time arrives,
it ripens as fruit for embodied beings.

O monks, in a time long past, in a bygone age, there was a brahmin who dwelt upon a rocky mountain. He took a wife of equal birth, and together with her he played and rejoiced and took his pleasure. Through their play and rejoicing and pleasure, a son was born. Again they played and rejoiced and took their pleasure, and from that a daughter was born. They raised and nurtured them, and they grew up. After some time, that brahmin died together with his wife, and that brahmin's son, separated from his parents, came to delight in solitude. He took his sister and went to dwell in a forest hermitage, and there the two of them began to live on roots, trunks, flowers, and fruits."

The Blessed One declared: "O monks, a black serpent has five faults. What are the five? It is wrathful, it bears grudges, it is venomous, it does not requite what is done for it, and its poison is sharp. In the same way, certain women also have five faults. What are the five? They are wrathful, they bear grudges, they are venomous, they do not requite what is done for them, and their poison is sharp. O monks, this is what is meant by the sharp poison of women: women are for the most part possessed of excessive attachment and desire.

Now the sister of that brahmin's son was tormented by afflictions, and she said: 'Brother, I cannot bear the hardship of living in this hermitage on roots, trunks, flowers, and fruits. I am going out to the edge of the village.' He took her and went to the edge of the village, and there she entered a brahmin household to beg. As she begged alongside her sister-in-law, calling out together, a brahmin heard them, came out, and said: 'Do wandering ascetics also travel with their wives?' She replied: 'This is not my husband's wife — she is my sister. I have given her to no one and have not given her away to anyone.' The brahmin said: 'If that is so, why will you not give her to me?' She answered: 'It is because she has renounced that ignoble, sinful dharma.' But tormented by the desire of craving, she said: 'Brother, do you think there is no

hardship in living in the hermitage on roots, trunks, leaves, flowers, and fruits? It was in order that you might abandon afflictions without hardship that I spoke to you thus. Please give her to this brahmin.' He replied: 'That would be contrary to the Dharma, and so I will not give her to you — it is for you yourself to know your own mind.' When that brahmin came to understand her and her intentions, he took her as his bride with great and abundant wealth and brought her into his own home. Then her brother said to him:"

"Brother, come here — please vow to remain together with her as her head of household." He replied: "Sister, I have no interest in seeking sensual pleasures. If you permit me, I shall go forth into renunciation." She said: "Make a promise: if you come to visit me from time to time, I give you my permission." He replied: "Excellent — so be it." Having received her permission, he went forth into renunciation among the sages. Because he had already generated roots of virtue, without a teacher he directly realized the thirty-seven factors conducive to awakening and actualized solitary awakening face to face. Then he thought: "I promised my sister that I would come to her — therefore I must go to her." And so he went to her.

Upon arriving, he began to perform miracles: blazing fire, brilliant light, falling rain, and flashing lightning. Ordinary people are swift to gain faith in miraculous powers, and so she fell at his feet like a tree cut at its roots and said: "Brother, have you attained such an extraordinary distinction of qualities?" "I have." "If that is so, then you are one who seeks alms; I too am one who seeks merit — therefore please remain right here, and I will offer you alms." He replied: "Sister, you are dependent on another. Ask your husband." She said: "Very well, so be it." And she said to her husband: "My lord's son — my brother who has gone forth into renunciation has become a great being accomplished in ascetic practice. If you permit it, I wish to invite him for alms for three months." He replied: "Good woman, if he had not gone forth and we had had to support him against our will — well, he has now gone forth and become a great being accomplished in ascetic practice, so what need is there even to speak of it? Go and invite him." So she invited him for alms for three months.

Now that brahmin had another wife, a second one. She thought: "We share property in common, and if she is making merit in this way, why should I not do the same?" And she said to her: "Co-wife, your brother is also my brother-in-law in precisely the same way, so please offer one bowl of food to him, and I will also offer one bowl of food." She replied: "Excellent — so be it."

The sister of the pratyekabuddha, in order to protect his mind, wrapped fine and abundant food of excellent texture in inferior food and presented it to him, saying: "Co-wife, rejoice! I offer my brother-in-law food of this kind." The other replied: "Excellent!" and rejoiced. Then she too, likewise in order to protect his mind, wrapped fine food of excellent color in inferior food and presented it to him, saying: "Co-wife, you rejoice as well — I too offer our brother-in-law food that is fine and of excellent color, just like this."

Monks, what do you think? The one who was the sister of the pratyekabuddha — she who offered him excellent food of fine texture wrapped in inferior food — that very one is the goddess Mālyā. Through the karmic maturation of that deed she performed, that of offering him excellent food of fine texture wrapped in inferior food, for five hundred lifetimes she was endowed with excellent texture, and throughout that time she became supreme among those endowed with excellent texture. The other one — she who offered the pratyekabuddha excellent food of fine color wrapped in inferior food — that very one is the noble lady Āyuśmāna of royal lineage.

Through the karmic maturation of that deed — she who offered the pratyekabuddha excellent food of fine color wrapped in inferior food — for five hundred lifetimes she was endowed with good form, and throughout that time she became supreme among those endowed with good form.

O monks, it is thus: the karmic maturation of deeds that are purely dark is purely dark — and so on, as before, down to: O monks, train yourselves in this way.

At another time, the goddess Mālyā conceived a child. On the very same day that she conceived, the wife of a brahmin who was her neighbor also conceived. From the very day she conceived, she was afflicted by suffering. When nine months had passed, the goddess Mālyā gave birth to a boy who was handsome, pleasing to behold, and beautiful. A great birth-celebration was held for this newborn, and when the time came to give the boy his name, the king said: "Go and present him to his grandmother; she shall give him his name."

The ministers took the child and went to her presence and said: "O goddess, the king requests that you bestow a name upon the young one."

She replied: "O wise ones, did I not say from the very beginning that this daughter of Zunmā would cause the lineage of Kosala to flourish?"

The ministers said: "Indeed so. And since from the very moment of his birth the goddess was calling him 'noble-born,' we therefore give the young one the name Āryajāta." And so his name was fixed as Āryajāta.

On the very same day that the young Āryajāta was born, the son of the brahmin's wife was also born. When their kinsmen had come and assembled, and after seven times three — twenty-one days — a great birth-celebration was held, and when the time came to give the boy his name, some among them said: "On the very day this one entered his mother's womb, his mother was afflicted by suffering, and after his birth she has known only suffering; therefore the boy's name shall be 'Affliction to His Mother.'" And so his name was fixed as Mātṛdatta.

The young Āryajāta was entrusted to eight nurses: two who suckled him with milk, two who held him in their arms and kept him alive, two who bathed away his impurities, and two who played with him. Those eight nurses raised and nourished him — with milk, curds, butter, melted butter, and the essence of butter, along with other principal and excellent requisites — like a lotus dwelling in a pond.

When he had grown to maturity, he studied the written arts, and having mastered writing, he became proficient in these eight branches of examination: the examination of precious gems, the examination of wood, the examination of land, the examination of cloth, the examination of elephants, the examination of horses, the examination of women, and the examination of men. He became expert in analysis and in reading, his conduct was clear, and he was skilled in the ways of every aspect. He was then anointed by the king from the crest of the head, after the manner of royal consecration, as lord of the realm, possessing might and diligence, having brought the great earth-circle under his sway. The crafts and vocational arts practiced by those who dwell there are as follows: riding atop elephants, riding horses, the methods of chariot-driving, the methods of the sword, drawing the bow, shooting forward, shooting backward, the method of guiding with an iron hook, casting the lasso, the method of discharging a ballista, modes of gripping, modes of stance, the topknot, striking at range, striking so that a sound rings out, striking at a vital point, striking without missing, striking with great force, cutting, wounding, and —

— the five techniques of cutting: in all these he became skilled. Although the boy suffered harm, he was entrusted to the eight mothers — and from that

point, as stated before, down through "like a lotus dwelling in a pond," it is as in the preceding passage.

Now, at such time as he had grown to maturity, he was trained in letters and became skilled in the Brahmin view, the Brahmin conduct, the Brahmin rules of behavior, the Brahmin standards of purity, the Brahmin modes of deportment, the grasping of balls of food, the taking up of earth, the taking up of ash, the sacred syllable Om, the sacred syllable Bho, the Veda of formal proclamation, the Veda of burnt offering, the Veda of poetry, the Veda of statecraft and protection, the making of the sage Gārgya, the making of Māthara, the examination of earthquakes, the examination of the atmosphere, and the six terminal duties of Brahmin work: performing burnt offerings, causing others to perform burnt offerings, reciting, causing others to recite, giving, and receiving.

Then at a certain later time, the noble young man and his mother went out together to drive away deer in the mountains. A dog gave chase and ran off with something in its mouth, and they wandered here and there until they came to the pleasure garden of the Śākyaas dwelling in the yellow-robed community. The man who guarded the pleasure garden spoke to the Śākyaas dwelling in the yellow-robed community: "Good sirs, the noble young man, with a dog running off with something in its mouth, has come into your pleasure garden." Those men arose with indignation and said: "Good sirs, if that is how things are, the time has come — go and kill that interloper." And so, having divided up the task accordingly, they set out. But the elder Śākyaas, upon seeing them, said: "Young men, where are you going?" Those men replied: "The noble young man has come into our pleasure garden — we are going to kill him." The elder Śākyaas said: "Young men, this was an accident; bear with his fault in some measure and turn back." And they turned back.

Meanwhile, the four-division army host of the noble young man, having heard from one to another, came searching and arrived at the pleasure garden, and the four-division army host surrounded the pleasure garden on every side. The man who guarded the pleasure garden then spoke to the Śākyaas dwelling in the yellow-robed community: "Good sirs, the four-division army host of the noble young man has come to the pleasure garden, and the elephants and horses with their unclean matter have rendered the entire pleasure garden unfit." At this they became exceedingly indignant, and breaking the word of the elder Śākyaas, they set out to kill the noble young man. When the noble young man heard that the Śākyaas of the yellow-robed community were coming

to kill him, he left a man in place and said: "Come now, fellow — I will go on ahead. Whatever the Śākyas dwelling in the yellow-robed community say, report it back to me." When the Śākyas of the yellow-robed community arrived at the pleasure garden and the noble young man was nowhere to be seen, those men asked his servant: "Where has the son of the maidservant gone?" He replied: "He has fled." Some among them said: "If we had seen him, we would have cut off his hands." Others said: "If he had not fled, we ourselves would have cut off his feet." Others still said: "We for our part would have separated him altogether and in every way from his life — but since he has fled, what is to be done now?" They gave instructions to their hired men: "Sweep out the pleasure garden, and where the maidservant's son has gone, scrape away the ground in that direction and cover it over with fresh earth."

As for those sections of the wall they had been leaning against, let others scrub those spots thoroughly; then wash them down with milk-water, sprinkle them with fragrant water, and adorn them most beautifully with perfumes, flowers, and the like." The servant did exactly as instructed.

Then that man, having seen how everything had turned out, went before the noble-born one, prostrated at his feet, and sat to one side. The noble-born one said: "Well now, young man — what do the Śākyas dwelling in Kapilavastu say?" He replied: "Whatever Your Lordship may say to him, the curse of one who petitions a god shall not fall on him — let it fall on those very people instead. But, Your Lordship, please make it known only to the extent of what needs to be known." Understanding that the moment was right, he recounted it all in detail. Then he spoke to the people of his household: "Wise ones, the moment my father passes away and I become king, the very first thing I must do is to separate those people from their lives. You must urge forward everything that has been set in motion. As for the Śākyas dwelling in Kapilavastu, I will face them down." They agreed.

Mālagandhā said: "Excellent, excellent! Your Lordship, this too you shall certainly accomplish. Virtuous people stand firm in their pledges." He replied: "I do not know how soon I shall become king." Mālagandhā said: "Do not think that way. The aged king will not linger long before departing to his divine abode, and then you yourself will become king. When one serves desire, there is no evil deed one will not commit."

So it was that from among the five hundred ministers of Prasenajit, king of Kośala, the noble-born one began to dismiss the ministers one by one, and all

of them departed from his presence, save only Dīrghacārin. That chief of ministers, being the one closest to the sovereign's heart, did not depart.

Then, some time later, Dīrghacārin came before the noble-born one on some matter, and the noble-born one said to Dīrghacārin: "If I am to take revenge on the Śākya of Kapilavastu by making use of a plot to kill King Prasenajit, tell me when I shall become king." Dīrghacārin replied: "Your Lordship, why do you seek to generate demerit? The aged king will not linger long before departing to his divine abode, and the kingship will pass to no one other than yourself. As for Dīrghacārin, I say this to you alone — do not repeat it to anyone." His Lordship said: "But what have I done wrong? How could I tell this to anyone?" And with that he departed.

At that time the Blessed One was dwelling among the Śākyas, in the Śākya town called Meḍuludī. Then King Prasenajit of Kośala mounted a fine horse, with Dīrghacārin as his charioteer, and as they were traveling through the countryside they came to a certain city. There King Prasenajit caught sight of a secluded forest grove at the edge of a park — a lodging place set apart, free from wicked people, well suited to solitary retreat and proper composure within. Upon seeing it, he said to Dīrghacārin: "Dīrghacārin, the Blessed One is dwelling in just such a place as this — a forest grove at the edge of a park, secluded, free from wicked folk, suited to solitary retreat and proper composure within. If I were to pay attendance on the Blessed One from time to time, that would be good. Tell me, Dīrghacārin — where is the Blessed One now dwelling? Have you heard?" He replied: "Your Lordship, I have heard. The Blessed One is dwelling among the Śākyas, in the Śākya town called Meḍuludī. Your Lordship, how far is it to the Śākya town of Meḍuludī?"

"Your Lordship, it is a little more than three leagues away." Dīrghacārin then respectfully heard King Prasenajit of Kosala and said: "As your Lordship wishes, let the chariot be brought to that place — to the Śākya town of Meḍuludī." And so, having had the chariot brought and going by carriage as far as the road was passable, he alighted from the carriage and entered the park of Ānanda on foot.

At that time, the Blessed One was dwelling in a great hall, staying there through the day with the door closed. King Prasenajit of Kosala saw many monks walking in the open walkway outside the great hall. He went up to those many monks and addressed them thus: "Venerable ones, where is the Blessed One staying?" The great king was told: "Great King, the Blessed One is

staying in this very great hall, resting through the day with the chamber door shut. Great King, if you wish, go to that great hall with the door shut, and when you arrive, knock gently and softly on the door panel — the Blessed One will open it."

Then King Prasenajit of Kosala removed his five royal insignia — the diadem, the parasol, the sword, the jewel-handled fly-whisk, and the embroidered shoes — and gave them to Dīrghacārin, turning his face away. Dīrghacārin then thought to himself: "The king has placed upon me the five royal insignia — the diadem, the parasol, the sword, the jewel-handled fly-whisk, and the embroidered shoes — and has turned his face away. The king must wish to conduct some private business; I should remain right here."

Then King Prasenajit of Kosala went to that great hall with the door shut. He knocked gently and softly on the door panel, and the Blessed One opened the door. King Prasenajit of Kosala then went to where the Blessed One was, prostrated himself with his head at the Blessed One's two feet, covered them with his face and hands, and spoke these words: "Blessed One, it has been a long time since I have seen you. Sugata, it has been a long time since I have seen you."

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to King Prasenajit of Kosala: "Great King, why do you show yourself even more humble than the most humble before the Tathāgata?"

"Venerable Blessed One, I have faith in the Dharma arising from the Dharma itself. Therefore I think: the Blessed One is the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha; your Dharma and Vinaya are well taught; and the Śrāvaka Saṅgha is well entered upon the path."

"Great King, what is the nature of this faith you have in the Dharma?"

"Venerable One, I have observed here certain learned ascetics (śramaṇas) and brahmins who are arrogant in their learning, skilled in disputation, and accounted by ordinary folk as inspiring childlike wonder and awe. I have seen how these men, by their own wisdom and eloquence, shatter the positions of others and reduce their theories to nothing, and then proceed to disparage them, saying among themselves: 'Let us go to that wise Gautama and put such-and-such questions to him. If he fails to give a prophetic answer, we shall debate him, and if he answers in such-and-such a way, then we shall say to him thus:'

saying: 'O Gautama, this of yours is improper. This is unbecoming. This is untenable.' But having prepared all those questions they had planned to put, they came into the presence of the Blessed One, and before they could even begin to pose them — let alone actually pose them — they fell silent and did not speak. Instead, they simply gazed upon the Blessed One's face and reflected upon it, thinking: 'The Blessed One Gautama alone knows what is to be known; he sees what is to be seen.' Venerable One, this too is a faith in the Blessed One that has arisen from the Dharma.

Venerable One, I have yet another faith in the Blessed One that has arisen from the Dharma. Venerable One, here I have observed certain learned ascetics and brahmins who are arrogant in their learning — and what follows is the same as before, up to the point of 'I have seen some of them.' Having prepared all those questions, they went to where the Blessed One was and, having arrived, put their questions to him before they were even fully posed, and the Blessed One, while they were still putting their questions without having completed them, gave a prophetic answer that fulfilled them completely. Delighted and pleased by having their questions thus answered prophetically, those people went for refuge to the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha of monks, and undertook the training precepts as well. Venerable One, this too is a faith in the Blessed One that has arisen from the Dharma — and what follows is as before.

Venerable One, I have yet another faith in the Blessed One that has arisen from the Dharma. Venerable One, here I have observed certain learned brahmins and householders who are arrogant in their learning — and what follows, up to 'I have seen some of them,' is as before. Having prepared all those questions, they went to where the Blessed One was and, having arrived, put their questions to him in full. The Blessed One gave them a complete and prophetic teaching on the Dharma. Delighted and pleased by that prophetic teaching, those people requested from the Blessed One the going forth and full ordination as monks, and the Blessed One granted them the going forth and conferred full ordination upon them. Having thus gone forth and been fully ordained, having attained arhatship and experiencing the joy and bliss of complete liberation, they reflected to themselves: 'We were indeed improper. We were utterly improper. Formerly, when we were not yet true ascetics, we claimed to be ascetics. When we were neither true brahmins nor arhats, we claimed to be arhats. Now at last we truly are ascetics, brahmins, and arhats.' Venerable One, this too is a faith in the Blessed One that has arisen from the

Dharma — and what follows is as before.

Venerable One, I have yet another faith in the Blessed One that has arisen from the Dharma. Venerable One, here I have observed certain ascetics and brahmins who are thin and emaciated, gaunt of flesh, slight and feeble in frame, of poor complexion —

whose faculties were impaired, and who were disagreeable to look upon with the eyes of the many. Having seen them, I thought to myself: 'Are these wise men practicing the holy life against their will? Or has some long illness overtaken them? Or might it be that they have committed some evil, unwholesome action in secret and are now concealing it? For indeed, these wise men are pale and gaunt, their flesh wasted and poor, slight and feeble in body, their faculties impaired, and disagreeable to look upon with the eyes of the many.' I approached them and, having approached, spoke to them thus: 'Wise ones, why have you become pale and gaunt, your flesh wasted and poor, slight and feeble, your faculties impaired, and disagreeable to look upon with the eyes of the many?' They replied to me, Great King, that desire afflicts them. Venerable One, at that I thought: 'If, by obtaining, partaking of, and accumulating desired objects, one were to become fair of form, pleasing to behold, and beautiful, then I — Prasenajit, King of Kosala — would become the fairest of form, the most pleasing to behold, and the most beautiful, for I, Prasenajit, King of Kosala, obtain the five qualities of sense-pleasure to my heart's content and with ease. But since it is precisely because of obtaining, partaking of, and accumulating desired objects that one does not become the fairest of form, the most pleasing to behold, and the most beautiful, therefore I have seen that the Saṅgha of monks (śrāvakas) of the Blessed One is very fair of form, their faculties flourishing, their faces radiant, their complexions entirely pure, their minds free of anxiety, living in complete dependence on others — and therefore they are able to practice, for as long as they live, the holy life unmixed, perfectly complete, perfectly pure, and perfectly cleansed.' Venerable One, this too is a faith in the Blessed One that has arisen from the Dharma — and what follows is as before.

Venerable One, I have yet another faith in the Blessed One that has arisen from the Dharma. Venerable One, here I have seen how those who come to me for the sake of wealth quarrel with one another over the basis, the grounds, and the purpose of their desires — mothers with their children, children with their mothers, fathers with their children, children with their fathers, brothers with their sisters, sisters with their brothers, and friends with

their friends; to say nothing of person against person, they quarrel and dispute. And when they quarrel and fall into contention, the mother speaks ill of the child, the child speaks ill of the mother, the father speaks ill of the child, the child speaks ill of the father, the brother speaks ill of the sister, the sister speaks ill of the brother, the friend speaks ill of the friend — to say nothing of person against person.

Furthermore, here I have seen two monks who, having quarreled with other monks over some matter, surrendered their training and fell away. Yet in no manner whatsoever did they speak ill of the Buddha, nor did they speak ill of the Dharma or the Saṅgha. Rather, they reproached only themselves, saying: 'We two are inferior here, lowborn, and lacking in merit — we were unable to practice, in the presence of the Blessed One and for as long as we live, the holy life unmixed, perfectly complete, perfectly pure, and perfectly cleansed.' Venerable One, this too is a faith in the Blessed One that has arisen from the Dharma — and what follows is as before.

Venerable One, I have yet another faith in the Blessed One that has arisen from the Dharma. Venerable One, here I, Prasenajit, King of Kosala, have those who are to be executed put to death, and when it comes to those who are to be released, I have the power to release them —

when those of great clans, like great śāla trees, come before me on their own affairs, and when great brahmins, like great śāla trees, and great householders, like great śāla trees, come before me, they do not wait until I have finished speaking but interrupt me again and again with their own words, and I think to myself that I shall speak without discourtesy and without disrespect. Yet, Venerable One, there was once an occasion when the Blessed One was seated in the midst of a retinue of many hundreds, teaching the Dharma, and at that time there was not even the sound of a cough, not even the sound of a clearing of the throat. Then a certain person let out a cough, and another person said to that one, "My friend, you are making noise with your mouth. The Blessed One teaches the Dharma in a way that is sweet beyond sweet, like one who satisfies with honey." When this was said, that person fell completely silent. At that, I thought to myself: "How great is the power and how great is the miraculous ability of the Blessed One — that here, right now, he tames his assembly with the sweet Dharma, without punishment and without weapons. How wonderful!" Venerable One, this too is a faith in the Blessed One that has arisen from the Dharma — and what follows is as before.

Venerable One, I have yet another faith in the Blessed One that has arisen from the Dharma. Venerable One, here, when I encounter certain ascetics and brahmins, I deprive them of wealth — and after eight or nine months of their living the holy life, they cast off those appearances, those signs, those marks, and, equipped and endowed with the five strands of sensual pleasure, they indulge, they delight, and they engage in pleasure. Venerable One, yet the śrāvakas of the Blessed One whom I see here practice the holy life for as long as they live — unmixed, perfectly complete, perfectly pure, and perfectly cleansed — up to the very end of their lives. Venerable One, this too is a faith in the Blessed One that has arisen from the Dharma — and what follows is as before.

The Minor Matters of the Vinaya, the Eighth Fascicle.

Venerable One, I have yet another faith in the Blessed One that has arisen from the Dharma. Venerable One, I give to certain trusted and long-standing sages, Dāna and the others — I give them wealth, I give them renown, and I even give them my life — yet they do not think to render to the Blessed One what they render to me in the same way. Venerable One, there was once an occasion when I wished to examine certain trusted and long-standing sages, so I left the midst of my retinue and went off to a secluded corner, thinking: "Let me see how these ones turn their feet — toward the Blessed One's side or toward my side." Those sages then praised the buddha in many words and with many ways of speaking, and praised the Dharma and the Saṅgha, and they turned their heads toward the side where the Blessed One was, and turned their feet toward the side where I was. At that, I thought to myself: "How great is the miraculous ability and how great is the power of the Blessed One — that those to whom I give wealth, to whom I give renown, and to whom I even give my life, do not think to repay the Blessed One as they repay me. How wonderful!" From that point on — Venerable One, this too is a faith in the Blessed One that has arisen from the Dharma — and what follows is as before.

Venerable One, I have yet another faith that has arisen from the Dharma. Venerable One, I am a man of the land of Kosala, and the Blessed One is also of the land of Kosala.

My family lineage is the warrior caste (kṣatriya), and the Blessed One's family lineage is also the warrior caste. I am old, aged, burdened with years, having reached eighty years of age. The Blessed One too is old, aged, burdened with years, his body having reached eighty years of age. Venerable One, I am a

king of the warrior caste, anointed from the crown of the head. The Blessed One is the unsurpassed king of the Dharma. Venerable One, this too is a faith in the Blessed One that has arisen from the Dharma, and so I think to myself: the Blessed One is a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and completely awakened buddha; his Dharma and Vinaya are well proclaimed; and the Saṅgha of śrāvakas has entered well upon the path.

Then Prasenajit, king of Kosala, having spoken at length before the Blessed One on many aspects of the Dharma, prostrated at the Blessed One's feet and departed. Not long after King Prasenajit of Kosala had gone, the Blessed One perceived this and addressed the monks, saying: Monks, you should take up, learn by heart, and master the various Dharma categories of manifold teachings. And why? Monks, the various Dharma categories of manifold teachings have meaning, have Dharma, have pure conduct; they lead to direct knowledge, they lead to perfect awakening, they lead to nirvāṇa. Therefore, a son of good family who has gone forth in faith should take up these various Dharma categories of manifold teachings, master them thoroughly, and in that way hold them, retain them, and recite them.

Now, King Prasenajit of Kosala had been sitting a long time listening to the Dharma in the presence of the Blessed One. Prince Viḍūḍabha, who had been waiting there for some time, then mounted his chariot and departed for Śrāvastī. Prasenajit had left Viḍūḍabha in charge of the kingdom. Mālikā and Vāsabhā-khattiyā asked Viḍūḍabha: "Where is the king?" They were told: "He is residing in the village of Medaḷumpa." So they set out on foot for the village of Medaḷumpa.

After King Prasenajit of Kosala had listened to the Dharma and emerged from the assembly hall, Prince Viḍūḍabha was nowhere to be seen. He asked the monks: "Noble ones, where has Prince Viḍūḍabha gone?" They replied: "He departed just a moment ago by chariot." The king then went on foot. Now the Blessed One had already set out for Rājagṛha at an earlier time. Along the road the king encountered Mālikā and Vāsabhā-khattiyā, and he asked them: "Why have you come here on foot?" They replied: "Your Majesty, Prince Viḍūḍabha has placed Viḍūḍabha in charge of the kingdom and departed; and we, where else should we go but to follow the king?" The king said: "Mālikā, you have already enjoyed your reign as queen — go now and enjoy your son's reign. As for me, I will go to Rājagṛha with Vāsabhā-khattiyā." At that, Mālikā turned back weeping and lamenting with piteous cries. Then King Prasenajit of Kosala set out together with Vāsabhā-khattiyā and gradually made his way to

Rājagṛha. Wandering here and there, he came and sat in Ajātaśatru's pleasure garden. He said to Vāsabhā-khattiyā: "Vāsabhā-khattiyā, go and tell King Ajātaśatru that King Prasenajit of Kosala is sitting in the pleasure garden."

She told King Ajātaśatru: "Your Majesty, King Prasenajit of Kosala is sitting in your pleasure garden and wishes to have an audience with you."

Upon hearing this, Ajātaśatru was alarmed and said: "Wise ones, that king commands a great army — if he has come so suddenly, has not any one of you noticed?" The minister Vāsabhā-khattiyā said: "Your Majesty, what army does he have? His son has expelled him from the kingdom, and he has come here with only a single attendant." Ajātaśatru said: "Then the king is welcome. As for me, I shall stay in the quarters of the young." He then said to his ministers: "Wise ones, it would not be fitting for me to receive a king who has been consecrated as sovereign over the kṣatriya clans with no honour and no proper reception. Therefore, today beautify the city and beautify the roads." They cleared the city of stones, gravel, and weeds — and so forth, as before, up to the passage: "like the pleasure garden of delight among the gods."

Then, after the roads and the city had each been made especially beautiful and distinguished, a proclamation was sounded: "Let all the people — those dwelling in Rājagṛha, those in the palace environs, and those who have come from various lands — hear this! King Prasenajit of Kosala is seated in the pleasure garden. Go forth together with your lord, bearing parasols, victory banners, and flags to receive him."

Then King Ajātaśatru, with many thousands of chariots preceding him and accompanied by a fourfold army, went to meet King Prasenajit of Kosala. But Ajātaśatru had been delayed too long on the way, and Prasenajit, exhausted from the hardship of the journey, had gone to a certain enclosure of a thicket not far at all from the pleasure garden. There the bushes filled the entire hollow of the thicket with their shade. He then ate the roots and leaves of the plants in that hollow, and being utterly parched, went to the bank of a pool and drank his fill of water. When he rose, his hands were trembling and his legs would not bear him, so he stumbled and fell onto the road where the chariots pass, and there, his face filled with the dust churned up by wheels, he passed away from this world.

King Ajātaśatru went into the pleasure garden and, thinking to find him, searched about but could not. He dispatched mounted messengers in all four directions to search, and one of those messengers went to the enclosure of the

thicket and asked the bushes there: "Ho there! Has anyone come into this pleasure garden?" "Yes — he took the shade of that bush, went along this path to the pool, and left." Following that trail, the messenger found him lying dead on the chariot road. He then told King Ajātaśatru: "Your Majesty, in the direction of a certain chariot road, he has passed away." The king cried out, "Alas!" and surrounded by many hundreds and thousands of people, went in that direction. When he saw the corpse, which was exceedingly unpleasant to behold, he said once more to his ministers: "Wise ones, it is not agreeable to me that this king — consecrated as sovereign among the kṣatriya clans — should have passed away in my realm. Take him with great honour and convey him to the cool grove of the charnel ground. I too will go to the Blessed One to request that offerings be made over his remains." They accordingly conveyed him with great honour to the great charnel ground of the cool grove.

King Ajātaśatru then went to where the Blessed One was, arrived there, and bowing his head at the feet of the Blessed One, spoke these words: "Venerable One, King Prasenajit of Kosala has passed away in my realm — what manner of offerings shall I make over his remains?" The Blessed One declared: "Great King, honour the body with the fullest offerings that lie within your power and your means."

Then the king made great offerings over his remains. Afterward he went again into the presence of the Blessed One and addressed him: "Venerable One, what action did King Prasenajit of Kosala perform such that, by the karmic maturation of that action, he found himself at the end of a mountain pass, overcome by hunger, his limbs stiff and swollen, and passed away before his time?"

The Blessed One declared: "The very actions accumulated and gathered by King Prasenajit himself, having met with the right conditions, will ripen without fail — abiding close like a shadow that never departs, and arising inevitably to be experienced by none other than himself. Great King, the actions one has performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external element of earth, nor in the element of water, nor in the element of fire, nor in the element of wind. Rather, whatever virtuous and non-virtuous actions have been performed and accumulated ripen solely within the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense bases.

Even through a hundred aeons,
actions do not perish.

When conditions and the time converge,
they ripen as fruit for embodied beings.

Great King, once upon a time there was a brahmin who dwelt in a mountain pass. He took a wife of equal caste, and with her he sported and delighted and enjoyed pleasure. While they sported and delighted and enjoyed pleasure together, a son was born to them, and in the fullness of time they raised and nurtured him until he grew up. One day the son went out begging and found a bowlful of grain husks in the mountain pass. He said to his mother: 'Please keep this for me while I wash and return.' He gave it to her and went off to bathe.

Now, when buddhas have not appeared in the world, there arise in this world pratyekabuddhas — those who have compassion for the base and the lowly, who are devoted to solitary forest dwelling at the edge of the world, and who are the sole field of merit for the world. One such pratyekabuddha, wandering and traveling through the land, came to that mountain pass. He stayed there for a while. In the morning he dressed in his lower robe and his Dharma robe, took up his alms bowl, and entered the mountain pass for his alms round, coming step by step to that very house. The brahmin woman, seeing his beautiful form and beautiful mind and so forth, felt her heart filled with joy and offered the pratyekabuddha that entire bowlful of grain husks. Now, these great beings teach the Dharma through their body, not through speech. So he spread his wings like a king among geese and rose up into the open sky, displaying various miraculous feats.

Ordinary beings are quick to develop faith upon seeing miraculous power. He then alighted, touching the ground with his feet, as smoothly as a tree cut at the root falls. And he regarded her with compassion and went on his way.

In due course the brahmin boy returned and said: 'Mother, please give me that bowl of grain husks.' She replied: 'Son, rejoice! I offered it to a renunciant of peaceful nature who had come seeking alms.' At this, overcome by hunger, he fell into suffering and distress of mind, and said: 'Since that renunciant ate it, why did his arms not stiffen and swell so that he died before his time?'

Great King, what do you think? That brahmin boy — he is none other than King Prasenajit of Kosala in this very life. At that time, through the karmic maturation of having spoken harsh words to a pratyekabuddha, he was born in the hells for many years, for many hundreds of years, for many thousands of

years, for many hundreds of thousands of years. And by the remainder of that same karma, six times his arms stiffened and swelled and he passed away before his time."

And from that time until now, seven times in all his arms stiffened and swelled, and he passed away before his time by that alone.

Therefore, Great King, from the passage beginning 'those actions that are entirely dark' to 'one must strive toward those that are entirely bright' — you should train yourself accordingly, Great King — all of this is as stated before.

Then King Ajātaśatru, full of sincere faith in what the Blessed One had declared, rejoiced, and bowing his head to the feet of the Blessed One, withdrew from his presence.

Then Virūḍhaka said this to the noble Ajātaśatru: "My lord, while your father still reigns as king and the royal consecration has not yet been conferred upon you, when the time comes for me to become king, I shall make the Śākya bow their heads. That shall be the first thing I do." Having uttered these great and powerful words befitting a bull among men, he declared it with finality and proclaimed it with a lion's roar in the midst of the assembly. "Was this your intent? Now the time for it has come."

Ajātaśatru replied to him: "Whatever Virūḍhaka has said — all of it, shall it really be done? That matter is past; let it go. The affairs of a king and the deeds of a king will come to ruin."

Virūḍhaka said: "My lord, virtuous men are firm in their pledges. Therefore please let me carry out what I vowed. As for Virūḍhaka — set that aside for now. It will not be difficult."

Ajātaśatru said: "My lord, since this was a vow made at the very beginning, I will certainly not stop you. Whether today is a good time, or a moment hence is good, or an hour hence is good — even the umbrella of merit is good. So it is fitting, my lord, that you depart this very day, without requiring those gods to lay out a reception."

Then Virūḍhaka, the noble one, deceiving Ajātaśatru, armed a fourfold host — the assemblage of elephants, the assemblage of cavalry, the assemblage of chariots, and the assemblage of infantry — and set out from Śrāvastī toward Kapila, intending to slay the Śākya dwelling there.

Now at such a moment, the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, possess not even the slightest lack of knowledge, lack of vision, or lack of understanding. Knowing

that the karma of the Śākyas dwelling in Kapila would not be made fruitless, and moved by that knowledge, the Blessed One set out from Śrāvastī toward Kapila ahead of them all.

The Blessed One, traveling along the road, sat cross-legged in the midday resting beneath a certain śākoṭaka tree whose bark was peeling and unpleasant, whose leaves were sparse, and whose shade was meager.

King Virūḍhaka the noble one saw the Blessed One from afar. Seeing him, he went to where the Blessed One was and addressed him thus: "Venerable One, if there are other trees with pleasant leaves and fuller shade, why has the Blessed One abandoned those and chosen to sit under this śākoṭaka tree with its peeling bark, its unpleasant appearance, its sparse leaves, and its meager shade?"

The Blessed One declared: "Great King, the shade of one's kinsmen is cool."

Virūḍhaka thought: "The Blessed One looks upon his kinsmen with compassion and love. Alas, the Blessed One truly acts with love toward his kinsmen." Recognizing this, he turned back from that very place.

The Blessed One then reflected: "If the Śākyas dwelling in Kapila are struck by Virūḍhaka's army before they have seen the truth, they will not become vessels fit to realize the truth." Knowing this, he set out traveling through the lands of the Śākyas, journeying to Kapila and dwelling in the Nyagrodhā park there.

The Śākyas dwelling in Kapila heard that the Blessed One, who had been traveling through the lands of the Śākyas, had arrived there and was residing in this very Nyagrodhā park. And upon hearing this, they went to where the Blessed One was, and arriving there —

they prostrated at the feet of the Blessed One, touching their heads to the ground, and took their seats to one side. The Blessed One, knowing their dispositions, latent tendencies, constitutions, and characters, then taught them the Dharma in such a way that they would come to realize the four noble truths. Upon hearing this, many hundreds of thousands of living beings attained a great distinction: some directly realized the fruit called stream-entry, and some the fruit called once-returning — and so on as before, down through "those who are destined for the Saṅgha."

Now Virūḍhaka, seeing a noble-born man, said to him, "God, why have you come back?" The man replied, "Virūḍhaka, the Blessed One has regard and

compassion for his kinsmen. Alas, because the Blessed One has compassion for his kinsmen, the great king has spoken these words to them: 'The cool shade of a kinsman is a kinsman's shade.' This has entered my heart and settled there. Let the Śākyas dwelling in Kapila go free; do not slaughter them." Virūḍhaka replied, "God, the ascetic Gautama has gone beyond attachment. Those who are beyond attachment do not look upon their kinsmen. Therefore today, whether it be the divine sun, or a mere moment of time, or a star, or a parasol of merit — all are equally fine. Today, go to the territory of Kapila." But that man, having been misled and seized by a companion of unwholesome intent, equipped the fourfold army — the host of elephants, the host of cavalry, the host of chariots, and the host of foot soldiers — and marched to the territory of Kapila, setting up his encampment not very far off.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana went to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, prostrated at the feet of the Blessed One, touching his head to the ground, and taking a seat to one side, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana addressed the Blessed One thus: "Reverend One, I have heard that the deluded fellow Virūḍhaka, equipping the fourfold army — the host of elephants, the host of cavalry, the host of chariots, and the host of foot soldiers — has come to the territory of Kapila in order to massacre the Śākyas dwelling in Kapila. For that reason I should like, along with an army and its mounts, either to dispatch him to another world-realm, or to hurl him beyond the surrounding mountains, or to encircle the city of Kapila with an iron palisade, or to encircle it with an iron net." The Blessed One replied: "Maudgalyāyana, it is so. It is indeed so. You could do what you have described — encircle it, as before. And yet, the Śākyas dwelling in Kapila have themselves accumulated the assemblage of karma, the condition has fully matured, it draws near like a welling flood, and those actions that will inevitably ripen — the karma they have done and accumulated — who else would experience it? Monks, the actions one has done and accumulated do not ripen in the external element of earth, nor in the element of fire, nor in the element of water, nor in the element of wind. But the virtuous and non-virtuous actions one has done and accumulated ripen in those very aggregates, elements, and sense bases that one has appropriated.

Even across hundreds of aeons,
karmic actions do not perish.
When the conditions and the time are met,

they ripen as results for embodied beings.

Maudgalyāyana, the world is governed by karma, born from karma, living out karma's portion, relying on karma. Whoever has performed a virtuous or a sinful action becomes an heir to that karma. Therefore, Maudgalyāyana, one should incline toward wholesome karma."

Then the venerable Maudgalyāyana bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and departed.

The Śākyas dwelling at Kapilavastu heard that the man Virūḍhaka, born of a woman of low birth, was coming with a fourfold army — a host of elephants, a host of cavalry, a host of chariots, and a host of foot soldiers — to put them to death. Upon hearing this, they too equipped a fourfold army — a host of elephants, a host of cavalry, a host of chariots, and a host of foot soldiers — and arrayed themselves against Virūḍhaka to do battle. Yet because they were seers of truth, they would not kill even slightly. Instead, they drove back his men with sticks and whips, cut bowstrings, ropes, and cords, and shot arrows at ear-ornaments. Having broken apart the armor of Virūḍhaka's army, they entered Kapilavastu, shut the gates, and manned the ramparts.

Virūḍhaka's forces, having been repulsed in their hostile advance, came to the mother of Virūḍhaka and said, "Mother, do you not see? The Śākyas are going to destroy us — make way and let us pass." She replied, "My lord, do not be troubled. The Śākyas dwelling at Kapilavastu are seers of truth; they are unable to bring themselves to part even a living creature — even an insect — from its life. And this is evident from the fact that they have not killed even a single one of our men." He was taken in by this and sat in silence, saying nothing.

The Śākyas then established a rule among themselves: "Friends, none among us shall strike Virūḍhaka or his army. Whoever strikes them is no kinsman of ours and no Śākya."

At that time there was a certain Śākya named Śambhaka who was sitting alone on a cliff, off by himself, intent on some business of his own. He had not heard the rule the Śākyas had established. Being an ordinary person, he heard the news that Virūḍhaka had come to Kapilavastu to kill them, and that he was sitting in a great open quarter. On hearing this, seized by anger that had erupted and pervaded him, his mind disturbed, he charged into Virūḍhaka's army. There he killed many among the populace, and left some barely alive.

Virūḍhaka then, greatly troubled, said, "Mother, do you not see? You told us that these people are seers of truth and would not part even an insect from its life. Yet this one alone has killed so many of our people in this manner. If all of them were to come at once, not a single one of our beings would survive — what more need be said? We have been constrained by time; let us turn back for now."

She said, "My lord, the Śākya enacted a rule of this kind among themselves: none among us may strike Virūḍhaka or his army; whoever strikes him is no kinsman of ours and no Śākya. He did not hear this pledge, and so now there is ground for him not to be counted among them."

Then Śambhaka went to the gate of Kapilavastu, sat down, and said, "Friends, open the gate and let me in." They replied, "You have broken our rule; from this point on you are neither our kinsman nor a Śākya. How can we allow you inside? Be gone." He said, "I did not hear your rule — but what is the use of speaking at length?"

"If I have violated your rule, send my retinue back out and I shall go elsewhere." They sent his retinue out, and he led them to where the Blessed One was. Arriving there, he bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and sat to one side. Seated to one side, Śākya Śambhaka addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Venerable One, please grant me some token by which I may act in your service." The Blessed One gave him strands of hair, nail clippings, and teeth produced by his miraculous power. Śambhaka took these and went to the land of Kudara. There the people heard that one called Śākya Śambhaka, endowed with diligence, strength, and all the excellent qualities of a great champion, was coming, desiring the kingship of their land. Hearing this, they began to deliberate. The wise men said among themselves, "We have heard that one called Śākya Śambhaka, endowed with diligence, strength, and all the excellent qualities of a great champion, is coming to our land. Let everyone gather here for now — shall we go to meet him or not?" All of them assembled together for the time being and remained there.

Meanwhile, Śambhaka left his retinue to one side, dressed himself in the manner of a minister's attendant, and went to them. They greeted him with words of welcome, exchanged pleasantries, and then asked, "Where have you come from?" He replied, "Śākya Śambhaka, endowed with diligence, strength, and all the excellent qualities of a great champion, desires the kingship and wishes to come here. He has sent this letter — open it and read it." They said,

"There is not even a seat — where should we place it?" At that he drew his sword from its scabbard, chopped a flat stone into pieces, and said, "Place it on this." Seeing this, they looked at one another with astonished eyes and said, "Good man, how many men like you does he have?" He replied, "Wise ones, I am only his attendant — what am I capable of? He has many other brave warriors." Hearing this, they were filled with awe and said to one another, "Wise ones, if the attendant of such a man is like this, what must his other men be like? Let him come — we will make him our king." They read the letter and sent back a reply: "It is good that you are coming. We trust in this and will act according to your command." Śambhaka took the reply letter and arrived together with his retinue and all their best possessions, coming to the land of Kudara. The people there received him with great honor and established him on the throne. The proclamation spread everywhere: "Śākya Śambhaka has been enthroned over the kingdom!" And so he came to be known by the name King Śambhaka, King Śambhaka. There he had a shrine made for the hair and nail clippings of the Blessed One, and it came to be known as the Śambhaka Shrine, the Śambhaka Shrine.

His wife was a woman without faith. She was, however, his chief queen, and so he could not slight her in the least. He gave orders to his ministers: "Have the hermitage guarded." They guarded the hermitage, and from that time on no wild animals were killed there.

Ārya-jaṭa harmed his mother and said to her, "Now that you have harmed her, the Śākyas have shut the gates and enclosed the grounds, and they dwell there at ease. What do you want to do, hemmed in as you are by time's certainty?" He replied, "My lord, would a single enemy destroy an entire city? I, living in the royal palace, have heard that —"

"The wise accomplish their aims through five means: conciliation, lavish giving, deception, all-round practice, and fifth, armed force."

And so, he said, "Consider sowing division among them." Ārya-jaṭa sent word to the Śākyas: "O wise ones, I bear you no attachment and no anger, yet there is a small matter of personal dignity that concerns me. Once I have settled it and obtained what I need, open the gates quickly, that I may leave at once." The Śākyas said among themselves, "O wise ones, shall we assemble and open the gates, or shall we deliberate on whether to leave them closed?" They all gathered together, and some said, "Open them." Others said, "If we open them, it will not go well." Then some said, "O wise ones, some say open the

gates; others say it will not go well if we do. Therefore, if you wish, cast lots, and whatever the majority desires, let that be done." So they began to cast lots.

At that moment Māra the evil one thought to himself: "Many times I have sought an opportunity and looked for a flaw in the ascetic Gautama, following him again and again, yet never found an opening. Now I realize I can drive a wedge between his kinsmen." So he manifested himself in the visible form of an aged Śākya and sat at the end of the row of elders. He was the first to draw a lot, and seeing that an elder Śākya had drawn, all the others drew as well.

Then one of single mind sent word to Ārya-jaṭa: "Enter." He entered with his fourfold army and, having entered, declared, "I have driven a wedge between the Śākyas. I have utterly abandoned the Śākyas." The very instant those words had left his mouth, armed men began slaughtering the Śākyas on all sides, and a great outcry arose.

Hearing the great cry of the name Śākya, a kinsman was seized with distress born of love for his kin, and quickly, quickly went to Ārya-jaṭa and said to him, "Noble god, grant me a boon worthy of your nobility." He replied, "Tell me what boon you ask." The man said, "Noble god, grant fearlessness to my kinsmen." Ārya-jaṭa replied, "I will not grant fearlessness to your kinsmen. But you and your retinue may come out." The man said, "Noble god, for as long as I remain submerged in the water, grant fearlessness to those who come out." Ārya-jaṭa then looked toward his ministers, and they said, "Noble god, this great name is both your mother's kinsman and your father's friend, so it is fitting that you grant him this boon." He replied, "If that is so, I grant it at once."

The one who bore the great name Śākya, his mind distressed with grief born of love for his kin, his heart moist with compassion, went to a pool of water. Beside that pool stood a sāla tree whose branches dipped into the water of the pool. He clung to those branches, submerged himself, and remained submerged until his very life was spent.

Now, among those Śākyas dwelling in the dwelling of the yellow-robed ones, those who had not participated in the communal act — some left the dwelling of the yellow-robed ones and went out wandering as wanderers; some went to Nepal; some went to various villages, market towns, royal territories, and one palace or another.

Those who had participated in the communal act came out through the eastern gate of the ground of the yellow-robed ones and entered from the south; came out from the south and entered from the west; came out from the west and entered from the north; came out from the north and entered from the east. The ministers said, "Noble god, alas, the Śākyas are being cut down! Alas, the Śākyas are being cut down! Right now, those who enter through the eastern gate come out in the south; those who enter through the south come out in the west —"

those who enter from the west come out in the north; those who enter from the north come out in the south.

The noble one spoke: "Wise ones, look — it has been a long while since that ancestor sank beneath the water." The ministers went at length to inspect the pool, and by that point the time had already passed. They returned and reported to him: "Noble god, the time has passed." Then, surrounded by a great plain on all sides, he spoke: "Wise ones, prepare your seats. Until a rain of blood falls on the great highway, we shall not depart from this place. When brave men are slain, it is the natural order that little blood flows." The ministers began to deliberate among themselves: "Wise ones, if this being is one who commits sinful deeds and holds firm to his oath, how could so much blood possibly come from here? Let us send for some lacquer." And so they took lacquer and poured many hundreds and thousands of jars of lacquer-water onto the great highway.

The noble one thought to himself: "My oath is now fulfilled; I may go." Then that benighted and ignoble man killed seventy-seven thousand Śākyas, and the great majority of them were those who had seen the truth. Having slaughtered that multitude of beings, he took five hundred youths and five hundred maidens and went to the pleasure garden of the wandering non-Buddhist (tīrthika) teachers, a place called the Sow's Abode.

Mālanod said: "Noble god, you have fully nurtured your enemies. Why leave these enemies alive? Kill them." The noble one handed them over to the executioners and commanded: "Have these ones trampled by elephants." The executioners began to drive the elephants at them, but the youths and maidens pressed the elephants back on their haunches and began to pass one another hand to hand along the elephants' backs.

Mālanod said: "Noble god, do you see, do you behold, how these ones are getting the better of you? If you leave them alive, will they not do you harm?"

"Mālanod, you are right. Ask how they are to be killed, then tell me." He replied: "Noble god, put them in a pit and from above crush them with iron beams. Do as that dictates." So he had them put into the pit and from above crushed them with iron beams.

Then two of them escaped and went before the Blessed One. When they arrived, the Blessed One covered them with his begging bowl, and they died right there. When the Śākyas were slaughtered, the Blessed One's head became very painful.

Then that benighted and ignoble man said to a certain man: "You there — go, take a seat before the Tathāgata, and whatever the Blessed One says, listen and then come back and report it to me." Having said this, he departed. That man went and took his seat before the Blessed One.

Then the Blessed One said to the Venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, bring me a bowl of water." Ānanda offered a bowl of water to the Blessed One. The Blessed One poured just two or three drops of water into it, and from within the water they hissed and sputtered, bubbling with steam, and produced a sound.

The monks, having witnessed this marvel, were filled with faith, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One: "Reverend Blessed One, what deed was performed such that by the ripening of that deed the Blessed One's head has become painful? And as for those Śākyas who dwelled among the yellow-robed ones — what transgression did they commit in a former time? They had done no wrong, they had caused no harm, and yet they were killed by that benighted and ignoble man."

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, come — in that very place where the pig-park pleasure grove of the wandering non-Buddhist ascetics is located, where that deluded and ignoble man killed the Śākyas, I shall there and then prophesy the deeds of both those Śākyas and myself." "Reverend one, so be it," said the monks, and they listened, deferring to the Blessed One.

Then the Blessed One set out for that place — the pig-park pleasure grove of the wandering non-Buddhist ascetics — accompanied by a great many monks. A brahmin of ignoble birth and low lineage caught sight of the Blessed One from quite a distance, and having seen him, addressed the Blessed One in these words: "O Gautama! That deluded and ignoble man has separated from life those Śākyas who dwelled among the yellow-robed ones, who had committed no wrong and done no harm — he has produced a great deal of demerit."

The Blessed One replied: "Brahmin, it is so. It is indeed so. Because that deluded and ignoble man has separated from life those Śākyas who dwelled among the yellow-robed ones, who had committed no wrong and done no harm, he has produced a great deal of demerit."

Then, as the Blessed One arrived at the pig-park pleasure grove of the wandering non-Buddhist ascetics, those Śākyas who had been cut down by the iron swords and in whom a little spark of life yet remained — when they saw the Blessed One, they cried out in pitiful voices. The Blessed One then went to one side, and where a seat had been spread he sat down. Having sat, the Blessed One addressed the monks: "Monks, these Śākyas who dwell among the yellow-robed ones have now, for the third time, raised a great cry — the very same cry as when, in former times, they were fishermen catching fish for the sake of fish, and when, as bandits, they were the same ones who destroyed villages, and now, as those who dwell among the yellow-robed ones and have been left with barely a thread of life remaining by that deluded and ignoble man, they face death and move toward it. In the bursting forth of all these cries there is not the slightest difference, distinction, or variation — they are the same.

"Monks, what do you think? Have you ever seen or heard of a butcher — one who, from that trade, with that craft and that livelihood, rides upon an elephant, or rides upon a horse, or travels in a carriage, or goes about attended by a retinue of men, or comes to dwell having accumulated vast and abundant heaps of wealth?" "Reverend one, no." "Monks, excellent, excellent! I too, from a butcher who with that trade" — and so forth as before, through "comes to dwell having accumulated vast and abundant heaps of wealth" — "have neither seen nor heard of it. And why is that? Because butchers deliberate with evil intention, and therefore such a one does not come to ride upon an elephant or ride upon a horse or travel in a carriage or go about attended by a retinue of men, and does not come to dwell having accumulated vast and abundant heaps of wealth.

"Furthermore, monks, what do you think? Among those who kill chickens, kill pigs, who are fishermen, who snare game, who trap birds, who sell straying donkeys, who kill cattle — from that trade" — and so forth as before, through "comes to dwell having accumulated vast and abundant heaps of wealth — have you seen or heard of such a thing?" And so on as before. "And why is that? Because one who kills cattle deliberates with evil intention, and therefore

such a one does not come to ride upon an elephant" — and so forth as before, through "does not come to dwell having accumulated vast and abundant heaps of wealth" — as stated before.

Monks, even among those who have taken birth in the animal realm, if one deliberates with an evil intention, one will not come to ride upon an elephant, ride on a horse, travel in a carriage, or journey accompanied by a small retinue with all its trappings, nor will one come to dwell having accumulated vast and abundant heaps of wealth. How much less, then, is it possible for a deluded, ignoble, base-born man, overcome by the splendor of moral discipline that has been shattered, to ride upon an elephant, ride on a horse, travel in a carriage, or journey accompanied by a small retinue — to say nothing of dwelling having accumulated vast and abundant heaps of wealth. That simply has no basis whatsoever.

Monks, this very clan of Kosala will, within seven days, have its lineage cut off, as if smitten by a serpent's gaze. And that deluded, ignoble, base-born man, along with his mother and with harm done to her, will, within seven days, be consumed by fire, crying out in lamentation, and will be born in the great hell of Avīci.

Monks, therefore train yourselves thus: "If one should not harbor an evil thought even toward a piece of firewood, how much less toward a body possessed of consciousness." Monks, you should train yourselves in exactly this way.

Then the monks, having doubts arise, presented all their doubts to the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubt. They asked: "Venerable One, what karma did these five hundred Śākyas commit such that, through the karmic maturation of that action, they were killed by that deluded, ignoble, base-born man, having done no wrong and having caused no harm? And at the time the Śākyas were slaughtered, the Blessed One too was struck by a severe headache."

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, these very things, and the karma I myself have performed and accumulated — the conditions fully assembled, present like a creditor who has reached the threshold — will without doubt come to arise. Who else but oneself could experience the karma one has performed and accumulated? Monks, karma that has been performed and accumulated does not ripen in the external element of earth, nor in the element of water, nor in the element of fire, nor in the element of wind. Rather, virtuous and

non-virtuous karma that has been performed and accumulated ripens in nothing other than the appropriated aggregates (skandhas), elements (dhātus), and sense sources (āyatanas) themselves.

Even across a hundred aeons,
actions never come to naught;
when the assembly of causes meets the time,
their fruit ripens for those who bear a body.

Monks, in a time long past, five hundred fishermen dwelt on the bank of a river. They saw two great fish swimming together in the great ocean and then entering that river. Filled with delight, the fishermen ensnared them in a great net. When they saw the bodies of the two fish they began to deliberate: "Friends, how should we proceed with these? These bodies are so very large that if we kill them the flesh will not be manageable — it will rot. So what should be done?" Some said, "What is there to do? Let us kill one and tie up the other and keep it." Others said, "But that one too is enormous, and since it too cannot be managed, let us tie it to a stake, cut off the flesh while it is still alive, and sell it piece by piece." They all agreed: "Good — let it be done so." And as they began to do this, the fish, as they were being cut, began to cry out in their own voice. The suffering of those fish was heard by a young boy who was the child of a fisherman, and he felt delight arise in him at the sound.

Then when the two fish were being cut in this way, they gave rise to the following thought: "We have done no wrong and caused no harm, yet these men have killed us in this fashion. Therefore, wherever these men too have done no wrong —"

may they be killed without having done wrong and without having caused harm."

Monks, what do you think? Those two fish are none other than these very ones: Āryaskanda and Mālāgandha. And those five hundred fishermen are none other than these five hundred Śākyas. By the karmic maturation of the act whereby those two killed the fish in that manner, these five hundred Śākyas — having done no wrong and caused no harm — are now being killed by Āryaskanda and Mālāgandha, crying out as iron shafts press down upon them. As for the fisherman's boy, that was none other than myself at that time, in that life. By the karmic maturation of the act of generating delight when the fish were killed, even now I, having attained perfect and complete awakening, am struck by a severe headache. Had I not attained an

accumulation of qualities such as this, I too would have received karmic results of that very kind.

Monks, hear also what the Śākyas who dwell in the borderlands have done. Monks, long ago, five hundred bandits waylaid travelers on a road, seized their goods, and went to plunder in a rocky mountain gorge. They robbed and plundered every gathering of people dwelling in that rocky gorge. Two householders climbed up to a high ledge and sat there, and the bandits called out to them: "You there — come down! Vanish without a trace!" The two replied: "As long as we live, we will not come down." The bandits then stripped away most of the grass and wood, set that ledge alight, and the two — tormented and consumed by the pain of the heat — gave rise to this thought: "We have done no wrong and caused no harm, yet these men are killing us; therefore may these men too — having done no wrong and caused no harm — be killed."

Monks, what do you think? Those two householders are none other than these very ones: Āryaskanda and Mālāgandha. And those five hundred bandits are none other than these five hundred Śākyas. By the karmic maturation of that act — the act of separating those people from their lives though they had done no wrong and caused no harm — now Āryaskanda, joining with Mālāgandha, has separated these five hundred Śākyas from their lives though they had done no wrong and caused no harm.

Monks, thus it is: the karmic maturation of utterly dark actions is utterly dark; the maturation of utterly bright actions is utterly bright; and the maturation of mixed actions is mixed.

Therefore, monks, abandon utterly dark actions and mixed actions, and strive after utterly pure and bright actions. Monks, you should train yourselves accordingly.

After killing the Śākyas in this way, Āryaskanda went to Śrāvastī. Upon entering the city, he went to the palace in the pleasure garden of the royal prince Jeta, where he played, rejoiced, and made merry with women, without a man in sight. Āryaskanda saw this and said: "Good sirs, who is it that plays here?" The ministers replied: "It is the royal prince Jeta, my lord." He said: "Good sirs, summon him." They summoned him, and Āryaskanda said: "Prince Jeta — I have come after killing my enemies. Are you here amusing yourself?" Jeta replied: "My lord, who are your enemies?" "The Śākyas." "If the Śākyas were your enemies, then what manner of friends did you have?"

He said: "Good sirs, this one too is entirely on their side — he must be killed."
And so they killed him. When his time had passed, he was reborn among the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three. Before the sound of his human music had even ceased, the sound of divine music arose.

Then the Blessed One spoke verses concerning this event:

One who has made merit rejoices here and rejoices hereafter;
in both places one rejoices.

Seeing the ripening of one's own karma, one rejoices and is supremely glad,
and rejoices again at having gone to a good destiny.

One who has made merit is pleased here and pleased hereafter;
in both places one is pleased.

Seeing the ripening of one's own karma, one is pleased and supremely content,
and is pleased again at having gone to a good destiny.

Then the venerable Ānanda said to the Blessed One: "Venerable One, I have not understood the meaning of these verses." The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, the young royal prince Jeta, innocent and without harm, was separated from his life by the arrogant-born man (Āryaskanda), a being of delusion — and before the sound of his human music had ceased, the sound of divine music arose. Reflecting on that, I spoke thus: from 'One who has made merit rejoices here and rejoices hereafter' to 'and is pleased again at having gone to a good destiny.'" When the Blessed One said this, Āryaskanda sat there in silence.

Then at some later time, Āryaskanda was boasting and preening himself in the midst of his queen's retinue, arrogant and full of pride, saying: "I am powerful, heroic, and diligent, and I have crushed my enemies — who is there equal to me?" Then the five hundred Śākya women whom Āryaskanda had taken captive spoke a verse in reply:

Those whom you claim to have crushed
are sons of the Victor, children of the Śākyas,
bound by the restraint of their training.
What right have you to speak thus here?

When they said this, he flew into a rage and ordered his ministers in verse:

Just as the daughters of nāgas, when nāgas are killed,
are shrouded in clouds filled with venom —

cut off the hands and feet of these women,
then quickly release their kinsmen after them.

The ministers cut off the hands and feet of those five hundred Śākya women at the bank of a red pond. The place came to be named "the hollow of the hand, the hollow of the hand," and the elders likewise, at the opening of sūtra passages, inserted the phrase "the Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī, at the bank of the pond of the hollow of the hand."

The Minor Vinaya Matters, ninth fascicle.

When those women were experiencing pain that was unbearable, harsh, burning, and disagreeable, they thought: "We are in unbearable, harrowing, and wretched agony — can it be that the Blessed One has not taken notice of us?" In such a situation, there is not the slightest thing that the Blessed Buddhas do not know, do not see, do not comprehend, or fail to understand. Then, moved by great compassion, the Blessed One made his way to that place, and he saw that all those women were sitting there helpless. Seeing this, the Blessed One gave rise to a worldly resolve of mind. It is the nature of reality (dharma^{tā}) that whenever the Blessed Buddhas give rise to a worldly resolve of mind, even creatures as small as ants and insects know it through the Blessed One's intention and mind. But when they give rise to a transcendent resolve of mind, even śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas do not know the Blessed One's intention and mind through their own minds — let alone the creatures born in the animal realm: what need is there even to speak of them? The Blessed One considered:

"How wonderful!" the Blessed One thought inwardly, just as the divine daughters Bhadra and the others were coming, bearing robes and water. The moment the Blessed One formed this resolve, the divine daughters Bhadra and the others took five hundred pairs of linen cloth and drew water from the great unheated lake Anavatapta, then went to where the Blessed One was. When they arrived, they prostrated at the Blessed One's two feet, touching their heads to the ground, and said: "Venerable One, we have come to offer these five hundred bolts of cloth and water for bathing." The Blessed One replied: "Go, and let the Śākyan women breathe freely. Once they have done so, wash their feet and hands and clothe them in the garments." "It shall be done as you command, Venerable One," they said, and thereupon washed the feet and hands of those women and dressed them in the robes. Then they

prostrated at the Blessed One's feet, touching their heads to the ground, and took their seats before the Blessed One.

The Blessed One then, through his miraculous power, cut the stream of suffering of those five hundred Śākyan women. Having cut it, he declared: "Sisters, these karmic deeds that you yourselves have performed and accumulated, gathered together, brought to full ripeness in their conditions, dwelling close as though at the bank's edge — they are bound to arise without fail. Who else could experience the karma that you yourselves have performed and accumulated? Sisters, apply yourselves to virtue." Having said this, the Blessed One departed.

They, their minds filled with clear faith toward the Blessed One, passed from that life and were reborn among the gods of the Heaven of the Four Great Kings. It is the nature of reality that when a divine son or divine daughter has been born not long before, three recognitions arise: from where one has passed away, where one has been reborn, and by what karma. They saw for themselves that they had passed from among human beings, been reborn among the gods of the Heaven of the Four Great Kings, and that the karma responsible for this was the clear faith they had directed toward the Blessed One.

Then those five hundred gods who had formerly been the Śākyan women occupied with their weaving thought to themselves: "It would not be right for us to wait a number of days before going to see the Blessed One. Come, let us go this very day — without delay — to see the Blessed One." And so those gods who had been the weaving Śākyan women adorned themselves, their sparkling earrings and earrings gleaming, their bodies decorated with garlands and armlets, and that very night they filled their laps with divine flowers — utpalas, lotuses, kumudas, white lotuses, and māṇḍāravas — and illuminated the whole of Prince Jeta's Grove with a great radiance. They scattered those flowers over the Blessed One and sat before the Blessed One to hear the Dharma.

The Blessed One, knowing their intentions, their latent tendencies, their spiritual faculties, and their natures, taught them the Dharma in such a way as would lead them to realize the four noble truths. Hearing this, they shattered with the vajra of wisdom the mountain peak of the view of the transitory collection, twenty heights high, and directly realized the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, they uttered this inspired utterance three times: "Such

healing as the Blessed One has administered to us — this our mothers have not done for us, nor our fathers, nor kings, nor gods, nor the assembly of our own people and dear kinsmen, nor our ancestors of former times, nor ascetics and brahmins. He has dried the ocean of blood and tears, freed us from the mountain of bones, closed the doors to the lower realms, opened the doors to higher states and liberation, and set us in order among gods and humans."

They then spoke again:

Through your power, the paths to the lower realms,
So terribly hard to bear and fraught with harm, are cut.
The doors to higher states are opened; we have gained
Great merit and attained the path to nirvāṇa.

By drawing near to you, today we are freed from fault,
We have gained eyes utterly pure and perfectly clear,
Attained the noble state of joy and peace,
And crossed to the far shore of the ocean of suffering.

Among wandering beings, honored by asuras, gods, and humans,
Free from the faults of birth, aging, and death,
Seeing existence as empty — a thing most rare to find —
O Sage, today there is fruit in having seen you.

Then those of Śemoḍo who had arisen in joy
Prostrated at the two feet of the Blessed One,
Circumambulated the Subduer of Foes,
And departed once more in the direction of the divine world.

The monks, having grown uncertain, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubt: "Venerable One, what karma did those five hundred Śākya women perform, such that their hands and feet were cut off? What karma did they perform, such that they were born among the gods? And what karma did they perform, such that they came to see the truth in the presence of the Blessed One?"

The Blessed One declared: "O monks, these very ones performed and accumulated karma" — and from that point through the passage "ripens as a fruit for embodied beings," it is as before.

"O monks, long ago, in this very good eon, at a time when human life spanned twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and completely awakened buddha, endowed with knowledge and

conduct, a Sugata, a knower of the world, an unsurpassed guide for those to be tamed, a teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one — a Teacher by the name of Kāśyapa. These women had gone forth under his teaching. At that time, these women habitually used the words 'handless' and 'footless' toward monks who were in training and beyond training. Through the karmic maturation of that action, they were born for many years in the hells. Through the remainder of that very karma, for five hundred lifetimes they had their hands and feet cut off, and even up to the present they have had their hands and feet cut off. The karma of having turned their minds with full sincerity toward me ripened as birth among the gods. The fact that they received the scriptural transmission at that time, and recited and chanted it, is what caused them to see the truth in my presence.

"O monks, therefore, for those whose karma is exclusively dark" — and from that point through the passage "strive diligently; O monks, you should train in just this way," it is as before.

Then that man came to Viḍūḍabha, and Viḍūḍabha said: "Ho there, man — what did the Blessed One say?" He replied: "My lord, from the mouth of the Blessed One came these words: 'In seven days from now, Viḍūḍabha, the king of Kosala, will meet his end, struck down like a serpent's gaze.'" And he said: "Viḍūḍabha, together with his mother's harm, will fall like one consumed by fire into the great hell of Avīci, the Unceasing."

Upon hearing this, Viḍūḍabha rested his cheek in his hand and sat absorbed in his own thoughts. His mother, Mālagandha, said: "My lord, why do you sit with your cheek resting in your hand, lost in thought?" He replied: "Mālagandha, the Blessed One has declared: 'In seven days, Viḍūḍabha, together with Mālagandha's harm, will fall like one consumed by fire into the great hell of Avīci, the Unceasing.' How then can I not sit lost in thought?"

She replied: "My lord, one who does not offer a seat to a brahmin who has come — even that person, when he reflects, thinks of a hundred thousand ruinations."

"He killed that many friends and companions of the ascetic Gautama — need one even speak of it? Let him say what he will, or let others say what they will. Nevertheless, let the king have a pavilion built in the pleasure grove, standing on a single pillar in the middle of the water. Let the king go there and remain for seven days in the sky, and when the seven days have passed, let him return to Śrāvastī." He replied, "So be it," and together with the queen's

retinue he went there and took up residence.

When one day had passed, Mālagandha said: "My lord, one of the seven days in the sky has passed. Six days remain. Once the six days have passed, you are to depart for Śrāvastī." And from the second and third day on through to the seventh, she said likewise: "My lord, today you are to depart for Śrāvastī."

Now an ill omen arose. Women are fond of adornment, and so the ladies of the queen's retinue said to one another: "Sisters, since today we must set out for Śrāvastī, let us put on our ornaments." And they began to adorn themselves. One among the queen's retinue had set a crystal gemstone on the top of a tent-panel and was putting on her ornaments. Just then the ill omen cleared, and rays of sunlight struck the crystal, which burst into flame, and the fire spread to the tent-panel, and from there to the pavilion, and the queen's retinue fled.

Viḍūḍabha and Mālagandha also began to flee just as foretold, but spirits had already blocked all the exits. Viḍūḍabha spoke the words exactly as foretold: "Mālagandha, burn!" She replied: "Your majesty too!" And crying out those very words, they were born in the great hell of Avīci, the Unceasing.

Thereupon the Blessed One spoke these verses concerning what had come to pass:

One who has done evil burns here; he burns hereafter; he burns in both.
He burns and is utterly consumed, seeing the karmic ripening of his own deeds.

Having gone to an evil destiny, he burns again.

One who has done evil grieves here; he grieves hereafter; he grieves in both.
He grieves and is utterly tormented, seeing the karmic ripening of his own deeds.

Having gone to an evil destiny, he grieves again.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Ānanda addressed him: "Reverend sir, I do not understand the meaning of these verses."

The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, that man of delusion, Viḍūḍabha, together with Mālagandha, was consumed as if by fire and gone to the hell of Avīci, the Unceasing. With that in mind I spoke, from 'One who has done evil burns here' through 'Having gone to an evil destiny, he grieves again.'"

Now at the time when Viḍūḍabha had slaughtered the Śākya, the daughters of the Śākya, seeing the ornaments of the dead, began to weep. They

thought: "The Śākyas had faith in the noble ones; let these ornaments be offered to the noble ones." And so they gave those ornaments to the monks.

But the group of six monks put on those ornaments and entered the region of Serkya. When the daughters of the Śākyas saw this, they wept just as before and said: "Noble ones, we offered these for a good purpose, and yet this fault has come of it!" And the monks said nothing.

At that time the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One considered: "Whatever fault has arisen comes from the monks having worn ornaments." Therefore a monk shall not wear or sport ornaments,

and he shall not sport or wear pendants, crescents, gold thread, or any ornament whatsoever. If he does so, he incurs an offence entailing censure.

The summary verse:

Receiving and the training rule,
incense, yellow orpiment, and salve,
alms-bowl and cup, raw grain,
white butter, grain-oil, and ointment.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in Prince Jeta's Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. In a certain rocky region there lived a householder who had taken a wife of equal station and was sporting with her, delighting in her, and enjoying pleasures with her. At a later time his relatives all passed away, his wealth was exhausted, and his possessions were spent. He thought to himself: "Now that I am old I cannot acquire wealth, I have no possessions, and my relatives have all passed beyond their time. I will go and take the going-forth." And so he said to his wife: "Good woman, now that I am old I cannot acquire wealth, I have no possessions, and my relatives have all passed beyond their time. I tell you this and then go to take the going-forth."

Now, that householder was straightforward, yet he lived his life as a wanderer, always looking at other men. So she said: "Master, do as you see fit — but come to see me from time to time." He promised to do so, then went to the Jeta Grove. He approached a certain monk and said: "Noble one, I wish to go forth." The monk replied: "Well-favored one, your courageous aspiration is good and excellent. The Blessed One has declared that one who is wise and truly sees five benefits is worthy to aspire to the going-forth. What are those five? One who is wise and truly sees that one will thereby obtain one's own unconfounded aim is worthy to aspire to the going-forth. One who is wise and

truly sees that those who have been one's servants, employees, laborers, dependants, and those without freedom will come to venerate and praise one is worthy to aspire to the going-forth. One who is wise and truly sees that one will attain the accomplishment of nirvāṇa and the highest happiness is worthy to aspire to the going-forth. One who is wise and truly sees that even if one fails to attain the accomplishment of nirvāṇa and the highest happiness, one will be reborn among the gods is worthy to aspire to the going-forth. And one who is wise and truly sees that going-forth is praised in many ways by the buddhas and by those who have gone perfectly well — the most excellent among the holy disciples of the buddhas — is worthy to aspire to the going-forth."

Having spoken thus, the monk said: "You have aroused the mind in a way that is good and excellent. Go forth into this Dharma and Vinaya that has been well proclaimed!" And so he gave him the going-forth and conferred full ordination upon him.

Then, after two or three days, having trained him in the conduct of daily life, he said: "Well-favored one, wander through broad Śrāvastī — which deer do not avoid as they avoid hunters — going for alms in your accustomed domain, your native land, and living by what you receive." The next morning, having put on the lower robe and the Dharma-robe and taken up the alms-bowl, he entered Śrāvastī to go for alms. As he was wandering for alms, he caught sight of a woman who resembled his former wife, and he thought to himself:

"My former wife has come to see me since I went forth. She made a vow on account of that, and so I have only just now gone forth — I shall stay a little while, so that she will not be displeased, and then go on as I must."

With this thought he finished his alms-round and went to the Jeta Grove.

He stayed there for a short while and then said to the preceptor: "Preceptor, I have a former acquaintance who came to see me after I took the going-forth, and she bound me with a vow on that account. Please grant me leave to go to her." The preceptor said: "Go then, son — and guard your mind." He replied: "I shall guard it," and departed, making his way gradually to that rocky cliff.

When she saw him from a good distance away, she went out joyfully to meet him with quick steps and said: "Welcome, noble son! Well come indeed — it has been a long time and now I see you!" And she began to touch him. He said: "What are you doing? Take off the Dharma-robe and let me rest and stretch out on a bed." He said: "Do not touch me." "Why? The preceptor

instructed me to guard my mind against you." She said: "Noble son, guarding your mind is up to you — have I forbidden it? What is to stop you?" And she took his Dharma-robe, spread out a seat, washed his feet, and massaged them.

Then, after she had bathed him, she gave him food, and she too sat down there to eat. He said: "What are you doing?" She said: "Noble son, it has been a long time since you and I ate together." He said: "The preceptor instructed me to guard my mind against you." She said: "Noble son, guarding your mind is up to you — have I forbidden it? I have not. It has been so long since you and I ate together — certainly you must eat." And so she ate with him.

Then she prepared a bed and said: "Noble son, lie down here and recover the rest of sleep that you have long been missing." He washed his feet and lay down, and she too began to lie down right there beside him. He said: "What are you doing?" She said: "Noble son, it has been a long time since we lay together — do not scold me." He said: "The preceptor instructed me to guard my mind against you." She said: "Noble son, guarding your mind is up to you — have I forbidden it? You and I have not lain together for so long — certainly I shall lie here." He was unable to resist.

Then he thought: "If I take hold of her by the neck, she will come under my power." And so he seized her by the neck — but women are a poison to the touch, and from that mere contact he committed transgression.

After remaining there for a long while, he said: "Good woman, I must go." She thought: "Whatever secret has passed between him and me, the monks do not know of it, and so I will let many laypeople know of it. Then, shamed by them, he will have to come back." With that thought she said: "Noble son, before you go, please gather up some provisions for the road — coins and *kārṣāpaṇas*." He said: "Good woman, monks do not touch silver and gold — how am I to take them?" She said: "Noble son, I will arrange it so that you do not have to touch them at all — just let me gather them." And so she bundled the coins together, tied them up, and fastened them to the base of the monk's staff. Those intoxicated by pride, those intoxicated by craving, have not even the slightest restraint — and so he picked it up and went, making his way gradually back to Śrāvastī.

Now as for the conduct of the Group of Six: one of the Group of Six, seeing that the gate of the Jeta Grove was not empty, went to where the venerable Ānanda was walking and sitting at the gate of the Jeta Grove. Catching sight of

him from a great distance — his eyebrows hanging low, like a flower of dishevelled hair — the monk thought to himself: "Here comes an elder monk; I shall go and meet him." And so he went to meet him, saying: "Welcome, Elder! Welcome!" At this, the other said: "Homage to you, Teacher! Homage to you!" Hearing this, the venerable Ānanda thought: "My, this one is an old fellow — he does not know who is a teacher and who is a preceptor. Let me first ask him where he has come from." And so he asked: "Old fellow, where have you come from?" The other replied: "Teacher, I was in a certain place before, in a certain lodging, and I have come from there." Ānanda said: "Good, old fellow — you are one who guards what has been done. And guarding what one has done is praised by the wise." The Blessed One declared: "Therefore, monks, train yourselves thus: you shall guard what has been done, feel what has been done, and not waste even the smallest good deed — to say nothing of a great one." "Did you see your former wife?" "Yes, I saw her." "Was she well?" "She was well." "Old fellow — what was that thing hanging from the base of your staff?" "Teacher, she gave me some kārṣāpaṇas tied up in a bundle of old cloth." "Old fellow, look at you — you have made merit: you have seen your former wife, and you have obtained provisions besides." "It is thanks to your kindness, Teacher." The monk thought: "There may be more I can learn from this; let me question him on everything." And so, speaking to him with gentle words, he asked him about everything. Since the old fellow was by nature straightforward, he recounted to him exactly what had happened. The monk said: "Old fellow, tell all of this to your preceptor — your preceptor will be pleased." The old monk, having been deceived in this way, recounted exactly what had happened to his preceptor. The preceptor in turn told the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, this deluded man's bodily conduct has lapsed, but his intention has not lapsed. A root downfall has occurred. Therefore, from now on, promulgate in full the four conditions that entail a root downfall immediately upon ordination, so that this transgression will not occur again."

The Blessed Buddha was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At Śrāvastī there lived a monk named Priyadatta who constantly practised meditative concentration at forest-edge lodgings in remote places; and so his name became known as Dhyāyin Priyadatta — Priyadatta the Meditator. Whenever he sat cross-legged and meditated, the gods of Māra's host would harass him. On one occasion, as he sat cross-legged, a goddess of Māra's host came and sat upon his crossed legs.

Since a woman is a poison to the touch, she engaged in sexual intercourse with him. The moment the act was over, it struck him like a poisonous thorn, and with a mind aroused he thought: "I have engaged in sexual conduct, in the act of sexual intercourse — I have fallen into ruin." But then he thought: "The intention with which I held on has not for one moment been held by me willingly. Let me go before the Blessed One — if I still have the fortune to continue, I will remain; if not, I shall live as a layman." With this thought, he picked up his robes with his right hand —

— and with his left hand he covered his private parts, his face flushed with shame and his cheeks wet with tears, he made his way to where the Blessed One was.

At that time the Blessed One was seated on a prepared seat in the midst of a vast retinue of many hundreds and thousands of monks, and he was teaching the Dharma. The Blessed One saw the venerable Nandaka while he was still far off. Seeing him, he reflected: "If I do not speak to Nandaka now, there is a danger that he may vomit hot blood and die on the spot." With this thought, the Blessed One spoke these words to the venerable Nandaka: "Nandaka, it is good that you have come. But why does your face flush with shame?"

Nandaka replied: "Reverend sir, I who was formerly Nandaka am now one without joy. I am one without gladness."

"Nandaka, why do you speak like that? What have you done?"

"Reverend sir, without surrendering my training I engaged in unchaste conduct, in the act of sexual intercourse — yet I did not do so with even a single moment of willing intent to conceal it."

"Nandaka, are you willing to train in the precepts for as long as you live?"

"Blessed One, I am willing."

Then the Blessed One addressed the monks: "Monks, although the monk Nandaka engaged in what was not to be engaged in, since he did not do so with even a single moment of willing intent, this has not become a defeat for him. Monks, to Nandaka and to any other who is like him in this way, give the training-vow for as long as he lives. And it is to be given in this manner: set out the seats, strike the wooden signal board, summon all the monks with the words of inquiry, and when the entire Saṅgha is assembled and seated, let the monk Nandaka perform prostrations in order of seniority, and then, crouching down at the end of the senior monks, let him join his palms together and say

these words:

'May the venerable Saṅgha please listen. I, called the monk Nandaka, without surrendering my training engaged in unchaste conduct, in the act of sexual intercourse, yet I did not do so with even a single moment of willing intent to conceal it. I, the monk Nandaka, request from the Saṅgha the training for as long as I live. May the venerable members of the Saṅgha, out of compassion, please take me under the wing of their compassion and grant me, the monk Nandaka, the training for as long as I live.'

This is to be said a second time and a third time in the same way."

After that, the monk Nandaka is to be removed from among those who are within earshot and placed among those who are within eyeshot. One monk then makes the motion and performs the act. The motion is as follows:

"May the venerable Saṅgha please listen. This monk Nandaka, without surrendering his training, engaged in unchaste conduct, in the act of sexual intercourse, yet he did not do so with even a single moment of willing intent to conceal it. This monk Nandaka requests from the Saṅgha the training for as long as he lives. If the time is right for the Saṅgha and they consent, may the Saṅgha please grant it. This is the Saṅgha's granting to the monk Nandaka of the training for as long as he lives. This is the motion."

The act is then performed as follows:

"May the venerable Saṅgha please listen. This monk Nandaka, without surrendering his training, engaged in unchaste conduct, in the act of sexual intercourse, yet he did not do so with even a single moment of willing intent. This monk Nandaka requests from the Saṅgha the training for as long as he lives. In consequence, the Saṅgha grants the monk Nandaka the training for as long as he lives. Those venerable ones who consent to the granting to the monk Nandaka of the training for as long as he lives — let them remain silent. Those who do not consent — let them speak. This is the first recitation of the act."

The second and third recitations of the act are to be performed in the same way. The Saṅgha having consented and granted, the Saṅgha has bestowed the training upon the monk Nandaka for as long as he lives. Since no one spoke, it is held to be so.

I shall now set forth the rules of conduct to be observed by a monk upon whom the training has been bestowed. A monk upon whom the training has been

bestowed must not perform the acts of one who is junior toward a monk who abides in his natural standing — that is, he must not speak respectfully to him, must not bow down to him, must not rise to meet him, must not join his palms in greeting, and must not perform acts of service. He must not sit on the same seat. If he does sit, he must take a seat that is lower. He must not walk in the same procession. If he does walk, he must shorten his steps. The novice who follows behind him must not go to the houses of monks who abide in their natural standing, or to the houses of brahmins and householders. If he does go, he must send the novice ahead. He must not sleep under the same cover. He must not give the going-forth. He must not give full ordination. He must not grant a residence. He must not appoint anyone to act in the capacity of a novice. He must not perform the act of requesting. He must not perform the request-and-two and the request-and-four. He must not commission others to perform acts. He must not be a teacher of nuns. Even if he was previously appointed, he must not instruct the nuns. He must not raise objections against a monk on grounds of impaired moral discipline, impaired view, impaired conduct, or impaired livelihood. He must not seek to extract instruction from him.

These apply to the restoration ceremony, the invitation ceremony, the act of requesting, the request-and-two, and the request-and-four.

In the morning, before others, he must rise and open the doors. He must clear away the lamp vessels. He must sweep the shrine-hall. He must dust with a cloth. He must smear the floor with a good fresh coating of fresh cow dung. He must sweep the toilet rooms. He must set out earth, leaves, and water — cold or warm as the season requires. Then he must clean the rinsing basin. Knowing the proper time, he must set out the seats. He must place the incense burner and incense nearby. If he is able to proclaim the qualities of the Teacher, he must do so himself. If he is not able, he must request the speaker to do it. He must attend to the distribution of food, and once the food has been assigned, he must go up to the roof of the building and strike the gong. In the hot season, he must fan the monks with a fan. Then, after all who are fully ordained, and before those who are not yet fully ordained, with calm and composed conduct, cultivating the perception of himself as a monk, he must take his meal. When the business of the meal is done, he must confine himself to his dwelling and cell. He must relinquish his claim to the bowl stand. Knowing the proper time, he must sweep and clean the Tathāgata's hair and nail reliquary shrines, and smear them with a good fresh coating of fresh cow

dung. When it is time for the assembly to gather, he must arrange the seats and place the incense and incense burner. He must proclaim the qualities of the Teacher. He is to say to the venerable Saṅgha: "May the Saṅgha please listen. Today is the first day of the Saṅgha's month. For the sake of the shrine-hall's lord and the deities of the shrine-hall, please recite the verses." Then he must announce the date of the sun. If he is unable to do so, he must entrust it to a monk.

When the monks would not assign him a dwelling, the Blessed One declared: "Assign him a dwelling." When they would not give him his share of goods received, the Blessed One declared: "Give him his share of goods received." When he would not make effort on the side of virtue, the Blessed One declared: "He must make effort on the side of virtue." This is the conduct prescribed for him, and it continues for as long as he has not entered the path. Entry upon the path, in this context, means the exhaustion of the outflows (āsravas).

Through strenuous effort and exertion he understood this very fifth part of the wheel of saṃsāra — whether it moves or is still — and, meditating on how all conditioned phenomena, by virtue of their very nature of reality (dharmatā), decay, fall apart, disintegrate, and utterly collapse, he abandoned all afflictions and directly actualized arhatship. He became one who is free from attachment to the three realms, equal to gold and dung alike, equal to the sky and the palm of the hand, like sandalwood and a foul-smelling weed, one who has shattered the enclosure of the egg-shell of ignorance, who has obtained knowledge, the higher knowledges, and individual precise understanding, who has turned his back on attachment to worldly gain and on veneration, and who is to be worshipped, honored, and respectfully addressed by gods — both those of the primary faculties and those of the secondary faculties. Though he had attained arhatship, he remained as before, continuing to conduct himself in the same way. The Blessed One then declared: "Let him be seated in order of seniority, and whatever has been prohibited, the monks who remain of their natural disposition shall observe accordingly."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Rājagṛha in the bamboo grove, the Kalandaka park. The venerable Pīṇḍavatsa's companions — those who had taken the going-forth under him and who always lived in celibacy in like manner — went to him and inquired: "Elder, are you well?" He replied: "Friends, I am ill and unwell." "Elder, what ails you?" "Friends, I have a chest ailment." "Elder, please take some medicine." "Friends, I used to rely on the

smoke of a particular plant in the past." "Elder, why do you not rely on it now?" "The Blessed One has not permitted it." The monks then made the matter known to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "In that case, I permit it: a sick monk may inhale the smoke of that plant." The Blessed One having declared that a sick monk may inhale the smoke of the plant, the monks did so — and it was done improperly. The Blessed One then declared: "Make a hole in a bowl, fit another bowl over it, and inhale through that." Still it was done improperly, and the Blessed One declared: "Inhale through a tube." They inhaled through tubes of bamboo — and that same problem arose again. The Blessed One declared: "One must not inhale through a tube of bamboo; rather, make a metal smoking pipe." They made them too short, and the Blessed One declared: "Do not make them too short." They made them too long, and the Blessed One declared: "Do not make them too long; make them twelve finger-breadths in length." They made them sharp-edged, and the Blessed One declared: "Do not make them sharp." They made them rough, and the Blessed One declared: "Do not make them rough." They left them lying about on the ground, and the Blessed One declared: "Do not set them down loosely; put them in a container and keep them there." When they put them in a container and placed them on the ground, the Blessed One declared: "Do not place the container on the ground; rather, hang it on a peg or on a cloth rack." When they carried them about tucked in their robes, the Blessed One declared: "Coat them with butter or oil and store them. When the need arises and they have been used, wash them." The Blessed One declared: "Do not wash them; instead, pass them through fire — that itself is their cleansing."

Summary verse:

What has been accumulated, ointment for bathing, and nasal pouring used
and drinking cups,
What curves and water sources there are, and water and the place for washing
—
these are the topics here set forth.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada.

A sick monk went to a physician and asked him to show him a good medicine. The physician said: "Noble one, bathe with an accumulated-herbs bath and you will recover." The monk replied: "Noble one, the Blessed One has not

permitted it." The physician said: "Your Teacher is compassionate, so he will permit it."

At that point the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "If a physician prescribes it, one may bathe with an accumulated-herbs bath. In doing this bathing, one should feel no remorse."

When the Blessed One had declared that one may bathe with an accumulated-herbs bath, the monks, not knowing what an accumulated-herbs bath actually was, went again to the physician. The monks said: "Noble one, since the Blessed One has given permission, please show us what an accumulated-herbs bath is." The physician replied: "Noble ones, I myself do not know it precisely. From the medical literature of my tradition of the wheel-turning physicians, there is something called an accumulated-herbs bath, but I do not know exactly what it is. However, your Teacher is omniscient, so he himself knows it — go and ask him directly."

At that point the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "The roots, stems, flowers, and fruits of wind-releasing plants — these are to be boiled and used for bathing."

The monks boiled these and bathed with them, and their skin became rough. At that point the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Apply oil to the body." When they had applied it, the oil was so excessive that the bedding became unsuitable for use. The Blessed One declared: "Wash it off by counting as a bath." Even so their skin remained rough, and the Blessed One declared: "Into the last water-pot, pour two or three drops of grain oil."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Rājagṛha in the Bamboo Grove, the garden of the kalandaka birds.

The venerable Pilindavatsa, from the time he went forth in renunciation and onward, was always ill. Those who lived the holy life equally came to him and asked: "Elder, are you comfortable?" The venerable one replied: "Friends, I am ill and uncomfortable." "Elder, what ails you?" "Friends, I have a cold." "Elder, please take some medicine." "Friends, in the past I was accustomed to performing nasal-pouring. The Blessed One has not permitted it." "Elder, why do you not do it?" "The Blessed One has not permitted it."

At that point the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, permission is granted: the practice of nasal-pouring may

be performed."

When the Blessed One had declared that nasal-pouring may be performed, the monks at first poured it in the same way as the pouring itself was done. The Blessed One declared: "Do not pour it in that manner." The monks poured it using a leaf tube, and the same fault arose. The Blessed One declared: "Do not pour it using a leaf tube." The monks poured it using the corner of a monastic robe, and the same fault arose again. The Blessed One declared: "Do not pour it using the corner of a monastic robe. Instead, use a nasal-pouring implement." The monks made a nasal-pouring implement with a single spout. The Blessed One declared: "Make the nasal-pouring implement with two spouts." The monks made the spouts sharp, and the Blessed One declared:

"Do not make the spouts sharp." The monks poured the nasal medicine without having washed their hands. The Blessed One declared: "One should wash one's hands, receive it properly, and then pour it."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was residing at Rājagṛha in the Bamboo Grove of Kalandaka. The Venerable Pilindavatsa, from wherever he had gone forth, had up to that time always been sick, and those who were living the holy life in conformity with celibacy went to him and asked: "Elder, are you comfortable, are you well?" He replied: "I am sick; I am not well." "Elder, what is your illness?" "Venerable ones, it has been permitted." "Elder, please take a little medicine." "Venerable ones, I am holding a drinking bowl that was given to me previously." "Elder, why do you not hold it now?" "The Blessed One has not permitted it." At that point the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, let one hold a drinking bowl that has been permitted and given."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was residing at Rājagṛha in the Bamboo Grove of Kalandaka. Relatives of the Venerable Pilindavatsa came, and he taught them the Dharma. They then went home and said to their wives: "The noble Pilindavatsa has taught the Dharma in a fine and beautiful way, and we came here having listened to him." Their wives said to them: "Then you have come with the fruit of the buddha's arising." Why did they say that? "Because you listened to the noble Pilindavatsa teaching the Dharma in a fine and beautiful way. Why do you not listen?" "We are people of modest standing; we are shy. However, if the noble one were to come here and teach, we too would listen." "If that is so, let us invite the noble one." They said: "Excellent." They went to him and said: "Noble one, the women wish to hear the Dharma." He replied:

"Wise ones, let them listen and take it in. Did I forbid them?" They said: "Noble one, we are shy speaking on behalf of the women. We came to say that if the noble one would come here and teach, we would also listen." He replied: "Wise ones, I am too ill to go and teach." "Noble one, we request that you ride a palanquin and come. If the fair-faced Blessed One has not permitted it, how can you go?" At that point the monks heard this and reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, let it be permitted to travel by palanquin."

When the Blessed One had declared that one might travel by palanquin, the Venerable Pilindavatsa, with his attendants and personal servants around him, mounted the palanquin and set out to teach the Dharma. The Group of Six saw this, and they asked his attendants and personal servants: "Wise ones, who is this travelling?" They replied: "It is the preceptor." "Has the Blessed One permitted the palanquin?" "He has." "The Blessed One's intention is good — because these Śākya pleasure-folk cannot travel on foot, he has shown consideration for us in every way." Once they had gone, the Group of Six said among themselves: "Friends, dear friends, why are we left out? Let us also ride palanquins." "Yes, splendid, let us do the same." So they had palanquins made, adorned with tails and bells and the like, and mounted them. They then entered the main street, riding about in a manner that assumed a lordly status over the world, and the brahmins and householders said: "Wise ones, what is this?" "The Blessed One has permitted riding." "Noble ones, has he permitted you renunciants also to partake of sensual pleasures?" But they said nothing at all.

At that time the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "A sick monk must not travel by riding. If a sick monk travels by riding, it will constitute an offense. Nevertheless, there are two cases in which riding is permitted: one who is feeble with old age, and one who is ill and cannot manage the journey on foot."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was staying at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. In Śrāvastī there lived a faithful householder who went to the Jeta Grove together with a brahmin woman of no faith, and the faithful one began pointing out the surrounding grove to her. As the two wandered about, they came upon some excrement at the base of a tree. The brahmin woman said: "Friend, these renunciants, the sons of the Śākya, have no cleanliness whatsoever — they defecate and urinate at the base of flowering and fruit-bearing trees." The other replied: "Friend, the great ones

themselves would not do such a thing; it must certainly have been done by some layperson." As they were speaking thus, an old monk who had wrapped his head in a cloth began to defecate at the base of a tree. The faithless brahmin woman, seeing this, said: "Friend, did you not just say it was done by a layperson? Look — a renunciant with his head wrapped in cloth, defecating at the base of a tree!" The faithful one was ashamed and sat there saying nothing at all. The brahmin woman then reported the incident to the monks. The monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One considered it: "Whatever fault has arisen has come about through monks defecating at the base of trees. Therefore monks must not defecate or urinate at the base of trees. If they do, it will constitute an offense."

When the Blessed One had declared that monks must not defecate or urinate at the base of trees, the monks set out along the road and came to a remote place. There some monks needed to defecate. Others who needed to urinate, thinking that these trees had leaves and branches, refrained from both defecating and urinating, and as a result they fell ill. The monks then reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Trees in the wilderness that have leaves and branches — there one may defecate and urinate, and there should be no regret about this."

When the Blessed One had declared that defecating and urinating might be done in the wilderness, the monks who lived near towns did not do so. In time the spring season arrived, and as they defecated and urinated during the day the ground became soiled. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore it is permitted: one may defecate and urinate at the base of thorny trees, and there should be no regret about this."

When Upananda made the enclosure of a hermitage unsuitable for use by fouling it with excrement, the Blessed One declared: "A monk must not defecate or urinate where there is green grass." The monks then defecated and urinated in places where there was no green grass, and those places became filled with filth. When brahmins and householders saw this, they mocked and reviled them, saying: "Look how these renunciants, the sons of the Śākya, have a fine custom — just as they all gather together to eat, so too they defecate and urinate." The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore it is permitted: a latrine pit should be made."

The monks set about building a latrine house on the north and west sides, but not knowing how it should be constructed, they asked the Blessed One, and he declared: "A latrine pit should be of two kinds: one resembling a small house, and one resembling an open shed. The house-type is made square, with a crossbeam in the middle, and an opening is cut in it with a wooden frame fitted around it. The shed-type is constructed with the beams projecting outward, and thorny plants are grown beneath it. On the latrine site, above the pit of the latrine, footrests should be placed. There should also be a place set aside for a rinsing pot and a communal water ladle. The door should be hung so it closes downward, and both a door bolt and a door latch should be fitted. If someone has entered inside, the one waiting outside should make a sound; and if the person is still inside, one may enter only if it is all right to do so. The person inside should also make a sound. If it becomes malodorous, the one responsible for maintaining the building should clean it each day, and earth and leaves should also be kept on hand. Therefore a latrine pit together with its surroundings is hereby permitted."

Now follows the Vinaya section on minor matters, the tenth fascicle. Its summary verse reads:

A site for urination, vessels and utensils,
And delight in the Teacher himself,
Five foods, and milk,
Curds, solid food, and what was permitted.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. When the Blessed One had declared that a latrine pit together with its surroundings should be made, the monks urinated right in that same latrine area, and other monks were distressed by the smell of the excrement and were obstructed from passing through that way. The Blessed One then declared: "There should be a separate place for urination." The monks did not know in which direction or in what manner to make it, and the Blessed One declared: "Nearby that same spot, make one of the shed type: fit a wooden surround and install both a door bolt and a latch. Everything else about the urination place should be done just as before with the latrine."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. During the hot season a certain brahmin was so parched with thirst that, yearning for water, he entered the monastery. He went up to a certain monk and said: "Venerable monks, if you are thirsty,

please give me some water." The monk took up his rinsing vessel and went to him and said: "Brahmin, drink." The brahmin said: "Noble one, a vessel for cleansing is quite a different thing. Oh my! Leave your water vessel aside. Is there any harm in pouring water for a wandering ascetic or a brahmin? Are you not thereby earning merit?" At that point the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "A communal water vessel for the Saṅgha should be provided."

When the Blessed One declared that a communal water vessel for the Saṅgha should be provided, a certain householder heard that the Blessed One had permitted a communal water vessel for the Saṅgha. He had a stock of pottery vessels made by potters piled up inside the monastery. From that supply, those who lived in the garden as well as other laypeople took away whatever they wished and departed. Because the monks did not stop them, those vessels were exhausted. The monks then said to that householder: "Good sir, the vessels have run out; please give others." He said: "Noble ones, I offered a great many — why did they disappear so quickly?" When they told him how it had come about, he said: "Noble ones, whatever was simply thrown away and lost — that was not well done."

When he said, "I did not give those to the laypeople," the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "One must not simply throw things away and let them be lost. Rather, a keeper of vessels and utensils is to be appointed." When the monks appointed one without discrimination, the Blessed One declared: "One who lacks the five qualities should not be appointed as keeper of vessels and utensils, and if already appointed should be removed. What are the five? He is led by desire, led by aversion, led by delusion, led by fear, and does not know what vessels and utensils have been distributed and what have not. One who possesses the five qualities should be appointed as keeper of vessels and utensils, and if already appointed should not be removed. What are the five? He is not led by desire, not led by aversion, not led by delusion, not led by fear, and knows what vessels and utensils have been distributed and what have not."

"The appointment is to be carried out as follows: after seats have been arranged and the wooden signal-board struck" — and so forth, as before, down to "and let him consent" — "You, named so-and-so, do you consent to serve as keeper of vessels and utensils for the Saṅgha? If you consent, let him say, 'I consent.'"

After that, one monk is to make a motion and carry out the formal act: "May the venerable Saṅgha hear me. If the monk named so-and-so consents to serve as keeper of vessels and utensils for the Saṅgha, and if the time is right and the Saṅgha approves, may the Saṅgha grant its consent; and the Saṅgha shall appoint this monk named so-and-so as keeper of vessels and utensils for the Saṅgha. This monk named so-and-so shall be keeper of vessels and utensils for the Saṅgha. This is the motion."

"The formal act is also to be performed thus: May the venerable Saṅgha hear me. This monk named so-and-so consents to serve as keeper of vessels and utensils for the Saṅgha. Therefore the Saṅgha shall appoint this monk named so-and-so as keeper of vessels and utensils for the Saṅgha. Those venerable ones who approve of appointing this monk named so-and-so as keeper of vessels and utensils for the Saṅgha shall remain silent; those who do not approve shall speak. The Saṅgha has consented and approved; the Saṅgha has appointed this monk named so-and-so as keeper of vessels and utensils for the Saṅgha. So it is held, since no one has spoken."

That keeper then gave the old vessels and utensils to the monks and gave the new ones to the laypeople. The Blessed One declared: "New ones are to be given to the monks, and old ones to the laypeople." That keeper, having given some to the laypeople, did not reclaim them, but did reclaim them from the monks. The Blessed One declared: "What has been given to the laypeople may be reclaimed, but not what has been given to the monks." When vessels were left outside and became scattered about, the Blessed One declared: "A storeroom for vessels and utensils is to be made, and the vessels and utensils made by potters are to be kept there."

When the Blessed One had declared that a storeroom for vessels and utensils was to be made and the pottery kept there, it so happened that a traveler arrived from the north. He supplied the Saṅgha with all manner of provisions for three months. Then he thought: "Why should I serve the Saṅgha with inferior provisions? Rather, I shall serve them with my own vessels and utensils." With that in mind, he set out a great many bronze vessels and utensils. He then made an offering feast to the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of monks for three months, providing abundant provisions. At the end of the feast he took his leave and departed.

When he departed, he donated all those bronze vessels and utensils to the Saṅgha. The monks stored them in that same storeroom together with the

pottery made by the potter. The bronze vessels and utensils shifted against the pottery and broke it. The Blessed One then declared: "The bronze vessels and utensils are to be kept separately, and the pottery made by the potter is likewise to be kept separately."

Now it happened that a brahmin, suffering from thirst, came in distress to the Jeta Grove and went to the quarters of a certain monk, where he said: "Venerable monk, I am thirsty — please give me water." The monk gave him a water pot and a cord. The brahmin said: "Noble one, what am I to do with these? Please give me water." The monk replied: "Brahmin, water that is lifted by a rope is not available here." The brahmin said: "Noble one, you have entered upon the path of benefiting all sentient beings — how could it be unsuitable for you to keep water readily at hand?" The monk replied: "The Blessed One has not permitted it."

At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "The Saṅgha may keep water at hand." The monks then placed it here and there in the corridors, in the dwelling rooms, inside the assembly hall, in the gate-house, and on the stairways. The Blessed One declared: "It is not to be placed here and there in the corridors, in the dwelling rooms, inside the assembly hall, in the gate-house, and on the stairways. Instead, a water-house is to be built."

When the Blessed One had declared that a water-house was to be built, the monks did not know in which direction or what form it should take. The Blessed One declared: "Inside the assembly hall, on the south and west sides, a water-house is to be built."

When it became dark inside, the Blessed One declared: "Windows are to be fitted." When mud accumulated, the Blessed One declared: "A brick floor is to be laid and a drain hole fitted. A door is to be fitted, and a door panel and its frame are also to be installed." When the water pots were placed directly on the ground, the Blessed One declared: "They are to be placed on wooden stands." When there were no wooden stands, the Blessed One declared: "Brick platforms are to be made, and the pots placed on top without resting them against the wall." When the water inside the pots went bad, the Blessed One declared: "The pots are to be washed from time to time." When the monks did not know with what to wash them, the Blessed One declared: "A wooden scrubber — either a piece of wood with a pumice stone attached, or a bundle of thick leaves, or a bundle of cotton cloth tied together — may be used to

scrub and wash them." Nevertheless, the water continued to go bad. The Blessed One declared: "Half the pots are to be washed while fresh water is poured into the other half." When the Blessed One had declared that water was to be poured in, the monks did not know who should pour it. The Blessed One declared: "Those who are in residence are to pour the water."

Accordingly, the water-house along with its furnishings was permitted.

The Blessed One, the awakened Bhagavān, was residing in Kapilavastu in the Nyagrodhā Grove. Then the great Prajāpatī Gautamī came with five hundred followers to where the Blessed One was, and arriving there, she bowed her head to the feet of the Blessed One and sat to one side. As Prajāpatī Gautamī sat there, from the passage beginning "The Blessed One addressed her with words in keeping with the Dharma" up to "The Blessed One was refreshed," everything proceeds as before.

Then the great Prajāpatī Gautamī spoke these words to the Blessed One: "May the Blessed One live long, and may the Great Sage dwell for an aeon."

Hearing the voice of the great Prajāpatī Gautamī, the five hundred nuns likewise said in the same words: "May the Blessed One live long, and may the Great Sage dwell for an aeon." The yakṣas of the earth heard the voice of the five hundred nuns and cried out and sang: "May the Blessed One live long, and may the Great Sage dwell for an aeon." The voice of the earth-dwelling yakṣas was heard by the yakṣas of the sky, by the gods of the realms of the Four Great Kings, by the gods of the Thirty-Three, by the gods Free from Strife, by the gods of the Joyful Heaven, by the gods of the Heaven of Delight in Emanation, and by the gods of the Heaven of Mastery over Others' Emanations. In that very instant, in that very moment, in that very flash — in an instant, in a moment, in a flash — the sound spread all the way to the Brahmā world, and the gods of the Brahmā realms cried out and sang: "May the Blessed One live long, and may the Great Sage dwell for an aeon."

Then the Blessed One addressed the great Prajāpatī Gautamī with these words: "Gautamī, you have caused a hindrance to many sentient beings. Your voice was heard by the five hundred nuns, who thereupon raised the same cry; and through the voice of those five hundred nuns, the earth-dwelling yakṣas, the sky-dwelling yakṣas, the gods of the realms of the Four Great Kings, the gods of the Thirty-Three, the gods Free from Strife, the gods of the Joyful Heaven, the gods of the Heaven of Delight in Emanation, and the gods of the Heaven of Mastery over Others' Emanations heard it, and in that very instant,

in that very moment, in that very flash — in an instant, in a moment, in a flash — the sound pervaded all the way to the Brahmā world, and the gods of the Brahmā realms likewise raised that same cry. Yet, Gautamī, one should not pay homage to the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha in that manner — to pay homage in that way is not to pay homage well."

"Venerable One, how then should one pay homage to the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha? How should homage be paid so that it is homage well paid?"

"Gautamī, one should pay homage to the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha in this way: 'May my Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha of hearers, be in harmony, rejoicing together, without dispute, of one mind, reciting in unison, blended like water and milk, and may the teaching of the Teacher shine forth with clarity.' To pay homage in that way to the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha is homage well paid."

At that point a monk spoke these verses:

The great Prajāpatī Gautamī, sovereign of beings,
bowed at the feet of the Teacher,
and prayed: "May my Blessed One live long;
may the Great Sage dwell for an aeon."

She addressed the Teacher with those words,
and the Teacher replied to his disciple thus:

"Gautamī, the homage you have paid
is not homage to the Tathāgata.

How should one possessed of wisdom
pay homage to the Tathāgata
so that it is homage truly well paid?

Teach me, I ask, what I should know.

Those who strive with energy, who are themselves diligent,
who steadily and firmly surpass the other shore,
hearers who dwell in harmony, viewing one another as kin —
that is homage to the buddha."

The great Prajāpatī Gautamī reflected: "The Blessed One has spoken in praise of a harmonious Saṅgha. Therefore, for as long as the Blessed One remains and the Saṅgha of monks is in harmony, I shall pass completely into nirvāṇa."

Realizing this, she rose from her seat, turned to face the Blessed One, joined her palms, and bowed.

She said to the Blessed One: "Venerable One, I wish to pass into nirvāṇa deliberately and of my own accord." When she had spoken, the Blessed One sat in silence. The great Prajāpatī Gautamī addressed the Blessed One a second time and a third time: "Venerable One, I wish to pass into nirvāṇa deliberately and of my own accord." And the Blessed One sat in silence a second time and a third time. Then the great Prajāpatī Gautamī addressed the Blessed One once more: "Venerable One, I wish to pass into nirvāṇa deliberately and of my own accord." When she had spoken, the Blessed One said to her: "Gautamī, do you speak in order to pass into nirvāṇa?" "Blessed One, it is for the sake of your passing into nirvāṇa." "Gautamī, do you speak in order to pass into nirvāṇa?" "Sugata, it is for the sake of your passing into nirvāṇa." "Gautamī, if you speak in order to pass into nirvāṇa — all conditioned phenomena are of such a nature; what need have I to speak of it?" The five hundred nuns too bowed their heads to the Blessed One's feet and said: "Venerable One, we also wish to pass into nirvāṇa deliberately and of our own accord." The Blessed One declared: "Gautamīs, do you speak in order to pass into nirvāṇa?" "Blessed One, it is for the sake of your passing into nirvāṇa." "Gautamīs, do you speak in order to pass into nirvāṇa?" "Sugata, it is for the sake of your passing into nirvāṇa." "Gautamīs, if you speak in order to pass into nirvāṇa — all conditioned phenomena are of such a nature; what need have I to speak of it?"

Then the great Prajāpatī Gautamī, rejoicing and delighting in what the Blessed One had said, bowed her head to the Blessed One's feet and departed. The venerable Ānanda, Anupama, Selā, and the venerable Ānanda of the eastern quarter went to where the venerable Ānanda was, and having arrived they bowed to his feet and said to him: "Venerable One, we wish to pass into nirvāṇa deliberately and of our own accord." "Gautamīs, do you speak in order to pass into nirvāṇa?" "Venerable Ānanda, it is for the sake of your passing into nirvāṇa." "Gautamīs, do you speak in order to pass into nirvāṇa?" "Venerable Ānanda, it is for the sake of your passing into nirvāṇa." "Gautamīs, if you speak in order to pass into nirvāṇa — sisters, conditioned phenomena are of such a nature; what need have I to speak of it?"

Then the great Prajāpatī Gautamī together with her retinue of five hundred nuns bowed their heads to the feet of the elder monks and elders and went to the rains-retreat hall. There, having examined the nature of the assembly of

three groups, she taught the Dharma in such a way that over seven days, through whatever she taught, the great multitude of sentient beings attained great distinction. Then, in an open and spacious spot, she sat with her legs half-crossed in the midst of the community of nuns. The nuns likewise sat in the same manner.

Then the great Prajāpatī Gautamī entered into a meditative absorption of the following kind: having settled her mind in equanimity, she rose from her seat, became invisible, soared aloft into the sky to the east, and displayed the four kinds of deportment — walking, standing, sitting, and lying — and then also entered into the fire element. Having entered into the fire element, from the body of the great Prajāpatī Gautamī rays of many varied colors blazed forth — blue and yellow and

red and white and crimson and crystal-colored — and displayed pairs of miraculous transformations: from the lower part of her body flames blazed forth, while from the upper part of her body streams of cool water flowed; and then from the upper part of her body flames blazed forth, while from the lower part of her body streams of cool water flowed. Just as she had done in the eastern direction, so too she did in the southern, western, and northern directions. In this way she displayed all four varieties of miraculous transformation through supernatural power in the four directions, and then she entered into meditative absorption in the first dhyāna. The five hundred nuns likewise entered into meditative absorption in the first dhyāna. Rising from the first dhyāna, she entered the second; from the second, the third; from the third, the fourth; from the fourth, the base of infinite space; from the base of infinite space, the base of infinite consciousness; from the base of infinite consciousness, the base of nothingness; from the base of nothingness, she entered into the base of neither-perception-nor-non-perception. Then, rising from the base of neither-perception-nor-non-perception, she re-entered the base of nothingness; from the base of nothingness, the base of infinite consciousness; from the base of infinite consciousness, the base of infinite space; from the base of infinite space, the fourth dhyāna; from the fourth, the third; from the third, the second; from the second, she entered meditative absorption in the first dhyāna. Then, resting in the first dhyāna itself, she passed completely into nirvāṇa. The five hundred nuns likewise, having entered meditative absorption in the forward sequence and the reverse sequence in the same manner, resting in the first dhyāna itself, passed completely into nirvāṇa.

The moment the great Prajāpatī Gautamī, mother of beings, passed into nirvāṇa, the great earth trembled, shooting stars fell, the horizon turned red, and the sounds of divine music arose in the sky.

Then the monks who were practicing meditation on the terraced slopes of Mount Meru, and also those in towns and villages and districts, in royal palaces, and in remote and secluded dwellings — feeling the great earth tremble, they wondered why it was shaking. And when they saw that the great Prajāpatī Gautamī, mother of beings, together with her retinue of five hundred, had passed completely into nirvāṇa, they thought to themselves: since the foster-mother of the Buddha has passed into nirvāṇa, we should go and devote ourselves to making the finest offerings to her body. And so, taking fragrant wood, they went to the summer pavilion of the great Prajāpatī Gautamī.

The Blessed One too, together with the great śrāvaka Kuṇḍinya the All-Knower, the great Kāśyapa, Lāṅgika, Nāmaśān, Aniruddha, Śāriputra, Maudgalyāyana, and others, and also together with the great community of monks, went to the summer pavilion of the great Prajāpatī Gautamī. Likewise, the king of Kośala, Prasenajit, surrounded by his queen's retinue and by young nobles, ministers, townspeople, and country folk; the householder Anāthapiṇḍada surrounded by his retinue; Mrgāramātā Viśākhā; the elder sage Ṛṣidatta; Purāṇa; and other assemblies of people who had come from various regions — all went to the summer pavilion of the great Prajāpatī Gautamī.

Then King Prasenajit, with five hundred cushioned couches adorned with jewels and various silks, with incense, fragrant perfumes, flowers, garlands, parasols, victory banners, pennants, and

offered various kinds of music. Then the venerable Ānanda, Avighna, Nandaka, and Sundarananda raised up the litter of the great Prajāpatī Gautamī, and the Blessed One supported it with his right hand. The remaining monks likewise raised up the litters of the remaining nuns. Then, having performed a great offering, they carried the litters and set them down in an open space of ground at some distance. The Blessed One then removed the outer robes from the bodies of the great Prajāpatī Gautamī and the five hundred nuns, and declared to the monks: "O monks, look upon the great Prajāpatī Gautamī and these five hundred nuns — though they have reached one hundred and twenty years of age, there is not a single wrinkle on their bodies, not a single white hair; behold them as though they were girls of sixteen."

Then the king of Kośala, Prasenajit, together with the queen's retinue, young nobles, ministers, townspeople, and country folk, piled up heaps of fragrant wood of various kinds and cremated the great Prajāpatī Gautamī and the five hundred nuns. The Blessed One taught on the nature of impermanence and then departed for the monastery. Having arrived, he took his seat on the prepared throne in the midst of the monks' assembly. Seated there, he declared to the monks: "O monks, in regard to saying 'May there be recovery' when a fainting has occurred — there are faults such as these, and others besides. Therefore a monk must not say 'May there be recovery' when a fainting has occurred. If he says it, it becomes a serious transgression."

The monks, having arisen in doubt, asked the buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubt: "Venerable One, what karma did the great Prajāpatī Gautamī and the five hundred nuns perform, such that, though they had reached one hundred and twenty years of age, there was not a single wrinkle on their bodies, not a single white hair, and they appeared as girls of sixteen?"

The Blessed One declared: "O monks, the great Prajāpatī Gautamī and those five hundred nuns themselves assembled an accumulation of karma, transformed the conditions, abided like a flame, and brought about what would certainly be experienced. The karma accumulated by the great Prajāpatī Gautamī and those five hundred nuns — who else could experience the ripening of it individually? O monks, accumulated karma does not ripen in the external element of earth, nor in the element of water, nor in the element of fire, nor in the element of wind. Rather, the virtuous and non-virtuous karma that has been performed and accumulated ripens in the appropriated aggregates (skandhas), elements (dhātus), and sense bases (āyatanas). As it is said:

Even through hundreds of aeons,
karma does not perish;
when the conditions and the time arrive,
it ripens as fruit for embodied beings.

"O monks, in the distant past, in this very auspicious aeon, when the lifespan of beings was twenty thousand years, a Teacher called Kāśyapa appeared in the world." — and so on as before, up to: — "and he dwelt in dependence upon the Deer Park at the Sages' Discourse in the city of Vārāṇasī.

"When the perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa had performed all the deeds of a buddha and passed completely into nirvāṇa — the nirvāṇa without

remainder, like a fire whose fuel is exhausted — at that time a king called Kṛkī performed bodily offerings to his body, and at the four crossroads of the great highway erected a stūpa of one league in circumference and half a league in height, made of the four precious substances."

The queen Dampa and the other five hundred women of King Kṛkī — when they had grown old and wrinkles and grey hair had appeared on their bodies and the king had cast them aside, they began to speak among themselves. "Friends, why has the god cast us aside?" Some of them said, "What is there to reflect upon? We have grown wrinkled and grey-haired, and that is why we have been cast aside." Others said, "That is so. But now what shall we do regarding the god? There are other women who still possess beauty and youth; he will surely be taking his pleasure and delight with them. Therefore let us go to the stūpa of the Blessed One Kāśyapa, pay homage, and make an aspiration prayer: 'May we, from this point forward throughout saṃsāra, never be reborn with wrinkles and grey hair on our bodies.'" They said, "Excellent! Let us do just so." And so they made offerings at the stūpa of the perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa — with fragrant substances, garlands, unguents, parasols, victory banners, and pennants — and having hung beautiful bunches of various flowers fragrant and fresh, and charming garlands, they made this aspiration prayer: "By the root of virtue that we have accumulated through making offerings to the Blessed One, the perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa, the unsurpassed field of merit, may we never develop wrinkles or grey hair on our bodies even when we have lived to one hundred and twenty years of age."

Monks, what do you think? Those five hundred women — the queen Dampa and the rest — who were the attendants of King Kṛkī, those very same ones are these five hundred nuns, headed by the Great Mistress of Beings. By the karmic maturation of that deed — of having made offerings at the stūpa of the perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa and having made aspirational prayers — they are such that even now, having been born and reached the age of one hundred and twenty, they have no wrinkles or grey hair on their bodies, but appear like girls of sixteen.

Monks, therefore, from the passage beginning "Those whose karma is thoroughly dark" — it should be sought out thus, and the remainder is as before, up to "Thus, monks, should you train." When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the monks rejoiced in what the Blessed One had said and praised it with delight.

When the Blessed One had declared that a monk who falls unconscious should not be revived by anyone calling out to him, there was in Śrāvastī a certain householder who had taken a wife from an equal family. He would sport with her, delight in her, and take his pleasure with her. Though they sported and delighted and took pleasure together, there was neither son nor daughter. When old age came upon him, his wealth and property were exhausted, and he said to his wife: "My good woman, I am old and poor, with neither son nor daughter, and so I shall go to the Jeta Grove and go forth." She said, "Sire, please do so, please go forth." He went to the Jeta Grove and went forth.

Some time later, his former wife came to visit him, and when he fell unconscious, no monk called out to revive him. Then his former wife took up some earth with her left hand, rubbed it along the joint, and said, "May he live for a long time." The monks then began to investigate the matter, and she took him by the hand, drew him out, and said —

"Son of a king, you have gone forth among enemies. This Jeta Grove is not empty of five hundred yakṣas wearing blue garments, and it was I alone who revived you — that is why they did not carry off your vitality. Stay here, I urge you; come away to your own home." So saying, she took him by the hand and departed.

The monks said to him, "Old man, do not go." But he continued on his way and would not stay. The monks seized him by one arm and pulled him back, and he cried out, "It hurts, it hurts!" At that the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Ask him in which arm the pain is. If he says, 'In the arm you are holding,' then he definitely wants to go — release him entirely in all respects. If he says, 'In the arm my former wife was holding,' then he does not want to go, and you should not release him."

"However, monks, the old man is one whose intention is to stay alive, and therefore when an old man falls unconscious, you should call out to revive him."

The monks asked him, "Old man, which arm hurts?" He replied, "Venerable ones, the one you are holding." They released him, and he went to his own home. That very matter became an obstacle to his going forth and receiving full ordination and becoming a monk.

The Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At Śrāvastī there was a faithful layman who went to the Jeta Grove together with an unfaithful brahmin woman. When the layman fell

unconscious, no monk called out to revive him, but that same brahmin woman revived him and said, "Friend, you have faith in enemies. This Jeta Grove is not empty of five hundred yakṣas wearing blue garments, and it was I alone who revived you — so do not let them steal away your vitality; come back this way." When the monks reported this to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "Monks, laypeople are ones whose intention is to stay alive, and therefore when a layman falls unconscious, you should call out to revive him."

"Furthermore, monks, when an elder falls unconscious, a junior should rise and pay respect; and when a junior falls unconscious, the elder should say, 'Be well.'"

The Blessed One was dwelling at Vārāṇasī, in the Deer Park in the Ṛṣipatana grove. At the time when the Blessed One introduced the group of five monks, who were endowed with certainty, into the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, those monks did not know what they should eat as supplementary food and what they should eat as regular food. When the monks reported this to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "Monks, there are five kinds of supplementary food: root food, stem food, leaf food, flower food, and fruit food. The five kinds of regular food are: flour, grain porridge, hot cooked rice, meat, and oil-bearing foods."

When they still did not know what the condiments were and what could be eaten, the Blessed One declared: "Milk, yogurt, fresh butter, ghee, fish, meat, dried meat, and whatever else is suitable — even if it is simply moistened with water, it may be consumed. Monks, anything moistened is restorative."

Verses in summary: the bolt of the door and the handle, the lattice of the windows,

the lower hinge and the upper hinge, the waist-bar, the dry wooden peg.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The monks were building dwelling-houses but were not fitting them with doors. The Blessed One declared: "Doors are to be fitted." The monks fitted doors but did not insert door-panels, and those who had entered into meditative concentration and recitation were visible to all. Brahmins and householders saw them, came close, and addressed them in conversation, so that their one-pointed mental composure was lost. The Blessed One declared: "Door-panels are to be inserted." The monks inserted door-panels, but since the handles had no eye-holes bored in them, it was difficult to distinguish them. The Blessed One

declared: "Eye-holes are also to be bored into the handles." When these were opened, a noise arose. The Blessed One declared: "A piece of leather is to be inserted." Since no window-lattices had been fitted, it became pitch dark. The Blessed One declared: "Window-lattices are to be fitted." When they were fitted too low, thieves and miscreants were able to enter. The Blessed One declared: "They are not to be fitted too low." When they were fitted too high, the same problem arose. The Blessed One declared: "They are to be fitted in the middle." The monks made the inner recess narrow and the outer opening wide. The Blessed One declared: "The outer recess should be narrow and the inner opening wide, fitted in the shape of the ocean." Birds and pigeons entered. The Blessed One declared: "A net is to be made." The monks made a net, but since they had not inserted a door-sill, snakes, scorpions, insects called traymabuka, and trailata entered. The Blessed One declared: "A door-sill is to be inserted." The monks inserted a door-sill, but it did not hold at the bottom. The Blessed One declared: "A lower hinge is to be inserted." When the monks inserted the lower hinge, it was not suitable for resting on top. The Blessed One declared: "An upper hinge is to be inserted." When the monks inserted the upper hinge, the wind blew it open. The Blessed One declared: "A waist-bar is to be inserted." When the monks inserted the waist-bar, it was difficult to cut and difficult to remove. The Blessed One declared: "A dry wooden peg is to be held in place, and with it the bar may be cut and removed."

Verses in summary: the tool, the iron mallet, the bowl, the wooden fan, the stone pestle, the chair, the backrest, the axe, and the water vessel.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The Blessed One declared that an eye-hole for the handle was to be bored into the door-panel. The monks then bored into the door-panel with an awl, and the door-panel split. The Blessed One declared: "The door-panel is not to be bored into." Since the Blessed One had declared that the door-panel was not to be bored into, the monks affixed the eye-hole and pulled it, but it was unstable and came out. The Blessed One declared: "Therefore it is permitted: a tool is to be held in place, and with it an eye-hole is also to be bored into the socket."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The venerable Pilindavatsa — from the passage beginning "the venerable Pilindavatsa, from the time of his going forth," down to "reverend ones, I am ill and unwell" — the earlier portion

proceeds as before. "Venerable one, what is your illness?" "Reverend ones, I have a wind ailment." "Venerable one, please take some medicine." "Reverend ones, in former times I would heat an iron mallet, steep it in water, and steam my body with it."

"Elder, why do you not heat it?" "The Blessed One has not permitted it."

At that point the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Then I hereby permit it. One who has a wind ailment may heat an iron mallet, steep it in water, and steam the body with it."

When the Blessed One had declared that the iron mallet was to be heated, the monks were unable to lift it out once it had been heated. The Blessed One declared: "Grasp it with an iron chain." When the monks placed the iron chain in the fire as well, it too became hot. The Blessed One declared: "Do not put it in there directly. Place it inside a wet cloth and use that to handle the heated iron mallet."

The monks made the iron mallet ready by smoothing it with a grass called uṣatu. The Blessed One declared: "It is not to be smoothed down. The heated mallet itself is what is suitable."

The monks were heating the water first by full use, and afterwards by letting it cool to a suitable temperature. The Blessed One declared: "First heat the water to a suitable temperature, and afterwards heat it further for full use."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Rājagṛha in the Kalandaka Bamboo Grove. The venerable Pilindavatsa — from the passage beginning "the venerable Pilindavatsa, from the time of his going forth," down to "reverend ones, I am ill and unwell" — the earlier portion proceeds as before. "Elder, what is your illness?" "Reverend ones, I have this and that ailment." "Elder, please take some medicine." "Reverend ones, in former times I would hold a medicine bowl." "Elder, why do you not hold one now?" "The Blessed One has not permitted it."

At that point the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Then I hereby permit it. One may hold a medicine bowl."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. A householder built a steam-house for the Saṅgha, and after spreading charcoal inside and leaving it there, the Blessed One declared: "It is to be swept out."

When the Blessed One had declared that the charcoal was to be swept out, the monks did not know how to sweep it. The Blessed One declared: "Make an iron dustpan and use that to sweep it out." When the Blessed One had declared that an iron dustpan was to be made, monks in remote monasteries had no such thing available. At that point the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Let them have a wooden dustpan made to use." When the Blessed One had declared that a wooden dustpan was to be made, the monks did not know what form the dustpan should take. The Blessed One declared: "Make the head thick, then smear it with mud and clay, and use it to sweep up the charcoal."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. A certain monk, being ill, went to a physician and said: "Good sir, such and such an illness has come upon me; please prescribe a medicine." The physician said: "Noble one, do this and that, and you will recover." The monk needed a mortar for preparing the medicine, so he went to a householder and asked for one, and the householder gave him one. After preparing the medicine, the monk returned the mortar to that same householder, and the householder said: "Noble one, please keep it yourself." The monk replied: "Householder, the Blessed One has not permitted it." The householder said:

"Noble one, if that is how it is, then so be it — please go."

At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore I permit it: a monk may keep a mortar." When Mṛgāra's mother Visākhā heard that the Blessed One had permitted monks to keep mortars, she presented five hundred iron mortars. The monks did not know what to do, and the Blessed One declared: "Distribute them in order of seniority."

When the Blessed One had declared that they were to be distributed in order of seniority, on that occasion when the youngest monks had not yet received theirs, the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Give a stone mortar to those who have not yet received one."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in Prince Jeta's Grove, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. A certain monk slept on the ground, and his food did not digest. He went to a householder and borrowed a couch, and lying on it he recovered; he then returned it to the householder. The householder said: "Noble one, please keep it yourself." The monk replied: "Householder, the

Blessed One has not permitted it." The householder said: "Noble one, if that is how it is, then so be it — please go." At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore I permit it: a monk may keep a couch."

When Mṛgāra's mother Visākhā heard that the Blessed One had permitted monks to keep couches with decorative legs, she presented five hundred couches with decorative legs. The monks did not know what to do, and the Blessed One declared: "Distribute them in order of seniority."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in Prince Jeta's Grove, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. A certain monk needed a backrest. He borrowed one from a householder, used it for his need, and returned it. The householder said: "Noble one, please keep it yourself." The monk replied: "Householder, the Blessed One has not permitted it." The householder said: "Noble one, if that is how it is, then so be it — please go." At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore I permit it: a monk may keep a backrest."

When Mṛgāra's mother Visākhā heard that the Blessed One had permitted monks to keep backrests, she presented five hundred backrests. The monks did not know what to do, and the Blessed One declared: "Distribute them in order of seniority."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in Prince Jeta's Grove, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. A certain monk had a worker who was employed in the kitchen, and that worker needed an axe. The monk borrowed one from a householder, the work was done with it, and it was returned. The householder said: "Noble one, please keep it yourself." The monk replied: "Householder, the Blessed One has not permitted it." The householder said: "Noble one, if that is how it is, then so be it — please go." At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore I permit it: a monk may keep an axe."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in Prince Jeta's Grove, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. A certain monk's couch top broke, and he borrowed a plank from a householder;

The work was done with it, and it was returned. The householder said: "Noble one, please keep it yourself." The monk replied: "Householder, the Blessed One has not permitted it." The householder said: "Noble one, if that is how it is, then so be it — please go." At that point the monks reported the matter to the

Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore I permit it: monks may keep a peg."

A summary verse:

A peg and three kinds of ladder,
a latch and an interior support-bar,
wood, stone, and earthen
tread-boards — three kinds of ladder are permitted.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in Prince Jeta's Grove, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. A certain monk's chair leg broke and he needed a peg, so he borrowed a peg from a householder; the work was done with it, and it was returned. The householder said: "Noble one, please keep it yourself." The monk replied: "Householder, the Blessed One has not permitted it." The householder said: "Noble one, if that is how it is, then so be it — please go." At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore I permit it: a monk may keep a peg."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Eastern Park, in the mansion of Mṛgāramātā. The Blessed One instructed the monks that they should assist with building walls, and the monks accordingly helped to build stūpas and temples. When the mansion of Mṛgāramātā had been built to a great height and it became necessary to plaster it, the monks did not know from what they should do the plastering. The Blessed One declared: "Plaster it from a ladder." When the Blessed One had declared that they should plaster it from a ladder, the monks did not know how many kinds of ladder there were. The Blessed One declared: "There are three kinds of ladder: one of wood, one of rope, and one of bamboo."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Kapilavāstu in the Nyagrodhā Park. The Blessed One had a younger brother, a monk named Nanda, whose body was golden in colour and who bore thirty of the eighty minor marks of a great being, yet who was four finger-breadths shorter than the Blessed One. Nanda had a wife named Sundarī — beautiful of form, lovely, pleasant to behold, charming to men — and toward her he felt intense attachment, clinging, infatuation, the casting off of restraint, swooning, excessive longing, and passionate desire.

The Blessed One, knowing that the time had come to tame him, dressed in his lower robe in the morning, took his alms bowl and outer robe, and set off for alms at Kapilavāstu accompanied by the śramaṇa Nanda walking behind.

While making his alms round in Kapilavāstu he headed toward the dwelling of Nanda, and when he arrived and stood at the door he sent forth rays of light the colour of molten gold, so that the whole house appeared like liquid gold. Nanda thought: "Surely the Blessed One has come — that is why my house appears like liquid gold." He sent a man, saying: "Go and look — who is at the door?" When the man came back out and saw the Blessed One, he went quickly inside and said: "Master, the Blessed One has come and is standing at the entrance." Nanda, filled with reverence, began to go out. Then Sundarī thought: "If he goes before the Blessed One, the Blessed One will certainly ordain him." So she grabbed the hem of his robe and said: "My lord, do not go — stay here."

He said: "Let me go — I will pay homage at the feet of the Blessed One and return." She put a mark on him and said: "My prince, if you come back having dried off this mark, I will give you authority over five hundred kārṣāpaṇas." He replied: "Very well — let it be so." She bound him to this promise and let him go. He went, paid homage at the feet of the Blessed One, took the Blessed One's alms-bowl, and returned. Then, as he emerged carrying the alms-bowl filled with clean and fine food and drink, the Blessed One did not stop to accept it himself but continued on, and signaled to the venerable Ānanda not to take it either. For the blessed buddhas are difficult to approach and difficult to endure, and so no one was able to say to the Blessed One, "Please accept this." Then, when Ānanda began to present the offering, Nanda said: "Please offer it to the very one from whom you received it." Ānanda lost his nerve. So he took the Blessed One's alms-bowl and followed after him. The Blessed One had gone to the monastery and was seated there, and Nanda presented the alms-bowl. Then the Blessed One performed the act of eating, and declared to Nanda: "Nanda, eat what remains in the alms-bowl." Nanda replied: "As the Blessed One wishes." The Blessed One gave him what remained in the alms-bowl, and Nanda ate it. After he had eaten, the Blessed One declared: "Nanda, why do you not go forth?" For the Blessed One had not broken a single word of Dharma across all those generations — not with parents, not with teachers, preceptors, or others in the role of spiritual guides. So Nanda said: "Blessed One, I will go forth." Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, go and have Nanda's hair and beard shaved." The venerable Ānanda, having heard this command from the Blessed One, said: "As the reverend one commands," and went to find a barber and had him begin to shave. But Nanda threatened the barber: "Hey, barber! Before long I

will become a wheel-turning king who rules by the power of his might. If you shave my hair and beard, I will cut off your arm at the elbow." The barber, terrified, set down his razor and sat still. The venerable Ānanda reported this to the Blessed One. Then the Blessed One himself went to where the venerable Nanda was and asked: "Nanda, will you not go forth?" He replied: "Blessed One, I will go forth." Then the Blessed One himself poured water over his head from a water vessel, and the barber shaved away his hair and beard. And Nanda thought to himself: "For now I will go forth out of reverence for the Blessed One, and when night has passed I will leave." So when night had passed he set out. But the Blessed One conjured a great chasm. Nanda thought: "My beautiful wife is now far away, and I will surely die here in this desolate place — I will go when morning comes." And so, agonizing over thoughts of that most lovely one, he passed the night in misery. The Blessed One, knowing his mind, said to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, go and tell Nanda to guard the house." Ānanda went and relayed the Blessed One's instruction to the venerable Nanda: "The Blessed One commands you to guard the house." Nanda asked: "Reverend Ānanda, what is this thing called 'guarding the house'? What exactly does one do?" Ānanda replied: "The venerable Nanda is to do the work of the monastery. After the monks have gone out for alms, he should first sweep the monastery clean, then clean up the cow-dung and maintain the grounds, and guard the monastery." The monks then said:

"Whatever there is to be announced, let it be announced. Whatever incense, flowers, fragrant substances, and so forth there may be, let those also be distributed to the Saṅgha. In the evening the doors are to be closed, and in the morning they are to be opened. The latrines and the urinals are also to be cleaned. And whatever other duties are connected with the monastery, those too are to be carried out."

Nanda replied: "Reverend Ānanda, I shall do exactly as the Blessed One has commanded."

Then in due course, one morning the monks put on their lower robes, took up their bowls and outer robes, and went into the city of Śrāvastī for alms. Nanda thought to himself: "I will go and sweep the monastery." He took up a broom and began to sweep. The Blessed One, at that very moment when Nanda was sweeping a courtyard, blessed a second broom so that it became full.

Nanda thought: "I will put down this broom and go," but he could not put down his broom and began to shake it out. Before it was empty, he thought: "I will go and close the doors of the cells," and so he began to close the doors of the cells. But the Blessed One blessed things so that the very moment Nanda closed the door of one cell, another flew open, and Nanda grew weary. He said to himself: "When I become king, I will build a monastery far grander than this."

Then he thought: "I will go down a side path," and he went down a side path. The Blessed One, knowing the thoughts of Nanda's mind, went along that very path. Nanda saw the Blessed One from a great distance, and seeing him, he swiftly ran to a nearby tree with thick, hanging branches and hid beneath it. The Blessed One then blessed the branches of that tree so that they rose upward.

The Blessed One then said: "Nanda, where are you going? Come here."

Nanda was speechless, and with a mind full of shame he followed behind the Blessed One.

The Blessed One reflected: "This one is so intensely attached to his beautiful wife that he must be separated from her." Knowing that he should separate Nanda from her, the Blessed One stayed as long as he wished in the city of Śrāvastī, then set out toward Śrāvastī and arrived there directly.

Now the mother of Sundarī, wife of Mṛgāramat, had heard that the Blessed One's younger brother named Nanda, whose body was golden in color and who bore thirty of the thirty-two major marks of a great being, falling four finger-breadths short of the Blessed One, had come there together with the Blessed One, and she thought: "When will I get to see him?"

The Vinaya, Minor Matters. The Eleventh Fascicle.

Then, on another occasion, the venerable Nanda, one morning having put on his lower robe, took up his bowl and outer robe, and entered Śrāvastī for alms. He went straight to the house of the mother of Sundarī, wife of Mṛgāramat. When he saw her beautiful form and radiant complexion, he thought: "This must surely be the Blessed One's younger brother Nanda." And filled with faith, she touched his feet and paid homage. When she touched his feet, since the touch of a woman is a thing that stirs the passions, he was overcome by desire, and his semen was released and fell onto the top of Sundarī's head. Now, since awakened ones, the Blessed Ones, possess the quality of never

forgetting, the Blessed One blessed the matter so that it became turushka (a fragrant resin). Nanda thought: "From where could turushka resin have come here? Surely the noble Nanda has lost an impure substance. And the Blessed One, possessing the quality of never forgetting, has blessed it as turushka resin." Realizing this, she was filled with joy and cried out in delight: "O the Buddha! O the Dharma! O the Saṅgha!"

"How wonderful! The Dharma is indeed well proclaimed, and thus even I — along with the noble Nanda and others who are strongly given to passion — practice the holy life." This she declared aloud, again and again.

Then the venerable Nanda thought to himself, "Can it be that no offense against the Saṅgha has arisen for me?" and remorse arose in him. At that point he reported the matter to the monks, and the monks brought it before the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, for this monk Nanda, who is excessively given to passion, there is no offense. Therefore I permit it, and those who are of such a nature — that is, excessively prone to passion — should carry a receptacle for the outflow. They need not feel remorse over this."

When the Blessed One had given the ruling that those excessively prone to passion should carry such a receptacle, the monks did not know from what skin it should be made. The Blessed One declared: "It should be made from the skin of a goat, a deer, or a mouse." When they stored these as they were, they became unpleasant in smell. The Blessed One declared: "Wash them, knead them, and dry them." While they were washing and drying them, some monks, upon seeing women, emitted semen, and their lower garments became soiled and stained. The Blessed One declared: "Make two and dry one while wearing the other." For some monks, so much semen was produced that it soaked through. The Blessed One declared: "Stuff those with cotton wadding." When the monks stuffed them with pigs' bristles they were caused discomfort. The Blessed One declared: "Stuff them with sand or earth." While the monks were wearing these and eating food and making prostrations before a stūpa, the Blessed One declared: "Set that aside in a private place, then having bathed, eat food and make prostrations at the stūpa."

Then, on another occasion, the venerable Nanda was seated on a flat stone in a certain place, and he called to mind the beautiful Sundarī, and began to draw her likeness on that stone. The venerable Mahākāśyapa also came to that place and, seeing him, said: "Venerable Nanda, what are you doing?" He

replied: "Venerable Mahākāśyapa, I am drawing the likeness of Sundarī." Mahākāśyapa said: "Venerable one, the Blessed One has declared that a monk's activities are two: meditative concentration and recitation. Are you here drawing your own wife? He said nothing." At that time the venerable Mahākāśyapa brought the matter before the Blessed One. The Blessed One, reflecting on the matter, recognized that whatever fault had arisen had come about through the drawing of a likeness, and declared to the monks: "Monks, the deluded man Nanda, with a mind attached to Sundarī, drew the picture. Therefore monks must not draw pictures. A monk who draws a picture commits a serious transgression." The Blessed One thus declared that monks must not draw pictures.

Furthermore, monks must not anoint or smear the stūpas of a Tathāgata's hair-relics or nail-relics with perfume, nor scatter perfume upon them. The Blessed Ones, the buddhas, ask questions while already knowing the answer — and so the Blessed One questioned the venerable Ānanda:

"Ānanda, why is it that monks do not anoint or scatter perfume upon the stūpas of a Tathāgata's hair-relics and nail-relics?" At that, the venerable Ānanda gave a detailed account to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Very well then, I permit it. You may anoint and scatter perfume upon them — but you must not draw images of sentient beings."

The Blessed One then reflected: "This foolish man Nanda is still full of attachment to Sundarī and his mind is bound to her. I must devise a means to help him." Knowing this, he spoke to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, do you see the fragrance of the mountain incense rising?" "Venerable one, I do not see it." "In that case, take hold of the lower hem of the Tathāgata's robe." And he took hold of the lower hem of the Blessed One's robe.

Then the Blessed One rose into the middle of the sky like a king among geese spreading its wings, and passing through the upper sky he arrived at Mount Fragrance, wafted with sweet scent. And so, traveling together with the venerable Ānanda, going here and there, they came to stand beside a saha tree, where a young female monkey was roaming about as she pleased. She caught sight of the Blessed One and gazed at him without distraction.

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, do you see this young female monkey?" "Blessed One, I see her." "Ānanda, what do you think — between this female monkey and Sundarī, which is more beautiful, more lovely, more delightful to behold?" He replied: "Venerable one, this female

monkey does not come within one hundredth of the Śākya girl Sundarī, not within one thousandth, not within one hundred-thousandth — she is not to be reckoned, counted, compared, calculated, set as an example, or set as a basis in relation to her. Venerable one, the Śākya girl Sundarī is a match for the daughters of the gods."

The Blessed One said: "Ānanda, if that is so, take hold of the lower hem of the Tathāgata's robe." He took hold of the lower hem of the Blessed One's robe. Then the Blessed One rose into the middle of the sky like a king among geese spreading its wings, passed through the upper sky, and arrived directly in the realm of the Thirty-Three Gods.

Then the Blessed One, dwelling in the Joyful Grove pleasure garden, said to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, go and look upon the gods of the Thirty-Three." And so Ānanda went and looked upon the gods there — their sport and joy and delight, their places of happiness, the pleasure gardens, the Joyful Grove, the various chariots, the mingling and gathering and assembly, the beautiful Dharma and all the rest. And as he looked, seeing each one more splendid and more excellent than the last, he went about the beautiful city in wonder.

Going on from there and looking around, he saw a palace in which there were no god-sons at all, filled entirely with goddesses. He asked the goddesses: "In all the other palaces, the god-sons and goddesses together fill them with sport and joy and pleasure — what is the reason that in this palace there are no god-sons?" They replied: "The Blessed One's younger brother, named Nanda, who has been practicing the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One — when he passes from this life he will come here. That is why this palace has been reserved, and we too remain here, waiting for him."

Hearing this, Nanda was filled with delight, gladness, and great joy, and he returned before the Blessed One. The Blessed One said to him: "Did you see the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three?" He replied: "Blessed One, I did see them." The Blessed One said: "Tell me what you saw there." When Nanda had described in full what he had seen, the Blessed One said: "Nanda, did you see the goddesses?" "Blessed One, I did see them." "Nanda, what do you think — who is more beautiful, lovely, and fair to behold: the Śākyan girl Sundarī, or those goddesses?" He replied: "Venerable One, Sundarī the Śākyan girl does not come within even a hundredth part of those goddesses — not within a thousandth, not within a hundred-thousandth, not by count, by reckoning, by fraction, by calculation, by comparison, or by cause."

"Nanda, this being so, dwelling in the holy life brings benefits such as these and others as well. Rejoice in this, and practice the holy life — and you shall experience the splendor of the gods."

At this, Nanda consented in his mind to the Blessed One's words and sat silent.

Then the Blessed One disappeared from the realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three and departed for Śrāvastī.

From that time on, the venerable Nanda practiced the holy life with delight in the divine world in view.

Then the Blessed One, knowing his state of mind, addressed the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, go and convey to the monks this instruction: 'Monks, none of you shall sit together with Nanda on the same seat, walk together with him on the same walking ground, place a robe on the same robe-rack as his, place a bowl on the same bowl-stand as his, or place water on the same water-stand as his. You shall not recite together with him, and you shall not chant together with him.'"

"Venerable One, I shall do as you command," said the venerable Ānanda, and having listened to the Blessed One he conveyed this to the monks: "Venerable ones, the Blessed One has spoken thus: 'Venerable ones, you shall not sit together with Nanda on the same seat' — and so on, all as before, down to 'you shall not chant together with him.'"

"Venerable Ānanda, so be it. As the Blessed One has commanded, so shall it be done." And they did not sit with him on the same seat, did not walk with him on the same walking ground, did not place a robe on the same robe-rack, did not place a bowl on the same bowl-stand, did not place water on the same water-stand, and did not recite or chant together with him.

Because the monks had shunned him in this way, the venerable Nanda felt deeply distressed, ashamed, embarrassed, and mortified.

Then at a certain later time, when the venerable Nanda was doing work with robes together with a great many monks at the service hall, Nanda thought to himself: "These monks have shunned me, it seems. Now, this venerable Ānanda is my own younger brother — would even he shun me?" Realizing this, he went and sat down beside him. But the venerable Ānanda rose up very quickly and moved away.

Nanda said to him: "If it is right for these fellow practitioners of the holy life to shun me for now, you are my own younger brother — why would you shun

me?"

He replied: "Venerable Nanda, that is true — and yet you have entered upon one path, and we too have entered upon a path, and so there is indeed reason to shun you."

Nanda said:

"Venerable Ānanda, tell me: what path have you entered upon, and what path have I entered upon?"

He replied: "You practice the holy life out of delight in the realm of the gods, while we practice the holy life with the aspiration for nirvāṇa."

When these words were spoken, Nanda was filled with deep despondency.

Then the Blessed One, knowing Nanda's state of mind through his own awareness, said to the venerable Nanda: "Nanda, have you seen the hells?"

"I have not, Blessed One."

The Blessed One said: "Take hold of the hem of my robe." And Nanda took hold of the hem of the Blessed One's robe.

The Blessed One then led the venerable Nanda and departed to the hell realms. Standing a little to one side, the Blessed One said to the venerable Nanda: "Nanda, go and look at the hells."

Nanda looked. He saw rivers without fords, forests with leaves like swords, charnel grounds, smoldering fires, and in those various regions, one more terrible in its particular sufferings than the next — utterly unbearable. Going into those hell realms, he saw sentient beings enduring all manner of specific sufferings: being hauled up and cut down and shattered. Some had their eyes and teeth gouged out by dryness; some were being devoured by buzzards; some had their legs hacked off with axes; some were being skewered with short spears, great arrows, and single-pointed weapons; some were being beaten with iron hammers; some were being placed inside great iron cauldrons that blazed, burned fiercely, and burned on every side, their flames merging into one, and were being boiled within them. Having seen those many and varied specific sufferings, Nanda moved to another area. There he saw a great iron cauldron boiling, and seeing it he felt no joy. He asked the hell guardians: "O knowers, what is the reason that sentient beings are placed in all the other iron cauldrons while this one stands here boiling but empty?"

They said: "One called Nanda, the younger brother of the Blessed One, who delights in the realm of the gods, practices the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One. When he dies, he will come here — and for that reason this cauldron is being kept ready. We too are stationed here, waiting for him."

Upon hearing this, Nanda was seized with terror and dread and revulsion, his hair standing on end. Thinking, "Right now I am about to be cast in — I must flee at once!" he ran and ran as fast as he could, and arrived before the Blessed One breathless and disheveled, his face dark, and said:

The Blessed One said: "Nanda, have you seen the hells?"

Half-dead with fright, his tongue faltering, speaking words of pity in a slow, faint, subdued murmur, he said: "I have seen them, Blessed One."

The Blessed One said: "Tell me what you saw there." And Nanda reported in full what he had seen.

The Blessed One then said: "Nanda, for one who practices the holy life with the aspiration for the realm of the gods there are faults such as these and others besides. Therefore you should delight in nirvāṇa, not delight in the realm of the gods."

Nanda sat there silently, his mind overwhelmed with shame.

The Blessed One then vanished from the hell realms and proceeded to the Hot Springs of the Sages near the city of Campā.

Then at another time the venerable Nanda, rising from his afternoon meditation together with five hundred monks, went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, he prostrated with his head at the feet of the Blessed One and sat down to one side. Those five hundred monks likewise prostrated with their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and sat down to one side. The Blessed One, knowing that the Saṅgha of monks was seated to one side, spoke to the venerable Nanda: "Nanda, I shall teach you the Dharma — namely, the Dharma discourse called 'Entering the Womb,' good in the beginning, good in the middle, and good at the end, excellent in meaning, excellent in word, unmixed, perfectly complete, perfectly pure, perfectly cleansed, revealing the holy life. Listen to it well and hold it in mind." "Venerable one, I shall do as you command," said the venerable Nanda, and he attended to the Blessed One. The Blessed One then spoke as follows.

"Nanda, what are the conditions under which entry into a mother's womb occurs, and what are those under which it does not? Nanda, it is like this: the

parents must be attracted to each other and have come together; the mother must be in her fertile season; and the gandharva (Skt. gandharva) must also be present and ready to enter. Nanda, the word 'gandharva' is the designation for a being of the intermediate existence (Skt. antarābhava). It comes in two kinds: one of fair appearance and one of dark appearance. The intermediate existence of beings destined for the hell realms is of dark appearance — like, for example, a charred tree-stump. The intermediate existence of those going to an animal birth is like the color of smoke. That of hungry ghosts is like the color of water. The intermediate existence of humans and gods is like the color of gold. That of gods dwelling in the form realm is white. Gods dwelling in the formless realm, being without form, have no intermediate existence at all.

"Some beings of the intermediate existence have two hands and two feet; some have four feet; some have many feet; and some have no feet at all. A being of the intermediate existence takes on whatever form corresponds to the destiny it is to be born into through its previous karma. Every being of the intermediate existence is endowed with the supernatural power of moving through the air, and possesses, as it were, the divine eye.

"As for the mother being in her fertile season, Nanda, 'fertile season' means a particular time and period. Nanda, some women enter their fertile season for three days, or five days, or seven days. Others, through the power of causes and conditions, remain in their fertile season for a long time, and their fertile season may even come around again and again.

"Among these, women who are afflicted, who are of poor constitution, who are troubled, and who have eaten food and drink of poor quality — their fertile season does not last long, and it quickly comes to an end and passes. Nanda, it is just as when water is poured onto rough, coarse ground: it quickly dissipates and disappears. In the same way, for women who are afflicted, of poor constitution, troubled, and who have eaten food and drink of poor quality, the fertile season likewise does not last long and quickly comes to an end and passes.

"On the other hand, women who possess well-being, who have abundant comfort, who are not troubled, and who have eaten food and drink of good quality — their fertile season lasts long and does not quickly come to an end and pass. Their fertile season and —

their fertile season also arrives at the proper interval.

"Nanda, it is just as when water is poured onto smooth, soft ground: it does not quickly dissipate and disappear. In the same way, for women who possess well-being, who have abundant comfort, who are not troubled, and who have eaten food and drink of good quality, the fertile season likewise lasts long and does not come to an end and disappear. Their fertile season and their fertile season arriving at the proper interval both occur.

"Nanda, if semen comes from the father but not from the mother, then at that time no entry into the womb will take place. If it comes from the mother but not from the father, then at that time no entry into the womb will take place. If it comes neither from the mother nor from the father, then at that time no entry into the womb will take place.

"If the mother has become impure while the father has become pure, or if the father has become pure while the mother has become impure — and at that time the mother's womb is obstructed by wind, or obstructed by bile, or obstructed by phlegm, or obstructed by blood, or obstructed by fat; or it is filled with mucus; or it has been altered by medicine; or it is similar in the middle to an ant's waist; or it is like the mouth of a drum; or it is like the middle knob of a door-bar; or it is like the bolt of a door; or it is like a door-horse; or it is like a thorn; or it is like a leaf; or there has grown inside it something like a lump; or it is deep below; or it is deep above; or it is unsuitable as a vessel for the womb; or blood flows from it; or it is short; or it is like the beak of a crow; or it is spread wide to the left; or spread wide to the right; or spread wide above; or spread wide below; or it is raised; or it is sunken; or it is collapsed; or it has only the semblance of a mark; or it is unsteady; or it is defective; or its position has shifted; or it has been eaten by insects called besaraka — then at that time no entry into the womb will take place.

"If the father and mother are known to be potent but the gandharva (gandharva) is known to be weak, then at that time no entry into the womb will take place. If the gandharva is known to be potent but the father and mother are known to be weak, then at that time no entry into the womb will take place. If all are known to be weak, and moreover the father and mother have not performed and accumulated the karma that would result in finding a child, and the gandharva has likewise not performed and accumulated the karma that would result in becoming a father or mother, and the two minds of the gandharva — whether a male mind or a female mind — neither one has been placed in proximity, then at that time no entry into the womb will take

place.

"If all are known to be potent, but the father and mother have not performed and accumulated the karma that would result in finding a child, and the gandharva has likewise not performed and accumulated the karma that would result in becoming a father or mother, and the two minds of the gandharva — whether a male mind or a female mind — neither has been placed in proximity, then at that time no entry into the womb will take place.

"Nanda, how then does entry into the mother's womb come to take place? Nanda, in this case the father and mother come together in desire and union; the mother is fit and is in her fertile season; the gandharva is present nearby and has the wish to enter; semen comes from both father and mother; and both father and mother are pure. At that time the mother's womb is not obstructed by wind, not obstructed by bile, not obstructed by phlegm, not obstructed by blood, not obstructed by fat; it is not filled with mucus; it has not been altered by medicine; it is not similar in the middle to an ant's waist; it is not like the mouth of a drum; it is not like the middle knob of a door-bar; it is not like the bolt of a door; it is not like a door-horse; it is not like a thorn; it is not like a leaf; nothing like a lump has grown inside it; it is not deep below; it is not deep above; it is not unsuitable as a vessel for the womb; blood does not flow from it; it is not short; it is not like the beak of a crow; it is not spread wide to the left; it is not spread wide to the right; it is not spread wide above; it is not spread wide below; it is not raised; it is not sunken; it is not collapsed; it does not have only the semblance of a mark;"

it is not wobbly; it is not defective; it has not been displaced; it has not been eaten by the creature called a besaraka.

If the father and mother are renowned as being of high standing, the gandharva too is renowned as being of high standing. If the father and mother are renowned as being of low standing, the gandharva too is renowned as being of low standing. When all are renowned as being of high standing, and the father and mother have also performed and accumulated the karma that results in obtaining a child, and the gandharva has likewise performed and accumulated the karma that results in becoming a father or mother, then, if the gandharva keeps in mind whichever it may be of the two minds, a male mind or a female mind, it will enter the mother's womb.

Nandaka, when a gandharva is about to enter the mother's womb desiring to do so, it possesses an inverted mind and a wrongly oriented pride, and

through the force of the causes and conditions of its former karma, it acquires these ten false perceptions, each arising separately in each birth: the perception of warmth, the perception of sunlight, the perception of wind, the perception of rain, the perception of drizzle, the perception of cold, the perception of an unpleasant region, the perception of a red wind, the perception of heavy rain, and the perception of a great crowd of common people making a clamor.

Nandaka, after those perceptions have arisen and are present, when these other ten false perceptions arise inwardly in birth, they arise thus: the thought "I am entering my own house," the thought "I am climbing up into a fine mansion," the thought "I am going down into a multi-storied building," the thought "I am ascending a throne," the thought "I am entering a heap of grass," the thought "I am entering a pile of leaves," and the thought "I am going toward dense grass, or a thick forest, or the gap in a wall, or the foot of a wall." Nandaka, dependent upon whichever of these perceptions it may be, the gandharva enters the mother's womb, and having been born there, the soft and tender body comes to be fully formed.

Nandaka, as to that, the soft and tender body is not to be regarded as being the impure substance of the father and mother, nor is the soft and tender body other than the impure substance of the father and mother. Nandaka, nevertheless, dependent upon that very impure substance of the father and mother, through the assembling of causes and conditions, the soft and tender body arises, and thus the semen and blood serve only as its object of focus and its support, and nothing more.

Nandaka, take for example how, dependent on milk, and dependent on the pot, and dependent on the churning stick, and dependent on the effort arising from a person, butter comes forth from milk. Nandaka, in that case one does not observe the butter separately in each of those, yet, Nandaka, dependent upon that very milk, through the assembling of causes and conditions, the butter comes forth, and thus milk serves only as the object of focus and support of the butter, and nothing more.

In the same way, the soft and tender body is to be regarded as arising from the impure substance of the father and mother; the soft and tender body is not other than the impure substance of the father and mother, and yet it is not that either. Nandaka, nevertheless, dependent upon that very impure substance of the father and mother, through the assembling of causes and

conditions, the soft and tender body comes to be fully formed, and thus the semen and blood serve only as its object of focus and its support, and nothing more.

Nandaka, take for example how, dependent on green grass, a worm is born. Nandaka, in that case the worm is not to be regarded as being the green grass, nor is the worm to be regarded as other than the green grass. Nevertheless, dependent upon that very green grass, through the assembling of causes and conditions, a worm is born possessing the power of a matching color, and by that power of color the worm in its very nature becomes like a green leaf. Nandaka, in the same way, the soft and tender body is not to be regarded as being the impure substance of the father and mother, nor is the soft and tender body other than the impure substance of the father and mother.

Nandaka, nevertheless, dependent upon that very impure substance of the father and mother, through the assembling of causes and conditions, the great elements of the sense faculties come to be fully established.

Nandaka, consider, for example, how a worm is born in dependence upon cow dung. Nandaka, in that case the worm is not to be regarded as being the cow dung, nor is the worm to be regarded as other than the cow dung. Nevertheless, dependent upon that very cow dung, through the assembling of causes and conditions, a worm is born possessing the power of a matching color, and by that power of color the worm in its very nature becomes yellow.

Nandaka, in the same way, the soft and tender body is not to be regarded as being the impure substance of the father and mother, nor is the soft and tender body other than the impure substance of the father and mother. Nevertheless, dependent upon that very impure substance of the father and mother, through the assembling of causes and conditions, the great elements of the sense faculties come to be fully established.

Nandaka, consider, for example, how a worm is born in dependence upon cedar wood. Nandaka, in that case the worm is not to be regarded as being the cedar, nor is the worm to be regarded as other than the cedar. Nevertheless, dependent upon that very cedar, through the assembling of causes and conditions, a worm is born possessing the power of a matching color, and by that power of color the worm in its very nature becomes red.

Nandaka, in the same way, the soft and tender body is not to be regarded as being the impure substance of the father and mother, nor is the soft and

tender body other than the impure substance of the father and mother. Nevertheless, dependent upon that very impure substance of the father and mother, through the assembling of causes and conditions, the great elements of the sense faculties come to be fully established.

Nandaka, consider, for example, how a worm is born in dependence upon curds. Nandaka, in that case the worm is not to be regarded as being the curds, nor is the worm to be regarded as other than the curds. Nevertheless, dependent upon those very curds, through the assembling of causes and conditions, a worm is born possessing the power of a matching color, and by that power of color the worm in its very nature becomes white.

Nandaka, in the same way, the soft and tender body is not to be regarded as being the impure substance of the father and mother, nor is the soft and tender body other than the impure substance of the father and mother. Nevertheless, dependent upon that very impure substance of the father and mother, through the assembling of causes and conditions, the great elements of the sense faculties resembling those of the father and mother come to be fully established.

Nandaka, in that soft and tender body arisen from the impure substance of the father and mother, the earth element (Skt. pṛthivīdhātu) is present as solidity, the water element as moisture, the fire element as warmth, and the wind element as lightness and movement.

Nandaka, if in that soft and tender body arisen from the impure substance of the father and mother the earth element were present but the water element absent, it would become dry and would crumble apart, like a handful of flour or a handful of ash.

Nandaka, if in that soft and tender body arisen from the impure substance of the father and mother the water element were present but the earth element absent, it would dissolve away by moisture, like oil or water.

Nevertheless, because the water element is held together by the earth element it does not fall apart, and because the earth element is bound by the water element it does not dissolve.

Nandaka, if in that soft and tender body arisen from the impure substance of the father and mother the earth element and the water element were present but the fire element absent, it would become moist, it would decay, and it would putrefy. Nandaka, just as in the last month of winter a piece of meat,

lacking the fire element, becomes moist, decays, and putrefies, in the same way, Nandaka, if in that soft and tender body arisen from the impure substance of the father and mother the earth element and the water element were present but the fire element absent, it would become moist, it would decay, and it would putrefy.

Nandaka, if in that soft and tender body arisen from the impure substance of the father and mother the earth element, the water element, and the fire element were present but the wind element absent, it would not stir, and it could not grow, expand, and develop. Yet, Nandaka, these very elements — the four great elements (mahābhūtas) that arise from within, aroused inwardly, produced by the karmic maturation of previous actions, present and mutually conditioning, having come together — being supported by the earth element, cohered by the water element, ripened by the fire element, and set in motion by the wind element, they grow, expand, and develop.

Nandaka, just as when a butter-lamp carrier, or the student of a butter-lamp carrier, heats sugarcane juice that has been clarified, and then with the breath drives it through the hollow stalk of a lotus root, those very things grow, expand, and develop — in the same way, Nandaka, these very elements — the four great elements that arise from within, aroused inwardly, produced by the karmic maturation of previous actions, present and mutually conditioning — being supported by the earth element, cohered by the water element, ripened by the fire element, and set in motion by the wind element, they grow, expand, and develop.

Nandaka, that soft and tender body should not be regarded as being the impure substance of the father and mother. It is not from the father's loins. It is not from the mother's womb. It is not from that karma. It is not from that cause. It is not from that condition. Yet, Nandaka, in dependence upon that very impure substance of the father and mother — through the coming together, the assembling, the arriving, and the becoming manifest of the causes — dwelling in the womb is accomplished.

Nandaka, just as seeds that are intact, sound, not broken open, not punctured, not split, not rotten, and not damaged by wind and sun, when sown in a moist patch of ground, a meadow, or in a well-ploughed good field, and well irrigated — from those seeds, through the power of causes and conditions, the sprout, the leaf, the stalk, the pith, the flower, and the fruit gradually and manifestly come to be — Nandaka, in that case the sprout and the rest are not those very

seeds, nor, apart from those seeds, do the sprout and the rest arise without cause and without condition. Rather, they arise from the assembling of causes and conditions. In the same way, Nandaka, the soft and tender body should not be regarded as the impure substance of the father and mother. It is not from the father's loins. It is not from the mother's womb. It is not from that karma. It is not from that cause. It is not from that condition. Yet, Nandaka, in dependence upon that very impure substance of the father and mother — through the coming together, the assembling, the arriving, and the becoming manifest of the causes — dwelling in the womb is accomplished.

Nandaka, just as a man with good eyes, wishing to produce fire in the proper way, takes a fire-crystal, holds it up toward the sun, and then placing well-dried powder of cow dung there, produces fire — Nandaka, fire is indeed present in those causes, yet if those causes were set aside, fire would not arise from no cause and no condition. Rather, fire arises from the assembling of causes and conditions. In the same way, Nandaka, in dependence upon that very impure substance of the father and mother — through the coming together, the assembling, the arriving, and the becoming manifest of the causes — dwelling in the womb is accomplished.

Nandaka, as for that which is the soft and tender body arisen from the impure substance of the father and mother — this is form (rūpa). The feeling, perception, and formations that arise together with it, along with consciousness — these are name. This name, taken together with the form just described, is reckoned under the designation name-and-form (nāmarūpa). Nandaka, this is so: that name-and-form is no more than just that and nothing beyond. Nandaka, I do not praise even the slightest accomplished existence.

I do not praise even a single moment of accomplished existence. And why is that? Because accomplished existence is suffering. Just as even a small amount of vomit is foul-smelling, so too even a single moment of accomplished existence is suffering.

Nandaka, in this regard: the arising of form, its abiding, its becoming manifest, and its emergence; the arising of feeling, perception, and formations; and the arising, abiding, becoming manifest, and emergence of consciousness — that arising is suffering, that abiding is disease, and that emergence is old age and death.

Nandaka, what pleasure could there be in dwelling in the womb of a mother who harbors accomplished existence? Nandaka, in the first week, one dwells

within the slimy, impure, putrid, and blazing mire of the womb, with all the faculties of the body in pain, in great hardship, oppressed and afflicted, and that consciousness — with its one flavor of suffering — becomes a viscous mass in the mother's belly.

Nandaka, what is the nature of that viscous mass? Nandaka, the nature of the viscous mass is like the surface of whey-water or curds — such is the nature of the viscous mass. It dwells there for seven days, and throughout those seven days it is tormented, wholly tormented, heated, wholly heated, and utterly burning. The earth element is present as solidity, the water element as moistness, the fire element as heat, and the wind element as lightness and motion.

Nandaka, in the second week, one dwells within the slimy, impure, putrid, and blazing mire of the womb, with all the faculties of the body extremely heated, unbearably intense, oppressed and afflicted, and that consciousness — with its one flavor of suffering — is struck by the inner winds of the womb, born of the ripening of previous karma, called "gathering," and through their touch that pain of the womb becomes a firmer mass. Nandaka, what is the nature of that firmer mass? Nandaka, it is like solidified curds or butter — such is the nature of the firmer mass. It dwells there for seven days, and throughout those seven days it is tormented, wholly tormented, heated, wholly heated, and utterly burning. The earth element is present as solidity, the water element as moistness, the fire element as warmth, and the wind element as lightness and motion.

Nandaka, in the third week, one dwells within the slimy, impure, putrid, and blazing mire and mud of the womb, with all the faculties of the body extremely heated, unbearably intense, oppressed and afflicted, and that consciousness — with its one flavor of suffering — is struck by the inner winds of the womb, born of the ripening of previous karma, called "storehouse-door," and through their touch that pain of the womb becomes a lumpy mass. Nandaka, what is the nature of that lumpy mass? Nandaka, it is like a fine copper needle or a tiny worm — such is the nature of the lumpy mass. That pain of the womb dwells there for seven days, and throughout those seven days it is tormented, wholly tormented, heated, wholly heated, and utterly burning. The earth element is present as solidity, the water element as moistness, the fire element as warmth, and the wind element as lightness and motion.

Nandaka, in the fourth week, one dwells within the slimy, impure, putrid, and blazing mire of the womb, with all the faculties of the body extremely heated, unbearably intense, afflicted and oppressed,

and in suffering. In that being possessed of a single consciousness, winds arise within the mother's womb — winds born from the karmic maturation of prior karma, called the "inward-drawing" winds — and through them the one dwelling in the womb becomes a rounded mass. Nandaka, what is the nature of that rounded mass? Nandaka, it is like a lump of curd or a nodule of butter — such is the nature of the rounded mass. That being dwells there for seven days, and throughout those seven days it is tormented, wholly tormented, heated, wholly heated, and utterly burning. The earth element is present as solidity, the water element as moistness, the fire element as warmth, and the wind element as lightness and motion.

Nandaka, in the fifth week, winds arise within the mother's womb for the one dwelling there — winds born from the karmic maturation of prior karma, called the "gathering" winds — and through these, five signs appear on the body of that thorn of the womb: the signs of the two shoulders, the signs of the two thighs, and fifth, the sign of the head. Nandaka, just as when the seasonal rains fall in summer, shoots first spring forth from piles of wood, so too, for the one dwelling in the womb, winds arise within the mother's womb — winds born from karmic maturation, called the "gathering" winds — and through these, five signs appear on that being's body: the signs of the two shoulders, the signs of the two thighs, and fifth, the sign of the head.

Nandaka, in the sixth week, winds arise within the mother's womb for the one dwelling there — winds born from the karmic maturation of prior karma, called the "wide-spreading" winds — and through these, four signs appear on the body of that thorn of the womb: the signs of the two forearms and the signs of the two lower legs. Nandaka, just as when the summer rains fall, shoots of dark-blue grass first grow, so too, for the one dwelling in the womb, winds arise within the mother's womb — winds born from the karmic maturation of prior karma, called the "wide-spreading" winds — and through these, four signs appear on the body of that thorn of the womb: the signs of the two forearms and the signs of the two lower legs.

Nandaka, in the seventh week, winds arise within the mother's womb for the one dwelling there — winds called the "all-turning" winds — and through these, four other signs appear on that being's body: the broad signs of the two

palms of the hands and the broad signs of the two soles of the feet. Nandaka, it is like a heap of hollow reeds or a heap of fish scales. So too, within the mother's womb, four signs appear on the body of that thorn of the womb dwelling there: the signs of the two palms of the hands and the signs of the two soles of the feet.

Nandaka, in the eighth week, winds arise within the mother's womb for the one dwelling there — winds born from the karmic maturation of prior karma, called the "wholly-turning" winds — and through these, twenty signs arise on the body of that thorn of the womb: the signs of the ten fingers of the hands and the signs of the ten toes of the feet. Nandaka, just as when the summer rains fall, the root-bases of trees first spring up, so too, within the mother's womb, twenty signs arise on the body of that thorn of the womb: the signs of the ten fingers of the hands and the signs of the ten toes of the feet.

In the ninth week — the seventh day of the ninth week — within the mother's womb, nine signs arise on the body of that thorn of the womb: the signs of the two eyes, the signs of the two ears, the signs of the two nostrils, the signs of the two lower openings, and the sign of the mouth.

Nandaka, in the tenth week — the seventh day of the tenth week — winds called the "stable" winds arise within the mother's womb for the one dwelling there, born from the karmic maturation of prior karma, and through these, solidity and heaviness come to pervade the body of that one dwelling in the womb.

In that very same week, winds called the "all-opening" winds arise within the mother's womb for the one dwelling there, and these fill that one dwelling in the womb — fill it completely, fill it entirely. Nandaka, it is just as a bladder or bellows when fully inflated.

Nandaka, in the eleventh week — the seventh day of the eleventh week — winds called the "horse-making" winds arise within the mother's womb for the one dwelling there. Through these, the interior of that one dwelling in the womb becomes hollow, and the nine apertures of its body open. To whatever degree the mother moves, stirs, and shifts — whether she exerts herself strenuously or her body is thrown about — to that very degree the interior of the one dwelling in the womb becomes hollow, and those apertures are fully formed.

Nandaka, when those winds called the "horse-making" winds travel upward, they produce the upper apertures; when they travel downward, they produce

the lower apertures. Nandaka, it is just as when a skilled smith or a smith's apprentice takes a smith's bellows and works it with both hands — just as the bellows moves with each working — so too, those winds called the "horse-making" winds, when traveling upward, produce the upper apertures, and when traveling downward, produce the lower apertures. Nandaka, once those horse-making winds have opened those sense bases, they cease to exist in that very place.

Nandaka, in the twelfth week — the seventh day of the twelfth week — winds called the "crooked-opening" winds arise within the mother's womb for the one dwelling there. These form the intestines and the mesentery on the right and left sides of the belly of that one dwelling in the womb. Nandaka, it is just as the rootlet-tendrils at the base of a lotus are intertwined — bound inward, coiled and twisted — so too, they come to rest, supported by the body.

Then, in that very same week, winds called the "hair-producing" winds arise, and through these, no more and no fewer than three hundred and thirty joints are produced on the body of that one dwelling in the womb, and through the power of the wind, one hundred and one vital points come to rest, supported by the body.

Nandaka, in the thirteenth week — the seventh day of the thirteenth week — hunger and thirst arise in the one dwelling in the womb within the mother's belly. Whatever the mother eats and drinks, its essence enters through the navel of that one, and by that, the one is nourished there.

Whatever food and drink the mother of that one consumes —
by that, the one dwelling in the mother's womb
is sustained and nourished there.

Nandaka, in the fourteenth week — the seventh day of the fourteenth week — winds called the "channel-opening" winds arise within the mother's womb for the one dwelling there. Through these, nine hundred channels are produced on the body of that one dwelling in the womb: two hundred and twenty-five on the front of the body, two hundred and twenty-five on the back of the body, two hundred and twenty-five on the right side of the body, and two hundred and twenty-five on the left side of the body.

Nandaka, in the fifteenth week — the seventh day of the fifteenth week — winds called the "lotus" winds arise within the mother's womb for the one dwelling there.

Through these, twenty channels are produced on the body of the one dwelling in the womb. Nandaka, of these, five channels are on the front of the body, five channels are on the back of the body, five channels are on the right side of the body, and five channels are on the left side of the body. These channels have many names and various names, and many colors and various colors. There are those called "companions," those called "the powerful," those called "the stable," and those called "the mighty." In color, there are blue, yellow, red, white, a tawny color like raw wool, variegated, the color of butter, the color of yogurt, the color of oil from grain, those pervaded by unripe bile, and those pervaded by ripe bile.

Nandaka, each of these twenty channels has forty encircling channels surrounding it, making those channels eight hundred in number. Nandaka, of these, two hundred arise on the front of the body, two hundred on the back of the body, two hundred on the right side of the body, and two hundred on the left side of the body. Two hundred belong to the companions, two hundred belong to the powerful, two hundred belong to the stable, and two hundred belong to the mighty.

Nandaka, each of those eight hundred channels has one hundred encircling channels surrounding it, making those channels eighty thousand in number. Nandaka, of these, twenty thousand arise on the front of the body, twenty thousand on the back of the body, twenty thousand on the right side of the body, and twenty thousand on the left side of the body.

Nandaka, moreover, at the root of each of those eighty thousand channels there are many pores and various pores — some channels have one pore, some have two pores, some have three, some four, some five, some six, and some have seven pores. Nandaka, it is just as the roots and stalks of a lotus have many pores and various pores — some with one pore, some with two, some with three, four, five, six, and some with seven pores. In the same way, Nandaka, at the root of each of those eighty thousand channels there are likewise many pores and various pores — some with one pore, some with two, some with three, four, five, six, and some with seven pores.

Nandaka, each of those channels connects individually to each separate hair follicle.

Nandaka, on the seventh day of the sixteenth week, winds called the "deathless" winds arise within the mother's womb for the one dwelling there. Through these, they fully set in place, establish, position, correctly place, and

individually arrange the two sense bases of the eye of the one dwelling in the womb. And they also fully set in place, establish, position, correctly place, and individually arrange the two sense bases of the ear, the two sense bases of the nose, the opening of the mouth, the throat, the hollow around the heart, and that which digests what has been eaten, drunk, chewed, and tasted, and that in which it abides, and that through which it is expelled downward.

Nandaka, just as a skilled potter or a potter's skilled apprentice takes a well-kneaded lump of clay, places it on the wheel, and fully sets in place, establishes, positions, correctly places, and individually arranges the shape of a vessel — in the same way, Nandaka, those winds born from karmic maturation likewise fully set in place the two sense bases of the eye of that one,

establish, correctly place, and individually arrange the two sense bases of the ear, the sense bases of the nose, the opening of the mouth, the throat, the hollow around the heart, and that which digests what has been eaten, drunk, chewed, and tasted, and that in which it abides, and that through which it is expelled downward.

Nandaka, on the seventeenth week — that is, the week that is seven days times seventeen — winds known as "the face of the draw-string" arise from within the mother's womb for the one dwelling there. Those winds thoroughly purify, individually arrange, fully set in place, distinctly arrange, and completely establish the two sense bases of the eye of that one dwelling in the womb; and they also thoroughly purify, fully set in place, distinctly arrange, and completely establish the two sense bases of the ear, the sense bases of the nose, the opening of the mouth, the throat, the hollow around the heart, and that which digests what has been eaten, drunk, chewed, and tasted, and that in which it abides, and that through which it is expelled downward.

Nandaka, consider this example: a skilled boy or girl takes a mirror disc that is not yet fully clean, and with a hand holding ash, or fine earth, or sesame oil, or a cloth moistened with fermented grain-water, polishes it, wipes it all over, thoroughly cleanses it, and makes it brilliantly clear.

This is the twelfth fascicle of the basis of the minor Vinaya.

Nandaka, in just the same way, those winds born from karmic maturation likewise thoroughly purify, fully set in place, individually arrange, firmly establish, distinctly arrange, and correctly place the two sense bases of the eye, the two sense bases of the ear, the sense bases of the nose, the opening

of the mouth, the throat, the hollow around the heart, and that which digests what has been eaten, drunk, chewed, and tasted, and that in which it abides, and that through which it is expelled downward.

Nandaka, on the eighteenth week, winds known as "the stainless" arise from within the mother's womb for the one dwelling there. Those winds render all those sense bases thoroughly pure and thoroughly cleansed. Nandaka, consider this example: when the disc of the sun or the disc of the moon is covered by great clouds and a great wind scatters those clouds, it becomes thoroughly pure and thoroughly cleansed. Nandaka, in just the same way, on the eighteenth week as well, when the winds known as "the stainless" arise within the mother's womb for the one dwelling there, those winds render all that one's sense bases thoroughly pure and thoroughly cleansed.

Nandaka, on the nineteenth week, the one dwelling in the womb obtains, within the mother's womb, four sense faculties: the sense faculty of the eye, the sense faculty of the ear, the sense faculty of the nose, and the sense faculty of the tongue. The three faculties — the sense faculty of the body, the faculty of mind, and the faculty of the life-force — were obtained by that one at the very moment of entering the womb previously.

Nandaka, on the twentieth week, winds known as "the firm" arise for the one dwelling in the womb. Those winds, in dependence upon the left foot of the one dwelling in the womb, generate twenty bones; in dependence upon the right foot, they generate twenty bones. They generate the four bones of the ankle, the two bones of the lower leg, the two bones of the knee, the two bones of the thigh, the three bones of the hip joint, the eighteen bones of the spine, the twenty-four bones of the ribs, and the three bones of the waist. In dependence upon the left arm they generate twenty bones; in dependence upon the right arm they generate twenty bones. They generate the two bones of the shoulder,

the four bones of the forearm, the seven bones of the chest, the seven bones of the collarbone region, the breastbone, the two bones of the jaw, the thirty-two bones of the teeth and their roots, and the four bones of the skull.

Ānanda, consider a sculptor or a sculptor's skilled apprentice: he binds together solid pieces of wood with cord and thereby fashions figures of various colors and shapes. In just the same way, Ānanda, those winds born of karmic maturation bring about the formation of a body of bones such as this.

Thus, Ānanda, at the twentieth week — the twentieth seven-day period — there arise, apart from the small bones that come together in clusters and the fine ones, two hundred of the great bones.

Ānanda, at the twenty-first week — the twenty-first seven-day period — winds called "the arising of all" rise from within the mother's womb for the one dwelling there, and these generate flesh upon the body of that one dwelling in the womb. Ānanda, consider a plasterer or a plasterer's skilled apprentice: using well-prepared clay, he plasters the foundation of a wall. In just the same way, those winds of arising generate flesh upon the one dwelling in the womb.

Ānanda, at the twenty-second week, winds called "the all-victorious" rise from within the mother's womb for the one dwelling there, and these generate blood in the one dwelling in the womb.

Ānanda, at the twenty-third week, winds called "the holder of purity" rise from within the mother's womb for the one dwelling there, and these generate skin upon the body of the one dwelling in the womb.

Ānanda, at the twenty-fourth week, winds called "the all-floating" rise from within the mother's womb for the one dwelling there, and these bring clarity and smoothness to the skin upon the body of the one dwelling in the womb.

Ānanda, at the twenty-fifth week, winds called "the carrier of dissolution" rise from within the mother's womb for the one dwelling there, and these bring clarity and smoothness to the flesh and blood upon the body of the one dwelling in the womb.

Ānanda, at the twenty-sixth week, within the mother's womb, hair of the head, body hair, and nails begin to grow upon the one dwelling there, and each of those hairs of the head, body hairs, and nails is individually connected to its own root channels.

Ānanda, at the twenty-seventh week, winds called "the great medicinal offering" rise from within the mother's womb for the one dwelling there, and these bring clarity and smoothness to the hair of the head, the body hair, and the nails of the one dwelling in the womb.

Ānanda, however, if that being was previously enmeshed and entangled in a web of wrong views tinged with blue and yellow, if it grasped at all manner of possessions, and if, by not listening respectfully to its teachers, it committed and accumulated non-virtuous, unwholesome actions of body, speech, and mind — and if those actions now become manifest for the sake of karmic

ripening — then even though it may be reborn among human beings in like measure as others, it will arrive in a condition described by this verse on bodily form:

Long and short, connected,
likewise manifold in number,
even and broad and rough,
tall and dark — these are what appear beautiful.

Whatever features are beautiful when long will become short for that one; whatever features are beautiful when short will become long for that one. Whatever features are beautiful when thick will become thin for that one; whatever features are beautiful when thin will become thick for that one. Whatever features are beautiful when joined will become disjointed for that one; whatever features are beautiful when disjointed will become joined for that one. Whatever features are beautiful when numerous will become few for that one; whatever features are beautiful when few will become numerous for that one.

Whatever features are beautiful when even will become uneven for that one; whatever features are beautiful when uneven will become even for that one. Whatever features are beautiful when broad will become narrow for that one; whatever features are beautiful when narrow will become broad for that one. Whatever features are beautiful when firm will become soft for that one; whatever features are beautiful when soft will become firm for that one. Whatever features are beautiful when low will become high for that one; whatever features are beautiful when high will become low for that one. Whatever features are beautiful when dark will become pale for that one; whatever features are beautiful when pale will become dark for that one.

Moreover, Ānanda, to whatever degree that person has committed and accumulated wicked, non-virtuous karma, to that very degree he will become dull-witted and mute, unpleasant to behold, deformed, with impaired hearing, with an impaired tongue, with a contracted mouth, and with withered hands; he will come to resemble hungry ghosts and will be unlike ordinary human beings. His own relatives and blood-kin will not want him, will find him unpleasant to behold, and will come to have the quality of being avoided — to say nothing of how other people will regard him. Whatever he accomplishes in the world through body, speech, and mind will be entirely unworthy of being received by the world and will not come to fruition. Ānanda, why is this? It is

because, having committed and accumulated wicked, non-virtuous karma, he becomes such as this.

Ānanda, if, on the other hand, that person has abandoned the stain of miserliness and is endowed with generosity, and through respectful attendance upon a teacher has performed and accumulated wholesome karma of body, speech, and mind — then if that too were to come to fruition, and he were to arrive at a human rebirth a hundredfold equal in fortune to this, then whatever features are beautiful when long will become long for that one; whatever features are beautiful when short will become short for that one. Whatever features are beautiful when thick will become thick for that one; whatever features are beautiful when slender will become slender for that one. Whatever features are beautiful when joined will become joined for that one; whatever features are beautiful when disjointed will become disjointed for that one. Whatever features are beautiful when numerous will become numerous for that one; whatever features are beautiful when few will become few for that one. Whatever features are beautiful when even will become even for that one; whatever features are beautiful when uneven will become uneven for that one. Whatever features are beautiful when broad will become broad for that one; whatever features are beautiful when narrow will become narrow for that one. Whatever features are beautiful when firm will become firm for that one; whatever features are beautiful when soft will become soft for that one. Whatever features are beautiful when low will become low for that one; whatever features are beautiful when high will become high for that one. Whatever features are beautiful when dark will become dark for that one; whatever features are beautiful when pale will become pale for that one.

Moreover, Ānanda, to whatever degree that person has performed and accumulated wholesome karma, to that very degree he will become handsome, beautiful, pleasing to behold, and endowed with a complexion of the highest bloom. He will be desired and found pleasing by other people — to say nothing of his relatives and blood-kin. Whatever he accomplishes in the world through body, speech, and mind will all be worthy of being received by the world and will come to fruition. Ānanda, why is this?

It is because that one has performed and accumulated wholesome karma that it is thus.

Ānanda, if the being is to become a boy, it will sit crouched and huddled on the right side of the mother's womb, covering its face with both hands and looking

back toward the mother's spine, resting on top of the bladder, covered by the stomach, supported by the membrane, and bound as though tied with five cords or transfixed on a post. Ānanda, if the being is to become a girl, it will sit crouched and huddled on the left side of the mother's womb, covering its face with both hands and looking toward the mother's belly, resting on top of the bladder, covered by the stomach, supported by the membrane, and bound as though tied with five cords or transfixed on a post.

Ānanda, if the mother eats excessively, this harms the being dwelling in the womb; and if she eats too little, this likewise harms the being dwelling in the womb. In the same way, eating food that is excessively oily, excessively coarse, excessively cold, excessively hot, excessively salty, excessively sour, excessively sweet, excessively bitter, excessively spicy, or excessively pungent will all cause harm to the being dwelling in the womb. Engaging in sensual activities, running excessively, moving quickly, jumping, or swimming will disturb the being entering into existence and cause harm to the being dwelling in the womb; and sitting near a fire or sitting crouched and huddled will likewise cause harm to the being dwelling in the womb. Ānanda, the being dwelling in the mother's womb endures suffering that is intense, sharp, hot, and thoroughly disagreeable.

Ānanda, if even those beings who are named as migrating to a good destiny experience suffering of this kind, what need is there even to speak of the beings who have fallen into bad destinies, miserable destinies, and ruinous rebirths — into the hells? Their suffering cannot even be given as an example.

Ānanda, what benefit is there in dwelling in the womb for one who is seeking existence? Ānanda, on the twenty-eighth day of the seventh week, eight inverted perceptions arise for the being dwelling inside the mother's womb: the perception of a house, the perception of a vehicle, the perception of a pleasure grove, the perception of a multi-storied building, the perception of a pleasure garden, the perception of a throne, the perception of a river, and the perception of a pond.

Ānanda, on the twenty-ninth day of the seventh week, winds arise within the mother's womb for that being, called "the winds that thoroughly cleanse." These thoroughly cleanse and clarify the skin color of the body of that being dwelling in the womb. For some, the skin color — being dark through the ripening of karma, appearing dark in color, seemingly dark, and emitting a dark light — is thoroughly cleansed and clarified. For some, the skin color —

being a dusky blue, appearing dusky blue in color, seemingly dusky blue, and emitting a dusky blue light — is thoroughly cleansed and clarified. For some, the skin color — being coarse, appearing coarse in color, seemingly coarse, and emitting a coarse light — is thoroughly cleansed and clarified. Likewise, for some the color is oily, for some white, and so forth as before, described as "of a white color" and so on. For some, the skin color is like the color of the bark of kuśa grass — appearing in color like the bark of kuśa grass, seeming to be like the color of the bark of kuśa grass — and the skin is thoroughly cleansed and clarified so as to emit the color of kuśa-bark.

Ānanda, on the thirtieth day of the seventh week, winds arise within the mother's womb for that being, called "the iron-gate winds." These thoroughly cleanse that being's body, including the hair of the head, the body hair, and the nails.

and thoroughly clarified. For some, the hair of the head, the body hair, and the nails become dark — a dark color. For some, they are yellowish — a yellowish color, rough, of a rough color, oily, of an oily color — and these are thoroughly cleansed and clarified.

Ānanda, on the thirty-first day of the seventh week, the being dwelling in the womb will grow and expand within its mother's belly. Ānanda, in just the same way, on the thirty-second day, the thirty-third day, and the thirty-fourth day of the seventh week, the being dwelling in the womb will grow and expand within its mother's belly.

Ānanda, on the thirty-fifth day of the seventh week, the being dwelling in the womb will come to possess all its major and minor limbs, within its mother's belly.

Ānanda, on the thirty-sixth day of the seventh week, the being dwelling in the womb wishes to emerge and feels displeasure at remaining there.

Ānanda, on the thirty-seventh day of the seventh week, the being dwelling in the womb, within its mother's belly, will obtain the three accurate perceptions: the perception of impurity, the perception of foul odor, and the perception of emergence.

Ānanda, on the thirty-eighth day of the seventh week, winds called "the limb winds" arise within the mother's belly for the being dwelling in the womb. These turn that being about, bring its two hands together, and place it at the gateway of the mother's womb. Then, by reason of that being's karma and its

fruits, winds called "the downward-facing winds" arise. These raise its feet upward and lower its head downward, and push it in the direction of the mother's urinary passage.

Ānanda, if that being had previously performed and accumulated sinful, non-virtuous karma that would lead to death within an earlier womb, then its feet become reversed, or its hands become reversed. Unable to emerge in the reversed position, its life faculty is cut off.

Thereupon, skilled women or young persons expert in the care of the newborn anoint their hands with butter or grain-oil, or smear them with a well-prepared ointment of the śalmali plant, and fit onto that same hand a blade with a thin, well-sharpened edge, exceedingly sharp, like a razor. That womb — which is like a drain, utterly nauseating and foul-smelling, a dark cavity, damp and moist, the constant dwelling-place of many hundreds of thousands of species of worms, perpetually requiring cleansing, thoroughly putrefied by filthy fluids, blood, impurities, and pus, rotting and decaying all around, shrouded in the hide of a bladder-sac that is terrifying to behold when stretched out, and arisen from the karmic maturation of past actions — into the channel of that wound-cavity of the body they insert the hand, gently softened with butter, grain-oil, and a śalmali-plant ointment, and having carefully palpated the being dwelling within the womb, they cut it into pieces and extract it. On that basis, both the mother and child who desired the birth will experience intense, acute, unbearable, and disagreeable feelings of suffering, and tormented by those feelings they may die, or they will experience the suffering of near-death.

Ānanda, if that being had previously performed and accumulated virtuous karma that would lead to a long life, then it will not fail to emerge, and will not remain unable to come forth; its life faculty will not be cut off. And on that basis, its mother will not experience so much as a single moment of intense, acute, unbearable, and disagreeable feelings of suffering.

When the thirty-eighth week has passed, the being emerges from the mother's belly with great suffering, great intensity, great acuteness, and great unbearability. Ānanda, birth is utterly painful.

Ānanda, immediately upon emerging, two perceptions arise for that being:

"A boy has been born," or "A girl has been born."

Ānanda, immediately upon the birth of a boy or a girl, if that newborn is picked up by hand, it experiences from that very basis intense, harsh, unbearable, and disagreeable feelings of suffering individually. If it is picked up in cloth, it experiences from that very basis intense, harsh, unbearable, and disagreeable feelings of suffering individually. If it is held in the lap, or placed on a bed, or on a small cot, or on the ground, or on a flat plank of wood, or in a covered place, or in an uncovered place, or placed in shade, or touched by sunlight, or touched by wind, it experiences from that very basis nothing but feelings of suffering individually — experiencing their very intensity, their very harshness, their very unbearability, and their very disagreeableness.

Ānanda, consider this example: a freshly flayed ox-hide — if it is left leaning against a wall, then whatever creatures live on walls will feed upon it. If it is placed against a tree, or a pile of grass, or left suspended in open air, then whatever creatures inhabit those places will feed upon it. Ānanda, whatever that freshly flayed ox-hide is set against, the creatures dwelling there will devour it, and from that very basis it experiences intense, harsh, unbearable, and disagreeable feelings of suffering.

Ānanda, in exactly the same way, when a boy or a girl has just been born, if that newborn is picked up by hand, it experiences — as was said before, from "feelings of suffering" all the way through to "disagreeable" — exactly those things individually. If it is wrapped in cloth, or held in the lap, or placed on a bed, or on a small cot, or on the ground, or on a flat plank of wood, or in a covered place, or in an uncovered place, or placed in shade, or touched by heat, or touched by cold, it experiences from that very basis nothing but suffering individually — experiencing its very intensity, its very harshness, its very unbearability, and its very disagreeableness.

Ānanda, even if a newborn child is merely touched by gentle water, it experiences from that very basis nothing but suffering — from "suffering" all the way through to "nothing but disagreeableness" — individually.

Ānanda, consider this example: a man afflicted with leprosy, with a weeping body, a body inflamed, a body decaying — one who is suffering, whose faculties have deteriorated — if he is struck with a whip, he experiences nothing but suffering individually, experiencing its very intensity, its very harshness, its very unbearability, and its very disagreeableness.

Ānanda, in exactly the same way, even if a newborn child is merely touched by gentle water, it experiences from that very basis nothing but suffering

individually — experiencing its very intensity, its very harshness, its very unbearability, and its very disagreeableness.

Ānanda, born in this way, arisen in this way, fully manifest in this way — from that point onward it is nourished, sustained, and kept alive by the impurity of its own blood. Ānanda, in this noble Dharma discipline, that impurity of blood is to be understood as mother's milk.

Ānanda, when wandering in saṃsāra, what pleasure is there for one who desires existence and is thus endangered by manifold sufferings? For a body born in such a way, arisen in such a way, seven days after birth eighty thousand kinds of parasitic worms will arise, and they will devour every part of that sentient being's body. Ānanda, among those parasitic kinds: the kind called "hair-eaters" dwell at the roots of the hairs and feed upon the hairs. The second two kinds — those called "stick-shaped" and "large-headed" — dwell on the head and feed upon the head. The kind called "eye-devourers" dwell at the eyes and feed upon the eyes. The four kinds called "wanderers," "givers,"

"Orderly" and "Full" dwell on the brain and feed upon the brain. The kind called "Eye-of-Thought" dwells at the eyes and feeds upon the eyes. The kind called "Storehouse-Door" dwells at the nose and feeds upon the nose. The two kinds called "Thrower" and "Setter" dwell at the lips and feed upon the lips. The kind called "Honey-Petal" dwells at the teeth and feeds upon the teeth. The kind called "Wooden-Door" dwells at the roots of the teeth and feeds upon the roots of the teeth. The kind called "Needle-Mouth" dwells at the tongue and feeds upon the tongue. The kind called "Sharp-Lip" dwells at the base of the tongue and feeds upon the base of the tongue. The kind called "Handed" dwells at the palate and feeds upon the palate. The two kinds called "Water-Net" and "Half-Curved" dwell at the fingers and feed upon the fingers. The two kinds called "Dangling" and "Fully Dangling" dwell at the wrists and feed upon the wrists. The two kinds called "Shoulder" and "Near-Shoulder" dwell at the shoulders and feed upon the shoulders. The two kinds called "Digger" and "Near-Digger" dwell at the sides and feed upon the sides. The two kinds called "Wrathful" and "Great Wrathful" dwell at the heart and feed upon the heart. The two kinds called "Conch" and "Conch-Water" dwell at the flesh and feed upon the flesh. The two kinds called "Colored" and "Powerful" dwell at the blood and drink the blood. The two kinds called "Hero" and "Scented-Door" dwell at the lymphatic channels and feed upon the lymphatic channels. The two kinds called "Low" and "Hollow-Mouthed" dwell at the spine and feed upon the spine. The kind called "Fat-Colored" dwells at the fat and feeds upon the

fat. The kind called "Bile-Colored" dwells at the bile and feeds upon the bile. The kind called "Pearl" dwells at the spleen and feeds upon the spleen. The kind called "Great Pearl" dwells at the kidneys and feeds upon the kidneys. The kind called "Not-Yet-Come" dwells at the liver and feeds upon the liver. The four kinds called "Water-Mixture," "Great Water-Mixture," "Needle-Mouth," and "Great Needle-Mouth" dwell at the intestines and feed upon the intestines. The five kinds called "Moon," "Moon-Face," "Moon-Light," "Moon-Light-Face," and "Vast" dwell at the right lung and feed upon the right lung. The other kinds called by that same name dwell at the left lung and feed upon the left lung. The four kinds called "Sequential-Piercer," "Forward-Piercer," "Hard-Piercer," and "Firm-Piercer" dwell at the bones and feed upon the bones. The four kinds called "White," "Near-White," "Strength-Robber," and "Smooth" dwell at the channels and feed upon the channels. The four kinds called "Lion," "Powerful," "Muddy," and "Flower-Taker" dwell at the stomach and feed upon the stomach. The two kinds called "Stable" and "Near-Stable" dwell at the bladder and feed upon the bladder. The four kinds called "Worm-Mouth," "Aggregate-Face," "Net-Mouth," and "Render" dwell in the urinary tract and feed upon the urinary tract. The four kinds called "Ill-Sounding," "Great Ill-Sounding," "Drawer," and "Possessed-of-Slime" dwell in the digestive tract and feed upon the digestive tract. The two kinds called "Diseased-Mouth" and "Terror-Maker" dwell at the thighs and feed upon the thighs. The two kinds called "Leprous" and "Near-Leprous" dwell at the knees and feed upon the knees. The kind called "Root-of-Stupidity" dwells at the calves and feeds upon the calves.

The kind of worm called "Black-Head" dwells at the toes and feeds upon the toes.

Nanda, this body is thus gnawed day and night by eight hundred kinds of worms, and because of that it becomes tormented, utterly tormented, feeble, and afflicted. Nanda, arising from that very basis, one comes to experience, individually experience, feel, and fully feel torment, utter torment, and complete torment of body; and one comes to experience, individually experience, feel, and fully feel torment, utter torment, and complete torment of mind. One comes to experience, individually experience, feel, and fully feel bodily fever, exhaustion, and complete burning; and one comes to experience, individually experience, feel, and fully feel mental fever, exhaustion, and complete burning. When even physicians are bewildered by this and do not know how to compound the medicine for it, Nanda, what pleasure can there be in clinging to existence in cyclic existence, which is threatened in this way by

so many sufferings?

Nanda, since the body arises in this way and is fully constituted in this way, afflictions of the following kinds appear in it: affliction by gods, affliction by nāgas, affliction by asuras, affliction by wind-gods, affliction by garuḍas, affliction by gandharvas, affliction by kinnaras, affliction by great serpents, affliction by yakṣas, affliction by rākṣasas, affliction by hungry ghosts, affliction by flesh-eaters, affliction by elemental spirits, affliction by the pot-bellied ones, affliction by the decaying ones, affliction by the bodily decaying ones, affliction by the blind decaying ones, affliction by the withering ones, affliction by the maddening ones, affliction by the shadow-oppressors, affliction by the sweating ones, affliction by birds, affliction by wild animals, affliction by those of the sky-corner, affliction by lords of livestock, affliction by māmō spirits, affliction by the grinning ones, affliction by the skeletal ones, affliction by the weakening ones, affliction by the moon, affliction by the sun, and affliction by the stars. When such afflictions as these arise in the body, Nanda, what pleasure can there be in dwelling in the womb of a mother who is seeking existence?

Nanda, one who is born in this way, fully constituted in this way, is produced, sustained, and nourished by one's mother's own filth of blood. Nanda, a mother's breast-milk, in the noble Dharma-Vinaya, is called just this: "filth of blood."

Nanda, one who dwells in that way in the place of the womb of a mother seeking existence, born in that way, arisen in that way, fully constituted in that way — what pleasure can there be in eating coarse food in that way? Even if one is cared for excellently and comfortably, one lives at most a hundred years, or perhaps a little longer. Half of that is covered over by sleep. Ten years pass in childhood. At twenty one is old. And one is cut down by grief, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness, and distress; one is cut down by the many hundreds of manifold diseases arising from the body. Nanda, diseases of the body arise that are exceedingly difficult to bear, and when tormented by them, living beings even wish to die.

Nanda, the life of embodied beings at the present time is utterly unbearable, brief, and wretched; it is attended by suffering and leads onward to the next life. Therefore one should practice virtue and live the pure spiritual life, for there is no one who is born and does not die. Yet people at the present time abide heedlessly with respect to practicing what is meaningful, practicing

Dharma, practicing merit, practicing virtue, and practicing what is wholesome and good. It is through karma that virtuous and non-virtuous actions are performed here.

Nanda, dwell with mindfulness and heedfulness. In the end you will come to regret it: you will be separated from everything desirable, pleasant, joyful, and agreeable. Separation and parting are utterly inevitable.

Nanda, embodied beings are those for whom karma is their own possession, karma is their inheritance, and karma is their refuge. Whether karma is virtuous or sinful, whatever actions they perform, they become heirs to precisely those actions.

Nanda, one who lives for a hundred years passes through ten phases of life, each experienced in turn. In the first phase one is a helpless infant lying on one's back. In the second phase one is a youth given to play. In the third phase one sporadically indulges in sensual pleasures. In the fourth phase one is possessed of strength and enthusiasm. In the fifth phase one is possessed of wisdom and courage. In the sixth phase one is possessed of mindfulness and has a discerning nature. In the seventh phase one's steadiness reaches its full measure. In the eighth phase one's steadiness is like that of a king. In the ninth phase one is old and bent by age. In the tenth phase one's life is exhausted and one is subject to death. And so, Nanda, one who lives for a hundred years passes through each of those ten phases in turn.

A life of one hundred years amounts to three hundred seasons of life: one hundred seasons of winter, one hundred seasons of spring, and one hundred seasons of summer. A life of three hundred seasons amounts to one thousand two hundred months: four months of winter, four months of spring, and four months of summer. A life of one thousand two hundred months amounts to two thousand four hundred fortnights: eight fortnights of winter, eight fortnights of spring, and eight fortnights of summer. A life of two thousand four hundred fortnights amounts to thirty-six thousand days. One who lives thirty-six thousand days consumes seventy-two thousand meals, not counting the intervals when no meals are taken. The occasions when one does not eat are these: when one does not eat out of anger, when one does not eat out of contentment, when one does not eat out of suffering, when one does not eat even though food is obtained, when one does not eat because food is not obtained, when one does not eat because one is asleep, when one does not eat because one is keeping a fast, when one does not eat because one is

carried away in play, and when one does not eat because one is distracted by activities. Totalling together all meals eaten and all meals not eaten, and including mother's milk, the sum comes to seventy-two thousand.

Nanda, in this way the years, seasons, months, fortnights, days, meals, and meal intervals of those mortals who live for a hundred years have been set forth.

Nanda, for one born thus and come forth thus, with a body thus fully constituted, there arise in the body diseases of the following kinds: headache, eye disease, ear disease, nasal disease, tooth disease, throat disease, heart disease, catarrh, cough, scabies, foot disease, leprosy, tumors, fine pustules, mottled skin, amnesia, seizure, gout, night-sweat, dropsy, hiccup, nausea, jaundice, diarrhea, fever, virulent fever, vomiting, shortness of breath, wasting disease, hunger and thirst, vertigo, swelling, lipoma, bile disease, inflammation, infectious disease,

one-day fever, two-day fever, three-day fever, four-day fever, continuous fever, fever of the limbs, fever of the ribs, fever of the heart, pain in the limbs, pain in the ribs, pain in the heart, and pain in the joints. Nanda, for one constituted in such a way, there arise one hundred and one diseases arising from wind, one hundred and one diseases arising from bile, one hundred and one diseases arising from phlegm, and one hundred and one diseases arising from their combination. When these are totaled, four hundred and four diseases arise within the body. Nanda, this body is subject to disease, subject to eruptions, subject to pain; it does not last long; it is subject to destruction, impermanence, suffering, emptiness, no-self; it has rivals and adversaries; its breathing is labored; and it is subject to transformation.

Nanda, when sentient beings are born, they come to experience, to individually experience, to feel, to individually feel the suffering of having their hands cut off; the suffering of having their feet cut off; the suffering of having their ears cut off; the suffering of having their lips cut off; the suffering of having their tongues cut off; the suffering of having their heads cut off; and the various sufferings of being bound with unwanted restraints, with iron, with a neck-yoke, with arms pinioned behind the back, and with the fivefold binding. They come to experience, to individually experience, to feel, to individually feel various intense, harsh, unbearable sufferings that reach unto death: being rolled on a grindstone, being pierced with sharp stakes, being impaled on a wooden stake, being boiled in copper, and the like. They come to

experience, to individually experience, to feel, to individually feel the sufferings of being killed, bound, beaten, threatened, starved, and thirsted; and various sufferings arising from frost, rain, horseflies, mosquitoes, wind and sun, and the touch of venomous snakes.

Nanda, thus, when sentient beings are harassed and utterly overwhelmed by such sufferings, and when those who relentlessly seek, who pursue, who thoroughly search for rooted suffering — suffering sought after — cling again and again to that pursuit, there arise for them intense, harsh, unbearable, disagreeable physical and mental sufferings that torment and afflict. Nanda, therefore: birth is suffering, aging is suffering, illness is suffering, death is suffering, separation from what one loves is suffering, meeting with what one does not love is suffering, and not obtaining what one seeks and desires is also suffering. In brief, the five aggregates of clinging are suffering.

Nanda, know that each of the four postures — walking, sitting, standing, and lying down — is in its own way suffering. When a practitioner of meditative concentration examines those postures and their intrinsic nature: if one were to pass the entire day walking and were never to stand, never to sit, never to lie down, one would experience in that walking nothing but suffering — one would individually experience and feel its intensity, its harshness, its unbearability, its disagreeableness — and no perception of pleasure would arise with respect to that walking. If one were to pass the entire day sitting and were never to walk, never to stand, never to lie down, one would experience in that sitting nothing but suffering, and would individually experience and feel its intensity, its harshness,

its unbearability, its disagreeableness — and no perception of pleasure would arise with respect to that sitting. If one were to pass the entire day standing and were never to sit, never to walk, never to lie down, one would experience in that standing nothing but suffering, and would individually experience and feel its intensity, its harshness, its unbearability, its disagreeableness — and no perception of pleasure would arise with respect to that standing. If one were to pass the entire day lying down and were never to walk, never to stand, never to sit, one would experience in that lying down nothing but suffering, and would individually experience and feel its intensity, its harshness, its unbearability, its disagreeableness — and no perception of pleasure would arise with respect to that lying down.

Yet, Ānanda, it is because each successive suffering of those postures is interrupted that a perception of pleasure arises upon the arising of a different and distinct resting-point of suffering. And yet, Ānanda, when that arises, only suffering arises, and when it ceases, only suffering ceases. When it arises, it is formations alone that arise, and when it ceases, it is formations alone that cease. The Tathāgata, having thoroughly understood in his mind the continuity and interconnection of formations, declared to sentient beings the nature of death and rebirth. Ānanda, all formations are impermanent and unstable. All formations are oppressive and subject to change. Therefore, Ānanda, it is fitting to become disenchanted with all formations and fitting to seek liberation from them.

Ānanda, even among those who hold the perception that they are bound for a fortunate destiny, there arise such extremely unbearable, dreadful, contemptible, indescribable, deceptive, and manifold forms of suffering. What need then is there even to speak of those born in the hells, among animals, or in the realm of hungry ghosts? It is exceedingly difficult to give even an illustrative example to convey what their forms of suffering are like.

Ānanda, there are four ways of entering the womb. What are the four? In this world, some enter the mother's womb with full awareness, remain in the mother's womb with full awareness, and emerge from the mother's womb with full awareness. This is the first way of entering the womb. Ānanda, furthermore, some enter the mother's womb with full awareness, remain in the mother's womb with full awareness, and emerge from the mother's womb without full awareness. This is the second way of entering the womb. Ānanda, furthermore, some enter the mother's womb with full awareness, remain in the mother's womb without full awareness, and emerge from the mother's womb without full awareness. This is the third way of entering the womb. Ānanda, furthermore, some enter the mother's womb without full awareness, remain in the mother's womb without full awareness, and emerge from the mother's womb without full awareness. This is the fourth way of entering the womb.

How is it that one enters the mother's womb with full awareness, remains in the mother's womb with full awareness, and emerges from the mother's womb with full awareness? In this world, some person is by nature endowed with moral discipline — possessed of virtuous qualities, inclined toward virtue, consistently engaged in virtue, holding many restraints, given to much reflection, dwelling in heedfulness, and possessed of great wisdom — and at the time of death, whether that person is one who has not yet attained any

result, or a stream-enterer, a once-returner, or a non-returner who dies having had but a single intervening life: though touched by intense, harsh, unbearable, disagreeable, and life-taking feelings of pain at the moment of death, that person, supported and sustained by those virtuous qualities, does not lose mindfulness,

and passes the time of death without losing mindfulness. Thereupon, without losing mindfulness, with full vigilance, that person enters the womb of a mother. Having entered there, what comes to be is this: karma as one's own possession, born of karma, partaking of the inheritance of karma, relying upon karma, done by intention, arising through dependent origination — a womb intensely hot; karma as one's own possession, partaking of the inheritance of karma, relying upon karma, done by intention, arising through dependent origination; dependent upon māra, a vessel of māra, the home of māra; a treasury of every impurity; unstable; of a deceptive nature; leading fools astray; a mechanical contrivance of bones strung with sinews; enveloped in a net of channels; wrapped in flesh, blood, and fat; covered over by nothing more than skin; bristling with a host of lice, and destined to grow hair, nails, teeth, and bodily hair — clinging to pride, the conceit of "I," thinking "this is mine"; seized by ego-clinging and the sense of "I"; overtly addicted; without self-mastery; saturated and oozing with the damp seepage of rotting filth, with grease, pus, sweat, saliva, bile, phlegm, lungs, intestines, the small intestine, the spleen, the bladder, filled completely with many forms of impurity; the habitat of many thousands of species of worms, possessed of two extremely foul-smelling orifices; furnished with many holes and cavities in the bones; slimy with urine, brain, and cerebellum, and the drippings of the assembly of limbs — lying beneath the stomach on the hollow floor of the belly, its face turned toward the spine, its back presented to the skin of the abdomen, swallowing and swallowing in fine, grinding fashion with the double row of teeth what food arrives month by month with the monthly flow, in the form of predigested nourishment; moistened from below by the filth of the wound of the mouth and by saliva, pressed from above by the cerebellum; nourished by the taste of food resembling vomit as it enters through the navel opening within the belly; and thus gradually transforming into something soft and tender, then something firming and hardening, then something thickening, then rounding out, taking on the form of limbs sprouting hands and feet. The hands, feet, and flanks are wrapped in a membrane of raw flesh, foul-smelling beyond endurance like a used rag. It moves about here and there in utter

darkness. It is touched by the tastes of food — bitter, sour, acrid, salty, hot, and scorching like tongues of flame. It is nourished by unclean fluid as though by a grub-releasing vessel. It enters into the mire of impurity, oozing and blazing. The vital faculty is unstable. It is burned on all sides, through and through, utterly tormented, by the inner fire of the mother's body — burned everywhere and entirely, heated everywhere and entirely, scorched everywhere and entirely — and it experiences great, intense, harsh, unbearable, and disagreeable feelings of suffering. In whatever way the mother is still, moves a little, or moves fully about, or carries a heavy burden, or stretches her body, in just those ways that person, as if bound by five bonds and thrust into a pit of smoldering fire, experiences great, intense, harsh, unbearable, and disagreeable feelings of suffering that are hard to illustrate by comparison. Yet while dwelling thus in the abode of the mother's womb and beset by suffering, because the faculties are keen, mindfulness is not lost.

Among those dwelling in the mother's womb, moreover, there are some who, through the power of causes and conditions of previous karma, experience a reversal in the womb and come to feel discomfort while dwelling there. When the mother consumes and drinks what is discordant — something excessively cold, or excessively hot, or excessively sour, or excessively sweet, or excessively pungent, or excessively sharp, or excessively scorching, or excessively rough, or excessively salty; or when she is struck by indigestion from drink, or by indigestion from food; or when she is frequently ill, or speaks excessively,

or is greatly sorrowful, or excessively attached, or fatigued, or struck — then by those causes her body comes to be harmed. When her body is harmed, what depends upon it, namely the one dwelling in the womb, is also harmed. Being harmed there and threatened by extreme suffering, it stirs, and through that stirring it becomes reversed.

Thereupon a woman skilled in midwifery, or a young nurse, anoints her hand with a little warm water, white butter, and sesame oil, and introduces it into that great mechanism of bones — that opening which is like a cesspit: foul-smelling, stinking, unbearable, pitch-dark, filled with slimy mud, home to many hundreds of thousands of worms, constantly dripping and in perpetual need of cleansing, filthy, tainted with blood and serum and festering throughout, in a state of utter decay, swarming with flies, dreadful to behold, covered in the membrane of the birth canal. She slowly and gently feels her way and correctly repositions the child just as it was.

When she so repositions it, groping with a hand anointed with a little warm water, white butter, and sesame oil, the one dwelling there experiences a great feeling of suffering that is intense, rough, unbearable, and disagreeable. To give an analogy, Nanda: if a young man of noble family, whose body is extremely tender by nature, were to have all his limbs and minor limbs cut with a razor sharp enough to shave hair, and were then smeared all over with a fierce medicinal substance, an extremely intense, rough, unbearable, and disagreeable great feeling of suffering would arise in his body. In just the same way, Nanda, when that hand anointed with a little warm water, white butter, and sesame oil gropes about, an intense, rough, unbearable, and disagreeable great feeling of suffering arises in the body. Yet even when these intense, rough, unbearable, and disagreeable great feelings of suffering born from tactile contact arise in the body of the one dwelling in the womb, the mindfulness of that being does not deteriorate on account of having keen faculties. Thus it is that the being dwells in the mother's womb with full awareness.

Then, once all the limbs and minor limbs have formed, the wind born from the maturation of previous karma, by the force of causes and conditions, propels the being — with feet raised upward, head turned downward, and both hands drawn in — so that it is squeezed, pressed, and thoroughly crushed by the two mechanisms of bone at the opening of the bladder: that place of putrefaction, decay, collapse, unbearableness, foul smell, stench, pitch-dark darkness, dreadful to behold, smeared with excrement and urine, tainted with foul odor, constantly dripping with blood and serum. All the bony protuberances of the body's limbs become like one raw wound and turn blue. All the sense faculties of the body burn. The body is befouled by the extremely foul impurity of the womb. The mouth, throat, and heart dry out from thirst. Afflicted and tormented, dwelling in an unbearable state — then, propelled by the wind born from the maturation of previous karma through the power of causes and conditions, the being emerges, just as with great difficulty anything whatsoever emerges. The very moment it emerges, if the outer wind touches it — like the touch of a fierce medicinal substance on a raw wound — or if it is touched by a hand or by cloth, it experiences an intense, rough, unbearable, and disagreeable great feeling of suffering, as though being cut by a sword. And yet even when threatened by such suffering, the mindfulness of that being does not deteriorate on account of having keen faculties. Thus it is that the being emerges from the mother's womb with full awareness.

Therefore, Nanda, since entering the mother's womb is suffering, dwelling there is suffering, and emerging from the mother's womb is also suffering —

Nanda, what pleasure is there in dwelling in the mother's womb, longing as one does for existence? How is it that one enters the mother's womb with full awareness, dwells there with full awareness, and yet emerges from the mother's womb without awareness?

In this regard, there are some who are ordinary persons by nature and who are naturally endowed with moral discipline, who possess wholesome qualities, who are inclined toward virtue, who practise virtue in all things, who are richly endowed with restraint and discernment, who abide in heedfulness and are free from remorse — or those who are stream-enterers. When such a person, having reached the time of death — whether one who will be reborn seven more times, or one who is born from noble family to noble family, or a once-returner, or one who will die in an intermediate state — is sustained and stabilized in those wholesome qualities at the moment of death, even though they are touched by feelings of suffering at death that are intense, rough, unbearable, and disagreeable, that rend the life-force, their mindfulness does not deteriorate. And so they die without their mindfulness deteriorating. Thereafter, without mindfulness having deteriorated, they enter the mother's womb with full awareness.

Having entered there, as was described earlier from the passage "let it be known as one's own karma" up through "nourished by fluids like a creature in a net, gone into a swamp blazing with foul filth, the life-faculty unstable, scorched on all sides by the fire within the mother's body" — they are burned, utterly burned, completely burned, and experience a great feeling of suffering that is intense, rough, unbearable, and disagreeable. And according to whatever movement, every movement, and complete movement of the mother, they are correspondingly bound by the five bonds and experience a great feeling of suffering that is intense, rough, unbearable, disagreeable, and beyond compare, as though thrust into a pit of smouldering embers. And yet, dwelling thus in the mother's womb and threatened by such suffering, their mindfulness does not deteriorate.

Among those dwelling in the mother's womb, there are also some for whom, through the power of causes and conditions from previous karma, the womb becomes inverted and dwelling in the womb becomes uncomfortable. As described earlier from the passage "when the mother eats or drinks something

discordant, extremely cold or extremely hot" — if she is struck, jostled, or beaten, those causes harm her body. When harm comes to her body, harm comes as well to the being depending on her who dwells in the womb. When harmed there and threatened by intense suffering, it stirs, and through that stirring the womb becomes inverted. Thereafter, a woman who is experienced or a young midwife skilled in obstetrics, having coated her hand with warm water, white butter, and sesame oil, as described from that passage up through "massages it and repositions it properly in place" — when it is massaged by a hand coated with warm water, white butter, and sesame oil, the being experiences a great feeling of suffering in the body that is intense, rough, unbearable, and disagreeable.

Nanda, consider, for example, a youth of noble family, exceedingly tender in constitution, whose limbs and secondary limbs are all cut with a sharp razor fit for shaving hair, and whose body is then anointed all over with a fierce caustic substance — such a person would experience in the body a great feeling of suffering that is intense, rough, unbearable, and disagreeable.

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In just the same way, Nanda, when that being is massaged by a hand coated with warm water, white butter, and sesame oil, there arises in its body a great feeling of suffering that is intense, rough, unbearable, and disagreeable. Even though those great feelings of suffering arising from the painful contact that afflict the body of that being dwelling in the mother's womb — feelings so intense, rough, unbearable, and disagreeable — arise in this way, its mindfulness does not deteriorate. Thus it is that the being dwells with full awareness in the mother's womb.

Then, once all the limbs and secondary limbs have fully formed, the being dwells in a womb that is a festering place of urine, a site of falling filth, unbearably foul-smelling, rank, dark, and terrifying to behold — smeared with excrement and urine, oozing with impure odors, and with wounds that constantly seep blood and lymph. A wind born from the karmic maturation of past karma pushes the feet upward and the head downward; with both arms drawn in, the being is pressed and crushed on all sides by the two wheels of bone. Great feelings of suffering — intense, rough, unbearable, and disagreeable — afflict it, and every limb of the body, like a wound that is raw and exposed, becomes bruised and livid, while all the sense faculties of the body burn with heat. The womb's utterly defiling impurities wrap around the

body; thirst parches the lips, the throat, and the heart. Dwelling there in that wretched, pathetic misery, unbearably afflicted, the being is at last expelled by the wind born from the karmic maturation of past karma, through the force of causes and conditions, emerging with terrible difficulty. The very moment it emerges, the contact of the outer wind upon its raw body — like that of a sharp-edged substance, or the touch of a hand, or the touch of clothing — is experienced as a great feeling of suffering that is intense, rough, unbearable, and disagreeable, like being cut by a blade.

When afflicted by such suffering, because its faculties are only of middling strength, the being's mindfulness deteriorates and the mind is struck with confusion. Thus it is that, unlike the entry into the womb, the departure from the mother's womb occurs without full awareness.

Nanda, in this way, entering the mother's womb is suffering, dwelling in the mother's womb is suffering, and departing from the mother's womb is also suffering. Nanda, what pleasure, then, is there in wishing for continued existence and in dwelling in the place of the mother's womb? How is it that one enters the mother's womb with full awareness, dwells in it without full awareness, and departs from it without full awareness?

Here, there are certain ordinary persons who are by their very nature endowed with moral discipline, who possess virtuous qualities, who aspire to virtue, who practice virtue throughout, who have many vows and much discernment, who dwell in heedfulness, who are free from regret — or who have entered the stream of liberation. If such a person, having reached that point, is either a seven-times-returner, or one who is born from noble family to noble family, or a once-returner, or one who has an intervening existence of a single life and makes their death, then the stability of those very virtuous qualities, even when contacted by the intense, rough, unbearable, and disagreeable feelings of suffering at the moment of death — feelings that strip away the life-force — will not cause the mindfulness to deteriorate. That person passes away with mindfulness unimpaired, and then with mindfulness unimpaired enters the mother's womb with full awareness. Having entered there, dwelling in the womb in accordance with karma — the womb itself being born by karma, sustained by karma, supported by karma, created by intention, arising through dependent origination — that place is supremely hot.

It is a place where one dwells in accordance with karma, is born by karma, supported by karma, created by intention, arising through dependent

origination. It is dependent upon māra, a vessel of māra, a home of māra, a treasury of all that is impure, unstable, possessed of a deceptive nature, capable of leading children astray. It is a mechanical contrivance of bones, wound around by a lattice of tendons and ligaments, encased in a net of channels and veins, wrapped in flesh, blood, and fat, covered over with nothing but skin. It is an assemblage of impurities heaped together. Hair, nails, teeth, and body hair grow and appear on it. It is attended by conceit — the pride that thinks "I am" — and by the grasping of self and mine, made manifest through clinging. Without independence, it is moistened and soaked by the putrid moisture of the nasal discharge, along with the impurities of fat, lymph, and sweat.

It is filled entirely with bile, phlegm, lungs, intestines, the omentum, the spleen, the bladder, and a great many kinds of impurities. It is the dwelling place of many thousands of kinds of worms. It possesses two openings of extreme foulness. It has the many hollow cavities and channels of the bones. There, in the lower cavity beneath the stomach, the face turned toward the spine and the back exposed to the skin of the belly, drenched and sodden in a swamp of urine, brain fluid, and marrow — month after month, as the months and nights pass, the food of the womb is ground exceedingly fine by the two rows of teeth, chewed over and over, then swallowed. From below it is moistened by the filth and discharge of the lower wound, dampened by saliva. From above it is pressed upon by the cerebral matter. The flavor of the food, which is like vomit, enters through the navel passage within the belly, and it is nourished and transformed entirely in substance — soft and tender, then firming, then hardening, then rounding out, becoming the very form of limbs and members. The hands, feet, and flanks, wrapped in a casing of raw flesh, stink like a freshly turned field, fetid, unbearable, groping about in pitchy darkness. It is touched by the tastes and vapors of food — sour, rough, salty, hot, and scorching as a tongue of fire. It is nourished by the impure fluid of the womb as though by a wet-nurse. It enters into the interior of a seething swamp blazing with burning, festering impurity. The life faculty is unstable. The inner fire of the mother's body scorches it on all sides, torments it utterly, consumes it completely, heats it through and through, scalds it everywhere, burns it entirely. And so it comes to experience great, intense, rough, unbearable, disagreeable feelings of suffering.

In whatever way it remains without moving, or moves about, or turns completely, or carries a heavy burden, or hangs suspended — in just that way

it is bound by the five bonds, and experiences great, intense, rough, unbearable, disagreeable feelings of suffering beyond all comparison, as though it had been thrust into the pit of a smoldering fire.

While abiding thus within the mother's womb, beset by suffering, its mindfulness becomes impaired.

Among those dwelling in the mother's womb, moreover, some, through the force of causes and conditions from previous karma, come to lie transversely in the womb, bringing discomfort to the one dwelling within. If the food and drink consumed by the mother prove unsuitable — whether extremely cold or extremely hot — or if she experiences excessive attachment, agitation, or receives a blow, these causes will harm her body. And when her body is harmed, the being that depends upon her and dwells within the womb will likewise be harmed. This much as before.

Then the birth goes awry. Thereupon a woman who is knowledgeable, or a midwife skilled in care, anointing her hands with warm water, ghee, and grain oil, presses in and draws the child down by manipulation. When she presses in and draws the child down using hands anointed with warm water, ghee, and grain oil, the being comes to experience great, intense, rough, unbearable, disagreeable feelings of suffering in the body.

Ānanda, consider this example: the body of a young man of good family, extremely tender in nature, is cut in all its major and minor limbs by a sharp razor fit for shaving hair, and then smeared all over with a potent bodily medicinal substance — from this there would arise in the body great, intense, rough, unbearable, disagreeable feelings of suffering.

Ānanda, in just the same way, when the one dwelling in the womb is pressed upon and drawn down by hands anointed with warm water, ghee, and grain oil, the body comes to experience great, intense, rough, unbearable, disagreeable feelings of suffering.

rough, unbearable, and disagreeable. When those great, intense, rough, unbearable, and disagreeable feelings of suffering arising from painful contact strike the body of the one dwelling in the womb, because the faculties are dulled, mindfulness deteriorates and the mind becomes impaired. Thus it is that one enters the mother's womb without clear awareness, dwells in the mother's womb without clear awareness, and emerges from the mother's womb without clear awareness.

Ānanda, how is it that one enters without clear awareness, dwells without clear awareness, and emerges without clear awareness? In this world, there are those who by their very nature are of broken moral discipline, possessed of unwholesome qualities, inclined toward the unwholesome, habitually engaged in the unwholesome, abundantly without restraint, abundantly without discernment, dwelling in heedlessness, grasping at all manner of possessions, miserly, fearful, covetous, malicious, holding wrong views, and prone to remorse. When the time of death arrives, those unwholesome qualities, having become firmly established, are encountered as intense, rough, unbearable, disagreeable feelings of death's suffering that tear away the life-force. Then mindfulness deteriorates and the mind becomes impaired. At that point, this consciousness that is of one flavor with suffering — what is it? What is its nature? What is this self? From where did it die and transmigrate, from where did it come, and where will it be born? — all of this is not known. Thus it is that one enters the mother's womb without clear awareness, dwells in the mother's womb without clear awareness, and emerges from the mother's womb without clear awareness.

Ānanda, since entering the mother's womb is suffering, dwelling in the mother's womb is suffering, and emerging from the mother's womb is suffering — Ānanda, what satisfaction can there be for one who delights in continued existence in saṃsāra, who takes pleasure in dwelling in the mother's womb, that place beset by so much suffering?

Ānanda, although birth is thus afflicted and oppressed by so much suffering, human existence is still extraordinarily difficult to obtain, even across hundreds of thousands of millions of eons. Ānanda, when the gods are passing away, other gods urge them, saying: "Go to the world of the happy destinies and there establish yourselves firmly and with discernment." Ānanda, what is the world of the happy destinies for the gods? It is birth as a human being — so extraordinarily difficult to obtain is it. Therefore, a life of leisure and full endowment is extraordinarily rare and difficult to find.

Hell-beings are purely and entirely in suffering, purely and entirely in intensity, purely and entirely in roughness, purely and entirely in unbearability, purely and entirely in disagreeableness — Ānanda, they cannot even serve as an analogy for suffering. Hungry ghosts (pretas) are malicious, their minds afflicted, their minds ungentle, possessed of deceit and cunning, rough, harmful, their hands smeared with blood, disagreeable, obscured, naked, ugly in form, frightful, oppressed by the suffering of hunger and thirst. The gods are

ever in fear — subject to the suffering of death and transmigration, of falling and transformation, of separation from what is beloved, and ever under the power of sorrow. As for sentient beings born in the animal realm, there is no limit to their number — Ānanda, there among them there is no acting for true benefit, no accumulation of merit, no practice of Dharma, no engagement in virtue, no pursuit of what is good and wholesome.

They devour one another — the stronger among those sentient beings eating the weaker. Ānanda, among the sentient beings born in the animal realm, there are also those who are born in darkness, who age in darkness, and who meet their time of death in darkness. And who are these? They are such creatures as beetles, flatworms, long-proboscised insects, those whose food is sesame husks, the worm called traima-buka, the worm called traila-ta, and whatever other sentient beings are born in darkness, age in darkness, and meet their time of death in darkness. In this regard, an ordinary, childish person who lacks learning, who is excessively attached to the flavor of what is old and rotten, and who has engaged in misconduct of body, speech, and mind, will be reborn sharing the same lot as such sentient beings — and those beings are born in darkness, age in darkness, and meet their time of death in darkness.

Ānanda, among the sentient beings born in the animal realm, there are also those who are born from a body, who age upon a body, and who meet their time of death upon a body. And who are these? They are such creatures as lice, nits, left-coiling worms, mites, and whatever other sentient beings are born from a body, age upon a body, and meet their time of death upon a body. In this regard, an ordinary, childish person who lacks learning, who follows after the flavor of what is old and rotten, and who has engaged in misconduct of body, speech, and mind, will be reborn sharing the same lot as such sentient beings — and those beings are born from a body, age upon a body, and meet their time of death upon a body.

Ānanda, among the sentient beings born in the animal realm, there are also those who are born in water, who age in water, and who meet their time of death in water. And who are these? They are such creatures as fish, turtles, frogs, young crocodiles who kill, the creature called luka, and whatever other sentient beings are born in water, age in water, and meet their time of death in water. In this regard, an ordinary, childish person who lacks learning, who follows after the flavor of what is old and rotten, and who has engaged in misconduct of body, speech, and mind, will be reborn sharing the same lot as

such sentient beings — and those beings are born in water, age in water, and meet their time of death in water.

Ānanda, among the sentient beings born in the animal realm, there are also those who, catching the scent of excrement and urine, think "I will eat this, I will drink this," and run toward it, roaming about in that way. And who are these? They are such creatures as goats, sheep, crows, pigs, dogs, foxes, ravens, monkeys, flies, and whatever other sentient beings catch the scent of excrement and urine, think "I will eat this, I will drink this," and run toward it, roaming about in that way. In this regard, an ordinary, childish person who lacks learning, who follows after the scent of such things, and who has engaged in misconduct of body, speech, and mind, will be reborn sharing the same lot as such sentient beings — and those beings catch the scent of excrement and urine, think "I will eat this, I will drink this," and run about, roaming in that way.

Ānanda, among the sentient beings born in the animal realm, there are also those who gather dry and fresh grass with the tip of the tongue, cut it with the sharpness of their teeth, and eat it. And who are these? They are such creatures as elephants, horses, rhinoceroses, cattle,

donkeys, deer, buffalo, wild boars, and any other sentient beings that gather dry and fresh grass with the tip of the tongue and cut and eat it with the sharpness of their teeth.

Ānanda, saṃsāra is thoroughly bad, exceedingly thoroughly bad. All of it burns, blazes on every side, blazes up completely, and has become a single mass of flame. Ānanda, furthermore, all of it — the eye, the ear, the nose, the tongue, the body, and the mind; forms, sounds, smells, tastes, tactile objects, and mental phenomena — all of it burns, blazes on every side, blazes up completely, and has become a single mass of flame. And by what does all of it blaze on every side, blaze up completely, and become a single mass of flame? It blazes by the fire of attachment, the fire of aversion, and the fire of delusion. It blazes on every side through birth, aging, illness, death, sorrow, lamentation, pain, mental distress, and anguish. It blazes on every side through suffering — so it has been taught.

Ānanda, one who is lazy, who is afflicted through and through by wicked, unwholesome phenomena, who continues in further existence, whose karmic maturation is suffering, and who will be subject to birth, aging, and death in future lives — one associated with such things abides in suffering. But Ānanda,

one who has set forth with diligence, who possesses power, who is endowed with diligence, who is joyful, who is firm in overcoming whatever stands before them, who is not timid, and who does not abandon effort in wholesome phenomena — such a one abides in happiness.

Therefore, Ānanda, you should train thus: Even if only skin, sinews, and bones remain in this body, even if the flesh and blood wither away from this frame — never mind, for one who has set forth with diligence, who possesses power, who is endowed with diligence, who is joyful, who overcomes whatever stands before them, who is firm, who is not timid, and who does not abandon effort in wholesome phenomena must not abandon diligence in the interval before attaining what is to be attained. Train in this way, Ānanda.

Ānanda, I do not quarrel with the world; it is the world that quarrels with me. Why is that? One who speaks the Dharma does not quarrel with anyone. I do not quarrel saying "It is I." It is not through adopting views by way of speculative tolerance, nor through the form of one who has the fortune — rather, I speak only what I myself have seen, known, fully and perfectly awakened to, and directly realized.

Ānanda, what do you think? Would a Tathāgata speak words by which he could be held to be otherwise? Venerable one, he would not. Ānanda, excellent, excellent! For a Tathāgata to speak words by which he could be held to be otherwise — that is not possible, that has no occasion. Ānanda, the Tathāgata speaks what is true, speaks what is real, speaks the Dharma, speaks suchness, speaks without distortion. The Tathāgata has long desired the benefit of the world, desired its happiness, desired its accomplishment and happiness. He knows the path, has accomplished the path, teaches the path, proclaims the path, and guides beings fully along the path. The Tathāgata is an arhat, a fully and perfectly awakened buddha, one perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, the knower of the world, the unsurpassed guide who tames those who are to be tamed, the Teacher of gods and humans, the Blessed One, a buddha.

Ānanda, the world lacks faith, is boiled up by the senses, looks only at what is immediate, is drawn to what is ready at hand, has great conceit, has gathered little — it does not make things easy but through hardship strains in every way after itself.

Ānanda, scripture is not even needed, nor is wisdom needed. Understand directly just what you yourself see with the eye of flesh.

By examining thoroughly just what one sees, one will attain liberation.

Ānanda, do not go by faith in me. Do not go by affection. Do not go by what you have heard. Do not go by reasoning about appearances. Do not go by regarding someone as a contemplative. Do not go by tolerating or approving a contemplative's view. Do not go by reverence for a contemplative. Do not go by thinking, "This contemplative Gautama is my teacher." Rather, Ānanda, go off alone to a secluded place and reflect on those Dhammas by the direct knowledge of which I myself have become a perfectly and completely awakened buddha. Incline toward them. Comprehend them closely. Practise them again and again. And whatever Dhammas, when made directly manifest and brought to completion, allow one to dwell as one's own island, as one's own refuge, as a Dharma-island, as a Dharma-refuge, as an island that is no other, as a refuge that is no other — dwell in them.

Ānanda, how does a monk dwell as his own island, his own refuge, a Dharma-island, a Dharma-refuge, an island that is no other, a refuge that is no other? Ānanda, here a monk, endowed with ardour, with mindfulness and vigilance, having set aside covetousness and mental discomfort toward the world, dwells contemplating the body as body with respect to the inner body, dwells contemplating the body as body with respect to the outer body, dwells contemplating the body as body with respect to both inner and outer body. He dwells contemplating the body as phenomena of arising. He dwells contemplating the body as phenomena of the passing away of what arises. The mindfulness that there is a body is established in him just so — to the extent needed for bare knowing, bare seeing, and bare recollection — and he dwells unattached, not clinging to anything whatsoever in the world.

Ānanda, in the same way a monk, endowed with ardour, with mindfulness and vigilance, having set aside covetousness and mental discomfort toward the world, dwells contemplating the body as body with respect to the inner body, and with respect to both inner and outer body. He dwells contemplating feelings as feelings with respect to inner feelings, outer feelings, and both inner and outer feelings. He dwells contemplating mind as mind with respect to the inner mind, the outer mind, and both inner and outer mind. He dwells contemplating phenomena as phenomena with respect to inner phenomena, outer phenomena, and both inner and outer phenomena. He dwells contemplating phenomena as phenomena of arising. He dwells contemplating phenomena as phenomena of the passing away of what arises. The mindfulness that phenomena exist is established in him just so — to the extent needed for bare knowing, bare seeing, and bare recollection — and he dwells

unattached, not clinging in the slightest to anything in the world. Ānanda, it is in this way that a monk dwells as his own island, his own refuge, a Dharma-island, a Dharma-refuge, an island that is no other, a refuge that is no other.

Ānanda, consider a person who is unswaying, without deceit, upright, of a stable nature — if I were to teach him inwardly, he would be able to know and prophesy all evenings; if I were to teach him in the evening, he would be able to know and prophesy all mornings.

Ānanda, my Dharma is well taught, rightly seen, free of sickness, uninterrupted, leading to closeness, meaningful for those who see it here and now, to be individually understood by the wise. This scripture is such that when the Teacher becomes directly manifest, when the sacred Dharma is brought close, when one will pass completely into nirvāṇa, when one proceeds to perfect awakening — these are to be understood by the Sugata himself and their essence is to be drunk by the Teacher.

Therefore, Ānanda, you should look to your own benefit, the benefit of others, and the benefit of both, and train individually and perfectly in each. By all means, let my going forth have been purposeful and fruitful, and

may its karmic maturation become a source of happiness. And those who have made full use of the robes, alms-food, lodging, and medicinal requisites supplied on account of illness — so that the service rendered to them may become, by all means, of very great fruit, very great benefit, very great majesty, and of wide extent — this, Ānanda, is how you should train.

Whatever form one delights in, whatever form one cherishes with fondness — toward that form there arise change, alteration, grief, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness, and distress. A form in which these would not arise — not a single one have I ever rightly discerned.

Ānanda, what do you think? Is form permanent or impermanent?

Impermanent, Blessed One.

That which is impermanent — is it suffering or not suffering?

It is suffering, Blessed One, for whatever is impermanent has the character of becoming suffering.

Then how could a learned noble śrāvaka affirm of it: "This is mine," "This I am," "This is my self"?

Blessed One, it could not.

Ānanda, what do you think? Are feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness permanent or impermanent?

Impermanent, Blessed One.

That which is impermanent — is it suffering or not suffering?

It is suffering, Blessed One, for whatever is impermanent has the character of becoming suffering.

Then how could a learned noble śrāvaka affirm of them: "This is mine," "This I am," "This is my self"?

Blessed One, it could not.

Ānanda, therefore, whatever form there is — of whatever kind — whether past, future, or presently arisen; whether internal or external; whether coarse or subtle; whether inferior or excellent; whether far or near — all of it should be seen as it actually is with genuine wisdom thus: "This is not mine. This I am not. This is not my self."

And whatever feeling there is — of whatever kind — and whatever perception, whatever formations, whatever consciousness — whether past, future, or presently arisen; whether internal or external; whether coarse or subtle; whether inferior or excellent; whether far or near — all of it should be seen as it actually is with genuine wisdom thus: "This is not mine. This I am not. This is not my self."

When a learned noble śrāvaka sees in this way, they become disenchanted with form, disenchanted with feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness. Being disenchanted, they become free from attachment. Being free from attachment, they are fully liberated. Being fully liberated, the knowledge arises: "My defilements are exhausted. The holy life has been lived. The task is done. There is no knowing of further existence beyond this" — and thus the gnosis of liberation is seen.

When this enumeration of the Dharma was taught, the Venerable Ānanda's Dharma eye — pure and stainless — arose with respect to all phenomena. And five hundred monks were fully liberated in mind from the defilements, without remainder.

The Blessed One spoke thus; the Sugata having said this, the Teacher then spoke further:

Ānanda, in a mind not in equipoise,
all the aggregates come to exhaustion,
yet pure gnosis does not arise.
Therefore, take up diligence earnestly.

Contemplate again and again, each in turn,
the aggregates as they arise and dissolve.
When purity is genuinely produced,
all the gods rejoice.

One who keeps company with suffering, with companions, with association —
who rises to attend and pay homage, and who is given goods and honor in
verse —

abandon all such delight, Ānanda.

One who dwells in a house is likewise not truly a householder.

If you do not mingle with either,
you will bring suffering to its end.

Thus you shall reach the final goal.

At first it becomes a glutinous mass,
then from that it becomes a foam-like substance.
From the foam-like substance it becomes a hardening form.
From the hardening form it becomes rounded.
From the rounded form, four limbs arise,
and the head as well.

From karmic causes there emerge
the various joints and bones.

The skull holds nine bones,
and the bones of the cheeks are two.
The teeth number thirty-two,
and the roots of the teeth are thirty-two.
The throat, and those near the ears,
the nose, the palate above,
and the chest without its cartilage —
those bones number twenty.

The bones of the eye sockets number four,
and likewise the bones of the forehead number four.
In the right and left shoulders together,
the bones number fifty.

The bones of the chest are eight,
and within that, the vertebrae are thirty-two.
The bones of the ribs along the back
number thirty.

On the two sides, along the right ribs,
there are thirteen rib-bones.
Likewise on the left side,
there are again thirteen.
These together make twenty-six.
The third joints have three joints each,
the second joints have two,
and the remaining ones have no joints at all.

In the right and left thighs,
the bones number sixty-five.
In this body altogether, the bones
number one hundred and eight —
so the perfectly awakened buddha, supremely knowing,
declared, with the seal of truth.

Below, from the soles of the feet,
up to the brain above —
this body that one so closely relies upon
is as wretched as a mud-worm's dwelling.

Not held together by pegs and fasteners,
but covered over with flesh and blood,
like a puppet joined by a conjurer's strings
to a wooden machine —

so too this body is strung together by sinews,
wrapped separately in moist skin,
furnished with the great wounds of nine openings,
reeking with the stench of impurity and rot,
and dripping and oozing on all sides.

Just as a storehouse is packed full
with various grains and provisions,
so too this body
is a source of manifold decay.

This body, like such a machine of bones,
is a rotting thing without essence.
Yet the childish are heedless of it —
know it to be utterly without attachment.

Sweat and saliva and mucus,
phlegm and pus and blood,
liver and bile and fat,
discharge, brain and cerebellum,
heart and intestines, kidneys,
the impure lungs and bladder,
grease and hair and spleen,
entrails and membranes —
this is a collection of manifold rot,
a vessel that is the source of such things.

This sinful body is a source of great terror;
know it to be like an enemy.
Like an old, crumbling city,
this body of decay is wretched indeed.

Compounded things, by day and by night,
disintegrate and utterly collapse.
This city with its walls of bone,
plastered over with flesh and blood —
within it, attachment, aversion,
delusion, and concealment arise.

This city walled with bones,
smeared with flesh and blood,
within and without, at all times,
is tormented openly by the unfriendly.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the venerable Ānanda and those five hundred monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had taught.

Then the Blessed One composed the sūtra on entering the womb for the venerable Nanda, and having freed him from the wilderness of cyclic existence, established him in the utterly complete attainment of peace and happiness — nirvāṇa.

Then the Blessed One declared to the monks: "Monks, among my monks who restrain the doors of the senses, the foremost is this: the monk Nanda." Then the venerable Nanda, having attained arhatship and experiencing the joy and happiness of liberation, spoke at that moment these verses:

One who has been nurtured with clean bathing,
with food, with anointings of oil,
and sheltered beneath a parasol —
such a one has known many pleasures.

The monks, having arisen in doubt, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubt: "Venerable one, what karma did the venerable Nanda perform and accumulate such that, through the ripening of that karma, his bodily complexion has become like the color of gold, and he is adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being? And yet the Blessed One is four finger-breadths taller than him. And from his intense attachment to sensual pleasures, the Blessed One forcibly separated him and, freeing him from the wilderness of cyclic existence, established him in the utterly complete attainment of peace and happiness — nirvāṇa."

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, karma that Nanda himself performed and accumulated, a collection obtained, conditions fully ripened, dwelling nearby like a creditor — it was inevitable. Who else could experience karma that Nanda himself performed and accumulated? Monks, karma that has been performed and accumulated does not ripen in the external earth element, nor in the water element, nor in the fire element, nor in the wind element; rather, virtuous and non-virtuous karma that has been performed and accumulated ripens only in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense bases:

Even through hundreds of eons,
karma does not perish.

When the gathering and the time have come,
it ripens as fruit for those who have bodies.

"Monks, in a past age, when the lifespan of beings was eighty thousand years, there appeared in the human world a Teacher, a buddha, a Blessed One — fully endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, Teacher of gods and humans — named Vipassīyā. His retinue consisted of six hundred and twenty thousand monks. As he was traveling through the regions, he came to the royal palace called Bandhumat and dwelt in the Bandhuma Grove. The younger brother of

the house to his right had become intensely attached to sensual pleasures. The perfectly and fully awakened Vipāśyin forcibly separated him from those pleasures, freed him from the prison of cyclic existence, and established him in the utterly complete attainment of peace and happiness — nirvāṇa.

"At that time, in the royal palace of Bandhumat, a king named Bandhumat was exercising royal dominion. The royal kingdom was prosperous, flourishing, and happy; the harvests were good; it was filled with people and a great population; strife, dispute, conflict, and disturbance were at peace; bandits and disease were absent; rice, sugarcane, cattle, and water buffalo were abundant. He was a righteous king who administered affairs in accordance with Dharma and in the proper manner.

"The younger brother of the house to his right had become intensely attached to sensual pleasures. King Bandhumat heard that the perfectly and fully awakened Vipāśyin, together with his retinue of six hundred and twenty thousand monks, had arrived here and was dwelling in the Bandhuma Grove. Hearing this, together with his queen's retinue, the young men, and the ministers —

— together with the townspeople, they went to where the perfectly and fully awakened Vipāśyin was. And the perfectly and fully awakened Vipāśyin, having heard what had occurred, taught such Dharma as was fitting to King Bandhumat, together with the queen's retinue, the young men, the ministers, and the townspeople, so that they attained great distinction.

Now the younger brother of the house to the king's right, being intensely attached to sensual pleasures, had not come out from his house. So the sons of the ministers, the sons of the royal attendants, and the other younger companions went to him and said: "Friend, the king has gone with the queen's retinue, the young men, the ministers, and the townspeople to visit the perfectly and fully awakened Vipāśyin. You, who have obtained a human birth so rare and exceedingly difficult to find, are intensely attached to sensual pleasures and have not come out from your house." When they had spoken these words to him and he felt shame in his heart, he joined their company and went to where the perfectly and fully awakened Vipāśyin was.

Now when the younger brother of the perfectly and fully awakened Vipāśyin saw that they were leading this man there by taking hold of his face, he asked: "Why are they leading him like this, holding him by the face?" They then told him in detail what had happened. He said: "Friends, I too am actually the

younger brother of the perfectly and fully awakened Vipāśyin, and just as he was, I myself was intensely attached to sensual pleasures. But the Blessed One, the perfectly and fully awakened Vipāśyin, forcibly separated me from that and rescued me from the wilderness of cyclic existence, establishing me in the utterly consummate attainment and happiness of nirvāṇa. It is for this very reason that some persons who are deluded must be treated in just this way. You have done well in bringing him here. Now lead him before the Blessed One, and without doubt he will find faith in the Blessed One."

Then they brought him before the perfectly and fully awakened Vipāśyin, and the perfectly and fully awakened Vipāśyin taught him such Dharma as was fitting. Having heard it, he found faith in the Tathāgata Vipāśyin. He rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, joined his palms together, bowed in the direction of the perfectly and fully awakened Vipāśyin, and then addressed the perfectly and fully awakened Vipāśyin with these words: "Blessed One, would you please consent, along with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, to accept a bathing ceremony at my bathhouse?" The perfectly and fully awakened Vipāśyin consented by remaining silent.

Knowing from his silence that the perfectly and fully awakened Vipāśyin had consented, he was overjoyed and delighted at the teaching. He prostrated with his head at the feet of the Blessed One, rose from his seat, and departed, going to where King Bandhumat was. He arrived, prostrated with his head at the king's feet, and then addressed King Bandhumat with these words: "Your Majesty, I have invited the perfectly and fully awakened Vipāśyin, together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, to accept a bathing ceremony at my bathhouse, and he has consented by remaining silent. Since he is worthy of honor, it would be fitting, for his sake, to beautify the city through which he will pass as he enters it, and to beautify the roads along his route."

King Bandhumat thought: "If that is so, then I shall beautify the city and the roads along which the Blessed One will pass as he enters the city."

Realizing that the Blessed One had indeed tamed even this one who was so difficult to tame, King Bandhumat said: "Well done, younger brother! You go and make the preparations. I myself will beautify the city and the roads."

Filled with joy and delight, the king's younger brother bowed his head at King Bandhumat's feet, rose from his seat, and departed.

King Bandhumat then issued an order to his ministers: "Wise ones, proclaim it throughout the city that tomorrow the perfectly and fully awakened Vipāśyin

will enter the city of Bandhumat. Therefore, let all of you who dwell in the city, and all the multitudes of people who have come from various regions, beautify the city and the roads, and let each of you greet him with adornments befitting your own means."

The ministers listened to King Bandhumat and made the proclamation in these words: "Hear this, wise ones — you who dwell in the city, you townspeople, and all the multitudes who have come from various regions! By the king's command: the Blessed One, the perfectly and fully awakened Vipāśyin, will enter the city of Bandhumat. Therefore, let all of you who dwell in the city, and all the multitudes of people who have come from various regions, beautify the city and the roads, and let each and every one greet him with adornments befitting your own means. Thus does the king command."

They cleared the city of stones, gravel, and rubbish. They sprinkled it with sandalwood water and set out censers with fragrant incense. They hung many silk banners, raised victory standards and flags, and scattered flowers of many kinds, making the city as lovely and delightful as the pleasure groves of the gods. The roads were made even more beautiful than that. There too they prepared warm water scented with various fragrances, as well as sesame oil. The bathhouse was swept clean, seats were arranged, and all was made ready to welcome the perfectly and fully awakened Vipāśyin as he entered the city.

Then the perfectly and fully awakened Vipāśyin arrived, attended by King Bandhumat's queen and her retinue, by princes, ministers, townspeople, and a great multitude of other folk who had come to escort him, and he entered the royal palace of Bandhumat in supreme splendor.

Then the king's younger brother, his faith having arisen, invited him to enter the bathhouse. Once he had entered and the bathing had begun, the king's younger brother beheld the body of the buddha Vipāśyin, golden in hue like burnished gold, adorned throughout with the thirty-two major marks of a great being. Seeing this, his faith deepened further. When the bathing was complete, he touched his head to the Blessed One's feet and made this aspiration: "By the root of virtue I have generated through performing this service for so worthy a field of merit, may I too, just as this great being's body is golden in hue, and just as he has forcibly separated this younger brother of his from his intense attachment to sensual pleasures, led him forth into the going-forth, freed him from the wilderness of saṃsāra, and established him in the utterly final accomplishment and bliss of nirvāṇa — may I likewise become

the younger brother of just such a Teacher, and if at that time I too should happen to be deeply attached to sensual pleasures, may that Blessed One then forcibly separate me from them, lead me forth into the going-forth, free me from the wilderness of saṃsāra, and establish me in the utterly final accomplishment and bliss of nirvāṇa."

Now, monks, what do you think? King Bandhumat's younger brother at that time — he was none other than the noble son Ānanda himself. And at that time, having bathed the perfectly and fully awakened Vipassīyā with the bathhouse bathing,

through the karmic maturation of that aspiration he had made, he became the younger brother of the Tathāgata, and his body too became the color of gold. And I indeed forcibly separated him, led him forth into the going-forth, freed him from the wilderness of saṃsāra, and established him in the utterly final accomplishment and bliss of nirvāṇa.

Then the monks, having grown uncertain, put all their uncertainty to the Blessed One, the buddha, requesting: "Venerable one, what action did the long-lived Ānanda perform, such that through the maturation of that karma the thirty major marks of a great being have visibly come to perfection in him?"

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, it is this very one who performed and accumulated the karma, who gathered the accumulation, who fully transformed the conditions, and who came to abide as though at the water's edge. Could whatever karma this very one performed and accumulated be experienced by anyone else? Monks, karma that has been performed and accumulated does not ripen in the external element of earth, nor in the element of water, nor in the element of fire, nor in the element of wind. Rather, virtuous and non-virtuous karma that has been performed and accumulated ripens solely within the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense bases.

Though hundreds of aeons pass away,
karma is never lost.

When the time and conditions come together,
it ripens as fruit for embodied beings.

Monks, long ago in the past, on a certain mountain crag there lived a wealthy householder of great riches and abundant possessions. He had a pleasure grove adorned with flowers, fruits, and various roots, well supplied with water,

and ornamented with many kinds of trees — a grove suitable for those who have gone forth. In an age when no buddhas had appeared in the world, there arose in that world solitary buddhas, compassionate toward the poor and destitute, who delighted in dwelling in remote and isolated lodgings, and who each appeared as a singular field of merit for the world.

Then a certain solitary buddha, wandering through the countryside, came to that mountain crag. As he was seeking a dwelling and moving about here and there, he entered that pleasure grove. The grove-keeper greeted him with the respectful salutation of welcome and had him settle there.

That night the solitary buddha entered into meditative absorption on the element of fire, and the grove-keeper, seeing him, was filled with the greatest wonder, thinking: "This one who has gone forth is of such great majesty — accomplished in the discipline of austerities." Rising that very night, he went to the householder and said: "Master, please be glad! In your pleasure grove there has entered a one who has gone forth, a great being accomplished in the discipline of austerities. He has illumined that entire pleasure grove throughout the night."

Hearing this, the householder was filled with great joy. He went out at length, touched his feet to the ground, and said: "Noble one, you seek alms, and I seek merit. Please remain in this very pleasure grove. I shall provide you with alms."

The solitary buddha accepted, and dwelling there he experienced the bliss of meditative concentration, liberation, meditative absorption, and meditative attainment. After residing there for a short while, he reflected: "Whatever I was to obtain by means of this decaying body, I have already obtained. Now I shall enter into the expanse of the peace of nirvāṇa." Knowing this, he performed miracles of blazing fire, radiance, falling rain, and flashing lightning, and then passed into the nirvāṇa without remainder, beyond all residual aggregates, into the expanse of complete nirvāṇa.

The fourteenth fascicle of the foundation of the minor rules of Vinaya.

Then that householder gathered fuel of all kinds of fragrant wood and burned it, and extinguished those firewoods with milk.

He placed those bones in a golden urn, built a bone-stupa, and erected parasols, victory banners, and pennants. Having erected them, faith arose in him, and he then anointed the stupa with saffron and made thirty handprint

offerings of fragrant substances. Monks, what do you think? That householder is none other than this son of good family, Priya, and it was he who, at that time and on that occasion, built the stupa for the pratyekabuddha, erected parasols, victory banners, and pennants, arose in faith, anointed it with saffron, and made thirty handprint offerings of fragrant substances. Through the karmic maturation of that action, thirty of the major marks of a great being have come to be perfected in him.

Then the monks, having grown uncertain, requested the Blessed One, the buddha who cuts through all doubt: "Venerable One, what action did the long-lived Priya perform such that, through the karmic maturation of that action, if he had not gone forth into renunciation, he would have wielded the kingdom of a wheel-turning king who rules by force?"

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, whatever actions this son of good family Priya performed and accumulated, assembled and completed, drawing near like a crossbow bolt ready to fly — it is certain that the ripening of those actions will be experienced by him. By whom else could actions performed and accumulated be experienced? Monks, actions performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external element of earth, nor in the element of water, nor in the element of fire, nor in the element of wind. Yet the virtuous and non-virtuous actions that have been performed ripen in none other than the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense bases. As it is said:

Even across a hundred aeons,
actions do not perish.

When conditions are gathered and the time arrives,
they ripen as fruits for those who have bodies.

Monks, in a previous time, in this very Fortunate Aeon, when the lifespan of beings was twenty thousand years, the Teacher — a Tathāgata, arhat, fully and perfectly awakened buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha and Blessed One — by the name of Kāśyapa appeared in the world. He dwelt in the city of Varanasi, in the Deer Park forest called Ṛṣivadana. At that time and on that occasion there was a king in Varanasi named Kṛkī who ruled over the kingdom — prosperous, flourishing, happy, with good harvests, filled with people and populous — and governed in accordance with the Dharma, as stated before in full. That king had three sons: the eldest, the middle, and the youngest.

When the fully and perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa had accomplished all the deeds of a buddha and passed into the expanse of nirvāṇa without remainder, like a fire whose fuel is exhausted passing beyond all residual aggregates, King Kṛkī, after making offerings to his body, built a stupa constructed of four precious substances, measuring one league in circumference and half a league in height. As for erecting a parasol over it: King Kṛkī's middle son arose in faith and affixed a medium parasol. Monks, what do you think? King Kṛkī's middle son is none other than this son of good family, Priya, and it was he who, having arisen in faith at the stupa of the fully and perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa, affixed a medium parasol. Through the karmic maturation of that action, he carried out the rule of a wheel-turning kingdom by force for two thousand five hundred times,

Had he not gone forth into renunciation at this present time, he would even now be ruling a wheel-turning kingdom by force. Then the monks asked the Blessed One, the Buddha: "Venerable one, what action did the long-lived Priya perform such that, through the karmic maturation of that action, the Blessed One declared him supreme among those who guard the gates of the sense faculties?" The Blessed One declared: "It was through the power of an aspiration. And where did he make that aspiration?" "Monks, this one had gone forth into renunciation under the teaching of the fully and perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa. The one under whom he went forth — the Blessed One, the fully and perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa — declared him supreme among those who guard the gates of the sense faculties. Yet for as long as he lived the holy life, he did not attain even a portion of the assembly of qualities. Then, at the time of his death, he made this aspiration: 'In as much as I have lived the holy life for the full span of my life before the supreme worthy recipient, the Blessed One, the fully and perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa, yet have not attained even a portion of the assembly of qualities — by this root of virtue, may I, just as the Blessed One, the fully and perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa, declared my preceptor supreme among those who guard the gates of the sense faculties, now go forth under the teaching of the one whom that buddha prophesied to the brahmin youth Blama, saying, "O brahmin youth, when the human lifespan is one hundred years, there will arise a Tathāgata, an arhat, a fully and perfectly awakened buddha, Śākyamuni" — and, having gone forth, may I abandon all afflictions and directly realize the state of arhat. And just as the Blessed One, the fully and perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa, declared my preceptor supreme among those who guard the

gates of the sense faculties, may I likewise be declared supreme among those who guard the gates of the sense faculties by the Blessed One Śākyamuni, the great sovereign of the Śākyas.' It is through the power of that aspiration that the Tathāgata has now declared him supreme among those who guard the gates of the sense faculties. Monks, therefore, one should train beginning from the passage 'those who make karma altogether dark' down through 'monks should train in this way,' just as before."

The setting is Śrāvastī. A certain monk went to a physician and said: "Good sir, I have an illness of such and such a kind; please prescribe a medicine." The physician said: "Noble one, please take a medicinal enema, and you will recover." The monk said: "Good sir, the Blessed One has not permitted it." The physician said: "Noble one, your Teacher is compassionate; he will permit it." The monk then related this to the other monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Therefore I permit it: a sick monk may take a medicinal enema by prescription of a physician."

The setting is Śrāvastī. The Blessed One declared: "When monks build a monastery of five stories, the latrine is to have seven stories and the cooling chamber above the gatehouse is also to be seven stories. When monks build a monastery of three stories, the latrine is to have five stories and the cooling chamber above the gatehouse is also to be five stories." Then, since the monks did not know from which side to ascend, the Blessed One declared: "There are to be three kinds of stairway: wooden stairs, earthen stairs, and stone stairs. Monks, at the top, stone; in the middle, earth; at the bottom, wood — set these and then ascend." The Blessed One then declared:

"At the bottom, stone; in the middle, earth; at the top, wood — set these and then ascend."

This concludes the second chapter on minor matters, on the doors.

Summary verses:

The robe, the drying-rack, the inner room, and the sweeping,
the fine dwelling, salt, the gourd,
the face-cloth and the covering cloth,
the portable bed, the mat, and the razor.

Further summary:

The measuring-stick for the robe,
the tablets and the dust-broom,

the very act of smoothing the ground,
and the patches together with the patch-tent.

The awakened Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in Prince Jeta's park. The Blessed One had declared that monks must keep the three robes that have been sewn. The monks then began to sew the robes in a mesh pattern, and by doing so they made the panels and half-panels uneven. At that point the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Do not sew the panels and half-panels unevenly in a mesh; rather, sew them evenly." Not knowing how to make them even, the Blessed One declared: "Cut a measuring-stick for the panels and half-panels, and sew by that measure."

The awakened Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in Prince Jeta's park. The monks sewed the patches of the robe unevenly, and these turned out unsightly. At that point the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Sew the patches evenly." When the Blessed One had declared that the patches should be sewn evenly, the monks did not know how to do so, and the Blessed One declared: "Cut a measuring-stick for the patches, measure by it, and then sew." When the Blessed One had declared that the patches should be stitched using the measuring-stick, the monks made the patches oversized. The Blessed One then declared: "Do not make the patches oversized. There are, however, three sizes of patch: large, medium, and small. The large is four finger-widths, or the full width of a crow's wing. The small is two finger-widths, or the full width of a thumb's belly. The medium is between these two."

The awakened Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in Prince Jeta's park. The monks were sewing robes on dusty ground, and these became soiled. The Blessed One declared: "Smear on a clay paste and then sew the robes." When the Blessed One had declared that the robes should be sewn after applying a clay paste, and none could be found, the Blessed One declared: "In that case, sprinkle and sweep that spot, and then sew."

The awakened Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in Prince Jeta's park. The monks made the legs of their seats sharply pointed, and these tore up the ground in a way that was improper. The Blessed One declared: "Do not make the legs of seats sharply

pointed; rather, cut them rounded." When even this proved improper, the Blessed One declared: "Place them on a bundle of thatch, or wrap them with strips of cloth."

The awakened Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in Prince Jeta's park. Now at Śrāvastī there lived a brahmin who, having gone out on some business and wandered here and there, by midday was utterly exhausted. He entered the Jeta Grove and there saw a fine seat laid out and food set ready.

Seeing it, he was filled with reverent faith. The robe that brahmin wore was one suited to a great elder, and he offered it to the edge of the elder's seat as a cushion to sit upon. Then at another time it became soiled, and the verger placed it at the edge of the junior seat. Some time later, the brahmin entered the assembly hall and, not finding that robe at the elder's edge, looked along the rows and went to the junior's edge, where he saw that it had become soiled and been placed there. He thought to himself: "If this robe was suited to a great elder, I should first look into what cause has brought it to such a condition." He waited a little while, and presently the verger arranged the seats in order and began to dust them off. The brahmin then understood: "This is the cause by which the robe has become soiled." He said to the verger: "Noble one, do you not even know this much — that one should sweep by striking the ground and then arrange the seats in order? Moreover, you have made my robe dirty." The monks then reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Sweep by striking the ground and then arrange the seats in order."

The verger then laid out the sleeping mats on seats that were full of dust, and the very same fault arose. The Blessed One declared: "Shake out the seats and then lay the sleeping mats upon them." The verger did not know what to shake them with, so the Blessed One said: "Shake them with a cloth." When he shook them with a good cloth, the Blessed One declared: "Shake them with a coarser one." The verger shook them with a coarse cloth, and when that cloth became old and worn beyond repair, he discarded it. The Blessed One declared: "In that case, cut it into strips and patches, tie them around a stick, and use it to shake." When even that was too worn to use further and was discarded, the Blessed One declared: "Even when it is too worn to use further, do not throw it away — mix it with heavy or wet clay and plaster it into the gaps of pillars or the holes in walls, and the merit of the donor will thereby increase for a long time."

The awakened Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in Prince Jeta's park. At that time, a certain young monk was pacing back and forth in meditation in a certain spot, and the ground was worn bare by the dragging of his feet. A householder who was wandering here and there reached that place and thought to himself: "Given that things have come to this condition, one wonders what state this noble one's feet must be in." He said: "Noble one, what has worn this away so completely?" The monk replied: "Householder, it is from my pacing back and forth." The householder said: "Noble one, given that things have come to such a condition, what must your feet look like? Let me look at your feet." The monk showed him his feet, and the householder, seeing them, felt compassion arise and said: "Noble one, I shall lay stone paving on this ground here — please gather comfortably." The monk replied: "Householder, the Blessed One has not permitted it." The householder said: "Noble one, your Teacher is compassionate; he will grant permission." Then and there the householder reported the matter to the monks. The monks asked the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, I grant permission: stone paving may be laid on the meditation walkway of a monk who is striving with diligence." The householder laid the paving, and the monk began pacing back and forth along it. Presently that stone paving split into two pieces.

One piece of it lay to one side, the other piece lay elsewhere. When the householder came and saw that one piece of the stone paving lay to one side and the other lay elsewhere, he said: "Noble one, since the paving has come to be in this condition, what harm would there be in joining the pieces together with clamps?" The monks then reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "What that householder says is true. Therefore, the pieces may be joined together with clamps, and pegs may be used to fasten them. When the paving becomes very old and worn, and is difficult to repair, then plaster or mud should be mixed and spread over it. The merit of the donor will thereby grow for a long time."

The Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. A certain monk went to a physician and said: "Good sir, I have developed such-and-such an illness; please prescribe medicine." The physician said: "Noble one, do such-and-such, and you will recover." The monk needed a container for the medicine the physician had prescribed, so he went to a certain householder and requested one. That householder gave him a container with a lid. After using the medicine, the monk returned the

container, along with its lid, to that same householder. The householder said: "Noble one, please take it and keep it." The monk replied: "Householder, the Blessed One has not permitted it." The householder said: "Noble one, if that is so, then leave it and go."

The monks then reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, I grant permission: a monk may keep a container together with its lid."

A summary verse:

For robes placed inside and out on racks,
and likewise for tent poles, cords and strings,
for lamps, and for the walkways of the cloister —
the robes are to be marked with their distinguishing sign.

The Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. The monks were leaving their robes lying about at random, and they became soiled with dust and eaten by insects. The monks then reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Robes must not be left lying about at random. Rather, they must be placed on robe racks." The monks bored holes in the walls and inserted pegs for the robe racks, and the walls crumbled. The Blessed One declared: "Holes must not be bored in the walls. Rather, when the wall of a temple is being built, hooks should be set in from the outset, and the pegs of the robe rack should be inserted into those." When the Blessed One said that holes for robe rack pegs should be made in the temple, many were made all around, and the Blessed One declared: "Just as they are made in the temple, so they may also be made in the surrounding cells."

The Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. The Blessed One had declared that robes were to be placed on robe racks. Forest-dwelling monks, however, could not find robe racks. The monks then reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Those monks may hang their robes on tent poles and place them there." When others had no tent poles either, the Blessed One declared: "Those monks may tie a cord and place their robes on that."

The Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. The Blessed One declared that robes were to be given distinguishing marks and that the Dharma was to be listened to at night, and

—

The monks began giving the gift of listening to the Dharma at night. Now, at the time of listening to the Dharma, a snake came, and a young monk who saw it was startled and cried out, "Friends, move back! Move back!" The other monks, being ordinary persons, were also startled, and they disrupted the Dharma teaching. The monks then reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "The Dharma teaching is not to be interrupted. Instead, teach the Dharma by the light of a lamp." When the Blessed One had declared that the Dharma was to be taught by the light of a lamp, the monks taught the Dharma by lamplight on summer nights. But living creatures flew into the lamps, and so the Blessed One declared: "A lamp house is to be made." The monks did not know how to make a lamp house, and the Blessed One declared: "Make a framework of bamboo strips and cover it with white cloth." When white cloth could not be found, the Blessed One declared: "Cover it with gauze." When that too could not be found, the Blessed One declared: "Monks, make one with a hundred holes." The monks did not know what a hundred-hole lamp house should look like, and the Blessed One declared: "Have a potter make a vessel from wet clay and pierce it with a hundred holes. If no potter is available, take a broken potsherd or the base of a broken pot — anything suitable that is broken — and make it with a hundred holes. Then light a lamp and cover it with that."

The Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. When the season of heat arrived, the monks were tormented by the warmth, their bodies aching, their flesh wasting, their color becoming pale and wan and sallow. Since buddhas, the Blessed Ones, ask questions knowing full well the answers, the Blessed One asked the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, why is it that the monks now have aching bodies, wasting flesh, and color that has become pale and wan and sallow?" At that time Ānanda reported the matter in full to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore I permit a cloistered walkway to be built around the dwelling." The monks did not know how to build it, and the Blessed One declared: "It is to be made with three sides." They then built a wall on the inside and a row of pillars on the outside, and the Blessed One declared: "Place the row of pillars on the inside and build the wall on the outside." Because no windows were installed, it became hot inside again, and the Blessed One declared: "Windows are to be installed." They installed them too low, which caused the very same problem, and the Blessed One declared: "Install them higher." Having installed them too high, the Blessed One declared: "Do not install them too high; rather, install

them level with the seat." When sparrows and pigeons entered through the windows, the Blessed One declared: "The windows are to be fitted with lattice screens." When wind and rain caused damage, the Blessed One declared: "Shutters are to be fitted to the windows." When the monks closed the shutters while eating their meals and it became pitch dark inside, the Blessed One declared: "During the time of eating, the shutters are to be opened." When monks in the heat of the season were reading aloud, reciting, engaged in analytical discussion, or working on their robes, or were thoroughly exhausted from their labors, they were permitted to sit there wearing only their sweat cloth and their lower robe.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada.

The Blessed One had given the going forth and full ordination to Ānanda, and then led him, suffused with the fragrance of mountain incense, to the gods of the Thirty-Three and to the beings in the hells, before bringing him back again to Śrāvastī. Because this had happened suddenly, not all the monks recognized him. Seeing his body — radiant in color like gold, its marks shining forth brilliantly — they thought the Blessed One had departed, and even the elder monks, the senior ones, rose to their feet. When everyone came to know who it was, regret arose, and at that moment the monks appealed to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, this is the Teacher; this is someone else — in order that each may be easily distinguished, Ānanda and any other such person should have a mark sewn onto his robe."

The summary verse:

Monks who are to be expelled,
tooth-wood of three kinds,
those who are novices about to be expelled,
and those who are never to be expelled at all.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada.

At the time when the monks dwelling on the bank of the river Sundarī first applied themselves with effort, exertion, and striving through the use of water vessels and pots, and thereby abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhatship, the conduct and the practice of those monks inspired faith in a great many people. The Blessed One then declared to the monks: "Monks, those people in whose village district the monks dwelling on the bank of the

river Sundarī reside — those people have gained excellent gain."

The venerable Ānanda, who was attending upon the Blessed One and dwelling in his presence, understood through the Blessed One's intention — whether indicated by a sign or by direct speech — and sent word to those monks saying: "Venerable ones, the Blessed One wishes to speak of your virtues and to look upon you; it would be fitting for you to come."

When they heard this, they discussed it among themselves: "We are told that the Blessed One wishes to speak of our virtues and to look upon us — how then shall we go?" Some said: "What need is there to deliberate? Arhats do not engage in deliberation before their wisdom perceives." But others said: "That is well, yet let us go accompanied by a great assembly of people." And so they spoke to the monks: "Venerable ones, be informed: the Blessed One wishes to speak of our qualities and to look upon us, and he is coming to see you — it is fitting that you come." Those monks said: "Venerable ones, if that is so, we too shall go. Let it be done." And so they set out together with them, and gradually made their way to Śrāvastī.

Then in the garden of Anānda, a great and loud noise and the sound of a large crowd arose from the visiting monks and the resident monks greeting one another with genuine joy. The Blessed One heard the great and loud noise and the sound of the large crowd in the garden of Ānanda. And since the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, ask while already knowing, the Blessed One asked the venerable Ānanda: "What is this great and loud noise and the sound of a large crowd that is heard in the garden?" Ānanda replied: "Blessed One, it is because the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī have come here together with a great many monks, having brought along many people."

"That," replied Ānanda, "is the great and loud noise and the sound of a large crowd that is heard — the sound of the resident monks and the visiting monks rejoicing with one another in genuine joy."

Then the Blessed One addressed the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, go and tell the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī: 'Monks, the Blessed One bids you leave this place at once and not remain here.'"

"As you command, Blessed One," replied the venerable Ānanda. Having heard the instruction of the Blessed One, he went to the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī and said these words: "Venerable ones, know this: the Blessed One bids you leave this place at once and not remain here."

Understanding that they had been dismissed by the Blessed One, those monks took up their bowls and robes and departed, wandering through the countryside.

A second time and a third time the Blessed One addressed the assembled monks: "Monks, the people in whose village fields the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī have been staying — those people have truly found a good find" — and the passage continues as before, down through "it is fitting that they should come," just as above.

When those monks were talking among themselves, they said: "Why does the Blessed One wish to praise us and look upon us with favor, yet still he dismissed us? Before, he dismissed us because we had attached ourselves to many people. But now let us go away by ourselves alone, without attaching ourselves to anyone." And so, having resolved to go entirely unattached, they made their way straightaway to where the Blessed One was, bowed with their heads at his feet, and sat down to one side.

Then the Blessed One addressed the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, go and in one assembly hall prepare seats for the Tathāgata and for the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī."

"As you command, Blessed One," replied the venerable Ānanda. Having heard the instruction of the Blessed One, he arranged seats in one assembly hall for the Tathāgata and for the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī, then went to where the Blessed One was, bowed with his head at the Blessed One's feet, and sat down to one side. Sitting to one side, the venerable Ānanda said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, the seats in one assembly hall for the Blessed One and for the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī have been prepared. Now may the Blessed One consider that the time has come."

Then the Blessed One went to the assembly hall where the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī were. Having arrived, he washed his feet outside the hall, entered the assembly hall, and sat down cross-legged on the prepared seat, straightened his body upright, and settled his attention directly before him.

The monks from the bank of the river Sundarī likewise went to their own assembly hall. Having washed their feet outside the hall, they entered and took their places, each reclining on his own couch.

Then the Blessed One entered into the first meditative concentration, and the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī also entered into the first meditative concentration.

The Blessed One arose from the first meditative concentration and entered into the second, the third, the fourth, and then into the meditative absorption of the base of boundless space, the base of boundless consciousness, the base of nothingness, and the base of neither perception nor non-perception. The monks from the bank of the river Sundarī likewise arose from the first meditative concentration and entered into the second, the third, the fourth, and then into the base of boundless space, the base of boundless consciousness, the base of nothingness, and the base of neither perception nor non-perception.

Then the Blessed One arose from the base of neither perception nor non-perception and entered into the base of nothingness, and the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī likewise arose from the base of neither perception nor non-perception and entered into the base of nothingness.

The Blessed One arose from the base of nothingness and entered into the base of boundless consciousness, then the base of boundless space, then the fourth meditative concentration, the third, the second, and the first. The monks from the bank of the river Sundarī likewise arose from the base of nothingness, entered into the base of boundless consciousness, then the base of boundless space, and then entered into the fourth meditative concentration, the third, the second, and the first.

Then the Blessed One thought to himself: When I enter into the first meditative concentration, the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī also enter into the first meditative concentration. When I arise from the first and enter up through the base of neither perception nor non-perception, they too arise from the first and enter up through the base of neither perception nor non-perception. When I arise from the base of neither perception nor non-perception and enter into the base of nothingness, they too arise from the base of neither perception nor non-perception and enter into the base of nothingness. When I arise from the base of nothingness and enter back down through to the first meditative concentration, they too arise from the base of nothingness and enter back down through to the first meditative concentration. Now then, by means of these modes, these signs, and these reasons, I shall remain in that first meditative concentration which surpasses all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas,

having perfected it and abiding in it.

Then the Blessed One, by those very modes, those signs, and those reasons, remained in that first meditative concentration which surpasses all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, having perfected it and abiding in it.

Then the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī thought to themselves: Venerable ones, be aware of this. The Blessed One is now abiding in his own way of abiding, so let us also abide in our own way of abiding. And so they began to abide each in his own way of abiding.

Then, early the next morning, the Blessed One arose from that meditative absorption and took his seat on the prepared seat in the midst of the monastic community of monks.

Then the venerable Ānanda rose from his seat, arranged his outer robe over one shoulder, turned toward the Blessed One, joined his palms in reverence, and spoke these words to the Blessed One: Reverend Blessed One, you have again and again been pleased to praise and look upon the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī, and

yet the Blessed One had not been genuinely pleased with them. The Blessed One declared: Ānanda, the Tathāgata was genuinely pleased with the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī with a noble, genuine pleasure. Reverend One, what constitutes noble, genuine pleasure in the noble Dharma and Vinaya? How did the Blessed One express genuine pleasure with a noble, genuine pleasure?

Ānanda, in this case I went to the temple where the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī were staying. I washed my feet outside the temple, entered the temple, arranged the prepared seat, and sat down cross-legged, holding my body upright, with mindfulness established before me. The monks from the bank of the river Sundarī likewise washed their feet outside the temple, entered the temple, arranged their own prepared seats, sat down cross-legged, held their bodies upright, and established mindfulness before them.

When I entered into the first meditative concentration (dhyāna), the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī also entered into the first meditative concentration. When I arose from the first meditative concentration and entered into all the absorptions up through the sense base of neither-perception-nor-non-perception, the monks from the bank of the river

Sundarī likewise arose from the first meditative concentration and entered into all the absorptions up through the sense base of neither-perception-nor-non-perception. When I arose from the sense base of neither-perception-nor-non-perception and entered into the sense base of nothingness, the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī also arose from the sense base of neither-perception-nor-non-perception and entered into the sense base of nothingness. When I arose from the sense base of nothingness and entered, as before, into all the absorptions back down to the first meditative concentration, the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī likewise arose from the sense base of nothingness and entered, as before, into all the absorptions back down to the first meditative concentration.

Then I thought to myself: when I enter the first meditative concentration, the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī also enter the first meditative concentration. When I arise from the first meditative concentration and, as before, enter all the absorptions up through the sense base of neither-perception-nor-non-perception, the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī also arise from the first meditative concentration and, as before, enter all the absorptions up through the sense base of neither-perception-nor-non-perception. When I arise from the sense base of neither-perception-nor-non-perception and enter the sense base of nothingness, the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī also arise from the sense base of neither-perception-nor-non-perception and enter the sense base of nothingness. When I arise from the sense base of nothingness and, as before, enter all the absorptions back down to the first meditative concentration, the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī likewise arise from the sense base of nothingness and, as before, enter all the absorptions back down to the first meditative concentration. Now therefore, by these qualities, these signs, and these reasons, I shall dwell having perfected and established in the first meditative concentration that which surpasses all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. And so by these qualities, these signs, and these reasons I did dwell having perfected and established in the first meditative concentration that which surpasses all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas.

Then the monks from the bank of the river Sundarī thought to themselves: Venerable friends, the Blessed One is presently dwelling in the way of his own abiding,

and we too should dwell in the way of our own abiding. And so they too began to dwell in the way of their own abiding.

"Ānanda, this much is genuine noble joy in the noble Dharma and discipline, and through such genuine noble joy one has been made to rejoice genuinely. Venerable one, genuine noble joy in the noble Dharma and discipline is good. Venerable one, genuine noble joy in the noble Dharma and discipline is excellent — the Blessed One has caused the monks on the bank of the river Sundarī to rejoice genuinely with genuine noble joy. The Blessed One has caused the monks on the bank of the river Sundarī to rejoice genuinely with genuine noble joy."

When this report spread and was heard by the brahmins and householders living in the surrounding area, they came to see what had happened. As they drew near, the monks began to teach them the Dharma. While they were teaching the Dharma, a foul smell came from their mouths, and those people looked at one another and asked: "Noble ones, where does this foul smell come from?" The monks replied: "Venerable friends, it comes from our mouths." The people said: "Noble ones, do you not discard your tooth-wood?" The monks replied: "Venerable friends, we do not discard it." "Noble ones, why? Has the Blessed One not permitted it?" "Noble ones, would you become pure by not eating tooth-wood?" The monks said nothing.

At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, the brahmins and householders have spoken well. Therefore I permit monks to discard tooth-wood. And why? Monks, tooth-wood has five qualities. What are the five? It draws out bile; it draws out phlegm; it draws out wind; it removes foul smell from the mouth; and it improves the eyesight. Monks, tooth-wood is also beneficial for the eyes."

When the Blessed One had said that monks should discard their tooth-wood, a young monk was sitting in a non-secluded place and had just begun to discard a small piece of tooth-wood when the Blessed One happened to approach in that direction. Upon seeing the Blessed One the monk's hair stood on end, and he thought to himself: "For me to be eating tooth-wood openly before the Blessed One's eyes is not fitting on my part." And with that it became lodged in his throat and neck. The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, possess the quality of never being forgetful. The Blessed One then pressed down upon the monk's head with his left hand — the hand that bears the wheel, the auspicious marks, and the swastika, born from many hundreds of meritorious deeds,

which gives relief to those in fear — and with a crooked finger of his right hand drew it out from his mouth together with blood. He then said to the monk: "Monk, what is this?"

The monk at that moment reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One reflected, understood that whatever slight fault had arisen had come about from a monk eating tooth-wood while sitting in a non-secluded place, and declared to the monks: "Monks, a certain young monk of some seniority was sitting in a non-secluded place and ate a small piece of tooth-wood, and a fault such as this befell him. Therefore a monk must not sit in a non-secluded place and eat tooth-wood — not even a small piece. If a monk sitting in a non-secluded place eats tooth-wood or uses it as a small piece, it becomes a serious offense."

When the Blessed One had said that a monk must not sit in a non-secluded place and eat tooth-wood,

Some junior monks, sitting among the elder monks, began eating tooth-wood, and the Blessed One declared: "Junior monks must not sit among the elder monks and eat tooth-wood. Nor indeed should they eat it in a non-secluded place. However, there are three things that should be done in seclusion: defecating, urinating, and eating tooth-wood."

When the Blessed One had said that a monk must not eat a small piece of tooth-wood, the Group of Six began eating very long pieces. When the other monks saw this, they rebuked them, saying: "Venerable ones, what surplus are you cutting off? What surplus is there in this? You saw that when a monk ate a small piece of tooth-wood, the Blessed One saved him from dying from it — and now you want our alms-bowls and robes? There are other advantages to this too: blowing soot under a pot and striking ascetics." Those monks said nothing and remained where they were.

Then the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "A monk must not eat tooth-wood that is excessively long. If a monk eats tooth-wood that is excessively long, it becomes a serious offense."

The Vinaya of Minor Matters, the fifteenth bundle.

When the Blessed One had said that a monk must not eat tooth-wood that is too long, the monks did not know how much was the proper amount to eat. The Blessed One declared: "There are three sizes of tooth-wood: long, medium, and short. Long is twelve finger-widths. Short is eight finger-widths.

Medium is anything in between."

When the Blessed One had said that tooth-wood should be eaten in secluded spots, monks who were sick or elderly and infirm were unable to go to a secluded place. The Blessed One declared: "They may set out a spittoon."

Some monks placed spittoons next to their couches in the same way, and when these were knocked over by a foot the floor became unsuitable. The Blessed One declared: "Place ones like elephant's feet."

Others could not find a spittoon. The Blessed One declared: "They may eat at the entrance to a water-hole."

When monks were eating at a spot far too distant from the entrance of a water-hole, the Blessed One declared: "One should sit within a cubit's distance of the entrance to the water-hole and eat there."

When the Blessed One had said that monks should eat tooth-wood, some monks ate the tooth-wood without scraping the tongue, and that same fault arose. The Blessed One declared: "After eating tooth-wood, one should scrape the tongue."

When the Blessed One had said that after eating tooth-wood one should scrape the tongue, the monks did not know with what the tongue was to be scraped. The Blessed One declared: "Therefore, it is permitted to hold a tongue-scraper."

When the Blessed One had said that one should hold a tongue-scraper, the Group of Six used tongue-scrapers made of gold, silver, beryl, and crystal. When brahmins and householders saw this, they said: "What is this, noble ones? The beautiful Blessed One has permitted tongue-scrapers. Noble ones, are you ascetics tormented by the qualities of what you desire?" Those monks said nothing and remained where they were.

Then the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Four kinds of tongue-scraper are permitted: bone, copper, iron, and tin."

When monks made them sharp, the Blessed One declared: "They must not be made sharp."

When the Blessed One had said that four kinds of tongue-scraper are permitted, some monks were unable to obtain them, and —

the Blessed One declared: "Those who are unable to obtain them may use a tooth-stick itself, chewing one end to scrape the tongue."

When monks chewed a tooth-stick and used it without cleaning it to scrape the tongue, and this was reported, the Blessed One declared: "One should chew the tooth-stick, scrub it back and forth against itself, and then scrape the tongue."

When monks, having used a tooth-stick, discarded it silently without making a sound, and it struck those residing in the monastery on the head, they complained, and the Blessed One declared: "One must not discard it thus silently; one should make a sound when doing so."

Now, when monks discarded tooth-sticks by making a sound, some also discarded in the same silent manner whatever excrement, urine, saliva, mucus, vomit, or loose stool there was, and the same fault arose from this. The Blessed One declared: "Whatever excrement, urine, and all such things there are, one should make a sound and then discard them."

When the Blessed One had said that tooth-sticks may be used, some monks who had set out on a journey found that in certain directions there were no trees, leaves, or branches, and being unable to find a tooth-stick, they fasted. The Blessed One declared: "One must not fast. Instead, one should take tooth-stick powder, or rinse the mouth with the paste made from it, wash three times, and then eat. One need feel no remorse about this."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in Prince Jeta's park. The venerable Śāriputra had two novices: Cunda and Śroṇagrīta.

On another occasion, when the venerable Śāriputra was preparing to go on a regional tour, he said to the novice brothers Cunda and Śroṇagrīta: "Novices, I am going on a regional tour — will you stay, or will you come?" The venerable Cunda said: "Preceptor, I shall go along with you alone." Śroṇagrīta said: "Preceptor, I shall remain right here." The venerable Śāriputra said: "Śroṇagrīta, if that is so, in whose care shall you be left?" He replied: "Preceptor, please entrust me to the venerable Cāraka; I shall be in his company." Śāriputra said: "Śroṇagrīta, that one is of bad conduct and behaves badly everywhere — will he not harm you?" He replied: "Preceptor, he dwells toward me as a father and mother; how could he do me harm?"

So Śāriputra entrusted him to Cāraka and set out on the regional tour. Śroṇagr̥hīta then came out of the monastery, and Cāraka said to him: "Śroṇagr̥hīta, do this and this." He replied: "I will not." Cāraka grew angry and said: "You fool, if you will not do even this much, what else will you do?" He replied: "Are you my teacher? Are you my preceptor? I will not do it." Cāraka grew even angrier, seized him by the throat, and expelled him from the monastery. Śroṇagr̥hīta sat weeping at the gate of the Jeta Grove.

The great Gautamī, the mother of beings, came to the Jeta Grove with five hundred attendants to pay homage at the feet of the Blessed One, and she saw him weeping and said: "Noble Śroṇagr̥hīta, why do you weep?" He replied: "Gautamī, I have been expelled." She asked: "By whom?" He said: "By the venerable Cāraka." She thought to herself: "Whoever turns his back and abandons a son of the Buddha — that is no concern of mine," and so they gathered around him and surrounded him.

Then Prasenajit, the king of Kośala, came to pay homage at the feet of the Blessed One, and he too began to question him: "Noble Śroṇagr̥hīta, why do you weep?" He recounted what had happened, and —

He too thought to himself: "Whoever turns his back and abandons a son of the Buddha and a grandson of the Buddha — that is no concern of mine," and so he too gathered around him and surrounded him.

Shortly thereafter, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada came to pay homage at the feet of the Blessed One, and he too began to question him: "Noble Śroṇagr̥hīta, why do you weep?" Śroṇagr̥hīta recounted what had happened. Anāthapiṇḍada thought to himself: "Whoever turns his back and abandons a son of the Buddha, a grandson of the Buddha, and a king — that is no concern of mine," and so he too gathered around him and surrounded him.

At that very moment, a great tumult arose in the Jeta Grove — a loud uproar and the clamor of a great multitude of people. Since buddhas, the Blessed Ones, always know while feigning not to know, the Blessed One asked the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, what is this loud uproar in the Jeta Grove, this clamor of a great multitude?" Ānanda then related the full circumstances to the Blessed One.

The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, are monks expelling a monk from the Saṅgha's monastery?" "Blessed One, they are expelling him." The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, a monk has authority over his own dwelling cell, but not over the Saṅgha's monastery. Therefore a monk must not expel another monk

from the Saṅgha's monastery. If he does so, it becomes a serious offense."

When the Blessed One had declared that a monk must not expel another monk from the Saṅgha's monastery, the monks who were living together with the offending monks and those who were their attendants did not say so much as a word to them, so that those monks were neither brought under control nor subdued. The Blessed One then declared: "Apply the act of exclusion (Sanskrit: taghaniyakarman) to them."

When the Blessed One declared that the act of exclusion should be applied, the monks did not know how to apply it, and so the Blessed One declared: "Exclusion consists of five things: not speaking to them, not instructing them, not sharing resources with them, cutting off any wholesome undertaking on their part, and blocking their lodging."

As for not speaking — one must neither speak to them nor speak with them at all. As for not instructing — one must neither give them instructions nor offer them guidance. As for not sharing resources — one must not accept service from them for oneself, nor enjoy material goods from them, nor receive from them the sharing of Dharma. As for cutting off any wholesome undertaking — whatever wholesome activity they have begun must be interrupted. As for blocking their lodging — one must not allow them to appear at or enter a dwelling.

When the Blessed One had declared that the act of exclusion should be applied, the monks applied it indiscriminately to all. The Blessed One then declared: "The act of exclusion should be applied only to a fellow-resident or an attendant who possesses five qualities. What are the five? Lack of faith, laziness, being difficult to admonish, lack of respect, and keeping company with bad friends. Monks, it is only one who possesses all five of these qualities to whom the act of exclusion is to be applied; one who possesses only some of them is not to have it applied."

Then the Blessed One declared: "If someone possesses even one of these five qualities, the act of exclusion should be applied to him as well." When exclusion had been applied and others began to receive the excluded monk back, the Blessed One declared: "Preceptors and teachers must not receive back one who has been excluded. If they do so, they will incur the heavy offense of coming close to causing a schism." The Blessed One declared: "No one must receive back a fellow-resident or an attendant upon whom the act of exclusion has been applied."

If they do so, they will incur the heavy offense of coming close to causing a schism." Because no one received them back, those monks became very discontented. Some went away to another region, and some abandoned the teaching. The Blessed One then declared: "A monk skilled in reconciliation should be appointed." But they appointed someone without skill, and when he went to them and said, "Venerable one, your preceptor says please come back," this only made the excluded monks more arrogant. The Blessed One then declared: "One who is skilled in reconciliation, chosen by his own discernment, should be appointed." But when he sought consent from all without distinction, their virtuous qualities did not grow, and some new members also abandoned the teaching. The Blessed One then declared: "Consent should be sought from one who possesses five qualities: one who has faith, one who has undertaken diligence, one who is respectful, one who is easy to instruct, and one who has a spiritual friend."

The Blessed One further declared: "Monks, after seeking consent from one who possesses all five of these qualities, consent may then be sought from one who possesses any one of the five." "If a monk who is unfit to be ordained is ordained, it becomes an offense entailing serious transgression. If a monk who is fit to be ordained is not ordained, it becomes an offense entailing serious transgression. If consent is not sought from one from whom it should be sought, it becomes an offense entailing serious transgression. If consent is sought from one from whom it should not be sought, it becomes an offense entailing serious transgression. In such cases, consent should be sought from one who possesses any one of the five qualities mentioned above. If it appears that the mind will become favorable, consent should be sought. If it appears that the mind will not become favorable, consent should not be sought. From one who possesses all five qualities, consent should definitely not be sought; if consent is sought, it becomes an offense entailing serious transgression. If the one from whom consent is not to be sought is a novice, give him water, a ball of food, an upper robe, and a lower robe, and send him away. But if he is one who is fully ordained or one who desires full ordination, give him five requisites and send him away; do not send him away empty-handed."

The condensed summary verse:

Fine dwelling, platform, likewise
railings, lattice, and corbel,
broom, and pinnacle,
placing pinnacle and railing.

The Blessed One, the buddha Śākyamuni, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The Blessed One declared that among the various dwelling places, a place at the foot of a tree is suitable and easy to obtain, and that a monk who dwells there and has gone forth and received full ordination in the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya becomes a proper monk. If something better is obtained, then a cell, a front room, a multi-storied dwelling, or the like may be used. The monks then went about building dwelling cells, and the Blessed One declared: "Build fine dwellings." But when the Blessed One said "Build fine dwellings," the monks did not know how to do so. The Blessed One declared: "Lay a foundation seven or eight courses of bricks high, with a platform reaching to knee height, and set column bases in place. On top of that, arrange a row of columns. On top of the columns, set the column caps. On top of the column caps, place the rafters. On top of the rafters, lay flat planks. Cover all of that with bricks. Then plaster it over with powdered brick. This is how a fine dwelling should be built." After the Blessed One had declared this and the monks had built fine dwellings, they built them without railings. The Blessed One declared: "Build railings." But when the railings were built, they fell down. The Blessed One declared: "They should be fitted together and fastened with iron pegs."

When the monks were eating in the fine dwelling, sparrows and pigeons were pecking at them. The Blessed One declared: "Screens should be put up." When the Blessed One declared that screens should be put up, the monks did not know what kind to make, so the Blessed One declared: "There are five kinds of screens: those made from hemp, those made from muñja grass, those made from balvaja grass, those made from kuśa grass, and those made from cord." When the monks did not know on which side to fasten them, the Blessed One declared: "Fix them well with hooks projecting from the four corners." When they attached wooden hooks, these cracked in the sun and rotted in the rain, and the Blessed One declared: "Iron ones should be attached." Crows, sparrows, and pigeons then stopped coming, and the Blessed One declared: "On one side, a crow-hole should be made, and it should be open only at mealtimes; after the monks have eaten, it should be closed again."

While a monk was eating, a dog approached, and thinking to himself that it would certainly bite him if he did not give it something, he waited for a moment, expecting to give it food; but the monk did not give it anything, and that moment passed beyond its proper time. Thereupon the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "A food rack should be

set out for animals."

When the Blessed One had declared that a food rack should be set out for animals, a certain monk who was staying at a hermitage gave the rack of food to some foxes and drove away the crows. The crows became angry and, speaking in their own crow language, told the leader of a band of thieves: "That monk has a great deal of gold." The leader of the band of thieves was skilled in the language of crows, and he began to beat the monk. The monk said: "Good man, why do you beat me?" The man said: "Noble one, give me the gold you have." The monk said: "Good man, where would I get wealth in gold? Do not beat me without cause." The man said: "You have gold — give it to me. If you do not hand it over, I will kill you." The monk said: "Good man, if you have been deceived by one thing, tell me — who said this to you?" The leader of the thieves said: "The crows said it." The monk said: "Good man, those crows are angry with me." And he then explained what had happened. The leader of the thieves said: "Noble one, if you had not spoken the truth to me plainly, I would have killed you."

Thereupon the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "This flaw arose from setting out only one rack; therefore, for the sake of all sentient beings, a food rack that is comfortable for all should generally be set out."

When the fine summer dwelling became full of water, the Blessed One declared: "It should be drained." When the Blessed One declared that it should be drained, the monks did not know how to do it, and the Blessed One declared: "Between the columns, it should be cut through with flat planks." When they were cut through everywhere it became completely dark, and the Blessed One declared: "Do not cut it through everywhere; rather, leave spaces for light." When no timber was to be found, the Blessed One declared: "It may be cut with a saw or an axe." When these were cut through, they rotted in the water, and insects also got in, whereupon the Blessed One declared: "They should be set in place every four months and then removed."

The Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The householder Anāthapiṇḍada was in the habit of rising early each morning and going to the Jeta Grove to pay his respects to the Blessed One, sweeping it himself as he went.

Then on another occasion the householder Anāthapiṇḍada was occupied with some pressing business and did not come. The Jeta Grove went unswept, and

the ground was covered with fallen leaves. The Blessed One, while walking in meditation, saw this. Having seen it, he thought to himself: "Alas — even if Śakra (Indra), the sovereign of the gods, were to come bearing a broom, his garments fragrant with the scent of the Himalayas, it would be presumptuous." For it is the nature of reality that whenever the blessed buddhas give rise to worldly intention, the very insects and creatures sense it through the Blessed One's mind and thought. And when the buddhas give rise to a mind that transcends the world, even śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas do not know it through the Blessed One's mind and thought — so what need is there to speak of the creatures born in animal existences? Śakra, the sovereign of the gods, reflecting on why the Blessed One would give rise to a worldly intention, saw that he wished the Jeta Grove to be swept. Śakra, knowing the Blessed One's mind and thought, then took five hundred brooms soft as wool to the touch and placed them before the Blessed One.

Then, in order to show sentient beings who desire merit a basis for the accumulation of merit, the Blessed One himself took up a broom and set about sweeping the Jeta Grove. Seeing the Blessed One doing so, the great śrāvakas — Śāriputra, Maudgalyāyana, Kāśyapa, Ānanda, Nāmadru, and others — likewise took up brooms and swept. Then the great śrāvakas, together with the Blessed One, swept the Jeta Grove and went to the dwelling house. There, in the midst of the community of monks, a seat having been spread, the Blessed One took his seat.

Seated, the Blessed One declared to the monks: "Monks, there are five benefits in the act of sweeping. What are the five? One's own mind becomes thoroughly clear; the minds of others become thoroughly clear; the gods are pleased; the roots of virtue that give rise to beauty are accumulated; and at the dissolution of the body, one will be reborn among the gods of the higher realms, the happy destinies."

Then the householder Anāthapiṇḍada arrived at that spot. He heard how the Blessed One, together with the great śrāvakas, had swept the grove himself, and he thought: "How could I walk upon the very ground swept by the Blessed One together with the great śrāvakas?" The householder Anāthapiṇḍada, feeling a sense of shame welling up in his heart, remained where he stood and did not go forward.

Now the blessed buddhas, even while knowing something, may act as though they do not know, and so the Blessed One asked the monks: "Monks, who is

that?" The monks replied: "It is Anāthapiṇḍada, Blessed One. Having heard that the Blessed One himself swept the grove together with the great śrāvakas, he is too embarrassed to come before the Blessed One, and has dropped his walking staff and stands there with a sense of shame."

Then the Blessed One said to him: "Householder, you should recite and take to heart the teaching of the Buddha. For the blessed buddhas revere the Dharma, and the Dharma is the teacher even of the arhats."

Then Anāthapiṇḍada, chanting verses aloud, approached and drew near before the Blessed One.

Then the Blessed One instructed him thoroughly with talk rich in Dharma, drew him fully into it, praised him fully, and gladdened him fully. Having instructed him thoroughly with talk rich in Dharma, drawn him fully into it, praised him fully, and gladdened him fully, the Blessed One departed.

The monks, having given rise to doubt, asked the buddha, the Blessed One, in order to have all their doubts cut through: "Venerable Blessed One, it is wonderful that, having arisen to reverence and respect for the Dharma, he praised the Dharma in that way."

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, that the Tathāgata, who here and now is free from attachment, free from aversion, free from delusion — fully liberated from birth, aging, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, mental distress, and anguish — who, through omniscience and the wisdom that knows all aspects, has gained mastery over all objects of knowledge, that such a one should arise to reverence and respect for the Dharma and thus offer praises of the Dharma — what is so wonderful in that? Rather, monks, listen well and take to heart what I shall tell you: what is truly wonderful is what happened in a time past, when I had not yet been liberated from attachment, aversion, and delusion, from birth, aging, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, mental distress, and anguish, and yet for the sake of the Dharma entirely gave up my own life. I shall now tell it.

Monks, in a time long past, in the city of Vārāṇasī, there reigned a king named Brahmadatta. His kingdom was prosperous, flourishing, and happy; the harvests were good, the people were many, the population was great; strife, quarrel, tumult, and uproar were thoroughly stilled; there were no robbers; rice, sugarcane, cattle, and buffalo were abundant. He was a righteous king who governed in accordance with the Dharma, ruling by Dharma.

That king was faithful, of wholesome and good intention, devoted to the benefit of himself and others, compassionate, a great-souled one who loved the Dharma, affectionate toward his subjects like a mother toward her child, giving everything, relinquishing everything — he engaged in great generosity.

Then at another time he was enjoying himself, delighting, and taking pleasure together with his noble queen. As they were thus enjoying themselves, delighting, and taking pleasure, the queen conceived a being within her womb, and she felt a wish to hear well-spoken words. She said so to the king, and the king summoned the astrologers and asked them about it. They replied: 'Your Majesty, this is the power of the being conceived in her.'

Then the king, wishing to obtain well-spoken words, sent a hundred thousand gold coins and had messengers circle through towns, villages, districts, and the palace precincts, yet well-spoken words were not to be found.

In due course, nine months being complete, the queen gave birth to a son — handsome, pleasing to behold, beautiful, of golden complexion, with shoulders like a canopy, long-armed, with a broad forehead, arched eyebrows, a high nose, endowed with all limbs and minor members. Twenty-one weeks of seven days after the birth, a great naming ceremony was held, and they set about giving the boy his name. The ministers said:

"Because it was on account of the god for whom, from before his very birth, a search was made for well-spoken words, let the boy's name be Seeker of Well-Spoken Words." And so the name Seeker of Well-Spoken Words was given to him.

The boy Seeker of Well-Spoken Words was entrusted to eight nurses: two to carry him, two to suckle him, two to bathe him, and two to play with him. These eight nurses raised and nourished him on milk, yogurt, fresh butter, melted butter, clarified butter, and other finest provisions of every kind, so that he grew as a lotus grows in a pond. Yet even when he had grown great, when a search was made for well-spoken words, they were not to be found.

His father then passed away, and the kingdom was placed in his hands. He spoke to his ministers: "Lords, I have need of well-spoken words. Search for well-spoken words." The ministers then sent a hundred thousand gold coins and circled through all the towns, villages, districts, and palace precincts of Jambudvīpa, yet well-spoken words were not to be found. They reported this to the king, and the king was seized with longing, consumed with hope of hearing well-spoken words.

Śakra, the lord of gods — whose knowledge and vision penetrate below — saw that the king was suffering on account of well-spoken words, and thought to himself: "I should go to comfort the king." Then Śakra, lord of gods, transforming himself into the form of a yakṣa, with hands, feet, and eyes made ugly and repellent, sat down before the king. At that moment he spoke in verse:

Practice the Dharma of right conduct.
Practice it; do not practice wrongdoing.
One who practices Dharma abides in happiness
In this world and in the next.

The moment the king heard that verse, joy and great joy arose in him, and he said to the yakṣa: "Mysterious one, speak that verse again! Speak it again — I wish to hear it." Then the yakṣa said to the king: "O god, if you do what I tell you, then I too will do whatever you command." The king said: "Speak — what is it?" The yakṣa said: "For seven days, pile up logs of śāla wood in a fire-pit, and if at the end of that time you cast yourself into it, then afterward I will speak the verse."

The moment the king heard this, he rejoiced and said to the yakṣa: "So be it." Then the king proclaimed throughout all the land: "In seven days the king will cast himself into the fire-pit for the sake of hearing well-spoken words; those who wish to witness this wonder — let them come." Then many hundreds of thousands of living beings gathered, and in the sky too many hundreds of thousands of gods assembled, knowing the purity of the bodhisattva's elevated aspiration, and stationed themselves there to witness the wonder.

Then the yakṣa rose into the sky and said to the bodhisattva: "Great king, act according to your vow." Then the king appointed his eldest son over the kingdom, asked forgiveness of his ministers, the townspeople, and the people of the land, and while the crowd of people breathed out with held breath, he drew near to the fire-pit and spoke in verse:

Here at this fire-pit, whose terror is great
and whose light is like the rays of the rising sun,
for the sake of Dharma I shall leap in without fear for my life,
with a mind of certainty.
By the power of my merit, may this fire-pit too become filled with lotuses —
cool as a lake of water infused with sandalwood and blue lotus —

Having said those words, the bodhisattva leapt into the fire-pit, and the very instant he leapt in, that fire-pit turned into a lake. Then Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, seeing that miraculous display which made the king's wonder equal among gods and humans alike, caused the form of the yakṣa to disappear and sat there in his own form. At that moment he spoke in verse:

Practice the Dharma that is well practiced;
do not practice that which is wrongly practiced.
One who practices the Dharma abides in happiness
in this world and in the next.

The bodhisattva then took hold of those verses, wrote them on golden tablets, and sent them to all the towns, villages, districts, and royal palaces throughout Jambudvīpa.

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the king at that time and on that occasion — that was I. And if even then I gave up my life completely for the sake of the Dharma, what need is there to speak of the present? Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: hold the Dharma in reverence, regard it as supreme, take delight in it, and honor it. You should dwell in dependence upon the Dharma, having revered it, regarded it as supreme, taken delight in it, and honored it. Monks, you should train in exactly this way."

When the Blessed One had spoken those words, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada (the benefactor of the poor).

The Blessed One declared that there are five benefits of sweeping, and upon hearing this, the monks — the elder monks among them — abandoned their meditation and their recitation and set about sweeping the Jeta Grove. The Blessed One declared: "I spoke with the monk in charge of duties in mind, not with the elder monks." Nevertheless, a monk's two tasks, having gone forth into the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, are these: meditation and recitation. The Blessed One declared: "I spoke with the attendant monk in charge of duties in mind." Since that monk was unable to sweep the entire Jeta Grove, the Blessed One declared: "Whatever area the monk in charge of duties is able to sweep, he shall sweep, and on the eighth and fourteenth days the wooden board shall be struck and the entire Saṅgha shall sweep together."

When the Blessed One declared that the wooden board should be struck on the eighth and fourteenth days and the entire Saṅgha should sweep, some monks, holding no broom in hand, spoke ill of the task and did the work poorly. The non-humans dwelling in the Jeta Grove and other monks as well were reproached. The Blessed One then declared: "One should sweep while speaking words of resolution that accord with the Dharma, or one should sweep in noble silence." When the monks had swept the Jeta Grove and sat there with their bodies soiled by dust, those of little faith saw them and mocked them. The Blessed One declared: "Having swept and set aside the broom, those who wish to bathe may bathe. Those who do not wish to bathe should wipe the body with water, wash the hands and feet, and then enter. That same one should inspect the sleeping quarters during the day." When the entire Saṅgha had done so and inspected in that way, the Blessed One declared: "The entire Saṅgha need not inspect; rather, those who are appointed to look after the lodgings shall do the inspection." The Blessed One declared: "After sweeping, one should recite the words of the buddha while going along."

The monks, seeing that a shadow had fallen there, felt it would be improper to walk in that direction, and so they did not go. The Blessed One declared: "One should recite the words of the buddha while walking along; there is no need for remorse in this."

When the shadow of the bathhouse, of an image, or of the central pole of a stūpa fell in that direction, the monks again felt remorse and did not traverse it. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, shadows are unstable. In such cases as well, one should recite the words of the buddha while traversing. There is no need for remorse in this."

Now, the king of Kera sent two of his Kera-born servant boys as a gift to King Prasenajit of Kosala. One of these was called Servant Boy and the other was called Skyongwa. Of the two, Servant Boy was skilled in the service of food and drink, while Skyongwa was skilled in the service of lodgings and bedding.

The people who lived in the border regions were mostly by nature given to greed, and whenever the two went to the market, they would snatch fish, meat, and oil from the local people and eat them, and those people would beat them for it. The two then reported to the king: "Your Majesty, when we went to the market today and tried to take just a small portion of fish, they soiled us and nearly killed us."

King Prasenajit had it proclaimed by drum that no one was to beat Servant Boy or Skyongwa, though people should guard their own goods. After this proclamation, whenever the two went to the market, the people, upon seeing them, would hide their own goods.

Then one day, after growing weary from his royal duties, the king lay down to rest. Servant Boy and Skyongwa were kneading his feet and waiting at his side. They roused the king, and Servant Boy said to Skyongwa: "Skyongwa, has His Majesty fallen asleep?" Skyongwa replied: "He has fallen asleep." The king, having heard this, thought to himself: "These two certainly wish to exchange some private words." He then feigned sleep and remained still. Servant Boy said to Skyongwa: "Skyongwa, does the next world exist or not?" Skyongwa replied: "Servant Boy, the next world does indeed exist, I think." Skyongwa then said: "Servant Boy, are there arhats in the world?" Servant Boy replied: "There are indeed arhats in the world, I think."

When the king had heard all of this, he thought to himself: "These two are both practicing such wrong views — one holds the view of permanence, and the other holds the view of annihilation."

And so it came to be widely known throughout the land that of the two Kera-born boys belonging to King Prasenajit of Kosala, one held the view of permanence and the other held the view of annihilation.

At that time, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada raised a great lion's roar before the assembly with these powerful words: "Whoever in this world acts in a human way and does good deeds in my home shall, upon the breakup of the body, be reborn in a good destiny, in the higher realms among the gods." King Prasenajit thought: "When the householder Anāthapiṇḍada comes here, I shall arrange some means by which to present these two boys to him."

Then on another occasion the householder Anāthapiṇḍada came to the king's presence. One of the boys set out a seat for him and, thinking the time had come, went back out and began playing with the other children. The king, knowing that boy had gone, thought: "This is the very moment those two have arranged to present him." He quietly instructed the doorkeeper: "Do not let the Servant Boy who came out from the householder Anāthapiṇḍada's quarters back inside."

The doorkeeper did not let him back inside. When the householder Anāthapiṇḍada rose from his seat to leave, he looked around and the king said: "Householder, where is the boy who arranged the seat for you?" The

householder replied: "Your Majesty, please accept the Servant Boy and the Guardian as my gift and take them with you." The householder accepted this before the king's face, and then thought: "Why has the king given me these two boys?" He thought further: "These two hold wrong views, and the king wishes to test me through them." So he led the two of them home, called his steward, and said: "Good man, give these two whatever they desire." Then he went out to the marketplace and said to the assembled people: "Whatever the Servant Boy and the Guardian take, give it to them, record the price, and I shall pay double." Whatever the two took from the steward's hand, they received in full, and being pleased they said: "Good man, if you give us everything we have taken, who instructed you to do so?" He replied: "The householder instructed me to do exactly that." They thought: "The householder treats us just as our own parents would — we shall receive whatever we have taken." Then on another occasion, when the two went out to the marketplace, the assembled people called out and gave things to them — some saying, "Take what you like from us," and others likewise saying, "Take from us." The two said: "Wise ones, when you saw us before, you hid things away from us; now you call out and give them freely — what is the reason for this?" The people replied: "Before, you would snatch and eat things. Now the householder is paying double the price." The two thought: "The householder exerts himself greatly for our benefit." So they went to the householder and said: "Householder, please give us some work to do." He replied: "Friends, stay here — there is indeed work." After some time had passed, on another occasion the householder Anāthapiṇḍada took the Servant Boy and the Guardian with him to sweep the Jeta Grove. When they arrived and had begun the sweeping, something came up for him, and he said: "Servant Boy and Guardian, something has come up for me. You go on ahead and sweep in the direction of the Jeta Grove." As they began to sweep, the Blessed One blessed it so that, as when a sweeping cloth is inexhaustible, in just that way it did not come to an end, and because of their affection for the Lord they could not bring themselves to stop. Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, leave the remnants of the alms-bowl for the Servant Boy and the Guardian." And Ānanda left the remnants of the alms-bowl for them. When they put down the sweeping cloth and it continued to remain inexhaustible just as before, the two remained there working until nightfall. Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, call the Servant Boy and the Guardian to come before me." And to the monks he said: "Monks, I have spoken to you of not being indifferent to virtue and of

confessing misdeeds and dwelling accordingly. However, because the Servant Boy and the Guardian must be freed from wrong views, whoever among you has attained the absorptive dwelling in equipoise by which they abide — let that one make it known to them through that very absorptive dwelling." Venerable Ānanda replied: "Reverend one, it shall be done as you say." Having heeded the Blessed One's words, Ānanda said to the Servant Boy and the Guardian: "Come before me alone." And to the monks he said: "Venerable ones, the Blessed One has declared from his own mouth that I, monks —

"It shall be done as the Blessed One has declared," replied Venerable Ānanda. Then, at the first watch of the night, he began to display miraculous powers: some blazed with fire, some crackled with lightning. The Servant Boy and the Guardian asked: "Noble Ānanda, what is this?" He replied: "These are arhats at play with their supernormal powers." They said: "Ānanda, since there are arhats in this world, surely these cannot but appear directly before our very eyes — what is there to doubt about this?" And of those two, whichever one had held the view that there are no arhats in the world was freed from that view, and attained the right view that there are indeed arhats in the world.

Then, at the middle watch of the night, the Blessed One aroused in his mind the worldly intention that Śakra (Indra, king of the gods) and Brahmā and the other gods would come. Now, as concerns the passage beginning with "When the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, arouse in their minds the worldly intention" and ending with "Śakra and Brahmā and the other gods, knowing the Blessed One's intention through his mind, proceeded into the Blessed One's presence" — all of that proceeds as before. By their power, a vast radiance arose. The Servant Boy and the Guardian asked: "Noble Ānanda, what is this?" He replied: "These are Śakra, Brahmā, and the other gods who have come into the Blessed One's presence. There is another world beyond this one — surely these cannot but appear directly and vividly — what is there to doubt?" And of those two, whichever one had held the view that there is no world beyond was freed from that view, and the right view that there is indeed a world beyond was born in them.

Faith having arisen in them, they went to where the Blessed One was, and having gone there, they touched their heads to the Blessed One's feet, and sat down to one side. The Blessed One, having understood their dispositions, latent tendencies, constitutions, and natures, taught them the Dharma of such a kind that they would realize the Four Noble Truths. Having heard this, the Servant Boy and the Guardian struck down with the vajra of wisdom the

mountain peak of the view of the transitory collection — twenty heights high — and directly manifested the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truth, they touched the Blessed One's feet and implored him: "Reverend one, if we may obtain the going-forth and full ordination in this well-taught Dharma and Vinaya and receive the status of monks, we wish to practice the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One." The Blessed One addressed those two: "Servant Boy and Guardian, come, practice the holy life" — and by this utterance of "Come, monks," he fully ordained them.

The moment the Blessed One spoke, they found themselves with their heads shaved, robed in patched cloth, bowl in hand, water-pot borne, their hair and beards cut — appearing as though seven days had passed since the shaving, and comporting themselves like monks who had been fully ordained for a hundred years.

When the Tathāgata spoke the word "Come,"
their heads were shaved and their bodies clothed in patched robes;
in that instant their faculties were perfectly stilled,
and through the Buddha's intention their outer form was transformed.

The basis for the minor rules of the Vinaya.

The sixteenth fascicle.

The Blessed One gave instruction to the two of them, and through their earnest and sustained effort they abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhatship. As arhats, they were free from attachment to all three realms — their minds even and equal, like clay and gold, like open sky and the palm of the hand, like a mongoose and sandalwood. They had split open the shell of the egg of ignorance, attained clear knowing, higher knowledge, and the four kinds of individual discriminating awareness; they had turned their backs on attachment to existence, to gain, and to honor; and they had become worthy of veneration, reverence, and respectful address by the gods of the sense faculties and the faculties' near-dependents.

Now when the Blessed One ordained those servants and herdsmen, King Prasenajit lost faith, thinking: "It is not a good thing that the Blessed One has done — ordaining servants and herdsmen; these are people who practice every manner of wrong view." The Blessed One, perceiving with his wisdom that King Prasenajit had lost faith in those great hearers who were like Mount Meru, thought: "I must therefore proclaim their virtues."

With that intention the Blessed One remained silent, and then the householder Anāthapiṇḍada came to where the Blessed One was, prostrated with his head at the Blessed One's feet, and sat to one side. Once he was seated to one side, the Blessed One instructed the householder Anāthapiṇḍada with a Dharma discourse that was genuine, led him to genuine acceptance, genuinely praised him, and genuinely gladdened him; and in many ways with such a Dharma discourse he taught genuinely, led him to genuine acceptance, genuinely praised him, and genuinely gladdened him — and then remained silent.

Then the householder Anāthapiṇḍada rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, turned to face the Blessed One with palms pressed together in reverence, and addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, would you grant permission for me to offer tomorrow's noon meal to the community of monks together with the Blessed One?"

The Blessed One remained silent, and by that silence gave his assent.

The householder Anāthapiṇḍada, understanding from the Blessed One's silence that permission had been granted, rejoiced in what the Blessed One had taught, expressed his delight, prostrated with his head at the Blessed One's feet, and departed from the Blessed One's presence.

Then the Blessed One addressed the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, go to where the two — the servant and the herdsman — are staying, and when you arrive, say this to them: 'Tomorrow, when the householder Anāthapiṇḍada prepares the noon meal, the two of you are to arrange the water for rinsing.'"

"Venerable one, it shall be done as you say," said the venerable Ānanda. Respectfully complying with the Blessed One's instruction, the venerable Ānanda went to where the venerable servant and herdsman were staying and said to them: "Venerable ones, the Blessed One has spoken from his own mouth and commanded: 'Tomorrow, when the householder Anāthapiṇḍada prepares the noon meal, the two of you are to arrange the water for rinsing.'"

They replied: "Venerable Ānanda, it shall be done exactly as the Blessed One has commanded."

And they thought to themselves: "Why has the Blessed One, leaving aside the elder monks, commanded us alone to arrange the water for rinsing tomorrow? Surely he intends to proclaim our virtues before the meal is consumed — he wishes to fulfill the Teacher's intention completely."

That very night the householder Anāthapiṇḍada prepared the food and drink, clean and well-arranged, and rose early the next morning to set out the seats. He set out the water vessels, and then sent a messenger to the Blessed One, saying: "Lord, the food and drink have been prepared at the noon hour. May the Blessed One please take notice that the time has now come." And so he announced the hour.

Then the Blessed One, in the forenoon, donned his robe, took up his bowl, and surrounded by the assembly of monks, with the community of monks going before him, proceeded to the residence of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada, going directly to the place. Upon arriving, he took his seat on the appointed seat in the midst of the community of monks.

Then the householder Anāthapiṇḍada sent a messenger to King Prasenajit, saying: "My lord, I have invited the buddha and the community of monks to the noon meal. It would be fitting for you to come and rejoice in this." At that, the king, accompanied by his queen's retinue, his youths, and his ministers, came to the house of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada to rejoice at the noon gathering, and they sat down, paying homage in order of seniority.

Then the Venerable Śroṇa, sitting at the elder's end, blessed the stream of water just as one pours water from the younger end. The Venerable Pāṃśukūlika likewise blessed the stream of water just as one pours water from the elder end. King Prasenajit thought to himself: "Which among the monks is displaying these miraculous powers before the Teacher?" And following the stream of water, he went to the younger end, and at a certain moment he saw the Venerable Pāṃśukūlika. Then, following the stream of water back again, he went to the elder's end, and at a certain moment he saw the Venerable Śroṇa. He was utterly astonished, bared his upper body, extended his right hand, and exclaimed aloud: "Wonderful — the Buddha! Wonderful — the Dharma! Wonderful — the Saṅgha! Wonderful — that the Dharma has been so well proclaimed! Even now, here among us, Śroṇa and Pāṃśukūlika and others who hold mistaken views have attained qualities such as these!"

Then the householder Anāthapiṇḍada, knowing that the Blessed One and the community of monks were comfortably seated, with his own hands served them with food and drink, clean and well-prepared, satisfying them fully and completely, in all respects filling them to contentment. After serving them fully and repeatedly with his own hands with food and drink, clean and well-prepared, and satisfying them and filling them completely, he informed

the Blessed One that the noon meal was done, and perceived that the Blessed One had covered his bowl and withdrawn his hand. Then he took a low seat and sat before the Blessed One to listen to the Dharma.

Thereupon the Blessed One instructed, guided, inspired, and gladdened King Prasenajit and the householder Anāthapiṇḍada with a discourse in harmony with the Dharma, and then rose from his seat and departed.

The monks were filled with doubt, and put to the Blessed One, the buddha, all their doubts to be resolved: "Venerable one, what karma did Śroṇa and Pāṃśukūlika perform such that they were born in an outlying borderland, with one holding the view of eternalism and the other the view of annihilation? And what karma did they perform such that they went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One, abandoned all afflictions, and directly realized the state of arhatship?"

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, the karma that Śroṇa and Pāṃśukūlika performed and accumulated in former lives in other existences" — from the passage beginning "Having obtained a gathering" through "ripening as a fruit for embodied beings" — is as before.

"Monks, long ago in this very auspicious age (kalpa), when the lifespan of beings was twenty thousand years, there was a Teacher named Kāśyapa" — from that passage through "a sage who speaks in the deer-forest grove" — is as before.

In the teaching of that Teacher, these two went forth. But then the two of them went to an outlying borderland and, without any master's instructions, aroused in themselves a mental engagement in meditation. There, with what they had not understood, they conceived a perception of having understood. Then, at the time of their death, they arrived at wrong views concerning the transcendence of the world. Damaged by those wrong views, the two said: "We have been deceived by the perfectly complete buddha Kāśyapa. If for the time being there is no arhatship for us in which the afflictions are abandoned, let there at least be something of the sort for others." Monks, what do you think? Those who, having gone forth in the canonical teaching of the perfectly complete buddha Kāśyapa and having gone to an outlying borderland without instructions, aroused that mental engagement in meditation — those very ones are these same servants and attendants here. And because they went to that outlying borderland, aroused in themselves a mental engagement in meditation without instructions, and thereby obtained wrong views — through

the karmic maturation of that action they were born among the lower realms, and for many years were born in outlying borderlands, becoming holders of wrong views. Right down to the present they have still been born in outlying borderlands and held wrong views.

However, because these two, at that time, had recited the scriptures, chanted them aloud, and trained in understanding the aggregates (skandhas), the elements (dhātus), the sense sources (āyatanas), dependent origination (pratītyasamutpāda), and what is possible and what is not possible — by virtue of that, they went forth in my teaching, abandoned all afflictions, and directly realized the state of arhatship.

Monks, there are these faults — and others as well — in meditating without a master's instructions. Therefore a monk should not meditate without a master's instructions. A monk who meditates without a master's instructions will come to ruin.

Monks, therefore, the karmic maturation of actions that are wholly dark is itself wholly dark; the karmic maturation of actions that are wholly bright is itself wholly bright; and for mixed actions the maturation is likewise mixed. Therefore, monks, having abandoned actions that are wholly dark and mixed, strive for actions that are wholly bright. This is how you, monks, should train."

The origin story takes place in Śrāvastī. A householder there had a squirrel come to live in his park. A monk was also there, and from the intense heat of fever he had become pale and dry, his body wasted, wretched, and thin. He said to the householder: "Please let the householder know; I will go elsewhere." The householder replied: "Noble one, I hope I have caused you no trouble at all." The monk said: "Householder, there is no trouble at all — but the time of fever has come upon me, and the squirrel in that place is a bother." The householder said: "Noble one, please stay. I will have an underground chamber made for you." The monk replied: "Householder, the Blessed One has not permitted this." The noble one said: "The Blessed One is compassionate — he will permit it."

At that time the monks made the request to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Then I grant permission: let a monk have an underground chamber made." When the Blessed One declared "I grant permission: let him have an underground chamber made," the householder had an underground chamber built. During the rainy season it became damp, and the monk went to the householder and said:

"Householder, know that I will go elsewhere." The householder said: "Noble one, surely you are not inconvenienced?" The monk replied: "Householder, I am not at all inconvenienced, but I cannot stay in this damp underground chamber." The householder said: "Noble one, if that is so, then please allow me to have a roof made and remain here." The monk replied: "The Blessed One has not permitted this." The householder said: "The Blessed One is compassionate — he will permit it."

At that time the monks made the request to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Then I grant permission: let a monk have a roof made." When the Blessed One declared "I grant permission: let him have a roof made," the householder had a roof built. When it collapsed, the Blessed One declared: "A railing is to be erected." When that too shifted, the Blessed One declared: "Support beams are not to be used; instead, it is to be fastened with iron nails."

A summary verse: Salt, and a hollow-stemmed container, a covered medicine bowl, a parting board and a cross-beam, a foot-rest and a mortar.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling in Rājagṛha at the Kalandaka Bamboo Grove in the Cool Wood. The venerable Pilindavatsa, from the time he went forth until now, was always ill. The celibate practitioners went to him and asked: "Elder, are you well?" He replied: "Friends, I am ill and unwell." They asked: "Elder, what did you take as medicine before?" He replied: "Friends, it was salt." They asked: "Elder, if that is so, why do you not take it now?" He replied: "Friends, the Blessed One has not permitted it."

At that time the monks made the request to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Then I grant permission: salt is to be taken as medicine." When the Blessed One declared that salt was to be taken as medicine, the monks stored it in small heaps and it spoiled. The Blessed One then declared: "It is not to be stored in small heaps; rather, it is to be stored in a hollow container." The monks stored it in hollow bamboo stems, and when those became saturated, the Blessed One declared: "It is to be stored in a horn container." The monks put it inside a horn flask, and it acquired an unpleasant smell. The Blessed One then declared: "It is not to be put inside a horn flask; rather, it is to be washed with cow's urine and dye and then put inside." The narrative occasion is in Rājagṛha.

When the Blessed One declared that salt was to be stored inside a horn container, the son of the venerable Pilinda put salt inside a horn container and

left it uncovered, so that dust got in. At that time the monks made the request to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "A lid is to be put on it." When the Blessed One declared that a lid was to be placed on it, the monks did not know how to make one. The Blessed One declared: "Make a second piece identical to that very horn, and place it as a paired horn-lid."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling in Rājagṛha at the Kalandaka Bamboo Grove in the Cool Wood. The venerable Pilindavatsa, from the time he went forth until now, was always ill. The celibate practitioners went to him and asked: "Elder, are you well?" He replied: "Friends, I am ill and unwell." They asked: "Elder, what did you formerly use to hold medicine?" He replied: "Friends, it was a medicine bowl." They asked: "Elder, if that is so, why do you not use one now?" He replied: "Friends, the Blessed One has not permitted it."

At that time the monks made the request to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared:

"Therefore I permit it: a monk may hold a medicine bowl."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in Prince Jeta's grove. At that time there was a householder in Śrāvastī who had taken a wife from an equal family. He sported with her, delighted in her, and enjoyed her company. From their sporting, delight, and enjoyment together, a son was born; they raised him, cared for him, and he grew up. In due course he went forth into the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, and he had obtained a throne and couch but no bed-mat. Some time later the householder went to the Jeta Grove and, seeing his son lying on an empty throne without a bed-mat, said to him: "Son, these monks have bed-mats — why do you have none?" The son replied: "Father, these monks have been gone forth for a long time and that is how they obtained bed-mats, but I have only just now gone forth and so I have not yet obtained one." The father said: "Son, if that is so, I will send you a blanket; spread it out here as a mat." The son replied: "The Blessed One has not permitted it." The father said: "Son, the Blessed One is compassionate — he will permit it."

At that point the monks made the request to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore I permit it: a monk may spread out a blanket." When the Blessed One had declared that a monk may spread out a blanket, that monk used the blanket without spreading it out, and it became soiled. Some time later the same householder also came to the monastery, saw the soiled blanket, did not recognize it, and said: "Son, you have become quite deserving

of great merit! Father, have you found another blanket besides this one? How fortunate to have found another, father! Son, why has this one become so soiled?" "Father, because I used it without spreading it out." "Son, have you thus made this fine garment, fit for a great person, unsuitable? Alas, it would have been better had you spread it out and then used it."

At that point the monks made the request to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One must not use even a person's parti-colored cloth without spreading it out; if one does, it constitutes a serious offense."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in Prince Jeta's grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. When the Blessed One declared that the gift of Dharma-listening was to be given, the Dharma-speaker sat on a lion-throne with his feet dangling down. The Blessed One declared: "A foot-rest is to be provided." When the Blessed One had declared that a foot-rest is to be provided, the monks did not know how to make one. The Blessed One declared: "For a throne that is firm and solid, make steps of ivory. If it is moved about repeatedly, make a small wooden seat." When it became difficult to move, the Blessed One declared: "Fit iron roller-wheels to the four base legs and, holding it by those, move it about as desired."

Merit-wishing monks, and faithful brahmins and householders, anointed the foot-rest with fragrant hand-impressions and with perfumes, and the Dharma-speaker was reluctant and would not set his feet upon it. The Blessed One declared: "Place a layer of leaves or grass on top of it, and having placed it, then set the feet upon it — there is no need to be reluctant about this."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling in the Jeta Grove of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the pleasure garden of Prince Jeta. The Blessed One declared that a foot-rest should be placed at the lion throne. But monks dwelling in forest hermitages had no foot-rests, and as they taught the Dharma with their feet hanging down, they became fatigued. At that time the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "They may place a stone."

Summary verse:

A wiping cloth, a lion-throne cloth, a spittoon,
a body-wiping cloth, a long basin,
a strainer, a burning lens,
a cushion-layer, and a flat board.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling in Rājagṛha at the Kalandaka Bamboo Grove in the Squirrel-Feeding Park. From the time the venerable Pilindavatsa (Skt. Pilindavatsa) had gone forth until now, he had been continuously ill. Those living the holy life (brahmacarins) came to him and asked: "Elder, are you comfortable?" He replied: "Friends, I am ill and not comfortable." "Elder, what did you use before as a remedy?" "Friends, a face-wiping cloth." "Elder, why do you not use one now?" "The Blessed One has not permitted it." At that time the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore it is permitted — one may keep a face-wiping cloth."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling in Rājagṛha at the Kalandaka Bamboo Grove in the Squirrel-Feeding Park. When the summer season arrived, the venerable Pilindavatsa became feverish and fell ill. He became pale and wan, his bodily flesh wasted away, and he grew thin, frail, and emaciated. Those living the holy life came to him, and seeing his bodily condition, they said: "Elder, why have you become pale and wan, your flesh wasted away, thin, frail, and emaciated?" He replied: "Friends, because of fever my body has come to this state." "Elder, what did you use formerly in the summer season?" "Friends, a linen cloth." "Elder, if that is so, why do you not use one now?" "Friends, the Blessed One has not permitted it." At that time the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore it is permitted — a monk may keep a linen cloth."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling in the Jeta Grove of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the pleasure garden of Prince Jeta. A monk fell ill with a cold and cough and spat on the ground, making both sides of his sleeping mat unsightly. In the morning, one who had been dwelling with him rose early, entered the dwelling, made his obeisance, enquired after his illness, and then departed. As he bowed, the spittle-residue touched his forehead, and the monks saw this and said to him: "Friend, where did your forehead come into contact with this spittle?" He replied: "I thought perhaps the preceptor who was ill with the cold had not spat on the ground — let me check," and he entered the dwelling, where he saw that spittle had been spat on both sides along the edge of the sleeping mat. He reported this to the monks, and they criticized, rebuked, and reproached the ill monk, saying: "How could it come to this? Monks are making the permitted dwelling of the Saṅgha unseemly with their spittle." At that time the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One should not spit on the ground near a monk's

sleeping mat and bedding. When making obeisance in the dark one should not bump one's head against the other person's body; rather, one should make obeisance with words alone. And if there is something to be attended to, one should inquire about that also with words alone."

Furthermore, whoever has a cold or is coughing up phlegm should keep a spittoon close at hand. When monks spat into bowls and stirred up the contents, making them greatly unpleasant, the Blessed One declared: "A spittoon should be provided together with a stand, or alternatively a large bronze vessel should be set out." When the monks placed bronze vessels of just any kind close by, these too were stirred up and the same fault arose, whereupon the Blessed One declared: "Something shaped like an elephant's foot should be set out." When others were spitting and thorns rose upward from below, the Blessed One declared: "The surface should be spread with a mat." The monks not knowing what to spread it with, the Blessed One declared: "Wood shavings, or else sand." When flies gathered there, the Blessed One declared: "They should be shooed away." When an unpleasant smell arose, the Blessed One declared: "It should be washed out from time to time." When the monks washed it out without drying it and living creatures appeared, the Blessed One declared: "After washing it out, it should be dried." When certain other monks vomited up phlegm and remained in a pitiable state until it was dry, the Blessed One declared: "Those who are gravely ill should keep two spittoons close at hand."

When monks in the assembly halls were reciting, chanting, or meditating, they would drool, and being mentally distracted, would spit carelessly. The Blessed One declared: "One must not spit carelessly near one's bedding and sleeping mat. However, four spittoons of the Saṅgha should be placed at the four corners by the pillars of the assembly hall, and while one is reciting, chanting, or meditating there, one should practice mindfulness and then spit into those."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was residing in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in Śrāvastī. At that time the Venerable whose paternal kinsman had, through five hundred lifetimes, died in hells and been reborn in hells, and who had then returned and been reborn here — from the time of his childhood he had been a householder, deeply attached to household life, delighting in the joy of play and intent on earning a livelihood, so that no recollection directed toward the hells had ever arisen in him. At another time, having gone forth into the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, when the Blessed One was teaching about hells, hungry ghosts, animals, gods, and humans in

such and such passages of the sūtras, the Vinaya, and the Abhidharma, that monk, upon hearing the discourse on hells, vividly experienced the sensation of hell, and blood poured from every single pore of his body; his robes became stained with it, and a foul odor arose. At that time the monks informed the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, it is permitted — monks should wear a cloth wrap around the body." When the Blessed One had declared that monks should wear a cloth body-wrap, those monks wore it on the outside of their robes, and the same fault arose again, whereupon the Blessed One declared: "It should be worn on the inside." When, by wearing it on the inside alone, they chafed and wounds appeared, the Blessed One declared: "One must not drag it against the bare skin alone; rather, having rinsed it with warm water, one should gently wash and cleanse it." The cloth body-wrap should also be washed from time to time to remove the pus and blood, and it should furthermore be dyed with coloring.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was residing in Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove, the abode of the kalandaka birds. The Venerable Pilindavatsa (Skt. Pilindavatsa), from the time he went forth and onward, was always ill. Those who were living the holy life (Skt. brahmacarya) alongside him came to him and asked —

"Venerable one, are you well? Is your countenance pleasant?" "I am ill and not well."

They asked him: "Venerable one, what did you use before to make fire?" "Friends, an iron fire-pan with a long handle." "Venerable one, if that was so, why do you not use one now?" "Friends, the Blessed One has not permitted it."

At that time the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore I permit it: a monk may keep an iron fire-pan with a long handle."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. When monks were paying homage at a stūpa, mud and mire clung to their feet. The Blessed One declared: "Scrape it off." They did not know from what to scrape it, so the Blessed One declared: "Use a wooden scraper, and then apply powdered wood-ash and smear it with stone-ash." The courtyard around the stūpa became large and insufficient, so the Blessed One declared: "Scrape within a fathom of the enclosing fence." Still it was not enough, so the Blessed One declared: "If it is not sufficient, scrape as far as the flat paving-stones." That too was not enough, so the

Blessed One declared: "Place wooden scrapers at intervals." When mud and mire collected in the corridors of the monks who were dwelling at the gateways, the Blessed One declared: "There too, proceed in the same sequence."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. There was a householder in Śrāvastī who had arranged for a garden hut to be built, and one monk was staying there. When the cold season arrived, he was afflicted by the cold and became pale and thin, his body wasted away to a pitiful state. He went to that householder and said: "Householder, please be informed — I will go elsewhere." The householder said: "Noble one, have you not a little time to spare?" He replied: "I have not the slightest trouble to spare, yet I am oppressed by the cold." The householder said: "Noble one, please stay. I will give you a fire-crystal." He replied: "Householder, the Blessed One has not permitted it." The householder said: "Noble one, the Blessed One is compassionate — he will grant it."

At that time the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore I permit it: a monk may keep a fire-crystal and use it to kindle fire and perform fire-related tasks."

That householder gave the fire-crystal to the monk, who used it to kindle fire and perform fire-related tasks. Now it happened that five hundred bandits were going to work in a rocky crag, and they went in that direction. They said to that monk: "Noble one, afflicted by the cold as we are, is there fire here?" He replied: "Friends, there is none." "Noble one, how do you perform your fire-related tasks?" "Friends, I kindle fire with a fire-crystal and perform fire-related tasks." "Noble one, where is that crystal?" "Friends, it is right here in this direction." They looked at it, then went to the rocky crag, carried out their work, and returned, saying: "Friends, let us go and take that crystal from the noble one." They went to him and said: "That fire-crystal — friends, it is right here in this very place." They took it and left.

Again the monk was afflicted by the cold and went to that householder, saying: "Householder, please be informed — I will go elsewhere." He said: "Noble one, have you not a little time to spare?" He replied: "Householder, I have not the slightest trouble to spare, yet I am oppressed by the cold." He said:

"Noble one, did I not give you a fire-crystal? Householder, you did give it. But those thieves took it. A gem of that quality, fit for a great one — and you hand

it over to thieves like that. Ah, but you did leave it in an isolated spot."

At that time the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Gems of that kind should not be shown to those who take what is not given. However, they may be entrusted to a fire-tender. A water-crystal is just like a fire-crystal in this regard."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the park belonging to Prince Jeta. The group of six monks were sending their robes to a laundryman to be washed. Then at some point a festival took place at Śrāvastī, and the brahmins and householders of Śrāvastī sent their brightly colored garments to the laundryman to be washed. The venerable Ānanda, toward sunset, took one saffron robe and went to the laundryman's place, saying: "Good man, please wash this robe." The laundryman replied: "Noble one, today I have a great many lay garments to see to — please leave and come back tomorrow; I will wash it then." Ānanda grew angry and began to threaten him. The laundryman said: "Noble one, what cause is there to threaten? If you cannot wait, leave it and go — I will wash it in the morning." Ānanda left the robe and departed. Then, distracted by the commotion of Ānanda's outburst, the laundryman bundled that robe into a bundle of garments and placed it among the brightly colored clothes. After some days had passed, the brightly colored garments had dyed it all mottled. The laundryman slapped his hand against his cheek and sat there, inwardly distressed. The crowd of people became displeased.

At that time the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One, knowing that this had fallen upon the brahmins and householders and caused them to lose faith, declared to the monks: "The saffron robe that the monk Ānanda sent to the laundryman to be washed has been made mottled by the brightly colored garments. Therefore, monks must not send their saffron robes to a laundryman to be washed. If a monk sends his saffron robes to a laundryman, it will become an offense."

The Blessed One declared: "Monks must not send their saffron robes to a laundryman to be washed." Whereupon the group of six monks began sending white garments instead. The laundryman carelessly beat them on a washing board and washed them, with the result that some garments tore and some frayed at the edges. At that time the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, therefore monks must not under any circumstances send garments to a laundryman."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the park belonging to Prince Jeta.

The Blessed One having declared that monks must in all cases not send garments to a laundryman, the group of six monks went to the laundryman's washing place, wrapped their heads in their robes, and crouching down muttering to themselves in the manner of laundrymen while washing their own garments — this was seen by brahmins and householders, who became displeased.

At that time the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, monks must not go to a laundryman's washing place and, crouching and muttering to themselves in the manner of laundrymen, wash their own garments. A monk who goes to a laundryman's washing place

and, crouching and muttering to themselves in the manner of laundrymen, washes his own garments, is guilty of an offence.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, belonging to Prince Jeta. When the Blessed One had declared that monks must not go to a laundryman's washing place and wash their own garments in the manner of laundrymen, crouching and muttering to themselves, the group of six monks began washing their garments on flat wooden boards, and that same fault arose again. The Blessed One then declared: "Monks must not wash garments on flat wooden boards. However, they may wash their own garments by gently agitating them back and forth in a basin with a little soft water." When the Blessed One had declared that they should wash garments by gently agitating them back and forth in a basin, certain other monks were unable to wash with both hands, and the Blessed One declared: "Those who are unable to wash with both hands may wash with both feet." When certain others were unable to wash with either both hands or both feet, the Blessed One declared: "For those, let others be permitted to wash on their behalf."

A summary verse:

A mat of straw, and a snake's slough,
a chisel, contrition itself,
a basin for dye and a dye vat wall,
and four kinds of dye-paste — these are the topics.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, belonging to Prince Jeta. When monks had bathed and then put on their Dharma robes while their bodies were still wet, those robes became mottled and developed an unpleasant odor. At that time the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, it is permitted for monks to use a body-drying cloth." When the Blessed One had declared that they may use a body-drying cloth, certain other monks did not have one, and the Blessed One declared: "Those who do not have one should for the time being sit squatting, dry their bodies with a bathing cloth, and then put on their Dharma robes." When monks' sandals became dusty, the monks beat them clean, but when they beat them the sandals split and the fastening threads broke. The Blessed One declared: "Monks must not beat their sandals." When the monks washed them with water, that too proved unsatisfactory, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks must not wash sandals with water; rather, they should wipe them with a water-dampened cloth and polish them. Therefore it is permitted to use a sandal-polishing cloth."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was residing in the land of Campā on the bank of the pond of the sage Gagā. In the land of Campā there was a nāga-girl (nāga daughter) named Campā who was faithful and of good, virtuous intention, and her son was a faithless, undisciplined young man. She caused him to listen properly to the Dharma, saying: "Son, go to the presence of the noble ones and listen to the Dharma — it will become a source of merit for you." He was accordingly brought to listen and entered among those who had sat down in their natural manner of dress to hear the Dharma. A certain young man saw him and was alarmed, and called out, "Venerable ones, behind you — behind you!" Hearing this, those monks who had not been freed from attachment were alarmed, and those men seized the nāga's son by the neck, tied him with a rope attached to his tail, and hurled him from the top of the assembly hall. His mother saw this and said: "Son, did you hear the Dharma from the noble ones?" He replied: "Mother, may no one ever become a noble one of that sort! What did they do to you?" He then recounted what had happened to him.

She said to him: "Son, those very ones are noble ones. Had others caught sight of you, you would have been killed." At that he said nothing more.

At that, the young nāga men burst into laughter and began to taunt him, calling out again and again, "Sore throat! Sore throat!" And because they all

called out this mockery at him, his body became pale and thin, his flesh wasted away wretchedly, and his neck shriveled and dried up.

Then his mother said to him: "Son, why has your body become so pale and thin, your flesh wasted away wretchedly, your neck shriveled and dried up?" He replied: "Mother, these young nāga men keep taunting me and crying out, 'Sore throat! Sore throat!' — there is no escape from it, no help for it."

"Son, you went in your own natural form, and so this situation has come about. Had you gone in an emanated form, they would not even have been able to attach a rope to your tail. Now go in an emanated form and listen to the Dharma, and all will go well for you. However, if you listen in your own form, simply remain where you are and listen from there."

But he, lacking faith, did not agree to this, and said nothing further to his mother.

Then he thought to himself: "The noble ones tying a rope to a young nāga's tail will also obstruct those who wish to hear the Dharma. This, then, is what I must do." And so, before dawn broke, he went to where the Blessed One was, and arriving there, he bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and sat down to one side.

At that moment, by the power of the complexion of the young nāga daughter of the nāga Campā, the entire bank of the sage Gārgā's pond was suffused with a great radiance.

Sitting to one side, the young nāga daughter of the nāga Campā addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Venerable One, I have a son who is without faith. I granted him permission to properly receive the hearing of the Dharma, and he went to hear the Dharma from the noble ones. The noble ones attached a rope to his tail, threw him out, and his throat was injured. Then the young nāga men taunted him over and over, crying, 'Sore throat! Sore throat!' When he was thus tormented in that way, his body became pale and thin, his flesh wasted away wretchedly, his neck shriveled and dried up. O Blessed One, please think with compassion: may you issue just a small admonishment to remind the noble ones not to tie ropes to young nāgas' tails."

The Blessed One, by remaining silent, gave his consent to the nāga daughter of Campā. Then the nāga daughter of Campā bowed her head at the feet of the Blessed One and vanished from that very spot.

Then the Blessed One, when that same night had passed, sat down upon the seat that had been spread for him in the midst of the Saṅgha of monks. Having sat down, the Blessed One addressed the monks: "Monks, last night the nāga daughter of the nāga Campā came to where I was, and arriving there she bowed her head at my feet and sat down to one side. At that moment, by the power of the complexion of the young nāga daughter of Campā, the entire bank of the sage Gārgā's pond was suffused with a great radiance.

"Sitting to one side, the nāga daughter of Campā addressed me with these words: 'Venerable One, I have a son who is without faith. I granted him proper permission to receive the hearing of the Dharma, and he went to hear the Dharma in the presence of the noble ones. They attached a rope to his tail and threw him out; his throat was injured. Then the young nāga men taunted him, crying out, "Sore throat! Sore throat!" When he was thus taunted, his body became pale and thin, his flesh wasted away wretchedly —'"

"Alas, when his throat had become sore and thin — O Blessed One, please, out of compassion, give some instruction to remind the noble ones so that the noble ones will no longer attach a rope to a young nāga's tail." Thus she spoke.

Therefore, monks, since it is neither seemly nor fitting that the gods themselves should now taunt the ascetics who are sons of the Śākyas, saying, "Alas, the renunciants who are sons of the Śākyans have utterly deteriorated from their virtuous qualities" — therefore a monk must not attach a rope to a young nāga's tail. However, if a young nāga is seen, one should make a snapping sound and say: "Good sir, do not remain on the path where you may be seen." If he is not on the visible path, then well and good. But if he is there, one should gently take a dry stick, insert it into a pot or clay vessel, make a hole in it, close off the opening, and pull the nāga out with it. If no dry stick is available, one may use a reed, an iron tong, or a pair of tongs tied around the neck to pull him out. If no reed, iron tong, or pair of tongs is available, one should wrap cloth around the loop of a cotton rope or hemp rope, use that to catch him, then place him in a pot and remove him.

The monks did accordingly, removed him, and threw him into the forest. But he, enraged, burned down the forest with fire, and in that same place he too was burned up. Then the Blessed One declared: "One must not throw them into the forest." The monks threw him into an open area, and without a moment's pause an animal carried him off. Then the Blessed One declared: "One must not turn it away immediately from that very spot; rather, having

placed it in an open area, one should remain there until it has entered its proper abode."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling in Rājagṛha, in the Kalandaka Bamboo Grove. In Rājagṛha there lived a householder who was skilled in the working of stone. He would fashion stone chips and sell them. At another time, he had accumulated much gain, and he thought: "What is the means by which I might both accrue merit and at the same time come to accumulate much gain?" Since he was a man of faith, he thought: "I shall invite a monastic Saṅgha of monks with the Buddha at their head to my home, and offer them a meal prepared from the earnings from my stone chips — thereby I shall accrue merit, and my gain shall also increase." The passage from there up to "he went to where the Blessed One was" and onward to "he remained seated in the middle of the monastic Saṅgha of monks, where seats had been laid out" — all this is as before.

Then, having discerned that the Buddha and the monastic Saṅgha of monks were sitting comfortably, the householder served them personally with his own hands, providing clean and pure food and provisions, satisfying them fully and abundantly — in many ways he served them personally with his own hands, providing clean and pure food and provisions, satisfying them fully and abundantly. Having served them thus, perceiving that the Blessed One had finished eating and had drawn back his hand from the bowl, he took a low seat and sat before the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One expressed his rejoicing in that act of giving with these words of rejoicing:

Among offerings, the fire sacrifice is supreme.

Among metrical compositions, the Sāvittī verse is supreme.

Among humans, the king is supreme.

Among rivers, the ocean is supreme.

Among stars, the moon is supreme.

Among luminaries, the sun is supreme.

Above, below, and in all directions —

Of all the destinies of beings there are,

In the world together with its gods,

The perfect buddha is the supreme worthy of honor.

Up to this point, and then after he had caused him to rejoice thoroughly, he rose from his seat and departed — all this is as before.

He then invited the buddha and the rest — the monastic Saṅgha — to his home, and after he had served them there, he began to scatter gravel and sand in order of seniority as they walked about. The monks felt remorse and would not accept it. The Blessed One declared: "It has been completely purified by a layman — with that understanding, you should receive it; there is no cause for remorse in this."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the prince Jeta's grove.

The Blessed One declared that dyeing work should be done. When the monks boiled the dye, it was curdled because it contained whey, and when cooked it turned foul and became unsuitable. The Blessed One then declared: "Dry it first and then boil it."

The monks dried it in the sun, but it shrank and became too small. The Blessed One declared: "Do not dry it in the sun."

The monks then dried it in the shade, but the wind carried it away. The Blessed One declared: "Do not dry it in the shade; rather, dry it where there is partial sunlight."

The monks put the dye and the robes together in the same water and boiled them, and the robes became ruined. The Blessed One declared: "Boil the dye separately."

The monks boiled it once only and then discarded it. The Blessed One declared: "Boil it up to three times before discarding it."

When the monks boiled it up to three times, they kept everything in a single vessel. The Blessed One declared: "Keep them in separate vessels."

The monks did not know which was the first, which was the second, and which was the third. The Blessed One declared: "Write on them: 'This is the first, this is the second, this is the third.'"

The monks put the robes directly into the dye itself. The Blessed One declared: "Do not put the robes directly into the dye; instead, pour the dye into a basin and rub the robes in it."

A monk rubbed a robe in dye that was far too wet, and it washed out. The Blessed One declared: "Do not rub them when they are far too wet."

The monks rubbed the robes when they were far too dry, and the robes became mottled. The Blessed One declared: "Do not rub them when they are

far too dry; rather, rub them when they are of just the right moisture."

The monks dried the robes on the ground, and the robes became soiled with dust. The Blessed One declared: "Do not dry them on the ground."

The monks laid down grass and dried them on that, but the dye ran to one side. The Blessed One declared: "Hang them on a drying line and dry them there."

When the monks laid the robes on the line in that way, the dye did not set evenly in the middle. The Blessed One declared: "Tie cords at the corners, spread them on poles, prop them up, and dry them thus."

When the monks rubbed the robes, they did not turn them over, and the dye ran to one side and was absorbed unevenly. The Blessed One declared: "Turn them over again and again."

Some other patched robes were very large and would not fit on the drying line. The Blessed One declared: "Lay down grass and dry them on it, turning them over again and again."

The monks applied fresh dye to old robes and old dye to fresh robes. The Blessed One declared: "Apply fresh dye only to fresh robes, and old dye only to old robes."

The monks dried the new robes in the shade and the old robes in the sun. The Blessed One declared: "Dry the new ones in the sun and the old ones in the shade."

The monks applied the first dye first, then the second beneath it, and then the first dye again on top — resulting in the first dye being in excess. The Blessed One declared: "Apply the first and second dyes first, and only afterward apply the third."

The monks did not soak the robes in water, and the robes became mottled. The Blessed One declared: "They are to be soaked in water."

The monks soaked them in water on that very same day, and the Blessed One declared: "Soak them the following day."

While some other monks were doing dyeing work, wind and rain arose, and the monks, not knowing where to dry the robes, piled them on top of one another. The Blessed One declared: "When wind and rain arise, do the dyeing work inside a hall."

When the Blessed One had declared that the dyeing work should be done inside a hall when wind and rain arise, the monks did the dyeing inside the hall. The hall walls became heavily stained and streaked with dye, and some brahmins and householders who saw this said: "Noble ones, where does all this blood come from?" The monks replied: "This is not blood — we were doing dyework here." Those people said: "We thought it was blood." Thereupon the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Plaster that area with cow dung or mud."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At the time when the householder Anāthapiṇḍada had offered the Jeta Grove to the community of monks headed by the Buddha, the thought arose in him: "Since I offered the Jeta Grove to the community of monks headed by the Buddha, the walls there are unadorned with paintings, and it would be good to ask the Blessed One's permission and paint them." With that in mind, he went to where the Blessed One was, arrived there, paid homage at the Blessed One's feet by bowing his head, and sat down to one side. Having sat to one side, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada spoke thus to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, the walls here have no paintings on them. Therefore, if the Blessed One would permit it, I would now wish to have the walls painted." The Blessed One declared: "Householder, you have permission — have it done."

When the Blessed One had declared that the walls should be painted, the monks did not know how to make multicolored paintings, and so they asked the Blessed One. The Blessed One had given permission to the householder Anāthapiṇḍada and declared that the walls should be painted — "With which of many colors should we paint?" The Blessed One declared: "Monk, it is excellent, excellent that you asked what the householder Anāthapiṇḍada did not know to ask. Paint using all four colors: every shade of blue, every shade of yellow, every shade of red, and every shade of white."

This is the Vinaya, the Minor Matters, the seventeenth fascicle. In summary:

The utensils of those who do plastering work,
Stools with holes,
The receiving of washcloths and hair,
Rosaries, needles, and combs.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. In Śrāvastī there lived a certain householder at whose

home an almsman came regularly from time to time, and that man went for refuge and was established in the training precepts. On another occasion, praises were recited to him regarding the seven objects that generate merit through material things, and he said:

The noble one said, "I shall perform whichever of the seven meritorious works produced from material things I am able to." The almsman said, "Householder, very good — do exactly so." The noble one said, "What shall I do?" The almsman said, "Householder, build a monastery for the Saṅgha." The noble one said, "I have kārṣāpaṇas, but I have no one to assist me in the Dharma work." The almsman said, "Householder, give the kārṣāpaṇas, and I shall be your partner in the Dharma work." The noble one said, "Very good," and gave him the kārṣāpaṇas one by one.

The almsman thought to himself, "This money belongs to the monks of the four quarters who practice the holy life, so how can I use it? I shall set it aside for now and ask others to take it up." And so he deposited the kārṣāpaṇas in a strongbox and kept them there.

Some time later, the householder thought, "The noble one is building my monastery; let me go there and see what is being done." He went, and when he arrived he could see nothing at all being done. He said, "Noble one, has not even a little of my monastery been built?" The almsman said, "If there is not even the procurement of building materials for the monastery to begin with, what is to be done?" The noble one said, "Alas! Where are the kārṣāpaṇas?" The almsman said, "They are in the strongbox." The noble one said, "Please use those very funds to procure the building materials." The almsman said, "Householder, how can I use money belonging to the monks of the four quarters for procuring building materials?" The noble one said, "But this monastery too is being built solely for the monks of the four quarters — what contradiction can there be? Let us ask the Blessed One." The almsman said, "Noble one, please do so."

The householder then reported the matter to the monks, and the monks presented it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared, "Let the building materials be procured from those very funds, and let there be no regret about this."

While that almsman was building the monastery and also going on his alms round, the householder said, "Noble one, since you are building the monastery and still going on your alms round, why not take your alms from these very

funds, and I shall give you additional kārṣāpaṇas as well." The almsman said, "Householder, how can I take alms from building-fund money?" The noble one said, "I give this with an easy and open mind — what contradiction is there in this?" The almsman said, "Let us ask the Blessed One." The noble one said, "Please do so."

The householder reported the matter to the monks, and the monks presented it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared, "One who is engaged in building work shall take his alms solely from the building fund."

When the Blessed One had declared that one engaged in building work should take his alms solely from the building fund, he began eating very bad food. The Blessed One declared, "You must not eat excessively bad food." He then began eating excessively refined food. The Blessed One declared, "You must not eat excessively refined food either; rather, you should use the fund only up to the level of an equivalent from another monastery."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. A certain monk suffered from diarrhea and had to go repeatedly to the latrine, which exhausted him greatly. At that time the monks presented the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared, "Make a stool with a hole." When the Blessed One had declared that a stool with a hole should be made, the monks without distinction bored holes in stools with knives. The Blessed One then declared, "Only in one that is fastened with a hidden joint or fastened with a cord shall a hole be bored from beneath. One that is fastened with a peg shall have a hole bored in it and then be bound." When he defecated, he suffered pain in the tailbone.

The Blessed One declared, "Place a leaf cushion on that side." When the defecation fell to the ground, the Blessed One declared, "Place a chamber pot underneath." When they set it too high, the Blessed One declared, "It shall not be set too high." The pot became foul-smelling, and the monks removed it and threw it away and set out another, but that one also became foul-smelling. They threw that one away too, and when they could not find another, the Blessed One declared, "Do not throw them all away. Keep two: wash one and dry it, and do the same with the other. But if it comes about that they cannot be found in pairs, place a woven-leaf mat over the top of it and defecate upon it, and then set out another of the same kind." When the Blessed One declared that the pot should be washed, they washed it, but it still became foul-smelling. The Blessed One then declared, "Anoint it with sesame oil." Yet

it still became foul-smelling, and the Blessed One declared, "Anoint it with mustard oil."

The Blessed One declared that the sick monk should be attended to, and upon hearing this, both senior monks and junior monks came to his side. The junior monks paid homage to him, and since the sick monk had to pay homage in return to the senior monks, he became distressed. The Blessed One then declared: "One who is ill shall not pay homage. One who is ill shall not receive homage. One who is ill shall not claim homage as something due to oneself. From one who is ill, homage shall not be appropriated as something due to oneself. If one who is ill pays homage, or receives homage, or claims homage as something due to oneself, or appropriates homage from an ill person as something due to oneself, one incurs an offense."

The venerable attendant then addressed the Blessed Buddha: "Blessed One, you have declared that one who is ill shall not pay homage, shall not receive homage, shall not appropriate homage, and shall not have homage appropriated from one who is ill. Reverend Sir, how many kinds of illness are there?" The attendant replied: "There are two kinds of illness — illness from food, and illness from impurity. Illness from food is distress caused by eating tooth-cleaning sticks, food, drink, fruit, roots, and the like. Illness from impurity is the attending to excrement and urine, and the cleaning of unclean places in order to wash them."

The Blessed Buddha was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, at the prince's park.

The venerable attendant then addressed the Blessed Buddha: "Reverend Sir, the brahmin Padmahṛdaya has made this request to the Blessed One: whenever you, Gautama, see me mounting a carriage, taking the reins, raising a whip, or speaking in a loud voice, please acknowledge my homage at that moment; and whenever you see me standing in a doorway, removing my shoes, or stepping aside from the path, or stretching out my hand, please acknowledge my homage at that moment; and whenever I come from within a gathering, rise from my seat, or am struck by the topknot or by an umbrella, please acknowledge my homage at that moment — this is what he has requested. Reverend Sir, is such a manner of paying homage reckoned in the noble Dharma-Vinaya?" The attendant replied: "The attendant did not perform a physical homage. What the attendant did was merely a word of reverent speech, while the bodily bow and the verbal utterance — that constitutes an

offering. However, in the noble Dharma-Vinaya there are two forms of homage: the five-limbed prostration, and the embrace at the hands."

The case is at Śrāvastī. The monks, the very same ones who, while wearing their Dharma-robles, were having their hair and beards shaved, wore those same robes while eating their meals, wore those same robes while paying homage to the Teacher,

provoked the scorn of those without faith, who said: "The monks, the disciples of the Śākyan, are without cleanliness. The very same robes they wear while having their hair and beards shaved, those same robes they wear while eating their meals, and those same robes they wear while paying homage to the Teacher." On that occasion the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One must not wear the Dharma-robles while having one's hair and beard shaved. Rather, one should hold a hair-catching cloth, and having spread it out, shave the hair." When the Blessed One had declared that a hair-catching cloth should be held, some monks had none to hand. The Blessed One then declared: "Those who have none shall wrap the body in a sweat-cloth and then shave the hair." After the monks had shaved their hair and beards and then went about as before, brahmin householders (brāhmaṇas and gṛhapatis) mocked them, saying: "The ascetics who are disciples of the Śākyan are without cleanliness, for after the work of the razor they do not bathe." On that occasion the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "After the work of the razor, one shall bathe." Some other monks were old, decrepit, and weak. Others were ill and could not endure the preparation for bathing. Others had no water available. The Blessed One declared: "Those monks shall wash just the five limbs."

The Blessed One, the fully awakened buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in Prince Jeta's grove. Faithful brahmin householders offered garlands of flowers to the monks, but the monks did not accept them. The brahmin householders then said: "Noble ones, at the very time one speaks of the Blessed One, the fully awakened buddha — do we not come from this world to the next with the stock of virtue exhausted? Please accept them" — and so on, as before. On that occasion the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "It is therefore permitted to accept garlands of flowers." The monks accepted them and then threw them down right in front of those same donors. The donors mocked them, saying: "Noble ones — these we purchased at great price, so why have you accepted and then discarded them?" The Blessed One declared:

"They must not be discarded." The monks placed them on stūpas enshrining the hair and nails of the Tathāgata, and the donors said: "Do the noble ones not see that we have stūpas enshrining the hair and nails of the Tathāgata? We have given these to you, yet you have first offered them at the stūpas enshrining the Tathāgata's hair and nails — that is precisely right." The monks accepted the garlands and placed them at the doorway of the dwelling. Faithful brahmin householders, seeing them, thought it was a toilet and paid homage accordingly. The Blessed One declared: "They must not be placed at the doorway of the dwelling; they shall be placed inside." The monks placed them directly opposite the door, and this produced the very same fault. The Blessed One declared: "All fragrant things, since they are beneficial to the eyes, shall be placed in a secluded corner and preserved." When the Blessed One had declared that they were to be placed in a secluded spot and preserved, the monks did not know how to store them properly. The Blessed One declared: "On the inner side, a pin or thorn shall be driven in, and they shall be hung upon it."

The summary verse:

A fine seat and a backrest,
an anointing vessel, a bowl with a hole,
three containers for grain and oil,
a rope for wringing, and a well.

The Blessed One, the fully awakened buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in Prince Jeta's grove.

Then the Blessed One declared to the monks: "When the Saṅgha has the means, fine seats may be given to it, but they shall not be given to individual persons. When the Saṅgha has the means, backrests may be given to it, but they shall not be given to individual persons."

The Blessed One, the fully awakened buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in Prince Jeta's grove.

Faithful brahmins and householders offered perfume to the monks, but the monks did not accept it, whereupon those donors said: "Noble ones, when the Blessed One, the fully awakened buddha, has not appeared in the world" — and so on as before, up to the point where the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, it is permitted. Perfume may be accepted." The monks accepted it, and then threw it down right in front of those very donors. The donors then reproached them, saying: "Noble ones, we purchased this at great price, and

you accepted it only to throw it away!" When the matter was reported to the Blessed One by the monks, the Blessed One declared: "They shall not throw it away."

The donors then offered perfume to a stūpa containing the hair and nails of the Tathāgata, and said to the monks: "Noble ones, do you not see the stūpa of the hair and nails of the Tathāgata? We are offering this to you, but we already made our first offering to the stūpa of the Tathāgata's hair and nails." The monks accepted it and placed it at the door of the residence hall. Faithful brahmins and householders, seeing it there, thought it was a fragrant bathing room and brushed their feet against it. The Blessed One declared: "It shall not be placed at the door of the residence hall; rather, it shall be kept inside."

The monks then placed it directly opposite the door, and the same fault arose again. The Blessed One declared: "It shall not be placed directly opposite the door. However, since all fine fragrances are beneficial to the eyes, one should draw a line of fragrance with the perfume alongside the window recess, and it should be carried about from time to time."

Other faithful donors invited monks to their homes, offered them a feast, and had lines of perfume drawn on the monks' feet. The monks did not accept this, and those donors said: "Noble ones, those who are devoted to brahmins offer them garlands and perfume first, and the brahmins accept and apply them to their heads and bodies. We, having devotion to you, offer this to your feet — what contradiction could there be? Please accept." When the matter was reported to the Blessed One by the monks, the Blessed One declared: "Offerings made to the feet are to be accepted as one's own."

The monks accepted the perfume and then threw it down right in front of those very donors. The donors exclaimed: "Alas, noble ones! Please go to the monastery and make yourselves comfortable. Though faith arose in us in the way it did, now the opposite of faith has arisen too." When the matter was reported to the Blessed One by the monks, the Blessed One declared: "They shall not throw it down in front of those very donors."

The Blessed One, the fully awakened buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in Prince Jeta's grove.

The monks were placing their bowls down carelessly, so that the bowls were being damaged. When the matter was reported to the Blessed One by the monks, the Blessed One declared: "Bowls shall not be set down carelessly. Rather, a bowl-niche shall be made in the wall, and bowls shall be placed

there."

The monks then dug into the wall. The Blessed One declared: "One shall not dig into the wall. However, at the time when the wall of a monastery building is being constructed, a bowl-niche shall be built into it at that time. Likewise, this shall be done in the case of the surrounding residential quarters as well."

The Blessed One had declared that bowls are to be placed in the bowl-niche. When the monks who were dwelling in remote monasteries had no bowl-niche, the Blessed One declared: "Let them make a peg of wood or twisted cord, smear it with cow dung or clay, and place the bowl upon it." When dust carried onto the bowl became a problem, the Blessed One declared: "A cover matching it in size shall be made for it." When monks placed their bowls on the ground, the Blessed One declared: "One shall not place a bowl on the ground. Rather, it shall be set leaning against a rope or a tree branch."

When the monks went wandering through the countryside, they carried their bowls and went out. Some faithless people mocked the noble ones, saying: "Look — are these home-builders, or monkeys carrying things off?" When the matter was reported to the Blessed One by the monks, the Blessed One declared: "Whenever one goes anywhere, one shall not carry the bowl-stand along. Rather, wherever one goes, a separate one shall be left there."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. A certain monk was wandering through the countryside and came to a rocky cliff. He took lodging in a certain house, washed his feet, and began to rub them with sesame oil. Just then a woman arrived carrying sesame oil, and the monk stretched out his hand. She said: "A noble one who begs yet has no vessel — how can that be? Oh, would you please fill your sesame-oil container for yourself?" He replied: "Sister, the Blessed One has not permitted it." She said nothing more to this and departed. When the matter was then reported to the Blessed One by the monks, the Blessed One declared: "In that case, permission is granted: one may fill a sesame-oil container."

After the Blessed One had declared that a sesame-oil container may be filled, the venerable Nandaka's two novices took a sesame-oil cask and went out to collect sesame oil on alms round. A woman came carrying sesame oil, and when she saw the two novices holding the sesame-oil cask, she struck her chest and said: "Noble ones, who is it that will fill this for you?" They replied: "Poor woman, first set down whatever you yourself have given. The remainder

— look — the faithful brahmins and householders will fill it." She said nothing more and left. When the matter was then reported to the Blessed One by the monks, the Blessed One declared: "Monks shall not fill a sesame-oil container that is excessively large."

After the Blessed One had declared that monks shall not fill an excessively large sesame-oil container, the monks filled one that was excessively small, and this proved insufficient for what was needed. The Blessed One then declared: "One shall not use an excessively small one either. Rather, sesame-oil containers are of three kinds: large, medium, and small. The large holds a full pha (a standard measure); the small holds half a pha; and the medium is what falls between these two."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. An elder monk and a younger monk set out together on the road. As they walked along they were exchanging words that were not wholesome. A faithless yakṣa overheard them and thought: "These two śramaṇas (Skt. śramaṇa), sons of the Śākyas, go about exchanging unwholesome words — I shall dim their radiance." And so the yakṣa followed along behind the two of them. Then the yakṣa thought again: "What is past is past. But if they now speak further unwholesome words, I will certainly dim their radiance."

While the faithless yakṣa was thus thinking and following along behind the two monks, another yakṣa who had faith arrived in that direction and asked the first, "Friend, where are you going?" The faithless yakṣa told him what had happened. The faithful yakṣa said: "Friend, these monks are men of ascetic practice. They go along speaking Dharma talk without interruption. What have the monks done to you? Leave it alone. Let us walk along exchanging words of genuine mutual delight." The faithless yakṣa replied: "Friend, I will certainly not let these two go — come, let us follow them." The faithful yakṣa, knowing it was time to restrain him, followed along together behind the two monks.

Now, as the two monks continued on their way speaking nothing but unwholesome words, they came to a fork in the road. One of the monks went toward the Jeta Grove, and the other went toward the mansion of Mṛgāramātā. The younger monk bowed his head at the feet of the elder and said: "Venerable one, I am going to the mansion of Mṛgāramātā. Please be heedful, and may you go in good health." With that he departed.

Then the faithless yakṣa raised up his hair on end and made to dim the elder monk's radiance. But the faithful yakṣa said: "Friend, do not be so rash. The two of them spoke Dharma. When one said, 'May you be in good health,' health is the supreme gain; and when one said, 'Be heedful,' heedfulness is the root of all virtuous qualities. Indeed, the Blessed One himself declared:

Heedfulness is the ground of the deathless;
heedlessness is the ground of death.

The heedful do not die;
the heedless are as if perpetually dead.

So said he, and with this the faithful yakṣa turned the other back.

The faithful yakṣa then thought: "This is exactly what I should do," and went to where the Blessed One was. He arrived, bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, and sat down to one side. Seated there, the yakṣa addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Venerable Blessed One, there ever dwells here a yakṣa who has no faith in the Blessed One's teaching — a vile being, a fierce yakṣa. Venerable One, those who do have faith are very few. Venerable Blessed One, the fierce yakṣa who lacks faith in the Blessed One's teaching and ever dwells here are very many. Venerable One, these noble ones go along speaking unwholesome words, and others follow in their wake. Alas, Blessed One, out of compassion please offer some counsel by which the noble ones would not go along speaking unwholesome words with others following in their wake, and by which the noble ones would be mindful."

The Blessed One said nothing to the yakṣa and remained silent. Then the yakṣa, understanding from the Blessed One's silence that he had given his assent, bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and departed from the Blessed One's presence.

Not long after the yakṣa had gone, the Blessed One, knowing this, had a seat arranged in the midst of the assembly of monks and took his seat. Seated there, the Blessed One addressed the monks: "Monks, I have heard from a yakṣa that when monks go along the road speaking unwholesome words, faithless yakṣas seek an opportunity and watch for a weak point."

"Monks, those who have gone forth into the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya — for them to speak unwholesome words is neither seemly nor fitting. Therefore I shall establish rules of conduct for monks when they set out on the road. A monk who sets out on the road shall travel in one of two ways: either speaking on the Dharma, or observing the noble silence. At a place of rest, he shall

recite a sacred verse. At a river crossing, he shall recite a verse addressed to the spirit of that river and its deity. At whatever place he takes lodging, he shall recite the third of the Anumodanā verses."

"If a monk who has set out on the road does not properly take up and practice the rules of conduct as established, he shall be guilty of an offence."

The Blessed One, the buddha Bhagavān, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time monks had taken up their robes — robes dyed in colour and completed — slung them over their shoulders, and set out on the road, but the robes became spoiled by dust and grime. The Blessed One then declared: "They should be rolled up and carried that way."

When the Blessed One had said "roll up the robes and carry them," the monks, not knowing how a robe-roll should be made, the Blessed One declared: "Take a length of cloth three cubits long and one and a half cubits wide, fold it in two, and stitch it together."

When the monks turned the ends outward, the roll became like an elephant's trunk. The Blessed One declared: "Do not turn the ends outward; turn them inward at the centre."

When they did not sew the edges and dust got in just the same, the Blessed One declared: "Make something like a net of thread, and then run another thread through it."

When some monks placed the robes they were wearing underneath and pulled the others to the top, and then, opening the roll again and again, they came undone, the Blessed One declared: "Place the robes that are being worn on top, and put the remaining ones underneath."

The Blessed One, the buddha Bhagavān, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time some bandits had waylaid some travellers, shooting at each other, while those who fled took refuge in their own villages. The bandits bound their prisoners tightly, and then, themselves without shelter and tormented by thirst, went searching for water from one place to the next until they found a well somewhere and went to it. The bandit chief said: "Friends, look here for a water-vessel and a rope." They looked, but there was no rope and no water-vessel. The chief said: "Friends, if any travellers come along, take their rope and water-vessel, climb a tree, and keep watch." They climbed a tree and began to look, and from

quite a distance they spotted some monks approaching. They said: "Chief, a number of Śākya-sons are coming." He said: "Friends, since they are wise, they will certainly have a carrying rope and a water-vessel." They said: "Chief, if they have them, so much the better; but if they do not, we will slit their bellies and drink their blood." Having made this plan, they waited.

The monks arrived. The bandits asked: "Venerable ones, we are thirsty — do you have a carrying rope and a water-vessel?" The monks replied: "Virtuous ones, we do not."

The bandits became enraged and reached for their weapons. Now, a senior monk (sthavira) in the Saṅgha who was an arhat began to reflect: "Why are these men enraged and reaching for their weapons?" He looked, and he saw that they wanted to kill the monks. He said to them: "Venerable ones, why have you become enraged?" They told him what had happened. He said: "Venerable ones, be at ease — there is a way. Sit down here and drink water." They sat down, and the monks knotted together their carrying rope, lower robes, and sashes, lowered the alms-bowl into the well on this line, drew up water, and gave it to them to drink. Once all the bandits had drunk their fill, they said: "Noble ones, if you had not given us water, we would have killed every one of you. How wonderful — please do keep a carrying rope with you." The monks replied: "Venerable ones, we will do so." The bandits bowed and departed.

The monks too drank as much water as they wished to be satisfied, filled their water-pots and pitchers, and set out, gradually making their way to Śrāvastī. The monks performed the customary welcome greeting of "Welcome, well-come," and then asked: "Venerable ones, did you travel comfortably?" The monks told them everything that had happened. At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, I permit it — monks may keep a carrying rope." When the Blessed One had said that monks may keep a carrying rope, the monks began keeping extremely long ones. The Blessed One declared: "One must not keep an extremely long one." They then kept extremely short ones. The Blessed One declared: "One must not keep an extremely short one either. Rather, three lengths of carrying rope are to be kept: long, medium, and short. The long is one hundred and fifty cubits; the short is one hundred cubits; and the medium falls between these two." The Blessed One having said that three lengths of carrying rope are to be kept, the monks kept them. Then, in another region where water was also scarce, monks set out carrying their ropes, and the

Blessed One declared: "Carrying ropes are to be kept adapted to the various localities."

The summary verse reads:

Razor-honing and nail-cutting,
medicinal thorns and thorn-wood sticks,
the application of ointment to different kinds of blisters,
and what has been thoroughly refined with fragrance.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. A monk's hair had grown very long. He went to a barber and said: "Good man, please cut my hair." The barber thought: "These Śākya monks are shameless — they have you do work without any payment. If I cut this one's hair and word gets out, others will come too." He kept putting him off for a long time, setting him aside, thinking that the monk himself would lose interest and go away. So the barber gave him an appointment, saying: "Noble one, come back tomorrow — morning or afternoon, whichever you prefer, or at midday." The monk was put off in this way and kept going back again and again. A monk who was a close friend of his saw him going back again and again and said: "Venerable one, why do you keep going there? Is that a relative's house or a family home?" He replied: "Venerable one, it is neither a relative's house

nor a family home — but my hair has grown very long, and I spoke to that barber as follows: 'Please trim my hair, which has grown so long, and it will accrue as merit for you.' Yet he kept putting me off with appointments and would not cut it." The friend said: "Venerable one, have you not heard it said that it is rare to find a craftsman who speaks the truth? Even though he is skilled at cutting hair, the Blessed One has not given permission for it." The monk then related this matter to the other monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "In that case, permission is given. A monk who is skilled in it may cut hair in a secluded place, and there should be no regret in this." The Blessed One having declared that a skilled monk may cut hair in a secluded place, monks went to that monk and said: "Venerable one, the Blessed One has given permission — please trim your hair." He replied: "Venerable ones, it is well that the Blessed One has given permission, but must one trim it with a finger? One also needs a razor, a whetstone, scissors, and tweezers." He said this to the monks at that time, the monks again reported to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "In

that case, permission is given — barber's implements may be kept for the sake of the Saṅgha."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Kapilavatthu in the Nyagrodha Grove, the pleasure park. When the Blessed One ordained members of the Śākya clan who were living at Kapilavatthu one by one, those who were ordained were by nature very young. They went to sleep exposed and uncovered without any bedding, and they slept that way. Sleeping thus uncovered, their constitutions became unbalanced and they grew feverish, so they went to a physician and said: "Good sir, our bodies have grown feverish — please prescribe a remedy." He said: "Noble ones, please come, and lie and sit as you normally do." They came, and when he saw how they were lying exposed and uncovered, he said: "Noble ones, because you are sleeping uncovered, your constitutions have become unbalanced and you have grown feverish. You should use bedding and sleep wrapped up." They replied: "The Blessed One has not given permission for that." He said: "Noble ones, your Teacher is compassionate — he will grant permission." The monks then reported this to the Blessed One at that time, and the Blessed One declared: "In that case, permission is given — one may insert bedding and sleep on it." They inserted bedding and slept on it, but still did not recover, so they again spoke to the physician. He said: "Noble ones, you should sleep with stuffed mattresses inside." They replied: "Good sir, the Blessed One has not given permission for that." He said: "Noble ones, your Teacher is compassionate — he will grant permission." The monks then reported this at length to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "In that case, permission is given — monks may keep stuffed mattresses." When the Blessed One had declared that monks may keep stuffed mattresses, the monks did not know what kind to make. The Blessed One declared: "That cloth should be made four cubits long and one cubit minus a span wide, and stitched; it should then be filled with tree-cotton and used as a mattress."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Rājagṛha in the Bamboo Grove, the Kalandaka park. The passage beginning with "Venerable Pilindavatsa had gone forth" and ending with "Elder, what did you keep?" is as before. He replied: "Venerable ones, I kept mud that had been asked for and given." The Elder asked: "But why did you not keep it now, Venerable one?" He replied: "The Blessed One has not given permission."

The monks then requested this of the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "A sick monk may keep mud that has been asked for and given."

There is no fault in this."

Here ends the third section of the bases in the minor Vinaya.

The summary verse is:

The elder who was helped, the sick, the inferior pig,
The drawing, the absent bowl,
The one who took up residence, and the wood that was grown.

The second summary verse is:

The elder's entreaty, another's turn,
The restoration ceremony with its interval,
The two kinds of drink,
And the temple at all times.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The Blessed One declared: "Every half-month, at the time of the restoration ceremony, the recitation should be performed." When the monks did not know who should perform the recitation, the Blessed One declared: "The elder of the Saṅgha should perform the recitation."

After the Blessed One had declared that the elder of the Saṅgha should perform the recitation, the elder of the Saṅgha took up performing the recitation at the time of the restoration ceremony every half-month. But on a certain occasion, an elder residing in another temple was unable to perform the recitation. The monks said to him: "Elder, the restoration ceremony is approaching — why do you not think of this?" He replied: "Venerable ones, what am I to do if I am unable?"

The monks then reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "If the elder of the Saṅgha is unable, the second elder should perform the recitation."

After the Blessed One had declared that the second elder should perform the recitation, there was on a certain occasion another temple where even the second elder was unable. The monks then reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "If even the second elder is unable, the third elder should perform the recitation."

After the Blessed One had declared that the third elder should perform the recitation, there was on a certain occasion another temple where even the third elder was unable. The monks then reported this to the Blessed One, and

the Blessed One declared: "If even the third elder is unable, the monks should take turns and perform the recitation."

After the Blessed One had declared that the monks should take turns and perform the recitation, the monks began to take turns performing the recitation. But among those taking turns in rotation, the turn fell on some who were capable and on some who were not. When it fell on a capable monk, he would perform the recitation of the Prātimokṣa sūtra every half-month on the appointed turn. When it fell on an incapable monk, he would say on his appointed turn, "I do not know it — what am I to do?" The monks then reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "He should delegate his turn to whichever monk is capable."

After the Blessed One had declared that the incapable monk, when his turn comes, should delegate to another, there was on a certain occasion another temple where the monk to whom the incapable one's turn had been delegated also declined. The monks then reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "He should delegate permanently to whichever other capable monk there is."

The Blessed One declared: "Every half-month, the elder of the Saṅgha should perform the recitation of the Prātimokṣa sūtra. If he is unavailable, the second elder should do so. If he too is unavailable, the third elder should do so."

If he too is unavailable, one should recite the text by turns as a choral recitation, or else delegate to whichever other capable monk there is. This was so declared.

Now in another temple there was no one at all who had memorized the Prātimokṣa sūtra in full. The elder of the Saṅgha recited the four rules entailing defeat, and the monks then performed the Poṣadha ceremony based on the remainder. The monks reported this to the Blessed One at that time, and the Blessed One declared: "One should not hold the Poṣadha in that way. Rather, whoever has memorized whatever section should recite that section. If the elder of the Saṅgha has memorized the four rules entailing defeat, he should recite those. Another should recite the thirteen rules requiring a formal meeting of the Saṅgha. Another should recite the two rules of indeterminate cases. Another should recite the thirty rules involving forfeiture. Another should recite the ninety rules of transgression. Another should recite the four rules requiring individual confession. Another should recite the rules of the many trainings. And another should recite the seven rules for settling disputes."

If the Poṣadha is joined together in this way, I shall not say that it constitutes an interruption of the Poṣadha." The occasion for this ruling was at Śrāvastī.

The venerable Upāli asked the Blessed One: "You have declared, Venerable One, what is permitted at the proper time, and you have also declared what is permitted at an improper time. What, Venerable One, is what is permitted at the proper time, and what is what is permitted at an improper time?" The Blessed One replied: "What has not yet been fermented is what is permitted at the proper time. What has been fermented and mixed with water is what is permitted at an improper time." The occasion for this ruling was at Śrāvastī.

The group of six monks, being of evil intent, occupied temple buildings improperly out of miserliness, claiming exclusive use for all seasons, claiming use by turns of residence, claiming use for alternating periods, or claiming prior use by having their footprints already there. As for how they claimed exclusive use for all seasons, it was by saying: "This is my winter temple. This is my spring temple. This is my summer temple." That is how they claimed it for all seasons. As for how they claimed use by turns of residence, it was by saying: "This is my temple for tomorrow. This is my temple for the day after. This is my temple for the day after that." That is how they claimed use by turns. As for how they claimed use for alternating periods, it was by saying: "I am staying here in the morning. I am staying here in the afternoon." That is how they claimed it for alternating periods. As for how they claimed prior use by footprints, it was by saying: "This is my teacher's temple, my preceptor's temple, the temple of one who resides with me, the temple of my attendant, the temple of one I converse with, the temple of one who visits me." That is how they claimed prior use by footprints.

The monks who dwelt in various localities arrived and found themselves without accommodation. The monks then reported this to the Blessed One at that time, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, one must not exclusively occupy the temple buildings of monks by claiming them for all seasons, by turns of residence, for alternating periods, or by having footprints there. If one does so, it becomes a serious offense."

Verse summary:

Enclosures and wooden fences,
roads and wells and Kārttika,
Dharma robes washed and dried,
the ritual portions and the brahmin.

The Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in Anāthapiṇḍada's pleasure garden. At the time when the householder Anāthapiṇḍada offered the Jeta Grove to the Saṅgha of monks from the four directions, people of the world went and came to the Jeta Grove with great joy and celebration, and the householder Anāthapiṇḍada thought to himself:

"My temple has become a great thoroughfare, and so, if the Blessed One would permit it, I shall enclose it with a fence." Having thought this, he went to where the Blessed One was, and upon arriving he touched his head to the feet of the Blessed One in homage, then sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Venerable One, this temple has become greatly exposed, and so, if the Blessed One would permit it, I would enclose it with a fence." The Blessed One declared: "Householder, in that case you are permitted to do so. Enclose it."

He enclosed it with a fence, and then, when the time of the rains retreat arrived, the Jeta Grove became completely flooded with water.

Now at the time when the householder Anāthapiṇḍada went to pay homage at the feet of the Blessed One, he saw that the Jeta Grove was entirely filled with water. He thought to himself: "I enclosed the Jeta Grove with a fence but did not install a drainage outlet, and that is why it has become filled with water like this. Therefore, if the Blessed One would permit it, I shall install a drainage outlet." He then addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Venerable One, I enclosed the Jeta Grove with a fence but did not install a drainage outlet, and so it became filled with water and I came to see this. Therefore, if the Blessed One would permit it, I would install a drainage outlet." The Blessed One declared: "Householder, in that case you are permitted to do so. Install it."

He installed the drainage outlet. Then cattle came and came again, rubbing their bodies against the wall and boring through it with their horns. At the time when the householder Anāthapiṇḍada saw this, he thought: "I enclosed the Jeta Grove with a fence but did not weave a wooden lattice, and that is why cattle come and rub their bodies against it and bore through it with their horns. Therefore, if the Blessed One would permit it, I shall weave a wooden lattice around it." He went to where the Blessed One was and, upon arriving, touched his head to the feet of the Blessed One in homage, then sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Venerable One, I enclosed the Jeta Grove with a fence but did not weave a wooden lattice, and cattle came and came again,

rubbing their bodies against it and boring through it with their horns. Therefore, if the Blessed One would permit it, I would weave a wooden lattice." The Blessed One declared: "Householder, in that case you are permitted to do so. Weave the wooden lattice."

He wove the wooden lattice, but then those who take what is not given broke apart the wooden lattice and stole the wood. On another occasion, as the householder Anāthapiṇḍada was walking along, he saw that the wooden lattice had been broken apart in various places and the wood stolen. He thought: "I enclosed the Jeta Grove with a fence and wove a wooden lattice, yet it has been broken apart in places and the wood stolen. Therefore, if the Blessed One would permit it, I shall surround it with a wall." Having thought this, he went to where the Blessed One was and, upon arriving, touched his head to the feet of the Blessed One in homage, then sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Venerable One, I enclosed the Jeta Grove with a fence and wove a wooden lattice, but because I did not surround it with a wall it was broken apart in places and the wood stolen. Therefore, if the Blessed One would permit it, I would surround it with a wall." The Blessed One declared:

"Householder, in that case I permit it. Surround it with a wall." And he surrounded it with a wall.

The occasion for the next rule took place at Śrāvastī. At Śrāvastī there was a nun named Kārtikā whose hair had grown very long. She went to the barber's shop and said, "Good man, please trim my hair. It will be a source of merit for you." The barber thought to himself: "The ascetics who are sons of the Śākyans are quite demanding, and these nuns likewise put people to work without any payment. If I trim this one's hair, others will keep coming as well. I'll put her off for a long time and she herself will lose interest and give up." So he set an appointment for the noble nun, telling her to come in the morning, or at midday, or in the afternoon. She was kept going back and forth by his excuses again and again. A nun who was a friend of hers saw her going back and forth repeatedly and asked her: "Noble one, why do you keep coming here again and again? Is this the house of a relative of yours, or of your family?" She replied: "Noble one, this is neither the house of a relative nor of my family. However, my hair has grown very long, and I went to the barber and said, 'Good man, please cut my very long hair; it will be a source of merit for you.' But he did not cut it and kept making appointments." The other nun said: "Noble one, have you not heard that craftsmen rarely speak truthfully? She

may be skilled at cutting hair, but the Blessed One has not granted permission for this." At that point she reported the matter to the nuns, the nuns reported it to the monks, and the monks informed the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Therefore, a nun who is skilled in this may cut hair in a secluded spot."

After the Blessed One had declared that a skilled nun may cut hair in a secluded spot, that same nun went to the nun Kārtikā and said: "Noble one, the Blessed One has given permission. Come here and have your hair trimmed." Kārtikā replied: "Noble one, if the Blessed One has given permission, that is excellent. But how is one to trim it with fingers alone? For this one needs a razor, a whetstone, scissors, and tweezers." She then reported this to the nuns, the nuns reported it to the monks, and the monks informed the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "In that case I permit it. The nuns are to keep a set of razor implements on behalf of the Saṅgha."

The Vinaya of Minor Matters, the Eighteenth Fascicle.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At the time when the Blessed One gave going forth to Ānanda, Bhadrā sent robes both stitched and fully stitched to Śrāvastī. Venerable Ānanda then distributed the stitched and fully stitched robes that had been washed, cleaned, and prepared, and holding an alms bowl that sparkled, he sauntered in front of the monks with an air of conceit. The monks informed the Blessed One of this, and the Blessed One, reflecting on the matter, understood that whatever fault had arisen had come from the monks wearing stitched and fully stitched robes. He then addressed the monks: "Monks, because of this, that foolish person Ānanda distributed the stitched and fully stitched robes that had been washed and cleaned, took up a sparkling alms bowl,

and sauntered in front of the monks with an air of conceit — this is neither seemly nor appropriate. Therefore, a monk must not keep stitched and fully stitched robes. If he keeps them, he commits an offense."

When the Blessed One had declared that monks must not keep stitched and fully stitched robes, faithful brahmin householders and lay householders came to offer stitched and fully stitched robes to the monks, but the monks would not accept them. The householders then said: "Noble ones, in the times when no buddha, no Blessed One, has appeared in the world, it is the non-Buddhists who are proper fields of giving. Now that the Blessed One has appeared in the

world, you are the proper fields of giving. If you will not accept, shall we have no way to accumulate virtue for the journey from this world to the next?" Upon hearing this, the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, accept them with permission, and having accepted them, shake out the shine and use them fully. If they cannot be shaken free of shine by hand, the Blessed One declared: place them in soak and shake out the shine that way." If when soaked and placed thus the shine could still not be removed entirely, the Blessed One declared: "Scrub them in water." If the monks scrubbed them in water and still the shine could not be removed, the Blessed One declared: "If it still cannot be removed even after doing all that, then use them fully — there is no need for remorse in this matter."

Likewise, when faithful brahmins and lay householders offer stitched and fully stitched robes to the Saṅgha, those too should be used fully, following this same procedure in sequence.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the park belonging to Prince Jeta. At that time the brahmins and lay householders of Śrāvastī had gathered and assembled in a meeting hall, and were exchanging conversation of this kind among themselves: "The renunciant Gautama, the Blessed One, is not by nature one who distributes, and his hearers too are not by nature ones who distribute. In that case, even those shaven-headed renunciants who are non-Buddhists would be more fitting — not these ones."

Then one brahmin spoke up: "As for whether the renunciant Gautama is by nature one who distributes or not, and whether his hearers are by nature ones who distribute or not — let tomorrow make that clear to you directly." They agreed, saying: "Very well, do it and let us see." He then took a length of cloth and went to the Jeta Grove. He set the cloth down at the edge of the old-age hall and offered it to the Saṅgha of monks of the four directions, saying: "Noble ones, I offer this length of cloth to the Saṅgha — please do with it as you see fit." The senior elder of the Saṅgha replied: "O great brahmin, may you be free of illness. May this act of giving adorn your mind, furnish your mind with what it needs, complete the gathering of meditative practice, bring you attainment of the highest aim, and grant you the robes of gods and humans." The brahmin then bowed his head in a polite gesture and departed.

The Blessed One then addressed the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, go and tell the monks that this length of cloth was offered by the brahmin in order to test us. Therefore you should divide it equally, and some should receive a full share, some should be listed as receiving it, and some together —

and some should use it to make a tent of robes." The venerable Ānanda replied, "As you wish, Reverend One," and having listened to the Blessed One, he conveyed those very words to the monks: "The Blessed One has declared that this length of cloth was offered by the brahmin in order to test us. Therefore you should divide it equally — some should receive a full share, some should be listed as receiving it, some together, and some should use it to make a tent of robes." The monks replied, "Venerable Ānanda, we shall do exactly as the Blessed One has declared," and they divided it and distributed it in that very way.

Now, the brahmin had risen early and was standing at the gate of Śrāvastī. When the monks, having divided their lower garments that morning, took up their bowls and outer robes and set out to enter Śrāvastī for alms, the brahmin said to them, "Noble ones, what have you done with the cloth I offered to the Saṅgha?"

One monk replied, "Great brahmin, the Saṅgha divided it equally and distributed it. My own share — this is what I received as a full portion." Another said, "Mine was listed as received." Another said, "Mine was placed together with another's." And another said, "Mine was made into a tent of robes."

The brahmin then thought to himself: "Those who say that the ascetics who are sons of the Śākya have no custom of sharing things — well, a flash of surprise has just struck me, for these great ones do indeed have a custom of sharing. I shall go forth among them alone." Faith arose in him, and he went to where the Blessed One was. Arriving there, he bowed his head to the feet of the Blessed One and addressed him thus: "Reverend One, if I may go forth and receive full ordination in this well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, and so obtain the state of a monk, I shall live the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One."

The Blessed One declared, "Excellent! Excellent, brahmin! The resolve you have generated is good, and going forth is supreme. A wise person who sees five benefits ought rightly to be devoted to going forth alone. What are the five? A wise person who sees that he will attain the unsullied accomplishment of his own goal ought rightly to be devoted to going forth alone. A wise person

who sees that even those who were his slaves, his employees, those who acted on his instructions, those who were under his authority, and those who worked for his pleasure will themselves become worthy of offerings and worthy of praise ought rightly to be devoted to going forth alone. A wise person who sees that he will attain the unsurpassed accomplishment and bliss of nirvāṇa ought rightly to be devoted to going forth alone. A wise person who sees that even if he falls short of attaining the unsurpassed accomplishment and bliss of nirvāṇa, he will be reborn among the gods ought rightly to be devoted to going forth alone. And a wise person who sees that going forth has been praised in many ways by the buddhas and by the noble ones — the holy śrāvakas of the buddhas who have entered [the path] rightly — ought rightly to be devoted to going forth alone. Therefore, go forth well."

The Blessed One then called out, "Come here, monk," and thereby conferred on him the going-forth and full ordination, and gave him instructions.

By striving and applying himself with vigor, he came to understand this very wheel of saṃsāra — both its moving and its stationary parts — as one fifth, and he realized that all aspects of the formations are subject to deterioration, downfall, dispersion, and destruction by their very nature. Having abandoned all afflictions, he directly actualized arhathood. He was an arhat, free from attachment throughout the three realms — equal in composure, like clay and gold; equal in composure, like the sky and the palm of the hand; equal in composure, like leather and sandalwood. Through knowledge he had torn open the hollow cave-door of ignorance. He had attained supernormal cognitions and the four individual discriminating awarenesses. He had turned his back on existence, on material gain, and on honor. He became one to be revered, praised, and addressed with respect by the gods, together with Indra and those in his retinue.

The Blessed One then declared to the monks: "Monks, for one who is restrained there are these benefits, and there are others as well. Therefore, monks, if a gain of food arises, divide it equally, even if it be only the leaves of a grain plant. If a gain of cloth arises, divide it equally, even if it be only the wick of a butter lamp."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At Śrāvastī there was a brahmin who was devoted to purity and who wished to go forth. He thought: "I shall go forth into the teaching of whichever one whose purity brings contentment to my

mind." He wandered to the dwellings of the non-Buddhists, but their purity did not bring contentment to his mind. He then thought: "I have visited all the non-Buddhists, and none of them has brought contentment to my mind. Now then, the śramaṇas, the sons of the Śākya, remain. Let me go and visit them." With this in mind he went to the Jeta Grove.

Just then he saw the venerable Śāriputra taking up his begging bowl and setting out to go to the latrine. He thought: "This one is the foremost among the śrāvakas of the śramaṇa Gautama. Let me watch and see just how he conducts himself regarding purity." He followed along behind him.

Now, since arhats do not engage their unintentional primordial wisdom in seeing, the venerable Śāriputra entered into deliberate attention and, knowing that this brahmin was following him, he thought: "Why is the brahmin following behind me? He must wish to see how I attend to purity." And he again turned his attention to consider: "Does this man have any root of virtue, or not?" He saw that he did. He then considered: "On whom does it depend?" and he saw that it depended on himself alone.

Having reflected thus, Śāriputra removed his sandals and set aside his outer robe. He then placed seven mounds of earth on one side, seven mounds on another side, and two mounds of earth on yet another side. Then, taking three mounds of earth, he began to relieve himself in such a way that the brahmin could see. After finishing, he wiped himself with one mound of earth, and washed with two. Then he rose slowly and came to that place, and with his left hand washed with seven mounds of earth. Then he washed with both hands together using seven mounds. Then he scrubbed from his shoulders downward with one mound of earth. Having washed his hands, he then washed his begging bowl with the second. Then he rose slowly, and with calm deportment he put on his robe and washed his feet.

When the brahmin saw this, he became filled with faith. He thought: "A single mound of earth used by the śramaṇas, the sons of the Śākya, is supreme — not even a hundred of the non-Buddhists can equal that." Knowing this, he touched his head to the feet of the venerable Śāriputra and addressed the venerable Śāriputra with these words:

"O noble Śāriputra, if I may obtain the going forth and full ordination in the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, and thereby receive the status of a monk, I will practice the holy life in the presence of the noble Śāriputra."

Śāriputra said: "Excellent, brahmin! The intention you have aroused is good, and the going forth is supreme. The Blessed One himself, with the wisdom that sees five benefits, declared that one ought to be devoted to the going forth alone" — and so on as before, up to — "the buddhas, and the noble śrāvakas of the buddhas who have entered correctly, those holy persons, have praised the going forth in many ways; and with the wisdom that sees this, one ought to be devoted to the going forth alone" — thus he spoke.

And so he gave him the going forth and full ordination well, bestowed instruction upon him, and that one, through earnest and sustained effort, came to know this very wheel of cyclic existence with its five parts — both moving and unmoving — as before, up to: "he came to speak with respect."

Then the monks, having grown uncertain, asked the Blessed One, the buddha, to cut through all their doubts: "Venerable One, behold how the elder Śāriputra caused this brahmin of pure conduct to arise in faith, freed him from the wilderness of cyclic existence, and established him in nirvāṇa — in accomplishment and happiness unsurpassed, utterly supreme, and final."

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, not only now — hear also how in times past he turned this man away from theft and established him in the five bases of moral discipline. Monks, long ago there was a brahmin who lived on a rocky crag. He took a wife from among those equal to his own station, and together with her he took pleasure, rejoiced, and made merry. While they were taking pleasure, rejoicing, and making merry in this way, at another time a living being entered into the wife. Eight or nine months passed, and she gave birth to a girl who was beautiful of form, pleasing and lovely to behold. After giving birth, he held a grand celebration lasting twenty-one days — seven times three — and gave her a name befitting her lineage. He raised and nurtured her, and she grew to adulthood.

Then one day five hundred bandits came to that rocky crag, intent on plunder. Their leader was tormented by thirst and entered the brahmin's home. As soon as he entered, he saw the girl. He said to her: 'Girl, give me water.' She replied: 'Wait just a moment.' She said nothing more, but quickly blew out the lamp. The bandit chief gazed at the girl and reflected. The girl, having blown out the lamp, was looking into the water. The bandit chief said: 'Girl, what are you looking at?' She said: 'I am looking at the water.' He said: 'What is there to look at in that?' She said: 'Because bubbles or strands of hair are coming in.' He said: 'Girl, I have entered here in order to harm you, and I intend to pour

poison for you — yet you speak to me thus!'

She then spoke these verses:

Those deceitful ones who seize what belongs to others —
whatever deed it is that bandits do,
whether they do it or whether they do not,
I myself must ever guard the Dharma.

He was greatly pleased and said: 'Girl, if I were to make you my sister, what would you do? Tell me.' She replied: 'If you were to generate attachment to the wealth of others, and were then struck by an arrow and died, I would be desolate with the suffering of separation from my brother and would cry out in grief — I would not rejoice. Therefore a brother who is a thief — such a one as that — I do not need.'

'Therefore, if you are able to take up fully the five bases of moral training, then I will make you my sister.' Though he was unwilling, she spoke in a pleasing, agreeable manner, and he became greatly delighted and eager to become her brother. He said: 'Sister, excellent — let it be so.' She turned him away from banditry and established him in the five bases of moral training.

Monks, what do you think? The leader of that band of bandits at that time and place — he is none other than this brahmin here. The brahmin's daughter at that time and place — she is none other than the monk Śāriputra. And even then, as now, Śāriputra turned that one away from theft and established him in the five bases of training. Now, too, having purified and inspired him with faith, he has freed him from the wilderness of cyclic existence and established him in the utterly final nirvāṇa — the accomplishment and supreme bliss that is the absolute culmination.

Monks, thus there are these and other benefits of purity. Therefore, monks, just as Śāriputra did, practice purity in that same manner.

The summary verse:

Patches and arm-cloths and sweat-cloths,
nuns and the months,
residences with six furnishings,
and three ways of sitting on a seat.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time the monks were using robes distributed in due season without taking care of them, and as a

result the stitching at the edges frayed apart. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: 'Frayed edges of robes are to be patched.' When the Blessed One had said that frayed edges of robes were to be patched, the monks applied patches; yet the threads continued to fray. The Blessed One then declared: 'Patches are to be applied at intervals throughout.'

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The Blessed One declared: 'An outer robe is to be cared for as one would care for one's skin.' Now certain monks had no other suitable robe to wear, and so they wore the outer robe all the time; in the heat of summer it became soaked with perspiration from the armpits, grew soiled and dank, and developed an unpleasant odor. The monks then reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: 'A sweat-cloth is to be inserted at the armpit side.'

When the Blessed One had declared that a sweat-cloth was to be inserted at the armpit side of the outer robe, the monks did not know what kind of sweat-cloth to make. The Blessed One declared: 'A piece of cloth that is half a cubit wide and one cubit long — that is to be inserted on that side.' The monks sewed it in. The Blessed One declared: 'It is not to be sewn in.' When it became soiled, the Blessed One declared: 'It is to be washed from time to time and turned.' The monks inserted it on one side only. The Blessed One declared: 'It is to be inserted on both sides.' When the Blessed One had declared that it was to be turned, the monks dyed it saffron. The Blessed One declared: 'It is not to be dyed saffron; it is to be turned by wringing it out.'

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At Śrāvastī there was a brahmin who had taken a wife from a family of equal rank.

He played with her, delighted in her, and sported with her in joy. While they were playing, delighting, and sporting together, at another time a being entered into his wife's womb. Nine months passed, and she gave birth to a daughter. A great birth celebration was held, and the girl was given the name Candramāsā, "Moon-Month." She was raised and nurtured until she grew up.

Then at another time, the Great Mistress of Creatures Gautamī went forth and received full ordination. After that, the Great Mistress of Creatures Gautamī, surrounded by a retinue of five hundred, went to where the Blessed One was, arrived there, and bowed with her head to the Blessed One's two feet, then sat down to one side.

Once she was seated to one side, the Blessed One properly instructed, properly guided, properly exhorted, and properly delighted the Great Mistress of Creatures Gautamī with a Dharma-endowed discourse. Having properly instructed, properly guided, properly exhorted, and properly delighted her with a Dharma-endowed discourse in many ways, he then fell silent.

Thereupon the Great Mistress of Creatures Gautamī rose from her seat, turned and faced toward the Blessed One with hands pressed together in reverence, and said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, you have taught the Vinaya of monks to the monks. Pray, out of compassion, may the Blessed One also teach the Vinaya of nuns to the nuns."

The Blessed One declared: "Gautamī, for a Tathāgata to teach even a single phrase at a time — that is not the proper way, and there is no occasion for it. However, if there are some nuns who are willing to take up what I teach in one recitation, then I shall teach it in that manner."

Then at that very moment the nun Candramāsā assembled together and sat there. The nun Candramāsā rose from her seat, turned and faced toward the Blessed One with hands pressed together in reverence, and said this to the Blessed One: "The Blessed One has spoken once. I wish to receive and hold it; please teach it."

Thereupon the Blessed One taught her, and she retained what was spoken in that single recitation.

Then the Blessed One declared to the monks: "Monks, among my śrāvaka nuns, the foremost in retention of what has been heard is this very nun Candramāsā."

The Blessed One then reflected: "Everywhere, a nun such as Candramāsā, or even one who resembles Candramāsā, will not easily arise. Therefore monks should also take up the Vinaya of nuns and retain it, and should teach it to the nuns, giving it as well to those who recite and those who inquire."

With this in mind, the Blessed One declared to the monks: "Monks, though the nun Candramāsā has received the Vinaya of nuns taught in a single recitation tomorrow, nonetheless, since everywhere a nun like Candramāsā or one resembling her will not arise, monks too should take up the Vinaya of nuns, retain it, teach it to the nuns, and give it to those who recite and those who inquire."

The Blessed One then said: "One should cultivate the two qualities of calm abiding and special insight by relying on moral discipline and abiding in moral discipline." And the nun Candramāsā, in accordance with the Vinaya, by relying on moral discipline and abiding in moral discipline, strove and exerted herself through the practice of meditative concentration and recitation. She came to know directly that this very fifth portion of the wheel of cyclic existence — whether moving or unmoving — and understood by its very nature of reality that all formations are subject to deterioration, downfall, disintegration, and destruction.

Having abandoned all mental afflictions, she directly realized arhathood. The arhat nun, freed from attachment to the three realms, her mind equal to gold and butter, equal to the sky and the palm of a hand, comparable to heartwood and sandalwood, had torn open the dark cavern of ignorance with the light of wisdom. She had attained the higher knowledges and the individual perfect insights. She had turned her back on craving, gain, and honor. She came to be venerated, revered, and spoken of with reverence by the gods of the faculty realms and the realms close to them.

Then the Blessed One declared to the monks: "Among my śrāvaka nuns, the foremost in great wisdom, great eloquence, and retaining what she has heard is none other than the nun Candramāsā."

The monks, having given rise to doubt, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, to resolve all their doubts: "Venerable Blessed One, what karma did the nun Candramāsā perform, such that through the karmic maturation of that action she came to possess great wisdom and great eloquence, and such that the Blessed One also proclaimed her foremost in retaining what she has heard, and such that having gone forth in the teaching of the Blessed One she abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhathood?"

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, it was the nun Candramāsā herself who performed and accumulated the karma — from the passage beginning 'she obtained a retinue' down to 'ripening as fruit for embodied beings' — just as before."

"Monks, in a past age, ninety-one great aeons ago, when the lifespan of beings was eighty thousand years, a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly complete buddha arose as a Teacher in the world — endowed with knowledge and feet, a Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide and driver of persons to be tamed, Teacher of gods and humans — by the name of the Blessed One

buddha Vipāśyin. He traveled with a retinue of sixty-two thousand monks to Rājagṛha at Jīvaka's mango grove, and dwelt there in that grove.

"At that time there lived in Rājagṛha at Jīvaka's mango grove a householder who had taken a wife from an equal family. He sported with her, delighted with her, and enjoyed her company. While they were sporting, delighting, and enjoying each other's company, after some time a being entered the wife's womb. After nine months had passed, a daughter was born. A great birth feast was held, a name befitting the family was given, and she was raised and reared until she had grown up.

"Now that householder was a man of faith, and at the time of the pravāraṇā ceremony he took the girl and went to the nuns' rains-retreat dwelling. He performed the pravāraṇā for the community of nuns with various implements such as needles and knives, and so forth, offering them individually to the nuns of the Saṅgha.

"The girl, seeing the beauty of the occasion, gave rise to faith, and said to her father: 'Father, I too would like to perform the pravāraṇā for the community of nuns.' The householder replied: 'Daughter, excellent — do perform the pravāraṇā just so.' She then performed the pravāraṇā for the community of nuns with distinguished gifts of needles, knives, gold, iron, and other implements. With intense and powerful delight, she went from the eldest to the last, prostrated at their feet, and made this aspiration: 'By this wholesome root of generating the mind of awakening and giving away things to be given, may I come to possess great wisdom and great eloquence, and may I retain what I hear.'

"Monks, what do you think? The daughter of that householder — she is none other than the very nun Candramāsā herself."

By this very act — having performed the pravāraṇā for the community of nuns of the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Vipāśyin with distinguished gifts of needles, knives, gold, iron, and other implements, and having made the aspiration, 'By this wholesome root of generating the mind of awakening and giving away things to be given, may I come to possess great wisdom and great eloquence, and may I retain what I hear' — through the karmic maturation of that deed, she has now come to possess great wisdom and great eloquence, and retains what she hears.

Furthermore, she went forth under the scriptural teaching of the Blessed One Kāśyapa, and though during that life she practiced the holy life for a full

lifespan, she did not attain even a single collection of virtuous qualities. The preceptor under whom she went forth was designated by the Blessed One, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Kāśyapa, as supreme among those who retain what they hear. And so she made this aspiration: 'Although I practiced the holy life for an entire lifetime before the Blessed One, the perfectly and completely awakened, peerless field of offerings, Kāśyapa, without attaining even a single collection of virtuous qualities, by this wholesome root may I — just as my preceptor was designated by the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Kāśyapa as supreme among those who retain what they hear — likewise be designated by the Blessed One Śākyamuni, the chief of Śākya kings, as supreme among those who retain what they hear.' Through the power of that aspiration, she has now been designated by the Tathāgata as supreme among those who retain what they hear.

Therefore, monks, from the passage beginning, 'The karmic maturation of those that are wholly dark is likewise wholly dark; the karmic maturation of those that are wholly bright is likewise wholly bright,' strive accordingly. Monks should train in just that way — and all that follows is as before.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the park of Prince Jeta. At that time a young monk was traveling together with another monk, and they arrived at Śrāvastī. The other monk went to the fine lodging house of Mṛgāramātā, while the young monk went to the Jeta Grove and sought lodging with a monk there. He sat for a little while in that monk's presence and then said: 'I left my bowl and robe in a certain great assembly hall and have come here; I will retrieve them and return.' The other monk said: 'Go, child, and come back quickly.' He replied: 'Teacher, what would you have me do there? I will come back quickly' — and having prostrated at his feet, he departed and proceeded in due course to that assembly hall.

Now, the community had established a rule that no one was to spend even a single night in that assembly hall without the community's permission to reside there. Having duly obtained permission from a monk to lodge there, he slept that night. At dawn he thought: 'Let me go and look in on the teacher,' and so he went to the teacher's lodging, knocked on the door, and offered his respects. 'Are you well?' he asked. 'Child, I am ill; I am not well.' The young monk then thought: 'To go off and abandon a sick teacher — that is not right for me.'

The Blessed One had also, for this very reason, granted permission for them to lodge together in order to care for one another in illness. It was with that in mind that he had tended to the teacher, thinking: 'When he recovers, I will go.' Having nursed him back to health, the young monk said: 'Venerable sir, please be informed that I shall take my leave.' The teacher replied: 'Child, I wonder whether you are slightly unwell?' 'Venerable sir, there is not the slightest thing wrong with me. However, I did not come here to reside; I came only to retrieve the robe and bowl I had left behind. The community has established a rule that no one is to spend even a single night in the assembly hall without the community's permission to reside there. It was for that reason that I properly obtained permission to lodge, and then, when you fell ill, I thought: "To go off and abandon my teacher — that is not right for me. The Blessed One, for this very reason, granted permission for them to lodge together in order to care for one another in illness. So I will care for the teacher, and when he recovers I will go." Now that you have recovered, venerable sir, please be informed that I shall take my leave.' 'Excellent, excellent, venerable one. Continue to dwell just as you have entered upon the path, and let those who share quarters with you and those who serve as attendants fulfil their duties toward their preceptors and teachers. If they fulfil them in that way, then — just as the blue lotus (utpala) arises from the water — virtuous qualities will grow and flourish. Noble one, be heedful, and go.' The young monk paid his respects and proceeded in due course to the Jeta Grove. When his own teacher saw him, he said: 'Welcome, venerable one. Why have you been so long in coming?' The young monk recounted all that had happened. The teacher said: 'Excellent, excellent, venerable one. Continue to dwell just as you have entered upon the path, and let those who share quarters with you and those who serve as attendants fulfil their duties toward their preceptors and teachers. If they fulfil them in that way, then — just as the blue lotus arises from the water — virtuous qualities will grow and flourish.'

Now that monk was seized by doubt. He wondered: 'Is that same lodging-place sufficient, or must another be given?' And so he raised the matter with the monks, and the monks asked the Blessed One about it. The Blessed One declared: 'Monks, he obtained only a temporary permission to lodge. Therefore that very same lodging-place is sufficient; no other is needed.'

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At Śrāvastī a young monk had lodged with a monk who was a renunciant, and the young monk thought: 'The

Blessed One has said that to ordain monks, to give them full ordination, and then to give them no instruction and no guidance — that is worse than butchering them.' And further: 'Even an attendant is like a student in this regard. Since I too am a renunciant, I should entrust this one to someone who will give something.' Thinking thus, he went to a certain monk and said: 'Please teach this young venerable one.' The monk replied: 'If you will serve me, then on that condition I will teach him.' The young monk said: 'I respectfully ask to be taught.' And so he began to train under him.

At another time the young monk fell ill, and the teacher with whom he had lodged nursed him in his sickness. Then at yet another time, when that very teacher with whom he had lodged fell ill, the young monk did not look in on him — and likewise did not look in on him even after three times had passed. Then the teacher said to him: 'Venerable one, go to someone else and take up residence there.' The young monk replied:

"Noble one, I have come to you alone, and I am not lacking in anything." The teacher replied: "Venerable one, it is true that you lack nothing. Yet I was in want, and when you fell ill I nursed you through your sickness — so when I fell ill three times over, why did you not look in on me even once? Go, and take up residence with someone of your own kind who would give lodging to one as disrespectful as you."

The young monk had no reply and sat in silence. At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One who lodges with a preceptor must attend upon the preceptor."

Then at another time the reading-teacher fell ill, and the young monk did not look in on him. When the reading-teacher had recovered, the young monk went to him and said: "Teacher, please assign me a text to recite." The teacher replied: "Venerable one, when I was ill you did not look in on me even once. Go, and learn from someone who would take on a pupil as disrespectful as you."

Again the young monk had no reply and sat in silence. At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One must attend upon one's reading-teacher."

After the Blessed One had declared that one must attend upon one's reading-teacher, it came about at yet another time that both the reading-teacher and the residential preceptor fell ill at once, and the young monk did not know whose attendance he should give first. The monks reported

the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "If one is able, one should attend upon both. If one cannot, one should attend upon the residential preceptor — for one may reside without a reading-teacher, but one may not reside without a residential preceptor."

The Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the prince Jeta's grove. A certain person who wished to go forth came to a monk, and that monk gave him the going-forth and performed his full ordination, then left to wander through the provinces. As for the residential teacher who had remained with him, he had gathered him only with material things and not with Dharma, so that young monk took up residence with someone else.

Now the Blessed One had taught the four bases of attraction: giving, pleasant speech, beneficial conduct, and consistency of purpose. Because this monk gathered his student through both Dharma and material things, that student kept watch over the teacher at all times and held him constantly in mind.

In due course the preceptor of that young monk had wandered through the provinces as he pleased and then returned to Śrāvastī. When those who were newly leading the holy life saw him coming, they rose from their seats. Those who were elder monks received him with the customary greeting of "welcome." But that same young monk who had lived with him did not rise from his seat.

The other monks said to him: "Venerable one, when your preceptor arrives, some of those leading the holy life rise to their feet, some come forward openly to greet him, and some receive him with the words 'welcome.' Since they all conduct themselves thus, it is not fitting that you, seeing him, should not rise from your seat."

He replied: "Was it he who ordained me through material generosity, or through Dharma? Remembering that, why should I rise?" They said: "Venerable one, say no such thing."

Did not the Blessed One also declare: "The person in dependence upon whom another person, trusting in the Dharma-Vinaya as taught by the Tathāgata, has shaved hair and beard, donned the ochre robe, and gone forth from home into homelessness with genuine faith — that person can never easily be repaid by that other person for as long as life lasts, not even with robes, alms food, medicines for illness, bedding, and requisites"?

The other monks said to him: "Venerable one, saying such a thing is not fitting." He had nothing to say in reply and sat there in silence.

At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Co-residents and attendant monks must rise from their seat the moment they see their preceptor. The moment a preceptor is seen there must be no remaining seated."

When the Blessed One had declared that no one was to remain seated the moment a preceptor was seen, certain others came who were unable to sit with a preceptor — they would arrive, sit for a short while, and then leave. Some of them would scold the preceptors and teachers, while others would be pleased with them. Those toward whom there was scolding would receive no lodging allocation going forward, nor would such a monk take them under his own care. Those toward whom there was pleasure he would take under his care — but then those previous teachers would fall into dispute and depart, and even they would not be taken in. At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Even toward those who are unable to sit with a preceptor, everything is to be done; and toward the previous teachers too, everything is to be done. Nevertheless, one should make it one's chief concern to please both parties, and one should consult both. If in every single matter it is the preceptors who are present, then it is to them that one should address one's questions."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the monastery of Prince Jeta. A monk gave lodging to a certain young man. That young man spent half a month there, and when the time of the restoration ceremony came he went to his host and said: "Teacher, I pay homage to you. I request that you bless the restoration ceremony." The monk said: "Good sir, how could I become your teacher?" The young man said: "Because it is to you yourself that I was assigned as a lodger." The monk said: "Good sir, one who assigns a lodger to someone as disrespectful and impudent as you — understand it was he who did so, and make your request to him." The young man had nothing to say in reply and sat there in silence.

At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One, perceiving that some slight fault had arisen, reflected that it had arisen from monks not attending upon their preceptors and teachers at the three times of day. Therefore, thinking that co-residents and attendant monks

should go to visit their preceptors and teachers at the three times of day, the Blessed One declared to the monks: "Monks, therefore co-residents and attendant monks should go at the three times of day to visit their preceptors and teachers."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the monastery of Prince Jeta. A monk gave lodging to a certain young monk and raised him like a son. On another occasion that young monk prepared to go on a journey through the region and said: "Teacher, I pay homage to you. Please take note: I am going to travel through the region." The teacher said: "My son, are you not the least bit unwell?" He replied: "Teacher, I am not in the least unwell. Yet I am eager to travel through the region and shall return again."

The teacher said: "My son, if you have a change of heart along the way, then turn back." The young monk replied: "Teacher, very well — I shall turn back," and departed. Before long, he did have a change of heart along the way, and he thought: "My teacher has provided me with all my requisites, yet I left — that was wrong. I shall turn back." So thinking, he returned, and when the teacher saw him he said: "My son, why have you come back? Have you forgotten something?" He replied: "Teacher, I have forgotten nothing at all. Yet I thought: 'My teacher has furnished me with all my requisites — what purpose is there in going?' And so I have returned." The teacher said: "My son, if you have turned back, that is good. Your teacher is none other than myself." Then the teacher thought: "Is it sufficient that this one simply stay here, or should I give him instruction from the outset?" He then raised the matter with the monks, and the monks put it before the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, if the preceptor has not dismissed him yet the attendant has, it is said that the lodging-arrangement is not broken. If the preceptor has dismissed him yet the attendant has not, it is said that the lodging-arrangement is not broken. If neither the preceptor nor the attendant has dismissed him, it is said that the lodging-arrangement is not broken. If both the preceptor and the attendant have dismissed him, then it is to be said that the lodging-arrangement is broken."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. In Śrāvastī there was a certain teacher living among the assembly of monks who set many young men to studying. On another occasion that teacher fell ill, and yet those monks did not look in on him again; and even when he fell ill a second and a third time, those monks still did not

look in on him. Then on another occasion he recovered, and his attendants came to him. One said: "Teacher, please give me a recitation lesson." Another said: "Please give me a lesson in question and answer." Yet another said: "I request instruction." The teacher replied: "Venerable ones, I was ill three times over and not once did any of you look in on me — so go to such a disrespectful person as yourselves to receive teachings and recitations." Then the monks put the matter before the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "You must attend upon the reading-teacher." When all of them had done so, their accumulation of virtue diminished, and the Blessed One then declared: "Do it in turns." When they began doing it in rotation, they said to an elderly monk who was staying there: "Elder, tomorrow it is your turn." He replied: "Venerable ones, should I serve the teacher by turns? I shall serve him by myself alone. The rest of you may set your minds at ease." They said: "Elder, if that is how it is, excellent." And since the Blessed One has also said, "Whoever attends upon the sick attends upon me," the elder said: "Noble one, you should do so." He then began to tend to the sick monk, and that monk recovered. Knowing the state of his own body, the monk said: "Teacher, please give me a teachings-lesson." The elder replied: "It is not yet your turn; wait a while." Again he said: "Teacher, let there be a recitation and a question session." Again the elder replied: "It is not yet your turn; wait a while." Then the monk said: "Teacher, if tending the sick is my turn, while reading and recitation are the turns of those others — please understand why I say this." The elder replied: "My son, stay here until everything is done."

He said nothing and remained silent. At that time, the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One who is constantly serving others should not become displeased, and should give to others their scripture lessons, recitations, and question sessions."

When both skilled and unskilled monks were reading together, and scripture lessons were given to the skilled ones in a way that caused harm to the unskilled, the Blessed One declared: "Scripture lessons, recitations, and question sessions should be given to them as well, according to occasion."

Summary verse: Abandoning the sick, the preceptor, the half-month arrival, and the one who conducts the reading of the assembly — these are correctly taught as the summary topics.

The awakened Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. The group of six monks went to the house of a noble

family. Those hosts brought out a chair and said: "Noble ones, please be seated as you like." All of them sat down at once and the chair broke. The monks struck one another with horse-whips. Other monks came there, and seeing what had happened, one said: "Venerable ones, why did you behave in such an unseemly manner — was it to cause laughter?" The group of six replied: "Did someone drink wine? Did someone eat garlic? Did they do these things too? What else was done? Was the chair broken? Was the wood used up? Are the woodworkers dead?" The others, displeased, said nothing and remained silent. At that time, the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, six should not sit on a single chair." When the Blessed One had declared that six should not sit on a single chair, five sat on it and the same fault arose again. The Blessed One declared: "Five should not sit on it either." Four sat on it and the same fault arose again. The Blessed One declared: "Four should not sit on it either — and furthermore, three should not sit on a large seat; two may sit on a medium seat; and one only on a small seat."

Summary verse: The attendant to the sick, climbing a tree, receiving full ordination while leprous, and cutting off a hand — these are correctly taught as the summary topics.

The awakened Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. The venerable Neyaka, a novice, wished to receive full ordination. He approached the monk who was to perform the act of full ordination, and the monk who would train him privately, and he petitioned the monks who were to come to the assembly. The novice then took his robe and mat, went ahead to the assembly hall, swept the assembly hall, and arranged the seats. But the monks did not come. As Neyaka looked around, he saw a flowering tree and said: "Novice, gather flowers from that tree and distribute them to the monks." He climbed up but did not get a firm footing, fell, and broke his arm. That very injury became an obstacle to his receiving full ordination as a monk. At that time, the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared:

"Just as the eldest son of a wheel-turning king, who is worthy of receiving consecration, has not yet been consecrated and therefore must be guarded and tended during that interval, so too a novice who wishes to receive full ordination from a monk must likewise be guarded and tended. Therefore a monk must not allow a novice who wishes to receive full ordination to climb a tree. If he permits it and the novice climbs, it becomes a serious

transgression."

The Minor Vinaya. The nineteenth fascicle.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was residing at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. There was a man of the Kosala kingdom in the service of King Prasenajit who was known as "the Great Inner Chamberlain." On another occasion the king became displeased with him, and he thought to himself: "Kings are difficult to please no matter what one does. I will go and take ordination." And so he went to the Jeta Grove. Now it was the practice of the group of six monks that one or another of them would never leave the gate of the Jeta Grove unattended, and so the venerable Nanda was sitting at the gate. Since Nanda had known this man before, he greeted him as he approached, saying the customary welcome: "Great one, it has been a long time — like the moon that has stayed away — where have you come from?" The man replied: "Noble one, one who is seen again and again becomes contemptible; it is good to be seen after a long absence. Noble one, what need has brought you here?" "Noble one, the king is difficult to please. I am unable to satisfy the god — and so I will go forth into ordination." "Great one, your intention is good — excellent! Renunciation is supreme. The Blessed One himself, beginning with 'He perceived five benefits' and ending with 'Going forth has been praised in many ways by the buddhas, by the noble śrāvakas of the buddhas who have entered properly, and by noble, holy persons' — just as before." "Then go forth well!" And so that man went forth and received full ordination.

The king then said to his ministers: "Wise ones, if the Great One is not to be seen, he must have died." They replied: "Your majesty, he has not fled anywhere, but at your majesty's command he went to the Jeta Grove and took ordination." "Who ordained him?" "The venerable Nanda did." Upon hearing this the king became furious, and he sent a messenger to Nanda, saying: "Noble ones, did you ordain one who had been expelled by us? If you ordain the Great One, then I will have you, the venerable noble-born one, the one with the garland, and the rainy-season women all ordained too, and you yourselves can govern the kingdom!" Nanda sent this reply: "Your majesty, come here. You, the venerable noble-born one, the one with the garland, and the rainy-season woman — all of you take ordination, and I myself will govern the kingdom. Did I deceive your Great One or anyone else and ordain them? Whoever comes to the Jeta Grove and petitions me — those I ordain." When the king heard this he became displeased. At that time the monks reported the

matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One, perceiving the fault, considered: "Whatever small fault has arisen here has come about through monks' ordaining those expelled by the king. Therefore monks must not ordain those expelled by the king." And he declared to the monks: "Monks, the deluded man Nanda ordained a minister, and the king has become displeased. Therefore, monks must not give full ordination to one who has been expelled by the king."

Whenever someone wishing to go forth comes to any monk, that monk must ask whether the person has been expelled by the king. If he gives full ordination without having asked, he commits a serious offence. When the Blessed One had declared that one expelled by the king must not be ordained, some came from distant regions, some came whose background was unknown, and some came who had not been granted permission. The monks were uncertain and did not ordain these people either. Then the Blessed One declared: "Those who come from distant regions, those whose background is unknown, and those who have not been granted permission — these may be ordained; one should not feel remorse in such cases."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove (Jetavana), the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, the benefactor of the destitute. The venerable Nanda shaved his hair and beard, and shortly thereafter, early in the morning, he put on his Dharma robe, took up his alms bowl, and went into Śrāvastī for alms. As he proceeded gradually along the street, there happened to be a brahmin teaching the brahminic sacred texts to about five hundred brahmin youths. This brahmin was fierce, dissolute, and rough, and he said to one of the brahmin youths: "Hey, brahmin youth — can you jab the top of this shaven-headed ascetic's head with a shoulder-pole?" The youth replied: "If the master goes first, I'll follow." And so he went over to Nanda and struck his head with a shoulder-pole. The venerable Nanda turned around and looked at the brahmin, whereupon the brahmin grew all the more enraged and said: "Strike the brahmin youth again!" The youth struck him twice more with the shoulder-pole, and the venerable Nanda thought: "I looked back — whatever comes of it, let it be." And he went on his way.

He arrived at the Jeta Grove, finished the business of the meal, washed his alms bowl, and said to the monks: "Venerable ones, do not go to the great main thoroughfare." The monks asked: "Why?" He told them: "There in that street a fierce, dissolute, and rough brahmin is teaching the brahminic sacred texts to about five hundred brahmin youths, and he jabbed me twice with a

shoulder-pole." They said: "What was your offence in this?" He replied: "Venerable ones, one thing was an offence, and the second was not. How was the first an offence and how was the second not? Without any provocation he jabbed me with a shoulder-pole, and I turned and looked back at him — that was the offence. That he then jabbed me a second time after I had turned to look at him — that was not an offence." The venerable Ānanda heard this and said: "Noble one, what are you saying?" Nanda replied: "It is nothing of consequence, great one." Ānanda said: "Noble one, I have heard it; please tell it again." Nanda recounted what had happened, and Ānanda, shaking his head three times, thought: "I will go and confront him and be displeased." Thinking thus, he shaved his head again, anointed it with sesame oil, washed it, and early in the morning put on his lower robe, took up his alms bowl and Dharma robe, and entered Śrāvastī for alms. As he proceeded gradually along the street, the brahmin was distracted elsewhere and did not see him. But as the venerable Ānanda began to walk right in front of him, the brahmin saw him and said to a brahmin youth: "Brahmin youth, go and jab the head of this shaven-headed ascetic with a shoulder-pole." The venerable Ānanda, hearing this, said: "Why send the wretch? Come yourself!" When these words were spoken, the brahmin grew furious and went himself and jabbed Ānanda with a shoulder-pole. Ānanda then seized the brahmin by the arm and said: "Shall I strike back — or shall we go to the king's palace?" And grasping the brahmin by the arm, he dragged him along.

He then called over those brahmin youths, and they too seized the brahmin's other arm and dragged him along. The venerable Ānanda, possessed of great physical strength, took those five hundred brahmin youths and the brahmin and dragged them to the gate of the king's palace, where he sat down.

Now it is the nature of things that whenever the group of six monks sat in anger at the gate of the king's palace, the palace of King Prasenajit would begin to tremble. The king looked and saw this, and said to a man: "Go and look — it seems some of the noble group of six have come to the gate." The man went and looked: the venerable Ānanda was sitting at the gate with some five hundred brahmin youths. He returned and told the king: "Your Majesty, the noble Ānanda is at the royal gate." The king said: "Invite him inside." Ānanda came in and said: "Your Majesty, had the noble Ānanda not gone forth into homelessness, what would he have become?" "A noble wheel-turning king." "And what would I have become?" "A minister, noble one." "Your Majesty, you granted monks as servants for princes and nuns as attendants for

the queen's retinue. And yet, treating us in this way, a single brahmin has struck Your Majesty and jabbed the teacher Ānanda twice with a shoulder-pole, and when I became angry at this he struck me too with a shoulder-pole."

The king, furious, issued a command to his ministers: "Go and cut off that brahmin's hand." They took him and went to the marketplace. When the brahmin's father and mother heard of this, they gathered with friends, siblings, and relatives, and went weeping to the marketplace speaking soft and piteous words and wailing "O my child!" There, together with the crowd, they spoke to the minister: "Good sir, since this brahmin has committed an offense against a god and since cutting off a hand is appropriate, yet as this brahmin earns his living by his hands, it would be fitting to cut off his left hand." So they cut off his left hand. Then, some time later, that same brahmin was seen going about with his left arm bandaged, writing and teaching the brahmin youths with his right hand.

Some time after that, Ānanda saw this, grew very angry, went before the king, and said: "This is a king's happiness? If the firm fruit of a royal command is reduced to this, then even that is nothing to His Majesty." The king said: "Noble one, what has happened?" Ānanda replied: "Your Majesty, that brahmin's hand was not cut off." The king summoned his ministers and said: "Did you not cut off that brahmin's hand?" The minister replied: "Your Majesty, it was cut off." "Then why does the noble Ānanda speak thus?" The venerable Ānanda said: "Your Majesty, that brahmin goes about managing things with his right hand and has the brahmin youths learning their texts." The minister said: "Your Majesty, the brahmin's father and mother petitioned that since this brahmin earns his living by his hands, the left hand should be cut off — and on account of that I cut off his left hand." The king said: "If his parents caused his left hand to be cut off, I shall have his right hand cut off — go and cut it." The minister went before him and cut off his right hand, and the brahmin sat there with both arms hanging useless.

As he sat there in pain, the venerable Ānanda said: "Brahmin, why do you sit there with your arms dangling, without beating us with a shoulder-pole?" The brahmin was humbled and his arrogance and pride were broken; he sat saying nothing. Then brahmins and householders began to mock, revile, and slander the śramaṇas, the sons of the Śākyaans, saying: "Those sons of the Śākyaans have no compassion — even after punishing him by amputation they still seek to cut further." It was at this juncture that the monks reported the matter to

the Blessed One.

The Blessed One considered the matter and concluded that whatever fault had arisen came from allowing monks to proceed with the cutting off of hands. He therefore thought: "Monks must not cut off hands and feet," and he addressed the monks accordingly: "Monks, this foolish companion has done what is not the work of a śramaṇa. That those who have gone forth into my teaching should engage in such conduct is neither fitting nor appropriate. Therefore monks must not cut off hands and feet. If they do so, it shall become a grave offense."

The monks then raised a doubt, and submitted every aspect of that doubt to the Blessed One, the Buddha: "Venerable One, at that time the brahmin was protected by the venerable Gavampati, while it was his companion Upananda who entirely abandoned him."

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, listen now — it was not only in the present that Gavampati protected and Upananda abandoned. Even in the past it was so. Monks, in former times there was a pleasure grove adorned with a variety of trees, rich in flowers and fruit and water, where a hermit (ṛṣi) dwelt, living on fruit, roots, and water, dressed in grass mat and bark, sitting beneath a wood-apple tree and attending to his own spiritual purpose. From above, a monkey flung a wood-apple fruit, which struck the hermit on the head, and the hermit recited these verses:

What would cause your undoing —
that I shall not do;
what would cause your undoing —
that is exactly what you yourself are doing.

Now, a hunter who had been staying with that hermit had gone out and lost track of his quarry, and so made his way to that dwelling. The hermit had left the foot of the wood-apple tree and gone elsewhere on some business. The hunter, not seeing him, looked around and sat down at the foot of that very wood-apple tree. The monkey then hurled a wood-apple fruit at the hunter's head. The hunter had no hat, and the fruit struck his skull; the pain and distress caused by the blow made him look upward. The moment he caught sight of the monkey he was enraged, and notching a poisoned arrow to his bow, he shot it into the monkey's vitals. The monkey fell to the ground and died.

Monks, what do you think? The hermit of that time and place was none other than this very monk Gavampati. The monkey of that time and place was none other than this very brahmin. The hunter of that time and place was none other than this very Upananda. Even then Gavampati protected, and Upananda abandoned. So too in the present: Gavampati protects, and Upananda abandons."

The summary verse:

Bad lineage and Ācāra together;
a patched robe, contempt,
a fine border region and Supriya,
taking the bowl with a sense of ownership;
Aparājita and Candrarakṣitā —
each stole the cloth of the other's ward.

This summary verse is to be expanded in full exactly as it appears in the second root defeat, with no difference whatsoever.

The summary verse:

Pigs, sugarcane,
a palm tree, a dark Dharma robe, Gavampati;
a vessel smeared with lard,
a fat bowl — beloved of Subhaga.

The Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time a famine struck, and some thieves stole pigs, drove them into a dense thicket, and slaughtered them there. Having killed them, they ate the good meat and discarded the heads, the bones, and the innards.

The practice of the Group of Six was to rise early in the morning, climb up onto a rooftop, and look out in all four directions. Wherever they saw smoke rising or vultures circling, they would all gather and head there. Rising early one morning, they climbed up onto a rooftop and began looking out in all four directions. When they spotted smoke and circling vultures inside a dense thicket, they said to one another: "Friends, there is smoke rising and vultures circling inside that thicket — there may well be something to be found there; let us go."

They went there quickly and found pig heads, bones, and discarded innards. They said to one another: "Friends, we have found something like a windfall —

let us cook it and eat it." As they were gathering these things up and boiling them, the owners of the pigs came searching and arrived on the scene. When they saw the Group of Six eating the pork, they said: "Noble ones, even while bearing the victory banner of the holy life, do you do such things as this?" The monks replied: "Good sirs, if we were fit to kill, could we not slaughter fine, fine game and eat good meat ourselves? Why should we gather and boil heads, bones, and innards? These things were stolen and eaten by someone who had not been given them, and then thrown away — we have merely picked them up as one picks up a windfall." The pig owners said: "Noble ones, even if that is so, you are nonetheless those who have gone forth into renunciation, and this is not fitting," and with that criticism having been voiced, the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, a monk must not pick up a windfall of that kind. If he does, it becomes an offense requiring expiation."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. Those who take what is not given stole sugarcane, ate it, and then discarded the roots, the small stalks, and the shoots. The Group of Six, wandering about and teasing one another, went in that direction. When they saw these remnants, they said to one another: "Friends, here is something like a windfall — let us pick it up." As they began to do so, the guards of the sugarcane came searching and arrived on the scene. When they saw the Group of Six picking up the sugarcane roots, small stalks, and shoots, one of them said: "Noble ones, even while bearing the victory banner of the holy life, do you commit such sinful acts?" The monks replied: "Good sir, if we were fit to take what is not given, could we not choose carefully and pluck fine sugarcane, or even scatter jewels, pearls, and other precious things? Someone who takes what is not given stole the cane and ate it — we have only now gathered up the roots and the small tips and stalks." The guards said: "Noble ones, even if that is so, you are nonetheless those who have gone forth into renunciation, and this is not fitting." The monks sat there without saying anything further, and then the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, a monk must not pick up a windfall of that kind. If a monk does pick up such a windfall, it becomes an offense requiring expiation."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. Those who take what is not given stole palm fruits, carried them into a dense forest, chose the best ones and ate them, and

discarded the refuse. The Group of Six, wandering about and teasing one another, went in that direction. When they saw these remnants, they said to one another:

"Joyful and Delight-in-Joy, let us gather these windfalls as though they were rags." When they began to gather them, the guardian of the palm grove arrived on his rounds and saw the Group of Six picking up the crown cuttings and dregs of the palm trees. He said: "Noble ones, kings among the ascetics of the forest! Though you wear the marks of renunciation, do you still perform such sinful deeds as these?" They replied: "Good fellow, if we were permitted to take what is not given, could we not simply choose and select fine palm fruits, and indeed scatter abroad jewels, pearls, and other precious things? Some thieves stole these things by taking what was not given, and we have merely gathered up what they left behind." The guardian replied: "Even if that is so, you who have gone forth into renunciation — this is not fitting." They said nothing further and sat there quietly.

At that juncture, the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks must not pick up windfalls of that kind. If a monk does pick up such a windfall, it becomes an offense requiring expiation."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time in Śrāvastī there was a young incense-seller who had a fine woolen shawl, and he had become extremely attached to it. Then on another occasion he fell ill, and, as much as those dear to him would mourn for other possessions, for this shawl there was no grief. Though medicines were made from roots, stems, leaves, flowers, and fruits, none of them availed him. When the time came that he understood the state of his body, he gathered his relatives and said: "When I die, do not cremate me; instead, wrap me in this shawl and cast me out in the charnel ground." They sighed and said: "Do not be afraid — not everyone who is struck by illness dies; some recover." But when his life ran out and he perished, and neither care nor tending helped, he died. Because of his intense attachment to the shawl, he was reborn among the hungry ghosts who possess dangling gullets. His relatives wrapped the corpse in blue, yellow, red, and white cloth, wound that very shawl around it, and cast it in the charnel ground.

A group of monks saw this and said to the monk who worked in the charnel ground — whose name was Nāgānanda — "Venerable one, the young incense-seller has died; his relatives wrapped him in a shawl and cast him in

the charnel ground. Go and pick up that windfall of rags." He quickly went to the charnel ground and took up the shawl, whereupon a non-human being said to him: "Noble Nāgānanda, do not carry off my shawl." Most who dwell in charnel grounds are brave of heart, so he said to the being: "Wretch, because of your extreme attachment to this shawl you were reborn among the hungry ghosts with dangling gullets. Do you now wish to be reborn in hell as well? Let it go!" Yet the being would not release it. So great was the being's attachment that it struck the monk with its fist, snatched the shawl back, and carried it off. The monk went to the Jeta Grove.

The being followed him, wailing, crying out all the way: "Noble Nāgānanda, please give back the shawl!" He ignored it and entered the Jeta Grove. Now in the Jeta Grove there dwelt gods, nāgas, and yakṣas who had faith in the Buddha, and the being, being of scant power, was unable to enter. It remained at the gate of the Jeta Grove, wailing. The Blessed Buddhas, though they know all, feign not to know, and so the Blessed One asked the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, why is there a non-human being at the gate of the Jeta Grove?" Ānanda replied:

"Venerable Nāgānanda has taken its shawl." The Blessed One considered the matter, thinking: "This non-human being is crying as it does from such intense longing, and there exists the possibility that, if it does not recover the shawl, it will vomit hot blood and die." With that thought, he spoke to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, go to the monk Nāgānanda and give this non-human being back its shawl. If the shawl is not given to it, it will certainly vomit hot blood and die. When you give it, tell it to move on ahead. When it has gone to the charnel ground, tell it to lie down, and when it lies down, drape the shawl over it." The venerable Ānanda replied: "As you command, venerable one." He listened to the Blessed One and went to where the venerable Nāgānanda was, and when he arrived he said to him: "Venerable Nāgānanda, please take note. The Blessed One has declared from his own mouth: give this non-human being back its shawl. If you do not give it the shawl, it will certainly vomit hot blood and die. When you give it, tell it to move on ahead. When it has gone to the charnel ground, tell it to lie down, and when it lies down, drape the shawl over it. That is what was declared." The venerable Ānanda conveyed exactly what the Blessed One had said.

The venerable Ānanda then departed, and Nāgānanda said to the non-human being: "If you want the shawl, move ahead and I will give it to you." It moved ahead. Then he said: "If you want the shawl, lie down." It lay down, and he

draped the shawl over it. The non-human being then pressed and kneaded him with its foot, and since he was endowed with power, he was overpowered by it.

This matter was then reported to the monks, and the monks informed the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, one should not hesitantly take or give a corpse's garment. If one is to take it, one should go from the feet to the head and take it. Whoever gives it should also go from the head to the feet and give it. Monks, there are five faults in a corpse's garment: it is of poor color, it has an unpleasant smell, it is old and worn, it is full of lice, and it is not tolerated by yakṣas. Nevertheless, a shroud-gatherer should not take a corpse's garment as long as the wound has not opened." The Blessed One declared that one should not take garments from a corpse before the wound has opened.

Then the group of six took a dog with them and went out, and those without faith, seeing them, said: "Noble ones, why are you leading a dog out to the wilderness? Are you going to take a life?" These monks gave back an impertinent reply. The matter was then brought before the Blessed One by the monks, and the Blessed One declared: "One should not go about leading a dog."

Then those monks used a weapon to open a wound and took the garment. The Blessed One declared: "One should not open a wound with a weapon and take it. However, once maggots and ants have fed upon it, then one may take it." Those monks took it and wore it just as it was. The Blessed One declared: "One should not wear it just as it is. Rather, one should leave it in an isolated place for seven or eight days, and when it has been dried out by wind and sun, one should wash it, boil it, and then wear it." Those monks put it on and entered the temple, prostrating before the stūpas. The monks then brought this before the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared:

"I shall establish a code of conduct for monks who are charnel-ground dwellers. A monk who is a charnel-ground dweller, having taken a corpse's cloth, should not go to a temple. He should not prostrate before stūpas. Even if he does prostrate, he should not approach within one armspan of the stūpa. He should not make use of dwelling quarters. He should not sit on a bed or seat. He should not sit within the Saṅgha assembly. He should not teach the Dharma to brahmins or householders who have come and arrived. He should not go to the homes of brahmins or householders. If he does go, he should remain at the door. If a householder says, 'Noble one, please come inside,' he

should say, 'I am a charnel-ground dweller.' If the householder then says, 'Noble one, such ones as yourself, who have properly undertaken the qualities of training, have entered the home — would it not be that my gains are well gained?' then he may enter, but he should not sit on a seat. If the householder says, 'Noble one, please be seated,' he should say, 'I am a charnel-ground dweller.' If the householder then says, 'Noble one, such ones as yourself, who have properly undertaken the qualities of training, who use the seat and dwell in the home — would it not be that my gains are well gained?' then he may sit there, and need not feel regret about it. If a monk who is a charnel-ground dweller, having properly received the code of conduct just as it has been established, does not put it into practice, he commits an offense."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the pleasure grove of Prince Jeta. Some monks were leaving needles and blades scattered about in disarray, and these were being swallowed by rats. The monks then brought this before the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One should not leave them scattered about in disarray; rather, one should store them in a container." When the Blessed One had declared that they should be stored in a container, the monks did not know what kind of container to make. The Blessed One declared: "Smear a piece of cloth with monkey fat, and place the needles and blades inside it."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the pleasure grove of Prince Jeta. At Śrāvastī there was a nun named Pom Gamo. At a certain time, another nun, faint with thirst and wishing to drink water, went to her and said, "Noble sister, I am thirsty — please lend me your drinking bowl." She replied, "It is right here — go fetch it yourself." The other nun took it and went, but it slipped from her hands, fell, and broke, and she sat there in silence. At another time, Pom Gamo remembered this, went to that nun, and said, "Noble sister, please return the bowl you took." The other replied, "Noble sister, I am sorry, but it slipped from my hands and broke. I will buy another and offer it to you." Pom Gamo said, "Give me that very one" — and she harassed and tormented her over it for a long time. At that time the nuns reported this to the monks, and the monks brought it before the Blessed One. The Blessed One considered the matter, and understood: "Whatever fault has arisen has come about through nuns drinking from a bowl. Therefore nuns should not drink water from a bowl." He then declared to the monks: "Whatever fault has arisen has come about through nuns drinking water from a bowl. Therefore nuns should not

drink water from a bowl, and neither should they eat or drink other things from it. If a nun drinks water from a bowl or eats or drinks anything else from it, she commits an offense."

The summary verse:

Taking a picture-fort, fire, and —
bathing, obstruction, and a bowl —
not leftovers, a bowl as base,
feet not placed, and sandals too.

The Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada (Anāthapiṇḍada, the householder known as "feeder of the destitute"). At the time when the householder Anāthapiṇḍada had offered the Jeta Grove to the Saṅgha of the four directions, the thought arose in him: "Without paintings it is unattractive. Therefore, if the Blessed One permits it, I shall have it painted." Knowing this, he went to where the Blessed One was, arrived there, prostrated with his head at the Blessed One's feet, and sat down to one side. Sitting to one side, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada spoke these words to the Blessed One: "Reverend Sir, this Jeta Grove, being without paintings, is unattractive. For that reason, if the Blessed One permits it, I would have it painted." The Blessed One declared: "Householder, in that case, permission is granted — have it painted."

Having declared permission to paint it, Anāthapiṇḍada also gathered pigments and summoned the painters, and said to them: "Friends, the Blessed One has granted permission. Therefore, using these pigments, paint the Jeta Grove." They said: "Householder, for the painting, tell us: in which location should what be painted?" He replied: "Friends, I do not know — wait while I ask the Blessed One." They said: "Householder, very well — please do so, and we shall wait." He then went before the Blessed One, prostrated with his head at the Blessed One's feet, and submitted: "Blessed One, I have gathered the pigments and summoned the painters. They ask through me: 'Householder, in which location should what be painted?' Therefore, out of compassion, may the Blessed One please declare in which location what should be painted." The Blessed One declared: "Householder, if that is so, then go and have the following executed: At the outer gateway, a yakṣa (yakṣa) holding a staff. In the gatehouse, a great miracle scene and the five-part wheel of cyclic existence. In the cloisters, a garland of the Jātaka stories. At the door of the bathing chamber, yakṣas holding garlands. In the monks' residence halls, elder monks engaged in

establishing the Dharma. In the pantry area, yakṣas holding food. At the door of the storehouse, yakṣas holding iron hooks. In the water hall, nāgas (nāgas) holding vases, adorned with various ornaments. In the bathing house or the warming room, stories drawn from divine sūtras, or alternatively, stories of the hells. In the infirmary, the Tathāgata acting as nurse to the sick. At the latrine site, a charnel ground that inspires great dread. At the door of the dwelling rooms, paint skeletons and skulls." The Blessed One then said: "Reverend Sir, I request this." The householder Anāthapiṇḍada, having listened to the Blessed One, had everything executed exactly as specified.

Then, at the time when the householder Anāthapiṇḍada had the Jeta Grove painted, some monks who were residing there carelessly lit fires, and the smoke damaged the paintings and rendered them unsightly. At that occasion, the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, I grant permission for a fire room. Any monk who needs a fire should light it in the fire room — not in a good dwelling. Lighting a fire in a good dwelling would create a serious offense."

When the Blessed One had declared that fires should be lit in the fire room and not in a good dwelling, some other monks who were residing there fell ill and suffered from cold. The Blessed One declared: "Those monks who suffer from cold may light a smokeless fire outside the assembly hall or beside a pond, and place a warming vessel inside."

The monks then bathed in a good dwelling and damaged the paintings. The Blessed One declared: "Do not bathe in a good dwelling. Rather, bathe in one corner of the pond that does not fall within the Teacher's line of sight, or else build a bathhouse and bathe there."

When the ground became muddy, the Blessed One declared: "Spread a layer of pig bristles in that area."

When water pooled up, the Blessed One declared: "Dig a drain channel for the water."

Having declared that a drain channel should be dug, the mouth of the drain became blocked. The Blessed One declared: "Clear it regularly, and bathe right at the mouth of the drain channel."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada.

At Śrāvastī, the son of a brahmin fell ill and went to a physician and said: "May you be blessed! May you be blessed!" The physician replied: "Good sir, please say what you wish." The man said: "I myself have no desire for merit whatsoever, yet my son has been struck by such and such an illness — please prescribe a medicine for him." The physician was a person of faith, and so he said: "Brahmin, go to the presence of the noble ones and request water from their alms bowls. Have him bathed in that, and he will recover." The brahmin said, "May you be blessed!" and set off for the Jeta Grove.

Now the behavior of the group of six monks was such that whichever one of them it happened to be never left the gate of the Jeta Grove unoccupied. The venerable Nanda was standing at the gate of the Jeta Grove when he saw that brahmin and said: "Great brahmin, welcome! Welcome! You are like the moon — it has been a long time since you came from afar. Noble one, I pay homage to you. It is good to see you after such a long time — if one sees a person again and again, one comes to look down on them. For what purpose have you come?"

"Noble one, my son has been struck by a very serious illness. The physician has indicated that I should take water from the alms bowl of the noble ones, bathe him in it, and he will recover. I have come here for the purpose of obtaining water from an alms bowl — please grant me some."

He replied: "So you have come here for water from an alms bowl! Noble one, yes, that is indeed the purpose. If that is so, wait here, and I shall fetch you water from the alms bowl." Saying this, he went inside.

He ate his meal, washed his alms bowl, and poured into it a small amount of bones, raw meat, fish scraps, a grain-paste gruel, flour, bark fibers, and dregs. Then he came back out and said: "Brahmin, take this alms bowl water."

When the brahmin saw it, he said: "Noble one, this is like the water used to wash a corpse — it is impure and it is not fitting to bathe my son in such a thing."

The venerable Nanda said: "You who possess such faith — your son is already cured."

The brahmin then became incensed. At that time the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One considered the matter. Whatever slight fault had arisen had come about because monks were discarding the leftover rinse water from their alms bowls.

For that reason, the Blessed One considered that monks should not discard the leftover rinse water from their alms bowls, and he declared to the monks: "Monks, for this reason a monk must not discard the leftover rinse water from his alms bowl. If he does so, he commits an offense. However, I shall establish a code of conduct for monks who give away alms-bowl water: a monk who gives away alms-bowl water shall wash the alms bowl three times, then shall praise the alms-bowl water by reciting a verse from the sacred scriptures over it, and only then give it away. If a monk who gives away alms-bowl water does not properly take up the code of conduct as it has been established, he commits an offense."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the pleasure grove of Prince Jeta.

Some monks placed their alms bowls on the ground as a base and ate their meals, and when brahmins and householders saw this they reproached them, saying: "The ascetics who are sons of the Śākya are unclean — they place their alms bowls on the ground as a base and eat their meals." When the monks reported this to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "Monks, the reproach of the brahmins and householders is fitting. Therefore a monk must not place his alms bowl on the ground as a base and eat. If a monk places his alms bowl on the ground as a base and eats, he commits an offense."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Vaiśālī, in the Monkey Pond Pavilion, the many-storied building.

Some monks ate their meals without removing their sandals, and when brahmins and householders saw this they reproached them, saying: "The ascetics who are sons of the Śākya are unclean — they eat without removing their sandals." When the monks reported this to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "Monks, the reproach of the brahmins and householders is fitting. Therefore a monk must not eat without removing his sandals. If a monk eats without removing his sandals, he commits an offense."

When the Blessed One had declared that monks must not eat without removing their sandals, the monks took off their sandals and began to eat, and in the course of this some fell ill. The monks then reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Those who are sick may eat without removing their sandals, and in this regard there is no cause for remorse."

Summary verse:

Without an alms bowl, and with a famous elder,
during the rains retreat, and without a fixed dwelling,
and for five years having one and the same source of support,
the lungs, the back, the waist, and the head.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the pleasure grove of Prince Jeta.

A certain person who had been ordained by Ānanda had not previously set an alms bowl in readiness. So when the time for the monks' meal arrived, all the monks washed their own alms bowls, set them on the ground as a base, and went to pay their respects at the stūpa. He then thought: "There are so many alms bowls here — surely whoever takes any one of them will eat from it and then set it back in the very same place. Therefore I too shall take one for now and put it back afterward." With that thought, he began to take the alms bowl of the elder Kuṇḍinya, who is known as Ājñāta Kuṇḍinya. Then another monk said to him: "Venerable one, this alms bowl belongs to the elder Ājñāta Kuṇḍinya — do not take it." He set it down, and then reached for the alms bowls of the venerable Aśvajit, the venerable Bhadrīka, the venerable Vāṣpa, the venerable Mahānāman, the venerable Gavāmpati, the venerable Vimāla, the venerable Gavāmpati, the venerable Subāhu, and

he began to reach for the alms bowls of certain other monks. The monks said to him: "Venerable one, if you have no alms bowl, who gave you full ordination without an alms bowl?" He replied: "The preceptor Nanda did." The monks reproached him, saying: "Who but someone of utterly depraved conduct would ordain someone without an alms bowl?" At that juncture the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "A monk must not confer full ordination on one who has no alms bowl. To do so constitutes an offense. One who confers full ordination must ensure that the candidate is provided with the six requisites."

The venerable Upāli then addressed the Blessed Buddha with this question: "Blessed One, if monks were to confer full ordination on someone who has no alms bowl, should the ordination be called a full ordination? Upāli asks: is it a full ordination? Those who perform the ordination incur an offense." He continued: "Blessed One, if monks were to confer full ordination using a small alms bowl, a large alms bowl, or a clay alms bowl, should it be called a full ordination? Upāli asks: is it a full ordination? Those who perform the ordination incur an offense."

At that time the Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in Prince Jeta's park. At that time, a man known as a notorious thief was caught in the act of stealing. He dropped the stolen goods and fled. Exhausted from his flight, he sat down in a thoughtful daze beside a roadside tree along the path to the Jeta Grove, leaning his arm against its trunk. The venerable Upāli, having dressed in his lower robe early that morning and taken up his alms bowl and outer robe, was setting out toward Śrāvastī to go on alms round. He saw the man and said to him: "Venerable one, who are you?" The man replied: "Noble one, I am a destitute man with no one to protect me — I have nothing at all." Upāli said: "Good friend, if that is so, why do you not go forth into the renunciant life?" The man replied: "Noble one, since you yourself have gone forth, let me speak plainly for a moment: I am known as a notorious thief — who would ordain me? The teaching of the Blessed One is opened by compassion, but would anyone truly ordain me?" Upāli said: "Take heart. I will ordain you." The man replied: "Noble one, excellent — I will go forth."

Upāli then gave him the going-forth and conferred full ordination upon him, and said: "Good friend, a deer does not rear a deer. Make your living on alms rounds through the wide reaches of Śrāvastī, your own domain, your home territory." He then dressed in his lower robe that same morning, took up his alms bowl and outer robe, and entered Śrāvastī to go on alms round. While he was going about on his alms round, the brahmins and householders recognized him. Some of them said: "Wise ones, this is the notorious thief — and he has gone forth!" Others said: "The Dharma of the Śākyan ascetics is fine indeed: they even ordain notorious thieves. These people go about the houses by day disguised in the equipment of alms-seeking, then come back at night to steal."

At that juncture the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One reflected: "Whatever fault has arisen has come about from monks ordaining someone who is a notorious thief. Therefore monks must not ordain one who is known as a notorious thief." Having reflected thus, he declared to the monks: "Monks, the reproach of the brahmins and householders has indeed reached us. Therefore a monk must not confer full ordination on someone who is known as a notorious thief."

When the Blessed One declared that a monk must not confer full ordination on one who is known as a notorious thief, the monks did not ordain even those who were not manifestly thieves, and their going-forth and full ordination were

thereby obstructed. On that occasion the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One who is manifestly a thief must not be ordained; one who is not manifestly so may be ordained. Therefore, when someone who wishes to go forth approaches any suitable person, that person must ask him: 'Are you not someone known as a notorious thief?' If one confers ordination without asking, it becomes an offence."

The Minor Matters of the Vinaya, the Twentieth Fascicle.

The Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time a number of monks were residing together at a certain dwelling. When the residential preceptor of that place passed away and those monks did not know to whom they should make a request for their immediate needs, nor with whom they should reside, they reported the matter to the monks. The monks then reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Those monks should seek another monk by relinquishing the assignment of a monk, relinquishing the dwelling, relinquishing the bedding, and relinquishing the attendant. If one is found, that is well. If none is found, those monks must not remain in that dwelling until a second observance day, for if they do remain it becomes an offence."

Other monks at a certain place wished to commit to spending the rains retreat with a particular residential preceptor, but that preceptor also passed away, and those monks did not know how to proceed. On that occasion the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Those monks as well should seek another monk by relinquishing the assignment of a monk, relinquishing the dwelling, relinquishing the bedding, and relinquishing the attendant. If one is found, that is well. If none is found, those monks must not make a commitment to enter the earlier rains retreat at that place; if they do make such a commitment, it becomes an offence."

Other monks at a certain place had already committed to spending the earlier rains retreat with a particular residential preceptor, but that preceptor also passed away, and those monks did not know how to proceed. On that occasion the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Those monks as well should seek another monk by relinquishing the assignment of a monk, relinquishing the dwelling, relinquishing the bedding, and relinquishing the attendant. If one is found, that is well. If none is found, those monks must not remain there; they should go elsewhere and commit to entering the later rains retreat for the nearby preparations of the second

period. If they remain there, it becomes an offence."

Other monks at a certain place wished to commit to spending the rains retreat with a particular residential preceptor, but that preceptor also passed away, and those monks again did not know how to proceed. On that occasion the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Those monks as well should seek another monk by relinquishing the assignment of a monk, relinquishing the dwelling, relinquishing the bedding, and relinquishing the attendant.

If another monk is found, that is well and good. If one is not found, those monks should not commit to spending the earlier rains retreat there, for if they do commit, it will become an offence.

Other monks at a certain place had committed to spending the later rains retreat with a particular residential preceptor, and that preceptor also passed away, and those monks likewise did not know how to proceed. On that occasion the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Those monks should remain for up to two months inquiring of one another and examining each other individually. After the two months have passed, they should seek another monk by relinquishing the assignment of a monk, relinquishing the dwelling, relinquishing the bedding, and relinquishing the attendant. If one is found, that is well and good. If one is not found, those monks should not remain in that place until the second restoration ceremony, for if they remain, it will become an offence."

Other monks at a certain place had been given the going forth (pravrajyā) and full ordination by a particular monk, and that preceptor passed away, and those monks as well did not know how to proceed. From that point onward, everything is to be stated just as before, up through what is said regarding the preceptor.

The Blessed One Śākyamuni was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the Garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At a certain place called Riyor, a householder who lived there had a temple built, filled it with all manner of requisites, and offered it to the Saṅgha of monks from the four directions. Then at some later time, that householder was arrested at the royal palace, and the monks heard of this. Upon hearing it, they abandoned the temple and fled, and those who received without giving — taking what belonged to the Three Jewels — stole it. Then at some point the householder was released, and the monks heard that the owner of the temple had been set free, and they

went to that householder. The householder had already heard beforehand how the monks had abandoned the temple and fled, and that those who received without giving had stolen what belonged to the Three Jewels, and so he reproved them: "Noble ones, why did you flee?" They replied: "We heard how you were arrested at the royal palace, and upon hearing that we became frightened and fled." The householder said: "Noble ones, even if I was arrested at the royal palace, why should you flee on that account? If my relatives were not arrested, would they not have provided you with requisites?" The monks had no answer and said nothing. On that occasion the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One should not flee in that manner. However, one should ask the relatives of the owner of the temple: 'Since the owner of the temple has been arrested in the royal palace, are you able to provide us with our alms-round requisites?' If they can provide them, that is well and good. If they cannot, one should go on alms-round and remain there for up to five years. If after five years the owner of the temple is released, that is well and good. If he is not released, then, having performed a motion-and-one-proclamation act, one should stay for another five years together with those who maintain the subsidiary temples surrounding that temple and who have separate acquisitions and separate restoration ceremonies. The act is to be performed as follows: in the subsidiary temples, bedding is to be set out, the gong is to be struck, and the monks are to be properly informed by means of the words of inquiry; then, with the entire Saṅgha assembled and convened, one monk should make a motion and perform the act.

'May the venerable Saṅgha please hear.

The king has seized ownership of a certain great temple. If the time is right for the Saṅgha and they are willing, let the Saṅgha give its consent, and let the Saṅgha make that temple one that shares acquisitions and has a separate restoration ceremony from these temples. This is the motion. The act is to be performed as follows: May the venerable Saṅgha please hear. The king has seized ownership of a certain great temple. Therefore, if the Saṅgha were to make that temple one that shares acquisitions and has a separate restoration ceremony from these temples, then let those venerable ones who are willing that that temple share acquisitions and have a separate restoration ceremony from these temples remain silent, and let those who are not willing speak. The Saṅgha has consented and agreed, and the Saṅgha has made a certain great temple one that shares acquisitions and has a separate restoration ceremony.

Thus, since no one has spoken, so it is held.

If, in that way, the owner of the temple comes to those who have remained for up to ten years, that is well and good. But if he does not come, bedding, vessels, and utensils are to be placed in the subsidiary temples surrounding that temple, the inner door is to be closed, and one should depart. When the owner of the temple eventually releases it, the articles that were deposited in the subsidiary temples are to be retrieved and given back to that same place. If the monks residing in the subsidiary temples hand them over, that is well and good; but if they do not hand them over, they will be guilty of an offence.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the park of Prince Jeta. The group of six monks were seen carrying loads with their bodies by brahmins and householders, who then mocked them, saying: "Noble ones, we are householders living at home, and yet we carry loads with our bodies for the sake of our fathers and mothers, sons and daughters, male servants and female servants, laborers, dependants, kings, gods, the spirits of the deceased, ascetics, and brahmins. For whose sake do you carry loads? They sit there saying nothing." On that occasion the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, the mocking by the brahmins and householders is entirely appropriate. Therefore, monks must not carry loads with their bodies. If a monk carries a load with his body, he will be guilty of an offence." When the Blessed One had declared that monks must not carry loads with their bodies, the group of six then began carrying loads on their backs, on their hips, under their arms, and on their heads, thereby incurring that very same fault. The Blessed One then declared: "One must not carry a load on the back, on the hip, under the arm, or on the head. If one does so, one will be guilty of an offence."

Summary verse:

Dwelling place and six utensils,
then seizing from that place,
enticing and taking, the five,
and cooking shelter, doorway, and place of walking.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the park of Prince Jeta. At that time a brahmin who wished to go forth came to the Jeta Grove, and he saw a number of monks carrying their alms bowls in their hands, holding rinsing vessels, and setting

out for alms. He thought to himself: "Let me ask where these people are going." So he asked them: "Noble ones, where are you going?" They replied: "Brahmin, we are going for alms." He then asked: "Do all monks go for alms?" They replied:

"As for monks who have spiritual friends among brahmins, brahmins and householders bring alms to the monastery and offer them there. Those who have no such friends go for alms."

He thought to himself: "What difference is there between going forth among the ascetics who are sons of the Śākya? I too should go for alms in the same way." Then he thought again: "First let me ask another monk whether they have gone forth on the basis of alms alone, or whether there is something else as well." So he went to a monk, and that monk welcomed him properly with the full customary greeting for a visitor, and then said: "Brahmin, from where have you come, and why have you come here?" He replied: "Noble one, I came simply to see you; but first I wish to ask what you have gone forth on the basis of." The monk said: "Brahmin, excellent, excellent! Your thinking is sound — sit down and we shall speak." The brahmin who wished to go forth paid homage at the monk's feet and sat before him. The monk said: "Brahmin, these four are the prescribed supports in which, within the well-taught Dharma and Vinaya as proclaimed by the Blessed One, one goes forth, receives full ordination, and stands as a monk. Brahmin, what are the four? The Blessed One declared that among robes, a cast-off rag robe is suitable and easy to come by; abiding in that, a monk who has gone forth and received full ordination in the well-taught Dharma and Vinaya becomes a true monk. Among foods, alms; among lodgings, the foot of a tree; and among medicines, fermented urine that has been discarded — these are suitable and easy to come by. Abiding in those, a monk who has gone forth and received full ordination in the well-taught Dharma and Vinaya becomes a true monk. Brahmin, these are the four prescribed supports the Blessed One has established for us; abiding in these, we who have gone forth and received full ordination in the well-taught Dharma and Vinaya become true monks."

The brahmin said: "Noble one, who could sustain life on these supports? I had come here thinking to go forth, but since going forth is so arduous, I pay my respects and take my leave." So saying, he departed.

Now that very matter became an obstacle between going forth, receiving full ordination, and becoming a monk. At that time the monks reported the matter

to the Blessed One. The Blessed One reflected: "Whatever slight fault has arisen has come about from proclaiming the four supports only to those who have not yet gone forth. Therefore a monk should not proclaim the four supports to one who has not gone forth or has not received full ordination. Only at the time when one has gone forth and received full ordination should the four supports be proclaimed. To proclaim the four supports to one who has not gone forth and not received full ordination constitutes a serious transgression."

The occasion is at Śrāvastī.

At Śrāvastī a householder who lived there took a wife from a family of equal rank, and he sported with her, delighted in her, and enjoyed her company. From his sporting, delighting, and enjoying her company — as described before — a child was born, given a name befitting the family, and was raised and grew up. Then at another time the father passed away, and the son thought: "Father has passed away, and matters have become difficult. I shall go to the Jeta Grove and go forth." So he went to the Jeta Grove.

The conduct of the Group of Six is this: one or another of the Group of Six would keep the gate of the Jeta Grove unguarded. The venerable Ānanda was sitting at the gate, and when he saw the young man approaching he said: "Welcome, good-looking one! It has been a long while — where have you come from?" The young man replied: "Noble one, it is good to see someone after a long time, but seeing them again and again leads to contempt. Nevertheless, noble one, I wish to go forth — please ordain me." Ānanda said: "Good-looking one, your intention is excellent, and going forth is the highest thing. The Blessed One has said that a wise person who sees five benefits should be disposed to go forth" — and so on, from that point up to "the buddhas and the noble persons who have genuinely entered upon the path, the blessed disciples of the buddhas," just as before. "Therefore, go forth and be well ordained. However, for that one needs the six requisites — do you have the six requisites?" "Noble one, what are those six requisites?" "Good-looking one, they are: the alms bowl, the water strainer, the three robes, and the sitting cloth." "Noble one, I do not have them." "Good-looking one, I too do not have them at hand — go for now, and I will seek out the six requisites."

The young man then left his father behind and went to his relatives. When they heard that the boy was about to go forth, they took a wife for him. Meanwhile the venerable Ānanda set down the six requisites and entered

Śrāvastī for alms. While doing so he saw the young man in the street and said: "Good-looking one, I have obtained the six requisites — come here, let us go and take them." The young man replied: "Noble one, I too have obtained six requisites." Ānanda said: "Good-looking one, what sort of things?" The young man replied: "Noble one, eye, ear, nose, tongue, body, and mind." Ānanda said: "Good-looking one, what does that mean?" The young man replied: "Noble one, my relatives have taken a wife for me — how then can I go forth now?"

That very matter became an obstacle to his going forth and to his receiving full ordination and becoming a monk. At that juncture the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, monks, I permit that one may confer going forth and full ordination after the six requisites have been set aside. Since going forth, receiving full ordination, and attaining the status of a monk in this well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya is something difficult to obtain, let the six requisites be sought out one by one and then, once set aside, returned."

The occasion is at Śrāvastī.

At that time a great many monks were travelling through the countryside on a journey, and some thieves attacked them and took what they had stolen away, bringing it to the Jeta Grove to sell. The very monks who had been attacked then arrived there, and recognizing their own alms bowls and robes, they cried out: "O wise ones, these men have stolen our alms bowls and robes! Seize the thieves! Seize them!" Upon hearing the outcry, the thieves became frightened and fled. The monks took back their own alms bowls and robes respectively, but then they sat uncertain whether these items were now allowable for them or not. At that juncture the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "These belong to whomever they were taken from, and therefore they should not be regarded as suspect." After the Blessed One had declared, "These belong to whomever they were taken from," some other monks, while travelling through the countryside on a journey, were spotted by thieves, and the thieves began to attack them —

The thieves touched with their hands as many of those monks' alms bowls and robes as there were, then abandoned them without a glance and left, so that the monks ended up bereft of their alms bowls and robes. At that juncture the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "For as long as the thieves have taken and carried off the items and the continuity of

their handling has not been broken, one must not disregard them." After the Blessed One had declared, "For as long as the thieves have taken and carried off the items and the continuity of their handling has not been broken, one must not disregard them," those very thieves carried off what they had seized and entered Śrāvastī, where they began selling it in the market. The monks recognised what had been seized, and having recognised it, they brought those thieves before the royal court. There the thieves were made to suffer acutely with various kinds of pain — execution, imprisonment, mutilation, fines, and the like. At that juncture the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One should not denounce them at the royal court. Rather, one should first speak to them with the Dharma and urge them. If they do not give the items back, one may recover them by paying half the price. If they still do not return them, one should pay the full price and take them back — for monks, alms bowls and robes that have been well made are difficult to come by." The context is Śrāvastī.

Monks abandoned dry excrement, tooth-cleaning sticks, painting-palette scrapers, and the like without looking back at them, and when some monks did not pick them up out of scrupulousness, those things were in that very place eaten away by water. At that juncture the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Taking with five kinds of mental engagement is allowable — namely, taking with the thought that the person is a friend, or agreeable, or a senior, or one to be remembered, or that upon hearing of it they will be pleased. That is a proper taking, and one should feel no remorse over it." The context is Śrāvastī.

The Blessed One declared that the work of dyeing should be done. The monks dyed robes in the gatehouse and in the walking-meditation areas, and those robes were hit by dust and soaked by dirty rain. At that juncture the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "The dyeing work should be done inside the monastery." When the monks began doing the dyeing work inside the monastery, the brahmins and householders saw that the runoff from the dye pools appeared blood-red and said: "Noble ones, are goats and sheep being slaughtered over here?" The monks replied: "Friends, we have been doing dyeing work here, so here there is dye-water." Those people said: "Noble ones, if the dye has gone into the soil and appears unpleasant to the senior monks, please pour it out on the ground." At that juncture the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Apply it layer upon layer." When they applied it everywhere in that

way, the stone floors became unusable. The Blessed One then declared: "If there are stone floors, wash them. Otherwise apply it layer upon layer."

The summary verse:

Permission to plant trees was granted,
along with nameru robes,
and the long-tailed garment — in verse
these are gathered and summarised correctly.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Rājagṛha in the Bamboo Grove, the place where the kalandaka birds stay. At the time when the Blessed One established Śakra, lord of the gods (Indra), in truth on Vulture's Peak, King Bimbisāra arranged a festival there, and all the crowds of people dwelling in the land of Magadha assembled there.

Vulture's Peak was rocky and bare of trees, and the crowds of people dwelling in the land of Magadha were scorched by the heat and said, "Noble ones, please grow trees here." The monks replied, "Friends, the Blessed One has not permitted it." The people said, "Noble ones, what objection could there be to this?" The monks remained silent. The monks then reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "In that case, permission is given — trees may be grown." When the Blessed One had declared that trees were to be grown, the monks planted trees and watered them, but the trees dried up just as before.

The following year, when the crowds of people dwelling in Magadha came again and were equally tormented by the heat, they said, "Noble ones, did you not plant those trees?" The monks replied, "Friends, we planted them, but because we did not tend them they did not thrive." The people said, "Noble ones, if your own parents had planted you and then failed to tend you, you too would not have thrived. Please do tend them." The monks again reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One must not plant trees and then abandon them to wither; one must tend them." When the Blessed One had declared this, the monks did not know how to tend the trees. The Blessed One declared: "At regular intervals you should water them." The monks took this instruction alone to heart, and their wholesome activities fell into neglect. The Blessed One then declared: "This should not be made the sole occupation. At times wash the hands; at times wash the feet; at times chew tooth-sticks; at times wash the begging bowls; at times bathe. That will count as tending them." In the winter season the trees were scorched by frost,

and the Blessed One declared: "Cover them with straw." When the monks covered them with straw, the trees were scorched by a forest fire. The Blessed One declared: "Surround them with a fence." When the wind did not reach them the trees were burned by heat, and the Blessed One declared: "Make ventilation holes in the fence." During the rains retreat the monks sat with water flooding all around them, and the Blessed One declared: "In the rainy season, breach the wall and drain the water away." The monks abandoned the trees before they had grown large, and the trees dried up as before. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "I shall establish a rule of conduct for monks who plant trees. A monk who plants trees: if he has planted a flowering tree, he must not leave until it has flowered; if he has planted a fruit tree, he must not leave until it has fruited." When the Blessed One had declared that a monk who plants trees must not leave before the flowers or fruit have formed, certain monks had long journeys to make and did not know how to fulfil this obligation. The Blessed One declared: "They may entrust the tree to the caretaker of the monastery or to a monk who can be contacted, and then depart — there is no transgression in this."

The narrative setting for what follows is Rājagṛha. King Śreṇya Bimbisāra sent a precious gem as a gift to King Prasenajit. King Prasenajit gave it to the venerable Pilindavatsa. The venerable Pilindavatsa put it on and went to stay at a forest dwelling.

The thieves had heard exactly what had happened — that King Śreṇya Bimbisāra had sent a precious gem to King Prasenajit, who had given it to the venerable Pilindavatsa, and that he was wearing it while staying at a forest dwelling — and they began to deliberate among themselves. Some said: "What need is there to scheme? Let us simply go there and rob him." They went, knocked softly at the door, and the venerable Pilindavatsa asked, "Who is there?" They replied, "Noble one, we are thieves." "What do you want?" "Noble one, the precious gem." "Very well, good fellows — if that is the case, stretch your hands through the window." One of them extended his hand, and the venerable Pilindavatsa blessed the gem, saying, "May it not cut, may it not burn, and may it not be exhausted when drawn upon," and then passed a portion of it out through the window. The thieves pulled and pulled, making a heap of it, and tried to drag it away — but they could not exhaust it. When they tried to cut it with a weapon, it would not be cut; when they tried to burn it with fire, it would not burn. Then they said, "Noble Pilindavatsa, what use do

you have for us? Let us go." He replied, "Deluded fellows, since you yourselves have not attempted anything against me, how could I have attempted anything against you? If it was by your own strength, your own diligence, and your own superior force that you dragged it, how could I not let it go?" They said, "Wise ones, since the noble Pilindavatsa is of great miraculous power and great might, if we do not depart before he summons those who might seize us, it will not go well for us — let us flee!" And so they fled.

At that time the monks reported what had happened to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One reflected: whatever slight fault had arisen had arisen from a monk of that kind wearing a precious gem and staying at a forest dwelling. Therefore a monk should not bring such precious gems to a forest dwelling. Reflecting thus, he declared to the monks: "Monks, what the monk Pilindavatsa did — wearing such a precious gem and staying at a forest dwelling — was improper. Therefore a monk should not wear such a precious gem and stay at a forest dwelling. If he does so, he incurs an offense. However, if a monk who is living at a forest dwelling happens to possess such a precious gem, he should leave it in a household."

When the Blessed One had declared that such a precious gem should be left in a household, another monk who was staying at a forest dwelling and who had received a gem befitting a great person left it in a household — and then insects infested it. When the monks reported this to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "It should be placed inside a box sealed with nāmeru wood. If that cannot be found, it may be placed inside any wood, or wrapped in leaves of the vāśaka plant or in arista leaves, one layer after another, and kept in that way." When placing it layer by layer was not feasible, the Blessed One declared: "If the means are not at hand, place it on top and dry it out from time to time."

The narrative setting for what follows is Śrāvastī. On the occasion when the householder Anāthapiṇḍada offered a meal in the Jeta Grove to the Saṅgha of monks from the four directions, the Teacher would come at that time in due season, together with the elder monks and elder nuns, to receive reverential salutation.

Then on another occasion, during winter, some monks were overcome by the cold and huddled in their dwellings lying and sitting still. The householder Anāthapiṇḍada, having come to the Jeta Grove to pay reverential salutation at the feet of the Teacher, saw those monks sitting there facing away from the

wholesome direction, and said: "Noble ones, why do you sit facing away from the wholesome direction in the teaching of the Strenuous One?" They replied: "Householder, we are overcome by the cold." Without another word he paid reverence at their feet and departed. He went home and sent five hundred robes to the Saṅgha. The monks trimmed the edges and dyed them with other colors and wore them as they pleased.

Then again, when the householder Anāthapiṇḍada came to pay reverential salutation at the feet of the Teacher, he looked into the monks' dwellings and those robes were nowhere to be seen. He said: "Noble ones, since those robes are not to be found, where have you put them?" They told him what had happened. He said: "Noble ones, you have wasted robes of a quality fitting for a great one. Alas! Please keep such things for a good long while and keep them in good order." They sat there without the confidence to say anything. On that occasion the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore I permit the Saṅgha to keep new robes for a long time, a good long time, before wearing them."

Here ends the Fourth Gate of the Bases of the Minor Vinaya.

The verse of summary:

The body, the discourse, the buddha,
renunciation, and the deceased,
monks outside the boundary —
together with the occasion for a feast and its cause.

A further summary verse:

A corpse is to be cremated;
the stūpa of Śāriputra's son;
the festival to be held there;
and the merchant of conch shells and dried fish.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. A certain householder was living in Śrāvastī. He took a wife of equal birth, and from that point onward — "together with her," and so forth — she gave birth to a son. A great birth celebration was held for seven days, twenty-one days together, a name was given in keeping with the family lineage, and he was raised and nurtured until he grew up — all as before down to "and he became grown."

Then on another occasion, having gone forth into renunciation in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, and his physical constitution being unbalanced, he fell ill. Though he was treated with medicines of roots, stems, flowers, and fruits, none of them helped, and his time passed. The monks cast him aside near a road, together with his bowl and his Dharma robes.

Then some brahmins and householders walking along that road saw him, and some among them said: "Friends, a son of the Śākyas has passed beyond his time." Others said: "Come, let us go and look." They went and saw him, recognized who he was, and said: "Friends, this is the son of such-and-such a great householder. Having gone forth among the Śākyan renunciants, the sons of the ascetic Śākya, the shelterless ones, he has come to such a state as this. Had he not gone forth among them, his relatives would have tended to him."

At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, therefore I permit: monks shall perform the last rites for a deceased monk." When the Blessed One had declared that monks should perform the last rites for a deceased monk, the monks did not know how those rites were to be carried out, and so the Blessed One declared:

"He is to be cremated." When the Blessed One had declared that cremation was to be performed, the venerable Upāli addressed a question to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, you have said that there are eighty thousand species of worms in this body — what of those?" The Blessed One declared: "Upāli, they are born when the person is born, and they die when the person dies. Nevertheless, the openings of the wounds should be examined and then the cremation carried out."

When the Blessed One had declared that cremation was to be performed, there was no wood available. The monks then reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Then cast the body into a river." When there was no river either, the Blessed One declared: "Dig the earth and inter the body within it."

In the rainy season the ground became waterlogged and the wood became infested with living creatures. The Blessed One then declared: "Go to a dense spot, lay the body with the head pointing north, place a bundle of grass beforehand, lay the body on its right side, cover it with a mass of grass or leaves, dedicate the merit, give the gift of hearing the Dharma continually for the three successions, and then depart."

The monks departed accordingly, and brahmins and householders then mocked them, saying: "The renunciants, the sons of the Śākyan, carry out a corpse and walk away without washing — they have no cleanliness." When the monks reported this to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "You should not depart in that manner; you should wash." When all of them began to wash, the Blessed One declared: "Not all need wash. Those who have touched the body should wash together with their robes. The others need wash only their hands and feet."

When those monks then failed to pay respects at a stūpa, the Blessed One declared: "You should pay respects at the stūpa."

The Blessed One, the buddha, was residing at Rājagṛha in the Kalandaka bamboo grove. The venerable Śāriputra and the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, in the course of their wanderings, would at various times pass through the hells, pass through the animal realms, pass through the realm of hungry ghosts, pass through the realm of the gods, and wander among human beings.

On one occasion the two of them, while wandering through the hells, descended into the great Avīci hell. There the venerable Śāriputra said to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana: "Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, please bring relief to the beings of the hells." The venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana replied: "So be it — I shall bring them relief," and deferring to the venerable Śāriputra, he rose into the sky and began to pour down a continuous stream of rain the size of chariot axles. But that water was dried up in mid-air by the flames of the Avīci fire.

The venerable Śāriputra then said: "Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, please rest. I shall bring them relief." Mahāmaudgalyāyana replied: "Excellent — please do so, and bring them relief," and the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana stood by. The venerable Śāriputra entered into the meditative absorption known as "inspired concentration," and by means of it cooled that great Avīci hell, cutting off the stream of suffering of the beings within it.

Then the two of them, while teaching the complete Dharma to those with wrong views, took on a great bodily form, and saw that the tongue of that being was being pierced by five hundred ploughshares. That being said: "Noble Śāriputra and Mahāmaudgalyāyana, if you would go to Jambudvīpa, please convey my words to those of pure conduct: I taught the Dharma falsely and deceived great multitudes of people."

"Whatever precepts they received from me and put into practice — for those very practices their tongues are pierced by five hundred ploughshares; and just as you have desecrated my reliquary stūpa in whatever manner you have done, so too have I come to suffer unbearable anguish in exact proportion. Tell them to stop doing so from this day forward." This was the message he asked them to convey.

The venerable Śāriputra and Mahāmaudgalyāyana, completing the task, accepted this in silence without saying anything further. Then the two of them departed from Avīci hell unseen and traveled to Rājagṛha.

When the two of them arrived at Rājagṛha, some wanderers carrying staffs and wearing topknots came out and confronted them. Some among them said: "Friends, let us beat these ascetics, these sons of the Śākya!" Others said: "It would not be right to beat them outright — find a pretext first and then beat them." They agreed: "So be it."

The venerable Śāriputra had gone on ahead. Those men came up to him and said: "Noble Śāriputra, among the wandering ascetics are there any true ascetics?" He replied in verse:

Among wandering ascetics, there is no true ascetic.

Among the Śākyas, there is.

Among arhats, there is none possessed of attachment.

Among the foolish worldly folk — none at all.

Not grasping the meaning of that verse, they said: "Friends, this one has praised us! Let him go without saying another word," and off he went.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana came along behind, walking slowly, slowly, weighed down by the ripening of former karma that was close upon him. Seeing him, those men said: "Noble Mahāmaudgalyāyana, among the wandering ascetics are there any true ascetics?" He replied: "Friends, how could there be true ascetics among wandering ascetics? It is the Blessed One who has proclaimed: in this teaching there is the first ascetic, the second ascetic, the third ascetic, and the fourth ascetic — whereas outside this teaching there are neither ascetics nor brahmins. Those who loudly proclaim themselves superior to us are utterly devoid of ascetics and brahmins." And he thus proclaimed the lion's roar rightly in the midst of the assembly.

He continued: "Moreover, your teacher was born into the great Avīci hell. Through teaching the Dharma falsely, he took on a great body, and his tongue

is being pierced by five hundred ploughshares. He sent this message to me: 'I taught the Dharma falsely to those of my companions in the holy life, thereby deceiving great multitudes of people. Whatever precepts they received from me and put into practice — for those very practices their tongues are pierced by five hundred ploughshares; and just as you have desecrated my reliquary stūpa in whatever manner you have done, so too have my sufferings become unbearably intense in exact proportion.' This is what he asked me to tell you."

At these words they flew into a rage and said: "Friends, this wretch has not only abused us, he has spoken ill of our teacher as well — what is to be done?" Then some among them said: "What is there to do about it? Just smash his head and be done with it." Others said: "We told you so before — beat him, beat him! You were the ones who said, 'Find a pretext first and then beat him.' Well, now he has spoken against us and our teacher — the deed is accomplished by his own words!" And with that they shattered his limbs and joints like reeds in mud and went away.

The venerable Śāriputra, wondering what was keeping the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, turned back and looked — and there he saw him collapsed on the ground, his limbs and joints shattered like reeds. He said: "Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, what has happened to you?" He replied: "Venerable Śāriputra, it is karma exhausting itself — what else could it be?" The venerable Śāriputra then said:

"Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana — were you not declared the foremost among those with miraculous powers by the Blessed One? How has it come to this?" He replied: "Venerable Śāriputra, when I am so crushed by karma that I cannot even remember the word 'miracle,' what need is there to speak of miraculous powers?"

Then the venerable Śāriputra placed the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana inside his outer robe, as one would a small child, and carried him to the assembly hall. When the monks saw such a dreadful sight, they were alarmed and gathered around, asking the venerable Śāriputra: "What is this?" He replied: "The wandering mendicants armed with clubs and shaved-headed topknots have done this to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana," and he set him gently down on the ground.

The monks said: "Was not the venerable Śāriputra — was not the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana declared by the Blessed One to be the foremost among those with miraculous powers?" He replied: "Yes, he was declared so,

venerable ones — but look at the force of karma. He who stirred, thoroughly stirred, and completely stirred the palace of Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, named Vaijayanta, with the great toe of his right foot — he who was declared by the Blessed One to be the foremost among those of great miraculous power and great might — today, crushed by karma, cannot even remember the word 'miracle,' let alone miraculous powers."

Thereupon those monks in whom the noble path had not yet arisen, disheartened and deeply grieved, went to dwell in forest glades, jungle groves, and remote lodgings at the foot of trees, and began to rouse their minds to earnest effort.

And the report spread through every quarter of the city of Rājagṛha: "The wandering mendicants armed with clubs and shaved-headed topknots have beaten the great noble Mahāmaudgalyāyana and shattered his limbs and joints like reeds in mud; the noble Śāriputra has placed him inside his outer robe as one would a small child and has carried him to the Bamboo Grove; only a little life remains in him, and it will not be long before he passes away." When this report became known, many hundreds of thousands of living beings gathered in the Bamboo Grove.

The ministers of King Ajātaśatru came and reported to him: "Your divine majesty, the great noble Mahāmaudgalyāyana has been beaten by wandering mendicants armed with clubs and shaved-headed topknots; his limbs and joints have been shattered like reeds in mud; the noble Śāriputra has placed him inside his outer robe as one would a small child and has gone with him to the Bamboo Grove; only a little life remains in him, and it will not be long before he passes away."

When the king heard this he was enraged, and said to them: "Wise ones, seek out those wandering mendicants armed with clubs and shaved-headed topknots!" And together with his queen's retinue, his princes, and the people of the palace court, he went to the Bamboo Grove.

As the great crowd of people saw the king, they parted to make way. His eyes filled with tears, and with compassion in his voice, his words heavy with sorrow, he gently asked: "Great noble Mahāmaudgalyāyana — what is this?" He replied: "Great King, karma has consumed me — what else could it be? Was not I, noble one, declared by the Blessed One to be the foremost among those with miraculous powers? Great King, that is so — he did declare it — but karma has crushed me so utterly that I cannot even remember the word

'miracle,' let alone miraculous powers. The Blessed One never speaks in two voices. The Blessed One himself proclaimed:

Even across a hundred aeons of time,
actions do not waste away or come to nothing.
When causes ripen and the moment arrives,
their fruit matures for those who bear a body.

This teaching stands confirmed." At that, the king wiped away his tears with the hem of his garment, summoned all the physicians, and commanded them.

"Wise ones, if the noble Mahāmaudgalyāyana is not healed within seven days, your authority shall be stripped from you." With that command given, he also entrusted the matter to his ministers and departed. The wanderers carrying staffs, those who wore topknots, had also heard this, and they fled. The physicians began to deliberate among themselves: "Wise ones, the king has spoken in such terms — how are we to accomplish this? The noble Mahāmaudgalyāyana is old, and every one of his limbs and joints has been shattered like reeds. How can we possibly heal him? He himself is mighty, possessed of great miraculous powers — let us go to him for refuge." Some of them said, "Good — let us do exactly that." And so they all gathered together and went before the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana. They prostrated at his two feet and said, "Noble one, the king has commanded us thus: 'If the noble Mahāmaudgalyāyana is not healed within seven days, your authority shall be stripped from you.' Since you are old, we have no means to restore you as you were before. But you yourself are possessed of great miraculous power and great might — please act in such a way that our authority is not stripped from us." He replied, "Wise ones, if that is so, then go now and tell King Ajātaśatru this: 'The noble Mahāmaudgalyāyana himself will enter Rājagṛha for alms in seven days.'" Overjoyed, they prostrated at his feet and went before King Ajātaśatru, where they touched their heads to his feet and said, "Your Majesty, the noble Mahāmaudgalyāyana himself will enter Rājagṛha for alms in seven days." The king was greatly delighted and said, "Wise ones, if that is so, excellent! When the seven days have passed, the noble Mahāmaudgalyāyana himself, by his own miraculous powers, dispelled his discomfort entirely, and entered Rājagṛha to collect alms.

Now, the gnosis of arhats operates by intention: the venerable Śāriputra contemplated why the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, though gravely ill, had himself entered Rājagṛha for alms, and he perceived that he wished to pass

fully into nirvāṇa. Because Śāriputra's own stream of being was suffused with the habitual tendencies of their friendship, he himself fell ill that very same day. He thought: "If the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana is to pass fully into nirvāṇa, what am I to do remaining here? I shall pass into nirvāṇa before him." And so he journeyed from Rājagṛha to the town of Nālā. There the venerable Śāriputra, in the town of Nālā in the land of Magadha, was attended by those who cared for him, calling for a monk to tend to him, while he lay in great pain and suffering from a severe illness. Then the venerable Śāriputra passed fully into nirvāṇa from that very illness. And the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana also went to the city of Kalasikā, and that same afternoon passed fully into nirvāṇa. At the time when the venerable Śāriputra passed fully into nirvāṇa, some eighty thousand monks who were for the most part possessed of spiritual powers likewise passed fully into nirvāṇa. And at the time when the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana passed fully into nirvāṇa, again some seventy-seven thousand monks who were for the most part possessed of spiritual powers likewise passed fully into nirvāṇa. Then the one who had been attending to him performed bodily veneration before the relics of the venerable Śāriputra, and taking those relics, together with his begging bowl and his Dharma robes, he set out traveling in the direction of Rājagṛha, journeying by stages until he arrived at Rājagṛha.

The attendant of the monk set down the begging bowl and the Dharma robes, washed his feet, and went to where the venerable Ānanda was staying. Upon arriving, he bowed his head to the feet of the venerable Ānanda and sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the attendant of the monk said this to the venerable Ānanda: "May the venerable Ānanda please take note: my preceptor, the venerable Śāriputra, has passed fully into nirvāṇa, and here are his relics, his begging bowl, and his Dharma robes."

Then the venerable Ānanda, bringing the attendant of the monk with him, went to where the Blessed One was staying. Upon arriving, he bowed his head to the feet of the Blessed One and sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the venerable Ānanda said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable sir, the attendant of the monk came here to me and said this: 'May the venerable Ānanda please take note: my preceptor, the venerable Śāriputra, has passed fully into nirvāṇa, and here are his relics, his begging bowl, and his Dharma robes.' And upon hearing this, venerable sir, my body became as though scorched, I lost my bearings, and even the Dharma I had known seemed to slip away."

The Minor Matters of the Vinaya, the twenty-first fascicle.

Ānanda: "Did the monk Śāriputra pass into nirvāṇa taking with him the aggregate of moral discipline?"

"Venerable sir, he did not."

"Did he pass into nirvāṇa taking with him the aggregate of meditative concentration, the aggregate of wisdom, the aggregate of liberation, or the aggregate of the wisdom of the vision of liberation?"

"Venerable sir, he did not. And nor did he pass into nirvāṇa taking with him those teachings that I myself have fully awakened to through direct knowledge, namely: the four foundations of mindfulness, the four right abandonments, the four bases of spiritual power, the five faculties, the five powers, the seven limbs of awakening, and the noble eightfold path."

"Venerable sir, it is not that the venerable Śāriputra passed into nirvāṇa having carried off the aggregate of moral discipline — he did not. Nor the aggregate of meditative concentration — he did not. Nor the aggregate of wisdom — he did not. Nor the aggregate of liberation — he did not. Nor did he pass into nirvāṇa having carried off the aggregate of the wisdom of the vision of liberation — he did not. And nor did he pass into nirvāṇa having carried off those teachings that the Blessed One himself has fully awakened to through direct knowledge, namely: the four foundations of mindfulness, the four right abandonments, the four bases of spiritual power, the five faculties, the five powers, the seven limbs of awakening, and the noble eightfold path — he did not. Nevertheless, the venerable Śāriputra was one endowed with moral discipline, learned in much teaching, contented, of few desires, dwelling in seclusion, having aroused diligence, established in mindfulness, possessed of meditative equipoise, possessing wisdom — wisdom that is swift, wisdom that is quick, wisdom that is sharp, wisdom of renunciation, wisdom of discernment, wisdom that is great, wisdom that is vast, wisdom that is profound, wisdom that is without equal, wisdom that is like a precious jewel. He was one who rightly teaches, who rightly leads others to receive the teaching, who rightly encourages, who rightly delights. One who rightly teaches, rightly leads others to receive,

rightly praises with true and heartfelt delight. When teaching the Dharma to the four assemblies, he was inexhaustible. When I, the Venerable one, recall the Dharma of the Venerable Śāriputra, and those enjoyments of Dharma that were his, then on account of the complete nirvāṇa of the Venerable Śāriputra, I am filled with grief and utter lamentations.

Ānanda, do not grieve, do not be dejected, do not lament. Whatever is born, come into being, made, compounded, intended, or arisen through dependent origination — that has the nature of disintegration. That it should not disintegrate when possessed of those conditions — where could that be? It is impossible.

Ānanda, have I not taught you from the very beginning that all things dear to us, beloved, pleasing, and agreeable will become separated, lost, parted from, and no longer ours?

Ānanda, consider this simile: the highest branch of a great tree possessed of roots and heartwood, with trunk, leaves, foliage, flowers, and fruit — it is the first to fall. The highest peaks of a great mountain of precious gems are likewise the first to crumble. So too, among the Saṅgha of monks dwelling with the Buddha and the other elders, the monk Śāriputra has passed into complete nirvāṇa. In whatever direction the monk Śāriputra dwelt, in that direction I find my concern to be but small — for I see the direction where the monk Śāriputra dwelt as not empty.

Therefore, Ānanda, do not grieve, do not be dejected, do not lament. Whatever is born, come into being, made, compounded, intended, or arisen through dependent origination — that has the nature of disintegration. That it should not disintegrate when possessed of those conditions — where could that be? It is impossible.

Ānanda, have I not taught you from the very beginning that all things dear to us, beloved, pleasing, and agreeable will become separated, lost, parted from, and no longer ours?

Therefore, Ānanda, whether I am present now or have passed beyond, dwell with yourselves as your own island, yourselves as your own refuge, the Dharma as your island, the Dharma as your refuge, no other island, no other refuge.

And why is that? Ānanda, whether now or after I have passed beyond, those who dwell with themselves as their own island, themselves as their own refuge, the Dharma as their island, the Dharma as their refuge, no other island, no other refuge — these shall be the highest among my monks who wish to train.

And how does a monk dwell with himself as his own island, himself as his own refuge, the Dharma as his island, the Dharma as his refuge, no other island, no

other refuge? Here, a monk dwells contemplating the body as body internally, having overcome covetousness and discontent with regard to the world, abiding with ardor, vigilance, and mindfulness. He dwells contemplating the external body, and the body internally and externally; the internal feelings, external feelings, and feelings both internal and external; the internal mind, external mind, and mind both internal and external; the internal phenomena (dharma), external phenomena, and phenomena both internal and external — contemplating each as phenomena, having overcome covetousness and discontent with regard to the world, abiding with ardor, vigilance, and mindfulness.

Ānanda, in this way a monk dwells with himself as his own island, himself as his own refuge, the Dharma as his island, the Dharma as his refuge, no other island, no other refuge.

Then the Venerable Ānanda, having openly praised what the Blessed One had said, rejoiced in it, bowed his head to the feet of the Blessed One, and departed from the presence of the Blessed One.

How the crowds of people dwelling in Rājagṛha roamed about armed with clubs and staves, and, with those weapons, broke the limbs and lesser limbs of the noble Mahāmaudgalyāyana like the joints of a reed — and how the noble Śāriputra, saturated with the habitual tendencies of friendship and affection for him, passed away in the village — so too, when in the morning the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana had fully passed into nirvāṇa, word reached him that the great one had gone to the village of Kalasikā and there had fully passed into nirvāṇa.

At that interval, the monks were seized by doubt, and in order that all doubt might be cut through, they addressed the Blessed One, the buddha: "Venerable sir, what deed had the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana done, that through the karmic maturation of that deed, those wandering ones armed with clubs and staves should have broken his limbs and lesser limbs like the joints of a reed?"

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, the deed that this very monk Maudgalyāyana performed and accumulated — 'the karma has been done and gathered, the conditions have been fully transformed, it abides close at hand like a glowing flame, it will certainly arise, it will ripen as a fruit for embodied beings' — all this is as stated before."

"Monks, long ago in a past time there was a brahmin who dwelt in a certain mountainous region. He took a wife from among those of equal birth, and with her he sported, rejoiced, and delighted in pleasures. While they were thus sporting, rejoicing, and delighting, at another time a being entered into his wife's womb. After eight or nine months had passed, a boy was born. On the twenty-first day — that is, within three weeks of seven days — the birth feast was held in full; he was named, raised, and nurtured, and in time he grew great.

His father took that wife of his and sported with her, rejoiced, and delighted in pleasures, and became deeply attached to her as well. But his mother constantly stoked him with harsh and unpleasant words, speaking ill of him. He repeated these to his husband, and in this way that husband was deceived: the son came to have no great love for his mother and would contradict everything she did.

Then the son said to his wife: 'Is it on account of her that you are so attached to me that you oppose me?' She fell silent, saying nothing.

The son's wife then thought to herself: 'Though this venomous creature grows old and passes on, she will not relinquish even the smallest attachment to her own husband, and she insults my husband.' Realizing this, she began to look for an opportunity.

In time, at another moment, when the mother had bathed, adorned her body with perfumes and flowers, and before the sun had set, she lay with the husband in secret without the household members noticing. Then that daughter-in-law led her husband away and arranged matters so that he went in that direction. And then — the father and the mother were seen lying together in secret.

The son thought: 'This creature — while accusing me of being deeply attached to women — has herself, even now without ceasing, lain in secret before the sun has set, without any regard for the household members.'

Thinking this, he became enraged and spoke a harsh verbal act, saying: 'Is there no one who will break the limbs and lesser limbs of these two like the joints of a reed?'"

The Blessed One then declared: "Monks, what do you think? The one who at that time and in that period was born as the brahmin's son — that one is none other than this very monk Maudgalyāyana. Because he became agitated in

mind and uttered a harsh verbal act against his father and mother, through the karmic maturation of that deed his limbs and lesser limbs have been broken like the joints of a reed for five hundred lifetimes. Now, having reached his final existence, his final abiding, his final body, his final self,"

even among those possessing miraculous power, he was proclaimed supreme — and yet his limbs and lesser limbs have been broken like the joints of a reed. Therefore, monks, the karmic maturation of deeds that are utterly dark is utterly dark; the karmic maturation of deeds that are utterly bright is utterly bright; and the maturation of mixed deeds is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandoning deeds that are utterly dark and deeds that are mixed, strive toward deeds that are utterly bright. Monks, you should train yourselves accordingly."

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Then the monks made this request to the buddha, the Blessed One: "Venerable One, the wanderers carrying staffs and wearing topknots let the venerable Śāriputra pass away, while they beat the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana. We ask the Blessed One to look upon this."

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, this is not so only now. Even in times past, Śāriputra was let pass and Maudgalyāyana was beaten. Listen to how this came about. Monks, long ago, some boys and girls who were at play saw two brahmin boys and said to them: 'We shall beat those brahmin boys.' Then someone said: 'Before beating them, let us ask them a question. If they please us with their answer, we will not beat them; otherwise we will.' So they asked one of the brahmin boys: 'When is it cold?' That one thought to himself: 'With what sort of intention are these ones asking me this? I know they want to beat me without any pretext,' and so he spoke in verse:

Whether it be cold or whether warm,
when the wind arises and blows upon one,
there is cold when wind strikes,
and without wind, no cold.

When they had dismissed him and asked the other one, that one replied: 'Is it not plain? It is the cold of winter.' And so they beat him.

Monks, what do you think? The one who was let pass — that was none other than this very Śāriputra. The one who was beaten — that was none other than

this very Maudgalyāyana. Even at that time Śāriputra was let pass and Maudgalyāyana was beaten. And now again Śāriputra is let pass and Maudgalyāyana is beaten.

Now listen to yet another account of how Śāriputra was let pass and Maudgalyāyana was beaten. Monks, long ago, some boys and girls who were at play along a dried riverbed saw a śālmālī flower being carried along by the current, and they saw two brahmin boys coming." From here onward it unfolds as before: "They asked one of the brahmin boys: 'What is this that the water carries?' That one thought to himself: 'With what sort of intention are these ones asking me this? They want to beat me without any pretext'" — and so on as before. He too replied in verse:

Cut down by one of great strength,
in quest of what is sure to arise,
think not of it as a śālmālī tree —
think of it as a lotus on dry land.

When they had dismissed him and asked the other one, that one replied: 'Can you not see? It is plainly a śālmālī flower.' And so they beat him.

As for what you think, monks — and so forth, as before in full.

Thereafter, the Blessed One, having remained in Rājagṛha as long as it pleased him, set out journeying toward Śrāvastī and traveled on until he arrived there by stages. In Śrāvastī he resided in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. And it was there that the householder Anāthapiṇḍada learned that the noble Śāriputra had passed into complete nirvāṇa,

and that the noble Śāriputra's relics were in the hands of the venerable Ānanda. Upon hearing this, he went to where the venerable Ānanda was staying, and arriving there, he prostrated with his head at the venerable Ānanda's feet and sat to one side. Seated to one side, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada said this to the venerable Ānanda: "May the noble Ānanda take note. The noble Śāriputra has long been dear to me, agreeable to me, a teacher to me, one whom I hold in remembrance. He has now passed into complete nirvāṇa. Please give me those relics of his that are in your possession, and I will perform a relic offering for his relics."

Ānanda replied: "Householder, he too has long been dear to me, agreeable to me, a teacher to me, one whom I hold in remembrance. And so I myself am making a relic offering for his relics."

Then the householder Anāthapiṇḍada went to where the Blessed One was staying, and arriving there, he prostrated with his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat to one side. Seated to one side, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, may you take note. The noble Śāriputra has long been dear to me, agreeable to me, a teacher to me, one whom I hold in remembrance. Those relics of his that are in the venerable Ānanda's possession — may the Blessed One direct that they be given to me. I wish to perform a relic offering for his relics."

Then the Blessed One summoned the venerable Ānanda by messenger and declared: "Ānanda, give the relics of the monk Śāriputra to the householder Anāthapiṇḍada and let him perform offerings for them. Brahmins and householders are faithful on account of this kind of matter. Moreover, Ānanda, you have not thereby benefited my teaching or repaid your debt to it — not by this much alone. Therefore, go forth, receive full ordination, provide lodging, set yourself to the purposes of the ascetic life, and let people recite and hold whatever arises from it, and teach it — by this much you will have benefited my teaching and repaid your debt to it."

Then, acting on the Teacher's word, the venerable Ānanda gave the relics of the venerable Śāriputra to the householder Anāthapiṇḍada. He did so because, in all the times when the Blessed One was formerly a bodhisattva, he had never once broken the word of those who stood in the position of parents, preceptors, teachers, or other spiritual guides.

Then the householder Anāthapiṇḍada took the relics of the venerable Śāriputra, went to his own home, placed them up high in the finest part of the house, and together with his household, his friends, his relatives, and his kinsmen, began to perform offerings with lamps, incense, flowers, scents, garlands, and unguents.

The assembly of people dwelling in Śrāvastī heard how the noble Śāriputra had passed into complete nirvāṇa in a village in the land of Magadha, and how the noble Ānanda had collected his relics and given them to the householder Anāthapiṇḍada, and how he had placed them in his home and, together with his household, his friends, his relatives, and his kinsmen, was performing offerings with lamps, incense, flowers, scents, garlands, and unguents.

Likewise, Prasenajit, the king of the land of Kosala, also heard the news. Together with his queen Vāsuladattā, the royal lady Āvanti, the brahmin Giribhadra, his elders, his mother Sagā of the Mṛgārin lineage, and many other

faithful people, he took offerings and went to the home of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada. There they began to make offerings with the various offering articles, and some among them attained an accumulation of virtues in that very place.

Now at a certain point the householder Anāthapiṇḍada had a little business to attend to somewhere, and he went out, locking the door behind him. Many ordinary people then arrived in the same way, and when they saw that the door was locked, they began to revile, reproach, and disparage him, saying: "The householder Anāthapiṇḍada has locked the door and gone away, and by doing so he has created an obstacle to our accumulation of merit."

Then the householder Anāthapiṇḍada returned from that errand, and the people inside said to him: "A great crowd of people came bearing offering articles, but when they saw the door was locked, they reviled, reproached, and disparaged you, saying that you had locked the door and gone away and thereby created an obstacle to their accumulation of merit."

When he understood that this matter was his own responsibility, he went to where the Blessed One was. Upon arrival, he bowed his head to the feet of the Blessed One and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, he spoke to the Blessed One, saying: "Venerable One, a great crowd of people filled with deep faith in the noble Śāriputra came bearing offering articles and assembled at my home. I had gone out, having locked the door for a moment to attend to a small piece of personal business. When they found the door locked, they reviled, reproached, and disparaged me, saying that I, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada, had locked the door and gone away, thereby creating an obstacle to their accumulation of merit. Therefore, Venerable One, if the Blessed One would permit it, I should like to build a great stūpa for the noble Śāriputra in a wide and open space, and to allow the great crowd of people to make offerings there freely."

The Blessed One declared: "Householder, it is permitted. Go ahead and do so."

When the Blessed One had thus declared it permitted, he did not know how to proceed. The Blessed One then declared: "Build it step by step with four tiers of steps, and upon that place a vase-base. Then make a vase, a harmikā, a life-pole, and canopies — one, two, three, or four — up to thirteen, and place a rainspout."

When the Blessed One had described how such a stūpa should be built, the householder did not know whether a stūpa of that form was intended only for

the noble Śāriputra, or for all noble ones. At that juncture, the monks asked the Blessed One about this, and the Blessed One declared:

"Householder, a Tathāgata's stūpa is to be made complete in every respect. For a pratyekabuddha, no rainspout is to be placed. For an arhat, there are four canopies. For a once-returner, three. For a twice-returner, two. For a stream-enterer, one. The stūpa for virtuous ordinary persons is to be a mound. The Blessed One has declared: this is the form of stūpas for noble ones, and such is the form for ordinary persons."

When he still did not know in what location and where to build it, the Blessed One declared: "Just as Śāriputra and Maudgalyāyana sat in the presence of the Tathāgata, so too should the stūpa of one who has passed into complete nirvāṇa be built."

Furthermore, the stūpas of the elders (sthaviras) are to be arranged in order of seniority. For virtuous ordinary persons, the stūpa is to be placed outside the monastery's assembly hall.

The householder Anāthapiṇḍada then addressed the Blessed One: "If the Blessed One grants permission, I shall hold festivals for the stūpa of the noble Śāriputra." The Blessed One declared: "Householder, you have permission. Do so."

Just as King Prasenajit of Kosala, upon hearing that the Blessed One had granted the householder Anāthapiṇḍada permission to hold festivals for the stūpa of the noble Śāriputra, thought, "I too should assist in this," and had the following proclamation announced: "O wise citizens dwelling in Śrāvastī, and all the companies of people who have come from other regions, hear this! Whoever comes bearing provisions to the festival of the stūpa of the noble Śāriputra shall face no tax, no toll, and no ferry charge. Let them come here freely and at ease."

During this interval, five hundred merchants who had returned to Śrāvastī with great wealth gained from the ocean also heard the king's proclamation throughout Śrāvastī, which ran: "Whoever comes bearing provisions to the festival of the stūpa of the noble Śāriputra shall face no tax, no toll, and no ferry charge. Let them come here freely and at ease."

Upon hearing this announcement, they reflected: "Even though this king abides in the fruit of his own merit, he is never satisfied with merit — he gives gifts, he accumulates merit. Why then should we not give gifts and accumulate

merit?" Their minds became supremely joyful, and at the time of the festival they offered conches, jewels, pearls, and the like. When the monks did not know how to proceed with these offerings, the Blessed One declared: "Whatever is from the offerings — let those be offered to the image of the Blessed One seated in the shade of a rose-apple tree. A portion is to be set aside for the proper maintenance of Śāriputra's stūpa, and the remainder is to be divided among the assembled Saṅgha. These offerings are for the stūpa of Śāriputra, not for a Tathāgata's stūpa — therefore one need not feel regret."

Condensed summary in verse:

Reproach, recollection itself,
finding occasion, and speaking out —
reciting scripture and the restoration ceremony,
and the invitation ceremony are what is established.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The group of six monks, having seen, heard, or suspected a fault, reproached the monks. When those monks were reproached on the grounds of what had been seen, heard, or suspected, they stood as if ashamed. Standing thus in shame, they became pale and thin, languishing and physically unfit, and they lost their activities of teaching the scriptures, reading, recitation, yoga, and inward proper mental engagement. The monks then reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One considered the matter. He discerned: "Whatever drawback has arisen has come from monks reproaching other monks on the grounds of what they have seen, heard, or suspected. Therefore monks shall not reproach other monks on the grounds of what has been seen, heard, or suspected. If a monk does reproach another monk on the grounds of what has been seen, heard, or suspected, he commits an offense involving a meeting of the assembly."

As for those who carry out such reproach — how one recollects it, how one finds occasion —

— making someone not speak, imposing a formal recitation of scripture, setting aside the restoration ceremony, and setting aside the invitation ceremony: these are all similar. All the summary verses are to be recited as before.

The summary verse:

Named for the Buddha's marks, and
Conduct none of the venerable may engage in,
Devising expedient means, lack of faith,
And the Vinaya in brief: this is the summary.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Vārāṇasī in the deer park of the Sages' Speaking, the Grove of Isipatana. Then the Blessed One spoke to the five monks:

"Monks, when, with regard to these things never before heard by me — 'This is the noble truth of suffering' — I attended to them properly, vision arose. Knowledge, understanding, intelligence, and realization arose.

"Monks, when, with regard to these things never before heard by me — 'This is the noble truth of the origin of suffering; this is the noble truth of the cessation of suffering; this is the noble truth of the path, the noble path leading to the cessation of suffering' — I attended to them properly, vision arose. Knowledge, understanding, intelligence, and realization arose.

"Monks, when, with regard to these things never before heard by me — 'This noble truth of suffering is to be fully known through direct knowledge' — I attended to them properly, vision arose. Knowledge, understanding, intelligence, and realization arose.

"Monks, when, with regard to these things never before heard by me — 'This noble truth of the origin of suffering is to be abandoned through direct knowledge' — I attended to them properly, vision arose. Knowledge, understanding, intelligence, and realization arose.

"Monks, when, with regard to these things never before heard by me — 'This noble truth of the cessation of suffering is to be directly realized through direct knowledge' — I attended to them properly, vision arose. Knowledge, understanding, intelligence, and realization arose.

"Monks, when, with regard to these things never before heard by me — 'This noble truth of the path, the noble path leading to the cessation of suffering, is to be cultivated' — I attended to them properly, vision arose. Knowledge, understanding, intelligence, and realization arose.

"Monks, when, with regard to these things never before heard by me — 'This noble truth of suffering has been fully known through direct knowledge' — I attended to them properly, vision arose. Knowledge, understanding, intelligence, and realization arose.

"Monks, when, with regard to these things never before heard by me — 'This noble truth of the origin of suffering has been abandoned through direct knowledge' — I attended to them properly, vision arose. Knowledge, understanding, intelligence, and realization arose.

"Monks, when, with regard to these things never before heard by me — 'This noble truth of the cessation of suffering has been directly realized through direct knowledge' — I attended to them properly, vision arose. Knowledge, understanding, intelligence, and realization arose.

"Monks, when, with regard to these things never before heard by me — 'This noble truth of the path leading to the cessation of suffering, the noble path, has been cultivated through direct knowledge' — I attended to them properly, vision arose. Knowledge, understanding, intelligence, and realization arose.

"Monks, so long as, with regard to these four noble truths, in their three rounds and twelve aspects, such vision had not arisen — such knowledge, understanding, intelligence, and realization had not arisen — for as long as that was so, I had not been released, had not fully emerged, had not been freed, had not been utterly liberated from this world with its gods, its māras, its Brahmā, with its assemblies of ascetics and brahmins, with its gods and humans —

— and had not dwelt abundantly in a mind free from error. For so long as that was so, I did not know that I had fully awakened to the unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening. But, monks, from the moment that, with regard to these four noble truths, such vision had arisen in me — in their three rounds and twelve aspects — such knowledge, understanding, intelligence, and realization had arisen — from that moment I was released from this world with its gods, its māras, its Brahmā, with its assemblies of ascetics and brahmins, with its gods and humans; I had fully emerged, was utterly liberated, and dwelt abundantly in a mind free from error. From that moment I knew that I had fully awakened to the unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening.

While this exposition of the Dharma was being taught, the vision of the Dharma arose in the venerable Kauṇḍinya and in eighty thousand gods — a vision pure and unstained, free from all dust and defilement.

Then the Blessed One addressed the venerable Kauṇḍinya: "Kauṇḍinya, have you understood all the Dharma?" "I venerate you, Blessed One." "Kauṇḍinya, have you understood all the Dharma?" "I venerate you, Sugata."

Because the venerable Kauṇḍinya had understood all the Dharma, he came to be known by the name Ājñāta-Kauṇḍinya — Kauṇḍinya Who Has Understood.

At the moment the venerable Kauṇḍinya understood all the Dharma, the yakṣas (Skt. yakṣa) dwelling on the earth raised up their voices and proclaimed aloud: "Friends, the Blessed One, for the benefit of the many and the happiness of the many, out of compassion for the world, for the welfare, the benefit, and the happiness of gods and humans, has turned the wheel of Dharma in accordance with Dharma — a turning that no ascetic, no brahmin, no god, no māra, no Brahmā in this world has ever turned in accordance with Dharma — turning it three times, in its twelve aspects, here in the deer park at Isipatana near Vārāṇasī. The ranks of the gods shall increase, and the ranks of the asuras shall dwindle."

The yakṣas of the earth raised their cry, and the yakṣas moving through the middle sky heard it; they in turn raised their voices and proclaimed it aloud. From them it was heard by the gods of the Heaven of the Four Great Kings, then by the gods of the Thirty-Three, then by the gods of the Realm Free from Strife, then by the gods of the Joyful Realm, then by the gods who Delight in Creation, then by the gods who Wield Power over Others' Creations — and in that very instant, that very moment, that very flash of time, the sound rose all the way to the Brahmā world. And the gods of the Brahmā realm raised up their voices and proclaimed aloud: "Friends, the Blessed One, for gods and humans" — and so on, just as before — "has turned the wheel of Dharma, here in the deer park at Isipatana near Vārāṇasī, in its twelve aspects, three times over, in accordance with Dharma. The ranks of the gods shall increase, and the ranks of the asuras shall dwindle."

Because the Blessed One turned the wheel of Dharma in accordance with Dharma — turning it three times, in twelve aspects, here in the deer park at Isipatana near Vārāṇasī — this exposition of Dharma is therefore called the Turning of the Wheel of Dharma.

When the Blessed One had turned the wheel of Dharma in the mindstreams of those five monks and they had thus become, through full ordination, the very substance of the monkhood, they then, addressing the Tathāgata, began to use expressions of intimacy and tenderness toward him, calling him "venerable one." And the Blessed One addressed them thus: "Monks, do not address the Tathāgata with expressions of intimacy and tenderness and —"

"— calling him 'venerable one' at every turn. Monks, why is this? Whoever uses expressions of intimacy toward the Tathāgata, or expressions of tenderness toward him, or calls him 'venerable one' at every turn — for that deluded person this will bring harm over a long time, will bring no benefit, and will bring suffering. The Blessed One reflected: whatever fault has arisen has arisen from monks using expressions of intimacy toward the Tathāgata, expressions of tenderness toward him, and calling him 'venerable one' at every turn. Therefore a monk must not use expressions of intimacy toward the Tathāgata, expressions of tenderness toward him, or call him 'venerable one' at every turn, for to do so would constitute a serious offense." With this thought in mind, the Blessed One declared to the five monks: "Monks, therefore a monk must not use expressions of intimacy toward the Tathāgata, expressions of tenderness toward him, or call him 'venerable one' at every turn; to do so would constitute a serious offense."

When the Blessed One had declared that a monk must not use expressions of intimacy toward the Tathāgata, expressions of tenderness toward him, or call him 'venerable one' at every turn, for to do so would constitute a serious offense — it then came about that junior monks were addressing senior monks by name or by clan, and calling them 'venerable one' at every turn. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "A junior monk must not address a senior monk by name or by clan. However, the two forms of address 'venerable one' and 'reverend one' may be used at every turn. If a junior monk addresses a senior monk by name or by clan, it will constitute a serious offense."

The occasioning incident is from Śrāvastī. The full account of what is found in Śrāvastī — concerning a monk who was scheming and a nun named Gosomā who in various ways would go wandering through the households in a manner that caused many people to lose faith — is as it appears in the detailed analysis.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Kuśinagara in the twin sāla trees in the forest near the stronghold of the Mallas. At that time, when the hour of the Blessed One's passing into nirvāṇa had come, he declared to the monks: "Monks, I have taught the Vinaya in extensive detail, and I have not taught it in brief. Now listen well and take to heart what I am about to say. Monks, whatever I have neither previously permitted nor prohibited — if it is improper, conducive to impropriety, and inconsistent with what is allowable, then it must not be practiced on the grounds that it is not allowable. But if it is

proper, conducive to propriety, and consistent with what is allowable, then it may be practiced on the grounds that it is allowable, and one need not feel regret in doing so."

Summary verse:

Things that are abandoned: what is torn,
refuge for bees,
worn-out cloth and winnowing baskets,
stiff outstretched things, and many more.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the park of Prince Jeta. A monk came to cast off his monastic robe, and having done so he sat to one side of the elders and cast it before the Saṅgha. The steward of the Saṅgha thought: "This is property that belongs to the Saṅgha; it should be distributed after being put out." He had it put out and distributed to the Saṅgha, whereupon that monk was left destitute. Then the monks reported this to the Blessed One.

The Blessed One reflected that whatever fault had arisen had come about because a monk had cast off his robe and given it to the Saṅgha. He therefore thought: "A monk should not give his cast-off robe to the Saṅgha," and he declared to the monks: "Monks, a monk cast off his robe and gave it to the Saṅgha, and the steward of the Saṅgha had it distributed. Therefore a monk should not give a cast-off robe to the Saṅgha; rather, he should give it to an individual person. Even if it was given out of ignorance, the Saṅgha should not distribute it. If a monk gives his cast-off robe to the Saṅgha and the Saṅgha distributes it, both parties incur a serious transgression." The Blessed One declared: "A monk should not give a cast-off robe to the Saṅgha; rather, he should give it to an individual person."

After the Blessed One had thus declared, another monk came to cast off a monastic robe, and he gave it to a monk who did not know what to do with it. That monk took it and said nothing. The monks then reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Another monk should indicate the matter to him. If he gives it back, well and good. If he will not hand it over, it should be taken by force and consecrated by blessing. Since the robe was cast off in order to make it available for use, the cast-off robe should not be kept permanently; rather, it should be returned to the one who cast it off."

The setting for this was Vaiśālī.

During the summer season, mosquitoes bit the monks, and they scratched themselves all over with their nails, so that from time to time drops of blood and sores appeared. Brahmins and householders saw the monks in that unsightly bodily state and said to them: "Noble ones, how did your bodies come to be in such a condition?" The monks described what had happened, and the brahmins and householders said: "Noble ones, will you not keep mosquito nets? If the Blessed One, who has a beautiful complexion, has not permitted it, how can you keep them? But your Teacher is compassionate, so he will grant permission." The monks then reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Very well then, I permit it. Monks should keep mosquito nets."

When the Blessed One had declared that monks might keep mosquito nets, the monks did not know what kind to keep. The Blessed One declared: "A cloth four cubits in length and two cubits in width should be hung over a wooden frame and covered from above, and a cloth twelve cubits around should encircle it on all four sides." The monks made the cloth without any opening left, whereupon mosquitoes entered from inside. The Blessed One declared: "It should be kept with the remaining cloth, and that cloth should be wrapped around from inside." The monks, having made the mosquito net, lifted the cloth from one side to enter, whereupon the Blessed One declared: "A door-flap should be made." The monks made the door-flap straight across, and the Blessed One declared: "It should be made as a cross-over flap." When it was hot, the Blessed One declared: "In that same place a fan should be set." When mosquitoes entered from below, the Blessed One declared: "It should be covered with a mat, and in whatever manner mosquitoes bite, all means to deal with them are permitted." The setting for this was Śrāvastī.

The Blessed One had declared that water should be sprinkled, and when the monks held water containers in their hands they became fatigued. The Blessed One declared: "They should be attached to a pole and the sprinkling done that way." When the monks attached them to a pole and sprinkled in that way, they still became fatigued, and the Blessed One declared: "Three sticks should be used together." When the monks attached them to three sticks and it would not stand steady, the Blessed One declared:

"Their holes should be bound together with cord or with small nails, and the water strainer placed on top. When the monks set up the water strainer and poured water, it spilled on the ground, and the Blessed One declared: "Be mindful not to let it spill on the ground, and pour carefully." When the monks

placed the jar without a base support and it tipped over, the Blessed One declared: "A base support should be inserted." When another monk among them began to draw water, and at that moment the water strainer was not yet fitted, the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "A filter should be inserted." When the monks did not know what to insert, the Blessed One declared: "Sand or cow dung." But still it would not strain properly, and the Blessed One declared: "A vessel to support the strainer should be filled." When the Blessed One had declared that a vessel to support the strainer should be filled, the monks did not know how it was to be held, and the Blessed One declared: "There are two kinds of vessel for supporting the strainer: one made of copper and one made of clay." When the monks held the strainer-support vessels in their hands and became fatigued, the Blessed One declared: "The one made of copper should be hung at its hole on three sticks by means of a soft iron chain. The one made of clay should be hung at its hole by means of a cord." When other water strainers would not let the water pass through, the Blessed One declared: "They should be struck repeatedly with a mallet." When the monks, upon inspecting a jar that was not full while drawing water, could not discern any living creatures in it, the Blessed One declared: "Fill the jar full, let it stand until the water is still, and then examine it." When the jar was filled and dust had entered it from above, the monks did not remove it and so could not discern any living creatures, and the Blessed One declared: "Remove the dust and then examine it." When the monks pointed out living creatures with the tip of a finger and the creatures moved but could not be seen with the naked eye, the Blessed One declared: "They should be pointed out with the tip of a small stick, the tip of a blade of grass, or any other fine point." When the monks drew water out of the water strainer itself and the living creatures were harmed by being crushed and pressed, the Blessed One declared: "A draining strainer should be fitted." When the monks fitted one of the sort that, when filled and released, comes back full again, the Blessed One declared: "Fit one of the sort that, when filled and released, comes back empty." When some others lacked a draining strainer, the Blessed One declared: "Let them attach a cord to the water strainer, and release it in such a way that when filled and sent down it comes back empty." When the monks, after drawing water, did not wash, rinse, squeeze, dry, or fold the water strainer, the Blessed One declared: "After drawing water with the water strainer it should be washed, rinsed, squeezed, dried, and folded." When the monks were straining the Saṅgha's water with the water strainer and the greater part of the monks' Saṅgha grew weary, the

Blessed One declared: "If the greater part of the monks' Saṅgha is involved, either have many water strainers filled, or alternatively fill a jar-strainer fitted with a spout." When the Blessed One had declared that a jar-strainer fitted with a spout should be used for straining, the monks did not know what such a jar-strainer looked like, and the Blessed One declared:

"It should be made from clay or copper in the shape of a pot, and holes like the heart of a lotus should be pierced in it. To gather those holes together, one large hole should be bored above them. To collect them further still, a spout should be inserted. Then it should be covered on top with cloth, the water strained through it, and that cloth too should be rinsed, washed, and dried."

The Minor Matters of the Vinaya, the twenty-second fascicle.

When monks were discarding lice, grass, and other living creatures from a height, those creatures lost their senses and were harmed. At that time the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One must not throw any living creature from a height. When they were throwing them wherever they happened to land, the Blessed One declared: "One must not throw them just wherever they happen to land. Lice should be put back into the seam of the garment. If that cannot be found, let them be placed in the groove of a pillar or in a crack of a wall. Grass should be placed in the direction of a blue-green meadow. If that cannot be found, then in a cool spot. Other living creatures too should be released into their own proper habitat."

The venerable Upāli asked the Blessed One, the Buddha: "Venerable one, is it permissible to use water that has been strained without examination?" "It is not permissible if Upāli has not examined it with his eyes." "Venerable one, is it permissible to use water that has been strained after examination?" "It is permissible, since Upāli has examined it with his eyes." The setting of this rule is at Śrāvastī.

The Blessed One declared that the Saṅgha that had committed to a rains retreat should distribute robes. When Prasenajit, King of Kosala, heard this, he offered robes to the Saṅgha. Likewise, Queen Mālikā, the Kṣatriya lady observing the rains, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada, the brahmin Jīvaka, the elders, the diviners, and many others offered robes. The monks, having consecrated one robe each, began returning the remainder to those same donors. The donors said: "These noble ones — we have offered these to the Saṅgha, so how can we take them back?" The monks then reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, these should be

accepted with permission, and once accepted, many monks should be appointed to distribute the stored goods. Let one robe be distributed after another in the manner previously appointed. The remainder should be set aside, and since this is the acquired property to be divided among the Saṅgha that has committed to the rains retreat, the assembled Saṅgha that has committed to the rains retreat should divide it as they see fit, and in this matter there should be no regret."

The summary verse:

No gift after I have passed,
one who has dedicated it dying,
one to whom it was entrusted dying,
what has come, and regret.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. A certain householder living at Śrāvastī took a wife from the same social class, and with her he played, rejoiced, and took his pleasure. From their playing, rejoicing, and taking pleasure together, in time three sons were born. The youngest of these went forth in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya. Then at another time he went wandering through the provinces. While he was wandering through the provinces, his father fell ill, and though he was treated with medicines of roots, stems, leaves, flowers, and fruits, the illness did not subside. When the moment came that he felt death approaching, and it was clear he would die before long, he called his dear friends, his relatives, his elder and younger brothers, and

the household intimates together, and spoke to those two sons: "Sons, whatever little there is in my house, take it all and come." They heeded his words and came, bringing everything. Then he spoke to his dear friends, his relatives, his elder and younger brothers, and the household intimates: "Good people, listen well. Of my three sons, the two elder ones are here before you. As for the youngest, he has gone forth among the ascetics of the Śākyas. Therefore, let all the wealth, whatever little there is in my house, be divided equally among them." Having said this, and knowing that all that is accumulated is exhausted in the end, that what has risen high must in the end come down, that what has gathered must in the end separate, and that the end of the living is death, he passed on at the appointed time. Wrapped in blue, red, yellow, and white shrouds, he was carried to the charnel ground and cremated. His sons performed the rites of mourning and lamentation and

remained there.

Now when that son — the one who had gone forth — heard that his father had died, he thought: "I shall go back, preach the Dharma to my mother and my elder brothers, and console them in their grief." He stayed in the provinces as long as he wished, and then, taking up his alms bowl and Dharma robes, he set out wandering toward Śrāvastī and arrived there in due course, journeying stage by stage. He left his Dharma robes and alms bowl in the Jeta Grove, and after resting there to recover from the weariness of the road, he went to his own home. When the members of the household saw him, they wept. Hearing their weeping, the household intimates gathered, and some among them wept aloud while others filled with tears.

Because he was a worldly person, on hearing the great crowd of people lamenting together he too sat with eyes brimming with tears. Then one of the women among the household intimates said to him: "Child, do not grieve. Your father performed meritorious deeds and has gone to the realm of the gods. Your father also gathered your dear friends, your relatives, your elder and younger brothers, and the household intimates, and gave you as well a third share of the wealth."

He reflected: "The Blessed One has taught that there is no such thing as someone who has passed on saying, 'Give this to such a person.' Understanding that this is exactly what the Blessed One meant by those words, I am not weeping on that account. Rather, it was my father's hardships on my behalf that caused these tears to fall against my will. The Blessed One taught that parents labor hard for their children — carrying them, nursing them, raising them, and showing them the many wonders of Jambudvīpa. Even if one were to carry one's father on one shoulder and one's mother on the other, honoring them for a full hundred years, or even if one were to install them as lords and masters of this great earth with all its jewels, pearls, beryl (vaiḍūrya), crystal, coral, silver, gold, precious stones, topaz, rubies, and all that is auspicious — even so, by that alone a son would not have benefited his father and mother, nor repaid the debt he owes them. But whoever leads parents who lack faith into the fullness of faith, who praises them, tames them, settles them, and firmly establishes them; and whoever leads parents who are deficient in moral discipline into the fullness of moral discipline, who leads those given to timidity into the fullness of generosity, and who leads parents deficient in wisdom into the fullness of wisdom — who praises them, tames them, settles them, and firmly establishes them — by that alone does a

son truly benefit his father and mother and repay the debt he owes them." So it was taught.

Furthermore, the Blessed One forbade the practice of saying "give it to so-and-so after I am gone," declaring that such a statement does not constitute a gift. The woman in question said nothing at all about it.

On that occasion the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, I did not frame this teaching with the layperson in mind, but rather with the one who has gone forth in mind. A householder dies still bound by attachment, whereas one who has gone forth does not. Therefore, when a layperson thinks, 'after I am gone, give this to so-and-so,' that does constitute a gift. But it does not apply to one who has gone forth. The gift should be accepted, and once accepted, one may enjoy and make full use of it as one wishes."

The case arose in Śrāvastī.

A monk dedicated robes to another monk. Having made this dedication, the one who received them passed away before the appointed time, and his fellow monks carried them off to be cremated. In the meantime, the dedicating monk took those robes from the deceased's cell and placed them in his own cell. When the other monks returned from performing the funeral rites and came back to the monastery, the duty-officer inspected the deceased's cell and found only a bowl, the three robes, and a water-strainer. He brought these to the assembly of elders, and the monks said to the one who had made the dedication: "Venerable one, did you take these three robes and bring them here? And if there are other items that were rendered suitable as robes, bring those as well." He replied: "There is nothing else in his cell beyond what is here." The monks said: "Venerable one, ask the elder known as the Senior Monk who was his close companion." He asked that monk, who replied: "I took them. He had dedicated them to me."

On that occasion the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, for the purpose of making things acceptable I permit the dedication. You should address the one who took those robes thus: 'Present those gains from the belongings of the deceased to the Saṅgha and be satisfied with your own share.'"

The case arose in Śrāvastī.

Another monk dedicated robes to a fellow monk, and the one to whom they were dedicated passed away before the appointed time. The monks carried him to the cremation ground, burned him, and on returning brought those robes to the assembly of elders. The monks asked the one who had made the dedication: "To whom do these belong?" He replied: "These are mine, yet I dedicated them to him." The monks did not know how to resolve the matter, and so on that occasion they reported it in detail to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, although for the sake of making things acceptable I permit the dedication, the robes nonetheless belong to the one who made the dedication."

The case arose in Śrāvastī.

Another monk dedicated robes to a fellow monk. The one to whom the robes were dedicated then fell ill. He thought: "That monk dedicated robes to me. Though I am ill, I shall go and claim them by my own authority." He went to that monk and said: "Noble one, you dedicated robes to me — give them to me now." When this was reported to the monks, they did not know how to deal with it, and so on that occasion the monks reported the matter in full to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One considered the situation.

The fault that arose was this: the monk had trusted in that particular monk alone and brought the robes, and the dedication was made in the presence of that monk alone. Therefore, the Blessed One reflected: a monk should not make a dedication in the presence of the very monk toward whom he has directed his trust and brought robes. Having so reflected, he declared to the monks: "Monks, for this reason, a monk must not dedicate robes in the presence of the very monk toward whom he has directed trust and for whom he has brought them. If the dedication has not been made directly before him, then no offense is incurred thereby."

The case arose in Śrāvastī. Another monk dedicated robes to a certain monk. The one to whom the robes were dedicated was a quarrelsome person, ever picking quarrels with the monks. He then made trouble with a different monk and set off to leave. The monk who had dedicated the robes to him began trying to prevent him from going, saying, "Venerable one, do not go," and he seized him by the arm. The man could not be made to stay. He was turned back again and again. Then one of the monks said to him, "This venerable one is a quarrelsome fellow who constantly causes trouble for the monks — let him go." The other monk replied, "It is not for another's sake that I am not letting

him go. Rather, I dedicated my own robes to him, and I am holding on to them." When this was reported to the monks, they reported the matter in full to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Even if the monk one trusts in is on the far side of the ocean, one may still direct one's trust toward him, make the dedication, and take the robes. One should feel no remorse about this." And the Blessed One declared: "Even if the monk one trusts in is on the far side of the ocean, robes may still be dedicated to him."

Then another monk dedicated robes to a monk who was residing in a very distant land. That monk died, and the dedicating monk only learned of the death after a considerable time had passed. He was stricken with remorse. He spoke of this to the monks, and the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "At the moment one hears of the death, one should dedicate the robes to another. One should feel no remorse about this."

A summary verse:

One who resides outside the boundary
must not present faith-offerings or give.
One must not do so between one another,
nor during the Restoration nor the Invitation ceremony.

The Blessed One, the buddha Śākyamuni, was dwelling in Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada (Anāthapiṇḍada, the "Feeder of the Destitute," was the great lay patron who donated the park). The Group of Six monks, though residing outside the boundary, were presenting faith-offerings. When this was reported to the monks, they reported the matter in full to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One who resides outside the boundary must not present faith-offerings."

Then, following the Blessed One's declaration that one who resides outside the boundary must not present faith-offerings, some other monks went outside the boundary. While they were away, some Saṅgha business arose, and the Group of Six monks took faith-offerings from those who had gone outside. When this was reported to the monks, they reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One must not receive faith-offerings from monks who have gone outside the boundary."

Following the Blessed One's declaration that one residing outside the boundary must not present faith-offerings and that one must not receive faith-offerings from monks who have gone outside the boundary, the Group of

Six monks, while residing outside the boundary, began presenting offerings to one another — Gāvampati to Nandika, Nandika to Gāvampati, Udāyin to Canda, and Canda to Udāyin —

and Gāvampati to Nandika, and Nandika to Gāvampati. When this was reported to the monks, they reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks must not present faith-offerings to one another. If they do so, it becomes an offence." The origin of this rule is at Śrāvastī.

When the Blessed One declared that at the time of the fortnightly restoration ceremony (poṣadha) the Prātimokṣa sūtra should be recited, the Group of Six, while residing outside the boundary, offered their intention and declaration of purity for the ceremony. When this was reported to the monks, the Blessed One declared: "One who resides outside the boundary must not offer intention or declaration of purity for the restoration ceremony." Following this declaration by the Blessed One, some other monks went outside the boundary. When they had gone out and then came back, the Saṅgha assembled wishing to perform the restoration ceremony, and the Group of Six received from those monks their intention and declaration of purity. When this was reported to the monks, the Blessed One declared: "One must not receive intention or declaration of purity from monks who have gone outside the boundary."

Following the Blessed One's declaration that one residing outside the boundary must not present faith-offerings or a declaration of purity, and that one must not receive faith-offerings or a declaration of purity from monks who have gone outside the boundary, the Group of Six, while residing outside the boundary, continued to present faith-offerings to one another — Nandika to Nanda, Nanda to Nandika, Udāyin to Canda, Canda to Udāyin, Gāvampati to Nandika, and Nandika to Gāvampati — and when this was again reported to the monks and they reported it to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "Monks must not present to one another intention or declaration of purity for the restoration ceremony. If a monk presents to another monk intention or declaration of purity for the restoration ceremony, it becomes an offence." The origin of this rule is at Śrāvastī.

When the Blessed One declared that a monk who had undertaken the rains retreat must perform the invitation ceremony (pravāraṇā) on the basis of three grounds — what was seen, what was heard, and what was suspected — the Group of Six, while residing outside the boundary, presented faith-offerings and declarations of purity for the invitation ceremony in full, just as if it were a

restoration ceremony.

The summary verse:

Counting monks, toilet wood, and whatever one wishes,
Sitting on one seat, dwelling in a house,
And novices newly joined — these are not to be present.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. There was a brahmin residing at Śrāvastī who had gone outside for some small errand and made his way to the Jeta Grove. After a moment he thought to himself, "I wonder how many monks are residing here," and so he asked the monks: "Noble ones, how many monks are dwelling here?" They replied: "Brahmin, we do not know." The brahmin said: "If you know the count of the market quarters in the capital of Prasenajit, the king of Kosala, how is it that you do not know the count of your own monks?" They said nothing in reply, and the brahmin went away. The monks then reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, you must count one another."

When the Blessed One declared that the monks must count one another, the monks counted by saying "one" and so on. Later, forgetting this, they heard the Blessed One declare: "You must not count by saying 'one' and so on." When the monks then tried to count by raising fingers, they still forgot, and the Blessed One declared: "You must not count by raising fingers." After the Blessed One had declared that monks must not count by saying 'one' and so on, and must not count by raising fingers, the monks did not know how they were to count. At that point the monks asked the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Tally-sticks are to be prepared and distributed, and after they are distributed, counting is to be done. When the count is complete, one should announce to the Saṅgha: 'There are so many monks.'"

When the Blessed One declared that tally-sticks were to be prepared, the monks did not know for which day, month, or year the sticks were to be distributed. The Blessed One then declared: "The tally-sticks are to be distributed at the time of the invitation ceremony at the end of the rains retreat."

Now, when the Blessed One had declared that monks were to be counted, there was a householder living in Śrāvastī who would come regularly to the Jeta Grove. He saw the monks there striving in the practice of meditative concentration, of recitation, and of the yoga of mental cultivation, and from

their conduct, their comportment, and their practice he gained faithful confidence. He thought to himself: "For now, let me first ask how many monks there are here, and afterward invite them and offer them a meal." He asked the monks: "Noble ones, how many monks are residing here?" The monks replied: "So many." He then paid homage at their feet and departed, went to his own home, and said to his household: "Go! Prepare a meal for a monastic Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha — prepare food for so many monks." They replied: "Master, that is good; we will do exactly so." They then began to prepare honey, molasses, sugar, and the like. The householder also gathered his friends, relatives, and family members, and when all was prepared, he set out together with them to the Jeta Grove. Starting from the eldest, he paid homage at the feet of the monks, and then said to the monastery steward: "Noble one, a great householder wishes to invite the monastic Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha tomorrow at midday. Please convey this message." The steward made the announcement, the monastic Saṅgha of monks consented, and the householder paid homage at their feet and departed.

However, some other monks who were wandering on tour had also come to Śrāvastī. That same evening the householder prepared a clean and plentiful meal with food and provisions, rose early the next morning, set out seats and placed out water vessels, and then sent a messenger to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, the midday meal is now prepared. May the Blessed One be pleased to consider that the hour has come." This was conveyed at the midday hour.

The monks in the early morning, having adjusted their robes, took their alms bowls and Dharma robes and set out for the householder's home. The Blessed One remained in the assembly hall and was summoned at the midday hour.

Awakened ones, Blessed Ones, remain in the assembly hall and are summoned at the midday hour for five reasons. What are the five? They wish to settle properly within; they wish to teach the Dharma to the gods; they wish to inspect the lodgings; they wish to attend to the sick; and they wish to establish rules of Vinaya training for the hearers. In this case, the Blessed One, wishing to establish rules of Vinaya training for the hearers, remained in the assembly hall and was summoned there at the midday hour.

That householder had set out seats in proportion to the number of monks in the Saṅgha and had prepared food accordingly. But when he saw that the

monks were exceedingly numerous, he said, "Noble ones, I laid out seats for exactly as many monks as you told me there were, and I prepared food to match — yet far more monks have come."

The monks replied, "Householder, be glad that these additional monks have arrived unexpectedly."

He said, "Noble ones — alas! You should have told me that other monks were also coming. I would have prepared more food and laid out more seats." The monks fell silent, having no confidence to say anything further. And then some of the last to arrive had nothing at all, while the monks ate only what they could scrape into their mouths, struggling as it was shared out among them.

At that point, the monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared, "The monk who is the duty-officer shall, upon learning how many unexpected monks have arrived, announce this to the householder-patrons. Other monks who come only at mealtime — the Blessed One declared that these too shall be announced. Other monks who arrive late, beyond the first announcement — the Blessed One declared that these too shall be announced. Furthermore, I shall establish a rule of conduct for the senior monk of the Saṅgha's community. The senior monk of the Saṅgha shall inspect the Saṅgha of monks, and if the monks are many but the food is little, he shall say to the donor, 'Honored sir, the food is little and the monks are many — please serve them in turn by going round.' But if the food is much and the monks are few, he shall say, 'Honored sir, the food is plentiful — please serve them in turn as much as is available.' If the senior monk of the Saṅgha does not properly take up and apply the rule of conduct thus established, he incurs an offense."

The narrative occasion is in Śrāvastī.

Then the venerable Śāriputra, in the early morning, robed himself, took up his bowl and robes, and entered Śrāvastī on alms-round. Having made his way through Śrāvastī on alms-round, he went to where Queen Mālinī was and, having arrived, began to teach her the Dharma. While he was teaching her the Dharma, Queen Mālinī heard the sound of song and music coming from the direction of Mṛgāra's mother Sādhā, who was carrying medicine for the ailing Saṅgha of monks and making her way toward the Jeta Grove. She asked, "Noble one, whose is that sound of song and music?"

He replied, "Queen, it is Mṛgāra's mother Sādhā, carrying medicine for the ailing Saṅgha of monks — that sound belongs to her."

She said, "Noble one, if that is so, it would be fitting for me to have it announced to the Saṅgha of monks in my own name, saying: 'Queen Mālinī has offered medicine to the Saṅgha of monks.'"

He replied, "Queen, very well. The Blessed One himself has said, 'Whoever tends to the sick tends to me.' Therefore, let it be announced to the Saṅgha of monks in your name." So saying, he wished Queen Mālinī freedom from illness, rose from his seat, and departed.

He then went to the monastery, sat at the end of the row of elders, and said, "Queen Mālinī has offered medicine to the Saṅgha of monks. Whoever wishes for whatever medicine — go and ask for it." When the duty-officer made this announcement, the monks said:

The venerable Cāraka said, "Did the Blessed One not declare that there are ten faults in going to the royal palace? How then should we transgress our training for the sake of medicine?" Having no answer to this, he said nothing, and not a single monk requested medicine from Queen Mālinī.

After some time, the venerable Cāraka himself went to where Queen Mālinī was. She said to him, "Noble one, did you not distribute medicine for the sick in the name of the Saṅgha of monks?" "Queen, I did." "Noble one, if that is so, why have the monks not come?" "Queen, did the Blessed One not declare that there are ten faults in going to the royal palace? How could the monks come here?" "Noble one, if that is the case, how am I to arrange this?" "Queen, if you were to place the kārṣāpaṇas in the hands of a marketplace merchant, then whatever medicine any monk wishes for, he may request it from him."

She replied, "Noble one, excellent — let it be done so." She placed the kārṣāpaṇas in the hands of a marketplace merchant and said, "The noble ones will not come to the royal palace; therefore, whatever any monk wishes for, give it to him." The merchant received the kārṣāpaṇas at the queen's command and set them aside.

The monks then entrusted the kārṣāpaṇas to a certain large perfume-seller's stall belonging to the goddess Mālinī, instructing her: "Whatever any monk wishes for, you are to give it to him." Hearing this instruction, they left, thinking she would do so.

Then certain monks came and said, "Good woman, prepare for us dried broth, broth, and meat, and give it to us." Others said, "Give us broth and dried meat." Yet others said, "Give us raw meat broth and lard." She was troubled by

all this and said, "Noble ones, I am neither a soup-maker nor a meat-preparer. Please take this money and go, and let whoever wants whatever arrange it for themselves." They said, "Good woman, the Blessed One has not permitted monks to handle money." She replied, "Noble ones, I am a perfume-seller living by trade in the marketplace — if it comes to this, my livelihood will be ruined."

At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Trusting in the patron, one may take the *kārṣāpaṇas* and make whatever use of them one wishes. There is no fault in this."

The setting for this is Śrāvastī.

The group of six monks were sitting together on one seat with laypeople. Faithful brahmin and householder devotees saw this and mocked them, saying, "Noble ones, you have gone forth and lead the holy life — how is it that you sit on the same seat together with those who enjoy sensual pleasures?" When the monks said nothing in response, the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, it is fitting that the faithful brahmins and householders mocked them. Therefore, monks must not sit on the same seat together with laypeople; if they do, it becomes an offense. The Blessed One has declared that one must not sit on the same seat together with laypeople."

When it was then seen by lay practitioners that the monks were sitting on the same seat together with novices, they said, "Noble ones, you have received full ordination — how is it that you sit on the same seat together with novices?" The monks said, "Venerables, these are not laypeople — these are renunciants; what transgression is there in this?" When they said nothing further in response, the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One.

The Blessed One declared: "One must not sit on the same seat together with one who has not received full ordination." When the Blessed One had declared that one must not sit on the same seat together with one who has not received full ordination, senior monks began sitting on the same seat together with junior monks, and the junior monks showed disrespect toward the senior monks on that account. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Senior and junior monks must not sit on the same seat together. However, one may sit on the same seat together with one who is in the intermediate period of three years. One who has not yet completed a year and one who has completed three years may sit together; one who has

completed one year and one who has completed four years, and similarly up to one who has completed nine years and one who has completed twelve years, may also sit together."

When the Blessed One had declared that one may sit on the same seat together with one who is in the intermediate period of three years — that one who has not yet completed a year and one who has completed three years may sit together, that one who has completed one year and one who has completed four years, and similarly up to one who has completed nine years and one who has completed twelve years, may also sit together — the monks would not sit together with those in the intermediate period of three years even inside a layman's house, and as a result those monks went without seats. The Blessed One then declared: "Inside a layman's house, one may sit together even with one's preceptor and abbot — there is no cause for remorse in this."

The summary verse:

Not giving a novice a cushioned stool,
not correcting a novice in speech,
not administering an oath or making one kneel,
and not eating tiger-food.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. When the Blessed One declared that seats should be arranged for listening to Dharma, the novices sat on cushioned stools and listened to the Dharma. They fell asleep there and in that very place lost control of their urine and feces, and the cushioned stools became soiled. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One must not give novices cushioned stools."

When the Blessed One had declared that one must not give novices cushioned stools, the novice known as Śāradvatīputra's (Śāriputra's) charge went to hear the Dharma, and the monks gave him a plain stool. He said, "Venerables, why do you give me a plain stool?" They said, "The Blessed One has forbidden cushioned stools for novices." He said, "Venerables, do you think I too would commit that offense?" The monks then reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "To those novices who are established in mindfulness, one may give a cushioned stool; to others, one may not."

The setting is Śrāvastī.

There was a monk who had a novice, and he reprimanded him harshly. The novice sat weeping at the gate of the Jeta Grove. Since one or another of the group of six was always to be found at the gate of the Jeta Grove, the venerable Ānanda, who was sitting at the gate, saw him and said, "Novice, why do you weep?" He said, "Venerable Ānanda, my abbot has reprimanded me harshly." He said, "Come here, my child — I will ensure that you are not lacking in your almsbowl, your robes, your straining cloth, your bowl, your belt, and whatever else you are in need of," and he led him to his dwelling.

The Blessed One declared that one must not harshly rebuke and then simply abandon the novice, but that he should instead be recalled. The monk accordingly sent another monk to that novice, who spoke to him. The novice replied, "What do I need an abbot for? My friend Ānanda has provided me with all my requisites — I will not go." The monk began to mock him, to slander him, and to revile him, saying, "The one I ordained has been won over by a companion." When the monks reported this to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "A monk must not draw away another's novice. If he draws him away, it becomes a grave offence close to creating schism."

The origin of this rule was at Śrāvastī.

Members of the group of six would renounce their vows wherever and whenever it suited them — renouncing before the Buddha, renouncing before the Dharma and the Saṅgha, renouncing before their teachers and their abbots. When brahmin and householder devotees observed this, they said, "Venerable sirs, even we householders do not renounce the Teacher, yet you who have gone forth — how is it fitting that you renounce the Teacher in this way?" When those monks sat in silence, the other monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, the reproach of brahmin and householder devotees has truly struck home. One who has gone forth is of sincere intention. Therefore a monk must not renounce his vows. If a monk renounces them, it becomes an offence entailing a serious breach."

The origin of this rule was at Śrāvastī.

Members of the group of six, wherever and whenever they wished, would make a pack of their almsbowl, their robes, their straining cloth, their bowl, their belt, and whatever other requisites of a renunciant they had. When brahmins and householders saw this, they mocked them, saying, "Noble ones, why are you bundling up your almsbowl and other requisites as laypeople do? That is not fitting." Those monks replied, "Have you eaten garlic? Have you

drunk ale? What impropriety is there in this?" And they sat in silence. When the monks reported this to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "Monks, the reproach of brahmins and householders has truly struck home. Therefore a monk must not make such a bundle of his requisites. If a monk makes such a bundle, it becomes an offence entailing a serious breach."

The origin of this rule was at Śrāvastī.

The conduct of the group of six was as follows: they would rise before dawn, climb to the roof, and look out in all four directions — wherever they saw smoke rising or vultures circling, they would quickly set off at a brisk pace for that place. Then one day a companion of theirs rose before dawn, went up to the roof, and began to look. He saw vultures wheeling in the distance, flying far and farther away. Then he saw that a tiger had hidden a carcass somewhere in a dense forest, and he was delighted. He took it and went to the Jeta Grove. The tiger, following the scent and tracking him, began to make a commotion at the gate of the Jeta Grove. Now, the blessed buddhas, even when they already know something, feign not knowing, and so the Blessed One asked the venerable Ānanda, "Why is the tiger roaring?" Ānanda replied, "Venerable sir, it is because the venerable one's companion has come seeking the carcass that the tiger had hidden." The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, does a monk eat a tiger's carcass? It is fit only for a wild beast to seek out. Ānanda, the king of beasts, the lion, kills noble and noble prey, eats fine flesh, drinks pure blood, and then leaves the remainder behind. A tiger, however, hides carcasses away. Therefore a monk must not eat a tiger's carcass.

To eat it would constitute a grave offence. Furthermore, O monks, I shall establish a rule of conduct to be observed by the senior resident of a Saṅgha residence: the senior resident monk of a Saṅgha residence, when distributing meat, must ask, 'Is this not a tiger's carcass?' If he takes it without asking, he incurs a grave offence.

The summary verse:

When the tooth-wood sticks are distributed,
the two friends who concealed themselves,
the reversal of the shares received,
and matters such as these are the subject.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, belonging to Prince Jeta. On a certain hillside there was a monastery. One day Nanda and Upananda were wandering and

exploring in the countryside, and they went to that hillside. While they were there, a gain accrued to the Saṅgha. Since those two were practitioners of wrongful conduct, no monk had gone to summon them. Then Upananda said to Nanda, "Teacher, these arrogant ones with their black bowls filled to the brim are harassing us. Let us hide and watch how they divide up whatever they get." Nanda replied, "Good, let us do just that." They hid themselves and watched as the Saṅgha divided the gains. When the distribution was finished, those two came forward and said, "Venerable ones, divide the Saṅgha's gains that have come in." The monks replied, "Where have you come from only now? The time for distributing those gains has passed." Those two said, "Are you the ones who are supposed to divide? You may have divided it, but it was wrong to divide it. Did you make the announcement and then divide?" At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "When gains are to be distributed to the Saṅgha, make the announcement to the Saṅgha that no monk is to go anywhere, and then distribute the gains." The monks collected those gains back together. After collecting them, they announced to the Saṅgha that when the Saṅgha's gains were to be distributed no monk was to go anywhere, and began to divide them. Nanda and Upananda hid themselves just as before.

The Minor Matters of the Vinaya, twenty-third fascicle.

When the Saṅgha had finished distributing those gains, those two came again and said, "Venerable ones, give us our share of those gains." The monks said, "Where have you come from only now? The time for distributing the gains was when the announcement had been made to the Saṅgha." Those two replied, "Even if you made the announcement, you cannot divide it away from us — it was wrong to divide it. Did you sound the gong (gaṇḍī) after making the announcement?" At that point the monks again reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "After making the announcement, sound the gong and then distribute the gains to the Saṅgha." The monks again collected the gains back together, and after collecting them, made the announcement just as before, sounded the gong, and began to divide. Those two hid themselves exactly as before. When the distribution of those gains was finished, they came again and spoke exactly as before. The monks replied, "We made the announcement to the Saṅgha and we sounded the gong — where have you come from only now?" Those two said, "You made the announcement and sounded the gong, but did you distribute the tooth-wood sticks? You cannot divide it away from us — it was wrong to divide it." When

this was said, the monks again reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "After making the announcement, sound the gong, distribute the tooth-wood sticks, and then divide the gains."

The monks again collected those gains. Having collected them, they made the announcement, sounded the gong, distributed the tooth-wood sticks, and were just beginning to divide the gains — whereupon those two hid themselves exactly as before. When the distribution of the gains was finished, those two came forth and spoke exactly as before. The monks said, "Venerable ones, how do you dare make such a claim to the Saṅgha? We made the announcement to the Saṅgha, sounded the gong, and distributed the tooth-wood sticks — from where have you come only now?" Those two replied, "Venerables, never mind the gains. If that is so, then tell us: in what manner did we make a claim to the Saṅgha? If you made the announcement, sounded the gong, and distributed the tooth-wood sticks — did you then show us our share? That is all. Even without any gains, we would still go on our way." When this was said, the monks again reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "After making the announcement to the Saṅgha, sounding the gong, and distributing the tooth-wood sticks, show the share of anyone who is absent, and then make the division. Whatever share belongs to one who comes only after the division is complete — gains shall not be given to that person. If the division is made in this way, it is a proper division, and there shall be no remorse in this. A monk must not deliberately stir up such trouble for the Saṅgha. If a monk deliberately does stir up trouble for the Saṅgha, it becomes a serious offense."

The basis of this rule is at Śrāvastī.

At a certain time, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada offered the Jeta Grove to the Saṅgha of monks from the four directions, and had it painted inside and out with various and distinct colors. When the multitude of people dwelling at Śrāvastī heard how the householder Anāthapiṇḍada had painted the Jeta Grove inside and out with various and distinct colors of excellent quality and made it supremely magnificent, many hundreds of thousands of living creatures came near to the Jeta Grove to see it.

Now at that time a brahmin was residing at Śrāvastī. The king, his ministers, and the townspeople looked upon this brahmin with admiration and said, "This brahmin is handsome," and so he received a considerable gift fitting for one of high standing, from the royal palace. He shared out that gift and went to the

Jeta Grove to see the spectacle. The moment he saw it, an immense faith arose in him, and he offered that entire gift to the Saṅgha of monks from the four directions.

The Blessed One had said, "Whenever gains of cloth arise, divide them equally, down to even what is enough for the wick of a lamp." So the monks cut the cloth into strips and divided it equally. The brahmin thought, "That gift was one of great worth. Let me offer the noble ones some kārṣāpaṇa coins and receive it back." So the next morning he rose early and went to the Jeta Grove. At the gate of the Jeta Grove many monks were sitting. He addressed them: "I pay homage to the noble ones. May the great brahmin be in good health. That gift which was offered to the noble ones — what have you done with it?" The monks replied, "Great brahmin, rejoice! We have divided it equally." One said, "I used my share to mend my hat." Another said, "I used mine to mend my short shoes." Another said, "I used mine to patch my upper robe." Another said, "I used mine to wipe out my begging bowl." Then he said —

"Noble ones, something befitting the great gift would be to exchange those kārṣāpaṇas and divide the kārṣāpaṇas among yourselves." At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, what the brahmin says is true. Therefore, whatever gain of robes of that kind has come to the Saṅgha, it should be exchanged for kārṣāpaṇas, and those kārṣāpaṇas should be divided."

Summary verse:

The five unsuitable kinds,
the prohibition of shoes,
shoes of bear hide,
and the layers upon them.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The group of six said: "Friend, dear friend! If we were to go through all of Śrāvastī to every last person without exception and set up a round of meals, those royal elephant-trainers would give us nothing at all. Let us go and stir up a little trouble." Some of them said: "Good — let us do so; but we should devise a plan. What shall we do? Let us make shoes from a lion's hide, divide them up, go and sit in the place where the elephants walk, and startle the elephants." Others said: "First let us go and ask them, and if they refuse to give anything, we can do that afterward." So the next morning they rose early, went to those

elephant-trainers, and said: "Friends, you brutes! Will you not pay us the price of our meals?" The trainers replied: "Noble ones, what do we owe you? Why should we pay you the price of meals?" The group of six measured them up and left.

Then, just as they had planned, they made shoes from a lion's hide, divided them among themselves, went and sat down in the place where the elephants were accustomed to walk, and when the elephants caught the scent of the lion they panicked, lost control of their bowels, and began to bolt. The royal elephant-trainers tried to hold them with their iron hooks, thrusting with all their might, but could not restrain them. The group of six called out: "Venerable ones, do not let them go! Do not let them go!" The trainers replied: "Noble ones, if we cannot hold them, how can we not let them go?" The group of six said: "Then will you pay us? Noble ones, if you accept this arrangement, all the better. Venerable ones, if you promise to give us the price of our meals, we will pay you back." The trainers replied: "Noble ones, we are destitute." "Is that so?" And with that, they moved off to a direction away from the elephants' path and sat down there; no longer catching the lion's scent, the elephants stood still. The elephant-trainers said: "Noble ones, do you know any incantations?" "Friends, we know no incantations." "Noble ones, then how did you stop them?" The trainers described what had happened, and those trainers then said: "See what harm you have done! If these excellent royal elephants with their superb limbs were to have strayed off into the forest, would you not have done great injury to the king?" The group of six sat there smiling, saying nothing in reply.

The monks then reported this to the Blessed One. The Blessed One considered the matter: "Whatever fault has now arisen has come about because monks wore shoes of lion's hide. Therefore monks should not keep shoes of lion's hide." Having so considered, he addressed the monks: "Monks, therefore a monk should not keep shoes of lion's hide. If a monk keeps shoes of lion's hide, he incurs a serious offense."

When the Blessed One had declared that monks should not keep shoes of lion's hide, the group of six then began to keep shoes of tiger's hide. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore monks should not keep shoes made from the hides of any of the five kinds of animals possessing claws and fangs: the trained elephant, the trained horse, the lion, the tiger, or the bear. Monks should not keep shoes made from the hides of these five animals possessing claws and fangs."

When the Blessed One had declared that monks should not keep shoes made from the hides of the five animals possessing claws and fangs, the venerable Upavāna asked the Blessed One: "Venerable sir, are there yet other animals possessing claws and fangs? Should shoes made from their hides likewise not be kept?" "Shoes made from the hides of those animals likewise should not be kept; if kept, one incurs a serious offense."

The setting for the next rule is Śrāvastī. At Śrāvastī a certain monk was afflicted with an illness of swelling sores. He went to a physician and said: "Revered sir, I am afflicted with swelling sores; please prescribe a medicine." The physician said: "Noble one, tread upon shoes of bear's hide and you will recover." The monk replied: "The Blessed One has not permitted this." The physician said: "Noble one, your Teacher is compassionate; he will permit it." At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore it is permitted: a monk afflicted with the illness of swelling sores may keep shoes of bear's hide."

When the Blessed One had declared that a monk afflicted with swelling sores may keep shoes of bear's hide, it happened that many layers could not be obtained. The Blessed One then declared: "If many layers cannot be obtained, one may fasten a single upper layer with a piece of felt."

Here ends the fifth chapter from the Vinaya on minor matters.

The summary verse is as follows:

By hide of leopard, of bright fine-cloth, harsh,
of servant, and likewise of bark,
of one who has fallen, of a merchant,
and of a monk who does not discard the remainder.

The further summary verse:

The lining of those hides, with cording,
and likewise inner toe-piece and heel-piece,
with long handle and with short handle,
and those with a strap — these should not be made.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. When the Blessed One had declared that monks should not keep shoes made from the hides of the five animals possessing claws and fangs, the group of six stitched shoes using the lining of those hides, and on account of that very fault the Blessed One declared: "One should not

stitch shoes using their lining." When the Blessed One had declared that one should not stitch shoes using their lining, the group of six stitched shoes using leather cording from those hides, and on account of that very fault the Blessed One declared: "One should not stitch shoes using leather cording from those hides." When the Blessed One had declared that one should not stitch shoes using either their lining or their leather cording, the group of six made inner toe-pieces from those hides, and on account of that very fault the Blessed One declared: "One should not make inner toe-pieces from those hides." When the Blessed One had declared that one should not make inner toe-pieces from those hides, the group of six made heel-pieces from those hides, and on account of that very fault the Blessed One declared: "One should not make heel-pieces from those hides." When the Blessed One had declared that one should not make inner toe-pieces or heel-pieces from those hides, the group of six made shoes with long handles from those hides, and on account of that very fault the Blessed One declared:

"One should not make shoes with long handles from those hides." When the Blessed One had declared that one should not make inner toe-pieces, heel-pieces, or shoes with long handles from those hides, the group of six made shoes with short handles from those hides, and on account of that very fault the Blessed One declared: "One should not make shoes with short handles from those hides." When the Blessed One had declared that one should not make shoes with short handles from those hides, the group of six made shoes with tassels from those hides, and on account of that very fault the Blessed One declared: "One should not make shoes with tassels from those hides."

Summary verse: Vairocana, all desires, the Saṅgha's heating and craft-training, giving food to the unprotected, children, the temple — and excellence.

Intermediate summary verse: The birth, the great king, and his own power; likewise the white man, the renunciant, the viceroy; the buddha-realm itself, and the supreme limb; likewise the dream, the earth-holder, the birth and the dwelling.

When the bodhisattva, the Blessed One, was dwelling in the Tuṣita heaven, he surveyed the world through the five surveys — the survey of lineage, the survey of time, the survey of place, the survey of clan, and the survey of women — and, having stirred the six gods of the desire realm three times and

indicated the form of a great elephant, he entered his mother's womb. At that moment the great earth shook mightily, and this entire world was pervaded by a great radiance that surpassed even the power of the brilliant hues of the gods of the Heaven of Thirty-Three. The darkness — the dense, impenetrable gloom — that lies between world and world, where the sun and moon, though possessed of such great miraculous power and such great might, cannot illuminate with their light, was likewise at that moment pervaded by that great radiance. Those sentient beings who had been born there and could not see even their own hand held before them, they too, by that light, saw one another; and those with understanding knew: "Look, other sentient beings too have been born here! Look, other sentient beings too have been born here!"

At the time when the bodhisattva, the Blessed One, was born, the sons of the four great kings were also born: in Rājagṛha the son of King Mahāpadma was born; in Śrāvastī the son of King Brahmadatta; in Vaiśālī the son of King Anantamekhalin; and in Kauśāmbī the son of King Śātānīka was born. When the bodhisattva was born, this great earth appeared like molten gold, and each king thought to himself, "This is the power of my son! This is the power of my son!" — and each of them, separately, gave him a name.

King Mahāpadma spoke: "Wise ones, when my son was born he made the world shine like the form of the sun; therefore I give the youth the name Rūpasāra, 'Essence of Form.'"

King Brahmadatta Long-flight spoke: "When my son was born the valleys appeared clear and brilliant; therefore I give the youth the name Jayaprabha, 'Victorious Radiance.'"

King Anantamekhalin spoke: "When my son was born the world was illuminated by a most excellent light; therefore I give the youth the name Suprabha, 'Excellent Light.'"

King Śātānīka spoke: "When my son was born the world was illuminated as though the sun had risen; therefore I give the youth the name Udaya, 'Rising.'"

At that time, in the Rikṣavana forest, there dwelt a sage named Śvetakarna, skilled in the destruction and the arising of this world. He had a nephew named Nālada, who came repeatedly to visit him. Whenever Nālada came, the sage would constantly speak to him of destruction and arising. Having heard these teachings on destruction and arising, Nālada grew weary and, right there in that place, went forth into renunciation.

Then, at another time, Nālada saw the cave of Śvetakarna pervaded by a vast and spreading light. Upon seeing it he spoke in verse:

Have all the suns together
risen here at once?
Like this — mountains and cave ablaze,
burning with rays of light!

Śvetakarna replied in verse:

The sun's light is warm; this light is cool.
Since it enters and illumines the body here,
this is certainly the light of the Mighty One —
the great radiant bodhisattva
has beyond all doubt emerged from the womb.
This is that bodhisattva's light,
stainless upon his arising.
All three worlds spread out
resemble gold.

Nālada said: "Master, if that is so, come this way! Let us go and behold the bodhisattva!"

He replied: "Son, at this very moment the bodhisattva is attended by those celebrated as greatly powerful among the gods, surrounded by the greatly powerful, and it is not easy for us to see him. We shall go at the time when he has gone to the palace, received his name, and come back out."

On the very day the bodhisattva was born, five hundred male attendants and five hundred female attendants were born and brought along; five hundred she-elephants and five hundred wild mares were also born and followed; and five hundred treasures opened and became manifest. The ministers reported to King Śuddhodana: "Blessed one, whose face the gods delight to see, please be of good cheer! At the birth of the youth these many things have come to be: five hundred male attendants and five hundred female attendants have been born; five hundred she-elephants and five hundred wild mares have followed; and five hundred treasures have opened and been displayed."

King Śuddhodana heard this and a feeling of joy arose in him. He spoke: "Wise ones, at the birth of the youth all my aims and the fullness of all my deeds are accomplished; therefore I give the youth the name Sarvārthasiddha, 'All Aims Accomplished.'" And so the bodhisattva received this name, Sarvārthasiddha.

The bodhisattva was placed in a palanquin adorned with the four precious substances, surrounded by many thousands of sentient beings, and with great honor from gods and humans he entered the city of Kapilavastu. When the bodhisattva entered the city, the proud Śākyaas were speaking noisily all at once, while those who held themselves to be restrained sat in silence, composed like sages. Then King Śuddhodana spoke:

"Since these proud Śākyaas were speaking noisily all at once, yet when the youth entered the city they fell silent, composed like sages, therefore let the youth's name be proclaimed Śākyamuni, 'the Sage of the Śākyaas.'" And so the bodhisattva received this second name: Śākyamuni.

Now among the Śākyaas there dwelled a permanent yakṣa by the name Śākyavarddhana, "the Increaser of the Śākyaas." Whenever a son or a daughter was born among the Śākyaas, the child was first brought to bow at the feet of the yakṣa Śākyavarddhana. So King Śuddhodana spoke: "Wise ones, let the youth now be brought to bow at the feet of the yakṣa Śākyavarddhana." When the ministers led him before the yakṣa, the yakṣa Śākyavarddhana caught sight of the bodhisattva from a great distance. Upon seeing him, the yakṣa rose up, striding forth with long, sweeping steps, went to receive the bodhisattva, and bowed at his feet. Then King Śuddhodana spoke: "Wise ones, the yakṣa Śākyavarddhana himself has bowed at the youth's feet. Therefore this youth is a god above gods, and so let the youth's name be proclaimed Devātideva, 'God above Gods.'" And thus the bodhisattva received his third name: Devātideva, "God above Gods."

Then King Śuddhodana presented the bodhisattva before the brahmins, the masters of bodily marks, and the astrologers, and said: "Wise ones, a youth who possesses certain signs will follow one of two paths of a great man and none other. If he remains a householder dwelling at home, he will become a wheel-turning king (cakravartin), victorious in the four directions, a righteous king of Dharma, possessing the seven precious treasures. And those seven precious treasures are these: the precious wheel, the precious elephant, the precious horse, the precious jewel, the precious woman, the precious householder, and seventh, the precious minister. But if with faith he shaves his hair and beard, dons the ochre robes, and goes forth from home to homelessness, he will become renowned throughout the world as a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and fully awakened buddha. Does he possess the thirty-two marks of a great man?" They replied: "Sire, it is just as you say. The youth possesses those signs through which one becomes a great man in one

of two ways and no other" — and so they declared, from "the youth possesses those signs through which one becomes a great man in two ways and no other" up to "he will become renowned throughout the world, and he possesses the thirty-two marks of a great man."

Then Nālada spoke: "Master, the bodhisattva has gone to the city of Kapilavastu and his names have been bestowed. Come now, let us return and behold him." He replied: "Good, child. Let us do so." The two then set out by means of their supernormal powers — but through the power of the bodhisattva, those supernormal powers were rendered ineffective, and they entered the city of Kapilavastu on foot alone. They went to where King Śuddhodana's palace was, and having arrived, they stood at the gate of the royal palace.

Then the sage Nārada said to a man: "Friend, please go and announce to King Śuddhodana that the sage Nārada wishes to see him and is standing at the gate." The man went and announced: "Sire, the sage Nārada wishes to see the king and is at the palace gate." The king replied: "Wise ones, quickly invite the sage Nārada inside." When he entered, King Śuddhodana received him with the proper courtesies of welcome, offered a ceremonial gift to his feet, and had him seated upon a lion throne.

Then King Śuddhodana, touching his two feet, spoke: "Great sage, for what reason have you come?"

He then spoke in verse:

Great king, I have come wishing to behold your son —
I have come desiring to see him,
the guide, the lord of the world,
the Sage whom I long to behold.

King Śuddhodana said: "Great sage, the young one is asleep."

Nārada replied: "Then let me behold him as he sleeps."

King Śuddhodana said: "Great sage, very well — please go and look."

Nārada went and saw the bodhisattva gazing at forms without blinking his eyes. Upon seeing this, he spoke in verse:

A pure thoroughbred of noble lineage,
like one lying down at the midnight hour,
does not long keep sleep in his eyes —

for those who pursue purposeful aims do not linger in sleep.

Having said this, he asked: "O king, were those young brahmins, the astrologers, and the stargazers shown to him?"

Nārada said: "Great sage, they were shown to him."

"And what did those gods and seers prophecy?"

King Śuddhodana replied: "They said he would become a wheel-turning king (cakravartin)."

Then Nārada began to examine the bodhisattva from head to toe. As he beheld the marks of a buddha upon the bodhisattva, he fell into this contemplation: "In how many years, having seen the marks of a buddha upon this bodhisattva, will he attain the nectar of immortality?" And he perceived that at the age of twenty-nine he would go forth from the home life, and that after six years of austerities he would attain the nectar of immortality. Then, turning his contemplation upon his own stream of being, he saw that he himself would die in the interval, and the craving for existence in the desire realm arose in him. With eyes filled with tears, he spoke in verse:

The minds of those who reason and speculate err.

At the end of time there will be no wheel-turning king.

This one of supreme merit is a treasury of Dharma;
victorious over all faults, he will become a buddha.

By those who discern only the lesser marks of a great being,
he is proclaimed sovereign lord over the four continents.

He whose marks shine forth completely, the Lord of Sages, the perfect buddha

—

this most excellent of men will turn the wheel of Dharma.

Then the king, seeing Nārada's eyes filled with tears, felt embarrassed and displeased, and in turn spoke in verse:

Men and women who encounter him
will not grow weary but will find delight.

This beautiful one, the giver of joy — you have seen him here.

Why then do your eyes brim with tears?

Surely my young one faces no danger,
nor is his life drawing near its end?

Therefore quickly tell me this good news.
Your mournful expression makes me tremble.

Nārada then spoke in verse:

Even if upon this earth from the sky
a fierce and terrible rain of vajras were to fall,
not a single hair of the great Sage's body
could be made to move.

Driven by a great storm-wind,
unbearable and keen and utterly sharp weapons,
the venom of vicious serpents and most terrible poisons —
were they to fall upon the young one's body, they could not harm him.

O lord of men, I weep because I, having encountered
this supreme treasury of the highest Dharma,
will die without accomplishing my purpose —
I will not attain peace. Seeing my own failing,
for that reason I weep.

Those in the world who, at the proper time,
hear the Dharma of this incomparable and peerless teacher,
and having heard, go to supreme peace —
they are joyful, full of merit, free of disease.

King Śuddhodana, upon hearing that the bodhisattva would attain the nectar
of immortality, sat in silence without a word.

Now Nārada the white-clad sage — having become corrupted through wrong
views, he had entered into great falsehood and the constant practice of deceit
— spoke: "O king, the gathered people dwelling in your city may think: 'Alas, it
is wrong that the white-clad sage Nārada should come on foot to the city of the
Śākya land.' But I have long aspired, out of compassion for beings, to come on
foot to the city of the Śākya land, and indeed I have come on foot. Please grant
that the city be beautified by the mere fact of my coming on foot."

King Śuddhodana gave orders to his ministers: "Wise ones, have the
white-clad sage Nārada depart the city on foot. Let the city and roads be made
beautiful. Have the drums beaten, proclaiming aloud: 'Let all who dwell in the
Śākya land, the assembled peoples, and those who have come from various
regions, as well as others, ask: Who is the white-clad sage who departs the city

on foot?" The ministers, saying "As the king commands," had the city of the Śākya land cleared of stones, gravel, and clods of earth. They sprinkled it thoroughly with sandalwood water, placed bowls fragrant with perfume, hung many silk pennants, raised victory banners and flags, scattered flowers of many kinds, and made the city as beautiful and joyful as the pleasure groves of the gods — indeed more delightful even than a divine park of delight. They made the city and roads beautiful, then sounded the drums, proclaiming: "Let all who dwell in the city, the inhabitants of the palace, and the assembled peoples who have come from various regions hear this! The king has commanded: 'Tomorrow, the white-clad sage Nārada departs the city of the Śākya land on foot. Therefore all of you — ask who he is!'"

When morning came, the white-clad sage Nārada departed the city of the Śākya land on foot, escorted with great honor by many thousands of the finest of men.

He went some distance away, and there he gave rise again to meditative concentration and accomplished miraculous powers. But then, his karma having fully ripened and been exhausted, he was struck by illness. Though he was treated with medicines of roots, stems, flowers, leaves, and fruits, that illness did not subside.

Nārada, knowing the condition of his own body in its final stage, bowed at his feet and said: "Master, all who have gone forth to whatever degree seek nectar and search for nectar. Therefore, if you have found the nectar, I pray you share a portion of that nectar with me."

He replied: "My child, though I too, having gone forth, seek nectar and search for nectar — I have not found it. Nevertheless, you should go forth in the presence of the youth born among the Śākyans. Do not take pride in your clan, do not take pride in your lineage, do not take pride in being a brahmin's son. With that humility, practice the holy life — and so you will attain the nectar."

Then he spoke these verses:

All that is gathered must reach its end.

All that is high must come to fall.

All meeting must end in parting.

All that lives must end in death.

And so he met his time, in accordance with the nature of the hour.

Nāḷada performed the bone-rites for his bones, and then went to the city of Vārāṇasī, where he dwelt among the sages. And since Nāḷada was kin to Nārada through his bones, his name came to be the sage Nāḷada.

The youth Suprabhā was entrusted to eight nurses: two who would carry him in their arms and sustain him, two who would suckle him, two who would cleanse him of impurity, and two who would be his companions in play. These eight nurses reared and nourished him with milk, curds, fresh butter, clarified butter, the essence of butter, and other principal provisions and necessities, so that he grew and flourished like a lotus dwelling in a lake.

When he had grown to adulthood, he was instructed in letters, numerals, calculation, accounting, and the royal consecration poured upon the head of the kingly lineage. The various crafts and occupations of those who had attained lordship over the land and power over the realm, and those who abided in the settled domain of the great earth, were as follows: riding on the neck of an elephant, riding a horse, the handling of chariots, the handling of swords, archery,

pulling back, thrusting forward, the method of steering with an iron hook, the casting of a lasso, the hurling of a great arrow, cutting, splitting, the manner of seizing, the manner of stepping, striking at the crown, striking at a distance, striking so as to make a sound, striking a vital point, striking without missing — in all these formidable arts he became skilled, and he also became accomplished in the five fields of knowledge.

Now, whenever the bodhisattva sported in the play of youth, the young prince Rab Snang likewise sported in youthful play. When the bodhisattva was consecrated as crown prince, the young prince Rab Snang was likewise consecrated as crown prince.

When the bodhisattva, having seen an old person, a sick person, and a dead person, felt weariness and renounced sixty thousand women — including those known as Sā Tsho Ma, Ri Dags Skyes, Grags Dzin Ma, and the rest — and at midnight went to dwell in the forest of austerities, then, in the presence of the ascetics who had freed themselves from the coarser and subtler forms of existence, he proceeded from freedom from attachment to the desire realm (kāmadhātu), through freedom from attachment to the form realm (rūpadhātu), and — in the matter of the excellent conduct of the son of Raṅs Byed — freedom from attachment all the way up to the sphere of nothingness (ākimcanyāyatana) within the formless realm (ārūpyadhātu). Thinking that

since he had not yet found liberation through scriptural transmission, it was fitting to undergo austerities, he practiced austerities for six years, and yet did not attain any exceptional realization. Then he breathed comfortably in and out as he pleased, ate coarse food with rice and warm gruel, anointed his body with white butter and sesame oil, and bathed in water neither too cold nor too warm. He proceeded to the village called Sde Grong, and from the maidens Dga Mo and Dga Stobs he received sixteen portions of milk-porridge sweetened with honey, pressed into essence, and consumed them. Praised by Nāgarāja the Black, the king of nāgas, he received fresh grass from the auspicious grass-seller, and went to that very place, the foot of the tree of awakening. Arriving there, he spread the grass in an undisturbed and unentangled manner, sat down, crossed his legs, straightened his body, set his awareness in direct presence, and resolved in his heart — and also declared aloud — that until he attained the exhaustion of all defilements, he would not uncross his legs:

"Until I have found the exhaustion of all defilements,
I shall not unfold my crossed legs."

When the Blessed One vanquished Māra, together with his host of sixty myriads of demon troops, with the weapon of loving-kindness, and thereby obtained unsurpassed wisdom; when at Brahmā's urging he proceeded to the region of Vārāṇasī and, reciting three times, turned the wheel of Dharma in twelve aspects in accordance with the Dharma — at that time the young prince Rab Snang was likewise consecrated as a great king.

At that time, in the noble realm of Ārya, there was a king named Rab Snang, a Dharma-king, whose kingdom was prosperous, flourishing, happy, with good harvests and many people, filled with humans; and quarrels, disputes, conflicts, and the disturbances of conflict were thoroughly pacified; there was no banditry, and no illness. He governed in accordance with the Dharma, ensuring abundance of sālu rice, sugarcane, and mahā. By his power he always rejoiced greatly in festivals.

In that city of the noble realm there were the five sense faculties and the five proximate faculties. Five hundred streams flowing from five hundred ponds flowed into the very place called the Beautiful Palace of the King.

King Rab Snang had five supreme-limbed elephants: the elephant Dam Bu's Mountain, the great elephant Mo Bzang Ldan, the female elephant Ocean-Footed, the horse Kha Dog Mgrin, and the one called Phar Ma Pa Kha.

Of these, Dam Bu's Mountain could in a single day cover a distance of one hundred leagues. Mo Bzang Ldan could cover eighty leagues. Ocean-Footed could cover seventy leagues.

The horse Kha Dog Mgrin could cover fifty leagues, and Phar Ma Pa Kha could cover twenty leagues.

With all such abundance and perfect prosperity, the king was struck by a condition called "sleeplessness from unbalanced elements." The king loathed butter and was fond of alcohol, so when the physicians prepared clarified butter blended with various special medicinal substances and offered it to him to drink, he would not drink it. If the consort's retinue, the young men, the ministers, or the people of the palace household tried to offer him butter, he would grow ever more enraged, and whoever so much as uttered the word "butter" he would have beheaded and thrown to the ground. Because of his sleeplessness, during the first watch of the night he would sport and take pleasure with the consort's retinue. During the second watch, he would inspect the elephants and horses. During the third watch, he would go to those of his subjects who tended the fires and ask, "Who is stoking the fires right now?" Whoever failed to answer on the first asking, he would let pass. Whoever failed to answer on the second asking, he would also let pass. But whoever failed to answer on the third asking, he would have beheaded and thrown to the ground. Because of this, the name by which he had been known, King Rab Snang, came in time to be replaced from all sides by the name the Fierce King Rab Snang, Grim Rab Snang the Fierce.

On another occasion he said to the consort's retinue: "Women, I tend the fires — why do you not tend the fires?" They replied, "Your Majesty, we too will do so when our turn comes." They tended the fires for a little while and then said, "Your Majesty, if we were to tend them always, this is not our duty — it is not our task, for we must guard Your Majesty's heart; this work of stoking falls on no ordinary person." He said, "If this is not your work, then whose work is it?" They replied, "Your Majesty, it belongs to the young men." He dismissed them and went to the young men and said, "Young men, I tend the fires — why do you not tend the fires?" They replied, "Your Majesty, we too will do so when our turn comes." They also tended the fires for a little while and then said, "Your Majesty, if we were to tend them always" — and from the passage "what are the duties of a king" up to "in five places," just as before — "this work of maintaining the kingdom is not our task." He said, "If this is not your work, then whose work is it?" They replied, "Your Majesty, it belongs to the

ministers." He dismissed them and went to the ministers and said, "Wise ones, I tend the fires — why do you not tend the fires?" They replied, "Your Majesty, we too will do so when our turn comes." They also tended the fires for a little while and then said, "Your Majesty, if we were to tend them always, ruling the kingdom in accordance with the Dharma — this work of stoking falls on no ordinary person; this is not our task." He said, "If this is not your work, then whose work is it?" They replied, "Your Majesty, it is the work of the town guild." He dismissed them and went to the town guild and said, "Wise ones, I tend the fires — why do you not tend the fires?" The town guild replied, "Your Majesty, we too will do so when our turn comes." They also tended the fires for a little while and then said, "Your Majesty, if we were to tend them always, engaging in battle alongside those who attack Your Majesty and those who counterattack — this work of stoking falls on no ordinary person; this is not our task." He said, "If this is not your work, then whose work is it?" They replied, "Your Majesty, it belongs to the townsfolk and the villagers." He dismissed them and went to the townsfolk and

He went to the townsfolk and said, "Wise ones, I tend the fires — why do you not tend the fires?" They replied, "Your Majesty, we will do so when our turn comes." He then appointed them to tend the fires constantly, and they divided the duty among themselves in rotation and began to take their turns.

Now, at a certain point the turn fell upon a young incense-seller. He feared that the fierce king would kill him, and so he sat in distress, resting his chin on his hand and brooding inwardly. A friend of his saw him brooding and said, "Friend, why do you sit resting your chin on your hand and brooding?" The young man told him what had happened. Near that friend's home there was a certain guard, and the friend said to the young man, "Friend, you have a guard living near your home — why don't you commission him?" The young man replied, "Friend, just as my own life is precious to me, his life is equally precious to him — why would he do my errand?" The friend said, "Friend, give him some kārṣāpaṇas and without fail he will tend the fires." So he commissioned the guard, and the guard said, "Give me five hundred kārṣāpaṇas and I will tend the fires." The young man promised, "I will give them." Then the guard said, "For now, give me two hundred and fifty. As for the remainder — if I return alive, give it to me then; but if not, it is yours to do with as you wish." The young man said, "Very well, let it be so," and gave him the two hundred and fifty kārṣāpaṇas. The guard took them and went to the market, where he bought a great quantity of meat and ale.

Then the fierce king Rabhasrabha invited all the household servants as guests, fed them, and poured out as much ale as they wished. He said, "Wise ones, when the fire-tending duty falls on me, tell me what the behavior of this king is like." They told him everything about how things actually were. He said, "Wise ones, remember that I have done you a small service." They replied, "O lord of the earth, you have fed us and quenched our thirst, and we have not yet finished drinking — why should we not remember? Tell us what you need done." He said, "If I fall asleep while on fire duty and the king sends the fire-watchers around, please wake me." They said, "Very well, we will do so." He then wrapped his lower robe around himself and began tending the fires — and overcome by deep drowsiness, he lay down and fell asleep.

As it happened, that same king, during the first watch, had taken pleasure and delight together with the retinue of his queens. In the middle watch he had reviewed the elephants and horses. When the final watch came and he began to inspect the fire-tenders, those servants roused the guard, saying, "O lord of the earth, the king is coming — get up!" He leapt up at once and sat there just as he had been, with his lower robe wrapped around him.

The king called out, "Who is tending the fires?" The guard thought to himself: "If I answer only this first call and fail to answer thereafter, this king will surely cut off my head without a second thought and cast it to the ground." Knowing this, he said nothing. The king called out a second time, "Who is tending the fires?" Still he said nothing. The king called out a third time, "Who is tending the fires?" Only then the guard spoke: "It is I, O lord of the earth." The king said, "Guard, what do you have in mind?" For though his intentions were base, he was a man well versed in the lore and tales of the world. The guard replied, "Your Majesty, I am thinking a worldly thought."

The verse summary is as follows:

An owl, a crane, muñja grass,
a black thing, burning, a pot,
salt, powder, death,
a pit, a snare, an earthen vessel — these are inauspicious.

What sort of worldly thought, O lord of the earth, is the guard thinking?

"Your Majesty, an owl with feathers and an owl without feathers, when weighed on a scale, come out exactly equal. That is most remarkable, O lord of the earth. Can this truly be so?" "Guard, you shall see it with your own eyes." "Well done, guard."

The next day the guard came bringing an owl, and before the king weighed it with its feathers, then plucked out its feathers and weighed it again — it was exactly the same. The king said, "Guard, what is the reason for this?" The guard replied, "Your Majesty, it is because the feathers catch the wind." The king said, "Guard, you are a learned man." The guard replied, "Your Majesty, it is by your gracious command." And the king said nothing more.

The guard waited until dawn had not yet broken, then at first light anointed his head and departed from the royal palace. The incense merchant's boy also gave him those two hundred and fifty kārṣāpaṇas. In the kingdom of Kośala, whatever person's turn it was received five hundred kārṣāpaṇas from him as payment, and so that person always tended the fires in his stead. Again the king, just as before, called out, "Who is tending the fires?" The guard replied as before, "Your Majesty, it is I who do so when it is my turn." The king said, just as before, "Guard, what are you thinking?" The guard replied, "Your Majesty, I am thinking a worldly thought." The king said, "Guard, what sort of worldly thought are you thinking?" The guard replied, "Your Majesty, those birds called cranes — when one gives them milk mixed with water, they drink the milk and leave the water behind." "Guard, can this truly be so?" "Your Majesty, you shall see it with your own eyes." "Well done, guard."

The next day the guard came bringing a crane, and before the king mixed milk with water and poured it out before him — the crane drank the milk and left the water behind. The king said, "Guard, what is the reason for this?"

The Vinaya of minor matters. The twenty-fourth section.

The guard replied, "Your Majesty, it is because there is sourness in its beak, and by that sourness, as it drinks, the milk it desires curdles and separates from the water." The king said, "Guard, you are a learned man." The guard replied, "Your Majesty, it is by your gracious command." And the king said nothing more.

Again the king, just as before, called out, "Who is tending the fires?" The guard replied as before, "Your Majesty, it is I who do so when it is my turn." The king said, "Guard, what are you thinking?" The guard replied, "Your Majesty, I am thinking a worldly thought." The king said, "Guard, what sort of worldly thought are you thinking?" The guard replied, "Your Majesty, muñja grass that has been beaten with a mallet and muñja grass that has not been beaten — when placed on a scale, they come out exactly equal." "Guard, can this truly be so?" "Your Majesty, you shall see it with your own eyes." "Well done,

guard."

The next day the guard came bringing muñja grass and demonstrated before the king exactly as described — and everything was just as he had said. The king said, "Guard, what is the reason for this?" The guard replied, "Your Majesty, it is because beating it with the mallet compresses the air within it." The king said, "Guard, you are a learned man." The guard replied, "Your Majesty, it is by your gracious command." And the king said nothing more.

Again the king, just as before, called out, "Who is tending the fires?" The guard replied as before, "Your Majesty, it is I, the guard." The king said, "Guard, what are you thinking?" The guard replied, "Your Majesty, I am thinking a worldly thought." The king said, "Guard, what sort of worldly thought are you thinking?" The guard replied, "Your Majesty, the creature called the black-headed spider monkey — its body and its tail are of exactly the same length." "Guard, can this truly be so?" "Your Majesty, you shall see it with your own eyes." "Well done, guard."

The next day he brought a black-headed spider monkey and demonstrated it before the king exactly as he had described, and everything proved to be just so. The king said, "Guard, how did you know this?" The guard replied, "Your Majesty, when this creature entered its burrow I observed its tail reaching the opening at the same moment as its head." The king said, "Guard, you are a learned man." The guard replied, "Your Majesty, it is by your gracious command." And the king said nothing more.

Again the king called out as before, "Who is tending the fires?" The guard replied as before, "Your Majesty, it is I, the guard." The king said, "Guard, what are you thinking?" The guard replied, "Your Majesty, I am thinking a worldly thought." "Guard, what sort of worldly thought?" "Your Majesty, among the wing-feathers of a bird that has been singed, however many are scorched, exactly that same number are unscorched." "Guard, can this truly be so?" "Your Majesty, you shall see it with your own eyes." "Well done, guard."

The next day he demonstrated it before the king's very eyes, and everything proved to be just so. The king said, "Guard, how did you know this?" "Your Majesty, I had counted them beforehand." The king said, "Guard, you are a learned man." The guard replied, "Your Majesty, it is by your gracious command." And the king said nothing more.

Again the king called out in the same way, "Who is tending the fires?" The guard replied as before, "Your Majesty, it is I, the guard." The king said, "What

are you thinking?" "Your Majesty, I am thinking a worldly thought." "Guard, what sort of worldly thought?" "Your Majesty, if a full pitcher of water is poured into a full pitcher of sand, all that water will be absorbed within it." "Guard, can this truly be so?" "Your Majesty, you shall see it with your own eyes." "Well done, guard."

The next day he demonstrated it before the king's very eyes, and everything proved to be just so. The king said, "Guard, how did you know this?" "Your Majesty, it is because sand is born from water." The king said, "Guard, you are a learned man." "Your Majesty, it is by your gracious command." And the king said nothing more.

Again the king called out in the same way, "Who is tending the fires?" The guard replied as before, "Your Majesty, it is I, the guard." The king said, "Guard, what are you thinking?" "Your Majesty, I am thinking a worldly thought." "Guard, what sort of worldly thought?" "Your Majesty, if a full measure of water is added to a full measure of salt, the result will be nothing more than a full measure of water." "Guard, can this truly be so?" "Your Majesty, you shall see it with your own eyes." "Well done, guard."

The next day he demonstrated it before the king's very eyes, and everything proved to be just so. The king said, "Guard, what is the reason for this?" "Your Majesty, it is because salt comes from water." The king said, "Guard, you are a learned man." "Your Majesty, it is by your gracious command." And the king said nothing more.

Again the king called out in the same way, "Who is tending the fires?" The guard replied as before, "Your Majesty, it is I, the guard." The king said, "Guard, what are you thinking?" "Your Majesty, I am thinking a worldly thought." "Guard, what sort of worldly thought?" "Your Majesty, if a full measure of water is added to a full measure of flour, the mixture will be neither loose nor stiff." "Guard, can this truly be so?" "Your Majesty, you shall see it with your own eyes." "Well done, guard."

The next day he demonstrated it before the king's very eyes, and everything proved to be just so. The king said, "Guard, what is the reason for this?" "Your Majesty, we guards are those who sift flour, and I have observed this many times." The king said, "Guard, you are a man of mindfulness." "Your Majesty, it is by your gracious command." And the king said nothing more.

Again the king called out in the same way, "Who is tending the fires?"

He replied in the same manner as before. "Your Majesty, it is I, the earth-holder." The king said, "Earth-holder, what are you thinking?" "Your Majesty, I am thinking a worldly thought." "Earth-holder, what kind of worldly thought?" "Your Majesty, if a dead man and a living man were placed on the two pans of a scale, they would not balance." "Earth-holder, can this truly be so?" "Your Majesty, I shall demonstrate it before your own eyes." "Well done, earth-holder."

The next day he demonstrated it before the king's very eyes, and everything proved to be just so. The king said, "Earth-holder, what is the reason for this?" "Your Majesty, a dead man is no longer a man, and so his vital lustre has been taken from him." "Earth-holder, you are a knowledgeable man." "Your Majesty, it is by your gracious command." And the king said nothing more.

Again the king called out in the same way, "Who is tending the fires?" He replied in the same manner as before. "Your Majesty, it is I, the earth-holder." The king said, "Earth-holder, what are you thinking?" "Your Majesty, I am thinking a worldly thought." "Earth-holder, what kind of worldly thought?" "Your Majesty, when a pit is dug, if the very same earth taken from it is put back, it will not be level." "Earth-holder, can this truly be so?" "Your Majesty, I shall demonstrate it before your own eyes." "Well done, earth-holder."

The next day he demonstrated it before the king's very eyes, and everything proved to be just so. The king said, "Earth-holder, what is the reason for this?" "Your Majesty, a dead man is no longer a man, and so his vital lustre has been taken from him." "Earth-holder, you are a knowledgeable man." "Your Majesty, it is by your gracious command." And the king said nothing more.

Again the king called out in the same way, "Who is tending the fires?" He replied in the same manner as before. "Your Majesty, it is I, the earth-holder." The king said, "Earth-holder, what are you thinking?" "Your Majesty, I am thinking a worldly thought." "Earth-holder, what kind of worldly thought?" "Your Majesty, when a weaver weaves cloth day and night, I cannot tell where it has gone." "Ah, earth-holder, the curious thing is that one does not know where it goes." "Your Majesty, it has become ground." "Ah, earth-holder, look at that — it has become ground indeed."

Again the king called out in the same way, "Who is tending the fires?" He replied in the same manner as before. "Your Majesty, it is I, the earth-holder." "Earth-holder, what are you thinking?" "Your Majesty, I am thinking a worldly thought." "Earth-holder, what kind of worldly thought?" "Your Majesty, when a

potter makes vessels day and night, I cannot tell where they have gone." "Ah, earth-holder, the curious thing is that one does not know where they go." "Your Majesty, they have become ground." "Ah, earth-holder, look at that — they have become ground indeed. Earth-holder, you are a knowledgeable man, and if you know everything, what is the reason for this sleeplessness of mine?" "Your Majesty, grant me freedom from fear and I will speak." "Earth-holder, I grant you freedom from fear — speak without anxiety." "Your Majesty, you were born of evil." "Earth-holder, are you speaking ill of me?" "Your Majesty, do not say such a thing. How have I spoken ill of Your Majesty? I have not spoken ill. I shall demonstrate it before Your Majesty's own eyes." "Well done, earth-holder."

He then filled a freshly dug pit with dry ox dung, spread a bed over it, and the next day told the king, "Your Majesty, please sleep on this bed." The king lay down there, and as soon as he lay down he fell fast asleep. When he awoke, he said, "Earth-holder, have you seen?" The earth-holder, understanding that he had demonstrated his point before the king's eyes, went to the queen's retinue and asked the queen mother directly: "Mother, tell me truly and without falsehood — from whom was I born?" "Your Majesty, I will speak. Grant me freedom from fear." "Mother, I grant it." "Your Majesty, your father, accompanied by a great retinue of the queen's ladies-in-waiting, had gone away to some region, and at that time I found myself with the marks of pregnancy. When I was bathing because of those signs of pregnancy, I saw a wicked man, and a thought arose in me: 'If only this were a male child, I would enjoy the pleasures of desire with him in delight and happiness.'

That man became a male child, and with him I enjoyed the pleasures of desire in delight and happiness. From that union you were born."

He thought to himself: "This king-holder of the land is a learned man. If he knows this about me, and I have granted him freedom from fear, it would not be right to kill him — yet I must ensure he tells no one else. Therefore I will give him a reward and banish him from the realm." With that thought, he gave the man five hundred kārṣāpaṇas and expelled him from the country.

Here ends the summary verse: Jīvaka, Golden Light, the Ela leaf, the Nala, the renunciant with hair, food, grain, butter, and vessel — these are the final ones.

The fierce king Pradyota thought to himself: "This illness of mine has become severe at its root; I should gather physicians and have them examine me." He therefore assembled all the physicians dwelling in his realm and said:

"Learned ones, examine me regarding this illness of mine." They replied: "Your Majesty, we do not have the capacity to examine you. However, in the city of Rājagṛha there is the son of King Bimbisāra, the king of physicians, named Jīvaka. If Your Majesty were to have him examine you, he would have the capacity." He then sent a letter to King Bimbisāra: "Send the king of physicians, Jīvaka, here — or else I shall come myself. Prepare herbs and equipment." When King Bimbisāra read the letter, he was alarmed; he rested his hand on his cheek and sat absorbed in thought. He reflected: "If I do not send Jīvaka, and that king summons whatever he requires by force, I too shall become the object of his reprisal — that would not be good." Seeing the king's distress, the king of physicians Jīvaka approached and, paying homage at his feet, said: "Your Majesty, why do you sit with your hand resting on your cheek, absorbed in thought?" He replied: "My son, you have trained in such a craft as this — and now harm has come of it." Jīvaka said: "How has harm come?" When the king explained what had happened, Jīvaka said: "Your Majesty, please command me; I will go and attend to him." "My son, that king is fierce — why does he keep killing sentient beings? Would he not kill you?" "Your Majesty, what sort of physician would I be if I cannot protect myself? Please send me without apprehension." He replied: "My son, if that is so, then go — but take care that my retinue, the queen's attendants, the young men, the ministers, the people of the palace, and the crowds who come from various lands do not fall into grief." Jīvaka said: "Your Majesty, why has this come about? I will be able to protect the mind of the patient." The king said nothing more.

Jīvaka then asked the messenger: "Fellow, what are the king's habits like, and what sort of illness has afflicted him?" The man explained in detail what had occurred. Jīvaka then mixed butter infused with the color, scent, and taste of liquor, performed auspicious, fortunate, and propitious rites, assembled his companions, kinsmen, and younger brothers, and set out for the realm of the noble king. Arriving at the border town of Kanyākubja, he heard that the king of physicians Jīvaka had come and was making his way to the realm of the noble king. A young physician dwelling there took a single āmalaka fruit, went to him, and the two rejoiced in one another's company. Jīvaka said: "Brother in the Dharma, what sort of illness has afflicted the fierce king Pradyota? Have you not examined him?" He replied: "That king is afflicted by an illness of sleeplessness. When butter benefits him, he has an aversion to butter; he delights in liquor and is violent —

Whoever were to speak the name of butter in his presence would have their head struck off on the spot and cast to the ground — and so, in their terror, they would all flee. Who then could dare to examine him?" Jīvaka said: "For this reason, I have come carrying butter that has been boiled with the color of liquor, the smell of liquor, and the taste of liquor. When I give you the signal, you must give the king that measured portion of butter. I shall go before him first; you, meanwhile, attend to him for a time. Once he has recovered, I will give you an exceedingly great reward, and I will continue to give it." The young physician said: "Excellent! Let us go," and the two set off together.

Jīvaka gradually drew near the realm of the noble king. King Pradyota, the fierce one, heard that Jīvaka, the king of physicians, had arrived, and he thought: "He is a prince as well as the king of physicians; he should come into the city with honor and ceremony." With this in mind, the king had the city adorned and the roads made beautiful, and setting out with the queen's retinue, the young attendants, the ministers, and the palace household to receive him, he welcomed Jīvaka, the king of physicians, who entered the city surrounded by many thousands of people.

After arriving, Jīvaka rested from the weariness of the road and stayed for a short while. Then King Pradyota the fierce said to Jīvaka: "My affliction of sleeplessness has become greatly aggravated — examine me." Jīvaka replied: "I shall do so, Your Majesty, but in treating this illness the remedies are to be found in many different lands and many different places. Some medicines I know of but others do not; some others know of but I do not; some both I and others know of; some are to be found in distant places, and some close at hand. Therefore, Your Majesty, please grant us the use of the excellent great elephant Bhadravatī as we require." The king said: "Jīvaka, do so exactly as you see fit," and he commanded the elephant keepers: "Let Jīvaka use the excellent great elephant Bhadravatī as he pleases; do not hinder him." He likewise commanded the ministers and the palace gatekeepers: "By day or by night, whether Jīvaka rides the excellent great elephant Bhadravatī coming or going, do not obstruct him — let him pass and return at will, as he desires." The ministers, the gatekeepers, and the elephant keepers all replied: "As Your Majesty commands."

The king of physicians Jīvaka mounted the excellent great elephant Bhadravatī and began accustoming his eyes to the sight. Sometimes he went out in the morning and returned in the afternoon; sometimes he went at midday and returned in the afternoon; sometimes he went in the afternoon and returned

after the evening watch — and in this way, by going and coming, he built up the king's trust and confidence.

The king said: "Jīvaka, examine me." Jīvaka replied: "Your Majesty, please bathe first." When the king had bathed, he asked again: "Jīvaka, now that I have bathed, what should I do?" Jīvaka replied: "Your Majesty, please take your meal." When the king began to eat, Jīvaka said: "Your Majesty, I have brought a very choice drink from the land of Magadha; if Your Majesty will accept it, I offer a small portion." The king said: "Jīvaka, excellent — let us have a look at it." Jīvaka gave the signal to the young physician to administer that measured portion, and the young physician gave the measured portion, and the king drank it. The moment he had drunk it, he fell into a deep sleep. Jīvaka then mounted the excellent great elephant Bhadravatī and fled.

When the king awoke at midnight, the burning sensation of the butter came upon him.

He called to someone: "Hey, send for the physician Jīvaka!" The man had poured melted butter over his head and then cut it off at the neck and thrown it to the ground. He searched everywhere but could not find Jīvaka, so the messenger reported back: "Your Majesty, he is nowhere — he has certainly fled." The king, now furious, said: "Hey, send for my messenger-crow!" and the man summoned him. The king said: "Listen, messenger-crow — go quickly, mount the elephant Damburi, take Jīvaka by the neck, bring him here, and cut off his head. But if that trickster gives you even a little something, do not accept it. Go and search at once." The messenger-crow, heeding the wrathful King Pradyota's command, quickly mounted the elephant Damburi and set off in pursuit.

When the crow saw Jīvaka enter a grove of emblic myrobalan trees, he called out: "Jīvaka, Your Divine Honour, come here this instant." Jīvaka replied: "Ah, crow, how long a journey — come rest a moment; eat some myrobalan." The crow said: "The king has ordered me: 'That man is a trickster — do not accept so much as a scrap from him.'" Jīvaka said: "Well then, crow, if that is so, you eat half and I will eat half." The crow thought: "He says eat half — but what kind of trick could there be in just the half?" and so he reasoned and replied: "Jīvaka, you may give me mine to eat." Jīvaka ate half of the myrobalan, then cut the remaining half with a fingernail that he had packed full of powder, and handed it over. The crow ate it — and immediately, from both ends, he was drenched through and through, for it was laced with a powerful purgative.

Jīvaka then placed him with some hill-folk and instructed those hill-folk: "Wise ones, the three most prized possessions of King Pradyota are: the elephant Damburi, the great she-elephant Bhadravatī, and this messenger-crow. Treat him here with this remedy, nurse him back to health, and he will recover. Otherwise the king will surely destroy you all." Having said this, he departed. They tended him and he recovered, and they went on their way.

The king too, treated by the young physician with the remedy as prescribed, likewise recovered. In time the messenger-crow gradually made his way back to the king's presence, and the king questioned him: "Crow, why did Jīvaka flee? If he fled, that was wrong of him. But crow — if he had been captured, what would I have done to him?" The crow answered: "Your Majesty, you would have cut off his head at the neck and cast it to the ground." The king said: "Majesty, the king of physicians who healed both Your Majesty and me — to kill such a one is not fitting." The king said: "Crow, if that is so, then what shall be done with him?" "Your Majesty, give him a generous reward — that is best. Do likewise."

The king then sent Jīvaka a letter: "Jīvaka, physician-king, why did you flee? Come back; you will be rewarded — take your reward." Jīvaka sent back a reply: "Your Majesty, by your kindness there is enough wealth in my home. Yet if Your Majesty would truly think of me, it would be fitting to bestow honour upon the young physician who treated Your Majesty." The king gave many gifts to that young physician. To Jīvaka he also sent a great robe of fine linen, a hundred thousand cubits in length. Jīvaka thought: "This robe befits a king. To whom should I give it?" He reflected: "The Blessed One is by his very nature my father — I shall offer it to him." And so he offered it to the Blessed One.

The Blessed One then addressed the Venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, make this into a Dharma-robe and offer it back to me." The Venerable Ānanda took it, and as he did so, he saw that the three Dharma-robos of the Blessed One were already more than sufficient. As he set about the task, from those robes of the Blessed One there emerged three Dharma-robos and —

— a full upper robe together with an under-robe for the Venerable Ānanda, and a sweat-cloth for Sāṅkāśya also arose.

Now, in the Joyful Heaven (Tuṣita), a riddle was spoken by the buddha, and it went like this:

What king is it who, when attached, is covered in dust,
yet when without attachment, becomes free of dust?

Who here would speak of such attachment?
How does a foolish one grieve?
How does a wise one rejoice?
By abandoning what one possesses,
who here is said to have accomplished peace?

This was written down. At any time when a buddha, a Blessed One, has not appeared in the world, no one is able to grasp these questions, nor is anyone able to explain their meaning. Even at a time when a buddha, a Blessed One, has appeared in the world, though the questions can be grasped, their meaning cannot be explained.

Now, at a certain time, a lord of yakṣas named Son of Vaiśravaṇa went into the assembly of the gods of Tuṣṭita on some errand, and there he saw those questions that had been posed. Struck with wonder, he took hold of them but was unable to penetrate their meaning. He carried them to the Palace of the Spreading Willows, wrote them on a board, and set them there.

At that time, in a place called Resting-Stone, there dwelt a king of nāgas named Elā's Wing, who had long held this aspiration in his heart: "When will I ever see a buddha, a Blessed One?" A friend of his, a yakṣa named Golden Light, went on some errand to the Palace of the Spreading Willows of the yakṣa lord Son of Vaiśravaṇa, and there he saw those questions written on the board. He took them, memorized them thoroughly, and began to analyze them — yet he could not penetrate their meaning. He brought them to Resting-Stone, gave them to the nāga king Elā's Wing, and said: "Friend, these questions were spoken by a buddha. No one has yet understood their meaning. Take these and a hundred thousand gold coins, and travel through villages, towns, and royal courts, announcing: 'Whoever is able to explain the meaning of these questions — to that person I will give a hundred thousand gold coins and honor them with the highest respect.' If anyone can explain them, give him the hundred thousand gold coins. If no one can, then proclaim that it is no village or town, and go on elsewhere."

He took them, memorized them completely, and then, having transformed himself into the form of a brahmin youth, he took the hundred thousand gold coins and traveled through villages, towns, and royal courts, eventually reaching Vārāṇasī. There, on the broad roads of Vārāṇasī, at crossroads of four and three ways, he addressed the gathered wise residents of Vārāṇasī and the

crowds of people who had come from various lands: "I have brought these questions; whoever is able to explain their meaning — to that person I will give these hundred thousand gold coins and honor them with the highest respect."

Some claimed to be learned, others were seized with wonder, and though many hundreds and thousands of living beings assembled, none was able to explain the meaning. He then began to announce that it was no village or town. At that point the brahmins and householders dwelling in Vārāṇasī said: "Do not yet proclaim that it is no village or town. Let the renunciants and brahmins who dwell in forest hermitages and who are truly honored by our people come first — and only afterward proclaim that it is no village or town."

He asked: "Who are they?"

"Nālandā and others," they replied.

He agreed that this was the right course, and so —

He waited, and after some time Nālandā arrived. Nālandā sat before him and said: "Great sage, I have come bringing these questions. To whoever is able to explain their meaning, this hundred-thousand in gold will be given, and he shall be honored with great veneration."

Nālandā read them through and said: "The brahmin youth Legky did just so and spoke accordingly. How long ago? Twelve years have passed." "Great sage, that time is long." "Six years." "Still long." "Three years." "One year." "Six months." "Three months." "One month." "Half a month." "Seven days have passed." "Great sage, Legky, do it in that very way — wait until then," he said. And so he waited.

Now, Nālandā's closest companions were the five monks, and so he went to them and said: "Wise ones, a brahmin youth has come to me with these questions and a hundred thousand in gold, saying that whoever can explain the meaning of these questions shall receive this gold and be honored with great veneration. But since these questions are numerous in meaning yet few in words, and since they are difficult to penetrate, how is one to resolve this?" They replied: "Go to Nālandā — go and ask the Buddha, the Blessed One." "Wise ones, has the Buddha, the Blessed One, appeared in the world?" "He has." "Where does he dwell?" "In the forest of the Ṛṣipatana, the deer park," said the sage.

He arose with joy and delight, and swiftly, swiftly, made his way to where the Blessed One was. And Nālandā beheld the Blessed One — his body adorned

with the thirty-two marks of a great being, beautified by the eighty minor marks, encircled by a fathom of radiance, shining with a light exceeding that of a thousand suns, like a moving mountain of jewels, glorious on all sides. Just as one who has accumulated roots of virtue beholds a buddha for the very first time, or as one who has trained the mind in calm abiding for twelve years, or as a childless person who finds a child, or as a poor person who discovers a treasure, or as one who delights in sovereignty and is anointed with the power of kingship — the joy of beholding was not like a faint or ordinary delight. Having seen him, he went to where the Blessed One was, and upon arriving he bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and sat to one side.

As he sat to one side, the Blessed One, perceiving his intention, his disposition, his constitution, and his character, taught Dharma of such a kind that he would come to realize the Four Noble Truths. Upon hearing this, the sage Nālandā shattered with the vajra of gnosis the twenty peaks of the mountain of the view of the transitory collection, and directly actualized the fruit of stream-entry.

Having seen the truth, he bowed at the feet of the Blessed One and implored him: "Venerable one, if I may obtain the going-forth and full ordination as a monk in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya — the state of a fully ordained monk — I wish to practice the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One."

The Blessed One declared: "Nālandā, you have pledged to explain the meaning of those questions to that brahmin youth. Therefore go back, first discharge that prior commitment, and afterward go forth."

He replied: "Venerable one, though I have obtained such a collection of qualities, if I am unable to set forth the meaning of those questions before him, what purpose would be served by going there?"

The Blessed One declared: "Nālandā, go, approach him, and say these words: 'Speak those questions aloud for now.'" And whenever he recites these words —

What king, the sovereign lord, is he?
When there is attachment, dust is there.
When dust is absent, freed from dust he is.
Who in this world is called "attached"?
How does the foolish one fall into sorrow?
How does the wise one come to joy?

"When one is freed from its possession, that is called accomplishment and bliss." When those words have been spoken, you should then say: "Sixth — the sovereign lord and king: when there is attachment, dust is there; when dust is absent, freed from dust he is. When attached, the childish one is so called here. The one of wicked mind falls into sorrow in that way; the wise one comes to joy in that way. When one is freed from the possession of this, that is called accomplishment and bliss."

If he says, "I do not understand the sign," then say to him:

One who knows what is well spoken is to be prized.

One who knows both learning and meditative absorption is to be prized.

For any person who has become doubtful and negligent,
not knowing — for such a one, hearing is of little benefit.

If he should say, "You speak the words of the buddha, yet no mark of distinction appears in you. My mind is dull in this matter — quickly resolve my doubt," then pluck a blade of grass with your fingernail before him.

If he asks, "Has the buddha, the Blessed One, appeared in the world?" say, "He has appeared."

If he asks, "And where does he dwell?" say, "In the forest of the deer-haunting sage, he speaks."

"Venerable one, so be it," said the noble youth Nālandā, and, following the Blessed One's instruction, he went to where the brahmin youth was and said to him: "Brahmin youth, recite those questions for now."

Then the brahmin youth recited the verse:

What king, the sovereign lord, is he?

When there is attachment, dust is there.

When dust is absent, freed from dust he is.

Who in this world is called "attached"?

How does the foolish one fall into sorrow?

How does the wise one come to joy?

When one is freed from its possession,
what is that called accomplishment and bliss?

He replied:

Sixth — the sovereign lord and king:
when there is attachment, dust is there;

when dust is absent, freed from dust he is.
When attached, the childish one is so called here.
The one of wicked mind falls into sorrow in that way;
the wise one comes to joy in that way.
When one is freed from the possession of this,
that here is called accomplishment and bliss.

The brahmin youth said: "Great sage, I do not understand the sign."

He replied:

One who knows what is well spoken is to be prized.
One who knows both learning and meditative absorption is to be prized.
For any person who has become doubtful and negligent,
not knowing — for such a one, hearing is of little benefit.

The brahmin youth said: "Nālandā, you speak the words of a buddha, yet no mark of distinction appears in you. My mind is dull in this matter — quickly resolve my doubt."

Then Nālandā plucked a blade of grass with his fingernail before him, and the other said: "Nālandā, has the buddha, the Blessed One, appeared in the world?"

He replied: "Brahmin youth, he has appeared."

"Where does he dwell?"

"Right here in this land of Vārāṇasī."

"In what direction?"

"In the forest of the deer-haunting sage, he speaks."

The brahmin youth thought to himself: "If I reveal my own lineage to him, he will look down on me. But if I go in the guise of a brahmin youth, the brahmins who dwell in Vārāṇasī and who possess the three Vedic knowledges — or those who say a brahmin youth of high birth has gone to the presence of the ascetic Gautama — will lose their faith. And if I go in my own guise, I have many enemies among the nāgas, and some of them will come and do me harm on the way. Therefore I shall manifest myself in the appearance of a wheel-turning monarch and go before the Blessed One."

Then the nāga king, through the power of Elā, manifested himself in the form of a wheel-turning monarch. Seven precious jewels were arrayed before him;

nine hundred and ninety million troops of the city's army surrounded him; a thousand sons, adorned with ornaments of various precious things, encircled him like a crescent moon. Non-Buddhists, ascetics, brahmins, the poor, the destitute of every kind —

a thousand of the foremost among men followed behind. Above, an umbrella with a thousand spokes was held aloft, and a radiance of a thousand rays of sunlight illumined everything, outshining even the glorious palace adorned with the moon, the planets, the stars, and their constellations, its brilliance surpassing all. In this manner he proceeded to where the sage was speaking.

Now at that time the Blessed One was seated before a retinue of many hundreds, teaching the Dharma. The members of that assembly, from a great distance, caught sight of Elā, the nāga king. Upon seeing him they were struck with wonder, their eyes wide open, and various thoughts arose in their minds. Some said, "Friends, from where has this king come?" Others said, "Friends, whoever possesses such complete and perfect wealth — this is no ordinary king; this must be some lord of the earth, a sovereign of the land." Still others said, "This is no king at all — this is Śakra, lord of the gods, who has come here to behold the Blessed One." And those who were under the sway of attachment, upon seeing him, gave rise to longing, thinking, "Oh, when shall I too become like this?"

While they were thus thinking in many different ways, Elā the nāga king proceeded to where the Blessed One was and arrived there. He bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the Blessed One addressed Elā the nāga king in these words: "You foolish man — you transgressed the boundaries of the training laid down by the perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa, and were consequently reborn in the wretched state of a nāga. Do you now wish to deceive my retinue as well? Enough of this — drop the emanation and come in your own proper form."

He replied, "Venerable One, I have many enemies among the nāgas, and some of them might do me harm."

Then the Blessed One addressed the yakṣa Vajrapāṇi (the vajra-holder): "Vajrapāṇi, go and guard Elā the nāga king." "Venerable One, so be it," said the yakṣa Vajrapāṇi, and heeding the Blessed One's word, he took upon himself the task of guarding Elā the nāga king and followed along behind him.

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Then Elā the nāga king departed from the presence of the Blessed One and manifested himself in his true form. His tail rested at Rājagṛha, while his seven heads lay at Vārāṇasī. On each head, through the ripening of past karma, elatrees had grown, and they were entirely filled with many hundreds of thousands of kinds of insects; many swarms of flies were buzzing and settling; an ooze of foul and extremely pungent smell, of pus and blood, dripped down.

Then, having transformed his body in the same way that sentient beings avert their eyes when they see something repulsive, he proceeded to where the Blessed One was, arrived there, bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, and sat down to one side. The members of the assembly, upon seeing the body of Elā the nāga king, beheld something utterly repulsive and thoroughly terrifying, frightful and distressing to those not yet free from attachment, vast and cracked, rough, without lustre, and displaying many differences in color and shape. Seeing this they were alarmed, and addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, what is this utterly terrifying thing that has come into the Blessed One's presence?"

The Blessed One replied: "Monks, this is the very one who, bearing the appearance of a wheel-turning monarch, came before me, and toward whom you gave rise to attachment, captivated by the distinguishing features of the gates of saṃsāra. This body he now bears is the intrinsic result, fully accomplished through the fault of undesirable karma. The earlier form was an emanation."

Upon hearing this, those who had experienced discomfort of mind, finding that karma cannot be escaped, sat in silence and said nothing.

Then the nāga king Elapatra addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, I beg you to grant me a prophecy. Sugata, I beg you to grant me a prophecy."

The Blessed One declared: "Lord of nāgas, when the lifespan of human beings reaches eighty thousand years, at the time when human beings are capable of living eighty thousand years, a Teacher named Maitreya, a Tathāgata, an arhat" — and so on as before, through "the Teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a Blessed One, will arise in the world" — "he will grant you a prophecy."

Then the nāga king Elapatra bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and vanished from that very spot.

The monks were seized by doubt, and they addressed the Buddha, the Blessed One, who dispels all doubt: "Venerable One, what karma did the nāga king Elapatra perform and accumulate such that, through the ripening of that karma, he was born in the lowly birthplace of nāgas with a cardamom tree growing from his head, so that he is filled by many hundreds of thousands of kinds of insects, swarmed over and fallen upon by many swarms of flies, dripping and oozing with the flowing suffering of the stench and foul smell of pus and blood — and experiences suffering such as this?"

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, karma that has been done and accumulated by the nāga king Elapatra — who else would experience it? Monks, karma that has been done and accumulated does not ripen in the external element of earth, nor in the element of water, nor in the element of fire, nor in the element of wind. Rather, virtuous and non-virtuous karma that has been done ripens solely within the very aggregates, elements, and sense bases that have been appropriated.

Though a hundred aeons pass,
karma is never lost or wasted.

When the conditions are assembled and the time arrives,
it ripens as a fruit for embodied beings.

Monks, in this very good aeon that has gone before, when the lifespan of living beings was capable of supporting twenty thousand years, there arose in the world a Teacher named Kāśyapa, endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, a knower of the world, an unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, a Teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a Blessed One. He resided and dwelt in the Deer Park forest of the seers (R̥ṣipatana) near the city of Vārāṇasī.

One man went forth into homelessness under that one's teaching, became a monk (bhikṣu) versed in all three collections of scripture, and in a secluded spot made himself a walking path beside a cardamom tree. While he was walking there, the branches of the cardamom tree struck him on the forehead, and he felt irritated by this. On another occasion, as he was walking, weary from meditation, and the branches again struck his forehead, he became enraged, cut the tree down, chopped it into pieces with both hands, threw it away, and said: "This thing has neither life nor breath — what offense did the Blessed One Kāśyapa see in it that he made it a basis for training?" And with these words he angrily broke his vows, abandoned his training, left the body, and was reborn among the nāgas, with a cardamom tree growing from his

head, filled by many hundreds of thousands of kinds of insects, swarmed over and fallen upon by many swarms of flies, dripping and oozing with the stench and foul smell of pus and blood.

Monks, what do you think? The monk of that time, versed in the three collections, who had gone forth — that very one is this nāga king Elapatra. It was he who, having gone forth under the teaching of the perfectly and fully awakened Buddha Kāśyapa, fell into fierce rage and abandoned his training, and through the ripening of that karma was reborn among the nāgas.

with a cardamom tree growing from his head, filled by many hundreds of thousands of kinds of insects, swarmed over and fallen upon by many swarms of flies, dripping and oozing with the stench and foul smell of pus and blood.

Monks, just as the karmic maturation of actions that are wholly dark is itself wholly dark, so too the maturation of actions that are wholly bright is itself wholly bright, and the maturation of mixed actions is itself mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon actions that are wholly dark and mixed, and strive for actions that are wholly bright alone. Monks, you should train in this way.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Then the sage Nālada went to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, prostrated at the feet of the Blessed One with his head, and sat down to one side. Sitting to one side, the sage Nālada addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Venerable One, I have now broken my former vow. Venerable One, if I may obtain going forth and full ordination and the state of a monk in this well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, I wish to lead the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One."

The Blessed One said to him, "Monk, come here — live the holy life!" And by that word of the Blessed One, "Monk, come," he was immediately ordained: his hair was shaved, he wore the patchwork robe, he held in his hands a begging bowl and a water vessel, his head and beard were shorn, and he came to abide in the conduct of one who has been fully ordained for seven days, yet was as one who had maintained it for a hundred years.

By the Tathāgata's word "Come here," his form was transformed — hair shaved, body clad in the patchwork robe — and through the Buddha's intention his bearing was changed; in an instant he abided with faculties perfectly stilled.

When the Blessed One had ordained the venerable Nālada with the words "Monk, come here," those who led the holy life did not know by what name to call him, and the monks asked the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, his clan is that of the Kātyāyanas, therefore call him the Son of Kātyāyana." The monks then began to call him the Son of Kātyāyana, and the name Son of Kātyāyana became established.

Then the Blessed One addressed the venerable Son of Kātyāyana: "Son of Kātyāyana, this world mostly relies upon two things: existence and non-existence. Son of Kātyāyana, this world is mostly bound by the aggregates and by clinging, and relies upon existence and non-existence. Son of Kātyāyana, those things that become latent as the underlying tendency of mental grasping — toward these one does not assert 'self,' does not take them up, does not abide in them, does not cling to them.

Son of Kātyāyana, when arising occurs, this suffering arises; when ceasing occurs, this suffering ceases.

Son of Kātyāyana, if regarding this there arises in you a knowledge that is without doubt, without wavering, not dependent on another — then, Son of Kātyāyana, this alone is right view, and this alone is what the Tathāgata designates as right view in his designating.

Why is this? Because, Son of Kātyāyana, one who sees, just as it truly is, with correct wisdom the true arising of the world does not conceive of non-existence with respect to the world. And one who sees, just as it truly is, with correct wisdom the true cessation of the world does not conceive of existence with respect to the world."

"Son of Kātyāyana, the Tathāgata, without relying on those two extremes, teaches the Dharma to the world by the Middle Way, thus: Because this exists, that arises; because this has come to be, that is born. That is to say: conditioned by ignorance, formations arise; conditioned by formations, consciousness; conditioned by consciousness, name-and-form; conditioned by name-and-form, the six sense sources; conditioned by the six sense sources, contact; conditioned by contact, feeling; conditioned by feeling, craving; conditioned by craving, grasping; conditioned by grasping, becoming; conditioned by becoming, birth; conditioned by birth, aging and death, grief, lamentation, suffering, mental distress, and agitation all arise. In this way there comes about the arising of this entire great mass of suffering.

Because this does not exist, that does not arise; because this ceases, that ceases. That is to say: when ignorance ceases, formations cease; when formations cease, consciousness ceases; when consciousness ceases, name-and-form ceases; when name-and-form ceases, the six sense sources cease; when the six sense sources cease, contact ceases; when contact ceases, feeling ceases; when feeling ceases, craving ceases; when craving ceases, grasping ceases; when grasping ceases, becoming ceases; when becoming ceases, birth ceases; when birth ceases, aging and death, grief, lamentation, suffering, mental distress, and agitation all cease. In this way there comes about the cessation of this entire great mass of suffering."

Then the venerable Kātyāyana, having seen the truth, and having known through this very instance the wheel of cyclic existence in its five aspects of movement and non-movement, and having comprehended that all conditioned phenomena are by their very nature subject to decay, falling away, dissolution, and destruction, abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhatship. He became an arhat: free from attachment to the three realms, his mind equal and steady like refined gold, like the expanse of space and the open palm of a hand, like sandalwood and the cool of shade; through knowledge he shattered the hollow gateway of ignorance; through direct knowledge he attained the individual perfect cognitions. Turning his back on attachment to continued existence and gain, and on the seeking of honor, he came to be venerated, revered, and respectfully addressed by the gods of the surrounding heavens together with their lords.

The Blessed One addressed him, calling out "Son of Kātyāyana," and from that point on his name became known as Kātyāyana the Great.

Now at a certain later time there appeared in the realm of the noble Aryans a fierce man roaming about bent on battle, and the fierce king Rabsnang sat stricken with grief together with his queen, the prince, the ministers, and the people of the palace retinue. Some among them said, "May the gods please be propitiated." Others said, "Please send for the brahmins." And others said, "Please seek out whatever ascetic or brahmin dwelling nearby who is honored as a being of virtue." The fierce king Rabsnang commanded those in charge of the gates: "Wise ones, if any ascetic or brahmin, whoever it may be, who is capable of bringing the plague to an end should come here, report that person to me."

In such an occasion as this, the blessed buddhas have not the slightest lack of knowing, not the slightest lack of seeing, not the slightest lack of awareness or understanding. The blessed buddhas possess great compassion; they have entered upon the path of benefiting the world; they are the sole protector, uniquely courageous, without equal, speaking nothing twofold, abiding in calm abiding and insight.

skilled in the three elements of taming beings, one who has crossed the four rivers, one in whose soles the four legs of miraculous power rest perfectly, one long accustomed to the four means of attraction, one who has abandoned the five limbs, one who has utterly transcended the five destinies, one possessed of six limbs, one in whom the six perfections are perfectly complete, one rich with the flowers of the seven limbs of awakening, one who teaches the noble eightfold path, one skilled in the nine successive meditative absorptions, one possessed of the power of the ten powers, one whose renown pervades the ten directions, one supremely distinguished by sovereignty over a thousandfold — such blessed buddhas, by the very nature of reality, three times by day and three times by night, look upon the world with the eye of a buddha, perceiving who is in decline and who is thriving, who has come to poverty, who has fallen into distress, who is being harmed, who has fallen into poverty and distress and harm, who is inclining toward the lower realms, who is descending into the lower realms, who has fallen into the lower realms, who is to be drawn out from the lower realms and established in the higher realms and liberation, whose root of virtue has not yet arisen and is to be caused to arise, whose root of virtue has arisen and is to be fully ripened, whose ripened virtue is to be brought to full liberation, who is sinking in the mire of desire and is to be drawn out by hand, who is deprived of the noble wealth and is to be established as one who commands the lordship of noble wealth, and for what world, adorned by the arising of buddhas, a fruitful outcome is to be brought about — and so their gaze of primordial wisdom is set in motion.

It was said:

The ocean, home of sea-monsters, may be overturned by the waves of time,
yet for the sons who are to be tamed,
the buddhas never miss their moment.

Just as a mother gazes upon her only beloved child
and guards that child's very life,
so too the Tathāgata gazes upon the beings who are to be tamed

and guards the stream of their being.

Abiding in the stream of omniscience,
with the hook of compassion traversing the difficult expanse of cyclic
existence,
he searches, without weariness, for the wandering sons who are to be tamed,
as a mother cow searches for her lost calf.

The Blessed One then considered: among those to be tamed — the fierce king
Rabsnang, together with his queen's retinue, the young nobles, the ministers,
and the assembled people dwelling in the noble realm — and he saw that it
was the great monk Kātyāyana who was the one to tame them.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the venerable great Kātyāyana: "Kātyāyana,
attend to the fierce king Rabsnang of the noble realm, together with his
queen's retinue, the young nobles, the ministers, and the assembled people
dwelling in the noble realm."

"Venerable one, I shall do so," said the venerable great Kātyāyana, and having
listened and obeyed the Blessed One, when that very night had passed, he
dressed in his robe and lower robe in the early morning, took up his bowl, and
set out to seek alms in Vārāṇasī. Having made his alms-round in Vārāṇasī and
completed the business of the meal, setting aside the acceptance of further
food, he folded his bedding just as it was, took up his bowl and robe, and
departed, travelling together with five hundred attendants toward the noble
realm.

At that time, in the region of Kanyākubja, there lived a brahmin who had
previously been a householder friend of the venerable great Kātyāyana, and
this brahmin's daughter, who possessed exceptional beauty, was given the
name Śrāvaṇī in keeping with the name she had borne in former lives. Now as
it happened, a master of dance came from the south and, seeing that her hair
was excellent, went to the brahmin and said to him: "O great brahmin, give me
this girl's hair."

The brahmin said: "I will give you a thousand kārṣāpaṇas." But the master of
dance replied: "We are brahmins; it is not fitting for us to sell hair — how then
could we sell hair?" And so the master of dance left without another word.

The next day that brahmin passed away. His wife then heard how the
venerable great Kātyāyana, together with his five hundred attendants, was

staying not far from there and wished to travel on to the noble realm. Grief-stricken and distressed at the loss of her husband, when she heard that the venerable great Kātyāyana was coming, she sat with her cheek resting in her hand, lost in her own thoughts. The daughter with the beautiful hair saw her mother sitting in this way, and asked: "Mother, why do you sit with your cheek in your hand, lost in thought?" The mother replied: "Daughter, the noble great Kātyāyana — the younger companion of your late father — is staying not far from here. He wishes to travel on to the noble realm. Your father has passed away, and the situation of our household has become such that when someone who has come from afar arrives, we are unable even to offer him alms for a few days. That is why." The daughter said: "Mother, if that is so, let the master of dance buy my hair for a thousand kārṣāpaṇas right here and now, and with that very sum offer alms to the noble great Kātyāyana. My hair will grow back, so please do not grieve." Hearing these words, which arose from such faith, the mother said: "Good, daughter — do just that." She went to where the master of dance was and upon arriving said: "Master, if you will weigh out a thousand kārṣāpaṇas for my daughter's hair, take it now and give us the thousand kārṣāpaṇas." The master of dance replied: "Sister, at the time I needed those things, but now I do not. Nevertheless, I will take it for five hundred kārṣāpaṇas." The brahmin woman said: "Master, please accept it — take these." And so he took them.

By this time the venerable great Kātyāyana had arrived in the region of Kanyākubja and was sitting in a secluded, open place. Then the brahmin woman set out with a brisk step, went to where the venerable great Kātyāyana was, and spoke to him thus: "Noble great Kātyāyana, would you kindly come tomorrow at mealtime to take your midday meal at my home?" He replied: "Brahmin woman, my retinue is made up of ordinary people, quite numerous." She asked: "Noble one, how many are in the retinue?" "Brahmin woman, my retinue numbers five hundred." She said: "Excellent, noble one — I shall indeed do so. Please grant your consent." And the venerable great Kātyāyana accepted by saying nothing in refusal to that brahmin woman. When the brahmin woman understood that the venerable great Kātyāyana had accepted by remaining silent, she bowed at his feet, rose from her seat, and departed.

That very evening she prepared clean and pure food and drink, and the next morning rose early and arranged seats, set out water vessels, and went to invite the venerable great Kātyāyana, saying: "Noble one, the midday meal is prepared — please consider that the time has come." She then formally

announced the hour.

The following morning the venerable great Kātyāyana dressed in his robe and lower garment, took up his bowl, and surrounded by many monks, with the monastic Saṅgha of monks preceding him, he went to the place the brahmin woman had designated. Upon arriving he took his seat on the spread seat in the midst of the monastic Saṅgha. Then the brahmin woman, knowing that the great Kātyāyana and the rest of the monastic Saṅgha of monks were comfortably seated, with her own hands served clean and pure food and drink, and satisfied them fully and gave them their fill.

In many ways she served clean and pure food and drink with her own hands, fully satisfying them and seeing that they were well supplied. When the venerable great Kātyāyana had eaten his meal and she perceived that he had set aside his bowl, she placed a low seat before the venerable great Kātyāyana and sat down to hear the Dharma.

Then the venerable great Kātyāyana, wishing to teach the Dharma to that brahmin woman, said to her the following: "O daughter of a brahmin, you with the hair — what is she doing?" She replied, "Noble one, her conduct has been remiss. Since arhats do not engage primordial wisdom without prior reflection, he considered the conduct of the girl with the hair and then said: "Brahmin woman, call that girl of wholesome intention." When she was called, she came out of the house, and with intense faith prostrated at the feet of the venerable great Kātyāyana and sat to one side. The brahmin woman then said, "Noble one, this girl with the hair has abandoned evil and is your spiritual daughter. Therefore, whatever may be done, when we inquire of you and only you in this matter, please tell us to whom we should give her." She replied, "The brahmin woman has asked something improper, and it does not befit one who has gone forth. Nevertheless, this girl will come to obtain five hundred pieces of intimate adornment, five hundred pieces of outer adornment, and five hundred of the finest things in the village." She said, "Noble one, we brahmins are poor — how would we obtain all of these?" He replied, "Brahmin woman, do not say such a thing. Because this girl has acted with intense faith toward the excellent field of merit, she is known to have great power of merit. All of this will certainly come to her, so do not lament." And at that she said nothing more.

The venerable great Kātyāyana then taught that brahmin woman and her daughter in many ways with talk that accorded with the Dharma, fully instructing them, fully engaging them, fully praising them, and fully delighting

them. Having fully taught, fully engaged, fully praised, and fully delighted them in many ways with talk that accorded with the Dharma, he rose from his seat and departed, and in due course arrived at Śrāvastī.

At the moment he entered the city, half of the plague sickness was stilled. And the gatekeeper reported to the king: a certain ascetic bearing signs and marks of the gods never before seen, accompanied by five hundred attendants, had arrived — and the very moment he arrived, half of the plague sickness was stilled.

The king said, "Good people, show him honor." The brahmins said, "O lord, because we have striven at the ritual of pacification day and night, it is through our power that half of the plague sickness has been stilled; without delay everything will be fully pacified before long." The monks meanwhile said, "May the fierce king, Glorious Light, be freed from sickness," and said nothing more and left.

The king said to his ministers, "Wise ones, the gatekeeper says that a certain ascetic bearing signs and marks of the gods never before seen has arrived here with a retinue of five hundred, and the very moment he arrived, half of the plague sickness was stilled. And the brahmins say: 'O lord, because we strove at the pacification ritual from morning to night, it is through our power that half of the plague sickness was stilled.' If it is not known whose power this truly is, then today let these ascetics and brahmins be given poor cooked rice and broth, the food of the filthy quarter where elephants are washed, and after they have eaten and come back out, ask them both what sort of meal they had." "As your lordship commands," he replied, and —

Following the ministers' instructions, seats were spread in a filthy quarter where elephants are washed, and the ascetics and brahmins were given food. Once they had eaten and come back out, the doorkeeper asked the brahmins: "O great brahmins, with what sort of meal did the god satisfy you?" At that, they grew angry and said, "The king and all his conduct are devoted to what is contrary to the Dharma. He satisfied the brahmins with dirty cooked rice of inferior grain, two-legged legumes, and coarse broth." And at that they said nothing more.

The doorkeeper then went and asked the monks: "Noble ones, with what sort of meal did the god satisfy you?" They said, "A generous giver gave the gift, and the recipients ate it. The great elements were satisfied, and the day's sustenance was taken in." The doorkeeper reported this to the king: "Your

lordship, the brahmins said such-and-such, and the monks said such-and-such."

The king then commanded his ministers: "Wise ones, now give them both excellent clean food in a clean quarter that is no place where elephants are washed, and ask them the same question again." They spread seats for both groups in a clean quarter no place where elephants are washed, and satisfied them with fine food. When the doorkeeper asked them the same question, the brahmins said: "The king is an anointed sovereign of the warrior caste, consecrated from the crown of the head, and he gave whatever food one could desire and satisfied us fully. These brahmins say that this royal palace, seen now and then from the edge of its gateway, has sometimes seemed inferior and sometimes fine — so do not mock us!" And at that they said nothing more.

The doorkeeper then went and asked the monks, and they said exactly as they had before. The doorkeeper reported this to the king in just the same way. The same procedure applied to the washing place of elephants was then applied in turn to the washing place of horses, to the ash-heap, and to clean and agreeable places.

King Candragupta reflected: "I understand that the monks are worthy recipients of gifts, while the brahmins are not." Faith arose in him, and he went directly to where the venerable Mahākātyāyana was staying. He prostrated himself with his head at the venerable Mahākātyāyana's feet and sat to one side. As he sat there, the venerable Mahākātyāyana gave King Candragupta thorough instruction in Dharma-filled discourse, led him to thoroughly receive it, offered him thorough praise, and gladdened him thoroughly. With many categories of Dharma-filled discourse he gave thorough instruction, led him to thoroughly receive it, offered thorough praise, and made him thoroughly joyful. Then he sat in silence.

Then King Candragupta rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, turned and faced the direction of the venerable Mahākātyāyana with palms joined, and said: "Noble Mahākātyāyana, would you grant that tomorrow, together with the community of monks, you accept a noon meal within my household?" The venerable Mahākātyāyana gave his consent to King Candragupta by remaining silent. Then King Candragupta, understanding by the venerable Mahākātyāyana's silence that consent had been given, prostrated with his head at the venerable Mahākātyāyana's feet, rose from his seat, and departed.

That very evening King Candragupta arranged clean and excellent food and drink, and rising early the next morning, spread seats and set out water vessels.

He then sent word to the venerable Mahākātyāyana with this invitation: "Noble Mahākātyāyana, the seats have been arranged; please be aware that the hour has now arrived."

The venerable Mahākātyāyana, in the early morning, robed in his outer and inner garments and taking up his alms bowl, set out surrounded by the community of monks, with the monastic Saṅgha preceding him, and proceeded to the residence of King Candragupta. Upon his arrival, seats had been spread in the midst of the monastic Saṅgha, and he took his seat. Then music was struck up, and dancers began to perform dances of many kinds. The venerable Mahākātyāyana and the monks restrained their sense faculties and remained composed.

When the sound of those songs, dances, and music had subsided, King Candragupta said: "Noble one, was the dancing good? Were the songs pleasing?"

The venerable Mahākātyāyana replied: "Great King, it was for those who heard or saw them."

The king said: "Noble one, if those who had withdrawn their sense faculties inward did not see, how then did they not hear?"

Mahākātyāyana said: "O King, do you have anyone who would not recoil from killing a man? If so, noble one, what do you wish of such a person?"

The king replied: "Take that man and fill a vessel with sesame oil to the very brim — so full that a crow could drink from it — and have him carry it. Send him to tour all the fine districts and bring it back here. Meanwhile, station an executioner behind him, sword raised, and give him this instruction: 'If even a single drop of sesame oil falls to the ground, this executioner with his raised sword will cut off your head at the neck and cast it to the ground.' Then have varied music played before him and have various dances performed in front of him. After that, you will believe me."

King Candragupta did precisely as had been described, step by step. He then asked the man: "Well, fellow — was the dancing good? Were the songs pleasing? Was the music pleasant?"

The man replied: "O King, it was for those who saw or heard them."

The king said: "Come now — if those who had withdrawn their sense faculties inward could not see, how did they not hear?"

The man said: "O King, I thought to myself: if even a single drop of sesame oil were to fall from this vessel to the ground, that executioner with his raised sword would cut off my head at the neck and cast it to the ground. In terror of dying, I fixed my mind one-pointedly on the vessel of sesame oil, straining my eyes to watch it — so how could I possibly have seen or heard anything?"

The king fell silent, having nothing to say.

The venerable Mahākātyāyana then said: "O King, did you see?"

"Noble one, I did see."

"O King, that man, for the sake of the suffering of a single life, kept himself from distraction and maintained constant vigilance. We monks, having taken up the training precept of abandoning the watching and listening of musical performances, need we even speak of watching or listening to dances, songs, and music? For it is a cause of suffering across many lifetimes — that would simply be out of the question."

King Candragupta, convinced by the sight of the vessel of sesame oil, and filled with heightened faith, together with his retinue of queens, young princes, ministers, and the people of the royal household, personally served Mahākātyāyana and the rest of the monastic Saṅgha — who were seated at ease — with clean and pure food and drink from his own hands, satisfying and refreshing them fully. Again and again he served them with clean and pure food and drink from his own hands, satisfying them completely.

When the meal was properly concluded, the Venerable Mahākātyāyana, perceiving by the shadow of the sun's position that it was time, and knowing that his alms-bowl had been washed and returned, took up a seat lower than Mahākātyāyana's own and sat down before the Venerable Mahākātyāyana. Having sat down, he spoke to the Venerable Mahākātyāyana as follows: "Noble one, was there anyone else who, as I have done, satisfied your retinue of five hundred with pure and wholesome food?"

Mahākātyāyana replied: "You who have surpassed many gods — what is so remarkable about the fact that you satisfied my retinue of five hundred with such food? When I was coming here, a girl living in the hills sold her own hair and thereby satisfied my retinue of five hundred with food of this very kind. That, I tell you, is far more remarkable and wonderful than what you have

done."

King Candragupta reflected: "A woman who sold her hair for five hundred kārṣāpaṇas — where in the world, even among the gods, could there be such a woman?" He thought, "In short, I must find her." But since the Venerable Mahākātyāyana was difficult of approach, the king could not ask him directly where in the hills this girl was. Instead he gave instructions to those of his men who lived by selling curds: "Good sirs, seek out along whatever road Mahākātyāyana came by some girl living in the hills who sold her hair and today provided pure food to the noble Mahākātyāyana along with his retinue of five hundred — find her and bring her back for my sake. Such is the king's command."

His men who lived by selling curds obeyed King Candragupta's order and searched in due course. They went to Kanyākubja and searched for her there. After searching and resting from the fatigue of the road, they went to the house where that brahmin woman lived, and standing at the doorway called out, "May there be auspiciousness! May there be auspiciousness!"

The brahmin woman said, "Good sirs, what do you wish?"

They said, "The girl with the hair."

The brahmin woman said, "For whose sake do you come?"

They said, "For the sake of King Candragupta, O brahmin woman."

She replied, "Good sirs, very well — but the bride-price for her will be considerable."

They said, "Sister, how much is required?"

She replied, "Five hundred intimate ornaments, five hundred outer ornaments, and the five foremost towns."

They conveyed this matter to King Candragupta, telling him the price the brahmin woman was asking. The king sent back his reply: "Good sirs, find out the full amount of the girl's bride-price, and pay it all." They received the command, and the king fixed the day of the month, the auspicious moment, and took her as his bride with great splendor and wealth.

On the very day he went to Magadha, throughout Magadha all the people everywhere became completely calm and at peace, and from that time the place came to be known as "the Peaceful."

Here ends the twenty-sixth fascicle of the Vinayakṣudrakavastu.

The summary verse is as follows:

Birth, and the one sustained by curds, and the son of Kātyāyana,
the peaceful one, the merchant, the battle,
the chanter before the assembly, and the goddess Tārā,
the lute-player, the hair-cutting,
and the episode of the skeleton —
all these are rightly gathered into this chapter.

At that time in Magadha there lived a merchant's son who took a wife from a family equal to his own, and he would sport with her, delight in her, and take pleasure with her. After sporting and delighting with her for a little while, he loaded up his goods and went off to another region. His wife, tormented intensely by affliction from eating fine and delicious food and wearing fine clothes —

One day she went up to the roof and gazed out in every direction. Some time later, the fierce king Rānaprabhā came riding past on an elephant, passing close by her house. She threw a garland of flowers toward him, and it landed on the fierce king Rānaprabhā's shoulder. He looked up, and there he saw her — young, in the full bloom of youth, supremely beautiful by virtue of her exceptional complexion and figure, standing at the edge of the parapet, glancing sideways with a sidelong gaze, her bearing suffused with desire. Seeing her, his mind became utterly captivated, and he called out to her, "If that is so, come down!" She replied, "O lord, come up here to me in secret." And indeed, overcome by passion, he was unable to turn back. He dismounted from the elephant, entered her house, sported with her in joy and delight, and she conceived a child.

Now, some women of discerning nature possess five qualities found in none other. What are those five? They know when a man is attached to them and when he is not; they know the right time and can tell by the signs of their monthly cycle; they know when conception has occurred; they know from whom conception has occurred; and they know whether a boy or a girl has been conceived.

She reported to the king exactly what had happened, saying, "O lord, I have conceived." The king gave her a pearl necklace and told her, "If a boy is born from you, give him this pearl necklace and send him to me. But if a girl, she shall be yours alone." With that he departed.

When the signs of pregnancy appeared, the merchant sent a letter: "I too am coming in comfort; do not be unhappy — take care." When she received this she was frightened, and she reported the matter to the king, saying, "O lord, my husband is drawing near — what am I to do?" The king sent word back to her: "Do not be unhappy, take care; I shall arrange for him to travel far away." And so the king said nothing further on the matter.

The king sent word to the merchant: "I require such-and-such goods — do not return without finding them." To obtain these, the merchant set out on a long and distant road.

Nine months having passed, a boy was born, handsome, beautiful, and pleasing to behold. The woman filled a box with butter and honey, laid cotton-wool inside, placed the infant upon it, wrapped him in white cloth from above, set the pearl necklace upon him, sealed the lid, and affixed a wax seal to the box. She then instructed her maidservant, "Take this box and go; set it down at the city gate of the royal capital, placing it in a circle of lamps; and once you have set it there, stand to one side until someone takes it up." The maidservant did exactly as she was told.

Not long after, cattle passing along that road gathered around the box and stood surrounding it. Meanwhile, the fierce king Rānaprabhā was sitting up in his fine pavilion together with his tranquil queen, and he saw those cattle standing clustered together. He instructed his cowherds, "Good men, go see what that is that the cattle are encircling." They looked and reported, "O lord, there is a box sealed with a wax seal." The king said, "Bring it here." The tranquil queen made a request: "O lord, whatever contents the box may hold, pray grant them to me." The king replied, "Excellent — let it be so." When the box was brought before the king, he opened it and looked, and there he saw a pearl necklace and a child.

He recognized the pearl necklace and the thought arose in him, "This child is mine." He entrusted the child to the tranquil queen, saying, "This is your son." She asked, "O lord, what name shall we give this boy?" He replied, "This boy was nurtured by the cattle, and so let his name be Gopalaka — Keeper of Cattle." And thus the boy was named Gopalaka. From that time on, because the tranquil queen had raised him, she too came to be known as the Mother of Gopalaka.

At that time, in the land of Droṇapṛāsāda, a king named Padmahṛdaya was ruling the kingdom — and from "the prosperous" down to "he ruled the

kingdom in accordance with the Dharma" is as before.

In his land the rains fell in their season, the trees bore flowers and fruits without cease, the harvests were good, and even beggars found food easily. Then, at a certain later time, King Padmahṛdaya went up to the roof of his palace and was seated there surrounded by a company of ministers. He spoke to the ministers: "O wise ones, is there any other king in whose land the rains fall thus in their season, the trees perpetually bear flowers and fruit, the harvests are good, and even beggars always find food easily?" They replied, "O lord, in the land called Ārya-rājya under King Ugraprabha, it is said the rains fall in their season, the trees perpetually bear flowers and fruit, the harvests are good, and beggars always find food easily." He said, "O wise ones, if that is so, then arm the fourfold host of troops, and let us go to destroy that kingdom." They armed the fourfold host of troops, and King Padmahṛdaya set out with that fourfold host toward Ārya-rājya, advancing by stages until he arrived in the land of King Ugraprabha.

When he began to attack, the people dwelling in that land sent word to King Ugraprabha: "A great army has been gathered by one called King Padmahṛdaya from another land, and he is coming to conquer this realm." King Ugraprabha then armed his own fourfold host — the corps of elephants, the corps of cavalry, the corps of chariots, and the corps of foot soldiers — and marched out to do battle with King Padmahṛdaya.

Then King Padmahṛdaya seized the entire corps of elephants of King Ugraprabha, and seized the corps of cavalry, the corps of chariots, and the corps of foot soldiers as well. He captured, bound, and overpowered King Ugraprabha and routed him in battle. In the rout and the general scattering on all sides, the ministers and the rest of the troops and people fled into Ārya-rājya and gathered at the edge of the enclosure, where they sat. The king himself, entirely alone, went to a certain mountain cave.

In that mountain cave there was a farmer named Kṣetraka who was plowing his field. He saw the king and said, "It is being proclaimed that the hero of the market — King Padmahṛdaya — captured, bound, and overpowered King Ugraprabha and routed him in battle. Is that true?" The man replied, "It is true, friend. Though you live in this land, King Padmahṛdaya who has come from another land has captured, bound, and overpowered him and routed him in battle. Whatever the ministers and generals of that king are like — if I were to become a minister of his, I could swiftly, and without delay, seize King

Padmahṛdaya by the neck, bring him to Ārya-rājya, and present him." So the man was speaking these words as he sat there.

His wife, a woman named Riktrödma, came carrying food. She dug up the earth, laid down leaves, washed her hands, and set about eating. She looked at the king and said, "Oh, hero of the market, you are weary and tormented by hunger and thirst. Though what we have to eat and drink is meager, and affliction diminishes our strength, please do not hold back — come, draw near, and partake of whatever there is." At these words, King Ugraprabha thought to himself, "If I do not eat, I shall starve and die." Realizing this, he dismounted from his horse, washed his hands and feet, took the saddlecloth from the horse, spread it on the ground, and sat down. Having sat, he began to eat with the thought of sustaining his life.

Then the woman poured beer from a bowl that was chipped at the rim. The king thought to himself, "The bowl is chipped, but I shall drink from the side that is not chipped." Now, kings are endowed with wisdom and possess excellent character, and so he thought further, "If I drink from the side that is not chipped, she may feel embarrassed, thinking, 'He drank from the unbroken side,' and she may shun me. It would be far better for me to drink from the very side from which she herself drank." And so he drank from that very same side. The man, Namdö Gyi, observed this and thought to himself, "This hero of the market is a man of no pretension at all — he drank from the very same side of the bowl from which I drank. I should make him a lasting friend, one who will not soon be parted from my household and way of life." And so he said to his wife, "Good woman, this hero of the market is a friend of my heart. Take him home, give him a proper welcome and bath, and feed him food. Give his horse fodder and provisions as well." She took the king home, welcomed him properly, gave him a bath, fed him food, and gave the horse fodder and provisions.

Now, certain mountain cliff-dwellers called Gyabrak Kyaseng had gathered against King Padmahṛdaya, and, descending from their mountain cliff valleys, they began to ravage the lands of King Padmahṛdaya. His ministers sent him a letter saying, "Your Majesty, the divine mountain cliff-dwellers Gyabrak Kyaseng have attacked and devastated the divine lands. Please give thought to what is to be done." Within the letter they also wrote a verse:

Just as you have striven with great diligence
to destroy the lands of your enemies,

so too please, Your Majesty,
act in the same way to protect your own realm and its borders.

King Padmahṛdaya read the letter and thought, "If I return the same way I came, the people of the world will think that King Padmahṛdaya has been defeated and has therefore turned back." Deciding that he would go to meet his friend one last time before departing, he sent word to King Ugraprabha: "Dear friend, what is done is done — what has become ash is ash. Now please come out. I shall do nothing whatsoever to you. Otherwise, we would simply part by embracing each other at the neck and going our separate ways." When the ministers heard this message, they thought, "If we send word that the king is not here, we may find an opportunity — let us try something deceptive." And so they sent him a letter: "Dear friend, even if that is so, we view the king with suspicion, like a crow, and so he will not come out. Your ally's son, the young prince Langkyong, will come — please hand authority over to him and depart." King Padmahṛdaya handed authority over to the young king Langkyong, encircled him with a royal escort, and then departed for Dōjok. The ministers then said:

"Wise ones, King Padmahṛdaya has been put at ease and has gone to the land of Dōjok — now let us go in search of the god." So saying, they sent mounted messengers out in every direction.

When King Tumpo Rabnang heard that King Padmahṛdaya had encircled the noble king with a royal escort and then departed for the land of Dōjok, he spoke to a farmer named Namjé: "Namjé, I am free from fear, and for that reason I shall go to the noble king. If you come to the noble king's realm, come to my house."

Namjé replied: "Hero of the marketplace, I do not even know your name — how then could I come to your house?"

The king said: "Namjé, even if you do not know my house, never mind — when you arrive in the noble king's realm, simply ask whichever of the many horse-owners lives there, and come." So saying, he departed and journeyed gradually until he reached the land of the noble king. There he instructed the gatekeeper: "Hey, if someone comes asking which house belongs to the one with many horses, bring that person to me." Then he entered the house.

Some time later a festival came to the land of the noble king, and the crowds of people who lived in that region all went out to it. The farmer's wife,

Ritrömma, said: "My lord's son, a festival has come to the land of the noble king and those crowds of people are going out to it — let us go too, enjoy the festival, and also catch a glimpse of the one with many horses."

He replied: "Good woman, can everything that the hero of the marketplace said really be true? One should consider three possibilities: that he was defeated, that he fled, or that he has fallen from his kingdom."

She said: "My lord's son, if that is how it is, very well — let us go, enjoy the festival, and then return." He agreed: "Good woman, fine — let us do just that." The two of them set out and journeyed gradually until they reached the noble king's realm. Namjé asked the gatekeeper: "Hey, which is the house of someone called the one with many horses?" The gatekeeper led him and his wife to the presence of King Tumpo Rabnang. The king greeted them with the full ceremony of welcoming guests who have come from afar, and then addressed Namjé directly: "Namjé, have you come?" Namjé answered: "Your Majesty, I have arrived."

Now the king was wearing plain, ordinary clothes, and because he had a crown bound on his head Namjé did not recognize him as the king. But when the king descended from his lion throne, Namjé recognized him, and together with his wife he prostrated at the king's feet.

King Tumpo Rabnang received them with great honor, led them into the queen's retinue, had them bathed and given a change of clothes, provided them with food, and also gave them a sleeping chamber. He then instructed the ladies of the queen's retinue: "These two are my father and mother — therefore you are to attend upon them with food, drink, bedding, seats, male and female servants, working people, attendants, and all necessary provisions." Thinking that the king was honoring and venerating them, all the ladies of the queen's retinue, the young men, the ministers, and every person of the palace household began to wait upon them.

After sitting for a while, the farmer Namjé spoke: "Your Majesty, please hear me. I am here, and being in your royal presence is not difficult." The king replied: "Namjé, stay right here and let us hold the kingdom together." Namjé said: "Your Majesty, what use would it be for someone like me, a farmer, to take hold of a kingdom?" The king said: "Namjé, at that time you yourself said: 'If I were that king's minister, or —'"

"— if I were made a general, I would swiftly and without delay seize King Lotus-Heart by the throat and drag him away to be taken to the noble king."

When I said I could not do it, what kind of thing was that? And he had nothing more to say.

Now, King Tumpo Rapnang had five hundred ministers, and the king had them nurse Söpa back to health. When they had nursed him and he had recovered, he came to be known by the name Söpa, meaning "the recovered one." At another time the king asked him: "Söpa, how are you faring? Your Majesty, how are things with me? The ministers are treating me with contempt." The king replied: "Söpa, if that is the case, then when counsel is being taken on matters that concern them, you too shall enter into it, and no one will treat you without respect." Söpa said: "Your Majesty, what use is there in a farmer like me entering into councils?" The king commanded: "Söpa, do it just so, and all the ministers will come to show you respect." And at that Söpa said nothing more.

Some time passed, and then King Tumpo Rapnang was sitting surrounded by his assembly of ministers. Wishing to have Söpa speak, he first sent his own thoughts ahead and asked the ministers: "Wise ones, how should this matter be handled?" Some of them said: "Your Majesty, we would do such-and-such." The king replied: "This matter should not be handled that way." Others said: "Your Majesty, for this matter we would do such-and-such." The king replied: "This matter should not be handled that way either." Then the king asked Söpa how this matter should be handled, and Söpa said: "Your Majesty, this matter should be handled thus. If it is done in that way, things will go well." The king did accordingly. The ministers said among themselves: "The king has acted in accordance with this man's counsel, so we must not fail to show him respect," and they began to treat him with deference.

Again the king asked Söpa: "How are you faring?" He replied: "Your Majesty, how should things be? At first I had no house." The king commanded his ministers: "Wise ones, give Söpa a house." They replied: "Your Majesty, there is a certain great minister whose time of service has passed, and his house stands empty, along with his household and dependents." The king commanded: "Give that house to Söpa, complete with a wife and possessions," and they gave him that house together with a wife.

Again the king asked Söpa: "Söpa, how are you faring?" He replied: "Your Majesty, the servants of the household keep treating me with contempt, saying: 'This man is a farmer.'" The king said: "Söpa, if that is the case, then whenever you wish to bathe, at that time send word to me, and when you

have finished bathing, announce that you are coming. And do the same when you wish to eat: send word to me a second time, and when you have finished eating, announce that you are coming. And then I myself will come to your house, and when I arrive I will eat together with you from one vessel." Söpa said: "Your Majesty, I am a subject and you are the lord. It is not fitting that I should eat together with you as one. That would not be proper." The king replied: "Söpa, if I grant you this, what contradiction is there in it? You eat, and if you do so, they will come to show you respect," and having said this, Söpa accepted and said nothing more.

Then the king sent a messenger to Söpa at the time of his bathing, saying: "Söpa, there is something I need of you — come quickly." Söpa went to the king's presence and said:

"I have some small need of Söpa — tell him to come quickly," the king declared. Söpa said: "Very well, my lord, I will wash and come — go ahead." And the messenger went back.

Some women of Söpa's wife's retinue then began to gossip: "Sisters, look at that husband of ours, the farmer — he is so shameless! See how he dismisses even the king's command." At this, some said: "Sisters, those who are born of low family will grow arrogant even over barley." Others said: "Sisters, wait and see: what goes up high must fall, so without any doubt the king will ruin this one," and so they spoke.

When Söpa had finished bathing and had begun to eat, the king sent a second messenger to him saying: "There is some small matter I need Söpa for — he has not arrived, so let him come at once." The messenger went to him and delivered the message just so. Söpa said: "Good fellow, go on your way — I will eat and come." Before long the king himself arrived and said: "Söpa, have you eaten?" Söpa replied: "Your Majesty, I have not." The king said: "Söpa, will you not play host to me?" Söpa replied: "Your Majesty, I will be your host — please take your meal." The wives thought: "He is laughing and joking together with the king!" and were so astonished that they began to stare fixedly.

The king washed his hands and feet and began to eat together with Söpa. When the wives saw this, they were alarmed and spoke among themselves: "Sisters, we scorned this man as nothing but a farmer, and look — there he sits eating with the king himself. Now, some said: "Sisters, what is to be done about this?" Others said: "What is there to be done? The king eats together with him, and if we have not shown him respect and the king comes to know of

it, he will certainly harm us. What is done is done. From now on let us never be disrespectful toward him." Others said: "Good — let it be so." And though they felt ashamed and unhappy, they did not gainsay that counsel.

Later, the king asked Söpa: "How do you find yourself? How are things, Your Majesty? That father-in-law of yours has been extremely contemptuous toward me." The king replied: "Söpa, he may not be capable of doing as you wish, yet all of it depends on you alone — you yourself know what to do." Söpa said: "Your Majesty, if that is so, please grant me one thing — do not rebuke me for it." The king said: "Excellent — do it just so."

Some time later Söpa was passing through the market. There he saw two children who had been separated from their parents, wandering as they pleased wherever they liked, having found their daily food and now playing cheerfully in an alleyway.

Then a serving woman carrying a water jar came walking along that road, and one of the boys said: "Friend, look — this one has punctured the jar with a dry needle." She replied: "If you had made a hole with a dry needle, that would be no great wonder. That I have plugged the leak with this wet needle — that is the great wonder!" He said: "Very good, do it just so," and the boy plugged it with the dry needle, while the other stopped the leak with a wet one.

When Söpa saw this he was greatly astonished, and thought: "If the two of them cooperate, they could be capable of healing flesh." He called out: "Hey children — whose are you two?" The two replied: "Your Majesty, we have been separated from our parents and are from somewhere or other, searching for our daily food." Söpa said: "If that is so, why not stay with me?" They replied: "Your Majesty, we will gladly come."

Nevertheless they had a request: "What work of yours do you wish us to do?" He replied: "There is nothing at all to be done — simply let them become accustomed to this very cesspit and leave them there. However, I want you to do one thing for me: whenever someone joins me in eating, the two of you are to fill that person's mouth with filth steeped in excrement." The two of them said: "Your Majesty, we shall gladly do just so."

Some time later, when he began dining with someone for whatever reason, the two of them filled that person's mouth with filth steeped in excrement, and that person, choking on it, wiped his lips in disgust and fell silent, unable to utter a word.

The king then went to attend to the patient, and asked: "Patient, how are you faring?" The patient said: "Your Majesty, how am I faring! That household servant of yours insulted me by saying I was a farmer's man." The king replied: "Patient, if that is so, then whenever I go into the inner quarters of the queen's retinue, you are to come there and ask, 'Where is the king staying?' If they say, 'He is staying within the queen's retinue,' then say this: 'If he resides and remains within the queen's retinue, the king's affairs and the king's business will fall into ruin.' And furthermore, if you see my bed and throne there, sit down on them, and I shall wash your feet." The patient replied: "Your Majesty, you are the lord and I am the subject — how could that be fitting? That would not be proper at all." The king said: "Patient, if that is what I wish, what objection can you have to it? In that way, all of them will show you respect and attendance." The patient accepted and everything was gradually carried out accordingly. He was told to rest a while on the king's very own bed and throne, and he lay down there, and fell asleep on the spot. When the king came back out and asked, "Who is this?" they replied, "It is the patient, Your Majesty." The king said: "Has no one washed his feet? Bring water and come — I will wash his feet," and the king washed his feet. The attendants, though uneasy and reluctant, began to wait upon him.

Now King Rāpana (Raudra-prabhā) was violent in nature and consumed with lust for women. So it was that on another occasion he went up to the rooftop of the fine palace together with the sons of ministers, the young courtiers, and sat with them in improper conversation, asking the wise men: "In which village, town, or region are the women beautiful?" Some said: "Your Majesty, the women of Kānyakubja are beautiful." Others said: "Your Majesty, the women of Campājika are beautiful." Others said: "Your Majesty, the serpents that are fierce and fine." Others said: "Never mind the women living in other cities — right here in this very noble land there dwells one called Suvarṇā the beauty, and whoever sees her sees a goddess worthy of the veneration of the thirty-three, endowed with form, complexion, youth, and figure such that, as the brilliance of sunlight overwhelms the glow of stars dwelling in the celestial palace of the gods, so is she." When the king heard the description of her form and the qualities of her youth, he desired all the more to go to another man's wife. He disguised himself and that very evening took five hundred kārṣāpaṇas and went to her house. She received him with every welcoming courtesy befitting his arrival, and then entrusted him to her daughter, the maidservant. "Daughter, go and rub this noble young man down and bathe him. Mistress

commands it so." The daughter obeyed Suvarṇā the beauty and began to rub down King Raudra-prabhā.

While she was rubbing him down, another man also arrived there carrying five hundred kārṣāpaṇas, and he said to Suvarṇā the beauty: "Come, let us take our pleasure together." Now the practice of Suvarṇā the beauty, who lived by her body, was this: if one man had come inside and then another came, she would kill the first and take her pleasure with the second. The maidservant looked upon King Raudra-prabhā — his form and the beauty of his youth — and thought to herself, "Even a young man of royal birth like this one will be killed by this woman who practices every manner of wickedness," and she wept. As she wept, drops of her tears fell upon the body of King Raudra-prabhā. He looked up and saw the girl weeping, and said, "Girl, why do you cry?" She replied, "My lord, do not ask." The king grew suspicious and asked again, "Girl, why are you crying? Speak plainly and without shame." And she told him everything in full.

King Raudra-prabhā then said, "Girl, is there any means by which I might escape from here?" She replied, "This house is surrounded on all sides by the madam's men carrying drawn swords, so there is little hope — yet there is one direction. It is unclean, so it may be improper to mention it." The king said, "Girl, clean or unclean, speak — and save my life." She said, "In this direction there is a drainage channel, and it has been fastened shut with an iron peg. If you can pull it out, open it and flee." The king said, "Girl, show me which direction that is — I can pull it out." And she showed him that direction.

Now, adjacent to the house of that courtesan lived the house of a brahmin astrologer. At that moment the brahmin had come outside to urinate, and his wife had also come out carrying water to rinse. The brahmin looked up at the stars and, seeing that the omens were inauspicious, said to his wife, "Brahmin lady, the stars are inauspicious — I fear that the portent of the gods is most dreadful." She replied, "Brahmin, do not say such things — the king will be displeased." He said, "Brahmin lady, we ourselves dwell safely under the king's protection, and therefore I do not approve of these words — yet I say them nonetheless."

All of this the king overheard. Then the king began to work at pulling out the iron peg, but he could not move it. He gathered his full strength and forced it loose and pulled it free, and at that very moment his bowels gave way, and he went forth together with that discharge. The brahmin said to his wife,

"Brahmin lady, that dreadful and fearful portent of the god of which I spoke — it has passed. The king is alive, our power and authority remain great." Meanwhile, the king, still dripping with filth as he was, made his way to Queen Śāntā. She asked him what had happened, and he told her how it had all come to pass. Queen Śāntā, her eyes filled with tears, pressed her body against his with a clump of reeds, rubbed him down with a clump of reeds, bathed him with water scented with various perfumes, and dressed him in fitting garments.

The next morning he sat in his place of business and said to his ministers, "Wise men, summon the astrologers." They summoned the astrologers, and the king asked them, "Wise men, how did last night pass for me?" They replied, "Your Majesty, it passed just as it ought for a king of royal lineage, anointed with the consecration poured upon the crown of his head, ruling the earth according to the Dharma." The king said, "Wise men, in a certain large district there lives a brahmin astrologer — summon him." And they sent the king's men to fetch him.

They went there and announced to the brahmin, "The king summons you." He replied to his household members, "Wise men, do as the king has commanded — I will come to attend upon the king," and sent them back. When they returned, the brahmin's wife said, "Brahmin, before this I told you not to speak of the king becoming furious and angry, yet you would not listen to my words — and now it has come to pass." He said to the brahmin woman, "All will turn out well — do not be anxious," and with that he composed himself and went before the king.

The king, seeing him from a great distance, called out words of welcome — "It is good that you have come!" — and said, "Master, it is good that you have come — please be seated here." Gladdened, the brahmin offered the king a prayer of victory and long life, then sat where he had been directed. The king waited a short while and then said, "Master, do you know my omens?" He replied, "I shall probe and divine it for the king's pleasure." "Master, how did last night pass for me?" "Your Majesty, what appeared threatening and terrifying by way of some dreadful portent, yet you are a man of great merit, and because of that you fainted and escaped from among your enemies." The king was pleased and said to his ministers, "What the master has said is precisely so — it is exactly as he states and nothing other." Then the king said, "Master, tell me what excellent gift I should give you." He replied, "Please allow me first to consult with my household members, and I will make my

request afterward." The king said, "Master, very well — do so." The brahmin took his leave and departed, going home to his own house. He called his household members together and said, "If the king is resolved to give me an excellent gift, tell me what each of you desires." The brahmin's wife said, "Brahmin, first ask yourself what you desire." He replied, "Brahmin woman, I desire five excellent townships." She said, "Brahmin, if that is so, then I desire a hundred cows." The son said, "Father, I desire a chariot of the finest sandalwood." The daughter said, "I desire jeweled earrings with pendant loops." His maidservant Kyedma said, "If you all have such desires, then I desire a fine flat stone."

The brahmin thought to himself: "I will ask the king for the gift in the melody of verse — I shall not do it in the common way of others." With that in mind, he composed the verse in his thoughts and went before the king, saying:

"Your Majesty, hear what we desire. I seek five cities; my brahmin wife seeks a hundred cows; the son seeks a fine sandalwood chariot; the daughter desires jeweled earrings; and my maidservant Kyedma — she too desires a fine flat stone."

The fierce king Rabsang replied to him in verse in kind:

"To you I grant five excellent townships; to your wife, a hundred cows; to your son, a chariot adorned with horse-drawn glory; to your daughter likewise, earrings; to your maidservant Kyedma, who sought a fine flat stone — may that hope of hers too bear fruit, and let every wish be fulfilled just as desired."

Then the king gave him the gift he had desired, and said, "Master, now enter my service and counsel me in affairs of state." He replied, "Your Majesty, I am a brahmin, and that is not my proper domain." The king insisted upon it earnestly and had him brought before him.

Now some time passed, and there came to the fierce king Rabsang certain grey-robed forest ascetics. He commanded the officer who greeted them, "Go and drive those ascetics away." So the officer mustered the fourfold army — the divisions of elephants, cavalry, chariots, and infantry — put on their armour, and went. They drove those ascetics away, and afterward seized their encampment as well.

They were also made to hand over the tribute and the head-tax before they departed. When the king had nursed her back to health, he laid the grey-robed ascetics low in defeat and seized their encampment, and word came that they

had been made to hand over the tribute and the head-tax as well. Upon hearing this, he went out to meet them with the fourfold army. Now after some time, within that encampment he caught sight of a girl who had been struck and bruised by the rocky crags of the mountain. He saw her, and asked the physician, "Is there anyone living with this physician who enjoys pleasures together with him?" The physician replied, "Your Majesty, it is not only for pleasure that I have her. Whoever has been granted her favors and then seeks her from behind — there is one present who would make him neigh like a horse." The king said, "Physician, can that really be so?" He replied, "Your Majesty, it will be demonstrated before your very eyes." The physician entrusted the girl to the healers and said, "Learned ones, I shall prepare all the medicines; you examine her." They examined her, and she recovered from her illness. Then gradually, through the excellence of the various medicines, she grew beautiful in form. The physician took her as his own daughter and gave her the name Tārā, the Daughter of the Grey-Robed One. The physician instructed the girl, saying, "Daughter, I am going to summon the god here within the hour — adorn yourself with all your ornaments and present yourself to the god." But she sat there saying not a word. The physician said to the king, "Does Your Majesty not see how the god has utterly cast aside my embarrassment?" The king replied, "Physician, how could I look, when you have not called?" He said, "Your Majesty, if that is the case, I shall invite him now. Excellent — a kindness has been done." The physician prepared food and drink fit for a king, had the house swept and cleaned, and came to the king's dwelling. He then wiped the king with fine cloths fit for royalty, bathed him with water perfumed with many fragrances, anointed him with various unguents, dressed him in many fine garments, offered him refreshments fit for a king, and sat conversing with him. Then from behind a curtain she tossed out a shuttlecock, and he deflected the curtain, and said, "Please return the shuttlecock." At that moment the king caught sight of her — young in years and beautiful. The instant he saw her, desire arose in him, and he said, "Physician, whose daughter is this?" "Your Majesty, she is my own daughter." "Physician, has she been given to anyone?" "Your Majesty, she has not." "Physician, if that is so, why will you not give her to me?" "Your Majesty, I wish to present her." So the fierce king Rabsang took her as his queen with great and splendid wealth. Since it is the very nature of things that what is new eclipses all that is old, the king gazed upon her alone, his mind filled with desire, neglected other affairs, and attended only to her. The physician thought to himself, "Now is the time to fulfill the vow I made before," and

spoke these words to the girl: "Daughter, are you able to have this king ride on your back and make him neigh like a horse?" She laughed a little and replied, "Father, wait but a moment — I shall see whether it is possible or not."

The Vinaya: the Section on Minor Matters. The twenty-seventh bundle.

Now women, being skilled without having been trained, spread out a soiled garment and lay and sat upon a latticed couch. The king said, "My queen, what is the meaning of this?" She replied, "Your Majesty, the gods are in turmoil." He said, "What have you done to the gods?" She said, "Your Majesty, when the god sent my father, the grey-robed forest ascetic, away in defeat, I prayed to the gods in order to pacify the matter,

"If my father, having accomplished his purpose rightly, returns in victory, then he who took me in marriage shall mount my back, and I grant him the right to make the sound of a horse." This was the vow I made, and so I was offered to the god. Since the retinue of the god's queen is vast, I could by no means have failed to fulfill this vow. Those who are enslaved by the attachment of desire will stop at nothing." The king then said, "O goddess, since you prayed on my behalf and for my sake, fulfill everything and rest at ease." She said nothing further.

King Pracandarabha said, "O goddess, why do you not speak? Is there perhaps something more you prayed for, goddess?" She replied, "There is nothing further from the god — yet at that time I vowed that I would have the brahmin reciter chant an auspicious blessing of the gods, and that a lute-player would take up the lutes." He said, "O goddess, that too is easy enough — there are brahmin reciters — but a lute-player must be sought." She said, "Then, O god, please be so good as to seek a lute-player." At that time a man from the provinces, a landowner, came to Āryarāja carrying a basket. He was so completely overcome by attachment and desire for a courtesan that he sold everything in the basket, ate with her, and grew all the more attached. All the hired servants he had with him abandoned him and fled. She then said to him, "Son of a lord, I am not a farmer, I am not a merchant, and I am not a village person traveling with a basket to another region. Otherwise, living is sustained by whatever one finds from people such as you, so give me kārṣāpaṇas, or else open the door to another man." He replied, "Dear woman, I have no kārṣāpaṇas. But if I had kārṣāpaṇas, who would there be more worthy than you to give them to? Yet since you are dear to me, stay here and do not drive me away. If you do what I say, then I shall truly know that you hold me dear."

She said, "Very well, I bow my head to that." He relieved himself and placed a twig of cypress upon the excrement, saying, "If you love me, pick up this cypress twig." As she began to pick it up, he smeared a lump of dung upon her and offered it to her, saying, "Do even beggars behave like this? Filth — I shall not sit together with you. Get out!" And with that he drove her from the house.

Now he was a man skilled in the lute, and he set about making his living by playing the lute. The king said to the nurse, "Your daughter prayed to the gods in this manner. Now that I have brahmin reciters, who shall play the lute?" She replied, "Your Majesty, there is a landowner who makes his living playing the lute — cover his eyes with a cloth and bring him inside." The king said, "Excellent, nurse — do exactly so and bring him in."

The king and the reciter ascended to the top of a seven-storied palace, and the reciter was told everything that had come to pass, yet he said nothing. The nurse covered the landowner's eyes with a cloth and placed him at the top of the seven-storied palace.

The daughter of the grey-robed ascetic, Tārā, having made all auspicious, propitious, and fortunate arrangements, and having dressed in white garments, mounted on the back of the king. The brahmin reciter began to chant the auspicious blessing. The landowner took up the lute. King Pracandarabha began to make the sound of a horse. The landowner then thought to himself:

"This building is seven stories high — how could anyone escape on horseback from up here? Without doubt, some woman has mocked a man like me who has fallen under a woman's sway." Thinking this, the landowner took up those words as a song:

Just as the branches of a pine are bent and bowed,
just as the branches of a pine are bent and bowed,
so too this matter is much the same —
so too this matter is much the same.

He sang on, not picking up the lute again, repeating the song again and again without interruption, speaking those very words of the song. The king then asked him: "Good fellow, what is the meaning of that song?" The landowner recounted everything that had come to pass. The king then thought, "He has seen through what I did — I must send him away from the land." So the king gave him five hundred kārṣāṇas and banished him from the country.

On another occasion, the royal reciter said to the king: "Sire, you have done something improper — kings ought not to fall under the sway of women." At those words the king said nothing whatsoever in reply.

The next day the king said to his attendant: "If today that brahmin were to be made to have his head shaved by his own wife, could you manage it?" The attendant looked around for a moment and said, "I can, Sire." The attendant then went home and said to his wife: "My dear, the brahmin reciter said such-and-such to the king, and now the king has commanded me to bring about an arrangement of this kind — to have that brahmin's head shaved by his own wife. Can you contrive it?" She replied: "My lord's son, what need is there to ask? Just watch and see — it has already been done." He said: "My dear, if that is so, very well. A cunning wife is cunning indeed." And so she began to befriend the brahmin's wife.

When the two of them had grown fond of one another, she said to the brahmin's wife: "My friend, my husband loves me deeply and does whatever I say." The brahmin's wife replied: "My friend, you imagine she can bear it? How could you possibly have the same power over your husband as he has over you?" The attendant's wife said: "My friend, if you think your husband is under your power, go ahead and shave his head." Emboldened by this taunt, the brahmin's wife said, "My friend, just wait and see!" — and with that she put on a soiled garment and lay down on a cot with a net canopy.

The reciter asked: "Brahmin's wife, what does this mean?" She replied: "Brahmin, I have angered the gods." He said: "Brahmin's wife, is there no one in your house? Whatever vows you made to the gods — fulfill them all, and you will be well." She said nothing. The reciter said: "Brahmin's wife, what did you vow to the gods?" She replied: "Brahmin, at the time when you were living as a brahmin and the god called to you, I prayed to the gods: 'If my husband returns home safely, I will shave his head and offer his hair to the gods.' And after that, fortune arose for you as well. But I forgot the vow, and now the gods are angered — in short, I am perishing." He said: "Brahmin's wife, that prayer you made to the gods was made on my account, so fulfill it — pray to the gods and accomplish everything." So she conveyed to the attendant's wife: "My husband says to pray to the gods and do it all." And she in turn sent word to the attendant: "My lord's son, the reciter's wife says to me: 'I made my husband agree, and he says — pray to the gods and do everything.'"

The attendant then spoke to the king: "The matter of the gods has been accomplished, my lord. The reciter has conveyed his compliance to me — please be informed of this." The king said: "That compliance was done for my sake — never mind, let it go." Before long, the reciter came to the king and said: "My lord, I will do something for the gods and I wish to come and visit the gods' presence in six months." The king said: "Good — do it just so." He went home and had his head shaved. But after shaving his head he simply stayed indoors. His wife sent word to the attendant's wife: "Friend, that husband of mine has had his head shaved." And she in turn informed the attendant. The attendant then spoke to the fierce king Prabha, who was greatly pleased and gave the order: "Summon that reciter."

The attendant then taught two young boys a song with these words:

Where there is a woman fair of form,
noble-born and continuing her line,
there, without a horse, a horse-sound rings —
look, O reciter, at your shaven head.

When the reciter came before the king wearing a hat, the two boys began to sing:

Where there is a woman fair of form,
noble-born and continuing her line,
there, without a horse, a horse-sound rings.

And then one of them snatched off the reciter's hat and sang:

Look, O reciter, at your shaven head.

At that, great laughter broke out. The reciter felt deeply ashamed, hung his head and left in disgrace, chin dropped to chest.

When the attendant had gotten what he needed from this, he began to harass them, saying: "Whoever falls under a woman's power like this — how can the king's interests be served?" The king then said to the reciter: "Learned one, are you capable of harassing that attendant?" He replied: "My lord, I will look for a chance — whether by day or by night — and do it." The attendant had a nephew who was skilled in illusion, and the attendant said to him: "If this uncle-by-marriage, the attendant, is put to shame before the king and his retinue, and if you are capable of humiliating him over it, then I shall be repaid in flesh." The nephew said: "Let me look and see whether it is possible or not, and then I will do it." Using illusion, he conjured a guest; from a pile of cloth he

conjured a house; and from a skull-bone he conjured the merchant's wife — beautiful, lovely, and ravishing to behold.

Now it was the king's custom that whenever a guest arrived, the king himself would cut a gambling portion for him, or else he would send the attendant. The attendant began cutting gambling portions for those guests, and he asked the guests: "Good people, which is the merchant's house?" They pointed and said: "It is this house, my lord." He entered it. Before long he saw the merchant's wife — beautiful, lovely to look upon, entrancing to the senses, stirring to the mind. The moment he saw her, desire arose in him. He said: "Good woman, if I enjoy pleasure with you, I will cut no gambling portion for the guests." She replied: "Young lord, if you do it in that way, then let it be — but only enjoy pleasure at night." Through illusion she appeared to him that night. He enjoyed pleasure with her, and after a time he embraced her around the neck and fell asleep. Then the illusionist withdrew the illusion, and there was the attendant, asleep and lying with his arms wrapped around a skeleton's neck amid a pile of cloth. The reciter then said to the king: "My lord, look at the condition to which the attendant has been brought by the gods."

The king went, having assembled many hundreds of thousands of living creatures to witness the scene. The king then woke the attendant by rattling a rattle, and when he had roused him he said: "Tell me — did you even eat the flesh of the woman with whom you took pleasure?" At that the attendant was seized with tremendous shame, rose up, and thought to himself: "If this king keeps questioning me while I am alive, then whatever comes of it, I would rather die by my own hand." Then he thought again: "To kill myself by my own hand is going too far. I will instead take ordination before the noble great Kātyāyana." With that he went to wherever the venerable great Kātyāyana was staying, and when he arrived he said to the venerable great Kātyāyana: "Noble one, I wish to go forth — I beg you, please ordain me with the going forth." Kātyāyana then gave him the going forth, conferred full ordination upon him, and had him recite the scriptural transmission that flows from one to the next.

The fierce king Prabhaśvara, finding him gone, became displeased. He had him removed from the going forth and reinstated in his former position exactly as before.

Now a summary verse:

The cowherd and the hunter himself,
the women and the king of the land of the dead,
the one given by the god of wealth, and Prabhaśvara,
the king who went to Śīlānikṣepa,
and the one who dreamed a dream — these are the last.

The fierce king Prabhaśvara, as he sat upon his great bed, gave rise to this thought: "If I were to pass away, would young Govarddhana be capable of ruling the kingdom, or would he not?" He thought further: "I should put this to the test for a while." He summoned the young man and said to him: "Son, there is a small matter to attend to in the queen's retinue. I will be inside the queen's retinue for seven days. In that interval, you act as king." Having so instructed him, the young man performed the duties of king while the fierce king Prabhaśvara remained within the queen's retinue.

Young Govarddhana, training himself well in the language of those who bring cases forward and those who oppose them, had the king's men who acted as go-betweens approach the men and women brought before him and ask each one individually: "Sir, do you desire this woman?" and of the women: "Do you desire this man?" — and if they showed mutual desire for one another, he then declared to the ministers: "Wise ones, if these two desire each other, why should I refuse them? Let no one under my rule say even a word against them living as they please together." Toward those who brought tribute payments he kept close and attentive watch.

When seven days had passed the king came out and asked the attendant: "Tell me, attendant — is young Govarddhana capable of ruling the kingdom after I am gone?" The attendant replied: "Your majesty, though lightning strikes above, those who act as go-betweens will flourish." The king said: "Attendant, what exactly is meant by acting and not acting as a go-between?" The attendant explained what the matter was, and the king thought: "Is this young man free of jealousy concerning other men's wives? Or does he hold the same attitude toward his own wife as well? I should test this." He instructed a territorial lord, saying: "Go, territorial lord, and enjoy pleasure together with young Govarddhana's wife." The territorial lord covered both ears and said: "Your majesty, this is ruination through wickedness!" The king said: "Territorial lord, the king's business stands as I have stated — go. If you do not proceed in order, the king's business will be undermined." The man replied: "Your majesty, though I will do it, I have no appetite for such a deed — but I will do it out of fear." The king said: "Then do it just so. When the time comes, territorial

lord, what method will you use?" The man replied: "Your majesty, I will prepare a spread of refreshments near her gathering place, offer them to her, become acquainted with her, and then carry out the royal command."

The king gave him funds, and with those funds he gathered goods and spread out a market stall. One of the handmaidens of the cowherd's wife came to buy incense sticks at the stall. The territorial lord asked the girl: "Young woman, for whom are these incense sticks?" She replied: "For the cowherd's wife, my mistress." "What is her name?" "Her name is such-and-such." The territorial lord said: "My own mother bears that very same name — she is like my mother," and he then discounted the price of the incense sticks and gave her a generous measure of goods. The cowherd's wife asked the girl: "Before, with that same amount of money you brought back only a little — why now have you brought back so much?" The girl told her everything as it had happened. The cowherd's wife said: "Excellent! He is like a son to me." This went on a second and a third time, and she grew fond of him.

On another occasion the territorial lord said to the girl: "Tell your mistress that I wish to come and pay my respects many times over." The girl did so, and the cowherd's wife said: "Good — tell him to come here." The girl conveyed this, and he came, bringing gifts of fragrant goods. He embraced her and wept. She asked: "My son, why do you weep?" He answered: "Dear lady, my own mother was of exactly your appearance and bearing, and it is for that reason that tears have come to me." She said: "My son, I myself am your mother — you are my son, so do not weep," and she grew all the more fond of him.

Some time later, when the cowherd's wife had gone off in one direction, he called her back and said: "Young woman, come and bow at your uncle's feet." She came. The cowherd's wife asked: "Mother, what is this girl's name?" "Her name is such-and-such." "Mother, my daughter-in-law also bears the same name and has the same appearance — she is my daughter-in-law!" He replied: "Excellent, my child."

When the two of them had grown intimate with each other, the territorial lord feigned illness and lay as if sick. The girl came to buy goods, and the territorial lord's young man said to her: "Young woman, my master is suffering from a certain illness — will the lady not come? She does not know he is sick." The girl replied: "I will do it." The cowherd's wife then came to visit and asked: "My son, how are you?" He said: "Dear lady, there is a peculiar heaviness in my body." She said: "My son, consult a physician and have an examination done."

He replied: "Dear lady, this is not an illness that can be healed by examination. There is something here that will cause me to die from this illness alone." She said: "My son, what do you have in mind — what means might cure this illness?" He said: "Dear lady, there is indeed a means by which it could be cured, but it is unattainable." She said: "My son, say what it is that is unattainable — everything will be provided." He said: "Dear lady, if I could enjoy pleasures together with the cowherd's queen, then this bodily heaviness would be healed."

At this she flew into a violent rage and said: "You wretch — you are finished! Do you want to enjoy pleasures together with the king's queen?" And she cursed him roundly, rose, and left.

Now, the territorial lord was a crafty man. He wrote down all his possessions in a register, and in that register he wrote the following: "Should I die, all my goods belong to the cowherd's wife."

He sent that register to her, and when she read it her anger subsided. She thought: "He has gone to such lengths just to win me over — if he comes now, he will love me all the more." And so, since it is in the very nature of women to be like this, she thought: "It would be wrong for him to die — I should help him." With that she summoned the girl and recited at length the praises of the territorial lord, then said: "My girl, your thread — is it still in that condition? Has it improved at all? And has a doctor been consulted? Has an examination been made?" He said: "My lady, his illness is of a curious kind — there is indeed a condition in which that very illness will bring him to his end. However, he says: 'If I could enjoy pleasures together with the bride, then I would survive.'" At this she flew into a rage and said: "You wretch — is he at death's door, and he still wants to enjoy pleasures with the king's queen?" He said: "My lady, do you know from whom your own garment was born?" She said: "I do not know." "That girl was born from a wicked man who became a king and held a great army. Your husband too is the son of a merchant who will in turn become a king. You too should enjoy pleasures together with him, and whatever son comes from you will also become a king." So she was deceived by him, and she agreed. Then he sent word to the territorial lord's boy: "Son, this girl has agreed, but she may yet cause you harm, so be alert to the timing and come quickly."

The territorial lord sent a message to the king: "Your god's wish is accomplished — but please, for a little while, do not send the cowherd away."

The king thought: "After I am gone, the young cowherd will become king, and after him his son will be king. If a son is born to the cowherd's wife by the territorial lord, that son would become king. Therefore I must give him a medicine of such a kind that the territorial lord's faculties cannot become seed." With that in mind, he sent him certain pills that prevent the faculties from becoming seed, and sent word: "Territorial lord, at the moment when you enjoy pleasures together with the young cowherd's wife, you are to eat these pills."

He also instructed the cowherd: "There is a small matter of business to discuss — do not go home just yet." And so he stayed. The territorial lord ate the pills that prevent the faculties from becoming seed, then enjoyed pleasures with the cowherd's wife, and exhausted with the bliss of desire, fell asleep with his arms wrapped around her neck.

The king thought: "He has enjoyed pleasures with her and gone — I should send the young man home now." So he said to the young cowherd: "Son, the bride will be displeased — do not stay long, go home." When he arrived home, he found his wife sitting together with another man, and he saw the arm of that territorial lord hanging loosely. He folded that arm up, thinking: "Some people are going to notice this," and covered them with a garment.

The territorial lord slept on until dawn broke. When the sun rose he woke up, and wondering whether he had been seen or not, he ran off. The king said to the cowherd: "Son, last night in my dream I saw your wife enjoying pleasures together with another man." The god replied: "What your majesty saw in a dream, I witnessed directly, in person." "How so?" And he then recounted in full how it had come about.

The king said: "Son, are you not jealous?" The god answered: "I am not, my lord." "Son, why is that?" "My lord, I naturally remember my past lives. In another life of mine long ago, I was a merchant captain's wife —"

That merchant captain had fallen into ruin and set out for another land, and I said to him, "My lord, I too shall come with you." He replied, "Who will look after you here?" He refused to take me along, and I wept. The dairy folk then said to me, "Merchant captain's wife, why are you crying?" I told them what had happened, and they said, "Lead the merchant captain here and we will look after you," whereupon he brought me along. But as we traveled the road, some five hundred brigands appeared and fell upon those travelers, slew the merchant captain, and those five hundred brigands used me for their pleasure.

When they found another woman among the travelers they had killed, I thought, "This one will become my rival," so I threw the old one away and that very instant perished.

My lord, seeing that I was used for pleasure by five hundred brigands and yet was not satisfied, what jealousy could I possibly feel toward women? My lord, moreover, anyone in the world who places trust in women is a fool. It is only right that women place trust in men.

The king said: "Son, that is exactly so. Women ought to place their trust in men."

In the land of Āryāvarta there lived a hunter whose wife was beautiful and lovely to behold, and he was deeply attached to her. He thought: "If I leave my wife and go off to dwell in a forest retreat, she will end up enjoying pleasure with another man. But if I do not go, I am a hunter — I make my living by taking others' lives and sustaining myself by killing. I am not a farmer, I am not a merchant, and no one else will support me either, so I will certainly starve to death. So I had better take my wife with me as I go." He took his wife, went to a forest retreat, built a leaf shelter in a certain spot, and stayed there. He would choose the finest wild game, kill it, sell the good meat, and make his living that way.

Then one day the ferocious king Rabsang went out on a hunt, and his horse bolted and galloped off in that direction. The hunter recognized the king, and knowing that the horse had bolted, used all manner of welcoming words to attend to him, and the king dismounted and sat down at the foot of a tree.

The hunter thought: "My due — the tribute of game flesh I owe the royally consecrated king of the warrior caste — is no debt yet fallen due, so I shall bring him some other game not yet owed." He strung his arrow, took his bow in hand, and went off in pursuit of the game.

King Rabsang, ferocious as he was, caught sight of the hunter's wife, who was beautiful and in the full bloom of youth. Overpowered by the force of violent affliction, he gave rise to lustful desire and at once committed adultery with that hunter's wife on the spot. When the hunter had killed the game and was returning, he came upon his wife in the very act of being violated. Now, among the reasons for anger, anger on account of women is the decisive kind, and so he fell into fury and thought: "This wicked-times king who has transgressed the royal law — I will kill him." Then again he thought: "Should I kill him merely on account of a woman?" While he was turning this over in his mind he had not

yet decided, when he came face to face with a lion, and the lion killed him. Because he had aroused a mind of loving-kindness toward King Rabsang, he was reborn, upon dying, among the gods of the realm of the Four Great Kings. King Rabsang thought: "I have enjoyed this woman, and when her husband's time is past and he is gone, to abandon her would not be proper on my part" — and so he kept her close and stayed there conversing pleasantly with her. After some time, his ministers, young men, and the troops of the town began searching here and there and made their way to that place. They asked: "Your Majesty, to whom does this woman belong?" He replied: "I am the king — who would present a woman to me? From this day forward, place her among the queen's retinue." And they placed her among the queen's retinue. The king then departed with his army and cavalry and train of attendants as he pleased, and proceeded to the Noble Kingdom; and there the queen's retinue grew very large indeed.

The Blessed One then said: "I have not rightly seen even a single phenomenon that changes as swiftly as the mind." When King Tumpo Rabsang saw how vast the queen's retinue had become, he thought: "If that afflicted hunter took just one wife to a remote wilderness and could not even keep her safe, what need is there to speak of my guarding a retinue of queens so exceedingly large?" And so he had it proclaimed throughout the Noble Kingdom in these words: "Listen, all you wise people dwelling in the Noble Kingdom, all you city-dwellers, and all you crowds of people who have come from various lands. I am sending the queens of my retinue to enjoy themselves however they please. Whoever fully enjoys the company of the queens shall be said to have done well." And to the queen's retinue he also issued this command: "You too, each of you, go and enjoy yourselves with other men, and any woman who does not return when the drum is beaten will have her head cut off from her shoulders and flung to the ground."

Now since all women desire men, what need is there to speak of the king's own retinue of queens? They roamed everywhere throughout the Noble Kingdom, and each woman, upon seeing whatever man she saw, began to amuse herself with him. However, Śānti, the wife of the cowherd Balangskyong, and Drölma, the daughter of the gray-robed ascetic, out of their especially deep affection for King Tumpo Rabsang, did not lose their respect for the king and did not go. The king said to Śānti: "Śānti, you too, go and amuse yourself with other men." She replied: "Your Majesty, I was sent by a god — I will not amuse myself with another man." He then said to Drölma, the

gray-robed ascetic's daughter: "You, go!" Now she was young and of an unsteady nature, and so, desiring another man, she consented and went down the street.

As she was wandering about, she saw a perfume-seller's apprentice boy and said to him: "Come, let us amuse ourselves together." He replied: "First hold this lamp for me while I finish reckoning these accounts, and then afterward we shall amuse ourselves." So she held the lamp and stood there. The perfume-seller's boy was busy calculating: "I made this much profit from this, and this much is to be given to such-and-such a person," and he gave her no thought at all — and so it went on until dawn came. When the drum was beaten at the royal palace, the daughter of the gray-robed ascetic set the lamp down on the ground and left. He said: "Stay and amuse yourself!" She replied: "How should I amuse myself? The king has established this law: any woman who does not return when the drum is beaten will have her head cut off from her shoulders and flung to the ground. The drum has now already been beaten — do I have two heads that I should go?" And so she returned without having amused herself at all.

The king asked: "Drölma, did you amuse yourself?" She replied: "Your Majesty, I did not." "Why not?" he asked.

She told him what had happened, and the king said nothing more.

Once again the king made the same proclamation by drum, and the announcement spread everywhere: "King Fierce Blazing Light grants, as his queen's retinue desires, the enjoyment of men." The son of the king of Kauśāmbī heard how King Fierce Blazing Light had granted the enjoyment of men as his queen's retinue desired. Having heard this, he said to Śabara: "Śabara, it is proclaimed that King Fierce Blazing Light grants the enjoyment of men as his queen's retinue desires. Let us go together and enjoy ourselves with the retinue of Queen Fierce Blazing Light." Śabara said: "Your Majesty, King Fierce Blazing Light is your longstanding enemy — he has been trying to kill you — and if you go there and meet with him, there is every reason to fear harm." The prince replied: "Śabara, there are foolish men in this world, but you stay here — I shall go." Śabara said: "If Your Majesty is determined to go, though Your Majesty may have no fear, it is still fitting to take care." Now the son of the king of the East was extremely lustful toward women, and so, dismissing Śabara's words, he went to the Noble Palace. There the daughter of the gray-robed ascetic saw that he was handsome, fine-looking, and beautiful.

Seeing him, she said: "O prince, come here — let us enjoy ourselves together with Drölma, daughter of the gray-robed ascetic." He said: "You make the bed." She replied: "You make the bed." And since both of them were haughty and full of pride, the son of the king of the East did not make the bed, and the daughter of the gray-robed ascetic, Drölma, likewise did not make it. They went on saying "You make it — I will not," until dawn came. When the drum was beaten at the royal palace, the daughter of the gray-robed ascetic, Drölma, left. The son of the king of the East said: "Stay and let us amuse ourselves!" But the daughter of the gray-robed ascetic, Drölma, said: "How am I to amuse myself? The king has established this law: any woman who does not return when the drum is beaten will have her head cut off from her shoulders and flung to the ground. The drum has already been beaten — do I have two heads that I should stay?" And so, without having amused herself at all, she pulled the ring from the finger of the son of the king of the East and left.

The king asked: "Drölma, did you amuse yourself?" She said: "Your Majesty, I did not." "Why did you not amuse yourself?" She recounted everything that had happened, then displayed the ring and said: "Your Majesty, I have come bearing this ring of his." King Fierce Blazing Light read the inscription on the ring and summoned Gosā, saying: "Gosā, the son of the king of the East arrived here with a great army and no one noticed. He desired my queen's retinue — how is it that you let him slip away?" Gosā replied: "Your Majesty, he arrived here undetected — what can be done about that now? But if he comes again, he will not be tolerated."

Thereupon King Fierce Blazing Light again made the same announcement by drum. The son of the king of the East heard it in the same way and said to Śabara: "Śabara, it is proclaimed again that King Fierce Blazing Light grants the enjoyment of men as his queen's retinue desires. Come along — let us go and enjoy ourselves with the retinue of Queen Fierce Blazing Light." But Śabara said: "Your Majesty, last time you went there undetected and returned safely. But now King Fierce Blazing Light is prepared and ready — it would be better not to go."

The Eastern king's son said: "Among the men who bear weapons there are some who are careless and inattentive — I will go." And so he went, and the weapon-bearing men had also been sent out by the king's order. The son of the king of the East made his way gradually into the royal city and entered a certain house. The guards there — men armed with drawn swords — had

surrounded it on all sides, and he gave them this instruction: "Good men, if a woman comes out, let her pass. But if a man comes out, do not let him go."

Śabara perceived what was happening and thought to himself: "That I abandoned my lord in his hour of need — leaving him to his fear and anxiety about the king's terrible wrath — that was not right on my part." And so he dressed the king in ordinary women's clothing and ornaments, then had him carry a water pot and drew a garment over his head with a spindle, and, teasing him playfully, said: "God, if you do not bring water to drink and do not come back, the river will carry you off!" — and with that he pushed him outside. The king's men thought he was just a maidservant being sent on an errand and let him go. Śabara then threw the water pot down by a small pond and fled.

When the guards checked that house and realized in a moment that he had escaped, they seized Śabara, brought him before King Fierce Blazing Light, and said: "Your Majesty, this man-god sent away the son of the king of the East." Śabara said: "Your Majesty, I had used his food and clothing for myself, and that I sent him away was the right thing for me to do. But in his case — he had used your food and clothing for himself, and then when he was sent away he simply wandered off and deserted you. That was not right." When Śabara said this, King Fierce Blazing Light became furious with the guards and said: "Guards! Was it right that the son of the king of the East be allowed to slip away with what my queen's retinue desired? Therefore, if you bring the son of the king of the East back here right now, all will be well. But if you do not bring him, I will cut you down with a heavy punishment." Terrified, they sat there scheming about how to capture him.

Before long a master of the art of mechanical automata (yantra) came from the south. The guards asked him: "Good man, are you able to construct an automaton of such and such a kind?" He replied: "Your Majesty, I will undertake it gladly." The guards hid the lead elephant — the great elephant known as the Hill of the Muddy Reed — in a secluded place, and had it cried out through the royal city: "The lead elephant, the great elephant of the Hill of the Muddy Reed, has fled!" At that moment the sound of this proclamation spread in all directions far and wide. Then the guards said to the master of automaton-craft: "Make an automaton of just this kind!" And he built an automaton made to look exactly like the Hill of the Muddy Reed, the great elephant, placed five hundred men inside it, and loaded it with a great quantity of elephant dung and water. Then he instructed those men: "By

whatever means, drive this automaton in such a way that it appears before the eyes of those who dwell in the vicinity of Kauśāmbī. If the son of the king of the East comes forth with a fourfold army, do not give him into their hands. But if he comes alone, seize him by both hands and bring him back here without delay." Those men drove the automaton along so well that it looked convincingly like the vicinity of Kauśāmbī, and the cowherds, cowherd women, grass-cutters, wood-cutters, those who lived by the road, and wayfarers all stared wide-eyed in astonishment and gathered around to look. Some among them said: "Good people, this is the rogue lead elephant!"

Others said: "This is no rogue elephant — it is the chief of the herd of King Tumpo Rabnang of the noble realm of Ārya, the one named Damburi Mountain, who ran away; that is what has come here."

Then some of them went to the king of the East and announced: "Your Majesty, the one that had been the chief of the elephant herd of King Tumpo Rabnang who dwells in the noble realm, the one named Damburi Mountain who had fled — by the power of Your Majesty's merit, it has arrived here, appearing like many hundreds and thousands of living creatures." When the son of the king of the East heard this, joy and gladness arose in him. He beat the drum of rejoicing, had the pair of conches sounded, and commanded his general: "Go, array the fourfold host of troops, and have the city drums beaten with this proclamation: to all who dwell in the city and to all the multitudes of people who have come from various lands, the king goes to take hold of the elephant chief Damburi Mountain — come, bearing all manner of weapons and ropes!" The general arrayed the fourfold host of troops and had the city drums beaten with this proclamation: "Listen, all you wise ones who dwell in the city, all who dwell in the palace and its environs, and all the multitudes of people who have come from various lands — the king commands: the king goes to seize the elephant chief Damburi Mountain; come, bearing all manner of weapons and ropes!" And so it was proclaimed.

Then the son of the king of the East set out toward the elephant chief Damburi Mountain together with the fourfold host of troops and many thousands of the finest men. The operators of the automaton drove it in such a way as to make it appear that the fabricated likeness of the elephant chief Damburi Mountain was beginning to flee, and so they drove the automaton forward. The ministers said: "Your Majesty, you yourself are skilled in the rites of elephant-keeping; please devise a means to make this elephant flee, and apply it yourself." The king commanded his general: "You keep the fourfold host of troops back — I

myself will approach it by skillful means." The general held the fourfold host of troops back, and the king himself began to approach, playing a pleasing lute melody and drawing near. The operators of the automaton drove it so that the automaton went straight toward the son of the king of the East and came to rest there. Then those five hundred men emerged from the automaton and seized him. Having seized him, they placed him inside the automaton, and drove it away as swiftly as the force of the wind. The son of the king of the East had been taken.

"The son of the king of the East has been taken!" — when the ministers spread this cry on all sides, the many hundreds and thousands of living creatures and the fourfold host of troops began to give chase. When they had passed beyond a certain critical distance, the general said: "Wise ones, the king has already been taken away — think of some other plan and turn back." And they all turned back.

The son of the king of the East was brought to the noble realm and looked after. He was then presented to King Tumpo Rabnang, and it was said: "Your Majesty, this is the son of the king of the East." The king beat the drum of rejoicing, had the pair of conches sounded, and gathered the many suffering living creatures of villages, towns, market settlements, and roadsides. Then he commanded the keepers: "I am releasing the son of the king of the East — tend to him." The ministers said: "Your Majesty, this prince is skilled in the rites of elephant-keeping; if he is killed, the tradition of elephant-keeping will be lost. Therefore, for the time being, Your Majesty should please learn the rites of elephant-keeping from him."

"We shall do just as Your Majesty commands." The king said: "Keeper, if that is so, then learn the rites of elephant-keeping from him. But once I have learned the rites of elephant-keeping from him and he has become my teacher, how could I then have my own teacher put to death?" The keeper said: "Your Majesty, the same fault would fall upon me as well — that would not be right." The king said: "Keeper, if that is so, who should be made to learn from him, so that I may then learn from that person?" The keeper said: "Your Majesty, your daughter Norha Jin is without idleness, possessed of diligence, learned, and accomplished. Have her be the one to learn from him, and she in turn shall teach Your Majesty."

The fierce king Rab Nang then said to Norha Jin: "My daughter, that man has eighteen ugly marks, yet he is skilled in the rites of elephant-keeping.

Therefore, you shall separate yourself from him by a screen, learn the rites of elephant-keeping from him, and afterward teach them to me. You must not look at him at all — if you see him, bad luck will befall you, and you will die." And so she separated herself by a screen and began to learn the rites of elephant-keeping from him.

Jungwa Chang thought to himself: "If His Majesty searches for me and I am still alive, I should think of a means of escape. If, however, I have died and passed my time, another will be consecrated as king." He then spoke to his sister, whose name was Sertrengchen, who was even more skilled in deception than Jungwa Chang himself: "Sister, go to the Noble Kingdom, make haste there, and search everywhere for the king. If he is still alive, think of some means of his escape. If he has died and passed his time, let another be consecrated as king." She said nothing in reply to this, accepting it in silence, and then, disguising herself in the garb of a wanderer, she set out for the Noble Kingdom.

She sat at the king's gate and asked the king's men: "Good people, is the son of the king of the East alive or dead?" The king's men said: "Ask the monk who is just inside — what harm did he do to you?" She said: "Good people, he separated my husband and children from their lives and seized all my goods and wealth." They said: "That monk has not yet passed his time. He is teaching the rites of elephant-keeping to the king's daughter Norha Jin." In the same way she asked the king's men at the four gates of the palace, and in each case they gave the same reply.

By those very stratagems she gained entry inside. When she saw the son of the king of the East, she looked in all four directions and quietly asked: "Is His Majesty still alive?" And he too, feeling shame and inward unhappiness, looked in all four directions and said: "Sister, you are alive." Having thus made direct contact, she used another stratagem and, catching sight of Norha Jin, said: "My daughter, from whom are you learning the rites of elephant-keeping?" She replied: "There is an old woman possessed of eighteen ugly marks, and I am learning from her, separated by a screen." He said: "There is no one here whatsoever who possesses eighteen ugly marks. The one from whom you are learning is the son of the king of the East — handsome, beautiful, lovely to behold, endowed with all fine marks. Who has deceived you with such a tale? If you do not believe me, open the screen and look." Upon hearing a description of his form and his youth, she felt faith arise, opened the screen, and saw him. The very instant she saw him, she was agitated by desire as though stirred by

the force of a gust of wind, and she said: "Old woman, whatever you have said may be as it is, but there is a request I have to make."

"Will you arrange for me to meet with him?" The old woman replied: "Daughter, I will accomplish exactly what you wish. Wherever one wanders, it is difficult enough to encounter a man such as this — how much more need be said of your bringing such an improper request to me!"

The Vinaya, the fourth, resides here.

The Minor Vinaya Topics, the twenty-eighth fascicle.

"Your desire shall be fulfilled — you will meet with a king, a sovereign of the royal lineage, anointed by consecration from the crown of the head. I will arrange your meeting with him." She then brought her together with the son of the eastern king. Dattā (Nora Lhé Jin) and he became deeply attached to one another. Suvarṇamālā (the Golden Garland One) maintained the liaison while the god lived on. The fierce and brilliant king sent word to Dattā: "The princess is to be taught the elephant ceremony." She then concealed her five ornaments, dressed herself in ragged clothing, took the name Vasantī (the Spring One), and went to the royal capital in the guise of a madwoman. There in the great roads, the market streets, the crossroads, and the three-way junctions, she ran and leaped about, calling out the mad words: "I am Vasantī — how delightful!" Those who recognized her as the one maintaining the liaison she rewarded with ornaments, and they took them and went away without saying a word. Those who did not recognize her dismissed her, thinking: "This one is mad." Wherever she entered — the royal palace, its environs, and fine houses — she found food, flowers, and clothing, and she secretly made common counsel with the eastern prince.

When another time came, Dattā said to the son of the eastern king: "My lord, if my father notices, flee here quickly." He replied: "My lady, if it should come to that, go to your father and say this: 'Father, I have learned the elephant ceremony, and yet I see no work to be done with it. For that reason, please grant me a fine, well-trained elephant to do with as I please, so that I may practice with it and examine its capabilities.'" She went and spoke to the king accordingly. King Caṇḍapradīyā then commanded the elephant keepers: "Knowledgeable ones, give the princess Dattā the fine, well-trained she-elephant to do with as she pleases, and let her ride it to examine its capabilities." They gave it to her to do with entirely as she wished, and together with the son of the eastern king, she mounted it and began plotting

escape. Sometimes she went out in the morning and returned at midday; sometimes she went at midday and returned in the afternoon; sometimes she went in the afternoon and returned in the evening; sometimes she went in the evening and returned at midnight; sometimes she returned at the third watch of the night; sometimes at the fifth watch; sometimes in the small hours; and sometimes at the breaking of dawn.

When the eastern prince, who maintained the liaison, had described the plan of escape to her, she began removing the elephant's dung. The grooms said: "Vasantī, what is this for?" She replied: "Knowledgeable ones, I have made this an offering to the king — take it there, and it will become sacred food." At that they laughed, thinking: "This one is mad," and said nothing more. She then carried the dung and hung it on the branches of trees along the road to Kauśāmbī. Then she began filling pots with the elephant's urine and carrying them away. The grooms asked the same question as before. She replied: "Knowledgeable ones, I have made this an offering to the king — this will become a libation there." They laughed in the same way, thinking: "She is mad," and left it alone.

She likewise carried it and hung it on the branches of trees along the road to Kauśāmbī.

Now, the prince of King Śarva, along with Holder-of-the-Bow and Golden-Garland, had set a time, agreeing to assemble at a certain place on a certain great day of the sun. The prince of King Śarva mounted the great elephant Bhadravatī, who had been given by the god of wealth, and set off toward that place. Holder-of-the-Bow and Golden-Garland likewise mounted that same elephant, and as they went along enjoying pleasant melodies, the prince of King Śarva took up a musical refrain, and Holder-of-the-Bow, delighted, broke into song:

Bhadravatī and Sweet-Voiced,
Dhanavardhana and Śarva's son,
Golden-Garland and Spring-Blessed —
all these journey toward the same aim.

Whatever time it is when they return, may that time come swiftly. Whatever final moment there may be, may it also pass —

and he spoke to fierce King Pradyota, who had revived him: "Revived one, Dhanavardhana — what has become of him now?" The revived one began to search, but could not find him, and so he said to the king: "The prince of King

Śarva seized the great elephant Bhadravatī and fled, taking Dhanavardhana with him." The king was startled and said: "Revived one, go quickly — mount the marsh-land elephant and bring back Śarva's son and Dhanavardhana." He mounted the marsh-land elephant and chased them for a long distance.

He pursued them and caught up with them. Then Holder-of-the-Bow untied the bundle of the elephant's dung, and the marsh-land elephant began trying to eat it. For as long as it was eating, the great elephant Bhadravatī gained a distance of ten leagues. Again the marsh-land elephant caught up with them, and Holder-of-the-Bow poured out a single pot of the urine, and the marsh-land elephant began trying to drink it. For as long as it was drinking, the great elephant Bhadravatī gained another ten leagues, and they passed into foreign territory. The revived one then thought: "This is foreign territory; I will lose the marsh-land elephant too if I go further" — and at that decided it was hopeless, and turned back.

King Pradyota asked: "Revived one, what news?" He replied: "Your Majesty, there is nothing for it — they have fled." The king rested his hand against his cheek and sat sunk in thought.

The prince of King Śarva, having recovered from his brush with death, came to Kauśāmbī and gave gifts to ascetics, brahmins, the poor, the destitute, friends, brothers, and kinsmen, held a great feast, and together with Dhanavardhana played and rejoiced and took pleasure in merriment.

On another occasion, the two of them went up to the roof of a fine mansion and sat there exchanging private conversation. He said: "My lady, you too were stolen away from me by that trick." She said: "My lord, and you likewise were seized and held by my father through his stratagem." He said: "My lady, if your father is not summoned here and put to work learning the rope-maker's trade, then I am no longer the son of King Śarva" — and she, though angry, said nothing.

King Śarva said to Holder-of-the-Bow: "Are you able to dispel my displeasure? My lord, what should I do?" She said: "Seize King Pradyota by the neck, bring him here, and put him to work learning the rope-maker's trade." He said: "My lord, when you seized Dhanavardhana and the great elephant Bhadravatī, that in itself was sufficient to dispel your displeasure. Nevertheless, if you have truly thought this through and insist upon it, I will do it" — and so saying, she made preparations for caravans traveling to the noble realm and inspired the caravan leader with enthusiasm.

A courtesan of fine form and youthful beauty, adorned with varied ornaments, was made to pose as the caravan leader's wife, and they made their way gradually through villages, towns, districts, and royal palaces, surveying the markets as they went, until they arrived in the noble realm.

King Pradyota heard that a wealthy caravan leader had arrived, possessed of great riches. Being covetous by nature, he went himself to inquire of the travelers: "Friends, which is the caravan leader's house?" They pointed it out to him, and the king went there. Standing at the door, he asked where the caravan leader was. They replied: "He has just gone out." He said: "Then who is inside?" They answered: "The caravan leader's wife is within." He pushed the door wide open and entered, and the moment he did so he beheld the caravan leader's wife — a woman of such surpassing beauty and youth that she outshone every woman in all the noble realm. The sight of her kindled in him a fierce passion, and he said: "Fair one, share pleasure with me, and I will give you the caravan leader's dice." She replied: "If that is so, sit here on this bed." Now there is nothing a man corrupted by attachment will not do, and so he sat down there — whereupon the king's men blocked the door, bundled him into a palanquin, lifted it on the shoulders of four men, and singing as they went, they carried him out through a single gate and into the noble realm.

Some among the onlookers clapped their hands, some laughed, and some sang this song:

The moon was swallowed by the wasps.

Vaiśravaṇa's steward drove him on.

Earth and forest soared into the sky.

The courtesan led Pradyota away.

The inhabitants of the noble realm wondered why the merchants were saying such things. But the travelers came out through a different gate, cut short their disguises, fled, and made good their escape. The scouts, meanwhile, searched in all directions for the king, and in this way they eventually made their way back to Kauśāmbī.

The ministers said to King Śarva: "May the king rejoice — King Pradyota has been brought here and captured." King Śarva commanded: "Friends, seize him today and set him to learning the rope-maker's trade. As for King Pradyota's arrival here — let it be established as law that the god Dhanavardhana has given this, and that no one is to say a word about it."

Now some time after this, King Śarva's son Dhanavardhana was seated up on the roof of a fine mansion together with his companions when King Pradyota came out through the door of the weaving workshop on some errand. King Śarva caught sight of him and said to Dhanavardhana: "That man over there — do you know who he is?" Dhanavardhana looked for a long time and, recognizing the king from his bare crown, sat there with tears streaming down his face. He thought to himself: "This wicked king has brought my father to such a condition as this. If I do not kill this wicked king, I am no son of Dhanavardhana. And I will kill him in such a way that he himself does not know he has been killed."

Now that king too was a man of sharp mind, and perceiving that Dhanavardhana was angry, he summoned his attendant and gave instructions: "Attendant, go and make peace with the enemy — gain his trust — and then release King Pradyota, bathe him, feed him, honor him with great ceremony, and escort him back to the noble realm." The attendant carried out this command and escorted him back to the noble realm.

Dhanavardhana thought to himself: "If I begin plotting to kill him here, that deceitful one will see through it and we shall come to blows — so let me distract him for a little while." And so he engaged him with some light conversation, with laughter and play, and —

— distracted him with pleasures and merriment.

Now, there was a queen who was wearing soiled garments and lying on a net-covered cot. The son of King Śarva spoke to her: "My lady, what is the matter?" She replied: "My lord, the gods are in turmoil." He said: "My lady, can you not calm them? Let someone else fulfill whatever vow you have made." She replied: "My lord, the vow I have made cannot be undone. When my father took my lord captive and kept him confined, I made a vow to my lord, saying: 'If my lord and I might travel together in safety and happiness to Kauśāmbī, then there, for seven days, my lord and I shall eat no food together, and when the seven days have passed, my lord shall be wrapped in flower garlands from the tips of his toes to the crown of his head and seated at the gate of the enclosure; and I, having completed my austerities, shall give food to a thousand brahmins and honor them with great ceremony and reverence.' That was the vow I made. But now the retinue of the queen's household has grown very large, and I was wondering to myself why things would be done in this manner — and in short, my lord, it has been lost." The king replied: "My lady,

the request you made to the god was in truth made entirely on my account. Be at ease — everything shall be accomplished." With that, she rose, tied two young dogs at the gate of the enclosure, and from that time forward, day by day, fed them ever-increasing portions of meat, however much they were capable of eating. Once the two young dogs were able to eat that much meat, she remained with the king for the full seven days — and during those seven nights she herself ate only at night. As for King Śarva's son, out of his attachment to that wife, he did not eat for seven days, and as a result his complexion became pale and wan, his flesh wasted, his vitality diminished, and he grew haggard and faint.

When the seven days were complete, Dhanavardhana gave instructions to those skilled in threading and stringing flower garlands: "Have those well-acquainted with the matter quickly bring fragrant, beautiful flowers and come here." He also gave instructions to the one who held the provisions: "Today the god's austerities are fulfilled — adorn the city beautifully and prepare food for a thousand brahmins, together with the king, the queen, the retinue, the young attendants, the ministers, and the assembled citizens of the city." As for the other ministers, so that they would notice nothing, he assigned them to various other tasks in various other places. The keeper of the provisions, being close to the king and devoted to him, cleared the city of stones, pebbles, and gravel, sprinkled sandalwood water all about, set out censers of sweet-smelling incense, raised banners and victory standards, hung strings of pearls, swags of silk, and tinkling ornaments, and spread flowers of every kind in profusion, making the whole place as delightful and joyous as the pleasure gardens of the gods. Throughout every quarter and every corner, various sounds of music were proclaimed, and dancers, poets, and skilled performers of every kind began to dance and perform.

When this great festivity and commotion was at its height, Dhanavardhana had King Śarva's son wrapped in flowers from the tips of his toes to the crown of his head and pushed off the top of the enclosure wall. Scarcely had he fallen before he was alive no longer — the dogs left nothing but a skeleton. Then crows, vultures, jackals, and other creatures that feed on human corpses fought over what remained.

All of Kauśāmbī resounded with a great cry: "The god has fallen from the top of the enclosure wall while gazing out at the beautiful city — and the dogs have eaten him!" At that, some wept, some rejoiced, and some sat in indifference.

Some among the people began to loot and plunder. When the great clamor broke out, the monks who had been residing in Kauśāmbī each fled for themselves: some went to Śrāvastī, and some went to one distant place or another. At that point, the commander-in-arms, the other ministers, the leading men of Kauśāmbī, the brahmins, and the householders quieted the uproar. Then the commander-in-arms began a thorough investigation into how the king had come to go to the top of the enclosure wall, and how the dogs came to be gathered at the foot of that wall. Through this investigation the truth came to light: Dhanavardhana had used a stratagem to commit the murder. Enraged, the commander-in-arms had Dhanavardhana locked inside a house of lac and burned alive.

The monks were filled with doubt, and in order to resolve all their doubts they put a question to the buddha, the Blessed One: "Venerable one, what deed had King Śarva's son done, such that through the ripening of that karma he was devoured by dogs and died before his time?" The Blessed One declared: "Monks, King Śarva's son accumulated a mass of karma and, like conditions ripening as they do, what was resting close at hand inevitably came to pass — for what he had done and accumulated was inescapable. Monks, by whom else could what King Śarva's son had done and accumulated be separately experienced? Monks, the karma that has been done and accumulated does not ripen in the outer element of earth, nor in the element of water, nor in the element of fire, nor in the element of wind. Rather, the virtuous and non-virtuous deeds that have been performed ripen solely within the acquired aggregates (skandhas), elements (dhātus), and sense bases (āyatanas). As it is said in verse:

Even across hundreds of aeons,
karma does not perish.
When the conditions and the time converge,
the fruit ripens for embodied beings.

Monks, long ago there was a reciter of vedic texts who lived near a certain mountain. At a time when no buddha had appeared in the world, a pratyekabuddha — one who takes compassion on the impoverished and the lowly, who delights in remote dwelling places at the forest's edge, and who serves as a singular field of generosity for the world — was wandering through the regions and arrived at that mountain. He stayed there for one night. The following morning, that reciter of vedic texts donned his lower robe and outer robe, took up his alms bowl, and entered that mountain village to collect alms.

As the man came out again with his dog on a leash, he set the dog upon that great and venerable pratyekabuddha — who was utterly blameless and would harm no one.

Now monks, what do you think? That reciter of vedic texts was none other than King Śarva's son himself. Through the ripening of the karma of having set a dog upon that blameless, harmless pratyekabuddha at that time, in that place, he was devoured by dogs and died before his time five hundred lifetimes in succession — and even now he has been devoured by dogs and died before his time.

Therefore, monks, the ripening of karma that is wholly dark is itself wholly dark; the ripening of karma that is wholly bright is wholly bright; and the ripening of what is mixed is itself mixed. Therefore, monks, having abandoned karma that is wholly dark or mixed, strive exclusively for karma that is wholly bright. Monks, you should train accordingly."

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

After King Śarva's son had died, a king who was fierce, radiant as the sun, and without rival came to rule as king in his place.

Then, at another time, he came up to the roof of a fine mansion and sat surrounded by a throng of ministers, and they spoke words that were not proper. They said: "O wise ones, in what town, city, or place is there a beautiful courtesan?"

The ministers replied: "O king, if you must know, there is a courtesan of beauty and youth who is skilled in the sixty-four arts, and there is no one on earth who, upon seeing her, would not instantly become enamored. There she is, constantly at the pleasure quarter."

King Rabhasa Prabhā, upon hearing of her beauty and youth, became instantly smitten and said: "Whatever care is taken, it is useless. I must go to take pleasure with a woman of that kind. Go to the pleasure quarter and take delight with her."

One of those present said: "O king, the one known as Lotus-Hearted has long been your enemy, your opponent, your adversary. He is always at the pleasure quarter. If you go there, he will certainly bring ruin upon you."

The king replied: "There may well be faint-hearted men among people, but you stay here. I shall go."

That one said: "If it is the king's pleasure, the king knows best — yet it would be wise to be careful."

But King Rabhasa Prabhā, being gripped by lust for the woman, did not heed those words. He mounted his finest elephant named Dambha and set out for the pleasure quarter. Proceeding along the way, he arrived at Sandal Wood Mountain, and there he left behind his finest elephant Dambha and proceeded on to the pleasure quarter. Then, removing from the neck of a young hill-man a pearl necklace worth a hundred thousand, he went into the dwelling of the beautiful woman who lived by her form, and there he played with her, rejoiced with her, and took pleasure with her.

The brahmins and householders who dwelt in the noble realm of Āryā, wise men all, began to wonder where the king had gone since he was nowhere to be seen. Some of them said: "What is strange about this? He is simply somewhere out of sight and will appear again soon. He has not gone anywhere." Others said: "He has a great retinue of queens, so why would he come outside? He is taking his enjoyment and amusement privately within the queen's quarters." Some said: "Why doubt it? Come, let us go and inquire of the minister." Some said "Very well, let us do so," and so they all gathered together and went to the minister and asked: "Minister, where has the king gone, since he cannot be found?"

He replied: "Wise ones, you will see him before long."

They asked: "Minister, when will we see him?"

He said: "After twelve years have passed."

They grew angry and said: "Minister, you speak that way only because you surely intend to kill the king and seize the royal throne for yourself. Therefore, let us say this: if within seven days the king is found alive, then well and good; but if he is not, then we shall consecrate another as king."

With that, he said nothing but rested his cheek in his hand and sat sunk in thought. The mother of Balaṅkya, who was tending cattle nearby, heard this and called to him and asked: "Minister, why do you rest your cheek in your hand and sit sunk in thought?"

He replied: "O goddess, when the brahmins say such things to me, how could I not sit sunk in thought?"

She said: "Minister, if that is the case, go and place barley-flour mixed with butter and honey into a golden vessel and pour it in, and then —"

— place it before whichever horse-herder is familiar with horses, and say these words: 'Whatever horse eagerly goes to set down stones, let it eat of this, which has been mixed with butter and honey.' Do it in just that way, and whichever fine horse eats it, let me know." The minister did exactly as instructed, but not a single horse showed any eagerness to eat.

In another quarter there was a horse that was lean and bony, its body covered in sores, that ate dung, breathed with difficulty, and had a broken ear. The minister went to it, sat down before it, and said: "Whatever horse eagerly goes to set down stones, let it eat of this, which has been mixed with butter and honey." And that horse ate it all up.

The minister went back and told the mother of Balañkya, the cattle-tender, what had happened. She said to him: "Go, minister, and groom it. And if when you are grooming it the horse is unruly, do not be afraid — just summon your courage. No one can make a fool of one who has the strength of heart." He went and began to groom it, and as he was doing so, the horse transformed itself into a terrifying form and said: "Hey, you there — have you ever before seen a horse of this kind?" The minister drew his sword from its scabbard, pointed it, and said: "Hey, demon of a horse! Of all the riders you have carried, have you ever seen a whip like this?" The horse replied: "No, indeed, I have not seen that before." Then the minister said: "Hey, demon of a horse, if for now you will not be disobedient, well and good. But if you are, I shall cut off your head from the neck and throw it to the ground." The horse replied: "Hey, you there — if that is so, then swear that you will not bring me back here, and I will go." The minister said: "Excellent — I wish it to be so, done just like that." He mounted the horse and rode off, and in due course arrived at the land of setting-down-stones.

The fierce king Rab-snang saw him and said: "Has the minister come?" The minister replied: "Yes, Your Majesty, I have come." The king asked: "And for what purpose?" The minister then recounted everything that had happened. The king said: "Minister, for now take your ease for seven days, and when the seven days have passed, know that the time has come." With that, the minister spent seven days in good cheer and enjoyment together with a woman of gracious appearance who sustained him well. When the seven days had passed, he set out.

He went to a jungle hill and began to groom the great elephant, the chief bull of the herd. While he was grooming it, the elephant cried out. Not far away there lived a blind brahmin astrologer, who heard this, and said: "According to the cry of this great bull elephant, it will go from here and, traveling a hundred leagues to the south, will drink from the great ocean."

Then King Rab-srang and the minister mounted the great bull elephant of the jungle hill and rode off. Before long, in one place, the legs of the jungle-hill elephant crushed the unfired vessels of a potter who was sitting there, and the potter began to lament. The minister said: "Those who live at others' expense shall come to this." King Rab-srang, upon hearing this, thought: "The minister is mocking me with that. Does he think that I alone live at others' expense?" He thought this but said nothing and rode on.

Then in another place, the legs of the jungle-hill elephant broke the egg-filled nest of a dung beetle that had been built in the middle of the road, and that one too began to lament. The minister said: "Those who conduct themselves outside their proper domain shall come to this." King Rab-srang again felt a thought arise and considered: "Again the minister is mocking me. Does he think a prostitute is outside my proper domain?" He thought this but said nothing and rode on.

They descended further to a tree on the jungle hill, and —

a snake that was lurking in the branches of that tree struck and began to swallow King Rab-srang. After a moment the minister saw this, drew his sword from its scabbard, cut the snake into pieces, and threw it on the ground. As it writhed and convulsed, the minister watched and said: "Those who pursue what should not be pursued shall come to this." King Rab-srang, as before, felt a thought arise and considered: "Now for the third time he has mocked me. Does he think a prostitute is not what I should be pursuing?" He thought this but said nothing and rode on.

At another time, a hare of the jungle hill leapt across their path. The king tried to catch it but could not, and the minister said: "Your Majesty, a brahmin astrologer (jyotiṣa) has prophesied that this creature, after travelling a hundred leagues, will go and drink from the great ocean to the south. That is why it sprang quickly to grasp a tree branch — release the elephant, I say!" And with that, the creature swiftly seized a branch of the tree. The minister too grasped a branch of the tree, and so the jungle hill passed beneath them and was gone.

The king said to the minister: "Go and tell her quietly, without her noticing, that the god has come and is resting in the pleasure grove."

He went and told her this, and she was delighted and sat in silence without a word. The king also began to enter through a gap in the fence. Just then two girls came out to relieve themselves, and one of them said: "Friend, I hear the god has come!" The other replied: "He entered through a gap in the fence." The king heard this and thought: "I told the minister to tell her without her noticing, yet he has gone and told every soul in the house." Furious, he recalled everything the minister had done and began to seek a grievance against him.

"Minister! You have set yourself to harm me. Do I survive by my children alone? Why do you in one place mock me with the saying 'Those who are sustained by children shall come to this'? Is a prostitute not within my proper domain? And yet in another place you mock me with 'Those who act outside their proper domain shall come to this.' And is a prostitute not what I should be pursuing? And yet in still another place you mock me with 'Those who pursue what should not be pursued shall come to this.' And even now, while I sit here in the pleasure grove, I commanded you to go and tell her quietly, without her noticing, that the god has come and is resting in the pleasure grove — and you went and told every soul in the house! You have set yourself to harm me."

Suspicious and displeased, the minister spoke in order to be believed: "May I perish by my own wickedness if I have at any point mocked my lord the god. In what manner did I mock him? As for what my lord says — that in one great place I spoke the words 'Those who are sustained by children shall come to this' — in that direction some unfired pottery vessels of a potter were smashed by the legs of the jungle hill, and that potter began to grieve. From that I reflected and said: 'Those who are sustained by children shall come to this.' As for what my lord says — that in another great place I spoke the words 'Those who act outside their proper domain shall come to this' — in that direction the dung-beetle's nest filled with eggs was crushed by the legs of the jungle hill, and that creature too began to grieve.

From that I reflected and said: 'Those who act outside their proper domain shall come to this.' As for what my lord says — that in another great place you said to me, 'Those who pursue what is not worth pursuing shall come to this' — in that direction a snake was dwelling on the branch of a tree, and it reared up and began to devour a god. I then drew my sword from its scabbard, cut it into

pieces, and it fell to the ground. From that I reflected and said: 'Those who pursue what is not worth pursuing shall come to this.'

As for your saying, 'Without my knowing it, arrange for me to be stationed in the pleasure grove of the gods at Śānti,' and that you then reported this to all the household — even in that, my lord, if I arranged it in complete secrecy, how could I have set about harming a god?

The king said: Physician, since you have answered every one of my charges well, you need not be distressed. Nevertheless, when I went to place the stone, there were certain brahmins who had begun to consecrate another man as king, and now is the time to destroy them. Let them be killed.

The physician said: My lord, let those brahmins be set aside for now. As for those spies, I shall have them put to death.

The king said: Physician, how can they be killed?

The god said: My lord, I will devise a means to entrap them.

The physician said: Very well, do so.

The physician then went to a certain young man in his entourage who was skilled in incantation and knowledgeable in spells, and said to him: These spy-women are killing many people — is there any method for catching them?

He replied: Father, what is to be done? I can catch them.

The son said: Excellent.

He then transformed something in a man's hand to look like a blue lotus flower, handed it to the man, and said: Go, fellow, go out to the marketplace and sit there. Whoever laughs upon seeing what is not bought for a price — ask that person's name and write it on a tablet.

The man took it, sat there, and for whoever saw it and did not buy it for a price but laughed — he asked that person's name and wrote it on the tablet. In this way he asked the names of five hundred spy-women of the noble king and wrote them down.

He then showed the list to the physician, and the physician in turn showed it to the king.

The king said: Physician, how shall all these many spy-women be dealt with?

The physician said: My lord, please ask me for the method by which those women are to be put to death, and set your mind at ease.

The king said: Physician, good — you yourself know it.

He then set up an enclosure on one side of the noble king's compound, and had it announced by proclamation: By the pledge of the mother of the gods, let all the she-demons dwelling in the noble king's realm gather in the courtyard of the enclosure.

And they thought:

"If we go to the pledge-gathering in the courtyard of the divine retinue's compound, they will give us many fine things" — thinking this, even those who had been staying hidden came forward out of greed for the reward and revealed themselves, and more than five hundred she-demons gathered in the courtyard of the compound.

Then the head herald's son bound them all with the noose of a spell, and the physician had their mouths covered and gagged. The king then summoned the brahmins dwelling in the noble realm and declared: "O wise ones, if this many spy-women are killed, great demerit will be incurred. Therefore, so that I may be freed from that wilderness of cyclic existence, assemble each day in the courtyard of the compound and eat your fill." And they, rejoicing and expressing their blessings, agreed to this.

The fierce king Radiant Light then commanded the herald: "O good man — every brahmin who has eaten their fill in the courtyard of the compound and then departs, you shall duly count them and report to me." The herald replied: "My lord, it shall be so. I beg to report as commanded." The king also commanded his ministers: "O wise ones, give abundant food to all the brahmins dwelling in the noble realm who come to eat in the courtyard of the compound, for brahmins are for the most part driven by their bellies" — and hearing that the king had ordered this done, they all came and set to eating.

When they had eaten and were leaving the courtyard of the compound, the herald counted them, and without exception eighty thousand brahmins had come out. He then reported to the king: "My lord, without lack or surplus, eighty thousand brahmins are present." The king then thought: "What method can be used to cut off all their heads at once?" And he commanded those who lived by the chopper's trade: "Behind each brahmin as he eats, station one executioner holding an unsheathed sword — and at the moment I say the word 'milk,' let all their heads be cut off at once."

The fierce king Radiant Light did exactly that. Of all the brahmins dwelling in the noble realm, the full eighty thousand who had gathered in the courtyard of the compound — those seized by the noose of the Lord of Death — were all beheaded at that moment by this device. Thus eighty thousand brahmins from among those dwelling in the noble realm were slain by King Radiant Light.

After he had slain them, that night as he lay in his great bedchamber, he heard in a dream six sounds from below the earth and six sounds from the sky, and he saw eight kinds of dream-visions.

What were the six sounds from below the earth? They were these: "six," "not," "self," "evil," "mind," "we, these ones here" — these are the opening syllables of six verses, as given below.

From "six," the verse runs:

For sixty thousand years,
and for six thousand hundreds —
the torment of beings burning in hell:
when will that ever reach its end?

From "not," the verse runs:

Boundless — where could any bound be seen?
Neither you nor I ourselves
shall ever come to perceive a bound.
Thus was this sinful deed done.

From "self," the verse runs:

We built up our wealth and goods
by means both favourable and foul.
Others take delight in that ease,
while we ourselves inherit only suffering.

From "evil," the verse runs:

The life we led here was wretched and vile.
What we possessed, we never gave away.
When wealth and goods were ours to enjoy,
we did no good for ourselves.

From "mind," the verse runs:

Deceived by mind,
and led astray by ignorance —

born now in hell among its beings,
who is there to blame but ourselves?

From "we, these here," the verse runs:

We, these here, went on to happy destinies,
performed many virtuous deeds,
and having thus accumulated merit,
those wholesome acts shall lead us to the higher realms.

As for the six sounds in the sky, they are as follows: "All," "Who," "Whatever,"
"Now," "Those," and "These" — these are the opening syllables of the six
verses.

From "all," the verse runs:

All has been drawn out and spent,
and only the bare essence remains.
The king has grown miserly with even that essence,
and, finding no joy in it, has abandoned hope.

From "who," the verse runs:

Whoever, by foul and dishonest means,
might contrive to obtain even a single eye —
by that very act, such a one
would deliver my children and myself from suffering.

From "whatever," the verse runs:

In this pond, from its many
fish and turtles that fill it,
frogs may well make their living now,
but I shall not abandon my home.

From "now," the verse runs:

Those blind afflictions (kleśas) that trampled me underfoot
upon the savage mountain —
they are now without any protector.

From "those," the verse runs:

From that fine lake, cool
and sweet waters

will be found with ease.

I, for my part, am glad to be there now.

From "these," the verse runs:

These ones, having bathed and eaten,
go wandering from place to place,
while I, seized by a net,
wonder what evil deed I committed in the past.

Now, what are the eight dreams? They are as follows: his body anointed with white sandalwood; red sandalwood scattered over him; fire blazing upon his head; two snakes hanging from both armpits; two fish licking both feet; two geese flying up into the sky; a dark mountain approaching from in front; and clusters of foam swirling and dispersing upon his head.

He awoke from that sleep in a state of terror, alarmed and with his hair standing on end, and he thought: "Surely, on account of this, I shall not lose the kingdom, nor shall my life be cut short." He then summoned those brahmins who were versed in the interpretation of dreams, and related the dreams to them. They deliberated among themselves and concluded: "Although the god has seen favorable signs in these dreams, they ought not to be praised. For if they are praised and this turns out badly, it will bring ruin to whatever brahmins remain, leaving not one of them behind." Having reached this judgment, they spoke: "O God, your dreams are not auspicious."

He replied: "Wise ones, what will come of them?"

They said: "On this account, O God, you will either lose the kingdom or your life will be cut short."

The king said: "Wise ones, is there any means by which I shall neither lose the kingdom nor have my life cut short?"

They replied: "O God, you have committed a great evil — you caused the slaying of eighty thousand brahmins. On account of that, if you act accordingly, there is one means."

When he heard of the killing of the brahmins, his heart trembled throughout, and he said: "Wise ones, tell me what must be done."

They replied: "O God, have a pond dug in the pleasure garden, and once it is dug, grant it with a lining of powdered stone. Then have the five finest limbs

nourished there, along with a chanter, an unweaned mother cow, a freed brahmin girl, and young cowherd boys — have them slaughtered and placed within it. Bathe in their blood; then emerge from the pond, press both knees to the ground, lick the feet of the brahmins — and by doing so, you shall not lose the kingdom,

and it shall not become an obstacle to your life." The king reflected: "If I slaughter the five finest limbs I have nourished, and the chanter, and the unweaned mother cow, and the freed brahmin girl, and the young cowherd boys, what will be the use of my remaining king?" With that thought, he spoke to the brahmins: "Wise ones, I have heard what you have said. Give me a little time, for I must think before I act." The brahmins departed, and the king sat with his arms resting on his knees, sunken in his own thoughts. The unweaned mother cow saw him there and said: "O God, why do you sit with your arms on your knees, lost in thought?" He told her everything that had come to pass, and she replied: "O God, those brahmins are always in the habit of giving improper counsel — what could they know? Go instead and present your question to the great noble one, the son of Kātyāyanī." He said: "Excellent, excellent, O Peaceful One! You have pointed me in time to the great noble one, the son of Kātyāyanī — I shall go." And so he went to where the venerable one, the son of Kātyāyanī, was staying. Having arrived, he bowed his head to the feet of the great venerable son of Kātyāyanī and sat to one side.

Sitting to one side, the fierce king Suprakaśa spoke these words to the great venerable son of Kātyāyanī: "Master, great son of Kātyāyanī — last night, as I lay in my great bed, I heard in a dream six sounds from the earth below and six sounds from the sky above, and I saw eight dreams. What were the six sounds from the earth? They were these: 'Six,' 'Not,' 'Self,' 'Evil,' 'Mind,' 'We these.' These are the first syllables of six verses. And the verse beginning with 'Six' runs:

For sixty thousand years,
and for six thousand centuries,
beings tormented in the hells —
when will they ever reach the end?

The verse beginning with 'Not' runs:

Without end — how could there be a view of an end?
Neither you nor I myself
shall ever come to perceive that end.

Thus has this evil karma been done.

The verse beginning with 'Self' runs:

We pursued our pleasures
by every favorable and unfavorable means;
others rejoice and delight in happiness,
while we have become the heirs of suffering.

The verse beginning with 'Evil' runs:

Here our livelihood was wretched;
we did not give away what we possessed.
Though we had wealth and riches,
we did no good for ourselves.

The verse beginning with 'Mind' runs:

Deceived by the mind,
bound by ignorance —
for those who are born in the hells,
who will be their protector?

The verse beginning with 'We these' runs:

We these ones went to a happy destiny,
performed many virtuous deeds,
then made merit,
and those who did what was auspicious went to the higher realms.

And what were the six sounds from the sky? They were these: 'All,' 'Who,'
'Whatever,' 'Now then,' 'Those ones,' 'These here.' These are the first syllables
of six verses. The verse beginning with 'All' runs:

All has been drawn out and spent;
only the bare essence remains.
The king, grudging even that essence,
has abandoned hope through joylessness.

The verse beginning with 'Who' runs:

Whoever with wicked ways of grasping
would gain even a single eye —
by that one, both my sons and grandsons
and I myself have been freed from suffering.

The verse beginning with 'Whatever' runs:

This pond, though it be filled
with many fish and turtles,
I shall live on frogs for now,
but I shall not abandon my dwelling.

The verse beginning with 'Now then' runs:

The verse beginning with 'Now then' runs:

Those blind ones who, on the fierce mountain,
trample me underfoot with their feet —
those very ones shall now
be left without a protector.

The verse beginning with 'Those' runs:

From this fine lake, those ones
shall find cool and sweet water
easily obtained —
and I too rejoice in that now.

The verse beginning with 'These' runs:

These ones, having bathed and eaten,
go off in every direction.
I, caught in a snare —
what evil did I do before?

Now, what are the eight dreams? They are as follows. He anointed his body with white sandalwood; he was sprinkled with red sandalwood; fire blazed on his head; from both armpits hung two snakes; two fish licked both his feet; two geese flew up into the sky; a black mountain approached from the front; and he saw a mass of frogs scattering at the blows of otters upon his head. He woke from sleep in terror, overcome with anxiety, his hair standing on end, and he thought: "I wonder whether, on account of these signs, I shall lose my kingdom or meet with an obstacle to my very life." He thought: "If I were to present this matter to the great noble Kātyāyana, I wonder whether he would know whether, on account of these signs, I shall lose my kingdom or meet with an obstacle to my very life."

The venerable great Kātyāyana said: "Great King, have you related these sounds and these dreams to any other person?" He replied: "Noble one, I have

related them." "To whom?" "To the brahmins." "And what did they foretell for you? Relate in full what transpired." He replied: "Great King, those brahmins always delight in sensual pleasure and desire a divine world — what do they know? You have heard some good sounds and seen some good dreams. Do not be afraid! On account of these signs, you shall not lose your kingdom, nor shall any obstacle come to your life."

"Why is that so? Great King, as for the six sounds from below the earth that you heard in your dream — what are they an omen of? Six kings before you, having ruled their kingdom by both Dharma and non-Dharma, passed away from their bodies and were reborn among the beings of the hells."

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Now, one of those beings, oppressed by the suffering of hell, uttered this verse:

For sixty thousand years,
for six thousand years,
those tormented in the hells —
when at last will any of them reach the end?

The second spoke this verse:

A limitless limit — where could such a boundary be?
Neither you nor I together
shall ever come to perceive any end.
Such is the evil karma we have made.

The third spoke this verse:

The wealth we gathered
through both harmony and discord —
others rejoice in it with pleasure,
while we have become heirs to suffering.

The fourth spoke this verse:

Here, where our lives are wretched,
we gave away nothing of what we had.
When wealth was still there,
we brought no benefit even to ourselves.

The fifth spoke this verse:

Deceived by mind,
led astray by ignorance —
for those born into the hells,
who is there to be their protector?

The sixth spoke this verse:

Let us, once gone to a happy destiny,
perform many virtuous acts,
and then, having made merit
and done what is auspicious, go to the higher realms.

These, then, are the omens of those sounds.

Great King, you ask of whose omen are the six sounds you heard from the sky. There is a woodworm living in the ridgepole of your house. It has eaten away everything that is not the heartwood, leaving only a little heartwood remaining. Displeased with its situation there, it spoke this verse:

All the sapwood has been hollowed out and taken;
only a little heartwood is left.

O King, the worm, finding no joy
in the heartwood, has abandoned hope.

That was the first sound from the sky. Therefore you should remove that beam and replace it with another.

Great King, there is also this: your horse-keeper, the one called Gnyerlen, went to the nest of a crow, and when eggs appeared he smashed them. Because of this the crow was separated from her young and became distressed. Crying out in grief with a sound of lamentation, she slowly spoke this verse:

Whoever, with wicked and dishonest ways,
procures even a single eye's worth —
by that one, both my children
and I myself have been freed from suffering.

That was the second sound from the sky. Do not have him punished.

Furthermore, there is in your home a pleasant ornamental pond, one that was full to the brim with water just at the depth a crow could drink from, and in which many fish, tortoises, and frogs lived. A single otter was there eating the fish, and now it has dried up and become waterless. The otter, seeing things come to this pass, was displeased and spoke this verse:

This pond was once filled
with many fish and tortoises.
Now I may yet live on frogs,
but I will not abandon this place.

That was the third sound from the sky. Have that pond refilled with water.

Furthermore, in your realm there is a mountain called Tumldän. On it there lived a bull elephant and a blind cow elephant. These two had a single calf, which tended to their needs. When it went out to find food for the two of them, it joined up with another cow elephant. You had it lured away by a stratagem and brought back and kept tethered. It grieved for its mother and father, refused to eat grass or drink water, and thinking of them with sorrow and displeasure, it spoke this verse:

Those blind and afflicted ones on the mountain Tumldän,
who once fed at my feet —
they are now left without a protector.

That was the fourth sound from the sky. It is wrong that the one who cared for its parents should perish. Release it.

Furthermore, there is a deer that has been caught and is kept in your home. Separated from its herd, it remembered the deer of the forest wilderness and spoke this verse:

From a good lake there,
the water is cool and sweet
and easily found.
Even now I rejoice to think of that place.

That was the fifth sound from the sky. Release it.

Furthermore, there are some geese that have been caught and are kept in your home. Seeing the geese flying through the sky, they were displeased and spoke this verse:

These others, having bathed and fed,
go wherever they will, in every direction.
I am caught in a trap —
what evil did I do in the past?

That was the sixth sound from the sky. You should release those as well. These are the omens of those sounds.

Great King, you ask what foretold the eight dreams you saw represent.

As for what you saw — your body anointed with white sandalwood — a great fine bolt of cotton cloth is on its way to you as a gift from the king of the northern continent, and it will arrive within seven days. Your first dream was the foretoken of that.

As for what you saw — red sandalwood scattered over your body — a precious cow is on its way to you as a gift from the king who holds your treasury lands, and it too will arrive within seven days. Your second dream was the foretoken of that.

As for what you saw — fire blazing on your head — a golden garland is on its way to you as a gift from the king of the land of Yavana, and it too will arrive within seven days. Your third dream was the foretoken of that.

As for what you saw — two snakes hanging from both your armpits — a pair of swords is on its way to you as a gift from the king of China, and it too will arrive within seven days. Your fourth dream was the foretoken of that.

As for what you saw — two fish licking both your feet — a pair of jeweled shoes is on its way to you as a gift from the king of Siṃhala, and it too will arrive within seven days. Your fifth dream was the foretoken of that.

As for what you saw — two geese flying through the sky — a pair of horses is on its way to you as a gift from the king of Vaṅgāla, and it too will arrive within seven days. Your sixth dream was the foretoken of that.

As for what you saw — a black mountain coming toward you from the front — a chief elephant is on its way to you as a gift from the king of Kaliṅga, and it too will arrive within seven days. Your seventh dream was the foretoken of that.

As for what you saw — crabs scattering about with their heads broken open — this means that you will come to learn of the death of Gopālā's mother. You must not give rise to ill thoughts even toward the brahmins.

When these words were spoken, King Radiant Light felt joy, delight, elation, gladness, ease, and mental happiness, as though he had regained his life after losing it. Rejoicing in what the venerable great son of Kātyāyana had explained, he bowed his head to his feet, rose from his seat, and departed.

He went to his own home and carried out everything exactly as the venerable great son of Kātyāyana had said: he installed a different person in the funeral

litter, he did not allow the horse-keeper to go on tending the horses as before, he filled the pond again with water, and he released the elephants, the deer, and the geese.

Seven days later, all the gifts that had been foretold arrived, and finding himself thus enriched he was filled with mental happiness. He developed deep and open faith toward the venerable great son of Kātyāyana and thought to himself: whatever wealth, power, and prosperity exist in my home, all of it has come about through reliance on the noble great son of Kātyāyana. Therefore I shall first send him this great fine bolt of cotton cloth, and afterward I shall offer him the kingdom.

With that thought he spoke to a man: "Here, friend — take this great fine bolt of cotton cloth and present it to the noble great son of Kātyāyana." The man took the great fine bolt of cotton cloth and gave it to the noble great son of Kātyāyana.

Then Gopālā's mother passed away. And he spoke to the daughter of the śramaṇa woman, Tārā, to the young Gopāla, to the attendant, and to the one leading in front:

"Wise ones, the kings who hold sway over many lands have sent these gifts to me. Take them as you each desire."

Then Gopālā's mother, Śivā, took the golden garland; the daughter of the śramaṇa woman, Tārā, took the precious coral; the young Gopāla took the two horses; the attendant took a pair of swords; the one leading in front took a pair of jeweled shoes; and the chief of the elephants that remained was taken by the king.

Then King Pradyota, having distributed among the five foremost attendants all the precious things, went to where the venerable great son of Kātyāyana was, and having arrived he prostrated with his head at the venerable great son of Kātyāyana's feet and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, King Pradyota spoke to the venerable great son of Kātyāyana thus:

"Noble one, you are a healer and one who holds dear. Therefore I pray that out of affection you would accept the royal domain and exercise it — please receive the kingdom."

The venerable great son of Kātyāyana replied: "Great king, the Blessed One has prohibited monks from ruling a kingdom."

The king said: "Noble one, if that is so, then please fully enjoy every sensual pleasure I can offer."

He replied: "Great king, the Blessed One has also prohibited every sensual pleasure."

The king said: "Noble one, if that is the case, then please accept and fully enjoy material wealth and the finest material provisions that I can offer."

He replied: "Great king, let me first put this to the Blessed One and then act accordingly."

The king said: "Noble one, please do so."

At that time the Blessed One was dwelling in Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada.

Now at such a moment as this, the awakened Blessed Ones possess not the slightest unknowing, not the slightest unseeing, not the slightest unawareness, not the slightest non-discernment. The Blessed One perceived: "The monk, the great son of Kātyāyana, does not seek material wealth and the finest material provisions for his own sake; yet he does this intending to benefit beings of future generations." With that intention he gave rise to a worldly thought.

By the nature of reality, at the very moment the awakened Blessed Ones give rise to a worldly thought, even living creatures such as ants know it through the Blessed One's mind. When he gives rise to a supramundane thought, even śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas do not know it through the Blessed One's mind — so what need is there to speak of those reborn in animal destinies? In this matter, what arose was a worldly thought corresponding to and meeting the minds of both the Blessed One and the venerable great son of Kātyāyana.

Then the Blessed One and the venerable great son of Kātyāyana each actualized the divine eye and divine ear and thereby entered into mutual seeing and hearing.

Then the venerable great son of Kātyāyana addressed the Blessed One thus: "Reverend One, is it permissible for a monk to accept material wealth and the finest material provisions on behalf of the Saṅgha?"

The Blessed One declared: "Great son of Kātyāyana, for the sake of compassion toward beings of future generations and in order to increase the wealth of donors — it is permissible. Therefore material wealth and the finest

material provisions may be given to the Saṅgha, but not to individual persons. Of these, 'material wealth' refers to villages and fields; 'the finest material provisions' refers to cattle, water buffalo, goats, and sheep."

Then the venerable great son of Kātyāyana, having put this to the Blessed One, spoke to King Pradyota thus:

"Great King, the Blessed One, out of compassion for beings of future generations and in order to increase the wealth of donors, has granted material wealth and the finest material provisions to the Saṅgha."

Thereupon King Pradyota, taking his lead from the venerable great son of Kātyāyana, had a temple built fully equipped with all furnishings, and offered it to the Saṅgha of monks from the four directions; and he offered material wealth and the finest material provisions as well.

Then the Blessed One declared to the monks: "O monks, among my lay devotees, among those who first gave all desired things to my śrāvaka Saṅgha, the foremost is this very one: the noble king Pradyota. O monks, among my lay devotees, among those who first offered cooked food to my śrāvaka Saṅgha, the foremost is this: Bimbisāra, the artisan-king of Rājagṛha. O monks, among my lay devotees, among those who first offered lodgings to my śrāvaka Saṅgha, the foremost is this: Anāthapiṇḍada, the householder of Śrāvastī. O monks, among my lay devotees, among those who first built a temple for my śrāvaka Saṅgha, the foremost is this: Supriya, the householder of Vārāṇasī."

A summary verse:

Pradyota, the supreme illuminator of all desires,
Bimbisāra, the artisan, the cook for the Saṅgha,
Anāthapiṇḍada, the lodging-giver and feeder of the shelterless,
And Supriya, the excellent one of the temple.

Now King Pradyota, among his queens' retinue, took his meals in turns: on one day in the presence of the cowherd woman Śāntā, and on another in the presence of Tārā, daughter of the wandering ascetic.

Then on another occasion, while he was eating in the presence of the cowherd woman Śāntā, the king, fond of curds, was holding a bowl of curds from Śāntā's herd and was sitting before the meal. Just then Tārā, daughter of the wandering ascetic, came from that direction; she was wearing a jeweled necklace, and at her arrival there appeared, as if a flash of lightning had burst

forth, a radiance illuminating the king together with the cowherd woman Śāntā.

Śāntā, seeing that radiance, was astonished and said: "My lord, what is this? Has a bolt of lightning suddenly appeared, or has someone lit a flame?" She replied: "This radiance is neither the light of lightning nor the light of a lamp; rather, it was Tārā, daughter of the wandering ascetic, who came from that direction, and she was wearing a jeweled necklace — this is the light of that."

"You were foolish to give away such a precious jeweled necklace and take a gold garland in its place. Is there no gold garland in my house? Or is this how one born of a low lineage behaves? How disgraceful."

She replied: "My lady, how could she have had such wisdom? Without any doubt it was you yourself who showed her, saying 'accept the precious necklace,' and that is why she took it."

The king said: "I did not tell her that — she took it of her own accord."

"You said it."

"I did not say it."

The two fell to quarreling, whereupon Śāntā struck her on the head with the bowl of curds. The king, his crown altogether shattered, had his skull cracked open. She touched it with her hand and thought: "My skull is also cracked; my brains are also seeping out — she has already killed me. So long as I have life, I shall kill this woman." Having resolved on this, she gave an order to her attendant: "Attendant, go and kill the cowherd woman Śāntā once and for all."

The attendant thought: "She has been so terribly wronged that, being completely overcome with fury, she is saying this much — but I must not kill immediately. Once she has cooled from that state of being overwhelmed, I must understand what she truly intends; then, perhaps, the killing may proceed. For now let me place her somewhere secluded." Thus reasoning, he said:

"Indeed, Your Majesty, I sought her out and killed her." So saying, he placed her in a secluded spot.

When the king had recovered from his state of being utterly beside himself, he spoke: "Attendant, what of Śāntā, the cowherd woman?"

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, you yourself commanded me, saying, 'I bid you send Śāntā the cowherd woman away and have her killed.' And so I

killed her in accordance with Your Majesty's command."

The king said: "Attendant, well done. Now then — I, and Tārā the daughter of the weaver, and the young Gopāla, and even the herald too shall go, and you yourself, having bound on a crown, shall take the royal throne and rule. As for that woman — because she showed me disrespect, I thought to press her down hard and afterwards be glad of it; but you have killed her outright in an instant."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, there is a meaning conveyed by the words of certain wise men here — a meaning that even through example becomes fully apparent. Please therefore first hear the example. It is summarised thus:

A hawk and a heron,
something hard to obtain, and deception,
insatiability, and one overcome by sleep —
these are properly gathered in a concise summary.

The summary itself:

Hawks and monkeys in this world
and the blind — these are the last.

In former times there was a great king. On a mountain slope, remote from human habitation and free of danger, adorned with a forest of various trees, roamed lions, tigers, bears, cats, deer, and wild boars. The place was attended by many kinds of flocks of birds. In one particular spot, a living creature called a thī-ba had made its nest in a great tree. It filled the nest with ripe fruits and said to its mate: 'Dear one, you must not eat these fruits. For now, sustain yourself on whatever else is at hand. When the wind blows hard and adverse conditions arise, then these are to be eaten.'

The mate replied: 'Good — so it shall be.'

In time, the fruits dried out from the wind and the sun, and the nest became cramped. Then the thī-ba said: 'Dear one, did I not forbid you, saying you must not eat these fruits, that you should eat them only when wind blows or adversity comes? Then why have you eaten them?'

The mate replied: 'I have not eaten them.'

The thī-ba said: 'I filled this nest and left it so. If you did not eat them, then why has this nest become cramped?'

The mate replied: 'I do not know why the nest is cramped. I have not eaten a single one of the fruits from it.'

As they went back and forth, each saying 'You ate them' and 'I did not eat them,' a quarrel broke out, and the thī-ba seized his mate by the beak, took her life, and she hung there dead in that very spot.

After some time had passed, a great unseasonable rain fell, and the nest filled up again, just as before, with those same fruits. The thī-ba then thought: 'This nest is full of fruits again — and so she did not eat them.' He began to beg her forgiveness:

'Beautiful spotted one, forgive me —
you did not eat these things,
yet for some wrong done to my nest
I beg you, please forgive.'

Then the god spoke these verses:

The thī-ba who roams the forest,
with dappled wings and red eyes,
killed the very one he loved,
then in his dull mind grieves — to what end?

Just as the thī-ba, acting rashly,
killed here his beloved, faultless one,
then in dull bewilderment mourns her, calling her 'dear' —
so he approaches her and begs her to forgive his wrong.

Just so the king, acting carelessly,
killed here Śāntā who was pleasing to his heart,
then in dull bewilderment mourns her, calling her 'dear' —
so he approaches her and begs her to forgive his wrong.

This is what I have to say, Your Majesty. I think the meaning you have spoken corresponds to exactly this example."

The attendant continued: "Furthermore, Your Majesty, there was a householder who, when summer had passed and the season of autumn had come, gathered up a load of pulses and set out for his field."

He set down his load of pulses at the foot of a tree and went aside to relieve himself. Just then a monkey came down from that tree, took a double handful of pulses, and climbed back up. As it was climbing, a single pulse fell and

dropped to the ground. The monkey thereupon cast away the whole double handful of pulses it was holding and began searching for that single pulse. Seeing this, the householder took a stick and struck it, and at that moment a deity spoke this verse:

Who throws away a double handful
to search for a single grain —
this monkey, so richly endowed with company,
is foolish indeed. What a pity!

The attendant then said: "This, Your Majesty, is what the deity declared. And the meaning the deity spoke — that he who killed the cowherd's mother and then wishes to beg her forgiveness — I believe corresponds exactly to that example."

The king said: "Attendant, with a single word alone you have killed the cowherd's mother, Śāntā."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

The Teacher, a person without equal,
speaks but one word, and one word only.
Since what he speaks is certain truth,
my mind in this cannot change."

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you have made me blind."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

In this world, together with its gods and humans,
two kinds of blind are held for certain:
those who are blind by nature from birth,
and those who do not abide in the Dharma.

And in both this world and the next,
there are yet two more who are blind:
one in whom a sinful view is present,
and one who does not rely upon the law."

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you have made me desolate."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard the verse on the three kinds of desolation?

A river without water is desolate.
A city or district without travelers is desolate.
Even if a woman has ten brothers,
without a husband she is desolate."

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you have made me good for nothing whatsoever."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard that there are three things in the world that are good for nothing whatsoever?"

The king said: "Attendant, what are those three?"

The attendant replied:

"A white-ashed horse presented as tribute,
a festival held with no one there,
a woman who brings ruin to her household —
these three are good for nothing whatsoever."

The king said: "Attendant, you killed the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, without having made use of her."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

Clothes used for wiping soot,
shoes used for cleaning and washing,
and the retinue of a king's queen —
all go to waste without being enjoyed.

And those are not the only three, Your Majesty — there are three more:

The blossoms of a forest tree,
the youth of one who lives in austerity,
and the wives of chariot-masters —
all go to waste without being enjoyed."

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you deserve to be beaten with a club."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

A carpenter who makes rough joints,
a tailor who cuts his thread too long,
a charioteer who is short of sight —
these three deserve to be beaten with a club.

And those are not the only three, Your Majesty — there are three more:

A messenger who plays the go-between,
an envoy who is employed as a spy,
and a woman who acts as a seductress —
these three deserve to be beaten with a club."

And those are not the only three — there are three more:

A cowherd who wanders through the village,
a woodcutter who roams through the forest,
and a son-in-law who is forever coming to visit —
these three deserve to be beaten with a club.

The king said: "Attendant, you killed the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, with a single blow."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

A king speaks once and that is final,
a daughter is given in marriage once and that is final,
and the sight of a noble one is granted once and that is final —
these three each happen but once."

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you have brought sickness upon yourself."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

One who wears armour of many different kinds,
a herdsman with a short rope but many cattle,
and an old man who takes a young wife —
these are they who have brought sickness upon themselves."

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you have shamed me."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

One who chatters and babbles without end,
another who wears shabby, wretched clothing,
and one who eats by stealing and scrounging —
these three are worthy of contempt and shame."

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you have set an enemy upon me by means of a net."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

Fish are to be caught with a net,
mountains are to be climbed with a net of ropes,
and all one's aims are to be accomplished by one's network —
these three are to be done, net by net, through connections."

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you are a child."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

Placing trust in one who is unfamiliar,
relying on one who is unsuitable,
and abandoning everything in a fit of doubt —
these are the three defining marks of a child."

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you are one who drives away friends."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

Not spending time with one's friends at all,
or on the other hand clinging to them far too much,
and asking favours of them at the wrong time —
by these things one drives friends away."

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you are a base person."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

Always coveting the wealth of others,
stirring up trouble for one's own desires,
and likewise taking delight in others' suffering —
these three are the marks of a base person."

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you are to be executed by the wheel of a chariot."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

A painter who does not know how to apply colours,
a mechanic who does not know how to fix the axle,
and a wrestler's son who does not know how to throw his opponent —
for one who is to slay, there is always the means to do it without fail."

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you are a deceiver."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

A woman who has passed through three husbands,
a monk who has come back from outside,
and a bird that has escaped from a trap — these three:
among deceivers, that last is the most devious of all."

In summary:

What is hard to obtain, what is distinct, and what is singular,
what is accumulated, and likewise what is discordant —
what is beaten, what is absent, and what is discordant — these are without purpose.

The attendant said: "Your Majesty, you have killed the cowherd's mother, Śāntā — the one that was hard to obtain."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

A horned rabbit is hard to find,
a feathered tortoise is hard to find,
a courtesan who sits alone,
and a miser who speaks straight — these are hard to find."

The king said: "Attendant, you killed the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, for someone else's sake."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

One who accepts what is forced upon him, a guarantor,
and the four great ones among the treacherous —
a fool who flatters: these four
are unfit for another's purposes."

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you have left me alone."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

At birth, one is born into this alone.
Likewise at death, one dies in this alone.
It is as a lone person that one experiences suffering here.
In saṃsāra, there is no companion."

The king said: "Attendant, you killed the cowherd's mother, Śāntā — she who had accumulated stores."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

Fish eggs and mango blossoms,
the striving of one whose aim has turned to sorrow —
like an autumn cloud, for example:
even what has been accumulated comes to nothing."

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you have become one who is discordant."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

The sun is discordant with shadow,
light is discordant with darkness,
day is discordant with night —
Dharma and what is not Dharma are always discordant."

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you deserve to be beaten."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

Garments, when beaten, become soft.
Donkeys, when beaten, become swift.
Women, when beaten, come under control.
Drums, if not beaten, will not make a sound."

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you deserve to be destroyed."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

Wind destroys bubbles.
The sound of a crowd destroys a song in just the same way.
Keeping company with a bad person,
and ugliness — these destroy virtue."

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you are not fitting."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

A king who speaks falsely,
a physician who speaks out of turn, a renunciant who quarrels,
and a wise man who is utterly confused —
these four are not fitting."

The king said: "Attendant, you killed the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, for no purpose."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this verse?

Lighting a lamp in daytime is without purpose.
Rain falling on the ocean is without purpose.
Giving a feast to one who is sated is without purpose.
Keeping company with a bad person is without purpose."

In summary:

Deceiving, watching, wrongdoing, expulsion,
fear, sending away in disgust,
craving, acting without thought, grief and its attendants —
these were properly proclaimed to the assembly.

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you are a deceiver."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard that there are four kinds of deceivers? What are the four?

Instructing one who does not wish to learn,
explaining to one wearied by sleep,
seeking a purpose from one who seeks no purpose,
and dividing what belongs to the powerful —
these are the four."

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you deserve to be watched."

The attendant replied:

"Your Majesty, have you not heard:

On the field of battle, watch the hero;
for unbearable poison, watch the mantra;
at the time of eating and drinking, watch the kinsman;
and to grasp the meaning, watch the wise.

Has your Majesty not heard this?"

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you have done wrong."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard:

A householder who is lazy — that is wrong.

One gone forth who holds no proper vow — that is wrong.

A king who behaves negligently — that is wrong.

And a scholar who sows discord — that too is wrong.

Has your Majesty not heard this?"

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you are to be expelled."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard:

An unskilled driver breaks the cart.

Overloading with a heavy load kills the ox.

Nursing too eagerly kills the calf.

Staying too long in a relative's home drives away the young wife.

Has your Majesty not heard this?"

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you fill me with dread whenever I see you."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard:

There is the wasp, and the water-blister,

third, the silk-cloth moth,

and fourth, the wet leather shoe —

these make one dread what is not truly dreadful.

Has your Majesty not heard this?"

The king said: "Attendant, the absence of the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, displeases me."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard:

A monkey is displeased in the village.

The crocodile that kills children is displeased in the mountains.

The thief is displeased in the house of the ascetic.

And the mouse is displeased in its own home.

Has your Majesty not heard this?"

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you are to be dismissed."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard:

For the sake of a clan, one individual is dismissed.

For the sake of a village, a clan is dismissed.

For the sake of a realm, a village is dismissed.

And for one's own sake, a realm is dismissed.

Has your Majesty not heard this?"

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, my craving cannot be cut."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard:

One who has no root, and another man's wife,
drinking water with only one hand,
and wine poured by another —
these are things whose craving cannot be cut.

Has your Majesty not heard this?"

The king said: "Attendant, you killed the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, without having given it any thought."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard:

A king who gives no thought to the royal treasury,
one who sets out on a road without thinking of bandits,
a woman at the hearth who gives no thought to fire,
and one gone forth who gives no thought to material gain —

Has your Majesty not heard this?"

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you are a cause for grief."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard:

An aged person of attachment — cause for grief.

A woman who has not become good — cause for grief.

An aged courtesan — cause for grief.

And a violent one who has gone forth — cause for grief.

As a summary verse:

One who is never satisfied by looking, one who seems agreeable in mind,
one whom it is wrong to cherish, and wealth,
one whom it is wrong to speak to, one full of hatred,
a friend without protection — these are to be relied upon by the resolute.

The king said: "Attendant, you killed my cowherd's mother, Śāntā — one who was never satisfied by looking."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard:

The lord of elephants, and a king,
the ocean, and Mount Meru,
and a buddha — the highest of all speakers —
these are things that are never satisfied by looking.

Has your Majesty not heard this?"

The king said: "Attendant, you killed my cowherd's mother, Śāntā — one who was agreeable to my mind."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard:

A woman of beautiful form, of good lineage,
who brings pleasure and extends the family line,
in the prime of youth — these five qualities
make a woman agreeable to a great king's mind.

Has your Majesty not heard this?"

The king said: "Attendant, by killing the cowherd's mother, Śāntā, I shall not play together with you."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this:

A child, a snake, a frog,
a woman of loose conduct,
and a friend whose love is impermanent —
these are not things to play with.

Has your Majesty not heard this?"

The king said: "Attendant, because you killed my cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you have stolen my wealth."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this:

Musicians, soldiers,
physicians, thieves, and herdsmen —
these will take a person's wealth
even when that person is in a weakened state.

Has your Majesty not heard this?"

The king said: "Attendant, because you killed my cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you are not fit to be spoken to."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this:

One who is far too rich and one who is far too poor,
one who is lowly and one who is far too exalted,
one who is far too distant and one who is far too near —
these six are said not to be fit to speak with.

Has your Majesty not heard this?"

The king said: "Attendant, because you killed my cowherd's mother, Śāntā, I bear you deep enmity."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this:

One who gives without being seen to do so, who acts in opposition,
who fails to act in accord and broadcasts one's faults,
and who, having given, gradually takes back what was given —
these are the signs of one who bears deep enmity.

Has your Majesty not heard this?"

The king said: "Attendant, because you killed my cowherd's mother, Śāntā, I have been left without a protector."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this:

A senior monk, an aged king,
one whose counsel is improper and brings no ease,
and one who harms one's teacher —
these six are said to be without a protector.

Has your Majesty not heard this?"

The king said: "Attendant, because you killed my cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you are not fit to be befriended."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this:

A jester, a dancer,
a messenger, a prostitute, one addicted to alcohol,
a eunuch, and likewise one of wicked disposition —
with these one should not make friends.

Has your Majesty not heard this?"

The king said: "Attendant, because you killed my cowherd's mother, Śāntā, you are not to be trusted."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this:

Water that ebbs by only a neck's breadth, a horse,
an elephant, a monkey, a black snake,
one whose hair stands on end, one whose brow is furrowed,
and one with sparse facial hair — in these one should place no trust.

Has your Majesty not heard this?"

Now in summary:

Sleeplessness, unwished-for things,
a mind tormented from all sides, material things,
and likewise compassion, the crow,
and finally, strength — these are the means of repelling.

The king said: "Attendant, because you killed my cowherd's mother, Śāntā, I cannot sleep."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard this:

Wanton conduct, illness from emaciation,
being struck by cold sickness, suffering,
a troubled mind intent on gain, exertion,
and fear — in all these forms,

sleep does not come. In this world
these eight are by their very nature suffering.

Has your Majesty not heard this?"

The king said: "Attendant, because you killed my cowherd's mother, Śāntā, I am in a state of unwished-for things."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard of the eight unwished-for things? What are these eight?"

Illness, old age, and death,
separation from the pleasant, meeting with the unpleasant,
hail, lightning, and impermanence —
these eight are what the world wishes for least of all.

Has your Majesty not heard this?"

The king said: "Attendant, because you killed my cowherd's mother, Śāntā, a mind tormented from all sides has arisen in me toward you."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard of the nine things that subdue a tormented mind? What are these nine, Your Majesty?"

One thinks: 'This person wishes to harm me, does not wish me benefit, does not wish me happiness, does not wish me comfort, does not wish me success and well-being — this one has done, is doing, and will do what I wished against me.' And then one thinks further:

'How could it ever come to pass that, just as this has befallen me through another, I should bring about exactly the same to that other — for that would be wrong?' And thinking thus, one dispels the tormented mind that has arisen toward that person.

This is the case of one who wishes to harm me, does not wish me benefit, does not wish me happiness, does not wish me comfort, does not wish me success and well-being — one who wishes harm to that person, does not wish benefit, does not wish happiness, does not wish comfort, does not wish success and well-being; one who has done, is doing, and will do harm to that person. And yet one thinks:

'How could it ever come to pass that, just as this has befallen me through another, I should bring about exactly the same to that other — for that would be wrong?' And thinking thus, one dispels the tormented mind that has arisen toward that person.

This is the case of one who wishes to harm me, does not wish me benefit, does not wish me happiness, does not wish me comfort, does not wish me success and well-being — yet who wishes that other person well, wishes them benefit, wishes them happiness, wishes them comfort, wishes them success and well-being; one who has done, is doing, and will do good to that person. And yet one thinks:

'How could it ever come to pass that, just as this has befallen me through another, I should bring about exactly the same to that other — for that would

be wrong?' And thinking thus, one dispels the tormented mind that has arisen toward that person.

The king said: "Attendant, because you killed Śāntā, the cowherd's mother, you are without compassion."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard of the ten who are without compassion — the butcher, the poultry-seller, the pig-seller, the fisherman, the deer-hunter, the fowler, the rabbit-snarer, the thief, the executioner, and the slaughterer of cattle?"

The king said: "Attendant, because you killed Śāntā, the cowherd's mother, you are like a crow."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard it said that one who possesses ten qualities is like a crow? What are these ten? Your Majesty: one who snatches, one who speaks harshly, one who breaks things off abruptly, one who steals, one who is ungrateful, one who is without compassion, one who takes what is not given, one who hoards, one who is hard to satisfy, and one who is dissolute."

The king said: "Attendant, because you killed Śāntā, the cowherd's mother, you are one who turns things away."

The attendant replied: "Your Majesty, have you not heard it said that there are ten who turn things away? What are these ten? Your Majesty: the sun, which turns things away; the moon, which turns things away; fire, which turns things away; water, which turns things away; a young woman, who turns things away; a wife, who turns things away; a brahmin, who turns things away; a naked ascetic, who turns things away; a monk, who turns things away; and fallow ground, which turns things away.

As for the sun being one who turns things away: when the sun comes in winter it does not bring warmth, yet when it comes from a great distance in summer it does bring warmth — this is why the sun is called one who turns things away.

As for the moon being one who turns things away: when the moon is in its waning phase all people bow to it, yet when it has become completely full in every aspect no one bows to it — this is why the moon is called one who turns things away.

As for fire being one who turns things away: fire burns the very thing that is burning into fire itself — this is why fire is called one who turns things away.

As for water being one who turns things away:

water in a winter pond, though cold, is not fit to drink; water in a well, though warm, is fit to drink; water in a summer pond, though warm, is fit to drink; water in a well, though cold, is not fit to drink — this is why water is called one who turns things away.

As for a young woman being one who turns things away: when she has not yet been given away in marriage she delights in a wealthy household, yet when she has been taken to that wealthy household she also grows fond of her own home and weeps — this is why a young woman is called one who turns things away.

As for a woman being one who turns things away: when she is young and pleasing to look upon she goes about with her body covered, yet when she is old and no longer pleasing she goes about with it uncovered — this is why a woman is called one who turns things away.

As for a brahmin being one who turns things away: when a brahmin is a child and desire and attachment have not yet arisen he practises the holy life of celibacy, yet when he has come of age and desire and attachment have arisen he indulges in sensual pleasures — this is why a brahmin is called one who turns things away.

As for a naked ascetic being one who turns things away: when a naked ascetic is at home he sits dressed in robes, yet when he goes out into his domain he goes about naked — this is why a naked ascetic is called one who turns things away.

As for a monk being one who turns things away: when he is young and in the prime of life and is able to digest what he has eaten, drunk, chewed, and tasted, those things are not to be had; yet when he is old and unable to digest what he has eaten, drunk, chewed, and tasted, those very things are obtained in abundance — this is why a monk is called one who turns things away.

As for mud being one who turns things away: when mud is wet it floats upon water, yet when it dries it sinks — this is why mud is called one who turns things away.

Thirtieth fascicle of the Vinaya, the section on minor matters.

The king said: I have heard and understood all of this — enough. Now answer me this directly: by what power did you kill the herdsman's mother, who had

not been subdued? He replied: O king, how could I ever have had the power to subdue the herdsman's mother? O king, it is rather that this great noble Kātyāyana is a śrāvaka of one who is a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and fully awakened buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, tamer of persons to be tamed, a charioteer, unsurpassed, Teacher of gods and humans — a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and fully awakened buddha who, by the power of wisdom unobstructed, turns the wheel like a wheel-turning monarch, and whoever is endowed with what that one possesses roars the lion's roar in the great and lofty station of the finest bull of the herd, turns the wheel of Brahmā, and is endowed with the ten powers. What are those ten? O king, the first is this: that one fully and correctly knows, just as they are, what is a basis as a basis and what is not a basis as not a basis — that, O king, is his first power. Endowed with that power, he roars the lion's roar in the great and lofty station of the finest bull of the herd, turns the wheel of Brahmā, and roars the lion's roar in the midst of the assembly. Furthermore, O king, that one fully and correctly knows, just as they are, in terms of basis, ground, cause, and karmic maturation, the deeds and the Dharma rightly undertaken by sentient beings in the past, the future, and the present.

That one fully and correctly knows, just as they are, in terms of basis, ground, cause, and karmic maturation, the deeds and the Dharma rightly undertaken by sentient beings in the past, the future, and the present — that, O king, is his second power. Endowed with that power, he roars the lion's roar in the great and lofty station of the finest bull of the herd, turns the wheel of Brahmā, and roars the lion's roar in the midst of the assembly.

Furthermore, O king, that one fully and correctly knows, just as they are, the defilement and the purification, as they are established and as they are clarified, of the meditative concentrations (dhyāna), liberations, meditative absorptions (samādhi), and meditative attainments. That one fully and correctly knows, just as they are, the defilement and the purification, as they are established and as they are clarified, of the meditative concentrations, liberations, meditative absorptions, and meditative attainments — that, O king, is his third power. Endowed with that power, he roars the lion's roar in the great and lofty station of the finest bull of the herd, turns the wheel of Brahmā, and roars the lion's roar in the midst of the assembly.

Furthermore, O king, that one fully and correctly knows, just as they are, whether the faculties of other sentient beings and other persons are superior

or inferior. That one fully and correctly knows, just as they are, whether the faculties of other sentient beings and other persons are superior or inferior — that is his fourth power. Endowed with that power, he roars the lion's roar in the great and lofty station of the finest bull of the herd, turns the wheel of Brahmā, and roars the lion's roar in the midst of the assembly.

Furthermore, O king, that one fully and correctly knows, just as they are, the diversity of the inclinations of other sentient beings and other persons. That one fully and correctly knows, just as they are, the diversity of the inclinations of other sentient beings and other persons — that, O king, is his fifth power. Endowed with that power, he roars the lion's roar in the great and lofty station of the finest bull of the herd, turns the wheel of Brahmā, and roars the lion's roar in the midst of the assembly.

Furthermore, O king, that one fully and correctly knows, just as they are, what is called the variety and multiplicity of world-realms. That one fully and correctly knows, just as they are, what is called the variety and multiplicity of world-realms — that, O king, is his sixth power. Endowed with that power, he roars the lion's roar in the great and lofty station of the finest bull of the herd, turns the wheel of Brahmā, and roars the lion's roar in the midst of the assembly.

Furthermore, O king, that one fully and correctly knows, just as they are, the path that leads everywhere. That one fully and correctly knows, just as they are, the path that leads everywhere — that, O king, is his seventh power. Endowed with that power, he roars the lion's roar in the great and lofty station of the finest bull of the herd, turns the wheel of Brahmā, and roars the lion's roar in the midst of the assembly.

Furthermore, O king, that one recollects his many former lives in their various aspects — one life, two lives, three, four, five, six, seven, eight, nine, ten, twenty, thirty, forty, fifty, a hundred lives, a thousand lives, a hundred thousand lives, many hundreds of lives, many thousands of lives, many hundreds of thousands of lives, an aeon of dissolution, an aeon of formation, an aeon of both dissolution and formation, many aeons of dissolution, many aeons of formation,

many aeons of both dissolution and formation — and recollects them, thinking: "In such and such a place my name was this, my clan was such, my lineage was such, my food was such, the pleasure and suffering I experienced were such, my lifespan reached this far, my stay lasted as long as this, and when

that end of life came to pass, those sentient beings arose there. I passed away from that existence and was born in such and such a place. From there too I passed away and was born here." In this way he recollects his many former lives in all their aspects, together with their places and directions.

Having thus recollected his many former lives — from "recollecting even one life" all the way through "was born here" — with their many aspects, together with their places and directions: this is the eighth power of that god. Endowed with that power, he takes on the magnificent station of the finest bull of the herd, turns the wheel of Brahmā, and roars the lion's roar in the midst of the assembly.

Furthermore, O king, with the divine eye — purified and surpassing human capacity — that one sees sentient beings dying and being born: fair in form and ugly in form, fortunate and unfortunate, high and low. He fully understands, exactly as it is, how sentient beings pass on in accordance with their karma: those who go to a happy destination and those who go to a bad destination. He fully understands, exactly as it is: "These sentient beings are endowed with misconduct of body, speech, and mind; they have slandered the noble ones; they hold wrong views; and having taken up actions and dharmas rooted in wrong view, at the breaking up of the body after death they will be reborn in a bad destination, a bad realm, a fallen state — in the hells. And these sentient beings are endowed with good conduct of body, speech, and mind; they have not slandered the noble ones; they hold right views; and having taken up actions and dharmas rooted in right view, at the breaking up of the body they will be reborn in a happy destination, a higher realm, among the gods."

From "the divine eye" through "reborn among the gods in a happy destination, a higher realm" — all of this is as before. This is the ninth power of that god. Endowed with that power, he takes on the magnificent station of the finest bull of the herd, turns the wheel of Brahmā, and roars the lion's roar in the midst of the assembly.

Furthermore, O king, that one — for the sake of the exhaustion of all defilements, and in this very visible existence alone — realizes through direct personal knowledge the undefiled liberation of mind and the liberation of wisdom, enters into them, and brings them to completion, and declares: "My defilements are exhausted. The holy life has been demonstrated. What had to be done has been done. I shall not know another existence beyond this." From

"the undefiled liberation of mind and the liberation of wisdom" through "I shall not know another existence beyond this" — all is as before. This is the tenth power of that god. Endowed with that power, he takes on the magnificent station of the finest bull of the herd, turns the wheel of Brahmā, and roars the lion's roar in the midst of the assembly.

When these words had been spoken, King Prabhāsa sat in silence, utterly speechless. Gośa thought to himself: "The god sits in silence, saying nothing at all — how much longer must this cow-herder's mother remain uncalmed?" And so he took her by both arms and led her forward, and she bowed at the king's two feet in prostration.

She approached the king to beg his forgiveness and sang these verses:

O god, O lord of human beings, behold how here the way of the Dharma of permanence is traveled and traveled again, truly and rightly. Patience is the foremost virtue of kings, O god — please extend your forgiveness for the transgression of the cow-herder's mother.

She is a precious jewel of excellent speech, a wonder for the world to behold. If you, who even tame great elephants, have not yet seen or heard her — what need is there to speak of a woman's slight offense? Endowed with form and qualities that do not stray from you, she has been and will be your devoted queen, before as now. For the sake of the king alone, O god, please grant full forgiveness to this cow-herder's mother — thus did she speak.

The king, in response to her plea, spoke again in verse:

This you have spoken, and spoken well — you have said it with deep affection for me. Therefore I grant you the gift of Kanyākubja, and I forgive, from my heart, even the offense against Śiva.

Here ends the reply.

The summary verse:

Ugraśena, with the golden vessels,
Bhaddā the luminous, and the forest-dweller,
The life-giver, the medicine of fruits,
And many in his retinue who caused offense.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Vaiśālī in the Pavilion with Many Storeys on the bank of the Monkey Pool. At that time a large assembly of brahmins and householders had gathered and were seated in a gallery,

speaking among themselves in conversation of this sort: "Learned ones, the ascetic Gautama and his śrāvakas are greatly filled with desire. The non-Buddhists are not so," they said.

Now at that very gathering, the householder Ugraśena was also seated in that assembly. Then the householder Ugraśena addressed the many brahmins and householders of Vaiśālī with these words: "Learned ones, wait a moment. I will show you, face to face, whether the Blessed One has great desire or little desire, and whether his śrāvakas have great desire or little desire." And having said that, he had vessels of gold, silver, vaiḍūrya, and crystal filled and loaded, then went to where the Blessed One was and, going there, exchanged with the Blessed One various pleasant and appropriate words of greeting and celebration, and sat down to one side.

As he sat to one side, the Blessed One taught the householder Ugraśena thoroughly with a Dharma talk, fully guided him, fully encouraged him, and filled him with joy. In many different ways, using words in accord with the Dharma, he taught him thoroughly, fully guided him, fully encouraged him, and filled him with joy — and then remained in silence.

Then the householder Ugraśena rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, and turning toward the Blessed One with palms pressed together in reverential salutation, said to the Blessed One: "Might the Blessed One be pleased to consent to come to my home tomorrow at mealtime together with the monastic Saṅgha of monks?" The Blessed One consented to the householder Ugraśena's request by remaining silent.

Then the householder Ugraśena, knowing from the Blessed One's silence that consent had been granted, praised what the Blessed One had said, rejoiced, and rising from his seat, departed.

He then invited the non-Buddhists as well, saying: "Learned ones, tomorrow I have invited the buddha, the Blessed One, along with the monastic Saṅgha of śrāvakas, to my home at mealtime — come you also to that place for the meal." And he invited the brahmins and householders of Vaiśālī likewise: "Learned ones, I have invited the buddha, the Blessed One, along with the monastic Saṅgha of śrāvakas, and —"

"— and the non-Buddhists have been invited to my home tomorrow at midday; come you also at that time to be of company." Then he went to his own home and gave instructions to those in his household who prepared food, saying: "Learned ones, prepare a great abundance of pure and varied food." And they

prepared a great abundance of pure and varied food.

Then, the following morning, the householder Ugrasena rose early, arranged seats, set out water vessels, and sent word to the Blessed One announcing the midday hour: "Venerable One, you were invited for midday — now that the time has come, may the Blessed One be pleased to know that the hour is at hand."

Thereupon the Blessed One, in the time of the morning, donned his under-robe and outer robe, took up his alms bowl, and went to the place to which the householder Ugrasena had directed him. Having arrived, he took his seat on the prepared cushion at the head of the monastic Saṅgha of monks.

Then the householder Ugrasena, together with the brahmins and householders of Vaiśālī, began serving the buddha and the members of the monastic Saṅgha of monks with vessels of gold, silver, vaidūrya, and crystal.

At that point the Blessed One addressed the Venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, go and announce to the monks that the householder Ugrasena is serving with vessels of gold, silver, vaidūrya, and crystal as a way of testing them — let none among you monks accept any of them." The Venerable Ānanda, having heard the Blessed One's words, assented, saying "As you instruct, Venerable One," and then went and announced to the monks: "Venerable ones, the Blessed One has declared that the householder Ugrasena is serving you with vessels of gold, silver, vaidūrya, and crystal with a mind intent on testing you — let none among you monks accept any of them." Having been so informed, the Venerable Ānanda said, "As the Blessed One has commanded, so shall we do: we shall not accept them" — and indeed they did not accept them.

Then the householder Ugrasena, perceiving that the buddha and the monastic Saṅgha of monks were comfortably seated, served them himself by hand, thoroughly satisfying and replenishing them with an abundance of pure and varied food and drink. Many times over, serving them himself by hand with an abundance of pure and varied food and drink, he thoroughly satisfied and amply served them all. When he knew that the Blessed One had finished eating and had covered his bowl and withdrawn his hand, Ugrasena placed a low seat before the Blessed One and sat down in front of him to hear the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One thoroughly taught the householder Ugrasena with discourse in accord with the Dharma, thoroughly guided him to receive it, thoroughly praised him, and thoroughly gladdened him. Many times over he

thoroughly taught him with discourse in accord with the Dharma, thoroughly guided him to receive it, thoroughly praised him, and thoroughly gladdened him. Then, having spoken the dedication of merit, he rose from his seat and departed.

Thereafter, certain of the untamed non-Buddhists sat about making a clamour, grumbling in all directions. The householder Ugraśena then instructed his gatekeeper: "Good steward, if any non-Buddhist attempts to leave by the gate carrying a vessel of gold, silver, vaidūrya, or crystal, do not give it to him. If he says 'The householder gave it to me,' reply: 'The householder gave it to you for the meal — he did not give it to you to keep.' And if he still will not hand it over, beat him and take it back."

The man obeyed the householder Ugraśena's instruction. Then the householder Ugraśena began distributing vessels of gold, silver, and vaidūrya to the non-Buddhists, and a great uproar and commotion broke out, with some crying, "Householder, give me something made of gold!" and others, "Give me something made of silver!" and so on, all clamouring together. A brawl then broke out among them, and they began striking one another with fists, slaps, sticks, cudgels, and clods of earth. The householder Ugraśena had them threatened, overpowered, and by the device of separating them, compelled each to sit down and eat in his own place. Whoever had eaten his fill from whatever vessel then tried to leave taking that very vessel with him, and the gatekeeper moved to seize them. They protested: "Hey, steward — the householder gave it to us, so why are you stopping us?" He replied: "The householder gave it to you for the meal — he did not give it to you to keep. Hand it over at once." When they refused to give it back, the gatekeeper beat them, and a tremendous outcry arose, so that all the great multitude of men, women, boys, and girls residing in Vaiśālī gathered together.

The householder Ugraśena, seeing those disagreeable scenes, spoke these words to the brahmins and householders of Vaiśālī: "O you of discernment, have you observed the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of monks and śrāvakas, and the distinction they display?" They replied: "Householder, we have indeed observed it." He then said: "O you of discernment, see how the Blessed One is of few wants, and his śrāvakas likewise are of few wants — whereas these non-Buddhists, who are criticized in the Dharma and Vinaya as people of many wants, are not like that at all."

Thereupon, many who had lacked faith in the Blessed One and the Saṅgha of monks and śrāvakas came to have faith. Even among the neutral bystanders, some developed faith in the Blessed One.

The Blessed One then went to the meeting hall, washed his feet, and took his seat on the seat that had been prepared for him in the midst of the Saṅgha of monks. Seated there, the Blessed One addressed the monks: "Monks, since there are these and other benefits to knowing moderation, a monk must not eat from vessels of precious materials — gold, silver, vaidūrya, crystal, and the like. If he does, it becomes a serious offence. The Blessed One declared that monks must not eat from vessels of gold, silver, vaidūrya, crystal, and so forth, from vessels of precious materials."

Now because of such other monks who were free from faults, ordinary people who had gone to the abodes of gods and nāgas were invited to eat there. But in those divine and nāga dwellings there were only vessels of gold, silver, vaidūrya, and crystal, fashioned by the power of their own merit, and no other vessels were to be found. The monks regretted this and did not eat.

On that occasion the monks informed the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, in a place where no other vessel can be found, I permit you to eat from vessels of gold, silver, vaidūrya, crystal, and the like — you need feel no remorse about this."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. In Śrāvastī there lived a certain householder — wealthy, of great property, possessed of vast resources and extensive holdings, endowed with the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa (the god of wealth), a rival to Vaiśravaṇa in riches. He had taken a wife from a family of equal rank, and with her he sported and took delight and enjoyed himself.

From that sport and delight and enjoyment, at a certain time a being entered into that wife's womb. From the very day that the being entered her womb, her complexion became radiant and lovely. Eight or nine months passed, and she gave birth to a daughter — beautiful of form, fair to see, lovely to behold, endowed with all her major and minor limbs. At the moment of her birth, that household blazed with light like the rays of the sun, and throughout all of Śrāvastī the news spread: "A great householder's daughter has been born — beautiful of form, fair to see, lovely to behold, endowed with all her major and minor limbs — and at the moment of her birth, that household blazed with light like the rays of the sun." On hearing this, many hundreds of thousands of

living beings, filled with wonder, gathered at that householder's home.

Now, a brahmin astrologer had come from another region, and he too gathered there out of wonder. He gazed at the child carefully, then said to the assembled people, "O wise ones, have you seen this girl?" They replied, "We have seen her." He said, "O wise ones, this girl will without doubt take delight and find enjoyment in the company of five hundred men." They answered, "Given how beautiful this brahmin's girl is in her form, she will certainly, without fail, take delight and find enjoyment in the company of five hundred men."

And throughout all of Śrāvastī the report spread: "A householder's daughter has been born — beautiful of form, fair to see, lovely to behold, endowed with all her major and minor limbs — and at the moment of her birth that household blazed with light like the rays of the sun; and an astrologer has prophesied that this girl will take delight and find enjoyment in the company of five hundred men." Everyone who heard the news came there as well.

After twenty-one days — three sets of seven — a great birth-celebration was held, and it came time to give the girl her name. The relatives said, "At the moment this girl was born, the household blazed with light like the rays of the sun. Therefore let the girl's name be Prabhāvatī — Radiant with Light." And so she was named Prabhāvatī.

Prabhāvatī was entrusted to eight nurses: two to carry her in their arms, two to suckle and nurse her, two to bathe and cleanse her, and two to play with her. These eight nurses reared and raised her on milk, yogurt, clarified butter, fresh butter, the very essence of butter, and other excellent and choice provisions, so that she grew and flourished like a lotus in a pond.

When she came of age, she was endowed with beauty, the flush of youth, grace, and the particular excellence of artistic accomplishments, and she was as lovely in that household as a forest goddess amid a forest in full bloom. Such were her beauty, her youth, her complexion, her bearing and deportment that she captured the minds even of sages who had renounced attachment by the ordinary worldly path — to say nothing of those people who, from beginningless time, have accumulated the pervasive practice of affliction and who are intoxicated with the pride of caste, form, youth, and wealth. That householder himself, together with his household retinue, applied himself to guarding her and did not even sleep at night.

The king of the land of Kośala, Prasenajit, together with his queens' retinues, his young princes, his ministers, his palace attendants, and also kings and sons of ministers dwelling in outlying regions,

Though the heralds and others had been sent to summon her, since the astrologers had prophesied that the girl Śrī-prabhā would live in joy together with five hundred men, there was fear that she might be regarded as belonging to the world at large, and so no one came to take her away. Even so, men would sit at the latticed windows, the ordinary windows, on the balconies, and on the rooftops of her house, gazing at her and hoping to win her. When the householder saw her conduct, he began offering her to others of equal birth who had not even sought her — yet not a single one of them would accept. The householder, seeing that no one at all wanted her, grew disheartened and abandoned all his other affairs, consuming himself with thoughts of how to give her away. His body became pale and wan, his flesh wasted, and he was reduced to a gaunt and emaciated state.

Now at that time there lived in Śrāvastī a certain householder — wealthy, possessed of great riches, and of ample means — who had taken a wife from a family of equal standing, but she died by her own karma. Similarly, a second wife, and then from the third to the seventh, each likewise died by her own karma. Because those wives had performed deeds that caused them to be short-lived, and because he had performed deeds that caused him to be fined and penalized for it, he had come to bear the name "Wife-killer, wife-killer." When he sought a wife from others, they said, "Why should our daughter be killed?" When he then tried to seek widows, they too said, "Why should our body be cast away on your account?" — and every one of them refused him. And so, having cut off all hope of ever getting a wife, he began to keep company with wandering ascetics (śramaṇas), brahmins, wanderers, and mendicants.

Now, his father was a lay practitioner who had gone for refuge to the Buddha, and that son thought: "If my father is a Buddhist layman, what do I need with wandering ascetics, brahmins, wanderers, and mendicants? I should attend upon the Blessed One's hearers, serve them, and then right there go forth into the renunciant life." With this in mind, he began going again and again to the Jeta Grove.

After some time a friend saw him and said, "Friend, if you go again and again to the Jeta Grove, surely you would do well to make the effort to go forth." The

man replied, "Friend, even if I had not gone forth, why should I go forth? I took one wife and she died by her own karma. Likewise a second, and then from the third to the seventh — all died by their own karma. They had performed deeds that caused them to be short-lived, and I had performed deeds that caused me to be penalized, so that my name has become 'wife-killer, wife-killer.' I have lost all heart. It is my father's custom to attend respectfully upon the monks. If I do not do this, whom else should I serve?" The friend replied, "Friend, even granted all that, you must without fail produce a son — otherwise your lineage will be cut off. Why not seek a girl from another family?" The man said, "Friend, what use is that? Every family I have approached says: 'Why should our daughter be killed?'" The friend said, "Friend, if that is the situation, what harm is there in seeking a widow?" The man replied, "Friend, if I were to seek widows, they too say: 'Why should our body be cast away on your account?'" The friend said, "Friend, if that is so, why not seek Śrī-prabhā?" The man replied, "Friend, she is known throughout the entire world — would she be taken to the house of some lowly courtesan?" The friend said, "Friend, since you are a person of faith, go and invite a monk from your household to come and seek her."

"Friend, even if she will not give — friend, just ask! Her father is grieving and dejected, so he will give her." The man went to that householder's house, and the householder said to him, "Be well! Be well!" The householder asked, "What do you want?" "Śrī-prabhā." "She is given." And so the man, with his great wealth, took her as a bride. He gave her the keys — both the keys and the crooked keys — and established her as mistress of the household. He said to her: "Good woman, according to the custom of our family lineage, the Teacher, the Buddha, and the monks are the fitting recipients of our generosity, so you too should serve them accordingly." She replied: "My lord, well and good — I shall do exactly so."

Each day the monks came to that householder's house to eat, and Śrī-prabhā herself waited upon them and served them with her own hands. Now, when she saw those monks who were distinguished in complexion, in form, and in the excellence of their youth, conceptual thoughts arose in her. As these thoughts about them multiplied, a feeling of pleasure arose in her mind.

Then the householder had some business to attend to in a certain hill country. He said to his wife: "Good woman, I must go somewhere in a remote hill region on a matter of business. While I am away, continue to offer food and hospitality to the worthy recipients just as before." She replied: "Son of a noble

house, I shall do exactly so before you have gone." She also said to the monks: "Noble ones, I must attend to some business in a remote hill region and will go there. In my absence, please come and take your meals here at my table just as before." They replied: "Householder, go, and may you be in good health. We will come and eat." And so he went to that hill country village.

The monks then continued to come to his house to take their meals. Śrī-prabhā, thinking to herself, "My husband is absent," began to display before the monks the guile of a woman, the deceit of a woman, and the wiles of a woman. The monks, finding fault with one another on this account, took counsel together, saying: "What should be done about this?" Some of them said: "What is there to be done? We simply need not come tomorrow." Others said: "We, the venerable ones, are mendicants — tomorrow we will simply go on our alms round." Yet others said, "Very well, let us do just that," and so from the very next day they began going on alms rounds.

When some time had passed, the householder returned and asked Śrī-prabhā: "Śrī-prabhā, have you been feeding the worthy recipients?" She replied: "They came on the first day, but after that they never came again." He thought to himself: "She must certainly have displayed feminine guiles before them, failed to honour them properly, and out of embarrassment they stopped coming." He went to them and invited them again. They replied: "Householder, we are mendicants — we shall go on our alms rounds." He said: "Noble ones, please come at my request. Such a fault will not occur again." They consented, and he prostrated at their feet and departed.

The next morning the monks came to his house. The householder had Śrī-prabhā stay inside the house, shut the outer door, and left her there. He himself then began to wait upon the monks and serve them with his own hands. But now Śrī-prabhā, sitting inside the house, conceived thoughts about those monks who were eating — thoughts about a certain noble person's feet, how such they were; his calves, how such they were; his thighs, how such they were; his waist and flanks and back; his belly; his face; his teeth; his lips; and —

his nose; his eyes; his brow; his head — how such they were — she so dwelt in conceptual thought about each of these things that the fire of attachment at the tenth ground blazed up, and fanned by the blast of the wind of conceptual thinking, it flared and consumed her, and she died on the very spot.

When the monks had eaten, expressed their thanks, and departed, the householder opened the door and called out, "Śrī-prabhā, come — come and eat." But there was no one to answer, for her time had passed. When he went inside, he found her lying collapsed on the ground. He thought to himself, surely she has only fallen asleep — and began to rouse her. But after a moment he saw that her time had indeed passed. His face turned dark, his beard disheveled, and he said to the people of the household, "Wise ones, look upon me, wretched one that I am, parted from a wife so precious and rare. Tell her friends and companions, her brothers and sisters and kinsmen that Śrī-prabhā has passed from her time." They raised a lament; some threw themselves on the ground and wept; others grasped the householder by his hands and feet and wept. Friends and companions, brothers and sisters and kinsmen uttered cries of sobbing. Because the householder had a great circle of his own people and associates, and they wept throughout all that time, by the time the sun had set they adorned her with blue, yellow, red, and white cloths and, with great honour, carried her to the charnel ground.

Now it happened that some five hundred wild men had gone out to a mountain pass, found goods and profit, and were returning, and drew near to that charnel ground. A man living in the city saw them and thought: the great crowd of people who went out from the city to escort Śrī-prabhā to the charnel ground — if those wild men were to harm them wrongfully, it would be terrible. He went quickly and warned the great crowd of people, saying, "Wise ones, some five hundred wild men are very close by — flee!" Those people set guards to attend to the funeral rites later, and then, just as Śrī-prabhā had been laid out adorned with a wealth of ornaments, perfumes, incense, cloths, powders, a parasol, victory banners, and pennants in all their glory, they abandoned her as though casting her aside, set the people fleeing, and entered the city. Shortly after, those wild men arrived at that very place, and the guards fled. The wild men saw her lying there so splendidly adorned and were supremely astonished. They then stripped away her robes and examined her, and seeing the youth and beauty of her form they were overcome with desire. They said among themselves, "Wise ones, wherever one wanders, there is nothing but enjoying pleasure with a woman like this" — and they enjoyed pleasure with her, and they set down five hundred kārṣāpaṇas. And word spread everywhere that five hundred men had given five hundred kārṣāpaṇas to the corpse of Śrī-prabhā and taken pleasure with it.

The monks were seized with doubt, and to resolve that doubt they presented it to the Blessed One, the Buddha. "Venerable One, what karma did the householder's wife Śrī-prabhā perform, such that through the ripening of that karma she was endowed with radiance and, just at the moment of birth, illuminated the entire house with light — and yet even in death five hundred wild men gave five hundred kārṣāpaṇas and took pleasure with her?"

The Blessed One declared, "Monks, the karma performed and accumulated by Śrī-prabhā, the householder's wife, the resources she gathered, the conditions she fully transformed, and what abided near her like a weapon's thrust — these are indeed determined.

Monks, the karma performed and accumulated by Śrī-prabhā — could any other person experience its ripening? Monks, karma performed and accumulated does not ripen in the external element of earth, nor in the element of water, nor in the element of fire, nor in the element of wind. Rather, virtuous and non-virtuous karma performed and accumulated ripens solely in the appropriated aggregates (skandhas), elements (dhātus), and sense sources (āyatanas).

Even across hundreds of aeons,
karma is never lost or wasted.
When conditions gather and the time arrives,
it ripens as fruit for those who bear bodies.

Monks, long ago in this very fortunate aeon, when the lifespan of beings was twenty thousand years, there arose in the world a Teacher named Kāśyapa — one endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, a fully awakened buddha, a Blessed One. He resided near the city of Vārāṇasī, in the deer park called the Grove of Sages Who Speak Truth. At that time, in the city of Vārāṇasī, a king named Kṛkī was ruling the kingdom — a kingdom prosperous, flourishing, joyful, with good harvests, full of people and a great population, where fighting, quarrelling, internal strife, and all disturbances were thoroughly pacified, free of disease, and rich in rice, sugarcane, cattle, and buffalo — a dharma-king who ruled in accordance with Dharma.

When the fully and perfectly awakened Buddha Kāśyapa had performed all the deeds of a buddha and passed into nirvāṇa — into the expanse free of any remainder of aggregates, like a fire extinguished when its fuel is spent — King Kṛkī, together with his queen, his young prince, his ministers, and the people

of the royal palace, paid great honour to the Teacher's relics, performed the relic worship, and erected a stūpa of four precious substances, one league in circumference on all four sides and a half-league in height.

At that time, a merchant's daughter arose in faith and hung a mirror on the central pole of the stūpa. Monks, what do you think? That merchant's daughter who, having arisen in faith toward the stūpa of the fully and perfectly awakened Buddha Kāśyapa, hung a mirror on the central pole — she is none other than this very householder's wife Śrī-prabhā. Through the karmic ripening of that act — having hung a mirror on the pole of the stūpa of the fully and perfectly awakened Buddha Kāśyapa — she was born endowed with radiance, life after life, and at the very moment of birth illuminated the entire house with light. Now hear also the explanation of how, after death, five hundred men gave five hundred kārṣāpaṇas and took pleasure with her.

Monks, long ago in the city of Vārāṇasī there was a king named Brahmadatta who was ruling the kingdom — a kingdom prosperous, flourishing, joyful, with good harvests, full of people and a great population, where fighting, quarrelling, internal strife, and all disturbances were thoroughly pacified, free of thieves and disease, rich in rice, sugarcane, cattle, and buffalo — a dharma-king who ruled in accordance with Dharma. At that time, in Vārāṇasī, there lived a woman who made her living by her beauty, named Sudarśanā — beautiful, lovely, pleasant to behold, agreeable to the minds of men — who had formerly been enjoyed by the maternal uncles of King Brahmadatta.

Now, on another occasion, five hundred pleasure-seekers gathered together much food and drink and went to a pleasure grove. There they conferred with one another, saying, "We have arranged all the pleasures of the pleasure grove, yet we have no woman. Let us go and invite some courtesan." They agreed: "Yes, let us do so. Whom shall we invite?" "Sudarśanā." They went to Sudarśanā and said, "Sudarśanā, come here. Come to the pleasure grove." She replied, "If you give me a thousand kārṣāpaṇas, I will go — otherwise, no." They said, "Take five hundred kārṣāpaṇas now, and after we have enjoyed your company we will give you the other five hundred." She said, "Very well, let it be so." They gave her five hundred kārṣāpaṇas, and she said, "Today, then — having adorned yourself with perfumes, garlands, and fine garments — come." And they departed.

Then regret arose in her. She thought: "If I spend time in pleasure with these five hundred pleasure-seekers, what will become of my standing? I have

already accepted five hundred kārṣāpaṇas — what am I to do now?" Then this thought arose in her mind: "Since I was formerly taken up entirely by the king's maternal uncle, it is to him alone that I shall look for protection, to no one else." So she sent no servant-girl in her own place, but herself went to the king's maternal uncle and spoke these words: "I am in a bad situation. I have accepted five hundred kārṣāpaṇas from these five hundred pleasure-seekers. Now if I were to enjoy their company, all five hundred of them together — what would become of my standing? Since you have formerly taken me as your own, it is fitting that you protect me from them. Please speak on my behalf."

The girl went to him and spoke, and he — relying on the king — had her snatched away from them.

Now, at that time when buddhas do not appear in the world, inferior pratyekabuddhas arise — those who are compassionate toward the impoverished, who delight in remote and secluded dwellings, who are the sole field of generosity in the world. And so a pratyekabuddha was wandering through the regions and came to Vārāṇasī, that great being, peaceful in nature, and seeking utter seclusion, he came to that very pleasure grove. The five hundred pleasure-seekers saw him — beautiful in body and beautiful in mind — and thought to themselves: "Wherever we may wander, one should serve such a field of merit as this." Consulting one another, they filled his bowl with clean and excellent food and drink and offered it to him. Now, that great being teaches the Dharma not by word but by body. So he rose visibly into the sky above, performing miracles — blazing, shining, sending down rain, flashing lightning, and so on. Ordinary people, inspired by these miracles, fell at his feet like trees cut at the root, and made this aspiration: "By this root of virtue which we have created through serving such a perfect field of generosity as this, may we — even those of us who live by our bodies — upon dying, come to give five hundred kārṣāpaṇas and enjoy pleasure."

Monks, what do you think? She who was called "Sudarśanā, she who lives by her body" — she is none other than this householder's wife, Prabhāvatī (Odbzangma), right here. And those five hundred pleasure-seekers of that time and that occasion are none other than these five hundred ruffians here.

Through the karmic maturation of the aspiration they made after offering alms to the pratyekabuddha at that time and on that occasion, as they have wandered in saṃsāra, for five hundred lifetimes they have given five hundred kārṣāpaṇas and enjoyed pleasure — and now, having become the

householder's wife, she will continue to give five hundred kārṣāpaṇas and enjoy pleasure until the moment of her death.

Thus it is, monks: the karmic maturation of those who are wholly dark is itself wholly dark; the karmic maturation of those who are wholly bright, and of those who lead others, is likewise wholly bright and fit to lead. Therefore, monks, abandon actions that are wholly dark and those that lead downward, and strive only in actions that are wholly bright. Monks, you should train accordingly.

Whatever slight fault arose in the Blessed One's consideration was the result of going to such a household. Therefore, knowing that monks should not go to such households, the Blessed One declared to the monks: Monks, a monk who sees the householder's wife Prabhāvatī may give rise to a thought and die of it. Therefore, monks, a monk should not go to a household in which such a fault as this may arise. If a monk goes to such a household, it will be an offense.

The setting is in Rājagṛha.

There was a monk who had gone forth into renunciation, and who again and again went to a secluded dwelling place to practice meditative concentration. There a goddess of the class of Māra waited, hoping to lead him into improper conduct, but she failed. She said: "Noble one, I will not rest until I harm you!" He replied: "Sister, I am a monk who observes the moral discipline — what power do you have to harm me?" She retorted, "We shall see!" and devoted herself to seeking an opportunity against him.

On another occasion, he untied the knot of his patched robe at the knee and fell asleep. The goddess thought: "Now is the time to roast this one's flesh," and taking him up, she dropped him on the upper story of the pleasure palace of King Rūpavadana, who was sleeping there. He awoke with a start and, seeing her, asked: "Who are you?" She said: "A wandering ascetic." "Which wandering ascetic?" "A wandering ascetic among the sons of the Śākya." "Noble one, how did you come to be here?" He told her what had happened. She then said: "Noble one, why do you dwell in such a dangerous and treacherous resting place? If the Blessed One does not gain his trust, I will have you killed, or you will be expelled from the teaching." He said nothing.

At that moment the monks reported this to the Blessed One. The Blessed One considered the matter: whatever slight fault arose was the result of a monk dwelling in such a dangerous and treacherous resting place. Therefore, knowing that a monk should not dwell in such a dangerous and treacherous

resting place, the Blessed One declared to the monks: Monks, the slander of King Rūpavadana has struck. Therefore a monk should not dwell in such a dangerous and treacherous resting place. If a monk dwells in such a dangerous and treacherous resting place, it will be an offense.

The setting is in Rājagṛha.

At that time a young monk was afflicted by a disease called "the fruit of wrong food and conduct," and tormented by that illness he was vomiting, while the monks sat around him. Then the king of physicians, Jīvaka, arrived and asked: "Noble ones, what is this?" The monks replied:

"Jīvaka, this young monk has been struck by a disease. Please examine what the illness is and what treatment should be applied." Jīvaka looked at him and said: "Noble ones, it is an abscess. Lancing it will be beneficial." The monks said: "If that is so, then lance it." He lanced it, and after the procedure had begun, he left without completing the dressing. The monk became gravely ill, and the monks said: "Let whichever venerable one is skilled attend to the dressing." Then another young monk did the dressing. Jīvaka thought: "I ought not to return without having dressed the wound of that noble one," and so he turned back and asked: "Noble ones, which noble one was it whose abscess I lanced?" The monks replied: "What does it matter? Noble one, we shall have the dressing seen to." Jīvaka said: "The dressing has already been done." "Noble one, by whom?" "By this young monk here." "Noble one, let us look at how it was done." He went to the monk's side and examined the wound, and seeing that the dressing had been done well, he said: "Noble one, the dressing is excellent. Even in my absence, please continue to do likewise in the future." The monk replied: "Jīvaka, even performing this without my having received permission is something — why speak at all of formally doing so? It has not been determined whether the Blessed One has permitted or forbidden it." Jīvaka said: "Noble one, the Blessed One is compassionate — why would he not permit it?"

At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, whichever monk is skilled is hereby permitted to perform the dressing." Now that the Blessed One had declared that whichever monk is skilled is permitted to perform the dressing, they began doing so in the corridors, beside the ponds, in the gatehouse, and on the steps. The Blessed One declared: "Do it in a secluded place. If done elsewhere, it will be an offense."

The setting is in Śrāvastī.

Faithful brahmin and householder devotees came to the monastery and said to the monks: "Noble ones, if I am afflicted by such-and-such a disease, what food should I seek? What medicine should I take?" They asked about dietary practice, and those monks who did not know said nothing at all, while those who knew fell into doubt and remained silent. The brahmin and householder devotees departed dissatisfied. At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, whichever monk is skilled is hereby permitted to teach dietary practices and medical treatments. One should have no regret in doing so."

The setting is in Śrāvastī.

At the time when the Blessed One displayed the great miracle (mahāprātihārya), the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) were overcome and humbled, gods and humans were filled with delight, and noble persons were gladdened. At that time, non-human beings dwelling in various lands came to Śrāvastī from villages, hamlets, districts, and royal palaces, and from other world-realms as well. Gods, nāgas, yakṣas, and the Kośala king Prasenajit, the queen Mālikā, the noble woman Viśākhā, the brahmin ascetic Dīrghanakha, elderly persons, the mother of Mṛgāra, and many other devotees came to Śrāvastī with reverent faith in the Blessed One, and there, with material gifts and honors of worship, the great multitude of people was brought to complete satisfaction.

This is the Vinaya of Minor Matters, the thirty-first fascicle.

Upon witnessing such excellent abundance, some of the non-human beings rejoiced right there on the spot, while others departed and returned to their own dwelling places.

Those who remained and rejoiced — when desire arose and their minds became entirely bound by sensual attachment, they would take on the appearance of the husbands of women whose husbands had gone out on business, manifest in that guise, and sport in pleasure with those women. From those women, boys and girls were then born as the result of that union, coming into the world with unpleasant limbs, eyes, and bodies. Some were dark-skinned with red eyes. Some had large heads and small bodies. Some had yellowish heads. Some had green hair. When their mothers saw them, they were terrified and abandoned them — some in the space between the houses, some in the direction of the thickets — and the non-human beings

sustained those children with their own non-human essence. Some were born not clearly appearing in human form, and when they had grown up they would manifest changes. These too were abandoned at the main crossroads, and they also were nurtured by the non-human beings with their essence.

The conduct of the Group of Six monks was such that they would ordain all such beings and confer full ordination upon them, and so long as those ordained ones did not know that their co-resident was one of bad conduct, they lived together with them. But when it became known, the monks who were of naturally upright conduct would separate from them, and thereafter at the times indicated by the Teacher they would depart accordingly.

Now one day, the Venerable Ānanda rose early in the morning, put on his lower robe, took up his bowl and outer robe, and entered Śrāvastī on alms-round. While walking on the alms-round he saw a being with green hair, and he thought: "This one will not be snatched away by those with black bowls. If someone were to ordain this one, I shall take him forth." With this thought he went up to him and asked: "Good sir, to whom do you belong?"

The other replied: "Noble one, there is no one at all I belong to. I am without a protector."

Ānanda said: "Good sir, if that is the case, why do you not go forth?"

The other replied: "Noble one, who would take forth one such as me with green hair?"

"Good sir," said Ānanda, "the teaching of the Blessed One is opened wide by compassion. If no one else will take you forth, come here — I shall give you ordination. Let us go."

At that the being's heart was gladdened, and he went to the Jeta Grove, where Ānanda took him forth and conferred full ordination upon him.

After a few days, having taught him the principles of proper conduct, he gave him his charge: "Good sir, deer do not feed deer. Śrāvastī is both a broad domain of your own and a land of your fathers, so sustain yourself by going about for alms."

He did not like this, and so the very next morning he put on his lower robe, took up his outer robe and bowl, and entered Śrāvastī on alms-round. Now it happened that a woman came out carrying alms food she had collected, and when she saw him she beat her breast and cried out: "Noble one, you with the green hair — who ordained you?"

He replied: "Sister, the preceptor Ānanda ordained me out of compassion."

She said: "Who but someone of bad conduct could so degrade and mar the beauty of the Blessed One's teaching!" Others likewise mocked him, and those faithless, fault-finding people in the main roads, at crossroads, and at triple junctions called out: "The discipline of the ascetics, the sons of Śākya, is worn threadbare! Even the brahma-conduct is worn threadbare!"

It was at this time, while such ill reputation was being spoken — that people were now ordaining even those with green hair — that the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One reflected: "Whatever fault has arisen has come about through monks ordaining persons of that sort. Therefore a monk should not confer ordination on persons of that sort." Knowing this, he declared to the monks:

"Monks, the mockery of brahmins and householders has fallen upon us. Therefore a monk must not keep in his vicinity a retinue that brings the retinue into disrepute. If a monk does keep in his vicinity a retinue that brings the retinue into disrepute, it will become a serious offence."

When the Blessed One had declared that a monk must not keep in his vicinity a retinue that brings the retinue into disrepute, the monks did not know what kind of retinue brings the retinue into disrepute. The Blessed One declared:

"Monks, a retinue brings the retinue into disrepute by two means: by lineage and by marks.

"As for by lineage: it is by any lineage whatsoever — lowly, base, impoverished, utterly destitute, wretched, lacking sufficient food and drink. When those born from such lineages are ordained by monks, that is the case of bringing disrepute by lineage.

"As for what is meant by marks, it is as follows:"

Yellow hair and green hair,
and likewise red hair,
white hair among men,
elephant-like hair, and no hair at all —
persons of such kind
were rejected by the great sages.

A swollen head or an elephant-like head,
a shrunken head or a flat head,

the head of a donkey or of a pig,
or a person who has two heads —
persons of such kind
were rejected by the great sages.

Ears like an elephant's or like a horse's,
ears like a cow's or like a monkey's,
ears like a donkey's or a pig's,
a single ear or no ears at all —
persons of such kind
were rejected by the great sages.

Eyes extremely red or extremely large,
eyes that are small or exceedingly yellow,
eyes of glass and protruding eyes,
a single eye or no eyes at all —
persons of such kind
were rejected by the great sages.

A nose like an elephant's or like a horse's,
like a cow's or like a monkey's,
noses like a donkey's or a pig's,
a single nostril or no nose at all —
persons of such kind
were rejected by the great sages.

Lips like a horse's or an elephant's,
lips like a cow's or a monkey's,
lips like a donkey's or a pig's,
a single lip or no lips at all —
persons of such kind
were rejected by the great sages.

Teeth like an elephant's or like a horse's,
teeth of a cow or of a monkey,
teeth like a donkey's or a pig's,
a single tooth or no teeth at all —
persons of such kind
were rejected by the great sages.

A neck that is short or extremely long,
pig-eyed, or hunchbacked,
with genitals that are mutilated or shrivelled,
with a single testicle or none at all —
persons of such kind
were rejected by the great sages.

Extremely tall or extremely short,
withered, or racked by excessive fatigue,
of a complexion that is the fourth colour,
with skin that hangs loose or is rough, or with prominent teeth —
persons of such kind
were rejected by the great sages.

With a hand severed or a foot severed,
with fingers rounded and webbed,
with no lips, a body covered in marks,
extremely old or extremely young —
persons of such kind
were rejected by the great sages.

Lame and limping in the lower body,
with fingers missing, hunchbacked, a dwarf,
with a goitre, or mute,
bent and leaning on a support, with club feet —
persons of such kind
were rejected by the great sages.

One with leprosy, with boils, with cataract,
with a swollen throat, scrofula, or crooked limbs,
and indeed any other disease whatsoever —
all such were rejected by the great sages.

Worn out by journeys and by burdens, a woman —
a slave woman, a kept woman,
a pledged woman — these and others with damaged limbs:
all such were disruptive to the retinue.

As for the one who is supremely beautiful,
the perfectly pure candidate for full ordination,
the fully awakened Buddha, the Blessed One, discerned this well

and declared it by the mark of truth.

Upananda of the green hair — at the time when his hair too had been sold into the hands of a dancer, the monks made a report to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Therefore a monk must not sell hair. If one does so, it becomes a serious offense."

The summary verse:

A slave, a kept woman,
an occasion, a petition,
a great miracle and one of good repute,
an entire army, and a mountain of worms.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The venerable Upananda had two novices: one who was a slave and one who was kept. These two were intimate with each other, conversing freely, speaking in each other's presence, exchanging words, and companions to one another. One of the two said to the other: "You should take full ordination, and I will serve as your preceptor and perform your attendant duties." The other said exactly the same thing in return. Since each was deferring to the other in this way, neither of the two received full ordination.

Then the venerable Upananda went to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, prostrated with his head at the feet of the Blessed One and sat to one side. The venerable Upananda then said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable one, is it proper for two persons to be fully ordained by means of one preceptor, one teacher, and one formal act?" The Blessed One replied: "Upananda, it is proper." "Of those two, which is the elder?" "Neither is." "Venerable one, is it proper for three persons to be fully ordained by means of one preceptor, one teacher, and one formal act?" "Upananda, it is proper." "Of those, which is the elder?" "None is." "Venerable one, is it proper for four persons to be fully ordained by means of one preceptor, one teacher, and one formal act?" "Upananda, it is not proper. Why? Because the assembly performing the formal acts of the assembly is itself irregular — it is contradictory for the Saṅgha to be fully ordained by the Saṅgha, and if the Saṅgha were to perform full ordination for the Saṅgha it would become seriously contradictory."

The venerable Upananda then performed full ordination for those two together by means of a single formal act. Not knowing to whom among the two they

should bow, what duties should be assigned to each, and how gains should be received, the venerable Upananda reported this at length to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "The two must not bow to each other. As for gains, they should be received according to whoever came first. The one who came later should be appointed junior in duties, and gains should be distributed to him later."

The occasion for this was at Śrāvastī.

The venerable Upananda asked the Blessed One: "Venerable one, in the future there will arise monks who are forgetful and of weak memory. If they are unable to find, in whatever monastery, town, or village they reside, which sūtra was taught and what rule of training was established, how shall they proceed? Furthermore, if sūtras, Vinaya, and Abhidharma are lost to transmission, how shall they proceed? Moreover, with respect to prior instructions given by kings, householders, and male lay practitioners concerning a monastery, and concerning a king, a city, a town, a householder, and

the lay practitioners whose names were forgotten — how shall those monks proceed?" The Blessed One declared: "Upananda, those who have forgotten the name of the monastery and so forth may invoke either any one of the six great cities, or else the place where a Tathāgata resided on many occasions. If the name of the king is forgotten, it shall be Prasenajit. The name of the householder shall be Anāthapiṇḍada. The name of the laywoman shall be Mṛgāramātā Viśākhā. The former traditional seat shall be Vārāṇasī. The king shall be Brahmadatta. The householder shall be Saṃgharakṣita. The laywoman shall be declared to be the wife of the householder Poṣadhajāta. If the sūtras, Vinaya, and Abhidharma are forgotten, they shall be written on tablets and preserved, and in this one should have no regret."

The buddha, the Blessed One, was residing at Rājagṛha in the Kalandaka Bamboo Grove. Kings, ministers, brahmins, householders, townsfolk, countryfolk, the wealthy, merchants, and caravan leaders paid him honor, held him as supreme, paid him homage, and made offerings to him; and thus the Blessed One obtained robes, alms-food, lodgings, and medicines as remedies for illness, along with all requisites. The tīrthikas, however, were not honored, held as supreme, paid homage, or offered reverence by kings, ministers, brahmins, householders, townsfolk, countryfolk, the wealthy, merchants, or caravan leaders; and thus they did not obtain robes, alms-food, bedding,

medicines as remedies for illness, or any requisites.

Then the evil Māra thought to himself: "For a long time I have been looking for an opportunity against the ascetic Gautama but have not found one. Now I shall look for an opportunity against the tīrthikas." At that time, Pūraṇa and the other six teachers — those who arrogated to themselves omniscience without truly being omniscient — were dwelling in Rājagṛha. Then the evil Māra manifested himself in the very appearance of Pūraṇa and went to the son of the dark-roaming god Kāḷa, and upon arriving before the son of that dark-roaming god, he displayed miraculous feats of blazing, radiance, rainfall, and flashing lightning. The son of the dark-roaming god Kāḷa said: "Pūraṇa, have you attained such a collection of qualities as this?" "I have." In the same way, he also went before Saṅgha's son Vairatīputra, before Ajita Keśakambala, before Kakuda's son Kātyāyana, and before Nirgrantha's son, and before each he displayed those miraculous feats of blazing, radiance, rainfall, and flashing lightning, and each of them said: "Pūraṇa, have you attained such a collection of qualities as this?" "I have."

In the same way, manifesting himself in the appearance of the son of the dark-roaming god Kāḷa, he went before all of them; and then, likewise manifesting himself in the appearance of Ajita Keśakambala, he went before all of them and said: "Have you attained such a collection of qualities as this? I have" — and so forth, as before. In the same way, manifesting himself in the appearance of Saṅgha's son Vairatīputra, he went before all of them — and so forth, as before. In the same way, manifesting himself in the appearance of Kakuda's son Kātyāyana, he went before all of them — and so forth, as before.

In the same way, manifesting himself in the appearance of the Nirgrantha's son, he went before all of them — and so forth, as before. Each of them then thought to himself: "All of these, apart from me alone, are of great power and great supernatural ability."

Then, at another time, the six teachers beginning with Pūraṇa Kassapa assembled and gathered in a council hall, and there they raised conversation of this kind: "Friends, in former times kings, ministers, brahmins, householders, townspeople, country folk, the wealthy, merchant chiefs, and caravan leaders honored us, paid homage to us, and venerated us, and thereby we obtained robes, alms-food, lodgings, medicinal remedies for the sick, and requisites. Now they no longer honor us, no longer attend upon us, no longer revere us, no longer venerate us" — and so on through to: "and we

no longer obtain robes, alms-food, lodgings, medicinal remedies for the sick, and requisites" — all as before. "Friends, the śramaṇa Gautama is honored and paid homage" — and so on through to: "the śramaṇa Gautama obtains robes, alms-food, lodgings, medicinal remedies for the sick, and requisites" — all as before. "Friends, therefore let us challenge the śramaṇa Gautama to a contest of the miraculous display of superhuman qualities and supernatural powers. If the śramaṇa Gautama displays one miraculous display of superhuman qualities and supernatural powers, we will display two; if he displays two, we will display four; if he displays four, we will display eight; if he displays eight, we will display sixteen; if he displays sixteen, we will display thirty-two — however many miraculous displays of superhuman qualities and supernatural powers the śramaṇa Gautama displays, we will display them doubled and tripled."

Then the six teachers beginning with Pūraṇa Kassapa went to wherever King Bimbisāra was, and having greeted the king and exchanged pleasantries, they said this: "Your Majesty, we claim to possess supernatural powers and to be endowed with gnosis. The śramaṇa Gautama likewise, we believe, claims to possess supernatural powers and to be endowed with gnosis. Therefore it would be fitting that both those claiming to be endowed with gnosis together display miraculous displays of superhuman qualities and supernatural powers. If the śramaṇa Gautama displays one, we will display two" — and so on through to "we will display them doubled and tripled" — all as before. "Please also invite the śramaṇa Gautama to the second half of the day; we too shall come for the second half of the day."

Then the king of Magadha, Bimbisāra the artisan — Śreṇya — spoke to the six teachers beginning with Pūraṇa Kassapa: "Well then, shall you likewise challenge the Blessed One to a contest of the miraculous display of superhuman qualities and supernatural powers?" When the king spoke these words, they went off.

Now at another time, the king of Magadha, Bimbisāra the artisan — Śreṇya — departed from Rājagṛha and went into the presence of the Blessed One in order to see him and pay him respect. They intercepted the king on his road and greeted him and exchanged pleasantries, then said: "Your Majesty, we claim to possess supernatural powers and to be endowed with gnosis" — and so on as before.

"— displaying the miraculous display of superhuman qualities two-fold and three-fold: let the ascetic Gautama be invited to the latter half of the contest; we too will come to the latter half" — and so on as before.

The king said: "Enough of this for now. If you say this sort of thing a third time, I shall have you driven out and sent away." He had them turned back, and they departed.

When they returned to their own place, they deliberated again: "Sages, it is said that the king of Magadha, Bimbisāra the artisan — Śreṇya — is inclined toward the ascetic Gautama, and that in Śrāvastī there is a king of Kosala named Prasenajit who is, as it were, a bystander. When the ascetic Gautama comes to Śrāvastī, let us issue a challenge to him there regarding the miraculous display of superhuman qualities."

Then after some time the Blessed One stayed in Rājagṛha as long as he wished, and then set out travelling through the provinces in the direction of Śrāvastī. While he was making his way progressively through the provinces, he arrived at Śrāvastī and dwelt there in the Jeta Grove — the pleasure grove of Anāthapiṇḍada — belonging to the prince Jeta.

Then the six teachers beginning with Pūraṇa likewise followed after the Blessed One and went to Śrāvastī. When they too arrived at Śrāvastī in due course, weary from the road, they rested, then went to the place where the king of Kosala, Prasenajit, was. They greeted the king of Kosala, Prasenajit, with lengthy salutations, and said: "Your Majesty, we claim to possess supernatural powers and to be endowed with gnosis. The ascetic Gautama too, we believe, claims to possess supernatural powers and to be endowed with gnosis. Because of this, it is fitting that those who claim gnosis together with one who claims gnosis should display the miraculous display of superhuman qualities. If the ascetic Gautama displays the miraculous display of superhuman qualities once, we will display it twice; if the ascetic Gautama does so twice, we will do so four times; if the ascetic Gautama does so four times, we will do so eight times; if the ascetic Gautama does so eight times, we will do so sixteen times; if the ascetic Gautama does so sixteen times, we will do so thirty-two times — whatever the miraculous display of superhuman qualities the ascetic Gautama may display, we will display the miraculous display of superhuman qualities two-fold and three-fold beyond it. Let the ascetic Gautama be invited to the latter half of the contest; we too will come to the latter half."

The king of Kosala, Prasenajit, said: "Sages, if that is so, wait while I petition the Blessed One about this." They replied: "Your Majesty, please do so; we will wait."

Then the king of Kosala, Prasenajit, went to where the Blessed One was, touched his head to the feet of the Blessed One in homage, and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the king of Kosala, Prasenajit, addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Venerable One, these non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) are challenging the Blessed One to a contest of the miraculous display of superhuman qualities. Therefore, may the Blessed One please display the miraculous display of superhuman qualities. May the Blessed One please defeat the non-Buddhists. May the gods and humans be made glad. May the holy ones rejoice." When he had spoken these words, the Blessed One declared to the king of Kosala, Prasenajit as follows:

"Great King, I do not teach the Dharma to the hearers in this way: 'Monks, display for these brahmins and householders who have come here the miraculous display of superhuman qualities that surpass the human.' Rather, I teach the Dharma to the hearers in this way: 'Monks, do not be indolent in virtue. Confess wrongdoing and be purified of it.'"

The king of Kosala, Prasenajit, then addressed the Blessed One a second and a third time with these words: "Venerable One, since these non-Buddhists are challenging the Blessed One to a contest of the miraculous display of superhuman qualities, may the Blessed One please display the miraculous display of superhuman qualities. May the non-Buddhists be defeated. May the gods and humans be made glad. May the holy ones rejoice."

The Blessed One declared to the king of Kosala, Prasenajit, a second and a third time: "Great King, I do not teach the Dharma to the hearers in this way: 'Monks, display for these brahmins and householders who have come here the miraculous display of superhuman qualities that surpass the human.' Rather, I teach the Dharma to the hearers in this way: 'Monks, do not be indolent in virtue. Confess wrongdoing and be purified of it.'"

There are five things that the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, perform without fail. What are these five? They cause sentient beings, without distinction of earlier or later, to give rise to the mind of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. They confer empowerment upon the hearers who have accumulated wholesome roots, empowering them as regents. They establish father and mother in the truth. They display the great miraculous performance

at Śrāvastī. And they tame all those whom a buddha is to tame.

Reflecting on where the previous perfectly and completely awakened buddhas had displayed the great miraculous performance, the Blessed One saw that it was at Śrāvastī. And reflecting on how much time it would take for the great assembly of people to comprehend it fully, he knew it would be after seven days had passed. He then declared to the king of Kosala, Prasenajit: 'Great King, go and make the necessary arrangements and preparations.' 'Blessed One, how much time?' 'Great King, seven days.'

Then the king of Kosala, Prasenajit prostrated with his head at the feet of the Blessed One, withdrew from the presence of the Blessed One, and went to the non-Buddhists and said: "The Blessed One will display the great miraculous performance in seven days. Whatever preparations and arrangements you need to make, do so."

The non-Buddhists deliberated among themselves: "Friends, the ascetic Gautama will either flee or he will seek allies. If he seeks allies, how are we to counter him?" They said to one another: "Friends, the ascetic Gautama will certainly seek allies. So if that is indeed what happens, we too shall seek allies."

Now at that time in the city of Kuśa there lived a wanderer called Supriya — old, bent, and worn — who was honored, attended upon, venerated, respected, and revered as an arhat by the warriors of the city of Kuśa. Having conferred among themselves, the non-Buddhists went to him and said: "Supriya, you and we are fellow practitioners of the holy life. We implore you: be an ally to us against the ascetic Gautama in the contest of the miraculous display of superhuman qualities." He replied:

"Friends, you have done wrong in challenging the ascetic Gautama to a contest of the miraculous display of superhuman qualities. Why? Because his miraculous power is great, his might is great." "How do you know this?" "It is a well-founded assertion. What reasoning supports it?"

"Friends, during the time when the ascetic Gautama had not yet appeared in the world, I used to dwell by day on the bank of the great lake called Anavatapta, and after taking my alms-round I would go to the great lake Anavatapta to eat. There, as I sat in one quarter, the gods dwelling at Anavatapta would pour water over me and offer it as a gift. Yet when the ascetic Gautama appeared in the world, his foremost śrāvaka — the one called Śāriputra, the one who urges the ascetic's monks — would come to the great

lake Anavatapta carrying a cloth-fan. Those same gods dwelling at Anavatapta would wash that cloth-fan of his and present it as an offering, and they would then pour the water from the washing upon their own heads. For this reason, you have done wrong in challenging one whose very disciple is so incomparably exalted above us — you have done wrong in challenging him to a contest of the miraculous display of superhuman qualities."

The non-Buddhists said among themselves, "This one too is on his side; let us go and seek others elsewhere." Then, treating him with customary shows of respect while inwardly dissembling, they departed. They sat down in another secluded place and deliberated: "Friends, how should we go about seeking other allies?"

Some of them said, "In the city's pleasure grove there dwells a great one possessed of the five higher knowledges. Go to him — he will become our ally." Others said, "He will not be able to help. But in the forest of ascetics there dwells a great one called the Great Ascetic who possesses the five higher knowledges. Go to him — he will become our ally."

Now at that time, in a mountain valley adorned with forests of many kinds of trees, lovely with springs of water, flowers, fruits, and roots in abundance, and beautified with streams and lakes, there lived some five hundred seers, most of whom possessed the five higher knowledges. Among them, one seer possessing the five higher knowledges had come to the vicinity of the city, and as he wandered about, he happened to come to where those non-Buddhists were gathered. They greeted him with the customary welcome, saying "Well come!" and asked him, "Where have you come from?" He told them all that had transpired. They felt heartened and went along with him. After taking mutual delight in one another's company and resting from the weariness of the road, they said: "Friends, you and we are fellow practitioners of the holy life. Since we are challenging the ascetic Gautama to a contest of the miraculous display of superhuman qualities, please be our ally as well." The seers replied: "Very well, let it be so — but first, show us a sign."

Those non-Buddhists departed, having pleased the seers with respectful and agreeable speech.

Now, in that same period, a younger brother of Prasenajit, the king of Kosala — a young prince by the name of Nagnaja — adorned with garlands of scent and flowers, had passed below the royal palace on his way down, when one of the king's consorts, from the upper terrace of a fine chamber above, dropped a

flower garland which fell upon his body. Another person saw this. Since in the world there are those who are friendly, those who are hostile, and those who are indifferent, that person reported it to a minister. The minister then informed the king: "Majesty, the young prince Nagnaja has been intimate with the royal consort."

Since kings act without proper investigation, the king issued an order to his ministers: "Wise ones, dispatch the young prince Nagnaja at once and have him rendered without hands and feet." They dragged him to the marketplace, cut off his hands and feet, and left him there, while his kinsmen, their eyes filled with tears, and great crowds of other people as well, all gathered around him and sat watching.

It was then that some tīrthikas arrived in that same place. His kinsmen addressed them and asked: "Noble ones, please make a truth declaration so that the limbs and members of the young prince Nagnaja may be restored to what they were before." At that, the tīrthikas, having no confidence, rose up and departed without saying a word.

It was then that the venerable Ānanda, while wandering on his alms round, came to that place. His kinsmen said to him: "Noble Ānanda, please make a truth declaration so that the limbs and members of the young prince Nagnaja may be restored to what they were before." He replied: "Friends, I will go and ask the Blessed One." At this they breathed a sigh of relief, saying: "Now he is saved!"

The venerable Ānanda went without delay to Śrāvastī, set down his alms bowl, approached the Blessed One, and reported the matter to him at length. The Blessed One then declared: "Ānanda, go and let the kinsmen of the young prince Nagnaja position his limbs and members in their proper place, and then make a truth declaration in this manner:

By the truth and the truth declaration through which, among all sentient beings — those without feet, those with two feet, those with four feet, those with many feet, those with form, those without form, those with perception, those without perception, and those that are neither with nor without perception — the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha is proclaimed the highest; and through which, among all conditioned and unconditioned phenomena, the state free of attachment is proclaimed the highest; and through which, among all assemblies, multitudes, congregations, and retinues, the Saṅgha of the Tathāgata's śrāvakas is

proclaimed the highest; and through which, among all those who abide in moral discipline, vows, austerity, and the holy life, the noble Vinaya of which the noble ones delight is proclaimed the highest: by this truth and this truth declaration, may the limbs and members of the young prince Nagnaja be restored to what they were before.

And they will be restored to what they were before."

The venerable Ānanda respectfully accepted the Blessed One's words just as he had spoken them, and the kinsmen, having positioned the limbs and members in their proper place, then began to make the truth declaration in this way, from the words "By the truth and the truth declaration through which, among all sentient beings — those without feet" all the way through to "may the limbs and members be restored to what they were before by this truth and truth declaration, through which the noble Vinaya in which the noble ones delight is proclaimed the highest" — just as before. And through the power of that truth declaration, his limbs and members were restored to exactly what they had been before. The crowd of people opened their eyes wide in amazement, and a great cry went up: "Wonderful! The noble Ānanda has defeated the tīrthikas!"

Then the venerable Ānanda led the young prince Nagnaja to where the Blessed One was, and arriving there, he bowed his head to the feet of the Blessed One and sat down to one side.

Seated to one side, the venerable Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "Venerable sir, the young prince Nagnaja is here." Thereupon the young prince Nagnaja bowed his head to the feet of the Blessed One and sat down to one side.

The Blessed One, having understood the prince's disposition, his latent tendencies, his elemental constitution, and his inherent nature, then taught the Dharma suited to him. The moment the young prince Nagnaja heard it, he directly realized the truth and actualized the fruit of non-returning, and he also attained miraculous powers.

Then Prasenajit, king of Kosala, heard that the noble Ānanda, by performing the truth declaration exactly as told, had restored the limbs and members of the young prince Nagnaja to what they had been before. Hearing this, he went to where the young prince Nagnaja was, and upon arriving, said to him: "Young man, come — return home." The prince replied, "Your Majesty, I wish to attend upon the Blessed One and shall remain right here." "Very well, do as you please," said the king, and he had lodgings prepared for him within the

Ānandavana grove. While he was dwelling there, his scattered limbs and members rejoined one another, and so the place came to be called the Grove of Rejoining — the Khaṇḍānandavana.

Then King Prasenajit of Kosala went to where the Blessed One was, bowed his head to the feet of the Blessed One, and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, King Prasenajit of Kosala said to the Blessed One: "If the Blessed One would permit it, I wish to build a hall for the display of the Great Miracle along the entire road from Śrāvastī to the Jeta Grove." The Blessed One declared, "Well done, great king — do so! There, without doubt, a great assembly of people will gather."

And so King Prasenajit of Kosala, along the entire stretch from Śrāvastī to the Jeta Grove, had the ground thoroughly cleared and prepared a hall for the display of the Great Miracle. The hall was draped with hundreds of thousands of cloth canopies arranged in tiers; it was sprinkled with fragrant sandalwood water; vessels of sweet-smelling incense were set out; banners and victory standards were raised; clusters of silk streamers were hung; flowers of many kinds were scattered — all so that the place was made as delightful as the pleasure groves and gardens of the gods. And for the Blessed One, he also had prepared a golden lion throne adorned and ornamented with vajra, lapis lazuli, emerald, coral, wish-fulfilling gems, pearls, the crystal andara stone, great blue sapphires, and rubies.

The lay supporters of the tīrthikas likewise constructed six halls of their own, draped with cloth befitting their respective resources, and set out six seats. The tīrthikas then came early, surrounded by their own retinues, and sat there. They sent a messenger to the king saying, "Your Majesty, we are present — please invite the ascetic Gautama."

When the king heard this, he set out for the hall of the Great Miracle together with his queens, his young courtiers, and the people of the palace. From there he said to the brahmin youth who served as his chief minister: "Brahmin youth, come here — go to where the Blessed One is dwelling." The minister went, bowed his head to the feet of the Blessed One, and inquired after his health on the king's behalf, asking: "Is there little discomfort? Little weariness? Are you at ease? In good health? Are you in a state of strength and comfort? Is nothing troubling?" Then he said further: "Venerable sir, those tīrthikas have assembled and are present. Please, Blessed One, be mindful that the time has come."

"So be it, Your Majesty" — thus the brahmin youth who served as chief minister received the command of Prasenajit, King of Kosala, and went to where the Blessed One was dwelling. On arriving, he and the Blessed One exchanged various pleasant and cordial words with one another, and then he sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the brahmin youth who served as chief minister said to the Blessed One: "Gautama, Prasenajit, King of Kosala, bows his head to the feet of Gautama and inquires after his health: Is there little discomfort? Little weariness? Are you at ease? In good health? Are you in a state of strength and comfort? Is nothing troubling?" And he added: "May you be well, brahmin youth who serves as chief minister of Prasenajit, King of Kosala. From Prasenajit, King of Kosala: Gautama, those tīrthikas have assembled and are present in the Hall of the Great Miracle. Please, Blessed One, be mindful that the time has come." The Blessed One declared: "Minister, go ahead — I too shall come." The brahmin youth who served as chief minister departed.

Then the Blessed One, blessing himself just as the king of swans stretches forth its wings, rose into the middle of the sky. Countless hundreds of thousands of living beings opened eyes of wonder and cried out "Aha!" in sounds of astonishment and amazement, gazing upward as he descended from the sky into the Hall of the Great Miracle. When Prasenajit, King of Kosala, saw this arrival, his mind was filled with wonder and faith, and he said to the tīrthikas: "Behold — the Blessed One has already displayed the supreme superhuman miracle-display transcending the human. Now your turn has come: you display yours." They replied: "Your Majesty, with this great assembly of people gathered here, whose is this great miracle — is it the ascetic Gautama's, or is it ours? Whose is it? Let someone determine that."

Then at that very moment, by the miraculous power of Cullapanthaka of the Jeta Grove, a mango tree arose fragrant with the scent of mountain herbs, wreathed in many white mango branches, leaves, and petals, with many flocks of birds giving voice — and he set it to the north of the Hall of the Great Miracle. The king saw this too, and joy arose in him. He said to the tīrthikas a second time: "Behold — the Blessed One has already displayed the supreme superhuman miracle-display transcending the human. Now your turn has come: you display yours." They replied: "Your Majesty, did we not already put this question to you? With this great assembly of people gathered here, whose is this great miracle — is it the ascetic Gautama's, or is it ours? Whose is it? Let someone determine that."

Then at that very moment the householder Anāthapiṇḍika, by his miraculous power, took the wish-fulfilling tree of the gods of the Thirty-Three and set it to the south of the Hall of the Great Miracle. When Prasenajit, King of Kosala, saw this as well, great delight and joy arose in him, and he said to the tīrthikas a third time: "Behold — the Blessed One has already displayed the supreme superhuman miracle-display transcending the human. Now your turn has come: you display yours." They replied: "We did ask, Your Majesty. But now we ask a third time: Your Majesty, with this great assembly of people gathered here, whose is this great miracle — is it the ascetic Gautama's, or is it ours? Whose is it? Let someone determine that."

Then many hundreds and thousands of living beings who were delighted to behold the Blessed One's great miracle-display gathered there, and many hundreds and thousands of gods gathered in the midst of the sky. The Blessed One washed his feet outside the hall, entered the hall, sat upon the prepared seat, and entered meditative absorption in the element of fire. From within the crevice of the door a beam of light emerged and began to burn all the tīrthikas' tents of the great miracle-display. The tīrthikas said: "Your Majesty, now that the ascetic Gautama's tents of the great miracle-display are burning and ablaze, surely if the ascetic Gautama is here in time he will extinguish them." But the king said nothing, sitting silently with the thought held inwardly to himself. Likewise, Queen Vimalā, the noble lady of the kṣatriya caste Yārtsulma, the brahmin soothsayer Jyin, and Nyingpa, and the householder Anāthapiṇḍada, and the female lay practitioner Migdak Dré'i Masa, and many other faithful ones, and some who remained neutral — all likewise said nothing and sat in silence. But the tīrthikas and their disciples became exceedingly delighted.

Then that fire burned away every impurity of the tents of the great miracle-display and then subsided of its own accord, so that — by the power of the buddhas, the power of a buddha, and by the power of the gods, the power of a god — the tents of the great miracle-display stood immaculate, clear, and beautiful. Then again the king, filled with joy and happiness as if rescued from the loss of his own life, addressed the tīrthikas, saying: "Behold — the Blessed One has already displayed the supreme superhuman miracle-display transcending the human. Now your turn has come: you display yours." But they, having no boldness, said nothing and sat in silence.

Then the Blessed One, with deliberate intention, placed his right foot inside the privy, and the earth shook in six ways: this great earth trembled, trembled

all around, trembled all around and thoroughly; it quaked, quaked all around, quaked all around and thoroughly — so that when the east rose high the west sank low, when the west rose high the east sank low, when the north rose high the south sank low, when the south rose high the north sank low, when the center rose high the edges sank low, and when the edges rose high the center sank low.

That earthquake stirred the hermits dwelling in the pleasure grove amid the Himalayan ranges. They said to one another: "Wise friends, those brahmins who practice brahmahood equal to ours are displaying their signs — let us go and see them." And having said so, they set out. The Blessed One, seeing that they were to be tamed, spread forth rays of light with a brilliance surpassing a thousand suns, the color of refined gold, so that the entire distance from the Blessed One to those hermits was transformed to the likeness of pure molten gold.

Those hermits then beheld the Buddha, the Blessed One: as beautiful as the disc of the sun rising for the first time; like a heap of refined gold nuggets piled together; with the luster of a mass of kurandaka flowers and a cluster of campaka blossoms; with a voice deep, stable, and clear as a rain cloud, as the ocean, as the finest of swans, and as the sound of a drum — pleasing and sweet to hear; adorned with a treasury of whiteness like the fresh foam of an ocean of milk on the side that falls away, like a garland of pearls, like the root-tendrils of a lotus, like a white goose, like kunda flowers, like a mound of crystals; abiding in an inconceivable and boundless assemblage of wondrous qualities beyond all reckoning —

free from the blemish of the swamp of defilement that delights in the joys and pleasures of existence and in the mire of attachment to honor and veneration; renowned as one adorned with the ornament of unsurpassable wisdom, utterly perfected, accumulated over measureless ages; whose two feet are touched by the jeweled sprouts of the crowns of the lord of gods (Śakra, Indra); revered by gods, asuras, humans, devas, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, mantra-holders, and serpentine beings worthy of worship — in brief, that body, excellent and beautiful, was seen adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being and ornamented with the eighty minor marks, encircled by a fathom-wide halo of radiance, his brilliance exceeding that of a thousand suns, altogether beautiful to behold like a moving mountain of precious jewels.

Just as a sentient being who has accumulated the roots of virtue sees a buddha for the first time — like one who has cultivated the mind of calm abiding for twelve years, or a childless woman who finds a child, or a pauper who discovers a treasure, or a prince long eager for the throne who is at last consecrated as king — yet not quite like any of these, those sages prostrated at the feet of the Blessed One, touching their heads to the ground, and then sat to one side.

The Blessed One, knowing their intentions, their underlying dispositions, their elements, and their natures, taught Dharma of such a kind as would lead them to realize the Four Noble Truths. Upon hearing it, they shattered with the vajra of wisdom the twenty-peak mountain of the view of the transitory collection (the belief in a substantial self), and they directly actualized the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truth, they rose from their seats, joined their palms and bowed in the direction where the Blessed One was, and addressed the Blessed One in these words:

"Venerable One, if we might receive the status of monks — going forth and receiving full ordination — in the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, we wish to lead the holy life of brahmacarya in the presence of the Blessed One."

The Blessed One gave them the going-forth and full ordination, and they received his instructions. Through zealous and sustained effort, they came to know this very fifth part of the wheel of saṃsāra — its moving and its still — and to understand that all formations are characterized by disintegration, downfall, dispersion, and destruction. Having abandoned all afflictions, they directly actualized arhatship itself.

Those arhats were free from attachment and desire in all three realms; they were impartial toward gold and clods of earth, toward the sky and the palm of the hand, toward sandalwood and dung. By wisdom they shattered the hollow throat of the cave of ignorance. They attained the superknowledges (abhijñā) and the individual perfect understandings (pratisaṃvid). They had turned their backs on attachment to existence and gain, and on the receiving of gifts and service. They came to be honored, revered, and respected by the gods together with Indra and Upendra.

Then the Blessed One, attended by a retinue of five hundred arhats surrounding him like the orb of a full moon, went to that hall of great miracles and arrived there, and in the midst of an assembly of many hundreds of thousands he took his seat upon a lion throne.

Then the laywoman Rdzu'phrul len ma went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, she prostrated at the feet of the Blessed One and addressed him thus:

"Blessed One, please be without even a small concern. I shall display before the tīrthikas the miraculous performance of superhuman Dharma, the great miracle of supernatural power, and I shall put the tīrthikas to flight. I shall gladden the gods and humans. I shall delight the noble persons."

The Blessed One then declared:

"Rdzu'phrul len ma, have no concern whatsoever. Although you are indeed capable of displaying before the tīrthikas the miraculous performance of superhuman Dharma, the great miracle of supernatural power, of putting the tīrthikas to flight, of gladdening the gods and humans, and of delighting the noble persons — nevertheless, these tīrthikas will not summon you to the miraculous performance of superhuman Dharma. They will summon me to the miraculous performance of superhuman Dharma, and so I myself shall display to them the miraculous performance of superhuman Dharma. For if you were to display before them the miraculous performance of superhuman Dharma, the tīrthikas would say: 'The ascetic Gautama possesses no miraculous performance of superhuman Dharma — yet this śrāvaka laywoman, Rdzu'phrul len ma, one of such great supernatural power and such great might, displays the miraculous performance of superhuman Dharma together with us.' Therefore remain seated just as you are."

And she remained seated just as she was. The householder Anāthapiṇḍada, the novice monk Kulabhadra, the novice nun Amogha, the nun Utpalavaṇṇā, and likewise most of the others who possessed supernatural powers — all were the same.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, he prostrated with his head at the feet of the Blessed One and addressed the Blessed One thus:

"Blessed One, please be without even a small concern. I shall display before the tīrthikas the miraculous performance of superhuman Dharma, the great miracle of supernatural power, and I shall put the tīrthikas to flight. I shall gladden the gods and humans. I shall delight the noble persons."

The Blessed One then declared:

"Maudgalyāyana, have no concern whatsoever. Although you are indeed capable of displaying before the tīrthikas the miraculous performance of superhuman Dharma, the great miracle of supernatural power, of putting the tīrthikas to flight, of gladdening the gods and humans, and of delighting the noble persons — nevertheless, these tīrthikas will not summon you to the miraculous performance of superhuman Dharma. It is I whom they have summoned to the miraculous performance of superhuman Dharma, and so I myself shall display to them the miraculous performance of superhuman Dharma. For if you were to display before them the miraculous performance of superhuman Dharma, the tīrthikas would say: 'The ascetic Gautama possesses no miraculous performance of superhuman Dharma — yet this śrāvaka monk Maudgalyāyana, one of such great supernatural power and such great might, displays the miraculous performance of superhuman Dharma together with us.' Therefore remain seated just as you are."

And he too remained seated just as he was.

Then the Blessed One addressed Prasenajit, the king of Kośala:

"Great king, who is it that has requested the Tathāgata to display the miraculous performance of superhuman Dharma before the tīrthikas?"

Thereupon Prasenajit, king of Kośala, rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, turned toward the Blessed One, joined his palms in reverence, and addressed the Blessed One thus:

"Venerable Blessed One, it is I who request you to display before the tīrthikas the miraculous performance of superhuman Dharma, the great miracle of supernatural power, to put the tīrthikas to flight, and to"

"bring joy to gods and humans, and to gladden the hearts of noble beings — it is I who make this request. This will be for the long-term welfare, benefit, and happiness of the multitude of beings, including ascetics and brahmins, gods and humans."

Upon this request, the Blessed One gave his consent to Prasenajit, king of Kośala, by remaining silent. Prasenajit, king of Kośala, understanding from the Blessed One's silence that consent had been granted, remained seated in his place.

Then the Blessed One, entering into that meditative absorption wherein he would be invisible from his own seat as he remained in equipoise, rose visibly into the sky to the east and there performed the four deportments — walking,

standing, sitting, and lying down. Entering into the meditative absorption of the fire element, from the body of the Blessed One, the Buddha, there streamed forth rays of many colors: blue, yellow, red, white, crimson, and the color of crystal. In the miracle of the twin display, from the lower part of his body fire blazed forth while from the upper part a stream of cool water flowed down; and then fire blazed from the upper part while a stream of cool water flowed from the lower part. As it was to the east, so too to the south, west, and north: having displayed in all four directions the fourfold miracle of supernatural power, he gathered in the display of miraculous power and then took his seat upon the lion throne.

The Blessed One then addressed Prasenajit, king of Kośala: "Great king, this miraculous power of the Tathāgata is held in common with all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas."

The Blessed One then put this question: "Great king, who is it that has requested the Tathāgata to display before the tīrthikas and the assembly of people the supreme great miracle?"

Thereupon Prasenajit, king of Kośala, rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, turned toward the Blessed One, joined his palms in reverence, and addressed the Blessed One thus: "Venerable Blessed One, it is I who have requested the Blessed One to display before the tīrthikas and the assembly of people the supreme great miracle, to put the tīrthikas to flight, to bring joy to gods and humans, and to gladden the hearts of noble beings. This will be for the long-term welfare, benefit, and happiness of the multitude of beings, including ascetics and brahmins, gods and humans."

Upon this request, the Blessed One gave his consent to Prasenajit, king of Kośala, by remaining silent. Prasenajit, king of Kośala, understanding from the Blessed One's silence that consent had been granted, remained seated in his place.

The thirty-second fascicle of the Minor Bases of Discipline.

Then the Blessed One touched the earth with his hand — that hand marked with a wheel, with auspicious signs, and adorned with a webbed pattern, born from many hundreds of meritorious deeds, granting relief from fears — and he roused within himself a worldly intention, thinking: "Even if the nāgas were to come bearing a lotus-wood wheel the size of a chariot wheel, fitted with a thousand petals, made entirely of gold, with streams of jewels and dewdrops of vajra, it would still be manageable."

Now it is the very nature of reality that when the blessed buddhas rouse a worldly intention, even small creatures such as ants and worms come to know the mind and thought of the Blessed One; yet when they rouse a supramundane intention, not even śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas are able to know the mind and thought of the Blessed One.

To say nothing of the nāgas who had taken birth in the animal realm — as the Blessed One touched the earth, they saw that he was displaying a great miracle. They carried a lotus the size of a chariot wheel, with a thousand petals, made entirely of gold, with streams of jewels and dewdrops of vajra, and emerged from beneath the ground. The Blessed One then took his seat at the heart of that lotus.

Thereupon, to the right and left of the Blessed One, a great multitude of other lotuses just like it arose, and upon each of them emanation buddhas (nirmāṇakāyas) took their seats. To the right and left of those in turn, still other such lotuses appeared, and upon them yet others — and so it continued, all the way to the realm of Akaniṣṭha, with emanation buddhas filling the expanse without limit. Among those buddhas, some blazed with light, some shone with radiance, some caused rain to fall, some sent forth lightning, some proclaimed omniscient prophecy, some posed questions, some gave replies, some paced in walking meditation, some sat cross-legged, some stood, some remained seated, and some lay in repose — and through this, a blessing was granted such that even young children could behold the body of the Buddha without obstruction.

Witnessing this great miracle, Prasenajit, king of Kosala, together with the retinue of the queen, the princes, the ministers, the people of the royal court, and the many hundreds of thousands of living beings who had come from various lands, and the many hundreds of thousands of gods in the midst of the sky — all gazed upon the Blessed One's great miracle with unblinking eyes and paid homage to him without cease. The gods dwelling in the sky beat their drums. In every quarter, great kettledrums were struck, conch shells were blown, and all manner of musical sounds arose; some sang and some danced.

Even the creatures belonging to the animal realm felt joy arise in their hearts and called out in many varied sounds and voices, each according to its own kind: horses neighed, elephants trumpeted, donkeys brayed, cattle lowed, and peacocks cried. Joy and great delight arose in all beings, gods and humans alike, and they became eager to make offerings to the Blessed One.

Then the gods scattered divine flowers — utpala, lotus, kumuda, white lotus, and māṇḍārava. They also scattered divine powdered agaru, powdered saffron, powdered sandalwood, and divine garments, and all the humans and non-humans did likewise.

When this great festival arose, the Blessed One himself, in order that those to be trained might understand, declared these verses:

One should strive and renounce,
and exert oneself in the Buddha's teaching.
Like a great elephant at a house of reeds,
one should crush the hosts of the lord of death.

Whoever practices this discipline of Dharma
with care and diligence,
having utterly abandoned the wandering of birth,
will bring suffering to its end.

Then all the remaining emanation buddhas likewise declared these verses in unison:

So long as the sun has not yet risen,
fireflies glow bright in the darkness.
But when the sun rises in the sky,
the fireflies grow dim and their brightness is gone.

So long as the Tathāgata has not yet appeared,
logicians shine bright and stand in the fore.
When the perfectly awakened Buddha illumines the world,
the logicians grow dim — they are not his disciples.

Then the Blessed One addressed the monks: "O monks, the great miracle is about to disappear — take note of these signs."

The moment the Blessed One had spoken these words, the great miracle instantly became invisible. As soon as it vanished, Prasenajit, king of Kosala, addressed the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) with these words: "The Blessed One has now displayed the great miracle — the supreme wonder surpassing all human mastery. Now it is your turn: let each of you demonstrate what you can."

Then Pūraṇa Kassapa, saying nothing at all, passed the matter on to the son of the wanderer Kṛṣṇadeva. He in turn passed it to Vijayaputra, son of Smarā. He passed it to the one with matted hair, disciple of Ajita. He passed it to the one

with dark hair, son of Kātyāyanī. He passed it to the naked ascetic, son of Jñāti. And when it came back again to Pūraṇa Kassapa, not a single one of them spoke. Even when the king addressed them two and three times, they simply kept passing it one to another, saying nothing — each retreating into himself, shrinking down, hanging their heads in shame, without a word of confidence, crushed inwardly with dismay.

Then Vajrapāṇi the yakṣa thought to himself: "These foolish men have long been challenging the Blessed One, and so now I must find a way to make them scatter and flee." To this end he sent down a fierce downward wind and a driving rain of such force that the great miracle hall became utterly invisible to their eyes. Some fled in terror and took shelter in the clefts of mountains; some in thickets of grass; some in dense forests; some in the assembly hall; and some in temples.

The Blessed One, meanwhile, remained seated within his own great miracle hall, and he declared these verses:

People seized with fear and panic
mostly go for refuge to mountains,
to forests and sacred groves,
to trees, and to stūpas.

That is not the foremost refuge,
that is not the supreme refuge —
relying on such refuge,
one is not fully freed from all suffering.

But whoever, at any time, goes for refuge
to the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha,
and, with wisdom, truly contemplates
the Four Noble Truths of the noble ones —
suffering, the origin of suffering,
the genuine transcendence of suffering,
and the noble eightfold path
that leads to the bliss of nirvāṇa —

that is the foremost refuge,
that is the supreme refuge —
relying on that refuge,
one is fully freed from all suffering.

Then the Blessed One, having discerned the intentions, latent tendencies, faculties, and natures of the assembled gathering, taught the Dharma accordingly — a teaching such that, upon hearing it, many hundreds of sentient beings attained great distinction. Some directly realized the fruit of stream-entry; some the fruit of once-returning; some the fruit of non-returning; some abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhatship. Some generated the mind of awakening aimed at the enlightenment of a śrāvaka; some aimed at the enlightenment of a pratyekabuddha; and some generated the awakening mind (bodhicitta) aimed at unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. The great majority of the assembly was thereby established as those who inclined toward the Buddha, who entered into the Dharma, and who took refuge in the Saṅgha.

Then the Blessed One rightly instructed that assembly with a Dharma discourse, rightly led them to receive it, rightly praised and gladdened them, and then rose from his seat and departed.

Thereafter the disciples of Pūraṇa Kassapa asked him: "Master, please tell us — what is the real nature of things?" In response he told some of his disciples this: "My son, this is the way it is: the world is permanent — that is the true reality." But to others he said: "It is impermanent."

To yet others he said: "It is both permanent and impermanent." To others: "It is neither permanent nor impermanent." To some he said: "It has a limit." To others: "It is limitless." To others: "It both has a limit and is limitless." To others: "It neither has a limit nor is limitless." To some he said: "The life-principle and the body are one." To others: "The life-principle is one thing and the body is another." To some he said: "A Tathāgata exists after death." To others: "A Tathāgata does not exist after death." To others: "A Tathāgata both exists and does not exist after death." To others: "A Tathāgata neither exists nor does not exist after death — this alone is true; everything else is delusion." And so each was deceived in a different way, with one view after another.

Overwhelmed with shame, Pūraṇa Kassapa hung his head and, tormented by the fire of grief and wishing to cool himself in water, went to a pond. There on the road a eunuch saw him and spoke these verses:

Like a buffalo whose horn-tip has been broken,
you wander along, lusterless — where have you come from so far?
Not knowing the Dharma of the Śākya,

you flounder about shamelessly like a donkey.

He too replied in verse:

Before me stands the lord of death himself,
and in my body there is neither strength nor striving.
All things rest on pleasure and on suffering —
I am released. I go now to make my joy.
Those who are scorched by the blazing rays of the sun,
their body and mind utterly tormented and exhausted —
tell me quickly: where is that cool and excellent pond
free of weeds, that I may find refreshment there?

The eunuch replied in verse:

O wretched and sinful man, no excellent person you —
have you not seen the superb little pond
adorned like a lotus lake with geese,
whose water is wholly pure as glacial streams?

He replied again in verse:

You are neither a man nor a human woman.
Give me a sign, show me the way,
to that pond filled with good water, cool water —
for I go there to cool my burning.

Then, turning off the road and leaving his companion behind, Pūraṇa Kassapa went to the bank of the pond, tied around his neck a clay pot filled with sand, and sank beneath the water. There and then his time was spent.

Thereafter his disciples asked one another: "Did any of you see the Master?" They replied: "We did not see him." "Who among you received a final teaching from the Master?" At that, some said: "O wise ones, our Master taught us: 'The world is permanent — this alone is true; everything else is delusion.'" Others said: "We were taught: 'It is impermanent.'" Yet others said: "We were taught: 'It is both permanent and impermanent'; 'It is neither permanent nor impermanent'; 'It is limitless'; 'It has a limit'; 'It both has a limit and is limitless'; 'It neither has a limit nor is limitless'; 'A Tathāgata exists after death'; 'A Tathāgata does not exist after death'; 'A Tathāgata both exists and does not exist after death'; 'A Tathāgata neither exists nor does not exist after death — this alone is true; everything else is delusion.'"

Then they all said: "O wise ones, see how it is — being taught in such varied ways, we have all come into disagreement with one another. Come then, let us search everywhere for the Master and ask him what the truth of things really is." And so they set out.

Along the road they saw a young woman, and they asked her in verse:

O wearer of the Dharma robe,
you who eat the fare of ascetic practice —
Pūraṇa Kassapa, who departed from here,
noble one, did you not see him?

She replied in verse:

That unfortunate one, that hell-being,
who walks with arms stretched out —
Pūraṇa Kassapa was distracted by the water
and now sits there with his limbs turned white.

They then replied in verse:

O wearer of the Dharma robe,
one who is capable of Dharma practice —
what you have said is not well said.

"Good woman, do not say such things!" She too replied in verse:

One in whom the signs of manhood have arisen —
what wise man in the world
would forever be seen by the world
wandering naked through the town,
examining his male members from the front?
One whose Dharma is of such a kind —
let King Vaishravana
have him cut down with an arrow shot from a crossbow!

With that, they went away without saying another word and arrived at the pool. There they saw him — his completing vessel filled with sand and tied around his neck — dead, his time having passed. Those among them who had wished to take up the training said, "This one truly has it right; all the others are confused," and they too tied vessels filled with sand around their necks and died on the spot. The remainder turned back and went to dwell in the borderlands.

Now, when the Blessed One — the peerless tamer of persons, who turns the wheel without obstruction by the power of the unimpeded, who had fully awakened to unsurpassed and perfect awakening and was turning the wheel of Dharma — when all the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) challenged him to a contest of superhuman miracles, miracles of superhuman Dharma surpassing that of ordinary people, the Blessed One utterly defeated them all, turned their backs, and left them without confidence, and they came to dwell in the borderland regions. There the monks became uncertain, and they asked: "Venerable one, the Blessed One, having fully awakened to unsurpassed and perfect awakening, challenged all the non-Buddhists to a contest of superhuman miracles surpassing ordinary human Dharma, utterly defeated them all, turned their backs, and left them without confidence — we have witnessed this. We marvel at it greatly."

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, now I am free from attachment, free from aversion, free from delusion, fully liberated from birth, aging, illness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, mental distress, and agitation — omniscient, knowing all aspects, having mastery over all that is to be known, the peerless tamer of persons. Having fully awakened to unsurpassed and perfect awakening, I utterly defeated all the non-Buddhists, turned their backs, and left them without confidence. What is so wondrous about that? In times past, when I was not yet free from attachment, not yet free from aversion, not yet free from delusion — not yet liberated from birth, aging, illness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, mental distress, and agitation — even then, I defeated these six teachers together with their retinues, turned their backs, left them without confidence, routed them, and drove them to dwell in the borderland regions. Listen well to that account and take it to heart.

"Monks, long ago in times past, in a land called Uttarakuru, there was a king named Janaka — a passage beginning with 'whose kingdom was prosperous and flourishing' and ending with 'he came to undertake' — and so forth in full. Then King Janaka took as his queen a woman who was beautiful, lovely, and fair to look upon. He sported with her, delighted in her, and enjoyed her company. In time, a being entered into the queen's womb, and when nine months had gradually elapsed, she gave birth to a boy who was beautiful, lovely, and fair to look upon. When that boy was born, the regions of Uttarakuru became rich in good harvests, food, and drink in abundance, and the gods sent rain at the proper times, and the winds arose seasonably, so that food and drink were ever plentiful. Then a great birth-festival was held for

the young prince,

When the king was pondering what name to give the young prince, he reflected that at the time of the prince's birth, food and drink in the region had become plentifully abundant. For that reason he gave the young prince the name Abundant Food and Drink. The young prince was then entrusted to the care of eight wet-nurses. When he had grown older, he was set to learning letters, and before long he had mastered them completely. In the crafts appropriate to his lineage as well, he became proficient in no long time — all of which should be told in full, as described above. That young prince too was brave, unfaltering, and ferociously fierce.

Then the queen, made proud by her son, became thoroughly disobedient to the king, his father, and took to thwarting him. By that cause the king was afflicted with displeasure. When the ministers perceived his displeasure, they said to him, "Sire, why have you become displeased?" The king said, "My queen, made proud by her son, no longer obeys my commands at all and takes to thwarting me. That is why I have become displeased."

Then the ministers said, "Sire, if she will not act according to your commands, we shall take another queen, and that one will be brought under control, while you, Sire, will once again enjoy happiness together with another." The king said, "From where shall she be taken?" The ministers said, "We shall take her from the king of the south." The king said, "If he and I are not friends, how can she be taken from there?" A minister said, "This southern king, if allied through marriage from youth, will become a friend. Therefore let your Majesty be at ease and leave no care for this — we shall accomplish it."

Then the ministers went directly to that southern king, and they pleased him greatly. He said to them, "I shall make a pledge and give my daughter, but only if a certain nephew of mine is given the means of succession to the throne — if that is so, then I shall give her." They replied, "So it shall be done." The king said, "First, proceed accordingly with that king — and if he is able to fulfill the pledge as made, then she shall be given thereafter."

Then the ministers bowed to him and said, "Sire, regarding the granting of the means to act as regent, since it has been made the trust of the ministers, should there be a nephew of yours, he will certainly be given the regency." And thus it was obtained. The southern king accepted her as his bride with great festivity, and together with that king he sported, rejoiced, and enjoyed delight.

Then that queen, being exceedingly devoted and careful, so greatly pleased the noble king that the king said to her, "What boon shall I grant you?" She joined her palms together and said, "If the Sire would grant me an opportunity, then let the son I have borne be given the regency." The moment the king heard those words, he was struck as though pierced by a weapon, and he fell silent. He thought to himself: I opened the way to grant her a boon, and she has now made such a request of me. And yet this son of mine, Abundant Food and Drink, is brave and diligent, fair of form and lovely to look upon, born fittingly of noble lineage, my one and only son — how then could I send him away and grant the means of kingship to another? What am I to do about this? And so doubt arose and he fell into brooding.

After a while the ministers, perceiving that the king was ill at ease, asked him, "Sire, what are you thinking?" The king told them the matter plainly: "I opened the way to grant the queen a boon, and she petitioned me, saying that if she were to have a son, he should be granted the regency — and on account of this I have become troubled within myself."

Then the ministers said, "Sire, in this too do not be distressed.

"We took this prince from a king beneath the sun who made such a solemn oath — but, Sire, whether a child will come or not, and whether it will be a boy or a girl, no one can yet say. Please, for now, grant the regency to whoever seeks it first."

Then the king ordered that it be done accordingly.

Some time later, the queen conceived and, when the nine months were complete, she gave birth to a son, handsome, beautiful, and lovely to behold. A great birth celebration was held, and they proceeded to give the boy a name. "What shall this young man be called?" The king, Skyed-pa, reflected: "Because even before this child was born he was ardently desired and celebrated as heir to the royal throne, his name shall therefore be Rgyal-srid-la-Mngon-par-dga'-ba — 'Rejoicing-in-the-Royal-Throne.'" He was then entrusted to eight wet-nurses, and they raised him on milk, honey, and clarified butter, bathing, washing, and massaging him; yet even when he had grown to maturity, he was not installed as regent.

Then the maternal grandfather, the king beneath the sun, sent a messenger to King Skyed-pa with the following words: "If my grandson Rejoicing-in-the-Royal-Throne is not installed as regent, I shall arm my fourfold military force and march against you." Upon hearing the messenger's words,

the king was overcome with fear and sat in distress and discomfort.

When the ministers perceived that King Skyed-pa was frightened and displeased, they said, "Sire, why do you appear so troubled?" Skyed-pa replied, "The king beneath the sun has sent a messenger on his grandson's behalf, and that messenger has said this: 'If my grandson is not installed as regent, I shall come and depose you as king and install my grandson in your place.'"

Then the ministers said, "Sire, grant the regency to Rejoicing-in-the-Royal-Throne, and as for the boy's food and drink, we shall have it poisoned." But King Skyed-pa said to the ministers, "Do not speak such lawless words as these! Here one may hear of a son killing his father, but not of a father killing his son — I will absolutely not do such a thing."

The ministers said, "If you will not kill him outright, then let us have him dismembered." King Skyed-pa replied to the ministers, "If he is dismembered, that amounts to killing him." Then the ministers, having heard the king's words, said to him, "Sire, what else can be done with him? Let him be banished." The king said, "How can one be banished who has committed no offence?"

The ministers said, "There is no need to wait long or to delay. Grant Rejoicing-in-the-Royal-Throne the regency for now, and first find a pretext to lay fault at the boy's door — then the boy himself will seek his own food and drink."

Then King Skyed-pa waited for an auspicious and fortunate day under a propitious sun and, having pronounced blessings and good omens, granted the regency to Rejoicing-in-the-Royal-Throne.

When the boy heard that the regency had been granted, he thought: "The king has cast me aside — what use is it for me to remain here any longer? They will come to kill me." He went to his mother's presence, recounted the unhappy news, and said, "Please know that I am going to the land of the five kings."

Then she, intoxicated with manifold sufferings, overwhelmed by the anguish of separation from her son, took him by the neck and embraced him, and with a voice full of compassion she cried out and lamented:

He who slept at ease upon the great and fitting bed,
adorned with its coverlet of fine cotton cloth —
my only son now wanders alone upon the bare ground.

How did he lie, with his robe spread out to one side?
He who lay in ease upon the bed, awakened
by the sounds of many kinds of music and song —
how can a body so radiant rejoice in the forest
when touched by cold or burning water?

He who once enjoyed the food and drink granted by the king,
who used carriages and mounts and traveled in the finest conveyances,
who was attended by perfumes, ornaments, and fine garments —
by whose power does he now wander in suffering?

He who, meeting with the world and its crowds of people,
was honored fittingly by hearts and ears alike
with joined palms, the beat of drums, and melodious songs —
where does he now wander, tormented by thirst?

Then the young man spoke:

Who is there who knows only happiness forever?
Who is there who knows only suffering forever?
Who is there who has never tasted unhappiness?
And who is there for whom nothing will ever be obtained?

By the power of change, people know happiness and suffering —
like the wheel of the constellations turning in the sky.
There is no joy without happiness, and no sorrow without pain.
This is the sign that the lord of men follows the way of his kind.

Having made his mother understand these and many other such points, he set out for that place where the five kings had their territories. He arrived near a village, and being tired in body and hungry, he lay down to rest in the shade of a tree.

After some time had passed, a group of scouts from the territory of the five kings came that way on some business for the king, and seeing him lying and resting in that shade, they said among themselves: "This man is so fine of form, so handsome to behold, so tall and firm and well-proportioned, with such a broad chest and long arms — who could he be?" They roused him and asked whose son he was. He replied: "I am called Bzabtung, the son of the king who founded the land of the noble body. I have come with a certain purpose." And he told them all that had come to pass.

Then those scouts took the prince and brought him before the king of the five territories, and presented Bzabtung to him, saying: "Your Majesty, this man is called Bzabtung, the son of the king who founded that realm. His father banished him for such-and-such a cause, and so he has come here." Bzabtung then gave the king of the five territories a full and detailed account of everything.

He also spoke these words in verse:

He is the very son of the lord of men —
this prince who is the equal of a sovereign god,
endowed with form and with all excellent qualities —
and having lost the royal domain, he has come here.

Then the king of the five territories embraced him around the neck, spoke to him many delightful and comforting words, filled his heart with joy, and gave him daughters and lands as well.

And so the two of them passed time together in play, in joy, and in pleasurable enjoyment, until after a while the queen of all the people became with child, and when the nine months were complete, she gave birth to a boy — beautiful of form, handsome to behold, lovely, with a countenance like that of a seated lion, with long arms and a chest like a lion's. A great birth celebration was held, and when they came to give the boy a name, they thought: "My own name is Bzabtung, so let this one be called Bzabtung the Many." Then the young Bzabtung the Many was entrusted to eight wet nurses, who anointed, wiped, bathed, and nourished him with milk, honey, and white butter, and when he had grown to maturity, the boy was sent to school to learn letters.

Now Bzabtung his father was struck by illness. Despite the efforts of physicians, medicines, and attendants, he could not be healed, and he passed beyond his time. When he passed away, the king's daughter was overwhelmed with profound grief, and she wept and lamented.

Then the king of the five territories reflected —

"The wishes of most women are to desire a man, so I shall give her to one," he thought, and he presented her, together with young Bzabtung the Many, to the herald. Thereafter the herald experienced great joy together with her. After some time, a crow was crying out near the herald's house. A brahmin astrologer who happened to be passing by heard it and declared, "Whoever eats the flesh of this bird will become a king." These words were heard by the

herald, and he questioned that same brahmin further. He then caught the crow, killed it, and said to his wife, "Cook this crow at once — I will return from the royal palace." And so he went to the royal palace.

Meanwhile young Bzabtung the Many came home from school, hungry, and his mother was nowhere to be seen. He thought, "What have we cooked? What is there to eat?" For a moment he looked about, his mother being absent, and he spotted a crow's head turned upward in a pot. He then cut off the head right there as it sat in the pot, and ate it. When the mother returned, she asked him, "Who ate the head?" He replied, "I ate it myself." She gave him food and sent him back to school. When the herald came home and asked to eat, the crow's neck was missing. "What happened to the neck?" The wife said, "The boy ate it." The herald then ate the remainder of the crow and reflected: "Will becoming a king come from having eaten the whole crow? Or might one still become a king from eating it incompletely?" Doubt arose in him, and in order to resolve his doubt he used a stratagem to summon that same brahmin astrologer. He said, "O great brahmin, you said before that whoever eats this crow will become a king — does that apply even if one has eaten it incomplete, or only if one has eaten it whole?" The brahmin replied, "Even if the parts are not complete — whoever ate the head of that bird will become a king. Or alternatively, if someone kills the one who ate its head and then eats that head, that very person will become a king."

Then the thought arose in the herald's mind: "If I kill this boy and eat his head, and his mother discovers it, she will not allow the killing or the eating. So first let me sound out his mother's own feelings about this." He approached her with many sweet words and said, "Good woman, would it be better if you became queen, or would it be better if your son became king?" She looked carefully from the corners of her eyes, considering, and thought: "If she says it would be better for the son to become king, this man will turn away from me — so no matter what, I shall say what agrees with him." And so she said, "It would be better if you became king."

Now that woman was clever and wise and discerning. She had reflected: "He is nursing a grudge over the crow's head, and is scheming to kill my son. Now the moment has come — I must protect my son at all costs." She secretly told her son, "What you did in eating the crow's head was something ill done. Leave this land quickly! Go to the kingdom where your grandfather rules as king — there you will find your own people. Stay safely there." When she had said this, he fled and made his way into the highlands.

Weary and afflicted by poverty and thirst, his body tormented, he spread out a garment beneath a tree in a pleasure grove near a certain border region and lay down resting. At that time, the one who had rejoiced in royal sovereignty was struck by illness, and physicians, medicines, and attendants could not cure him, and he died — and the royal line was extinguished. It is the very nature of kingship that so long as no other person has been consecrated as king, the body of a king is not removed.

Meanwhile the ministers, others in the king's service, the brahmins, and the omen-readers set out searching in all directions, saying to one another, "If we find some being renowned for great merit, we shall place him upon the royal throne." In their search they came upon, at the foot of a tree outside the city, a handsome youth, beautiful and pleasing to behold, fine-looking as a lion at first sight, who was lying resting there — and although the sun had moved, the shadow of the tree had not shifted to the east, but stayed upon his body.

When the six ministers saw this they were filled with wonder and said, "We have seen no being endowed with the power of merit greater than this one who is renowned for great merit. Moreover, he is handsome, beautiful, and pleasing to behold, and possesses the marks of a great being. He is worthy to be placed upon the royal throne." Having reached this single firm conclusion, they called out, "Young man, rise up!" He rose and asked, "Why do you rouse me? What is it for?" They replied, "To make you king." He said, "Do you rouse a sleeping king in this way?" The ministers asked, "Then how should we rouse you?" The youth replied, "One should be roused by the sounds of song, cymbals, and music — not without them."

When they heard this, they thought: "This one has not come from a low lineage; surely he was born of a high lineage." So they asked him, "Who are you? Whose son are you?" Then that youth raised his face like a lion and declared his lineage: "The son of the one called 'King who Gives Rise to the Noble Ones' is Bha-tung. The son of that Bha-tung is called Bha-tung Mangpo — and that is I."

Then the six ministers broke into smiles and said, "We have found our own youth!" And right there on that spot, surrounded by a great gathering of people, led forward with songs, cymbals, the sounds of music, and auspicious proclamations, he was brought into the city and consecrated as king. Because he had repaired the broken royal line, he was known henceforth by that epithet alone — "the one who restores" — and the name Bha-tung Mangpo,

whatever it had been, ceased to exist.

Then, as he began to govern the kingdom, the ministers thought him a mere boy and held him in contempt, so that he had no real power whatsoever.

Later, at another time, King Bha-tung Mangpo went on a tour of inspection of the realm. Having surveyed the villages, the towns, and the mountain districts, he asked, "To whom do all these villages, towns, and mountain districts belong?" They all replied, "They belong solely to those six ministers." He pondered alone: "Whomever I ask — from each and every direction — they all say the same. So it seems I am master only in matters of food and clothing, and nothing else." Recognizing this himself, the thought sank into the ocean of his heart and he reflected: "What is to be done?"

While he was thinking thus, a god spoke to him: "O King, do not be dismayed. In your own realm there is a mountain district called 'Full Mountain.' In it there is a village headman called Gangpo who has a son called Great Medicine. Appoint him as your minister. He will make the realm his own and present it to you, and you will come to have benefit, happiness, and all that you desire." Such was the command.

Then Bha-tung Mangpo sent men to search in the mountain district called Full Mountain for the village headman called Gangpo, and commanded them to find out whether or not Gangpo and his wife had a son. They went and when they found him and asked, he said, "My wife has a son."

They returned and reported to the king: "The one in the northern region is indeed there, and moreover his wife is pregnant."

Then the king sent a letter summoning Gangpo, and with friendly words gave him the mountain district Full Mountain, commanding him: "From this day forward, fully care for and protect the child who is now in the womb of your own daughter-in-law, and see to it that no limb of that child is harmed in any way."

When the nine months were complete, she gave birth to a boy who was handsome, beautiful, and lovely to behold. A great birth celebration was held with whatever was available, and they asked, "What name shall we give this boy?" The mother spoke: "I had long been afflicted with illness, and physicians, medicines, and attendants were unable to calm my disease. But from the very moment this boy entered my womb, my illness was calmed. Therefore I shall name him Great Medicine."

She spoke in verse:

Among all medicines,
my son is the great medicine.
He is a medicine beyond the physician —
and so his name is Medicine.

Then Great Medicine was carried on his father's shoulders to be taken to a pond in the middle of the marketplace for bathing. Along the way he saw a piece of fish lying on the ground. Thinking it was a jewel, Gangpo began to pick it up with his big toe from the ground. Just then Great Medicine said:

Dear father Gangpo, thinking a jewel has fallen,
you fix your gaze unblinking on a piece of fish,
you look at it and then imagine it a jewel.
Dear father Gangpo, understand — it is no jewel.
It is nothing but a red piece of fish to be kicked aside.
Dear Vaiśravaṇa's son, do not act heedlessly.

Then they went on to the pond. Gangpo set Great Medicine and his clothes at the pond's edge and entered the water to bathe. On the surface of a lotus there sat a water-bird, and thinking to catch that water-bird, Gangpo approached it — whereupon it flew away. Great Medicine then said:

A water-bird sat upon a lotus.
The bird took flight and the lotus was stirred.
A water-bird upon a lotus —
dear father, look, it flew away for a moment.

Then on another occasion Gangpo carried Great Medicine on his shoulder to bathe in the Ganges River. He set him and his clothes at the river's edge and entered the water to bathe. He saw a pot being carried along in the current of the Ganges, and upon the pot sat a goose. Seeing this, Great Medicine said to his father:

The Ganges carries along a pot.
Upon that pot sits a goose.
Dear father, look for a moment —
the pot and the goose together, carried by the Ganges.

Then on yet another occasion they again went to the Ganges River wishing to bathe. He set Great Medicine at the water's edge and entered the water to bathe. After a while he saw a fleece being carried along downstream in the

current of the Ganges, and upon it sat a crane. Seeing this, Great Medicine said:

The Ganges carries along a fleece.

Upon it likewise sits a crane.

The fleece and the crane together —
dear father, look, carried by the Ganges.

After that, Great Medicine was playing with other children. After some time the children gathered and made him their king. He in turn appointed some as ministers, and he played and remained together with them.

Now, it happened that an elderly brahmin was travelling along the road together with his young wife, who was in the bloom of youth, heading to another region, when the brahmin went off to relieve himself. A rogue then approached the woman and said to her: "Good lady, where has your father gone?" The woman replied, "What do you mean?" The rogue said, "Surely that man must be your grandfather." She replied, "What are you saying?" The rogue said, "Then surely he must be your great-grandfather." The woman said, "He is neither my father, nor my grandfather, nor my great-grandfather — he is my husband." At this the rogue laughed a little and said, "You fool, are you not ashamed to say 'he is my husband' in front of your friends or other respectable people? Do you not see that this blessed earth is filled with men who are like the form of a god? Such beauty as yours is being wasted. Come, let me be your husband and we shall go off together. And if the old brahmin puts up a fight over you, you need only declare before a great crowd of people that I am your husband."

With that, she went off with the rogue. When the brahmin finished relieving himself and rose up, he could not find her. After a while he climbed to the top of a high mound and looked out, and saw her going along in the company of another man. The brahmin ran after them and seized her by one arm. The rogue likewise seized her by one arm. The brahmin said, "Why are you taking away my wife?" The rogue said, "If this were your wife — good heavens, you are deluded! She is mine." The brahmin also said, "She is mine." And the two of them struggled over her right there on the road, pulling her back and forth. Since the rogue was in the prime of youth, he was stronger and pulled her away from the brahmin and seized her.

The brahmin, utterly defeated, was then taunted by the brahmin's wife with the words, "Arrow reversed!" At that moment, Great Medicine was playing with

the children in the wilderness. The cry "Arrow reversed at the brahmin's wife!" reached the ears of the children. The children then said, "Oh, Great Medicine, you say you are our king, yet when your father the brahmin is called out and shamed as 'arrow reversed at the brahmin's wife,' why do you not protect him from this danger?" Great Medicine then went to the children, directed them, and said, "Come, bring everyone." The children gathered them all together and came. Someone asked, "What is the matter?" The brahmin said, "I, who am without allies and of little standing, have had my wife stolen away by this powerful rogue." The rogue said, "He is lying — this woman is my wife." The woman too declared, "This man here is my husband," and affirmed that he was none other than the rogue.

Great Medicine, recognizing that the brahmin was suffering an unjust and dejected defeat, thought to examine the matter, and said, "Good sir, where did you come from when you first met this woman?" The rogue said, "I came from a dyer's house." Great Medicine asked, "And what did you eat and drink there?" He replied, "I had meat, oil, a sweet dish, and beer."

Thus ends the thirty-third bundle of the basis of the Vinaya of minor matters.

Great Medicine said, "If that is so, vomit — and we shall see whether it is true or false." When told this, the rogue put his fingers in his mouth, and when he vomited, nothing of the kind of food described came up.

Great Medicine then asked the brahmin where he had come from. The brahmin said, "I came from a dyer's house."

Great Medicine asked, "And what did you eat and drink there?" The brahmin said, "I ate flatbread, cooked grain, dried curd, and barley broth." When told to vomit, he vomited, and everything he had eaten and drunk appeared plainly before them.

Having seen this, Great Medicine concluded that it was the rogue who had deceived the young woman and stolen the brahmin's wife. He beat the rogue with a stick and his fists, dug a pit deep enough not to collapse, buried him up to his neck, and wrote across his forehead in peacock bile: "Whoever steals a woman in this manner shall be punished by Great Medicine with a penalty of this kind." Then, just as he had done with the woman-stealer, he had some five hundred thieves seized — those who had stolen children, oxen, goats, thread, and the like — and beat them with sticks and fists, buried them up to their necks in the earth, and wrote their names on them in peacock bile, adding: "Whoever else commits theft shall be punished by Great Medicine in this

manner."

Now it happened that the six ministers had been seen by the king consuming the country's revenues, and the king thought to himself, "Let me go and see what Great Medicine is doing now." He told his ministers, "I am going to chase a deer," intending to visit the rocky cliff village. He feigned a deer hunt, gathered a large retinue, and set out toward the rocky cliff village. When the rogue buried up to his neck in the earth saw the king coming, everyone around began calling out "The king! The king!" When the king heard this cry he could not make out who had spoken, and though he looked all around, the sound continued. Then one of the rogues caught sight of the king and called to him. The king looked, and when he read what was written on the board in peacock bile he saw: "Whoever steals a woman, steals a child, steals an ox, steals a goat, or commits such offenses shall be punished by Great Medicine with a penalty of this kind." When Great Medicine and the children saw the king coming, they all ran away.

The king observed what had been done there, and his heart was pleased. He thought: "Though these are children, looking at what they have done, there is nothing wrong in it." And so the king had them all released and sent them away.

When Pūrṇakacchana heard that the king was coming, he welcomed him with water-filled vessels, a parasol, banners, victory standards, and the like. The king reassured him, saying, "Have no fear," and then said to Pūrṇa, "Bring your son and let me see him." Pūrṇa replied, "Your Majesty, since the child is very young, I would not presume to bring him before the king." The king again said, "Bring him." So the father brought the boy, and when the king looked at him he saw a handsome, fine-looking, excellent, and courageous child, though still a boy who had not yet fully grown. The king gave the father many instructions and commands, then departed.

Some time later, the king thought, "I shall question Great Medicine to test the full extent of his wits." The king sent a messenger from his palace to the headman Pūrṇa at the rocky cliff village of Pūrṇakacchana, with the message: "Send me here a rope made of sand, one hundred arm-lengths long." The messenger went to the rocky cliff village, came before Pūrṇa, and delivered the royal command: "Send a rope made of sand, one hundred arm-lengths long." When the village headman Pūrṇa heard this, he was deeply disturbed and distressed, filled with fear and alarm. He said, "In all my life I have never

seen or heard of such a thing, and now a disgrace like this is being sought from me." He was utterly miserable.

The great physician asked Pūrṇa, "Father, what is wrong? Why are you displeased?" The father said to his son, "Even though I myself have never heard of or seen such a thing, the king intends to punish me by some means, though I do not know what." Then the great physician said, "Bring that man to me, and I will send a reply to the king who sent him." The father brought the messenger, and the great physician said to the messenger, "Do not forget to deliver this my request to the king. We who dwell here in the countryside are rough in mind, unskilled and foolish, so forgive us. If the king commands that it be loaded, we wish to load it. If the king wishes it sent, let a deity send us a sample rope one arm-length long, and from that sample we will measure it out a hundredfold — even a thousandfold — load it onto the rock face, and dispatch it." The messenger went and reported to the king, saying, "Your divine majesty, this is what has been said." The king asked, "Who said this — Pūrṇa, or his son?" The messenger replied, "Your divine majesty, it was the young great physician who said this." At that, the king was filled with wonder and reflected, "This is truly a sign from the gods. It is clear that this one will cause my kingdom to flourish."

Then again, at a later time, the king, wishing to test the great physician, sent a messenger to Pūrṇa at the rocky cliff village of Pūrṇakacchana with the following command: "Send me a load of rice that has not been struck even by a rice stalk, that has not been broken into pieces, that is cooked neither inside the house nor outside, neither by fire nor without fire, that is brought neither by road nor off road, that has not been touched by sunlight nor by shadow, sent neither by a woman nor by a man, carried neither by mount nor on foot." Carrying the king's command, the messenger traveled through villages, towns, and settlements in turn until he came to the rocky cliff village and, arriving there, called out to Pūrṇa. He exchanged various pleasant words with Pūrṇa, and then relayed the king's words in full and said, "The king has issued this command." The moment Pūrṇa heard those words, he was deeply and utterly displeased, and the great physician asked him, "Father, what is wrong? Why are you unhappy?" Pūrṇa replied, "Son, how should I not be distressed? The king has sent a command of this kind." "What kind?" asked the physician. Pūrṇa then described everything in detail just as it had been said. Then the great physician said, "Father, do not be unhappy. I will manage all of it."

The great physician then dried rice in the sun, gathered a large number of men and women together, gave each person a few grains of rice and instructed them to remove the husks with their fingernails without breaking the grains. Those grains, removed unbroken, were to be poured into a pot and cooked on the threshold of the doorway, neither by fire nor without fire — for on its one side it was over fire, and on the upper side it was cooked by the sun. As for bringing it neither by road nor off road, the instruction given to the man was: let one foot go on the road and one foot go off the road. As for carrying it neither in sunlight nor in shadow, the instruction to that man was: tie the pot to the tip of a staff, wrap it in a thin cloth, and go. As for carrying it neither by mount nor on foot, the instruction given to that man was: put a shoe on one foot and leave the other foot bare, and go. As for sending it neither by a man nor by a woman, it was entrusted to a hermaphrodite. That person brought it and came before King Ajātaśatru, and the king questioned the person, who then explained everything in detail to the king.

When the king heard this, he was delighted, and he asked whether it was Jīvaka himself who had devised and sent the message, or whether it had been the great physician. The messenger replied that it had been sent by the great physician. The king then said: "That great physician possesses understanding, resourcefulness, proper method, and correct procedure." Some time later, the king dispatched another messenger with this instruction: send a pleasure grove with a park, fruit trees, and a pond. The messenger went to the town of Pūrṇakaṭṭha, and conveyed to Jīvaka the king's words: the king commands that you send something that has a pleasure grove, a park, fruit trees, and a pond. When Jīvaka heard this, he was displeased, and he fell to wondering how on earth he could manage it, having never before seen a pleasure grove of that kind. Then the young great physician noticed that his father was troubled, and the great physician asked: "Father, what is it that displeases you?" Jīvaka replied: "Son, how could I not be displeased? The king has sent this command: send something that has a pleasure grove, a park, fruit trees, and a pond — but how in the world am I to put such a thing together?" The great physician said: "Father, do not worry. I will do whatever will please the king." He then called the messenger and said: "Go back and report to the king as follows: these cliff-side pleasure groves have nothing particularly fine to recommend them; how, then, could they be sent to the king? Let the king send one of the pleasure groves of the royal palace; Father will observe how such a pleasure grove is arranged, learn from it, and then afterward send one modeled on it."

The messenger was sent back and duly reported to the king exactly what had been said. The king was pleased and asked whether this had been Jīvaka's own idea or whether it was the great physician who had suggested it. The messenger replied that it was the great physician's message. The king said: "Truly, that young one is possessed of wisdom." Some time afterward, the king sent a messenger of the same kind, with instructions to go to that town of the cliff country and send back a tree that was one year old yet bore both blossoms and fruit. The messenger went and conveyed this to Jīvaka, who fell into worried thought as before and was displeased. Seeing this, the great physician said: "Father, do not be displeased — this matter is not difficult." He then cultivated a castor-oil plant, and when it produced both fruit and blossoms within its first year, sent it off. When the king saw it, he was amazed, and he said to the messenger: "Was this Jīvaka's idea, or the great physician's — whose was it?" The messenger replied that it was the great physician's. "Excellent, excellent!" said the king, and sat in silence, saying nothing more. Some time later still, the king had five hundred oxen driven to Jīvaka in that town of the cliff country, with these instructions: feed them grass to fatten them, then milk them and from that milk produce curd, butter, fresh butter, and whey, and send all of it back. The messenger obeyed the king's command, went gradually to the town, and summoning Jīvaka with words that won his trust, told him: "The king has had these five hundred oxen driven here, and instructs you to fatten them on grass, then produce from them milk, curd, butter, fresh butter, and whey, and send it all back." When Jīvaka heard these words, he was disheartened and said to the other townspeople: "The king is certainly going to have me put to death by some such stratagem — he has issued a command to take milk from the bulls." He sat there deeply agitated. The great physician said: "Father, do not be displeased — I have already thought of an answer, and I will find a way to please the king while also making certain that none of this has to be done."

Then the great physician trained two servants and sent them off, saying: "Go to a place not far from the king in the great city. Find a hollow in a tree, wrap yourselves in cloth, and roll back and forth on the ground as though weeping. And you, boy, make supplication in all directions, scatter flowers, incense, and offerings of parched grain to the ten directions, and say aloud: 'May this father be well, prosperous, and auspicious, and may a son be born to him.'"

The two servants did exactly as they had been taught. They went from the village of Pūrṇakaccha to a place near where the king was born, sat down not

far off, and did as they had been instructed — lamenting and weeping and so forth. And the boy called out: "O whoever in this world protects the world, guard my father, and may he be well, prosperous, and auspicious, and may a son be born to him!" King Prasenajit heard this and sent a man to find out what was happening.

The man went and looked, and saw a large-bodied man rolling back and forth on the ground, weeping. He also saw the man's son making supplication to Yama, the king of the nāgas, the gods of rest, Vāsava, and the lords of the gods. When they asked him why, the boy said: "I am doing this so that a son may be born to my father." They went back and reported to the king, and the king summoned the two servants. The boy said exactly as before: "May a son be born to my father." Then the king laughed and said: "I have never heard or seen anywhere that a son is born from a man." Then the boy replied: "Your Majesty, is that not exactly what you yourself have just said?" "Indeed it is." The boy then said: "In that case, why did you have five hundred oxen driven to the village of Pūrṇakaccha in the hills and send word that milk, curd, fresh butter, and whey should be produced from them? If you say that oxen can give birth and bear young, then where have you seen it, and where have you heard of it?"

At this the king laughed and asked: "Whose is this clever mind — is it the father's, or is it the great physician's, or whose?" The messenger replied: "Your Majesty, it is the divine great physician's." The king and his ministers were filled with great wonder.

Then, at a later time, the king, wishing to test him, sent a messenger with a monkey, and the messenger went to the village of Pūrṇakaccha in the hills with instructions: "Tell Gaṅgapa to keep this monkey unrestrained and unenclosed, to let it roam freely without shelter or confinement." The messenger duly went to the village of Pūrṇakaccha in the hills and delivered the order to Gaṅgapa: "You are to keep this monkey, and if it escapes through any negligence on your part, you will be punished most severely in body." When Gaṅgapa heard this he was frightened. He thought: "All of this is manageable, but this one is not. For the king to give me such a command — not even a god could make this easy." He sat there in great distress.

The great physician saw that his father was in distress and said: "Do not be displeased." He had the monkey tethered to a post by day and let it go wherever it wished in the open, and at night he had it surrounded by twenty

men, with five men to each torch held at each watch, one man holding each limb, and one man constantly riding on the monkey's back. By such means twenty men kept watch over it with no shelter whatsoever.

King Prasenajit sent a man to observe Gaṅgapa and see how he was keeping it. The man observed and reported to the king: "Your Majesty, the physician is doing it by means such as these." The king said: "If it is guarded like that, it cannot escape — but question one of those men." The minister asked: "Which one should be questioned?" The king replied: "Question the one who rides on top at night."

"When the others have fallen asleep, bring him here." This was said, and the king then had the man who rode on top brought forward, and that man too came, leading the monkey.

When dawn broke, Gaṅgapa said that the monkey had escaped. The man who had been riding on top was terrified, thinking, "My life is now forfeit," and he began to wail and lament, saying "What shall I do? What shall I do?" — sitting there in utter misery. The great physician saw him sitting thus in wretchedness, and he too began to turn the matter over in his mind. "All those measures," he thought, "can be accomplished through clever means — but no means for this one appears to me." He said nothing, for he too was afraid. Yet, pondering a stratagem, he said to his father: "If you are able to accomplish this aim, there is one way." The father asked: "What is it?" The great physician replied: "Only if you are willing to bear some slight humiliation to yourself will the aim be accomplished." Gaṅgapa then said: "Do whatever will ensure that I am not deprived of my livelihood."

Thereupon the great physician shaved his father's head in seven furrows, tattooed his scalp with designs using ink, indigo, white pigment, and the like, seated him on a donkey, and proceeded gradually toward the great city. Everywhere the announcement was cried out: "The great physician is coming!" And this too became known: "He has shaved his father's head in seven furrows, mounted him on a donkey, and is coming!"

When the king and his ministers heard what had happened, they said: "He is learned! He is wise!" — and the praises spread everywhere. And yet: "If he is so excellent, why has he done this unseemly thing?" Then the king, filled with curiosity, went out together with his ministers and retinue to meet the great physician. "Is what they say true — or is it a lie?" When the king and his retinue witnessed the scene with their own eyes, the ministers said to the

king: "Your Majesty, we praised the great physician, calling him learned, clear-sighted, and wise — and yet he has done a thing like this. Is it possible?" At that, the king asked the great physician directly: "Great Physician, why did you treat your father with such humiliation?" He replied: "Your Majesty, this is not humiliation — it is homage. I desired to obtain far more from my father than my father had given me, and so I paid him this full and distinguished honour." The king said: "Which is better — you or your father?" He replied: "I am good; my father is bad." The king said: "I have never heard or seen anywhere that a son surpasses his father — for it is the father who makes the son famous, while it is the mother who nurses, raises, and protects him. Therefore I, for my part, have always thought that the father must be the better one." Then the great physician said to the king: "Your Majesty, please understand clearly whether or not the father is truly as I have said." Both the king and the ministers declared: "It is so, and not otherwise." Thereupon the great physician touched the king's feet and said: "Your Majesty, if that is indeed so, then the monkey Your Majesty gave us to guard has escaped. Since both Your Majesty and the ministers have just now praised the father as supremely good — and the father of that monkey is this very donkey here — please accept it in exchange." Then the king and the ministers, hearing how he had deployed such a stratagem through those very words, were struck with wonder and exclaimed: "Extraordinary! How clever, to accomplish both the fitting and the unfitting in such a manner!" Fully understanding this, the king was delighted and joyfully conceived a great happiness, and he adorned him with ornaments of many kinds and bestowed upon him the authority of a minister. To the father as well he gave that clifftop village.

The intermediate summary verse:

The one laden with sand, the fruiting tree,
the castor plant, the ox,
the monkey, and the man who went there —
to him the minister's stratagem was given.

Then, when the great physician had been granted the authority of a minister and reflected with complete ease of mind on what was to be done and how to serve the king's interests,

Throughout the entire city the fame was proclaimed that the great physician was a man of intelligence and skill. Then, after some time had passed, a brahmin spent a great deal of wealth on the wedding gifts for a bride he had

taken, and having lived together with her for a long while, he thought to himself: "I have spent a great deal of wealth on wedding gifts for this wife of mine, and now there is no great prospect of wealth increasing, and it would not be good to remain idle at home." So this brahmin, who had memorized many recitations and was versed in the branches of the priestly arts, went to another region in order to acquire wealth through his mastery of learning. As he traveled on, going gradually from place to place, he found five hundred gold coins buried in the ground, took them up, and returned home. He thought: "If I bring wealth home openly she will not let me into the house." For who can know the workings of a woman's mind? The brahmin's wife was fair of form and beautiful to look upon, and being of such good appearance, he thought it quite possible that while he was away she had become attached to some other man. So he waited until nightfall, went to the charnel ground, dug a hole at the foot of a nyagrodha tree, placed the coins inside, and when day broke he went home. His wife indeed had become attached to another man, a brahmin named Karṇabhadra, and at that very moment the two of them had eaten fine food together, anointed their bodies with sweet-smelling perfume, and were lying in bed taking pleasure in each other's company. When the brahmin arrived at his own house and called out for the door to be opened, his wife said, "Hey — who are you?" He gave his own name, and she herself let out sounds of delight and welcome, roused Karṇabhadra from his sleep, hid him under the bed, then came to open the door. She made a show of affection toward her husband, received him warmly as he entered, opened the door weeping, embraced him by the neck, and offered him gifts and honor. She gave him warm food. While the brahmin was eating, he thought to himself: "She has certainly become attached to another man — why else would food like this be prepared so late at night?" Now he was by nature a straightforward and simple man, so she asked him, "Dear husband, is it not a lucky day, or has some festival come along, or a city celebration, that such food as this should appear?" He replied: "A deity appeared to me and told me that your husband is coming today, so I prepared all this in readiness for you." The brahmin exclaimed, "How wonderful! I must be a man of great merit indeed — a deity appeared even in my wife's dream!" He ate the meal, washed himself, lay down in bed, and the two of them spoke affectionately with each other: "Are you well, or have you suffered any trouble?" Then his wife asked, "My lord, did anything of any significance come your way?" He replied: "A little something did come." Then his wife spoke in a roundabout way, saying, "Listen to what he is saying." Karṇabhadra spoke, saying: "If you don't show me those five

hundred gold coins, where have you put them?" He said: "Be patient — they are here." "But where have you put them?" He replied: "I will show you tomorrow." Then the woman said: "You and I share one body — why keep secrets?" The brahmin, being simple and straightforward by nature, said: "I buried them outside the city." The woman then said: "Listen here, Karṇabhadra — tell me exactly where you buried them." The brahmin replied: "I dug a hole at the foot of the nyagrodha tree in the charnel ground and buried them there." At that point the brahmin's wife patted and stroked her husband along the way as he went to lie down, and said, "You too are weary — now go to sleep." When she perceived that he had fallen into sleep, she said to Karṇabhadra: "Go quickly and do what you have heard."

Then Karṇabhadra crept out stealthily and left the house, making his way to the charnel ground. Just as he had been told, he took the jewels from the foot of the nyagrodha tree in the charnel ground and went to Karṇabhadra's own home.

The next day the brahmin went to look, and going to the charnel ground he found nothing in that spot. He beat his head and chest and came home, and his wife, his kinsmen, his other friends, and his brothers and sisters asked him what was wrong. He said that he had taken five hundred gold coins and brought them there, and at a time when no one was passing along the road he had dug a hole in the charnel ground, buried them, and gone home — yet today when he had gone back to look they were nowhere to be found.

They then told him to go to the great minister, saying: "That chief minister is learned and wise, skilled at investigation and examination, and able to reason out the meaning of affairs. Go to him for help. Even if it seems impossible, there may be a way — no other refuge presents itself." So the brahmin went to the great minister with tears streaming down his face, weeping, and after offering salutations and wishing him long life, he appealed to him, saying: "My lord, I brought the coins and came there, and at a time when no one was passing along the road I dug a hole in the charnel ground, hid them, and went home. Today when I went back they were gone."

The chief minister, the great minister, sat silent for a moment without speaking, and then asked the brahmin: "In which direction did you place them? At what time? Was anyone seen nearby, or is there any indication that you spoke of it to someone?" The brahmin then told him exactly how everything had happened.

The great minister, thinking to himself that the brahmin's wife had clearly developed attachment to another man and that this was certainly her trick, said to the brahmin: "To put your mind at ease — do not be troubled. If the coins are not found, I will give you the equivalent from my own wealth." He then, having reassured the brahmin, asked: "Is there a dog at your house?" The brahmin replied that there was. The minister instructed him: "Go and invite eight brahmins as guests. You yourself should invite four of them, and you should also have your wife invite four. And then have this said: 'If I return home safely and auspiciously, I have vowed before the god Indra (Śakra, lord of the gods) to give food to eight brahmins.' Then when you bring them home, come first from my presence with this man, and when they go inside, station him at the door. When they are eating, do not let him do anything — just place him in front. And you yourself should watch for the signs: observe which brahmin the dog approaches and around which one's legs it wags its tail. The behavior of dogs is such — instruct him accordingly."

He further instructed him: "Direct it so that the wife serves that brahmin woman, not the brahmins themselves. And the man you station there should observe this: when the brahmin's wife is serving, notice which one she catches the eye of and gazes at with a lingering look, which one she laughs with and exchanges words with, and which one she serves with special attention — make sure these are noted clearly."

After these instructions were given —

The brahmin stationed that man at the doorway. He instructed the brahmin woman: "You yourself call in the brahmins that I have invited as guests" — and then he too called in those he himself had invited. As they entered one by one, the dog looked on. When a certain Raṇabadra arrived, the dog looked at him, then dropped its ears and wagged its tail, and following him inside, let out a sound of joyful recognition. The king's man thus knew that this was the one called Raṇabadra.

Then, when the serving of the meal was observed, the brahmin woman came forward to serve, and she made a slight flick of an eyebrow to Raṇabadra, let her gaze linger on him, chatted and laughed with him in particular, and served him with special attention. The king's man then reported to the Great Minister exactly what he had witnessed, saying, "My lord, this is the state of affairs." The Great Minister, hearing this at once, dispatched the king's man with orders to seize Raṇabadra.

When he was brought before him, the Great Minister instructed him: "Is it the way of brahmins to plunder another's wealth? Return what you have taken." The man replied, "May this wrongdoing be pacified — I do not want it to remain with me." The Great Minister then ordered his men: "Throw this wicked one into prison and press him hard until the bones come out of him." Threatened in such a manner, Raṇabadra was seized with extreme terror and anguish, and cried out: "Save me, O god! I will return it!" He then went to his own house and brought back the earring just as it had been, along with the five hundred antique gold coins that had been bound with it, and presented everything to the Great Minister. The Great Minister in turn restored them to the brahmin.

The brahmin was overjoyed, his mind filled with delight. He then reflected to himself: "All of this — the recovery of my five hundred antique gold coins and the earring that I had lost — is entirely due to the power of the Great Minister. How shall I show him proper respect and repay his kindness? The Great Minister is kind to me, and I must repay him in kind." Thinking thus, he took half of the antique gold coins and went to the Great Minister's presence, presenting them to him and saying, "Please accept this gift." The Great Minister accepted it, then gave it all back to him. Word of this deed spread throughout that city. The king, his ministers, and the citizens all proclaimed far and wide: "This man is endowed with wisdom!" And they thought to themselves: "We are truly fortunate to have a minister of such quality."

Now at a certain time, another man had gone to a foreign land on some business of his own. On his return, he arrived at the bank of a pond and, opening his traveling food-bag, took out his provisions and ate. Having eaten, he went out to relieve himself in the open air without closing the bag. While he was sitting there, a poisonous and deadly snake crept into the food-bag. When the man returned, without checking inside he tied the bag closed, slung it over his shoulder, and proceeded toward the great city. Along the way, a diviner pronounced an omen, saying: "Young man of good family, you are on the verge of losing your life." The man turned back and looked. Then, having heard those words, he was seized with regret: "Why did I not question that diviner?" Filled with doubt, he said to himself — and spoke aloud — "I will not go home until I have gone to the minister, the Great Minister, and asked him about this matter." He went to the presence of the Great Minister and —

"When I was on my way to the city, a diviner gave this prophecy," he said, and recounted those matters in full. "I did not question him at the time, and so it is

to you that I put the question."

The Great Minister asked where he had come from, and the man told him in detail exactly what had happened.

The minister thought: "If a venomous snake is found inside a bag, this truly is dangerous — and that is surely why the diviner spoke as he did."

Then the Great Minister, in full view of a great crowd of people, declared: "Open that bag — from a distance, with a stick — and the truth will become known at once." When this was done, from within the bag the venomous creature raised its head, flicked its tongue, and writhed as it emerged. The Great Minister said: "There — that is the danger you suspected."

Thereupon the Great Minister, wishing to inspect the territory, had his four-division army equipped and set out. When he surveyed the villages, towns, and markets, he asked: "To whom do these villages, towns, and districts belong?" The local landholders replied: "This one belongs to such and such a great minister; these belong to those," and so on.

The Great Minister investigated and observed, and came to see that the entire realm had been seized by the six ministers, and that the king who had engendered the realm held authority over nothing more than his food and drink.

Then the Great Minister inquired of the gods of the celestial villages and of the cliff-towns and cities whether they would submit. As to what the king should do, the kindly-disposed gods had revealed this to him: "In the cliff-town of Pūrṇakaccha there lives a son of a man named Gaṅgapa — appoint him, O Great Minister, as your great chief minister. When the territories have been developed and enriched, they will be offered up to you, and at that time you yourself will become a king with dominion over all."

So it had been prophesied. "For this reason, and because you will have need of things in just this way, I have kept you these years in the womb, nourishing you with the provisions of ease. Now, if you are appointed chief of ministers, then — showing the gods' words and your own capability to me — bring it about, by whatever means, that I become a sovereign king."

The Great Minister then bowed to the king and said: "Set your mind at ease, Your Majesty; I shall do whatever is needed to please the gods."

The Great Minister then set the leading figures of those territories, villages, towns, and cliff-settlements at odds with one another, separating them one by

one, saying: "I shall act in whatever way makes you favor me." Those ministers, being exceedingly greedy, levied unlawful fees and irregular dues, and this caused harm — the minister made this known to each of them. "If you act according to my words, I shall have it brought to light and see that the fees are levied rightly; beyond that, I shall provide for your ease and maintain you with all the provisions of comfort. By every means, bring about discord among yourselves."

Having thus set them at odds, he instructed them: "Even if the king and the ministers come to hear of it, do not fall under their authority — not until I myself arrive. Say only this: 'We submit to the authority of our chief, the Great Minister, and to none other.'"

Having first applied intelligence of this kind, he stirred all those territories into discord and had it sustained — and so the royal commands were cut short.

Then those ministers presented themselves before the king, and —

In this way, the king Skyedpa dispatched those six ministers together with a great force of fourfold military strength, yet even so they were unable to subdue so much as a single fortified mountain village. Messengers were then sent to the king, reporting: "If Your Majesty himself does not come, we cannot bring these people under control." The king then came in person, yet still not a single fortified mountain village could be subdued. Many were killed in the fighting, and both the king Skyedpa and the six ministers grew deeply displeased.

At that point the people of the fortified mountain villages said to one another: "If the Great Minister were to come here, and we listened to his words and acted according to his authority, our being at odds with King Skyedpa would not truly be our own doing — it is the ministers who have been harming us." Thereupon the king sent a messenger to the Great Minister, saying: "We have been unable to travel to the territories ourselves — please come here." As soon as the Great Minister saw that letter, he came before the king. Upon seeing him arrive, all the local people bowed to him, and he said to them: "Do not be afraid." He had taxes levied in accordance with the law. He gave comfort and relief to the lowly, the destitute, and those without protection. To the country-dwellers and city-dwellers alike he showed equal honor and affection — as though they were his own parents, brothers, and kinsmen — and he embraced them warmly. All the elders, young men, and women of those territories came to look upon the Great Minister as their own son or

maternal uncle. He brought joy and contentment to everyone, and in time gathered all the territories together as one, and returned with King Skyedpa to the royal palace. Through deeds such as these, his fine reputation spread even to other kings.

The king, greatly pleased, gave his own daughter to the Great Minister as wife, and together they enjoyed the pleasures of life in full. Then, from another land, a king who had fallen on misfortune came before King Skyedpa. The king Skyedpa, having no desire to receive him, sent him on to the Great Minister. Out of compassion the Great Minister took him in and gave him provisions. Later, a brahmin came, and having borrowed a measure of grain from him, the Great Minister agreed and entrusted it to a creditor, promising to repay on the following day — yet it was not repaid.

Then, at a later time, the king was sitting in a place where many people came to pay homage, surrounded by ministers, city-dwellers, and country folk. He said to the ministers: "A secret — to whom should one speak it? In whom should one place trust?" The ministers fell to pondering this. Among them, one said it was fitting to tell a friend; another said a man should tell his wife; another said his mother; another said his sister and father; and still another said his brother — and so others spoke in those ways. The king then asked the Great Minister: "Since others have spoken as they thought fit, why have you not spoken?" The Great Minister replied to the king: "Your Majesty, I have thought to myself this: a secret is not right to tell to anyone at all — how much less to one's wife. I shall demonstrate this openly before Your Majesty's very eyes."

Then, some time later, the king's peacock went missing. The Great Minister had it found, concealed it in another place, and obtained a different peacock that resembled it. He then asked his wife: "Have you heard, my dear, that a peacock has gone missing from the royal palace?" She replied: "Yes, I have heard it."

The Great Minister instructed his wife: "Tell no one whatsoever — cook this quickly and eat it." She then thought to herself: "Look at how this village man from the rocky crags is eating the king's peacock. My father trusts this man greatly, yet he is doing something that harms the king." Some time later, the Great Minister dressed a prostitute in all the adornments of a queen and had her enter among his women. He then told his wife: "This is a certain queen of the king's — I trust her greatly. If you love me, do not tell anyone." At this, the

king's daughter thought: "This woman is consorting with the Great Minister," and in her anger a quarrel arose within her. She went to her father and slandered him, saying: "My father has no discrimination in these matters whatsoever. That man came from the base village people of the rocky crags, and yet he has been made the foremost minister and all the king's affairs have been entrusted to this wicked one — how is that fitting? Let things be restored to what they were before, as in former times." She went and spoke to her father: "How is it fitting, father, that without examining this wicked man's character, you made him the foremost minister and placed your trust in him? For he is in this way intimate with one of the king's queens — associating with her under the title of 'Your Majesty's queen.' Furthermore, he ate the king's peacock. He receives and entertains those who come from foreign lands and supplies them with all necessities. And yet, father, you are always saying that you are very fond of this Great Minister, and that there is no one more pleasing to you than he — let such things not be done, and please find out what the truth of the matter is." Upon hearing these words, the king had his executioners summoned in order to examine the matter.

The executioners then placed a garland of karavīra flowers about the Great Minister's neck, beat drums with a sound like the braying of an ass, abused him with harsh words, bound him, and sentenced him. Men who were like the servants of the Lord of Death, bearing weapons, led him toward the charnel ground — and yet no one moved to kill him. The townspeople and those from the countryside wept tears from their eyes and, suffering as if their own son were being slain, let out cries of lamentation and prayed to the gods. To such an extent had the Great Minister been close to the poor of the royal lineage and had shared out his wealth and given to them — and so those people said to the king's men: "You are killing him for our sake; go back, all of you."

The Vinaya Kṣudraka-vastu, thirty-fourth fascicle.

Now, as he emerged from the city, a brahmin named Mongtul grasped him by the hem of his robe and said: "You once promised to give me a measure of barley — give it and be on your way." At that place the Great Minister spoke in verse:

A king becomes no true friend.
With an outcast there is no fellowship.
To women one does not reveal secrets.
The flesh of a peacock one does not eat.

From the brahmin Mongtul
not even a measure of barley shall be claimed.

Having spoken these words, he departed. Then the executioners said: "Great Minister, if you have such knowledge and excellent discernment, why do you not appeal?" The Great Minister replied: "I do not appeal — but then again, what would be the use of appealing?" They said: "We, your lordship, do not appeal either — but we speak out of necessity, being ourselves oppressed by suffering. And what is it?" They said: "The line 'A king becomes no true friend' — explain it at length." He then said again: "If your lordship would hear a request, please listen for a moment. When I said 'A king becomes no true friend,' formerly — whether it was a village of the gods, a city, or a settlement — there was none who was not subject to him; and as for the meaning of why you spoke those words, you simply did not understand it." Having said that, they went on.

They said to the king: "What great medicine is superior to vitality? Please grant us permission to recite it back." Then the king called them and questioned them. They said: "As for the food, drink, and clothing that were yours — from those you came to rule over this realm of the gods, the kingdom, the army, the treasury, and the troops. If I had done likewise, then without any thought of you repaying what you had previously done for me, the god cast me out to be killed. For that reason I said: 'A king becomes no true friend.'

"As for the saying 'A candāla has no friend' — the god, this candāla bereft of bed and clothing, thought: 'If the king provides me with the means of livelihood, I shall live by that.' And so he came before the god, but the god did not fully receive him. Thinking 'I am impoverished' and 'I am a wanderer from the land,' I shared what I had, and it is on that account that he is now well off. Yet today he has set out to have me killed — and for that reason I said: 'A candāla has no friend.'

"As for the saying 'One should not tell one's secrets to women' — once the king was seated within his assembly and spoke these words: 'To whom should one entrust one's confidence?' The ministers then said: 'To one's father, one's mother, one's sister, and one's companions' — each naming whomever he would speak to. The god then said: 'One should tell it to one's wife, for a wife is half of one's own body, and therefore one should tell her.' Thereupon I thought: 'I shall bring this matter before the god's eyes,' and so in order to test

him, I hid the king's peacock and took another peacock to present. From among the royal garments, I took an ornament from a rather shabby one and hung it around the neck of a certain courtesan and left it in a house, and invited the god to look at that courtesan as well.

"The king then had both the garment and the courtesan brought and placed side by side. When both were examined, their marks, color, manner, and shape were identical, and not the slightest difference could be detected in either one. Having thus investigated, the king understood inwardly that I, the great physician, was without fault.

"As for the words:

Do not become attached even to a measure of barley
belonging to a dull-witted brahmin —

when the god sent me to be killed and I was being led away by the executioners, that one gave me a measure of barley. For the sake of that measure of barley he seized the hem of my garment — and it is for that reason I said those words.

"Then the king, all these matters having been demonstrated plainly before him, rejoiced, released me, and honored me with great honor." Thereupon he prostrated before the king and said: "Your majesty, have you seen through the secrets of women? As for your daughter — there is no need for her to come to me. Nevertheless, I shall take a female companion whose lineage, form, conduct, and wisdom are like mine." With the king's leave, he himself took on the appearance of a brahmin — in his right hand he held a water-pot with a bird atop it, he adorned his body with a fly-whisk to beautify it, he clothed his body in the hide of a forest antelope, he painted three stripes on his face — and set out thus for the densely forested mountains and valleys to seek a girl. After some time, it grew dark midway on the road in a certain village. Presently a brahmin asked him: "Where do you come from?" He answered: "From the noble land of Āryāvarta." "Where are you going?" "To the dense forest." "Do you have the acquaintance of anyone at whose house to lodge?" He replied: "No." The brahmin then took him home and entertained him hospitably with generous and fitting provisions.

He also warned the brahmin's wife, saying that she ought not to give herself over to attachment to another man. The next morning, after asking for directions and setting out, the brahmin said to him: "Friend, this house of mine — whenever you pass this way going to and fro, treat it as your own home." He

replied, "I shall do so," and departed.

After some time, at a certain point along the road, there was a barley field. There he saw a girl who was beautiful of form and pleasing to behold, of noble family, and possessed of great gentleness. Upon seeing her, his mind became attached to her. He then asked: "Dear one, who are you? Whose are you? What is your name?" She replied: "Sa-ga." "And whose are you?" She said: "I belong to him who provides wood for all the village."

The great physician thought to himself: "If this girl is of fine form, let me first test her intelligence to see what it is like." He then entered the barley field and, raising his arm as if to throw it up, kicked the barley stalks with his foot. At that, Sa-ga said: "Good sir, just as you threw your arm, so too throw your two legs." He thought: "This girl is clever."

Then he spoke to her with a laugh: "Young woman, you are wearing a very large ear-ornament — a ring and a pendant — quite weighty indeed." Sa-ga replied: "Sir, it is to cover both ears." Then the great physician said: "The girl is of fine form, pleasing to behold, and beautiful." Sa-ga replied: "It is by the kindness of the village masters." After sitting a while, he said: "Go to your father's house." The girl replied: "I am able to make a single road into two — I gather the branches of thorn-bushes and block the path, so that people must make a second way around. Go to your mother's house as well." "Where has your mother gone?" "She has gone to the field for seed grain."

"Will you be my wife, girl?" The girl replied: "If the village masters consent." He said: "Show me which road through the dense forest is comfortable and direct." Again he said in verse:

Through the dense forest's tangled paths,
where no thorns snag and no thicket stands,
smooth, comfortable, and straight —
show me from which way I should go.

She then showed him a roundabout road, but herself ran ahead by another way. She removed her clothes at a small pond, closed one eye, and sat there — as if she did not know him, or perhaps did not. She blew one breath and sat still. Again she said in verse:

Leave by the road where you shall eat,
abandon the road where you shall not eat,
and, having left the rest behind,

proceed into the forest of grain.

The great physician then traveled by the road she had indicated. After some distance, he recognized her from afar and said in verse:

One who wears no woven woolen cloth,
who wears unwoven, unspun cloth instead,
the beautiful one with a left eye — from which way
is she who goes to the flower-village? Show me.

Then the girl laughed a little and said in verse:

Here on the left-hand road and trail
where rabbits may be found,
and the blossoms of the palāśa tree bloom fully —
from there, let the brahmin proceed.

He went on and on until he arrived, but when he reached the home of Sa-ga's father, her parents were not to be found. He then spoke to the village masters: "If you will permit it, I shall take Sa-ga as my wife." No sooner had those words been spoken than all the village masters replied with one voice, rebuking him: "You shameless, wretched, begging brahmin! How dare you beg for our Sa-ga, who is like a daughter of the gods! Get out of this village at once! Shall we set untamed dogs on you?" And they drove him away with abuse.

He was chased away by those people and went to her very presence. Sa-ga saw him coming from afar and said: "Welcome — it is good that you have come."

The great physician then reported to her the words the village masters had spoken — that they had beaten him off like a fly.

Sa-ga said: "How did you put it to them, and by what means did you speak?"

The great physician then recounted the exchange just as it had occurred.

Sa-ga then said to the great physician: "Noble brahmin, do not be discouraged. I shall do as you have done in seeking to win a girl. Act as you acted."

The brahmin said: "What else can be done?"

The girl said: "First, come close and enter my presence. Then, in keeping with that agreement, proceed accordingly. Once the agreement is settled, invite them as guests and give a feast with food and drink. After that, whatever it is you need to do, do it."

He went and, just as she had instructed, gave the village masters a feast in the manner of various kinds of food. Then he rose and formally asked for Sa-ga, and they consented, saying: "Today we shall fulfill whatever you have wished in your heart." Having arrived at an agreement of that kind, just a short while later her parents arrived. The great physician and the village masters then appealed to her parents, saying: "This matter should be considered." The village masters then said: "What is there to consider? He is a young brahmin of good form and pleasing to behold, learned in many treatises, and accomplished in the Vedas and their auxiliary branches — he will not fail in anything. Give her to him." The great physician then summoned the brahmin assembly and the girl was formally given in marriage.

On another day, the groom and the bride were called, honored with ceremony, dressed in fine clothes, and made to sit together; then they set out for the house of the one who causes the body to flourish.

On the way there, a certain brahmin gave a feast on the occasion of the fourteenth and offered a full measure of barley as a sacrificial gift. That brahmin then tucked the full measure of barley into the hem of his garment and went to a friend's house, where he knocked at the door.

A brahmin woman inside said: "Who is that?"

He said: "I am your husband's household friend."

She said: "The master of the house is not here, and there is no one else at home; it would not be proper to let another man enter the house in the absence of the master. Go find another house."

Then the great physician thought: "Why is she not letting me in?" and on reflection, he saw that she was letting another man in on one side. The great physician then said: "It is entirely fitting that she would not let me in."

While he was thinking this, just then that brahmin arrived from another village and called at the door. Hearing the sound of the dog, she was displeased and wondering what to do, she let him come in.

Then the two of them went inside together and settled in comfortably.

After a while, the great physician said to the brahmin woman: "Where shall I put this barley?"

The brahmin woman said: "On the ground over there."

The brahmin said: "Mice will eat it." And so he searched under the bedding and in all the corners of the house, but it was nowhere to be seen. Then, shortly after, a storage vessel appeared on one side, and he thought: "There it is."

The great physician then said: "Pour the barley into this vessel."

The brahmin woman said: "My precious goods are in there — how can you pour barley into it?"

He said: "Brahmin woman, that wretched pot — move it into any suitable vessel." And so the barley was poured in there.

The great physician also said: "Otherwise, mice will spoil the barley, and that is why it should be poured in here."

Then the brahmin woman, suddenly understanding with certainty, cried out in fear and alarm: "This vessel too will become wet, and the barley will be spoiled!"

The great physician then said to the brahmin woman: "You need have no worry at all — I shall arrange things in such a way that it will not get wet, and the barley will not be spoiled either." With that, he rose, turned a deer skin inside out and outside in, and hung it doubled around his neck as a sacred offering-cloth. He then said, "The vessel will be dry," and began to heap in ox-dung and pieces of wood.

Then the brahmin woman, clearly perceiving the suffering that had arisen from separation from what she loved, thought, "This will soon be gone," and sent an urgent message to the rat's household, saying: "Come quickly — let it be arranged thus!"

Her father, the moment he heard, went immediately and said to the great physician: "I will buy this item at whatever price you ask." The great physician replied: "Look carefully and take note. What is the arrangement? It is five hundred gold coins — no less than that." Even as he said these words, he was also arranging oil lamps around the vessel. The father thought to himself: "This matter should not be spoken of abroad." He then opened the house door, and with great physical strength lifted the vessel and carried it to his own home.

The very next day, the great physician gave one hundred gold coins to that householder and told him: "Your wife is such-and-such a person" — relating to him those domestic matters — "and therefore you should be on your guard." He then entrusted the remaining four hundred gold coins to the brahmin and said: "Go to the forested and overgrown place and give these to Sāgā,

wherever she is encamped. Tell them: I am not a brahmin — I am the great physician, the finest minister of the king who nourishes the Noble Ones, and I have come solely to find this token. Therefore, care well for the girl." Having said this, he flung those gold coins, sent a letter along with them, and went to the court of the king who nourishes the Noble Ones.

That brahmin then went to the forested and overgrown place and gave Sāgā the letter and three hundred gold coins. When Sāgā had read the letter, it said in verse:

Of the four portions due,
if even one is not delivered,
take a wooden skewer unasked
and let it be plunged into him there.

Seeing that one hundred gold coins had not arrived, Sāgā searched for a long while under the bed. Then he said: "What are you looking for there?" The brahmin replied: "Word came from around the palace saying that when the king's men arrive they will cause harm — seize them! — and that is why I was searching for someone to take as a substitute." Sāgā took him up and said to the brahmin: "Whoever such a person might be, if she does not recognize him, let his foot be placed here for a moment first, to see whether it fits or not." The brahmin, intending to test his suspicion, placed his foot inside, and Sāgā drove a long nail into it. The brahmin said: "Why are you seizing me?" Sāgā replied: "Because when four hundred were to be sent to him, you withheld one hundred."

The brahmin was then filled with amazement and thought: "The great physician and this one — they must be demons. Two great demons have assembled in one place." With that thought, he handed over the remainder.

Just then the parents arrived. The letter was shown to them, and it was announced: "This is not a brahmin — this is the great physician, the finest minister of the king who nourishes the Noble Ones." Hearing this, the parents, the girl, and the members of her family all rejoiced greatly, saying: "We have made alliance with a great man. We are meritorious and made pure by this — now our lineage has been received by the great physician." From that time on, Sāgā was attended with the most excellent care in the form of massage, bathing, food and drink, clothing, and ornaments, and before long she became a person of exceptionally fine and beautiful form.

Then the great physician traveled to the city, and the king heard that he had arrived. The king and all the senior ministers were filled with great joy when they learned that the great physician had come.

King Skyed pa said: "How did you come to find her?" He replied: "I found myself a bride." The king said: "What is she like?" The great physician said: "She is beautiful of form, lovely and fair to behold, and richly endowed with intelligence — she has fallen to my lot as my daughter-in-law. And yet, O king, may I ask whether you yourself would take her?" The king then said: "Who other than I should fall to your lot? For you are the foremost of ministers. Therefore, take her with such wealth as will cause her to delight in me in every way." Saying "As the king commands, so it shall be," the great physician, surrounded by an assembly of ministers and accompanied by brahmins, householders, and other invited crowds of people, along with a great multitude of elephant-riders, cavalry, charioteers, and infantry, went to the forested woodland home of Gyopo (the hunter). There a great wedding was performed, and in due course he brought his new wife to the city, where she lived together with him in play, joy, and festive pleasure.

Now at that time, five hundred merchants from the north arrived in the region of Lus 'phags (Uttarakuru), traveling by horse caravan, and came to the court of King Skyed pa. In that place there were five hundred courtesans disposed and suited to the manners, conduct, form, and grandeur of the place — skilled in flattery, adornment, the arousing of delight, in song, in dance, in platforms for display, and in clever conversation — and these five hundred stripped bare of their goods all the merchants who arrived and came there. Having heard that the party of merchants from the north had arrived, each of the courtesans undertook to entertain one merchant each, drew them close, and with them engaged in play, joy, and festive pleasure. Now among those merchants, the one who was their caravan leader was a man of prudence and care, and he did not join in reckless sport with the rest. The one who was the chief among all those courtesans desired that caravan leader, yet the caravan leader would not comply. She then gathered the merchants together and entreated them: "Please bring about a reconciliation between me and the caravan leader." The merchants and the courtesans thereafter arranged a daily round of wagers, so that he might not fall under the power of recklessness. Then that courtesan came herself and engaged the caravan leader in flattery and banter. The caravan leader said: "Since you cannot deceive me, why do you torment yourself?" She replied: "If I were to deceive you, what would a wise man give?"

He said: "I will give five excellent horses. But if you fail to deceive me, I will henceforth follow you without a single karṣāpaṇa (a coin of currency) to my name." She then made her scheme and tried with all her effort, but was unable to prevail.

After some time the merchants said to the caravan leader: "The chief courtesan of the city is unattainable — let us behave then as the world behaves." The caravan leader then said to them: "Friends, in a night dream I enjoyed her fully." The merchants spread this tale abroad, and she had the caravan leader seized by the king's men, saying: "You enjoyed yourself with me as you desired — now give me the five excellent horses." The caravan leader said: "You wicked woman, are you saying I lied?" And so the two of them quarreled and went to the royal palace. There the king together with his retinue held court from the opening of proceedings until the sun set in the west, yet not one side was defeated, nor the other either.

The king and all his ministers, wearied and threatened by hunger, said they would deliberate further the next day, and each went home to his own dwelling.

That evening the great physician went home and Sagā asked him: "Your Highness's son — why was there a delay today?" The great physician told her at length the whole story of how the case had proved impossible to decide. Then Sagā said: "That you, with your perfect powers of analysis and resolution, could not settle this case — that is the nature of your being male, it seems." The great physician replied: "Well then, could you settle it?" She said: "Indeed I could. Watch what my mind is capable of." She then said: "Go and have the five excellent horses tied up at the edge of the pool, and have the king and his ministers also assemble at that place and be given a meal. If the courtesan says they had intercourse — the two of them together — then say the five horses are to be taken. But if she says the intercourse took place in a dream, then show her the reflections of the horses in the water. If she says, 'What do I need with these, which cannot be taken?' then say: 'Just as these cannot be taken, so too the pleasure enjoyed in a dream is like them in precisely that way.'" Hearing this, the great physician himself was filled with wonder.

The next day the king assembled and the ministers gathered, and the five excellent horses were led to the pool. There the five excellent horses were tethered and a meal was provided. Then the great physician settled the case exactly as Sagā had shown him, and the king and the ministers and the

members of the court, hearing it, were filled with wonder. The king said: "O great physician, this verdict that has just now been pronounced — if there is something that does not perplex me, and my ministers, and other people besides — it has come about through your skillful means." The great physician replied: "This was Sagā's skillful means; it was she who also showed the verdict." At that the king and the ministers and the other assembled people were filled with wonder and said: "How very wise is Sagā, daughter of the carpenter! Sagā is truly intelligent!" And her fame spread through every land.

Then a merchant from the northern regions presented the king with two wild geese as a gift, saying: "Your Majesty, these wild geese are said to be female — but as to which is the mother and which the offspring, that no one has been able to determine." The king and his retinue were once again vexed, and in exactly the same manner the great physician put the question to the carpenter's daughter Sagā and described the difficulty of determining which was male and which was female at length. Then Sagā thought for a moment and said: "That you, one who is a minister — or rather the minister of a great and learned king — you who are adorned with such perfect powers of analysis and resolution, should ask me about such a matter: do you truly not know?" She said: "Take a wisp of soft wool or a tip of lampwick, or the tip of a reed, wrap it in cotton or wool, and stroke both their backs with it. Whichever one cannot bear the touch — that one is male." The next day it was done accordingly, and the king was delighted.

Then at another time, merchants from the south arrived carrying a sandalwood log, but they could not tell which end was the root and which was the top. Just as before, the prince's wife was asked about it, and she said: "Cast it into the pond, my lord, and whichever end sinks — that is the root."

This too filled the king with delight, and when the assembled people heard of it they were filled with wonder. The thought arose in the king's mind: "I should find out which among my ministers is skilled and knowledgeable in the assessment of precious jewels." He had a jewel fastened to the tip of a victory banner atop a multistoried building, and below that building lay a pond. The king made a solemn pledge that whoever could identify that jewel would receive it as a gift. Those who entered the pond and reached up to take the jewel, grasping at it, could not obtain it.

Then the carpenter's daughter Sagā was told of this, and she said: "Look upward, my lord. That which is fastened to the tip of the victory banner — it is

only its reflection appearing in the water below. One must take it from the tip of the banner itself." The next day it was done accordingly, and the king asked: "Whose solution was this?" When told it was Sagā's solution, the king was pleased and praised her, saying she was supremely skilled in every respect.

Now the six ministers came to know that Sagā was exceedingly beautiful of form, and they conceived a plan among themselves: "Let us seduce her with jewels, silver, lapis lazuli, gold, coral, rubies, crystal, and the like, and then meet with her alone." But nothing came of it. As they kept speaking of this among themselves, one of them spoke to the physician and said: "You know the custom of this land — if any young and beautiful woman is seduced by another's husband, consider what that is like." The physician replied: "This is the way of all people. Men pursue all women, yet it is women themselves who must be discerning about it. If a woman is wise, it cannot be done."

Then Sagā said: "My lord, if someone were to make improper advances toward such a person, or do her some harm, would that not put them in danger?" The physician replied: "Be careful in what you do." Then Sagā said: "Pretend to say, 'Yes, it is I who will do it,' and then carry it up to a certain height. Otherwise, feign agreement and sit." She herself then sent a reply through each of the messengers who had come from those ministers: "While it is disagreeable to be forced by you messengers in this way, I will offer whatever service has been commanded." She then made a wooden effigy in the likeness of the physician, wrapped it in cloth, and laid it in a bed. She also said separately to each of them: "The physician is unwell. Come at such and such a time, at such and such a time, and let no one come seeking him, but do so covertly." Then she had six large boxes made and placed one in each of her six rooms. When they came, she placed them one by one into the boxes, bound them fast, and the following day announced with a proclamation that the physician had died.

Upon hearing this, the royal consort together with her retinue, and likewise the assembled populace, were stricken with great grief. Lamenting, "We are now bereft of such a being," they plunged into an ocean of sorrow and cried out with voices of compassion. But the carpenter's daughter Sagā had the six ministers, bound well in their boxes, brought before the king, and announced: "The divine physician has in fact passed beyond his time. Here, sealed with his own seal, are his possessions — his lapis lazuli, gold, silk, jewels, and the like." Then the king spoke.

"He died today, and today these were delivered to me." So saying, the king was overcome with profound grief.

But at that very moment the great physician himself appeared from another place, adorned with flowers and smiling, and went to the royal palace. He bowed before the king and said: "Has Your Majesty accepted any marriage contract that I, your servant, failed to approve with loving consent? The king replied: "I have not taken one myself — they were brought here from your own house." Then the physician spoke in verse:

Great king, the divine physician
has departed to the world beyond.
These are his treasures and possessions —
may the lord of men be pleased to receive them.
I, the great king's servant, am destitute,
for I have been separated from my spouse and home.
Having been thus despised and wronged,
they now come to rob me of my wealth.

Then the great physician also demonstrated the excellence of the chief ministers' reasoning and discernment. When king Skyedpa looked up, he saw the six ministers with their hair and beards shaved off and their four limbs bound and folded. He laughed, and said to the great physician: "Great physician, tell me — whose stratagem was this?" The physician replied: "It was Sagā's," and recounted everything in full detail.

Then the king reflected: "How remarkable is the intelligence of this woman! How remarkable her steadiness! How remarkable her discernment! She has reduced these chief ministers to such a state!" Delighted, he honoured her greatly. And throughout all the provinces the fame spread abroad: "Such is the wisdom of Sagā, the carpenter's daughter."

The summary verse:

Just as I too was healed by the physician,
food and reward were given to dog and cattle.
The oath-stone, the musical instruments —
all like a false udumbara flower.
Even the necklace was lost,
and the secret of the mynah bird was told.
This is the verse-summary of the second middle tale.

Now, the king came to know that Sagā was learned and wise, and he thought: "The great physician, endowed with merit, has found such an intelligent wife." Then the king said to the great physician: "If it pleases you, I too would like to seek and take a wife as wise as this for myself — it would be of great benefit for the affairs of the household, and moreover for the affairs of the outer royal palace." The great physician asked: "Where shall I seek her?" The king then said: "I have heard that the daughter of the king of Ngalen, named Menden, is beautiful and lovely in form, and moreover is endowed with mindfulness and vigilance, and has wisdom of the same calibre as Sagā. Go and take her as a bride." The great physician replied: "Your Majesty, if I am to devise a stratagem in this matter, that kingdom is like an enemy beyond your Majesty's borders. I shall first seek out a means." Then king Skyedpa dispatched the minister-envoys, and they set out on the mission.

When the king of Ngalen assembled his ministers and asked them what should be done, they replied: "King Skyedpa has in the past not heeded the royal command, and there are those who would bring this matter under the power of strife. Let him grant a little time first, for us to determine what to do." Having been given that time, they set a certain great date, combined it with a brief interval, and said: "Let them come to receive the bride." Then they departed and informed king Skyedpa that the princess Menden had been obtained for him. As for when she was to be fetched — they reported the reply: "Come on such and such a great date combined with the brief interval."

Shortly after that time, the king of Ngalen began preparations for sending the bride: all manner of food and drink were readied, but every kind of food and drink was mixed with poison, and he dispatched messengers with orders that no one should escape alive from the expedition of king Skyedpa.

When this was learned, the great physician said to king Skyedpa: "Your Majesty, this must not be done in haste. And why is that?"

"And why is that? He is a king who dwells beyond the boundaries of the divine realm, one with whom there is constant conflict and with whom this king has long been at odds. Let this be investigated."

The king said: "Whom shall we send to investigate?" The physician replied: "May Your Majesty rest at ease. I have here a parakeet of mine named Caryāprakāśa — clever, bright, and agreeable — whom I shall send there. He will speak with everyone and then return."

"Let it be done." So Caryāprakāśa went there and thought: "Whom shall I approach, and with whom shall I keep company and converse?" He looked all around but saw no one at all. He then thought: "By what worldly convention shall I act?" Presently he entered the royal palace, and looking about, he spotted between the rafters a mynah bird sitting there. He went to her, and the two of them, delighting in each other's company, took mutual pleasure together. He then asked her: "Where do you come from?"

The parakeet said: "I come from the northern king named Śibi. I guard the pleasure grove. My wife — a fine mynah bird, well-formed, gentle, congenial, pleasing, and sweet-spoken — was carried off violently by another, and so I am tormented with grief, wandering to and fro, and have come to your side. Dear one, could you not become my wife?"

The mynah said: "I had not heard nor seen that the parakeet's wife was a mynah bird. Be that as it may, I have heard it said by the wise that the parakeet's wife is none other than a parakeet itself."

Thereupon, speaking and pursuing his intention just so, Caryāprakāśa played with her, made her joyful, and sported together with her in delight.

Then the parakeet Caryāprakāśa, while in the royal palace, saw many foods being prepared — things called the finest honey, and treats called "sorrow-free sweets," and fried puffed grain being stirred abundantly, and many dishes made of raw sugar — and he said to the mynah: "Why are all these being prepared? Might we obtain some?"

Then he spoke to the mynah in verse:

"These many dishes set in heavy crocks,
all being stirred and made ready —
might some of them be ours?
Speak to me softly, dear mynah."

The mynah replied:

"Parakeet, you clever Caryāprakāśa,
these porters laden with heavy loads,
all this that is being stirred and made —
none of these foods are for you.
All of this, for the sake of Skyedpa,
has been mixed entirely with poison."

Then Caryāprakāśa, having sent his understanding ahead, spoke again to the mynah with a skilful stratagem:

"If sounds like these were to spread
in every direction — that Lnalén's own daughter
has been given to Skyedpa —
then whose words would be true,
and whose words would be just as they are?"

The mynah said:

"You clever parakeet, Caryāprakāśa —
that wrathful one will not give her;
those with wicked minds
strive only to slay him."

Having heard all this, Caryāprakāśa turned back. What he had seen and heard, grasped and understood, was as fully accomplished as a merchant who has found and obtained the object of his quest.

For the sake of Śibi he spoke to the mynah:

"I have found a wife just right for me —
a mynah who speaks so gently —"

"So that the king of Śibi may know,
noble one, I shall go."

The mynah said:

"If the lord's son departs,
let the king of Śibi be informed,
and in no more than seven days
let him come to know.
Let the king of Śibi know as well
my lineage and clan
and my resources, just as they are.
I too, for my part, will not betray you hereafter."

Having gone and arrived, the minister Smāchen reported everything at length to the minister of state. Then Smāchen informed King Skyedpa. Upon realizing that the enemy would not come of his own accord, the king of Lnalén armed his fourfold host — his corps of elephants, his corps of cavalry, his corps of chariots, and his corps of foot soldiers — and marched to the presence of

King Skyedpa, surrounding King Skyedpa's palace.

Then the foremost of ministers, Smanchen, reflected: "If I cannot break through and fight alongside him, what is to be done? I must drive a wedge." So he sent lavish gifts of every variety to the five hundred ministers of the king of Lnalén and sowed division among them. Having sown that division, King Skyedpa sent an envoy to the king of Lnalén, saying: "It is not that I am unable to fight you — but you and I are kin, and since you yourself are the one who is a kinsman, I will not cross you. Nevertheless, know this well: whether you live or die is in my hands. Even though I have the power, I will not cross you. But if you are in doubt, examine whether those gifts were indeed sent to your chief ministers." The envoy, together with the gifts, was then seized.

That very evening the king of Lnalén departed and went to his own home. When it was reported as true that those five hundred ministers had been put to death and that their sons had been installed as ministers, joy arose among King Skyedpa and those with him. Smanchen too, upon hearing that they had been killed, thought, "I have accomplished such deeds as these," and was glad.

After they had been killed, Smanchen submitted to the king: "Now I myself will go in person and ascertain whether we have gained the victory or not." So saying, he set out with his own army to the territory of the king of Lnalén. The king of Lnalén said: "Come inside the city." He replied: "I will remain right here in this pleasure grove. However, if I am definitely to come inside, I wish to come to the residence of a great chief minister." Thereupon the king of Lnalén grew suspicious, thinking, "Why does he speak in this manner? Surely there is yet someone who is driving a wedge between me and my ministers." He sent word back: "If it pleases you so, stay just where you are."

His ministers then conferred among themselves: "The one who has managed to convey all our counsel to our master's ears — it is none other than this Smanchen. Let us therefore call to mind our old grievance, press the king by all means to hold firm, and ensure that this man does not go back." They assembled and said to the king: "Whoever has devised such a stratagem of mind — that is the doing of this great minister Smanchen. King Skyedpa himself cannot harm the other side directly. Therefore, while Smanchen is here present with us, we others will go from here to King Skyedpa's side." The king said: "Well spoken."

Then, arming his fourfold host — the corps of elephants, the corps of cavalry, the corps of chariots, and the corps of foot soldiers — they marched to the palace where the king resided. King Skyedpa too made preparations. And Smanchen came to know that the king of Lnalén had set out by the main road toward King Skyedpa's territory.

He stayed there for a short while, and came to know that somewhere in a great distant quarter there was a treasury of the king, and that in that treasury there dwelt a princess called Smanldenma, the king's own daughter. Then he took a lady of the inner retinue, settled the escort outside, and straightway entered the royal treasury. He opened it up, took the princess along with the wealth — the valuables and the gold — equipped his fourfold host, and went by a different road to King Skyedpa's presence.

Then King Skyedpa, his ministers, the townspeople, and all the others rejoiced greatly, saying that a great deed had been accomplished, and they performed many acts of celebration and festivity.

When the chief minister of the king of Lnalén arrived in turn, Smanchen had already taken the princess and the treasury, abandoned those palaces of the king, and departed for his own land. King Skyedpa, for his part, took the princess as his bride amid auspicious ceremonies, and he made merry with her, rejoiced, and lived in delight.

Thereupon the king of Lnalén sent a messenger to the princess Smanldenma, saying: "Find out and report back to me whose stratagem this was, who devised it, who caused this division, and what the meaning of these deeds is. Examine it and send word."

She examined the matter and sent a messenger back. It was a myna bird, known in the language of humans as Chösäl, belonging to Smanchen — and it had worked all this out.

Then the king of Lnalén declared: "By all means send Chösäl back to me." Chösäl was caught at great effort and dispatched to him. But the king, consumed by anger, had it tortured in manifold ways and ordered it killed.

Then Chösäl prostrated at the king's feet and petitioned him: "My lord, just as you killed my father and grandfather, please permit me to be killed in the same manner. If that is how it is to be, then kill me thus." And the king consented.

Chösal asked him: "In exactly what way were my father and grandfather killed?" He was told: its tail was bound with raw cotton wool, it was smeared with sesame oil, set ablaze, and released. It then flew up into the sky, set the entire royal palace ablaze all round, and plunged into the water.

After that it went to King Skyedpa's presence. Smanchen also questioned it: "From where have you come here?" It made known everything that had happened, and Smanchen was delighted.

Then the king of Lnalén, consumed by anger, sent another letter: "This one has caused harm in such and such a manner — send it back without fail." It was caught again and dispatched. The king of Lnalén in his rage had its feathers plucked, put it in a cage of bones, and had it cast outside, saying: "Go on your way." A hawk then carried it off.

But Chösal made a petition to the hawk: "Eating me will last you but a single day's meal, whereas if you release me, I will provide you with as much food and provisions of every kind as you need for day after day in the same measure." The hawk, having sworn a trustworthy oath on this, released it.

Chösal then said: "Set me down in a great and distant quarter, at the royal temple there." The hawk did so, and Chösal went to the temple and entered a hollow in it. The next day, brahmin priests came there to make offerings to the deity. They wiped the image clean and were engaged in offering incense, flowers, divine cakes, and torma. Then Chösal spoke: "O brahmins, repeat these words of mine to the sinful king, the king of Lnalén. 'These and these offenses that have been committed — it is I who brought this harm. If you do not act in accordance with my words, I shall come again.' In this manner, day by day, red flesh and sesame and —"

thick rice porridge, a small bowlful, was offered as a divine cake. And from that time on she made plans. She went and conveyed the message into the heart of the king of Lnalén. The king, for that very purpose, took up the making of divine cakes and torma-offerings. Each day, the king, his ministers, and the court attendants came forward and prayed, asking the deity whether such-and-such should be permitted or not, and the reply was always, "Do so."

In this way, much time passed. The mynah bird Chösal grew feathers and became able to fly, and she conceived the wish to leave. She then spoke these words: "Thus to me — you, together with your military forces, your queens, your princes, and your ministers, all bowing your heads, shall come before me. Grant me your pardon and your permission." She conveyed this to the king,

and the king did so. All of them, bowing their heads, went to where the deity was, touched their foreheads to its feet, and begged forgiveness. Then the mynah bird soared up into the sky and recited this verse:

The doer is repaid in kind —
look back, and the scorned one scorns in turn.
Here it was one alone, a despised one,
who swept out every last queen perfectly.

Having spoken these words, she then went to the Great Physician. When the Great Physician had not seen Chösal for quite a long time, he asked where she had gone. She told him at length, saying, "I carried out such-and-such schemes." The Great Physician was delighted and gladdened, and told the king, explaining how the mynah bird Chösal had done all this. The king too was filled with the greatest joy and said, "How wonderful — to meet one so purely skilled as you is a mark of good fortune."

Then, at a later time, the king formed the thought that he wished to test which of his ministers was the most capable. He summoned them and gave each one a dog, commanding them: "Within such-and-such a time, make all of these speak in the human tongue." They took the dogs home and tried to feed and raise them, but while they could teach them to recognize food, they could not get them to speak in the human tongue.

The Great Physician took his dog home, went inside, and tied it to a stake not far from his throne. Whenever the Great Physician's food was set out and prepared — various eatables, dishes, and broths — the dog would look on but could not take any. Then he gave it a small amount of something unpleasant, not enough to kill it nor to restore it, leaving it wasted, famished, and thin.

Then the king ordered that all the dogs be brought before him to see whether they had been trained or not. Since those ministers knew no method, they had been unable to train them. The Great Physician too was told, "Bring yours — whatever state it is in," and so he came before the king. When the king looked, the dog was thin and famished. The king asked, "Why is it so thin?" The Great Physician replied, "My lord, I gave this one whatever I ate and whatever I desired." The dog then spoke up: "The lord lies — I am starving; he has killed me with hunger." The Great Physician then submitted, "This is how I made this one speak in the human tongue." The king was greatly pleased.

Then again, at a later time, wishing to fatten the sheep, the king commanded, "Give these sheep delicious food and drink, and make them plump and full of

vigor without fat." The five hundred ministers, knowing no method, simply fed the sheep well and made them fat. The Great Physician, however, placed delicious food before them and then fashioned a likeness of a wolf from wood and set it in front of the sheep. When the sheep saw it they were terrified, and so they did not put on fat but became full of vigor.

When they all looked, the others had become sleek in coat and heavy with fat. But the Great Physician's sheep were seen to be free of fat and full of vigor, and the king was pleased and praised him, saying, "Well done — wise man!"

Then at a later time, wishing to test who was truly clever, the king had the five hundred sons of those ministers invited to a garden for a meal. They were eating, drinking, and at their ease when he began a conversation filled with marvels, saying, "Let each of you tell a wondrous tale, or speak of something remarkable you have heard or seen at home." In their friendship they told one another every marvelous thing they had, and spoke of what they had seen at their own homes and in other directions. Then the boys urged the son of the Great Physician, saying, "You too must speak." So the boy said, "In the home of the Great Physician there is a stone — it alone serves as a support — and when it is placed on water it floats back and forth, bobbing and dipping, and performs all manner of tasks." The boy then told those at his own home what he had described, saying, "A marvel such as this exists at our house and nowhere else." They took him at his word from then on, and when he told them, "In our house there is a stone that floats and moves on water," they replied, "We have never seen or heard of anything like a stone floating and moving on water." So he and the others wagered five hundred gold coins. Then the youth went to his father and told him what had happened and how he had wagered against them. His father said, "Son, do not show it to them yet." When they came and it was not shown to them, the five hundred gold coins were won. Then the Great Physician caught some monkeys, trained them in music, and said to his son, "Now go to the garden feast. Bring up the earlier conversation, and when they ask you what marvels you have seen or heard or what is to be found at home, say: 'You made me lose the wager twice already. In my house there are performing monkeys — skilled in song, skilled in dance, skilled in drumming.'" He instructed him thus. The boy, weaving this in among other topics, said, "I have seen such a thing and it exists." Then they said, "We have never seen or heard of monkeys performing music." He said, "If I show you, what will you give me?" They replied, "We already gave you five hundred gold coins before. Now you would wrongly and improperly say such a thing

again — if you still fail to show us, we wager one thousand gold coins; but if you show us, we will pay you." Having made this wager, he led the monkeys to the royal palace. He drove the monkeys into the king's palace and displayed before the king every manner of song, dance, and drumming. Thereupon they gave him one thousand gold coins. The king too was filled with wonder, saying, "Such things I have never before seen or heard." Then the king, the ministers, and the townspeople all exclaimed, "Behold — in all things, this one alone is wise and possessed of intelligence!" Everyone paid their respects to the Great Physician.

Now in the land of Videha there was a brahmin who had taken a wife of equal birth, and together they sported and lived in full enjoyment. After some time the brahmin's wife conceived, and when nine months had passed she gave birth to a girl who was lovely in form and beautiful to behold. That brahmin had mastered the Vedas and their branches to perfection, had mastered the eighteen branches of the fields of knowledge, and was sharp in mind and wisdom. He thought, "Whoever resembles me and studies and recites in my presence — to such a one I will give this girl."

A great birth-celebration was held for the newborn, and when they deliberated on what name to give her, they named the girl Udumbārikā. She was nursed and raised until she grew up.

Now another brahmin had a son who was ugly in complexion, unpleasant in form, swarthy in colour, and inauspicious in marks — one who bore the eighteen inauspicious signs. From the very moment of his birth, even his own parents, finding him so unattractive and displeasing, gave him a name that reflected his ugly appearance. He was nursed and raised until he grew older, but his father, thinking it shameful to teach a son of such ugly appearance and feeling it would not be worthwhile, did not teach him.

When the ugly boy had grown older and wished to study, since his father would not teach him, he thought, "I shall go to another region," and went to another brahmin. The brahmin boy rose and said: "I am the son of the brahmin named such-and-such. I have come to you for the purpose of studying under you, and I request that you teach me." The other brahmin likewise granted him the opportunity. Before long, that brahmin had taught everything he knew to the ugly one, and the ugly one had mastered it all. Then the teacher thought: "I made a solemn pledge to give the girl Udumbārikā to whoever would study in my presence and whose learning would become equal to mine. Now this

ugly brahmin has studied with me and his learning has indeed become equal to mine. Though he is unpleasant to look at, I cannot do otherwise. And yet, if I give her to him, that will be disgraceful to me and my ancestors, and it will be unseemly in the eyes of the world — other brahmins too will reproach me." Then, deciding he must nonetheless honour his pledge as he had given it, he adorned the girl Udumbārikā with all her ornaments and gave her to the ugly brahmin boy. He accepted her, yet could not bring himself to live with her in happiness.

He then came to his own home, and thinking there should be rejoicing and festivity, he brought her to his own house. But Udumbārikā, whenever she looked upon his ugliness, felt no pleasure, thinking: "I am endowed with good form, while this one has a swarthy complexion and bears all eighteen inauspicious signs — to be joined to a husband like this is a disgrace." Then the ugly one took her and they set off toward his homeland, but provisions ran out along the way. They reached the bank of a certain pond, and both were sitting there hungry, when a companion of his stirred some flour into water with a stick and began to drink it. She too, tormented by hunger, asked him to let her up. The ugly one then took a handful of flour, drank it himself, and told Udumbārikā, when she said she too was deeply tormented by hunger, "Here, at least drink some water," yet when she asked him, he replied to the woman: "It is not permitted by the ancient sages skilled in Dharma for a woman to drink such a water-gruel; therefore I will not give it to you." And he gave her none.

Then, as no rain had fallen, they wandered through a wilderness, tormented by hunger. The two of them found the carcass of a dog, and the ugly one roasted it, ate of it himself, and when Udumbārikā too asked him for some, he again said: "The sages have not permitted this for women," and gave her none. He tormented her with the suffering of hunger, leaving her, like a lizard, to starve unfed.

She thought: "What fault of mine did my parents see, that they gave me to one such as this?" And she spoke at length to her parents in her mind, reproaching them in many ways.

Then, as the two of them wandered on, they came upon a ripe udumbara fig tree. The ugly one climbed it and sat eating, whereupon Udumbārikā said: "Do not eat alone — throw some down to your poor wife as well." He ate the ripe ones himself, but threw down only the unripe ones.

She threw down none of the ripe ones to her, yet she gave her the ripe ones too — but by force. The ugly one then said to her, "If you want the ripe ones, climb up yourself and pick and eat them." Compelled by the pangs of hunger, she climbed hard up into the udumbara fig tree and sat there eating. And the ugly one thought to himself: "A merciless one like me has no merit — what need is there to say he would look after a wife like this? She is not even fit to look at me." With that, he came down from the tree, surrounded the base of the udumbara fig with thorny branches, and abandoned her there and went away.

Then it is further told. The two of them walked on through the forest and saw a ripe udumbara fig tree. He climbed it just as before and sat eating, giving her nothing. The sweet-spoken woman spoke to him, saying: "I too have grown hungry — my lord, give me some as well." He replied to her with harsh words: "Wicked woman, if you want to eat, climb up yourself." She too, pressing herself hard, climbed the great tree. Seeing her climb, he came down, surrounded the base of the trunk with branches, and went away.

Now at that very time and moment, King Udayana had gone out hunting deer and came in that direction. And she was left there, tormented by the suffering of separation from her husband — with no one coming, no one to call out to — sitting alone in the wilderness, weeping most pitifully and piteously. Then, as King Udayana pursued the deer in that direction, he heard her voice — someone in the wilderness, crying out in such pitiful, heartfelt lamentation. He thought to himself: "Who is this, lamenting so piteously alone in the wilderness? I must investigate." He followed the sound and came to where Udumbārikā was. He saw a woman of exceedingly fine eyes, beautiful of form and lovely to behold, like a goddess of the forest. He said: "O beautiful one — are you a goddess, a female yakṣa, a gandharva woman, or a daughter of the gods? What are you? For what purpose have you come to this place?" he asked.

And it is further told in verse:

O you of exceedingly beautiful eyes, enchanting, adorned and covered with every ornament —
With the melodious voice of a goose and anklet-rings,
Like lightning amid great clouds,
Blessed with a shapely navel and fair complexion —
Are you a goddess, a nāga woman,

A gandharva, a human, or what?

Tell me clearly what you are when I ask you thus.

Let me know you in this way.

Then, when the king had asked her thus, she answered in these words:

I am no goddess, no nāga woman,

No gandharva, no human woman —

O great king, I am a human being,

One separated from her husband.

Then he brought her down from the tree, and right there they lay together. King Udayana, the great lord of the earth, that lord of men, was captivated by her. He placed her upon his chariot and brought her to the city, and together with her he enjoyed himself in pleasure and delight.

The brahmin, alone on the road, repented, thinking: "It was wrong of me to abandon my wife in the wilderness and go — I must return and bring her back." And so he went back to where Udumbārikā had been, but she was nowhere to be found. Then he heard from another that King Udayana had taken her away and made her his queen. Hearing those words, his mind was once again pierced with great suffering. He went to the king's gate but was not allowed inside. Looking on from outside, he saw the king's retinue carrying stones to work. He thought: "I will take up stones and go along with these workers." So he picked up stones and entered the king's palace. He looked, and there was his wife, sitting with the king, rocking back and forth a hundred times in intimate closeness. He thought to himself: "My wife is with this man — by what means could I speak with her?"

He said:

The base is made of gold —

set in eights, a delight to behold —

does my lovely one not love me?

The carpenter picked up a stone.

There in that place, when I spoke,

a woman said it was not right to drink flesh,

and even now I remember those words —

she who discards and sets down this one.

The udumbara tree,

and you, my pleasing one, asked me —
born on the banks of the Gaṅgā,
let the carpenter take up a stone;
stirred by a frog with a wooden stick —
tell me now the answer to what was asked.
A woman said it was not right to drink,
and that is why she is set here.
The one of vast learning who speaks on many things,
speak now for the sake of the countless rays of gold —
does my lovely one not love me?
Master, take up a stone;
the unripe ones you threw at me,
the ripe ones you yourself ate.
Even those harsh words I remember.
Here one sits having cast off the owl.
From the mountain peak he cast me away,
and poison too shall I eat, O brahmin woman —
I come for your sorrow.
Let the carpenter take up a stone;
push me from the mountain peak.
The brahmin shall indeed eat poison —
when I wished, you did not wish it.
The owl made its home there.

Then, as the two of them exchanged these words back and forth, suspicion arose in the king's mind. He said: "Goddess, whatever the two of you are saying to one another — I cannot make it out. Speak clearly so that I may hear what is being said." Since the king was under the power of a woman, the woman Udumbārikā told the king everything that had happened, in full detail. "This is my husband. My parents gave me to him as his wife. He is a learned brahmin who knows all the branches of learning."

Then the king said to the goddess: "What is to be done? How is his mind to be pleased? Should you go and stay with him?" She replied: "I shall act in such a way that he will not desire me, that his spells will not work against me, and that I will not come under the power of the brahmin's mantras." She said: "I shall do it thus."

The king then related the whole situation to the Great Physician. The Great Physician said: "I shall act in such a way that the goddess cannot be separated from you." He asked: "How is it to be done?" The Great Physician replied: "This brahmin's power is limited and not extensive, and the queens are extremely majestic and radiant. Therefore I shall do the following: have him made to choose among the queens, and he will not be able to recognize her." Having said this, the Great Physician made the king understand the plan.

They called the brahmin over and asked him: "What is the carpenter looking for? Why have you come to the king's palace?" He replied: "My wife was brought here by the king's desire, and so I have come seeking her." The Great Physician said: "Do you recognize your own wife?" The ugly-featured one replied: "I do." The Great Physician then warned him: "Five hundred queens will be placed before you. If you take hold of any queen other than your own, your body will be cut to pieces with weapons." He agreed: "I shall do as you say."

Then King Prasenajit dressed all the queens in every adornment and commanded them: "Come before me — make sure there are differences in the ornaments." Then, in the place where the path of the food offering was visible, he adorned the goddess Udumbārikā like the queen of Śakra (Indra) and placed her at the head of all the queens, so that she came before the king just as she were surrounded by divine maidens. The Great Physician placed the brahmin in front of the assembly and commanded him: "If you recognize your own wife, take hold of her from among them."

Then, when that brahmin saw Udumbārikā and the other queens all adorned with every ornament, he sat rooted to the spot as though struck by a serpent-charmer's spell. Just as one cannot bear to gaze directly at the open sun, so he sat staring at them all. Then he noticed, following behind the others, a servant woman resembling a demoness, walking in the rear of another queen — and he seized her by the hand, declaring: "This is my wife." The Great Physician said: "If that is she, then take her." And he led the servant woman away, reciting:

One of the finest takes a fancy to one of the finest.

One of the middling takes a fancy to one of the middling.

Even to the stooped one my heart is drawn.

O beautiful one — I am like a demon, and you too are a demoness.

As demonesses delight in the forest of the gods, come hither, demoness!

I too am demon-like, so let the two of us delight together.

Having spoken thus, he went away.

Now, some time later, the king became enraged at his chief minister, the Great Physician, on account of some fault and dismissed him. One day the king went with his queens to the royal garden and there spent the whole day sporting and taking pleasure together with the queens. Then one queen removed her pearl garland of a hundred thousand strands and hung it on a branch of an aśoka tree; and in the midst of her sporting with the king, she forgot that pearl garland of a hundred thousand strands. The king then returned to the palace together with the queen. At midnight that queen remembered that the pearl garland had been left behind in the very garden. A monkey had taken the garland and placed it in a treetop.

Then the king commanded his servants to go quickly to the garden and bring back the pearl garland. When they went there, they did not find it. After a while, a beggar who had gone into the garden searching for scraps of food discarded by others found some such scraps on the ground, ate them, and was leaving the garden — whereupon the king's men seized that beggar and commanded him: "No one else is to be seen here; hand over the pearl garland." He replied: "I did not take it and I have not seen it. I am a beggar; I came in here to search for leftover food." They beat him with fists and clubs and threw him into prison. There, tormented by hunger, he thought to himself: "If I do not devise some stratagem here, I shall starve and die." He then said to the prison guards: "It is true that I took that pearl garland — but I gave it to a certain merchant's son of such-and-such a name." When the king's men heard this, they summoned that person too and had them both bound to the pillory. Then food of many kinds arrived from the merchant's son's household, and when he was about to eat it the beggar urged him to share. The merchant's son shoved him away and said: "You are surely plotting to steal from me so as to oblige me to feed you — I will give you nothing," and ate by himself.

After that, the merchant's son was gripped by intestinal discomfort and asked him: "Go and relieve me" — meaning, attend to him. The other replied: "I am not one to listen to your words — I will not go." Thereupon the merchant's son addressed him with soft and conciliatory words, winning his confidence, and the one with the discomfort was duly relieved of it.

The next day the merchant's son sent word home: "From today onward, bring food here for the two of us." The beggar's comfort improved, and he thought to himself: "Before, even when I wandered through every city I could not find enough to fill my belly — yet now here I have food to eat,

and fine drink to satisfy me — yet a single companion is not enough for me; I shall bring in a courtesan as well." He then sent word to a courtesan that she too was among those who had been carrying off goods, telling her to be seized, and the king's men had her imprisoned there as well. Together the four of them ate fine food and drank fine drink, and he spoke again: "Even if I could not escape from a situation like this for twelve years, it would still be worth it." And so it went as they continued to enjoy themselves — yet later desire arose in him again, and he thought: "This one courtesan alone is not enough for me; when desire is upon me and I want to experience great pleasure, I should bring in a musician as well." The beggar then said to a musician, "This one too has carried off a pearl necklace," and thereupon the king's men likewise imprisoned the musician there as before. So the merchant's son, the courtesan, and the musician were together in the prison, living in comfort and merriment, enjoying themselves fully.

Some time passed, and his companions petitioned the beggar: "Whatever it takes, find a way to free us. If you free us, you will want for nothing — we will see to it." He agreed that he would do so. He thought to himself: "No one else can manage this — only a great physician can," and with that conviction he said to the others: "Nothing but a great physician can get our people out of this prison — no other way have we seen." He then told the king's men: "The son of a great physician is also involved in this." The king's men brought him in and had him imprisoned there as well.

When the great physician heard that his son had been thrown into prison, he thought: "No matter what it takes, I cannot fail to go to the royal palace on his account — and if I do not go, my son will suffer." So he went to the royal palace. Arriving there, he addressed the king: "Your Majesty, a command has come down upon me: my son has done what great wrong to Your Majesty that he has been placed in prison?" The king replied: "A pearl necklace worth a hundred thousand was lost in the pleasure garden, and that beggar says he went there — that is the reason." The physician listened carefully to the full account of their scheme, and then said: "Your Majesty, these persons have not been sought out by anyone else; I ask that those I have named be released." And they were released.

Then the physician went to the pleasure garden. Someone who had previously been present there was asked where he had been staying, and pointed out the direction, saying, "He was sitting at the foot of a tree." The physician looked at that tree and saw a female monkey sitting at its top. He thought: "This creature must have taken the pearl necklace — I must devise some stratagem to lure her down." He then petitioned the king: "Your Majesty, please come here together with the queen." The king came with the queen to that pleasure garden and took his place there. The physician said: "Your Majesty, if the queen adorns herself with ornaments, the monkey will put on ornaments too." The female monkey, sitting there at the treetop, then put on the pearl necklace. The physician said: "If the queen dances," and when she danced, the monkey too sat at the treetop and danced — but the pearl necklace did not fall from her neck, for the monkey watched whatever people did and how they were dressed, and imitated them exactly. The physician said: "Your Majesty, if the queen bows her head and dances, that too would be fitting." The king ordered it done; the queen bowed her head and began to dance, and the monkey likewise bowed her head and danced — and the pearl necklace fell from her neck.

The king, overjoyed, embraced the great physician about the neck, honored him, and bestowed wealth upon him.

Then the six ministers gathered together and conferred: "In former times, and in times before that, the king treated us with honor, held us as superiors, esteemed us, and revered us. Now this man — a dull-witted villager from the crags, come from a family of hungry folk — has cast all of us out from our place of dignity. What is to be done about him?" Then one of the ministers spoke: "In the past, we went against one another separately, and that is what rendered us powerless. Therefore, let us now go together to the pleasure grove. Let us go there, swear oaths to one another, place our trust in one another, and become allies. If we do so, the king will grow fond of us again, and the great physician will cease to shun us and will come to rely on us once more." They all agreed, gathered together, and went to the pleasure grove.

As they set out, the great physician saw them. He thought to himself: "These men have never before assembled all together like this and gone off somewhere — something unusual is being planned." Growing suspicious, he sent a servant woman named Mātarā to follow after them secretly and find out what they were deliberating, what they were saying, and what they were

doing.

The six ministers arrived at the pleasure grove, made alliance with one another, and said: "If we rake up one another's faults and expose one another's secrets, we will never come to trust each other. So let it not be so." Another said: "Agreed." Then one of them said: "I have eaten the king's peacock." Another said: "I have lain with the king's queen." Another said: "I too have had such a thought in mind." And thus those six confided their secrets to one another and ate together from one vessel.

Mātarā heard all of this and reported it to the great physician. The great physician then went before King Prasenajit and told him everything: "Your divine ministers behave in this manner — such are their discipline, their cleanliness, and their conduct."

King Prasenajit came to understand and, having perceived all this clearly, resolved to rid himself of them, saying: "Ah — these ministers of mine have acted so improperly! Let them this very day be expelled to wherever they have no power," and so he banished them and drove them out.

The Blessed One then declared: "Monks, what do you think? The great physician of that time and that occasion was none other than myself. The king Prasenajit of that time — that is the monk Śāriputra here present. And those six ministers of that time are these six teachers of today. Even then, serving as ministers, they were driven out and stripped of their domain. And now, after I have fully awakened to the unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening, they have been defeated by my miraculous powers and wonders and expelled to the borderlands.

Therefore, monks, you should strive diligently to rely upon a true spiritual friend — one from whom wisdom, learning, and the highest gnosis arise. Cultivate such qualities as will lead to such attainment.

When the Blessed One displayed the great miracle, bringing the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) to silence by every means, gladdening gods and humans, and delighting noble beings — at that very time, craftsmen residing in various regions, from villages, towns, and palace courts, came to Śrāvastī from all those places, went forth into the renunciant life, along with their sons, daughters, wives, and still others — friends and relatives —

Brothers and sisters searched for one another and came to Śrāvastī. When they met, those who had gone forth said to the ones who had remained

behind: "Noble ones, you have come here — but now that we have gone forth and settled here, who will provide for our livelihood?" And the others replied: "Stay right here, and train right here." The renunciants answered: "Very well, we shall do so," and entered upon the training.

Before long, brahmins and householders also arrived, and when they saw what had happened, they cried out in dismay: "All these craftsmen have gone forth — who will do our work?"

When this was reported by the monks to the Blessed One, the Blessed One reflected that for one who holds such an intent — namely, a vessel of such a kind — this would be an occasion for fault. Therefore, considering that from such a stream of being one should not take on conduct of that kind, he declared to the monks: "Monks, it is fitting that those brahmins and householders bring their complaint. Therefore, monks, one should not take on conduct of that kind from a stream of being of such a kind. If monks were to take on conduct of that kind, it would become a transgression." The Blessed One declared: "Do not take on conduct of that kind from such a stream of being."

After some time, another physician went forth and was travelling through the countryside and came to Śrāvastī. The monks there said to him: "Venerable one, please examine and treat this sick monk." But that person replied: "The Blessed One has not permitted it — the instruction was that from such a stream of being one should not take on conduct of that kind. Why then should I treat him?"

When this was reported by the monks to the Blessed One, the Blessed One accordingly granted permission, declaring: "When a physician has gone forth into the renunciant life, let him practise the art of incision and treatment. As for one who was formerly a scribe, let him practise with a reed pen. And when a barber has gone forth, let him practise the cutting of nails."

The Vinaya on Minor Matters, the thirty-fifth fascicle.

The occasion was at Śrāvastī, at the time when the Blessed One displayed the great miracle, bringing the non-Buddhists to silence, gladdening gods and humans, and delighting the minds of many people. At that time, the Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha of hearers, was held in very great gain and honour. The Blessed One then, reflecting that he should cut off the arising of gain and honour, went to the realm of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three. Near the white stone slope, among the trees — the pārijāta and

the kovidāra — not far off, he entered the rains retreat. There the Blessed One taught the Dharma to his mother, who had given him birth, and to the other gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.

At that time, the great Maudgalyāyana entered the rains retreat in the Jeta Grove of Anāthapiṇḍada at Śrāvastī. Then the four assemblies went to where the venerable great Maudgalyāyana was. They bowed at his feet with their heads touching the ground and sat to one side. Seated to one side, the venerable great Maudgalyāyana instructed those four assemblies with Dharma talk rightly given, rightly roused, rightly exhorted, and rightly gladdened. With Dharma talk in its many expressions rightly given, rightly roused, rightly exhorted, and rightly gladdened, he then fell silent. Thereupon the four assemblies rose from their seats, draped their robes over one shoulder, and with palms joined in reverence, bowed toward where the venerable great Maudgalyāyana was —

they said to the venerable great Maudgalyāyana: "Venerable one, great Maudgalyāyana, have you heard where the Blessed One has entered the rains retreat at present?" He replied: "I have heard that the Blessed One has entered the rains retreat at the heaven of the Thirty-Three, not far from the white rock called Pāṇḍukambala, near the trees called Pārijāta and Kovidaraka, and that he is teaching Dharma to his mother and to the gods of the Thirty-Three."

Then the four assemblies, delighted and rejoicing at what the venerable great Maudgalyāyana had said, bowed at his feet with their heads touching the ground, rose from their seats, and departed.

Three months then passed for the four assemblies. The venerable great Maudgalyāyana went to where they were. They bowed at his feet with their heads touching the ground and sat to one side. Seated to one side, the venerable great Maudgalyāyana instructed those four assemblies with Dharma talk rightly given, rightly roused, rightly exhorted, and rightly gladdened. With Dharma talk in its many expressions rightly given, rightly roused, rightly exhorted, and rightly gladdened, he then fell silent. Thereupon the four assemblies rose from their seats, draped their robes over one shoulder, and with palms joined in reverence, bowed toward where the venerable great Maudgalyāyana was, and spoke to him thus:

"Venerable one, great Maudgalyāyana, please take note of this: it has been a long time since we have seen the Blessed One, and we are exceedingly thirsty

with longing to behold him. We wish to see the Blessed One. If it be fitting and good in the eyes of the venerable great Maudgalyāyana, would you please go to where the Blessed One is, approach him, and on our behalf bow at the feet of the Blessed One and inquire: 'Is the Blessed One's discomfort little? Is he free from discomfort? Does he arise quickly? Is he well? Does he have strength? Is he at ease? Is his illness slight? Does he dwell in comfort? Has he become comfortable?' And please also say this: 'Venerable sir, the four assemblies of Jambudvīpa wish to see the Blessed One. Venerable sir, the humans of Jambudvīpa do not possess the supernatural powers and might to ascend to the abode of the gods of the Thirty-Three and come into the presence of the Blessed One to see and pay reverence to him. As for those gods of the Thirty-Three — if they have the supernatural power and might to descend to Jambudvīpa and come into the presence of the Blessed One to see and pay reverence to him — it would be good if you would say: If the Blessed One would be pleased in his compassion to depart from the abode of the gods of the Thirty-Three and come to Jambudvīpa, that would be excellent.'"

When they had said this, the venerable great Maudgalyāyana granted the four assemblies his consent by remaining silent. Then the four assemblies, understanding from his silence that the venerable great Maudgalyāyana had given his consent, bowed at his feet with their heads touching the ground, rose from their seats, and departed.

Then, knowing that the four assemblies had not gone far after departing, the venerable great Maudgalyāyana entered into a meditative absorption of such a kind. And just as he stilled his mind and entered that absorption, it was as when a strong man extends an arm that had been drawn in —

or as when a drawn-in arm is extended — in just that way, the venerable great Maudgalyāyana vanished from Śrāvastī and appeared at the dwelling of the gods of the Thirty-Three, near the trees of white coral, the Pārijāta and the Kovidaraka. And there, not far off, the venerable great Maudgalyāyana saw the Blessed One seated before many hundreds and thousands of divine attendants, teaching the Dharma. Seeing the Blessed One thus seated before many hundreds and thousands of divine attendants and teaching the Dharma, Maudgalyāyana smiled and said: "Blessed One, it is just as it is here — being in the company of many gods, just as with the four assemblies of Jambudvīpa."

Then the Blessed One, knowing the thought of the venerable great Maudgalyāyana, spoke to him as follows: "Great Maudgalyāyana, it is not that

you arrange this yourself. Rather, whenever I think 'I shall come,' at that moment I come; and whenever I think 'I shall go,' at that moment I go. Knowing my mind through my mind, I come and go."

Then the venerable great Maudgalyāyana went to where the Blessed One was, bowed at his feet with his head touching the ground, and sat down to one side. Sitting to one side, the venerable great Maudgalyāyana looked over all the divine assembly and said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, this divine assembly has gathered here in great variety. Among those assembled, there are those who, being endowed with knowledge of and faith in the Buddha, have passed from the body and been born here. And among those assembled, there are also those who, being endowed with knowledge of the Dharma, the Saṅgha, and the moral discipline esteemed by noble ones, have passed from the body and been born here."

And so it was: Great Maudgalyāyana confirmed that this diverse divine assembly had gathered and was present. Among that divine assembly, there were those who, endowed with knowledge of and faith in the Buddha, had passed from the body and been born there. And there were also those who, endowed with the Dharma, the Saṅgha, and the moral discipline esteemed by noble ones, had passed from the body and been born there.

Then Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, rejoiced in what the Blessed One and the venerable great Maudgalyāyana had said, and spoke these words to the venerable great Maudgalyāyana: "So it is, so it is indeed, venerable great Maudgalyāyana. Just so — this diverse divine assembly has gathered and is present. Among this divine assembly there are those who, endowed with knowledge of and faith in the Buddha, have passed from the body and been born here. And there are those who, endowed with the Dharma, the Saṅgha, and the moral discipline esteemed by noble ones, have passed from the body and been born here."

Then another divine youth, rejoicing in what the Blessed One, the venerable great Maudgalyāyana, and Śakra, lord of the gods, had said, spoke these words to the venerable great Maudgalyāyana: "So it is, venerable great Maudgalyāyana. So it is indeed — this diverse divine assembly has gathered and is present. Among this divine assembly there are those who, endowed with knowledge of and faith in the Buddha, have passed from the body and been born here. And there are those who, endowed with the Dharma, the Saṅgha, and the moral discipline esteemed by noble ones, have passed from

the body and been born here."

Then at that moment one of the gods rose from his seat, arranged his outer robe over one shoulder, turned to face the Blessed One, joined his palms together in homage, and said: "Blessed One, I, being endowed with knowledge of and faith in the Buddha, passed from the body and was born here." And another spoke likewise, saying: "I, in the Dharma; I, in the Saṅgha —"

"I, endowed with the moral discipline esteemed by noble ones, passed from the body and was born here." Then many hundreds of thousands of gods, one after another, received from the Blessed One the prophecy of their stream-entry, and in that very moment became invisible.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, perceiving that the assembly of gods had dispersed, rose from his seat, arranged his outer robe over one shoulder, went to where the Blessed One was, joined his palms together in homage, and addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, the four assemblies from Jambudvīpa bow their heads at the Blessed One's feet and inquire: Is there little affliction? Is there no affliction? Are you in good health? Are you vigorous? Are you at ease? Are there few ailments? Do you dwell in comfort? Are you well?"

The Blessed One replied: "May you, Maudgalyāyana, and the four assemblies of Jambudvīpa likewise be well."

Then the venerable one said: "Blessed One, the four assemblies of Jambudvīpa wish to behold the Blessed One. They say this: 'Blessed One, the people of Jambudvīpa do not possess such miraculous power and might as to ascend to the realm of the Thirty-Three Gods in order to see and pay homage to the Blessed One there. But the gods of the Thirty-Three do possess such miraculous power and might as to descend to Jambudvīpa and come into the Blessed One's presence to see and pay homage to him. Therefore, Blessed One, it would be good if, out of compassion, you were to come down from the realm of the Thirty-Three Gods to Jambudvīpa.'"

"Therefore, Maudgalyāyana, go to Jambudvīpa and announce to the four assemblies: 'The Blessed One will, seven days from today, come down from the realm of the Thirty-Three Gods to Jambudvīpa, to the city of Sāṃkāśya, to the forest of Apaṇajarī, to the foot of the udumbara tree.'"

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, having heard this from the Blessed One, bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and entered into meditative

absorption of just such a kind. And the manner of his mind's settling in absorption was this: just as a strong man might extend a bent arm or bend an extended arm, so did the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana vanish from the realm of the Thirty-Three Gods and arrive in Jambudvīpa.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, having come to Jambudvīpa, announced to the four assemblies: "Hear this — the Blessed One will, seven days from today, come down from the realm of the Thirty-Three Gods to Jambudvīpa, to the city of Sāṃkāśya, to the forest of Apaṇajārī, to the foot of the udumbara tree."

Then, when seven days had passed, the four assemblies took perfumes and ointments and set out for the city of Sāṃkāśya. And the many people dwelling in Sāṃkāśya cleared the city of stones, weeds, and rubbish, sprinkled it with sandalwood water, and hung festoons of sweet-smelling incense; they raised victory banners and divine pennants, draped silken streamers, and scattered flowers of every kind. The place was transformed into something like a divine pleasure garden — a grove of delight — and seats were set out and arranged in an open, unobstructed expanse of ground.

Then the Blessed One rightly taught, rightly exhorted, rightly inspired, and rightly gladdened the gods of the Thirty-Three with a discourse on the Dharma. Then, together with the gods of the Thirty-Three, he vanished from the realm of the Thirty-Three Gods and descended to the Yāma heavens. There the Blessed One rightly taught the gods of the Yāma heavens with a discourse on the Dharma —

rightly exhorted, rightly inspired, and rightly gladdened them. Then, together with the gods of the Thirty-Three and the Yāma gods, he vanished and proceeded in just the same way to the Tuṣita heaven. In like manner he proceeded onward through the heavens of those who Delight in Emanation, those who Wield Power over Others' Emanations, the Brahmic orders — the gods of Brahmic Retinue, the gods of the Brahmic Attendants, and the Great Brahmic gods — then the gods of Minor Radiance, Immeasurable Radiance, and Resplendent Radiance, then the gods of Minor Virtue, Immeasurable Virtue, and Complete Virtue, then the Cloudless gods, the gods of Increasing Merit, the gods of Great Fruit, the gods who are Not Great, the Untroubled gods, the gods of Fair Appearance, the gods of Great Vision, and finally to Akaniṣṭha, where dwell the gods inhabiting the desire realm and those inhabiting the form realm alike.

Then the Blessed One rightly taught the gods of the Akaniṣṭha heaven with a discourse on the Dharma, rightly exhorted them, rightly inspired them, and rightly gladdened them. He then vanished from Akaniṣṭha and proceeded to the abode of the gods of Fair Appearance. In reverse order, he descended step by step through the ranks of the gods — those inhabiting the desire realm and those inhabiting the form realm together — down as far as the level of the gods of the Thirty-Three.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods (Indra, king of heaven), addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, are you descending to Jambudvīpa? O Kauśika, by what means do you descend — by miraculous power, or on foot?"

"O Kauśika, on foot," he replied.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, instructed the divine son Sarvārthasiddha: "Sarvārthasiddha, conjure three stairways — one of gold, one of lapis lazuli, and one of crystal."

Sarvārthasiddha replied, "O Kauśika, excellent indeed!" And having heard the command from Śakra, lord of the gods, Sarvārthasiddha conjured three stairways — one of gold, one of lapis lazuli, and one of crystal.

The Blessed One then descended by the stairway of lapis lazuli. Brahmā, lord of the assembly, came down the golden stairway from the right side, holding a thousand jeweled fans, accompanied by the gods of the form realm. Śakra, lord of the gods, came down the crystal stairway from the Blessed One's left side, holding a parasol with a hundred spokes, accompanied by the gods of the desire realm.

Now the Blessed One had considered the following: if he were to descend on foot, the non-Buddhists would say, "The ascetic Gautama went to the realm of the Thirty-Three Gods by miraculous power, but upon seeing beings of enthralling beauty he lost his power and descended to Jambudvīpa on foot." And if he were to descend entirely by miraculous power, then the deeds performed by the All-Accomplished One would come to nothing. He therefore resolved: "Let half the descent be on foot, and half by miraculous power."

And so the Blessed One descended alternately — now a step on foot, now a step by miraculous power. Within twelve leagues below, the smell of human impurity rose up, and the gods could not bear it. The Blessed One then manifested the fragrance of sandalwood and gośīrṣa-sandalwood, so that the odor of humanity was overcome.

The Blessed One then considered further: "If men were to behold divine sons and women were to behold divine daughters, it would inevitably come to pass that they would vomit warm blood and die on the spot. How then shall I bring about such a miraculous display that men may behold the divine sons and women may behold the divine daughters?" And so the Blessed One manifested precisely such a miraculous display — that men could see the divine sons, and women could see the divine daughters.

At that very moment, the Venerable Subhūti was sitting beneath another tree, spending the midday hours in repose.

The Venerable Subhūti saw the Blessed One descend from the realm of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three to Jambudvīpa, together with supreme riches and splendor. Having seen this, he thought to himself: "These gods, great as their miraculous powers and might may be, have nevertheless left the Blessed One behind and returned each to his own dwelling place. And these people here will pass away when a hundred years have gone by. The Blessed One too will pass into complete nirvāṇa, and all of this great wealth and abundance will utterly cease to be, in every way, for everyone. In this regard, what the Blessed One has so well declared is precisely this: all conditioned phenomena are impermanent, unstable, not to be relied upon, subject to change — one should be satisfied with all conditioned phenomena, for it is fitting to be wearied by them, fitting to be without desire for them. Knowing that one must attain liberation, one should apply the mind to the five appropriating aggregates as being impermanent, suffering, empty, and without self."

He then entered upon that very contemplation — turning the mind to the five appropriating aggregates as impermanent, suffering, empty, and selfless. And by having turned the mind to the appropriating aggregates in this way as impermanent, suffering, empty, and selfless, through the aspect of impermanence he shattered — as with a vajra of gnosis — the twenty peaks of the mountain of the view of the transitory collection that had arisen upward, and thereby actualized the fruit of stream-entry.

Then, having seen and understood the truth and possessed of faith, he swiftly unfolded his crossed legs, placed his right knee upon the ground, and made obeisance to the Blessed One.

Now the nun Utpalavarnā thought to herself: "When the Blessed One descends from the Heaven of the Thirty-Three to Jambudvīpa, by what means might I be

the first to pay homage to him? If I were to go just as I am, people would say 'A wandering ascetic woman has merely touched the head,' and since gods and men, great and many, surround the Blessed One and would not allow one to pass within, I shall go by miraculous power." So she manifested herself openly in the guise of a wheel-turning king (a universal monarch), led at the front by the seven precious treasures, attended on all sides by seventy-nine hundreds of thousands of ministers of supreme strength, encircled like the orb of the moon by a thousand sons adorned with ornaments of every variety, followed in procession by a thousand tīrthikas, brahmins, the destitute, the lowly, and the foremost among men, bearing over her head an umbrella with a hundred spokes, dazzling and radiating a thousand rays like the light of the sun, and accompanied by the moon, the stars, and a magnificent palatial hall — outshining them all in splendor — she proceeded to where the Blessed One was.

When that retinue then saw the nun Utpalavarnā from a distance, they were struck with amazement. They gazed at her with fixed eyes and their thoughts turned in many directions. Some said, "Where has such a king as this come from?" Others said, "There is no army as splendid as this anywhere upon the land of a king — this must truly be a wheel-turning king who has come from another world to behold the Blessed One." And seeing the wealth and splendor of that wheel-turning king, they thought with longing, "Oh, may we too accomplish something of this kind!" and they opened a way for her.

At that moment the Venerable Śāriputra was sitting within that assembled retinue. He said: "This is not a wheel-turning king — this is the nun Utpalavarnā, who has come by miraculous power to behold the Blessed One."

They replied: "Noble one, how is it that you know this to be the nun Utpalavarnā?"

He said: "Because of the exceedingly fragrant scent of the blue lotus — it is Utpalavarnā who has come by miraculous power into the presence of the Blessed One."

The nun Utpalavarnā then drew back the miraculous display she had manifested and went to where the Blessed One was. She bowed her head at the feet of the Blessed One and sat down to one side.

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to the nun Utpalavarnā: "Nun, go — do not sit here before me. It is not fitting for a nun to perform miracles in the presence of the Teacher."

Dismissed by the Blessed One, she moved away and sat to one side.

The Blessed One reflected: "Whoever, being a nun, displays miracles in the presence of the Teacher, that is a basis for an offence. Therefore, nuns should not perform miracles in the presence of the Teacher." With this in mind, he addressed the monks: "Monks, it is not fitting for a nun to display miracles in the presence of the Teacher. Therefore, let nuns refrain from displaying miracles in the presence of the Teacher. A nun who displays miracles in the presence of the Teacher will incur a transgression."

Now, some among those who had seen the nun Utpalavarnā in the form of a wheel-turning king's splendour had given rise to attachment to human existence. Others, who had seen her in the form of the miraculous splendour of the gods, had given rise to attachment to divine existence. The Blessed One therefore taught the Dharma to that assembled retinue in such a way as to turn them back from rebirth as gods or as humans. Upon hearing it, some among them realized the fruit of stream-entry (Skt. *srotāpatti*). Some realized the fruit of non-return. Some realized the fruit of once-return. Some, having abandoned all afflictions, realized arhatship. Some aroused the mind of awakening aimed at the awakening of a śrāvaka; some, at solitary awakening; and some, at unsurpassable and perfect complete awakening. Some produced roots of virtue that had reached the level of heat. Some reached the summit; and some produced the lesser and middling forms of patient acceptance. The greater part of that assembled retinue was established as inclining toward the Buddha, falling into the Dharma, and thoroughly falling into the Saṅgha.

Thereupon the Blessed One, on account of this, spoke these verses:

Better than winning grounds one by one,
better than going again among the gods,
better even than attaining meditative absorption —
the fruit of stream-entry is supreme.

The Blessed One then thoroughly instructed, thoroughly exhorted, thoroughly praised, and thoroughly gladdened that assembled retinue with words of Dharma. He rose from his seat and departed.

The monks, having given rise to doubt, asked the Blessed One, the Buddha, to cut through all their doubt: "Venerable one, we observed that the Venerable Śāriputra recognized the nun Utpalavarnā by her scent."

The Blessed One replied: "Monks, this is not only so at present. In times past as well, Śāriputra recognized her by her scent. Therefore listen, monks. In former times there lived in the city of Camkarmojik a certain merchant. He took a wife of equal station and enjoyed himself with her in sport and pleasure. While they were thus sporting together, his wife became with child. That merchant then made ready to sail across the great ocean, and said to her: 'My dear, I am taking goods and departing for another land. Be diligent in managing the affairs of the household.' She said to her husband: 'If that is so, then take me along as well.' He replied: 'My dear, who would serve you there?'"

She sat there weeping. When the servants asked the merchant why his wife was weeping, he replied: "She wishes to come with me. I have not taken her, and that is why she weeps." The servants then said to the merchant: "Then why not take her? Who here will serve her? There is no fault in it, merchant — take her along, and we will attend to her." So he took her, and they set out in due course and entered upon the great ocean. But while they were on the great ocean, a large sea-creature resembling a water-serpent or a great fish struck the ship unseasonably, and the merchant perished there in that very moment. His wife clung to a plank, and the wind carried her along in due course until she came to the island of Kāśeru. There the king of birds, Śubhapakṣa — Splendid-Wings — dwelt, and he took her as his consort. Nine months passed, and she gave birth to a son, fair of form, lovely to behold, and beautiful in every way. Thereafter, she and the bird-king Splendid-Wings sported together in great delight. Through that sport she gave birth to a bird, a young Splendid-Wings. Then in time the bird-king Splendid-Wings passed away. When all the birds had gathered, they installed the son as king in the rightful succession of Splendid-Wings his father. His mother said to him: "Now that you have been installed as king in your father's succession, you must let your elder brother here rule as human king of Camkarmojik." He replied: "So it shall be done."

At that time the king of Camkarmojik was a man called Brahmadata, and the realm was prosperous, flourishing, comfortable, with good harvests and many people. Yet it was troubled by conflict, dispute, strife, and discord. So in order to accomplish that purpose, at a gathering the wife of the bird-king Splendid-Wings seized her son by the hand, cast him into the great ocean, and then adorned his elder brother with all ornaments and placed him upon a lion throne. She then said to the ministers: "This is your king. Should anyone do

him even the slightest harm, I shall deal with them in such a manner." They were afraid and obeyed her words. And because they told this to no one else, the people of the world assumed that he was none other than Brahmadatta himself.

He said to the bird-king: "Brother, keep an eye on me from time to time." And the bird-king replied: "I will watch over you well."

Then at a later time a she-buffalo belonging to King Brahmadatta gave birth to a calf, and the calf became stuck at the mouth of the womb. When the ministers reported this to the king, he said: "Have it brought to the queen's quarters, and let the queens free it from this affliction by the power of a truthful declaration." So it was brought to the queens' quarters, and the queens made aspirational prayers through truthful declarations — yet even so they were unable to free the calf from its affliction, and a great and terrible cry arose. Not far from the royal palace there lived a certain cowherdess who heard this sound and asked someone: "What is this great terrible cry from the royal palace?" When it was explained to her what had happened, she said: "I will make an aspirational prayer through my own truthful declaration and free it from its affliction." And she went to report this to the ministers.

The ministers brought her into the queens' quarters, and she made an aspirational prayer through a truthful declaration. "If it is true that I have had only one husband and have never known a second man, then by the power of this truthful declaration, may the cow be swiftly freed from her affliction." When she had made this aspirational prayer through a truthful declaration, the calf emerged from the cow but became stuck at the tail. The cowherdess burst out laughing, and the queens asked her: "What is this — that you cannot even bear so much as this?" She replied: "I had taken a small infant boy onto my lap, and when he urinated and the urine ran down to my private parts, I felt pleasure at that — it is for that reason that I am stuck at the tail." She then told exactly what had happened, and thereupon the tail was freed. The ministers reported to the king: "Your Majesty, the cow has given birth to the calf." When asked who had freed it from its affliction, they explained what had taken place. The king reflected: "It is certainly the case that all my queens have become corrupt in their moral discipline, and it is the cowherdess who, by making an aspirational prayer through a truthful declaration, freed it from its affliction." He gave the order: "Go and summon that cowherdess." They summoned her, and the king asked her: "Is it true that you freed the cow from its affliction by means of a truthful declaration?" "It is true, Your Majesty." The

king thought: "A daughter born of such a woman would herself be of such a character." And thinking, "If she has a daughter, I shall take her as my queen — let me ask straightaway," he said: "Do you have a daughter?" "I do, Your Majesty." "What is her name?" "Your Majesty, her name is Śoṣumā." "To whom has her mother given her, or has she not been given?" "Your Majesty, she has not been given to anyone." "Well then, if that is so, offer her to me — I shall take her as my queen." "As Your Majesty commands." She gave her consent, and the king joined her in a great and splendid gathering and took her as his bride.

The king then thought: "If I keep this woman here in the company of my queens, she will certainly become corrupt in her moral discipline." So he told the king of birds, the Golden Wing (Suparṇa), what had occurred and gave him this command: "Take her by day to the island of Kāśeru, and bring her back at night." The Golden Wing replied: "Very well, it shall be done as you say." He was bound to the bird of Golden Wings, and thus she was taken there and brought back again. By day she was taken to the island of Kāśeru, and by night she was brought back to the capital. On the island of Kāśeru there was a sweet-smelling flower called the timarī, and garlands of it were sent every single day to King Brahmadatta. Now at Khorumo Jig there lived another brahmin youth, and one day he went into the forest to gather wood. While he was there, a kinnara woman caught sight of him and drew him into a cave and kept him there. She sported and played with him in complete delight. When he went out one time to gather flowers and fruit, the brahmin youth covered the mouth of the cave with a great flat stone so that she could not move it. After some time had passed, she gave birth to a son by that brahmin youth, and wherever the child went he moved with great speed, so he was given the name Swift-Goer. The brahmin youth would constantly speak before the child of the qualities of the land of Khorumo Jig, saying: "In the city of Khorumo Jig there are such-and-such qualities and things of this kind." When the child asked him: "Father, what land are you from?" he replied: "I was born in the land of Khorumo Jig." The father said: "If that is so, then why do you not flee?" He replied: "Son, when your mother went out to gather flowers and fruit, the mouth of this cave was blocked by a great flat stone, and so —"

"I am unable to move it, so how could I flee?" he said. The child replied: "Father, I myself will shift it. Son, excellent! Train yourself in lifting stones," he said. On the first day he lifted a small stone. On the second day, one larger than that. On the third day, one larger still. In this way he trained until he was

able to lift a great flat stone. Then the child said to the father: "Throw aside the flat stone and flee, and be gone." But the father said: "Son, even your mother, who went out to gather flowers and fruit, will soon return, and if she finds me gone she will without fail make the two of us suffer for nothing." The child said: "Father, whatever causes her not to return quickly, that I shall arrange." "Son, excellent!" Then the child came back carrying flowers and fruit, and the father kept placing them into the child's mouth, again and again, tossing them in. The mother asked: "Son, why do I keep putting things into your mouth and throwing them away?" He replied: "Mother, you are lazy. When you go nearby, you bring back flowers and fruit all covered in frost and snow, and they are not sweet — I cannot eat them. That is why I throw them away. Mother, tomorrow I will go far away. Nearby there is nothing sweet, so tomorrow I will go far away." She said: "Good, then tomorrow do as you like, and eat what is sweet." After that, the next day she went a very long way off. Swift-Goer said to the father: "I have sent her far away. Now is the time to flee." The father said: "Son, excellent! Throw aside the flat stone." The child threw aside the flat stone, and together with Swift-Goer they fled and arrived at the city of Khorumo Jig.

Now the mother had gone a great distance carrying flowers and fruit, and when she finally returned and looked, the cave was empty. She sat weeping, and her companion, seeing her, asked: "Why are you crying?" She told her: "Sister, that brahmin youth took my son too and fled." Her companion said: "Sister, he is a human being — what grief is there in that among humans? Do not grieve that he does not dwell with you. As for me, I gave him not even a little livelihood. Sister, what shall you give? Pass it into my hand — if you find one, give it." She gave her a lute, saying: "Play this and live by it. Do not touch the highest string of the instrument, lest it become a cause of wrongdoing." She took it and went away.

As for the brahmin, he entrusted the boy Swift-Goer to many brahmin youths who were studying, saying: "Teach this brahmin youth," and had them instruct him in reading. The boys memorized their lessons, and whenever any of them was not reciting, at that moment he would go out to urinate. However swift-footed Swift-Goer was, when a great distance had passed and the boys were no longer reciting, they went to urinate. When Swift-Goer had gone very far away, his mother's companion saw him and asked: "Boy, what news is there to tell?" He replied: "What kind of news? I am tormented by hunger and thirst." She said: "Boy, your mother is in grief, sitting and weeping — why do

you not go to her? I am unable to speak together with that wrathful woman. Son, but if you will not go, I will give you a livelihood — do not give it to anyone else. Here it is — do not give it to anyone." She gave him the lute, saying: "Play this and live by it. So that it does not become a cause of wrongdoing, do not touch the lowest string of the instrument." She replied: "Good, mother, I will do just so." She took it and went among those brahmin youths. They asked: "Boy, why did you delay so long in coming, and who gave you that lute?" He replied:

"My mother's friend saw me and gave me this lute." They asked: "Boy, do you know how to play the lute?" He replied: "I do. Watch." He took it up and played it, singing as he played. He did not touch the lowest string of the instrument, and they asked: "Boy, why do you not touch the lowest string?" He said: "Ah, if one touches that, it will become a cause of wrongdoing." They said: "What wrongdoing could there be in a brahmin boy's touching it?" — and they touched it, whereupon they all leapt up and began to dance. When they had danced, they became exhausted, and toward evening they came to the teacher's house. He asked: "Boys, why have you come so late?" They told him everything that had happened in detail. He quickly asked that brahmin boy: "You — do you know how to play the lute and sing?" He replied: "I do." "Then, brahmin boy, let the lute be heard — play it." He took it up and began to play and sing, and he did not touch the lowest string. The teacher asked: "Brahmin boy, why do you not touch the lowest string?" He replied: "Teacher, if one touches that, it will become a cause of wrongdoing." The teacher said: "Brahmin boy, what wrongdoing could there be in touching it? Touch it." He touched it, and the brahmin, together with his wife, leapt up and began to dance. The whole house shook from their leaping and was ruined. In the ruin, all the clay pots and vessels were smashed. The brahmin flew into a rage and seized that brahmin boy by the throat and threw him out. Having been thrown out, he took up the lute and entered upon a livelihood of playing it.

Some time later, a group of about five hundred merchants prepared a vessel to set out across the great ocean, and set sail for it. They said among themselves: "When we enter the great ocean, let us take along a musician who can lift our spirits." One of them asked: "Whom shall we take?" Another said: "Let us take the brahmin boy called Swift-Going." Some agreed: "Excellent, let it be so." And they brought the brahmin boy Swift-Going along and entered the great ocean. When they had gone out into the great ocean, someone said: "Swift-Going the musician, let the lute be heard — play it." He

took up the lute and began to play and sing, and he did not touch the lowest string of that lute. The merchants said: "Swift-Going, why do you not touch that lowest string?" He replied: "Ah, if one touches that, it will become a cause of wrongdoing." They said: "Brahmin boy, what wrongdoing could there be? Touch it." He touched it, and a great wave surged up, the ship capsized and was wrecked, and those merchants perished before their time. But he, by the power of his former karma, seized hold of a plank and a swift wind carried him to an island. There he sat in another grove, and when there was no other person about, he saw a certain woman of the crocodile kind, and he lay down together with her. By day he spent his time together with Swift-Going; by night he consorted with King Brahmadatta. She asked: "Fair one, where do you go at night?" Since she had become intimate with him, she told him everything. She then said: "Fair one, even so — take me too when you flee." He replied: "My lord, I shall gladly take you. Tell me your name." He said: "Fair one, my name is Swift-Going. Tell me your name." She replied: "My lord, my name is Crocodile-Woman."

He then began to devise a plan involving stones. On the first day he took a small stone and rode upon Swift-Going's wings. On the second day he carried two stones of that size. On the third day he carried three stones of that size, and so on until he was carrying a weight equal to that of a man. Then he mounted Swift-Going's wings together with Swift-Going and flew away. As they went, Śoṣumpa said: "My lord, you must not open your eyes — there will be harm." So he shut his eyes. When they were close to the point where Nāmakhormo was about to fall away beneath them, he heard the clamour and noise of a great multitude of people. He thought: "Now I may look." When he opened his eyes, his eyes came out and he was rendered blind. Śoṣumpa set him down in a pleasure grove and went inside among the wives of King Brahmadatta.

Some time later spring arrived. The trees were in blossom, and in a dense forest filled with the calls of geese, cranes, peacocks, parrots, śārikā birds, cuckoos, and the creatures that live by living — surrounded by Brahmadatta's consorts, Queen Brahmadatta went together with Śoṣumpa to the pleasure grove. Now the brahmin's son, Swift-Going, smelt the fragrance of tīmira flowers and, having taken them up, thought to sing a song of that kind. Borne along on the wind, it carried the fragrance of tīmira flowers — in the place where Śoṣumpa dwells, among the kāśeru groves.

When King Brahmadatta heard this, he said to the consorts: "Find out who is singing here." They said: "There is a man deprived of his god-eyes, who is here in this pleasure grove singing." The king summoned him and asked: "Young man, was it you who sang?" He replied: "Sire, it was I who sang." The king said: "Young man, sing again — I will listen again." He thought: "It is not another's — it is what I myself sang, and it was pleasing to hear. Therefore the king wishes to hear it, and perhaps I may gain some small benefit." So he sang:

Borne along on the wind,
the fragrance of tīmira flowers —
in the place where Śoṣumpa dwells,
among the kāśeru groves.

The king asked: "Young man, how far is it from here to these kāśeru groves?" He replied in verse:

A hundred leagues from here
lie the waters of the great ocean.
There dwells Śoṣumpa,
in the kāśeru groves.

Then King Brahmadatta answered him in verse:

If this Śoṣumpa, who delights my heart,
were seen or heard by you to have any flaw,
speak too of whatever marks are on her body.

He in turn replied in verse:

A svastika mark is on her thigh,
her breasts curve round upon her,
and the tīmira flowers
are strung along the back of your beloved.

The king thought: "This one has conducted himself badly. I have no need of him — I shall give him to the blind one." But then growing further angry, he spoke in verse:

I shall give you Śoṣumpa,
adorned with every ornament —
mount a donkey, and depart
from the city with all haste.

In his anger the king had Śoṣumpa and the blind man put together upon a riding donkey and expelled them. The blind man led her, and they wandered here and there. When the sun set they arrived at a village on a rocky cliff and spent the night in an empty shrine. That night some five hundred wild men came to plunder the village on the rocky cliff. The many people dwelling in the village of the rocky cliff became aware of this and raised a general alarm, and the villagers of the rocky cliff captured and routed the wild men. Their leader, however, was not caught, and he entered that very shrine.

The villagers of the rocky cliff surrounded that very shrine on all sides, and the leader of the wild men barred the door from within. The villagers called out: "Who is in there?" The brahmin's son Swift-Walker replied: "We are travelers." They said: "Let this wild man come out. You yourself have surely been made to suffer for nothing." The leader of the wild men said to Śoṣumpa: "What use is this blind man? Drive him off and the two of us will enjoy each other fully." She replied: "Good sir, please do as you like. As for me, I am yours." And then she and the leader of the wild men threw the blind man from the top of the cliff wall, whereupon the villagers of the rocky cliff cut off his head and threw it away.

The next day, as the leader of the wild men led her and they were going, they came to the river Kāradā and found no boat for crossing. He said: "Fair one, this river Kāradā is full of water, and you cannot cross it adorned with all your ornaments. You wait here and bathe while I take your ornaments across. I will come back and carry you over afterward." She agreed and said, "So be it, I will bathe," and gave him all her clothing and ornaments. Then she entered the water and sat there naked. When he had gone to the middle of the river, she began to feel regret, thinking: "Has he not stolen my ornaments and clothing and gone without returning?" And she spoke in verse:

This river Kāradā is full of water.

To you, fair one, I gave all my goods.

Now doubt has arisen in my heart.

O wicked one, do not deceive me!

He too replied in verse:

You, no friend, have slain an old friend.

That man is now as nothing.

Therefore it is hard to trust you.

Will you not slay me too?

And with that he stole them and fled. She, still naked, crouched down inside some thick grass. Just then an old fox came along the bank of the river Kāradā carrying a piece of meat, and a large fish, leaping out of the water onto dry land, fell there. The fox dropped the meat and ran after the fish, but the fish jumped back into the river. And a crow swept up the meat. Thus losing both, the fox sat with its ears drooping in regret. Śoṣumpa, sitting inside the thick grass, saw this and spoke in verse:

The piece of meat was seized by the crow.

The fish escaped into the river.

Both are now beyond reach.

Why should the fox not be sorrowful?

The fox looked in all four directions. It saw no one. Then it spoke in verse:

No wild men dance here,

and songs do not delight me either.

Who is it that dwells within the grass

to mock and laugh at me?

She answered: "Uncle, it is I, Śoṣumpa." The fox was angered and thought: "This wicked woman knows how to taunt me," and spoke in verse:

Your husband was slain by you yourself.

Because the mouse fled away,

both were lost to you.

Why should the wicked woman not grieve?

She replied in verse:

I will go to my own home

and take an excellent husband there.

Once a husband has been found,

one need not cast shame upon one's lineage.

The fox spoke in verse:

When the Gaṅgā flows back upstream

and crows turn the color of yogurt,

when such fruit appears,

only then will you truly be a woman of virtue.

When someday a crow and an owl,

having made their dwelling on a single tree,

dwell together in happiness,
 then, at that time, virtue will be yours.

When someday a snake and a mongoose, both —
 dwelling together in a single burrow,
 dwelling there in happiness and contentment —
 then, at that time, virtue will be yours.

When someday a tortoise's wool
 has been well spun and fashioned
 into a winter garment —
 then virtue will be yours.

When someday from a gnat's kneecap
 a ladder has been well constructed
 and set up as a stairway to the heavens —
 then, at that time, virtue will be yours.

When someday upon the stalk of a jasmine plant
 a bridge has been well built
 and an ox-cart passes over it —
 then, at that time, virtue will be yours.

When someday even in the middle of the ocean
 a fine fire blazes brightly
 and people enter into it —
 then, at that time, virtue will be yours.

When I have finished mocking you, woman, that will be the end of it. Now, if I am to restore you to your former place, what will you give me in return? The woman said to that fox: If you, dear one, restore me to my former place, I will give you a piece of meat every single day. The fox said: Very well then, watch carefully. Enter the river, submerge yourself up to your neck in the water, face east, and remain there. I will make supplication to the god. The fox then went near the royal palace and addressed the deity thus: O god, this woman is virtuous and truthful and is practicing austerities; she is one who is fit to be summoned quickly. Upon hearing this, King Brahmadatta, who was skilled in the language of foxes, commanded his minister: I have heard that on the bank of the river Karanadana a woman is practicing austerities. Go and bring her here. The attendants dressed her in fine garments and ornaments and brought

her, and the king restored her to her former place. Each day she gave the fox a piece of meat. She gave it for a certain period of time, and then she stopped giving it. The fox, sitting near the royal palace, threatened the woman, saying: If you give me a piece of meat, well and good. If you do not, I will give you a sound thrashing and restore you once again to your former place as before. Hearing this, the woman was frightened and again began giving the fox a piece of meat each day.

Now, monks, what do you think? That woman at that time and on that occasion was the nun of blue-lotus complexion. That swift-footed one at that time and on that occasion was the monk Utpalā. At that time and on that occasion, he knew her by her scent, and even now he knows her by her scent.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the monks rejoiced and delighted in what the Blessed One had taught.

The Thirty-Sixth Fascicle of the Miscellaneous Matters of the Vinaya.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time, on the bank of the river Vaṅgumatī, certain monks, by means of a compound of clay pills and a purgative preparation, abandoned all afflictions and directly attained arhatship. At that time the Blessed One declared to the monks: Therefore, monks, strive, be diligent, make effort with this very compound of clay pills and a purgative preparation, just as those monks on the bank of the river Vaṅgumatī strove, were diligent, and made effort. Monks, do not be slothful in diligence. Monks, if one is slothful in diligence, one will be finished, along with all that has passed.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was residing in the dense forest of Rikāta, near the town of Kīṭa. At that time, in Rikāta, monks Thāskaryesd and Nābso and — the reddish-brown monks were staying there. These monks engaged in, arranged, and deliberately attended the following kinds of fights and contests: wool-sheep fighting, horse fighting, chariot fighting, ram fighting, staff fighting, fist fighting, bull fighting, buffalo fighting, goat fighting, cock fighting, dog fighting, quail fighting, partridge fighting, crane fighting — and they set women, men, youths, and girls to competing in tests of strength, and they abused, reviled, and spoke ill of faithful brahmins and householders, saying: "Why should one give alms or make offerings to this bald-headed ascetic who, though he has gone forth into the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, goes about arranging wool-sheep fights and the like?" When this had happened, the monks reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks,

the brahmins and householders are right to criticize. Therefore, monks, they must not be allowed to arrange fights involving wool-sheep and the like, nor even to watch them. If monks arrange fights involving wool-sheep and the like, or arrange for others to do so, or watch them, they will be finished, along with all that has passed."

In brief: what was asked in full
and answered by the nun who had entered confinement —
those deeds too are to be performed.
The nun who has descended again.

The awakened one, the Blessed One, was residing in the Nyagrodha pleasure grove at Kapilavāstu. Then Gautamī, the great Progenitress, together with five hundred Śākya women, went to where the Blessed One was, bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet, and took a seat to one side. Seated to one side, Gautamī, the great Progenitress, was taught the discourse of Dharma, rightly exhorted, rightly encouraged, and rightly gladdened by the Blessed One. Having been rightly taught, rightly exhorted, rightly encouraged, and rightly gladdened through the discourse of Dharma in its many aspects, and the Blessed One then remaining silent, Gautamī, the great Progenitress, rose from her seat, turned to face the Blessed One, joined her palms together, paid homage, and addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Venerable One, if there were an occasion for women to attain the four fruits of the ascetic life, may the Blessed One please permit women to go forth into the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, to receive full ordination, to conduct themselves in the manner of nuns, and to live the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One." To this the Blessed One replied to Gautamī, the great Progenitress, with these words: "Gautamī, in just this way, wearing the white robes of a laywoman for the rest of your life, practice the holy life that is in all things complete, entirely pure, and entirely perfected — and it will be for your long-term benefit, welfare, and happiness." Gautamī, the great Progenitress, again a second and a third time addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Venerable One, if there were an occasion for women to attain the four fruits of the ascetic life, may the Blessed One please permit women to go forth into the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, to receive full ordination, to conduct themselves in the manner of nuns, and to live the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One."

The Blessed One, a second and a third time, addressed Gautamī, the great Progenitress, with these words: "Gautamī, you should, in exactly this way, for

as long as you live, shave your head and wear stitched robes, and for as long as you live practice the holy life that in that alone is entirely perfected, entirely pure, and entirely purified — and it will be for your long-term benefit, welfare, and happiness."

Then, since the Blessed One had refused three times, Gautamī, the great Progenitress, bowed her head to the feet of the Blessed One, paid homage, and departed from his presence.

Thereupon the Blessed One remained in the settlement of the Śākyas as long as he wished, then took up his bowl and robes and traveled onward through the country toward Nādikā, and came to dwell at the Guñja residence at Nādikā.

When Gautamī, the great Progenitress, heard that the Blessed One had remained in the settlement of the Śākyas as long as he wished, had taken up his bowl and robes, and was traveling through the country toward Nādikā, she, together with five hundred Śākya women, at once cut off her own hair and distributed robes of the Dharma among them. With their heads shaved and wearing stitched robes, they followed after the Blessed One, walking in his wake, and set out.

The Blessed One, having traveled through the country of the Vṛjīs, arrived at Nādikā and resided there at the Guñja residence.

Then Gautamī, the great Progenitress — her body weary, her body aching, her body exhausted, covered in dust — went to where the Blessed One was and arrived there. She bowed her head to the feet of the Blessed One, paid homage, and stood to one side.

Having stood to one side, Gautamī, the great Progenitress, was then thoroughly shown, thoroughly urged, thoroughly encouraged, and thoroughly gladdened by the Blessed One with a discourse on Dharma. After being thoroughly shown, thoroughly urged, thoroughly encouraged, and thoroughly gladdened with a discourse on Dharma in many ways, the Blessed One remained in silence.

Then Gautamī, the great Progenitress, rose from her seat, pressed her palms together in reverence toward where the Blessed One was, paid homage, and addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Venerable One, if there were an occasion for women to attain the four fruits of the ascetic life, may the Blessed One please permit women to go forth into the well-proclaimed Dharma and

Vinaya, to receive full ordination, to conduct themselves in the manner of nuns, and to live the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One."

The Blessed One then addressed Gautamī, the great Progenitress: "Gautamī, you should, in exactly this way, in just this manner, for as long as you live, with your head shaved and wearing stitched robes, practice for as long as you live the holy life that in that alone is entirely perfected, entirely pure, and entirely purified — and it will be for your long-term benefit, welfare, and happiness."

Gautamī, the great Progenitress, again a second and a third time addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Venerable One, if there were an occasion for women to attain the four fruits of the ascetic life, may the Blessed One please permit women to go forth into the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, to receive full ordination, to conduct themselves in the manner of nuns, and to live the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One."

And when she had so spoken, the Blessed One a second and a third time addressed Gautamī, the great Progenitress: "Gautamī, you should in exactly this way, in just this manner, for as long as you live, with your head shaved and wearing stitched robes, practice what in that alone is entirely perfected, entirely pure, and —

entirely pure, the holy life. And this will be for your long-lasting benefit, welfare, and happiness."

When the Blessed One had refused Gautamī, the great Progenitress, a second and a third time in exactly this way, she sat down to one side of the outer gatehouse and wept, shedding tears. The venerable Ānanda then saw Gautamī, the great Progenitress, sitting to one side of the outer gatehouse, weeping and shedding tears. Seeing this, he said to her: "Gautamī, why are you sitting to one side of the outer gatehouse, weeping and shedding tears?"

She replied: "Venerable Ānanda, it is because the Blessed One has not permitted women to go forth into the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, to receive full ordination, to conduct themselves in the manner of nuns, and to live the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One."

"Gautamī, remain here. I shall petition the Blessed One."

Then the venerable Ānanda went to where the Blessed One was and approached him, bowed his head to the Blessed One's feet in reverence, and sat down to one side. Sitting to one side, the venerable Ānanda addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, if women are capable of attaining the four fruits of

the ascetic life, may the Blessed One please permit women to go forth into the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, to receive full ordination, to conduct themselves in the manner of nuns, and to live the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One."

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One replied: "Ānanda, do not petition me to permit women to go forth into the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, to receive full ordination, and to conduct themselves in the manner of nuns. And why not? Ānanda, if women go forth into the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, this Dharma and Vinaya will not long endure.

It is like this, Ānanda. Consider a household in which there are many women and few men — it will be plundered and utterly ruined by thieves and robbers. In just the same way, Ānanda, if women go forth into the Dharma and Vinaya, this Dharma and Vinaya will not long endure.

Or consider this, Ānanda. When an excellent field of rice and sālū grain is struck by an overwhelming hailstorm, that very rice and grain becomes damaged, completely ruined, and unsuitable by reason of what is contrary to its nature. In just the same way, Ānanda, if women go forth into the Dharma and Vinaya, this Dharma and Vinaya will not long endure.

Or again, Ānanda. Consider a prosperous householder-farmer whose excellent sugarcane is afflicted by the blight of rust-disease — the sugarcane becomes unsuitable and is entirely wasted and ruined. In just the same way, Ānanda, if women go forth into the Dharma and Vinaya, this Dharma and Vinaya will not long endure.

Nevertheless, Ānanda, in order to restrain women and prevent them from transgressing, I now establish eight chief rules by which women must train for as long as they live.

It is like this, Ānanda. Consider a householder-farmer who, when autumn has passed and the harvest season has come, builds a dike to dam a river or an irrigation channel — the water that is held back will not overflow the dam. In just the same way, Ānanda, I now establish these eight chief rules in order to restrain women and prevent them from transgressing. Women must train in them for as long as they live.

What are the eight?"

Ānanda, women must clearly understand that going forth and receiving full ordination from among the monks is what constitutes becoming a fully

ordained nun. Ānanda, I now establish this as the first chief rule, in order to restrain women and prevent them from transgressing. Women must train in it for as long as they live.

Ānanda, nuns must seek instruction and scriptural transmission from the monks every fortnight, in accordance with the Teacher's word. Ānanda, I now establish this as the second chief rule, in order to restrain women and prevent them from transgressing. Women must train in it for as long as they live.

Ānanda, nuns must not enter the rains retreat in a place where there are no monks. Ānanda, I now establish this as the third chief rule, in order to restrain women and prevent them from transgressing. Women must train in it for as long as they live.

Ānanda, at the close of the rains retreat, a nun must perform the invitation ceremony before both communities regarding three matters: what was seen, what was heard, and what was suspected. Ānanda, I now establish this as the fourth chief rule, in order to restrain women and prevent them from transgressing. Women must train in it for as long as they live.

Ānanda, a nun must not speak of, nor bring to mind, any lapse in ethical conduct, any lapse in view, any lapse in behavior, or any lapse in livelihood on the part of monks. A nun is not permitted to speak of or call attention to any such lapses in ethical conduct, view, behavior, or livelihood on the part of a monk. As for monks speaking of and calling attention to such lapses on the part of nuns — there is no prohibition against that. Ānanda, I now establish this as the fifth chief rule, in order to restrain women and prevent them from transgressing. Women must train in it for as long as they live.

Ānanda, a nun must not speak harsh words to a monk, must not be angry with him, and must not be contemptuous of him. A nun is not permitted to speak harshly to a monk, to be angry with him, or to be contemptuous of him. Ānanda, I now establish this as the sixth chief rule, in order to restrain women and prevent them from transgressing. Women must train in it for as long as they live.

Ānanda, if a nun has transgressed a chief rule, she must perform a fortnight's probationary conduct to satisfy both communities. Ānanda, I now establish this as the seventh chief rule, in order to restrain women and prevent them from transgressing. Women must train in it for as long as they live.

Ānanda, a nun who has received full ordination — even if she has completed a hundred years — must speak words of welcome, offer praise, rise to her feet, join her palms together, and make prostration to a monk who has only just received full ordination. Ānanda, I now establish this as the eighth chief rule, in order to restrain women and prevent them from transgressing. Women must train in it for as long as they live.

Ānanda, if the great lady Gautamī sincerely takes up and diligently upholds these eight chief rules, that itself shall constitute her going forth, that itself her full ordination, and that itself her status as a fully ordained person.

Thus the Blessed One declared. Then the venerable Ānanda, greatly rejoicing and delighted at the words of the Blessed One, prostrated with his head to the feet of the Blessed One, and departed from the Blessed One's presence.

He then went to where the great lady Gautamī was, and said to her the following: "Gautamī, it has been granted that women may go forth, receive full ordination, and be established as fully ordained nuns in the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya. However, Gautamī, the Blessed One has established eight chief rules in order to restrain women and prevent them from transgressing. Women must train in these for as long as they live, and must do so diligently. Venerable Ānanda has spoken. Please hear what he said. Gautamī, the Blessed One declared the following. 'Ānanda, women are to understand that, from monks, they receive going forth, full ordination, and establishment as fully ordained nuns. Gautamī, this is the first chief rule that the Blessed One has established in order to restrain women and prevent them from transgressing. Women must train in it for as long as they live.' Gautamī, the Blessed One then further declared: 'Ānanda, a fully ordained nun must, twice each month, seek from monks the scriptural transmission of the Teacher's instruction. Gautamī, this is the second chief rule that the Blessed One has established in order to restrain women and prevent them from transgressing. Women must train in it for as long as they live.' Gautamī, the Blessed One then further declared: 'Ānanda, a fully ordained nun must not enter the rains retreat in a place where there are no monks. Gautamī, this is the third chief rule that the Blessed One has established in order to restrain women and prevent them from transgressing. Women must train in it for as long as they live.' Gautamī, the Blessed One then further declared: 'Ānanda, a fully ordained nun who has completed the rains retreat must perform the invitation ceremony before both communities — the Saṅgha of monks and the Saṅgha of nuns — on the three grounds of what was seen, what was heard, and what was suspected.

Gautamī, this is the fourth chief rule that the Blessed One has established in order to restrain women and prevent them from transgressing. Women must train in it for as long as they live.' Gautamī, the Blessed One then further declared: 'Ānanda, a fully ordained nun must not discuss or bring up matters concerning a monk who has violated ethical conduct, who holds a wrong view, who has engaged in wrong conduct, or who maintains a wrong livelihood. Ānanda, a fully ordained nun is not permitted to discuss or bring up such matters concerning a monk who has violated ethical conduct, who holds a wrong view, who has engaged in wrong conduct, or who maintains a wrong livelihood. Ānanda, however, it is permitted for a monk to discuss and bring up such matters concerning a fully ordained nun who has violated ethical conduct, who holds a wrong view, who has engaged in wrong conduct, or who maintains a wrong livelihood. Gautamī, this is the fifth chief rule that the Blessed One has established in order to restrain women and prevent them from transgressing. Women must train in it for as long as they live.' Gautamī, the Blessed One then further declared: 'Ānanda, a fully ordained nun must not speak harsh words to a monk, must not become angry at him, and must not scold him. Ānanda, a fully ordained nun is not permitted to speak harsh words to a monk, to become angry at him, or to scold him. Gautamī, this is the sixth chief rule that the Blessed One has established in order to restrain women and prevent them from transgressing. Women must train in it for as long as they live.' Gautamī, the Blessed One then further declared:

'Ānanda, a fully ordained nun who has emerged from under the preceptorship must conduct herself in a pleasing manner toward both assemblies of the Saṅgha for a fortnight in turn. Gautamī, the Blessed One has established this as the seventh chief rule in order to restrain women and prevent them from transgressing. Women must train in it for as long as they live.' Gautamī, the Blessed One then further declared: 'A fully ordained nun who has been fully ordained for a hundred years must speak pleasing words to, praise, rise before, join her palms toward, and bow down to a monk who has only just received full ordination. Gautamī, this is the eighth chief rule that the Blessed One has established in order to restrain women and prevent them from transgressing. Women must train in it for as long as they live.'

The Blessed One then further declared: 'Ānanda, if Gautamī the Great Lady takes up and earnestly upholds these eight chief rules, then for her this itself shall count as the going forth, this itself as full ordination, and this itself as the status of a fully ordained nun.'

The venerable Ānanda then said: 'Venerable one, these eight chief rules that the Blessed One has established in order to restrain women and prevent them from transgressing — women must train in them for as long as they live — I accept these with speech, with mind, and even with the crown of my head.

Venerable Ānanda, it is just as when a daughter of the warrior class, or a daughter of the brahmin class, or a daughter of the merchant class, or a daughter of the common class, well bathed, well anointed, with her hair and nails dressed and wearing white garments, is offered by someone a garland of blue lotus flowers, or a garland of campaka blossoms, or a garland of jasmine flowers, or a garland of atimuktaka flowers — she would receive it joyfully with both hands and place it upon the crown of her head, the highest of all limbs. In just the same way, venerable Ānanda, these eight chief rules that the Blessed One has established in order to restrain women and prevent them from transgressing — women must train in them for as long as they live — I accept these with speech, with mind, and even with the crown of my head.

And since the Blessed One has now been pleased to grant Gautamī the Great Lady, through her acceptance of these chief rules, the going forth and full ordination and the status of a fully ordained nun, the venerable Upāli then said to the Buddha, the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, you declared that if Gautamī the Great Lady takes up and earnestly upholds these eight chief rules, that itself shall count as the going forth, that itself as full ordination, and that itself as the status of a fully ordained nun — but how then are other women to go forth, receive full ordination, and attain the status of fully ordained nuns?"

The Blessed One declared: 'Upāli, other women shall be given the going forth and full ordination in successive order.' When the Blessed One had declared that other women should be given the going forth and full ordination in successive order, the monks did not know what the successive procedure should be, and those monks therefore asked the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: 'Gautamī the Great Lady together with the other five hundred Śākya women have gone forth, received full ordination, and become fully ordained nuns by virtue of their acceptance of the chief rules.'

As for other women, the procedure is as follows in successive order. One who wishes to go forth shall come before any fully ordained nun she chooses, who shall then ask her about the obstructing factors and receive her. Having received her, the nun shall give her the three refuges and the five training

rules that form the basis of a laywoman's practice.

What are the three refuges? The Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha.

What are the five training rules? They are the complete abandonment of taking life; of taking what is not given; of sexual misconduct through desire; of false speech; and of the state of heedlessness that arises from intoxication by fermented or distilled liquor. Having thus fully abandoned that state of heedlessness caused by intoxicating fermented or distilled liquor, the formula is as follows: 'I, who am called such-and-such by name, from this day forward and for as long as I live, fully abandon taking what is not given, sexual misconduct, false speech, and the state of heedlessness caused by intoxicating fermented or distilled liquor.' In this same manner the taking of refuge and the giving of the training rules shall be performed.

First, let her make prostration to the Teacher. Then let the fully ordained nun who is giving the refuge and training rules allow her to make prostration and join her palms together. After that, she shall speak these words:

'Noble one, please hear me. I, who am called such-and-such by name, for as long as I live take refuge in the Buddha, who is supreme among two-footed beings. I take refuge in the excellent and holy Dharma, which is free from attachment. I take refuge in the excellent Saṅgha, which is supreme among assemblies. I request the noble one to hold me as a laywoman for as long as I live.' This shall be done a second and a third time in the same manner.

Then the five training rules shall be given: 'Noble one, please hear me. Just as those noble arhats have for the duration of their lives abandoned taking life and fully refrained from it, so too I, called such-and-such by name, from this very day forward and for as long as I live, abandon taking life and fully refrain from it. By this first rule I follow, accomplish, and carry out the training of those noble arhats. And just as those arhats have for the duration of their lives abandoned taking what is not given, sexual misconduct through desire, false speech, and the state of heedlessness caused by intoxicating fermented or distilled liquor, and have fully turned away from it, so too I, called such-and-such by name, from this day on and for as long as I live, abandon taking what is not given, sexual misconduct through desire, false speech, and the state of heedlessness, and have fully turned away from the state of heedlessness caused by intoxicating fermented or distilled liquor. By these five rules I follow, accomplish, and carry out the training of those noble arhats.'

The preceptor shall then say: 'It is well.' And the laywoman shall say: 'Excellent!'

Then a fully ordained nun shall be appointed to make the announcement within the assembly of nuns. The one so appointed shall ask that fully ordained nun: 'Did you question her about the obstructing factors?' If the announcement is made without having asked, it shall constitute a transgression. The appointed nun shall then, whether the assembly of nuns is gathered together or whether they are in their individual dwelling places, proclaim the following:

'Hear me, noble assembly of nuns. This person, called such-and-such, who is a householder clothed in white with uncut hair, seeks going forth from the preceptor called such-and-such. If this person called such-and-such — who has cut her hair, put on ochre robes, and with genuine faith has gone forth from home into homelessness under the preceptor called such-and-such — seeks to achieve the status of going forth and full ordination and becoming a fully ordained nun in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, going from the household life to homelessness, then...'

If she herself declares 'the obstacles are fully purified,' then let her receive going forth. And all should say: 'Then, since they are fully purified, let it be so.' If they speak accordingly, it is well. But if they do not speak, there will be a transgression.

Then a request is to be made to the preceptor nun: 'Venerable preceptor, please give your attention. I, called such-and-such, request of you, the venerable preceptor, through the acharya nun: may the venerable preceptor become my preceptor. I request going forth from the venerable preceptor.' This is repeated a second and third time in the same way. At the third recitation, the word 'from the preceptor nun' is to be said. The preceptor nun says 'It is possible,' and the novice candidate says 'Excellent.'

Then the preceptor nun is to request the hair-cutting nun to cut the candidate's hair. The hair-cutting nun asks: 'Sister, shall I cut your hair?' If she says 'Cut it,' the hair is cut. If she says 'No,' say to her: 'Then leave from here.'

The fully ordained monks assign to the hair-cutting nun the following duty to perform directly in that way: if the candidate becomes cold after the hair-cutting nun has attended to her in this way, she is to be bathed with warm water; if she is warm, she is to be bathed with cool water. Then in a single moment, after drying the water from the body, she is to put on the lower robe. When the lower robe is being put on, the candidate's sex characteristics are to

be examined, to determine whether she is without characteristics, or has ambiguous characteristics, or is hermaphroditic.

If the hair-cutting nun, having taken up the duty to perform directly in that way, does not carry it out, there will be a transgression.

Then the going forth is to be carried out. First, the candidate is caused to prostrate before the Teacher. After that, she is caused to prostrate before the preceptor nun. She is then made to sit cross-legged in front of her, caused to join her palms together, and thereupon she is to speak these words:

'Venerable preceptor, please give your attention. I, called such-and-such, for as long as life lasts, take refuge in the Buddha, who is supreme among two-footed beings. I take refuge in the holy Dharma, which is free from attachment. I take refuge in the supreme Saṅgha, which is the highest among assemblies. Following in the going forth of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened Śākyamuni — the Lion of the Śākyas, the King of the Śākyas, the Chief — I have gone forth and renounce the marks of a householder. I take up the marks of one who has gone forth.'

This is repeated a second and third time. The preceptor nun says 'It is possible,' and the one who has gone forth says 'Excellent.'

Then the preceptor nun is to request a fully ordained nun who is skilled in imparting the training rules of a novice nun. Whoever is requested should cause the candidate to prostrate before the Teacher, seat her cross-legged in front of her, cause her to join her palms, and then impart the taking of refuge and the training rules of a novice nun.

'Noble one, please give your attention. I, called such-and-such, for as long as life lasts, take refuge in the Buddha, who is supreme among two-footed beings. I take refuge in the holy Dharma, which is free from attachment. I take refuge in the supreme Saṅgha, which is the highest among assemblies. I request the noble one to accept me as a novice nun for as long as I live.'

This is repeated a second and third time. At the third recitation, the words 'the acharya nun' are to be said. The acharya nun says 'It is possible,' and the novice nun says 'Excellent.'

After this, a fully ordained nun is to measure the shadow and is to state the person's name, the day and night portions, and the time.

Then the ten training rules are to be given:

'Noble one, please give your attention. Just as the noble ones, the arhats, have throughout their lives abandoned the taking of life and turned back from the taking of life, so too I, called such-and-such, from this day forth, for as long as life lasts, abandon the taking of life and turn back from the taking of life.'

By this first training rule, just as the noble ones, the arhats, have trained, practised, and acted, so too shall I follow in their training, accomplish it, and carry it out.

Furthermore, just as the noble ones, the arhats, have throughout their lives abandoned taking what is not given, unchaste conduct, false speech, grain-based alcohol and fruit-based alcohol, the intoxicants that lead to heedlessness, singing, dancing, playing instruments, wearing garlands, perfumes, ointments, and cosmetics, high beds and large beds, eating at improper times, and accepting gold and silver, and have turned back from accepting gold and silver — so too I, called such-and-such, from this day forth, for as long as life lasts, abandon taking what is not given, unchaste conduct, false speech, grain-based alcohol and fruit-based alcohol, the intoxicants that lead to heedlessness, singing, dancing, playing instruments, wearing garlands, perfumes, ointments, and cosmetics, high beds and large beds, eating at improper times, and accepting gold and silver, and I turn back from accepting gold and silver. By these ten training rules, just as the noble ones, the arhats, have trained, practised, and acted, so too shall I follow in their training, accomplish it, and carry it out.

The acharya nun is to say 'It is possible,' and the novice nun is to say 'Excellent.'

If the one who resides as a householder has completed ten years of age, or if she is a young woman who has completed eighteen years of age, she is to be given the training in the six rules and the six rules that accompany them for a period of two years. It is to be given in the following way.

The assembly of nuns is to gather and convene. She is to be allowed to bow to the assembly, and even if there are as few as twelve nuns gathered, she is to be seated cross-legged before the eldest and is to make a request of the preceptor nun. She is to be allowed to bow to the preceptor nun, to sit in a low posture, and to join her palms. If the preceptor is a preceptor nun, she is to make the request in these words: 'Please attend, Preceptor. I, called such-and-such, request of the preceptor nun — may you, Preceptor, become my preceptor nun. I request of the preceptor that I be fully allowed to take up

the vows of the training.' If she is an acharya nun instead, the request is to be made in these words: 'Please attend, Acharya. I, called such-and-such, request of the acharya — may you, Acharya, become my preceptor nun. I request of the acharya that I be fully allowed to take up the vows of the training from the preceptor nun.' Likewise this is done a second and a third time. On the third repetition, one says 'preceptor nun.' The preceptor nun is to say 'It is possible,' and the student is to say 'Excellent.'

Then the vows of the training are to be requested. The candidate should attend and say: 'Noble members of the Saṅgha, I, called such-and-such, for the sake of the matter — stating her name — request full ordination from she called such-and-such. I, called such-and-such, with the preceptor nun called such-and-such, request of the noble Saṅgha the training in the six rules and the six rules that accompany them for a period of two years. May the noble Saṅgha, out of compassion and for the sake of that compassion, grant to me, called such-and-such, a householder of ten years' standing, or a young woman who has completed eighteen years of age, the training in the six rules and the six rules that accompany them.' Likewise this is to be done a second and a third time.

After this, one nun who has received the request is to perform the act. The candidate should attend: 'Noble members of the Saṅgha, she called such-and-such, a householder who has completed ten years of age, or a young woman who has completed eighteen years of age, requests of the noble Saṅgha of nuns the training in the six rules and the six accompanying rules for a period of two years.

If the noble Saṅgha of nuns is agreeable and the time is right, let the noble Saṅgha of nuns grant permission, and let the noble Saṅgha of nuns confer upon her called such-and-such, a householder who has completed ten years of age, or a young woman who has completed eighteen years of age, with the preceptress called such-and-such, the training in the six rules and the six rules that accompany them for a period of two years from the Saṅgha of nuns. This is the motion. The act is to be performed as follows. 'Noble members of the Saṅgha of nuns, she called such-and-such, a householder who has completed ten years of age, or a young woman who has completed eighteen years of age, with the preceptress called such-and-such, requests of the noble Saṅgha the training in the six rules and the six rules that accompany them for a period of two years. On her behalf, the noble Saṅgha of nuns is requested to confer upon her called such-and-such, a householder who has completed ten years of

age, or a young woman who has completed eighteen years of age, with the preceptress called such-and-such, the training in the six rules and the six rules that accompany them for a period of two years from the Saṅgha of nuns. Those among the noble members of the Saṅgha who are agreeable to conferring upon her called such-and-such, a householder who has completed ten years of age, or a young woman who has completed eighteen years of age, the training in the six rules and the six rules that accompany them, should remain silent. Those who are not agreeable should speak.' She called such-and-such, a householder who has completed ten years of age, or a young woman who has completed eighteen years of age, has been conferred the training in the six rules and the six rules that accompany them by the noble Saṅgha of nuns. The noble Saṅgha of nuns has consented and granted this by remaining silent. This is accordingly held to be so.

Then the six rules and the six rules that accompany them are to be taught to her in detail. What are the six? They are:

She shall not go alone into a village,
she shall not ford to the far bank of a river,
she shall not make physical contact with men,
she shall not dwell together with a man,
she shall not act as a go-between,
she shall conceal no wrongdoing.

These are the six rules of the scriptural teaching
proclaimed by the Tathāgata.

And what are the six accompanying rules? They are:

She shall not take hold of gold and the like,
she shall not shave the hair of the secret place,
she shall not dig the earth,
she shall not, out of foolishness, cut green grass,
she shall not eat food before receiving it as an offering,
she shall not eat food that has been set aside.

These six accompanying rules
the Sugata has not permitted.

When she has trained for two years in the six rules and the six rules that accompany them, she is then to be given the vow of full ordination into the celibate life in proper order. First, the preceptress should prepare the five

robes and the bowl, then instruct her privately, and then request a nun to perform the act. After that, when the Saṅgha of nuns has assembled and gathered, and when the assembly consists of at least twelve nuns, the candidate should bow three times to the assembly and then make a request to the preceptress. If she is indeed the preceptress, the request is made in these words: 'Please give heed, preceptress. I, called such-and-such, request of the preceptress that she become my preceptress. Preceptress, please become my preceptress. I request full ordination from the preceptress.' If she is likewise requesting from a preceptress-teacher, she should make the request in these words: 'Please give heed, preceptress-teacher. I, called such-and-such, request from the preceptress-teacher that she become my preceptress. Preceptress-teacher, please become my preceptress. I request full ordination from the preceptress-teacher through the preceptress.' Likewise this is done a second and a third time.

Then the robes are to be consecrated with blessing. 'Please give heed, preceptress. These robes of her called such-and-such are consecrated as paired garments and are the completed robes to be worn throughout.' Likewise a second and a third time. In the same way this is done for the upper robe and

the middle robe, the skirt, and the perspiration cloth are likewise consecrated with blessing.

Then the alms bowl is to be shown to the assembly of nuns. The nuns are to say: "The alms bowl is good." Then the alms bowl is consecrated with blessing. "Please give heed, preceptress. This alms bowl of her called such-and-such is the vessel of a sage; it is consecrated as a vessel to be lifted and used as a receptacle for eating at all times." Likewise a second and a third time.

After that, from the place of hearing, she is to be led away and set apart in a place of seeing, with her palms pressed together, shown to those assembled. Then the acting nun is to say: "Designate someone to reveal the secret matters to her called such-and-such." Whoever is appointed, let her say: "I am called such-and-such." Then the acting nun is to say: "First, win her confidence. She called such-and-such — with the preceptress called such-and-such — with her called such-and-such as the revealer of secret matters, having won confidence: if she has consented, say that she has consented."

Then the acting nun is to make a brief application. "Heed this, noble assembly of nuns. I, called such-and-such, am preceptress. She called such-and-such, whose secret matters are to be revealed by me called such-and-such, has consented. If the time is right and the noble assembly of nuns is agreeable, may the noble assembly of nuns approve, and may the noble assembly of nuns — with the preceptress called such-and-such — reveal the secret matters to her called such-and-such. This is the application."

Then the nun who reveals secret matters is to have her sit cross-legged before her, let her press her palms together, and say to her: "She called such-and-such, listen. This is your time of truth; this is the proper time. Whatever I ask you, answer without embarrassment: to what has occurred, say that it occurred; to what has not occurred, say that it has not occurred — answer without error."

"Are you a woman? — I am a woman."

"Are you a laywoman of twelve years, or a young woman who has reached the age of twenty? — I have reached it."

"Are you furnished with the five Dharma robes and an alms bowl? — I am furnished."

"Are your parents and your husband living? — Have your father, mother, and husband given permission?"

"Are you not a slave girl? Not one who has been seized? Not one who was purchased? Not one who has been sold? Is there no dispute? Are you not one who has been stolen away? Is there no attachment of another? Are you not a magical emanation? Not an animal? Not one who has been troublesome to the king? Not one who has a quarrel with the king? Not one who performs acts harmful to the king? Have you not yourself performed or caused to be performed acts harmful to the king? Are you not one who is not at peace? Not one afflicted by grief? Not pregnant? Not without the feminine characteristic? Not possessed of both characteristics? Not a person with a festering wound? Not one who constantly bleeds? Not one without blood? Not one who has only the mark? Have you not deceived a monk? Have you not killed your father? Not killed your mother? Not killed an arhat? Have you not, with malicious intent, drawn blood from the body of a Tathāgata? Are you not a tīrthika adherent? Are you not one who goes over to the tīrthikas? Are you not one who bears the banner of a thief? Not one who abides as a thief? Not one who lives separately? Not one who does not abide?"

"Have you previously gone forth into the homeless life? — If she says, 'I have gone forth,' say: 'In that case, go back.' If she says, 'I have not gone forth,' then: Have you, having now gone forth, been practicing the holy life properly? — I have been practicing it. Have you requested from the assembly of nuns the training in the six rules and the six rules to be followed for two years? — I have requested it. Have you trained for two years in the six rules and the six rules to be followed? — I have trained. Has the vow that generates the holy life been conferred upon you by the assembly of nuns? — It has been conferred."

"Has the assembly of nuns performed for you what was to be done beforehand?" — "It has been performed." "Have you shown respectful regard toward the assembly of nuns?" — "I have shown respectful regard." "Are you fully pure of the impediment-factors?" — "I am fully pure." "Do you have any debt to others, whether great or small, that remains unpaid?" "What is your name? What is your preceptress's name?" — "My name is such-and-such." Stating her name for the purpose of the matter: "My preceptress's name is such-and-such."

"You, named thus-and-such, listen. There are bodily afflictions that may be harmful to the female body, and they are as follows: leprosy, skin eruptions, scabies, open sores, fever, dappled flesh, emaciation, convulsions, severe itching, nausea, vomiting, haemorrhoids, epidemic illness, foul breath, intoxication, urinary obstruction, fatigue, stupor, difficulty breathing, coughing, wasting disease, loss of memory, trembling, white disease, swollen feet, nocturnal discharge, tumors, blood disease, bile disease, anal fistula, indigestion, burning sensations in the limbs, burning sensations in the sides, deterioration of the bones, severe fever, quartan fever recurring every day, every second day, every third day, every fourth day, daily fever, aggregative fever, chronic fever, and fever accompanied by exhaustion and collapse. Are there any such bodily afflictions of this kind, or other afflictions harmful to the body, that you have on your person?" — If she is fully pure of them, instruct her privately in this way: "Just as I asked you, speak the same inside the assembly. Remain here and do not come until you are called." Then the one who teaches privately shall sit by the path and say these words: "Listen, noble one: I have taught and questioned you, named thus-and-such, regarding the impediment-factors, and you have said, 'I am fully pure.' Shall I go in?" All the nuns should then say: "If she is fully pure, come forward." If that is said, it is well. If it is not said, she will be accompanied by a transgression.

Then the officiating nun shall place her in front and confer upon her the vow that generates the holy life. "Attend, noble assembly of nuns! I, named thus-and-such, request full ordination from the preceptress named thus-and-such. I, named thus-and-such, request from the noble assembly of nuns the vow that generates the holy life" — stating the matter by name — "my preceptress being named thus-and-such. May the noble assembly of nuns confer upon me, named thus-and-such, the vow that generates the holy life, out of compassion, for the sake of compassion." Likewise a second time, likewise a third time.

Then the officiating nun, having received the petition, shall perform the act. "Attend, noble assembly of nuns! This one, named thus-and-such, requests full ordination from the one named thus-and-such; this one named thus-and-such, whose preceptress is named thus-and-such, requests from the noble assembly of nuns the vow that generates the holy life. If it is the proper time for the noble assembly of nuns, and if they consent, let the noble assembly of nuns give their assent. I, named thus-and-such, shall ask in the midst of the assembly about the impediment-factors. This is the petition."

"You, named thus-and-such, listen. This is the time for truth; this is the time for accuracy. Of everything I ask you, speak without concealment: what has occurred, say it has occurred; what has not occurred, say it has not occurred, without error. Are you a woman?" — "I am a woman," says she —

"Does your body suffer from such a disease or any other?" — and she says, "It does not." This completes the section up to that point.

Then she should make the petition. "Listen, noble assembly of nuns. This one, named thus-and-such, seeks full ordination from the preceptress named thus-and-such. She is either a householder of twelve years' standing, or a young woman who has completed twenty years of age. She possesses the five Dharma-robles and the alms-bowl as well. She declares herself to be entirely pure of the impediment-factors. She, named thus-and-such, with the preceptress named thus-and-such, asks the noble assembly of nuns for the vow that generates the holy life. If it is the proper time for the noble assembly of nuns, and if they consent, let the noble assembly of nuns assent. Let the noble assembly of nuns give to her, named thus-and-such, with the preceptress named thus-and-such, the vow that generates the holy life. The preceptress is named thus-and-such. This is the petition." The formal act is performed in this same manner.

"Listen, noble assembly of nuns. This one, named thus-and-such, seeks full ordination from one named thus-and-such. She is either a householder of twelve years' standing, or a young woman who has completed twenty years of age. She possesses the five Dharma-robles and the alms-bowl as well. She declares herself to be pure of the impediment-factors. She, named thus-and-such, with the preceptress named thus-and-such, asks the noble assembly of nuns for the vow that generates the holy life. The noble assembly of nuns is to give to her, named thus-and-such, with the preceptress named thus-and-such, the vow that generates the holy life. Those among the noble assembly of nuns who consent to granting the vow that generates the holy life to her, named thus-and-such, with the preceptress named thus-and-such, let them remain silent. Those who do not consent, let them speak. The noble assembly of nuns has given to her, named thus-and-such, with the preceptress named thus-and-such, the vow that generates the holy life. The noble assembly of nuns has consented and approved by remaining silent. So it is held to be."

After that, the entire assembly of monks gathers and is seated — a minimum assembly of ten monks — and the entire assembly of nuns gathers and is seated — a minimum assembly of twelve nuns. Before the officiating monk, she is placed on a bundle of grass or a cushion with a proper covering, and with palms pressed together she requests full ordination from both assemblies.

"Listen, both venerable communities. I, named thus-and-such, for the sake of the matter — naming the preceptress by name — seek full ordination from the preceptress named thus-and-such. I, named thus-and-such, request full ordination from both communities. May both venerable communities fully ordain me. May both venerable communities lift me up. May both venerable communities take me under their care. May both venerable communities show me kindness — for those who are kind, out of kindness." This is to be done three times, in this same way, a second and a third time.

After that, the officiating monk makes the petition: "Listen, both venerable communities. This one, named thus-and-such, seeks full ordination from the preceptress named thus-and-such. She, named thus-and-such, with the preceptress named thus-and-such, requests full ordination from both communities. If it is the proper time for both communities, and if they consent, let both communities assent."

"I will now question this candidate about the impediment factors in the presence of both venerable communities. This is the petition.

You, named thus-and-such, listen. This is your moment of truth; this is the proper time. Whatever I ask you, answer without embarrassment: if it occurred, say it occurred; if it did not occur, say it did not occur — speak without error.

Are you a woman? I am a woman.

Are you a lay resident of twelve years of age, or a young woman who has completed twenty years? I have completed them.

Are you provided with the five robes and the alms bowl? I am provided with them.

Are your father, mother, and husband living? They are living. Have your father, mother, and husband given their consent? They have given consent.

Are you not a slave? Not a slave. Are you not a kidnapped person? Not a kidnapped person. Are you not a purchased person? Not a purchased person. Are you not a sold person? Not a sold person. Are you free of attachment? Free of attachment. Are you not an emanated being? Not an emanated being. Are you not one cherished by the king? Not one cherished by the king. Are you not in enmity with the king? Not in enmity with the king. Are you not one who performs acts harmful to the king? I am not. Have you not caused harm to the king, or caused harm to be done to him? I have not. Are you not rebellious? Not rebellious. Are you not one consumed by grief? Not consumed by grief. Are you not pregnant? Not pregnant. Are you not without the female sex organ? I am not without it. Do you not have a double sex organ? I do not. Are you not one with a blocked organ? Not blocked. Are you not one who perpetually flows with blood? Not so. Are you not one without blood? Not so. Are you not one who possesses only a mark? Not so. Have you not deceived a monk? I have not. Have you not killed your father? I have not. Have you not killed your mother? I have not. Have you not killed an arhat? I have not. Have you not, with malicious intent, drawn blood from the body of a Tathāgata? I have not. Are you not a tīrthika (non-Buddhist adherent)? I am not. Are you not one who goes over to the tīrthikas? I am not. Are you not one bearing the banner of a thief? Not so. Are you not one who dwells as a thief? Not so. Are you not one who remains separately? Not so. Are you not one who is without a proper residence? Not so.

Have you previously gone forth into renunciation? If she says, 'I have gone forth,' then say: 'In that case, proceed.' If she says, 'I have not gone forth,' then ask: 'Have you now gone forth into renunciation? I have. Have you properly observed the celibate life? Have you been given by the community of nuns the training in the six rules and the six consequential rules for two years? They have been given. Have you trained for two years in the six rules and the six consequential rules? I have trained. Has the community of nuns conferred upon you the restraint that produces the celibate life? It has been conferred. Has the community of nuns performed for you the preliminary acts? They have been performed. Have you gained the approval of the community of nuns? I have gained it. Are you fully purified of all the impediment factors? I am fully purified. Do you have any debts to others, whether many or few? I am free of them.'

What is your name? What is the name of your preceptress? My name is thus-and-such. Speaking the name explicitly for the sake of clarity, the name of my preceptress is thus-and-such.

You, named thus-and-such, listen. There are bodily ailments that may afflict the female body. They are as follows: leprosy, swelling, consumption, eye disease, fever, mottled-flesh disease, emaciation, epilepsy, severe trembling, vomiting, hemorrhoids, hiccups, contagious fever, foul breath, madness, exhaustion, dizziness, burning fever, coughing, difficulty breathing, wasting, forgetfulness, chronic sores, white disease, swollen feet, nocturnal eruptions, tumors, blood disease, bile disease, rectal hemorrhoids, goiter, heat of the limbs, heat of the sides, dissolution of the bones, severe epidemic fever, intermittent fever occurring on the first day, on the second day, on the third day, on the fourth day, daily intermittent fever —"

— congregate fever, intermittent fever with exhaustion, and constant fever — and all other such bodily illnesses and bodily harms that may afflict your body: tell us truthfully and accurately whether they are present or not."

The Vinaya on Minor Points, fascicle thirty-seven.

Then the monk who makes the request, having obtained permission, shall perform the act. "Hear me, venerable ones of both Saṅghas. This one here, called such-and-such, requests full ordination from both Saṅghas with the preceptress called such-and-such. She who is called such-and-such, with the preceptress called such-and-such, requests full ordination from both Saṅghas. She is a woman; she possesses the faculties of a woman. Whether she is a

woman who has lived in a household for twelve years or a young girl who has completed twenty years of age, she has the five Dharma-robles and the alms bowl. Her father, mother, and husband have given their consent. The impediment-factors are entirely pure. She has practiced the holy life well. The community of nuns has imposed upon her the training in the six qualities and the six accompanying qualities for two years. She has trained in the training of the six qualities and the six accompanying qualities for two years. The community of nuns has given her the vow that produces the holy life through the three factors. The community of nuns has already performed the preliminary acts for her. The community of nuns has been satisfied. Declaring herself that the impediment-factors are pure — this one called such-and-such, with the preceptress called such-and-such, requests full ordination from both Saṅghas. If the time has come for both Saṅghas and they consent, both Saṅghas should remain silent, and both Saṅghas should grant full ordination to this one called such-and-such with the preceptress called such-and-such. This is the motion. The act shall be performed as follows."

"Hear me, venerable ones of both Saṅghas. This one called such-and-such, with the preceptress called such-and-such, requests full ordination from both Saṅghas. She who is called such-and-such, with the preceptress called such-and-such, requests full ordination from both Saṅghas. She is a woman; she also possesses the faculties of a woman. Whether she is a woman who has lived in a household for twelve years or a young girl who has completed twenty years of age, she has the five Dharma-robles and the alms bowl. Her father, mother, and husband have given their consent. The impediment-factors are entirely pure. She has practiced the holy life well. The community of nuns has imposed upon her the training in the six qualities and the six accompanying qualities for two years. She has trained in the training of the six qualities and the six accompanying qualities for two years. The community of nuns has given her the vow that produces the holy life. The community of nuns has already performed the acts required for her. I have satisfied the community of nuns. Declaring herself that the impediment-factors are pure — this one called such-and-such, with the preceptress called such-and-such, has received full ordination from both Saṅghas. The community of nuns hereby grants full ordination to this one called such-and-such with the preceptress called such-and-such from both Saṅghas. If both Saṅghas have granted full ordination to this one called such-and-such with the preceptress called such-and-such and both Saṅghas consent and

agree, let the venerable ones remain silent. Those who do not consent should speak. This is the wording of the first act. In the same way, the wording of the act is to be spoken a second time and a third time."

Such-and-such, with the preceptress called such-and-such, has received full ordination from both Saṅghas. Since both Saṅghas consent and agree and remain silent, it is accepted as so.

Then the shadow is to be measured. Since the nuns were measuring the shadow with a long measuring rod, the Blessed One declared that one should not measure the shadow with a long rod. And since they measured with the foot, the Blessed One declared that one should not measure with the foot. One should measure with a wooden rod of four finger-widths. The span of that rod shall be called a person's measure. After that, you should know the seasons. There are the winter season, the spring season, the summer season, the end of the rains retreat, and the long season. The winter season is four months. The spring season is four months. The summer season is one month. The end of the rains retreat is one day. The long season is three months less one night. You should also know the times of day: first dawn, middle dawn, last dawn, before sunrise, at sunrise, one-eighth of the day after sunrise, one-quarter of the day after sunrise, before midday, at midday, past midday, the afternoon quarter, the afternoon eighth, at sunset, before sunset, before the stars rise, and when the stars rise.

Then the three foundations are to be spoken. "You who are called such-and-such, listen. The Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the fully and perfectly awakened Buddha, knowing and seeing, declared these three foundations to a nun who has gone forth and received full ordination. If a nun abides in these, she, having gone forth and received full ordination in the well-taught Dharma and Vinaya, shall become truly established as a nun. What are the three? The first is dust-heap robes within the class of Dharma-robes — that which is permitted and fitting. If one abides in this, a nun, having gone forth and received full ordination in the well-taught Dharma and Vinaya and thereby becoming truly established as a nun, may by means of dust-heap robes be content. Venerable one called such-and-such, do you accept this as sufficient from this day forward for as long as you live?" She should respond, "I accept." If one obtains more, the additional acceptable robes are: silk, cotton, coarse cloth, bark-cloth, linen, hempen cloth, cotton cloth called ami-la, so-mi-la, a woven fabric the color of a lac-insect resembling the color of a crimson worm, fine Kāśī cloth, fine zarma cloth, fine wool called dugulaka, and

fine cotton cloth called kotampaka. Whatever other suitable robe-material one obtains, whether from the Saṅgha or from an individual, from these you should take what you need and be satisfied. Do you take a solemn vow regarding such a foundation?" She should respond, "I also take a solemn vow."

"You who are called such-and-such, listen. Within the class of food, alms-food is what is permitted and fitting. If one abides in this, a nun, having gone forth and received full ordination in the well-taught Dharma and Vinaya, shall become truly established as a nun. Do you, called such-and-such, accept alms-food as sufficient from this day forward for as long as you live?" She should respond, "I accept." If one obtains more, additional allowable foods are: cooked rice, sour gruel, porridge, regular meals, meals to which one is invited, meals offered on the spot, prepared foods, the festival of the fifth, the eighth-day meal, the fourteenth-day meal, and the festival of the fifteenth. Whatever other suitable alms-food one obtains, whether from the Saṅgha or from an individual — from these too you should take what you need and be satisfied. "Do you take a vow regarding such a foundation?" She should respond, "I take a vow."

"You who are called such-and-such, listen. The permissible medicines are those that have been boiled and then discarded. If you abide by this foundation, you will become a fully ordained nun — one who has gone forth and received full ordination in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya. You who are called such-and-such, do you from this day forward for as long as you live take a vow of contentment with medicines that have been boiled and cast away?" She should respond, "I accept." If one obtains more, additional allowable medicines are: butter, oil, honey, molasses, root medicines, trunk medicines, leaf medicines, flower medicines, fruit medicines, those taken in the morning, those taken in the evening, those taken on the seventh day, and those taken for life. Whatever other suitable medicines of this kind one obtains — whether from the Saṅgha or from an individual — from these too you should take what you need and be satisfied. "Do you take a vow regarding such a foundation?" She should respond, "I take a vow."

"You who are called such-and-such, listen. The Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened Buddha, having known and seen, proclaimed eight grounds of defeat for nuns who have gone forth and received full ordination. If a nun commits any one of them — the very instant she commits and enacts it — she is no longer a nun, no longer a female renunciant, no longer a daughter of the Śākyas. She loses the status of a nun

and loses the status of a female renunciant. She is gone, expelled, fallen, defeated — one who has incurred a defeat — and she cannot be reinstated as a female renunciant. It is like the top of a palm tree that has been cut down: it cannot grow green again, cannot sprout, cannot grow, cannot increase. There is no possibility of its ever growing tall again. In exactly the same way, if a nun commits any one of those eight grounds — if she commits and enacts any one of those eight grounds — the very instant she commits and enacts it, she is no longer a nun, no longer a female renunciant, no longer a daughter of the Śākya. She loses the status of a nun and loses the status of a female renunciant. She is gone, expelled, fallen, defeated — one who has incurred a defeat — and she cannot be reinstated as a female renunciant.

"You who are called such-and-such, listen. What are the eight? The Blessed One, in numerous categories, has blamed sensual desire, calling it clinging, attachment, intention, fondness, dwelling, certainty, and deep infatuation; while renouncing sensual desire he has praised, extolled, commended, proclaimed, encouraged, glorified, and declared it as something to be specially praised — returning it, exhausting it, being free of attachment, being noble, being thoroughly pacified, being extinguished. You who are called such-and-such — even if, from this day forward, with a mind of attachment you were to gaze eye-to-eye at a man with a desirous mind and not look away, how much more so would it be to engage with him in the act of unchaste conduct, the act of sexual intercourse. The Blessed One has also declared: if a nun, without having surrendered her training or declared her training to be weak, and without having formally prepared the ground — even with one born in an animal realm — commits the act of unchaste conduct, the act of sexual intercourse in any such circumstance whatsoever, and if a nun commits and enacts it, the very instant she commits and enacts it, she is no longer a nun, no longer a female renunciant, no longer a daughter of the Śākya. She loses the status of a nun; she loses the status of a female renunciant. She is gone, expelled, fallen, defeated — one who has incurred a defeat — and she cannot be reinstated as a nun. It is like the top of a palm tree that has been cut down: it cannot grow green again."

It cannot grow green again, it cannot flourish and spread. In just the same way, if a nun commits and enacts such a circumstance as this, the very instant she commits and enacts it, she is no longer a nun, no longer a female renunciant, no longer a daughter of the Śākya. She loses the status of a nun; she loses the status of a female renunciant. She is gone, expelled, fallen,

defeated — and she cannot be reinstated as a female renunciant.

Therefore, from this day forth, you are to take up with enthusiasm the refraining from this act, the not committing of it, the not engaging in it, and the giving it up entirely. Guard your mind. Be mindful, be heedful, be diligent. Ask whether she refrains from such a thing as this, and let her say that she does refrain from it.

Now, you whose name is so-and-so, listen. The Blessed One has, in many categories, condemned the taking of what is not given. The giving up of taking what is not given he has praised, encouraged, extolled, and proclaimed. Therefore, from this day forth, you whose name is so-and-so, even if you would not take so much as a sesame husk that belongs to another without stealing intent — to say nothing of five māśas or more than five māśas, as the Blessed One has taught — if a nun, whether dwelling in a village or in a remote place, takes by theft what is known to belong to another, to whatever amount, and is on that account seized by a king or his minister and killed, or bound, or expelled, and they say to her: "You are a thief, you are a fool, you are ignorant, you are a thief" — if she commits and enacts such a circumstance as this, the very instant she commits and enacts it, she is no longer a nun, no longer a female renunciant, no longer a daughter of the Śākyas — and all the rest as before, up to: be mindful, be heedful, be diligent. Ask whether she refrains from such a thing as this, and let her say that she does refrain from it.

Now, you whose name is so-and-so, listen. The Blessed One has, in many categories, condemned the taking of life. The giving up of taking life he has praised, encouraged, extolled, and proclaimed. Therefore, you whose name is so-and-so, from this day forth, even if you would not intentionally deprive even an insect of its life — to say nothing of a human being or one who has come to be in a human body — as the Blessed One has taught: if any nun, whether in regard to a human being or one who has come to be in a human body, intentionally deprives that person of life with her own hand, or provides a weapon for that purpose, or procures a weapon for that purpose, or urges that person toward death, or praises the virtues of death, saying to him: "O man, living as you do in such sinful, impure, wretched circumstances — what is the use of living? For you, sir, death is better than life" — thinking this in her mind, if she urges him toward death in many ways with this thought fixed in her mind, or if she praises the virtues of death, and by such means that person dies — then if a nun commits and enacts such a circumstance as this, the very instant she commits and enacts it, she is no longer a nun, no longer a female

renunciant, no longer a daughter of the Śākyas, and she loses the status of a nun — and all the rest as before, up to: be mindful, be heedful, and be diligent. Ask whether she refrains from such a thing as this, and let her say that she does refrain from it.

Now, you whose name is so-and-so, listen. False speech the Blessed One has, in many categories, condemned. The giving up of false speech he has praised, encouraged, extolled, and proclaimed. Therefore, you whose name is so-and-so, listen: even for the sake of play as a child, one should not knowingly speak falsehood —

— how much more so to falsely claim, as though one possessed it when one does not, the superhuman Dharma of one's spiritual teachers. The Blessed One has declared: Moreover, whatever nun does not directly know, does not comprehensively know, and does not possess — yet falsely claims, as though she possessed it when she does not, to have realized, to have seen, or to have attained contact with the noble distinction that is the superhuman Dharma of one's spiritual teachers — and when asked what she knows, says "I know this, I see this" — if what she claims to know is: "I know suffering, I know the origin of suffering, I know cessation, I know the path" — and if what she claims to see is: "I see gods; I see nāgas, yakṣas, garuḍas (Skt. garuḍa), gandharvas (Skt. gandharva), kinnaras (Skt. kinnara), great serpents, flesh-eaters, hungry ghosts, kumbhāṇḍas (Skt. kumbhāṇḍa), and putrefying bodies. The gods see me; the nāgas, yakṣas, garuḍas, gandharvas, kinnaras, great serpents, flesh-eaters, hungry ghosts, kumbhāṇḍas, and putrefying bodies also see me. I hear the voices of gods; I hear the voices of nāgas, yakṣas, garuḍas, gandharvas, kinnaras, great serpents, flesh-eaters, hungry ghosts, kumbhāṇḍas, and putrefying bodies also hear my voice. I go to visit gods; I go to visit nāgas, yakṣas, garuḍas, gandharvas, kinnaras, great serpents, flesh-eaters, hungry ghosts, kumbhāṇḍas, and putrefying bodies. Gods come to visit me; nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, garuḍas, kinnaras, great serpents, flesh-eaters, hungry ghosts, kumbhāṇḍas, and putrefying bodies also come to visit me. I converse with gods, converse with all of them, delight in each of them, and constantly dwell together with them. The nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, garuḍas, kinnaras, great serpents, flesh-eaters, hungry ghosts, kumbhāṇḍas, and putrefying bodies converse with me, converse with me about everything, delight in me, and constantly dwell together with me. Gods

converse with me, converse with me about everything, delight in me, and constantly dwell together with me. The nāgas, yakṣas, garuḍas, gandharvas, great serpents, kinnaras, flesh-eaters, hungry ghosts, kumbhāṇḍas, and putrefying bodies also constantly converse with me about everything, delight in me, and constantly dwell together with me" —

— and if, without having attained it, she says "I have attained the perception of impermanence," or perceives what is impermanent as suffering, perceives what is suffering as selfless, perceives food as disagreeable, perceives the entire world as something to be disenchanted with, perceives it as a basis for recognizing faults, perceives it as something to be abandoned, perceives it as separation from attachment, perceives it as cessation, perceives it as death, perceives it as impure, perceives it as turning livid, perceives it as festering, perceives it as decaying, perceives it as being devoured by worms, perceives it as bloated, perceives it as eaten away, perceives it as red and bloody, perceives it as scattered, perceives it as a heap of bones, perceives it individually as emptiness — and without having attained it she says "I have attained" the first meditative concentration, the second, the third, the fourth, loving-kindness,

compassion, joy, equanimity, the base of infinite space, the base of infinite consciousness, the base of nothingness, and the base of neither-perception-nor-non-perception — and without having attained it she says "I have attained" the fruit of stream-entry, the fruit of once-return, the fruit of non-return, the divine eye, the divine ear, knowledge of others' minds, recollection of former lives, knowledge of death and rebirth, exhaustion of the outflows, arhatship, cultivation of the eight liberations, and liberation from both aspects — if a nun engages in and carries out conduct of such a kind, the moment she has so engaged and carried it out, she is no longer a nun, no longer a female contemplative, no longer a daughter of the Śākyan. She will have lost the substance of a nun and the substance of a female contemplative. She is without it. She is expelled. She has incurred a downfall. It is a defeat. She cannot be restored to the state of a female contemplative. It is like the top of a palm tree that has been cut: it cannot turn green again, cannot sprout again, cannot grow and spread. In the same way, if a nun engages in and carries out conduct of such a kind, the moment she has so engaged and carried it out, she is no longer a nun, no longer a female contemplative, no longer a daughter of the Śākyan. She will have lost the substance of a nun and the substance of a female contemplative. She is without it. She is expelled.

She has incurred a downfall. It is a defeat. She cannot be restored to the state of a female contemplative.

Therefore, from this day forward, you should refrain from such conduct, not fall into such engagement, and with swift and earnest resolve to abandon such conduct, guard your mind, be mindful, be heedful, and be diligent. If there is anyone who does not engage in conduct of this kind, or who says "I do not engage in it," then announce: "Let she who bears such-and-such a name hear this."

The Blessed One has declared: if a nun, acting out of attachment and having become attached, takes pleasure in touching and fully contacting from the waist down to the knee together with a man who is born — if a nun engages in and carries out conduct of such a kind, the moment she has so engaged and carried it out, she is no longer a nun, no longer a female contemplative, no longer a daughter of the Śākyan — from that point up to and including the injunction that she should refrain from such engagement, and with swift resolve to abandon such conduct, guard her mind, be mindful, be heedful, and be diligent. If there is anyone who does not engage in conduct of this kind, or who says "I do not engage in it," then announce: "Let she who bears such-and-such a name hear this."

The Blessed One has declared: if a nun, acting with attachment and having become attached, together with a man exchanges words of flattery, plays, laughs, shows pride, runs, makes bodily contact, exposes herself at an appointed time or on an impulse, sets up a signal, or whether the man comes or goes takes pleasure in it — if she is such a one, leans her body toward him, and has become subject to a man in that manner, being endowed with those eight such qualities, and a nun engages in and carries out conduct of such a kind, the moment she has so engaged and carried it out, she is no longer a nun, no longer a female contemplative, no longer a daughter of the Śākyan — up to the point where she should refrain from such engagement, and with swift resolve to abandon such conduct, guard her mind, be mindful, be heedful, and be diligent. If there is anyone who does not engage in conduct of this kind, or who says "I do not engage in it," then announce: "Let she who bears such-and-such a name hear this."

The Blessed One has declared: if a nun knows that another nun has previously committed a defeat and no longer remains in good standing, and when that nun has died, or has returned to lay life, or

has fled to another district — after that, she should speak thus: "Noble ones, I previously knew that such-and-such a nun had committed a defeat and no longer remained in good standing." If she then acts and conducts herself in a manner befitting that same category of offense — that same conduct involving the transgression of a nun — then the moment she so acts and conducts herself accordingly, she is no longer a nun, no longer a female contemplative, no longer a daughter of the Śākya, and so on as before, up to the point where she should refrain from such engagement, and with swift resolve to abandon such conduct, guard her mind, be mindful, be heedful, and be diligent. If there is anyone who does not engage in conduct of this kind, or who says "I do not engage in it," then announce: "Let she who bears such-and-such a name hear this."

The Blessed One has also declared: if a nun knows that a certain monk has performed an act for which he is to be expelled by the assembled Saṅgha of monks, and the assembled Saṅgha of nuns has also imposed a vow of not paying homage to him — and yet, while that monk is lying down with his hair unbound, she goes to prostrate herself before the Saṅgha by lying flat, bowing down with her body stretched out; she prepares to rise; she shows readiness to make obeisance; she sits within his boundary and requests his approval — and all this she does knowingly — then she should be told the following: "Noble one, do not lie prostrate with your hair unbound, and do not, while rising, prostrate yourself before the Saṅgha by stretching out flat. Do not prepare to rise. Do not show readiness to make obeisance. Do not sit within the boundary and request approval. I will see to it that your alms-bowl, your robes, your strainer, your cup, your waist-band, your reading, your recitation, your meditative mental engagement, and whatever else concerns you, noble one — all of these I will arrange so that they are not left unattended." The nuns should then instruct that nun in these words: "Noble sister, that monk has performed an act for which the assembled Saṅgha expelled him, and the assembled Saṅgha of nuns has also imposed upon him a vow of not receiving homage. Yet that monk, while lying down with his hair unbound, has others prostrate themselves before the Saṅgha by stretching out flat; he prepares to rise; he shows readiness to make obeisance; he sits within the boundary and requests approval — all this knowingly. Noble sister, do not speak to him thus: 'Noble one, do not lie prostrate with your hair unbound, and do not, while rising, prostrate yourself before the Saṅgha by stretching out flat. Do not prepare to rise. Do not show readiness to make obeisance. Do not sit within

the boundary and request approval. I will see to all of this for you — your alms-bowl, your robes, your strainer, your cup, your waist-band, your reading, your recitation, your meditative mental engagement, and whatever else concerns you, noble one — all of these I will arrange so that they are not left unattended.' Noble sister, abandon the words and the course that follow from what has been abandoned, and let go of that path." If the nuns admonish that nun in this way and she abandons the matter, that is good. But if she does not abandon it, she should be admonished and instructed a second and a third time. If after being admonished and instructed a second and third time for the purpose of causing her to abandon the matter she does abandon it, that is good. But if she does not abandon it, and instead follows after what the nun has abandoned and conducts herself in a manner befitting that same category of offense, then the moment she so conducts herself, she is no longer a nun, no longer a female contemplative, no longer a daughter of the Śākyan, and so on as before, up to the point where with swift resolve to abandon such conduct she should guard her mind, be mindful, be heedful, and be diligent. If there is anyone who does not engage in conduct of this kind, or who says "I do not engage in it," then announce: "Let she who bears such-and-such a name hear this."

These eight are the chief rules (Skt. *gurudharma*) that the Blessed One — knowing and seeing, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha — has laid down for women who have gone forth and received full ordination as nuns, in order to restrain them and prevent transgression. Women are to train in these for as long as they live.

What are the eight? She who bears such-and-such a name, being a woman who has gone forth and received full ordination among the monks and thereby become established in the substance of nunhood, should clearly understand this. She who bears such-and-such a name: the Blessed One has laid down, as the first chief rule for women in order to restrain them and prevent transgression, that women are to train in this for as long as they live. Nuns are to seek, every fortnight, the instruction that shows them the teaching from the community of monks. She who bears such-and-such a name: the Blessed One has laid down, as the second chief rule for women in order to restrain them and prevent transgression, that women are to train in this for as long as they live. A nun must not enter the rains retreat in a place where there are no monks. She who bears such-and-such a name: the Blessed One has laid down, as the third chief rule for women in order to restrain them and prevent

transgression, that women are to train in this for as long as they live. When a nun has emerged from the rains retreat, she must make the invitation ceremony before both communities in three respects: what was seen, what was heard, and what was suspected. She who bears such-and-such a name: the Blessed One has laid down, as the fourth chief rule for women in order to restrain them and prevent transgression, that women are to train in this for as long as they live. A nun must not speak of, or make mention of, a monk's lapse in moral discipline, lapse in view, lapse in conduct, or lapse in livelihood. A nun who speaks of or makes mention of a monk's lapse in moral discipline, lapse in view, lapse in conduct, or lapse in livelihood is not permitted to do so. A monk, however, is permitted to speak of and make mention of a nun's lapse in moral discipline, lapse in view, lapse in conduct, or lapse in livelihood. This is what the Blessed One has laid down for she who bears such-and-such a name, as the fifth chief rule for women in order to restrain them and prevent transgression, and women are to train in this for as long as they live. A nun must not speak harshly to a monk, must not be angry toward him, and must not upbraid him. A nun who speaks harshly to a monk, who is angry toward him, or who upbraids him, is not permitted to do so. She who bears such-and-such a name: the Blessed One has laid down, as the sixth chief rule for women in order to restrain them and prevent transgression, that women are to train in this for as long as they live. If a nun has incurred a chief rule, she must perform the probationary practice before both communities for a fortnight. She who bears such-and-such a name: the Blessed One has laid down, as the seventh chief rule for women in order to restrain them and prevent transgression, that women are to train in this for as long as they live. A nun who has been fully ordained for a hundred years must pay courteous respect, offer praise, rise, join her palms in reverence, and bow down before a monk who has only just then received full ordination. She who bears such-and-such a name: the Blessed One has laid down, as the eighth chief rule for women in order to restrain them and prevent transgression, that women are to train in this for as long as they live.

"Have you received and will you observe these eight chief rules?" "I will observe them." "She who bears such-and-such a name, listen. The Blessed One has connected the following four, just as the preceding ones, until they are known by a perfectly awakened buddha. What are the four? From this day forward, she who bears such-and-such a name: do not speak back against one who has spoken ill of you; do not be angry in return against one who is angry

with you; do not strike back against one who has struck you; do not revile in return one who has reviled you.

She who bears such-and-such a name, listen. You formerly wished, saying: 'May I go forth and receive full ordination in this well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, and may I come to the full status of a nun.' That wish is now fulfilled: you have gone forth and received full ordination, with a preceptress endowed with moral discipline, an ācārya endowed with moral discipline, and both communities of the Saṅgha assembled, by means of the motion and the fourfold act, without anything to be done and without anything to be set aside. You have gone forth and received full ordination.

She who bears such-and-such a name, listen. The training that a nun who has been fully ordained for a hundred years observes — that same training must also be observed by one who has been fully ordained just today. And the training that one who has been fully ordained just today observes must also be observed by one who has been fully ordained for a hundred years. You who are equal in moral discipline, equal in training, and equal in the recitation of the Prātimokṣa sūtra — from this day forward you must give satisfaction to each other, and must not give dissatisfaction to each other. From this day forward you must regard your preceptress as a mother, and your preceptress must likewise regard you as a daughter. From this day forward you must attend upon your preceptress for as long as you live, and your preceptress must likewise attend upon you for as long as you live. From this day forward you, reverencing with fear and living a holy life equal to that of your teacher, must show courtesy to senior nuns, nuns of middle standing, and newly ordained nuns alike.

She who bears such-and-such a name, from this day forward receive scriptural transmission, learn by heart, and recite. Become skilled in the aggregates (skandhas), skilled in the elements (dhātus), skilled in the sense bases (āyatana), skilled in dependent origination, skilled in what is a proper case and what is not. Do not relax your diligence toward attaining what has not yet been attained, realizing what has not yet been realized, and manifesting what has not yet been manifested. These things I have set forth to you as the basis of training in what is great and foremost. All the rest your ācārya, your preceptress, your co-ācārya, your co-preceptress, your speaker, your general speaker, your praiser, and your friend will likewise teach you. Every fortnight, listen to the reading of the Prātimokṣa sūtra."

In this way, upon full ordination:

You are now fully ordained
in the supreme teaching of wisdom.

A precious human opportunity, so hard to find —
do not be disheartened by it.

You went forth from what is good,
received full ordination from what is pure.

The buddha called Satya,
having fully known this, has declared it so.

"She who bears such-and-such a name, having received full ordination,
conduct yourself with heedfulness."

The origin of this rule is at Śrāvastī. At that time, when the Blessed One, the Buddha, had given full ordination and the status of nuns to Gautamī, the Great Progenitress, and to the five hundred Śākya women who came with her, accepting the chief rules as their vow — at that very time those women gave full ordination and the going-forth as nuns to other women as well. And those in turn gave it to yet others. In this way the community of nuns became numerous and continued to grow. Then the elder monks and elder nuns went to where Gautamī, the Great Progenitress, was, approached her, and addressed her as follows.

"Alas! These elder nuns — those monks who are newly ordained, who are of middle standing, or who are juniors who have not been long since ordained, they should salute one another in order of seniority." When these words were spoken, Gautamī, the Great Progenitress, said to those nuns: "Sisters, wait here. I shall go and ask the noble Ānanda, and it shall be done accordingly." And so Gautamī, the Great Progenitress, went and spoke to the venerable Ānanda. When she had spoken, the venerable Ānanda said to Gautamī, the Great Progenitress: "Gautamī, wait here. I shall go and ask the Blessed One." And having said this, he went to where the Blessed One was. Upon arriving, he bowed his head to the feet of the Blessed One and sat down to one side.

Seated to one side, the venerable Ānanda addressed the Blessed One: "Alas, Blessed One! Among these elder monks and elder nuns, those monks who are newly ordained, who are of middle standing, or who are juniors not long since ordained — it is said they should not salute one another in order of seniority. How is this to be?" The Blessed One then declared to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, do not speak such words again. And why? If, Ānanda, women had not

gone forth into the well-taught Dharma and Vinaya, then devout brahmins and householders would still fill begging bowls with alms and offer them warm to the monks. If, Ānanda, women had not gone forth into the well-taught Dharma and Vinaya, then devout brahmins and householders would lay down fine uncut cloth with long fringes in the road and say: 'Monks, please walk upon this cloth with the long fringes that we have spread out; this will be for our long-lasting benefit, welfare, and happiness.' If, Ānanda, women had not gone forth into the well-taught Dharma and Vinaya, then devout brahmins and householders would scatter upon the ground the finest hair grown on their limbs and say: 'Monks, please walk upon this hair; this will be for our long-lasting benefit, welfare, and happiness.' If, Ānanda, women had not gone forth into the well-taught Dharma and Vinaya, the radiance of my śrāvakas — who, being of great power and great miraculous ability, would outshine the moon and sun — how much more would they outshine the tīrthikas! If, Ānanda, women had not gone forth into the well-taught Dharma and Vinaya, my teaching would have remained for a full thousand years, without fault and without decline.

Therefore, Ānanda, let even a nun who has been fully ordained for a hundred years perform acts of respectful greeting, praise, rising, joining the palms together, paying homage, and so forth toward a monk who has just been fully ordained."

The setting was at Śrāvastī. Among the nuns there are deeds to be performed by an assembly of four, deeds to be performed by an assembly of five, and deeds to be performed by an assembly of twelve. These became numerous deeds to be performed before the assembled community of both orders. Carrying out so many deeds became an obstacle to teaching, reciting, chanting, yoga, and mental practice. The monks who were in that situation informed the Blessed One, and the Blessed One permitted the deeds of full ordination and

apart from the deeds to be performed in common, the deeds of the monk-fathers are to be performed separately, and the nuns are likewise to perform theirs separately." This was declared by the Blessed One.

The setting was at Śrāvastī. At that time in Śrāvastī there was a certain householder who had taken a wife of equal rank and lived with her in pleasure and delight. Through their pleasurable and delightful life together, after some time his wife conceived, and nine months having passed, she gave birth to a

daughter. The very moment she was born, the father passed away. The mother raised her and brought her up, and when the girl had grown, the mother too passed away. Then some time later, the nun Sthulanandā was out on her alms round and happened to see the girl on a street. She asked, "Girl, whose are you?" The girl replied, "Noble one, I belong to no one — I have no protector." Sthulanandā said, "If that is so, girl, why do you not go forth into the religious life?" The girl asked, "Who would give me the going-forth?" Sthulanandā said, "I will give you the going-forth, girl — come along." "Excellent," said the girl, and she went with her to Sthulanandā's dwelling, where Sthulanandā gave her the going-forth. But the girl, tormented by affliction, later disrobed. Sthulanandā was again out on her alms round, and when she saw the girl she asked, "How are you living, girl?" The girl bowed at her feet and said, "Noble one, I live in suffering." Sthulanandā said, "If that is so, girl, why do you not again go forth?" The girl said, "Noble one, who would give the going-forth to one who has once disrobed?" Sthulanandā said, "Shall I give you the going-forth again, girl?" "Excellent," the girl replied. So Sthulanandā ordained her again, and when the girl went out on the alms round, the brahmins and householders who saw her mocked her, saying: "The female disciples of the Śākya monks practice the holy life wearily, wearily — they practice the Dharma while worn out." The nuns, having witnessed this, told the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One reflected: "The fault that has come into view here is that nuns who have disrobed are being ordained again. Therefore, intending that nuns who have disrobed should not be ordained again," he declared to the monks: "Monks, the brahmins and householders mock them with reason. Therefore, a nun who has once disrobed, being without power, shall not be given the going-forth by a nun. If she is given the going-forth, there is an offense."

This is the basis in the Vinaya of minor matters, the thirty-eighth fascicle.

In summary:

She who sneers and lusts greatly,
who reviles and mocks again —
the nun who mocks the monk:
she is a nun, a novice nun.

The Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada (the benefactor of the unprotected). At that time in the town of Khormo Jig there was a householder named Gautama, wealthy, of great

possessions and resources. He had taken a wife of equal rank and lived with her in pleasure and delight. At one point he loaded up goods and went to the village of Donjog, where he visited the house of another householder. That householder greeted him with words of welcome and they rested. Through mutual affection that householder of Donjog and the householder Gautama became friends. The householder Gautama sold his goods, took up his return goods, and went back to the city of Khormo Jig. The householder of Donjog too, at a later time, loaded up goods and came to Khormo Jig, and likewise went to the householder Gautama's home.

He greeted him with words of welcome and delight, saying, "Have you come in comfort?" and they rested. The two of them grew deeply fond of one another. The householder of Donjog said to the householder Gautama, "Friend, after the two of us have passed on, what means is there to ensure that the friendship between our children, grandchildren, great-grandchildren, and great-great-grandchildren will never be broken?" Gautama replied, "Friend, well said — I have been thinking the very same thing. Therefore, let us betroth them before any children are even born. If a son is born to me and a daughter to you, you shall give her to my son; and if a son is born to you and a daughter to me, I shall give her to your son." The other replied, "Friend, excellent — let it be so." And so the householder of Donjog and the householder Gautama pledged to one another that they would betroth their children before any were born. Then the householder of Donjog sold his goods, took up his return goods, and went back to Donjog. There he lived with his wife in pleasure and delight, and after some time his wife conceived. When eight or nine months had passed, she gave birth to a boy. For twenty-one days — three sets of seven — a great birth-feast was held in lavish celebration, and the child was given a name befitting his family lineage. When the householder of Khormo Jig heard that a son had been born to the householder of Donjog, he thought, "My friend has had a son, and that boy may well become my son-in-law, so it is fitting that I send him clothes and ornaments." He sent the child clothes and ornaments, and wrote a letter to the householder of Donjog saying, "Friend, I have heard that a son has been born to you. I am overjoyed that my friend has had a son, and I send these clothes and ornaments for the boy — please accept them." The other read the letter and sent a reply, and the householder Gautama read it, hoping that a daughter would be born to him, and continued to live with his wife in pleasure and delight. As they lived thus in pleasure and delight, his wife conceived, and when nine months had passed, she gave birth

to a daughter. The girl was beautiful and lovely to behold, yet she was somewhat thin and slight of build. For twenty-one days — three sets of seven — a great birth-feast was held in lavish celebration, and they turned to the matter of giving the child a name. They asked, "What shall this girl be called?" The relatives replied, "This girl is thin and slight, and she is the daughter of the householder Gautama — therefore let this girl's name be Gauthami the Thin." When the householder of Donjog heard that the householder Gautama of Khormo Jig had had a daughter, he thought, "My friend has had a daughter, and that girl is surely destined to become my daughter-in-law — it is right that I send her clothes and ornaments." He wrote to the householder Gautama: "Friend, I have heard that a daughter has been born to you. I am greatly delighted that my friend has had a daughter, and I send these clothes and ornaments for her — please accept them." The householder Gautama read the letter and wrote back in reply: "What our dear friend has done is excellent. We made this alliance before the children were born, and now that a daughter has been born she shall be taken as bride." The householder Gautama then read that letter, and he had the girl instructed in the training proper for women. Likewise, the householder of Donjog had his son instructed in his training, and entrusted the boy's education to women who had formerly lived as courtesans, saying, "Let this girl be taught her proper training."

She began instructing him. When she had taught him with words for some time, he said, "I have learned my lessons — now I shall go." The woman said, "My son, learn them well. Do not go yet." He replied, "Mother, I have learned them well. I am going." She picked up a bundle of lac and said, "If you insist on going and leaving me behind, I will strike myself on the head." He said, "Mother, do not do that — I will not go," and he stayed.

Then she said, "Wretch! You claim to have learned your lessons from me, yet you do not even know this much — you would strike your own head for the sake of another's son. You are no person of sense. Stay until such time as you say, 'Mother, I will go.'" He agreed to stay a while longer.

When he still insisted on going, she said, "If you are so set on going and leaving me behind, I will throw myself into a well." He said, "Mother, if that is so, I will not go — please do not do it," and he stayed.

Again she said, "Wretch! You claim to have learned your lessons from me, yet you do not even know this much — why would you throw yourself into a well for the sake of another's son? If you cannot stay, then I myself can sit by a well

with its rope and pulley and stay there. You are no person of sense. Stay." He agreed to stay a while longer.

Then she said, "Son, since time drags on like this while you sit here, cook some porridge, drink it, and be on your way." He stayed, and she cooked the porridge and set it before him. Into the bowl she put butter and honey, he drank it, and then vomited it back into the very same bowl. She poured it back into the same cup and said, "Son, come here — drink this." He said, "Mother, this is vomit — how can I drink it?" She pretended to weep, and when the neighbors heard her they all gathered and asked, "Why are you crying?" She told them everything in detail, and they said to the boy, "She prepared this porridge for your sake — why will you not drink it?" He said, "But this is vomit — how can one drink vomit?" He turned away, beat his chest, and sat there weeping.

The neighbors began saying, "Why did she vomit into it?" The neighboring households of that area pressed the boy hard, and he began to drink. At that moment she seized him by the hand, slapped him across the face, and declared: "Wretch! You claim to have learned your lessons from me — how have you learned them? Even though you saw with your own eyes that it was vomit, you were about to drink it. You are no person of sense." With that, she drove him out and sent him away.

Some time later he set out with five hundred merchants, carrying goods to trade, and went into the middle of a district. In front of those merchants he kept slandering women, one occasion after another. They then went in a group to the Āvantī quarter. Now, those merchants had previously enjoyed themselves freely and consorted with the courtesans there. But because of their association with him they too began speaking ill of women and stopped going to any courtesan's house. The courtesans then took counsel with one another.

One of the courtesans spoke up: "Distinguished friends, merchants from the district of Roḍa used to come here and consort with us freely. Now they have all become dispassionate and not one of them consorts with us anymore." Another said: "Distinguished friend, I have heard that the caravan leader of that group is very skilled in the rites of seduction and deals with women most adeptly. Because of their association with him, they all refuse to consort with us." Then an old courtesan among them said: "Girls, is that person a man, or is he not?" They replied: "Distinguished friend, he is a man — fully possessed of

a man's faculties." She said: "If that is so, can you arrange for my daughter to win him over — and if she succeeds, will you make her your madam?" They said: "It would not be fitting for that." She then said: "If she cannot win him over, what will you give?" She replied: "I will give you five hundred kārṣāpaṇas." They said: "Excellent! Let it be so."

The old woman then rented a house near them and gathered there a great many vessels and household goods. The caravan leader's boys came and visited, and they borrowed the vessels. She asked them: "Boys, who are you?" They replied: "Mother, we are the boys of the caravan leader from the district of Roḍa." She said: "Boys, my own son too is a caravan leader. He has taken his goods and gone to another district, and I thought that his boys, just as you do now, must be borrowing vessels from others in the same way. Therefore, all the vessels and household goods here in this house — use them all just as you wish, as though they were your own." From then on they came each day and took the vessels.

One day the caravan leader asked them: "Who gives you vessels and utensils every day?" They told him: "Caravan leader, there is a certain mother of a caravan leader staying here. She says: 'My son too has taken his goods and gone to another district, and his boys will certainly be borrowing vessels from others just as you do — therefore, all the vessels and household goods in this house, use them all as you please, just as if they were your own.' That is what she tells us, and so we come and borrow vessels and goods each day." When the caravan leader heard this, affection arose in him, and he said: "If you are on such friendly terms with her, then she is like a mother to me as well."

The boys said to him: "Caravan leader, she speaks of your good qualities in the highest terms. She says that one who is so well matched with you is like a mother to her too." The old woman replied: "Boys, is it not fine to meet one's child?" And they said: "Mother, we will do well by the caravan leader." Then they said to him: "Caravan leader, our mother wishes to come and visit you." He replied: "Excellent! Please go ahead," and so she went to his house.

She greeted him with a pleasant and welcoming form of address, saying: "Have you arrived comfortably?" and added: "My own son is just like you." He in turn told her his name. She said: "His name too is the same. In short, you and he are both my sons without any difference — do not think of yourself as a stranger." He replied: "Mother, if that is so, then it is just as you say — I am he, and I am no different from your son."

The wife of the householder then called her daughter over, saying: "Daughter, come here! Pay your respects to your elder brother." When the girl came out she was of the right age, and when he saw that her beauty was in full bloom and that she was lovely, the force of passion struck him like a gust of wind, and he found himself overcome before he could even take notice of it himself.

He gazed at her intently and asked: "Mother, who does this girl belong to?" She replied: "Son, she is your very own sister." He asked: "Mother, have you given her to someone else or not?" She said: "Son, I have not given her to anyone at all." He said: "If that is so, then why will you not give her to me?" She replied: "Son, to whom else would I give her if not to you? Though there is one small fault in you: you are unsteady in your friendships — you take a wife and then abandon her and leave." He said: "Mother, please grant her to me, and I will bring her along with me to high places and low alike, and will not abandon her." She said: "Son, if you were to deposit all your goods and possessions here first, then she could be confident that you would indeed take her along everywhere, high station and low." He said: "Mother, if that is what is required, then so be it." When he deposited the goods at her house — and that house had two doors — he brought them in through one door, but she was removing them out through the second door. Once he had deposited all his wealth and goods, she had removed them entirely through the other side, and only then did she give him the girl.

He arranged an auspicious day and date, and when the time came to receive his bride, she invited all the prostitutes, adorned with every kind of ornament, as the guests. While he was receiving his bride and the two were moving about and mingling together, the caravan leader said: "Mother, is it that among everyone here there is not a single man?" He was told. Then someone drew close to his ear and whispered: "Did you not know that the caravan leader had come to this? All of us here are prostitutes — where would there be a man?" Hearing this he thought to himself: "It seems I have taken a prostitute as my wife. In short, I have been deceived." Then the girl said: "I and he shall enjoy ourselves together for as long as we may — but master, please give me some gold coins." He said: "My good woman, I have deposited every single thing I possessed here. If I come to you now, where would I get other gold coins?" Thereupon he fell fast asleep, and she rolled him up inside a blanket and threw him out in the middle of the marketplace.

In the morning, as dawn broke, the many people who lived in the city came and went, and their movement roused him. When he woke and looked about,

he saw that his own situation was disgraceful, and his mind and the mental factors born of mind collapsed. His eyes filled with tears, and he wandered about the ruined and dilapidated marketplace, through the streets, the crossroads, and the junctions, until hunger tormented him and he went to where the hired laborers gathered, seeking food, and sat down among them.

Now at that time the householder Gautama was building a wall on his house, and he was looking there for laborers. Another man brought him before the householder Gautama. When Gautama saw him he said: "This one is altogether young — far too young. He has never done such work before; he is looking for something else." Even as Gautama spoke, the young man looked back at the householder Gautama's face with eyes still brimming with tears.

The householder Gautama asked him: "Son, whose are you, and where have you come from? Tell me." Pitiably, of low station, and racked with suffering, his eyes filled with tears, and he struggled to speak, his voice breaking: "Father, I am from that city of Droṇa in the north. By the force of past karma I traveled here comfortably enough, but now I have searched everywhere and cannot find where to go, and even if the time comes to pass away destitute and abandoned midway, I cannot find it."

Hearing both his appearance and the train of his words, the householder Gautama felt his heart drawn to him with affection. "Son," he said, "do you know any of the many people who live in Droṇa?" "Father, I do." "Son, do you know one called this householder?" "Father, that is my poor unfortunate father — I know him." The householder Gautama felt yet deeper warmth and fondness rise in his heart and said: "Son, there is no need to be unhappy — do not weep."

"You shall become my son-in-law, and all these houses shall be yours." At these words the young man's spirits lifted, and his unhappiness fell away. The householder Gautama restored him with ointments, food, drink, clothing, ornaments, a house, a bed, and servants, and with words of warm encouragement. Then he spoke to his wife: "Good woman, your son-in-law has come — make ready and send our daughter to him as a bride." The householder had the auspicious day, date, moment, and stellar conjunction examined, and when all was properly arranged, he summoned his brothers, friends, and kinsmen and announced that the daughter should be given in marriage. The young man's father said that the wealth accumulated over a lifetime should not be seized all at once. The young man then said: "All the

wealth there is in this house — all of it is yours. What need is there of wealth?" At this, the courtesan, wishing to take revenge on him, said: "Father, it may be as you say, but I, unlike a low-born woman, will not take a bride." He said nothing further to this. He left the circle of her company, wandered about aimlessly for a time, and eventually went to the riverbank. There a corpse came floating down the river. A crow was sitting on the bank and wished to eat the corpse, but its beak could not reach it. Then the crow rubbed its beak against a small piece of wood, and the beak grew very long, and with it the crow ate the corpse. After that, the crow rubbed its beak on another piece of wood, and things became as they had been before. The caravan leader then picked up those two pieces of wood with his hand and went home. He then took five hundred kārṣāpaṇas and went to the courtesan's house. "Good woman," he said, "you threw me out saying I had no kārṣāpaṇas — now take these kārṣāpaṇas and enjoy them fully, then come back." She, being attached to the money, spent them together with him. Then, as he spent time with her, he rubbed her nose with the second piece of wood, and it grew extremely long. He summoned every physician and had them examine her, but none of them was able to treat it. Thus, abandoned by all the physicians, she implored the caravan leader: "Master, please be patient — please find a cure for this." He replied: "If you vow to return everything you took, then and only then will I act." She said: "Master, I shall restore it all to you twofold." He then rubbed her with the second piece of wood, and just as before it returned to its former state, and she gave back to him everything she had taken. Then the caravan leader united the young woman, the slender Gautamī of great splendor, with himself and took her as his bride. The householder Gautama had a field in another village in the rocky hills, and he said to his son-in-law: "Son, take your wife and go to settle in that village in the rocky hills." He gave him all the fields in the rocky-hills village, and the slender Gautamī mounted a horse and went there to live. Together they enjoyed every pleasure and delight. While they were enjoying those pleasures, after some time had passed, the slender Gautamī became with child, and when the time for giving birth drew near, she said: "Master, the time for giving birth has come — let me go to my kinsmen's house. There they will attend to me as my mother's servants." He agreed, saying "Excellent," and escorted the young woman to the kinsmen's house. When she gave birth there, a boy was born. On the twenty-first day — the third seven-day period — after the birth, they held a great birth celebration, gave the child a name fitting to his lineage, and then she took the boy and returned to the village in the rocky hills. Later she again became with child, and when

the time for giving birth drew near, she said: "Master, the time for giving birth has come — let me go to my kinsmen's house. There they will attend to me as mother's servants." He replied

He agreed, saying "Excellent — go safely," and loaded both mother and son onto a cart and set off. But she gave birth halfway along the road. Seeing that she had given birth, he descended from the cart and sat down beside another tree — and there fell fast asleep. As he lay in deep sleep, a venomous snake seized him, and he passed beyond his time. She, still up on the cart, gave birth to another boy; then she descended from the cart, went to the tree, and said, "My lord, I have given birth to a boy — rejoice!" But he was without consciousness and gave no reply. She shook him with her hand and, examining him, saw that he had passed beyond his time. She wept aloud. A cow, too — without being given — was snatched away by someone taking what was not theirs. Then she wept for a long while, grief arose in her, and looking in all four directions, she held the newborn in her arms and took the elder boy by the hand.

Just then, a great unseasonable storm arose, and ponds, marshes, and wells all filled with water; and along her road a river had to be crossed. She thought: "If I cross together with the boy, both I and the boy will be lost. Let me first cross the little one." She left the elder boy on the bank and carried the small one across. Then she left the small one on the far bank and crossed back for the elder, and when she had reached the middle of the river, a fox carried off the little boy. Then she stood in the middle of the river, waving her arms and calling out again and again. The elder boy, thinking "Mother is calling to me," leapt into the water. The bank, too, was crumbling at its edge, and he perished the moment he fell. Then she hurried along, swift and frantic, chasing after the fox; but it dropped the child and fled, and when she looked, she saw it was dead. She wept and flung herself into the water. Then, looking back, she saw the elder boy also being carried away by the current, and overcome with anguish she ran weeping — and saw that he too had passed beyond his time.

Bereft of husband and sons, she fell into despair. Alone, wrapped in a single cloth from the waist down, sitting on the river bank listening to the wind and the great forest and the sounds of the rivers and the calls of many birds, she wept with streaming tears full of grief and heartache, crying out, "Woe — my husband! Woe — my elder son! Woe — my little one!" and rolled back and forth upon the ground.

Since all karma will surely and inevitably ripen in full when it has entirely expanded and been completed, at that very moment her father and mother and many members of the household were struck by a thunderbolt and died. Of those inside, one man alone escaped. With tears streaming down his face and full of grief and heartache, he came quickly toward her and appeared before her. Seeing him running toward her, she thought he looked frightened, and asked: "Good man, why do you run in such a frenzy?" He threw himself down before her, weeping, his face wet with tears, and said: "Your father and your mother and all the many members of your household were struck by a falling thunderbolt and died — I alone escaped through karma."

Hearing this, she wept even more piteously, lamenting again and again:

"What evil did I do in lives gone by
that in a single moment I am parted
from husband, sons, and all my dearest kin?
What use was there in dwelling in a home?
Without good fortune — wherever I may turn —
I am again cut off from husband, kin.
It is not fitting that I stay at home.
Better to dwell in desolate hermitages
or empty houses, any one of those.
To remain in a home is harmful — it is wrong.
Only grief and suffering multiply there."

She set off in one direction and wandered here and there until she came to another village among the rocky crags. There she found an old woman sitting and spinning cotton thread, and she went up to her. The old woman gave her rest and let her join in the spinning. Now in that same place there was a young weaver boy who made his living at his craft, and the old woman would sell him her cotton thread from time to time.

One day Gautamī carried a fine thread to him and went to his door. He asked, "Mother, you used to bring thicker thread — where has this thin stuff come from?" She replied, "My son, I did not spin this." "Then who did, Mother?" "My son, there is a woman staying in my house — she spun it." He said, "Mother, why do you not give her to me? I have no wife. I will provide her with food, clothing, and all the means of livelihood." The old woman replied, "Son, wait a little. Let me ask her first, and whatever she says I will tell you afterward." He then paid a good price for the thread and gave her food as well, and sent her

off adorned with scent and flowers.

When the lean Gautamī returned, the old woman said to her, "Daughter, you sold the thread for a good price — and who adorned you with scent and flowers?" She answered, "Mother, it was not only the adornment with scent and flowers — he gave food too." So the old woman asked, "How did all this come about?" Gautamī told her everything in detail, then spoke warmly of the young weaver's fine qualities: "Daughter, you should accept that young weaver. Agree to be his wife and all will be well." Gautamī replied, "Honoured mother, please do not speak of this again. I am weary of living in a home. However things may be, I will not lead that kind of life." The old woman said, "Daughter, a woman without support lives in a place of suffering, and men from outside will find occasion to take advantage of you. Think carefully, settle somewhere, and agree." Gautamī refused. The old woman pressed her again, pointing out the dangers, and at last Gautamī consented.

The weaver boy then, having chosen an auspicious day, month, and constellation, brought her home as his wife. Yet he was quarrelsome, wild, and quick to anger, and he constantly beat her with a stick and struck her with his fists. She said to the old woman, "Mother, you handed me over to a demon. He beats me with a stick and strikes me with his fists every single day, and I do not know what to do." The old woman replied, "Daughter, until you have borne him a child, he will beat you. But once you have brought him a son, you yourself will rule that household — do not be displeased."

In time she became pregnant, and the weaver boy grew fond of her. Yet she disdained him in return, and he tried to keep her there by coaxing. Then one day his weaver companions plied him with much wine, and he came home drunk and wild. The door was shut, for she was in the pains of labour, and when he called out for the door to be opened, she was so pierced all through by the agony of childbirth that she could not open it. He flew into a great rage, went and sat in a corner. When the child was born, she opened the door, and as he came inside she greeted him respectfully, saying, "My lord, be pleased — a son has been born to you." But he was entirely enveloped in anger, utterly covered over by unrelenting hostility, and he thought: "Even before this child was born she treated me with contempt. Now that her son has actually come into the world, she and her son together will —"

— certainly kill me." Thinking this, he said to her: "Good woman, stoke the fire in the hearth and set a bronze vessel on it." She stoked the fire and placed the

bronze vessel on the hearth. He said, "Pour mustard oil in and bring it to a boil." She poured in the mustard oil and brought it to a boil. Then he said, "Put this infant in and cook him." At that she said, "My lord, this is your own son — what wrong has he done that you would kill him while he is still a child?" He beat her with a stick. Since there was nothing dearer to her than herself, she was terrified, and she put the child into the boiling mustard oil. He passed away in that instant. When the oil had cooked him through, he said, "Take him out," and she did. He said, "Eat." She said, "My lord, how can I eat the flesh of my own child?" At that he beat her all over her body, struck her again and again, and beaten like that, she ate the flesh of her son.

The Blessed One then said: Attachment is a minor fault but difficult to be free of. Anger is a grave fault but easy to be free of. And so it was that the weaver's boy, tormented afterward by the fire of remorse and unable to sleep for a long time, fell into a stupor of exhaustion. He slept so very deeply that Gautamī perceived it clearly and thought to herself: "This man killed my son and then made me eat the child's flesh. He is a demon. I must flee." She snatched up whatever she could carry and ran. She met some fellow travelers heading north and sold goods belonging to the locality called Khormo-jik, then took back the goods she had sold and set out along the northern road, traveling on — and she went along together with those companions.

In time the caravan leader caught sight of her beauty. Seeing her, he was drawn to her and asked, "Whose woman are you, and where are you going?" She said, "Caravan leader, my husband was devoured by a venomous snake. Of my two sons, one was carried off by a fox, and one perished in a river. My mother and father were killed by a thunderbolt. I am without protector — I go wherever I please — and I shall go wherever this great company of travelers goes." He thought to himself: "Wherever I travel, I shall enjoy the company of a woman such as this." And so he made her his wife.

Before long, that great company of travelers was attacked by bandits, and that caravan leader too was killed in the fighting. The lean Gautamī was taken as wife by the chief of the bandits, and that bandit chief was in turn killed by the king of the region. The lean Gautamī became the king's chief queen. In time that king too passed away, and the queen, the young attendants, the ministers, and the many people of the court honored the lean Gautamī greatly and placed her inside the royal tomb. But the northern people came as grave robbers and began digging into the tomb. Dust flew up into the lean Gautamī's nose and she sneezed. The grave robbers, terrified and thinking a corpse had

risen, fled — and the lean Gautamī dug her way out through the excavated opening.

Reflecting on her suffering in all its many forms, she was utterly undone by the wind, and for lack of food she lost her mind. She cast off her lower garment, her hands and feet cracked, her matted hair grew long and pale, and she wandered here and there until she came at last to Śrāvastī.

Then the Blessed One said: The karmic maturation of sentient beings is inconceivable. Having experienced in this way the ripening of the fruit of the deeds she had performed in former times, she now arrived at the Jeta Grove through the force of her past karma.

At that time the Blessed One was seated before many hundreds and thousands of monks, teaching the Dharma. From a distance, the emaciated Gautamī caught sight of the Blessed One — the awakened one, the Blessed One — perfectly adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being, his body beautifully arrayed with the eighty minor marks of excellence, his surrounding aura of light surpassing the radiance of a thousand suns, filling a fathom's breadth all around, moving like a mountain of jewels. Upon seeing him, her own mind and memory were restored to her, and overcome with a sense of shame, she sat down to one side, huddled into herself.

Now, throughout all of this, there was not the slightest thing that the Blessed One did not know, did not see, did not discern, or did not perceive. By his very nature as the Blessed One, great compassion had become his way of benefiting the world. He is the sole protector, the sole hero; he speaks of non-duality and does not proclaim a second; he abides in calm abiding and insight; he is skilled in the three objects of discipline; he has crossed beyond the four rivers; the four bases of miraculous power are utterly firm beneath him; he is untroubled by the four fearlessnesses; he has fully abandoned the five limbs; he has genuinely transcended the five destinies; he is endowed with the six faculties; he has completely perfected the six perfections; he constantly abides in the six abodes; he is adorned with the flowers of the seven branches of awakening; he holds the eightfold path; he is skilled in the nine successive meditative absorptions; he is endowed with the strength of the ten powers; and he is absolutely certain — beyond all the hundreds of renowned ones who hold dominion in the ten directions. Three times by night and three times by day he surveys the world with the eye of a buddha, and his vision of primordial wisdom arises, beholding: who has declined, who has

advanced, who has come to suffer, who is afflicted, who is harmed, who has come to suffer and be afflicted and harmed, who inclines toward the lower realms, who is falling toward the lower realms, who is plunging headlong into the lower realms — thinking: I shall draw such ones out of the lower realms and place them in the higher realms and in liberation. Those in whom the roots of virtue have not yet arisen — I shall cause them to arise. Those in whom they have arisen — I shall bring them to full maturation. Those in whom they have matured — I shall bring them to liberation.

He then spoke in verse:

Even the ocean, home of sea-creatures,
may at times transgress its season —
yet a buddha will never miss the hour
for those disciples who are ready to be tamed.

The Blessed One then addressed the venerable Ānanda: Ānanda, give an upper robe to Gautamī, the merchant's wife, and teach her the Dharma.

The venerable Ānanda gave an upper robe to Gautamī, the merchant's wife. Thereupon the emaciated Gautamī, wife of the merchant, having put on the robe, went to where the Blessed One was, prostrated with her head at his feet, and sat down to one side.

Once she was seated to one side, the Blessed One, having known her intention, her latent dispositions, her constitution, and her character, taught her the Dharma in such a way that she would thoroughly realize the four noble truths. Upon hearing this teaching, the emaciated Gautamī, wife of the merchant, shattered the twenty peaks of the mountain of the view of the transitory collection with the vajra of primordial wisdom, and manifestly attained the fruit of stream-entry.

Having thus seen the truth, she rose from her seat, and facing the Blessed One with palms joined in reverence, she prostrated and then addressed the Blessed One with these words: Reverend One, having gone forth in this well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, having received full ordination, and having become a fully ordained nun,

may I be permitted to practice the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One? Or would the Blessed One entrust me to the Great Matriarch, that she might grant me the going forth, bestow full ordination, give instructions in the Vinaya, and confer the scriptural transmission, so that under her I may strive

with effort, apply myself with diligence, and accomplish the training?

Through striving, applying herself with diligence, and accomplishing the training, she came to know this wheel of saṃsāra in its motion and stillness. Having utterly vanquished, through the very nature of reality, all conditioned continuums as subject to decay, collapse, disintegration, and dissolution, she abandoned all mental afflictions, directly realized the fruit of arhatship, and became an arhat. She was freed from attachment to all three realms. Like clay and gold alike, like a hand that finds no purchase on the sky, her mind was utterly even. Like a thorn and sandalwood alike, she shattered the treasury of the storehouse of existence with the weapon of knowledge. She attained knowledge, the higher knowledges, and perfect individual discrimination. She turned her back on gain, attachment, and honor in this existence, and was venerated, prostrated to, and praised with pleasant words by those with controlling faculties and those approaching the controlling faculties, and by the gods.

She went to prostrate at the feet of the Blessed One. Then the Blessed One addressed the monks: Monks, among my female śrāvaka nuns who uphold the Vinaya, the foremost is the nun Kṣemā Gautamī.

When the Blessed One had declared that the nun Gautamī was foremost among those who uphold the Vinaya, the nuns at that time came to her presence. She, in order to inspire weariness in them, recounted the threads of karma. The nuns in turn reported in full detail to the monks what had thus occurred. Then at a later time, Kṣemā Gautamī went to prostrate at the feet of the Blessed One. When the monks saw her, they recounted to one another the threads of her karma. Kṣemā Gautamī then prostrated with her head at the feet of the Blessed One and departed from the presence of the Blessed One.

The following is a question asked knowingly by the Blessed One, the fully awakened Buddha. The Blessed One said to the Venerable Ānanda: Why, Ānanda, did you allow the monks to whisper to one another? And Ānanda reported the matter in full.

The Blessed One then declared: Ānanda, the stream of being and the karmic maturation of sentient beings is inconceivable. For beings of the world, karma is their own possession. Karma is the womb of birth. Karma is the intermediate state. Karma is what follows and accompanies them. Whatever karma one has performed, one will experience that maturation individually.

When doubt arose among the monks, they asked the Blessed One, the buddha who cuts through all doubt: Venerable One, what karma did the nun Kṣemā Gautamī perform such that her husband was eaten by a serpent and died before his time; one son was killed by a fox; a second son was swept away by a river and died before his time; both her parents were killed by a meteorite; and then, after she had eaten her own son's flesh, wandered here and there out of her mind with distracted thoughts, she went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One, abandoned all mental afflictions, and directly realized arhatship? And why did the Blessed One declare her foremost among those who uphold the Vinaya?

The Blessed One replied: Monks, the karma that the nun Kṣemā Gautamī herself performed, accumulated, and gathered, whose conditions have ripened, will necessarily come to manifest like a river. The karma that Kṣemā Gautamī performed and accumulated will not be experienced by another.

Monks, the karma that has been performed and accumulated does not ripen in the external element of earth, nor in the element of water, nor in the element of fire, nor in the element of wind. Rather, it is in these very appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense bases that virtuous and non-virtuous karma ripens.

Actions are never lost,
even after a hundred aeons have passed.
When the time and conditions meet,
they ripen as fruit for embodied beings.

Monks, in a past time, in another village on a rocky hillside, there lived a certain householder who was wealthy, with great possessions and resources, whose dwelling was wide and spacious — his wealth was like wealth earned through toil. From that wealth earned through toil, he took a wife of equal family background, and together they enjoyed themselves in pleasure. Yet though they enjoyed themselves in pleasure, there was no son and no daughter. He thought: "Though much wealth is gathered in my house, there is no son and no daughter. When I am gone, all that I govern will be declared 'without an heir' and will pass into the royal treasury." And so he sat cheek resting in his hand, deeply absorbed in worry. His wife noticed this and said: "My lord, why do you sit with your cheek resting in your hand, so deeply absorbed in thought?"

He replied: "My dear, though much wealth is gathered in my house, there is no son and no daughter. When I am gone, all that I govern will be declared 'without an heir' and will pass into the royal treasury. That is why I sit so absorbed in thought."

She then thought: "Can it be that his fortune is small? There is no son and no daughter — can it be that my fortune is small? No, this is something else: he wishes to find fault with me and take another wife. That is why he sits before me, cheek in hand, so absorbed in thought, saying that though much wealth is gathered in his house there is no son and no daughter, and that when he is gone all he governs will be declared without an heir and will pass into the royal treasury. Therefore he intends to be rid of me."

With this in mind, she spoke: "My lord, since I am so unfortunate and you have no son and no daughter, take another wife, and from her sons and daughters will come."

He replied: "My dear, have you not heard it said that a man who has two wives can never drink the cold water of peace? His house is always filled with fighting, quarrelling, discord, and strife, and the people of the household are thrown into turmoil, so that he cannot attend to his own affairs."

She said: "My lord, please, go ahead and take one. If she turns out to be just like an elder or younger sister to me, I will care for her as a sister. And if she is just like a daughter, I will care for her as a daughter."

He was persuaded by her urging, and so he set out in search of a bride. Then, in another village on a rocky hillside, a daughter had been born to a certain householder, and both her parents had since passed away. He arranged with her kinsman to take her, and joined her in marriage to his great estate. And since it is the nature of things that the new overshadows the old, he came to feel very fond of and attached to the new wife.

In time, the old wife, by nature envious, caused her own womb to become barren. But then the new wife became pregnant, and the old wife, glad, said to her husband: "My lord, rejoice! I have become pregnant."

He replied: "My dear, excellent! If you give birth to a son, you will become my heir and the mistress of the household."

Then she said:

"My lord, your new wife has performed a ritual of miscarriage upon the child in her womb. If the child is not miscarried, she will become mistress of the

household."

He replied: "My good woman, even before this I said something of the sort, and yet you had not even a little child to show for it. Did you have no answer to that?" She said nothing and fell silent.

Eight or nine months later, the new wife gave birth to a boy. A great birth celebration was held, and the child was given a name befitting his family line. Now the old wife thought to herself: "This child was born through the karma of a past life. If this mother does not kill him, it will be to my disadvantage. I must therefore make use of her." And so she said to her: "Sister, this boy belongs to both you and me — let us raise him together." The new wife gladly agreed, saying, "Very well, I shall do just that," and she took up his care.

But as the old wife nursed the child, a false notion arose in her mind: "Whichever woman's son he is, that is whose household it will be. Even though I am raising him, it will be she who becomes mistress of the house, and I shall be reduced to a slave. I must kill him." Moved by this perverse thought, she thrust a needle into the mouth of the boy. Tormented by the pain, he began to cry. The old wife said, "Why is this child crying?" The new wife replied: "Sister, why should he not cry?" She took the child up, trying to comfort him, held him, cooed at him, took him in her arms — but still he would not be calmed. Then she gave him her breast to nurse, and when she examined him more closely, she saw a needle had been thrust into his mouth. She quickly opened his mouth and pulled it out with her hand. But the child had no breath left. His time had passed, and he was dead.

The new wife beat her breast and wept, falling prostrate upon the ground. The people of the household came running and asked, "What is the matter?" She, her eyes streaming with tears of grief and sorrow, cried out: "Alas! That wicked woman of evil conduct, in her jealous rage, thrust a needle into my son's mouth and killed him!" They too began to weep. The neighbors of the household heard, and they too came running, saying: "What a sudden, terrible thing — this child, innocent and harmless, has been killed!" And many people surrounded her, calling out in lamentation. Then she beat her breast and wept, and made this sworn oath:

"If I have killed your son, may my husband be eaten by a snake and die. May one of my sons be eaten by a rat. May the second fall into a river and die. May my parents be struck by a thunderbolt and killed. And may I eat my son's flesh, go mad, and wander back and forth with a wandering, distracted mind!"

Now, monks, what do you think? The second wife of that householder was none other than the nun Sthavirā Gautamī (Skt. Gautamī) herself. Because she was utterly veiled by affliction, she not only killed the child but also spoke falsehood and swore that oath. And through the karmic maturation of those actions, her husband was eaten by a snake and died. One of her sons was killed by a rat. Another fell into a river and died. Her parents were crushed by a fallen meteorite and perished. She ate her son's flesh, went mad in her dotage, and wandered back and forth with a wandering, distracted mind.

Furthermore, the Blessed One Kāśyapa (the buddha Kāśyapa) had gone forth into the renunciant life, and she too went forth in that same lifetime and practised the holy celibate life, yet she gained not a single one of the many qualities it can bring. The preceptress under whom she had gone forth was declared by the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the fully and perfectly awakened Kāśyapa, to be the foremost among those who uphold the Vinaya.

And at the time of her death, that one made this aspiration prayer:

"By whatever root of virtue I have accumulated through practising the holy celibate life for a single lifetime in the presence of the Blessed One Kāśyapa, the unsurpassed field of merit — though I gained not even a single one of the many qualities it can bring — by this root of virtue, may I go forth into the teaching of the one whom the Blessed One, the fully and perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa, prophesied to the brahmin's son, his preceptor, saying: 'Brahmin's son, when beings live to the age of one hundred, Śākyamuni will become a Tathāgata, a fully and perfectly awakened buddha.' And having gone forth into that one's teaching, may I abandon all afflictions and realise arhatship. And just as this my preceptress was declared by the Blessed One, the fully and perfectly awakened buddha Kāśyapa, to be the foremost among those who uphold the Vinaya, so too may I be declared the foremost among those who uphold the Vinaya by the Blessed One Śākyamuni, the king of the Śākyas."

And because she had practised the holy celibate life for a single lifetime, she went forth into this one's teaching, abandoned all afflictions, and realised arhatship. And she made the aspiration prayer to be the foremost among those who uphold the Vinaya — and by the power of that aspiration prayer, the Tathāgata has now declared her the foremost among those who uphold the Vinaya.

Furthermore, the monks put this question to the Blessed One, the buddha: "Venerable one, what karma did the parents of the nun Gautamī perform such that through the ripening of that karma they came to be struck by a meteorite and killed? What karma did her husband perform that he met his end through a snakebite? What karma did her two sons perform such that one was killed by a rat and the other fell into a river and perished?"

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, the karma that those individuals themselves committed and accumulated, having gathered its collection and ripened its conditions, will without any doubt come to abide close at hand, like a river. What karma they themselves committed and accumulated, no one else will experience. Monks, karma committed and accumulated does not ripen in the external element of earth, nor in the element of water, nor in the element of fire, nor in the element of wind — rather, virtuous and non-virtuous karma committed ripens in these very appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense bases.

Actions are never lost,
though hundreds of aeons pass;
when the time comes and conditions meet,
they ripen as fruit for embodied beings.

Monks, long ago in this Fortunate Aeon, when human beings lived to the age of twenty thousand years, a Teacher called Kāśyapa appeared in the world — a Tathāgata, arhat, fully and perfectly awakened buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, a blessed buddha — and he resided at the Deer Park of the sages near the city of Vārāṇasī. At that time there lived in Vārāṇasī another householder who was wealthy, with abundant resources and great possessions, whose dwelling was spacious and vast, whose riches were gathered in the manner of Vaiśravaṇa, and who was endowed with the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. That householder built a monastery on the far bank of the river Varakā, and monks from various regions came to reside there. Men of the town had borrowed a loan from this householder and were leaving without repaying it. One of them was called to account three times by the householder, and when he heard the demand made three times, that man said to him: 'You ungrateful wretch, you have borrowed and heard my demand for repayment three times, yet you will not repay me — do not go until you have paid.' The other replied: 'Householder, grant me one repayment period, and then if I have not repaid, my three sons and —'

"— together with my wife and children, accept as your servants." He then drew up a signed bond and gave it to the householder as surety. Being quite unable to do anything, he was heard out, and the householder then handed him over, along with his wife and sons, to serve in that monastery. Since he lived in a village nearby on the other side of the river, each day he would cross the river and cook rice for the monastic community of monks there, while his wife and sons did the sweeping. In that monastery there was a monk who was an arhat and who served as the community's steward.

Then, at a later time, rain fell and the river Varakā rose with water, so that the servant, together with his sons and wife, was long delayed. The monk who was an arhat came to him and said: "Hey, man — the sun has already moved this far across the sky and still you have not come. Are the cooked meals of the monastic community of monks to be cut short?" When he had spoken thus, the wife flew into a rage and said: "When he comes, why did no thunderbolt fall on his head?" The eldest son said: "Why did a venomous snake not eat him?" The middle son said: "Why did he not fall into the river and fail to come in time?" The youngest son said: "Why did no fox eat him?"

Monks, what do you think? Those two — the householder and his wife — are the father and mother of the nun Skaṃmā Gautamī. The eldest son is her husband. The middle son is her eldest son. The youngest son is her younger son. In that way, having directed harsh words with malicious intent at an arhat, through the karmic maturation of that action they were struck down by a thunderbolt, by a venomous snake, and by a fox and the like, and one fell into the river — and all four perished before their time.

Therefore, monks, the karmic maturation of extremely dark karma is likewise extremely dark. Extremely white karma is extremely white. Mixed karma is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon dark and mixed karma, and be diligent in extremely white karma. Train yourselves likewise in this way, monks.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and delighted in what the Blessed One had said.

The Vinaya, the minor bases. The thirty-ninth fascicle.

The narrative context is Śrāvastī. Once, when the foolish man Āryaskanda killed members of the Śākya clan without fault or cause for harm, and the wives of the Śākyas became separated from their brothers, husbands, and fathers, and being tormented by suffering, they went forth into the

well-proclaimed Dharma-Vinaya. Suffering is like the sound of a bell — at the time when those who have been parted from their grief are then, at that very moment, tormented by afflictions in which attachment is extremely strong, they are unable to bear it.

The Blessed One said: A black snake has five faults. What are the five? It is irascible, it is resentful, it is cold-hearted, it is ungrateful, and it has sharp venom. In just the same way, certain women also have five faults. What are the five? They are irascible, they are resentful, they are cold-hearted, they are ungrateful, and they have sharp venom. Now, what is the sharp venom of women? Women, for the most part, have great attachment.

Those women consulted one another and went to where the nun Sthūlanandā was. Having gone there and paid homage at Sthūlanandā's feet, they stood before her and said: "Noble one, afflictions are difficult to restrain. When they act to deceive women, please tell us how we may be turned away from them." She replied:

"Sisters, what is there to understand about this? You are in the bloom of youth. Submit yourselves to my authority, and go and enjoy yourselves freely with wealthy men, with merchants, with caravan leaders, and also with the sons of good families and with the sons of anyone at all without exception. And if I were young, I would go along with you." She deceived them with these words. They paid homage at her feet and departed, and then said: "How remarkable — the noble Sthūlanandā said, 'What is there to understand about this?'" Some among them said, "Excellent — she has spoken well; enjoy pleasures to the full." But others said: "Sisters, it is hard to find women who have gone forth into the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya. Let us go at once and ask the noble Gautamī as well." They said, "Excellent, let us do just that," and went to where Gautamī was. Having paid homage at her feet, they said: "Noble one, afflictions are difficult to restrain. When they act to deceive women, please tell us how we may be turned away from them." She replied:

"Noble ones, do not even take the name of desires upon your lips. Why so? Because desire yields little pleasure and great suffering, and has many objects of fault. The Blessed One declared: a wise person who truly sees the five objects of fault does not rightly indulge in desires. What are the five? A wise person who truly sees that desire yields little joy and great suffering, and has many objects of fault, does not rightly indulge in desires. A wise person who sees that indulging in desires leads to the proliferation of attachments does

not rightly indulge in desires. A wise person who sees that indulging in desires brings restlessness, insatiability, and discontentment does not rightly indulge in desires. A wise person who sees that indulging in desires leaves no room whatsoever for refraining from harmful actions does not rightly indulge in desires. A wise person who sees, through many categories, that desires are condemned by the buddhas, by the śrāvakas of the buddhas, by the wise, and by noble persons of right conduct does not rightly indulge in desires.

A wise person who sees these five qualities does rightly aspire to the going-forth. What are the five? A wise person who sees that the going-forth offers one's own purpose unmixed does rightly aspire to it. A wise person who sees that while, as a householder, one is subject to servants, to those one has dispatched on errands, to weariness, to the power of others, and to going wherever one is bidden, those in the going-forth are honored and praised — such a wise person does rightly aspire to the going-forth. A wise person who sees that through the going-forth one will attain the supreme meditative bliss of yoga and the attainment of nirvāṇa does rightly aspire to it. A wise person who sees that even if one has not yet attained the supreme meditative bliss of yoga and nirvāṇa, one will at least be reborn among the gods — such a wise person does rightly aspire to the going-forth. A wise person who sees, through many categories, that the going-forth is praised by the buddhas, by the śrāvakas of the buddhas, by the wise, by those of right conduct, and by noble persons does rightly aspire to the going-forth.

Do you wish to hear about the suffering experienced on account of desires in future lives, or the suffering experienced in this very life?" They said: "Noble one, let the suffering experienced on account of desires in future lives wait for a moment — please speak first of what is experienced in this life." She then described to them in detail how it comes to pass: the suffering of separation from mother, father, husband, and children, and the suffering of one who has eaten the flesh of her own child.

Upon hearing this, they were so shaken that the hair all over their bodies stood on end. They raised their ears and looked, wan and dry, into the face of Gautamī. She, perceiving their thoughts, their latent tendencies, their faculties, and their temperaments, taught the Dharma in such a way that they would come to thoroughly realize the Four Noble Truths of the noble ones. Upon hearing it, those twenty peaks of the mountain of the view of the transitory collection (the belief in a self within the aggregates) were shattered by the vajra of primordial wisdom, and they actualized the fruit of

stream-entry. Having seen the truth, they said: "Noble one, we have been saved! We are utterly saved! This one called Bhomā has caused us to sink into the mud of desires." Gautamī then asked her sisters what had happened, and they recounted it to her in full detail. She said to her sisters: "What is to be done about this? She is engaged in a serious offense. She has cast aside the teaching of the Blessed One like riverbank grass." The nuns who were of little importance ridiculed her and spoke harshly, saying: "How could a nun possibly drive other nuns back into lay life?" Those nuns who had witnessed this reported the matter to the monks, and the monks informed the Blessed One.

The Blessed One then declared: "Therefore, a nun must not send another nun back into lay life. If she does so, it will become a serious offense." The ancillary case took place at Śrāvastī. A certain nun had slandered a monk, and that monk became frightened. Those nuns who had witnessed it reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Therefore, if a nun slanders a monk, it shall entail a transgression. Just as a nun must not do this to a fully ordained monk, so too must she not do it to a fully ordained nun, a female trainee, a novice monk, or a novice nun. A female trainee must not do this to a fully ordained monk, a fully ordained nun, a female trainee, a novice monk, or a novice nun. A novice nun must not do this to a fully ordained monk, a fully ordained nun, a female trainee, a novice monk, or a novice nun."

In brief:

Do not go ahead unbidden —

rise to your feet, O nun.

Sit only when asked,

and cross-legged sitting is without category.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was residing at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time, the venerable Mahākāśyapa was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the former pleasure grove, in the Deer-Sound Hall. Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa, in the early morning, donned his lower robe and his outer robe, took up his alms bowl, and entered Śrāvastī to go on alms round. The nun Bhomā likewise, in the early morning, donned her lower robe and outer robe, took up her alms bowl, and entered Śrāvastī on alms round. Seeing the venerable Mahākāśyapa, she thought to herself: "I must displease this fool." She went ahead of him to whatever household the venerable Mahākāśyapa was heading for, seated herself inside the doorway, and said: "Noble one, there is nothing at all prepared here right now — please move on." He then went to another household. There too she went on ahead and

obstructed him as before. This she did repeatedly from house to house. Since he did not pay her any heed, the arhat's wisdom-eye did not engage; but when he turned his attention to the thought of who might be harassing him, he perceived that it was Bhomā, and he said: "Sister, it is not you who has erred — it is the venerable Ānanda who has erred, in that he gave women who engage in serious offenses the going-forth into the well-proclaimed Dharma-Vinaya and granted them full ordination, thereby establishing them as fully ordained nuns."

When the monks heard what had occurred, they informed the Blessed One, and the Blessed One considered the matter. Since any nun who goes on ahead into the alms-round domain of a monk becomes an object of offense, the Blessed One reflected: therefore nuns should not solicit alms in the domain of monks. He then declared: "Monks, the monk Kāśyapa justly rebuked the nun. Therefore let nuns not solicit alms in the domain of monks. Any nun who does so will incur a transgression."

When the Blessed One had spoken — saying that nuns should not solicit alms in the domain of monks — the nuns abandoned the monks' domain, and those nuns were left destitute of alms. The nuns who were in that situation told the monks, and the monks informed the Blessed One. The Blessed One then declared: "Therefore nuns should not go on ahead into the domain of monks who are going on alms-round. As for those domains that the monks have relinquished, let the nuns go there."

The occasion for what follows is this: it was at Śrāvastī. Bhomā was seated before an assembly of many hundreds, teaching the Dharma. The venerable Mahākāśyapa came along that road, and those in the assembly, seeing the venerable Mahākāśyapa, rose to their feet. Bhomā, however, did not stir even from her seat. When those people saw the noble Mahākāśyapa — honored by gods and humans alike — they said to her: "We stood up, yet you have not so much as risen from your seat. That is unseemly." She replied: "I went forth from among the tīrthikas. Fool upon fool, dullard upon dullard — I, a Śākyan nun, master of the Three Baskets, versed in doctrinal discourse, confident in knowledge and liberation: why should I rise from my seat upon seeing this one?" When the monks heard this, they informed the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, faithful brahmins and householders will rightly take offense. Therefore, the moment a nun sees a monk, let her rise from her seat. If she does not rise, she will incur a transgression." When the Blessed One had spoken — saying that the moment a nun sees a monk she should rise

from her seat — some time later the nun Utpalavarṇā was seated outside the nuns' summer residence before an assembly of many hundreds, teaching the Dharma.

The venerable Ānanda, in the early morning, dressed in his lower robe and Dharma robe, took up his alms bowl, and set out from Śrāvastī on alms-round. Returning from the alms-round through Śrāvastī, he made his way to where the nuns' summer residence was. The nun Utpalavarṇā saw the venerable Ānanda, and the moment she saw him she rose from her seat. The venerable Ānanda sat down, and having sat, asked: "Sister, which sūtra have you been expounding?" She replied: "Noble one, this one, called such-and-such." The venerable Ānanda then began to explain the sūtra at length, and Utpalavarṇā stood listening with her ear turned toward him. Since the venerable Ānanda was engrossed in teaching the Dharma, he did not say to her "sit down." She stood there for a long time, and the heat of the sun's rays exhausted her. She fainted and fell to the ground. Then those without faith said: "The nun Utpalavarṇā, we hear, is free from attachment — yet upon seeing this handsome young Śākya, her mind was moved by attachment and desire, and she fell to the ground." When the monks heard this slander, they informed the Blessed One.

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, brahmins and householders slander according to what seems fitting to them. Therefore, monks, when the Dharma is being taught, you must say to the noble one, 'Please be seated.' And if a monk is occupied and forgets to do so, the nun herself should request it, saying: 'Noble one, please know that I am present.' The buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling in Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. There the Blessed One declared to the monks: 'Monks, the sun rises; crows cry out; farmers till their fields; wild men weep. Therefore, monks, you should understand that this has the meaning of a simile. And the meaning should be understood as follows: When it is said that the sun has risen, that is an epithet for the speech of the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha. When it is said that crows cry out, that is an epithet for the speech of those who teach the Dharma. When it is said that farmers till their fields, that is an epithet for the speech of those who give generously. When it is said that wild men weep, that is an epithet for the speech of Māra's retinue. Therefore, monks, the Teacher, who is affectionate, compassionate, and devoted to the welfare and benefit of his śrāvaka disciples, says: I have done what was to be done out of compassion for you. Now you, for your part, should

dwell and meditate in remote forests, at the foot of trees, in empty houses, in valleys, in mountain caves, in piles of straw without cover, in charnel grounds, in groves, on mountains, and at the edges of ravines. Monks, do not be heedless! This is my teaching, lest you come to regret it later.' 'Monks, go to such places as lakes, marshes, mountain caves, pleasure groves, springs, and trees adorned with flowers and fruit — places of exceptional delight — and there apply yourselves to the cultivation of mental cultivation. Nuns too should go to dense thickets near the royal park, and to other places suitable for women, and there apply themselves to the cultivation of mental cultivation.' The Blessed One heard that, driven by the ripening of past karma, creatures had entered into what is called the wound that is womanhood, and declared: 'Therefore, monks, when a nun is engaged in mental cultivation, she should sit half cross-legged on a mat and practise mental cultivation in the proper manner, rather than sitting fully cross-legged.' The Blessed One said that nuns should sit half cross-legged on a mat and practise mental cultivation in the proper manner. When the nuns accordingly sat half cross-legged and began to apply themselves to mental cultivation, the Blessed One heard that during that night tiny creatures had entered there. The Blessed One therefore declared: 'In that place, after a leaf or a thin petal has fallen as a cushion, sit half cross-legged on it in the proper manner.'

The occasion is at Śrāvastī. The venerable Upāli asked the Blessed One: 'Venerable one, if a nun who has fallen from the precepts wishes to go forth again, receive full ordination in the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, and be established in the status of a fully ordained nun, may she go forth, or may she not?' The Blessed One declared: 'Upāli, she may not go forth. Upāli, a nun who has once fallen may not be received back through going forth and full ordination in the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, nor be established in the status of a fully ordained nun.'

The occasion is at Śrāvastī. The venerable Upāli asked the buddha, the Blessed One: 'Venerable one, in the case where the Blessed One has here declared that a monk should adjudicate a nun's offence of deterioration in moral discipline, deterioration in view, and deterioration in conduct —'

— and deterioration in livelihood, he should not bring it up or call it to mind,' and the Blessed One declared this — Venerable one, is there then any category whatsoever in which a nun may bring up or call to mind a monk's deterioration in moral discipline, deterioration in view, deterioration in conduct, or deterioration in livelihood?" The Blessed One declared: "Upāli,

there is no category whatsoever in which a nun may bring up or call to mind a monk's deterioration in moral discipline, deterioration in view, deterioration in conduct, or deterioration in livelihood."

In brief:

Even a merchant will not forgo
the leftover food set aside;
he does not ask about obstructions to the Dharma —
those are for others, and for the flow of blood.

The occasion is at Śrāvastī. At Śrāvastī there lived another merchant who was wealthy, with abundant resources and great possessions. He took a wife from a family of equal standing, and he enjoyed her company with great delight. Yet although they enjoyed each other's company, no son was born and no daughter was born. Then in later times his wealth became exhausted, and his resources ran out. He said to his wife: "My good wife, I am now old and cannot go out to seek wealth, so I shall go to the Jeta Grove and go forth." When he said this, she replied: "Master, if you go forth, at whose side shall I stay? I too shall go forth." He said: "Good, my dear, let us go," and leading her there, he came before the noble lady Gautamī, the mother of the people, bowed at her feet, and said: "Noble lady, may your reverence grant this my wife going forth and full ordination in the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, for I am going to the Jeta Grove to go forth." She replied: "My son, that you and your wife together have aroused the intention is excellent. As for going forth, the wise one who has seen the five qualities spoken of by the Blessed One ought to be drawn to going forth" — and then, just as before, she said: "Buddhas, the disciples of buddhas, the wise, those who have gone rightly, and holy persons have praised going forth in many ways; it is excellent. Go forth," — and she sent her forth. Then she went to the Jeta Grove and went forth among the monks. The merchant of Śrāvastī became known as one who had gone forth, and by great merit he obtained the requisites: robes, alms-food, a sleeping mat, and medicines and treatments for illness.

In later times he went out for alms. His wife too had gone on her alms round, and at that time a great famine arose, and she suffered from a lack of alms-food. He saw her and said: "Sister, how do you fare, how do you live?" She replied: "Noble one, since it is a time of famine, even alms-food is not given, and I live in hardship and suffering." He said: "Sister, I receive alms, and if the Blessed One permits it, I will give you half my alms-food." Without saying

anything further, he went to the residence and told the nuns exactly how things stood. The nuns told the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "In the case of such a nun, if a monk obtains any alms-food, that monk should, in a time of famine, give her half his alms-food. Let there be no hesitation in this matter." The Blessed One declared: "In the case of such a nun, if a monk obtains any alms-food, and a time of famine has come upon her, let that monk give her half his alms-food." He then set aside for her half his alms-food; she ate it and went on her way. Then in later times he obtained some alms-food that came unexpectedly —

she did not come to that monk. The monk thought to himself: "She is certain to have found food elsewhere — and if she does not come here, for whose sake am I to set this aside?" Thinking thus, he did not set aside a portion for her. After some time the nun came after all. He said to her: "Sister, I thought you would not come, and so I did not set aside any alms-food. If this food I have here were permitted by the Blessed One, I would give it to you." She bowed at his feet and went to the nuns' quarters. She related to the nuns what had taken place. They reported it to the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Whatever a monk has set aside, a nun may receive and eat. Whatever a nun has set aside, a monk may receive. In this matter there should be no hesitation: a nun may receive from a monk, and monks may receive from a nun."

The occasion arose at Śrāvastī. Monks asked a nun, in the midst of the nuns' Saṅgha, questions concerning matters of uncommon transgression. She grew ashamed and sat with her face cast down. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks must not ask nuns questions about matters of uncommon transgression. The nun herself should be questioned. If a monk asks a nun about uncommon transgressions belonging to nuns, he commits an offense with remainder. If elder monks have begun to ask common questions, and she nonetheless said nothing out of shame — " the Blessed One declared: "Place her before a nun and question her. That nun should speak to her, and that nun in turn should report to the monk."

The occasion arose at Śrāvastī. Another nun was being fully ordained by the venerable Śāriputra. In the course of his enjoining her thus — "Having received full ordination under the teaching of the supreme Wisdom, do not be disheartened at having obtained this precious and difficult-to-find leisure and endowment" — blood flowed from her during that time. The venerable

Śāriputra said to her: "Sister, please leave." She, bleeding and burning with shame, arose with thoughts of self-harm, and the venerable Śāriputra, perceiving this, departed. Then the nuns said to her: "Sister, when you are right in the midst of the assembly and are told by the teacher to leave — why did you not rise?" She replied: "Older and younger sisters, were it not for such a great virtue as this, would you yourselves say such a thing? I was sitting alone and bleeding — how was I to rise?" They fell silent and said nothing further. They reported the matter to the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Therefore, a nun who is undergoing full ordination should not sit alone on the bare ground; she should be seated on a board, on grass, or on a mat set over a pure surface, on account of a woman's delivery of the afterbirth."

In sum: a surplus remnant is not permissible for a monk.
The unclean is held between the belt
and the nursing-cloth, together with the nursing-band —
these must not be kept as an obstruction.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time Gautamī, the great lady (prajāpatī), the mother of the people, was traveling the countryside with her retinue of five hundred, and as the sun sank to the west she came to the Jeta Grove. She thought: "It is too late now to proceed to Śrāvastī — I shall stay right here this night, in whatever manner I can, and set out at dawn in the morning."

She lay down on the ground there, and her robes became soiled with dust. In the morning, at dawn, she would have to return once more, and thinking, "I shall pay homage to the Teacher all at once before departing," she and her companions went to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed at the Blessed One's feet and stood in his presence. The Blessed One saw that her robes were soiled with dust and said, "Gautamī, who has soiled your robes with dust?" She explained to him in detail what had happened. The Blessed One then said to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, have the monks given the nuns the leftover bedding of the monks, or have they not given it?" "They have not given it, Blessed One." The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, therefore let this be permitted: monks shall give nuns the leftover bedding of the monks. Have no hesitation in this." The Blessed One declared that monks should give nuns the leftover bedding of the monks. Then another monk took very fine bedding, and the monks gave that leftover bedding to those nuns. Thereupon the Blessed One declared: "Do not give from what is fine — give

from old cloth, coarse wool, or the like."

The second narrative occasion is set at Śrāvastī. The venerable Mahākāśyapa, in the morning, dressed in his lower robe and outer robe, took up his almsbowl, and entered Śrāvastī to seek alms. The nun Sthūlanandā had also entered the monastery. Because it was the autumn season and the rivers were full of water, the venerable Mahākāśyapa crossed over a bridge. Sthūlanandā saw him, and she thought: "I shall do something to displease this fool." She went swiftly and quickly, and as he was crossing the bridge she shook it. The venerable Mahākāśyapa fell, his undergarments and lower robe were drenched with water, and his almsbowl slipped and sank into the river. Only his neck-cloth was saved. He said to her: "Sister, it is not you who have done wrong — it is the venerable Ānanda who has done wrong. Women who conduct themselves in such a gross manner have gone forth, taken full ordination, and become nuns within the well-taught Dharma and Vinaya (the discipline) — that is to be rejoiced in." When the monks heard what had happened, they reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One reflected: "Whoever — whether a nun or a monk — crosses a single bridge together, that is an occasion for transgression. Therefore a nun shall not cross a single bridge together with a monk her father in the Dharma. If she does so, she incurs a transgression." The Blessed One declared that a nun shall not cross a single bridge together with a monk. Then those nuns refrained from crossing even other bridges that were firm and broad, and the Blessed One declared: "Bridges that are firm and broad they may cross — have no hesitation about that."

The third narrative occasion is also set at Śrāvastī. The nun Sthūlanandā then, in the morning, dressed in her lower robe and outer robe, took up her almsbowl, and entered Śrāvastī to seek alms. In due course she went before the queen Mālagandha. Mālagandha welcomed her with pleasant words of greeting and set out a seat. While they were talking and sitting together for a moment, Sthūlanandā said, "Mālagandha, your waist is so very, very slender." Mālagandha replied: "Noble lady, why do you ask? Whatever it takes, I do what pleases my husband's mind." Sthūlanandā said: "Mālagandha, so it may be — but tell me, just enough to resolve my doubt."

She replied, "Noble lady, I wear a waist-cincher." Sthūlanandā said, "Good — that is why so many people find you pleasing and delightful." Mālagandha said nothing further.

Sthūlanandā went to her summer quarters and put on a waist-cincher. Some time later, Sthūlanandā was bathing together with other nuns at the river Aciravatī. When they saw her, they asked, "Noble lady, our waists are so very, very thick — why is yours so very, very slender?" She replied, "Sisters, I wear a waist-cincher. That is why my waist is like this." They asked, "Noble lady, is it fitting for you to wear a waist-cincher?" She replied, "Whether it is fitting or not, sisters, I have put one on." The nuns criticized and reproached her. The wicked ones said, "How could a nun possibly wear a waist-cincher?" When those who had witnessed this told the monks, the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared, "Therefore, a nun must not wear a waist-cincher. If a nun wears a waist-cincher, she shall incur an offense."

The setting of this rule is at Śrāvastī.

Then the nun Sthūlanandā, in the morning, dressed in her lower robe and outer robe, took up her almsbowl, and went just as before. While they sat together talking for a moment, she asked, "Mālagandha, why are your breasts so high and firm?" Mālagandha replied, "Noble lady, why do you ask about this? Whatever it takes, I do what pleases my husband's mind." Sthūlanandā said, "So it may be, Mālagandha — but tell me, just enough to resolve my doubt." She replied, "Noble lady, I wear a breast-band." Sthūlanandā said, "Excellent! That being so, dear Mālagandha, you are truly a precious woman." Mālagandha said nothing further.

Sthūlanandā went to her summer quarters, and having put on a breast-band, the same sequence of events as before then followed. Therefore, monks, a nun must not wear a breast-band. If a nun wears a breast-band, she shall incur an offense.

The setting of this rule is at Śrāvastī.

Then the nun Sthūlanandā, in the morning, dressed in her lower robe and outer robe, took up her almsbowl, and went just as before. While they sat talking together for a moment, she asked, "Mālagandha, why do your breasts hang down?" She replied, "Noble lady, why do you ask about this? Whatever I do, I do what pleases my husband's mind." Sthūlanandā said, "So it may be — but tell me, just enough to resolve my doubt." She replied, "Noble lady, I wear a breast-support." Sthūlanandā said, "Excellent! In that case, the ladies of the inner palace are pleased and delighted with you." Mālagandha said nothing further.

Sthūlanandā again went to her summer quarters, and having put on a breast-support there, the same sequence as before followed. Therefore, a nun must not wear a breast-support. If a nun wears a breast-support, she shall incur an offense.

The setting of this rule is at Śrāvastī.

Now the Blessed One had declared that a nun must not wear a waist-cincher, whereupon Sthūlanandā bound her waist with whatever cloth she could find. Then some time later, Sthūlanandā was bathing at the river Aciravatī together with other nuns. When they saw her, they asked, "Noble lady, if the Blessed One has not permitted nuns to bind the waist with a waist-cincher, why is your waist so very, very slender?" She replied, "Sisters, I have wrapped it with whatever cloth was at hand."

They then asked her, "Sister, is it permissible to bind the waist with just any cloth?" She replied, "Sisters, whether it is permitted or not permitted — I have bound it." The nuns criticized and reproached her sharply: "How could a nun bind her waist with just any cloth?" And so those who had acted in this way were treated as in the previous case, up to the words: "A nun shall not bind her waist with just any cloth. If a nun binds her waist with just any cloth, she shall incur an offense."

In brief:

Do not discard it in an unclean place —
The womb, impurity, and foul drink,
One may touch one's own child,
But one must not touch another's child.

The setting of this rule is at Śrāvastī. The Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. The venerable Mahākāśyapa, having dressed in his lower robe and outer robe in the morning, took up his alms bowl and entered Śrāvastī to collect alms. The nun Sthūlanandā had also gone out to collect alms. Now, the venerable Mahākāśyapa was coming down past a place near a cesspit, and Sthūlanandā saw him. She thought, "I shall do something to displease this fool," and she hurried along, going quickly and at length, and threw a bundle of refuse into the cesspit, fouling the outer robe and alms bowl of the venerable Mahākāśyapa. Then she said, "Sister, you have done no wrong" — and so forth as before. When monks who had witnessed what had happened reported it to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, monks, a nun shall not defile a monk with filth. If a nun defiles a

monk with filth, she shall incur an offense."

The setting of this rule is at Śrāvastī. At Śrāvastī there lived a certain householder who was wealthy, with great riches and many possessions. He had taken a wife from a family of equal standing, and he enjoyed himself and lived together with her. Some time later he took up trade and traveled to another region. Before leaving, he said to his wife, "My dear, I am going away on a trading journey to another land. Do not be distracted; guard the household diligently and attentively, and send me news from time to time." She replied, "Very well, my lord; it shall be done as you say." So he left on his trading journey to another land.

After her husband had gone, his wife was tormented by affliction, craving fine clothing and food, and she consorted with another man. She became pregnant and thought to herself, "I shall kill the one dwelling in my womb. When my husband returns, it will bring disgrace upon me." Having thus decided to kill the one in her womb, she then thought about how to discard it, not knowing how or where. She was sitting there, absorbed in anxious thought, when Sthūlanandā came to that house to collect alms. The woman said, "Noble lady, please give alms." The woman, tormented by her own distress, said, "There is no one to give alms today; please move on." Sthūlanandā said, "Noble lady, has someone died, or is something amiss?" The woman replied, "Noble lady, no one has died, but a child has come forth from me and I do not know how to discard it or where." Sthūlanandā said, "Noble lady, if I dispose of it for you, will you give me alms?" The woman said, "Noble lady, yes I will." "And will you give alms to the nun who accompanies me?" "Yes, noble lady, I will." "And to the duty-assigner as well?" "Yes, I will." "Then I shall dispose of it properly." So she placed it in a large alms bowl, carried it to an empty house, and began to dispose of it there.

A man who had previously entered that empty house saw her and said, "What are you doing, ascetic woman?" She replied, "The likes of you — a worthless son of nobody — have no business questioning a woman of good family who has done such a thing. Begone!" And she rebuked him eight times and he left.

Then she encountered a nun, and that nun said to her, "You shameless, disobedient woman — Sthūlanandā has done such and such a thing." Sthūlanandā had no reply and said nothing.

When things had come to pass in this way, the nuns told the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One reflected: since it is an

occasion for offense for a nun to carry a large alms bowl, the Blessed One, knowing that nuns should not carry large alms bowls, declared to the monks: "Monks, it was a woman who was not a nun who, with desire unbefitting one who is not a nun, acted as one who is not a nun. Therefore, a nun must not perform such an act. She must also not carry a large alms bowl. If a nun performs such an act or carries a large alms bowl, she incurs a transgression." The Blessed One declared: "A nun must not carry a large alms bowl." The Blessed One further declared: "Whatever counts as a small alms bowl for a monk counts as a large one for a nun."

The case arose in Śrāvastī. Once, the nun Guptā poured one drop of urine into her mouth and inserted one drop into the opening of her womb. By the inconceivable ripening of a sentient being's karma, the young Kāśyapa came into being. Since Guptā had not touched him, he cried. Her relatives and friends asked, "Guptā, why is this infant crying?" She said nothing. The nuns, recalling that the Blessed One had established the training rule that a nun must not touch a man, said, "He is not touching her, and that is why he is crying." Her relatives and friends said, "But the Blessed One is compassionate — why then would he prevent a mother from touching her own child? If this infant boy is not touched by his mother, he will surely die." They added, "Very well then, let the Blessed One be informed of this."

When things had come to pass in this way, the nuns told the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Then it is permitted to touch him, to nurse him, to care for him, to raise him."

The case arose in Śrāvastī. The Blessed One having declared, "She may nurse him, care for him, and raise him," women being by nature attached, the nuns passed the infant from lap to lap, and he grew thin and puny, his body wasted from being tossed about without rest. His relatives and friends saw this and asked, "Why has this infant become thin and puny, his body wasted and worn?" When Guptā explained it to them in detail, those relatives, out of affection, took to mocking the nuns.

When things had come to pass in this way, the monks heard of it and reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Therefore, nuns must not touch another's child. If a nun touches another's child, she incurs a transgression."

The sixth chapter on minor matters is complete.

The Vinaya Garland, the fortieth fascicle. The collected sūtra passages: On doubt and the solitary retreat, on Saṃkāṣī, and on account of both — whether monks who sell liquor, or whether nuns and outsiders: in brief, also sleeping in the presence of doubt, and not dwelling alone elsewhere.

The same applies to boys and girls, as well as to novices and to Rādha.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The Blessed One had declared that a nun must not sleep together with a man in a single room. Now, the nun Guptā had given birth to the young boy Kāśyapa, and she left him outside, where he cried alone. His kinfolk and friends heard this and asked Guptā why the young boy Kāśyapa was crying. She sat without saying a word, and the nuns said to the venerable ones: "Since the Blessed One has laid down the training rule that a nun must not sleep together with a man inside a single house, it is not permissible for her to sleep with this Guptā in the same room." Her kinfolk then said: "The noble Blessed One is compassionate — if the young Kāśyapa is not permitted to sleep together with Guptā, he will certainly and without question come to ruin." And they said further: "In that case, please let the Blessed One be informed." When things had come to pass in this way, they told the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Therefore, it is permitted: let Guptā receive the vow to sleep in a single room together with her son from the community of nuns. The request is to be made as follows. Spread out a mat, strike the gong, and when the entire community of nuns is assembled and in order, let the nun Guptā bow according to seniority, seat herself before the elder nun on a piece of cloth, grass, a mat, or a pure surface, join her palms, and speak these words:

'Hail, noble community of nuns! I, Guptā, have given birth to a boy child. I request the noble community of nuns for the vow to sleep in a single room together with my son. May the noble community of nuns, out of compassion and for the sake of compassion, grant Guptā the vow to sleep in a single room together with her son.'

This is to be said a second time and a third time.

Thereupon, let one of the nuns move Guptā from the place of hearing to a place where she may be seen, and say: 'Hail, noble community of nuns! A boy child has been born to Guptā. She has requested from the noble community of nuns the vow to sleep in a single room together with her son. If it is timely and agreeable to the noble community of nuns, let it assent. The noble community

of nuns grants Guptā the vow to sleep in a single room together with her son. This is the motion.'

The procedure is then as follows: 'Hail, noble community of nuns! A boy child has been born to this Guptā. She has requested from the noble community of nuns the vow to sleep in a single room together with her son. The noble community of nuns is granting Guptā the vow to sleep in a single room together with her son. Those among the noble community of nuns who consent to granting Guptā the vow to sleep in a single room together with her son: remain silent. Those who do not consent: speak.' The noble community of nuns has granted Guptā the vow to sleep in a single room together with her son. Since the community has consented and permitted, it remains silent; and so it is held to be.

Whatever nun has been given by the noble community of nuns the vow to sleep in a single room together with her son — she is permitted to sleep in a single room together with her son. On this point, let there be no doubt."

Guptā, however, continued to sleep there together with another nun as well, and the nuns who saw this told the monks. The monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Only the nun's own son may sleep together with her in a single room — no one else. Another nun must not stay there; if she does, she commits an offense. Guptā may sleep in a single room together with him even when he has grown up and become the great Kāśyapa the Elder." The nuns who witnessed this told the monks accordingly, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "When a nun's son has grown up, she may no longer sleep in a single room together with him. Train as the training has been prescribed."

The awakened one, the Blessed One, was residing at Rājagṛha in the bamboo grove of Kalandaka, in the cool forest. At that time, there dwelt in the city of Rājagṛha a yakṣa (Skt. yakṣa) named Sāta, who protected, guarded, and kept safe the learned, handsome, and eminent king of the land of Samānanda, together with his queens, the young princes, the ministers, and the people of the city and countryside. By that yakṣa's power, the wealth of the learned, handsome, and eminent king of Samānanda, of his queens, princes, ministers, and the people of the city and countryside increased and flourished; trees always bore flowers and fruit, rain fell in its proper seasons, the earth became laden with grain, and food offerings arrived in abundance. And from various villages, cities, provinces, royal residences, and outlying regions — ascetics,

brahmins, the poor, and the destitute all gathered in Samānanda, and the yakṣa Sāta likewise protected, guarded, and kept safe all of them.

Sāta had taken a wife of equal birth, and together with her he lived in joyful delight.

In the land of Gāndhāra there likewise dwelt a yakṣa named Pañcāla, who protected, guarded, and kept safe the king of Gāndhāra, his queens, the princes, the ministers, and the people of the city and countryside. By that yakṣa's power, the wealth of the king of Gāndhāra, his queens, princes, ministers, and the people of the city and countryside increased and flourished; trees always bore flowers and fruit, rain fell in its proper seasons, the earth became laden with grain, and food offerings arrived in abundance. And from various villages, cities, provinces, royal residences, and outlying regions — ascetics, brahmins, the poor, and the destitute all gathered in Gāndhāra, and the yakṣa Pañcāla likewise protected, guarded, and kept safe all of them. Pañcāla too had taken a wife of equal birth, and together with her he lived in joyful delight.

Then, at a later time, the yakṣa Sāta and the yakṣa Pañcāla both went to a gathering of yakṣas, and there the two became close friends with one another. Thereafter, the yakṣa Sāta would from time to time send Pañcāla gifts of flowers, fruits, and other produce from the land of Samānanda; and the yakṣa Pañcāla would likewise send the yakṣa Sāta gifts of flowers and fruits from the land of Gāndhāra. Growing ever more deeply friendly with one another in this way, the two again went together to the yakṣa assembly. There, the yakṣa Sāta spoke of his friend: two generations had passed, and yet his son, grandson, great-grandson,

and great-grandchildren — how could friendship among them be kept unbroken? So he spoke. Then the yakṣa Pañcāla replied: "Friend, excellent! I too have been thinking the very same thing. Therefore let us become kinsmen even before any children are born. If I have a son and you have a daughter, you shall give her to my son; and if you have a son and I have a daughter, then I shall give her to your son." The other said: "Friend, excellent — let it be so!" The two of them thus pledged kinship to one another before any children had yet been born, and departed.

Then, at a later time, the wife of the yakṣa Sāta became with child. When nine months had passed she gave birth to a daughter — well-formed, beautiful to look upon, lovely. At her birth all the clans of the yakṣas rejoiced. Those of his

own lineage and bloodline held a great birth-celebration and proceeded to the naming. When they deliberated on what name to give the girl, the kinsmen and friends said: "At the time of this girl's birth, all the clans of the yakṣas rejoiced; therefore let this girl be named Joymaker." And so she was named Joymaker.

The yakṣa Pañcāla of the land of Gāndhāra heard that a daughter had been born to the yakṣa Sāta in Rājagṛha, and he thought: "My friend has had a daughter — she will indeed become my daughter-in-law. It is proper that I send her gifts of clothing and ornaments." He then sent a letter to the yakṣa Sāta saying: "Dear friend, I have heard that you have had a daughter born to you and I am very glad. It is fitting that I send clothing and ornaments for my friend's daughter — please accept them." He also sent word: "Since we two are kinsmen, if you have a son, she is already promised to him." The yakṣa Pañcāla read the letter and thought constantly about when he would find a son, and took his pleasure in sport and enjoyment with his wife.

In their pleasurable enjoyment together a son was born to them. He too was of the same lineage and bloodline, and his kinsmen held a great birth-celebration and proceeded to the naming. When they deliberated on what name to give the boy, the kinsmen and friends said: "This boy is the son of the yakṣa Pañcāla; therefore let his name be Pāñcika." And so his name was set as Pāñcika.

The yakṣa Sāta of Rājagṛha heard that a son had been born to the yakṣa Pañcāla of the land of Gāndhāra, and he thought: "My friend has had a son — he will certainly become my son-in-law." He then sent him clothing and ornaments along with a letter: "Dear friend, I have heard that you have had a son born to you and I am very glad. It is fitting that I send clothing and ornaments for my friend's son — please accept them." Pañcāla read the letter and sent back word: "Then make ready the preparations for the wedding feast at which the bride will be received." The yakṣa Sāta read the letter and thought with satisfaction: "The girl Joymaker — I already gave her away before." He nurtured her and took his pleasure in sport and enjoyment with his wife. In their pleasurable enjoyment together his wife became with child, and on the very day she conceived, a crane cried out on the mountain. Nine months passed and she gave birth to a boy — handsome, beautiful to look upon, lovely — and at the very moment of his birth a crane again cried out from the mountain.

He held a great birth-feast befitting his lineage, of one blood with his own kind, and they proceeded to the naming ceremony. When it was deliberated what name the boy should be given, the kinsmen and friends said: "When he was conceived, a crane cried out from the mountain; when he was born, a crane cried out again; and his father is named Sāta. Therefore let this boy's name also be given in the line of Sāta" — and so his name was set as Sātakiri.

The boy Sātakiri was raised and nurtured and grew up. Then, some time later, the yakṣa Sāta passed away together with his wife, and Sātakiri became master of the household. Now the yakṣa girl Joymaker said to her brother Sātakiri that she wished to seize and devour the newborn children of the many people dwelling in Rājagṛha. He replied: "Sister, our father's home country is ruled by the wise, handsome, and noble king Manodatta, who constantly guards, protects, and shelters the queen, the youths, the ministers, the villages, the cities, and the people of the land. We belong to the class that must be thoroughly guarded. This is our own domain — and if others commit mischief here, it falls to us to stop them. Why then would it be fitting for you to act in this way? Turn back the resolve you have formed." But because she was possessed by the habitual tendency of a perverse aspiration from the past, she could not be restrained. Again she told Sātakiri that she wished to seize and devour the newborn children of the many people dwelling in Rājagṛha. Sātakiri recognized from the circumstances of the time that she could not be held back in this matter. He thought: "I cannot keep stopping this forever, and moreover, she was already given away earlier as a bride." So he sent a letter to the yakṣa Pañcāla, saying: "The girl Joymaker has now come of age — come here and take your bride." The yakṣa Pañcāla then arranged for the young yakṣa Pāñcika to take her as his bride, and she was led away to the land of Gandhāra. The young yakṣa Pāñcika sported and took his pleasure with her in every delight.

She was cheerful, bold, joyous, and grew greatly at ease. But at that time she told her husband that she wished to seize and devour the newborn children of the many people dwelling in Rājagṛha. He said: "Dear one, that is your home of kinship. If others commit mischief there, it is right that we should stop them — why then would you act in such a way? Turn back this improper resolve you have formed." But because she was driven by the habitual tendency of her former perverse aspiration, she merely sat in silence when he spoke, saying not a word.

She sported and took her pleasure with the young yakṣa Pāñcika, and gave birth to a son. A great birth-feast was held, and a name befitting their lineage was given. In like manner, a second time and a third, until she had borne five hundred sons, and the youngest of them all was named Joymaker. Now she had grown powerful through her sons, and when Pāñcika tried to restrain her he could not, and he became displeased and fell silent. Thereafter the yakṣa woman Joymaker went roaming and wandering wherever she wished, and she began to seize and devour the newborn children of the many people dwelling in Rājagṛha.

The many people dwelling in Rājagṛha went before King Bimbisāra and said: "Your Majesty, our newborn children are being seized. Whoever is doing us this harm is surely of the race of evil spirits." The king then commanded all those who held authority over every district: "Go and investigate who it is that is seizing the newborns of the many people dwelling in Rājagṛha." They set about searching with care and diligence. Yet even as they searched, the seizing continued and the harm grew great — and any woman who was with child was removed and placed in another district. The ministers then reported to King Bimbisāra: "Your Majesty, the harm has grown very great. Any woman who is with child is being removed and placed in another district." The king summoned his diviners and consulted them, and they replied: "Your Majesty, an enraged yakṣa is causing this harm. Make offering of torma at the yakṣa shrines and render worship and honor." The king then commanded his ministers: "Go and have proclamations made by drum throughout the city of Rājagṛha. Let all the many people dwelling in Rājagṛha, and all those who have come from other districts and towns, make torma offerings at the yakṣa shrines and render worship and honor." The ministers went and made the proclamation accordingly: "Hear, all you people of Rājagṛha, of the city, and of the various towns and districts who have come here — the king has declared: let all the many people dwelling in my realm, those who have come from cities and from every other district, make torma offerings at all the yakṣa shrines and render worship and honor." The many people dwelling in Rājagṛha then swept those city places clean of stones, pebbles, and dirt, sprinkled them with sandalwood water, and set out fragrant incense in individual bowls. They raised victory banners and divine victory-pennants, hung many silk streamers and garlands, and scattered diverse flowers, making those places as beautiful as the pleasure groves of the gods — like Joyous Heaven itself. Then torma offerings were made at all the yakṣa shrines, with full worship and honor. Yet

even so, Joymaker was not pacified.

Then the gods dwelling in Rājagṛha revealed to the many people there: "The yakṣa woman Joymaker has been seizing your children. You must all go to the Blessed One — it is the Blessed One who will tame her." But the people said: "That is not Joymaker; that is the Seizer! She is the one who has been taking our newborns!" And so the name Joymaker was reversed, and she came to be known instead as the yakṣa woman the Seizer.

The many people dwelling in Rājagṛha then went to where the Blessed One was. They prostrated at the feet of the Blessed One, touching their heads to the ground, and addressed him: "Blessed One, this yakṣa woman the Seizer has long harbored no enmity toward the many people of Rājagṛha — and now she bears enmity. She was no enemy — and now she has become an enemy. She was not estranged from them — and now she is estranged. She seizes newborns. Blessed One, out of compassion and loving concern, please do whatever is needed to tame the yakṣa woman the Seizer." The Blessed One, without saying a word, granted permission to the many people of Rājagṛha. Understanding that the Blessed One had granted permission by his silence, the many people prostrated at his feet, touching their heads to the ground, and departed from the Blessed One's presence.

Then, in the early morning, the Blessed One put on his lower robe and his Dharma-robe,

took up his alms bowl, went into Rājagṛha for alms, and returning from his alms round in Rājagṛha, took his meal. Having declined the offer of a second serving, he departed and went to the place where the yakṣa woman the Seizer dwelt.

At that time, the yakṣa woman the Seizer had left her child Joymaker at home and gone out to roam her territory. The Blessed One placed his alms bowl over the child and concealed it there, and then bestowed a blessing such that, just as the boys could not see the Blessed One, so too the Blessed One would be visible to all of them — that is, he rendered the situation so that she could not see the child, yet the child would be seen by all others.

Immediately, the yakṣa woman the Seizer returned from her wanderings and, not finding Joymaker, left that spot and looked around the entire neighborhood of the house, yet still could not find him. The other children said: "Joymaker cannot be found. They have not seen him. We have not seen him either." At these words she beat her breast; her color faded and joy left her. Her eyes

filled with tears, and she ran swiftly away, searching through the villages, the market districts, the streets, the crossroads, the three-way junctions, the pleasure parks, the gardens, the lakes, the ponds, the pools, the temples, the assembly halls, and all the other secluded dwellings of Rājagṛha — yet she did not find him.

Then, her hair disheveled and matted, she went mad, weeping and wailing: "Alas, my child! Alas, my father! Alas, Joymaker!" — calling out again and again. She searched through the villages, the towns, the outlying settlements, the royal palace, and all the palace precincts, yet still found him not.

Then she went to the great ocean in the east, and then to the oceans of the south, the west, and the north. In those four directions too, he was nowhere to be found.

Her hair now wild and matted, emaciated, she wandered aimlessly — leaping up, falling down, crawling on the ground, moving on her knees, crouching — and in this manner she crossed the seven black mountains of Jambudvīpa (the southern continent) and searched among the seven golden mountains, the snow mountains, the great lake Anavatapta, and the fragrant mountain ranges. Still weeping loudly, she searched through the eastern continent of Pūrvavideha, the western continent of Aparagodānīya, and the northern continent of Uttarakuru — yet she found him not.

Then she searched through the hells: the Sañjīva, the Kālasūtra, the Saṃghāta, the Raurava, the Mahāraurava, the Tāpāna, the Pratāpāna, the Avīci, the Arbuda, the Nirarbuda, the Aṭaṭa, the Hahava, the Huhuva, the Utpala-like, the Padma-like, the Mahāpadma-like, and all the rest — yet she did not find him.

Then she climbed to the first terrace of Mount Meru, and from there to the second and the third. Without asking the lord of the yakṣas, Maṇibhadra, she searched the realm of the Thirty-Three Gods, going through the pleasure groves called Varied Chariots, Becoming Rough, Mingling, and Delight, and went as far as the pārijāta (coral tree) and the kuvīdāra tree.

Then she entered into the divine assembly known as Sudharmā, the beautiful city. Just as she was making her way toward Sudharma, the palace of Śakra (Indra), the lord of the gods, she was seized by the yakṣa Vajrapāṇi and many other yakṣas and a thousand gods, and was quickly and swiftly expelled from the beautiful city. She went off to another direction and wept at length until at last she was utterly exhausted and despairing. She went to the presence of

Maṇibhadra, lord of the yakṣas, threw her body down upon a flat rock, and lamented, saying: "Alas, my child! Alas, my father! Alas, Joymaker!"

"Great chieftain, if someone has taken him and you are unhappy, please ask that your child be returned to you," she said. Then Maṇibhadra, the great king of the yakṣas, consoled her and said, "Come now, let go of your grief and wipe away your tears. Stay in your own dwelling and watch carefully to see who comes." She replied, "The chieftain is the ascetic Gautama." He then said to her, "Go to him, take refuge in the Blessed One, and he will show you your child Joymaker."

Like one who has found back what was thought to be lost with one's very life, she went quickly and swiftly to her own dwelling. The yakṣinī Aprāptā beheld the Blessed Buddha adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being, his body graced with the minor marks of excellence, ornamented with a radiant aura of light surpassing a thousand solar rays, moving in their midst like a mountain of precious jewels. The moment she saw him, joy arose in her, and thinking "I will find my Joymaker," she went to where the Blessed One was. She prostrated with her head at the feet of the Blessed One and sat down to one side.

Seated to one side, the yakṣinī Aprāptā addressed the Blessed One in these words: "O Gautama, please show me my son Joymaker. It has now been a long time since I last saw my son Joymaker."

The Blessed One said to the yakṣinī Aprāptā, "Aprāptā, if you have many children, how many do you have?"

She replied, "Blessed One, I have five hundred children."

The Blessed One said to Aprāptā, "You have five hundred children — what harm is it if you are missing just one?"

She then said, "Blessed One, if I cannot see my Joymaker, I will vomit hot blood and surely die."

The Blessed One said, "Aprāptā, even though you suffer so greatly at not seeing one of your five hundred children, you have yourself killed and eaten children who had only that one child — what must their suffering be like?"

She replied, "Blessed One, their suffering must be far greater than mine."

The Blessed One then declared, "Aprāptā, knowing what separation from a child feels like, why would you eat the children of others?"

She said, "Blessed One, please tell me what I should do."

The Blessed One said, "Come here, take refuge in me, accept the training precepts, grant fearlessness to the many people dwelling in Rājagṛha, and you will certainly see your son Joymaker right here before long."

She then said, "Venerable one, from this day forward I take refuge in the Blessed One, accept the training precepts, and grant fearlessness to the many people dwelling in Rājagṛha." And so it was that she took refuge in the Blessed One, accepted the training precepts, and granted fearlessness to the many people dwelling in Rājagṛha.

The Blessed One then showed her where her son Joymaker was, and he too took refuge in the Blessed One, accepted the training precepts, and granted fearlessness to the many people dwelling in Rājagṛha.

At the time when Aprāptā had taken refuge in the Blessed One, accepted the training precepts, and granted fearlessness to the many people dwelling in Rājagṛha, the monks arose with doubts, and to resolve all their doubts they asked the Blessed Buddha: "Venerable one, what karma did the yakṣiṇī Aprāptā perform? Through the maturation of what karma was she born as a yakṣiṇī with such a ravishing appearance, and in this life gave birth to five hundred children?"

The Blessed One declared, "Monks, the karma that Aprāptā performed and accumulated, and the conditions that have ripened — these stand close at hand like a river, and will inevitably come to pass. The karma that Aprāptā performed and accumulated cannot be experienced by another. Monks, karma performed and accumulated does not ripen within the external earth element, nor within the water element.

nor within the fire element, nor within the wind element. Rather, karma — whether virtuous or non-virtuous — that has been performed ripens within these very appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources. As it is said in verse:

Actions are never lost,
even after hundreds of aeons have passed.
When the time and conditions converge,
they ripen as fruit for embodied beings.

Monks, in the distant past, in another city within this very Rājagṛha, there lived a cowherd. He took as his wife a woman of equal station, and together they

enjoyed themselves in playful delight. Through that joyful union, after some time the wife became with child.

Now, in a period when no buddha appears in the world, a pratyekabuddha arises, dwelling in compassion for those who are weak and lowly — and in the end, a single worldly benefactor with warm devotion. At a certain point, another pratyekabuddha was wandering through the countryside and came to Rājagṛha. At that time, a festival was drawing near in the city of Rājagṛha. On the eve of the celebration, about five hundred revelers, carrying clean and well-prepared food and provisions, wrapped in garments of many colors, adorned with sweet-smelling flowers, dancing and singing and beating drums, were on their way to a pleasure grove — and along that path came a cowherding woman in the prime of her youth, carrying a brimming pot, walking down the road. The revelers, seeing her, called out, "Come, friend! Join the singing!" She, for her part, followed along with whatever they did, dancing exactly as they danced — and in doing so, her womb miscarried.

Enraged by this, she offered five hundred ripe mango fruits to the pratyekabuddha and made this aspiration: "By the root of this virtue, wherever and whenever I am born, may I be born as a ravishing yakṣinī, and may I seize and devour the sons and daughters of the people of Rājagṛha. And may I myself give birth to five hundred children."

Monks, the one who at that time was the wife of the cowherd is the very Aprāptā of the present. It is by the force of that aspiration that she has been born in such a manner.

The Vinaya Miscellany, the forty-first fascicle.

The narrative occasion is at Śrāvastī. The Blessed One had declared that nuns should not reside in forest hermitages. When those nuns entered into meditative concentration at market places, at the scales, and at crossroads, this too became an occasion for offense. When this had come about, the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One thereupon declared, "Therefore let the nuns reside in a rain-season dwelling." When faithful brahmin householders and laymen heard that the Blessed One had granted permission for nuns to have rain-season dwellings, they built nuns' rain-season lodgings outside the city. But then ruffians, the sons of ferrymen, and uncouth young men took advantage of this to harass the nuns. When this had come about, the monks reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared, "Therefore let nuns' rain-season dwellings not be built outside the

city, but within the city."

The narrative occasion is at Śrāvastī. The nun Sthūlanandā was sitting at the door of the rain-season dwelling and was mocking brahmins and householders, who in turn heaped insults and abuse upon her. When this had come about, the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One reflected: the one who has become the occasion for offense is the nun who is sitting at the door of the rain-season dwelling. Therefore, having resolved that nuns should not sit at the door of the rain-season dwelling, the Blessed One declared to the monks: "Monks, brahmins and

householders are given to mockery — therefore a nun must not sit at the door of the rain-season dwelling. If a nun sits at the door of the rain-season dwelling, she incurs a transgression.

The narrative occasion is at Śrāvastī. After the Blessed One had declared that a nun must not sit at the door of the rain-season dwelling, Sthūlanandā sat at a window and again mocked brahmins and householders, who in turn mocked her to her face, just as before. This continued until the rule was laid down: a nun must not sit at a window. If a nun sits at a window, she incurs a transgression.

In brief: the saṃkakṣikā garment is permitted. One must not bathe at a bathing place used by men. One must not go to market stalls. Through these, ordination is complete.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was staying at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The nuns were wearing all five Dharma-robles in the rain-season dwelling while performing all their tasks, and they became distressed. When the nuns heard how things stood, they told the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Therefore, let the nuns wear the saṃkakṣikā garment and perform all the tasks of the rain-season dwelling." Then when brahmins and householders came to the rain-season dwelling and saw the nuns working while wearing the saṃkakṣikā, they became attached. Others of different faith mocked them. When the monks heard how things had come about, they reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, brahmins and householders are given to mockery — therefore a nun must not wear the saṃkakṣikā and perform tasks in front of brahmins and householders. If a nun wears the saṃkakṣikā and performs tasks in front of brahmins and householders, she incurs a transgression. When performing tasks in the presence of brahmins

and householders, she should cover her shoulders with the saṃkakṣikā and then, wearing the saṃkakṣikā, perform all her tasks."

The narrative occasion is at Śrāvastī. Sthūlanandā bathed at a bathing place used by men, and when young boys saw her, they pointed her out to one another, saying: "Look! That shaven-headed śramaṇī — her body is like a doe in the forest!" When the nuns heard how things had come about, they told the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Whoever is a nun who bathes at a bathing place used by men is a basis for offense. Therefore, having resolved that a nun must not bathe at a bathing place used by men, he declared to the monks: Monks, brahmins and householders are given to mockery — therefore a nun must not bathe at a bathing place used by men. If a nun bathes at a bathing place used by men, she incurs a transgression.

The narrative occasion is at Śrāvastī. Sthūlanandā sat at a crossroads and jeered at brahmins and householders, and they mocked her in return, saying: "Look at this shaven-headed śramaṇī sitting at the crossroads — she is mocking us!" When the nuns heard how things had come about, they told the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, brahmins and householders are given to mockery — therefore a nun must not go to market stalls. If she goes, she incurs a transgression."

The narrative occasion is at Śrāvastī.

The venerable Upāli then asked the Blessed One: "Venerable one, the Blessed One has declared that Gautamī, the great mistress of beings, went forth and received full ordination by accepting the eight chief rules, and thereby became a fully ordained nun. Does it follow that those five hundred nuns as well became fully ordained nuns by accepting the eight chief rules, going forth, and receiving full ordination?" Upāli replied: "Those five hundred nuns also went forth and received full ordination by accepting the eight chief rules, and thereby became fully ordained nuns."

In brief:

Just as in the case of one with the two marks,
and likewise one who is stopped up with mud,
and one who always discharges blood,
and finally one who has no blood at all.

The Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. There at Śrāvastī, another nun gave full ordination to a person with two sex characteristics, and that person displayed those characteristics to the nuns. The nuns asked her, "Sister, what kind of being are you?" and she replied, "I am great — I have two sex characteristics." When things had come about in this way, the nuns reported it to the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, a person with two sex characteristics is a hermaphrodite. You monks must expel that person with two sex characteristics. Monks, a person with two sex characteristics cannot undergo ordination in this Dharma-Vinaya. Therefore, when anyone who wishes to go forth comes before you, you must ask that person: 'Are you not a person with two sex characteristics?' If ordination is given without asking, it entails an offense."

The narrative occasion is at Śrāvastī. There at Śrāvastī, another nun gave full ordination to a woman who was stopped up, that is, whose internal passages were blocked. She went to the latrine to urinate, but defecation also occurred, and having evacuated both, she withdrew. Then another nun entered that place and, seeing that the latrine was defiled by excrement, asked her, "Sister, who has defiled this latrine with excrement?" That woman replied, "I am great — it was I who defiled it through carelessness." The nun asked her, "Sister, what careless thing did you do?" She replied, "I am great — I am a woman who is stopped up. When I intended to urinate, defecation came as well. What could I do?" When things had come about in this way, the nuns told the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, you must expel that stopped-up woman. Monks, this Dharma-Vinaya is not a place of ordination for a stopped-up woman. Therefore, when anyone who wishes to go forth comes forward, ask whether she is not a stopped-up woman. If ordination is given without asking, it entails an offense."

The narrative occasion is at Śrāvastī. There at Śrāvastī, another nun gave full ordination to a woman who always discharged blood. The place where her lower garment rested became defiled with blood and was filled with insects. A nun asked her, "Sister, do you always discharge blood?" She replied, "Elder sister, what is to be done? I always discharge blood." When things had come about in this way, the nuns told the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, a woman who always discharges blood is a hermaphrodite woman. You monks must expel her. One who always discharges blood cannot undergo ordination in this

Dharma-Vinaya."

Therefore, whenever someone who wishes to go forth comes before a nun, that nun must ask her: "Are you a woman who always discharges blood?" If she gives full ordination without having asked, she incurs an offense carrying a remainder.

The originating case was at Śrāvastī. At Śrāvastī, another nun ordained a woman who had no menstrual flow. Because that nun had not abandoned attachment, the nuns would bleed at their time, and when she saw this, she said to the senior nuns: "What, are you thinking perverse thoughts? Why are you discharging blood? Sisters, what is wrong with you? Women by their very nature are this way — why do you not discharge?" She herself replied: "As for me, I have no blood — why would I discharge blood?" When things had come about in this way, the nuns told the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, a woman who has no menstrual flow is a hermaphrodite woman. You monks must expel her. Monks, one who has no menstrual flow cannot undergo ordination in this Dharma-Vinaya." Therefore, whenever someone who wishes to go forth comes before a nun, that nun must ask her: "Are you a woman who has no menstrual flow?" If she gives full ordination without having asked, she incurs an offense carrying a remainder.

In brief:

One who has only the mark of a woman, or a mole-mark, must also be bound by the cord in that case.

She may not receive the gesture of spitting, nor take on the form of a monk, nor may a nun give her confession.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At Śrāvastī, another nun ordained a woman who had only the mark of a woman. That woman entered the privy for a long while and then came out. The nuns asked her: "Sister, you were in there a long time — what were you doing?" She replied: "Elder sisters, I have only the mark of a woman; I do not have complete female characteristics. What am I to do?" The nuns asked her: "Sister, are you not a woman who has only the mark?" She replied: "Elder sisters, I have only the mark." When things had come about in this way, the nuns told the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, a woman who has only the mark is a hermaphrodite. You monks must expel her. Monks, this Dharma-Vinaya cannot

accommodate ordination for one who has only the mark." Therefore, whenever someone who wishes to go forth comes before a nun, that nun must ask her: "Are you not a woman who has only the mark?" If she gives full ordination without having asked, she incurs an offense carrying a remainder.

The originating case was at Śrāvastī. Because she had not abandoned attachment, by reason of previous karmic fault, a nun would from time to time discharge blood from her female organ, and the places where her lower garment rested became defiled, filled with insects, and unsightly. Although the nuns washed and treated the garment, it would return to the same state. When things had come about in this way, the nuns told the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Therefore, monks, let nuns wear a menstrual pad." When the Blessed One had said that nuns were to wear a menstrual pad, the nuns began to wear menstrual pads. Then at a later time, the joyful Nandā went out for her alms round, and her menstrual pad fell in the street. Some boys and girls who were playing in the street saw it and asked: "Noble one, what has fallen?" She was angered by what they said and replied: "Go and ask your mother's daughter and your sister about it right now, and they will show you." When the nuns heard what had happened, they told the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared:

Therefore, monks, a nun must not carry a menstrual pad in the bare manner described above. She should fasten it at the waist with a cord. In that way it will not become an occasion for offense.

The setting is Śrāvastī. On one occasion, the venerable Mahākāśyapa dressed in the morning, put on his lower robe and outer robe, took up his alms bowl, and entered Śrāvastī on his alms round. Pom-delight saw him from a distance and went to him quickly, hurrying along the road, and said "Utterly senseless fool!" and spat on him. He said to her, "Sister, you have done no wrong yourself, yet the venerable Ānanda has permitted women who engage in seriously improper conduct to go forth in the well-proclaimed Dharma and discipline, receive full ordination, and be accorded the status of nuns — and that is the reply to your question." When the monks heard what had happened, they reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, Pom-delight is not a contemplative, not a nun. Even a prostitute would not do to a monk what Pom-delight did. Therefore, a nun must not spit at a monk." The Blessed One so declared. If a nun spits at a monk, she incurs a transgression.

The setting is Śrāvastī. At that time another monk committed a transgression. He saw a nun and said, "Noble one, please wait a moment." She asked, "Noble one, what is it?" He said, "Noble one, I have committed a transgression and I confess it before you." She sat down, and he sat before her and said, "Please attend, noble one. I, the monk known by such-and-such a name, have committed such-and-such a transgression. I confess it before you, noble one. I acknowledge it, I do not conceal it. By confessing and acknowledging it I will come to ease; without confession and acknowledgment there is no ease." She asked, "Noble one, have you also committed such-and-such a transgression? What you have done is wrong." The monk was ashamed. When the monks heard what had happened and reported it to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, monks, a monk must not confess a transgression in front of a nun. He should confess before a monk who holds a compatible pure view. If a monk confesses a transgression before a nun, he incurs a transgression."

The setting is Śrāvastī. At that time another nun committed a transgression. She saw a monk, and together with the act of paying respect she prostrated at his feet and said, "Noble one, please be compassionate and remain a moment." He asked, "Noble one, what is needed?" She said, "Noble one, I have committed a transgression, and I confess it before you, noble one." He sat down. She too prostrated at his feet, sat before him, joined her palms, and said, "Please attend, noble one. I, the nun known by such-and-such a name, have committed such-and-such a transgression. I confess this transgression before you, noble one. I acknowledge it, I do not conceal it. By confessing and acknowledging it I will come to ease; without confession and acknowledgment there is no ease." He said, "That you, noble one, should have committed a transgression of such a form — that the noble one has done wrongly." The nun was ashamed. When the monks heard what had happened and reported it to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, monks, a nun must not confess a transgression before a monk who is her monastic father, before a fully pure nun of compatible view. If a nun confesses a transgression before a monk, it becomes a matter of the past and is done with."

In brief:

Let the monks perform the formal act;
let the nuns examine it.

Seats and small seats shall be provided,
but cushioned ones are not to be given.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The Blessed One had declared that the formal acts of the monastic fathers and the formal acts of the nuns were to be separate, with the exception of communal acts. When the nuns performed acts in the presence of the monastic fathers and then became frightened, they did not dare to perform those acts. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Let the monks perform the formal act; let the nuns examine it."

The Blessed One having declared, "Let the monks perform the formal act; let the nuns examine it," the nuns did not know how to carry out this examination. They reported this to the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Nuns should attend carefully and know: this is the petition; this is the first proclamation; this is the second; this is the third."

The occasion for this was at Śrāvastī. When the Blessed One announced that a Dharma teaching was to be proclaimed and the monks had not laid out seats, the Blessed One said, "Lay out seats." Then on a later occasion, when a Dharma teaching was announced, nuns came and sat on cushioned small seats and began to listen to the Dharma. At that point, another nun who had not been mindful had a discharge of blood and soiled the cushioned small seat, rendering it unfit. When the teaching was finished and the officer in charge of seats began to gather them in, he found one small cushioned seat that had been rendered unfit, full of blood-stains. The monks reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, monks, a cushioned small seat is not to be given to nuns who come to hear the Dharma, and they are not to sit on cushioned small seats."

The Blessed One having declared that cushioned small seats were not to be given to nuns who came to hear the Dharma, the monks accordingly gave those who came to hear the Dharma uncushioned small seats. Then it happened that a great lay patroness came to hear the Dharma, and they gave her too an uncushioned small seat. She said, "Noble ones, even when I lived in a household I never lacked for a cushioned small seat." The monks replied: "Gautamī, the Blessed One has not permitted it — he has declared that cushioned small seats are not to be given to nuns who come to hear the Dharma." She replied: "Noble ones, what fault of mine is the same as that of nuns who are not mindful?" When the monks reported this to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, monks, it is permitted: for those nuns

who are mindful, when they come to hear the Dharma, cushioned small seats shall be given to them. Have no doubt in this matter."

In brief:

With women who sell liquor or sell their bodies,

or with servant women — one must not make contact.

One should not strike a person with a harmful garment or the chest.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time, the nun Sthūlanandā, in the early morning hours, having donned her lower robe and outer robe and taken up her alms bowl, entered Śrāvastī on alms round. While she was on her alms round, she saw a certain housewife who was well dressed, wearing a fine lower garment and fine ornaments. That woman, upon seeing her, asked: "Sister, where did you get your robes and ornaments?" She replied: "Noble one, I sell liquor — it is from that that I obtained all of these." Sthūlanandā thought to herself: "This is quite a good method — let me see whether it would work for me or not." With that in mind, she kept that woman in view and followed her mindfully. A little further on, she saw another woman in a dirty garment, with no food, walking slowly and staggering on her feet. She asked her: "Girl, whose are you?" The woman replied: "I belong to no one. I work for whoever gives me food and clothing." Sthūlanandā then said to her: "In that case, girl, why don't you engage in selling liquor?" The woman replied: "Noble one, is it really right to engage in selling liquor as things stand? To begin with, one needs a great deal of capital. And even if there is a supply of grain, there are no large comfortable premises where vessels and drinkers may be at ease." Sthūlanandā said: "Girl, I will arrange all of that, and I will give you food and clothing as well — just give me everything you earn." The woman replied: "Noble one, very well, I shall do so." Sthūlanandā had a building erected near the winter quarters and gave her grain, vessels, and supplies. The woman set up a liquor business there, and the liquor turned out to be excellent, so that drinkers gathered there in great numbers. Seeing this, the other liquor sellers became jealous. Sthūlanandā's own gains increased.

Then at another time, liquor was needed at the royal palace, and when the king's men rounded up all the liquor sellers, the jealous ones among them said to the king's men: "There is a liquor seller of Sthūlanandā's near the winter quarters — take that liquor seller too." The men seized her and took her away. She began to cry out: "Noble Sthūlanandā, the king's men are taking me away!" Sthūlanandā rushed off at a quick pace and said to the children of the

grain merchants: "Where are they taking this girl of mine?" They replied: "Noble one, is she not a liquor seller who tramples on and presses down those who are unfriendly to her, and sells liquor? Does the noble one also have enemies?" She said: "You yourselves are my great enemies — that is why you have taken my girl away," and she began to quarrel with them. Brahmins and householders who witnessed the quarrel asked: "What is all this?" When those people explained the matter in detail, they mocked and reviled them, saying: "The ascetics who are sons of the Śākyas are truly disgraced! That an ascetic, a shaveling, should be engaged in selling liquor — ascetics and brahmacharins are utterly disgraced!"

When the monks heard what had happened, they reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Sthūlanandā has brought great disgrace upon the ascetic life. Therefore, monks, nuns must not sell liquor. If one does so, there is an offense with expiation."

The setting of this rule is Śrāvastī.

Then the nun Sthūlanandā, in the early morning hour, dressed in her lower robe and outer robe, took up her alms bowl, and entered Śrāvastī for alms. While she was going on her alms round, she saw a prostitute wearing a particularly fine dress and lower garment, adorned with excellent ornaments. When the prostitute saw her, she asked: "Sister, where did you come by such clothes and ornaments?" The prostitute replied: "Noble one, I obtained these things by practicing prostitution." Sthūlanandā thought to herself: "That method seems good — but will it succeed or not? I shall look into it," and she went on her way, keeping that woman in mind with full awareness.

After some time, in another place, she saw a girl whose clothes were soiled, who could not even obtain food, and who walked with a slow and listless gait, yet who had a beautiful face. She asked: "Girl, whose daughter are you?" The girl replied: "Noble one, whoever gives me food and clothing, for that person I will also do work." Sthūlanandā said to her: "Then, girl, why not become a prostitute?" The girl covered her ears and said: "Noble one, please do not speak like that! Such disgraceful things as that have never been done by anyone in my family before." Sthūlanandā said: "If that is the nature of a woman's way of life, then the daughter of so-and-so the king has done just that — she became a prostitute — and so it went for her. The daughter of so-and-so the brahmin likewise. Even among the highest families, many have done such things. Though a woman's mind turns toward men, if I had not gone

forth into renunciation, I too would have done something like that — but having gone forth, it is uncomfortable." Thus deceiving her, she said: "Noble one, does one practice prostitution like this? Noble one, if one is to practice prostitution in this way, one needs many supplies: a large house where many men can gather, and many fine clothes, ornaments, ointments, food, and drink." Sthūlanandā said: "Girl, if I provide all of that, and you give me all the earnings you receive, then I will supply you with food, clothing, and everything else." The girl replied: "Noble one, very well — I will give the earnings just as you say."

Sthūlanandā had a house built for her near the winter quarters, gave her everything as she had promised, then had her bathed and given fine clothes and ornaments. After several days had passed, the girl, young and beautiful in form, was made into the figure of a prostitute and installed there. Driven and tormented by affliction, men all gathered there. When another prostitute saw her, jealousy arose in her heart and she could not bear it. Sthūlanandā's earnings grew greatly.

Then, at a later time, there was a great festival at the royal palace. A large quantity of perfumes was needed, and the king's men, in order to apply perfumes, gathered all the prostitutes together. Out of their jealousy, those other prostitutes said to the king's men: "Near the winter quarters there is one who prostitutes herself for Sthūlanandā — bring her along as well." The men seized that girl and took her away. She wept and cried out: "Noble one, Sthūlanandā, I am being taken away by the king's men!" Sthūlanandā ran quickly and shouted: "Sons of that slave woman! Where are you taking my girl?" They replied: "What? Does the noble one also practice prostitution? You crush others underfoot, trampling them under the heel of your enemies! What — does the noble one also have enemies? Since you have taken my girl, you yourself are the greatest among my enemies!" While they were quarreling, brahmins and householders saw them and —

They asked her what had happened, and she told them everything in detail. Thereupon they mocked and reviled her with harsh words: "The śramaṇas (renunciants) of the Śākya's sons are thoroughly disgraced! Both śramaṇas and those of pure life are disgraced! Now even a śramaṇa who has shaved her head is practicing prostitution!" So they mocked her.

When the monks heard what had happened, they reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One considered the matter: Sthūlanandā has done

something unbefitting a śramaṇa. Therefore, with the intention that nuns should not be allowed to practice prostitution, he thought: Monks, since Sthūlanandā has done something greatly unbefitting a śramaṇa, it is fitting that brahmins and householders should mock, revile, and speak ill of her. Therefore nuns shall not be permitted to practice prostitution. If a nun permits prostitution, it shall become a grave offense. The origin of this rule is at Śrāvastī.

Then one morning Sthūlanandā dressed in her lower robe and outer robe, took up her alms bowl, and went into Śrāvastī on alms round. As she went on her alms round, she saw a maidservant wearing fine clothes, a fine lower garment, and fine ornaments. Seeing her, Sthūlanandā asked: "Sister, where did you find such fine clothes and ornaments?" The maidservant replied: "Noble one, I practice prostitution privately in a certain place, and that is how I obtained these." Sthūlanandā thought: That is a good method. Let me see whether this might work. Keeping that thought in mind, she went on her way mindfully observing the matter. Before long she saw a girl wearing soiled clothes, without food, walking slowly and looking worn, and she asked her: "Girl, whose are you?" The girl replied: "I belong to no one in particular. I work for whoever gives me food and clothing." Sthūlanandā said: "Girl, if that is so, why not practice prostitution privately?" The girl covered her ears and said: "Noble one, do not say such a thing! No one in our family has ever done anything like this before — it is wholly improper!" Sthūlanandā then said: "My girl, this is the nature of women. Even a king's daughter does it; even the daughter of such-and-such a brahmin does it; many women of great families have done likewise. Women set their minds on men. As for me, I have gone forth into renunciation, so it would not be fitting for me to do it." With these words she deceived the girl, and then said: "Noble one, as for how to practice prostitution privately — many supplies are needed for that. First, clothes and ornaments are needed. After that, a tent and a large net, and a man to act as a pimp. When rowdies come, one needs companions to deal with them. And to attract many men and keep them pleased, liquor, perfume, and cosmetics are needed." Sthūlanandā replied: "Very well then, I will provide everything — clothes, food, and all the rest. You give me everything you earn." The girl said: "Good, I will give it all." Then Sthūlanandā had her bathed, gave her clothes, ornaments, and the requisites of one dwelling in a monastery, kept her and looked after her for a few days, then provided a tent, sent a pimp to go with her, and directed her to go to the monastery and take up prostitution

privately. Before long she was caught and arrested, and was brought before Sthūlanandā. Then Sthūlanandā ran quickly and cried out: "Sons of that slave woman! Where are you dragging my girl?"

They said to her: "Noble lady, are you also privately engaged in prostitution?" And pressing her down with the heel of the enemy, they forced her to do it. She replied: "Noble ones, do you also have enemies? It is you yourselves who are my great enemies, for you have carried off my girl." Brahmins and householders who saw them fighting asked: "Hey, what is all this?" And they explained in detail what had happened. Those people mocked and reviled them harshly, saying: "The asceticism of the ascetics who are sons of the Śākyan is utterly scorched. The conduct of ascetics and those of holy life is utterly scorched. Now this ascetic, this shaved-head woman, is privately engaged in prostitution!" — and so they jeered.

When the monks heard what had occurred, they reported it to the Blessed One, the Buddha. The Blessed One, seeing that the nun Sthūlanandā had done something greatly unfitting for an ascetic, and intending thereby that nuns should not engage in private prostitution, declared: "Monks, it is an established fact that the brahmins and householders mocked, reviled, and spoke harshly — for Sthūlanandā did what is unfit for a nun. Therefore, monks, do not allow a nun to engage in private prostitution. If a nun allows private prostitution to take place, it becomes a grave transgression."

The basis for the minor Vinaya. The forty-second fascicle.

The setting is in Rājagṛha. At the time when some acrobats were levying fines against the Six Groups in the midst of a large crowd, the Six Groups conferred with one another among themselves. One of them said: "When the acrobats levy a fine against us here in the midst of a crowd — if the Twelve Groups do not give that fellow, the son of Buzanmo, a bowl and robe, and if he is thereby unable to pay the fine against us — then the time has now come. Tell us, what is the plan?" Neyagawa said: "What else is there to do? Let us go and give him a thorough beating." Another also said: "Yes, let us do exactly that." Having thus decided, they went to him. They caught sight of Sthūlanandā. Among themselves they said: "This is the chief among them — let us beat this one." And they struck her with open palms, sticks, clods of earth, cudgels, and fists. When the beating was done, she smeared her body with sesame oil and lay reclining upon a latticed couch.

When the nuns saw her, they asked: "Noble lady, what wrong have you done, that you should be like this?" She replied: "I have been beaten." They asked: "By whom?" She answered: "By the noble Six Groups." The nuns said: "What did you do?" She replied: "Sisters, those people who are of the clan of Dharma's kinsmen — it is wrong to speak ill of them. As for teaching and instructing a younger sister, there is surely no harm in that." Then the nuns felt indignant: "How could monks beat nuns?" When the nuns had said this to the monks, the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One considered the matter: "That which constitutes the wrongful act of which one can be accused is monks striking nuns." Therefore, intending that male monks should not be permitted to beat nuns, the Blessed One declared: "Monks, it is an established fact that the nuns felt indignant at what the Six Groups of ascetics did. Therefore, monks, it is not permitted for a monk to strike a nun. If a monk strikes a nun, he incurs a transgression along with what has already passed."

The setting is in Śrāvastī.

The Blessed One declared to the nuns that they should wear a menstrual cloth. When one of them wore the menstrual cloth, blood dripped through it, soaked the lower robe, and formed drops, and bees swarmed about her in every direction. She stood there overcome with shame and dread. When matters had come to this pass, the nun reported it to the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Therefore, monks, nuns should wear a protective cloth." When the Blessed One declared to the nuns that they should wear a protective cloth, they did not know how such a protective cloth should be made. The Blessed One then declared: "Wear an inner lower wrap." When they began wearing the inner lower wrap, blood dripped down even through that. When things came to this pass as well, the nuns reported it to the monks, the monks reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "At regular intervals wash it and dye it. Nuns should at all times maintain mindfulness and sleep with mindfulness in place. If a nun sleeps without mindfulness in place, she incurs a transgression along with what has already passed."

The setting is in Śrāvastī. At that time, a monk called Gunā of the Mūla group passed away. The Twelve Groups performed offerings for him, burned the body, and then struck their own chests in grief. The nuns mocked them, saying: "How could nuns strike their chests like that?" When matters had come to this pass, the nuns reported it to the monks, the monks reported it to the

Blessed One, and the Blessed One considered the matter: "The Twelve Groups of nuns have acted improperly. Therefore, intending that nuns should not strike their chests, the Blessed One declared: "Monks, the Twelve Groups of nuns mocking the nuns for acting improperly is an established fact. Therefore, nuns should not strike their chests. If nuns do strike their chests, they incur a transgression along with what has already passed."

The setting is in Śrāvastī. The venerable Upāli asked the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, if a nun has become known by a name, what should be done regarding her ordination in relation to monks?" The Blessed One declared: "Upāli, place her among the monks according to however many years have elapsed since she first became known by that name. She will be fully ordained and will have the standing of a male monk."

In brief:

A nun is placed among monks as one who has come from the nuns. She is not to be placed in every circumstance without qualification. Even through a messenger, likewise, full ordination is permitted — so has the great sage allowed.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was residing in Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. Then the venerable Upāli addressed the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, you declared that if a nun has become known by a name, she should be placed among the monks from the beginning, according to the number of years that have elapsed. Does this mean that if a monk has become known by a name, he too should be placed among the nuns from the beginning, according to the number of years elapsed?" The Blessed One replied: "Upāli, if a monk has become known by a name, he should indeed be placed among the nuns according to the number of years elapsed. But Venerable One, if either a monk or a nun has been so placed, and then becomes known by a name again from that placement, what should be done in that case?" The Blessed One declared: "Upāli, place them again as is appropriate."

The setting is in Śrāvastī. Then the venerable Upāli addressed the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, you declared that if either a monk or a nun has become known by a name twice, they should be placed wherever is appropriate.

"Venerable One, if from that placement a person becomes known by a name a third time, what should be done in that case?" The Blessed One declared:

"Upāli, in no circumstances whatsoever is such a person to be placed. Upāli, if someone has become known by a name a third time, the property of the monk and the property of the nun are immediately, in every respect, to be treated as forfeited. Have no doubt about this."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. In one part of Śrāvastī there lived a householder named Datta. He was very wealthy, with abundant riches and great means of enjoyment, prosperous and vast in his holdings, possessing wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, heaped up like the treasures of Vaiśravaṇa. He had taken a wife from a family of equal standing, and together with her he lived in delight and enjoyment. In another part of Śrāvastī there lived a householder named Mṛgadhvaja. He too was wealthy, with abundant riches and great means of enjoyment, prosperous and vast in his holdings, possessing wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, heaped up like the treasures of Vaiśravaṇa. He too had taken a wife from a family of equal standing, and together with her he lived in delight and enjoyment.

Each of the two was rivalrous with the other in wealth. One would say, "Your means of livelihood fall short of mine." The other would say, "Your means of livelihood fall short of mine." Thus they spoke. The two, however, became friends with one another, and from time to time the one would send gifts, and the other would likewise send gifts in return, and in this way the two became mutually dear friends.

Then some time later it happened that many people living in Śrāvastī had some business to attend to. They all went together to the pleasure grove, assembled there, conducted the affairs of the city, and then departed. The householder Datta and the one named Mṛgadhvaja sat together there exchanging affectionate conversation with one another. The householder Datta said: "Dear friend and companion, even after we ourselves have passed on, let us find a way to keep the bond of friendship unbroken, continuing among our children, our grandchildren, our great-grandchildren, and our great-great-grandchildren. What means shall we use to accomplish this?" Mṛgadhvaja replied: "Friend, excellent! I too have had that very thought. Come, let us arrange the kinship before the birth. If a son is born to me and a daughter is born to you, then you shall give her to my son. And if a son is born to you and a daughter is born to me, then I shall give her to your son." The other replied: "Friend, excellent! Let it be just so." And having arranged the kinship between each other before any birth had occurred, they departed.

Then some time later the wife of the householder Datta became with child, and after eight or nine months had passed she gave birth to a daughter — a child of fine form and pleasing to behold, well endowed with limbs and features, yet one who cried constantly. Then monks came to the home of the householder Datta to teach the Dharma, and at that time she pricked up her ears and listened. On the twenty-first day, the seventh day of the third week, a great birth-feast was given with lavish celebration, and they set about naming her. They deliberated: "What name shall we give this girl?" The family members said: "This girl always desires the Dharma, pricking up her ears to listen to it, and she is the daughter of the householder Datta; therefore let the girl be named Dharmadattā." The girl Dharmadattā was entrusted to eight nurses: two to suckle her, two to nourish her, two to bathe and cleanse her, and two to play with her. Raised and nurtured by those eight nurses, on milk, yogurt, fresh butter, and clarified butter,

and other special provisions of excellent food that had been properly prepared, she grew quickly, like a lotus born from the mud of a pond.

Now the householder Datta heard that a daughter had been born to his friend, the householder Mṛgaśabda. Thinking, "Since my friend's daughter has been born, I shall send her garments and ornaments" — for he had it in mind that she might become his daughter-in-law — he sent her garments and ornaments, along with this message: "Dear friend, I have heard that a daughter has been born to you, and I rejoice greatly. I send these garments and ornaments for my dear friend's daughter; it is fitting that you accept them." Mṛgaśabda accepted them and sent back the reply: "Dear friend, what you have done is excellent, and kinship has now been made. Should a son be born to you, I shall give her to him." When the householder Mṛgaśabda heard that reply, with a son in mind as his wish, he devoted himself fully to sporting pleasure with his wife. From that sporting pleasure, after some time his wife conceived a being in the womb, and when eight or nine months had passed, she gave birth to a son. After his birth, a grand birth-feast was held for him with lavish celebration for twenty-one days, through three weeks of seven days each, and they deliberated: "What name shall we give this boy?" His family members said: "This boy was born under the lunar mansion Viśākhā, and so let his name be Viśākha." And so his name was set as Viśākha.

The boy Viśākha too was entrusted to eight nurses: two to suckle him, two to nourish him, two to bathe and cleanse him, and two to play with him. Raised

and nurtured by those eight nurses on milk, yogurt, fresh butter, and clarified butter, and other special provisions of excellent food that had been properly prepared, he grew quickly, like a lotus born from the mud of a pond.

When the householder Datta heard that a son had been born to the householder Mṛgaśabda, he thought: "A son has been born to my dear friend. Before this slips away, he should become my son-in-law. I shall send him garments and ornaments." And so he sent him garments and ornaments along with this message: "Dear friend, I have heard that a son has been born to you, and I rejoice greatly. I send these garments and ornaments for my dear friend's son; it is fitting that you accept them." Mṛgaśabda accepted them and sent back the reply: "Dear friend, raise a daughter, and once she is born I will take her." Datta said: "It would be good to give a daughter. Let it be so." When the daughter Dharmadattā was born, she wished to go forth into homelessness, and she bowed at her father's feet and said: "Father, I request that you allow me to go forth into the well-proclaimed Dharma, the Vinaya." He replied: "Daughter, you were previously given to Mṛgaśabda's son Viśākha; he is your husband. It is no longer appropriate to grant this." And so he did not grant it.

At that household there came from time to time a fully ordained nun named Utpalavārṇā, who taught the Dharma to the assembled family. Dharmadattā said to her: "Noble one, I wish to go forth, to take full ordination, and to attain the state of a fully ordained nun in the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, but my father does not permit it and keeps me back, and he will not let me go forth. Could you yourself bring about my going forth right here?" The nun replied: "Daughter, it is good that you have aroused such a mind. Sensual pleasures offer little happiness yet bring great suffering and many faults; to go forth is wholesome. The Blessed One, when a wise person sees five faults, declared that it is not fitting to resort to the five sensual pleasures. What are the five? When a wise person rightly sees that sensual pleasures offer little happiness yet bring great suffering and many faults, it is not fitting to resort to them.

When a wise person rightly sees that resorting to sensual pleasures causes the proliferation of binding tendencies (saṃskāras), it is not fitting to resort to sensual pleasures. When a wise person rightly sees that resorting to sensual pleasures brings no satisfaction whatsoever, no contentment, no sense of enough, it is not fitting to resort to sensual pleasures. When a wise person rightly sees that resorting to sensual pleasures leaves no evil deed undone, it

is not fitting to resort to sensual pleasures. When a wise person sees that sensual pleasures are, by every account of this kind, what the buddhas, the śrāvakas of the buddhas, the learned, the rightly faring, and the holy persons have abandoned, it is not fitting to resort to sensual pleasures.

And when a wise person sees five virtues, it is fitting to have faith in going forth. What are the five? When a wise person sees that one will thereby attain a purpose unmixed with defilement, it is fitting to have faith in going forth. When a wise person sees that those who were once one's servants, one's commissioned agents, one's messengers, one's workers, and those who did whatever one pleased will in turn come to venerate and praise one, it is fitting to have faith in going forth. When a wise person sees that one will thereby attain the unsurpassed bliss of yogic practice and nirvāṇa, it is fitting for one to have faith in going forth. Even if one does not yet succeed in attaining the unsurpassed bliss of yogic practice and the passing beyond sorrow, when a wise person sees that one will be reborn among the gods, it is fitting to have faith in going forth. When a wise person sees that the virtues of the gone-forth life are praised by the buddhas, the śrāvakas of the buddhas, the learned, the rightly faring, and the holy persons, it is fitting to have faith in going forth.

"It is excellent that you have aroused such a mind. Go now and present your request to the Blessed One."

Thereupon the nun Utpalavarṇā went to where the Blessed One was. On arriving, she bowed her head to the Blessed One's feet, paid homage, and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the nun Utpalavarṇā addressed the Blessed One: "Venerable One, a girl named Dharmadinnā, daughter of the householder Datta, wishes to go forth into renunciation and receive full ordination in this well-taught Dharma and Vinaya, and to attain the full status of a nun. Yet the householder Mṛgasvara's son Sāga holds her under his authority and has not given his consent; he constantly guards her and will not allow her to go forth to freedom. I beg the Venerable One's permission."

The Blessed One then addressed the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, go and tell the nuns as follows: 'The daughter of the householder Datta, named Dharmadinnā, may be sent for by the nun Utpalavarṇā in that very house. Let her be given the three refuges and the five bases of training, and in that very place I grant permission for her to go forth into renunciation.'"

"Venerable One, so shall it be done," Ānanda replied. The venerable Ānanda then, having heard from the Blessed One, transmitted the instruction to the

nuns. The community of nuns instructed the nun Utpalavarṇā and sent her as their messenger. She went there and told the girl that the Blessed One had also given his permission. The community of nuns then gave her the three refuges and the five bases of training for a laywoman. "You have now gone forth; the ten bases of training are also given to you. In regard to these and these particular bases of training, take them up and restrain yourself in accordance with how they are to be trained."

At this, she was filled with great joy. And as she was filled with great joy —

The nun Utpalavarṇā then preached the Dharma in such a way that the girl would perfectly realize the Four Noble Truths. The moment Dharmadattā heard this teaching, the twenty peaks of the mountain of the view of a transitory collection were struck down by the vajra-like wisdom, and she actualized the fruit of stream-entry.

The nun Utpalavarṇā then reported this to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Go, venerable Ānanda, and convey this message to the community of nuns: let Dharmadattā remain there in that very place, and let Utpalavarṇā be sent as the messenger to give her, for two years, the training in the six rules and the six rules to be followed."

Venerable Ānanda replied, "So be it, Blessed One," and having heard the instruction from the Blessed One, he conveyed it to the community of nuns. The community of nuns then instructed the nun Utpalavarṇā and sent her as their messenger. She went there, and the community of nuns gave the girl the vow of training in the six rules and the six rules to be followed for two years, saying: "You have now become a probationary nun. You must do this and this. Restrain yourself in accordance with how each basis of training is to be trained."

Then, having heard such a Dharma teaching, Dharmadattā actualized the fruit of once-return.

And so it was that as Dharmadattā trained in the six rules and the six rules to be followed for those two years, she became youthful in form. She was fair and beautiful in appearance, and all the people of the household delighted in her and looked upon her with favor.

The householder Mṛgadhvaja then heard that the girl Dharmadattā had become youthful. He sent word to his friend, the householder Datta, saying: "Your son has become youthful, and the girl too has become youthful. Examine

what day would be auspicious and take her as your son's wife." His friend replied in a message: "Very well, let it be so." The householder Datta assembled astrologers and had them determine what day would be auspicious for sending the girl as a bride. They calculated a favorable time and indicated the wedding day. Likewise, the householder Mṛgadhvaja also indicated the day for receiving the bride.

The householder Datta then sent word to his friends, brothers, and relatives: "At such and such a time, the girl Dharmadattā is to be sent as a bride. Come, brothers and relatives and kinsmen, to accompany her and give your support." The householder Mṛgadhvaja likewise sent the same message to his own friends, brothers, and relatives. The households of both families were filled, as their friends, brothers, relatives, and many attendants arrived and gathered in great numbers at Śrāvastī.

Word also spread that the queens, princes, ministers, many people, and the people of the provinces of Prasenajit, king of the land of Kosala, were giving the daughter of the householder Datta to Mṛgadhvaja to be his bride, and that friends, brothers, relatives, and many people were gathering there from their respective quarters. The king told his ministers: "You too, attend to the affairs of these two families." And those ministers sent messages to the local governors and those of royal lineage in each district, saying: "Bring together whatever provisions you have in your region; I myself will bring and assemble them. Let everyone gather here." As soon as they heard this, each one assembled their wealth and came to Śrāvastī. Hundreds upon thousands of sentient beings thus gathered there. The ministers then prepared the gardens, the nearby groves, and the parklands of Śrāvastī, and —

All the surroundings of that place were swept clean of the outside. Stones, weeds, and lumps of earth were cleared away and removed. The ground was sprinkled with sandal-scented water in even, measured strokes. Bowls of fragrant incense were purified and set to left and right. Banners and victory standards were raised, and silk streamers were hung out. Flowers of every variety were scattered about. The whole place was made to resemble the joyous groves and pleasure gardens of the delightful gods.

Then Dharmadattā, seeing that the preparations were being made, said to the household servants: "What is this festival that is happening out of season?" They replied: "By the power of your previously accumulated store of virtue, a great festival has been convened outside its proper time — it has been

convened out of season in order to send you off as a bride. All these guests have come for that purpose." When she heard this, she was frightened and prostrated at her father's feet, saying: "Father, I ask a boon of you. Mother, may I go to the nunnery known as the Royal Garden, which serves as the rains retreat quarters for the nuns? Please allow it." He replied: "Daughter, before you were born, I gave you in betrothal to the householder's son Mṛgadhvaja of Sāgala. I no longer have authority in this matter. He is your husband. Moreover, King Prasenajit of the land of Kośala is here, along with his queen consort, young attendants, male servants, female servants, and many people, as well as many people who have come from various regions. If all this were known, how could I now grant you what you ask? Would I really want my beloved friends, brothers, and kinsmen to be imprisoned and put to death? You must go tomorrow as a bride. My dear ones, my people, my relatives, and many folk are assembled here — do not speak of this. You are very young and do not understand. Abandon the practice of the holy life." So he instructed her.

She, however, strove diligently and entered into the cultivation of the path, turning the mind toward the way, but she could not find the means to free herself from desire. Yet throughout all this, there was not even the slightest thing unknown, unseen, unrecognized, or unperceived by the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, endowed with great compassion, dwell for the benefit of the world. They are the single protector, the sole hero. They teach what is non-dual and beyond duality. They abide in calm abiding and special insight. They are skilled in the three objects of discipline and have crossed the four rivers. The soles of their feet are perfectly and permanently established in the four bases of miraculous power. They are unshaken by the four fearlessnesses. They have abandoned the five limbs. They have truly passed beyond the five births. They possess the six limbs. They have fully perfected the six perfections. They constantly engage in the six modes of conduct. They are adorned with the flowers of the seven branches of awakening. They hold the noble eightfold path. They are skilled in entering meditative absorption through the nine successive stages. They are endowed with the strength of the ten powers. Their renown resounds and spreads throughout the ten directions. They have attained supremacy over the thousand-fold realm. Three times by night and three times by day, with the eye of a buddha, they survey the world and engage their vision of primordial wisdom, looking to see: who is declining, who is increasing; who has come to suffer, who is in distress, who has been harmed; who is in difficulty, distress,

and pain; who is tending toward the lower realms; who is falling into the lower realms; who has already fully fallen into the lower realms — and who among them they shall draw out of the lower realms and firmly establish in higher states and in liberation; whose roots of virtue have not yet arisen they shall cause to arise; those whose roots of virtue have arisen they shall bring to full maturation; and those who have matured they shall cause to be fully liberated. With this vision they looked.

And then it was spoken in verse:

That ocean, the dwelling of sea-monsters —

Though they may slip past their appointed time,
for those disciples who are yet to be trained,
a buddha does not pass beyond at the wrong moment.

Then the Blessed One smiled, and such being the nature of reality, whenever a blessed buddha smiles, rays of light in colors of blue, yellow, red, and white stream forth from his mouth. Some of these rays descend downward, and some ascend upward.

Those that descend enter the hells — the Hell of Revival, the Black Line Hell, the Hell of Crushing, the Hell of Crying, the Hell of Great Crying, the Hot Hell, the Very Hot Hell, the Hell of Ultimate Torment, the Blistering Hell, the Bursting-Blister Hell, the Ah-ha-ha Hell, the Ha-ha Hell, the Hu-hu Hell, the Blue-Lotus Hell, the Lotus Hell, and the Great-Lotus Hell — and when they descend into whichever hot hell it may be, that place becomes cool; and when they descend into whichever cold hell it may be, that place becomes warm. Through this, the particular suffering of those sentient beings is relieved and turned to ease, and those beings think to themselves: "Oh — have we died and passed away from here? Or have we been reborn somewhere else?" To arouse faith in them, an emanation of the Blessed One is sent to that place. When they behold the emanation, they think: "We have not died or been reborn elsewhere — yet through the power of this being, whom we have never before seen, our particular suffering has been turned to ease." From this direct and heartfelt faith in the emanation, those beings exhaust the karma of their suffering in the hells, and they then take rebirth, as gods or humans, wherever they are fit vessels for the noble ones' truths.

As for the rays that ascend upward, they proceed to the assemblies of the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, and then to the

gods of the Brahmā realms — the Brahma Retinue, the Brahma Ministers, the Great Brahma — and on to the gods of Lesser Light, Limitless Light, Radiant Light, the gods of Lesser Virtue, Limitless Virtue, Abundant Virtue, the Cloudless gods, the gods of Merit-Born, the Great-Result gods, the gods who are not too exalted, the gods without affliction, the gods of Clear Vision, the gods of Beautiful Sight, and the gods of the Akaniṣṭha heaven. Going to all these, the rays proclaim the words: "Impermanence, suffering, emptiness, selflessness" — and also recite these two verses:

Seek out the occasion for arising;
apply yourselves with diligence to the Buddha's teaching.
Crush the armies of the lord of death
as a herd of yaks crushes a grass hut.
Whoever practices with heedfulness
in this Dharma and its discipline
will empty out the round of birth
and make an end of suffering.

Then those rays of light circle the great trichiliocosm, the realm of the three thousandfold worlds, and return to trail along behind the robe of the Blessed One.

Now, if the Blessed One intends to prophesy about the past, the light does not appear at the back of his robe. If he intends to prophesy about the future, it does not appear at the front. If he intends to prophesy a birth in hell, it does not appear at the soles of his feet. If he intends to prophesy a birth as an animal, it does not appear at the heels of his feet. If he intends to prophesy a birth as a hungry ghost, it does not appear at the toes of his feet. If he intends to prophesy a birth as a human, it does not appear at the knees. If he intends to prophesy birth as a wheel-turning king who rules by the power of force, it does not appear at the palm of the left hand. If he intends to prophesy birth as a wheel-turning king who rules by the Dharma-wheel, it does not appear at the palm of the right hand. If he intends to prophesy a birth as a god, it does not appear at the navel.

If he intends to prophesy awakening as a śrāvaka, it does not appear within his mouth. If he intends to prophesy awakening as a pratyekabuddha, it does not appear at his ūrṇā hair. If he intends to prophesy unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, it does not appear within his uṣṇīṣa.

Then those rays of light circled the Blessed One three times and disappeared into his mouth. Thereupon the venerable Ānanda joined his palms together and addressed the Blessed One in verse:

Adorned with a thousand colors of varied hues,
many rays stream forth from within his mouth,
illuminating all directions as they blaze —
just as the rising sun lights up the world.

Then he spoke further in verse:

Without agitation, without displeasure, with pride cast away,
the buddha has become the supreme cause for beings.
Without cause, the roots of the white conch and the lotus —
the Protector, steadfast as the ocean and the mountains.
Without cause, the Victor who has vanquished the foe does not smile,
does not show a smile.
Now I myself have understood, and with an mind of discernment
I wish to hear from the king of victors.
O Sage, best of the herd, by your firm and excellent words,
please dispel the supreme doubt that has arisen.
For what reason did the Steadfast One show a smile?
These many beings here wish to hear.

The Blessed One declared: "It is so, Ānanda. Without cause and without condition, Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas do not smile.

Ānanda, you sent the girl Dharmadinnā away without transmitting the blue-lotus color, and by my word she was released from the community of nuns. Beginning with the three refuges she was ordained in stages, and for two years she was also given the vow of training in the six rules and the six rules that follow them. Tomorrow she will be sent away, and for that reason — do you see the multitude assembled there?" "Venerable one, I see them." "Ānanda, that girl has no occasion and no place to remain as a laywoman in a household, no place to fully indulge in the enjoyment of sensual pleasures for the sake of pleasure — she will not remain in such a state. Rather, she will now attain the fruit of non-return and will actualize arhatship.

Ānanda, go and instruct the nuns thus: Dharmadinnā has trained for two years in the six rules and the six rules that follow them; now release her, the one of blue-lotus color who has not been transmitted, and grant her the vow that

generates pure conduct." "Venerable one, I shall do so."

The venerable Ānanda received this from the Blessed One, instructed the nuns accordingly, and the community of nuns sent off the one of blue-lotus color who had not been transmitted with the instruction: "Go, girl. The community of nuns grants you the vow that generates pure conduct; now you are to receive full ordination."

As soon as she heard this Dharma teaching of that kind, she immediately actualized the fruit of non-return and accomplished miraculous power. Utpalavarṇā then went and addressed the Blessed One. The Blessed One spoke to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, go and instruct the nuns thus: I have given leave; let the two assemblies of the Saṅgha release Utpalavarṇā who had not been transmitted, and fully ordain the girl Dharmadinnā." "Venerable one, it shall be done so." The venerable Ānanda received this from the Blessed One and gave the instruction to the nuns.

The assembly of nuns, having convened both assemblies of the Saṅgha together, fully ordained Dharmadinnā by messenger while she remained in that very house, through the agency of Utpalavarṇā. Utpalavarṇā then went to her and declared: "You have been given leave by the Blessed One and fully ordained by both assemblies of the Saṅgha." This Dharma teaching was also spoken to her, and upon hearing it, the nun Dharmadinnā came to know the turning and the non-turning of the five spokes of the wheel of cyclic existence. She fully broke through by means of the dharmatā — the nature of reality — in which all conditioned things disintegrate, all transgressions scatter and are destroyed, and all mental afflictions are abandoned. She actualized arhathood and became an arhat: freed from attachment to the three realms, equal in her regard for gold and clods of earth, her mind like open sky to which a palm cannot adhere, equally at ease with a thorn and with sandalwood. By her direct knowledge she broke the door-panel of the charnel ground. She attained the higher knowledges, the superknowledges, and the discriminating awarenesses; she turned her back on any desire for further existence and on all honors; and she became an object of offering, of reverence, and of words of praise from lords of the senses, their attendants, and the gods. An arhat nun with all defilements exhausted has no place remaining as a householder dwelling in a house; it is no place for her to enjoy the pleasures of desire for the sake of delight.

When Dharmadinnā actualized arhathood, she said at that very moment to her parents: "Father and mother, I have actualized arhathood. Please give me leave to go to the nuns' rains-retreat house in the king's pleasure garden." The householder Datta consulted with his wife, and the two of them spoke together, saying: "If it is like this with our daughter, surely the king would not reproach us. Let us proceed in due order, and let her go together with the Blessed One." She replied: "Excellent! I shall do so." Thereupon the householder Datta invited the Blessed One, the Buddha, together with the assembly of monks to his house. He sent word: "My dear friend, the householder Mṛgāradatta's daughter Dharmadinnā cannot remain in the house — she will certainly go forth — so come here, and do press her firmly to accept it." The householder Mṛgāradatta, for his part, went to report to Prasenajit, king of Kosala, and then set about gathering friends, brothers, relatives, and many people.

The householder Datta, that same evening, prepared pure and wholesome food and provisions. Rising early in the morning, he spread out seats, filled water vessels and set them in place. Having invited the Blessed One, he sent word: "Venerable one, come for the meal — but even by the time of the midday shadow, if it should fall, may the Blessed One please consider that the time has come." Then the Blessed One, in the forenoon, put on his lower robe and took up his bowl and outer robe, and surrounded by many monks, with the assembly of monks going before him, he proceeded to the dwelling of the householder Datta. Upon arriving there, he took the seat that had been spread out before the assembly of monks and sat down.

Then the householder Datta, surrounded by friends, siblings, and relatives, and knowing that the Buddha and the assembly of monks were seated comfortably, served and properly presented pure and wholesome food and provisions with his own hands until all were satisfied.

At that time the householder Mṛgāradatta, together with friends, siblings, relatives, young people, ministers, townspeople, and many people of the realm, celebrated the protection of the auspicious planetary conjunction, performed auspiciousness and peace ceremonies, and set out to claim the bride — and they took up their station right at the very gate of the householder Datta's house.

The householder Datta then served the Buddha and the community of monks with his own hands, giving them the rinse water and satisfying all. Having

properly attended to them, he discerned that the Blessed One had finished eating and withdrawn his alms bowl, and placing a low seat, he settled down together with his friends, siblings, and relatives before the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One properly instructed, exhorted, gladdened, and rejoiced the householder Datta together with his friends, siblings, and relatives through a Dharma discourse. Having properly instructed, gladdened, and rejoiced them with the Dharma discourse in its many categories, he rose from his seat and departed.

The nun Dharmadattā, for her part, had attained the antidote to all three realms and attained fearlessness.

When the time for fetching the bride had arrived, the householder Mṛgāradatta, his son Puṣya, together with friends, siblings, relatives, young people, ministers, townspeople, and many people of the realm, offered various kinds of music there.

Dharmadattā, wishing to follow the Blessed One, and just then the householder Mṛgāradatta's son Puṣya suddenly extending his arm reached out to seize Dharmadattā by the hand — whereupon Dharmadattā, in full sight of countless hundreds of thousands of sentient beings, spread her wings like the king of geese and soared into the sky, displaying miracles of many kinds.

Then the householder Mṛgāradatta's friends, siblings, and relatives, young people, ministers, townspeople, many people of the realm, the householder Mṛgāradatta's son Puṣya, and all the other sentient beings who had gathered to watch were overcome with great amazement. Falling at her feet as if cut down from the root of a tree, they said: "If this sister has attained such abundant qualities, this is no time and no place for you to indulge in desire — we beg your forbearance."

Then Dharmadattā descended from the sky and sat down before the great multitude. She taught the Dharma in such a manner that the hundreds of thousands of sentient beings who heard it realized it with exceptional clarity. Some of them actualized the fruit of stream-entry, some the fruit of once-returning, some the fruit of non-returning, and some — having gone forth into renunciation under the Blessed One's teaching and abandoned all afflictions — actualized arhathood. Some aroused the awakening mind aimed at the awakening of a hearer, some at the awakening of a solitary buddha, and some at the unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. Of that entire

assembly, the great majority were directed toward the Buddha, drawn toward the Dharma, and settled with firm faith in the Saṅgha.

Then the nun Dharmadattā, having obtained what she had obtained and found abundance, having accomplished this great benefit for sentient beings, went to where the Blessed One was. She prostrated with her head at the feet of the Blessed One and then departed from the Blessed One's presence.

The Blessed One then declared to the monks: "Among my fully ordained nun-disciples, śrāvikā-nuns who are masters of Dharma discourse, this nun Dharmadattā is supreme."

The monks, having generated a doubt and wishing to have all doubts cut through, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One: "Venerable sir, what did the nun Dharmadattā do that, while still living in a household, she went forth through her own power, received full ordination, attained the status of a nun, and right then and there actualized arhathood?"

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, the merit that the nun Dharmadattā created and accumulated through her actions, and the conditions that supplied it, stand close at hand like a river — it is beyond doubt. What Dharmadattā created and accumulated through her actions cannot be experienced by another.

Monks, karma that has been created and accumulated does not ripen in the external earth element, nor in the water element, nor in the fire element, nor in the wind element. Rather, it is in these very appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense bases that virtuous and non-virtuous actions ripen into their results.

Actions are never lost,
Even across a hundred aeons.
When the time arrives and conditions meet,
Their fruit ripens for those who bear a body.

Monks, long ago, in this very fortunate aeon, when the life span of beings was twenty thousand years, a teacher named Kāśyapa appeared in the world — a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened buddha, accomplished in knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide and charioteer of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, an awakened and blessed one — and he dwelt in the city of Vārāṇasī, in the Deer Park of the Hermitage of the Seers.

At that time there lived in Vārāṇasī another householder who had taken a wife of equal birth, and together the two of them lived in delight and enjoyment. While they thus enjoyed their delight, after some time his wife became pregnant. Eight or nine months passed, and a daughter was born to them. For twenty-one days — three sets of seven — a great birth celebration was held with great festivity, and a name fitting her lineage was given to her.

When she had grown up and her body was mature, she wished to go forth into renunciation, but her parents would not grant her permission to go forth. There was another, elderly nun who taught Dharma to that household and who came to that home from time to time. The young woman said to this elderly nun: "Noble one, I wish to go forth and receive full ordination in this well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya and attain the state of a fully ordained nun. But my parents do not permit it and will not let me leave the household. Is it possible for me to go forth right here in this very place?"

The elderly nun told the girl to request this of the Blessed One, and said it could be done. She then requested the perfectly and fully awakened Blessed One Kāśyapa, who sent a messenger. And so, while the girl remained in her home, she was caused to go forth, the vows of a fully ordained nun were conferred upon her, and full ordination was given by the dual assembly of the Saṅgha. The elderly nun then taught her the Dharma, and while still living in the household she actualized arhathood directly.

Then the elderly nun thought: "Everything that happened — this girl's going forth by means of a messenger while still in her home, her receiving the training vows and full ordination, her actualization of arhathood while still in the household — all of this came about through me. Through the roots of virtue from living the holy life during the time of the perfectly and fully awakened Blessed One Kāśyapa, the perfectly and fully awakened Blessed One Kāśyapa gave this prophecy to the young brahmin student Guru: 'Brahmin's son, when the life span of beings is one hundred years, you shall become a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened buddha named Śākyamuni.'

In the light of that teaching, it was I who, while still in a household, caused the going forth by messenger, and obtained the training vows and full ordination —

and obtained the status of a fully ordained nun, and while remaining in a household, she actualized the state of an arhat. Just as my own preceptress

was praised as foremost among those who speak on the Dharma by the Blessed One, the perfectly and fully awakened Tathāgata Kāśyapa, so too may I be praised as foremost among those who speak on the Dharma by Śākyamuni, the Blessed One, the Śākya King." Thus she spoke.

"What do you think, monks? That elderly nun is none other than the nun Dharmadinnā here today. In a single lifetime she lived the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One, the perfectly and fully awakened Kāśyapa, and through the power of her aspiration she went forth from the household while still living there, by means of a messenger; she received the training vows and full ordination; she obtained the status of a fully ordained nun; while remaining in the household she abandoned all afflictions and actualized the state of an arhat; and the Tathāgata praised her as foremost among those who speak on the Dharma.

"Therefore, monks, karma that is wholly dark ripens in a wholly dark way. Karma that is wholly bright ripens in a wholly bright way. Karma that is mixed ripens in a mixed way. Therefore, monks, abandon karma that is wholly dark and mixed, and accomplish only karma that is wholly bright. Monks, train yourselves accordingly."

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, those monks, rejoicing in what the Blessed One had taught, were greatly pleased.

The Supplementary Rules of the Vinaya, the forty-third bundle. In brief:

A monk outside need not be asked for patience.

One who scrapes alone does not scrape.

A summer dwelling is not to be assigned to a secular person.

The body of a respectful son is not to be washed.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. A certain nun was receiving reading instruction from a monk. Then on a later occasion she committed a fault, and he rebuked her for it. She went to the summer dwelling and sat there weeping. Her preceptress saw her and said, "Young one, what fault have you committed that you sit here weeping?" The nun replied, "I do not know what to do when my teacher and preceptress rebuke me." The preceptress said, "My child, what else is there to be done? The teacher and preceptress do so only to maintain the teaching. Go and ask for forbearance." She agreed and said, "Very well, I shall go and ask for forbearance," and she went to the Jeta Grove, but the monk was not to be seen. She searched for him, and after some time found

him walking about in the walkway outside the shrine hall. She prostrated at his feet, and the monk went away disrespectfully. Some novices who saw this, impelled by their own afflictions, taunted her, saying, "Noble one, we know you intend to ask for his forbearance — if he will not accept it, come here, and we will accomplish your purpose for you." She, out of shame, went away without saying a word.

The monks, having heard what had happened, reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One reflected: when the one who has given rise to an offense is rebuked by a nun and she then goes to ask forbearance, the monk leaves without showing proper respect, and the novices, for their part, conceive unwholesome thoughts about the matter from the outside. Therefore the Blessed One, understanding and knowing that a nun should not ask a monk for forbearance outside the shrine hall, and that the monk should not go away showing disrespect toward the nun, declared: "Monks, the novices will conceive unwholesome thoughts about the matter from the outside. Therefore a nun shall not ask an angry monk for forbearance outside the shrine hall."

Even so, if a nun has asked a monk for forbearance and he has shown disrespect, she should not leave. A nun may ask a monk for forbearance outside the shrine hall. But if a monk shows disrespect toward a nun who is asking him for forbearance and then departs, both of them will have incurred a transgression.

The occasion for the next rule arose in Śrāvastī. Some monks had their hair cut by a barber, and afterward, when that barber became a youth, he was not applying mindfulness. He saw some of them and became attached. When the monks heard what had happened, they reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, the mind is excitable; when mindfulness is not applied, one will be led astray. Women in general have very strong desire. Therefore, nuns shall not have their hair cut alone in the presence of a barber. Instead, let another nun be stationed with her. And if that barber becomes attached, the nun who is seated nearby should speak thus: 'Good friend, the body of this nun is a mechanism of bones; it is without adornment and the body is impure. She has gone forth — abandon such thoughts as these. How unfortunate it would be to fall into the hells!' And if the barber still becomes attached, speak to him again in these words: 'Sister, you have abandoned household work. Reflect on what you undertook before the Saṅgha of both orders at the time of your full ordination. The Blessed One has declared that sensual desire offers little pleasure but much suffering and is rife with faults

for the objects it fixates upon. Abandon improper mental engagement and remain close in spirit to the going-forth.' If she speaks to him in that way, well and good. If she does not speak, then the nun who is seated nearby will have incurred a transgression."

The occasion for the next rule also arose in Śrāvastī. The nun Sthūlanandā converted another householder to faith and had him build a rain-season dwelling, and a large number of nuns came to stay there. Around that time, approximately five hundred merchants carrying goods arrived in Śrāvastī from the south. Those merchants looked throughout Śrāvastī for a house to store their goods but could not find one. They searched everywhere in the city and still found nothing. At the time of the market, they gathered and set out their goods at a crossroads of the bazaar and at the roadside. Then thunder rumbled, the sun was drawing near to setting, and a light rain fell. They were standing there agitated, supporting themselves by leaning on their arms against their sides. Sthūlanandā saw them and said: "Good friends, rain is falling — why are you standing at the roadside? Why not store your goods somewhere? What harm could there be?" They replied: "Noble one, we searched throughout all of Śrāvastī, but the people of the world are unfriendly and we could not find a house to rent — what are we to do?" She then said: "Boys, go seek a house for the night, find out what kind of conditions you need, and offer extra payment." And she added: "As for this market situation, it will not do, and if the rain soaks everything, who will buy?" They replied: "Noble one, these people here are unfriendly — we offered them double rent for their houses and still no one gave us even one." "That is my own doing," she said. "Whatever it may be, one night and then we move on." Then she said to them: "Boys, pay extra rent for the house and take shelter inside my rain-season dwelling." They replied: "Noble one, excellent — so be it." Thereupon Sthūlanandā drove the nuns out of the rain-season dwelling that evening and rented it out to those merchants. The nuns, with their Dharma robes soaking wet from the rain, went off to another rain-season dwelling.

The nuns of that place asked them: "Noble ones, why have you come here in the evening with your Dharma robes soaking wet?" And they explained it in full detail. The nuns of Doṇamatī rebuked and scolded her harshly: "How could it be fitting for a nun to rent out a house that a donor had built as her rain-season dwelling?" When the monks heard what had happened, they reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One then declared: "Monks, it is indeed a case for rebuking nuns. Therefore, nuns must not rent out their

rain-season dwellings. If a nun rents out her rain-season dwelling, she incurs a transgression."

The setting for the next matter is also in Śrāvastī. The nun Sthūlanandā entered the bathing place where some young boys were washing themselves, and dragged them and bathed them with a scrubbing cloth. Those boys became attached to her and kept looking at her, saying among themselves: "Look there — that female ascetic, with her shaved head, is like a great warrior wearing armor, yet she has been wiping and scrubbing her body outside." They ridiculed her, and because of their ridicule, those boys burst out laughing. When the monks heard what had happened, they reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One, considering the matter and knowing that those young boys' behavior was a case for ridicule and that they had acted improperly, declared: "Monks, Sthūlanandā is unattractive and has acted badly, making herself an object of ridicule for those young boys. Therefore, nuns must not wipe their bodies with a scrubbing cloth. If nuns wipe their bodies with a scrubbing cloth, they incur a transgression."

In brief:

One must not wipe the body with a scrubbing cloth,
nor likewise with flat stones.

Nor with a cloth binding, nor with a fist —
by nothing whatsoever may one wipe.

The Blessed One, the awakened one, was dwelling in Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The Blessed One had declared that nuns must not wipe their bodies with a scrubbing cloth. When they wiped with a flat stone, that too became a basis for transgression. The Blessed One declared they must not wipe with a flat stone. When they wiped with a cloth binding, that also became a basis for transgression, and the Blessed One declared they must not wipe with a cloth binding. When they wiped with a fist, that too became a basis for transgression, and the Blessed One declared they must not wipe with a fist. When they wiped with whatever else they could find, that too became a basis for transgression. The Blessed One then declared: "Except with a single hand alone, by no means whatsoever may one wipe. If one does wipe in this way, one incurs a transgression."

Here ends the seventh chapter of the Vinaya on minor matters.

The summary verse:

Honor due to a nun — diminishing it,

giving instructions, and an iron vessel,
looking by two women,
and likewise the dark Udika.

In brief:

Without respect, and not universal,
except for the displaying of the body.
Not giving from what is snatched away;
from the restoration ceremony and from the training.

The Blessed One, the awakened one, was dwelling in Śrāvastī, in the garden of the Jeta Grove. At the time when the venerable Grelaskyé passed away, a group of twelve nuns gathered his bones together, and with great veneration they built a stūpa in a wide and spacious place. They adorned it with parasols, victory banners, and pennants, decorated it with fragrances and flowers, and appointed two eloquent nuns there, so that each day they would offer earth, water, incense, and flowers.

Then, for the monks who came from other regions, they washed their hands and provided them with flowers and incense, leading them in venerating the stūpa with the singing of verses. After some time had passed, the venerable Chutung, together with a retinue of five hundred, was travelling through that region and came to Śrāvastī. Arhats do not look with their wisdom-vision without first directing their attention, so it was only at a distance that he saw the stūpa, and he thought: "This is a stūpa built on a site containing the hair and nails of the Blessed One — let us go and pay our respects." When they arrived there, the two nuns provided them with the ground and water used for washing their hands and feet. They were then given flowers and incense, and they venerated the stūpa with the singing of verses. When he and the retinue of five hundred had paid their respects, they departed.

Not far from the stūpa, the venerable Utpalavarnā was sitting at the base of an utpala-colored tree, having settled there to pass the day. She saw them and said: "Venerable Chutung — whose stūpa have you just venerated? Please consider this." He reflected to himself: "Why is the venerable Utpalavarnā saying 'Venerable Chutung, whose stūpa have you just venerated? Please consider this'?" And so he replied: "Let me consider it for a moment." When he turned his attention inward, he saw that it was the stūpa built from the bones of the monk Grelaskyé. Immediately his mind-stream was overwhelmed by

habitual tendencies rooted in aversion, and he turned back. He said to the venerable Utpalavarnā: "If a thorn has appeared in the Teaching, then while you are sitting right here you have let it go unaddressed" — and with that he said nothing more.

He then said to his own students and attendants: "Venerable ones, those who are devoted to the Teacher and who cause grief — for that reason take a thorn from this heap of bones and bone-splinters, one each, and scatter them about." As his retinue was large, they took one thorn each from the heap of bones and bone-splinters, cast them aside, and in an instant the stūpa was demolished.

The two nuns wept and, weeping as they walked, went to the nuns' summer residence and told the other nuns what had happened. The group of twelve nuns, along with others who were attached and devoted to him out of desire that had not yet been relinquished, heard this and wept and wailed, crying out as if their own brother had just died that very day. Then the senior nun Bhomgamo spoke: "Sisters, who was it that did this?" They replied: "It happened suddenly, and we do not know from the heart, but the noble Utpalavarnā was sitting in that direction — she was the one who spoke to them, and that is the truth." Bhomgamo said: "Sisters, she went forth from being a weaver, and she is herself of degenerate character — as for what she has done, I know only what I have been told. The Blessed One clearly declared that one who brings disgrace to the assembly must not be kept within the assembly. Therefore, whatever thought you have toward her, come now." Those who were consumed by rage took up weapons, needles, and acacia stakes and set off. Utpalavarnā saw them coming from a great distance, walking and weeping as they came, and she thought: "Coming with such force, they will surely do me harm. But let me consider what intention lies behind their coming." When she turned her attention inward, she saw that their intention was to kill her. She blessed her robe through her power of concentration and entered into the meditative absorption of cessation.

They stabbed her robe with weapons, needles, and acacia stakes, yet through the power of her meditative absorption she sat as though dead, with no breath moving in or out. They said to one another: "This woman who lived by bad conduct has now been killed and got what she deserved — let us go," and they departed.

After they had gone, the venerable Utpalavārṇā arose from that meditative absorption and, looking back, she saw what harm they had done to her. She then went straightaway to the monastery. When the monks saw her and saw what had happened to her, they asked: "Venerable Utpalavārṇā, why have you come to be in this state?" She replied: "Noble ones, please look — the nuns have killed me right here." They asked her to explain everything that had occurred in full detail. When she had told it all in detail, the monks of few desires were angered, and in various places the venerable elders, though furious at the nuns, said merely that they should not be shown respect, while mocking the affair: "To have had the venerable Utpalavārṇā actually killed — that is a marvel of contemptible behavior."

Then one of them said: "Come now, wise ones — having gotten this far, let us consider how to properly address the matter." Another said: "What is there to address? We need only report it to the Blessed One." Another said: "What need is there to report it to the Blessed One? Let us simply convene and make a rule that no nun whatsoever shall be permitted to enter the Jeta Grove." They assembled and enacted just such a rule — that nuns were not to be admitted to the monastery. Once the nuns were barred from entering the monastery, they lost the honor and respect they had previously received.

Now the great matron of beings (Skt. mahāprajāpatī) Gautamī had the daily practice of coming to pay homage at the feet of the Blessed One, but on this occasion the monks said to her: "Gautamī, the monks' Saṅgha has enacted a rule that nuns are not to enter the monastery — remain here and do not go." She replied: "Noble ones, have I committed an offense of the kind they committed?" The monks said: "What can we do — the Saṅgha has determined it so." She turned back and went to her summer dwelling.

The blessed buddhas ask questions while already knowing the answer. Thus the Blessed One asked the venerable Ānanda: "Has the great matron of beings Gautamī been struck by illness, reverend one? Why has she not come?" Ānanda thereupon reported the whole matter to the Blessed One in full.

The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, what the monks' Saṅgha has enacted is in order. However, the nuns depend greatly on the monks in many respects, and if they are not permitted to come they will lose all honor. Therefore, let a nun ask at the monks' gate and be admitted, but instruction shall not be given to her." The Blessed One declared: "Let it be established that a nun who has asked at the monks' gate may enter the monastery, but instruction is to be

withheld."

Now the nuns did not know how to ask properly so as to be admitted inside, and so the Blessed One declared: "When a nun is not being allowed into the monastery, she should say thus: 'Noble ones, please be aware that we wish to enter the monastery and be admitted.' And the monk on his side should then ask: 'Sisters, you are not carrying weapons or needles out of hostility, are you?' If a nun enters without having been asked —"

— it becomes an offense. And if the monk has not spoken the question, it likewise becomes an offense. The Blessed One declared that the instruction should be recited, but the group of six monks did not recite it. The Blessed One then declared: "A monk should not give instruction to a nun who has an offense pending when the monks' Saṅgha has not yet consented. If a monk gives instruction to a nun who has an offense pending while the monks' Saṅgha has not consented, it becomes an offense. Just as with instruction, so too it is with the restoration ceremony (poṣadha) and the invitation ceremony (pravāraṇā)."

Summary verse:

A nun's seeking of consent, and the invitation ceremony —
these are not the same as the restoration ceremony.
Each seeks the other's consent in turn,
and both proceed according to seniority.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was residing at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in Anāthapiṇḍada's park. A certain nun was studying under a certain monk. In time an offense arose in connection with her, and he rebuked her for it. She then went to the rains-retreat building and sat there weeping. The preceptress (upādhyāyā), seeing this, said: "Young woman, why are you sitting here weeping?" She replied: "Preceptress, my teacher has rebuked me — I did not know what to do." The preceptress said: "My daughter, a preceptress and a teacher give correction for the sake of the preservation of the teaching. You need only ask for forgiveness — what else is there for you to understand? Go and ask for forgiveness properly." She went to the Jeta Grove and prostrated at the feet of that monk, then asked his forgiveness. But that monk turned away and left. The nun, left without confidence, came back to the nuns' rains-retreat building, and the nuns said: "Sister, did you ask the teacher for forgiveness — did he grant it?" She replied: "May no such person ever again become a teacher!" They said: "What was the offense? Tell us what

happened." When she had described what had occurred, the nuns said: "Sisters, daughters — in order to show contempt for women, he refused to grant forgiveness even when she asked for it once. And when she prostrated at his feet a second time and asked forgiveness, he turned away and walked off — look at this contemptuous behavior!" The nuns then told the monks about it, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, for a monk to show contempt for nuns in this way is blameworthy. Therefore, when a nun has prostrated at the feet of a monk and asked forgiveness, he must not turn away and leave. If a monk turns away and leaves when a nun has prostrated at his feet and asked forgiveness, it becomes an offense." Moreover, a nun need not ask forgiveness immediately on the spot; it may be done gradually. When the Blessed One declared that it should be done gradually, they did not know how to proceed gradually. The Blessed One then declared: "First, let her be thoroughly trained by another monk, nun, layman, or laywoman, and when she has become harmonious with that one, she may then ask forgiveness." The occasion for this ruling was at Śrāvastī.

The Blessed One declared that a monk who has observed the rains retreat should perform the invitation ceremony before the Saṅgha on three grounds: what has been seen, what has been heard, and what has been suspected. Having performed the invitation ceremony before the Saṅgha on these three grounds, the rains-retreat monk then conducts the restoration ceremony. Some among them said: "Venerable ones, just as the restoration ceremony is performed for the purpose of purification, I see that the invitation ceremony is likewise of the same nature. Therefore, that which is the restoration ceremony is also the invitation ceremony." Others said:

This was then put before the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, it is true that the restoration ceremony is one thing and the invitation ceremony is another. Yet, since there is nothing other to be done as a restoration ceremony beyond the invitation ceremony, therefore a monk need not perform the restoration ceremony after having performed the invitation ceremony. This is because the restoration ceremony is performed for the purpose of purification, and the invitation ceremony is itself entirely purification."

The occasion for this teaching arose in Śrāvastī.

Some monks, harboring resentment, abandoned equanimity of mind and began to look for fault in one another. At the time of the invitation ceremony they entered the midst of the Saṅgha and competed with one another there within, raising matters of degraded moral discipline, degraded views, degraded conduct in accordance with the rule, and degraded livelihood. They went about mixing others into their disputes, speaking of coming and going against one another, drawing in those who shared their aspirations, their companions, their teachers, their preceptors, those who shared the same teacher, and those who shared the same preceptor, until all were divided, each keeping to their respective sides. At that point a great schism arose in the Saṅgha: the Saṅgha broke into factions, the Saṅgha split in two, the Saṅgha fell into discord. Those who stood by watching then stirred things further, saying to the elders: "Venerable ones, there is no need to quarrel — rather, attain the individual states of mind belonging to those who have gone forth."

The Blessed One too declared: "Monks, in whatever quarter monks reside and there engage in fighting, in fault-finding, in abuse, in quarreling, and in acts of aggression — in such a quarter I have no wish even to hear much, let alone to go and dwell there. I will not go there.

"Monks, in whatever quarter monks abide and engage in fighting, fault-finding, abuse, quarreling, and acts of aggression — there, monks, these three things have been abandoned and these three things are cultivated in abundance. What are the three things that have been abandoned? The wholesome root of non-attachment has been abandoned, the wholesome root of non-aversion has been abandoned, and the wholesome root of non-delusion has been abandoned — these three things have been abandoned. And what are the three things cultivated in abundance? The unwholesome root of attachment is cultivated in abundance, the unwholesome root of aversion is cultivated in abundance, and the unwholesome root of delusion is cultivated in abundance — these three things are cultivated in abundance. In whatever quarter monks reside and fight, find fault, abuse one another, quarrel, and commit acts of aggression — monks, there these three things have been abandoned and these three things are cultivated in abundance: the wholesome root of non-attachment has been abandoned, the wholesome root of non-aversion has been abandoned, and the wholesome root of non-delusion has been abandoned — these three things abandoned; and monks, in whatever quarter monks reside and fight, find fault, abuse, quarrel, and commit acts of

aggression — monks, there these three things have been abandoned and these three things are cultivated in abundance: what three? The unwholesome root of attachment is cultivated in abundance, the unwholesome root of aversion is cultivated in abundance, and the unwholesome root of delusion is cultivated in abundance — these three things cultivated in abundance. And monks, in whatever quarter monks reside and fight, find fault, abuse one another, quarrel, and commit acts of aggression —"

— commit acts of aggression. And monks, in whatever quarter these three things have been abandoned and three things are cultivated in abundance, there I have no wish even to hear of it, let alone to go and remain there. I will not go there." When this was declared, the venerable ones said: "There is no need to quarrel; rather, let each recover his own mind of renunciation." But at that point their entanglement had grown and spread so far that there was no reversing it. When brahmins and householders saw this and recognized it, those of discernment mocked them, saying: "These shaven-headed ascetics — though the invitation ceremony has been performed, they have not each recovered their minds of renunciation; they do nothing but fight on and on." They mocked them, disparaged them, and jeered at them. At that juncture the monks reported this to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, that brahmins and householders mock you is fitting. Therefore, monks, monks who hold grudges must not perform the invitation ceremony. Rather, they should first ask for forbearance and then perform it. But even if on the very day of the invitation ceremony they ask for forbearance, the entanglement has grown and spread, and at that moment they will be unable each to recover his own mind." The Blessed One declared: "One must not ask for forbearance on that very same day. Rather, when the invitation ceremony is to take place in seven or eight days, one should ask for forbearance then." When the Blessed One had declared that one should ask for forbearance when the invitation ceremony is to take place in seven or eight days, thereupon all of them asked for forbearance. The Blessed One declared: "All must not ask for forbearance. Rather, let those who are in disagreement ask for forbearance. As for the rest, let them delight in one another properly and then perform the invitation ceremony." The setting of this rule is at Śrāvastī.

The Blessed One declared that in the fifth year and at the time of the topknot festival a great ceremony shall be held. The faithful brahmins and householders vied with one another in making offerings. At that time a great assembly of monks and nuns had gathered, and the Blessed One instructed

them to be seated in order of seniority. When the nuns were seated in order of seniority and began calling out, the nuns spoke to the monks. The monks then reported this to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Let two or three be seated in order of seniority. As for the rest, let them be seated according to the retinue and according to the order of the aspirants."

A summary verse:

Being seated near the doorway,
the Restoration being received by two together,
even a learned nun
alone does not give the Restoration.

The awakened one, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, Prince Jeta's park. The Blessed One declared that, apart from common transactions, monks and nuns should perform their formal acts separately. All the nuns assembled and came to the Jeta Grove to perform the Restoration, and they performed it together with the monks in the same gatehouse. Brahmins and householders were sitting there watching. Upon learning of this, the Blessed One declared: "Monks and nuns must not perform the Restoration together in the same gatehouse."

When the Blessed One had declared that monks and nuns must not perform the Restoration together in the same gatehouse —

The monks went inside and performed the Restoration together with the nuns, and the two groups sat there for a long time exchanging conversation. The monks then reported this to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Therefore, monks and nuns must not perform the Restoration together in the same temple. Monks and nuns must not perform the Restoration together in the same temple."

When the Blessed One had declared that monks and nuns must not perform the Restoration together in the same temple, the nuns stopped coming to the temple for the Restoration altogether. The Blessed One declared: "Therefore, let the monks go halfway along the road and let the nuns also go halfway along the road, and there let them perform the Restoration together."

When the Blessed One had declared that the monks should go halfway along the road and the nuns should also go halfway along the road and perform the Restoration there together, they began conversing there as before. Then some brahmins and householders happened to travel along that road, and they saw

the nuns performing the Restoration together with the monks. They then began to think improper thoughts and said to one another: "Friends, what are these shaven-headed nuns and these shaven-headed wanderers saying to one another?" One replied: "Friends, those two carry on secret talk at home — whatever secret things they do there, we have heard about it. Now they have gone to a deserted place and are simply telling one another whatever secrets there are to tell. What else could they be saying? And whatever punishment the king has inflicted on us because of reports made to him by these shaven-headed wanderers — all of that is being paid back in kind by these shaven-headed nuns."

When the monks reported this to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, monks and nuns shall not perform the Restoration halfway along the road. However, two nuns who receive the Restoration should be sent. They should go halfway along the road and then declare the complete purity of the community. The Blessed One declared that two nuns who receive the Restoration should be sent."

When nuns lacking confidence were sent and they were too timid to declare complete purity, the monks reported this to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "A confident nun should be invited to do it." When there were not two confident nuns, the Blessed One declared: "One confident nun should be invited." When they came to the temple, and the one to whom they were to address the declaration did not understand what the large assembly of monks was saying to her, she turned back then and there, and the nuns' community performed the Restoration without having addressed the monks. The monks reported this to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "A single monk should be invited, and when he arrives, the declaration should be made to him. When the monks had invited a single monk, he too did not understand, and the same fault arose again. The Blessed One declared: "The monk who has been invited must sit diligently in the gatehouse, and the nuns should go to him and make the declaration. He in turn should report to the monks' community, and the monks' community should appoint a teaching monk by the twofold act of request and formal motion. He should then give instruction to the nuns."

Here ends the summary verse.

Instructing them not to flee, asking their name and clan, the hat, the covered bowl, the rosary strand — these belong to the nun.

The Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The Blessed One declared: "Before the monk who has been invited, those nuns should make their declaration of purity." The invited monk sat in the gatehouse. But just as the nuns began to approach him, he cried out, "Do not touch me! Do not touch me!" and began to flee. They followed after him for a moment, then turned back and returned to the nuns' rains-retreat hall. The nuns thus failed to perform the restoration ceremony, and the nuns reported this to the monks. The monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "The invited monk must be instructed to remain without fleeing, and without letting the sisters touch him." If a monk, without giving such instruction to those nuns, were to flee far away just the same, he would be guilty of a serious offense. The Blessed One said: "One should request the monk who is appointed to give instruction to the nuns, and he too should remain diligently."

Then, at another time, a different monk who had been invited did not quickly go to the gatehouse; instead, a wandering ascetic who needed something came and sat in the gatehouse, examining the five-spoked wheel of a vehicle. The nuns thought, "This must be the one appointed to give us instruction," and went and touched his feet as they sat before him and said, "Noble one, please give us your attention. We wish to declare our purity to you by means of the restoration ceremony." He thought, "Let me first see what these shaven-headed female ascetics have to say," and said nothing. They spoke again: "Noble one, please give us your attention. The nuns' community of the garden of the king's son at the Jeta Grove bows with their heads at the feet of the monks' community of the Jeta Grove, and asks: are they well, free of affliction, free of distress, active, living, strong, comfortable, and dwelling without transgression? They also wish to declare their purity by means of the restoration ceremony." He did not know what he was supposed to say in reply and so said nothing at all. They said, "O noble one, will you not say at least 'It is well' or 'I will see'?" and he said, "I will see," and departed. The nuns also returned to the retreat hall.

The monk appointed to give instruction did arrive at the gatehouse on a later occasion, but stayed only a brief while before departing. Then, when the elder of the community had made only a single request and the monk appointed as overseer said to the monks, "Who accepted the declaration of purity from the nuns?" — no monk said, "I accepted it, I know of it." The monks concluded, "Surely no nun came at all, and no one accepted their declaration of purity."

Without making a request to another monk, the elder of the community himself recited the Prātimokṣa sūtra and the community performed the restoration ceremony.

When the nuns who had come to make their declaration of purity arrived the following restoration day, they found no one there to receive the scriptural recitation, so they waited a long time and then returned to the retreat hall. The nuns' community also failed to perform the restoration ceremony. The next day all the nuns gathered and assembled together, and said:

"Why does the noble Saṅgha not send us a monk to recite the scripture?" The monks said: "Sisters, on that restoration day just past, to which monk who was present did you make your declaration of purity?" The nuns who had been receiving the declaration said: "There was a noble one of such-and-such a complexion and such-and-such a stature, sitting in the gatehouse turning the wheel of cyclic existence in his mind — to him we made our declaration of purity." The monks recognized from these marks that there had been a lay person present, and said: "That one is not a monk, yet it was indeed to the lay person who was sitting there that you made your declaration." At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One reflected that the fault lay in the monk who had been sent to recite the scripture not having been asked his name. He therefore thought: the name of the monk sent to recite the scripture for the nuns' community should be asked. He declared: "There is no transgression on the part of the nuns for what they said to those monks. Nevertheless, the nuns who are receiving the declaration of purity should ask the name of the monk who was sent to recite the scripture."

"If they speak without first asking the name of the preceptor sent to recite the scripture for us, it will become a serious offence." The Blessed One declared that the nuns who are receiving the declaration of purity should ask the name of the monk sent to recite the scripture. But then those nuns, while knowing the name of the monk sent to recite, still asked it anyway — and at that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "If they know his name, they should not ask. If they do not know it, they should ask."

The setting of the next rule is Śrāvastī. The Great Progenitress Gautamī was living in a certain place, and the nuns came to her and asked: "Noble one, how are you faring?" She replied: "Daughters, I am cold." They asked: "Noble one, what did you use to wear?" She said: "Daughters, when I was a laywoman and

lived in a household, I used to wear a hat." "Noble one, why do you not wear one now?" "Daughters, I have gone forth, and unless the Blessed One permits it, how can I wear one?" — and at that point the nuns relayed this to the monks, and the monks to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Very well, it is permitted. Nuns may wear a hat in the retreat hall."

The setting of the next rule is Rājagṛha. A brahmin beggar woman of Rājagṛha was wandering about and entered another person's house, saying: "May you be well and fortunate — please give alms." The mistress of the house replied: "Brahmin, there is not even a little — be off with you." And so she departed and went away.

The great Progenitress Gautamī then also entered that house seeking alms. The brahmin thought to himself: "This shaven-headed renunciant has also entered — let me wait here a moment and see whether she too will be refused, or whether it is just me alone." And so he sought his opportunity and lingered there a little while. When he heard the words "The Buddha's mother has come," he rose up quickly, set out a seat, and with great joy went and filled her alms bowl with pure and fine food and drink and offered it to her. The brahmin, seized by jealousy and resentment, went off and said: "Noble one, please allow me to see what excellent things she has in her alms bowl." And being straightforward, she showed it to him. The brahmin spat into the alms bowl. The Great Progenitress Gautamī said:

"Child, why would you defile the alms round? Had you but asked, I would have given it to you just the same." The brahmin, having no boldness, said nothing and sat in silence. At that point the nuns reported it to the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One.

The Blessed One reflected: "Ordinary men also harm women by their very nature, and so too this deluded brahmin fellow has in just this way generated a great deal of demerit." Knowing therefore that the nuns ought to carry a cover for their alms bowls, he declared: "Monks, ordinary men also harm women by their very nature, and this deluded brahmin fellow has in just this way generated a great deal of demerit. Therefore, I hereby permit it: the nuns shall carry a cover for their alms bowls."

When the Blessed One had spoken the words "The nuns shall carry a cover for their alms bowls," the nuns did not know what kind of alms-bowl cover was meant, and so they reported it to the monks. The monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "The alms-bowl cover is a vessel into

which the alms bowl is placed, and the nuns shall take it when they go on their alms round."

The setting of this rule is at Śrāvastī. A great many people from the eastern regions were accustomed to gathering in the pleasure gardens. Now one day a festival fell at Śrāvastī, and those people took clean and fine food and drink and went to the pleasure gardens. They sent word to their wives: "Please string together garlands of flowers and send them." Their wives, thinking there were fine and varied flowers growing in the hedgerows and that they had been asked to send those, gathered flowers from the gardens along the long hedgerows but did not know how to string them into a garland. They sent word back: "Please send a garland-stringer to come." But that day the flower-sellers were there, and they had not yet arrived. Those people sat inwardly troubled, thinking: "When they asked us to send a garland of flowers, we who do not know how to string one called for a garland-stringer, and she could not come. How are we to manage this?"

Now Sthūlanandā was out going on her alms round and entered another house, where a pleasant-looking woman had gone to collect alms. The woman said: "Noble lady, please depart — we are inwardly troubled. We have no alms or words to give to anyone." Sthūlanandā said: "What is this you say? What small wrong have I done? Tell me in full how things stand." Sthūlanandā said: "Why don't you string them yourself?" The woman replied: "Noble lady, if we do not seek it, do you think we would know how?" Sthūlanandā said: "My good woman, I know how. Since the time has passed, there is not a craft or a trade I do not know." They presented it to the noble lady, and having strung it in just that way, what did she give? She said: "My good woman, will you give the price of some food?" The woman replied: "Noble lady, I shall offer it gladly. Please go around quickly and thoroughly." She put down her alms bowl, stretched out her legs and sat down, and quickly strung them just so. When the householders' wives saw this, they were astonished, and being thoroughly delighted with her, they gave Sthūlanandā a great deal of food in payment. Sthūlanandā, carried away by her success, strung garlands at another house as well, and there too she was given payment in food. Having thus obtained much in the way of gains, Sthūlanandā took what she had received and went to her seasonal dwelling.

Just then the garland-stringers arrived and said, "Please pass those flowers to us so that we may string them." She replied, "Where have you only just now come from? Those garlands have already been strung and sent to the pleasure

garden." They asked, "Who strung them?" She replied, "The noble Sthūlanandā did." At this, they reviled the monks, the sons of the Śākyan contemplative: "The contemplatives are frauds, and their celibate life is a fraud, for they are now stealing the livelihood of others." And so they mocked, they reproached, and they slandered.

When the monks heard this, they reported the matter to the Blessed One at that time. The Blessed One, reflecting that whatever fault had arisen from the garland-stringers' slander had come about on account of the nun's stringing of garlands, and that therefore nuns should not string garlands, declared: "Monks, the garland-stringers have become a basis for slander. Therefore nuns are not to string garlands. If a nun strings garlands, she incurs an offense."

After the Blessed One had thus spoken, saying that nuns were not to string garlands, it came to pass that the festival of the top-knot, the great festival, and the five-year festival all occurred. King Prasenajit of Kosala, along with Queen Mallikā, the royal lady Vāsavadattā, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada, the mother of Mṛgāra named Visākhā, the elderly maidservant, the laywoman who was the mother of the supernaturally gifted one, the householder Ugra, the great Śākyan named Mahānāma, and many other faithful people all celebrated with increasingly magnificent and excellent festivities for the top-knot festival and the great festival. People dwelling in various regions, monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen all assembled. Flowers were heaped up in abundance, and yet the garland-stringers were unable to string them well. Even when they were passed back and forth among other brahmin and householder faithful, the flowers still could not be strung properly.

Those people then said to the nuns, "Alas! If we are in need of garland-stringing, well now — noble ladies, you know the way of it. The time has come for you to honor the Teacher and string garlands." The nuns replied, "Wise ones, do you not know? The Blessed One has established a training rule that nuns are not to string garlands, so how could we string them?"

At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared, "Therefore I grant permission: nuns may string garlands for the sake of the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha." After the Blessed One had thus spoken, granting that nuns might string garlands for the sake of the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha, the nuns sat in the gatehouse and in the corridors with their legs stretched out and began to string flowers. Faithless people, seeing this, taunted them: "Alas! Noble ladies, have you gone

forth from nothing other than the garland-stringers' caste?" And the nuns sat there with their hair raised on end, unable to say a word.

At that point the monks again reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared, "Monks, those faithless ones have become a basis for slander through improper conduct. Therefore nuns are not to sit in the gatehouse or in the corridors and string flowers. If a nun sits in the gatehouse or in the corridors and strings garlands, she incurs an offense. Rather, if there is somewhere suitable, let them string garlands in a secluded area." Nuns are not to sit in the gatehouse or in the corridors and —

— string garlands incurs an offense.

The summary verse reads:

Pottery vessels and brewing,
Selling residential properties,
Likewise merchant shops and premises,
And images of divine form — none of these shall be held.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. A certain nun named Sthūlanandā went to a potter and said, "Good man, can you make a begging bowl of clay?" He replied, "Noble one, if you know the proper size, I will make a large and good one." She said, "Noble one, what need has a nun of a great clay begging bowl? You are poor — if you will not make it for me free of charge, then I will pay the full price." He thought, "There is nothing in this for me," and so he made a large clay begging bowl. He then said, "Make yet another one that will fit inside it." He made another, and so on, one nested inside the other, until he had made seven in all.

Sthūlanandā then had the nuns clean them and strung them in a net of five-colored thread, placed them one by one on a nun's head, and set off for the place to which she had been invited as a guest. When she arrived and had spread them out and was sitting there, some brahmins and householders said, "Noble one, have you been visiting the potter's shop?" She replied, "You poor folk, what do you know? Here I took some rice, here I took up a load, here I took some cooked grain, here I took some vegetables — noble one, do set aside the rest in the same way. Even if you find a great quantity of vegetables, it may still be possible." And she sat there saying nothing more. At that point the monks heard of this and reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One, discerning that the fault lay in a nun's carrying pottery vessels,

and knowing therefore that nuns should not carry pottery vessels, declared, "Monks, therefore nuns are not to carry pottery vessels. If a nun carries a pottery vessel, she incurs an offense. She may, however, carry a scraper, a salt container, and a drinking cup that has been offered."

The Basis for the Minor Vinaya, the forty-fourth fascicle. The occasion takes place in Śrāvastī.

In Śrāvastī there was a certain householder who took a wife from among those of equal caste, and with her he played, rejoiced, and enjoyed himself. From their playing and rejoicing and enjoyment a daughter was born on the right side — born laterally on the right — and because this girl was of ill omen, no one would take her. In Śrāvastī another householder took a wife, and she died in due course by her own karma. He then took a second, and then a third, up to a seventh; each of them likewise died by her own karma. He became universally known by the name "wife-killer," the wife-killer. He then sought the hand of another man's daughter, and that man said, "Would I give even my own daughter?" He sought the hand of a widow, and she said, "Would I myself be given away?" He then began to manage the household affairs on his own. A friend of his came to the house and asked him by name what was going on. The household folk replied, "He has gone inside and is managing the household affairs himself." The friend said, "Can you not feed your wives, give them instructions, and put them to work? Why is it that you are managing the household affairs yourself?" He said, "Friend, I could indeed manage,

but whenever I took a wife, she died in her own time by her own karma. The same happened with the second, the third, and up to the seventh wife I married — they all died in their own time by their own karma. Because of this I became widely known everywhere by the name 'wife-killer.' Would he seek anyone else? The people said, 'If he were to seek again, would we give him our own daughter?' He sought the hand of a widow, and she too said, 'Would I myself be given away?' As for taking a girl from a neighboring household — he had tried that too, but they said, 'Would we give away a girl of ours?' The friend said, 'Go ahead,' and so the householder, overcome by weariness, gave her. The friend urged him, went to that householder's home, said 'Good day, good day,' and the household folk replied, 'What are you asking for?' 'I am asking for the girl.' 'Which girl?' 'The neighbor's daughter.' 'She shall be given. Name the time of giving. Name the time of taking. Name the day auspicious for this.' Having said this, he departed.

Then the householder's wife, thinking she would send the girl off as a bride, brewed ale. The hot season had arrived, and the brew spoiled and became unfit. Then that householder's wife said to a female ale-seller, 'I am sending my daughter off as a bride and need just this much ale — prepare it.' The ale-seller replied, 'We shall supply it properly.' She began to make preparations with the ale when Plump-and-Joyful happened to be going on her alms round and entered that house. 'Lovely-featured one, please give alms.' The householder's wife, going back and forth looking at the ale in distraction, replied, 'Noble lady, please just go on your way. I am preoccupied with something in my mind, and as for alms — I am not going to offer them to anyone at all.' She said, 'Did I do something slightly wrong in saying what I said?' The wife then explained the matter in full, and Plump-and-Joyful said, 'Lovely-featured one, in that case why not have it fixed again?' She replied, 'Noble lady, if I had not sought help, would I have known how? What do I know of it?' Plump-and-Joyful said, 'Lovely-featured one, I do know — because the time has passed on it, there is no craft or trade matter that I do not know with certainty.' 'Noble lady, will you kindly fix it again for me?' She replied, 'Lovely-featured one, if I fix it again, will you give me the price of my food?' She said, 'Noble lady, I shall give it properly — give abundantly and fix it again.' Plump-and-Joyful said, 'Bring it here and let me look.' When she showed her the ale-jars, Plump-and-Joyful saw that the brew was spoiled. She examined the ale-jars against one another and, seeing from the warmth that the brew was unfit, she opened the air-holes, heaped much sand beneath the ale-jars, poured water over the outsides, wrapped them all about with fish-net weaving, then took up fans and began to fan them. Through this method of a distinctive cooling treatment, the ale was restored to fitness again.

The time to take the bride was near. Friends, companions, relatives, and people had assembled. The ale-seller had also made her ale preparations and sat ready, intending that whenever the wedding guests arrived she would give it to them. The householder had arranged with that very ale for the completion of sending off the bride. Then the ale-seller arrived and said, 'Householder, please take the ale.' He replied, 'Good woman, that is enough — the ale was fixed again and with that very ale the sending off of the bride has been completed.' She said, 'Householder, since that ale ran out there, who then fixed it again?' He explained: 'The noble Plump-and-Joyful fixed it again — that is her gift of benefit to us.' At this the fully ordained nuns of the śramaṇas, the sons of the Śākya, are burned. The brahmin life is burned.

It was on account of this that they were now mocking, reviling, and slandering her, saying she was robbing others of their livelihood. The monks heard this and reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One reflected: the conduct of the nun Plump-and-Joyful is not the way of a contemplative. Therefore, knowing that nuns ought not to engage in the business of ale, he declared: "Monks, the conduct of the nun Plump-and-Joyful is not the way of a contemplative. Therefore, nuns must not engage in the business of ale. If a nun engages in the business of ale, it shall become a grave transgression."

The origin of this ruling is at Śrāvastī. At Śrāvastī there lived a householder who delighted in generosity. At another time he was struck by illness, and as his bodily life was coming to its end he thought, "I am going to die." So he gave everything he owned and had in his home to contemplatives, brahmins, and also to friends, companions, and relatives, leaving only the house itself. When Plump-and-Joyful heard this, she came quickly, running to reach him in time. Upon her arrival she gave the householder a certain sign indicating that a woman of the household had been left with little to show for it. The householder understood and said: "Noble one, you have come late. Whatever there was, I have given it all away, and there is nothing left beyond the house alone — not even a little to give." She said: "Householder, you have praised me to the skies like an elephant's raised trunk, and now that I have come to you, how can I leave with all hope cut off?" He replied: "Noble one, did I not say that nothing remains beyond the house alone? If you wish it, take that house." She said: "Householder, so be it then." Then, saying "May you be free from illness," she departed.

Some time later, when that householder had passed away, his relatives wrapped the body in blue, yellow, red, and white cloth and carried it to the charnel ground. When Plump-and-Joyful heard that the householder had passed away, she came, taking her time, and sealed the door of his house with a lock and remained sitting there on one side.

After a while they came back from the cremation and said: "Who has sealed this house?" Plump-and-Joyful said: "The owner has sealed it." They said: "To whom was it given?" She said: "To me, Plump-and-Joyful." They said: "Noble one, if that is so, nonetheless pay a rental fee to enter." She said: "I will give it — I will give it," and having stamped a seal of agreement she let them in. Once they had entered and settled there, some brahmins and householders arrived, gathered among them, and the fully ordained monks who are the contemplatives, the sons of the Śākyas, were burned. The brahmin life was

burned. For it was now being mocked, reviled, and slandered, saying she was renting out and taking in houses.

The monks heard this and reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, take the mockery of the brahmins and householders as the basis for this ruling. Therefore, nuns must not rent out or take in houses. If a nun rents out or takes in a house, it shall become a serious offense."

At Śrāvastī there lived another merchant who delighted in generosity. At another time he was struck by illness, and as his bodily life was coming to its end he thought, "I am going to die." So he gave everything he owned and had in his home to contemplatives, brahmins, and also to friends, companions, and relatives,

Only the shop remained. Stubborn Delightful, upon hearing this, traveled a great distance and came to that place, entered inside, and gave a signal to that merchant indicating that the female donor had but little gain. The householder, understanding this, said: "Noble one, you have come late. Whatever little I had, all of it I have given away. Nothing remained except the one shop alone, so there is nothing at all I can give." She replied: "Benefactor, you raised my hopes high as an elephant's trunk and drew me to your side — how can I go away with my hopes dashed like this?" He said: "Noble one, did I not say that nothing remained except the one shop? If that is what you wish, then take that house." She replied: "Householder, so be it, I accept." Then she said, "May you be free from illness," and departed.

Not long after, at another time, that householder passed away. His relatives wrapped him round and adorned him with blue, yellow, red, and white cloths, and carried him to the charnel ground. Stubborn Delightful, upon hearing that the householder had passed away, traveled a great distance, sealed the door of his shop and affixed a lock to it, then went off and sat in a corner by herself.

After some time, when the cremation was done and the relatives, friends, companions, and kinsmen had returned and were sitting together grieving for a while, another man going to the market came to that house and said to them: "The shop has been locked up by Stubborn Delightful." When they heard this, they went a great distance and said: "Who sealed this shop?" Stubborn Delightful replied: "The one to whom it was given sealed it." They asked: "To whom was it given?" She answered: "To me, Stubborn Delightful." They said: "Noble one, even if that is so, pay the rent and we shall open the storehouse for you." She replied: "Will you give it, or will you give it?" and they broke the

seal and spread things out there.

Brahmins and householders who had gathered and were sitting there then mocked and criticized the monks, the ascetics who are sons of the Śākya: "The contemplatives are burning with shame! Those who practice the celibate life — burning with shame! For they now rent out and take in shops." And they continued to mock, revile, and slander them. The monks heard this and reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, take the mockery of the brahmins and householders as the basis for this ruling. Therefore, nuns must not rent out or take in shops. If a nun rents out or takes in a shop, it shall become a serious offense."

The case arose at Śrāvastī.

Stubborn Delightful, early in the morning, having arranged her inner robe and taken up her outer robe and bowl, entered Śrāvastī for alms. A female diviner carrying a bell was walking along and saw her. The diviner thought: "That is a fine method — I shall do the same myself." She then procured a bell for herself. The very next day she took the bell, entered Śrāvastī, and began bathing boys and girls; carrying incense and ringing the bell, she gave prophecies. Whichever boys and girls she bathed became well and at ease in their circumstances, and her prophecies likewise came true. The fame spread throughout Śrāvastī that this woman had obtained great spiritual attainment, and whenever anyone anywhere had need of a diviner they would seek her out.

Stubborn Delightful came to that woman and consulted her, and since no one else was approaching the diviner, she purposely went to the homes of brahmins and householders and said: "I shall perform offering-cake rites and give prophecies," and she visited whatever homes she went to.

Those various people said: "Our offering-cake rites and prophecies have already been performed." When those who had received prophecies said, "It was the noble Stubborn Delightful," abuse was directed at the monks, the sons of the Śākyan contemplative: "Contemplatives are burned out! The celibate life is burned out! For it is they who are now robbing others of their livelihood" — thus they mocked, reviled, and slandered them. When the monks heard this, they reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One, reflecting that the fault lay in the nuns' adopting the appearance of a goddess, understood that nuns must not adopt the appearance of a goddess, and declared: "Monks, the basis for those women's mockery is Stubborn Delightful's improper

conduct. And the fault lies in the nun's adopting the appearance of a goddess. Therefore nuns must not adopt the appearance of a goddess. If a nun adopts the appearance of a goddess, it shall constitute a serious offense."

The summary verse:

By a woman at the riverbank — not with bathing powder from the stream, not to be sought from the regular supply, a second alms-bowl carried along, and the gall-bladder vessel not to be held.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. Now at Śrāvastī a certain woman was sitting by the bathing place for women at the river Aciravatī, combing her hair. At that time Stubborn Delightful wished to bathe, and so she took her bathing powder and went to the river Aciravatī. From a distance she saw that woman combing her hair, and upon seeing her she was seized and gripped by jealousy, and she thought: "How could this slave-woman's daughter dare to rival me, sitting here combing her hair? Has Stubborn Delightful never before had hair? That woman will be displeased, and likewise in the future, so that when she sees me again she will not try to rival me in hair" — and she went up behind her and scattered terminalia powder into her hair.

She then said: "Noble one, what wrong have I done you that, after you had already bathed, you scatter terminalia powder on my head? Does the slave-woman not know? Has Stubborn Delightful never before had such hair? Therefore you have harmed me. Go and bathe again. Have I then defiled your hair with all manner of unclean things?"

When she began that abuse, the monks reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, these women have become a basis for mockery. Therefore nuns must not scatter bathing powder onto the head of a woman who has already bathed. If a nun scatters bathing powder onto the head of a woman who has already bathed, it shall constitute a serious offense."

The occasion is at Śrāvastī.

Stubborn Delightful wished to bathe, and she went to the Aciravatī together with the nuns. There they sat facing against the current of the water and amused themselves by splashing. The nuns said to them: "Noble ones, what are you doing?" They replied: "Great one, we are amusing ourselves by splashing." The nuns said: "Noble ones, is it fitting to sit facing against the

current and amuse yourselves by splashing?" They replied: "It is perfectly fitting. It is most fitting. Who has forbidden it, and where has it been forbidden?" At that point the nuns told this to the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, the nuns have become a basis for mockery.

Therefore, nuns must not sit facing against the current of the water and amuse themselves by splashing. If a nun sits facing against the current and amuses herself by splashing, it will become a serious transgression.

The origin of this rule is at Śrāvastī.

The nuns set their alms bowls down wherever they happened to fall, and rodents ate from them, and they were struck by falling sticks. On that occasion the nuns told this to the monks, and the monks reported it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Monks, the nuns have become a basis for mockery. Therefore nuns must not set their alms bowls down wherever they happen to fall. Rather, they should secure their alms bowls with a cloth ring."

When the Blessed One had declared that alms bowls were to be secured with a cloth ring, the nuns wrapped all of their alms bowls entirely in cloth. Brahmins and householders saw this and asked: "Noble ones, what is this?" The nuns replied: "Worthy friends, the Blessed One has permitted it." The brahmins and householders said: "Noble ones, surely the Blessed One did not say to wrap all the alms bowls entirely in cloth!" and exclaimed: "Have you renunciants become attached to sensual pleasures?" The nuns, having no confidence, sat in silence and said nothing. On that occasion the monks heard of this, reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, the brahmins and householders have become a basis for mockery. Therefore one must not wrap all the alms bowls entirely in cloth in that fashion. Rather, one should wrap just the foot of the alms bowl with a cloth ring in that same manner."

When the nuns wrapped the bowls with something resembling a mountain peak and something resembling a fence post, the Blessed One declared: "There are two fittings for the foot of the alms bowl: it should be done with leaves resembling the leaf of the awakening tree, or wrapped with leaves resembling the palm of a hand."

The origin of this rule is at Śrāvastī.

There was a certain nun named Stout-and-Glad who had a small water vessel. One day the husband of another woman came to her, approached

Stout-and-Glad, and said: "Noble one, may I borrow your small water vessel for a short while?" She asked: "What for?" He said: "Noble one, I have a son-in-law, and he has no vessel from which to drink." Saying this, she gave it to him, and through carelessness he broke it. Later, on another occasion, when Stout-and-Glad came to take it back, he said: "Noble one, that one lacked care and was broken, so I will pay for it." Stout-and-Glad said: "Brother, I do not need payment from you — just give me that very replacement." He said: "Noble one, I have already given another one in its place and paid for it." She said: "Give me that very one." And so they fell into a dispute with one another. On that occasion the monks heard of this, reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One, having reflected that the fault lay in the nun's having kept possession of a small water vessel, knowing this, declared: "Monks, Stout-and-Glad has come to quarrel on account of the small water vessel. Therefore nuns must not keep a small water vessel." If a nun keeps a small water vessel, it will be a matter involving an offence.

The summary verse:

A woman involved in dance,
a senior monk who teaches Dharma,
or again one who petitions another —
these four are to be encompassed.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada.

At Śrāvastī there lived a certain householder who was wealthy, of great means, and well-provided with enjoyments. His daughter-in-law gave birth to a son. Delighted to see the child, relatives, kinsmen, and other people came and held the naming ceremony on the very day of birth.

Afterward, that householder spent a long time feasting and making merry with the people of his household, and by the time dawn broke, he had lain down to sleep. His wife, too, overcome with drowsiness, had a dream in which she imagined herself lying together with her husband, and in that dream she experienced a nocturnal emission. Her robe and her lower garment became crumpled and fell to the ground.

Early the following morning at daybreak, a monk who was going on alms-round set out while it was still dark and came to that house. The house had many doors. He went to the first door and looked in — it was empty. He went to the second and third doors — they too were empty. When at last he came to the

fourth door and looked in, he saw the householder's wife lying there in that unseemly condition. Startled, she immediately began to flee, but her faculties were clouded and she had no idea where to go, so she ran this way and that until she blundered into the householder's bedroom.

She began beating on the bed, and the householder woke up. Seeing a monk standing there, he asked, "Venerable one, where have you come from to be here?" But the monk, trembling and with his hair on end, was unable to give any reply.

Presently the householder came out of the bedroom and saw his wife in that unseemly state. He thought to himself, "This shameless monk has abused my wife." So he set upon the monk, striking him indiscriminately with the back of a stick, with a whip, with a clod of earth, and with his fists, until the noise of the beating woke the wife. She cried out, "My lord's son, why are you beating this monk like that?" He replied, "While you were lying in a stupor of sleep, this shameless wretch had his way with you." She said, "My lord's son, may the sin be calmed. This monk who has gone forth has done no such thing. I was deep asleep and overcome with drowsiness, and I had such a dream — dreaming that you and I were together, and that my lower garment was all crumpled and had fallen to the ground. This monk has done no wrong; let him go." So he broke the monk's alms-bowl and struck him on the head, tore his Dharma robe, and left him just as he was, in that unseemly state, his eyes streaming with tears, contemplating what had happened to him, as he made his way to the Jeta Grove.

The monks saw him, and asked, "Venerable one, who left you in such a condition as this?" He told them in full what had happened. The monks thereupon reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One, having reflected, understood that the fault lay in monks going indiscriminately from door to door in a house with many doors. Knowing this, the Blessed One declared: "Monks, therefore monks must not go indiscriminately from door to door in a house with many doors." He then added: "However, when going to a household one has visited before, if afterward one wishes to enter a house with many doors, one should first place a signal — flour or a pickle — at the doorway the previous evening and then proceed inside."

The Blessed One had thus said that a monk should place a signal of flour or a pickle at the doorway in the evening before going through the many doors of a house. But the monks set up the signal at the doorway and then went in

without sweeping — and the men and women who were living there found lice in their lower and upper garments, and all the mothers...

A woman who was reclining with her body and voice at ease caught sight of this and, upon reflection, was deeply startled and alarmed. When the monks heard her cry of alarm, they reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, you have become a cause of alarm for women. Therefore monks should not enter in that sudden manner. Rather, they should make a sound and then go in."

When the Blessed One had said that they should make a sound before going in, the monks went along calling out "a-la-la!" and when they arrived, the people of the household said: "Noble ones, why do you come calling out 'a-la-la!' like little children?" The monks replied: "Sisters, the Blessed One instructed us to make a sound and go — so we spoke a word as we came." The householders said: "Noble ones, is there no other way to make a sound? Why do you come like that?" The monks, having no ready answer, sat in silence.

When the monks reported this to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "Monks should not go to a house calling out 'a-la-la!' They should make a different sound."

When the Blessed One had said they should make a different sound, the monks went and struck the door panels on their arrival, and the people of the household said: "Noble ones, why are you hitting the door panels?" The monks replied: "We are making a sound." "Did you break the door panels?" the householders asked. The monks, having no ready answer, sat in silence.

When the monks reported this to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "One should not strike the door panels. Rather, one should produce a sound with a staff."

The monks did not know what kind of staff was meant for producing such a sound, so the Blessed One declared: "One should carry a staff-bell (khakkhara), make a sound with it, and then enter."

When the Blessed One had said that one should make a sound with the staff-bell and enter, the monks went along making sound with their staff-bells, and dogs harassed them. Some monks, without paying attention, struck the staff-bell too many times, and the Blessed One declared: "One should not strike it repeatedly in that way; rather, one should simply give it a rattle."

When some dogs were rattled at in this way, they became all the more aggressive, and the Blessed One declared: "In that case, give the dog a single morsel from the alms-food."

The monks then went to the house of someone who lacked faith, and when the monks rang their staff-bells, that person was displeased and no one came to the door. The Blessed One declared: "One should not ring it over and over again; one should ring it only two or three times."

Now the basis of the following rule is set at Śrāvastī. At Śrāvastī there was another householder, and to his house the community of monks headed by the buddha was invited for a midday meal, and the community of monks duly arrived. The Blessed One was staying in a room built up with materials, and he was also receiving alms-food. There are five reasons why a buddha, the Blessed One, stays in a room built up with materials while also receiving alms-food. What are the five? He wishes to establish the proper interior arrangement; he wishes to teach the Dharma to the gods; he wishes to look after those who are sick; he wishes to inspect the sleeping places; and he wishes to establish a basis for training in the Vinaya for the hearers. On this particular occasion, the Blessed One was staying in a room built up with materials and receiving alms-food because he wished to establish a basis for training in the Vinaya for the hearers.

That householder had constructed a bower of leaves, and the community of monks sat beneath it. Then the gods began to cause rain to fall, and at a certain winter moment it fell.

That householder served the community of monks with soup, porridge, rice-porridge, and turnips. When some monks drank the soup, they made a slurping sound. When some ate the rice-porridge, they made a crunching sound. When some ate the turnips, they made a chomping sound. Where the rain dripped down, it fell with a dripping, pattering sound. When monks drank water from a pot, there was a splashing, pouring sound. Now among those present was a monk who had gone forth from the life of a musician. He did not maintain mindfulness, and recalling what he had done before, conceptual thought proliferated within him. Carried along by the force of that discursive thinking, he fitted what he was doing to the sounds he heard and began to dance, calling out: "Reverend ones — chomp chomp! Reverend ones — crunch crunch! Reverend ones — munch munch! Reverend ones — clatter clatter! Reverend ones — splash splash!" At this, those monks who had not maintained

mindfulness became pleased in mind and laughed. Those who had maintained mindfulness were undisturbed in their conduct and remained just as they were. Some of the attendants began to laugh out loud. Some began to jeer. The householder too became displeased. Then the monk who had gone to collect alms also became displeased. Having collected the alms-food, he went to where the Blessed One was staying, set the alms-food to one side, bowed his head to the Blessed One's feet, and sat down to one side.

It is the nature of things that the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, delight in the monks who go to collect alms and speak words of rejoicing with them. So the Blessed One spoke words of rejoicing, asking: "Were the members of the community of monks satisfied and made content with food?" He spoke these words of rejoicing, and the Blessed One asked that monk: "Monks — ah, were the members of the community of monks satisfied and made content with food?" The monk replied: "Venerable One, it is so. The members of the community of monks were satisfied and made content with food. However, the householder has become displeased." He then reported in detail what had happened and how things had unfolded. Thereupon the Blessed One, having finished the business of eating, washed his feet outside the assembly hall, entered the hall, and sat down in inner composure within it. Then the Blessed One arose from inner composure in the late afternoon, and seated himself on a seat prepared for him before the community of monks. Seated there, he addressed those monks in these words: "Monks, from what intention did you act in this way?" They replied: "Venerable One, it arose from a slight intention to jeer, and a slight intention to laugh." Then the Blessed One addressed the monks in these words: "Any monk who acted in this way from an intention to laugh incurs an offense involving a transgression. If it arose from an intention to jeer, there is no downfall. Nevertheless, monks, the fault here is that monks ate their food making noise with their mouths. Therefore monks must not eat their food making noise with their mouths. A monk who eats his food making noise with his mouth incurs a transgression." When the Blessed One had said that monks must not eat their food making noise with their mouths, faithful brahmin householders offered the monks royal sugar-cane, rice-porridge, clarified-butter porridge, turnips, and sugar-cane stalks. The monks, having doubts, did not accept them. Those people said: "Noble ones, had the Blessed One, the buddha, not appeared in the world, our field of generosity would have been among the non-Buddhists. Now the Blessed One has appeared in the world, and you are our field of generosity."

"If you do not accept these offerings, we will be cut off from the provisions for the journey to the world beyond, and the Blessed One himself has taught in the Sūtra on Timely Giving that whatever crops are first-ripe and whatever fruits are first-ripe should be given first and foremost to those endowed with moral discipline, and only afterwards used for one's own purposes. These are timely gifts, and so out of compassion please accept them." When they had spoken thus, the Blessed One declared: "I permit it. Sugarcane stalks with the fruit-bearing ones and the grain-bearing ones are to be eaten together with flour. Turnips, royal sugar-cane, and clarified-butter stalks are to be cut into pieces and eaten."

The incident arose in Śrāvastī. In Śrāvastī, another householder invited the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha to his home at midday. The monks came separately in groups without waiting for one another, and each group said: "Householder, serve us — we will eat." After they had eaten and gone, other groups came in the same way one after another, until the householder became worn out with serving and grew displeased. He said: "Oh! All of you should gather together and eat at the same time!" When the monks heard this, they reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, monks, you must not eat separately at a busy household. Those who arrive first are to wait at the door, and when all have assembled and entered together, then eat. If one eats there while the household is still busy, it becomes an offence of wrongdoing."

When the Blessed One had taught that monks must not eat at a busy household, another monk fell ill, and his attendant went out to fetch food but did not return for a long time, and the monk became troubled with regret. When the monks reported this to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "Therefore, I permit five categories of persons to eat sitting and receiving alms: one who has arrived unexpectedly, one who is departing, one who is sick, one who tends the sick, and one who is working. Giving is permitted to these."

The incident arose in Śrāvastī. In Śrāvastī there resided a householder who was wealthy, possessing great riches and abundant resources. At a certain time he came to have sincere faith in the Buddha and likewise in the Dharma and the Saṅgha. He invited the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha to his home at midday. The Saṅgha of monks went. The Blessed One, the Buddha, remained at a place prepared with requisites and also received alms. The text beginning with "For five reasons the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, remain at a

place prepared with requisites and also receive alms" — on this occasion the Blessed One, wishing to establish a rule of training in the Vinaya for the hearers, also remained at a place prepared with requisites and received alms, just as in the passage above.

When those monks had eaten their meal they left in the same way as before. The householder, wishing to hear the Dharma, looked about, but not a single monk remained, and he felt slighted. When the monks heard of this and reported it to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "Monks, you have become the basis for that householder's feeling slighted. Therefore, after eating, a monk must not leave in the same manner; he must teach the Dharma to a donor who desires it. If he departs without having taught, it becomes an offence of wrongdoing." When the Blessed One had instructed that the Dharma must be taught to a donor who desires it, the monks did not know who among them should teach. The Blessed One declared: "The elder of the Saṅgha is to teach."

If he is unable, then the second elder of the Saṅgha is to teach. If he too is unable, the monks are to be asked in order of seniority. Or, if there is another who is capable, that one is to be requested.

The narrative occasion is at Śrāvastī. At Śrāvastī there lived a householder who was wealthy, possessed of great riches, and of great means. He was also a man of faith, of good intention, and of virtue, and from time to time he would go to the Jeta Grove and listen to the words of the Buddha. On another occasion he invited the Saṅgha of monks, along with the Buddha and the rest, to his home for a midday meal, and the Saṅgha of monks went. The Blessed One, however, was occupied with a matter and remained behind, yet he did accept the alms-round. From the passage beginning "for five reasons" up through the words "the Blessed One the Buddha remained behind, occupied with a matter, yet also accepted the alms-round" — all of this is as stated above.

The Blessed One had declared: "If a donor wishes to hear the Dharma, the monk appointed for the purpose is to teach it." So the monks set out, leaving behind just the one monk who had been appointed, and the householder's friends, relatives, kinsmen, and those of great influence all gathered at the meal. Together with their wives they sat around that monk and said, "Noble one, please teach the Dharma." But the monk, seeing that assembly of powerful people seated around him, became overwhelmed with shyness and

sat in silence without saying a word. The householder thought to himself: "It seems that this noble one has been overcome with shyness on account of me and my influential retinue. Let me myself teach the Dharma." And so he said: "Noble one, the Blessed One has declared: 'Through generosity one comes to possess great wealth; through moral discipline one is reborn in the higher realms; through meditation one comes to be free.' This is the Dharma — now please, be on your way." The monk, having lost all confidence, left without saying a word and went to the monastery. The monks asked him: "Venerable one, did you teach the Dharma to that donor?" He replied: "Venerable ones, what can I say? You left me there alone, and when I saw that powerful retinue of the householder's, I became so overcome with shyness sitting there alone that in the end it was he himself who taught me the Dharma." At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "That monk said something good. For the monk appointed to teach, four companion monks are to be appointed."

The Vinaya of Minor Matters, the forty-fifth fascicle.

The summary verse:

One is to go after checking,
the monk of brahmin lineage,
four are to copy,
and tooth-sticks too are to be washed.

The Blessed One was dwelling at Rājagṛha in the Kalandaka Grove. The Blessed One had declared that four companion monks are to be appointed for a monk who is to teach the Dharma. So whenever monks went somewhere on an invitation to a meal, the monk requested to teach the Dharma had four companion monks appointed. But those companions, without having checked, went to relieve themselves — both for defecation and urination — at the homes of respectable families, and that very fact became a source of censure. At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "Those who have been appointed as companions to the monk teaching the Dharma must not go elsewhere without having checked with him first. If they do go, it becomes a serious offence."

The narrative occasion is at Śrāvastī. At Śrāvastī a brahmin had taken a wife from a family of equal birth, and he sported with her, took pleasure with her, and enjoyed pleasures together with her. Through their sporting and pleasuring and enjoyment of pleasures together, his wife came to be with

child.

After nine months she gave birth to a boy. Once he was born, they held an elaborate birth celebration and gave him a name befitting his clan.

Then at another time that boy grew up and went forth into renunciation in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya. While he was ill, his bodily condition being as it was, he went to a physician and said: "Good sir, given the present state of my body, please prescribe a treatment." The physician said: "Noble one, apply such-and-such a poultice and you will recover." He applied the poultice, and after bathing once he washed himself with cold water, and it broke open. The physician asked: "Noble one, did the poultice work well?" He replied: "Good sir, it did not work well — I bathed only once." The physician said: "Noble one, did you not wash with cold water?" He replied: "Good sir, I did exactly as you said." The physician said: "Noble one, you have done something harmful — if it breaks open from cold water, how can one bathe? That part is finished now, so apply that same poultice again, and this time complete the full bathing before washing, and wash with warm water."

He replied: "Good sir, the Blessed One has not permitted it."

The physician said: "Noble one, then how am I to perform the procedure for the poultice?"

At that point the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Therefore I grant permission: outer wrappings are to be placed on, and after completing the full bathing, one may wash." When the Blessed One had said that outer wrappings are to be used, the monks did not know what kinds of things to use as outer wrappings. The Blessed One declared: "Sponge, or leaves, or pieces of cloth may be used as outer wrappings; after completing the full bathing, one washes with warm water."

The narrative occasion is at Śrāvastī.

Then at that same time there was a venomous snake living in a forest. At some point the herders set fire to that forest, and the venomous snake, scorched by the fire, moved back and forth but was encircled again by the light of the flames and lay there barely alive. Leaping free from where it had been burned, it coiled and wound itself at the foot of a tree.

At some point the Venerable Śāriputra was wandering through the countryside and drew near to that spot. He went to the foot of the tree and looked, and he saw a venomous snake scorched by fire, severely burned, worn down by the

sensation of suffering. Upon seeing it, he examined whether there were any roots of virtue at all in its stream of being, and he saw that there were. He also examined under whose influence it would fall, and he determined that it would be under his own. He sprinkled water on it and spoke three Dharma phrases:

"Good friend, all conditioned things are impermanent. All phenomena are without self. Nirvāṇa is peace. Bring your mind into a state of complete clarity toward me, and thus, free from the attachment of animals, you will be reborn in a happy destiny."

Having said this, he departed. Immediately a hawk seized the snake. At that moment, with a mind of strong faith toward the Venerable Śāriputra, it passed away, and was reborn in Śrāvastī in the family of a brahmin endowed with the six qualities.

The Venerable Śāriputra reflected: "If that venomous snake passed away without interruption, where has it been reborn?" Examining it in a single moment, he saw that it had been reborn in Śrāvastī in the family of a brahmin endowed with the six qualities. Seeing this, he set out to go to that house in order to train it. Having gone there, he established both the brahmin and his wife in the going for refuge and in the foundation of the training.

Then at another time he went alone to that house, and the brahmin said to him:

"Noble one, is there no monk who will follow after me?" The Venerable Śāriputra replied: "Venerable sir, would a monk who follows after you spring up from elsewhere like kuśa grass or kaśa reeds? No — one who is born from someone such as yourself will become the monk who follows after me." The brahmin said: "Noble one, I have no boy who will come to be a monk following after a noble one. But if a son is born to the one who accompanies me with this longing in her heart, I will offer him to the noble one as a monk who follows after you." Śāriputra replied: "May it be so — may she be well. Take this and go." So saying, he departed.

In due course, after nine months had passed, the brahmin's wife gave birth to a boy. Twenty-one days after his birth — three times seven days — a great birth celebration was held and he was given a name suited to his lineage. He was nourished and raised on milk, yogurt, fresh butter, clarified butter, and the finest essence of butter, along with other principal provisions of every kind, and he grew quickly, like a lotus dwelling in a lake. When he drank from his mother's breast, if ever through carelessness a tooth or fingernail touched the

breast, it would swell. As he grew older and played together with other boys and girls, whenever he was seized by a fit of anger and bit or scratched one of them, that place would swell up before long without delay.

In time, the Venerable Śāriputra, knowing that the moment had come to ordain him, went to that house and taught the Dharma to the brahmin's wife. He showed a sign, saying: "This boy is the monk who will follow after me." The brahmin then said: "Son, even before you were born I had offered you to the Venerable Śāriputra as the monk who would follow after him — go!" That being of his last existence gazed for a long while at the face of the Venerable Śāriputra, then followed behind him step by step. At that time the Venerable Śāriputra gave him the going forth and conferred full ordination upon him.

Now, this monk ate a tooth-cleaning twig, and having chewed it, set it down without washing it. A fly ate from it and passed away at its appointed time. Then a house-cricket ate a little of what remained there and also passed away at its appointed time. Then various birds ate from it and they too passed away at their appointed time. Then a cat ate from it and that one also passed away at its appointed time. Then yet another fly and many ants ate from it and all of them likewise passed away at their appointed time.

While the many creatures lay there having passed away at their appointed times, the next day some monks began eating tooth-cleaning twigs in that spot. They saw the many creatures that had passed away and one of them said: "Venerable ones, why have all these many creatures died?" Others replied: "We do not know." As they were examining it thus, another young monk arrived and said: "Venerable ones, the one who went forth from a brahmin family in this region — the one who dwelt together with the Venerable Śāriputra — ate a tooth-cleaning twig, chewed it, and set it down without washing it. Many creatures ate from it, and having eaten the filth from the chewed end, they passed away." On that occasion the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, there exist some people of harmful character such as this. Therefore, monks must not discard a tooth-cleaning twig unwashed in just that way. If it is discarded, it becomes an offence involving a breach." The Blessed One taught that after eating a tooth-cleaning twig it must be washed.

Some other monks found themselves with too little water and did not know how to proceed. The Blessed One declared: "Whoever has too little water should first rub the tooth-cleaning twig on the ground so that it is free of the

residue of the tongue."

On another occasion someone had begun to do laundry, and having boiled cloth for dyeing, he was wringing and drying it. Just then the Venerable Ānanda came that way, and seeing what was happening, he said, "Venerable one, let me help you." The man replied, "Elder, please do well — Ānanda naturally goes about practicing depravity everywhere: he dries the new cloths in the shade, dries the old ones in the sun, and leaves the damp ones in the shade. Elder, do not act like that." The Venerable Ānanda did this again and again, but could not be stopped. The man, completely beside himself with fury, rushed at Ānanda, and Ānanda began to flee.

Just then the Venerable Śāriputra came that way and asked, "Venerable one, what are you doing, what are you doing?" But the man, now wrapped in rage that only grew, could not stay still and pursued Ānanda as he ran away. When Ānanda began striking him with a banyan branch, the man could not stand it. The Venerable Śāriputra stepped forward, restrained and caught hold of him, and let Ānanda escape — yet even so the man turned back to the banyan tree and devoured all its leaves.

On that occasion the monks heard of this and reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One must not give way to anger like that."

After the Blessed One had declared that one must not give way to anger like that, on yet another occasion a monk's duty assignment fell to Ānanda. He went to him and said, "Venerable one, a task of this sort has fallen — please do it," and at that very moment of seeing him, the man flew into that same all-consuming fury. The monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "One must not in person directly assign a task to someone who has anger and resentment of this kind. Instead, a monk who is sitting near that person should convey the instruction: he should say to him, 'You are to do such-and-such a task.' That monk should go up to the man, take hold of him, and say clearly, 'Do such-and-such a task.'"

The man then, with thorough earnestness and fierce diligent effort, came to know this very wheel of existence, fivefold, moving and unmoving, and fully comprehending that all conditioned things are subject to decay, to falling, to dispersion, and to destruction, he abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhatship. Free of attachment to the three realms, his mind was like stone and gold alike — equanimous toward both; like the sky and like the palm of the hand — unimpeded and open; not distinguishing sandalwood from mud,

he was one whose wisdom had burst open the door-panel of ignorance. He attained the higher knowledges and the individual perfect discriminative awarenesses. He had turned his back on the gains, honors, and acquisitions of further existence and desire. And he became one to be venerated, revered, and spoken of with praise by the gods together with Indra and the god-lords of the celestial hosts.

The monks then said to the Venerable Śāriputra: "Venerable Śāriputra, it is remarkable that even this one who lived alongside you in such extreme anger has attained arhatship itself." He then related at length to those monks the events that had occurred previously in that person's past. The monks gave rise to doubt, and wishing to have all doubts resolved, they asked the awakened Blessed One: "Reverend one, what deed did this monk do such that he was born as a venomous snake?" The Blessed One declared:

"Monks, the karmic accumulation this monk obtained — actions done and gathered that will inevitably come to maturation, abiding close like a flame whose conditions have been fully transformed — will certainly arise. No one other than this very monk can separately experience the actions he himself did and gathered. Monks, actions done and gathered do not ripen in the outer element of earth, nor in the element of water, nor in the element of fire, nor in the element of wind. Rather, they ripen in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense bases. As the verse says:

Even were it a hundred aeons,
actions do not perish;
when the conditions and the time arrive,
they bear their fruit for embodied beings.

Monks, in former times, in this very good aeon, when the lifespan of beings was twenty thousand years, a Teacher named Kāśyapa appeared in the world — one perfect in knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a Blessed One. He dwelt in the forest of the Deer Park of the Sages near the city of Vārāṇasī. A certain person went forth from that one's teaching and came to be known as a monk called 'Abiding in Loving-kindness.' When the other monks addressed him again and again as 'Abiding in Loving-kindness, Abiding in Loving-kindness,' he could not bear to remain silent at their teasing, and being thoroughly consumed by fierce anger he uttered to them, with malicious intent, these harsh words: 'I am the one

abiding in loving-kindness — you are vicious men!"

The Blessed One then declared: "Monks, what do you think? That monk in the teaching of the perfectly and fully awakened buddha Kāśyapa who was called 'Abiding in Loving-kindness' — that was none other than this very monk. At that time, in that era, he called the disciples of the perfectly and fully awakened buddha Kāśyapa 'vicious men' and acted accordingly. Through the karmic maturation of that deed, he was born as a venomous snake for five hundred lifetimes. And even now, by the remaining residue of that very karma, he was born as this venomous snake. But in that same existence he received scriptural transmission, recited and chanted it, and became skilled in the aggregates, skilled in the elements, skilled in the sense bases, skilled in dependent origination, and skilled in what is possible and what is not possible. Therefore, having gone forth in my teaching, he abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhatship.

Therefore, monks, the karmic maturation of wholly dark deeds is wholly dark; the maturation of wholly bright deeds is wholly bright; and the maturation of mixed deeds is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly dark deeds and mixed deeds, and strive after wholly bright deeds. Monks, train yourselves accordingly."

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, those monks were delighted and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Summary verse:

The patched robes were divided according to what was fitting —
the hermit and the subsistence-seeker,
the one carrying a load who makes no sound, who does not eat —
Vārāṇasī was not his domain.

The awakened Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. The monks divided patched robes and, making a rustling sound, used soft, gentle implements to smooth and press them. They urinated and defecated in the latrine areas, and additionally performed cooking and other such tasks, and in the same way wore both upper and lower garments. The monks said: "Venerable ones, these monks use these Dharma robes without discrimination."

The Blessed One had declared the patched robe to be the finest of Dharma robes. How then could they use this supreme patched Dharma robe without

discrimination? Another spoke up: "What the venerable one has said is true. There must be a reason that has not yet come to light. It ought to be investigated." At that point the monks submitted the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, take as the basis for what these monks have said this: monks, the patched robe is like a king. Therefore, when wearing the patched robe, one must not perform all tasks. The Blessed One having declared that when wearing the patched robe one must not perform all tasks, the monks, having distributed the patched robes, did not know what they should do and what they should not do. At that point the monks submitted the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, when going to the alms round, when taking the first seat at a meal, when paying respects at a stūpa, when receiving the Teacher's scriptural transmission and listening to it individually, when listening to the Dharma by day, when listening to the Dharma by night, when sitting in assembly to eat, when paying respects to the preceptor and the master, and furthermore when sitting together with those who keep the celibate life — at those times you shall put on the patched robe. The upper garment shall be put on neatly and in good order, and all tasks performed. The lower garment may be used freely as one pleases." The occasion of this instruction was at Śrāvastī.

Then the Blessed One addressed the monks: "Monks, the sun has risen. The crow is cawing. The farmers are ploughing their fields. The bandits are weeping. Monks, 'the sun has risen' is a code phrase for the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened buddha. 'The crow is cawing' is a code phrase for those persons who teach the Dharma. 'The farmers are ploughing their fields' is a code phrase for the donors and the givers. 'The bandits are weeping' is a code phrase for the host of Māra. Monks, the Teacher — whoever he is — acts out of loving care for the hearers, delighting in benefiting them out of compassion. I look upon you with compassion, and so what you must do is this: in forest hermitages, at the roots of trees, in empty houses, on mountains, in mountain retreats, in mountain caves, on seats of straw, in the open air, in charnel grounds, in forest groves, and in lodgings at the far edge of the wilderness, engage in meditative concentration. Monks, do not be heedless, and do not later come to regret it. This is my teaching." The Blessed One having said, "Monks, remain heedful and meditate in such lodgings," the monks set about meditating in the lodgings as they had been taught. Now, there was one monk of little learning who went off to a hermitage and sat there, not coming into the village in the evening and remaining in that same

place during the day except at the time of the alms round. The cowherd, the livestock herder, the grass-cutter, the wood-cutter, those who lived by the road, and those who lived by the side roads all came to know of his dwelling there.

Then, at another time, some bandits went to raid another village by the rocky crags. There they beat and thoroughly thrashed the people, sacked the place, and fled it. Going off in another direction, they consulted together: "Wise ones, tell us — which direction should we head and where should we go?" At that one of them said, "I am severely wounded and cannot walk." Another said, "I am thirsty." Another said, "I am hungry."

Another among them said, "Wise ones, in this direction there dwells a monk, a son of the Śākyas. This son of the Śākyas is learned and compassionate, and in that hermitage there is nothing to fear. If you are willing, wise ones, let us go there." To this they agreed, saying, "Very well, wise ones — come then, let us go there." And so, like elephants lifting their trunks, they roused their hopes and made their way gradually to his presence. When they arrived, he greeted them with every word of genuine and heartfelt welcome, saying, "Have you come well?" They were greatly gladdened, and their minds grew quite at ease. They sat for a while, then spoke: "Noble one, we are stricken with cold — is there perhaps a little fire?" He replied, "I am a forest-dweller." Another said, "We are thirsty — is there perhaps a little water?" He replied, "I am a forest-dweller." They said, "Noble one, is there perhaps a little powder to dress our wounds?" He replied, "I am a forest-dweller." They said, "Noble one, is there perhaps a little cloth suitable for binding wounds?" He replied, "I am a forest-dweller." They said, "Is there perhaps a little butter to dress the wounds?" He replied, "I am a forest-dweller." "We are hungry — is there perhaps some cooked rice or hot porridge?" He replied, "I am a forest-dweller." They said, "What is today's date, what is the lunar day, what constellation prevails, and which day of the week is it?" He replied, "I am a forest-dweller." Then one among them, who knew the conduct of monks and who had examined the matter from all sides, said, "Noble one, since that is so, let me ask you this. Tell me first — are you an arhat, or a once-returner, or a non-returner, or a stream-enterer?" He replied, "I am a forest-dweller." They said, "Noble one, since that is so, let us ask you something else. Have you attained the sense base of neither-perception-nor-non-perception, or the sense base of nothingness, or the sense base of infinite consciousness, or the sense base of infinite space, or the fourth dhyāna, or the third dhyāna, or the

second dhyāna, or the first dhyāna?" He replied, "I am a forest-dweller." They said, "Noble one, since that is so — are you a master of the Three Baskets, or do you hold the Sūtra collection, or do you hold the Vinaya, or do you hold the Māṭṛkā?" He replied, "I am a forest-dweller." They said, "Since that is so, let us ask you yet another thing — what is your name?" He replied, "I am a forest-dweller." They said, "Noble one, which direction is this?" He replied, "I am a forest-dweller." And so in every respect and in every matter he answered only, "I am a forest-dweller." Thereupon they grew extremely angry and said, "Wise ones, are we the thieves here? This is the real thief — one who does not even know his own name, who clings to a mere outward sign, and who deceives the world!" Intolerant of him, they beat him savagely. They smashed his begging bowl and staff, tore his Dharma-robe, and left him barely alive. Then that very night they departed in that direction.

When dawn broke, he made his way to the Jeta Grove in just that wretched and pitiable condition. The monks saw him and asked, "Venerable one, who left you in such a state? Tell us in detail exactly what happened." He then recounted everything in full. At that point the monks informed the Blessed One.

The Blessed One declared: Rules of conduct are to be established for forest-dwelling monks. A forest-dwelling monk must always keep a fire lit. He must carry a small amount of flour. He must keep clean cloths on hand. He must also keep on hand both any grain he has and leftover cooked food that has been eaten from. He must be knowledgeable about the stars, the reckoning of dates, and the sun. He must know the directions. He must know his own range of travel. He must keep water on hand. He must carry a small amount of oil and grain oil. He must be knowledgeable in sūtra, in Vinaya, in the Māṭṛkā, and at minimum in pleasant speech. A forest-dwelling monk who does not properly uphold and practice the rules of conduct thus established for his way of life will have committed a serious offense. The origin of this ruling is in Śrāvastī.

Now there was a certain householder living in Śrāvastī who on another occasion fell ill. He went to a physician and asked for a diagnosis and treatment. The physician said to him, "Noble one, bathe in a hot-spring bath and you will recover." The man replied, "Good physician, I live by going on alms-rounds. How will I manage to get to a hot spring?" The physician said, "Noble one, the mendicant Śākya-sons bathe twice a month. Go there and take a bath." So the man began to go for a bath, and when he entered among the

monks, he had put on a robe with the red-earth color turned to face outward, so all the monks assumed he too was a monk and no one stopped him. He quickly finished his bath, then sat there feeling unwell. After some time a group of monks came to that spot. When they saw him, one among them with a settled mind said, "Venerable ones, there is an elder monk sitting here — let him bathe." The others said, "Good, let it be so." They went to him and said, "Elder, come here and bathe." He shook his head, and they took him by the shoulder and helped him up. He then said, "Impure people who have not bathed are touching one who has already bathed — monks who are Śākya-sons." They replied, "We are the mendicant Śākya-sons. Who are you, to be like an elder monk?" He said, "I am a householder." They said, "Well then, householder, who gave you a bath?" — and at that point the monks reported this to the Blessed One.

The Blessed One declared: "Monks, it is therefore the case that when monks are bathing at the hot-spring bath, door-wardens are to be stationed, and those monks who enter from outside are to be asked their names." When they began asking monks for their names, the Blessed One then declared: "Do not ask for the names of monks who are known to you."

When the Blessed One Śākyamuni was touring the Kosala country and had arrived at Anupiya, he stayed in the Anupiya forest at Anupiya.

Now at that time a brahmin named Padmahṛdaya had been given by Prasenajit, the king of Kosala, a brahmin's benefice grant consisting of grass, wood, and water, and he enjoyed that great and prosperous property. Padmahṛdaya the brahmin had a student, a young brahmin called Maṣu, who was learned, of clear speech, and of unobstructed understanding. Padmahṛdaya the brahmin would instruct approximately five hundred brahmin youths in the recitation of brahmin sacred formularies.

Padmahṛdaya the brahmin had heard of the renown, the fame, the report, and the far-reaching praise of the wise Gautama — that the contemplative Gautama, son of the Śākya, born of the Śākya clan, had shaved his hair and beard, put on saffron-coloured robes, and gone forth from home into homelessness out of pure and genuine faith, and had then fully awakened to the unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening; that this Blessed One Gautama is the Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassable guide of persons to be trained, teacher of gods and humans, an awakened and

blessed one; that in this very visible teaching he, by his own direct knowledge, directly realised and accomplished the ending of his defilements: "My defilements are exhausted. I have dwelt in the holy life. What was to be done has been done. I know no further becoming beyond this." That his Dharma, too, is good in the beginning, good in the middle, and good in the end — of excellent meaning, excellent in word, unmixed, perfectly complete, perfectly pure, perfectly refined — and that it thoroughly reveals the holy life. This renown had also spread from the sacred brahmin formularies themselves, which say that a great man endowed with the thirty-two marks of a great man can go one of only two ways: if he remains a householder, he will become a wheel-turning king who conquers in all four directions, a righteous king, a dharma-king possessed of the seven precious treasures. These seven precious treasures are as follows: the precious wheel, the precious elephant, the precious horse, the precious jewel, the precious woman, the precious householder, and the seventh is the precious minister. Such a king will have brave and valiant sons, splendid in their limbs, who will utterly defeat enemy forces; and the great earth extending to the ocean's edge will be his possession without division, free from annoyance and without violence, established well and securely in accordance with Dharma, and governed evenly. But if he shaves his hair and beard, puts on saffron-coloured robes, and goes forth from home into homelessness out of pure and genuine faith, he will become one renowned throughout the world as a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha.

He had heard that this one had toured the Kosala country and departed, had come to Anupiya, and was dwelling in the Anupiya forest at Anupiya.

Having heard this, Padmaḥṛdaya the brahmin said to the young brahmin Maṣu: "Maṣu, do you know? I have heard it said that the contemplative Gautama, son of the Śākyas, born of the Śākya clan, shaved his hair and beard, put on saffron-coloured robes, and went forth from home into homelessness out of pure and genuine faith" — and everything up to "he will become one renowned throughout the world" — "and I myself have drawn this from the sacred formularies: that a great man endowed with the thirty-two marks of a great man can go one of only two ways: if he remains a householder he will become a wheel-turning king who conquers in all four directions" — and everything up to "he will become one renowned throughout the world" — "and that he has toured the Kosala country and departed, has come to Anupiya, and is dwelling in the Anupiya forest at Anupiya."

Having heard this, the brahmin youth Ambastha was told: "Go, young brahmin, to where the wise one Gautama is. Go and find out whether his virtue, renown, reputation, and the great verses of praise that have spread in all directions and to every quarter are exactly as reported or not, and whether the marks attributed to him are accurate or not."

The brahmin youth Ambastha listened to the brahmin Pokkharasāti and set out from the larger settlement accompanied by a great number of senior brahmins. He went to where the Blessed One was and, having arrived, sat down to one side. The senior brahmins then exchanged various pleasant and courteous words with the Blessed One and sat down to one side. Once they were seated, the Blessed One gave the senior brahmins a proper discourse on the Dharma, led them to take it up rightly, roused them to enthusiasm, and gladdened them thoroughly.

While the Blessed One was giving the senior brahmins this discourse on the Dharma, the brahmin youth Ambastha was walking about with his sandals on and breaking into the conversation with sudden remarks, refusing to stay until the topic was concluded — arrogant, disrespectful, and minded to contradict.

Then the Blessed One said this to the brahmin youth Ambastha: "Young brahmin, is it your habit to talk so abruptly like this in company with the three-knowledge brahmins? Or tell me, Gautama, what sort of talk is this — that while the Tathāgata is giving a Dharma discourse to the senior brahmins, you walk about with your sandals on, break in with sudden remarks, refuse to stay until the topic is concluded, and stand there arrogant, disrespectful, and minded to contradict?

"Young brahmin, those brahmins who walk — walk together with other walkers. Those who stand — stand together with other standers. Those who sit — sit together with other sitters. Those who lie down — lie down together with others who lie down. They speak well to one another. As for those shaven-headed ascetics, those dark-limbed menials born of Brahma's foot — with them it is fitting to hold such a sudden casual conversation, just as one might talk with the wise one Gautama now.

"Young brahmin, you have come here in pursuit of a purpose. Such lack of respect as this — no one else has shown it. Indeed, the brahmin youth Ambastha has shown no respect to the assembly of teachers."

When the Blessed One reproached the brahmin youth Ambastha with these words of disrespect, Ambastha became angry, agitated, and furious, his mind

displeased. He wanted to rebuke the Blessed One, to be bold against him, to dispute with him, to call him to account, thinking: "With this alone I shall rebuke, be bold against, dispute with, and call to account the ascetic Gautama." Realizing this, the Blessed One spoke:

"Listen now, Gautama — these Śākyas are mere upstarts, upstarts by lineage. They do not show brahmins honor, respect, deference, or veneration. Does that mean, young brahmin, that the Śākyas have done you even the slightest harm?

"Indeed, Gautama, there was once an occasion when I and my preceptor went to the Śākya settlement of Kapilavatthu. There, the Śākyas and the Śākya maidens went up onto their fine upper terraces and pointed at me with their fingers, saying: 'That is Ambastha, the brahmin youth, pupil of the brahmin Pokkharasāti! That is Ambastha, the brahmin youth, pupil of the brahmin Pokkharasāti!' They pointed at me with nothing but their fingers; they did not show me honor, respect, deference, or veneration."

"Young brahmin, even a nestling sparrow chirps as it pleases in its own nest — so what need is there even to speak of the Śākyas? Young brahmin, the settlement of Kapilavatthu is the Śākyas' own. Gautama, there are four castes: brahmin, noble warrior, merchant, and commoner. These four castes all show honor, respect, deference, and veneration to the brahmins. But these Śākyas are upstarts — they are of upstart lineage — and so they show no honor, no respect, no deference, and no veneration to the brahmins."

Then the Blessed One thought to himself: "Ah, this disagreeable young brahmin is making such extravagant claims against the Śākyas — 'the Śākyas are upstarts, the Śākyas are of upstart lineage!' Let me therefore search out this young brahmin's ancestral lineage." And as the Blessed One searched out the ancestral lineage of the young brahmin Ambaṭṭha, he saw that Ambaṭṭha was in fact the son of a slave woman of the Śākyas, and that the Śākyas were the sons of his masters.

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to the young brahmin Ambaṭṭha: "Young brahmin, what is your lineage?"

"Gautama, I am the son of Icchanangala."

"Young brahmin, when your ancestral lineage is traced back from here, you are the son of a slave woman of the Śākyas, and the Śākyas are the sons of your masters — that is what I see."

Vinaya — the Minor Matters. The Forty-Sixth Bundle.

Then the senior brahmins said this to the Blessed One: "Gautama, please do not speak the word 'son of a slave woman' to the young brahmin Ambaṭṭha. Why? Because the young brahmin Ambaṭṭha is learned, eloquent, and speaks without hesitation. Moreover, the young brahmin Ambaṭṭha is confident that he can reply to the wise Gautama on this matter in a way that accords with the Dharma. Brahmins, if you think that the young brahmin Ambaṭṭha is capable of giving a reply that accords with the Dharma, then say nothing yourselves and let the young brahmin Ambaṭṭha reply to him on this matter in a way that accords with the Dharma. Brahmins, if you think that the young brahmin Ambaṭṭha cannot give me a reply that accords with the Dharma on this matter, then let the young brahmin say nothing and let you, the learned ones, obtain from me a reply that accords with the Dharma on this matter. Gautama, the young brahmin Ambaṭṭha himself is indeed learned, eloquent, and speaks without hesitation. The young brahmin Ambaṭṭha is confident that he can reply to the wise Gautama on this matter in a way that accords with the Dharma — it is not the case that others cannot."

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to the young brahmin Ambaṭṭha: "Young brahmin, long ago there was a king named Okkāka. King Okkāka had four sons: Starface, Handear, Tamed by the Elephant, and Ornamented Feet. King Okkāka banished them for some offense or other, and they each took their own sisters and, leaving behind one territory and city after another, gradually went to a region near the Himalayas, to the bank of the river by the auspicious sal tree grove, not far from Kapilavatthu. There they made shelters from branches and leaves, and dwelt and settled there. There, in that place, they took their own sisters as wives, and —

in that place, setting aside the elder sisters, they lived together and settled there with the younger sisters. Living and dwelling there, they bore sons and daughters.

Then at another time, King Okkāka, remembering those beloved youths, spoke to his ministers: "Good people, where did those young men go?" The gods be praised — those youths were banished for some offense or other, and they took their own sisters and went from one territory and city to another, and gradually settled near the Himalayas by the bank of the river by the auspicious sal tree grove, bearing sons and daughters and dwelling there.

Then King Okkāka said to his ministers: "Good people, were those youths truly capable of this?" — "Indeed they were, Your Majesty!" Then King Okkāka bared his upper body, stretched out his right hand, and with a solemn utterance proclaimed: "Oh! Those youths were supremely capable!" — and by this cry, which resounded as far as beings of great power dwell — "Oh! Those youths were capable!" — this saying became a word, and they came to be known as "Śākya, Śākya."

Young brahmin, have you heard even a little of how it is that the Śākyas trace their origin to this and that this is the lineage and line of descent from which they come?

"O Gautama, I have indeed heard that the Śākyas trace their origin to this and that this is the lineage and line of descent from which they come."

Young brahmin, King Okkāka had a slave woman named Ngophōdma — Dishnī by name — who was beautiful, lovely, and fair to behold. She came together with a man of the outcast sage lineage, and from their union together a son was born. The moment the boy was born, his mother said: "Wrap me for a while, and wash him, and free him from impurity." Then at another time, the Unblinking Ones — the rākṣasas — said, the moment the boy was born, in words: "Wrap me for a while and free him from impurity, and — oh! — a son of the Unblinking One has been born!" And so he came to be known as "Son of the Unblinking One, Son of the Unblinking One."

Young brahmin, have you heard even a little of how it is that the Sons of the Unblinking One trace their origin to this and that this is the lineage and line of descent from which they come?

When this was said, the young brahmin Ambaṭṭha remained silent and said nothing. A second time, and a third time, the Blessed One said these very words to the young brahmin Ambaṭṭha: "Young brahmin, have you heard even a little of how it is that the Sons of the Unblinking One trace their origin to this and that this is the lineage and line of descent from which they come?"

A second time and a third time, the young brahmin Ambaṭṭha said nothing at all.

Then the yakṣa (yakṣa) Vajrapāṇi, holding aloft a vajra blazing, fiercely blazing, blazing all around, burning with a single tongue of flame, stood over the head of the young brahmin Ambaṭṭha, thinking: "If the young brahmin Ambaṭṭha, having been asked by the Blessed One three times in succession,

still plugs his ears and refuses to answer, may this vajra blazing, fiercely blazing, blazing all around, burning with a single tongue of flame split his head into seven pieces!"

The Blessed One saw Vajrapāṇi, and by the power of the Buddha the young brahmin Ambaṭṭha also saw him. Then the young brahmin Ambaṭṭha, terrified and with his hair standing on end, said this to the Blessed One: "O Gautama, it is indeed so — the Sons of the Unblinking One trace their origin to this and this is

their lineage — that is what I have heard."

Then the elder brahmins and the householders who were present thought to themselves: "If what the venerable Gautama has said is true — that the young brahmin Ambaṭṭha is the son of a slave woman and that the Śākyas are the sons of her masters — then we have simply failed to believe the wise Gautama when he spoke."

Then the Blessed One addressed the elder brahmins and the householders, saying: "You must not speak so harshly to the young brahmin Ambaṭṭha as to call him the son of a slave woman. For at that time there was a great and mighty sage of great supernatural power, and King Okkāka had him expelled on account of some minor offense. A brahmin penalty was imposed upon him. And when that brahmin penalty had been imposed, King Okkāka, seized with terror and fright, his hair standing on end, took a great lady adorned with all her ornaments by the left hand and held a golden water-pot in his right hand, and offered her to that sage as a wife. But the sage did not accept her."

Then, because the Blessed One had declared in words that the young brahmin Ambaṭṭha was the son of a slave woman, Ambaṭṭha sank down in shame, hunched his shoulders, bowed his head, lost his composure, fell into deep consternation, and sat there without saying a word. The Blessed One thought: "Since I have spoken the words declaring that this young brahmin Ambaṭṭha is the son of a slave woman, he has sunk down in shame, hunched his shoulders, bowed his head, lost his composure, fallen into deep consternation, and will not speak. He will not rise from this — let me engage him further in conversation." And so the Blessed One addressed the young brahmin Ambaṭṭha with these words:

"Young brahmin, consider this example. Suppose a young man of the warrior caste (kṣatriya) and a brahmin girl were to come together, and a son were born from that union. Would that son receive a seat, water, or the secret

words, or the recitation, from the brahmins? O Gautama, yes, he would receive them. And would he receive the anointing of the warrior caste from the warriors? O Gautama, yes, he would receive it. And why? Because he is the nephew — for this reason the warriors anoint the nephew with the warrior anointing.

"Young brahmin, consider another example. Suppose a young brahmin and a girl of the warrior caste were to come together, and a son were born from that union. Would that son receive a seat, water, or the secret words, or the recitation, from the brahmins? O Gautama, yes, he would receive them. And would he receive the warrior anointing from the warriors? O Gautama, yes, he would receive it. And why? Because he is the nephew — for this reason the warriors anoint the nephew with the warrior anointing.

"Young brahmin, consider yet another example. Suppose a young man of the warrior caste were expelled by the warriors on account of some minor offense. Would he receive a seat, water, or the secret words, or the recitation, from the brahmins? O Gautama, yes, he would receive them. And would he receive the warrior anointing from the warriors? O Gautama, yes, he would receive it. And why? Because he is a brother — for this reason the warriors anoint a brother with the warrior anointing.

"Young brahmin, consider yet another example. Suppose a young brahmin were expelled by the brahmins on account of some minor offense. Would he receive a seat, water, or the secret words, or the recitation, from the brahmins? O Gautama, no, he would not receive them. Would he receive the warrior anointing from the warriors? O Gautama, no, he would not receive it. And why? Because a brahmin is an outcaste — for this reason the warriors do not anoint a brahmin with the warrior anointing."

"Young brahmin, in that case, by blood, lineage, and oath, the warrior caste is supreme — not the brahmins."

The lord of the Mithilā brahmins, Brahmā, then spoke these verses:

Whoever stands connected by blood,
the warrior caste is most honored among two-legged beings.
Among gods and humans alike,
one endowed with lineage and virtue is most honored.

The young brahmin said that what the lord of the Mithilā brahmins, Brahmā, had spoken in verse was well spoken, not ill spoken; rightly expressed, not

wrongly expressed. And so it was:

Whoever stands connected by blood,
the warrior caste is most honored among two-legged beings.
Among gods and humans alike,
one endowed with lineage and virtue is most honored.

"And why? Young brahmin, I myself once said these words:

Whoever stands connected by blood,
the warrior caste is most honored among two-legged beings.
Among gods and humans alike,
one endowed with lineage and virtue is most honored.

Young brahmin, what do you think? In a place where brides are taken and given in marriage, do the brahmins receive a seat, water, secret words, or recitation from there?"

"O Gautama, in a place where brides are taken and given in marriage, indeed the brahmins do receive a seat, water, secret words, and recitation from there."

"Young brahmin, in a place where brides are taken and given in marriage, there is pride of lineage, there is pride of blood, and there is pride of brahminhood.

Young brahmin, all those sentient beings who are bound by pride of lineage, bound by pride of blood, and bound by pride of brahminhood — so long as they have not directly realized this unsurpassed science endowed with virtue, they have no fortune to directly realize it. But a brahmin's son who has abandoned pride of lineage, abandoned pride of blood, and abandoned pride of brahminhood — he will come to directly realize this unsurpassed science endowed with virtue that he has not yet directly realized.

I myself, O wise Gautama, have never before encountered, nor shall encounter hereafter, nor do I now encounter anything like unto this — I am filled with conviction. O wise Gautama, please teach the Dharma to me in such a way that I may come to be endowed with science and virtue."

"Young brahmin, therefore listen well, attend carefully, and I shall teach."

"Young brahmin, the Teacher — the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, endowed with science and virtue, the Sugata, the knower of the world, the unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, the

teacher of gods and humans, the Blessed One — has appeared in this world. He teaches the Dharma that is good at the beginning, good in the middle, and good at the end, with noble meaning and noble words, unmixed, perfectly complete, perfectly pure, and thoroughly clarified — and he reveals the holy life. A householder or a householder's son hears that Dharma. Having heard that Dharma, he attains genuine faith. Possessed of that genuine faith, he reflects thus: 'The household life is confined and dusty; going forth is unsurpassed. While dwelling in a home, it is difficult to live the holy life in a way that is singular, bright, perfectly complete, perfectly pure, and thoroughly clarified for as long as one lives. Let me shave off hair and beard, don the saffron-colored robes, and go forth from home into homelessness out of genuine faith alone.' And so, having thus reflected and examined, he abandons his many goods and possessions and his circle of relatives, shaves off hair and beard, dons the saffron-colored robes, and, going forth from home into homelessness out of genuine faith alone, he takes up residence in moral discipline. He is restrained by the vows of individual liberation (Skt. *pratimokṣa*)."

He is one of proper conduct and perfect comportment, seeing danger in even the subtlest transgression. He undertakes and trains in the bases of training. Having abandoned the taking of life, he has turned back from the taking of life: he has renounced violence, renounced weapons, and is possessed of conscientious shame. Toward all sentient beings — toward every creature — even down to the smallest living thing, even a worm or an ant, he has turned back from the taking of life.

Having abandoned taking what is not given, he has turned back from taking what is not given. He accepts only what is given, he rejoices in accepting what is given, and he rejoices in freely releasing through generosity. He is no thief; he is not one of great craving; he is pure, he is open-handed, he is blameless, and by guarding himself he has turned back from taking what is not given.

Having abandoned unchaste conduct, he has turned back from unchaste conduct. He is one who lives a chaste life; pure through abandoning base conduct, he is clean, free from foul odor, free from coupling, free from the ways of the lower region, and has turned back from unchaste conduct.

Having abandoned false speech, he has turned back from false speech. He speaks truthfully, he delights in truth, he is faithful, trustworthy, and steadfast, not a deceiver of the world, and he has turned back from false speech.

Having abandoned divisive speech, he has turned back from divisive speech. What he has heard on this side he does not repeat to those on that side in order to divide them; what he has heard on that side he does not repeat to those on this side in order to divide them. He reconciles those who are divided, encourages those who are in harmony, delights in harmony, rejoices in harmony, and speaks words that bring about harmony — and thus he has turned back from divisive speech.

Having abandoned harsh speech, he has turned back from harsh speech. He abandons any such words that are harmful and rough, unpleasant to others, offensive to others, unacceptable to the minds of many people, disagreeable to the hearts of many people, displeasing to many people, unwelcome to the minds of many people, not peaceful, and not conducive to settling the mind in peace. Instead he speaks such words as are inoffensive, pleasant to the ear, satisfying to the heart, delightful, like the sound of a royal court assembly, melodious and sweet, clear and distinct, worth listening to, not contrary to what one relies upon, boundless, dear to many people, pleasing to many people, delightful to many people, welcome to the minds of many people, peaceful, and conducive to settling the mind in peace — and thus he has turned back from harsh speech.

Having abandoned idle chatter, he has turned back from idle chatter. He speaks at the right time, he speaks truthfully, he speaks about suchness, he speaks about what is meaningful, he speaks about the Dharma, he speaks with certainty, he speaks about what can be understood, and he speaks words that lead to comprehension. What he says is timely, has a basis and a point of reference, is accompanied by purpose and reason, is grounded in the Dharma — and thus he has abandoned idle chatter and turned back from idle chatter.

Having abandoned fraudulent trading, he has turned back from fraudulent trading. He has abandoned falsifying measures of volume, falsifying scales, and falsifying measures of weight, and he has turned back from falsifying measures of volume, scales, and measures of weight.

He has abandoned taking bribes, embezzlement, and seizing things by force and making them his own, and he has turned back from taking bribes, embezzlement, and seizing things by force and making them his own.

He has abandoned the intention to kill, to bind, to cut, to stab, and to beat, and he has turned back from the intention to kill, to bind, to cut, to stab, and to beat.

He has abandoned lying down together with one who has a light and with a woman, and he has turned back from lying down together with one who has a light and with a woman.

He has abandoned taking plots of farmland, plots for houses, and plots for shops, and he has turned back from taking plots of farmland, plots for houses, and plots for shops.

He has abandoned taking elephants, horses, cattle, sheep, fowl, and pigs, and he has turned back from taking elephants, horses, cattle, sheep, fowl, and pigs.

He has abandoned taking male slaves, female slaves, workers, and those who subsist on whey, and he has turned back from taking male slaves, female slaves, workers, and those who subsist on whey.

He has abandoned taking women, men, boys, and girls, and he has turned back from taking women, men, boys, and girls.

He has abandoned taking gold and silver, and he has turned back from taking gold and silver.

He has abandoned taking undamaged grain, and he has turned back from taking undamaged grain.

He eats but one meal a day, having relinquished eating in the evening and relinquished eating food at an improper time. He is devoted to practice at the proper time and to engagement at the proper time. He is content and knows his measure with robes sufficient for the body. He is content and knows his measure with alms food sufficient to fill his belly. Because he is content and knows his measure with robes sufficient for the body, and content and knows his measure with alms food sufficient to fill his belly, wherever he goes he goes carrying only his bowl and his robes. Just as a winged bird, wherever it flies, flies carrying only its feathers and its wings — so too he is content and knows his measure with robes sufficient for the body, content and knows his measure with alms food sufficient to fill his belly, and wherever he goes he goes carrying only his bowl and his robes.

O friend, there are also certain ascetics (śramaṇas) and brahmins who, living on food given out of faith, apply themselves with diligence to undertaking various kinds of seed-collections and plant-collections in the following manner: root seeds, stem seeds, node seeds, cutting seeds, and fifth, seed-seeds. From such application and diligence on the part of ascetics and brahmins in

undertaking various kinds of seed-collections and plant-collections, he has turned back.

O friend, there are also certain ascetics and brahmins who, living on food given out of faith, apply themselves with diligence to undertaking various kinds of storing, in the following manner: storing food, storing drink, storing cloth, storing fragrance, storing flavors, storing leaves, storing flowers, and storing fruits. From such application and diligence on the part of ascetics and brahmins in undertaking various kinds of storing, he has turned back.

O friend, there are also certain ascetics and brahmins who, living on food given out of faith, apply themselves with diligence to acquiring high seats and great furnishings, and who dwell in the following manner: cushioned seats, thrones, thrones with wool coverings, thrones with cotton coverings, seats with inner padding, great lengths of cloth, variegated cloth, cloth woven with pālelā fiber, elephant battle-mats, horse battle-mats, single-sided wool, double-sided wool, fleece-wool,

wool worked from the back, coverings of Kāliṅga cloth, cloth with upper covers, cloth worked with red dye on both sides — he has turned back from the diligence of ascetics and brahmins in acquiring high seats and great furnishings in just such ways.

O friend, there are also certain ascetics and brahmins who, living on food given out of faith, apply themselves with diligence to acquiring various kinds of adornments and accessories, and who dwell in the following manner: massaging and bathing, rubbing and anointing, garlands and perfumes, unguents and cosmetics, coloring of nails, coloring of teeth, mouth-powder, face-scrubbing, gazing into mirrors, adorning the hands with bangles, binding the topknot, parasol-handles with fringe, swords, yak-tail fans with jeweled handles, embroidered slippers, new cloth, and fresh cotton cloth with long edges to be worn and carried — he has turned back from the diligence of ascetics and brahmins in applying themselves to acquiring various kinds of adornments and accessories in just such ways.

O friend, there are also certain ascetics and brahmins who, living on food given out of faith, apply themselves with diligence to attending various kinds of spectacles, and who dwell in the following manner: elephant fights, horse fights, chariot fights, contests with young soldiers, fights with staves, fights with fists, contests among champion bulls, buffalo fights, ram fights, cock fights, fights of quail, fights among boars, fights between women, fights

between men, fights between young men, fights between young women, climbing trees, gatherings for song and dance, leaping from shoulders, the tops of victory banners, the foremost feats of strength, viewing large armies, and desiring to see large assemblies — he has turned back from the diligence of ascetics and brahmins in applying themselves to attending various kinds of spectacles in just such ways.

O friend, there are also certain ascetics and brahmins who, living on food given out of faith, apply themselves with diligence to listening to various kinds of sounds, and who dwell in the following manner: the sounds of elephants, the sounds of horses, the sounds of chariots, the sounds of young soldiers, the sound of conches, the sound of paṭaha drums, the sound of great drums, the sounds of various musical instruments, the singing voice of dancers, the sounds of music, the sound of cymbals, the sound of bells, the sound of clapping hands, the sound of vases being struck, the sound of amateur performances, poetry, various writings, various words, and desiring to hear the talk of fame connected with proclamations of the world — he has turned back from the diligence of ascetics and brahmins in applying themselves to listening to various kinds of sounds in just such ways.

O friend, there are also certain ascetics and brahmins who, living on food given out of faith, apply themselves with diligence to games of dice, gambling, and sports, and who dwell in the following manner: boards with eight squares, boards with ten squares, the eye of nāya, contests from all sides, pot-games, trials of strength, walking-games, bouncing games, sports, dice, substitution-moves, needle-games, hand-ornament games, and contests played with pieces inserted in various ways — he has turned back from the diligence of ascetics and brahmins in applying themselves to games of dice, gambling, and sports in just such ways.

O friend, there are also certain ascetics and brahmins who, living on food given out of faith,

consume, living on food given out of faith, apply themselves to composing various kinds of talk — that is to say, talk of kings, talk of thieves, talk of armies, talk of food, talk of drink, talk of clothing, talk of marketplaces, talk of courtesans, talk of bad roads, talk of seas, talk of lands and great continents — he has turned back from the diligence of ascetics and brahmins in applying themselves to composing various kinds of such talk.

O friend, there are also certain ascetics and brahmins who, living on food given out of faith, dwell applying themselves to engaging in various kinds of dispute, such as: "I know this Dharma and discipline thoroughly. You do not know this Dharma and discipline. As I know this Dharma and discipline in full, so you do not know this Dharma and discipline in full. My position is consistent with reason; yours is not. My position is relevant; yours is not. You said last what ought to have been said first, and said first what ought to have been said last. You spoke too quickly and your point was not answered. You have been defeated in argument and your case has been overthrown — abandon that statement you made in the course of argument! If you think you can counter it, ask and speak!" — he has turned back from the diligence of ascetics and brahmins in applying themselves to engaging in various kinds of such dispute.

O friend, there are also certain ascetics and brahmins who, living on food given out of faith, earn their livelihood by the wrong means of carrying and delivering messages — acting as messengers for kings, or for great ministers, or for brahmins, or for householders, or for townspeople, or for country-folk, or for merchants, or for caravan leaders, carrying messages hence thither and leading the way, and carrying messages thither back hence — he has turned back from the diligence of ascetics and brahmins in earning their livelihood by such wrong means of carrying and delivering messages.

O friend, there are also certain ascetics and brahmins who, living on food given out of faith, engage in dissembling, flattery, canvassing, and measuring gain to gain further gain — he has turned back from the diligence of ascetics and brahmins in engaging in such dissembling, flattery, canvassing, and measuring gain to gain further gain.

O friend, there are also certain ascetics and brahmins who, living on food given out of faith, earn their livelihood by the wrong means of the debased arts of omen-reading — that is: reading of violent weather, reading of birthmarks, reading of dream signs, reading of burns from fire, reading of contact with water, reading of marks left by mice, making of auspicious offerings, reciting of pleasing words, reading the sounds of all manner of spirits, reading of bodily signs, reading of house-sites, reading of fields, reading of birds, reading of finger-signs, and the making of various applications — he has turned back from the diligence of ascetics and brahmins in earning their livelihood by such wrong means of the debased arts of omen-reading.

O friend, there are also certain ascetics and brahmins who, living on food given out of faith, earn their livelihood by the wrong means of the debased arts of omen-reading — that is: making of momentary conjunctions, reading of the rising of constellations, examination of portents of all kinds, performance of pacifying rites, performance of enriching rites, performance of fierce rites, performance of fire-offering rites, recitation of syllables, calculation of astrological charts, counting of numbers, finger-reckoning, and examination by mirror — he has turned back from the diligence of ascetics and brahmins in earning their livelihood by such wrong means of the debased arts of omen-reading.

O friend, there are also certain ascetics and brahmins who, living on food given out of faith, earn their livelihood by the wrong means of the debased arts of omen-reading — that is: the practice of healing examination, the giving of root medicines, the giving of eye medicines, the giving of emetics, the giving of medicines, the examination of women, the examination of men, the examination of boys, the examination of girls, and the application of medicinal treatments — he has turned back from the diligence of ascetics and brahmins in earning their livelihood by such wrong means of the debased arts of omen-reading.

O friend, there are also certain ascetics and brahmins who, living on food given out of faith, earn their livelihood by the wrong means of the debased arts of omen-reading — that is: reading the marks of precious gems, reading the marks of staffs, reading the marks of swords, reading the marks of arrows, reading the marks of weapons, reading the marks of elephants, reading the marks of horses, reading the marks of excellent bulls, reading the marks of buffaloes, reading the marks of goats, reading the marks of sheep, reading the marks of roosters, reading the marks of tortoises, reading the marks of hares, reading the marks of women, reading the marks of men, reading the marks of youths, reading the marks of maidens, reading the signs of a short life, reading the signs of a long life, reading the signs of little fortune, reading the signs of great fortune, reading the signs of little merit, reading the signs of great merit, reading the signs of little power, reading the signs of great power, reading the marks of masters, and reading the marks of servants — he has turned back from the diligence of ascetics and brahmins in earning their livelihood by such wrong means of the debased arts of omen-reading.

O friend, there are also certain ascetics and brahmins who, living on food given out of faith, earn their livelihood by the wrong means of the debased arts of omen-reading — that is: the simultaneous purging of medicinal food upward and downward, purging by means of swelling, the administration of enemas, inducing vomiting, purgation downward, nasal infusions, inhalation of smoke, procedures involving bile, examination of phlegm, examination of the stomach, examination of moles, examination of eyes that are underdeveloped, divination by the circling of deer, divination by the circling of crows, examining the movement of the shoulder blades, determining by taste with the tongue, and the application of procedures involving corpses and half-corpses — he has turned back from the diligence of ascetics and brahmins in earning their livelihood by such wrong means of the debased arts of omen-reading.

O friend, there are also certain ascetics and brahmins who, living on food given out of faith, earn their livelihood by the wrong means of the debased arts of omen-reading — that is: summoning spirits, full summoning, particular summoning, causing bewilderment, full bewilderment, particular bewilderment, bringing about scattering and destruction, causing well-being, causing suffering, causing conception in the womb, fire-offerings with sesame, fire-offerings with rice, fire-offerings with butter, fire-offerings with substances, fire-offerings of the fire-offering itself, paying homage to the sun, paying homage to the stars, paying homage to the gods, and paying homage to the great objects of veneration — he has turned back from the diligence of ascetics and brahmins in earning their livelihood by such wrong means of the debased arts of omen-reading.

O friend, there are also certain ascetics and brahmins who,

living off the full use of what was given in faith and sustaining themselves through the debased livelihood of the crooked arts of omen-reading — namely: predicting that there will be danger, predicting that there will be well-being, predicting that the harvest will be poor, predicting that the harvest will be good, predicting that rainfall will be scarce, predicting that rainfall will be plentiful, predicting that epidemic disease will arise, predicting that epidemic disease will not arise. He has turned back from such a debased livelihood of the crooked arts as is practiced by ascetics and brahmins.

The forty-seventh fascicle of the minor bases of Vinaya.

O friend, there are also certain ascetics and brahmins who live off the full use of what was given in faith and sustain themselves through the debased

livelihood of the crooked arts of omen-reading — namely: predicting that the inner king will be victorious and the outer king will be defeated, that the outer king will be victorious and the inner king will be defeated, that the inner king will flee and the outer king will advance, that the outer king will flee and the inner king will advance. He has turned back from such a debased livelihood of sustaining oneself through the crooked arts.

O friend, there are also certain ascetics and brahmins who live off the full use of what was given in faith and sustain themselves through the debased livelihood of the crooked arts of omen-reading — namely: predicting from such occurrences as the sun and moon straying from their courses; the path of the sun through a planetary conjunction; the path of the moon through a planetary conjunction; the falling of meteors; the appearance of lights on the horizon; the blazing of lights on the horizon; the drumming of the gods in the sky; the sun not being in conjunction with a planet; the moon not being in conjunction with a planet; the falling of meteors; the appearance of lights on the horizon; the blazing of lights on the horizon; the drumming of the gods in the sky; how the sun and moon, being of such great magic power and great might, rise on such a path or stray from the path, set on such a path or set from other than the path — and when the path is thus, predicting what will be affliction and what will be purification. He has turned back from such a debased livelihood of sustaining oneself through the crooked arts.

O friend, there are also certain ascetics and brahmins who live off the full use of what was given in faith and sustain themselves through the debased livelihood of the crooked arts of omen-reading — teaching such things as: if the sun and moon stray from their course in such a way, such and such a karmic maturation will result; such a karmic maturation of such a kind arises when solar and lunar conjunctions are entered in such a way, when meteors fall, when lights appear on the horizon, when lights blaze on the horizon, when the gods drum in the sky, the maturation will ripen in such a form; the sun and moon, being of such great magic power and great might, rise on such a path and set on such a path; when the path is thus, such will be the maturation of affliction and such the pleasant maturation of purification. He has turned back from such a debased livelihood of sustaining oneself through the crooked arts.

Endowed with such an aggregate of noble moral discipline, he is inwardly blameless and thus experiences well-being. He turns the sense faculties back from their objects and so dwells with mindfulness fully guarded. His mindfulness is clear; acting mindfully, he dwells in a place of mental

composure. Though he sees forms with the eye, he does not grasp at their marks, nor does he grasp at their secondary features. Because dwelling without being restrained by the restraint of the eye faculty allows attachment, low-mindedness, and the unwholesome and non-virtuous states of worldly wrongdoing to flow into the mind, he applies himself to restraint for the sake of that restraint, and by guarding the eye faculty he achieves restraint of the eye faculty. In the same way, with the ear he guards sounds; with the nose he guards smells; with the tongue he guards tastes;

with the body he guards touches; and with the mind he guards phenomena. Though he knows phenomena with the mind, he does not grasp at their marks, nor does he grasp at their secondary features. Because dwelling without being restrained by the restraint of the mind faculty allows attachment, low-mindedness, and the unwholesome and non-virtuous states of worldly wrongdoing to flow into the mind, by restraining the mind he achieves restraint of the mind faculty.

Being endowed with this noble moral discipline, and turning the faculties away from their objects, he is inwardly blameless and experiences happiness in his own right. He becomes fully aware of his coming and going, and dwelling in that awareness he knows and remains mindful of looking ahead and looking around, of drawing in and stretching out the limbs, of wearing the patch-robe and outer robe, of holding the alms bowl, of going, standing, sitting, lying down, and not lying down, of speaking and keeping silent, of falling asleep and of dispelling drowsiness.

Endowed with this aggregate of noble moral discipline, and with faculties turned inward, and being possessed of thorough mindfulness and clear introspective awareness, he feels inward blamelessness as genuine happiness. Then he resorts to seclusion and sits in a forest grove, at the root of a tree, in an empty house, or in any secluded or remote place. Sitting cross-legged, holding the body upright, and establishing mindfulness before him, he abandons the attachment of the world and dwells again and again in a mind free from attachment, purifying the mind of attachment. He abandons ill will, dullness and drowsiness, restlessness and remorse, and doubt in the world, and becomes free from expectation and free from doubt. He thoroughly purifies the mind of the doubtful thought: "Is this wholesome quality of such a kind, or of what kind?"

It is like this. An unfortunate man takes out a loan and applies it to a business. That business prospers, and with the proceeds he repays the loan and moreover has enough wealth remaining to support his wife and family. He then thinks to himself: "Before, I was an unfortunate man who had taken out a loan and applied it to a business. That business prospered, and so I repaid the loan and moreover I have enough wealth to support my wife and family." Because of that he becomes happy and joyful.

It is like this. An unfortunate man is sick, suffering, and gravely ill; when he eats food it harms his body, and when he drinks water his stomach becomes uncomfortable. Then at a later time he becomes well, free from illness, and strong; when he eats food it benefits his body, and when he drinks water his stomach is not troubled. He then thinks to himself: "Before, I was sick, suffering, and gravely ill; because of that, when I ate food it harmed my body, and when I drank water my stomach was uncomfortable. Now I am well and free from illness, endowed with strength; when I eat food it benefits my body, and when I drink water my stomach is not troubled." Because of that he becomes happy and joyful.

It is like this. An unfortunate man was a slave, under the command of others, at the bidding of others, in service to others — one who could not go where he himself wished. Then at another time he is no longer a slave, no longer under the command of others, no longer at the bidding of others, no longer in service to others — he can go where he himself wishes. He then thinks to himself: "Before, I was a slave, under the command of others, at the bidding of others, in service to others — one who could not go where I myself wished. Now I am no longer a slave, no longer under the command of others, no longer in service to others — I can go where I myself wish."

He became happy and glad on account of that. Just so — a miserable man who has been bound in chains with his hands tied behind his back, and who is then freed from that, becomes fortunate, happy, and untroubled. He thinks to himself: "Before, I was bound in chains with my hands tied behind my back. Now I am freed from that — I am fortunate, happy, and untroubled." He becomes glad on account of that. Just so — a miserable man who passes from danger to safety, and from a bad year to a good year, thinks to himself: "I have passed from danger to safety, and from a bad year to a good year." He becomes happy and glad on account of that.

In precisely the same way — just as with debt, just as with illness, just as with slavery, just as with bondage, just as with danger — he sees himself freed from these five obstacles (nīvaraṇas). He sees that these five, which afflict sentient beings, which diminish wisdom, which are on the side of harm, which obstruct passage beyond suffering — these five unfavorable obstacles — have been abandoned. Withdrawn from desire, withdrawn from negative and unwholesome phenomena, he dwells having directly accomplished the first meditative concentration (dhyāna), which is born of seclusion, accompanied by applied thought and sustained examination, with joy and bliss.

He thoroughly saturates, pervades, fills, and suffuses this very body with the joy and bliss born of seclusion. He drenches it, soaks it completely, satisfies it utterly, and permeates it throughout — so that there is not the slightest part of this entire body that is not reached and pervaded by the joy and bliss born of seclusion.

It is just as when a skilled bathman or a bathman's apprentice pours fine bathing powder into a bronze basin or bowl or bathing trough, works it through with water, kneading it again and again until it is moist — so that the ball of bathing paste becomes oily, permeated with oil, saturated with oil, gleaming — moistened evenly within and without, neither separating nor seeping. In precisely that same way, he saturates, pervades, fills, and suffuses this very body with the joy and bliss born of seclusion, thoroughly saturating and permeating it — so that there is not the slightest part of this entire body that is not pervaded by the joy and bliss born of seclusion.

Then, in order to still applied thought and sustained examination, with the mind inwardly settled and focused upon a single object of joy, he dwells having directly accomplished the second meditative concentration — which is born of meditative absorption (samādhi), free from applied thought and sustained examination, with joy and bliss.

He thoroughly saturates, pervades, fills, and suffuses this very body with the joy and bliss born of meditative absorption — so that there is not the slightest part of his entire body that is not pervaded by the joy and bliss born of meditative absorption.

It is just as a natural spring lake set upon a mountaintop, into which no water flows from the east, no water from the south, no water from the west, and no rain falls into it from the north at any time — yet from within the lake itself, a great upwelling of water rises from a great opening in the floor of the pool, so

that the entire pool is saturated, pervaded, filled, and suffused with cool water — so that there is not the slightest part of that pool that is not pervaded by cool water throughout. In precisely that same way, he saturates, pervades, fills, and suffuses this very body with the joy and bliss born of meditative absorption — so that there is not the slightest part of this entire body that is not pervaded by the joy and bliss born of meditative absorption.

Having abandoned joy, he dwells in equanimity, mindfulness, and full awareness, experiencing pleasure throughout the body — and, as the noble ones declare, he dwells at ease with equanimity accompanied by mindfulness. Thus he enters and abides in the third meditative concentration, having directly accomplished it.

This very body of his he saturates, pervades, fills, and suffuses with a bliss free of joy — so that there is not the slightest part of this entire body that is not pervaded by the bliss free of joy.

It is just as with a blue lotus, a red lotus, a white water lily, or a white lotus, each born from the water, grown in the water, with its roots sunk in the water and resting there — from root to tip there is not the slightest part that is not pervaded by cool water throughout. In precisely that same way, he saturates, pervades, fills, and suffuses this very body with the bliss free of joy — so that there is not the slightest part of this entire body that is not pervaded and suffused by the bliss free of joy.

Then, having relinquished pleasure and having relinquished suffering — and since mental ease and mental discomfort have already been set aside before — he enters and abides in the fourth meditative concentration, which is neither suffering nor pleasure, and in which equanimity and mindfulness are perfectly pure, having directly accomplished it.

He dwells suffusing this very body, having entered into and being devoted to a state of complete purity and utter luminosity, and he directly accomplishes this pervading presence. It is just as when a householder or the son of a householder, having been wrapped from head to foot — from head to hand to foot — in cloth that is fastened with eight or nine folds, so that from the crown of the head down to the soles of the feet there is not the slightest part of the entire body that is not covered and enveloped by that perfectly pure, utterly white cloth. In precisely that same way, he enters and abides directly accomplishing this pervading, devoting himself to this very body with a mind of complete purity and utter luminosity — so that there is not the slightest part

of this entire body that is not pervaded and suffused by a mind of complete joy and utter purity.

Dear one, it is just as the noble śrāvakas declare: having relinquished pleasure and having relinquished suffering, and since both mental ease and mental discomfort have already ceased before, he dwells having directly accomplished the fourth meditative concentration — which is neither suffering nor pleasure, in which equanimity and mindfulness are perfectly pure. His mind at that time becomes neither elevated nor depressed. Dwelling neither elevated nor depressed, it attains unshakeable stillness.

It is just as a flame of mustard-oil butter burning in an upper chamber or a great upper chamber — when that flame is not stirred or moved by wind, birds, people, or non-human beings — at that time it becomes neither elevated nor depressed, and, dwelling neither elevated nor depressed, it burns without wavering.

In precisely the same way, dear one, when the noble śrāvakas have relinquished pleasure and have relinquished suffering, and since both mental ease and mental discomfort have already ceased before, they dwell having directly accomplished the fourth meditative concentration — which is neither suffering nor pleasure, in which equanimity and mindfulness are perfectly pure. His mind at that time becomes neither elevated nor depressed. Dwelling neither elevated nor depressed, it attains unshakeable stillness, and this thought arises in him:

"This body of mine is form — it is great, being composed of the four great elements, and in it consciousness dwells, on it consciousness depends, and into it consciousness has entered. Now let me shift the mind from this body and accomplish a body of another kind — a form body, mind-made, complete, with its faculties unimpaired."

And so he does shift the mind from that body and directly accomplishes a mind-made form body, complete and with its faculties unimpaired.

It is just as a beryl gem — eight-sided, of fine quality, clear, and perfectly translucent —

threaded on a cord of four colours — blue, yellow, red, and white. A person with good eyes, seeing it, would know: "This is the cord; this is the gem; and the gem is threaded upon the cord." In just the same way, he shifts the mind from that body and directly accomplishes another body — a form body,

mind-made, complete, with its faculties unimpaired.

It is just as a person with good eyes, seeing a skillful man draw a single reed from a bundle of reeds, would know: "This is the bundle of reeds; this is the reed; and the reed has been drawn out from the bundle." In just the same way, he shifts the mind from that body and directly accomplishes another body — a form body, mind-made, complete, with its faculties unimpaired.

It is just as a person with good eyes, seeing a skillful man draw a snake out from a snake-basket, would know: "This is the basket; this is the snake; and the snake has been drawn out from the basket." In just the same way, he shifts the mind from that body and directly accomplishes another body — a form body, mind-made, complete, with its faculties unimpaired.

It is just as a person with good eyes, seeing a skillful man draw a sword from its scabbard, would know: "This is the scabbard; this is the sword; and the sword has been drawn from the scabbard." In just the same way, he shifts the mind from that body and directly accomplishes another body — a form body, mind-made, complete, with its faculties unimpaired.

With a mind thus undistracted, utterly pure, thoroughly cleansed, free from fault, free from the near afflictions, and having become straight and pliant, he attains imperturbability. Then, directing his mind toward the domain of miraculous power, the gnosis of that domain blazes forth, and his mind enters into the superknowledges.

He then directly experiences the various domains of miraculous power one by one: from one he becomes many; from many he becomes one; he passes from the manifest into the unmanifest; he directly experiences the luminosity of gnosis — passing through walls, through mountains, through enclosures, unobstructed, as though through open space; sinking into the earth and rising from it as though it were water; walking upon the surface of water without sinking as though upon solid ground; travelling through the sky cross-legged as though he were a winged bird; touching and stroking with his hand even the sun and moon, so mighty and so powerful; and exercising mastery of body as far as the Brahmā world.

It is just as a skilled goldsmith, or the able apprentice of a skilled goldsmith, who, knowing gold to be thoroughly refined, works it by whatever means and for whatever purpose he desires — fashioning from it a tablet, or an earring, or a necklace, or an armlet, or a bracelet, or a finger-ring, or a garland of silver and gold — swiftly and at length. In just the same way, with a mind in

meditative equipoise, utterly pure, thoroughly cleansed, free from fault, free from the near afflictions, having become straight and pliant, and having attained imperturbability, he directs his mind into the superknowledges in order to manifest gnosis in the domain of miraculous power. Thus, from one becoming many, and so forth as before, he exercises mastery of body as far as the Brahmā world.

It is just as a skilled potter, or the able apprentice of a skilled potter —

knowing how to work a lump of clay that has been thoroughly prepared, he swiftly and at length produces whatever particular vessel he desires, in whatever way he desires. Just so, in exactly the same way, with a mind in meditative equipoise, utterly pure, thoroughly cleansed, having become straight and pliant, and having attained imperturbability, he exercises mastery of body as far as the Brahmā world, just as before.

It is just as a skilled ivory-worker, or the able apprentice of a skilled ivory-worker — knowing how to work ivory that has been thoroughly prepared, he produces whatever particular form he desires, in whatever way he desires, swiftly and at length. Just so, in exactly the same way, with a mind in meditative equipoise, utterly pure, thoroughly cleansed, and so forth as before, he exercises mastery of body as far as the Brahmā world.

Then, with that same mind in meditative equipoise, utterly pure, thoroughly cleansed, free from fault, freed from the near afflictions, having become straight and pliant, and having attained imperturbability, he directs his mind into the superknowledges in order to manifest gnosis in the domain of the divine ear. With the divine ear, pure and surpassing that of ordinary human beings, he hears both kinds of sound — those of humans and those of non-humans, those far away and those near.

It is just as a man who blows a conch shell climbs to the summit of a high mountain, and at the hour of midnight blows the conch, so that the sound of that blowing resounds and spreads in all directions. Just so, in exactly the same way, with a mind in meditative equipoise, utterly pure, thoroughly cleansed, free from fault, freed from the near afflictions, having become straight and pliant, and having attained imperturbability, he directs his mind into those superknowledges in order to manifest gnosis in the domain of the divine ear. With the divine ear, pure and surpassing that of ordinary human beings, he hears both kinds of sound — those of humans and those of non-humans, those far away and those near.

Then, with that same mind in meditative equipoise, utterly pure, thoroughly cleansed, free from fault, freed from the near afflictions, having become straight and pliant, and having attained imperturbability, he directs his mind into the superknowledges in order to manifest gnosis in the domain of the enumeration of minds. He fully and correctly knows the minds of other sentient beings and other persons, having examined and investigated them as they truly are. A mind with attachment he fully knows as it truly is — namely, as a mind with attachment. A mind free from attachment he fully knows as it truly is — namely, as a mind free from attachment. A mind with aversion, a mind free from aversion, a mind with delusion, a mind free from delusion, a distracted mind and an undistracted mind, a contracted mind and a grasping mind, an exalted mind and an unexalted mind, a pacified mind and an unpacified mind, a mind in meditative equipoise and a mind not in meditative equipoise, an uncultivated mind and a cultivated mind, an unliberated mind — he fully knows as it truly is, namely, as an unliberated mind. A thoroughly and completely liberated mind he fully knows as it truly is — namely, as a thoroughly and completely liberated mind.

It is just as a sighted person who takes hold of a perfectly clear mirror and observes the features of his own face. Just so, in exactly the same way, with a mind in meditative equipoise, utterly pure,

thoroughly purified, flawless, freed from the proximate afflictions, straightened and abiding in a serviceable state, having attained imperturbability — in order to directly know the synonyms of mind through direct knowledge, one directs the mind toward those direct knowledges — proceeding just as before, up to fully knowing a thoroughly and completely liberated mind as it truly is, namely, as a thoroughly and completely liberated mind. This is called "the foot."

Now, what is knowledge? With a mind in meditative equipoise that is fully pure in just this way, thoroughly purified, flawless, freed even from the proximate afflictions, straightened and abiding in a serviceable state, having attained imperturbability — in order to directly manifest the gnosis of recollecting previous abodes, one directs the mind toward those direct knowledges. One then recollects manifold previous abodes in many forms, thus: one birth, two, three, four, five, six, seven, eight, nine, ten; twenty, thirty, forty, fifty; a hundred births, a thousand births, many hundreds of thousands of births; a kalpa of destruction, a kalpa of arising, a kalpa of destruction and arising; many kalpas of destruction, many kalpas of arising, many kalpas of

destruction and arising — all these one recollects. Those sentient beings who were born there — they were called such-and-such; I too had such-and-such a name, such-and-such a clan, such-and-such a lineage; my food was of such-and-such a kind; I experienced such-and-such pleasures and sufferings; my lifespan was of such-and-such a length; I dwelt for so long; and when the limit of that life was reached, I died and passed away, then was born in a certain place. From there too I died and passed away and was born in a certain place; from there too I died and passed away and was born right here. In this way, with specific details of appearance and location, one recollects manifold previous abodes in many forms.

It is just as a certain person who goes from one village to another village, then from that village on to another still, and thinks to himself: I went from such-and-such a village to such-and-such a village, and from there again to another place, and from there I arrived at this very village. In just the same way, with a mind in meditative equipoise that is fully pure, thoroughly purified, flawless, freed from the proximate afflictions, straightened and abiding in a serviceable state, having attained imperturbability — in order to directly manifest the gnosis of recollecting previous abodes, one directs the mind toward those direct knowledges. One recollects manifold previous abodes — beginning with "one," and so forth just as before, with specific details of appearance and location — all the way through to the recollection of manifold previous abodes.

Then, in just that same way, with a mind in meditative equipoise that is fully pure, thoroughly purified, flawless, freed from the proximate afflictions, straightened and abiding in a serviceable state, having attained imperturbability — in order to directly manifest the knowledge of death and birth, one directs the mind toward those direct knowledges. With the divine eye, purified and surpassing that of ordinary human beings, one sees sentient beings dying and being born, with beautiful forms and with ugly forms, with inferior and with excellent forms, going to fortunate realms and going to unfortunate realms. One fully knows them just as they fare according to their karma: Alas, these sentient beings — endowed with misconduct in body, endowed with misconduct in speech and mind, reviling and bearing wrong views toward the noble ones, engaging in the deeds of wrong view, and intent on the Dharma in such a wrong spirit — by reason of that cause and that condition, upon the dissolution of the body, after death, fall into unfortunate realms, into a bad destination, and are born among hell-beings.

Alas, yet these sentient beings are endowed with virtuous conduct in body, endowed with virtuous conduct in speech and mind; they do not revile the noble ones, they hold right views, and they are intent upon the Dharma with right views and right-view deeds. By reason of that cause and that condition, upon the dissolution of the body, after death, they go to fortunate realms and are born as gods in the heavens.

It is like this: a man with good eyesight, standing at the great crossroads where four main roads meet, sees the many people coming and going, standing and sitting and lying down, dwelling in all their various forms. And so, just as it is here — with his purified divine eye, surpassing that of ordinary humans — up to the point of "they are born as gods," as stated before. With a mind in meditative equipoise that is utterly pure, thoroughly cleansed, without blemish, free from proximate afflictions, become straight and workable, he attains imperturbability; and in order to see the wisdom born of the exhaustion of defilements, he applies his mind to the higher knowledges. He then fully knows as it really is: "This is suffering, a noble truth. This is the origin of suffering. This is the cessation of suffering. This is the noble truth of the path that leads to the cessation of suffering." Knowing it thus as it really is, and seeing it thus as it really is, his mind is fully liberated from the defilement of desire, fully liberated from the defilement of existence, and fully liberated from the defilement of ignorance. Being fully liberated, there arises the wisdom of knowing: "I am fully liberated." He knows: "Birth is exhausted. The holy life has been lived. What had to be done has been done. There is no more of this existence."

As an example: not far from a village or a town there is a pool of water, deep, unmuddied, clear, and pellucid. A man with good eyesight, sitting on the bank, sees shrimp or crabs or fish or turtles or a crocodile. So too, with a mind in meditative equipoise that is utterly pure, thoroughly cleansed, without blemish, free from proximate afflictions, become straight and workable, he attains imperturbability — and so on as before, up to "there is no more of this existence."

This is called knowledge. Together with the former knowledge, the two combined are called knowledge and conduct. Young man, in order to actualize this unsurpassable knowledge and conduct which has not yet been actualized, one should understand it by way of four methods. What are the four?

Here, young man, some ascetic or brahmin, failing to actualize this very unsurpassable knowledge and conduct, goes from the village to the wilderness, makes a shelter of branches and leaves, and dwells there, saying: "We shall live here on roots and fruits." And they do indeed live on roots and fruits. That young brahmin who, in order to actualize this unsurpassable knowledge and conduct which has not yet been actualized, follows this first method — young brahmin, what do you think? Have you, together with your teachers, ever lived according to that first method of unsurpassable knowledge and conduct which I have taught? "O Gautama, I have not."

Furthermore, young man, some ascetic or brahmin, failing to actualize this very unsurpassable knowledge and conduct, abandons that food of roots and fruits, goes off to one side, makes a shelter of leaves and branches, and dwells there.

"We shall live here on a diet of leaves," they declare, and so they sustain themselves there on leaves alone as their food. Young brahmin, know that this, the second method, is the means for actualizing this unsurpassable knowledge and conduct which has not yet been actualized.

Furthermore, young brahmin, some ascetic or brahmin, failing to actualize this very unsurpassable knowledge and conduct, abandons both that food of roots and fruits and that food of leaves, goes off to one side, makes a shelter of branches and leaves, and dwells there. "Here we shall memorize the mantras and compose the incantations," they declare, and so they diligently memorize the mantras and compose the incantations of old. Young brahmin, know that this, the third method, is the means for actualizing this unsurpassable knowledge and conduct which has not yet been actualized.

Furthermore, young brahmin, some ascetic or brahmin, failing to actualize this very unsurpassable knowledge and conduct, abandons that food of roots and fruits, that food of leaves, and the memorizing of mantras and composing of incantations, and, still without having actualized it, enters a village, builds a four-doored house, and dwells there. They then announce: "Here we shall give gifts, make merit, and offer alms to whatever ascetics and brahmins pass by, to the best of our ability and according to our means." And so they give gifts, make merit, and offer alms to whatever ascetics and brahmins pass by, according to their ability and whatever resources they have. Young brahmin, know that this, the fourth method, is the means for actualizing this unsurpassable knowledge and conduct which has not yet been actualized.

Young brahmin, what do you think? I have taught four methods for actualizing this unsurpassable knowledge and conduct. Have you, together with your teachers, ever lived according to any of those methods?

"O Gautama, I have not."

Young brahmin, since you have not completed any of those methods, why then do you speak these words to the Śākyas: 'Alas for the Śākyas, they are new! Alas, the Śākyas are upstarts!'

Young brahmin, what do you think? Those brahmins of former times, the brahmin seers — Aṣṭaka, Vāmadeva, Viśvāmitra, Jamadagni, Aṅgiras, Bharadvāja, Vasiṣṭha, Kaśyapa, Bhṛgu — they composed the mantras and brought forth the incantations. The brahmins of today, just as those of old, chant, praise, intone, compose, and recite those very mantra words and hymns. Is it the case that you, together with your teachers, live as one who is now surrounded by a moat, with iron stakes planted around, dwelling in a city under blockade? Is it like that for them too?

"O Gautama, it is not so."

Is it the case that you, together with your teachers, are the kind who gird on armor, survey the finest battle standards and supreme shows of strength, and witness many battles arrayed? Is it like that for them too?

"O Gautama, it is not so."

Is it the case that you, together with your teachers, mount a chariot drawn entirely by grey mares, take up golden whip and rein, and ride out through the countryside surrounded by many brahmin youths, with many brahmin youths going before you? Is it like that for them too?

"O Gautama, it is not so."

Is it the case that you, together with your teachers, are anointed, bathed, and attended in this manner — by women with their hair bound up on their heads, wandering about, with bracelets on their wrists, their breasts swelling like those of a young male buffalo —

— and the pleasures and so forth practised in that way: is it the same for them too?

"O Gautama, it is not so."

Is it the case that you, together with your teachers, wearing golden armlets, adorned with golden necklaces, stretch out your legs and lie abed with women

so bedecked until the sun has risen? Is it the same for them too?

"O Gautama, it is not so."

O brahmin youth, now listen to the faults of your own teacher. O brahmin youth, the brahmin's son called Padmaśīrṣa — his going before the king of the Kosala country was no different from going behind a wall or behind a curtain. Why? Is it fitting that a man who is known to be of such a kind would not show his face openly to the very person by whose cooking he eats? O brahmin youth, now listen also to your own faults. Once upon a time, O brahmin youth, Prasenajit, king of the Kosala country, was seated on his own throne and was issuing instructions to another man, saying: "O man, the matter is such and such; do this and this, conduct yourself thus and thus." Having given those instructions, the king rose from his throne and departed. Then that man, in secret, sat down on the king's throne and proceeded to issue instructions to yet another man, saying: "O man, do this and this, conduct yourself thus and thus." O brahmin youth, what do you think? If a man were to sit secretly on the king's throne in that way, and were to speak the words the king had spoken and repeat what the king had said — would he thereby be the king? Would he become a king?

"O Gautama, it is not so."

In just the same way, O brahmin youth: if you were to teach what has been taught by a sage, and to say what a sage has said — would you thereby be a sage? Would you become a sage?

"O Gautama, it is not so."

O brahmin youth, nevertheless, take the purpose for which you have come very well to heart, for it will bring you long-lasting benefit, meaning, and happiness.

Thereupon the brahmin youth Ambāṣṭha began to examine the thirty-two marks of a great man on the body of the Blessed One. Of the thirty-two he could see thirty; but as to two of them he was of two minds and had doubts — namely, the concealed male organ, which is withdrawn below, and the tongue, thin yet great. And so he spoke in verse:

I have heard there are thirty-two marks of a man,
marks of a great man said to be upon you, O Great Sage.
Of the thirty-two marks, O Gautama, I have heard you possess them all upon
your person —

yet as to two of them I cannot find them there.
O foremost of men, your concealed male organ —
is it truly withdrawn below?
And the words of your voice, like a woman's —
can it be that your tongue is not short?
Pray extend it swiftly, that slender tongue,
and dispel my doubt.
To behold the buddhas of widespread renown
is exceedingly rare to find.

Then the Blessed One thought: "The brahmin youth Ambāṣṭha, having examined the thirty-two marks of a great man on my body, has seen thirty of the thirty-two, but has two minds and doubts about two — the concealed male organ that is withdrawn, and the tongue that is great yet slender. How shall I show him a sign by which he, Ambāṣṭha, may see that my concealed male organ is withdrawn and that my tongue is large yet slender?" And so the Blessed One displayed those signs so that the brahmin youth Ambāṣṭha could see that the Blessed One's concealed male organ was withdrawn into a sheath. Then, extending his tongue from his mouth as far as the hairline of his face, stretching it to cover that space, he showed it. Upon seeing this, Ambāṣṭha thought to himself: "The ascetic Gautama is indeed endowed with the thirty-two marks of a great man. And one endowed with the marks of a great man has two paths before him — no other."

If he were to remain a householder and dwell at home, he would become a wheel-turning king — and so on, as before, down to becoming famous throughout the world with a name that has spread everywhere.

Then the brahmin youth Ambāṣṭha, rejoicing and delighting in what the Blessed One had declared, departed from the presence of the Blessed One.

The Minor Matters of Discipline. The forty-eighth section.

Now at that time, the brahmin Pokkharasādi was assembled and seated together with the eldest and most senior brahmins in the high place of a distinguished brahmin household. The brahmin youth Ambāṣṭha was also seated there among them. The brahmin youth Ambāṣṭha caught sight of Pokkharasādi from a distance. Seeing him, he went to where Pokkharasādi was, and upon arriving he prostrated with his head at Pokkharasādi's feet, bowed to the other senior brahmins as well, and sat down to one side.

Once he was seated to one side, Pokkharasādi addressed the brahmin youth Ambāṣṭha with these words: "Brahmin youth, is what is heard of the virtuous qualities, the fame, the renown, and the verses of the wise Gautama — spread far and wide in all directions and quarters — truly as it is said? Are the reports about his marks accurate?"

"It is so, learned teacher. The virtuous qualities, the fame, the renown, and the verses of the wise Gautama, spread far and wide in all directions and quarters, are indeed exactly as reported, and the accounts of his marks are indeed accurate."

"Brahmin youth, did you have an exchange of words with the wise Gautama?"

"I did, learned teacher."

"Brahmin youth, tell us fully everything that was said in the conversation you had with the wise Gautama."

Then the brahmin youth Ambāṣṭha related to Pokkharasādi in full everything that had been said in the conversation with the Blessed One.

When this was said, Pokkharasādi became furious, agitated, and enraged, his mind thrown into turmoil. He struck the brahmin youth Ambāṣṭha on the head with a sandaled foot, saying: "Ah, what a messenger! Ah, what an envoy! Such conduct, such a messenger, such a bearer of messages — even this alone could cause me to fall into a lower state of existence! Brahmin youth, in whatever way you intended to disparage and refute the wise Gautama, the wise Gautama has understood you to be reckoned among his own kind in each and every such instance. Wise sirs, even now I myself wish to go to see and pay homage to the wise Gautama, yet today it has simply not been possible for me to do so. Nevertheless, tomorrow I will go to see and pay homage to the wise Gautama."

Then, starting from that very evening, Pokkharasādi had pure and fine foods and delicacies prepared. Rising early the next morning, he had a carriage loaded with pure and fine foods and delicacies and departed in the direction of where the Blessed One was. Arriving there, he exchanged various words of cordial greeting and mutual rejoicing with the Blessed One, then sat down to one side.

Seated to one side, Pokkharasādi addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Wise Gautama, I have had a carriage loaded with pure and fine foods and delicacies, and I offer it."

The Blessed One, wise Gautama, accepted this offering out of compassion. At that time the venerable Ānanda was standing to one side of the Blessed One holding a fan, fanning the Blessed One as he sat. Then the Blessed One addressed the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, go and gather together all the monks who are dwelling in the vicinity of Kosambī into the dining hall." "Reverend sir, I will do as you command," said the venerable Ānanda, and having heeded the Blessed One's word, he gathered all the monks dwelling in the vicinity of Kosambī into the dining hall, then went to where the Blessed One was. Arriving there, he bowed his head to the Blessed One's two feet, then sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the venerable Ānanda addressed the Blessed One thus: "Reverend sir, all the monks dwelling in the vicinity of Kosambī have been assembled and are present in the dining hall. Blessed One, may it now please you to consider that the time has come." Then the Blessed One went and arrived at the dining hall and took the seat that had been arranged in the midst of the Saṅgha of monks, and sat down. Then the brahmin Pokkharasādi, perceiving that the Buddha and the Saṅgha of monks were comfortably seated, served and satisfied them with his own hands with pure and fine foods and delicacies, and in many ways he served and satisfied them with pure and fine foods and delicacies with his own hands. When the Blessed One had finished eating and had set aside his bowl, Pokkharasādi took a low seat and sat down before the Blessed One to listen to the Dharma. Then the Blessed One rejoiced in the brahmin Pokkharasādi's gift of generosity with this verse of rejoicing:

The best among fire-offerings and oblations,
the best of metres is the sun-deity,
the best among people is a king,
the best of oceans is among rivers,
the moon is chief among stars,
the sun is chief among those that give light,
and in all the worlds with their gods,
among whatever beings travel
above, below, and across,
the best of speakers is the fully awakened buddha.

At that moment, while the brahmin Pokkharasādi was making the dedication of merit, he saw an old man drinking sesame oil. Seeing this, he addressed the Blessed One thus: "Reverend sir, do all hearers act to please the wise Gautama?" "Brahmin, that is not certain. Some do please him, some do not

please him." "Gautama, some seek the Dharma, it seems, while others seek to drink sesame oil." "Gautama, is my student, the young brahmin Māsuka, here?" "Brahmin, he has come." "Wise Gautama, did you have an exchange of pleasantries with him?" "Brahmin, we did." "Gautama, please tell me in full everything that passed in that exchange between you and him." Then the Blessed One told the brahmin Pokkharasādi everything that had passed in the exchange between himself and the young brahmin Māsuka. Then the brahmin Pokkharasādi addressed the Blessed One thus: "Gautama, the young brahmin Māsuka has a nature that is unruly by temperament. Gautama, please be patient with the young brahmin Māsuka." "Brahmin, I am patient."

"Wise Gautama, whenever you see me entering a carriage, or taking up a whip, or raising a goad, or calling out loudly, at such a time please regard it as the brahmin Pokkharasādi bowing his head at your two feet, and please understand it as his asking after you: 'Are your ailments few? Is your discomfort slight? Do you live well, are you active, do you dwell in strength and ease?' O Wise Gautama, whenever you see me coming from the middle of the market square, or removing my sandals, or drawing back my robe, or stretching out my hand — at such a time, please consider it as my paying homage to the Wise Gautama" — and from that point the passage continues as before, up to "do you dwell in strength and ease?" O Wise Gautama, whenever you see me in the midst of a retinue, or seated on a couch or throne, or wearing a turban — at such a time, please consider it as my paying homage to the Wise Gautama" — and from that point the passage continues as before, up to "do you dwell in strength and ease?" And why is this? O Wise Gautama, brahmins live by their reputation, and it is from reputation alone that they seek their livelihood.

Then the Blessed One reflected thus: "How remarkable — this brahmin Pokkharasādi is extremely proud. Let me teach him the Dharma in order to abandon that pride." And so the Blessed One taught the brahmin Pokkharasādi thoroughly and rightly with a Dharma-endowed discourse, exalted him rightly, engaged him rightly, and gladdened him rightly.

The preliminary Dharma-endowed discourse given by the blessed buddhas is this: the talk on generosity, the talk on moral discipline, the talk on the higher realms, the drawbacks, the defilement, and the corruption of sensual pleasures, and the benefit of renunciation, of seclusion, and of the qualities on the side of purification — all of these he expounded fully and thoroughly.

When the Blessed One saw that the brahmin had become joyful at heart, with a wholesome mind, a pleased mind, a mind free from obscuration, that he was endowed with good fortune and power and was capable of understanding the supreme teaching of Dharma — at that very moment the Blessed One taught the supreme teaching of Dharma: suffering, its origin, its cessation, and the path — the Four Noble Truths — expounding them broadly and thoroughly. Just as a clean cloth free of stains is fit to receive dye, and when placed in dye takes the colour well — so too did the brahmin Pokkharasādi, seated right there on that seat, directly realise the Four Noble Truths: suffering, its origin, its cessation, and the path.

Then the brahmin Pokkharasādi, having seen the Dharma, attained the Dharma, understood the Dharma, known the categories of the Dharma, reached the depth of the Dharma, crossed beyond doubt, crossed beyond uncertainty, placed his reliance on no other, was carried along by no other, and having attained fearlessness with respect to the teachings in the Teacher's doctrine — he rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, turned toward where the Blessed One was, joined his palms in reverence with a bow, and spoke these words to the Blessed One: "Venerable one, I am one who has risen. I am one who has fully risen. I go to the Blessed One for refuge, to the Dharma, and to the Saṅgha for refuge. May the Blessed One please accept me as a layman. From this day forward, for as long as I live, I am committed even at the cost of my life, and I go to refuge with complete faith."

Then the brahmin Padmasnying (Lotus-Heart) rejoiced and was gladdened at what the Blessed One had said. He bowed his head to the feet of the Blessed One, rose from his seat, and departed.

The Blessed One reflected: the fault of which the brahmin Padmasnying is accused is that the monks were eating food while dedicating merit. Therefore, knowing that monks should not eat food while dedicating merit, he declared to the monks: "Monks, take the case of the brahmin Padmasnying as the basis for this rule. Monks are not to eat food while dedicating merit. If monks eat food while dedicating merit, it becomes a serious offense."

When the Blessed One had declared that monks are not to eat food while dedicating merit, a certain young monk found himself eating past the proper hour. At that time the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, if a monk was already eating beforehand and

he neither understands the meaning nor hears the sound of the declaration, he may eat, and there is no offense for him. If he hears the sound but does not understand the meaning, he may also eat, and there is no offense for him either. But one who both hears the sound and understands the meaning should not eat; if he does, it becomes a serious offense."

When the Blessed One had declared that those who both hear the sound and understand the meaning commit a serious offense if they continue to eat, a great many monks assembled in another monastery. There the monks were seated in two rows, the younger monks together and the elder monks together. At that point the younger monks were eating, and they both heard the sound and understood the meaning. They felt remorse, stopped eating, and sat fasting. The monks then reported the matter to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Wait until two or three verses have been recited, then eat — and there is no need for remorse."

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was dwelling at Vārāṇasī in the Deer Park of the Sages' Retreat.

Then, at the time of morning, the Blessed One put on his lower robe and outer Dharma robe, took up his alms bowl, and went into Vārāṇasī for alms. A certain other monk likewise put on his lower robe and outer Dharma robe at the time of morning, took up his alms bowl, and went into Vārāṇasī for alms.

This other monk sat down at the foot of a thicket tree, turning things over in unwholesome conceptual thought, his mind fixed upon and dwelling in sinfulness. The Blessed One saw that monk sitting at the foot of the thicket tree, his mind turning over in unwholesome conceptual thought, fixed upon and dwelling in sinfulness. Having seen this, the Blessed One addressed that monk with these words:

"Monk! Monk! Do not make yourself like a hot seed — rank and festering. Monk, know that if you make yourself here like a hot seed, rank and festering, you will become a place where bees will neither alight nor lick."

Then that monk thought to himself: the Blessed One knows the thoughts and reflections of my mind. Filled with fear and terror, his hair standing on end, he rose from the foot of the thicket tree and departed.

The Blessed One reflected:

"The fault arose from dwelling in a place that is not a monk's proper domain. Therefore, knowing that one should not dwell in a place that is not a monk's

proper domain, I went on alms-round in Vārāṇasī, completed the matter of food, set aside the remainder of the alms-food, put down my bowl and robes, washed both feet, and entered the assembly hall to settle into inner composure. Then the Blessed One rose from his inner composure and took the seat that had been arranged for him before the community of monks. Having taken his seat, the Blessed One addressed the monks with these words:

"Monks, today, in the morning hour, I robed myself, took my bowl, and went to Vārāṇasī for alms. Another monk also, in the morning hour, robed himself and took his bowl, and set out for Vārāṇasī for alms. That monk sat down at the foot of another thicket tree, engaged in unwholesome conceptual thought, fixed upon and dwelling in sinfulness. I saw that monk sitting at the foot of that other thicket tree, engaged in unwholesome conceptual thought, fixed upon and dwelling in sinfulness. Having seen him, I addressed that monk with these words: 'Monk! Monk! Do not make yourself like a hot seed — rank and festering. Monk, know that if you make yourself here like a hot seed, rank and festering, you will become a place where bees will neither alight nor lick.' Then that monk thought to himself: the Blessed One knows the thoughts and reflections of my mind. Filled with fear and terror, his hair standing on end, he departed hastily from the foot of that very thicket tree.

"Therefore, monks, this is the fault: it is dwelling in a place that is not a monk's proper domain. Therefore, monks, do not dwell in a place that is not your proper domain. If you dwell in a place that is not your proper domain, trouble will come of it."

Then another monk rose from his seat, drew his outer robe over one shoulder, joined his palms toward the Blessed One, bowed in that direction, and addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Venerable One, in the noble Dharma and Vinaya, what is called a hot seed? What is called rank? What is called festering? And what are called the bees of that festering?"

"Monks, what is called a hot seed is a term of elevation for conceptual thought directed toward sinful, unwholesome things — namely, conceptual thought directed toward sensual desire, conceptual thought directed toward malice, and conceptual thought directed toward harm.

"What is called rank is a term of elevation for the five qualities of sensual pleasure — form, sound, smell, taste, and touch. Yet, monks, it is not these qualities of sensual pleasure themselves that are meant; rather, it is the longing and attachment for them that is called desire.

"What is called festering is what some people do, dwelling in a state of seeping contact with the six sense bases — the sense base of eye-contact, the sense base of ear-contact, the sense base of nose-contact, the sense base of tongue-contact, and the sense base of body-contact.

"What are called the bees of the festering are what some people do, dwelling without restraint over the six sense bases — the mind seeping after the sinful, unwholesome phenomena of the world through attachment and discontent."

Having spoken these words, the Blessed One then —

The Teacher, the Sugata, then spoke these further words:

One who stirs up the desire of craving,
who guards neither eye nor ear,
who is intoxicated by conceptual thought —
that monk scorches his own seed.

He dwells attached to the foul,
abiding with defilement and the festering.
Whether in a village or in a wilderness,
by night or in the light of day,
he remains far from every happiness,
and wretchedness draws ever near.

But one who strives in inner calm abiding
and cultivates direct knowledge by himself —
such a one has done away with those bees
and dwells in ease within this world.

To rely on a person of virtue
is what the noble ones have called fair speech.
If one truly knows those words,
one will not go forth into rebirth again.

When the Blessed One had said that monks must not dwell in domains that are not their proper sphere, the monks, not knowing how many kinds of improper domain there were, asked the Blessed One about this. The Blessed One declared: "There are five kinds of improper domain — the places of music and entertainment, the places of prostitutes, the places of those who sell liquor, the gateway to the royal palace with its surrounding court, and the places of inferior castes."

Summary verse: Do not sleep where a black snake lies in the bed; do not bow with a single robe. One should bow to four who are senior, and likewise bow to the assembly.

The Blessed One, the buddha Śākyamuni, was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. Now, a certain monk who was living at Śrāvastī asked a monk companion to watch over his sleeping mat, and then went off wandering about the district. That monk left the sleeping mat just as it had been spread out, and no one slept on it or looked after it. As the mat lay there empty, a venomous snake came down at dusk and moved about at will, gliding back and forth, until it reached the mat and coiled itself up beneath it.

Before long, another monk came suddenly to the dwelling of the first monk. The second monk rested from his fatigue, and after he had recovered from the weariness of the road, he was brought to pay homage at the stūpa and to bow before those of pure conduct comparable to Brahma. When he had bowed before the stūpas the sun set. The first monk then said to him: "Venerable one, here is water, earth, and mustard oil — and here is the sleeping mat, spread out just as it is. You are weary from the road, so wash your feet and lie down."

Driven by the power of his former karma, the newcomer lay down without examining the mat and, overcome by sleep, fell into slumber. As he lay there sleeping, he pressed down upon the venomous snake, and the snake, finding no way to move back and forth, was tormented by the pain of being crushed and seized hold of the monk's body. The agony of its bite arose; the monk twisted and turned, and he died — and both of them had passed beyond their time.

When night gave way to dawn, the first monk came to the other's dwelling and knocked gently on the door, again and again. Since the other had passed beyond his time, how could he possibly answer? The first monk thought to himself: "He is tired from the journey and is surely lying in and feels cold." After a while the sun rose, and the monk went again to the dwelling and knocked hard on the door, calling out: "Venerable one, rise up — the morning sun is here!" But as the room was empty of any answer, how could there be a reply? The other monks said: "Why are you knocking on the door?" and he explained to them in full what had happened. The monks then took a crooked key and opened the door, and there they found the other monk had passed beyond his time. Looking around they saw that a venomous snake had pressed itself down beneath the bedding and had also perished. Some of them then

said: "This venerable one was devoured by this venomous snake — that is how he passed beyond his time."

At that point, some said: "This venerable one passed beyond his time because he transformed his body." The monks then reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One reflected and perceived that the fault lay in this: the monk, having been entrusted with the bedding, had not handed it over to the attendant of the bedding and had not examined it at regular intervals, and on that account the mishap had occurred. Knowing this, the Blessed One declared: therefore, a monk who has been entrusted with the bedding should hand it over to the bedding attendant, shake it out, and lay it on the rod of a robe.

The Blessed One spoke: "Monks, that monk acted with heedlessness and so incurred a fault. Therefore, monks, whatever monk has been entrusted with bedding should, as best he can, shake it out when it is damp and hand it over to the bedding attendant; or else shake it out and place it on the rod of a robe. And whoever is about to sleep should first inspect the bedding and then lie down."

The Blessed One declared: "Whoever wishes to sleep on a bed should inspect the bed and then lie down."

The monks then began inspecting beds by lamplight. The Blessed One declared: "One should not inspect a bed by lamplight; rather, one should inspect a bed during the daytime."

The monks then shook out all the bedding. The Blessed One declared: "Those that have been stored for a long time should be shaken out from the base and inspected. Other bedding that has been laid out need only be shaken lightly before one lies down."

The occasion is at Śrāvastī.

Two monks were staying together in one dwelling. Of the two, one had ordained a certain young man as a novice. Now this novice was a very heavy sleeper and rose only after a long while, and his preceptor would constantly scold him for it. Then one time, after sleeping very long, he awoke, startled, and got up, put on his sweat-cloth as a lower robe, and went in that state to his preceptor's side. The preceptor too had risen from his bed and was sitting there, wearing his lower robe. The novice prostrated with his head at the preceptor's feet. Since his hair and beard had only recently been shaved, as

he rose up the preceptor's lower robe caught on his head and fell off, leaving him uncovered. The sweat-cloth of the novice also fell away. Both were thus left uncovered, sitting in an indecorous manner, when another monk who was dwelling in the same room caught sight of them. He called out: "Well now, good sirs! Only now do I know you for what you are — that you bear the marks of a man born as such!" Both were mortified and fell silent, overwhelmed with shame. He then reproached that monk, and the other monks said to him: "Venerable one, if he scolds you constantly like that, what did you do?" The monk replied: "Venerable ones, in the past we could still be reconciled, but now we can no longer be, so I will go and confront him alone." The others asked: "What happened?" and he explained to them in full what had occurred. They said: "Venerable one, his scolding you for that fault was justified." The monk then said nothing more.

At that juncture the monks reported the matter to the Blessed One. The Blessed One reflected and declared: "That monk's reproach was justified."

"Monks, therefore the fault lies here: one who wears but a single robe making prostrations, and one wearing a single robe making prostrations, taking that as one's own affair. Therefore, monks, one wearing a single robe should not make prostrations, and one wearing a single robe making prostrations should not be taken as one's own concern."

Knowing this, the Blessed One declared: "That monk's reproach was justified. Monks, therefore, let the one wearing a single robe not make prostrations, and let not one wearing a single robe make prostrations to another wearing a single robe, and making prostrations while wearing a single robe should not be taken as one's own affair."

Monks, if one wearing a single robe makes prostrations, or makes prostrations to one wearing a single robe, or takes the prostrations of one wearing a single robe as one's own concern, that becomes a serious offense. The setting for this rule is Rājagṛha.

The Blessed One had declared to the monks that a monk should not rest without knowing the discipline. Monks dwelling in various localities came from their villages, towns, outlying districts, and the surrounding royal palaces to pay their respects at a stūpa. No one offered them rest, and having been turned away, they stayed in the cloisters, gatehouse, on the stairs, in the gatehouse corridors, and at the foot of trees. Certain brahmins and householders of little faith, seeing this, said to them: "Noble ones, have you

been expelled from the monastery? Why are you staying like this?" The monks replied: "Good sirs, we have not been expelled from the monastery; we have simply arrived as visitors." Those people said: "Noble ones, did your fellow practitioners of the holy life not give you a room?" The monks replied: "Good sirs, since our discipline is not known, who would open a room for us? In any case, we will stay here however we can, pay our respects at the stūpa, and then return to our own dwelling places."

When those brahmins and householders heard that the discipline of the monks, the sons of the Śākya, was equal and uniform, they said: "How is it that this uniform discipline still results in monks who have arrived as visitors not being given a room?" And they reproached, criticized, and derided them. The monks then reported this to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "I shall establish a rule of conduct for monks who arrive as visitors. A monk who arrives as a visitor should make prostrations to the four elders and sit before them. Those elders, for their part, should show him respect, allow him to rest, and, through the keeper of rooms and beds, provide him with a bed."

The Blessed One had declared that a monk who arrives as a visitor should make prostrations to the four elders and sit before them. Now it happened that another monk, while traveling on a journey through the countryside, arrived at Rājagṛha and asked the monks: "Where is the venerable elder Kuṇḍinya (Skt. Kauṇḍinya), he who knows all?" They replied: "He is in the Timber Grove." He went to the Timber Grove and knocked gently, gently on the door of his dwelling. The venerable Kauṇḍinya, who knows all, said: "Who is knocking at the door?" The monk replied: "Venerable elder, I am a visitor who has just arrived; my name is such and such." Kauṇḍinya said: "Venerable one, come inside and rest." The monk replied: "If I am to make prostrations to the venerable elder, the great Kāśyapa, please tell me where he is staying." Kauṇḍinya said: "The venerable one is staying in the cave of the Pippala tree; go there." He went to the cave of the Pippala tree and knocked gently, gently on the door. The venerable great Kāśyapa said: "Who is knocking at the door?" The monk replied: "Noble one, I am a visitor who has just arrived; my name is such and such." Kāśyapa said: "Venerable one, come inside and rest." The monk replied: "If I am also to make prostrations to the venerable elder, the great Maudgalyāyana, please tell me where he is staying." Kāśyapa replied: "The venerable one is staying on Vulture Peak Mountain; go there." He went to Vulture Peak Mountain and knocked gently, gently on the door of his dwelling. The venerable great Maudgalyāyana said: "Who is knocking at the door?" The

monk replied: "Venerable elder, I am a visitor who has just arrived; my name is such and such." Maudgalyāyana also said: "Venerable one, come inside and rest."

The monk said: "Elder, I wish to make prostrations to the venerable Kāśyapa of the Ten Powers — please tell me where he is staying." The other replied: "The venerable one is staying in the Pippala Cave; go there." The monk went to the Pippala Cave and knocked gently, gently on the door. The venerable Kāśyapa of the Ten Powers said: "Who is knocking at the door?" The monk replied: "I am a visitor who has just arrived; my name is such and such." Kāśyapa also said: "Venerable one, come inside and rest." At that the monk said: "Elder, it is already late in the night and we must soon go on alms round — how can I rest? The Blessed One has declared that, since we visitors have arrived wearied by the journey, one should go to pay respects to the four elders who have come from afar, in order to perform the act of reviving those exhausted by the penalty." When the monks reported this to the Blessed One, the Blessed One declared: "Monks, I said that one should make prostrations to elders seated on the ground everywhere without exception — yet one should, all the same, make prostrations to the elder who is residing in that same temple."

The summary verse:

At the Teacher's request, the eloquent one
presented it, and then practised according to the preceptor.
At Mṛgadāva there were five hundred,
and at the end seven hundred.

The Blessed One, the buddha, was dwelling in the prince's Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. Then the venerable Vāgīśa rose from the composure of resting in inward absorption at dusk, went to where the Blessed One was, arrived there, bowed his head to the Blessed One's two feet in prostration, and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the venerable Vāgīśa addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Reverend one, how should co-residents and attendants serve their preceptor and teacher?" The Blessed One replied: "Vāgīśa, I shall properly establish the Dharma that co-resident monks and attendants should practise throughout. Co-resident monks and attendants should rise early in the morning and enquire of the preceptor and teacher: 'Are you in good health?' If the preceptor says he is not well, one should enquire about the illness and speak to a physician thus: 'My preceptor is afflicted with such and such an ailment — please prescribe medicine.' Then one should act as instructed. If it goes well, good. If medicine

is not obtained in that way, one should send to his relatives. If there are many relatives, one should ask: 'From which of the preceptor's relatives should I obtain medicine?' and then obtain it from the one indicated. If there are no relatives, one should obtain it from whichever brahmin or householder is indicated. If there is no such person either, one should obtain it from the infirmary. If it cannot be obtained even there, one should attend to one's own work and remain content with just food, drink, and what one can taste. If it is something other than that — if a tooth-stick is to be used — one should sweep with a cloth and make a circle in the direction in which the preceptor has cast his tooth-stick; one should prepare a seat-spread, set out a water vessel, a rinsing basin, a spittoon, and a tooth-stick; then take up the rinsing basin. If there is one with an eye ailment, one should prepare the eye medicine as directed by a physician, and having prepared it, present it, and then take it back again. Dharma robes too should be presented; and whenever Dharma robes have been distributed and one goes to make prostrations at stūpas, one should set out the dwelling room with care and wipe it with a cloth. If there is dust, one should smear it to whatever extent is needed with cow dung or green leaves. Then one should make prostrations at the stūpas and, to those living the brahma-conduct, also make prostrations as best one can. After that one should remain in application to meditative concentration and recitation. Knowing the time, one should wash both bowls. If one is a wandering almsman, one should oneself carry the heavy bowl,

and whichever is the lighter one, that one should be given to the preceptor. If it is the cold season, whichever blanket-robe is the heavier one should be given to the preceptor, and whichever is lighter, that one should be worn by oneself. If it is the warm season, whichever is the lighter one should be given to the preceptor, and whichever is the heavier one should be carried by oneself. If the road is rough, one should go ahead; if it is smooth, one should follow behind. If a stream is to be crossed, one should take hold of the preceptor's hand. When going on alms round, one should ask the preceptor: "Venerable sir, shall we go on alms round together or separately?" If he says "together," one should go along together; and if, while going, one finds flour, one should take it into one's own bowl. If something with rice is found, one should say: "Please put it into the preceptor's bowl." If food made from beans and lentils, or food made from ground rice, is found, one should take it into one's own bowl. If something that is a richer dish is found, one should say: "Please put it into the preceptor's bowl." If boiled butter-milk or a thick broth is

found, one should take it into one's own bowl. If there is milk, or curds, or something prepared with cream, one should say: "Please put it into the preceptor's bowl." Then, having gone to the dwelling room, one should prepare two circles on the ground and, having removed any fallen leaves, set out two seats. Then one should sit and attend to the business of the meal. If one has gone on alms round separately and has received alms, one should say to the preceptor: "Venerable sir, this is what I have obtained on alms round. Please take from it whatever you wish." And the preceptor too should be mindful of what is fitting. If something is to be received from the Saṅgha, one should wash the vessels, go to the assembly, and inquire about the distribution, saying: "Venerable ones, what portion of the Saṅgha's share has been prepared today?" And one should do so respectfully and report it back. Then one should say to the preceptor: "Venerable sir, the Saṅgha has prepared such-and-such a portion. Please take from it whatever you wish." And the preceptor too should be mindful of what is fitting. Then, in whatever place the preceptor has washed his hands, one should prepare a circle on the ground there and set out a seat, a water vessel for rinsing the head, a spittoon, and tooth-wood; and one should also wash the preceptor's feet. After washing his feet, one should dry them and then offer the sandals. If no foot-washing is being done, one should offer water, earth, and a vessel of sesame oil. Then, when the meal is finished, one should ask the preceptor: "Venerable sir, will you devote yourself to virtue right here, or will you go to rest for the midday?" If he says he will go to rest for the midday, one should take up the seat; and while he goes and rests at midday, one should wipe it with a cloth and dust it off, and arrange the cushion, and at the appropriate times anoint it with the dung of a young bull. If he engages in extensive recitation, one should show him the text. If he engages in extended meditative concentration, one should demonstrate to him the mental application. When he returns from midday rest, one should examine the bed and seat, wash one's hands and feet, and make prostrations at the stūpa. One should also make prostrations to those practising the brahma-conduct; and one should place nearby the preceptor's small seat, water, sandals, and a vessel of sesame oil. If he washes his feet, one should wash them for him and anoint them. If not, one should offer water and earth. If it is the cold season, one should kindle fire and stoke the embers. If it is the warm season, one should set out a fan to cool the air.

He should also have him learn at the proper times to recite and chant by heart. In all matters concerning the alms bowl and the like, whatever is to be done, the preceptor and ācārya should do it first, and only afterwards should one do it oneself. Those who live in community and the personal attendants should serve the preceptor and ācārya in just this way. When those who live in community and the personal attendants serve the preceptor and ācārya in such a manner, the virtuous qualities of such a person will flourish abundantly, like a blue lotus (utpala) flower blossoming in water.

The Minor Matters of the Vinaya, the forty-ninth fascicle. The occasion for this is in Rājagṛha.

Then at that time, monks by the name of "Swift-walker" and "Nabso," and reddish-grey monks who were a disgrace to householders, who practiced every manner of evil, were dwelling on the Black Mountain. They sat together with women, exchanged conversation with them, played together, made noise together, were restless and carelessly swung their bodies about, sat together on the same seat, enjoyed things from the same vessel, drank many kinds of liquor from the same cup, plucked flowers and had them plucked, threaded garlands and had them strung, tied flower ornaments and had them tied, sang songs, played musical instruments and had others play them. They gave wages to skilled dancers, pleasant singers, and those adept at playing musical instruments. Hitching up their robes, they ran, leaped, and jumped over things. Drawing up one leg, they turned about; they also turned about doing a hand-walk, and turned about in a fish-leap. They dammed up water and released it, made frog sounds in the water, made drumming sounds in the water, made the sound of an elephant, made the cry of a crane, made the sound of a horse, made the strutting sounds of a fine stallion, made the sound of a clay drum, made sounds imitating a conch, a drum, and a peacock's cry, and made the sound of a cuckoo. They staged fights between elephants, fights between horses, fights between stallions, fights between buffalo, fights between rams, fights between sheep, fights between women, fights between men, fights between girls, fights between cocks, fights between goats, and fights between rams — and they also instigated such fights between cocks, goats, and rams. They also performed other acts unworthy of a contemplative.

On account of their conduct, their behavior, and these corrupt activities, monks who had not yet come to the Black Mountain did not come, and those who had come did not remain, so that the community abandoned the Black Mountain as a dwelling place. The brahmins and householders residing on the

Black Mountain spoke thus: "These monks perform acts unworthy of contemplatives," and they mocked, derided, and disparaged them.

When the monks heard of this, they reported it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One declared: "Monks, it is indeed the case that brahmins and householders mock, deride, and disparage them. Therefore, a monk should not perform such acts unworthy of a contemplative, nor should he cause others to do them. If monks perform or cause others to perform such acts unworthy of a contemplative, it will constitute a serious offense."

The Blessed Śākyamuni Buddha was dwelling on the Vulture Peak Mountain at Rājagṛha. At that time, Ajātaśatru, the son of Queen Vaidehī, king of the land of Magadha,

the Vajjians fell into mutual discord. Ajātaśatru said to his retinue: "I shall crush, reduce to dust, and utterly destroy without trace these Vajjians, who are prosperous and flourishing, at ease, enjoying good harvests, populous, and filled with many people."

Then Ajātaśatru, son of Queen Vaidehī, king of the land of Magadha, addressed the brahmin Vassakāra, chief minister of Magadha, with these words: "Come here, Vassakāra. Go to where the Blessed One is, and when you have gone, bow your head at the feet of the Blessed One on my behalf, and inquire after his health, saying: 'Does he have little discomfort? Does he have little affliction? Is he in good spirits? Does he dwell touching strength and ease? Is he free from blame?' After conveying these greetings, say this: 'Venerable sir, Ajātaśatru, son of Queen Vaidehī, king of the land of Magadha, and the Vajjians have come into mutual conflict, and he has said to his retinue: "I shall crush, reduce to dust, and utterly destroy without trace these Vajjians, who are prosperous and flourishing, at ease, enjoying good harvests, populous, and filled with many people." What does the Blessed One declare in this matter?' And whatever the Blessed One prophesies, remember it just as it is. For Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas do not speak falsely."

Then the brahmin Vassakāra, chief minister of Magadha, answered Ajātaśatru, son of Queen Vaidehī, king of the land of Magadha: "As your majesty commands," and he entered a white carriage drawn among all carriages by swift mares, taking a golden whip and a garland-vessel for anointing, and departed from Rājagṛha. He went as far as the ground was passable by carriage, then descended from the carriage and climbed Vulture Peak

Mountain on foot, and went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, he exchanged with the Blessed One the various words of cordial and pleasant greeting, and then sat down to one side.

Seated to one side, the brahmin Vassakāra, chief minister of Magadha, said this to the Blessed One: "O Gautama, Blessed Gautama, Ajātaśatru, son of Queen Vaidehī, king of the land of Magadha, bows his head at your feet and inquires after your health: does you have little discomfort? Does you have little affliction? Are you in good spirits? Do you dwell touching strength and ease? Are you free from blame? These are his greetings, Blessed One.

"And further: may Ajātaśatru, son of Queen Vaidehī, king of the land of Magadha, and you, Vassakāra, likewise be well.

"O Gautama, Ajātaśatru, son of Queen Vaidehī, king of the land of Magadha, and the Vajjians have come into mutual conflict, and he has said to his retinue: 'I shall crush, reduce to dust, and utterly destroy without trace these Vajjians, who are prosperous and flourishing, at ease, enjoying good harvests, populous, and filled with many people.' O Blessed One, O Gautama, what do you declare in this matter?"

"Vassakāra, this matter is not to be determined once and for all. Vassakāra, at one time when I was dwelling near the Vajjian stūpa at Capal, I taught the seven principles of non-decline for the Vajjians. Vassakāra, as long as the Vajjians rightly take up and practise these seven principles of non-decline, and as long as the seven principles of non-decline are manifest among the Vajjians, the wholesome qualities desired by the Vajjians will grow and not decline.

"Gautama has spoken thus in brief, but if he has not yet expanded upon it and I have not understood the meaning in full, then let Gautama unfold what he has spoken in brief and explain it at length — in that way I shall come to understand well the meaning that the Blessed One Gautama has unfolded and explained in full."

Then at that very moment the venerable Ānanda was seated to one side of the Blessed One, holding a fan and fanning the Blessed One. The Blessed One then spoke to the venerable Ānanda:

"What do you say, Ānanda? Have you heard that the Vajjians meet together often and attend their assemblies in full?"

"Venerable sir, I have heard it: the Vajjians do indeed meet together often and attend their assemblies in full."

"Ānanda, for as long as the Vajjians meet together often and attend their assemblies in full, one should know that the wholesome qualities of the Vajjians will not decline but will grow."

"What do you say, Ānanda? Have you heard that the Vajjians sit together in harmony and rise together in harmony, and that they conduct the affairs and business of the Vajjians in harmony?"

"Venerable sir, I have heard it: the Vajjians are indeed in harmony" — and so on in the same way as above.

"Ānanda, for as long as the Vajjians sit together in harmony and rise together in harmony, and conduct the affairs and business of the Vajjians in harmony, one should know that the wholesome qualities of the Vajjians will not decline but will grow."

"What do you say, Ānanda? Have you heard that the Vajjians do not establish what has not been established as a rule, and do not discard what has already been established, but live and conduct themselves in accordance with the rules that the Vajjians have laid down and properly adopted?"

"Venerable sir, I have heard it: the Vajjians do not establish what has not been established as a rule, and do not discard what has already been established, but live and conduct themselves in accordance with the rules that the Vajjians have properly adopted."

"Ānanda, for as long as the Vajjians do not establish what has not been established as a rule, do not discard what has been established, and live and conduct themselves throughout in accordance with the rules that the Vajjians have properly adopted, one should know that the wholesome qualities of the Vajjians will not decline but will grow."

"What do you say, Ānanda? Have you heard that the Vajjians do not seize by force or coerce women and girls of the Vajjians — those guarded by their fathers, guarded by their mothers, guarded by their brothers, guarded by their sisters, guarded by relatives, guarded by their clan, protected by the law, kept under guard, those who are the wives of others and are claimed by others, and even those who in their youth have cast but a garland of flowers — that the Vajjians do not immediately cast them aside and do not pursue their desires by force?"

"Venerable sir, I have heard it. The Vajjians do not seize by force or coerce women and girls of the Vajjians — those guarded by their fathers, guarded by their mothers," and so on as above, "and even those who in their youth have cast but a garland of flowers — the Vajjians do not immediately cast them aside and do not pursue their desires by force."

"Ānanda, for as long as the Vajjians do not seize by force women and girls of the Vajjians —

— those girls of the Vajjians who in their youth have cast but a garland of flowers — the Vajjians do not immediately cast them aside and do not pursue their desires by force. For as long as the Vajjians do not do so, it should be known that the virtuous qualities of the Vajjians will not decline but will grow and flourish.

"Ānanda, have you heard whether the Vajjians honor, revere, esteem, and venerate the Vajjian elders, the nobility, and those of distinguished family lineage whom the Vajjians hold in respect, and whether they listen with confidence to their words and take them to heart?"

"Venerable sir, I have heard it. The Vajjians do honor, revere, esteem, and venerate the Vajjian elders, the nobility, and those of distinguished family lineage whom the Vajjians hold in respect, and they do listen with confidence to their words and take them to heart."

"Ānanda, for as long as the Vajjians honor, revere, esteem, and venerate the Vajjian elders, the nobility, and those of distinguished family lineage whom the Vajjians hold in respect, and listen with confidence to their words and take them to heart — it should be known that the virtuous qualities of the Vajjians will not decline but will grow and flourish.

"Ānanda, have you heard whether the Vajjians, in the four regions of the Vajjians wherever Vajjian shrines are found, honor, revere, esteem, and venerate those shrines, and whether they do not abandon the offerings formerly consecrated at them?"

"Venerable sir, I have heard it. The Vajjians, in the four regions of the Vajjians wherever Vajjian shrines are found, do honor, revere, esteem, and venerate those shrines, and they do not abandon the offerings formerly consecrated at them."

"Ānanda, for as long as the Vajjians, in the four regions of the Vajjians wherever Vajjian shrines are found, honor, revere, esteem, and venerate those

shrines, and do not abandon the offerings formerly consecrated at them — it should be known that the virtuous qualities of the Vajjians will not decline but will grow and flourish.

"Ānanda, have you heard whether the Vajjians keep close and unwavering mindfulness toward the arhats with a mind of strong faith, invite those arhats who have not yet come, and rejoice in the presence of those who have come, and do not leave them without robes, almsfood, lodging, medicines for the sick, and other requisites?"

"Venerable sir, I have heard it. The Vajjians do keep close and unwavering mindfulness toward the arhats with a mind of strong faith, they invite those arhats who have not yet come, and they rejoice in the presence of those who have come, and they do not leave them without robes, almsfood, lodging, medicines for the sick, and other requisites."

"Ānanda, for as long as the Vajjians keep close and unwavering mindfulness toward the arhats with a mind of strong faith, invite those arhats who have not yet come, rejoice in the presence of those who have come, and do not leave them without robes, almsfood, lodging, medicines for the sick, and other requisites — it should be known that the virtuous qualities of the Vajjians will not decline but will grow and flourish."

For as long as the monastics who undertake the rains retreat take up and practice in full these seven qualities that prevent decline, and for as long as these seven qualities that prevent decline are seen to be present among those who undertake the rains retreat — it should be known that the virtuous qualities of those who undertake the rains retreat will not decline but will grow and flourish.

"O Gautama, even if the monastics possessed but one of these qualities, the army of Ajātaśatru, king of Magadha, would not be able to overcome them — how much less so when they possess all of them. And now, O Gautama, since I have many matters to attend to and many duties that await me, I shall take my leave."

"Brahmin Vassakāra, you know yourself that the time has come. You may go."

Then Vassakāra, the chief minister of Magadha, rejoiced and was glad at what the Blessed One had said, and rising from before the Blessed One he departed.

When Vassakāra, the chief minister of Magadha, had not long gone, the Blessed One knew this, and he spoke to the venerable Ānanda, saying:

"Ānanda, go and assemble all the monks who are dwelling in dependence at Vulture Peak and gather them here at the assembly hall."

"Reverend sir, I shall do as you command," said the venerable Ānanda, and having listened to the Blessed One, he went to Vulture Peak, assembled all the monks who were dwelling there in dependence, and then went to where the Blessed One was. He arrived and, bowing with his head to the Blessed One's feet, sat down to one side. Then the venerable Ānanda addressed the Blessed One thus: "Reverend sir, all the monks who were dwelling in dependence at Vulture Peak have assembled here and are present together. Blessed One, please consider that the time for this has now come."

Then the Blessed One proceeded to the assembly hall and sat down on the seat that had been prepared in the midst of the community of monks. Once seated, the Blessed One addressed the monks: "Monks, I shall teach you seven qualities that prevent decline. Listen well, take them to heart, and I shall speak."

"What are the seven qualities that prevent decline? Monks, for as long as the monks assemble again and again, and remain from that repeated assembly without departing — it should be known that their virtuous qualities will not decline but will grow and flourish. For as long as the monks gather in harmony, depart in harmony, and conduct the affairs and business of the Saṅgha in harmony — it should be known that their virtuous qualities will not decline but will grow and flourish. Monks, for as long as the monks do not promulgate what has not been promulgated, do not abandon what has been promulgated, and live in accordance with the trainings as they have been established, taking up and practicing whatever additional rules are rightly undertaken — it should be known that their virtuous qualities will not decline but will grow and flourish. Monks, for as long as the monks are not dominated by delight in things arising from craving — that craving for renewed existence, born of joyful desire and arising moment by moment in this or that form — it should be known that their virtuous qualities will not decline but will grow and flourish. Monks, for as long as the monks honor, revere, esteem, and venerate those elder monks who are like kings among long-dwellers in the community, who went forth long ago, who have made the holy life a habit, who have been praised by the Teacher, who have fully cultivated and clearly perfected the practice of the holy life — and for as long as they listen to such elder monks with faith in their words —

— it should be known that their virtuous qualities will not decline but will grow and flourish. Monks, for as long as the monks take up their dwelling in remote forest hermitages, woodland groves, and lodgings at the edges of settlements, it should be known that their virtuous qualities will not decline but will grow and flourish. Monks, for as long as the monks, guarding themselves continuously with a strong mind of faith toward those who live the holy life as their peers, remain with mindfulness close at hand — calling out to those living the holy life who have not yet come, rejoicing in those who have come, and not troubling those who have come with concern for robes, alms-food, bedding and seats, medicines for the sick, and other requisites — it should be known that their virtuous qualities will not decline but will grow and flourish.

Monks, for as long as the monks properly take up and live by these seven principles of non-decline, and for as long as these seven principles of non-decline are fully evident among the monks, it should be known that their virtuous qualities will not decline but will grow and flourish.

Monks, I shall now teach you yet another set of seven principles of complete non-decline. Listen carefully, take them to heart, and I shall explain them. What are these seven principles of complete non-decline?

Monks, for as long as the monks honor, revere, esteem, and venerate the Teacher, and dwelling in reliance upon the Teacher whom they have honored, revered, esteemed, and venerated — it should be known that their virtuous qualities will not decline but will grow and flourish. For as long as they cultivate meditative absorption, honor it, revere it, esteem it, and venerate it, demonstrating through it careful heedfulness in the trainings and thorough discernment, and dwelling in reliance upon that meditative absorption which they have honored, revered, esteemed, and venerated — it should be known that their virtuous qualities will not decline but will grow and flourish.

Monks, for as long as the monks properly take up and live by these seven principles of complete non-decline, and for as long as these seven principles of complete non-decline are fully evident among the monks, it should be known that their virtuous qualities will not decline but will grow and flourish.

Monks, I shall now teach you yet another set of seven principles of complete non-decline. Listen carefully, take them to heart, and I shall explain them. What are these seven principles of complete non-decline?

Monks, for as long as the monks take no delight in busyness, take no delight in idle chatter, take no delight in sleep, take no delight in gossip, take no delight

in gatherings, take no delight in socializing, and dwelling thus, setting aside other preoccupations, remain in steady pursuit of endeavor, content with the smallest and most meager of things, and through that contentment press ever further onward in accomplishing what is to be done — it should be known that their virtuous qualities will not decline but will grow and flourish.

Monks, for as long as the monks properly take up and live by these seven principles of complete non-decline, and for as long as these seven principles of complete non-decline are fully evident among the monks, it should be known that their virtuous qualities will not decline but will grow and flourish.

Monks, I shall now teach you yet another set of seven principles of complete non-decline.

Listen well, take it to heart, and I shall speak. What are these seven principles of complete non-decline? Monks, for as long as the monks come to possess faith, a sense of shame, a sense of conscience, applied diligence, the establishment of mindfulness, the establishment of meditative equipoise, and wisdom — it should be known that their virtuous qualities will not decline but will grow and flourish.

Monks, for as long as the monks properly take up and live by these seven principles of complete non-decline, and for as long as these seven principles of complete non-decline are fully evident among the monks, it should be known that their virtuous qualities will not decline but will grow and flourish.

Monks, I shall now teach you yet another set of seven principles of complete non-decline. Listen well, take it to heart, and I shall speak. What are these seven principles of complete non-decline? Monks, for as long as the monks come to possess knowledge of the Dharma, knowledge of its meaning, knowledge of the proper time, knowledge of measure, knowledge of themselves, knowledge of the assembly, and knowledge of persons — whether supreme or not supreme — it should be known that their virtuous qualities will not decline but will grow and flourish.

Monks, for as long as the monks properly take up and live by these seven principles of complete non-decline, and for as long as these seven principles of complete non-decline are fully evident among the monks, it should be known that their virtuous qualities will not decline but will grow and flourish.

Monks, I shall now explain to you yet another set of seven principles of complete non-decline. Listen well, take it to heart, and I shall speak. What are

these seven principles of complete non-decline? Monks, for as long as the monks cultivate the limb of awakening that is correct mindfulness — abiding in seclusion, abiding in dispassion, abiding in cessation, transforming the mind through complete relinquishment — and for as long as they cultivate the limbs of awakening that are discrimination of phenomena, diligence, joy, thorough pliancy, meditative absorption, and equanimity — each abiding in seclusion, abiding in dispassion, abiding in cessation, transforming the mind through complete relinquishment — it should be known that their virtuous qualities will not decline but will grow and flourish.

Monks, for as long as the monks properly take up and live by these seven principles of complete non-decline, and for as long as these seven principles of complete non-decline are fully evident among the monks, it should be known that their virtuous qualities will not decline but will grow and flourish.

Monks, I shall now teach you six principles that lead to universal delight. Listen well, take it to heart, and I shall speak. What are these six principles that lead to universal delight?

One who, with acts of loving-kindness in body, constantly abides and cultivates in the presence of the Teacher and those who practice the holy life — rejoicing in the wise, honoring them, gladly welcoming them, having welcomed them with gladness, having honored them, having held them in reverence — gathers all together in unity, and having truly gathered them, lives and practices in harmony without conflict and as one: this is a principle that leads to universal delight. Likewise, acts of loving-kindness in speech and acts of loving-kindness in mind.

Whatever is obtained in accordance with the Dharma — even if only a little, even something that comes into the begging bowl, even such a small gain as that — one does not consume it alone in seclusion, but shares it in common with joy together with those who practice the holy life, eating in fellowship. One rejoices in them, honors them, gladly welcomes them, having welcomed them with gladness, having honored them, having held them in reverence.

Having cultivated and fully gathered them together, and having completely assembled them, one acts without conflict and as one, practicing them in common: this is a principle that leads to universal delight. Whatever moral discipline is unimpaired and flawless, not dragged along, not patched together, self-governed, not blackened or mottled, thoroughly undertaken, completely perfected, praised by the wise, and such that those who live the

holy life are not censured by the wise — moral discipline of that kind one holds in common together with those wise ones who live the holy life, practicing it as one and practicing it in common with them. All the rest follows as before, up to "practicing them in common": this is a principle that leads to universal delight. Whatever noble view is one of definite emergence, of definite distinction, of genuine deliverance — a view that by its very cause brings suffering to a thorough end and leads to the final cessation of suffering — that kind of view one holds in common together with those wise ones who live the holy life, sharing the same view, acting as one and practicing it in common with them. All the rest follows as before, up to "practicing them in common": this is a principle that leads to universal delight.

Monks, so long as you rightly take up and practice these six principles of universal delight, monks, when these principles of universal delight are everywhere apparent, know that the wholesome qualities of the monks will not decline but will increase and flourish.

The intermediate summary in verse:

The Teacher, and the Vinaya,
Livelihood and faith and the nature of reality,
The limbs of awakening — universal delight,
The rains retreat, and the full exposition.

Then the Blessed One addressed the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, let us go to the village of Nāḍa." "Venerable sir, as you command," said the venerable Ānanda, and he complied with what the Blessed One said.

Then the Blessed One, traveling with the community of monks through the country of Magadha, spent the night at a royal resting place called Ambalaṭṭhikā, lying between the village of Nāḍa and Rājagṛha.

Then the Blessed One addressed the monks: "Monks, it is because you and I did not know, did not see, did not penetrate, and did not individually realize the Four Noble Truths that we have been running and wandering for so long upon this lengthy road. What are those four truths? It is because you and I did not know, did not see, did not penetrate, and did not individually realize suffering, the origin of suffering, the cessation of suffering, and the path that leads to the cessation of suffering, that we have been running and wandering for so long upon this lengthy road. But now, having followed and individually realized the noble truth of suffering, having cut off the craving for existence, the births of cyclic existence are exhausted, and there is no further existence.

And likewise having followed and individually realized the noble truth of the origin of suffering, the noble truth of the cessation of suffering, and the noble truth of the path leading to the cessation of suffering — having cut off the craving for existence, the births of cyclic existence are exhausted, and there is no further existence."

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the Sugata, the Well-Gone, having said this, the Teacher then spoke further in verse:

Because you and I alone
did not see as they truly are
the four noble truths,
we wandered for long upon the lengthy road.

Now, having seen those truths
and having cut off the craving for existence,
the births of cyclic existence are exhausted:
there is no further existence now.

Then the Blessed One addressed the venerable Ānanda: "Now, Ānanda, let us go to the village of Nāḍa."

"As you command, Venerable One," said the venerable Ānanda, and he did as the Blessed One directed. Then the Blessed One, travelling on tour through the land of Magadha, arrived at the village of Nāḍika and took up residence at the Nāḍika stūpa in the village of Nāḍika. The brahmins and householders of the village of Nāḍika heard that the Blessed One, travelling on tour through the land of Magadha, had arrived at the village of Nāḍika and was residing at the Nāḍika stūpa. Having heard this, they gathered in groups and assembled in crowds, and coming out from the village of Nāḍika they went to where the Blessed One was. Arriving there, they bowed their heads to the feet of the Blessed One and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the Blessed One spoke these words to the brahmins and householders of the village of Nāḍika:

"Brahmins and householders, these five are the faults of heedlessness. What five?

"Brahmins and householders, one who is heedless and who abides in heedlessness will, on account of that, fall away from great wealth. That a brahmin or householder who is heedless and abides in heedlessness falls away from great wealth on account of that — this is the first fault of heedlessness.

"Furthermore, brahmins and householders, one who is heedless and who abides in heedlessness will, on account of that, go into whatever assembly it may be — whether the assembly of the warrior-nobles, the assembly of brahmins, the assembly of householders, or the assembly of ascetics — and in each and every such assembly they will arrive timid and joyless, going about in shame and embarrassment. That a brahmin or householder who is heedless and abides in heedlessness goes into whatever assembly it may be and arrives timid, joyless, going about in shame and embarrassment — this, as stated above, is the second fault of heedlessness.

"Furthermore, brahmins and householders, one who is heedless and who abides in heedlessness will, on account of that, become known in all directions and throughout all quarters by a bad, unflattering, and ignoble report and reputation in verse. That a brahmin or householder who is heedless and abides in heedlessness becomes known in all directions and throughout all quarters by a bad, unflattering, and ignoble report and reputation in verse — this is the third fault of heedlessness.

"Furthermore, brahmins and householders, one who is heedless and who abides in heedlessness will, on account of that, come to die confused in mind. That a brahmin or householder who is heedless and abides in heedlessness comes to die confused in mind — this is the fourth fault of heedlessness.

"Furthermore, brahmins and householders, one who is heedless and who abides in heedlessness will, on account of that, at the breaking up of the body after death, fall into a miserable state, a bad destination, a downfall, and be reborn among the hell-beings. That a brahmin or householder who is heedless and abides in heedlessness at the breaking up of the body after death falls into a miserable state, a bad destination, a downfall, and is reborn among the hell-beings — this is the fifth fault of heedlessness.

"Brahmins and householders, these five are the benefits of heedfulness. What five?

"Brahmins and householders, one who is heedful and who abides in heedfulness will, on account of that, not fall away from great wealth. Brahmins and householders —"

Brahmins and householders, that one who is heedful and who abides in heedfulness will, on account of that, not fall away from great wealth — this is the first benefit of heedfulness.

Furthermore, brahmins and householders, one who is heedful and who abides in heedfulness will, on account of that, enter whatever assembly — whether an assembly of the warrior-nobles, an assembly of brahmins, an assembly of householders, or an assembly of ascetics — without timidity, with joy, and without embarrassment. Brahmins and householders, that one who is heedful and who abides in heedfulness will enter whatever assembly — as stated above from "on account of that" through "without embarrassment" — this is the second benefit of heedfulness.

Furthermore, brahmins and householders, one who is heedful and who abides in heedfulness will, on account of that, become renowned in all directions and quarters through virtue, fame, repute, and verses of praise spread far and wide. Brahmins and householders, that one who is heedful and who abides in heedfulness will, on account of that, become renowned in all directions and quarters through virtue, fame, repute, and verses of praise spread far and wide — this is the third benefit of heedfulness.

Furthermore, brahmins and householders, one who is heedful and who abides in heedfulness will, on account of that, pass the time without worry. Brahmins and householders, that one who is heedful and who abides in heedfulness will, on account of that, pass the time without worry — this is the fourth benefit of heedfulness.

Furthermore, brahmins and householders, one who is heedful and who abides in heedfulness will, on account of that, at the breaking up of the body after death, be reborn among the gods of the heavenly realms, a happy destination and a higher world. Brahmins and householders, that one who is heedful and who abides in heedfulness will, on account of that, at the breaking up of the body after death, be reborn among the gods of the heavenly realms, a happy destination and a higher world — this is the fifth benefit of heedfulness.

Then the Blessed One instructed, engaged, inspired, and delighted the brahmins and householders of Roruka with a Dharma-talk, in many ways instructing them, engaging them, inspiring them, and delighting them with a Dharma-talk; and then he fell silent.

Then the brahmins and householders of Roruka rose from their seats, arranged their upper robes over one shoulder, knelt on their right knees, and with palms joined in the direction of the Blessed One, bowed in reverence, and said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, may you consent to remain here in our place for a day."

The Blessed One consented to the brahmins and householders of the village of Roruka by remaining silent.

Then the brahmins and householders of Roruka, understanding by the Blessed One's silence that he had consented, rejoiced in what the Blessed One had said and expressed their approval. They prostrated with their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and departed from his presence.

Then, not long after the brahmins and householders of Roruka had departed, the Blessed One knew the time and rose, going to where his dwelling was. He washed both feet at the outer entrance of the dwelling and went inside the dwelling in order to sit in proper meditation.

Then at that time, the brahmin Vassakāra, chief minister of the realm of Magadha, was striving to build a city wall around the village of Pāṭaligāma in order to crush the Vajjian brahmins and householders. And at that time, the powerful and mighty gods were mingling in that place, dwelling by dwelling, throughout Pāṭaligāma. While the Blessed One was dwelling there engaged in his daytime practice, with his divine eye, purified beyond that of ordinary human beings, he saw the powerful and mighty gods mingling in that place, dwelling by dwelling, throughout Pāṭaligāma. Having seen this, he rose from the meditative equipoise in which he had rested during the afternoon, came forth from his dwelling, and took his seat on a prepared cushion in the shadow of the dwelling, in the midst of the community of monks.

When he was seated, the Blessed One addressed the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, who is it that you have heard is striving to build a city wall around Pāṭaligāma?"

"Venerable Sir, I have heard that it is the brahmin Vassakāra, chief minister of the realm of Magadha, who is striving to build a city wall around the village of Pāṭaligāma in order to crush the Vajjian brahmins and householders."

"Excellent, Ānanda, excellent! Ānanda, the brahmin Vassakāra, chief minister of the realm of Magadha, is skilled. He has, as it were, deliberated together with the gods of the Thirty-Three. Ānanda, while I was dwelling here engaged in my daytime practice, with my divine eye, purified beyond that of ordinary human beings, I saw the powerful and mighty gods mingling in that place, dwelling by dwelling, throughout Pāṭaligāma. Ānanda, in whatever direction the powerful and mighty gods have mingled by dwelling, in that direction the minds of powerful and mighty people will incline — it is on account of the dwellings. In whatever direction middling gods and common gods have

mingled by dwelling, in that direction the minds of middling people and common people will incline — it is on account of the dwellings. Ānanda, here in this Pāṭaligāma, in this direction where the powerful and mighty gods have mingled by dwelling, the minds of powerful and mighty people will incline — it is on account of the dwellings. Ānanda, there will be as many noble dwelling places, as many noble designations, and as many roads for noble merchants, and it will become a great trading center — that is to say, this city of Pāṭaligāma will become supreme. Yet know that three dangers will arise for it: from fire, from water, and from internal strife."

Then the brahmin Vassakāra, chief minister of the realm of Magadha, heard that the ascetic Gautama, having journeyed through the realm of Magadha, had come to the village of Pāṭaligāma and was dwelling near the Pāṭaligāma shrine in Pāṭaligāma, and that the brahmins and householders of Pāṭaligāma were attending upon him. Having heard this, he came out from Pāṭaligāma, went to where the Blessed One was, and upon arriving exchanged with the Blessed One various words of joyful and cordial greeting, and then sat down to one side.

Once he was seated to one side, the Blessed One instructed the brahmin Vassakāra, chief minister of the realm of Magadha, with Dharma-connected discourse, roused him, established him in it, encouraged him, and filled him with delight. Having in many ways instructed him with Dharma-connected discourse, roused him, encouraged him, and filled him with delight, the Blessed One fell silent.

Then the brahmin Vassakāra, chief minister of the realm of Magadha, rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, joined his palms in reverence, and bowed,

said the following to the Blessed One: "Wise Gautama, if it would be permitted for us to take our midday meal together with the community of monks, please grant your consent." The Blessed One consented to the brahmin Vassakāra, chief minister of the realm of Magadha, by remaining silent.

The Minor Matters of the Vinaya, fiftieth bundle.

Then the brahmin Vassakāra, chief minister of the realm of Magadha, understanding from the Blessed One's silence that consent had been given, rejoiced at what the Blessed One had said, praised him, rose from his seat, and departed.

That same night the brahmin Vassakāra prepared pure and choice food and drink, and rising early the following morning, he spread out seats and set out a water vessel adorned with jewels. He then sent word to the Blessed One of the hour, saying: "Gautama, it is midday. Wise Gautama, if the time has come, may he be pleased to know that the time has come."

Then the Blessed One, at the morning hour, dressed in his lower robe and robes, took up his bowl, and with the community of monks before him, went to the dwelling of the brahmin Vassakāra, chief minister of the realm of Magadha. He arrived and sat down in the seat that had been laid out in the midst of the community of monks.

Then the brahmin Vassakāra, chief minister of the realm of Magadha, having seen that the Blessed One and the community of monks were comfortably seated, served them with pure and choice food and drink with his own hands, satisfying them to the full. Again and again with his own hands he served them with pure and choice food and drink, and satisfied them to the full.

When the Blessed One had finished his meal and withdrawn his hands, Vassakāra, knowing that the bowl had been set aside, took up a golden water-sprinkler, sat before the Blessed One, and said: "O Gautama, whatever source of merit, source of virtue, and foundation of happiness arises from this act of giving — may it be dedicated here and now for the long-term benefit, welfare, and happiness of the gods who dwell in the city of Rājagṛha." He thus requested the Blessed One to dedicate the merit of the gift there and then.

Then the Blessed One rejoiced in the gift of the brahmin Vassakāra, chief minister of the realm of Magadha, with this rejoicing:

A person of faith,
whoever makes offerings to the gods,
who acts in accordance with the word of the buddhas —
such a one is praised by the buddhas.

One who is wise and of settled mind,
in whatever quarter he takes up his abode,
having offered food to those endowed with moral discipline,
let him dedicate the merit beneath them.

Those honored by such honoring shall be honored,
and worshipped by such worship shall be worshipped.
Then, as a mother to the child born of her womb,

let him show love to these.

The person whom the gods love
will come to see great happiness.

Then the Blessed One, having in many ways instructed the brahmin Vassakāra, chief minister of the realm of Magadha, with Dharma-connected discourse, roused him, established him in it, encouraged him, and filled him with delight. Rising from his seat, he departed.

Then the brahmin Vassakāra, chief minister of the realm of Magadha, gave away all the remaining food as a gift, and followed after the Blessed One, reflecting inwardly and forming this thought: "The gate through which the ascetic Gautama departed from the city of Rājagṛha — I shall name it Gautama's Gate."

"And the ford of the Ganges River by which he crossed — that too I shall name Gautama's Ford."

Then the Blessed One, knowing with his mind the thoughts of the brahmin Vassakāra, chief minister of the realm of Magadha, passed directly through the midst of the town of Ambalaṭṭhikā, emerged by the western gate, traveled northward, and arrived at the bank of the Ganges River. At that time the people of Magadha were crossing the Ganges back and forth: some on planks of sal wood, some on wooden rafts, some in boats, and some by swimming.

Then the Blessed One considered: "Shall I cross against the current of the Ganges, or shall I disappear from this bank and appear on the far bank?" Then the Blessed One entered into such a meditative absorption that, together with the community of monks, he disappeared from this near bank and appeared on the far bank — just as one places the mind in equipoise. And thereupon another monk spoke these verses:

Some build a bridge and, casting aside the shallows, cross the sea.

The wise among beings cross by means of rafts.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, having crossed while the brahmin still waded,
stands upon the far shore dry.

Here the monks who bathe — those hearers — are the ones making use of
rafts.

If water is everywhere found,
what use then is the water of a well?

Having cut the root of craving,
who would still go seeking what to consume?

Then the brahmin Vassakāra, chief minister of the realm of Magadha, named the gate of the town of Ambalaṭṭhikā by which the Blessed One had departed "Gautama's Gate," and named the ford of the Ganges by which he had crossed "Gautama's Ford."

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, let us go to the city of Pāṭaliputta." "As the Venerable One commands," replied the venerable Ānanda, and he listened to the Blessed One. The Blessed One traveled through the countryside, departing from that region, and arrived at the city of Pāṭaliputta, where he took up residence in a grove of śāpa trees to the north of the city.

Then the Blessed One addressed the monks: "Monks, moral discipline is of this kind; meditative absorption is of this kind; wisdom is of this kind. When moral discipline is thoroughly cultivated, one comes to dwell long in meditative absorption. When meditative absorption is thoroughly cultivated, one comes to dwell long in wisdom. When wisdom is thoroughly cultivated, the mind becomes completely liberated from attachment, aversion, and delusion, exactly as they are. Monks, when the noble hearers (śrāvakas) are thus completely liberated in mind, they directly and truly know: 'Birth is exhausted for me; the holy life has been lived; what had to be done has been done; there is no further existence beyond this.'"

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, let us go to the city of Vaiśālī." "As the Venerable One commands," replied the venerable Ānanda, and he listened to the Blessed One. The Blessed One traveled through the countryside, departing from that region, and arrived at Vaiśālī, where he took up residence at the Kundaka's Grove in Vaiśālī.

At that time a great fear arose among the common people of Vaiśālī. It was reported that the lay practitioner Udraka had passed away at his appointed time; and likewise the lay practitioners Neyya, Rabhassona, Kātyāyana's Bull of the Herd, Subhadda, Neyya-subhadda, Āciravata, Neyya-āciravata, Bhadra, Subhadra, Yasa, and

Yaśodatta and Yaśottara had also passed away at their appointed time. Then a great many monks, in the early morning hour, put on their lower robes, took up their outer robes and alms bowls, and entered Vaiśālī for the sake of alms.

As a great many monks were making their alms round in Vaiśālī, they heard that a great many common people of that city had died — that the lay practitioner Udraka had passed away at his appointed time, and likewise the lay practitioners Neyya, Rabhassona, Kātyāyana's Bull of the Herd, Subhadda, Neyya-subhadda, Āciravata, Neyya-āciravata, Bhadra, Subhadra, Yaśa, Yaśodatta, and Yaśottara had all passed away at their appointed time. Having heard this, they completed their alms round in Vaiśālī, finished the meal, set aside the alms bowl after the meal, put away their bowls and robes in order, washed their two feet, went to where the Blessed One was, approached him, prostrated with their heads at the feet of the Blessed One, and sat down to one side.

Sitting to one side, the great many monks addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Venerable One, we — a great many monks — in the early morning hour, having put on our lower robes and taken up our alms bowls and outer robes, entered this Vaiśālī for the sake of alms. Venerable One, as we, a great many monks, were going on our alms round through Vaiśālī, we heard that a great many common people of this city had died — that the lay practitioner Udraka had passed away at his appointed time, and likewise the lay practitioners Neyya, Rabhassona, Kātyāyana's Bull of the Herd, Subhadda, Neyya-subhadda, Āciravata, Neyya-āciravata, Bhadra, Subhadra, Yaśa, Yaśodatta, and Yaśottara had also passed away at their appointed time. Venerable One, where have they gone? In what place of the other world were they reborn?"

"Monks, the lay practitioner Udraka abandoned the five fetters that are not in conformity with the higher part, was born spontaneously in that very realm, attained complete nirvāṇa there, and entered the nature of one who does not return to this world and does not arise in it again. The lay practitioners Neyya, Rabhassona, Kātyāyana's Bull of the Herd, Subhadda, Neyya-subhadda, Āciravata, Neyya-āciravata, Bhadra, Subhadra, Yaśa, Yaśodatta, and Yaśottara likewise abandoned the five fetters that are not in conformity with the higher part, were born spontaneously in that very realm, attained complete nirvāṇa, and entered the nature of those who do not return to this world and do not arise in it again.

"Monks, as for the two hundred and fifty-one lay practitioners of Vaiśālī who have passed away at their appointed time — they too abandoned the five fetters that are not in conformity with the higher part, were born spontaneously in that very realm, attained complete nirvāṇa, and entered the

nature of those who do not return to this world and do not arise in it again.

"Monks, as for the more than three hundred lay practitioners of Vaiśālī who have passed away — they abandoned the three fetters, thinned out attachment, aversion, and delusion, and became once-returners, who will return to this world one more time and, having returned once, will make an end of suffering.

"Monks, as for the more than five hundred lay practitioners of Vaiśālī who have passed away — they abandoned the three fetters and, having entered the stream, entered the nature of those who do not fall back, and are certain to attain perfect and complete awakening.

at most, one will not pass beyond seven existences, and having taken birth seven times among gods or humans, one will make an end of suffering.

"Monks, you have asked the Tathāgata about the time of passing. To ask the Tathāgata 'when the time of passing has come' is to show disrespect to the Tathāgata. That it is uncomfortable for the Tathāgata is one thing; but that where there is birth there will certainly come a time of death — in that there is no great wonder. What is wonderful is this: whether or not Tathāgatas appear in the world, the way of the Dharma abides. These very dharmadhātus abide as the nature of reality — the Tathāgata himself knows and fully comprehends them, and then teaches, sets forth, establishes, analyzes, makes clear, reveals, and fully expounds them. And what he expounds is this:

When this exists, that arises; with the arising of this, that is born. That is to say: conditioned by ignorance, formations arise; conditioned by formations, consciousness arises; conditioned by consciousness, name-and-form arises; conditioned by name-and-form, the six sense bases arise; conditioned by the six sense bases, contact arises; conditioned by contact, feeling arises; conditioned by feeling, craving arises; conditioned by craving, clinging arises; conditioned by clinging, becoming arises; conditioned by becoming, birth arises; conditioned by birth, old age and death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, mental distress, and agitation arise. Thus this entire great mass of suffering comes to be.

And this: When this is absent, that does not arise; with the cessation of this, that ceases. That is to say: with the cessation of ignorance, formations cease; with the cessation of formations, consciousness ceases; with the cessation of consciousness, name-and-form ceases; with the cessation of name-and-form, the six sense bases cease; with the cessation of the six sense bases, contact

ceases; with the cessation of contact, feeling ceases; with the cessation of feeling, craving ceases; with the cessation of craving, clinging ceases; with the cessation of clinging, becoming ceases; with the cessation of becoming, birth ceases; with the cessation of birth, old age and death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, mental distress, and agitation cease. Thus this entire great mass of suffering ceases.

"Monks, such being the case, I have now taught the Dharma teaching that is a category of the Dharma Mirror. Listen to it well, take it to heart, and I will explain it. What is the Dharma teaching that is a category of the Dharma Mirror? Faith founded on knowing the Buddha — that is the Dharma teaching that is a category of the Dharma Mirror. Faith founded on knowing the Dharma, the Saṅgha, and the noble ones' beloved moral discipline — that too is the Dharma teaching that is a category of the Dharma Mirror. Monks, I have spoken to you of the Dharma teaching that is a category of the Dharma Mirror, and in that saying it has been said."

Then the Blessed One addressed the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, let us go to Vaiśālī." "Venerable one, as you command," said the venerable Ānanda, and he followed the Blessed One's lead. Then the Blessed One departed from that district, traveled through the countryside, and arrived at Vaiśālī, where he took up residence in the Āmrapālī Grove of Vaiśālī.

Āmrapālī heard that the Blessed One had departed from that district, traveled through the countryside, arrived at Vaiśālī, and was residing in the grove that was her own garden at Vaiśālī. Upon hearing this, she adorned herself with all her ornaments, surrounded herself with a retinue of women, mounted a fine carriage, and set out from Vaiśālī to behold the Blessed One.

She went into the Blessed One's presence to pay him honor and reverence. She rode in her carriage as far as the road was passable for carriages, then dismounted and went on foot to the pleasure grove.

At that time the Blessed One was seated in the midst of an assembly of many hundreds of monks, teaching the Dharma. The Blessed One saw Āmrapālī coming from a distance. Seeing her, he addressed the monks: "Monks, as Āmrapālī approaches, remain steadfast in diligence, vigilance, and mindfulness."

"Monks," he continued, "what is it that I am teaching when I say 'remain steadfast in diligence'? Monks, here one generates the intention to abandon sinful and unwholesome phenomena that have already arisen; one strives,

initiates diligence, grasps the mind, and applies it. One generates the intention not to give rise to sinful and unwholesome phenomena that have not yet arisen; one strives, initiates diligence, grasps the mind, and applies it. One generates the intention to give rise to virtuous phenomena that have not yet arisen; one strives, initiates diligence, grasps the mind, and applies it. One generates the intention to maintain virtuous phenomena that have already arisen, so that they do not decline, so that they become fully complete, so that they grow and expand; one strives, initiates diligence, grasps the mind, and applies it. Monks, this is what it means to remain steadfast in diligence.

"Monks, what is it to remain steadfast in vigilance? Monks, here one acts with vigilance when looking ahead and looking around, when drawing in and stretching out the limbs, when wearing one's robes and carrying one's bowl, when walking, standing, sitting, and lying down, when rising, speaking, and keeping silent, when drowsy, fatigued, and resting. Monks, this is what it means to remain steadfast in vigilance.

"Monks, what is it to remain steadfast in mindfulness? Monks, here one dwells observing the body as body in relation to the inner body, endowed with diligence, vigilance, and mindfulness, having abandoned ill-will and discontent with regard to the world. One dwells observing the outer body, the inner and outer body. One dwells observing feelings as feelings in relation to outer feelings, inner feelings, and inner and outer feelings. One dwells observing mind as mind in relation to outer mind, inner mind, and inner and outer mind. One dwells observing phenomena as phenomena in relation to outer phenomena, inner phenomena, and inner and outer phenomena, endowed with diligence, vigilance, and mindfulness, having abandoned ill-will and discontent with regard to the world. Monks, this is what it means to remain steadfast in mindfulness.

"Monks, when I said 'as Āmrapālī approaches, remain steadfast in diligence, vigilance, and mindfulness,' that is what I meant."

Then Āmrapālī went to where the Blessed One was, approached him, and bowed her head to the Blessed One's feet; then she sat down to one side. Once she was seated to one side, the Blessed One instructed her fully with a Dharma-endowed discourse, established her fully in it, praised her fully, and gladdened her fully. With many different categories of Dharma-endowed discourse he instructed her fully, established her fully, praised her fully, and gladdened her fully; and then he fell silent.

Then Āmrapālī rose from her seat, faced toward the Blessed One, joined her palms, bowed, and addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, may it please you to grant me the honor of accepting tomorrow's meal together with the community of monks." The Blessed One consented to Āmrapālī by remaining silent. Perceiving by his silence that the Blessed One had granted her request, Āmrapālī rejoiced in what the Blessed One had said, praised it openly, bowed her head to the Blessed One's two feet, and departed from his presence.

Now the Licchavīs of Vaiśālī heard that the Blessed One had set out, was traveling through the countryside, had arrived at Vaiśālī, and was residing in Āmrapālī's grove there in Vaiśālī. Hearing this, each of them mounted his own chariot. Some had blue horses, blue chariots, blue harnesses, blue whips, blue crests, blue parasols, blue sword-scabbards, blue yak-tail fans with jeweled handles, blue garments, blue ornaments, blue ointments, and blue retinues. Some had yellow horses, yellow chariots, yellow harnesses, yellow whips, yellow crests, yellow parasols, yellow sword-scabbards, yak-tail fans with jeweled handles, yellow garments, yellow ornaments, yellow ointments, and yellow retinues. Some had red horses, red chariots, red harnesses, red whips, red crests, red parasols, red sword-scabbards, yak-tail fans with jeweled handles, red garments, red ornaments, red ointments, and red retinues. Some had white horses, white chariots, white harnesses, white whips, white crests, white parasols, white sword-scabbards, yak-tail fans with jeweled handles, white garments, white ornaments, white ointments, and white retinues. Calling out loudly and with great noise, "Make way! Make way!", they set out from Vaiśālī and proceeded into the presence of the Blessed One to see him and pay their respects.

The Blessed One saw the Licchavīs of Vaiśālī approaching from a great distance. Seeing them, he addressed the monks: "Monks, any of you who has not seen the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three (Skt. Trāyastriṃśa) going to their pleasure grove — look upon the Licchavīs of Vaiśālī. For monks, just as the Licchavīs of Vaiśālī appear right now, with such splendor, such richness, and such magnificence of dress as they go to a pleasure grove — so too do the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three go to their pleasure grove."

The Licchavīs rode as far as the road allowed for riding, then dismounted and entered the park on foot, went to where the Blessed One was, approached him, bowed their heads to the Blessed One's two feet, and sat down to one side. Once they were seated to one side, the Blessed One instructed the

Licchavīs of Vaiśālī fully with a Dharma-endowed discourse, established them fully in it, praised them fully, and gladdened them fully. With many different categories of Dharma-endowed discourse he instructed them fully, established them fully, praised them fully, and gladdened them fully.

Now at that very time the brahmin youth Serkya was present there among that assembly. Then the brahmin youth Serkya rose from his seat and —

draped his upper robe over one shoulder, turned toward the Blessed One, joined his palms, bowed, and addressed him thus: "Blessed One, I am bold enough to speak. Sugata, I am bold enough to speak."

The Blessed One declared, "Brahmin youth Serkya, speak boldly." And then the brahmin youth Serkya addressed him in verse:

The king of Aṅga who wears the jewel-crown —
through the power of his mother he has gained a fortunate gain.
The buddha who appeared in that land
is like the sound of fame that stands like a snow mountain.

Just as a beautiful lotus that has bloomed well,
opening at dawn, bearing sweet fragrance —
look to the stream of the sun that, in the sky,
shines with a light surpassing the sun itself.

Just so, look to the power of wisdom of the Tathāgatas,
like a blazing fire in the night:
it is that which opens the eye and brings light,
and dispels entirely the doubts of those who have come.

The five hundred Licchavīs praised the brahmin youth Serkya for having spoken well. "The brahmin youth Serkya has spoken well!" they said, and gave him five hundred upper robes in honor of his having spoken so well. Then the Blessed One instructed the Licchavīs of Vaiśālī once more fully with a Dharma-endowed discourse, established them fully in it, praised them fully, and gladdened them fully, and then fell silent.

Then the Licchavīs of Vaiśālī rose from their seats, draped their upper robes over one shoulder, turned toward the Blessed One, joined their palms, bowed, and addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, may it please you to grant us permission to invite the community of monks together with yourself to our home tomorrow for a midday meal. The lodging-keepers, however, were first invited by Āmrapālī. Venerable Āmrapālī is a woman of low standing, of inferior

wisdom; she has deceived us. We had hoped from the very first to see and honor the Blessed One, but even so, even though she got there before us, we still wish to offer honor and service to the Blessed One and the community of monks."

The Blessed One declared to them, "The lodging-keepers have spoken well." Then the Licchavīs of Vaiśālī, praising what the Blessed One had said and rejoicing, bowed their heads to the Blessed One's two feet and departed from the presence of the Blessed One.

The brahmin youth Serkya, however, remained right there. Then the brahmin youth Serkya, knowing that the Licchavīs of Vaiśālī had not gone far after departing, rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, turned toward the Blessed One, joined his palms, bowed, and addressed the Blessed One thus: "Venerable one, these five hundred upper robes given to me here by the five hundred Licchavīs for having spoken well — may the Blessed One, out of compassion, be pleased to accept them."

The Blessed One, out of compassion for the brahmin youth Serkya, accepted the five hundred upper robes.

Then the Blessed One addressed the brahmin youth Serkya: "Serkya's son, when a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and fully awakened buddha appears in the world, five wondrous and marvelous phenomena arise in the world. What are the five? Serkya's son, in this regard, when the Teacher — the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, accomplished in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, the unsurpassed one, the guide who tames beings, the Teacher of gods and humans, the Awakened Blessed One — appears in the world, the Dharma he teaches is wholesome at the beginning, wholesome in the middle,

wholesome at the end, good in meaning, good in words, unmixed, complete, perfectly pure, perfectly clear, and it fully reveals the holy life. Serkya's son, when a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and fully awakened buddha appears in the world, this is the first wondrous and marvelous phenomenon that arises in the world.

Serkya's son, furthermore, those who listen to that Dharma with reverence, who regard it as supreme, who regard it as sacred, who take it to heart, who have made their minds one-pointed, who lend their ears and gather all their attention to listen — Serkya's son, when a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and fully awakened buddha appears in the world, this is the second wondrous and

marvelous phenomenon that arises in the world.

Serkya's son, furthermore, those who, having heard that Dharma, experience joy, delight, and the great wholesome quality of listening that is accompanied by renunciation — Serkya's son, when a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and fully awakened buddha appears in the world, this is the third wondrous and marvelous phenomenon that arises in the world.

Serkya's son, furthermore, those who, having heard that Dharma, practice accordingly, just as it was taught — Serkya's son, when a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and fully awakened buddha appears in the world, this is the fourth wondrous and marvelous phenomenon that arises in the world.

Serkya's son, furthermore, those who, having heard that Dharma, individually discern the ground of its profound meaning — Serkya's son, when a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and fully awakened buddha appears in the world, this is the fifth wondrous and marvelous phenomenon that arises in the world.

Serkya's son, noble persons are those who appreciate what has been done for them and who feel what has been done for them. If they do not let even the slightest good deed go to waste, how much more so with great deeds? Serkya's son, therefore, train yourselves to be ones who appreciate what has been done and who feel what has been done — not letting even the slightest good deed go to waste, let alone great ones. Serkya's son, you should train yourselves in just this way.

Then the brahmin youth Serkya's son, rejoicing in and approving of what the Blessed One had said, bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and departed from his presence.

Then, that very same night, Ambapālī prepared pure and excellent food and drink, and rising early the next morning, she spread out seats, set out jeweled water vessels, and then sent word to the Blessed One to inform him that the time of the invitation had come, saying: "Venerable One, the seats are prepared; please consider that the hour is now right."

Then the Blessed One, in the early morning, put on his lower robe, took his outer Dharma robe and his alms bowl, and surrounded by the assembly of monks, with the community of monks before him, went to Ambapālī's grove, the place where she resided. Having arrived, he took his seat on the prepared seat in the midst of the community of monks.

Then Ambapālī, perceiving that the Buddha and the community of monks were comfortably seated, served pure and excellent food and drink with her own hands, satisfying them to the full. In many ways she served and fully satisfied them with pure and excellent food and drink with her own hands.

When the Blessed One had finished eating and had set aside his bowl, Ambapālī took a low seat and sat down in the Blessed One's presence in order to hear the Dharma. Then the Blessed One, rejoicing in Ambapālī's act of generosity, expressed his rejoicing, and

Those who delight in giving are relied upon by others;
they gain a good name, and their renown increases.

Free from miserliness, entering any assembly,
they do not shrink but become fearless.

Therefore the wise who desire happiness
should relinquish the stain of miserliness and practice giving.

Those who have given dwell for a long age of thirty-three
and rejoice in a state equal to that of the gods.

One who gives and acts virtuously, on passing away,
wanders in the grove of delight in their own radiance.

There they play and make merry,
endowed with the many pleasures of sensuous enjoyment.

Having heard the words of the Unbound Protector,
the Sugata's śrāvakas rejoice in the higher realms.

Then the Blessed One, having instructed Ambapālī thoroughly with words rich in Dharma, having established her firmly in them, having praised her, and having fully gladdened her, rose from his seat and departed.

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, let us proceed to the town of Beluva." "As you command, Blessed One," replied the venerable Ānanda, and he complied with the Blessed One's words. Then the Blessed One, leaving that region and touring the land, came to the town of Beluva and stayed in a grove of beluva trees to the north of the town.

Now at that time a severe drought had fallen upon the region, bringing hardship and scarcity of food for the wandering mendicants. Then the Blessed One addressed the monks: "Monks, at present a harsh drought has come upon this region, bringing scarcity of food for the wandering mendicants. Therefore, monks, disperse now among whatever acquaintances, companions, and friends you each have in the vicinity of Vaiśālī, and undertake the rains retreat

there. I myself shall remain here in this very town of Beluva for the rains retreat, attended by the venerable Ānanda, and thus all of you will not go without alms." "As you command, Blessed One," those monks replied, complying with the Blessed One's words, and they dispersed among their various acquaintances, companions, and friends in the vicinity of Vaiśālī, undertaking the rains retreat there. And the Blessed One, attended by the venerable Ānanda, undertook the rains retreat in that very town of Beluva.

During that rains retreat, the Blessed One was struck by a severe, violent, and acute illness bordering on death. Then the Blessed One reflected: "I am afflicted by a severe, violent, and acute illness bordering on death, and the community of monks is dispersed. It would not be right for me to pass into final nirvāṇa while the community of monks is dispersed and without having addressed them. Let me instead, with vigorous effort, hold this feeling in check, attend to no signs whatsoever, and dwell having realized directly in the body the signless meditative absorption of the mind." Then the Blessed One, with vigorous effort, held that very feeling in check, attended to no signs whatsoever, and, having realized directly in the body the signless meditative absorption of the mind, dwelt therein. And thus the Blessed One recovered and regained his health.

Then the venerable Ānanda, rising from meditative composure deep in the night, went to where the Blessed One was, and having prostrated with his head at the Blessed One's feet, sat down to one side. Sitting to one side, the venerable Ānanda addressed the Blessed One in these words:

"Reverend Blessed One, you were struck by a great and grievous illness, fierce and verging on death, and I, reeling from that blow as though dazed by poison, found my body unsteady, my sense of direction confused, and even what I had learned of the Dharma was driven from my mind. Yet one thought gave me some comfort: that the Blessed One would surely not pass into complete nirvāṇa without first delivering even the briefest of final instructions to the community of monks."

"Ānanda, whoever thinks, 'The community of monks is mine; I shall instruct the community of monks; I shall lead the community of monks' — it is such a one who might leave some final instruction for the sake of the community. As for me, Ānanda, I do not think, 'The community of monks is mine; I shall instruct the community of monks; I shall lead the community of monks.' What reason would I have, then, to leave any final instructions at all for the community of

monks? Moreover, Ānanda, what more is there that remains for me with regard to the community of monks? I have already taught the Dharma that is to be practiced unceasingly: the four foundations of mindfulness, the four right exertions, the four bases of miraculous power, the five faculties, the five powers, the seven branches of awakening, and the noble eightfold path. All of these have already been taught.

Ānanda, the Tathāgata does not have the closed fist of a teacher who holds something back, thinking, 'This is something others should not know, so the Tathāgata will conceal it.' Yet, Ānanda, when the Tathāgata was struck by that great and grievous illness, fierce and verging on death, this thought arose in me: 'I am afflicted by a severe and terrible illness, one that touches the very brink of death. The community of monks has also dispersed. When the community of monks is dispersed, it is not fitting for me to pass into complete nirvāṇa. Let me, by vigorous effort, hold that very feeling in check, attend to no signs whatsoever, and, having realized directly in the body the signless meditative absorption of the mind, dwell therein.' And so, by vigorous effort, I held that very feeling in check, attended to no signs whatsoever, and, having realized directly in the body the signless meditative absorption of the mind, dwelt therein. And it was through this that the Tathāgata continued to live and to sustain himself.

Furthermore, Ānanda, the Tathāgata is now eighty years of age, and this body has grown old and worn. Just as a worn-out old cart keeps going by being held together with straps, so too the Tathāgata, now eighty years of age, with this body grown old and worn, keeps going by relying on these two means.

Therefore, Ānanda, do not grieve, do not be troubled, do not lament. For whatever has been born, has come into being, has been made, is conditioned, is compounded, and has been accumulated — being subject to dependent origination, it has the nature of dissolution. That such a thing should not fall apart — this is impossible; there is no such possibility.

Ānanda, whatever I have spoken to you of before — all that is dear and beloved, pleasant and agreeable — all of it is subject to separation, destruction, dissolution, and impermanence.

Therefore, Ānanda, whether now or hereafter, whoever dwells making themselves their own island, their own refuge, making the Dharma their island and the Dharma their refuge, not resorting to any other island or any other refuge — it is they who shall remain. And why is this so? Ānanda, whether now

or hereafter, whoever dwells making themselves their own island, their own refuge, making the Dharma their island and the Dharma their refuge —"

the Dharma as their refuge — not resorting to any other island or any other refuge — they are the very best among all my śrāvaka disciples who desire training.

And how, Ānanda, is it that a monk should dwell making himself his own island, his own refuge, the Dharma his island and the Dharma his refuge, not resorting to any other island or any other refuge?

Here, Ānanda, a monk abides observing the body in the body internally, dwelling with diligence, vigilance, and mindfulness, having abandoned ill-will and discontent with regard to the world. He abides observing the body externally, the body both internally and externally, feelings internally, feelings externally, feelings both internally and externally, mind internally, mind externally, mind both internally and externally, phenomena internally, phenomena externally, and phenomena both internally and externally, dwelling with diligence, vigilance, and mindfulness, having abandoned ill-will and discontent with regard to the world.

It is a monk such as this, Ānanda, who dwells making himself his own island, his own refuge, the Dharma his island and the Dharma his refuge, not resorting to any other island or any other refuge.

The basis of the minor matters of the Vinaya, the fifty-first fascicle.

A summary verse: the rains retreat at the city of Pāṭali, the commissioned work and the Ganges, Koṭigāma and Nāṭikā, Vaiśālī and the Ambapālī Grove.

Then the Blessed One declared to the venerable Ānanda, "Let us go, Ānanda, to the city of Vaiśālī." "So be it, Venerable One," replied the venerable Ānanda, and he listened to the Blessed One. The Blessed One then journeyed through the region of Bṛijī and came to the city of Vaiśālī, where he took up residence near the Monkey Pool in Vaiśālī, at the Kūṭāgāraśālā.

Then in the morning the Blessed One dressed, took his robe and alms-bowl, and entered Vaiśālī for alms, with the monk Ānanda following behind as his attendant. After going for alms, when the meal was done, having declined the invitation for a further meal, he set down his alms-bowl and robe, washed his feet, and proceeded to the Cāpāla Shrine. Having arrived, he settled at the foot of a certain tree to spend the day in repose.

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, Vaiśālī is a delight, and so too the region of Brījī, the Cāpāla Shrine, the seven Āmra trees, the Bahuputraka Shrine, the Gautama Nyagrodha tree, the pair of Sāla trees, the Udena Shrine, the shrine where the Mallas crown their kings, and the many varied beauty-spots of Jambudvīpa — all these are dear to people who cherish life.

Ānanda, whoever has cultivated and repeatedly practised the four bases of supernatural power (ṛddhipāda) could, if they wished, remain for a world-age or for what remains beyond a world-age. The Tathāgata too, Ānanda, having cultivated and repeatedly practised the four bases of supernatural power, could, if he so wished, remain for a world-age or for what remains beyond a world-age."

When this was said, the venerable Ānanda made no reply. A second time and a third time the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Ānanda:

"Ānanda, Vaiśālī is a delight, and so too the region of Brījī, the Cāpāla Shrine, the seven Āmra trees, the Bahuputraka Shrine, the Gautama Nyagrodha tree, the pair of Sāla trees, the Udena Shrine, the shrine where the Mallas crown their kings, and the many varied beauty-spots of Jambudvīpa — all these are dear to people who cherish life.

"Ānanda, whoever has cultivated and repeatedly practiced the four bases of supernatural power may, if he so wishes, remain for a world-age or for what remains beyond a world-age. The Tathāgata, too, has cultivated and repeatedly practiced the four bases of supernatural power; therefore the Tathāgata, if he so wishes, may remain for a world-age or for what remains beyond a world-age." Even though the Blessed One spoke thus a second and a third time, the venerable Ānanda said nothing at all.

Then the Blessed One reflected: "Alas, this monk Ānanda has surely been obscured by Māra the Evil One. That is why, even though I have three times made this great and luminous indication, he has been unable to take the meaning of it to heart." Knowing that Ānanda had been obscured by Māra the Evil One, and in order that neither of the two of them be disturbed, he declared: "Go now and sit for a while near another tree." "As you command, Venerable One," replied the venerable Ānanda, and having heard the Blessed One's words, he went and sat near another tree to spend the day there.

Then Māra the Evil One went to where the Blessed One was. On arriving, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and stood to one side. Standing to

one side, Māra the Evil One addressed the Blessed One: "May the Blessed One now pass fully into nirvāṇa. May the Sugata pass fully into nirvāṇa — the time for passing has come."

The Blessed One reflected: "This is surely Māra the Evil One, who has come here in an emanated body." Knowing this, he said to Māra the Evil One: "Evil Māra, why do you say, 'May the Blessed One now pass fully into nirvāṇa; may the Sugata pass fully into nirvāṇa — the time for passing has come'? Wicked One, not long after I had fully and perfectly awakened on the bank of the Nairāñjanā river at Uruvilā beneath the Awakening Tree, you came to me and said exactly this: 'May the Blessed One pass fully into nirvāṇa; may the Sugata pass fully into nirvāṇa — the time for passing has come.' And at that time the Blessed One replied: 'Evil Māra, I will not pass into nirvāṇa until my śrāvaka disciples — monks, nuns, male laypeople, and female laypeople — have become learned, clear, and endowed with wisdom, capable of refuting opponents' arguments according to the Dharma and the Vinaya, and of thoroughly purifying those who put forward challenges; and until the holy life has been widely proclaimed and spread, greatly beneficial to the many, to gods and humans alike.' But now, Evil One, the Blessed One's śrāvaka disciples — monks, nuns, male laypeople, and female laypeople — have indeed become learned, clear, and endowed with wisdom, capable of refuting opponents' arguments according to the Dharma and the Vinaya, and of thoroughly purifying those who put forward challenges; and you yourself have proclaimed the holy life to be widely spread and greatly beneficial to the many, to gods and humans alike. Therefore I now petition the Blessed One to pass fully into nirvāṇa. May the Sugata pass fully into nirvāṇa — the time for passing has come."

The Blessed One replied: "Do not press so urgently, Evil One. The Tathāgata will not be long — after three months have passed he will pass into nirvāṇa in the element of nirvāṇa with no remainder of the aggregates."

Then Māra the Evil One thought to himself:

Knowing for certain that the ascetic Gautama would pass fully into nirvāṇa, Māra the Evil One was filled with delight and great rejoicing, and in that very instant vanished from sight.

Then the Blessed One reflected to himself: "How might I, with an undistracted mind, perform such a feat of supernatural power as this — by blessing the life-formations and relinquishing the death-formations?" So thinking, the

Blessed One entered into meditative absorption of that kind, and with a mind in equipoise he blessed the life-formations and relinquished the death-formations. The moment the death-formations were relinquished, at that very instant the great earth trembled. Shooting stars fell. Directions blazed. And from the sky the gods beat their drums.

Then the Blessed One arose from that absorption and at that moment proclaimed this verse:

Existence — balanced and unbalanced alike —
the Sage has relinquished all the formations of existence.
Inwardly joyful, abiding in equipoise,
he has burst open his own shell, as a creature breaks forth from its egg.

Then the venerable Ānanda rose from his afternoon sitting meditation, went to where the Blessed One was, and when he had arrived, he bowed with his head to the feet of the Blessed One and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the venerable Ānanda addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, what was the cause, what was the condition, that the great earth trembled?"

"Ānanda, this great earth trembled on account of eight causes and eight conditions. What are those eight? Ānanda, this great earth rests upon water; water rests upon wind; wind rests upon space. Ānanda, at a certain time great winds arise in space. When great winds rise up from space, they stir the water. When the water is stirred, the earth is shaken. Ānanda, this is the first cause and first condition for the trembling of the great earth.

"Furthermore, Ānanda, there may be a monk of great supernatural power and great might who, having blessed the earth with the perception of it as small, applies to the water the perception of it as boundless — and then, should he wish, the earth trembles. Likewise a fully ordained nun, or a god endowed with great supernatural power and great might, who blesses the earth with the perception of it as small and applies to the water the perception of it as boundless — should they wish, the earth trembles. Ānanda, this is the second cause and second condition for the trembling of the great earth.

"Furthermore, Ānanda, at a certain time when a bodhisattva passes away from the assembly of the Tuṣita gods and enters his mother's womb, the great earth trembles most violently. A vast radiance pervades this entire world, outshining by its divine splendour the power and brilliance of the gods, so that even in those dark abysses between worlds and between world-systems — lightless,

pitch-black places where the sun and moon, though possessed of such great supernatural power and might, cannot shed their light separately — even there at that time a great radiance appears. The beings born in those places, who cannot see even their own hand held before them, become aware: 'Other beings too have been born here! Other beings too have been born here!' Ānanda, this is the third cause and third condition for the trembling of the great earth.

"Furthermore, Ānanda, at a certain time when that bodhisattva issues forth from his mother's womb, the great earth also trembles most violently" — and from there the account continues as before, up to and including the awareness: "Other beings too have been born here! Other beings too have been born here!" — "Ānanda, this is the fourth cause and fourth condition for the trembling of the great earth."

"Furthermore, Ānanda, at a certain time when the bodhisattva fully and completely awakens to unsurpassed, perfect awakening, the great earth also trembles most violently" — and from there the account continues as before, up to and including the awareness: "Other beings too have been born here! Other beings too have been born here!" — "Ānanda, this is the fifth cause and fifth condition for the trembling of the great earth."

"Furthermore, Ānanda, at a certain time when the Tathāgata turns the wheel of Dharma in its twelve aspects and three rounds, the great earth also trembles most violently" — and from there the account continues as before, up to and including the awareness: "Other beings too have been born here! Other beings too have been born here!" — "Ānanda, this is the sixth cause and sixth condition for the trembling of the great earth."

"Furthermore, Ānanda, at a certain time when the Tathāgata intentionally reinforces the life-sustaining formations and relinquishes the will-to-live, at that moment the great earth trembles most violently, meteors fall, fires blaze in every direction, and the gods in the sky beat their drums. Ānanda, this is the seventh cause and seventh condition for the trembling of the great earth."

"Furthermore, Ānanda, before long — when three months have elapsed and the Tathāgata passes into the nirvāṇa-element that is without remainder of the aggregates — at that moment the great earth trembles most violently, meteors fall, fires blaze in every direction, and the gods in the sky beat their drums. Ānanda, this is the eighth cause and eighth condition for the trembling of the great earth."

Then the venerable Ānanda said to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, having understood the meaning of what you have declared, I ask whether, just now, the Blessed One has indeed reinforced the life-sustaining formations and relinquished the will-to-live." The Blessed One replied: "Ānanda, it is exactly so. It is exactly so, Ānanda. Just now the Tathāgata has reinforced the life-sustaining formations and relinquished the will-to-live."

Then the venerable Ānanda said: "Venerable one, I heard directly from the Blessed One and received it directly from him that whoever cultivates and develops the four bases of miraculous power assiduously could, if he wished, remain for a kalpa or beyond a kalpa. Venerable Blessed One, since you have cultivated and developed the four bases of miraculous power assiduously, if the Blessed One so wishes, he could remain for a kalpa or beyond a kalpa. May the Blessed One remain for a kalpa! May the Sugata remain for a kalpa!"

The Blessed One replied: "Ānanda, the fault is yours. Ānanda, you have committed a fault. For when I gave you the broad and clear indication three times, you could not grasp its meaning — so thoroughly had the māra of evil overcome you. Ānanda, what do you think: would the Tathāgata ever speak words that would later prove otherwise? — "No, venerable one." — "Excellent! Excellent! Ānanda, there is no basis, no occasion, for the Tathāgata to speak words that would prove otherwise. That is simply impossible."

Then the Blessed One declared to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, go and gather together in one place all the monks who are staying and dwelling at the Cāpāla Shrine." "Venerable one, so be it," said the venerable Ānanda, and having received this instruction from the Blessed One, he gathered together in one place all the monks who were staying and dwelling at the Cāpāla Shrine. He then went to where the Blessed One was, and having bowed with his head to the Blessed One's feet, he sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the venerable Ānanda said to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, if you consider that the time has now come —"

"All the monks who are staying and dwelling at the Cāpāla Shrine have been gathered together in one place," he reported. Then the Blessed One went to where that gathered assembly was, and upon a seat that had been laid out before the community of monks, he sat down. Having sat down, the Blessed One spoke to the monks:

"Monks, all conditioned things are impermanent, unstable, subject to change. Monks, it is fitting to grow weary of all conditioned things, to become

disenchanted with them — they are proper objects of liberation. Therefore, monks, whatever Dharma teachings are beneficial in this present life, bring happiness in this present life, are beneficial in future lives, and will bring happiness in future lives — such teachings, monks, should be taken up, fully mastered, and in just that way upheld, practiced, and recited. Let this holy life (brahmacarya) abide here for a long time, for the benefit and happiness of the many, out of compassion for the world, for the sake, benefit, and happiness of gods and human beings.

"And what, monks, are the Dharma teachings that are beneficial in this present life, bring happiness in this present life, are beneficial in future lives, and will bring happiness in future lives? They are those which the monks have taken up and fully mastered, upheld in just that way, practiced, and recited — and through which this holy life will abide for a long time, bringing benefit to the many, happiness to the many, and compassion for the world. They are these: the four foundations of mindfulness, the four right abandonings, the four bases of miraculous power, the five faculties, the five powers, the seven limbs of awakening, and the noble eightfold path. Monks, these Dharma teachings are beneficial in this present life, bring happiness in this present life, are beneficial in future lives, and will bring happiness in future lives. These, monks, are to be taken up, fully mastered, and in just that way upheld, practiced, and recited. Let this holy life abide here for a long time — for the benefit of the many, the happiness of the many, out of compassion for the world, for the sake, benefit, and happiness of gods and human beings."

Then the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, let us go to Kuśinagara." "Venerable one, so be it," said the venerable Ānanda, and he received the Blessed One's instruction.

Then the Blessed One, departing from the grove of Vaiśālī, turned his entire body to the right and gazed back as an elephant looks back. And the venerable Ānanda saw the Blessed One turn his entire body to the right and gaze back as an elephant looks back. Having seen this, he said to the Blessed One: "Venerable one, without cause, without condition, a Tathāgata, a perfectly and fully awakened buddha, does not turn his entire body to the right and gaze back as an elephant gazes. What then is the cause, what is the condition, for this gaze like that of an elephant?"

"Ānanda, it is so. It is so, Ānanda — without cause, without condition, a Tathāgata, a perfectly and fully awakened buddha, does not turn his entire

body to the right and gaze back as an elephant gazes. Ānanda, this is the last time the Tathāgata, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, looks upon this city of Vaiśālī."

The Tathāgata would not come to Vaiśālī again. He departed thence toward the twin śāla trees in the grove near the Malla territory, in order to pass into nirvāṇa.

Then another monk, at that very moment, spoke these words in verse:

O Sage, this is the last time
you have looked upon Vaiśālī.
The perfectly and fully awakened buddha
shall return to Vaiśālī no more.
Near the territory of the Mallas,
by the twin śāla trees,
today he departs to pass beyond sorrow.

Then the Blessed One traveled through the land of Bṛijī, passing through village after village, and came to the village of Ruṭa. There, in the śāpa tree grove to the north of that village, he took up residence.

There the Blessed One declared to the monks: "This is moral discipline. This is meditative absorption. This is wisdom. When moral discipline is thoroughly cultivated, meditative absorption will long endure. When meditative absorption long endures, wisdom will be thoroughly cultivated. When wisdom is thoroughly cultivated, it is like this: the mind becomes fully liberated from attachment, from aversion, and from delusion. Just so, monks, those noble śrāvakas who possess minds that are completely and utterly liberated know directly: 'My birth is exhausted. The holy life has been lived. What had to be done has been done. There is no further existence beyond this.'"

In summary in verse:

Ruṭa, Dumpa, Āmra,
Jambu, Śurva, Balaglaṇ,
the two towns Bṛijī and Mallā —
such too is the prosperous city.

Just as Ruṭa village, so too the village of Dumpa, the village of Āmra, the village of Jambu, the village of Jī, the village of Śurva, the village of Balaglaṇ, the village of Bṛijī, and the village of Mallā — from each of these he journeyed onward to the prosperous city, and from the prosperous city he took up

residence in the śāpa tree grove to the north of the city.

At that time the great earth trembled. Shooting stars fell. In all directions there were flashes of light. And in the sky the gods beat their drums.

Then the venerable Ānanda rose from his afternoon meditation, went to where the Blessed One was, and having placed his head at the feet of the Blessed One in prostration, sat down to one side.

Sitting to one side, the venerable Ānanda addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Venerable one, what is the cause, what is the condition, for this trembling of the great earth?"

"Ānanda, there are three causes and three conditions for the trembling of the great earth. What are the three? Ānanda, the great earth rests upon water; water rests upon wind; wind rests upon space. Ānanda, there comes a time when a great wind rises from space. When a great wind rises from space, the water is set in motion. When the water is set in motion, the earth trembles. Ānanda, this is the first cause and condition for the trembling of the earth.

"Furthermore, Ānanda, a monk who has become of great power and great supernatural ability — such a one, making the perception of earth small and suffusing the perception of water boundlessly, can, if he wishes, cause the earth to tremble. A nun or even a deity who has become of great supernatural ability and great power — such a one likewise, making the perception of earth small and suffusing the perception of water boundlessly, can, if he or she so wishes, cause the earth to tremble. Ānanda, this is the second cause and the second condition for the trembling of the earth.

"Furthermore, Ānanda, when before long a Tathāgata is about to pass completely beyond sorrow into the realm of nirvāṇa — the nirvāṇa without remainder — at that time the great earth will tremble violently. Shooting stars will fall. In all directions there will be flashes of light. And from the sky the gods will beat their drums. Ānanda, this is the third cause and the third condition for the trembling of the great earth."

Then the venerable Ānanda said to the Blessed One: "Venerable one, how wondrous!"

"Such, then, are the wondrous and marvellous qualities that belong to the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas. And so it is: before long the Tathāgata will pass completely beyond sorrow into the realm of nirvāṇa — the nirvāṇa without remainder — and at that time the

great earth will tremble violently, shooting stars will fall, there will be flashes of light in all directions, and from the sky the gods will beat their drums. So it is, Ānanda. Thus, such great wondrous and marvellous qualities belong to the Tathāgatas, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas.

"Ānanda, I will go to visit the many hundreds of retinues of the warrior class. Having gone, just as their dominion and majesty are such, so too shall my dominion and majesty become the same. Just as their complexion is beautiful, so too shall my complexion be beautiful in the same way. Just as the sound of their voices resounds, so too shall the sound of my voice resound in the same way. Whatever meaning they speak to, I too shall speak to that meaning. Whatever they do not speak to, I too shall not speak to that. And beyond that, I shall teach them the discourse of Dharma properly, urge them properly, praise them properly, and gladden them fully — and then vanish from that very spot. And when I have vanished, I shall directly know whether whoever is present there, whether god or human, is without a trace of conceit.

"Just as I shall do with the retinue of the warrior class, so likewise shall I do with the retinue of the brahmin class, with the retinue of the householders, with the retinue of monks, with the assembly of the Four Great Kings, with the gods of the Thirty-Three, with those of Yāma, with those of Tuṣṭita, with those of Nirmāṇarati, with those of Paranirmitavaśavartin, with those of the Brahma class, with the gods of Brahma's retinue, with those of the Universal Brahma, with the Great Brahma, with those of Minor Radiance, with those of Immeasurable Radiance, with those of Resplendent Light, with those of Minor Virtue, with those of Immeasurable Virtue, with those of Pervasive Virtue, with those of Cloudless, with those of Merit-Increasing, with those of Great Fruit, with those of Not-Great, with those of Non-Afflicted, with those of Great Perception, with those of Sublime Vision, and with the gods of Akaniṣṭha. Having gone to each of them, just as their dominion and majesty are such, so too shall my dominion and majesty become the same. Just as their complexion is beautiful, so too shall my complexion be beautiful in the same way. Just as the sound of their voices resounds, so too shall the sound of my voice resound in the same way. Whatever meaning they speak to, I too shall speak to that meaning. Whatever they do not speak to, I too shall not speak to that. And beyond that, I shall teach them the discourse of Dharma properly, urge them properly, praise them properly, and gladden them fully — and then vanish from that very spot. And when I have vanished, I shall directly know whether whoever is present there, whether god or human, is without a trace of conceit.

"Such are the wondrous and marvellous qualities of the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha."

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda: "Therefore, Ānanda, from now on one should engage with the limits of the sūtras rather than engaging with the person. Ānanda, how is it that monks engage with the limits of the sūtras rather than with the person? Here, Ānanda, a monk comes and says the following: 'I heard this directly from the Blessed One and received it directly — this is Dharma, this is Vinaya, this is what the Teacher taught.' That monk's words should neither be praised nor disparaged. Without praising or disparaging, one should listen carefully, take up the words and letters of the Dharma, and check them against the sūtras.

One should also properly examine it against the Vinaya. When it is checked against the sūtras and the Vinaya, if it is discordant with the sūtras, does not appear in the Vinaya, and furthermore contradicts the nature of reality, then say this to that monk: 'Venerable one, the Blessed One did not teach this Dharma in that way. It is a mistake, venerable one, to take up this Dharma as your own. Therefore, since this Dharma, when checked against the sūtras and properly examined against the Vinaya, is discordant with the sūtras, does not appear in the Vinaya, and contradicts the nature of reality, know it to be not Dharma, not Vinaya, not what the Teacher taught, and set it aside.'

Furthermore, Ānanda, another monk comes and says the following: 'Venerable one, in a certain great monastery there reside elder monks who hold the Prātimokṣa, and a large community of monks dwells there. Venerable one, I heard this directly and received it directly from that large community of monks: this is Dharma, this is Vinaya, this is what the Teacher taught.' That monk's words should neither be praised nor disparaged. Without praising or disparaging, one should listen carefully, take up the words and letters of the Dharma, check them against the sūtras, and properly examine them against the Vinaya. If, when checked against the sūtras and examined against the Vinaya, it is discordant with the sūtras, does not appear in the Vinaya, and contradicts the nature of reality, then say this to that monk: 'Venerable one, that large community of monks perceives this as Dharma and perceives it as Vinaya; but if what they have declared is not Dharma and not Vinaya, then, venerable one, it is a mistake to take up this Dharma as your own. Since this Dharma, when checked against the sūtras and properly examined against the Vinaya, is discordant with the sūtras, does not appear in the Vinaya, and contradicts the nature of reality, know it to be not Dharma, not Vinaya, not

what the Teacher taught, and set it aside.'

Furthermore, Ānanda, another monk comes and says the following: 'Venerable one, in a certain great monastery there dwell many monks — monks who hold the sūtras, monks who hold the Vinaya, and monks who hold the Māṭṛkā. Venerable one, I heard this directly and received it directly from those many monks: this is Dharma, this is Vinaya, this is what the Teacher taught.' That monk's words should neither be praised nor disparaged. Without praising or disparaging, one should listen carefully, take up the words and letters of the Dharma, check them against the sūtras, and properly examine them against the Vinaya. If, when checked against the sūtras and the Vinaya, it is discordant with the sūtras, does not appear in the Vinaya, and contradicts the nature of reality, then say this to that monk: 'Venerable one, those many monks perceive this as Dharma and perceive it as Vinaya; but if what they have declared is not Dharma and not Vinaya, then, venerable one, it is a mistake to take up this Dharma as your own. Since this Dharma, when checked against the sūtras and properly examined against the Vinaya, is discordant with the sūtras, does not appear in the Vinaya, and contradicts the nature of reality, know it to be not Dharma, not Vinaya, not what the Teacher taught, and set it aside.'

Furthermore, Ānanda, another monk comes and says the following: 'Venerable one, in a certain great monastery there dwell elder monks, those who learned from the elders, those who learned from them in turn, and others of principal standing. Venerable one, I heard this directly and received it directly from those elder monks: this is Dharma, this is Vinaya, this is what the Teacher taught.'

Do not praise or disparage what that monk has said. Without praising or disparaging it, lend an ear, take hold of the words and syllables of the Dharma, and examine them against the sūtras and check them properly against the Vinaya. If, upon being examined against the sūtras and properly checked against the Vinaya, they are discordant with the sūtras, do not appear in the Vinaya, and are contradicted by the nature of reality, then say this to that monk: 'Venerable one, that elder monk has understood this as Dharma and understood it as Vinaya; but if you speak of what is not Dharma and not Vinaya, then it is wrong for the venerable one himself to take hold of this teaching.' Say further: 'Since this teaching, when examined against the sūtras and properly checked against the Vinaya, is discordant with the sūtras, does not appear in the Vinaya, and contradicts the nature of reality, know it to be

not Dharma, not Vinaya, not what the Teacher taught, and set it aside.'

Furthermore, Ānanda, a monk comes and says the following: 'Venerable one, I heard this directly and received it directly from the Blessed One himself: this is Dharma, this is Vinaya, this is what the Teacher taught.' Do not praise or disparage what that monk has said. Without praising or disparaging it, lend an ear, take hold of the words and syllables of the Dharma, and examine them against the sūtras and check them properly against the Vinaya. If, upon being examined against the sūtras and properly checked against the Vinaya, they are concordant with the sūtras, do appear in the Vinaya, and are not contradicted by the nature of reality, then say this to that monk: 'Venerable one, this teaching was indeed spoken by the Blessed One, and the venerable one himself has taken hold of it well. Since this teaching, when examined against the sūtras and properly checked against the Vinaya, is concordant with the sūtras, appears in the Vinaya, and is not contradicted by the nature of reality, know it to be Dharma, know it to be Vinaya, know it to be what the Teacher taught, and hold it fast.'

Furthermore, Ānanda, another monk comes and says the following: 'Venerable one, in a certain great monastery there dwell elders, along with a great community of monks possessing individual liberation. I heard this directly and received it directly from that great community of monks: this is Dharma, this is Vinaya, this is what the Teacher taught.' Do not praise or disparage what that monk has said. Without praising or disparaging it, lend an ear, take hold of the words and syllables of the Dharma, examine them against the sūtras, and check them properly against the Vinaya. If, upon being examined against the sūtras and properly checked against the Vinaya, they are concordant with the sūtras, do appear in the Vinaya, and are not contradicted by the nature of reality, then say this to that monk: 'Venerable one, that great community of monks has spoken thus as Dharma and Vinaya, and the venerable one too has taken hold of this teaching well. Since this teaching, when examined against the sūtras and properly checked against the Vinaya, is concordant with the sūtras, appears in the Vinaya, and is not contradicted by the nature of reality, know it to be Dharma, know it to be Vinaya, know it to be what the Teacher taught, and hold it fast.'

Furthermore, Ānanda, another monk comes and says the following: 'Venerable one, in a certain great monastery there dwell many monks — monks who uphold the sūtras, monks who uphold the Vinaya, and monks who uphold the Māṭṛkā. I have received directly from those many monks this: this is Dharma,

this is Vinaya, this is what the Teacher taught.' Do not praise or disparage what that monk has said. Without praising or disparaging it,

listen with open ears. Take up the words and letters of the Dharma, compare them with the sūtras, and examine them carefully against the Vinaya. If, upon comparison with the sūtras and careful examination against the Vinaya, they accord with the sūtras, appear consistent with the Vinaya, and are not contradicted by the nature of reality, then say this to that monk: 'Venerable one, those many monks have indeed taught the Dharma and the Vinaya, and the venerable one has received these teachings well. Therefore, since these teachings, when compared with the sūtras and carefully examined against the Vinaya, accord with the sūtras, appear consistent with the Vinaya, and are not contradicted by the nature of reality, know them to be Dharma, know them to be Vinaya, know them to be what the Teacher taught, and hold them fast.'

Furthermore, Ānanda, another monk comes and says the following: 'Venerable one, in a certain place there dwell monks — elder monks, other elder monks, senior monks, and other senior monks. I have received directly from those elder monks of that monastic community this: this is Dharma, this is Vinaya, this is what the Teacher taught.' Do not praise or disparage what that monk has said. Without praising or disparaging it, listen with open ears. Take up the words and letters of the Dharma, compare them with the sūtras, and examine them carefully against the Vinaya. If, upon comparison with the sūtras and careful examination against the Vinaya, they accord with the sūtras, appear consistent with the Vinaya, and are not contradicted by the nature of reality, then say this to that monk: 'Venerable one, those elder monks of that monastic community have indeed taught the Dharma and the Vinaya, and the venerable one has received these teachings well. Therefore, since these teachings, when compared with the sūtras and carefully examined against the Vinaya, accord with the sūtras, appear consistent with the Vinaya, and are not contradicted by the nature of reality, know them to be Dharma, know them to be Vinaya, know them to be what the Teacher taught, and hold them fast.'

Now, Ānanda, as for whichever of the first four great declarations was spoken on the side of the dark — that is, on the side of what is not Dharma — the monks, having applied their wholesome faculties and examined it carefully, shall know it to be not Dharma, not Vinaya, not what the Teacher taught, and cast it aside. As for whichever of the latter four great declarations was spoken on the side of the bright — that is, on the side of what is Dharma — the monks, having applied their wholesome faculties and examined it carefully, shall know

it to be Dharma, Vinaya, what the Teacher taught, and hold it fast. Thus, Ānanda, monks are to rely upon the sūtras and not upon persons.

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda: 'Ānanda, let us travel to the town of Sāpa.' 'So be it, Blessed One,' replied the venerable Ānanda upon hearing the Blessed One's words. And so the Blessed One set out from Mallā on a journey through the region and came to the town of Sāpa, where he took up residence in a great Jālikā grove near the town of Sāpa.

When the Mallās of Sāpa heard that the Blessed One had set out from Mallā on a journey through the region and had come to the town of Sāpa, taking up residence in the great Jālikā grove of Sāpa, they gathered together from their assemblies, assembled from their congregations, and, coming out from the town of Sāpa, proceeded to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, they bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet, did reverence, and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the Blessed One taught them the Dharma in full, urged them in full, praised them in full, and gladdened them fully. And at that very time, the smith's son Cunda was also gathered there in that very retinue, seated among them.

Then the Blessed One taught the Mallians of Sāpa the Dharma by means of many categories of teaching, urged them in full, praised them in full, and gladdened them fully, and then fell silent. The Mallians of Sāpa, delighted and rejoicing in what the Blessed One had said, bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet and departed from his presence. The smith's son Cunda had also been seated there all along. Then, not long after the Mallians of Sāpa had departed, the smith's son Cunda rose from his seat, arranged his robe over one shoulder, turned toward the Blessed One, joined his palms together, bowed in reverence, and addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, may it please you to come tomorrow to my dwelling with the Saṅgha of monks, for your midday meal." The Blessed One said nothing in reply to the smith's son Cunda, and by that silence he consented. The smith's son Cunda, understanding from the Blessed One's silence that consent had been given, delighted and rejoicing in what the Blessed One had said, bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and departed from his presence.

That very evening, the smith's son Cunda prepared excellent food with good rice, made ready fine dishes of food, and gathered together pure and choice food and accompaniments for the Saṅgha of monks. The next morning he rose early, spread out seats, set out water vessels, and then sent word to the

Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, the preparation for the meal is complete. Please know that the midday hour is now upon us." Then the Blessed One, in the early morning, dressed in his robes and lower garment, took up his alms bowl, and, surrounded by many monks, went forth at the head of the Saṅgha of monks to the dwelling of the smith's son Cunda. Having arrived, he sat down on the seat placed before the Saṅgha of monks.

Then the smith's son Cunda, knowing that the Buddha and the Saṅgha of monks were comfortably seated, served the Blessed One with excellent food, well prepared and placed in an iron vessel, with his own hand, offering and distributing it. He also served the Saṅgha of monks, with his own hand offering and distributing pure and choice food and accompaniments. At that time, another wicked monk seized an iron vessel and tucked it under his arm. The Blessed One saw that wicked monk, and through the power of the Buddha, the smith's son Cunda saw him too. Then the smith's son Cunda, having well prepared excellent food in many bowls, served it with his own hands, offering and distributing it. He also served the Saṅgha of monks, with his own hands offering and distributing pure and choice food and accompaniments. Knowing that the Blessed One had finished eating, he offered water for washing the hands. Then, taking up his alms bowl, he took a low seat and sat before the Blessed One, and addressed the Blessed One with a request in verse:

To the Sage of vast knowledge I address my petition.
You who have crossed over, gone to the far shore, who have crossed beyond
all doubt,
supreme helmsman, most excellent guide —
please declare that there are many true ascetics in the world.

There are four kinds of ascetic; there is no fifth.
Knowing this, I declare it to you.
The victor of the path, the teacher of the path,
the one who lives by the path, and the one who corrupts the path —
what did the Buddha say of the victor of the path?
How is the one who teaches the path said to be without equal?
I ask you: please speak of the one who lives by the path,
and speak to me too of the one who corrupts the path.

The one who cuts off the speech of doubt, freed from affliction,
not led astray by others, rejoicing in the passing beyond sorrow,
teacher of the world together with its gods —

that one, it is said, the Buddha calls the victor of the path.

The one who has thoroughly and supremely understood...

...who has thoroughly and supremely understood the Dharma the Buddha proclaimed in just the same way — that one is said to be the sage who cuts off doubt, not led astray by others, not of two minds. By means of austerity, that one is said to be the teacher of the path.

The one who teaches the words of the Dharma well, who lives by the path, who is the master of austerity and mindfulness, and who trains in blameless speech — these three things are said, through austerity, to be how one lives by the path.

One who harbors pleasure in excellence while concealing it inwardly, who is utterly desiccated, who disgraces the clan and claims to be a victor, who is deceitful, without restraint, and yet a great proclaimer, whose conduct is improper — that one corrupts the path.

Whatever householder reflects carefully, and who is possessed of learning and is thoroughly known by noble śrāvakas — all who truly understand will not become like that. Knowing such a one, their faith in him will not grow.

How can one treat as equal the discordant and the harmonious, the pure and the impure? When one person has done evil deeds, even those who do no evil become suspect among beings. One should not judge a person by complexion and form; one whose breeding is low, the moment one sees him the mind cannot rely on him. One who is utterly without restraint, full of many outward signs of virtue, and yet incapable — such a one moves through this world. Like an earring coated with gold, like a pin of iron coated with gold — inwardly full of aversion, outwardly bearing the appearance of a noble one: some who are possessed of deceit move through this world in just this way.

Then the Blessed One expressed his rejoicing in the gift of the smith's son Cunda with these words of rejoicing:

When one gives, merit increases greatly.

Through right restraint, no resentment grows.

One of virtue abandons evil deeds.

When afflictions are exhausted, one passes beyond sorrow.

Then the Blessed One taught Dharma to the smith's son Cunda, exhorted him rightly, praised him rightly, and filled him with joy rightly; and having exhorted

him, praised him, and filled him with joy rightly by means of Dharma in many ways, he rose from his seat and departed.

Here ends the fifty-second section of the Vinaya of minor matters.

Summary verse: He performed the formations of Cāpāla and of life; he gazed upon the Great Elephant; and the ten towns including Rurutā and the rest; the stirred sūtras; and the sinful one.

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, let us go to the town of Kushinagar." The venerable Ānanda replied, "As the Reverend One commands," and listened to the Blessed One. Then, as the Blessed One was passing through the district of the Mallas, from the sinful one as far as the river Kakuṭṭhā, the Blessed One, having gone ahead, turned back from the way and spoke to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, my back is uncomfortable. Let me rest. Fold the Tathāgata's outer robe into four layers and spread it out."

"As the Reverend One commands," said the venerable Ānanda, and following the Blessed One's instruction, he folded the outer robe carefully into four layers, spread it out, and laid it down. Then he said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, the Tathāgata's outer robe has been folded into four layers and laid out. May the Blessed One now consider that the time has come."

Then the Blessed One made many folds of his patched garment and placed it beneath him. Lying down on his right side, placing his feet one upon the other, he cultivated in his mind the perception of light, mindfulness, vigilance, and the intention to rise, and he rested.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, go and bring a bowlful of water from the river Kakuṭṭhā. I will drink it and pour it over my body." "As the Reverend One commands," said the venerable Ānanda, and following the Blessed One's instruction he took his bowl and went toward the river Kakuṭṭhā. At that time, the river Kakuṭṭhā had been crossed by a distance of about five hundred carts, and not long after...

they had stirred up the river, churned it, and made it turbid. Then the venerable Ānanda took a bowlful of water from the river Kakuṭṭhā and went to where the Blessed One was. Arriving there, he said to the Blessed One: "Reverend One, not long ago, a distance of about five hundred carts across, those carts had crossed the river Kakuṭṭhā and stirred it, churned it, and made it turbid. Reverend One, let the Blessed One rinse his mouth and wash his feet with this water. Not far from here, Reverend One, there is the river Kakuddhā.

Let the Blessed One drink from it and pour it over his body as well."

Then the Blessed One rinsed his feet and washed his mouth with the water from the bowl. And thereupon the Blessed One found relief and ease. Then the Blessed One rose, sat cross-legged, held his body upright, and remained seated with mindfulness clearly established.

Now at that very time, a wandering ascetic belonging to the great Mallian clan had entered upon that same road. And this wandering ascetic of the great Mallian clan saw the Blessed One — beautiful, inspiring faith, his faculties serene, his mind at peace, supremely tamed and perfectly tranquil, blazing with splendor like a golden pillar — seated, leaning against the trunk of another tree. Seeing him, he went toward the Blessed One, and arriving there, he prostrated with his head at the feet of the Blessed One and sat to one side.

As he sat to one side, the Blessed One said to the wandering ascetic of the great Mallian clan: "Wandering ascetic, which purity of conduct — that of a śramaṇa or that of a brahmin — do you delight in?"

"Reverend One, I am the son of Silāyin the Magician, I travel far through the air, and it is in purity of conduct that I delight."

"Wandering ascetic, why is it that you, the son of Silāyin the Magician, who travel far through the air, delight in purity of conduct?"

"Reverend One, on one occasion, while I had set out traveling far through the air on the path of Silāyin the Magician, I turned aside from the road and remained by the trunk of another tree, spending the day in the practice of one who rests. At that very time, on that same road, a distance of about five hundred carts had also passed, not long before. Then another man, who had been left behind on account of those carts, came to where I, the son of Silāyin the Magician, was, and said to me: 'Did you not see the passage of a distance of about five hundred carts?' 'Friend, I did not see them.' 'Did you not even hear the sound of about five hundred carts passing?' 'Friend, I did not hear them.' 'Have you been asleep?' 'Friend, I was not asleep.' 'Then with the perception of one not asleep, did you fail to hear the sound of about five hundred carts passing?' 'Friend, with the perception of one not asleep, I indeed did not hear the sound of about five hundred carts passing.'

Then that man thought to himself: 'Remarkable — a renunciant who dwells in peace, who with the perception of one not asleep has not even heard the sound of about five hundred carts passing, and whose robes he could see were

covered in a fine dust.' That man was filled with wonder and, having placed his faith in me, the son of Silāyin the Magician, he became devoted. Reverend One, that is why I delight in the conduct of purity that belongs to Silāyin the Magician, who travels far through the air."

"Wandering ascetic, what do you think? Which sound is greater — the sound of about five hundred carts passing, or the sound they call a thunderclap, or the sound of a thunderbolt that has fallen? Which of these two is the greater?"

"Reverend One, what is there to say? Setting aside five hundred carts, even a thousand carts, even a hundred thousand carts — none of them approaches what is called a thunderclap,

the sound of a thunderbolt that has fallen is the greater."

"Wandering ascetic, at one time I was dwelling in the courtyard of the spirit-house in the town of Ātumā. In the morning I dressed in my under-robe and outer robe, took my alms-bowl and robes, and went into the town of Ātumā to gather alms. Having gathered alms through the town of Ātumā and completed the meal, I set aside the alms of the subsequent meal, put away my bowl and robes, washed my feet, entered the courtyard of the spirit-house, and sat down within, composing myself in inner stillness.

"Now at that very time, in the town of Ātumā, what is called a great clap of thunder rang out, a thunderbolt fell, four oxen died, and two brothers, householders and farmers, died as well. As a result, many people in the town of Ātumā began crying out with a great din and much noise. I too rose from my inner stillness and composure at evening, came out from the courtyard of the spirit-house, and was walking back and forth in a place sheltered from the shadow of the spirit-house, without cover, when another man came toward me from among that crowd of people, approached me, prostrated with his head at my two feet, and walked along after me as I walked.

"I said to him: 'Good man, why is it that many people in the town of Ātumā are crying out with this great din and so much noise?'

"He said: 'Reverend One, it is thus: in the town of Ātumā there was what is called a great clap of thunder, a thunderbolt fell, four oxen died, and two brothers, householders and farmers, died. That is why the many people of the town of Ātumā have been crying out with a great din and much noise.' Then he said: 'Blessed One, did you not hear what is called the great clap of thunder and the thunderbolt that fell?'

"I said to him: 'Good man, I did not hear it.'

"He said: 'What then, Blessed One — were you asleep?'

"I said: 'Good man, I was not asleep.'

"He said: 'Then, Blessed One, could it be that you did not hear the thunder-clap and the falling thunderbolt because you had the perception of one who is asleep?'

"I said: 'Good man, I did not hear what is called the thunderclap and the thunderbolt that fell, yet I had the perception of one who is not asleep.'

"Then that man thought to himself: 'How remarkable it is that the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened Buddha, remained so peacefully still that, with the perception of one who is not asleep, he did not hear the sound of the thunderclap and the thunderbolt that fell.' And so that man came to have faith in me, and, moved by that faith, he said: 'Reverend One, who could fail to have faith in the Blessed One? As for myself, I have deep and extensive faith in the Reverend Blessed One.'

"Thereupon the wandering ascetic belonging to the great Gyad clan said to his attendant: 'Good man, give me a pair of fine bleached cloth, yellow as the color of gold, and I shall offer it to the Blessed One.' And that man gave to the wandering ascetic belonging to the great Gyad clan a pair of fine bleached cloth, yellow as the color of gold.

"Then the wandering ascetic belonging to the great Gyad clan took that pair of fine bleached cloth, yellow as the color of gold, and addressed the Blessed One thus: 'Blessed One, out of compassion please accept this pair of fine bleached cloth, yellow as the color of gold — it is something that brings us joy and gladness, something worthy to be cherished.' The Blessed One, looking with compassion upon the wandering ascetic belonging to the great Gyad clan, accepted the pair of fine bleached cloth, yellow as the color of gold."

Then the wandering ascetic belonging to the great Gyad clan, Gyungpo, addressed the Blessed One thus: "I would furthermore, Venerable Blessed One, render service to the Blessed One and to the Saṅgha of monks." And the Blessed One declared, "Gyungpo, this is said well."

Then Gyungpo, belonging to the great Gyad clan, was filled with delight and joy at what the Blessed One had said, bowed his head to the two feet of the Blessed One, and departed from the presence of the Blessed One.

Not long after Gyungpo of the great Gyad clan had departed, the Blessed One, knowing this, addressed the venerable Ānanda thus: "Ānanda, give me that pair of fine bleached cloth, yellow as the color of gold, trimmed and cut at the edges — I will divide it."

The venerable Ānanda, cutting the pair of fine bleached cloth, yellow as the color of gold, along the edge of its hem, offered it to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One received it. The radiant color of the Blessed One's body shone with an equal brilliance.

Then the venerable Ānanda said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable one, I have been in attendance at the feet of the Blessed One for more than twenty years, yet never before have I witnessed such a radiance as this arising in the body of the Blessed One. Venerable one, by what cause and by what condition has such a radiance arisen in the body?"

"Ānanda, a radiance such as this arises from two causes and two conditions. What are the two? The night on which a bodhisattva fully awakens to the unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening — and the night on which a Tathāgata passes utterly into nirvāṇa in the element of nirvāṇa that is without remainder of the aggregates. This is the second cause and the second condition for the arising of such a radiance in the body."

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda, "Ānanda, go to the river Kakudhā." "As you command," said the venerable Ānanda, and he complied with the Blessed One's word.

Then the Blessed One went to the river Kakudhā, and arriving at one bank of the river Kakudhā, he set down his outer robe and Dharma robe and remained there. He then entered the river Kakudhā, bathed well, crossed the river Kakudhā, and remained with only his inner robe and Dharma robe, his body refreshed.

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, the smith's son Cunda has given rise to remorse. Others have aroused remorse in him, saying: 'You have not obtained good fortune — you have obtained misfortune — you have not obtained happiness,' because the Teacher passed into nirvāṇa in the element without remainder of the aggregates after accepting Cunda the smith's son's final meal offering. Ānanda, you should dispel the remorse that has arisen in Cunda the smith's son by means of two points. Say to him: 'Cunda, I heard directly from the Blessed One and received it directly from him, that the karmic maturation of a meal offering is equal and unequalled in

two respects: the meal after receiving which a bodhisattva fully awakens to the unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening, and the meal after receiving which a Tathāgata passes into nirvāṇa in the element without remainder of the aggregates. These two are the equal and unequalled karmic maturations of a meal offering."

"Therefore, Ānanda, this is karma that has been done and accumulated by Cunda the smith's son — karma that will ripen as long life, as beautiful complexion, as strength, as prosperity, as fortunate rebirth, and as wealth together with a retinue."

The summary verse reads:

Long life, complexion, strength,
prosperity, fortunate rebirth, and wealth —

Then the venerable Ānanda addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Venerable One, this monk Sunakkhatta is fierce, shameless, insolent, angry, and constantly abusive toward us monks. After you have passed away, how shall we deal with him?"

The Blessed One replied: "Ānanda, after my passing, that monk Sunakkhatta is to be censured by brahmic penalty. Having censured him with brahmic penalty, he should be made to feel ashamed. And once that complete sense of shame has arisen in him, he is to be placed under the guidance of Kātyāyana."

Then the Blessed One declared to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, let us proceed to the city of Kuśinagara." "As you command, venerable one," replied the venerable Ānanda, and he complied with the Blessed One's word.

Then, as the Blessed One was travelling through the Malla country, he stopped short of the city of Kuśinagara and of the river Hirañṇavatī, stepped aside from the path, and declared to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, my back is uncomfortable. Let me rest. Fold the Tathāgata's outer robe fourfold and lay it down." "As you command, venerable one," replied the venerable Ānanda. And duly folding the outer robe fourfold, he laid it down.

The Blessed One then addressed the venerable Ānanda again: "The outer robe of the Tathāgata has been folded fourfold and laid down. Blessed One, may you now see fit that the moment has come." Then the Blessed One made of his patchwork robe a many-layered cushion, and having let down his right side and placed foot upon foot, he applied to his mind the perception of light, mindfulness, vigilance, and the perception of rising, and lay down to rest.

Then the Blessed One declared to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, recite the limbs of awakening." The Blessed One himself, having fully known and perfectly understood mindfulness as a limb of awakening, taught it thus: dwelling in seclusion, dwelling in dispassion, dwelling in cessation, thoroughly transformed by relinquishment — the discrimination of phenomena (Skt. *dharmapravicaya*), diligence, joy, thorough pliancy, meditative absorption, and equanimity are the limbs of awakening. "Venerable one, it is the Blessed One himself who fully knows and perfectly understands them, having taught them thus: dwelling in seclusion, dwelling in dispassion, dwelling in cessation, thoroughly transformed by relinquishment." "Ānanda, was diligence spoken of?" "Blessed One, diligence was spoken of." "Ānanda, if diligence is relied upon, cultivated, and made abundant many times over, it will lead to unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening."

Having spoken thus, the Blessed One rose, sat cross-legged, straightened his body upright, established mindfulness fully present, and remained seated.

Then another monk spoke this verse:

Though the Teacher himself lay ill,
he requested the teaching for the sake of hearing much Dharma.
The monk himself then taught the Dharma —
through those limbs of awakening, he became a teacher.
The wise one, endowed with intelligence, who understands —

The elder Ānanda spoke well:
from the utterly pure words of the Sage,
one will attain those very teachings themselves.
Right mindfulness, thorough discernment,
diligence, joy, a thoroughly trained body,
mind, meditative absorption, and equanimity —
these, brave ones, are the limbs of awakening.
Having heard the teaching on the limbs of awakening,
and knowing by omniscience the taste of the limbs of awakening,
the Blessed One, whose mind was in very great discomfort,
arose from that grave and severe illness.
Therefore, even that lord of Dharma
wished to hear Dharma as this precious teaching was being explained.
As for others who also wish to hear the Dharma —
why should any one of them not listen to this?

The one who has been shown to be supreme in wisdom,
shown so by one possessed of the ten powers of wisdom —
even that attendant, though himself ill,
goes for the sake of hearing the sacred Dharma.
Those who hold the sūtras, those who hold the Vinaya, those who hold the
Abhidharma,
the learned ones who know the ways of the Dharma —
if they listen to the teachings, what of others?
Why should anyone not listen to this?
Having heard and understood the Dharma's word with the mind,
and having settled it within —
through joy one will attain suchness
through this teaching of the Buddha, which is without taint.
With a mind filled with joy, the body is thoroughly trained,
and bliss too arises in just the same way.
A mind that has become blissful is one-pointed,
and through it one reaches and touches upon meditative absorption.
A mind that has become equanimous does not take refuge in formations,
and being wearied, one becomes free of attachments,
so that the mind arrives at thorough liberation.
Wearied of wandering in existence,
not clinging even to gods and humans —
just as a fire dies when there is no more fuel,
one becomes an arhat and passes into complete nirvāṇa.
The benefits of hearing the Dharma are many and various;
the Victors have explained them all throughout.
Therefore, with earnest effort,
one should listen most attentively to the Teacher's words.

Then the Blessed One declared to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, go to the
city of Kuśinagara." "As you command, Venerable One," said the venerable
Ānanda, and he attended upon the Blessed One.

Then the Blessed One passed through the land of the Mallas and arrived at the
city of Kuśinagara, and dwelt in the grove of twin śāla trees near the territory
of the Mallas. Then, at the very moment the Blessed One was to pass into
complete nirvāṇa there, he declared to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda,
between the two śāla trees, set up the Tathāgata's bed with its head toward

the north. The Tathāgata will pass into complete nirvāṇa in the realm of nirvāṇa without remainder of aggregates at this very midnight watch of tonight." "As you command, Venerable One," said the venerable Ānanda, and he attended upon the Blessed One. He set up the bed between the twin śāla trees with its head toward the north, then went to where the Blessed One was. Arriving there, he prostrated with his head at the Blessed One's two feet and sat down to one side.

Seated to one side, the venerable Ānanda reported to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I have set up the Tathāgata's bed between the twin śāla trees with its head toward the north."

Then the Blessed One went to where the bed was, and having arrived, he lay down on his right side, foot placed upon foot, and held in mind the perception of luminosity, mindfulness, vigilance, and the perception of passing into nirvāṇa.

Then again, at that time, the venerable Ānanda, sitting to the side of the Blessed One, grasped the bed and wept with tears streaming, and said these words: "The Blessed One has passed into nirvāṇa far too soon! The Sugata has passed into nirvāṇa far too soon! Far too soon has the eye of the world become blind! In former times, monks, from such and such directions and from such and such lands, they came to where the Blessed One was. To those who came, the Blessed One taught the holy life, good at the beginning, good in the middle, and good at the end, with excellent meaning, excellent phrasing, unmixed, perfectly complete, perfectly pure, and perfectly refined. Because of this, from time to time they also heard and obtained the deep discourse on profound Dharma — but now, having heard that the Blessed One has passed into nirvāṇa, they will not come, and in this way this great feast of Dharma, this singular thing, has set in the world."

Then the Blessed One said to the monks: "Monks, where is Ānanda sitting?" "Blessed One, the venerable Ānanda is here, to this side of the Blessed One, grasping the bed and weeping with tears streaming, saying these words: 'The Blessed One has passed into nirvāṇa far too soon! The Sugata has passed into nirvāṇa far too soon! Far too soon has the eye of the world become blind! In former times, monks' — and so on as before, up to — 'this great feast of Dharma has set in the world.'"

Then the Blessed One addressed the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, do not grieve, do not be distraught, do not lament. And why is that? Ānanda, the

service you have rendered in attendance upon the Tathāgata has been of benefit, of ease, non-dual, and immeasurable, through loving physical action, through loving verbal action, and through loving mental action. Ānanda, all those who in past times were Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas — their attendants served those Blessed Buddhas in just such a manner as you have served me. And all those who in future times will be Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas — their attendants will serve those Blessed Buddhas in just such a manner as you now serve me. Therefore, Ānanda, do not grieve, do not be distraught, do not lament. Whatever is born, whatever has arisen, whatever has been made, whatever is conditioned, whatever has come about through dependent origination — all such things are subject to disintegration. That they should not disintegrate: this is not possible; it cannot be conceived. Ānanda, I have said this before as well: all things dear and beloved, pleasing and agreeable — all of them come to separation, to parting, to dissolution, to non-existence."

Then the Blessed One, wishing to delight the venerable Ānanda, addressed the monks: "Monks, there are four wondrous and marvellous qualities in a wheel-turning king. What are the four? If the retinue of a noble warrior class comes to behold a wheel-turning king and sees him, they rejoice.

If Dharma is taught to those who have come near, they rejoice upon hearing it. If the retinue of brahmins, the retinue of householders, and the retinue of ascetics come to behold the wheel-turning king and see him, they rejoice. If Dharma is taught to those who have come near, they rejoice upon hearing it.

Monks, in the same way, the monk Ānanda also possesses four wondrous and marvellous qualities. What are the four? If the retinue of monks comes to behold the monk Ānanda and sees him, they rejoice. If Dharma is taught to those who have come, they rejoice upon hearing it. If the retinue of nuns, the retinue of laymen, and the retinue of laywomen come to behold the monk Ānanda and see him, they rejoice. If Dharma is taught to those who have come, they rejoice upon hearing it.

Monks, furthermore, the monk Ānanda possesses yet another four wondrous and marvellous qualities. What are the four? When the monk Ānanda teaches Dharma to the assembly of monks, he teaches with reverence and not without reverence. Then the assembly of monks thinks to themselves: "Ah, the venerable Ānanda never ceases to speak, and moreover he teaches only Dharma — how fitting this is!" And though the assembly of monks never tires

of listening to Dharma from the monk Ānanda, still the monk Ānanda falls silent. When the monk Ānanda teaches Dharma to the assembly of nuns, the assembly of laymen, and the assembly of laywomen, he teaches with reverence and not without reverence. Then the assembly of laymen and the rest think to themselves: "Ah, the venerable Ānanda never ceases to speak, and moreover he teaches only Dharma — how fitting this is!" And though the assembly of laymen and the rest never tire of listening to Dharma from the monk Ānanda, still the monk Ānanda remains silent.

Then the venerable Ānanda, having been truly delighted by the Blessed One, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Reverend One, for what reason, setting aside the six great cities of the different regions of the world — Śrāvastī, Sāketa, Campā, Vārāṇasī, Vaiśālī, Rājagṛha, and others, those six great cities — did you intend to pass into nirvāṇa here in this wretched town, this wilderness, this miserable fort, this branch of a town, this mere remnant of a city? Ānanda, do not say that this city of Kuśinārā is a wretched town, a wilderness, a miserable fort, a branch settlement, or a mere remnant of a city. For why? In former times, Ānanda, this city of Kuśinārā was the palace of King Kuśavat — prosperous, flourishing, happy, blessed with good harvests, full of people, thronging with many inhabitants — twelve yojanas in length and seven yojanas in breadth. Ānanda, the enclosure of King Kuśavat was fourfold: made of gold, made of silver, made of beryl (vaiḍūrya), and made of crystal; surrounded on all sides by seven enclosures. Ānanda, the four gates of the palace of King Kuśavat were made of gold, made of silver, made of beryl, and made of crystal. Ānanda, the four staircases of those gates were made of gold, made of silver, made of beryl, and made of crystal.

In height, the pillars were set to the depth that seven men standing could reach, with a quarter and a half of a man's height sunk into the ground as a foundation, and they were erected in sets of three. Ānanda, the four ponds of the palace of King Kuśavat — made of gold, made of silver, made of beryl, and made of crystal — were surrounded on all sides by seven enclosures of paneled walls. Ānanda, the four palm trees of the palace of King Kuśavat — made of gold, made of silver, made of beryl, and made of crystal — were surrounded on all sides by seven rows of palm trees made of those same four materials. Ānanda, the golden palm trees had leaves, flowers, and fruits fashioned from silver. Ānanda, the silver ones had leaves, flowers, and fruits of gold, beryl, and crystal. Ānanda, the crystal palm trees had leaves, flowers, and fruits fashioned from beryl. Ānanda, when those palm trees were stirred

by the wind, they gave forth a pleasing sound of this kind — like a skilled musician giving a full and perfect performance on a five-part instrument. Ānanda, between those palm trees there were beautiful ponds, and those ponds too were fashioned of panels of the four kinds: gold, silver, beryl, and crystal. Ānanda, the four kinds of steps of those beautiful ponds were made of gold, made of silver, made of beryl, and made of crystal. The parapets of those ponds were also surrounded on all sides by parapets of the four kinds: made of gold, made of silver, made of beryl, and made of crystal. Ānanda, the pins, rafters, and supports of the golden parapets were made of silver. Those of the silver parapets were made of gold. Those of the beryl parapets were made of crystal. And those of the crystal parapets — their pins, rafters, and supports — were made of beryl. Ānanda, within those beautiful ponds there grew various kinds of water-born flowers: the utpala, the padma, the kumuda, the white lotus, the supremely fragrant, the gently fragrant, and those that bloom in every season and flower at all times — yielding the causes for garlands of flowers, without obstruction, for all people. Ānanda, on both banks of those beautiful ponds there grew various kinds of flowers that grow on dry land: the atimukta, the campaka, the yellow jasmine, the pāriśāka, the mālikā, the navamālikā, the pleasing one, the yūthikā, the dhānuskari, and those that bloom in every season and flower at all times — yielding the causes for garlands of flowers, without obstruction, for all people. Ānanda, King Mahāsudarśana had placed in the spaces between those beautiful palm trees young attendants adorned with all manner of ornaments, who gave food to those who desired food, drink to those who desired drink, clothing to those who desired clothing, and garlands, perfumes, and unguents to those who desired garlands, perfumes, and unguents. Ānanda, those in the palace of King Kuśavat who wished to play, to rejoice, and to make merry — gamblers, dancers, and those who sell wine — played and rejoiced and made merry in great delight among those palm trees. Ānanda, in the palace of King Kuśavat, from those palm trees, there came pleasing sounds of this kind: the sound of elephants, the sound of horses, the sound of chariots, the sound of small drums, the sound of conches, the sound of great kettledrums, the sound of assemblies,

the sound of the paṭaha drum, the sound of music, the sound of song, the sound of the flute, the sound of "Generosity has been given!", the sound of "Merit has been made!", the sound of "Those who fast on one meal have undertaken fasting and have taken up ethical conduct rightly!" — and so it

became endowed with these twelve kinds of sound.

Ānanda, in the palace of King Kuśavat there dwelt a wheel-turning king (cakravartin) by the name of Great Sudassana, endowed with the seven precious things and the four kinds of human prosperity. What were the seven precious things he possessed? They were these: the precious wheel, the precious elephant, the precious horse, the precious gem, the precious woman, the precious householder, and the seventh, the precious minister.

Ānanda, what were the four kinds of human prosperity with which King Great Sudassana was endowed? He was long-lived and dwelt for a great span of time. He reached eighty-four thousand years playing the games of youth. He reached eighty-four thousand years acting as regent. He reached eighty-four thousand years acting as a great king. And he reached eighty-four thousand years living the royal sage's life of holy celibacy.

Ānanda, King Great Sudassana was long-lived and dwelt for a great span of time. He spent eighty-four thousand years in the joy of youth, playing games; eighty-four thousand years as regent; eighty-four thousand years as a great king; and eighty-four thousand years living the holy celibate life of a royal sage. This, Ānanda, is called the prosperity of King Great Sudassana.

Ānanda, furthermore, King Great Sudassana was handsome, beautiful, and lovely to behold — surpassing human complexion, though not yet attaining the complexion of the gods. Ānanda, King Great Sudassana was handsome, beautiful, and lovely to behold, surpassing human complexion though not yet attaining the complexion of the gods. This, Ānanda, is called the prosperity of King Great Sudassana.

Ānanda, furthermore, King Great Sudassana was of a constitution afflicted by little and free from illness. His stomach was neither too cold nor too hot; it was temperate, ever comfortable and free from distress, so that whatever he ate, drank, chewed, or tasted was well and easily digested. Ānanda, King Great Sudassana was of a constitution afflicted by little and free from illness — his stomach neither too cold nor too hot, temperate, ever comfortable and free from distress — so that whatever he ate, drank, chewed, or tasted was well and easily digested. This, Ānanda, is called the prosperity of King Great Sudassana.

Ānanda, furthermore, King Great Sudassana was beloved and pleasing to the townspeople and the country folk, just as a father is to his children. King Great Sudassana was beloved and pleasing to the townspeople and the country folk,

just as children are to a father.

Ānanda, on one occasion, as King Great Sudassana was going to the pleasure grove, he said to the charioteer: "Charioteer, drive the chariot slowly, step by step — I wish to gaze long upon the townspeople and the country folk." And the townspeople and the country folk also said to the charioteer: "Charioteer, drive the chariot slowly, step by step — we too wish to gaze long upon our lord."

Ānanda, thus it was that King Great Sudassana was beloved and pleasing to the townspeople and the country folk, just as a father is to his children.

That King Great Sudassana was beloved and pleasing to the townspeople and the country folk, just as children are to a father — this, Ānanda, is called the prosperity of King Great Sudassana.

Then the townspeople and the country folk took up great quantities of gold and silver and precious jewels and rare gems, went to where King Great Sudassana was, and said to him: "O lord, we have come bringing great quantities of gold and silver and precious jewels and rare gems for your majesty's sake. May your majesty, out of gracious compassion, accept them." But he said: "Friends, in my land there is wealth of this kind in abundance — I have no need of it." And he would not accept it.

Then the townspeople and the country folk said again to King Great Sudassana: "O lord, these great quantities of gold and silver and precious jewels and rare gems that we have brought for your majesty's sake — may your majesty accept them out of gracious compassion." And King Great Sudassana said to the townspeople and the country folk two and three times: "Friends, in my land there is wealth of this kind in abundance — I have no need of it." And he would not accept.

Then the townspeople and the country folk thought to themselves: "We have come bringing gold and silver and precious jewels and rare gems for the lord's sake. For us now to take these back and go each to our own place would not be fitting for us. Rather, let us heap up great mounds of gold and silver before King Great Sudassana, and set the precious jewels and rare gems all around, and say: 'These are the lord's treasury,' and then leave them behind and depart." And so they laid the gold and silver and precious jewels and rare gems down before King Great Sudassana, left them there, and departed.

Then King Great Sudassana thought to himself: "My wealth has been acquired in accordance with the Dharma and not otherwise. Therefore let me build a Dharma-fitting palace." And he heard that the eighty-four thousand border vassal kings wished to assist King Great Sudassana in building a Dharma-fitting palace. Hearing this, they went to where King Great Sudassana was and said to him: "O lord, please be graciously pleased to undertake the task of building a Dharma-fitting palace. We shall build a Dharma-fitting palace for your majesty." But he said: "Friends, in my land there is wealth of this kind in abundance — there is no need." And he did not grant it.

The eighty-four thousand border vassal kings said to King Great Sudassana two and three times: "O lord, please be graciously pleased to undertake the task of building a Dharma-fitting palace. We shall build a Dharma-fitting palace for your majesty." And King Great Sudassana said to the eighty-four thousand border vassal kings two and three times: "Friends, in my land there is wealth of this kind in abundance — there is no need." And he did not grant it.

Then the eighty-four thousand border vassal kings prostrated at the feet of King Great Sudassana, some taking hold of his hands, some taking hold of the hem of his garment, and some, from whatever direction they faced King Great Sudassana, joining their palms and bowing in reverence.

They said to King Great Sudassana: "Your majesty, please be pleased to give your mind to the task of building a Dharma-fitting palace. We shall build a Dharma-fitting palace for your majesty." King Great Sudassana granted it to the eighty-four thousand border vassal kings with silence. Then the eighty-four thousand border vassal kings, understanding that King Great Sudassana had granted it with silence, departed each to their own lands and, carrying gold, much silver, and precious pillars one by one, went to the place where King Great Sudassana was. When they arrived there, they said to King Great Sudassana: "Your majesty, where and of what size shall we build the Dharma-fitting palace?" The king said to them: "Friends, for that purpose, build to the east of Kuśavati a Dharma-fitting palace one league in length and one league in breadth." "As your majesty commands," replied the eighty-four thousand border vassal kings, and in obedience to King Great Sudassana they built to the east of Kuśavati a Dharma-fitting palace one league in length and one league in breadth.

Ānanda, the four foundations of the Dharma-fitting palace were made, respectively, of gold, of silver, of beryl (vaidūrya), and of crystal. The four

base-supports of the pillars of the Dharma-fitting palace were fashioned, respectively, of gold, of silver, of beryl, and of crystal. The four kinds of pillars of the Dharma-fitting palace were erected, respectively, of gold, of silver, of beryl, and of crystal. Ānanda, the golden pillars had their base-supports, column-caps, bracket-blocks, and crossbeams made of silver. Those of silver had theirs of gold. Those of beryl had theirs of crystal. Those of crystal had their base-supports, column-caps, bracket-blocks, and crossbeams made of beryl.

Ānanda, the four kinds of secondary rafters of the Dharma-fitting palace were laid of gold, of silver, of beryl, and of crystal. The four kinds of front beams of the Dharma-fitting palace were laid of gold, of silver, of beryl, and of crystal. The four kinds of main roof beams of the Dharma-fitting palace were laid of gold, of silver, of beryl, and of crystal.

The fifty-third fascicle of the Vinaya Kṣudrakavastu.

Ānanda, the four kinds of wall-panels of the Dharma-fitting palace were hung of gold, of silver, of beryl, and of crystal. The four kinds of wall-slabs cladding the Dharma-fitting palace were fashioned of gold, of silver, of beryl, and of crystal. The four kinds of steps of the Dharma-fitting palace were built of gold, of silver, of beryl, and of crystal. The four kinds of railings encircling the Dharma-fitting palace were fashioned of gold, of silver, of beryl, and of crystal. Ānanda, the dowel-pins, support-posts, and baluster-shafts of the golden railings were made of silver. Those of silver had theirs of gold. Those of beryl had theirs of crystal. Ānanda, the crystal railings had their dowel-pins, baluster-shafts, and

support-posts made of beryl. Ānanda, the four kinds of multi-storied pavilions of the Dharma-fitting palace were built of gold, of silver, of beryl, and of crystal. Ānanda, in the golden multi-storied pavilion there were placed, on both sides, thrones made of silver, fitted with divine canopies, spread with Golika cloth, furnished with inner cushions of Brahma-quality fabric, with owl-feather cushions, with Mentri cushions, with Armonig cushions, and with cushions of fine Kāliṅga cloth — all covered with coverings and having red borders. For the silver pavilion, these were of gold. For the beryl pavilion, they were of crystal. For the crystal multi-storied pavilion, beginning from "thrones made of beryl, fitted with divine canopies" down to "placed on both sides with red borders" — all is as stated above. Ānanda, in front of the golden multi-storied pavilion there were strung silver palm-leaf fronds, flowers, and

golden fruits. For the silver pavilion, these were of gold. For the beryl pavilion, they were of crystal. In front of the crystal multi-storied pavilion there were strung beryl palm-leaf fronds, flowers, and crystal fruits. When those palm fronds were stirred by the wind, delightful sounds arose — like, for example, a skilled person playing beautifully upon a lute furnished with five strings. Ānanda, the Dharma-fitting palace was spread with golden sand and sprinkled with sandalwood water, and adorned with golden nets and golden bells threaded on loops of wire.

The summary verse:

The foundations, column-bases, pillars,
the smaller rafters, fore-rafters, and great beams,
the eave-boards, wall-slabs, steps,
the railings, pavilions, and palm-trees — all of gold.

Then, knowing that all the construction of the eighty-four thousand Dharma-fitting palaces of the frontier kings was complete, in front of the Dharma-fitting palace a Dharma-fitting pool was made, one league in length and one league in breadth. Ānanda, the four wall-sides of the Dharma-fitting pool were built of gold, of silver, of beryl, and of crystal. Ānanda, the four kinds of steps of the Dharma-fitting pool were built of gold, of silver, of beryl, and of crystal. Ānanda, the Dharma-fitting pool was encircled by four kinds of railings made of gold, of silver, of beryl, and of crystal. The dowel-pins, baluster-shafts, and support-posts of the golden railings were made of silver. Those of silver had theirs of gold. Those of beryl had theirs of crystal. The crystal railings had their dowel-pins, baluster-shafts, and support-posts made of beryl. Ānanda, within the Dharma-fitting pool there grew various kinds of water-born flowers, namely: blue lotus (utpala), pink lotus (padma), white night-lotus (kumuda), white day-lotus (puṇḍarīka), flowers of supreme fragrance, flowers of mild fragrance, flowers in season for all occasions, and flowers for all times — producing, without obstruction for all people, the material for garlands of flowers. Ānanda, on both banks of the Dharma-fitting pool there grew land-born flowers, namely: atimuktaka, campaka, sky-blue lotus, pāriśāka, mālikā, navamālikā, the pleasing flower, yuṣṭika, dhanuṣkarī, flowers in season for all occasions, and flowers for all times — producing, without obstruction for all people, the material for garlands of flowers. Ānanda, the Dharma-fitting pool was spread with golden sand and sprinkled with sandalwood water,

and hung with golden nets and golden bells threaded on wire. Then the eighty-four thousand vassal kings, having learned that all the tasks pertaining to the Dharma-fitting pool were complete, planted before the Dharma-fitting pool a Dharma-fitting grove of tāla palms, one league in length and one league in breadth. Ānanda, in that Dharma-fitting grove of tāla palms there were planted tāla palms of four kinds: those made of gold, those made of silver, those made of vaidūrya, and those made of crystal. Ānanda, the tāla palms made of gold had leaves, flowers, and fruits made of silver fitted to them. Those made of silver had their fittings made of gold. Those made of vaidūrya had their fittings made of crystal. The tāla palms made of crystal had leaves, flowers, and fruits made of vaidūrya fitted to them. Ānanda, when those groves of tāla palms were stirred by the wind, a pleasing sound arose from them like that of a skilled musician performing a perfectly rendered melody on a five-part instrument. Ānanda, that Dharma-fitting grove of tāla palms was entirely enclosed by four balustrades — one made of gold, one made of silver, one made of vaidūrya, and one made of crystal. Ānanda, the balustrade made of gold had its pins, crossbars, and supports made of silver. The one made of silver had its fittings made of gold. The one made of vaidūrya had its fittings made of crystal. The balustrade made of crystal had its pins, crossbars, and supports made of vaidūrya. Ānanda, the Dharma-fitting grove of tāla palms was spread with golden sand and sprinkled with sandalwood water, and hung with golden nets and golden bells threaded on wire.

Then the eighty-four thousand vassal kings, having learned that all the tasks pertaining to the Dharma-fitting palace, the Dharma-fitting pool, and the Dharma-fitting grove of tāla palms were complete, went to where King Mahāsudarśana was, approached him, and spoke to him thus: "Your Majesty, all the works of the Dharma-fitting palace, the Dharma-fitting pool, and the Dharma-fitting grove of tāla palms have been accomplished. Your Majesty, please now consider that the time has come."

Then King Mahāsudarśana thought to himself: "It would not be fitting for me alone to dwell first in this Dharma-fitting palace. Rather, let me first give food in the Dharma-fitting palace to whatever ascetics, brahmins, and those of good conduct and worthy of veneration dwell in my realm, and let me present each one of them with a pair of fine woven cloth garments." Then King Mahāsudarśana did indeed first give food in the Dharma-fitting palace to whatever ascetics, brahmins, and those of good conduct and worthy of veneration dwelt in his realm, and presented each one with a pair of fine

woven cloth garments.

Then King Mahāsudarśana thought to himself again: "It would not be fitting for me to sport and play and take delight in the Dharma-fitting palace amid the fully supplied five qualities of sensual pleasure. Rather, let me in the Dharma-fitting palace practice, together with a single close attendant, the royal sage's holy celibate life." And so King Mahāsudarśana did practice in the Dharma-fitting palace, together with a single close attendant, the royal sage's holy celibate life.

Then King Mahāsudarśana entered the golden multi-storied palace and sat upon a silver throne. Seated upon that throne, withdrawn from sensual desires, withdrawn from non-virtuous and unwholesome phenomena, with applied thought and sustained thought, with the joy and happiness born of seclusion, he dwelt having completed the first meditative concentration.

Descending from the silver throne, he departed from the golden multi-storied palace, entered the silver multi-storied palace, and sat upon a golden throne. Seated upon that throne — from "withdrawn from sensual desires" up to "he dwelt having completed the first meditative concentration" — all is as stated above.

Descending from the golden throne, he departed from the silver multi-storied palace, entered the vaidūrya multi-storied palace, and sat upon a crystal throne. Seated upon that throne — from "withdrawn from sensual desires" up to "he dwelt having completed the first meditative concentration" — all is as stated above.

Descending from the crystal throne, he departed from the vaidūrya multi-storied palace, entered the crystal multi-storied palace, and sat upon a vaidūrya throne. Seated upon that throne — from "withdrawn from sensual desires" up to "he dwelt having completed the first meditative concentration" — all is as stated above.

Then the eighty-four thousand women of the court went to where the jewel queen was, approached her, and addressed her thus: "May your ladyship please know: it has been a long time since we have seen our lord the king. We are deeply thirsting to see him. We wish to behold our lord."

"Sisters, wait here for a moment while I inquire of the jewel minister." The jewel queen then summoned the jewel minister by messenger and said: "General, know this: it has been a long time since I have seen our lord, and I

am deeply thirsting to see him. Today I wish to behold him. Therefore, sisters, let all of you adorn yourselves with golden ornaments, golden garments, garlands, pendants, and golden unguents, and let the retinue too be arrayed in gold. In the meanwhile, let me assemble the eighty-four thousand frontier vassal kings, the eighty-four thousand elephants led by the elephant king Nearby Restoration and the others, the eighty-four thousand horses led by the horse king Cloud-Force and the others, and the eighty-four thousand chariots led by the chariot Joyful Sound and the others."

Then all the queens adorned themselves with golden ornaments, golden garments, garlands, pendants, and golden unguents, and the retinue too was arrayed in gold. Then the jewel minister assembled the eighty-four thousand frontier vassal kings, the eighty-four thousand elephants led by the elephant king Nearby Restoration and the others, the eighty-four thousand horses led by the horse king Cloud-Force and the others, and the eighty-four thousand chariots led by the chariot Joyful Sound and the others.

When all had been assembled, the jewel queen mounted the chariot Joyful Sound, and all the other women each mounted their own chariots, and they set out toward the Dharma-fitting palace.

At that moment, the noise and great clamor of the common crowd was heard from below the Dharma-fitting palace, and King Mahāsudarśana, from inside the Dharma-fitting palace, heard the noise of the common crowd rising from below. Having heard it, he spoke to his close attendant thus:

"Ho there, good man — what is this great noise and clamor of the common crowd that is heard below this Dharma-fitting palace?"

"Your Majesty, it is the jewel queen and the eighty-four thousand women who desire to look upon the king from below the Dharma-fitting palace, together with the eighty-four thousand border kings led by the jewel minister and the others, the eighty-four thousand elephants led by the elephant king Near-Observance and the others, the eighty-four thousand horses led by the horse king Cloud-Force and the others, and the eighty-four thousand chariots led by the chariot Joyful Sound and the others — all of them have come from below this Dharma-fitting palace, Your Majesty."

"In that case, good man, go and arrange a fine golden throne on the lower veranda of the Dharma-fitting palace, where I may sit and be seen by the many people."

"As Your Majesty commands," the man replied, and heeding the words of King Mahāsudarśana, he arranged a fine golden throne on the lower veranda of the Dharma-fitting palace. Then he went to where King Mahāsudarśana was and spoke to him thus: "Your Majesty, a fine throne of gold has been arranged on the lower veranda of the Dharma-fitting palace. Your Majesty, please be pleased to consider that the time has now come."

Then, as King Mahāsudarśana descended from the Dharma-fitting palace, he saw that all the women were adorned in yellow ornaments, yellow robes, garlands, pendants, yellow unguents, and yellow retinue-dress. Seeing this, he thought to himself, "Alas — these women will give rise to attachment in me," and so he sat looking upward toward the sky. The jewel queen then saw King Mahāsudarśana sitting there with his gaze directed upward toward the sky, and she thought: "Since the king sees us and yet sits looking up at the sky, he must surely be thinking that we will bring him some harm."

Then King Mahāsudarśana descended from the Dharma-fitting palace and took his seat on the fine golden throne that had been arranged. The jewel queen went to where King Mahāsudarśana was, and prostrating with her head at his feet, she sat to one side. Having sat to one side, the jewel queen spoke to King Mahāsudarśana in these words:

"Your Majesty, these eighty-four thousand women belong to Your Majesty — may Your Majesty be pleased to look upon them with delight and sustain them. The eighty-four thousand border kings led by the jewel minister and the others, the eighty-four thousand elephants led by the elephant king Near-Observance and the others, the eighty-four thousand horses led by the horse king Cloud-Force and the others, the eighty-four thousand chariots led by the chariot Joyful Sound and the others, the eighty-four thousand cities led by the royal palace Grassy and the others, and the eighty-four thousand multi-storied mansions led by the mansion Three-Balconied and the others — all of these, Your Majesty, belong to Your Majesty. May Your Majesty be pleased to look upon them with delight and sustain them. Sister — whereas before you treated me as a friend and companion, now you have made yourself my rival."

Then, at being addressed by King Mahāsudarśana with the word "sister," the jewel queen wept, and with tears flowing she spoke thus:

"How is it that Your Majesty has called us 'sister' and summoned us? Before long we shall no longer be together with Your Majesty — we shall be parted,

separated, and sundered."

Then the jewel queen took hold of King Mahāsudarśana's robe at its hem, and with tears flowing she spoke thus: "How has Your Majesty — who before treated us as a friend and companion — now made yourself our rival? 'Sister, come here,' you say. Human beings live but a short while, and none are free from death; they pass on to other lives. Therefore do virtue and practice the holy life." Then she said: "Your Majesty, those eighty-four thousand divine women toward whom desire, attachment, affection, delight, and longing arise — please abandon them for the sake of your living on. And those eighty-four thousand frontier lords led by the jewel minister, the eighty-four thousand elephants led by the elephant-king Nearby Poṣadha, the eighty-four thousand horses led by the horse-king Cloud-Force, the eighty-four thousand chariots led by the chariot Joyful Sound, the eighty-four thousand cities led by the royal palace Grassy, and the eighty-four thousand multi-storied mansions led by the mansion Three-Balconied — toward all of these, toward those places where desire, attachment, affection, delight, and longing arise — please abandon them and set them aside utterly, for the sake of your living on. For Your Majesty will perish entirely and in every part in but a single instant, a single moment — and that will bring you no joy."

They then replied: "Since we are treating Your Majesty as a friend and companion, and not as a rival, if Your Majesty so wishes — human beings live but a short while, and none are free from death; they pass on to other lives — then let us do virtue and practice the holy life. Your Majesty will perish entirely and in every part in but a single instant, a single moment, and that will bring no joy. Those eighty-four thousand divine women toward whom desire, attachment, affection, delight, and longing arise — please abandon them and regard them with equanimity for the sake of your living on. And those eighty-four thousand frontier lords led by the jewel minister, the eighty-four thousand elephants led by the elephant-king Nearby Poṣadha, the eighty-four thousand horses led by the horse-king Cloud-Force, the eighty-four thousand chariots led by the chariot Joyful Sound, the eighty-four thousand cities led by the royal palace Grassy, and the eighty-four thousand multi-storied mansions led by the mansion Three-Balconied — toward all of these, toward those places where desire, attachment, affection, delight, and longing arise — please abandon them and regard them with equanimity for the sake of your living on."

Then, when the jewel queen had given this counsel to King Mahāsudarśana, he ascended the Dharma-concordant palace, entered the golden multi-storied mansion, and sat upon a silver throne. Seated upon that throne, he cultivated a mind of loving-kindness — without ill-will, without rivalry, without harm, vast, expansive, boundless, and very well developed — pervading one direction with it, suffusing it, filling it, and completing it, and there he remained. In the same way he then cultivated the second direction, and in the same way the third,

and in the same way the fourth, and above, and below, and across — pervading every direction, suffusing this entire world complete in all its aspects with a mind of loving-kindness, without ill-will, without rivalry, without harm, vast, expansive, boundless, and very well developed — pervading one direction, suffusing it, filling it, and completing it, and there he remained.

Then he descended from the silver throne, left the golden multi-storied mansion, entered the silver multi-storied mansion, and sat upon a golden throne. Seated upon that throne, he cultivated a mind of compassion — without ill-will, without rivalry, without harm, vast, expansive, boundless, and very well developed — pervading one direction with it, suffusing it, filling it, and completing it, and there he remained. In the same way the second direction, and in the same way the third, and in the same way the fourth, and above, and below, and across — pervading every direction, suffusing this entire world complete in all its aspects with a mind of compassion, without ill-will, without rivalry, without harm, vast, expansive, boundless, and very well developed — pervading one direction, suffusing it, filling it, and completing it, and there he remained.

Then he descended from the golden throne, left the silver multi-storied mansion, entered the lapis lazuli multi-storied mansion, and sat upon a crystal throne. Seated upon that throne, he cultivated a mind of joy — without ill-will, without rivalry, without harm, vast, expansive, boundless, and very well developed — pervading one direction with it, suffusing it, filling it, and completing it, and there he remained. In the same way the second direction, and in the same way the third, and in the same way the fourth, and above, and below, and across — pervading every direction, suffusing this entire world complete in all its aspects with a mind of joy, without ill-will, without rivalry, without harm, vast, expansive, boundless, and very well developed — pervading one direction, suffusing it, filling it, and completing it, and there he remained.

Then he descended from the crystal throne, left the lapis lazuli multi-storied mansion, entered the crystal multi-storied mansion, and sat upon a lapis lazuli throne. Seated upon that throne, he cultivated a mind of equanimity — without ill-will, without rivalry, without harm, vast, expansive, boundless, and very well developed — pervading one direction with it, suffusing it, filling it, and completing it, and there he remained. In the same way the second direction, and in the same way the third, and in the same way the fourth, and above, and below, and across — pervading every direction, suffusing this entire world complete in all its aspects with a mind of equanimity, without ill-will, without rivalry, without harm, vast, expansive, boundless, and very well developed — pervading one direction, suffusing it, filling it, and completing it, and there he remained.

Then King Mahāsudarśana, having dwelt in and cultivated the four divine abodes many times over, relinquished sensual pleasures and attachment to them, and was reborn on an equal footing in the Brahmā world.

Ānanda, at the time of his death, King Mahāsudarśana experienced a feeling of that very kind — just as a strong man who has eaten a fine meal feels, in that very moment, wearied and sated by the food.

Ānanda, from the city of Kuśāvatī to the river Anomā, to the paired śāla trees, to the Caitya Adorned by the Champion, a distance of twelve leagues all around — in all these places the body of a Tathāgata, functioning as a wheel-turning king, was reborn six times. And, Ānanda, up to and including that very place, there were seven times that a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha appeared. As for an eighth occasion on which the body of a Tathāgata would be cast aside in some eastward, southward, westward, or northward direction from that place — I have not seen such a one. Why so? Because the craving for existence has been cut, births in cyclic existence are exhausted, and from this no further existence will arise.

At that time the venerable Upavāṇa was sitting in the presence of the Blessed One, and the Blessed One said to the venerable Upavāṇa: "Step aside, monk; do not stand before me."

Then the venerable Ānanda addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Reverend one, for more than twenty years I have served as the Blessed One's personal attendant, and yet I have never before heard such a sharp and rebuking word spoken to the venerable Upavāṇa as this. What is the reason, reverend one, for the Blessed One speaking so harshly and censuring him?"

"Ānanda, the gods of the many hundreds of kalpas' duration of the capable — thinking to themselves: 'A Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha appears in this world only rarely, like the udumbara flower — and this Blessed One will pass into the nirvāṇa without remainder this very night at midnight; and that monk, the one renowned for his great power, is sitting right here in the presence of the Blessed One, and by standing with his back to us he blocks us from going to see and attend upon the Blessed One' — they are resentful, they censure, they murmur against him. Reverend one, may the Blessed One be pleased to take note of however many gods there are." "Ānanda, from the city of Kuśāvatī to the river Anomā, and from the grove of the paired śāla trees to the Caitya Adorned by the Champion, within a circle of twelve leagues — there is not even the tiniest space, even as small as the point of a blade of grass pressed into the earth, that is not filled and pervaded by great and renowned gods. The monks, having arisen in doubt, and wishing to have all those doubts cut through, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One: 'Reverend one, what is it? What action did the venerable Upavāṇa perform that made him become renowned for great power?' The Blessed One declared: 'Monks, this monk Upavāṇa performed and accumulated actions that bring about the acquisition of a retinue, the full transformation of conditions, and the certain arising of radiant proximity. The actions performed and accumulated by monk Upavāṇa — who else would experience their fruits? Monks, actions performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external element of earth; they do not ripen in the element of water; they do not ripen in the element of fire; they do not ripen in the element of wind. Rather, virtuous and non-virtuous actions performed and accumulated ripen in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

Actions, though a hundred kalpas pass,
are never lost; when the conditions and the time arrive,
they bear their fruit for embodied beings.

Monks, in this very auspicious kalpa, when the lifespan of living beings was twenty thousand years, the Teacher named Kāśyapa — fully endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed, tamer of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a Blessed One — arose in the world.

He dwelt in dependence upon the Deer Park forest at Ṛṣivadana near the city of Vārāṇasī, and at that time he went forth under that one's teaching. Then, on

another occasion, it was the turn of the duty-monk, and the monks, in the early morning hour, donned their lower robes, took up their bowls and dharma robes, and entered Vārāṇasī on the alms round. At that time, in the winter season, a great storm arose out of season and rain fell. He thought: "Those who live the celibate life have been soaked by this unseasonable rain and are endangered by the cold; when they return I must kindle a fire." So he entered a fire-shelter and lit a fire, then strung ropes all around the courtyard, and sat by the door of the assembly hall watching for their return. When the monks returned, he laid down seats in the fire-shelter. Those monks gave their robes to one another, and those that had been soaked by the rain were hung on the ropes to dry. Then those monks entered the fire-shelter, gathered around the fire, and sat warming themselves. When the cold had passed, they turned their backs to the warmth of the fire and sat facing away from it.

Then the duty-monk felt faith arise, bowed at the feet of those monks, and began to make an aspiration: "By the root of virtue from this act of sheltering these celibate practitioners who were endangered by the cold, may I — whoever I may be — receive a prophecy from the fully and perfectly awakened buddha named Kāśyapa to the brahmin youth called Guru, and at the time when the lifespan of beings reaches one hundred years may I become a Tathāgata, arhat, fully and perfectly awakened buddha named Śākyamuni. Having received that prophecy, may I go forth under that one's teaching, abandon all afflictions completely, and actualize arhatship directly. And just as those monks could not bear the bright heat of the fire, so may the gods themselves be unable to bear the brilliance of my splendour." By the power of that aspiration he made, he went forth under my teaching, abandoned all afflictions, actualized arhatship directly, and became renowned for great power, so that even the gods are unable to outshine him with their radiance.

Then the venerable Ānanda addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Reverend Blessed One, after you have passed, how much effort should we devote to veneration of your bodily relics?" "Ānanda, concern yourself with this but little. This is something that brahmins and faithful householders will accomplish." "Reverend one, how do brahmins and faithful householders accomplish this?" "Ānanda, they do it in the manner done for a wheel-turning king." "Reverend one, how is it done for a wheel-turning king?" "Ānanda, the body of a wheel-turning king is wrapped in cotton wool, wound round with cotton wool, and then swathed in five hundred pairs of cloth. Wrapped in five hundred pairs of cloth, he is placed in an iron casket, filled with sesame oil,

and covered above with a sealed iron lid. Then all fragrant woods are heaped up, he is cremated with these, the fire is quenched with milk, and his bones are placed inside a golden urn. At the crossroads of a great highway a bone stūpa is built, and parasols, victory banners, and pennants are erected; incense, garlands, burnt offerings, powders, and the sound of music are offered; he is honoured, exalted, portrayed in painting, and worshipped, and a great festival is held. Ānanda, just as it is done for a wheel-turning king, so for a Tathāgata, arhat, and fully and perfectly awakened buddha it should be done even more and beyond that."

"Ānanda, go and tell the warrior-nobles of the city of Kuśinagara to make their preparations: your Teacher will pass into nirvāṇa, the nirvāṇa-element without remainder, at the middle watch of this very night. Warriors, perform your tasks and duties there, and do not afterwards lament, saying: 'Our Teacher has passed into nirvāṇa, the nirvāṇa-element without remainder, and we who dwell nearby in the city are unable to go and see him or pay him reverence.'"

The venerable Ānanda replied, "As you command," and having listened to the Blessed One, he took up his outer robe and, together with other monks and wandering ascetics who were following behind, went straight to the assembly hall of the warrior-nobles of Kuśinagara. When he arrived, there were in that assembly hall some five hundred warrior-nobles gathered together for a certain matter.

Then the venerable Ānanda spoke to the warrior-nobles of Kuśinagara as follows: "O great assembly of warrior-nobles of Kuśinagara, gathered here in numbers, wise ones who are keepers of the place, hear this! The Teacher will pass into nirvāṇa, the nirvāṇa-element without remainder, at the middle watch of this very night. Warriors, perform your tasks and duties there, and do not afterwards lament, saying: 'Our Teacher has passed into nirvāṇa, the nirvāṇa-element without remainder, and we who dwell nearby in the city are unable to go and see him or pay him reverence.'"

Then the warrior-nobles of Kuśinagara, having listened to the venerable Ānanda, departed from Kuśinagara along with their sons, their wives, their male servants, their female servants, their workers, those who lived on dairy produce, their friends and companions, their ministers, their relatives, and their kinsmen by marriage, and went straight to the grove of twin sāl trees. Having arrived, they bowed their heads to the feet of the Blessed One and sat to one side. The Blessed One then rightly taught the warrior-nobles of

Kuśinagara with talk in accordance with the Dharma, rightly guided them to uphold it, rightly praised them, and rightly caused them to rejoice.

Then the leading warrior-nobles among the warrior-nobles of Kuśinagara rose from their seats, arranged their robes over one shoulder, turned and bowed with palms joined toward the Blessed One, and spoke to the Blessed One thus: "Venerable One, we are the warrior-nobles of Kuśinagara. We go for refuge to the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha of monks, and we shall undertake the foundations of training."

Then the venerable Ānanda thought to himself: "If each of the warrior-nobles of Kuśinagara were to sit individually before the Blessed One to make their lay refuge declaration, the warrior-nobles would have to leave again at midnight without having made their declarations individually. Therefore I should sit before the Blessed One and administer the lay refuge declaration to all the warrior-nobles of Kuśinagara simultaneously."

Here begins the fifty-fourth section, the basis of the minor matters of the Vinaya.

Then the venerable Ānanda rose from his seat, arranged his robe over one shoulder, turned and bowed with palms joined toward the Blessed One, and spoke to the Blessed One thus: "Venerable One, the warrior-nobles of Kuśinagara, together with their sons, their wives, their male servants, their female servants, their female workers, those who lived on dairy produce, their friends, their ministers, their relatives, and their kinsmen by marriage — these ones go for refuge to the Buddha, the Dharma, and

the Saṅgha of monks, and we ask you to grant us the foundations of the training." Then the venerable Ānanda, together with those warrior-nobles of Kuśinagara, sat before the Blessed One, and before that night's middle watch had passed, they performed the individual confession of lay practitioners.

Then the warrior-nobles of Kuśinagara, delighted and rejoicing at the words the Blessed One had spoken, bowed with their heads at the two feet of the Blessed One and departed from his presence.

At the time when the bodhisattva was dwelling in the Tuṣita heaven and looked out with the five kinds of seeing, he surveyed the six classes of gods of the desire realm three times, manifested a great elephant, and entered the womb of his mother. At that time Śakra, lord of the gods (Indra), said to Rabjā (Pramudita), king of the gandharvas, these words: "Know this, Rabjā: the

Blessed One, dwelling in the Tuṣita heaven, has looked out with the five kinds of seeing, surveyed the six classes of gods of the desire realm three times, manifested a great elephant, and entered the womb of his mother. I am going forth to guard and protect him." Rabjā replied: "Let me first take up a song, O Kauśika — then go." At the time when the bodhisattva emerged from the womb of his mother, Śakra, lord of the gods, again said to Rabjā, king of the gandharvas, these words: "Know this, Rabjā: the Blessed One, the bodhisattva, has emerged from the womb of his mother. I am going forth to serve and attend upon him." Rabjā replied: "Let me first take up a song, O Kauśika — then go." At the time when the Blessed One, as bodhisattva in his youth, was at play and sport, Śakra, lord of the gods, again said to Rabjā, king of the gandharvas, these words: "Know this, Rabjā: the Blessed One, as a young bodhisattva, continues at play and sport. We are going forth to pay him honour and service." Rabjā replied: "Let me first take up a song, O Kauśika — then go."

At the time when the bodhisattva saw old age, sickness, and death, felt renunciation arise in his heart, and entered the forest of ascetic practice — and then, having accomplished the austerities, arose from that austerity — the village girls Gayā and Sujātā offered him a sweet milk-porridge like honey, prepared with sixteen rounds of boiling down to its essence, and a coarse meal of easy inhalation and easy exhalation, of comfortable grains and warm food. They then anointed his body with sesame oil and clarified butter, and bathed him with cool water.

At that time Śakra, lord of the gods, said to Rabjā, king of the gandharvas, these words: "Know this, Rabjā: the Blessed One, the bodhisattva, saw old age, sickness, and death, felt renunciation arise, entered the forest of ascetic practice, and performed austerities. Now the village girls Gayā and Sujātā have offered him sweet milk-porridge like honey, prepared with sixteen rounds of boiling, and a coarse meal of easy breath and comfortable grains and warm food, and have anointed his body with sesame oil and clarified butter and bathed him with cool water. I am going forth to pay him honour and service." Rabjā replied: "Let me first take up a song, O Kauśika — then go."

At the time when the Blessed One subdued the thirty-six billion hosts of Māra's demons and realized unsurpassable gnosis, Brahmā implored him, he proceeded to Vārāṇasī, and turning the wheel of Dharma in twelve aspects, reciting it three times — at that time, the Blessed One, in whatever directions there were villages, towns, and

royal precincts, and regions of every kind — wherever beings were to be tamed, he tamed them — and then proceeded to the city of Kuśinagara and entered his final resting place. Therefore, you should set out to that place to hear the Dharma." Rabjā replied: "Let me first take up a song, O Kauśika — then go."

Then once again Śakra (Indra, king of the gods) spoke these words to Rabjā, king of the gandharvas (celestial musicians): "Know this, Rabjā — the Blessed One has entered his final resting place and is about to pass fully into nirvāṇa. Let us set out to pay him honour and service." Rabjā replied: "Let me first take up a song, O Kauśika — then go."

The Blessed One then reflected: "The wanderer Supriya is one whom I can tame, but Rabjā, king of the gandharvas, is difficult to tame. Those who are to be tamed by śrāvakas the Tathāgata proceeds to tame; but those who are to be tamed by a buddha cannot be tamed by śrāvakas. For that reason, the knowledge by which the Tathāgata knows what beings are to be tamed is unsurpassable. I must not miss the moment for taming this one." With this thought, he entered into a meditative absorption of such a kind that, while remaining in equipoise, he left an emanation on the final resting place, took up a hollow lute with a thousand strings, its body made of lapis lazuli, rose from the final resting place, and came to stand at the door of Rabjā, king of the gandharvas, among the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.

Rabjā, king of the gandharvas, had grown proud, thinking: "There is no one like me." He had taken up his melodious lute, and sat there utterly delighted in mind. Then the Blessed One spoke these words to the doorkeeper: "Go and tell Rabjā, king of the gandharvas, that a gandharva who understands has come to the gate, wishing to see him." The doorkeeper went and announced this. Rabjā, intoxicated with pride, replied: "What does that person say? Is there really another gandharva besides me?" The doorkeeper said: "I shall not mention others for the moment — there is simply one here at this very gate." The gandharva, carried along by the force of his intoxicating pride, came to the door in an instant and said: "Are you a gandharva, good man?" The Blessed One declared: "I am indeed a gandharva, and more." Rabjā said: "If that is so, take up your song and come in." The Blessed One declared: "Very well, so be it" — and for as long as the Blessed One played alongside him, when the Blessed One plucked one string, Rabjā also plucked one string, and the sound and melody of both lutes were equal. When the Blessed One

plucked two strings, likewise the sound and melody were indistinguishable. So too with three strings, and from four strings down to a single string — and when Rabjā left it at two, three, and from four down to a single string, likewise both lutes were indistinguishable in sound and melody.

Then the Blessed One plucked even that one remaining string, and in the sky itself the sound and melody arose just as before.

Rabjā, the king of gandharvas, was filled with wonder and, his pride entirely deflated, thought to himself: "Is there truly another noble gandharva who surpasses me?" Then the Blessed One caused his gandharva appearance to vanish, and he stood revealed in his own true form — adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and the eighty minor excellent features, his body graced with an aura of light a fathom wide surpassing the radiance of a thousand suns, beautiful on all sides like a mountain of precious jewels. When Rabjā, the king of gandharvas, beheld this, faith arose in him. He prostrated at the feet of the Blessed One and sat in his presence to hear the Dharma.

The Blessed One, knowing his disposition, his latent tendencies, his elemental constitution, and his intrinsic nature, taught the Dharma in a manner suited to bring about realization of the Four Noble Truths. Upon hearing it, Rabjā, the king of gandharvas, shattered with the vajra of gnosis the twenty-peaked mountain of the view of the transitory collection — and thereby directly actualized the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truth, he uttered this solemn declaration three times:

"Venerable one, no such gift as this has ever been given to me — not by my mother, not by a king, not by a god, not by a friend, not by my own people and the assembly of my kin, not by those gone before me, not by ascetics or brahmins. What the Blessed One has done for me is this: he has dried the ocean of blood and tears, he has freed me from the mountain of bones, he has closed the door to the lower realms, and he has opened the door to the higher states and to liberation, establishing me in a place fitting for gods and humans. Venerable one, I now go to the Blessed One, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha for refuge. Please receive me as a lay practitioner. From this day forward, for as long as life lasts, I turn away from the taking of life and go to refuge with sincere faith and devotion."

Then the Blessed One, with words endowed with Dharma, thoroughly instructed Rabjā, the king of gandharvas, caused him to retain it thoroughly, praised him thoroughly, and caused him to rejoice thoroughly.

And just as the Blessed One entered meditative equipoise, he became invisible to the gods of the Thirty-Three and entered into such a meditative absorption as is the final resting place, the last couch.

At that time, in the city of Kuśinagara, there dwelt one called Suprabha, a wandering ascetic — old, ancient, decrepit, one hundred and twenty years of age — revered, honored, esteemed, and worshipped by the warriors of Kuśinagara as a reputed arhat. He was dwelling in his daytime abode beside a gently flowing pond at the foot of an udumbara grove in Kuśinagara.

At the time when the Blessed One, dwelling in the Tuṣita realm as a bodhisattva, surveyed with his five forms of vision, trained three times among the six classes of gods of the desire realm, manifested as a great elephant, and entered the womb of his mother — at that very moment the udumbara grove came to be covered with buds like frog-eyes.

At the time when he emerged from his mother's womb, those buds opened wide.

At the time when he played the sports of youth, the flowers were in full bloom.

At the time when, having seen old age, sickness, and death, his mind turned away and he entered the forest of austerities, the open flowers began to close again.

At the time when he was practicing austerities, the formerly open flowers became withered.

At the time when he recognized that the practice of austerities was without purpose, began to breathe as he pleased and breathe out as he pleased, and took coarse food of gruel and warm rice and fed his body with sesame oil —

— anointed with butter and sesame oil — up through and including the words "he awoke to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening": all as before. At that time, all the udumbara flowers burst into full bloom.

At the time when Brahmā petitioned the Blessed One and he set out for the city of Vārāṇasī, and having proclaimed it three times, turned the wheel of Dharma in its twelve aspects — at that time the grove of udumbara flowers blazed with a brilliant, clear radiance.

At the time when the Blessed One, in whatever directions there were — in villages, cities, towns, royal palaces and their surroundings, and in various provinces — had tamed those who were to be tamed, and had come to rest on

his final bed in the city of Kuśinagara: at that time the udumbara grove began to wither. All of this was witnessed as an auspicious sign by the wanderer Supriyā. And a deity dwelling in the city of Kuśinagara spoke to the inhabitants of that city, saying: "The Tathāgata will tonight, at the middle watch of the night, pass completely beyond sorrow into the realm of nirvāṇa without remainder."

Supriyā the wanderer heard this. And having heard it, she thought: "If the ascetic Gautama passes beyond sorrow tonight at the middle watch of the night into the realm of nirvāṇa without remainder, I have doubts about certain teachings. These doubts of mine are such that the Blessed One Gautama would dispel them for me — he would engage in clearing my doubts. Let me therefore go to where the Blessed One Gautama is, and if I am given the opportunity, after asking my questions and receiving his prediction, I shall ask about several points." And so she set out from the city of Kuśinagara and went to where the twin sāla trees stood.

At that moment, the venerable Ānanda had come outside and was walking and sitting in the open, in a place without cover. Supriyā the wanderer saw the venerable Ānanda from a considerable distance — walking and sitting in that exposed place outside. Having seen him, she went to where the venerable Ānanda was, and when she had arrived, she said to him: "O Ānanda, having heard that the ascetic Gautama will tonight, at the middle watch of the night, pass completely beyond sorrow into the realm of nirvāṇa without remainder, I have come to have doubts about certain teachings. These doubts of mine are such that the Blessed One Gautama would dispel them — he would engage in clearing my doubts. If the venerable Ānanda would allow me to enter within, and if an opportunity were given after I present my questions seeking his prediction, I would ask about several points."

"Supriyā, do not disturb the Tathāgata. It is enough. The body of the Blessed One is weary. The body of the Sugata is weary."

Yet Supriyā repeated her words to the venerable Ānanda a second and a third time: "O Ānanda, I have heard from elderly wandering teachers and masters of former times that a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly complete buddha arises in the world only rarely — at most perhaps once in a hundred — like the udumbara flower. The Blessed One Gautama will tonight, at the middle watch of the night, pass beyond sorrow into the realm of nirvāṇa without remainder. I have come to have doubts about certain teachings, and these doubts of mine are

such that the Blessed One Gautama would dispel them for me — he would engage in clearing my doubts. I have come thinking this, and so —"

"If the venerable Ānanda would permit me to enter, and if an opportunity were granted for me to put a question and receive instruction on it, I would ask about one matter" — so spoke the wanderer Subhadra to the venerable Ānanda, a second time and then a third. And Ānanda replied: "Enough, Subhadra. Do not trouble the Tathāgata. The body of the Blessed One is weary. The body of the Sugata is spent."

So it was that the two of them — the venerable Ānanda and the wanderer Subhadra — were speaking together in this way, the one urging and the other refusing, when the Blessed One heard them with his divine hearing, pure and surpassing that of human beings. Having heard, he spoke thus to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, do not prevent this wanderer Subhadra. Let him come and ask whatever he wishes. For this will be the last conversation I shall hold with a tīrthika. And this is how it is: this very wanderer Subhadra, once I have summoned him to my presence, will become the last among my disciples — the monks who have gone forth and taken ordination."

Then the wanderer Subhadra, delighted and greatly rejoiced that the Blessed One had granted him the opportunity, arose with joy and gladness in his heart and went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, he exchanged with the Blessed One various words of greeting and mutual rejoicing, and then sat down to one side.

Seated to one side, the wanderer Subhadra addressed the Blessed One thus: "O Gautama, if an opportunity is granted for me to put a question and receive instruction on it, I would ask about one matter."

"Subhadra, ask whatever you wish."

"O Gautama, in this world there are various tīrthikas — namely: Pūraṇa Kassapa, the wanderer Makkhali Gosāla, Sañjaya the son of the Belaṭṭha woman, Pakudha Kaccāyana, Nigaṇṭha Nātaputta, and the naked Kassapa — each with their own doctrines and each claiming their own form of knowledge. Have they, as they claim, truly known, or have none of them truly known?"

Then the Blessed One at that time declared these verses:

"Subhadra, I was twenty-nine years of age when I went forth,
and for more than fifty years since then
I have sought whatever is virtuous and good.

Subhadra, from the time of that going forth of mine,
in moral discipline, in meditative absorption, in conduct and awareness,
I have cultivated one-pointed concentration throughout,
and if I have set forth even a portion of the teaching of right reasoning —
beyond this, there is no other ascetic.

In whatever teaching and discipline the noble eightfold path does not appear,
there no first ascetic is to be found, no second ascetic, no third ascetic, no
fourth ascetic. But in whatever teaching and discipline the noble eightfold path
does appear, there a first ascetic is to be found, a second, a third, and a fourth
ascetic. Subhadra, in whatever teaching and discipline the noble eightfold path
appears, here is the first ascetic, here is the second, here is the third, and here
is the fourth. In what lies beyond this teaching, there is neither ascetic nor
brahmin. Thus do I roar the lion's roar rightly before this assembly, emptying it
of the rival claims of others' ascetics and brahmins."

When this presentation of the Dharma had been taught, the eye of Dharma —
free of dust and stainless — arose in the wanderer Subhadra with regard to all
phenomena. Then the wanderer Subhadra, having seen the Dharma, having
attained the Dharma, having realized the Dharma, having reached the very
depth of the Dharma, having crossed beyond doubt, having crossed beyond
uncertainty, having nothing more to ask of another, having no need to rely on
another's guidance —

having gained fearlessness with regard to the teachings the Teacher had
taught, he rose from his seat, arranged his outer robe over one shoulder,
turned toward where the venerable Ānanda was, joined his palms, bowed, and
spoke these words to the venerable Ānanda: "Venerable Ānanda has indeed
obtained a great gain — for the venerable Ānanda was ordained by the great
master and received full ordination. May I too obtain a great gain, in that I too
shall go forth and receive full ordination in the well-taught Dharma and Vinaya,
and attain the state of a monk." Then the venerable Ānanda addressed the
Blessed One thus: "Venerable sir, this wanderer Subhadra wishes to go forth
into the well-taught Dharma and Vinaya, receive full ordination, and attain the
state of a monk. May the Blessed One, moved by compassion, grant him the
going forth and full ordination." Then the Blessed One spoke to the wanderer
Subhadra: "Come, monk — live the holy life (brahmacarya)." With that, that
venerable one went forth and received full ordination, and attained the state
of a monk.

Having thus gone forth, that venerable one dwelt in seclusion, with vigilance, with diligence, and in austerity — dwelling in seclusion, with vigilance, with diligence, and in austerity. He accomplished precisely that for which sons of good family shave their hair and beard, put on the saffron robes, and go forth from home into homelessness with perfect faith — bringing to completion the unsurpassed holy life. In this very life he realized it directly through his own higher knowledge, actualized it, and dwelt in it, and proclaimed: "Birth is exhausted. The holy life has been fulfilled. What had to be done has been done. I know of no further becoming beyond this." That venerable one's mind was utterly liberated, and he became an arhat endowed with perfect knowledge.

Then the venerable Subhadra, having attained arhatship and experiencing throughout himself the joy and happiness of liberation, thought to himself: "It is not fitting for me to witness the Teacher's complete passing into nirvāṇa. I must by all means pass into complete nirvāṇa beforehand." So thinking, he went to where the Blessed One was, arrived, and having bowed his head to the Blessed One's two feet, sat down to one side. Sitting to one side, the venerable Subhadra addressed the Blessed One thus: "Venerable sir, I wish to pass into complete nirvāṇa beforehand."

When he said this, the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Subhadra: "Subhadra, do you speak in order to pass into nirvāṇa — or in order for the Blessed One to pass into nirvāṇa?" "For the Blessed One to pass into nirvāṇa, venerable sir." "Subhadra, do you speak in order to pass into nirvāṇa — or in order for the Sugata to pass into nirvāṇa?" "For the Sugata to pass into nirvāṇa, venerable sir." "Subhadra, if you speak in order to pass into nirvāṇa, what is there for me to say? It is the very nature of all conditioned things."

Then the venerable Subhadra thought: "I shall bless five places and then pass into nirvāṇa." He envisioned that those who live the holy life equally with himself would be seen with shaven heads wearing patched robes, while the tīrthikas would be seen bearing the banners of their own tradition — that those rival tīrthikas would be unable to raise his bier, while those who live the holy life equally with himself would be able to raise it. He conjured up a small pond, envisioning it thus: that the tīrthikas would be unable to walk into the pond or move about in it —

while those who live the holy life equally with himself would be able to move about in it freely; that the fish and turtles would be able to harm the tīrthikas,

but would not be able to harm those who live the holy life equally with himself; that the tīrthikas would be unable to kindle a fire or light a funeral pyre, while those who live the holy life equally with himself would be able to light it. Having thus blessed these five places, he passed fully into nirvāṇa in the realm of nirvāṇa without remainder.

When the other wandering tīrthikas heard that the wanderer Rabzang had passed fully into nirvāṇa, they raised great banners of white cloth and paraded through the broad avenues, colonnades, crossroads, and intersections of the city of Kusināra, proclaiming in this manner: "This is the first among renunciants. This is the second. This is the third. The fourth — beyond him there is no renunciant or brahmin whatsoever. The renunciants and brahmins who challenge him as rivals are utterly empty." Roaring thus with the true lion's roar before the assembly, they declared: "Our companion in the holy life, the wanderer Rabzang, has passed into nirvāṇa."

At this the monks said to them: "Friends, if this one was indeed your companion in the holy life, bring him here, place him upon a bier, carry him, and let us see." When those wanderers placed him upon the bier and began to lift it, they could not move it at all. Then the monks said: "Friends, shall we lift him? Let us try." And when the monks lifted him, the wanderers, having no confidence, said nothing and stood in silence.

When those wanderers then entered the small pond, the monks again said to them: "Friends, if this one was your companion in the holy life, come in here — enter the pond and let us see." They entered, and sank; the fish and turtles harmed them and they could not move about, so they retreated, coming out step by step from a distance. Then the monks said: "Watch while we enter." The monks entered and did not sink; the fish and turtles could not harm them, and they moved about freely. The wanderers again had no confidence, said nothing, and stood in silence.

Then the monks said further: "Friends, if this one was your companion in the holy life, light the pyre and cremate him — let us see." When those wanderers kindled the fire and began to cremate him, they could not light it. The monks then said: "Friends, let us light it." The monks lit the fire, and it blazed. And those wanderers, just as before, had no confidence, said nothing, and stood in silence.

Then many people, having witnessed all this, departed. The warriors of Kusināra were filled with great wonder and came to have deep faith in the

Blessed One.

At the very time when the Blessed One lay upon his final resting-bed, his joints severed and his articulations splitting — with that piercing sensation having come upon him — even while he remained thus lying, Rabzang was established in the state of arhatship. At that moment, as many warriors of Kusināra were being established in the Dharma, doubts arose among the monks. They brought all their doubts to be resolved and addressed the Buddha, the Blessed One: "Venerable One, at the very time when the Blessed One lay with his joints severed and his articulations splitting, with that piercing sensation having come upon him, even while lying thus — he drew the wanderer Rabzang out from the ocean of saṃsāra, made him perfectly accomplished and brought him to the consummation of happiness, and established him for nirvāṇa. Look upon this!" The Blessed One then declared:

"Monks, consider this: now I, who am fully free from attachment, fully free from aversion, fully free from delusion — free from birth, aging, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, mental distress, and agitation — having attained the knowledge of all things, the knowledge of all aspects, the wisdom of omniscience, drew the wanderer Rabzang out from the ocean of saṃsāra, made him perfectly accomplished, brought him to the consummation of happiness, and established him for nirvāṇa. How wondrous, how marvelous is that!

Yet in a former time, I had not yet freed myself from attachment, aversion, and delusion; I had not freed myself from birth, aging, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, mental distress, and agitation. I was without the power to examine and to save. I was born in the realm of animals. Without even regard for my own life, I became a refuge for the wanderer Rabzang, and I became a refuge for the warriors of the city of Kuśa — a refuge precious as life itself — and I protected all of them utterly from affliction. Listen well to this, take it to heart, and I shall tell it.

Monks, in a time long gone by, in a certain region there dwelt a deer king, surrounded by a herd of a thousand deer. He was wise, clear of mind, and composed. A hunter noticed that deer king and reported him to the king. Then the king set out with an army of fourfold forces and surrounded that deer king on every side.

Then the deer king thought: 'Mother, if I do not protect these deer, they will all be destroyed.' So the deer king looked to see in which direction the herd might

escape. He saw a river flowing through that region, and its current was violent and swift in the extreme. The deer, too, were weak and small. So at once the deer king himself entered the river, stood in the middle, and called out: 'Come here, all of you! Step upon my back from this bank, place your feet upon me, and cross to the other shore. There is no other way to survive; otherwise you will certainly perish.' The deer did as he said, and the hooves of those deer struck his back. His skin was torn open, flesh, blood, and bone were exposed — and yet he did not abandon his diligence.

When all had crossed, he felt compassion and looked back, wondering whether any had failed to cross. He saw that one young deer had not yet crossed. And then the body of the deer king was stricken to its joints, his articulations splitting, with that piercing sensation having come upon him — and yet, a refuge precious as life itself to the assembled ones on this riverbank, he carried the young deer upon his back, rescued it from the river, and set it down on the shore.

Knowing that he had led the great herd of deer across, as his time of death approached he began to make an aspiration prayer: 'Just as I have been a refuge precious as life itself to these deer and to this young deer, and have wholly protected them from affliction — by this merit, may I fully awaken to the unsurpassable, genuine, perfect awakening, and then draw them again from the ocean of saṃsāra, make them perfectly accomplished, bring them to the consummation of happiness, and establish them in nirvāṇa.' Thus he made his aspiration.

The Blessed One then declared: 'Monks, what do you think? He who was the deer king at that time in that place — that was I. Those deer were these very warriors of the city of Kuśa. And the young deer who had not yet crossed — that was this very Rabzang.'

"Monks, hear further this account of how, at another time when I had been struck through and was unable to move, when I had been born in an animal body, with my joints severed and my limbs split apart, pierced to the vitals by a sensation of agony, yet as I lay there, the wandering mendicant Rabzang took refuge in me. Listen to this.

Monks, long ago, in a time gone by, in the land of Vārāṇasī there was a king by the name of Brahmadaṭṭa who was ruling as king — wealthy, prosperous, happy, with fine harvests, full of people, thronged with a great multitude — with quarrels, disputes, attacks from enemies, and conflicts thoroughly

pacified, free from thieves and disease, abounding in grain, molasses, cattle, and buffalo: a Dharma-king endowed with the Dharma, governing as a king ought to govern according to the Dharma. His horse, named Wise-Knowing, died. And the tributary kings of the border regions, hearing that the horse named Wise-Knowing belonging to King Brahmadatta had died, sent messengers there with this instruction: 'Either exact a tribute from him, or let him not emerge from the city gate; otherwise, once a new one has certainly been born and harnessed, summon it here.' But no tribute was exacted, nor did he come out through the city gate. Nevertheless, he remained within the city itself and went searching for a horse as fine as Wise-Knowing. Then at another time he found such a horse, and mounted it. It happened to be the spring season, and the trees were in full bloom. To a garden grove where geese, cranes, peacocks, parrots, Indian cuckoos, common cuckoos, and śaṅkhaśaṭha birds were giving voice, he went forth surrounded by his queen's retinue. There he amused himself in pleasure, dwelling heedlessly in a state of delight, given over to the pursuit of various diversions, and did not enter the city. The tributary kings of the border regions heard how King Brahmadatta was dwelling heedlessly in the garden grove and not entering the city. They took counsel together, arrayed themselves with a fourfold army, and surrounded the gate of the city of Vārāṇasī. A minister then said to King Brahmadatta: 'Your Majesty, the tributary kings have surrounded the city gate. Please consider what is to be done for our welfare.' The king, upon hearing this, commanded: 'Seek out wherever the wise horse Wise-Knowing is to be found. Have the fourfold army equipped as well. We shall give battle together with them.' So the horse Wise-Knowing was also readied, the fourfold army was equipped, the forces were arrayed together with them, and battle was joined. Then another of the tributary kings thrust a single lance into the flank of King Brahmadatta's horse Wise-Knowing, so that its entrails spilled forth. Pierced by the sensation of suffering, with its joints severed and its limbs split apart, a sensation that penetrated to the very vitals had come upon it — and yet, as this was happening, it braced its mind and thought thus: 'The king, beset by anguish and distress, has come to a pitiable pass; for me to abandon him is not in accordance with my nature. With diligence I will ward off the suffering and by whatever means possible I will go through the small gate and enter the city.' Thinking this, it watched for an opening to make its way into the city. And in between, within the pleasure-grove of Vārāṇasī, there lay the pool of King Brahmadatta, known as the Brahmā-Endowed Pool, adorned with blue lotuses, red lotuses, white water-lilies, and white lotuses, with its islets

beautified by geese, kāraṇḍava ducks, and herons, ringed all about with flowering and fruit-bearing trees and dense thickets, resounding with the calls of many kinds of birds. With great force it plunged into that dense grove, placed its hooves upon a lotus leaf on the surface of the Brahmā-Endowed Pool, crossed over, came out through the small gate, and then the king dismounted."

Then it fell to the ground and passed away. Thereupon the king and those ministers began to search for it everywhere. Some went into the pleasure-grove, others ran off in the four directions, but none of them found it. Each took hold of his own horse or elephant and turned back.

King Brahmadatta, in order to perform the life-ransoming rite, assembled the townspeople and country-folk of Vārāṇasī together with the remaining ministers and said: "Since the one to be ransomed is a being who has been anointed at the crown as a royal heir, how shall this be accomplished?" They replied: "Your Majesty, we shall offer half the kingdom." He said: "The one whose life I would ransom was the horse Cañjaśa, and it has passed away. Even if we gave half the kingdom to it, what could it do with it?" They replied: "Your Majesty, for its sake we shall establish houses of giving at the four gates of the city, hold a festival of merit-making outside the normal festival season, and accumulate merit." The king said: "Wise ones, that is good. Let it be done accordingly."

Then the queen, the young nobles, the ministers, and the people of the land gathered together all the finest fragrant woods and burned the body. Moreover, they erected houses of giving at the four gates of the city; they had the city cleared of stones, gravel, and rubbish; sprinkled it with sandalwood water; set out bowls of fragrant incense; raised parasols and victory banners; hung many silk streamers; and spread throughout it a delightful carpet of many kinds of flowers like the pleasure-groves of the gods' gardens. Having held a festival outside the normal season, they had this proclamation announced by drum throughout the city: "Hear, wise ones — townspeople of Vārāṇasī and you crowds of people who have come from various lands! Here, for the sake of the divine horse Cañjaśa, giving is being dispensed at the four gates of the city, and a merit-festival is being held outside the regular festival season. Therefore let each of you come forth to the Dharma, adorned with various garments, ornaments, garlands, and the finest wealth." Then the townspeople and country-folk came and held a great festival outside the regular season, and at the four gates of the city they gave gifts of many kinds

of desired things.

O monks, what do you think? That horse Caṇḍaśa was none other than myself. Even then, at that very time, though my joints were severed and my sinews and tendons were struck through with a sensation piercing as ten millions of blows, still I protected that being's life.

Here ends the fifty-fifth fascicle of the Vinaya Kṣudrakavastu.

Then again the monks were assailed by doubt, and in order to resolve all their doubts they put a question to the buddha, the Blessed One: "Venerable One, what deed did the long-lived Supriya perform such that he was made manifest as the last, the lowliest, among the hearers?" The Blessed One declared: "O monks, the very karma that the monk Supriya himself performed and accumulated, having gathered its conditions and fully transformed them — karma ripening and waiting like a flame near at hand, certain to be experienced — that karma which Supriya himself performed and accumulated, who else would experience it? O monks, karma that has been performed and accumulated does not ripen in the external earth element, nor in the water element, nor in the fire element, nor in the wind element; but in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense bases, virtuous and non-virtuous karma that has been performed does ripen.

Actions do not perish even in a hundred aeons;
they do not decay, and when the assembly and the time
come together, they ripen into their full result
for those who bear a body.

O monks, in this very same Good Aeon, in a past and gone age, when the lifespan of beings endured for twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world a Teacher named Kāśyapa — one endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed, tamer of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and men, a buddha, a Blessed One. That Blessed One dwelt in dependence upon the city of Vārāṇasī, in the deer park of Ṛṣipatana.

Now, a householder of the Blessed One Kāśyapa named Anāthapiṇḍada — Sorrowless — went forth from the household life under the Blessed One Kāśyapa for the sake of liberation. Thinking "I am liberated, I have attained independence," he made no effort. For a very long time, Sorrowless wandered about and remained in the countryside. Then the Blessed One, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha Kāśyapa, having accomplished without remainder all the deeds of a buddha, passed into his final rest like a fire whose fuel is

spent.

O monks, Sorrowless was staying near an aśoka tree, dwelling inwardly in correct meditation. A god who dwelt in that aśoka tree heard that the Blessed One Kāśyapa had passed into nirvāṇa and wept. As the god wept, a single teardrop fell upon the body of Sorrowless. Sorrowless looked up and saw the god sitting there weeping, and said: "God, why do you weep?" The god replied: "Tonight, at the midnight hour, the Blessed One Kāśyapa passes into nirvāṇa."

Then Sorrowless, upon hearing the god's words, fell as though struck to the heart, and sat there weeping with cries of lamentation. The god asked: "Why do you weep?" Sorrowless replied: "Because I am parted from a kinsman, parted from my teacher. The perfectly and fully awakened buddha Kāśyapa is my uncle. Because I did not strive in training and practice, I have remained an ordinary person, and the path is so very long that I am unable to behold him."

The god said: "Venerable one, if that is so, if I were to bring you into the presence of the Blessed One, would you be able to gain some distinction?" Sorrowless replied: "If the god were to arrange for me to behold the face of the Blessed One, my mind would fully ripen, and I would indeed attain distinction."

Then the god, by miraculous power, brought Sorrowless into the presence of the Blessed One. And upon seeing the Blessed One, faith arose in him. With faith arisen, the Blessed One Kāśyapa taught Dharma of such and such a kind, and immediately upon hearing it, Sorrowless actualized arhatship directly. And so the venerable Sorrowless was the first to pass into nirvāṇa, before the Blessed One. Then the perfectly and fully awakened Blessed One Kāśyapa passed into nirvāṇa.

Then that god saw that the venerable Sorrowless had passed into nirvāṇa, and joy arose in him. He thought: "Whatever distinction the venerable one attained — all of that was owing to me. Therefore, in a future time, when the Blessed One Kāśyapa at his final rest prophesied to that brahmin boy, his disciple, saying: 'Brahmin boy, when the lifespan of beings endures for one hundred years, you will become the Teacher Śākyamuni, a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and fully awakened buddha' — at that very time I shall be the last among that Blessed One's hearers to actualize arhatship directly, and I shall pass into nirvāṇa before the Blessed One. And may it come to pass that the Blessed One Śākyamuni then passes into nirvāṇa." Thus did he make an aspiration.

The Blessed One then declared: O monks, what do you think?

That god was none other than Subhadrā himself. Therefore, monks, train yourselves in the following way: because one should rely upon a virtuous spiritual friend (kalyāṇamitra), dwell together with the virtuous, and depend upon virtue; and should not rely upon wicked companions, not dwell together with the wicked, and not depend upon wickedness — monks, train yourselves in precisely this way.

Then the venerable Ānanda addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Reverend One, while I had gone alone into seclusion and was dwelling in inner stillness, a thought of this kind arose in my mind: that relying upon a virtuous spiritual friend, dwelling together with the virtuous, and depending upon virtue, while not relying upon wicked companions, not dwelling together with the wicked, and not depending upon wickedness — this is half of the holy life." The Blessed One replied: "Ānanda, do not say that relying upon a virtuous spiritual friend, dwelling together with the virtuous, depending upon virtue, not relying upon wicked companions, not dwelling together with the wicked, and not depending upon wickedness is half of the holy life. Why is that? Ānanda, this is the holy life in its entirety, fulfilled to the utmost, unmixed, completely perfect, completely pure, completely purified — namely: relying upon a virtuous spiritual friend, dwelling together with the virtuous, depending upon virtue, not relying upon wicked companions, not dwelling together with the wicked, and not depending upon wicked companions. And why, Ānanda? Because through relying upon a virtuous spiritual friend, those sentient beings who are subject to birth become fully liberated from the nature of birth; and those who are subject to old age, sickness, death, grief, lamentation, suffering, mental unhappiness, and agitation become fully liberated from the nature of agitation. Ānanda, by means of such a category of reasoning you should understand this. This holy life that is fulfilled to the utmost, unmixed, completely perfect, and completely purified is precisely this: relying upon a virtuous spiritual friend, dwelling together with the virtuous, depending upon virtue, not relying upon wicked companions, not dwelling together with the wicked, and not depending upon wicked companions. Ānanda, train yourself accordingly."

Then the Blessed One declared to the monks: "Monks, therefore from this day forward, apart from Śākya kinsmen and those bearing matted fiery hair, none of the other wandering non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) shall be given the going forth or full ordination. Should Śākya kinsmen come bearing the banner of the non-Buddhists and wish to go forth in this well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya,

and to receive full ordination and obtain the status of a monk, the monks shall give them the going forth and grant them full ordination. Why is that? Monks, it is because this is a concession to kinship granted to our own kindred. If other wandering non-Buddhists come and wish to go forth in this well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, and to receive full ordination and obtain the status of a monk, the monks shall place them under the care of a preceptor, providing robes, for a period of four months. If during that time they render service and are able to satisfy the minds of the monks, the monks shall then grant them the going forth and full ordination. As for those bearing matted fiery hair, monks shall give them the going forth and grant them full ordination as well."

"And why is that, monks? Those who bear matted fiery hair are ones who speak of action. Monks, those who bear matted fiery hair are ones who speak of action, who speak of cause, who speak of diligence. Therefore, monks, you shall train in this way: 'One who speaks of action, who speaks of cause, who speaks of diligence — you too, monk, shall train to be just such a one.'

Therefore, monks, whatever Dharma you perceive that brings benefit and happiness in this present life, and benefit and happiness in future lives, that the monks shall uphold and bring to complete fulfillment. In whatever way they take it up, retain it, and recite it, the holy life will long endure, bringing benefit to the many, happiness to the many, compassion toward the world, benefit and happiness to gods and humans alike. These are the following: the category of sūtras, the category of mixed prose and verse, the category of prophetic declarations, the category of verse, the category of intentional sayings, the category of origin narratives, the category of stories of spiritual attainment, the category of accounts of past deeds, the category of birth stories, the category of extensive teachings, the category of marvellous Dharma, and the category of established doctrines. These, monks, are what bring benefit and happiness in this present life, benefit and happiness in future lives. The monks shall uphold them and bring them to complete fulfillment. In whatever way they take them up, retain them, and recite them, the holy life will long endure, bringing benefit to the many, happiness to the many, compassion toward the world, benefit and happiness to gods and humans alike.

Monks, after I, your Teacher, have passed into complete nirvāṇa and am no more, you shall not think: 'We have no Teacher, our Teacher is gone.' For the reason that I have taught the recitation of the Prātimokṣa sūtra every fortnight — from this day forward, that shall be your Teacher; that is your Teacher.

Monks, as for the minor and petty rules of training, the Saṅgha community may set them aside and abide in ease and comfort.

Monks, from this day forward, newly ordained monks shall not address senior monks by name or by clan. They may address them only as 'Venerable' or as 'Venerable One,' and not otherwise. And senior monks shall gather in junior monks with gifts of alms-bowls, robes, nets, bowls, and belts; they shall keep them close, have them recite, have them chant, transmit the scriptural teachings to them, and lead them to engage in yogic practice in mind.

Monks, the faithful sons and daughters of good family throughout these four directions shall be mindful of the following for as long as they live. What are the four? 'The Blessed One was born here. The Blessed One here fully awakened to the unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. Here the Blessed One turned the wheel of Dharma three times in its twelve aspects. Here the Blessed One passed into the utter nirvāṇa of the element beyond all remainders of the aggregates.' Monks, after I have passed on, those who come here to circumambulate the stūpa and to pay homage to the stūpa — to them you shall say these words: 'The Blessed One was born here.'"

"The Blessed One here fully awakened to the unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. Here the Blessed One turned the wheel of Dharma three times in its twelve aspects. Here the Blessed One passed into the utter nirvāṇa of the element beyond all remainders of the aggregates." All of these things are to be recalled. Those among them who die with a mind of faith in me — all of them shall go to a higher realm. Some shall go with a remainder of the aggregates still present. Monks, those from these four directions — sons of good family or daughters of good family who have faith — shall make their pilgrimage here for as long as they live. What are the four? "The Blessed One was born here. The Blessed One here fully awakened to the unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. Here the Blessed One turned the wheel of Dharma three times in its twelve aspects. Here the Blessed One passed into the utter nirvāṇa of the element beyond all remainders of the aggregates." Monks, after I have passed on, those who come here to circumambulate the stūpa and to pay homage to the stūpa — to them you shall say these words: "The Blessed One was born here. The Blessed One here fully awakened to the unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. Here the Blessed One turned the wheel of Dharma three times in its twelve aspects. Here the Blessed One passed into the utter nirvāṇa of the element without any remainder of the

aggregates whatsoever." All of these things are to be recalled. Those who die with a mind of faith in me — all of them shall go to a higher realm. Some shall go with a remainder of the aggregates still present. Thus shall you be mindful of them exactly as they are to be approached in practice.

Then the Blessed One addressed the monks in these words: "Monks, if any among you have doubt or uncertainty regarding the Buddha, the Dharma, the Saṅgha, suffering, the origin of suffering, cessation, or the path, do not suppress those questions — ask them, and I shall prophesy the answer for you. Do not think: 'We would not dare to answer directly in the presence of our Teacher.' Monks shall speak to monks, and companions shall speak to companions, and whatever is asked shall be prophesied in response."

Then the venerable Ānanda addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, so far as I can understand the meaning of what you, the Venerable Blessed One, have taught — among all these monks of the assembly gathered here, there is not a single monk who has doubt or uncertainty regarding the Buddha, the Dharma, the Saṅgha, suffering, the origin of suffering, cessation, or the path."

"Excellent, excellent, Ānanda! You say this out of faith, Ānanda. But the Tathāgata's gnosis, which sees without remainder, is unsurpassed. Indeed, among all the monks of the assembly gathered here, there is not a single monk who has doubt or uncertainty regarding suffering, the origin of suffering, cessation, or the path. Yet the Tathāgata's purpose in this is his compassion for the sentient beings of future times."

Then the Blessed One removed the upper robe from his own body and declared to the monks: "Monks, look upon the body of the Tathāgata. Monks, look well upon the body of the Tathāgata. And why is that?"

To behold a Tathāgata, a foe-destroyer, a perfectly and fully awakened buddha, is rare — like the udumbara flower.

"Monks, now say nothing. Know this: all conditioned phenomena are subject to disintegration." Having declared these, his final words as the Tathāgata, the Blessed One entered meditative absorption in the first dhyāna. Rising from the first dhyāna, he entered meditative absorption in the second dhyāna. Rising from the second dhyāna, he entered meditative absorption in the third dhyāna. Rising from the third dhyāna, he entered meditative absorption in the fourth dhyāna. Rising from the fourth dhyāna, he entered meditative absorption in the sphere of infinite space. Rising from the sphere of infinite

space, he entered meditative absorption in the sphere of infinite consciousness. Rising from the sphere of infinite consciousness, he entered meditative absorption in the sphere of nothingness. Rising from the sphere of nothingness, he entered meditative absorption in the sphere of neither-perception-nor-non-perception. Rising from the sphere of neither-perception-nor-non-perception, he entered meditative absorption in the cessation of perception and feeling.

Then the venerable Ānanda said to the venerable Anuruddha: "Venerable Anuruddha, has the Blessed One passed into complete nirvāṇa?"

"No, venerable Ānanda. The Blessed One, the Buddha, has entered meditative absorption in the cessation of perception and feeling."

"Venerable Anuruddha, the Blessed One, the Buddha, has entered meditative absorption in the fourth dhyāna, has obtained the eye of peaceful, unmoving stillness, and will pass into complete nirvāṇa." Thus did I hear directly from the Blessed One, and directly did I receive it.

Then the Blessed One arose from the cessation of perception and feeling and entered meditative absorption in the sphere of neither-perception-nor-non-perception. Rising from the sphere of neither-perception-nor-non-perception, he entered meditative absorption in the sphere of nothingness. Rising from the sphere of nothingness, he entered meditative absorption in the sphere of infinite consciousness. Rising from the sphere of infinite consciousness, he entered meditative absorption in the sphere of infinite space. Rising from the sphere of infinite space, he entered meditative absorption in the fourth dhyāna. Rising from the fourth dhyāna, he entered meditative absorption in the third dhyāna. Rising from the third dhyāna, he entered meditative absorption in the second dhyāna. Rising from the second dhyāna, he entered meditative absorption in the first dhyāna. Rising from the first dhyāna, he entered meditative absorption in the second dhyāna. Rising from the second dhyāna, he entered meditative absorption in the third dhyāna. Rising from the third dhyāna, he entered meditative absorption in the fourth dhyāna. And the Blessed One, the Buddha, having entered meditative absorption in the fourth dhyāna and having obtained the eye of peaceful, unmoving stillness, passed into complete nirvāṇa.

The very moment the Blessed One, the Buddha, passed into complete nirvāṇa, the great earth trembled, shooting stars fell, the directions blazed, and from the sky the gods sounded the roll of drums.

At that time the venerable Mahākāśyapa, who was staying at the Kalandaka Bamboo Grove in Rājagṛha, was roused by the earthquake and wondered: "What has happened?" He perceived that the Blessed One had passed into complete nirvāṇa. And he reflected, grounding himself in the nature of reality: "All conditioned phenomena are thus."

Now, the body-servant Ajātaśatru — a man of royal birth and genuine, rootless faith — upon hearing that the Blessed One had passed into complete nirvāṇa, Mahākāśyapa understood, would vomit warm blood and fall into a mortal crisis. He therefore thought: "I must devise some means to deal with this." And so he spoke to Varṣakāra, one of the great ministers of the land of Magadha, saying: "Varṣakāra, know this: the Blessed One has passed into complete nirvāṇa. If that body-servant, King Ajātaśatru of genuine, rootless faith, hears that the Blessed One has passed into complete nirvāṇa, he will vomit warm blood and fall into a mortal crisis. You must understand that a means must be devised for him."

Varṣakāra replied: "Noble one, please describe in order what the means should be."

Mahākāśyapa said: "Varṣakāra, come here. Go quickly, as fast as you can, to the king's pleasure grove. There you shall paint images depicting how the Blessed One, while residing as a bodhisattva in the Tuṣita heaven and surveying the world with his five kinds of vision, trained the gods of the six classes of the desire realm three times, then appeared in the form of an elephant and descended into his mother's womb; how, after descending, he fully and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed complete awakening at the foot of the tree of awakening; how the Blessed One turned the wheel of Dharma in its twelve aspects, proclaiming it three times, at Vārāṇasī; how he displayed the great miracle at Śrāvastī; how he ascended to the realm of the gods of the Thirty-Three to teach the Dharma to his mother, face to face, and then descended to the city of Sāṃkāśya; how he tamed those who were to be tamed in whatever direction they dwelt; and how, having thus completed all the deeds of a buddha, he departed to his final resting place in the city of Kuśinagara. Paint images of all these things.

As for the seven long-stemmed offering bowls, fill them with butter, arranged level at the bottom; and the eighth, fill it with sandalwood gosirṣa, and place it in that part of the pleasure grove.

As soon as the king comes through the gate, have someone say that a certain deity has gone to visit the pleasure grove. When the king sees the paintings and asks, 'Varṣakāra, what is this?' you shall explain at length: 'Sire, this is the city of Kapilavastu — it was in this direction that the Blessed One was born. This is the bank of the Nairāñjanā river — it was in this direction that the Blessed One, seated at the Vajrāsana, fully and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed complete awakening. This is the city of Vārāṇasī — it was in this direction that the Blessed One turned the wheel of Dharma in its twelve aspects, proclaiming it three times. This is the city of Śrāvastī — it was in this direction that the Blessed One displayed the great miracle. This is the city of Sāṃkāśya — it was here that the Blessed One descended from the realm of the gods of the Thirty-Three. This is the city of Kuśinagara — it was in this direction that, having tamed those who were to be tamed in whatever direction they dwelt and having completed all the deeds of a buddha, he departed to his final resting place.' And then, as soon as the king hears this and before the words have even passed, he will faint and fall to the ground. At that moment, you shall lower him into the long-stemmed bowl filled with butter. When that butter melts, transfer him from the second bowl, and so on through to the seventh. Then, lifting him out, place him in the long-stemmed bowl filled with sandalwood gosirṣa. He will recover."

Having said this, the venerable Mahākāśyapa departed for the city of Kuśinagara.

The painter, working with great haste, drew all the paintings on a large scale. When he had finished, the king came outside, and the painter said, "Your Majesty has come to the pleasure grove." As the king entered the pleasure grove and saw the paintings, he asked, "Painter, what is this?" The painter then explained in detail, just as before, up to the words: "It was in this very direction that the Blessed One departed to his final resting place." Then the king said, "Painter, what are you saying? Has the Blessed One passed completely into nirvāṇa?" But the painter sat there and said nothing.

Then King Ajātaśatru fainted and fell to the ground. The painter lowered him into the long-stemmed bowl filled with butter and immersed him seven times in succession. He then lifted him out and placed him in the long-stemmed bowl filled with sandalwood gosirṣa, and the king recovered.

Now, immediately after the Blessed One, the buddha and bhagavān, had passed into nirvāṇa, beneath a supreme śāla tree in the grove of twin śāla

trees, where flowers were falling, the Blessed One lay in repose like a lion. At that moment, another monk spoke these verses:

Here in this grove of twin śāla trees, most beautiful,
amid these supreme flowering boughs,
upon the Teacher who has passed into nirvāṇa
flowers have fallen and scattered all around.

Immediately after the Blessed One, the buddha and bhagavān, had passed into nirvāṇa, Śakra, lord of the gods and ruler of the hundred powers, spoke these verses:

Alas! Formations are impermanent,
their nature is to arise and to pass away.
Having arisen, they cease —
their coming to rest is peace and bliss.

Immediately after the Blessed One, the buddha and bhagavān, had passed into nirvāṇa, Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, spoke these verses:

All beings in this world have come to the end of what they have accumulated.
In this world that passes away, he was a person without equal,
a Tathāgata endowed with vision, who had attained the powers —
even a Teacher such as this has passed fully into nirvāṇa.

Immediately after the Blessed One, the buddha and bhagavān, had passed into nirvāṇa, the venerable Aniruddha spoke these verses:

With a mind of steadiness he protected beings,
and attained the unshakeable peace.
His exhalation and inhalation ceased,
and the one endowed with vision passed fully into nirvāṇa.

He who was endowed with excellence in every regard —
when the Teacher made his time,
then there arose a great trembling,
and even the hairs of the body stood on end.
With a mind free of despondency,
he remained especially present in his feelings.
His mind was completely liberated —
that lamp, just so, has passed into nirvāṇa.

Immediately after the Blessed One, the buddha and bhagavān, had passed into nirvāṇa, some monks flung themselves on the ground; some seized their

shoulders and cried out in lamentation; some sat pierced with pain; and some, grounding themselves in the nature of reality, reflected in this way: "That which the Blessed One taught to us so thoroughly — all that was dear and precious, a source of joy and delight — has now departed, has ceased, has been scattered and dispersed."

Then the venerable Aniruddha said to the venerable Ānanda: "Venerable Ānanda, if the monks do not gradually and gently restrain themselves, then the gods of the Mighty One who, through countless hundreds of eons, have gone forth into the monastic life in this well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, will taunt them, mock them, and speak ill of them, saying: 'See how these monks who have gone forth remain long in unthinking indolence.'" Aniruddha then asked how many gods were present. Ānanda, from the distance between the city of Kuśinagara and the river Hiraṇyavatī, and from the distance to the grove of twin śāla trees, to the stupa crowned with a warrior's diadem — within a radius of twelve yojanas all around, those of great power...

there was not the slightest space left uncovered or unfilled by gods of great renown — not even a gap the size of a mustard seed. Some of those gods fell prostrate upon the ground. Some beat their shoulders and wailed aloud. Some sat with minds pierced by grief. And some, reflecting upon the nature of reality, thought: "Thus has the Blessed One taught us again and again, in countless ways, that all which is dear and beloved to the heart must be separated from, lost, gone, dissolved, and dispersed."

That evening, the venerable Anuruddha spoke to the venerable Ānanda words of decisive Dharma, and then sat in silence with the composure of a noble one. Then, when that night had passed and dawn had come, the venerable Anuruddha said this to the venerable Ānanda: "Venerable Ānanda, go to the Mallas of the city of Kuśinagara and say to the leading men there: 'Tonight, at the middle watch of the night, the Teacher passed into the final nirvāṇa, the nirvāṇa without remainder, into the realm of complete cessation. Whatever you have to do and to accomplish, do it now, so that you do not afterward fall into the thought: "Our Teacher passed into final nirvāṇa, into the realm of complete cessation without remainder, and we were not able to honor him and to exert ourselves in his service."'"

After the venerable Anuruddha had spoken thus, the venerable Ānanda heeded him, took up his robe, and went to the assembly hall of the Mallas of the city of Kuśinagara, together with other monks and with wandering ascetics

who were in attendance. At that time, in the assembly hall of the Mallas of the city of Kuśinagara, there were gathered about five hundred Mallas who had come together for some affair.

Then the venerable Ānanda said this to the Mallas of the city of Kuśinagara: "O wise leading men, great assembly gathered together — you Mallas of many retainers — hear this. Tonight, at the middle watch of the night, the Teacher has passed into final nirvāṇa, into the realm of complete cessation without remainder. Whatever you have to do and to accomplish, do it now, so that you do not afterward fall into the thought: 'Our Teacher passed into the realm of complete cessation without remainder, and we were not able to honor him and to exert ourselves in his service.'"

After this was said, some of the Mallas of Kuśinagara fell prostrate upon the ground. Some beat their shoulders and wailed aloud. Some sat with minds pierced by grief. And some, reflecting upon the nature of reality, thought: "Thus has the Blessed One taught us again and again, in countless ways, that all which is dear and beloved to the heart must be separated from, lost, gone, dissolved, and dispersed."

Then the Mallas of the city of Kuśinagara, taking as much perfume, garlands, incense, powder, and musical instruments as there was, together with their sons, wives, male servants, female servants, workers, those who lived on wages, their friends and companions, kinsmen, ministers, and blood relations, came forth from the city of Kuśinagara and went to the grove of twin śāla trees. There they paid homage and honor to the Blessed One as he lay in the lion's posture — with perfume, garlands, incense, powder, and music — paying him reverence, doing him honor, venerating and adorning him.

Then again, the leading chiefs of the Mallas of the city of Kuśinagara spoke to the venerable Ānanda, saying: "Venerable Ānanda, how should we pay homage to the remains of the Blessed One, and with what diligence should we carry it out? The proper arrangement is this: it should be done as it is done for a wheel-turning king (cakravartin). Venerable Ānanda, how exactly is it done for a wheel-turning king?"

"The proper arrangement for a wheel-turning king is this: the body is wrapped in cotton wool, and having been wrapped in cotton wool, it is then wound with five hundred pairs of cloth. Having been wound with five hundred pairs of cloth, it is placed in an iron vessel, which is filled with sesame oil, and covered on top with two iron lids. All manner of fragrant woods are piled up, and the

body is cremated with these. The fire is then extinguished with milk. The bones are placed inside a golden urn, and at the crossroads of a great highway a bone stūpa is erected, with parasols, victory banners, and pennants set up, and it is venerated, exalted, adorned, and honored with perfume, garlands, incense, powder, and music, and great festivals are also held. That, good people, is what is done for a wheel-turning king — and for a Tathāgata, an arhat, a fully and perfectly awakened buddha, it should be done even more excellently than that."

Having heard from the venerable Ānanda what he had said, they understood what was being asked of them. Since assembling one, or two, or three canopies together proved difficult, within seven days the Mallas gathered cotton wool, and having gathered the cotton wool, they also gathered five hundred pairs of cloth. Having gathered five hundred pairs of cloth, they prepared an iron vessel. Having prepared the iron vessel, they piled up all manner of fragrant woods. Having piled up all manner of fragrant woods, they made ready the golden urn. Having made ready the golden urn, they arranged the golden bier. Having arranged the golden bier, from the city of Kuśinagara as far as the Hiraṇyavatī River, and from the grove of twin śāla trees as far as the stūpa crowned by the Mallas with a jeweled diadem — a distance of twelve yojanas — all along that length they took up supplies of perfume, garlands, incense, powder, and musical instruments, and set forth from the city of Kuśinagara. They went to the grove of twin śāla trees, and there they paid reverence, honor, respect, and homage to the Blessed One as he lay in the lion's posture, with perfume, garlands, incense, powder, and music.

Then the leading chiefs of the Mallas of Kuśinagara spoke to the assembled Mallas, saying: "Let the great multitude of the Mallas of Kuśinagara, you who are gathered and assembled, you men of understanding — listen well! Let the wives of the Mallas and the daughters of the Mallas each spread a layer of cloth over the Blessed One. Let the Mallas and the young Malla men carry the bier of the Blessed One. And let us pay reverence, honor, respect, and homage with perfume, garlands, incense, powder, and music."

They would enter through the western gate of the city of Kuśinagara, pass straight through the middle, emerge from the eastern gate of the city of Kuśinagara, cross the river Hiraṇyavatī, and place the bier of the Blessed One at the shrine adorned with a diadem by the Mallas, and there it should rest.

Then the Mallas of Kuśinagara agreed, saying "We shall do so." And the wives of the Mallas and the daughters of the Mallas spread layers of cloth over the Blessed One. The Mallas and the young Malla men then wished to lift the bier of the Blessed One, but they were unable to lift it. Since the venerable Ānanda had not yet spoken, he said this to the venerable Ānanda: "Venerable Ānanda, the Mallas of Kuśinagara have been unable to lift the bier of the Blessed One. Why is that?" "Because it is the intention of the gods." "Venerable Ānanda, what then is the intention of the gods?" "It is the intention of the gods that the wives of the Mallas and the daughters of the Mallas should spread layers of cloth over the Blessed One, and that the Mallas and the young Malla men should lift the bier of the Blessed One, and that we ourselves should pay reverence, honor, respect, and homage with divine perfume, garlands, incense, powder, and music; that we should enter through the western gate of the city of Kuśinagara, pass straight through the middle, emerge from the eastern gate of the city of Kuśinagara, cross the river Hiranyavatī, and place the bier at the shrine adorned with a diadem by the Mallas, and there let it rest." This was the intention the gods had formed.

"Venerable Ānanda, let it be done as the gods have intended."

Then the venerable Ānanda said this to the Mallas of Kuśinagara: "Men of understanding, you who are assembled — the reason you were unable to lift the bier of the Blessed One is that it is the intention of the gods." "Venerable Ānanda, what is the intention of the gods?" "The gods have intended this: that the wives of the Mallas and the daughters of the Mallas should spread layers of cloth over the Blessed One, that the Mallas and the young Malla men should lift the bier of the Blessed One, and that we ourselves should pay reverence, honor, respect, and homage with divine perfume, garlands, incense, powder, and music; that we should enter through the western gate of the city of Kuśinagara, pass straight through the middle, emerge from the eastern gate of the city of Kuśinagara, cross the river Hiranyavatī, and place the bier at the shrine adorned with a diadem by the Mallas, and there let it rest. This is what the gods have intended." "Venerable Ānanda, let it be done as the gods have intended."

Then the wives of the Mallas and the daughters of the Mallas spread layers of cloth over the Blessed One. The Mallas and the young Malla men lifted the bier of the Blessed One, and at the very moment they lifted it, the gods dwelling in the sky scattered divine flowers — utpalas, lotuses, white lotuses, kumudas — as well as powder of agaru and tamāla wood, and divine mādārava flowers

and other such blooms; they raised the sounds of divine music, and they cast down many garments.

Moreover, the leading chiefs of the Mallas of Kuśinagara spoke to the assembled Mallas of Kuśinagara, saying: "Men of understanding, you who are assembled — let us set aside our human musical instruments, and let us ourselves pay reverence, honor, respect, and homage with divine perfume, garlands, incense, powder, and music.

They said: "Let us proceed through the western gate of the city of Kuśinagara, pass straight through the city, exit by the eastern gate, cross the river Hiraṇyavatī, and place the remains to rest at the stūpa crowned with the garland raised by the champion."

The Minor Matters of the Vinaya, the fifty-sixth fascicle.

Then the champions of Kuśinagara set aside their human musical instruments, and with divine perfume, garlands, incense, powder, and the sound of music they paid reverence, honor, respect, and homage. They entered through the western gate of the city of Kuśinagara, passed straight through the middle of the city, emerged from the eastern gate, crossed the river Hiraṇyavatī, and placed the remains to rest at the stūpa crowned with the garland raised by the champion.

At that time, divine māṇḍārava flowers fell upon the city of Kuśinagara to the depth of a person's knees.

At that time, a certain wandering ascetic (ājīvika) took up a great quantity of those divine māṇḍārava flowers and set out for the land of Malla with some business in mind. And at that time, the Venerable Mahākāśyapa, accompanied by five hundred attendants, was traveling the road from the land of Malla toward the city of Kuśinagara, wishing to pay homage to the uncorrupted bodily relics of the Blessed One. The Venerable Mahākāśyapa saw that wandering ascetic there on the road, and seeing him, he said to him: "Venerable wandering ascetic, from where have you come, and where are you going?"

"Reverend Mahākāśyapa, I have come from the city of Kuśinagara and am going to the land of Malla on a certain errand."

"Venerable wandering ascetic, do you know of my Teacher?"

"Noble one, indeed — it is the monk Gautama."

"Noble Mahākāśyapa, that Teacher passed into complete nirvāṇa seven days ago today. These divine mādārava flowers that I have taken are ones that were offered in reverence to his bodily relics."

At that moment, a certain elder of another group began to speak improper words, saying: "Thus, racked with regret and the infirmity of age, I used to say to the monks, 'This is what should be done; this is what should not be done' — but now I am freed from that. Let us now do what we are able to do, and not do what we are not able to do." And as he was speaking these unseemly words, the gods dwelling in the sky obscured them so that not one member of the assembly of monks heard them — none, that is, except the Venerable Mahākāśyapa.

Then the Venerable Mahākāśyapa, in order to tame the one who had spoken such improper words, turned aside from the road and took his seat on a prepared seat in the midst of the assembly of monks. Having seated himself, the Venerable Mahākāśyapa spoke to the monks thus: "Venerable ones, all conditioned things are impermanent, unstable, unreliable, and subject to change. For so long as this is so, one should turn away from all conditioned phenomena and win liberation from them. Venerable ones, I shall now go far to look upon the uncorrupted bodily relics of the Blessed One."

Then the champions of Kuśinagara wrapped the bodily relics of the Blessed One in cotton batting, and having wrapped them in cotton batting, they wound them in five hundred pairs of cloth. Having wound them in five hundred pairs of cloth, they placed them in an iron casket and filled it with sesame oil. Having placed them in the iron casket and filled it with sesame oil, they covered it from above with two iron lids.

They piled up all the fragrant wood and tried to light the fire for the cremation, but they were unable to do so.

Then the Venerable Aniruddha spoke to the Venerable Ānanda, saying: "Venerable Ānanda, the champions of Kuśinagara have been unable to light the fire for the cremation of the bodily relics of the Blessed One. Why is that? Because the gods have so intended it. Venerable Aniruddha, what is it that the gods have intended? It is this: the Venerable Mahākāśyapa, accompanied by a retinue of five hundred, has set out on the road from the region of the sinful country and is journeying toward Kuśinagara, intending to come and pay homage to the uncorrupted bodily relics of the Blessed One. Venerable Aniruddha, you should act in accordance with what the gods have intended."

Then the Venerable Ānanda spoke to the champions of Kuśinagara, saying: "O champions of Kuśinagara, you who are assembled here in your great multitude — you who are wise and well-composed — hear this. The reason you have been unable to light the fire for the cremation of the bodily relics of the Blessed One is that the gods have so intended it. Venerable Ānanda, what is it that the gods have intended? It is this: the Venerable Mahākāśyapa, accompanied by a retinue of five hundred, has set out on the road from the region of the sinful country and is journeying to Kuśinagara, intending to come and pay homage to the uncorrupted bodily relics of the Blessed One."

They replied: "Venerable Ānanda, we shall act in accordance with what the gods have intended."

Then when the Venerable Mahākāśyapa arrived at Kuśinagara, his retinue saw him from a great distance. Seeing him, they took up perfumes, garlands, incense, powders, and musical instruments, and went to where the Venerable Mahākāśyapa was. Having gone there, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Venerable Mahākāśyapa and followed along behind him as he went forward.

The Venerable Mahākāśyapa, surrounded by many hundreds of attendants, many thousands of attendants, and many hundreds of thousands of attendants, proceeded to where the Blessed One was. All the fragrant wood was then removed. Having removed all the fragrant wood, the lid of the iron casket was opened. Having opened the lid of the iron casket, the five hundred pairs of cloth were unwound. Having unwound the five hundred pairs of cloth, the cotton batting was also removed. Having removed the cotton batting, they paid homage to the uncorrupted bodily relics of the Blessed One.

At that time on this great earth there were four great śrāvakas: the Venerable Ājñāta Kauṇḍinya, the Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, the Venerable Daśabala Kāśyapa, and the Venerable Mahākāśyapa. Among them, the Venerable Mahākāśyapa was endowed with wisdom and great merit, and he obtained robes, alms-food, a resting place, and medicines and necessities for the sick.

Then the Venerable Mahākāśyapa thought to himself: "I myself should perform the act of making offerings to the Blessed One." Having generated enthusiasm for this, the Venerable Mahākāśyapa prepared fresh cotton batting, and having prepared fresh cotton batting, he also prepared another five hundred pairs of cloth. Having prepared another five hundred pairs of cloth, he wrapped the

bodily relics of the Blessed One in the cotton batting. Having wrapped them in the cotton batting, he wound them in the five hundred pairs of cloth. Having wound them in the five hundred pairs of cloth,

he placed them in an iron casket and filled it with sesame oil. Having placed them in the iron casket and filled it with sesame oil, he covered the top with two iron lids and piled up all manner of fragrant woods. Having piled them up, he withdrew to one side, and then, just as it happens through the buddha-power of the buddhas and the divine power of the gods, the pyre ignited of itself.

Then the Venerable Ānanda circumambulated the piled-up bodily relics of the Blessed One, and at that moment he spoke these verses:

The guide who possessed the precious body,
who went with great miraculous power to the Brahmā world —
the buddha's body wound about with five hundred pairs of cloth
and with a thousand robes throughout:
by his own resplendence, the bodily relics
and all the wrappings were utterly consumed.
Of those robes, only two were not burned —
these two, the innermost and the outermost.

Then the warriors of the city of Kuśinagara extinguished those fires with milk, and from that milk four trees arose, namely: the Golden One, the Pale Yellow One, the Horse-Wish, and that called the Udumbara.

Then the warriors of the city of Kuśinagara placed those bodily relics in a golden urn, set them upon a golden palanquin, and paid them honor with fragrant substances, garlands, incense, powdered offerings, and the sounds of music; they held them high, they adorned them with ornament, they made offerings. They proceeded to the city of Kuśinagara and, having had the relics installed in the very center of that chief city, they paid them honor with fragrant substances, garlands, incense, powdered offerings, and the sounds of music; they held them high, they adorned them with ornament, they made offerings.

Then the warriors of the wicked country heard that, seven days having now passed since the Blessed One had passed into nirvāṇa in the city of Kuśinagara, the warriors there were performing relic-worship with the bodily relics. Upon hearing this, they equipped a fourfold army — a host of elephants, a host of horses, a host of chariots, and a host of foot soldiers — went to where

the warriors of the city of Kuśinagara were, and spoke to them thus: "You many gathered and assembled retainers of the warriors of Kuśinagara, listen well, you who are wise. The Blessed One was for us from long ago our cherished and beloved one. Since he passed into nirvāṇa while dwelling in the vicinity of your city, give us a share of the bodily relics of the Blessed One, a portion of the relics. We will erect a stūpa for the bodily relics of the Blessed One in the wicked country and honor it with parasols, victory banners, and flags; with fragrant substances, garlands, incense, powdered offerings, and the sounds of music; we will hold it high, adorn it with ornament, make offerings — and having made offerings, we will also hold a great festival."

The warriors of Kuśinagara replied: "The Blessed One was indeed from long ago our cherished and beloved one as well, and since he passed away while dwelling in the vicinity of our city, we will not give you a share of the bodily relics of the Blessed One, a portion of the relics. If you accept this, then well and good. But if you do not, we will ravage you with our armies."

The warriors of Kuśinagara held firm to this position.

The Kṣatriya prince Buluka dwelling in the rolling country of Ṭoka, the Kṣatriyas of the city of Rāmagāma, the brahmins dwelling in Viṣṇudvīpa, the Kṣatriya Śākyas dwelling in the city of Kapilavastu, and the Kṣatriya Licchavīs dwelling in Vaiśālī also heard the news, as did Ajātaśatru, son of Vaidehī, the king of the country of Magadha — that the Blessed One had passed into nirvāṇa, and that the warriors of the wicked country and

the Kṣatriya prince Buluka dwelling in the rolling country of Ṭoka, the Kṣatriyas of the city of Rāmagāma, the brahmins dwelling in Viṣṇudvīpa, the Kṣatriya Śākyas dwelling in the city of Kapilavastu, and the Kṣatriya Licchavīs dwelling in Vaiśālī had all armed their fourfold armies and marched to Kuśinagara to pay homage to the relics and to receive a share of the relics there.

Upon hearing this news, the brahmin Vassakāra, who was the great minister of the country of Magadha, spoke to him thus: "Vassakāra, I am unable to act. Go yourself, arm the fourfold army, and march to the warriors of Kuśinagara bearing my message. Ask after their welfare — whether their afflictions are few, whether their distress is slight, whether they are active, whether they are well, whether they dwell in contact with strength and ease — and speak these words: 'O wise ones, the Blessed One was long my cherished and beloved teacher. Now that he has passed into nirvāṇa in the vicinity of your city, O wise ones, grant me a share of the relics, the bodily remains of the Blessed One. I

shall erect a stūpa for the relics of the Blessed One in Rājagṛha and honour, exalt, adorn, and make offering to them with parasols, victory banners, pennants, forms, fragrant substances, garlands, incense, powder, and the sounds of music. Having made such offerings, I shall also hold a great festival.' Thus instruct them."

Vassakāra replied, "It shall be done, my lord." Then Ajātaśatru, son of Vaidehī, the king of the country of Magadha, mounted an elephant, and as he did so his mind turned to recollecting the qualities of the Blessed One, and he fell into a swoon. He was then taken down from the elephant and placed upon a horse, and upon that horse he swooned again. Then he said: "Vassakāra, I am unable to go. Go yourself, arm the fourfold army, and march to the warriors of Kuśinagara. Ask after their welfare on my behalf — whether their afflictions are few, whether their distress is slight, whether they are active, whether they are well, whether they dwell in contact with strength and ease — and then speak these words: 'O wise ones, the Blessed One was long my cherished and beloved teacher. Now that he has passed into nirvāṇa in the vicinity of your city, O wise ones, grant me a share of the relics, the bodily remains of the Blessed One. I shall erect a stūpa for the relics of the Blessed One in Rājagṛha and honour, exalt, adorn, and make offering to them with parasols, victory banners, pennants, forms, fragrant substances, garlands, incense, powder, and the sounds of music. Having made such offerings, I shall also hold a great festival.' Thus instruct them."

Vassakāra replied, "It shall be done, my lord." Having received these instructions from King Ajātaśatru, son of Vaidehī, the brahmin Vassakāra, great minister of the country of Magadha, armed the fourfold army and set out for Kuśinagara. Upon arriving there, he addressed the warriors of Kuśinagara before a large and assembled gathering of that city's warriors: "O wise ones, let the many warriors and retinue of Kuśinagara hearken. O wise ones, we bring the greetings of King Ajātaśatru, son of Vaidehī, king of Magadha — whether your afflictions are few, whether your distress is slight, whether you are active, whether you are well, whether you dwell in contact with strength and ease. And he speaks these words: 'O wise ones, the Blessed One was long my cherished and beloved teacher. Now that he has passed into nirvāṇa in the vicinity of your city, O wise ones, grant me a share of the relics, the bodily remains of the Blessed One. I shall erect a stūpa for the relics of the Blessed One in Rājagṛha and honour, exalt, adorn, and make offering to them with parasols, victory banners, pennants, forms, fragrant substances, garlands,

incense, powder, and the sounds of music.

I shall make offerings and hold a great festival as well.' The brahmin Vassakāra, who was in the service of the great minister of the land of Magadha, spoke these words to the Mallas of the city of Kuśinagara: 'If you grant a share, then well and good. If you do not grant a share, we shall come against you with our army.' The Mallas of Kuśinagara heard this and agreed to do so. But when they saw the great host of the royal retinue assembling, the wives and young men of the Mallas also began to practice archery. Now when the Mallas of the wicked land, the Pāva-dwelling Kṣatriya Buluka, the Kṣatriya Kroḍya of the city of Rāmagāma, the brahmins of Viṣṇudvīpa, the Kṣatriyas of the Śākya clan dwelling in Kapilavastu, the Kṣatriyas of the Licchavī clan of Vaiśālī, and the brahmin Vassakāra belonging to the great minister of the land of Magadha — when all of these had equipped their four-limbed armies with their troops of elephants, their troops of horses, their troops of chariots, and their troops of foot soldiers, they came to the Mallas of Kuśinagara in order to give battle. Then the Mallas of Kuśinagara arrayed their wives and young men outside the city, equipped their own four-limbed armies with their troops of elephants, their troops of horses, their troops of chariots, and their troops of foot soldiers, and marched out to meet the seven opposing armies in battle.

At that very moment, one who was equal to a brahmin of the brahmin lineage came to that very place. Knowing that if the two sides were to face each other in a great many battles, they would quickly slay one another, he made a wide circuit around them and went to where the Mallas of Kuśinagara were. He arrived and spoke these words to the Mallas of Kuśinagara:

'O wise ones, you great assembly of Kuśinagara's Malla community gathered here, listen well. The Blessed One Gautama has for a long time been one endowed with patience, one who taught the praise of patience. O wise ones, if the Blessed One Gautama was indeed endowed with patience and taught the praise of patience, then it is not fitting that for the sake of his relics you should slay one another. Therefore I, being glad to divide the relics of the Blessed One Gautama into eight portions, ask that the urn in which the relics were placed be given to me. I shall then erect a stūpa for the relics of the Blessed One Gautama in the brahmin city, and I shall honour, exalt, adorn, and make offering to them with parasols, victory banners, pennants, forms, fragrant substances, garlands, incense, and the sounds of music, and I shall hold a great festival as well.'

The Mallas of Kuśinagara heard him and agreed to do so. Then the one equal to a brahmin of the brahmin lineage went to where the Mallas of the wicked land, the Kṣatriya Buluka of the land of Pāvā, the Kṣatriya Kroḍya of the city of Rāmagāma, the brahmins of Viṣṇudvīpa, the Kṣatriyas of the Śākya clan dwelling in Kapilavastu, the Kṣatriyas of the Licchavī clan of Vaiśālī, and the brahmin Vassakāra belonging to the great minister of the land of Magadha were gathered, arrived there, and spoke these words to the brahmin Vassakāra, belonging to the great minister of the land of Magadha:

'O Vassakāra, hear this well.

The Blessed One Gautama, for a long time, possessed patience and was praised for his patience. Since the Blessed One Gautama possessed patience and was praised for his patience, it is not fitting, O wise Vassakāra, that you kill one another for the sake of his bodily relics. Therefore I am pleased to divide the relics of the Blessed One Gautama into eight portions. And give to me the urn in which the relics were placed, so that I may erect a stupa for the relics of the Blessed One Gautama in the city of Droṇa, and honor it with parasols, victory banners, and pennants, with fragrances, garlands, incense, and the sound of music; and hold it in the highest esteem, adorn it with images, make offerings to it, and also hold a great festival.' The brahmin Vassakāra, belonging to the great minister of the land of Magadha, and those equal to the brahmin lineage of Droṇa, agreed to do likewise.

Then the one equal to a brahmin of the brahmin lineage of Droṇa divided the relics of the Blessed One into eight portions. The first portion he gave to the Mallas of the city of Kuśinagara. And so the Mallas of the city of Kuśinagara erected a stupa for the relics of the Blessed One, raised parasols, victory banners, and pennants, and honored it with fragrances, garlands, incense, powder, and the sound of music; they held it in highest esteem, adorned it with images, made offerings, and held a great festival. The second portion went to the Mallas of the wicked land. The third portion went to the Kṣatriya Buluka of the land of Pāvā. The fourth portion went to the Kṣatriya Kroḍya of the city of Rāmagāma. The fifth portion went to the brahmins of Viṣṇudvīpa. The sixth portion went to the Kṣatriyas of the Śākya clan dwelling in Kapilavastu. The seventh portion went to the Kṣatriyas of the Licchavī clan dwelling in Vaiśālī. The eighth portion went to the brahmin Vassakāra, belonging to the great minister of the land of Magadha. And so the king Ajātaśatru, son of Vaidehī, of the land of Magadha, erected a stupa for the relics of the Blessed One, raised parasols, victory banners, and pennants, and

honored it with fragrances, garlands, incense, powder, and the sound of music; he held it in highest esteem, adorned it with images, made offerings, and held a great festival.

Then the Mallas of the city of Kuśinagara gave to the one equal to a brahmin of the brahmin lineage the urn in which the relics had been placed. Then the one equal to the brahmin lineage of Droṇa erected a stupa for the relics of the Blessed One in the city of Droṇa, raised parasols, victory banners, and pennants, and honored it with fragrances, garlands, incense, powder, and the sound of music; he held it in highest esteem, adorned it with images, made offerings, and held a great festival.

Then at that time the brahmin youth Nyagrodhajāta came to that very assembly. And the brahmin youth Nyagrodhajāta spoke these words to the Mallas of the city of Kuśinagara: 'O wise ones, great multitudes of the retinue of the Mallas of the city of Kuśinagara are gathered and assembled — hear this! The Blessed One Gautama has long been beloved and dear to me. He passed into complete nirvāṇa in your city. O wise ones, give to me the charcoal that remains from the burning of the relics of the Blessed One, so that I may erect a stupa of the charcoal of the Blessed One Gautama in the land of Nyagrodhajāta, and raise parasols, victory banners, and pennants, and honor it with fragrances, garlands, incense, powder, and the sound of music, hold it in highest esteem, and adorn it with images.'

'May we offer worship, and having offered worship, may a great festival be held.'

The Mallas of the city of Kuśinagara gave the charcoal of the relics to the brahmin youth Nyagrodhajāta. The brahmin youth Nyagrodhajāta then erected a stupa of the charcoal of the Blessed One in the land of Nyagrodhajāta, raised parasols, victory banners, and pennants, and honored it with fragrances, garlands, incense, powder, and the sound of music, held it in highest esteem, and adorned it with images. He offered worship to it and held a great festival.

At that time, in Jambudvīpa there came to be eight stupas of the relics of the Blessed One, and nine with the stupa of the urn, and ten with the stupa of the charcoal.

Of the eight measures of the glorious relics,
seven were obtained for the worship of those dwelling in Jambudvīpa.
One measure of the relics of that supreme being
was worshipped by the nāga king whose city is resounding with sound.

Of the four canine teeth of that supreme being,
one is worshipped in the world of the three summits.
The second is in the delightful city of Tsig-dzin.
The third is in the land of the king of Kalinga.
The fourth canine tooth of that supreme being
was worshipped by the nāga king whose city resounds with sound.
The sorrowless victor, abiding at Skar-snar,
caused the seven stupas to be greatly multiplied,
and through that power Indra also here
was adorned and fulfilled through aspirational prayer.
Thus, to those glorious relics,
the lord of gods, the lord of nāgas, and the lords of men,
as well as humans, nāgas, and yakṣas,
paid the highest honor and offered worship.

He who possessed supreme knowledge, endowed with compassion, master of
power,
born of the Śākya, was awakened in Magadha.
In Kāśī he turned the wheel of Dharma,
and relying on the city of Kuśinagara, he passed into nirvāṇa.

At the time when the venerable Śāriputra passed into complete nirvāṇa, eighty
thousand monks also passed into complete nirvāṇa. At the time when the
venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana passed into complete nirvāṇa, seventy
thousand monks also passed into complete nirvāṇa. At the time when the
Blessed One passed into complete nirvāṇa, eighteen thousand monks passed
into complete nirvāṇa as well. Then, over the course of many hundreds of
divine aeons, whatever teachings the Blessed One had spoken dwindled to a
mere wisp of smoke, and those monks who possessed authority, having
passed into complete nirvāṇa, jeered and mocked and slandered, saying: 'The
sūtras and Vinaya and the mahāmāyā texts of the Blessed One — they are not
recited.'

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa spoke these words to the monks: 'Venerable
ones, know this: at the time when the venerable Śāriputra passed into
complete nirvāṇa, eighty thousand monks also passed into complete nirvāṇa.
At the time when the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana passed into complete
nirvāṇa, seventy thousand monks also passed into complete nirvāṇa. Now
here, at the time when the Blessed One has passed into complete nirvāṇa,

eighteen thousand monks have also passed into complete nirvāṇa. Because so many monks have passed into complete nirvāṇa, divine sons who live for many hundreds of aeons — whatever teachings the Blessed One had spoken have dwindled to a mere wisp of smoke — and those monks who possessed authority, having passed into complete nirvāṇa, jeer and mock and slander, saying: "The sūtras, the Vinaya, and the mahāmāyā texts of the Blessed One are no longer recited." Therefore, let us come together and assemble here.'

The monks replied: 'Venerable one, it shall be done exactly so.'

Now, whoever serves as the disciplinary officer of the Saṅgha —

It was the venerable Gaṅgapoṣa.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa said to the venerable Gaṅgapoṣa: "Gaṅgapoṣa, come here. Strike the gong and assemble the Saṅgha of monks."

When the venerable Mahākāśyapa had spoken those words, the venerable Gaṅgapoṣa listened to the venerable Kāśyapa and, having entered into equipoise in the four perfected dhyānas, gazed out to the full extent that his sight of gnosis could reach. Then, rising from that meditative absorption, he began to strike the gong. When he struck it, five hundred arhat monks of the Saṅgha who were dwelling in various regions — all but one — assembled together.

When the monks had gathered and were sitting assembled, the venerable Mahākāśyapa said this: "Venerable ones, take note of which monks from the Saṅgha have not yet come." The monks who had come from various regions looked at one another, and then said to the venerable Mahākāśyapa: "Venerable one, all the many monks are assembled and present here, with the sole exception of the venerable Vāṇadatta."

At that time, the venerable Vāṇadatta was sitting in an empty mansion of śirīṣa wood.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa said to the venerable Gaṅgapoṣa: "Gaṅgapoṣa, come here. Go to where the venerable Vāṇadatta is, and when you have arrived, say this to the venerable Vāṇadatta: 'The Saṅgha of monks, Kāśyapa and the others, wish you good health, venerable Vāṇadatta. There is a small matter of Saṅgha business; please come quickly.'"

When the venerable Kāśyapa had spoken those words, the venerable Gaṅgapoṣa listened to the venerable Kāśyapa and entered into just such a meditative absorption — one in which the city of Tṛṇāvātī became invisible,

and he appeared to be sitting in an empty mansion of śirīṣa wood with mind placed in equanimity.

Then the venerable Gaṅgapoṣa went to where the venerable Vāṇadatta was. Having arrived, he bowed his head to the venerable Vāṇadatta's two feet, and said to the venerable Vāṇadatta: "The Saṅgha of monks, Kāśyapa and the others, wish you good health, venerable Vāṇadatta. There is a small matter of Saṅgha business; please come quickly."

Though Vāṇadatta was free from attachment, he was permeated by the habitual tendency of loving-kindness, and so the venerable Gaṅgapoṣa reflected: "Has not the Blessed One departed to another world to tame beings? Has not strife, contention, and discord arisen within the Saṅgha of monks, or have they been slandering one another? Has not the wheel of Dharma turned by the Tathāgata been deflected by non-Buddhists? Have those people assembled and done harm to the Saṅgha of the Tathāgata's śrāvakas? Has not the Tathāgata — who is like the sun — been scorned by mendicants, brahmins, wanderers, and itinerants who are under the power of mental afflictions that wrap around them like clouds? Have those of poor understanding, darkened by the gloom of ignorance, not caused a schism in the assembled Saṅgha? Have there not arisen words, letters, and webs of view similar to the Dharma, yet opposed to the Dharma and Vinaya as taught by the Tathāgata? Have those who practice the pure life not been turned away from reciting, chanting, and taking to heart those teachings, and come instead to gather and make idle chatter? Have those with doubting, wavering minds not taught what is non-Dharma as Dharma and Dharma as non-Dharma, what is non-Vinaya as Vinaya and Vinaya as non-Vinaya?"

"Monks, have they not failed to practice the six principles of harmony (sāraṇīyadharmas) and the like toward those living the chaste life who have arrived suddenly, and have they not shown them contempt? Have corrupt renunciants caused brahmins and faithful householders to lose faith in the teaching and come to rely on non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) instead? Have some fallen into wrong livelihood, ploughing fields, engaging in trade, and looking to kings for their sustenance? Have those who had properly taken up the qualities of training and dwelt in remote forest lodgings come to abandon those very qualities of training? Have those who are not true ascetics, claiming to be ascetics, not come to disturb the community's practice of the pure life? Yet even so, has the monk Saṅgha spoken of the worthy Gaṅgāpāla and others who are called 'buddha and so forth,' as Kāśyapa and the like? Has the

Teacher, who dwelt in great compassion and entered into practice, not passed into nirvāṇa in the realm of nirvāṇa without remainder of aggregates? Has the world been thrown into confusion because there is no one to lead the migrating beings? Has the one possessed of the ten powers (daśabala) been overpowered by the force of impermanence? Has the guardian who awakens us, the Teacher of all sentient beings, gone to sleep? Has the buddha, the sun, set? Has the sovereign sage, the moon, been vanquished by Rāhu and lost his light? In the Heaven of Thirty-three, has the lordly wish-fulfilling tree, fragrant and adorned with the blossoms of the limbs of awakening, been broken by a maddened wild elephant of impermanence that possessed the four good fruits of the ascetic life? Has the lamp of primordial wisdom been extinguished by the wind of impermanence, and has it fully passed beyond sorrow?"

Thus they spoke. Then at that time the venerable Gaṅgāpāla spoke these verses:

Those wise ones, for the sake of preserving the teaching,
gathered from the śrāvaka Saṅgha and assembled there,
remaining with you and striving in that very effort.

The great ship of the Victor has been destroyed.

The very mountain of primordial wisdom has crumbled.

The many monks of that most excellent teaching
have now fully passed into peace.

O Lady of gracious virtue,

I have come here as a messenger.

For the sake of preserving the teaching,
you must therefore now set forth without delay.

Then the venerable Vālbhaka spoke thus to the venerable Gaṅgāpāla:
"Gaṅgāpāla, enough — do not speak so. It is not yet time to go. And yet, noble Gaṅgāpāla:"

Though my mind intends to go to that place
where the guardian, the lamp of beings, still dwells,
once he has gone from there to supreme peace on the other shore,
what wise one will go to those worlds?

These finest of the three robes — bowl, Dharma robe, and all —
offer them yourself to the Saṅgha.

I will go where there is no peace, nor any further existence.

I ask the noble one to bear with what I have resolved.

Then the venerable Vālambhaka displayed a great miracle of lightning, warmth, rainfall, and supreme radiance, and passed into nirvāṇa in the realm without remainder of aggregates. His body was consumed by the element of fire arisen from within itself, and from it four streams of water flowed down.

From one stream of water came a teaching proclaimed in a melodious voice resounding:

Now the times have grown degenerate.
Sentient beings depend upon their own karma.
That lamp of beings has passed away —
know that all beings now proceed to their going.

A second spoke:

Conditioned and accumulated things are destroyed in an instant,
bearing the afflictions and suffering of birth and all the rest.
Ordinary persons are proud with a sense of self —
let them know that these things have no maker.

A third spoke:

One who is wise is always vigilant with care,
and should strive with mind devoted to merit.

All the hosts of elemental beings are gone and will perish,
and the glory of those who have life has grown unstable.

A fourth spoke:

To that Sage the finest disciples made perfect obeisance,
and accomplished, without remainder, everything that was needed.
With reverence and deep faith in that teacher,
I, Valandhara, followed after him just as a calf does.

Then the Venerable Gaṅgha performed a bone-relic offering at the bones of the Venerable Valandhara, took up his bowl and his robes, and entered into a meditative absorption of this kind: just as when the mind settles into equipoise, it is no longer seen within the palace of the śrīṣa tree, and the warriors of the city of Kuśinagara draw near, and one comes to dwell in the grove of the twin śāla trees — he entered into that very samādhi.

Then the Venerable Gaṅgha went to where the Venerable Mahākāśyapa and the other five hundred monks were, approached them, and bowed to them in order of seniority. He then gave to an elder monk his bowl and robe, and spoke

these words in verse:

Having heard that the body of the Protector is no more,
Valandhara, his mind supremely still through the karma of merit, passed away
in perfect peace.

This is his bowl and robe —
with this in mind, he asks forbearance of the Saṅgha.

Then the Venerable Mahākāśyapa spoke to the monks as follows:

Listen, you who lead the holy life (brahmacārins)!
In the noble manner he too has passed beyond.
Let others not likewise go to such a sudden peace.
Therefore, for as long as there is need, carry out the necessary work,
and as long as is needed, deliberate in the great assembly.

And then the Venerable Mahākāśyapa spoke again, in order to strengthen
those monks:

Just as Valandhara of the śīrīṣa tree, his mind most noble,
passed away calmed through the karma of merit —
let none of you think likewise,
but for the sake of benefiting beings, apply your intelligence in the assembly.

Then the Venerable Mahākāśyapa laid down a rule for those five hundred monks and said: Venerable ones, listen to what I say. Let us teach the Dharma just as it is, and when monks who are in anguish having been separated from the Tathāgata — wherever in whatever direction and region they dwell — hear of it and come here, even though they may distract our minds, nevertheless, it is where the Blessed One attained awakening in the region of Magadha, and where the Blessed One obtained the dharmakāya, that we should deliberate on the manner of the Dharma. One monk then said, "Excellent, we will do exactly so." But another said, "Venerable one, are we then going to the foot of the tree of awakening?" The Venerable Mahākāśyapa replied: Venerable ones, the faithful one — the king of Magadha, the son of the Licchavī lady, Ajātaśatru, whose root of faith is unimpaired — will provide the monastic community with the requisites of sustenance and will fully attend to the proper conduct of the Dharma, and will serve as patron; so we shall go to Rājagṛha. They said, "Excellent, we shall do just so." Then they said, "But the Venerable Ānanda has training duties still to complete, and the Blessed One entrusted all the sūtras to him — how are we to accomplish this?" The Venerable Mahākāśyapa then said: Venerable ones, if that is so, then the other monks

still in training who are here present will also be disturbed. So let a skillful arrangement be made: let Ānanda be appointed with joy to serve as water-bearer for the monastic community, and let the rest be sent back. They said, "Excellent, we shall do exactly so." Then the Venerable Mahākāśyapa spoke to the Venerable Ānanda and said: Venerable Ānanda, are you willing to serve as water-bearer for the monastic community? He replied: Venerable Mahākāśyapa, I am willing.

Then the Venerable Mahākāśyapa made the formal motion and the two-fold act of the Saṅgha began. "Let the venerable members of the Saṅgha please listen. The Venerable Ānanda has been the personal attendant of the Blessed One, has stayed close to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One has entrusted all the sūtras to him. Therefore, the Venerable Ānanda is to be appointed by the Saṅgha as water-bearer to the Saṅgha. If the time is right for the Saṅgha and the Saṅgha consents to appointing the Venerable Ānanda as water-bearer, and to the monk Ānanda's serving as water-bearer and drawing water, let the Saṅgha please approve. This is the motion. The act is to be performed as follows: Let the venerable members of the Saṅgha please listen. The Venerable Ānanda is the personal attendant of the Blessed One, has stayed close to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One has entrusted to him all the sūtras. Therefore, the Saṅgha appoints the Venerable Ānanda to draw water for the Saṅgha. The monk Ānanda is to draw water for the Saṅgha. Those venerable ones who consent to the Venerable Ānanda's drawing water for the Saṅgha should remain silent; those who do not consent should speak." The Saṅgha consented and approved, and the Venerable Ānanda was appointed to draw water for the Saṅgha. Since no one spoke, so it was held to be.

Here ends the section on minor Vinaya matters. The fifty-seventh fascicle.

Then the Venerable Mahākāśyapa said to the Venerable Ānanda: Ānanda, come here. Travel at your leisure together with the community of monks and go to Rājagṛha. I shall go by the direct route. The Venerable Ānanda replied: Venerable one, so be it. And the Venerable Ānanda traveled at leisure together with the community of monks and went on. The Venerable Mahākāśyapa likewise went to Rājagṛha by the direct route as before.

Now it was the custom of Ajātaśatru, king of Magadha and son of Vaidehī, that whenever he saw the Blessed One while riding an elephant, he would immediately dismount of his own accord, and the power of the Blessed One would cause him to alight upon the ground unharmed. When King Ajātaśatru of

Magadha saw the Venerable Mahākāśyapa, he was reminded of the Blessed One and in the same way fell to the ground of his own accord. At that moment the Venerable Mahākāśyapa caught him with his supernatural power and said: Great king, buddhas and blessed ones are always abiding in meditative equipoise. Śrāvakas, however, do not enter into the vision of gnosis without meditative equipoise; sometimes they abide having entered equipoise, and sometimes they abide without having entered it. Therefore, from now on, when you see a śrāvaka of the Blessed One, do not fall of your own accord from elephants or horses. And he established this as a rule for him.

The king replied: Noble one, I shall do exactly as the noble one has commanded. Noble one, while the Blessed One was living I paid reverence to the Blessed One; but now that the Blessed One has passed into complete nirvāṇa, to whom am I to pay reverence? The Blessed One himself has entrusted the teaching of the Blessed One to me. And so saying, he commanded his ministers: Provide the wise and noble Mahākāśyapa with everything he needs.

The Venerable Mahākāśyapa then said:

Great King, the Blessed One attained awakening in the land of Magadha. There the Blessed One obtained the dharmakāya, and the community of monks has set out on the road, wishing to deliberate on the manner of the Dharma at this divine abode. The king replied: Noble one, I shall gladly provide the community of monks with all requisites.

Then the Venerable Mahākāśyapa and the five hundred arhats set out for Rājagṛha in order to compile the sūtras, the Vinaya, and the Abhidharma. The king of Magadha, the son of the Vaidehī queen, Ajātaśatru, heard that the five hundred arhats had come to Rājagṛha. Upon hearing this, he had the towns swept and cleaned, the roads prepared, and then the queen, the young princes, the ministers, and the palace retinue went out to receive them. Then a thousand good men served as attendants, and having arranged everything splendidly, they entered the city; and the community of monks was provided with all requisites. Then they sat in order of seniority, and someone spoke to the Venerable Mahākāśyapa thus: Noble one, in which direction shall we deliberate?

He replied: Great King, here in the Kalandaka bamboo grove of Veḷuvana, the monks who have been separated from the Tathāgata have arisen in suffering, and from whatever regions and districts they had been residing in they have

come here, and this causes the fault of distraction to our minds. At Vulture Peak likewise there is this drawback. And though this cave of the nyagrodha tree is quite secluded, it nevertheless lacks bedding and seats.

The king said: Noble one, please be of good cheer — there are seats. The Venerable Mahākāśyapa said: Venerable ones, the king says thus: let us go to this cave of the nyagrodha tree. The five hundred arhats said nothing and consented. The king said: Noble one, Mahākāśyapa, the Blessed One passed into complete nirvāṇa without entrusting me with anything at all. Do not you also pass into complete nirvāṇa without first considering. The Venerable Mahākāśyapa likewise consented to this.

Then the Venerable Mahākāśyapa first repaired the fraying and damage of the early rains retreat boundary, and then undertook to spend the later rains retreat there, thinking to deliberate on the Dharma. He first repaired the fraying and damage of the early rains retreat, and then undertook the later rains retreat. Then the Venerable Mahākāśyapa, having surveyed the minds of the venerable ones and examined them all thoroughly, said this to the Venerable Ananda, who had not yet attained cessation: Venerable Ananda, take heed. Among this retinue who have been so praised by the Tathāgata, there are monks who are still in training — those with attachment, those with aversion, those with delusion, those with craving, those with clinging.

Then the Venerable Ananda, having entered into the absorption of the fourth dhyāna and examined carefully, saw that the Venerable Ananda alone was still in training — possessed of attachment, possessed of aversion, possessed of delusion, possessed of craving, possessed of clinging. Having seen this, he said to the Venerable Mahākāśyapa: Venerable Mahākāśyapa, please be aware. The community of monks is free of what is without essence, pure, clean, having essence, unsurpassed, a field of merit, a fit object of offering for the world — yet the Venerable Ananda is one with attachment, with aversion, with delusion, with craving, with clinging: he is still in training.

Then the Venerable Mahākāśyapa considered whether the Venerable Ānanda could be tamed by being treated gently, or whether he would be tamed by being treated harshly. Having examined this, and having seen how much harshness was needed to tame him, he said to him: "I am the foremost of the assembly, and you, Ānanda, have never discussed the Dharma together with me. Be gone!"

At this, as though struck to the quick, the Venerable Ānanda trembled violently and said: "Venerable Mahākāśyapa, enough! I have not broken my moral discipline, I have not broken my view, I have not broken my conduct, I have not broken my livelihood. I have committed no offense whatsoever against the Saṅgha. Venerable Mahākāśyapa, please bear with me."

Then Mahākāśyapa said to him: "Venerable Ānanda, you who have served so close to the feet of the Blessed One — that you have not broken your moral discipline, not broken your view, not broken your conduct, not broken your livelihood — how remarkable is that? And yet you would say 'I have committed no offense at all against the Saṅgha'? Come now, take up a sīla-wood, and I shall show you your offenses."

Then the Venerable Ānanda rose. The very moment he stood up, the great trichiliocosm shook three times — it shook, shook greatly, shook entirely; it trembled, trembled greatly, trembled utterly. The gods dwelling in the sky were filled with wonder and, opening their eyes wide, exclaimed "Ah!" Then they said: "Alas! The noble Mahākāśyapa speaks truth, he speaks for the good — and yet here in this very place, now that the Sage has passed from among us, he treats the noble Ānanda with such excessive harshness!"

Then the Venerable Mahākāśyapa spoke these words to the Venerable Ānanda: "Venerable Ānanda, you say, 'I have done no harm whatsoever to the Saṅgha.' But how can it be that you have done no harm to the Saṅgha? When the Blessed One did not wish to give full ordination to women who were living every day in corrupt conduct, you entreated him, and the Blessed One then gave Ānanda ordination to women, granting them full ordination and conferring the state of fully ordained nuns — do not speak to me of that! Why? Because when women are admitted to going forth in the Dharma and Vinaya, the Dharma and Vinaya do not endure for long. Just as when hail falls upon a field of excellent ripened rice, whatever rice there is is ruined and gone — so too, when women are admitted to going forth in the Dharma and Vinaya, the Dharma and Vinaya do not endure for long. Did he not say this? Venerable Mahākāśyapa, enough — please bear with me. It is not that I lacked conscience or lacked shame. But the great mother of the Blessed One's being, the great Gautamī, endured hardship — she who had nursed and raised the very one whose own mother had passed from this world before her time. Moreover, thinking that, just as the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas of former times each had a fourfold retinue, so too would this Blessed One have the same — and wishing to repay what had been done for me, I

entreated the Blessed One to grant ordination to women on behalf of my relative and kin. In this one matter alone I ask forgiveness for my fault."

Then Mahākāśyapa said: "Venerable Ānanda, by doing what you did in this way — by repaying a debt — you have caused harm to the dharmakāya. How can you say it was for the sake of relatives and kin? You acted like hail falling upon the perfectly endowed buddha-field, cutting short by a mere residue what would have endured for a full thousand years. To grant ordination on account of relatives and kin — that is improper, it is not good, it is an offense."

"Just as I have heard that fully awakened buddhas of former times had four assemblies, and just as I declared that this Blessed One too would have it so — in those earlier times people were of few desires, few faults, little attachment, little aversion, little delusion, and their underlying tendencies were thin. Those of that sort are appropriate in that way; this, however, is not appropriate. For in this manner, however much you entreated the Blessed One — even against his wish — it was granted accordingly. Therefore this is the first offense. Set down the disciplinary staff. You have yet another offense as well.

The Blessed One said: 'Ānanda, wherever one cultivates, develops, and repeatedly practices the four bases of miraculous power, one could, if one wished, remain for a full eon or even beyond.' Yet you did not entreat the Blessed One, saying: 'Blessed One, please remain for a full eon for the benefit of the world; Sugata, please remain beyond a full eon.' This is your second great offense.

Furthermore, you have this offense as well: when the Blessed One had issued a pronouncement — when the Blessed One had declared to the venerable Ānanda, 'It is to be thus' — you gave a different reply to what another said. This too is your third offense.

You have yet further offenses: you stepped upon the Blessed One's robe of golden hue with your foot. Venerable Mahākāśyapa, it is not that I was without shame or without profound shame — but at that moment there was no monk companion at my side on either left or right."

To which he replied: "Why did you not toss it into the air? The gods would have caught it." This is your fourth offense.

You have yet further offenses: when the Blessed One had entered upon his final passing and lay between the twin śāla trees, thirsty and asking for water — the water was turbid. Venerable Mahākāśyapa, it is not that I was without

shame or without deep shame — but at that time some five hundred carts had crossed the river Kakuṭṭhā and stirred it into muddiness. Because of that it was indeed your fault; yet why did you not hold up your begging bowl into the sky? The gods would have filled it with water endowed with eight fine qualities. This is your fifth offense.

You have yet further offenses: the Blessed One had declared that at the time of reciting the Prātimokṣa sūtra every fortnight, whoever recited the minor and lesser rules, the Saṅgha of monks would set them aside and take ease in comfortable contact. At that time you failed to ask the Blessed One: 'What are the minor and lesser training rules?' Therefore this is your sixth offense.

"As for what I say here: the four rules entailing defeat, the thirteen rules entailing the Saṅgha's remainder, the two indeterminate rules, the thirty rules entailing confession with forfeiture, the ninety rules entailing confession, the four rules requiring individual acknowledgment, and the many further rules of training — those that remain beyond these are the minor and lesser rules."

There is also this that is said: from the four rules entailing defeat through the four rules requiring individual acknowledgment inclusive —

those that remain beyond these are the minor and lesser rules. There is also this that is said: beyond the four rules entailing defeat, the thirteen rules entailing the Saṅgha's remainder, the two indeterminate rules, and the thirty rules entailing confession with forfeiture, and the ninety rules entailing confession — those that remain are the minor and lesser rules. There is also this that is said: beyond the four rules entailing defeat, the thirteen rules entailing the Saṅgha's remainder, the two indeterminate rules, and the thirty rules entailing confession with forfeiture — those that remain are the minor and lesser rules. There is also this that is said: beyond the four rules entailing defeat, the thirteen rules entailing the Saṅgha's remainder, and the two indeterminate rules — those that remain are the minor and lesser rules.

Thus it is that while monks, having fully understood them from within, abide by the four rules entailing defeat, some who abide by the thirteen rules entailing the Saṅgha's remainder have given opportunity to non-Buddhists, so that the Dharma of the monk Gautama has become like smoke dissipated into the air. When the ascetic Gautama was alive, the training of the hearers was properly observed under restraint; but now they conduct themselves as they please and have grown lax — if they wish, they do it; if they do not wish, they do not. Therefore it was your fault that you did not petition the Blessed One for the

sake of benefiting people in the future.

Venerable Mahākāśyapa, it is not that I was shameless or utterly shameless. Rather, at that time I was tormented by the suffering of grief at being separated from the Tathāgata. And yet that too was your fault: you who served as an attendant to the Tathāgata — since all conditioned phenomena are impermanent, your lamenting too was an offense. Moreover, there are these further offenses: you showed women of bad conduct in the household retinue the concealed and sunken places of the Tathāgata's body. Venerable Ānanda, it is not that I was shameless or utterly shameless — yet I reasoned thus in my mind: women, by nature greatly prone to attachment, if they see the concealed and sunken places of the Blessed One's body, will be rid of their womanly marks. Venerable Ānanda, from where did such an excellence of wisdom come to you — that if the concealed and sunken places were shown, women would thereby be rid of their womanly marks? This is the seventh offense.

Moreover, there are these further offenses against you: you showed women the Blessed One's body with its golden complexion, and that body was thus stained with their tears. Venerable Mahākāśyapa, it is not that I was shameless or utterly shameless — yet this thought arose in my mind: if sentient beings see the Blessed One possessed of such a complexion, great numbers of them will form the aspiration in their minds to be possessed of such a complexion. Ānanda, you who have no such single-pointed knowledge and no knowledge of others' minds — this is the eighth offense.

Since you are possessed of a measure of attachment, rise up and depart from this assembly of the supreme ones who are free from attachment. We shall not recite together with you.

Thus it was that the venerable Mahākāśyapa enumerated eight offenses committed by the venerable Ānanda, and having done so, gazed in all four directions and spoke slowly, with words of compassion and grief: Alas, my time has come to this — I have been abandoned by the Tathāgata, and there is no protector, no refuge.

Then, after the venerable Mahākāśyapa had enumerated the eight offenses of the venerable Ānanda, the gods who were dwelling in the expanse of the sky cried out "Ālālā!" and said: Now the bodies of the gods shall flourish, and the bodies of the asuras shall be wounded. The teaching of the Blessed One shall flourish — for so it is when a great śrāvaka who is the equal of the Teacher

enumerates the offenses of another great śrāvaka who is the equal of the Teacher.

Then the venerable Ānanda spoke to the venerable Mahākāśyapa in these words: Great venerable Kāśyapa, it is as you say — please grant your forbearance. I will act in accordance with the Dharma and shall not do so again. But the Blessed One had entrusted me to you. At the time when the Blessed One passed completely beyond sorrow, he said: Ānanda, do not grieve, do not be downcast, do not lament. I entrust you to the monk Mahākāśyapa. Ānanda, though it is hard, be patient with minor offenses and do not be unable to bear them. Ānanda, do not weep — your wholesome qualities will grow and not diminish. Rise up and depart from this assembly of the supreme ones, so that I may apply myself to the teaching. I shall not recite together with you — and with this he pronounced the formal censure.

Then the venerable Aniruddha spoke to the venerable Mahākāśyapa in these words: Venerable Mahākāśyapa, without the venerable Ānanda, how shall we recite correctly? He replied: Although the venerable monk Ānanda possesses good qualities, he cannot remain here with us. He is one who must still train while possessed of attachment, aversion, and delusion — and so I shall not recite together with you. And then he said to the venerable Ānanda: Venerable Ānanda, rise up and go. When you have striven with great diligence and become an arhat, we shall recite together.

Then the venerable Ānanda's eyes filled with tears. Remembering that he was parted from the Teacher, his heart was heavy with sorrow. He then rose from the midst of the assembly of the supreme ones and went to the city of Vṛjī, and there he entered properly into the rains retreat.

Now at that time, when Ānanda's attendant, the venerable Vṛjīputra, was serving him, the venerable Ānanda was teaching the Dharma to the four assemblies with great diligence. Then the venerable Vṛjīputra thought to himself: Does my preceptor train while free from the attachment of desire, or does he train while not yet free from the attachment of desire? I shall enter a meditative absorption such as this, and with the mind of one thus absorbed I shall look into my preceptor's mind. The venerable Vṛjīputra then entered into just such a meditative absorption, and with the mind of one thus absorbed he examined the mind of the venerable Ānanda. The venerable Vṛjīputra discerned the mind of the venerable Ānanda and saw that the venerable Ānanda was still training while not free from the attachment of desire. He then

arose from the meditative absorption, went to where the venerable Ānanda was, approached him, sat before him, and spoke these verses:

Gautama, do not be heedless.

Lean upon the dense shade of a tree and pass into peace.

Set your mind to it and enter into meditation —

before long you will attain the abode of tranquility.

Then the venerable Ānanda, taking up this instruction given by the venerable Vṛjīputra, purified his mind of all those phenomena that are obstructive when one walks and sits during the day. He purified his mind of those phenomena that are obstructive when one walks and sits during the day. During the first watch of the night he purified his mind of those phenomena that are obstructive when one walks and sits. He purified his mind of those phenomena that are obstructive when one walks and sits during the first watch of the night. At the middle watch of the night he washed his feet outside the assembly hall, entered within the assembly hall, lay down on his right side with one foot resting upon the other, and rested with only the perception of light, possessed of mindfulness and vigilance. The venerable Ānanda had not yet laid his head upon the pillow when, just so, the mind of the venerable Ānanda became liberated from the defilements without clinging. Then the venerable Ānanda, having individually experienced joy and happiness, was fully liberated and attained the state of arhat. He then went to Rājagṛha, to the place where the venerable Kāśyapa and the five hundred arhats were gathering and assembling the Dharma in the grotto of the Nyagrodha tree.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa spoke to the monks as follows: "Venerable ones, in a future time, when monks have become forgetful and their physical capacities have declined, they will be unable to retain the sūtras, Vinaya, and Abhidharma in the form of sūtra verses. Therefore, in the morning hours the sūtra verses should be recited, and in the afternoon the sūtras, Vinaya, and Abhidharma should be discussed." When the venerable Mahākāśyapa had spoken thus, those monks, having heard the venerable Mahākāśyapa, spoke to him as follows: "Venerable Mahākāśyapa, of the sūtras, Vinaya, and Abhidharma, which should be discussed first?" He said: "Venerable ones, for the time being let the sūtras be discussed first." "So be it."

The five hundred arhats then requested the venerable Mahākāśyapa to compile the Dharma. He sat upon a lion throne and encouraged the venerable Ānanda, saying: "Venerable Ānanda, if you are willing, are you then willing to

compile the sūtras of the Tathāgata? Yes, be willing." Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa began the act of petition and motion. He addressed the noble Saṅgha as follows: "Venerable ones of the Saṅgha, please hear. If the venerable Ānanda is willing to undertake the compilation of the sūtras of the Blessed One, and if the time is right for the Saṅgha and it meets with approval, let the Saṅgha grant its consent. This is the proposal: let the Saṅgha appoint the venerable Ānanda to undertake the compilation of the sūtras, and let the venerable Ānanda accomplish the compilation of the sūtras of the Blessed One. This is the proposal."

The motion is to be carried out as follows. The venerable ones of the Saṅgha, please hear. The venerable Ānanda is willing to undertake the compilation of the sūtras of the Blessed One. The Saṅgha appoints the venerable Ānanda, and the venerable Ānanda is to accomplish the compilation of the sūtras of the Blessed One. Those venerable ones who consent to the venerable Ānanda being appointed to accomplish the compilation of the sūtras of the Blessed One should remain silent, and those who do not consent should speak. The Saṅgha has consented and approved, and the Saṅgha has appointed the venerable Ānanda to accomplish the compilation of the sūtras of the Blessed One. Since no one has spoken, it is so held.

Five hundred patchwork robes were arranged by the five hundred arhats upon the lion throne of the venerable Ānanda, the Dharma-speaking lion. Then the venerable Ānanda gazed out in the four directions, aroused a mind of compassion toward sentient beings, generated reverence toward the Dharma, and, fixing his attention on those who live the holy life with reverent regard, circumambulated the lion throne to the right, touched it with his head, and paid homage in due order according to seniority. Holding impermanence in mind, he took his seat, overcoming the lion throne with his radiance.

Then, gazing upon that assembly, deep as the ocean, unmoving, he thought: "If I were to recite all the sūtras that the Blessed One taught without exception as I have retained them — among them there are sūtras that the Blessed One taught in the dwelling places of the nāgas, sūtras taught in the dwelling places of the gods, and sūtras taught directly to me, those which came transmitted one to another and were heard and retained in just that way — all of these that I have thus heard, I shall recite." And since the knowledge and vision of the gods is inferior, each one cried out to the others: "O noble Sage, the noble Ānanda, the mightiest of the noble ones — listen with one-pointed mind as he expounds the Dharma spoken by the Tathāgata!"

Then at that moment another divine son spoke these verses:

In whom the phenomena are well established,
whom the three worlds honor always —
this noble one, free of all hesitation,
roars out the Dharma like a lion.
O wonderful! When he speaks of the peaceful,
you who wish for happiness:
hearken with reverence and devotion
to the essence, the supreme of essences, the pure.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa spoke to the venerable Ānanda in these words:

The Teacher, who intends benefit for the world —
of the Dharma taught by the Victor,
the most excellent form, declared where?
The venerable one shall recite the sūtras.

Having deeply understood the recollection of the Buddha — arising from what the Teacher had fully proclaimed — and holding it in mind, the venerable Ānanda gazed intently in the direction where the Blessed One had entered perfect peace and had been received into the heart, then sat with palms joined together and, making his voice resound throughout the assembly, he declared:

"Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling at Vārāṇasī, in the Deer Park of the Sages."

The very instant those words were spoken, thousands of divine beings dwelling in the middle of the sky and in palaces, and many hundreds of monks and others who had not been separated from attachment, were stricken and overwhelmed with distress, and, feeling suffering, they cried out in lamentation:

Alas! Among these worlds,
in impermanence there is no distinction.
He who was that treasury of jewels —
the ocean of his qualities, too, is dried.
From him I directly heard
the Dharma that brings the bliss of liberation.
Having heard these words and joined them with wisdom,
that too is proclaimed this very day.

Then the Blessed One spoke thus to the five monks:

"O monks, this teaching not heard before — it is the noble truth of suffering" — and so, turning the wheel of Dharma in full, he expounded the sūtras.

Then the venerable Ājñāta Kauṇḍinya spoke to the venerable Mahākāśyapa in these words: "O venerable Mahākāśyapa, I heard this category of Dharma directly, and through the recitation and teaching of this sūtra for my own benefit, the ocean of my blood and tears has dried up, the mountain of my bones has been surmounted, the door to the lower realms has been closed, and the door to the higher realms and liberation has been opened.

Through the teaching of this precious sūtra, the stainless and immaculate eye of Dharma arose in me and in eight thousand gods. Today, upon hearing this, he spoke: "Alas, all things are without distinction, for they are impermanent." Having said this, he descended from his seat, sat upon the ground, and all those arhats, their minds steeped in habitual tendencies of attachment, descended one by one from their own seats and sat upon the ground, saying these words: "Alas, we who have beheld the Blessed One teaching Dharma face to face — even he has now gone by the path of hearing, carried away by the power of impermanence."

They then spoke these words:

When he who was the sovereign of gods, humans, asuras, and nāgas has passed into peace,

why do you remain alive and not enter the abode of peace?

When the omniscient one has visibly departed from among beings, what person of wholesome mind clings to life and holds it dear?

Then, one less than five hundred arhats entered into meditative equipoise in the four dhyānas at their respective lodgings at the edge of the world, and with the awareness born of aspirational prayer they looked out, and with joyful minds rose from meditative absorption and spoke to the venerable Ānanda these words: "Venerable Ānanda, is that your scriptural transmission?" The venerable ones answered: "That is my scriptural transmission, venerable ones." "Is it similar to our scriptural transmission, venerable ones?" "Venerable Ānanda, it is exactly so."

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa thought to himself: "When I compiled the first sūtra collection of the Blessed One, not a single person practicing the holy life objected or rebuked it. Therefore, this is Dharma, this is Vinaya, this was

taught by the Teacher." And he spoke to the venerable Ānanda: "Venerable Ānanda, where did the Blessed One teach the second sūtra? Clarify this." He replied: "It was at Vārāṇasī itself, for the sake of the five monks." And the content of it was thus: "Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling at Vārāṇasī, in the Deer Park of the Sages Who Speak Truth. There the Blessed One declared to the monks: 'O monks, these are the Four Noble Truths — the noble truth of suffering, the noble truth of the origin of suffering, the noble truth of the cessation of suffering, and the noble truth of the path leading to the cessation of suffering. What is the noble truth of suffering? The suffering of birth, the suffering of aging, the suffering of illness, the suffering of death, the suffering of separation from what is dear, the suffering of meeting with what is unpleasant, the suffering of seeking what one desires and not finding it, and in short, the five aggregates of clinging — these are suffering. This is called the noble truth of suffering. What is the noble truth of the origin of suffering? It is craving that leads to renewed existence, born from the impulse of joyful desire, taking delight in this and that. This is called the noble truth of the origin of suffering. What is the noble truth of the cessation of suffering? It is the complete abandonment of that very craving that leads to renewed existence, born from the impulse of joyful desire, taking delight in this and that — its relinquishment, its utter termination, its exhaustion, its freedom from desire, its cessation, its nirvāṇa. This is called the noble truth of the cessation of suffering. What is the noble truth of the path leading to the cessation of suffering? It is the noble eightfold path — that is to say, right view, right intention, right speech, right action, right livelihood,

right effort, right mindfulness, and right meditative absorption — this is the noble truth of the path leading to the cessation of suffering." When this enumeration of the Dharma had been taught, the venerable Kauṇḍinya, without any clinging, was liberated in mind from all defilements. As for the remaining four monks, the dust-free and stainless eye of Dharma with respect to all phenomena arose in them — so it was declared.

At that time the venerable Kauṇḍinya spoke thus to the venerable Mahākāśyapa: "O venerable Mahākāśyapa, I myself heard this enumeration of the Dharma directly, and at the very moment this enumeration of the Dharma was taught, without clinging I was liberated in mind from all defilements. As for the remaining four monks, the dust-free and stainless eye of Dharma with respect to all phenomena arose in them."

Then, from the passage beginning "one who finds it incomplete" down to "I summarize a second discourse of the Blessed One, by which no one who leads the pure life is turned back or reproached" — all of this proceeds as before.

Knowing thereby, "This is Dharma, this is Vinaya, this is what the Teacher has taught," the venerable Ānanda spoke thus to the venerable Kauṇḍinya: "O venerable Kauṇḍinya, where did the Blessed One teach the third discourse? Indicate clearly that it was in Vārāṇasī alone, and for the sake of the five monks — and what, then, is it?"

Thus have I heard. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling at Vārāṇasī, in the Deer Park at Ṛṣipatana. At that time the Blessed One spoke thus to the remaining four monks:

"Monks, form is not self. Monks, if form were the self, form would not be subject to harm or suffering, and it would be possible to say of form: 'May form be thus; may form not be thus.' Monks, precisely because form is not self, form is subject to harm and suffering, and it is not possible to say: 'May form be thus; may form not be thus.'"

"Monks, feeling, perception, and formations are not self — monks, if perception and the rest were the self" — and so on, as before — "it would not be possible to say: 'May such consciousness be thus.'"

"Monks, what do you think? Is form permanent or impermanent?" "Venerable one, it is impermanent." "And further, that which is impermanent — is it suffering or not suffering?" "Venerable one, it is suffering." "And further, that which is impermanent, suffering, and subject to change — would a learned noble hearer regard it as: 'This is mine, this am I, this is my self'?" "Venerable one, that is not so."

"Monks, what do you think? Are feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness" — as before — "'this is mine, this am I, this is my self'?" "Venerable one, that is not so."

"Therefore, monks, with respect to all form whatsoever — whether past, future, or present; whether internal or external; whether gross or subtle; whether inferior or superior; whether far or near — all of it should be viewed with correct wisdom exactly as it is: 'This is not mine, this am I not, this is not my self.'"

In the same way, with respect to all feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness whatsoever — whether past, future, or present,

whether internal or external; whether gross or subtle; whether inferior or superior; whether far or near — all of it should be viewed with correct wisdom exactly as it is, as before.

Monks, it is because the learned noble śrāvakas see the five clinging aggregates exactly as they truly are — as without self and without anything belonging to a self — that, having thus seen them exactly as they truly are, they do not cling in the slightest to anything in the world. Not having clung, they are not tormented. Not being tormented, they themselves attain nirvāṇa. They know with full understanding: "My birth is exhausted; the holy life has been lived; what had to be done has been done; there is no further existence beyond this."

When this exposition of the Dharma had been spoken, the five remaining monks were liberated from defilement, their minds freed without clinging.

From the passage beginning "The one arhat who was absent" through "that none who practiced the holy life turned away or spoke in reproach" — all of that is as before, as in the third sūtra of the Blessed One.

Knowing thus — "This is the Dharma; this is the Vinaya; this is what the Teacher taught" — the venerable Ānanda then recited the sūtras that the Blessed One had taught in various villages, cities, districts, and royal palaces, at their respective times, and compiled them together with the five hundred arhats, with one absent. Those sūtras that dealt chiefly with the aggregates were gathered and arranged under the heading of the aggregates. Those that dealt chiefly with the sense bases were gathered under the six sense bases. Those that dealt chiefly with dependent origination and the noble truths were gathered under the heading of originating conditions. Those in which śrāvakas spoke most extensively were gathered under the heading of śrāvaka teachings. Those in which the buddha spoke most extensively were gathered under the heading of buddha teachings. Those that dealt chiefly with the four applications of mindfulness, the four right abandonments, the four bases of miraculous power, the five faculties, the five powers, the limbs of awakening, and the limbs of the path were gathered under the heading of the limbs of the path. Sūtras with a great deal of precise and correct statement were gathered under the section of precise and correct statement. Those containing verse, together with properly elaborated material, were gathered under the heading of scriptures with proper elaboration. Long sūtras were placed under the heading of long scriptures. Medium-length sūtras were placed under the

heading of medium-length scriptures. Those entitled "of one phrase," "of two phrases," through "of ten phrases" were designated the scriptures derived from the one, the numerically arranged collection.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa said to the venerable Ānanda: "Venerable Ānanda, is this the full extent of your scriptural transmission?" The venerable Ānanda replied: "Venerable Mahākāśyapa, this is the full extent — there is nothing beyond this." And so saying, he descended from the lion throne.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa spoke: "Venerable ones, the sūtras of the Blessed One have now been compiled in their entirety. Let us now take up the discussion of the Vinaya." All replied: "So be it."

At that time the venerable Upāli had already become skilled in the Vinaya, learned in its occasioning circumstances and the stories behind its rules. Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa, seated on the lion throne, spoke: "Venerable ones, the venerable Upāli is skilled in the Vinaya, learned in its occasioning circumstances and the stories behind its rules, and the Blessed One himself prophesied him as the foremost upholder of the Vinaya. Therefore, with great enthusiasm, let him be appointed to compile the Vinaya." All replied: "So be it."

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa said to the venerable Upāli: "Venerable Upāli, you are a practitioner —"

"— are you willing to compile all the Tathāgata's Vinaya without remainder?" "I am willing."

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa descended from the lion throne, and the venerable Upāli took his seat upon it. The venerable Mahākāśyapa then began the formal act of the Saṅgha, addressing the assembly: "Venerable ones, please listen. The venerable Upāli is willing and undertaking to compile all the Blessed One's Vinaya without remainder" — and from there, through the words "since no one speaks against it, so it is accepted," all proceeded as before.

The venerable Mahākāśyapa descended from the lion throne, and the venerable Upāli took his seat upon the lion throne. Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa said to the venerable Upāli:

This is the fifty-eighth fascicle of the section on minor rules.

Venerable Upāli, where did the Blessed One establish the first training rule? He replied clearly: In the city of Vārāṇasī. For whose sake? For the sake of the five monks. And the reason? Because the rule was established thus: "The lower

robe is to be worn in a circular fashion." Then those among the five hundred arhats who had not yet been born entered into the four dhyānas perfected to their highest limit, and with the knowledge of aspiration they surveyed — and so forth as before, through the words "the venerable Mahākāśyapa thought to himself" — that when the Blessed One's first training rule had been properly compiled in this way, no practitioner of the holy life objected to it or found fault with it. Therefore they recognized: "This is the Dharma. This is the Vinaya. This is what the Teacher taught." The venerable Mahākāśyapa then said to the venerable Upāli: "Venerable Upāli, tell us where the Blessed One established the second training rule." He replied clearly: In the city of Vārāṇasī. For whose sake? For the sake of the five monks. And when the rule was established thus: "The upper robe too is to be worn in a circular fashion." Then those among the five hundred arhats who had not yet been born entered the four dhyānas perfected to their highest limit — and so forth as before for the second training rule — and no practitioner of the holy life objected to it or found fault with it. Therefore they recognized: "This is the Dharma. This is the Vinaya. This is what the Teacher taught." The venerable Mahākāśyapa then said to the venerable Upāli: "Venerable Upāli, tell us where the Blessed One established the third training rule." He replied clearly: In the village of Kalandaka. For whose sake? For the sake of Supriya, son of Kalandaka. And the reason? Because the rule was established thus: "Furthermore, if a monk who shares the same training and stands equal with the other monks — without having relinquished the training and without having declared his weakness in the training — engages in sexual conduct, the practice of unchastity, even with an animal born in a lowly state of existence, that monk has incurred a defeat and may not remain." Then those among the five hundred arhats who had not yet been born entered the four dhyānas perfected to their highest limit — and so forth as before, through the words "this is what the Teacher taught."

The remaining training rules of the Blessed One — those spoken in whichever villages, cities, districts, and royal residences — the venerable Upāli recited one by one for the monks, and those among the five hundred arhats who were not yet present made them into a canonical text. These are the defeats. These are the residues for the Saṅgha. These are the two undetermined rules, the thirty rules entailing forfeiture, the ninety rules entailing confession,

the four rules entailing individual confession, the many rules of training, and the seven rules for settling disputes. This is what was prescribed. This is what

was subsequently prescribed. This is what is to be individually abandoned. This is what is permitted. Ordination by going forth and full ordination are to be performed in this way. The act of a single motion is to be performed in this way. The acts of a motion with two proclamations and a motion with four proclamations are to be performed in this way. One of this kind is to be expelled. One of this kind is not to be expelled. The restoration ceremony is to be performed in this way. The invitation ceremony is to be performed in this way. From rules of this sort — this is the detail, this is the origin story, this is the intention — he compiled the Vinaya in full, point by point in just this manner. Then the venerable Upāli Sengge descended from the lion throne.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa, foreseeing that in times to come people would be of weak wisdom and would follow mere letters, and that among those who aspired to the profound meaning there would be some who needed only him to protect the meaning of the sūtras and the Vinaya — thinking "I shall set forth what is called the Māmakī," and so desiring that purpose, he performed the act of a motion with two proclamations, seated himself on the lion throne, and addressed the monks in these words:

"Venerable ones, what is called 'Māmakī, Māmakī' — that I alone shall now teach. The Māmakī is what makes the defining characteristics of all that is to be known perfectly clear: namely, the four close applications of mindfulness, the four correct abandonments, the four bases of miraculous power, the five faculties, the five powers, the seven factors of awakening, the noble eightfold path, the four specific knowledges, the four fruits of the contemplative life, the four Dharma-summaries, the absence of affliction, knowledge arising from aspiration, supreme culmination, emptiness that is emptiness, signlessness that is signless, the concentration cultivated through familiarity, what arises from the summit of direct realization, conventional knowledge, calm abiding, special insight, and the thorough compilation and analysis of the aggregates of Dharma-categories — all of these are what is called the Māmakī."

Then, those among the five hundred arhats who had not yet been present, beginning from "supreme culmination," recited all that follows — "This is the Dharma. This is the Vinaya. This is what the Teacher taught" — just as before.

Then the earth-dwelling yakṣas, having compiled and drawn forth the sūtras, the Vinaya, and the Abhidharma, proclaimed aloud with melodious voice: "Wondrous! The noble Mahākāśyapa and the five hundred arhats have fully compiled the three scriptural collections of the Sugata. The bodies of the gods

have thereby increased, and the bodies of the asuras have altogether diminished!" Thus they spoke. The earth-dwelling yakṣas' cry was heard by the yakṣas moving through the sky, and from these it resounded instantly, in that very moment, in that very instant — in a single moment, in a single flash — all the way to the realm of Akaniṣṭha. When the gods of Akaniṣṭha in turn proclaimed it, the announcement spread back down, and the bodies of the asuras had altogether diminished — and so forth as before, just as it was recounted.

Because it was compiled by five hundred arhats, it came to be known by the name "compiled by five hundred, compiled by five hundred."

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa, having completed the compilation, spoke these words:

The speech of the one who holds the ten powers is boundless.
For the benefit of beings, I have compiled this treatise on the Dharma.
Where the world is darkened by feeble minds and wasted away,
it stands as a lamp that clears the dimness from the intellect.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa reflected thus: "Having compiled the three scriptural collections, I examined with the wisdom of aspirational awareness how long they should be preserved so that the teaching of the Blessed One would endure" — and everything that was said to that effect, I have fulfilled in every way. Whatever the Blessed One declared and prophesied, I have accomplished to the best of my ability. I have regarded the Blessed One, the nature of reality, the lord of the Dharma, as a dear friend, looked to him closely, repaired what needed to be repaired, and rendered even a small measure of benefit in return. Yet who can fully requite that protector of the world — repaying him without remainder? I have practiced the holy life in conformity with the Dharma and have rendered benefit to the worlds. Having long ago been appointed by my teacher, I am now weary of this burden of the aggregates and this body full of filth. I have come to the moment of passing fully into nirvāṇa; it is time for me to go.

And having so reflected, he spoke:

I have compiled the sūtras of the Sage
and set the path of the Dharma in place.
From one to the next, through long ages,
these scriptures of the Teacher shall endure.
The shameless have been cut off by severance;

the conscientious have been thoroughly embraced.
Because I have brought benefit and virtue,
the time of my nirvāṇa has now come.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa approached the venerable Ānanda and said: "Venerable Ānanda, know this: the Blessed One entrusted the teaching to me and passed into nirvāṇa. Now I too shall pass into nirvāṇa — so guard the teaching. In Rājagṛha there will be born the son of another merchant, and because he will be wrapped in a garment of linen he will be given the name Linen-Clad. He shall cross the great ocean and return, and he will serve the teaching of the Blessed One for a period of five years. Ordain him as a monk and entrust the teaching fully to him." So he spoke.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa thought to himself: "Now, before I go, I wish to make offering for the last time at the relics and bodily marks of the Blessed One, who strove with great compassion and was nourished by a spiritual teacher of boundless qualities. I will go and rest at peace wherever his relics may be." With that thought, he went to the four great stūpas and, after paying reverence and making excellent offerings at the eight relic stūpas, he went to the dwelling place of the nāgas, made offering at the Blessed One's tooth relic, then rose upward into the sky and went to the realm of the Thirty-Three Gods.

There Śakra, the lord of the gods (Indra), and many other gods rejoiced and made offerings, and asked: "Why have you come? If you have a wish, please speak it."

"Kauśika," he replied, "I have come wishing to make offering for the last time at the tooth and other marks of the Blessed One."

When Śakra, the lord of the gods, and the other gods heard the word "last," they became downcast; and having stirred up that feeling, they said nothing at all. They then brought it forth. And then the elder Mahākāśyapa took the tooth relic in his hand, gazed at it without blinking, placed it upon his crown, and scattered over it an abundance of māṇḍārava flowers, blue lotuses, and powdered heartwood of sandalwood and serpent-wood. He gave a brief teaching to Śakra and the many hundreds and thousands of gods, urging them to be heedful. Then he vanished from the summit of Mount Meru and departed for Rājagṛha.

He thought to himself: "When the time comes for me to pass into nirvāṇa, I should send word to King Ajātaśatru." So he went to the royal palace and said

to the doorkeeper: "My good man, go and let King Ajātaśatru know that Kāśyapa is standing at the gate and wishes to pay his respects to the king."

He entered inside. Now the king happened to be asleep, and the doorkeeper said: "Noble sir, the king is sleeping." The elder said: "Go and rouse him." The doorkeeper replied: "Noble sir, the king is fierce-tempered; he will have me punished with execution." "Very well, then — when he has woken from sleep, tell him this: Kāśyapa is about to pass into nirvāṇa."

Meanwhile, the venerable Mahākāśyapa ascended the Vulture Peak, the southern mountain of Rājagṛha. In the midst of the three hills he made a grass seat, and he reflected: "The robe-cloth given to me by the Blessed One has been apportioned over my body and blessed until the time when Maitreya's teaching shall spread. All those beings who were foremost among the Blessed One's assembly of disciples have been caused to feel sorrow. Now I shall enter such a meditative absorption that my body will remain here within this chamber enclosed by the three hills, undecayed until the teaching of Maitreya has spread wide. When King Ajātaśatru comes, the door will open. If he does not see my body, I know that he will vomit warm blood and reach the point of death." And so he relinquished the life-formations. The very instant he relinquished the life-formations, the earth trembled in six ways, shooting stars fell, the directions blazed, and the gods beat their drums in the sky — or so he had foreseen.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa, having performed a joining together, a burning, a drawing of lightning, and various great miracles, blessed his own body, lay down on his right side, placed one foot upon the other, and passed fully into nirvāṇa in the sphere of nirvāṇa without remainder.

Then Śakra (Indra, the lord of the gods) and Brahmā and the other gods thought to themselves: "Why has this trembling arisen for us?" And when they understood that the venerable Mahākāśyapa had passed into nirvāṇa, Śakra and Brahmā and the other gods, together with many hundreds and thousands of gods, took up blue lotuses, red lotuses, white lotuses, and other such flowers, along with finest sandalwood and powdered aloe-wood, went to the place where the remains of the venerable Mahākāśyapa lay, and arrived there. They honored and strewed upon the elder's body blue lotuses, red lotuses, kumuda lotuses, fine white lotuses, finest sandalwood, and powdered aloe-wood, and then sealed the three hills together and covered him over.

Then the gods, bereft of the elder, were overcome with grief. They thought: "The grief we felt at being parted from the Blessed One had not yet subsided, and now, before it could clear, this too has come to pass." The gods dwelling in this Nyagrodha cave suffered obstruction to their wholesome practice of the Dharma. The kingdom of the ruler of the land of Magadha became empty and devoid of light. "Now there is no protector," they thought, "to care for the poor, the destitute, and the helpless with loving-kindness, no guardian to benefit them. People are impoverished of virtue. Now two Blessed Ones alone have passed into nirvāṇa." They thought: "Now the peak of the mountain of the holy Dharma has crumbled. Now the boat of the holy Dharma is wildly rocking. Now the light of the holy Dharma has faded. Now the ocean of the holy Dharma is churned into turmoil."

"Now the Teacher who bestows benefit is nowhere to be seen, and even the māras rejoice." With these words and many other such lamentations, the people paid their respects and disappeared from sight.

Now, as for King Ajātaśatru: in a dream he saw the lineage of the Kṣatriya clan severed. Seeing this, he woke in fright, and then heard the doorkeeper announce that the Elder Mahākāśyapa was about to pass fully into nirvāṇa. Upon hearing this, the king fainted and fell to the ground. When he had been revived with water and helped to his feet, he went to the Jeta Grove, prostrated himself with his whole body at the feet of the Venerable Ānanda, and wept, saying: "I have heard today that the Elder Mahākāśyapa has passed into nirvāṇa."

Then the Venerable Ānanda led King Ajātaśatru up to Kukkuṭapādagiri, the mountain of the rooster's foot. There the yakṣas split open the mountain, and the king saw the body of the Elder arrayed in robes of mandārava flowers, kuśeśaya blossoms, and the finest sandalwood powder. Seeing this, he stretched out his arms and, like a tree felled at the root, prostrated himself with his whole body at those feet; then he rose and was about to begin gathering wood to cremate the body.

The Elder Ānanda said: "Great king, what do you intend?"

The king replied: "I intend to consume the Elder's body in cremation."

The Elder said: "Great king, this body has been blessed to remain until the scripture of Maitreya arrives. The bodhisattva Maitreya will come to this very place surrounded by sixty-nine million śrāvakas, take up the body of the Elder Mahākāśyapa, and show it to those śrāvakas, saying: 'This one called Kāśyapa

was a śrāvaka of the Blessed One Śākyamuni — foremost among those who are content with little, who know sufficiency, and who uphold the quality of training — and he it was who properly gathered together the holy Dharma of that Blessed One Śākyamuni." Then, the Elder showed this to the assembled śrāvakas.

The people of that future time, it is thought, will have smaller bodies, and they will surely regard the body of the Blessed One Śākyamuni as having been immense. Then that Blessed One will take the patchwork robe from the Elder's body and show it to the śrāvakas, saying: "This is the patchwork robe of the perfectly and fully awakened Blessed One Śākyamuni." Hearing this, those very śrāvakas — sixty-nine million monks — having properly received the qualities of training, and having striven and accomplished as much as was possible, were blessed by him so as to actualize the state of arhat directly. Although this body cannot be consumed by fire, a stūpa is to be erected upon it.

Then the king arrived at the entrance, the mountain closed in and covered the Elder's body. Afterward the king erected a stūpa on top and made offerings.

Then King Ajātaśatru prostrated himself at the feet of the Venerable Ānanda and said: "Elder, I have not witnessed the Blessed One's passing into nirvāṇa, nor have I seen the Elder Mahākāśyapa. Now I should like to behold the Elder passing into nirvāṇa."

"So be it," the Elder agreed.

Now, a man wearing linen garments arrived in ease and good fortune from the great ocean. He had hidden his wealth as a hoard and then came to the Jeta Grove. He bowed to the Venerable Ānanda, who was walking at the door of the fragrant house, and said: "Venerable one, please know this: I am holding a five-year festival. I have crossed the great ocean and arrived in ease and good fortune. Therefore I wish to hold a five-year festival for the Saṅgha of monks, beginning with the buddhas. Where does the Blessed One reside?"

The Elder said, "My son, the Blessed One has passed into nirvāṇa." When the man wearing linen garments heard this, he fainted and fell to the ground. After some time, water was sprinkled on him and he was revived. When he had regained his senses, he said, "Elder, where is Śāriputra? He too has passed into nirvāṇa. And the Great Maudgalyāyana, and the Great Kāśyapa — they likewise." Then, with great sorrow arising in him, he made his offering of the five-year festival out of faith, and completed it fully. Afterward, the Elder said

to him, "My son, you have already drawn people to the teaching of the Blessed One through material gifts. Now gather them through the Dharma itself."

The man wearing linen garments said, "Elder, what do you command? How long before the Elder Ānanda tells someone to go forth into the Blessed One's teaching?" The man said he would do just so. And after a time, the Venerable Ānanda caused him to go forth and, through the formal act of entreaty and of the four-fold procedure, had him fully ordained, and accepted him, for the rest of his life, as one who wears and bears the linen robe.

He was one who upheld what he had heard. All that the Venerable Ānanda had heard and retained from the Blessed One — and everything the Venerable Ānanda had heard and kept among both communities of monks and nuns — the Venerable man of linen garments also retained, and he expanded the three knowledges and the three scriptural collections in full.

Now, the Elder Ānanda was dwelling in the Añjana Grove when a monk recited this verse:

One who lives a hundred years
is, without doubt, like a water-crane before a pool —
as the crane merely gazes at the pool,
a solitary life, lived well, excels it.

When the Venerable Ānanda heard this, he went to that place and said, "My son, the Blessed One did not say it in that way. Rather:

One who lives a hundred years
is, without doubt, subject to arising and perishing.
For one who teaches both kinds of person,
to proclaim it forever on this earth
is for one with faithlessness and aversion in mind,
or for one whose faith has gone utterly astray.

One who has grasped the sūtras wrongly
is like a cow that has wandered into a swamp —
that one is drawing near to ruin,
bereft of wisdom's own discernment:
one who does not know what has been heard bears no fruit,
and wrong understanding is like poison.
One who knows what has been heard truly
is the wise one who has gone beyond."

Then the monk's teacher said to him, "Ānanda has grown old, and his memory has declined." The Elder replied:

Tormented by old age,
the memory of the one with a body may falter.
One who no longer recollects correctly —
that one's mind is crushed by age.

"Go there and say this." The Elder Ānanda then returned, and when the monk recited those words again, the Elder said, "Did I not say that the Blessed One did not say it in that way?" And the monk spoke as the teacher had instructed.

Then the Venerable Ānanda considered: "If I myself were to speak to the monk, it would come to a dispute. It would not be fitting for him to come before me, nor is it proper that I should go to him." He then thought: "All those great ones — Śāriputra, the Great Maudgalyāyana, the Great Kāśyapa and the rest — have already passed. Before long I too shall pass into nirvāṇa, and the holy Dharma of the Blessed One will remain in the world for a thousand years." And he spoke:

Those who were old have gone before,
and I am not in harmony with the new and young.
I dwell alone in meditative concentration,
remaining here like a hatching egg.
All my companions and dear friends
have gone on and passed away before me.
One who remembers how to rest in meditative concentration —
a spiritual friend such as that is no longer to be found here.

Purified of stain, gone to peace — a lamp for wandering beings,
the great ones who, with their greatness of being, dispelled the pitch-black darkness of delusion.
Having tamed immeasurable beings to be tamed,
they stand alone, like what remains in a deserted hermitage grove of stūpas.

Then the Blessed One, clad in robes of hemp, having entrusted the teaching to the Great Kāśyapa, passed utterly into nirvāṇa. He in turn had entrusted it to me, saying: "Now I entrust the teaching to you; I shall pass into nirvāṇa. Guard it everywhere." And the Blessed One had given a prophecy that in the land of Broached-Ruin, at the place called Rimurunda, the sons of a merchant — Nata and Phata by name — would build a temple and become patrons of that temple. The temple at Rimurunda being already built, the Blessed One further

prophesied that in the land of Broached-Ruin there would come to be a son named Nyesba, born to a man known as the Hidden Incense Seller; that this boy should be ordained; and that one hundred years after the Blessed One had passed into nirvāṇa he would become a buddha without marks, and would perform all the activities of a buddha.

When the venerable Śāṇavāsin said this, the venerable Ānanda replied: "I shall do as the preceptor has instructed."

Then Śāṇavāsin said: "I too shall now pass into nirvāṇa, and I entrust you with this."

The elder Ānanda then thought: "If I pass into nirvāṇa here, King Ajātaśatru and the Vriji-subduer will quarrel with one another, and the people of Vaiśālī will not receive a share of the relics. If I pass into nirvāṇa in Vaiśālī, those others will not receive a share either. Therefore let me pass into nirvāṇa in the middle of the river Gaṅgā." And so he went there.

Now King Ajātaśatru dreamed that he saw the handle of the parasol held over the king become cracked. He woke in terror, and his doorkeeper told him: "O god, the elder Ānanda is about to pass into nirvāṇa."

On hearing this the king fainted and fell. After a time he was revived with water, regained his senses, and the king said: "Where is the venerable Ānanda passing into nirvāṇa?"

The venerable Śāṇavāsin replied:

Great King, this one who arose manifestly as the devoted son who followed the Blessed One,
the certain guardian of the treasury of the holy Dharma,
who brought conditioned existence to cessation, of utterly pure intelligence —
he has gone forth manifestly to the city of Vaiśālī.

Then King Ajātaśatru armed a fourfold host of troops and marched to the bank of the river Gaṅgā. And the gods addressed the people of Vaiśālī:

The noble Ānanda, lamp of wandering beings,
showed compassion to the multitude of common folk.
This sage, having dispelled the darkness of sorrow,
has gone to Vaiśālī, firm and at peace.

Then the Licchavīs of Vaiśālī likewise armed a fourfold host and came to the bank of the river Gaṅgā. The elder Ānanda, meanwhile, had boarded a boat

and was seated in the middle of the river Gaṅgā.

Then King Ajātaśatru prostrated at the feet of the elder Ānanda, touching his head to the ground, and spoke:

His eyes as wide-open as a lotus of a hundred petals, the awakened one of Vaiśālī —

he who was the lamp of the three realms of existence, now gone to peace.

We have come to you for refuge; yet if you are going to peace,
come back here for our sake — let your body linger here awhile.

The people of Vaiśālī spoke likewise. And then the venerable Ānanda gave rise to this thought:

If I leave my body in the town of Māgadhā,
the Licchavīs will certainly fall into suffering.

If I leave my body in the city of the Vajjians,
the lord of Māgadhā will surely be displeased.

Therefore I shall give half my body to the lord of men,
and give half my body to the assembly —

and thus, for both of them alike,

it will become a worthy object of veneration forever.

At the very moment the elder Ānanda passed into nirvāṇa, the great earth shook in six ways. At that time another ascetic (ṛṣi), accompanied by a retinue of five hundred, came by supernormal power to where the venerable Ānanda was. Joining his palms together in reverence, he addressed the elder Ānanda: "We wish to go forth and receive full ordination in this well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, and to be established in the state of a fully ordained monk."

No sooner had the elder Ānanda given rise to the thought — "Let the disciples come together and approach me" — than, even as he formed that intention, five hundred disciples arrived there. The elder Ānanda conjured solid ground in the middle of the river, rendering it impassable by boat.

Thereupon the five hundred ascetics who had gone forth and requested full ordination — all five hundred attained the fruit of non-return. Having declared the third karma ceremony and abandoned all afflictions, they attained the fruit of arhatship. Since they had gone forth in the middle of the river Gaṅgā, at the midpoint between sun and water — some in the midst of the river and some at the solar midpoint — they became known accordingly. Having accomplished what was to be done, they prostrated at the feet of the venerable Ānanda,

touching their heads to the ground, and spoke: "The Blessed One last ordained the foremost Supriya and then passed into nirvāṇa first. Now please, preceptor, grant us your command — for we too are about to pass into nirvāṇa before you, and we have no wish to witness the preceptor's own passing into nirvāṇa."

The elder replied: "Children, the Blessed One, having entrusted the teaching to the venerable Mahākāśyapa, passed into nirvāṇa. The elder Mahākāśyapa in turn entrusted it to me. Now, as I am about to pass into nirvāṇa, you must guard this teaching well. The Blessed One prophesied concerning the land of Kaśmīr as follows: 'The land of Kaśmīr is supremely suited to meditative concentration and is the finest of dwelling places.' And the Blessed One also prophesied: 'One hundred years after my nirvāṇa, a fully ordained monk called Madhyāntika will arise, and he will establish the teaching there.' Therefore, children, you too should take up the teaching." They replied: "We shall do so."

Then the venerable Ānanda began to display various miraculous manifestations. The people of Māgadha wept with compassion, calling out: "O Protector, come back to us!" The Vajjians too wept with compassion, calling out: "O Protector, come back to us!" Both peoples on either bank of the river cried out these words. Hearing them, the one of great wisdom divided his former body in two.

Then the venerable Ānanda, his body transformed by blessing, displayed various miraculous manifestations, and, like water being cast into fire, he passed into nirvāṇa. Half his body was received by the people of Vaiśālī, and half was obtained by King Ajātaśatru, who then declared:

With the sharp vajra of wisdom
he cleft the mountain of his own body.
Half he gave to the lord of men,
and half the Sage gave to the assembly.

Thereupon the Licchavīs erected a stūpa in Vaiśālī and established it there. And King Ajātaśatru likewise erected a stūpa at the southern gate of the city and established it there.

Then the thought arose in the venerable Madhyantika that his own preceptor had charged him, saying, "Go and establish the Dharma in the land of Kashmir." The Blessed One had likewise prophesied: "There shall arise a monk named Madhyantika, who will subdue the nāgas (Skt. nāga) hostile to humans in the land of Kashmir and establish the Dharma there." And so, thinking, "I

must fulfil the Teacher's intention entirely," the venerable Madhyantika journeyed to the land of Kashmir and sat down cross-legged.

Then Madhyantika, intending to overpower the nāgas of Kashmir and thinking, "If I agitate those nāgas, they will be tamed," entered into the appropriate meditative absorption. The land of Kashmir shook in six ways, and the nāgas, disturbed and furiously enraged, unleashed fierce hailstorms and advanced to do harm to the elder. But the elder entered into the meditative absorption of loving-kindness, and the nāgas were unable to stir even the hem of the elder's Dharma robe.

Next the nāgas sent a rain of arrows, and the elder caused shining flowers to fall — blue lotuses, red lotuses, kumuda lotuses, and white lotuses. The nāgas began to hurl single-pointed vajras, great bolts, single-tipped weapons, and enemy-axes, and upon the elder there rained down a shower of kusuma flowers, as they declared in verse:

Just as the peak of a snow mountain,
melted wholly by the sun's radiance,
is seen to vanish entirely away,
so too let all the mountain peaks be gone.

Raining down a shower of silk banners,
making fall a varied rain of kusuma flowers,
raining from the sky a shower of arrows —
all transformed into garlands of blossoms wherever they settled.

Then, through the elder's entering into the meditative absorption of loving-kindness, fire did not burn his body, weapons could not pierce him, and poison could not touch him. The nāgas were filled with wonder.

The nāgas then approached the elder and said, "Noble one, what do you command?" The elder said, "Give me this place." The nāgas replied, "We do not grudge to give it." The elder said, "This place was prophesied by the Blessed One as my residence: inasmuch as this land of Kashmir is a dwelling suited to meditation, from this day forward it is mine." The nāgas said, "Did the Blessed One truly declare this?" The elder replied, "The Blessed One declared it." The nāgas asked, "How large a place shall we give?" The elder answered, "Only so much as I occupy sitting cross-legged." The nāgas said, "Venerable one, we shall give it," and the elder, sitting cross-legged, pressed down with his crossed legs upon the confluence of nine valleys. The nāgas then asked, "How great a retinue does the elder possess?" The elder thought,

"How many monks will gather?" and reckoning, "Perhaps five hundred arhats," the elder declared: "Five hundred arhats." The nāgas said, "So be it — but if even a single arhat is missing, then at that time we shall reclaim the land of Kashmir for ourselves." The elder Madhyantika then said to the nāgas of Kashmir: "That being so, yet since wherever a patron dwells there must be recipients to receive offerings, I shall also bring in householders." The nāgas said, "So be it." And the elder himself established villages, towns, and districts, and groups of people entered in. These people then asked the elder, "How shall we prosper?"

Thereupon the elder led the assembled people to the saffron fields, told them to go in and harvest saffron, and they did so. But the nāgas of the saffron fields grew enraged. The elder then tamed them as well, and they declared: "How long will the teaching of the Blessed One endure?" The elder replied, "One thousand years." The nāgas then pledged: "For as long as the teaching of the Blessed One endures, we shall allow it to remain." The elder said, "So be it," and then he consecrated Kashmir for the planting of saffron.

Now, in the space of a single day, the elder established the teaching of the Blessed One in Kashmir, spread it widely, and gladdened both householders and those who lived the holy life by performing miraculous displays of many kinds. Then, like fire quenched by water, he passed into nirvāṇa, and his body was burned with supreme sandalwood and aloe and other such fragrant woods, and a stūpa was built and set in place.

After that, the venerable Śāṇavāsin himself gave the going-forth to the venerable Upagupta, spread the teaching broadly, and said to him: "Venerable Upagupta, know this: the Blessed One entrusted the teaching to the venerable Mahākāśyapa and passed into complete nirvāṇa; the venerable Mahākāśyapa entrusted the teaching to his preceptor and passed into complete nirvāṇa; my preceptor entrusted the teaching to me and passed into complete nirvāṇa. My son, I too shall now pass into complete nirvāṇa. Henceforth you must guard the teaching well and apply yourself diligently to all that the Blessed One has declared."

Thereupon the venerable Śāṇavāsin gladdened both householders and those who lived the holy life by performing miraculous displays of many kinds — blazing with fire, burning, causing rain to fall, and causing lightning to strike — and passed into complete nirvāṇa in the element that leaves no aggregates remaining.

The elder Upagupta then transmitted the teaching's purpose to the venerable Dhītika; the venerable Dhītika to the venerable Kṛṣṇa; and the venerable Kṛṣṇa to the venerable Sudarśana. In this way those great elephants passed into complete nirvāṇa.

One hundred and ten years had passed since the Blessed One, the fully awakened one, had passed into complete nirvāṇa, and the sun of the Victor had set. The monks of Vaiśālī then overstepped ten improper rules — transgressing the sūtras, transgressing the Vinaya, departing from the teaching of the Teacher, not in accord with the sūtras, not appearing in the Vinaya, contradicting the nature of reality — and they presented these as proper, practiced them, and actively followed them. As for what these ten were:

The monks of Vaiśālī made allowable a practice called "A-la-la," and then, both in discord and in accord, they acted contrary to the Dharma, and in a state of discord performed Dharmic acts. This is the first rule, one that overstepped the sūtras, overstepped the Vinaya, departed from the teaching of the Teacher, was not in accord with the sūtras, did not appear in the Vinaya, contradicted the nature of reality, and which the monks of Vaiśālī presented as proper, practiced, and actively followed.

Furthermore, the monks of Vaiśālī urged the resident monks, saying, "Venerable ones, you should rejoice along with us — come, rejoice with us," and having induced them to rejoice and having made such rejoicing allowable, they then, both in discord and in accord, acted contrary to the Dharma, and in a state of discord performed Dharmic acts. This is the second rule, one that overstepped the sūtras, overstepped the Vinaya, departed from the teaching of the Teacher, was not in accord with the sūtras, and did not appear in the Vinaya.

and was contrary to the nature of reality. With respect to these, the monks of Vaiśālī presented as allowable what was not allowable, and practiced and actively followed it.

Furthermore, the monks of Vaiśālī made it allowable to dig the ground and have others dig it with their own hands. This is the third rule, one that overstepped the sūtras, overstepped the Vinaya, departed from the teaching of the Teacher, was not in accord with the sūtras, did not appear in the Vinaya, and was contrary to the nature of reality. With respect to these, the monks of Vaiśālī presented as allowable what was not allowable, and practiced and

actively followed it.

Furthermore, the monks of Vaiśālī mixed salt that had been consecrated for lifetime use together with salt that was allowable only at the proper time, consumed it, and declared that mixed salt was allowable. This is the fourth rule, one that overstepped the sūtras, overstepped the Vinaya, departed from the teaching of the Teacher, was not in accord with the sūtras, did not appear in the Vinaya, and was contrary to the nature of reality. With respect to these, the monks of Vaiśālī presented as allowable what was not allowable, and practiced and actively followed it.

Furthermore, the monks of Vaiśālī traveled a league and a half, assembled together, ate a meal, and declared that eating in such a manner while on the road was allowable. This is the fifth rule, one that overstepped the sūtras, overstepped the Vinaya, departed from the teaching of the Teacher, was not in accord with the sūtras, did not appear in the Vinaya, and was contrary to the nature of reality. With respect to these, the monks of Vaiśālī presented as allowable what was not allowable, and practiced and actively followed it.

Furthermore, the monks of Vaiśālī ate food and provisions that had not been set aside as a remainder, doing so by means of a two-fingered gesture, and then declared that the two-fingered practice was allowable. This is the sixth rule, one that overstepped the sūtras, overstepped the Vinaya, departed from the teaching of the Teacher, was not in accord with the sūtras, did not appear in the Vinaya, and was contrary to the nature of reality. With respect to these, the monks of Vaiśālī presented as allowable what was not allowable, and practiced and actively followed it.

Furthermore, the monks of Vaiśālī strained fermented drink through a water-straining cloth as though filtering through a lotus, drank it, and declared it allowable for the sick. This is the seventh rule, one that overstepped the sūtras, overstepped the Vinaya, departed from the teaching of the Teacher, was not in accord with the sūtras, did not appear in the Vinaya, and was contrary to the nature of reality. With respect to these, the monks of Vaiśālī presented as allowable what was not allowable, and practiced and actively followed it.

Furthermore, the monks of Vaiśālī churned together a full measure of milk and a full measure of curds, ate them outside the proper time, and declared that what had been mixed in this way was allowable. This is the eighth rule, one that overstepped the sūtras, overstepped the Vinaya, departed from the

teaching of the Teacher, was not in accord with the sūtras, did not appear in the Vinaya, and was contrary to the nature of reality. With respect to these, the monks of the city of Vaiśālī presented as allowable what was not allowable, and practiced and actively followed it.

Furthermore, the monks of Vaiśālī took an old sitting mat that was trimmed with a border the width of a Sugata's span, used it without replacing it with a new mat, and declared that the use of such a sitting mat was allowable. This is the ninth rule, one that overstepped the sūtras, overstepped the Vinaya, departed from the teaching of the Teacher, was not in accord with the sūtras, did not appear in the Vinaya, and was contrary to the nature of reality. With respect to these, the monks of Vaiśālī presented as allowable what was not allowable, and practiced and actively followed it.

Furthermore, the monks of Vaiśālī took their round and pure alms bowls — ones fit for use — washed and rinsed them, perfumed them with fine incense, adorned them with various sweet-smelling flowers, placed them on a throne-cushion atop a seat, and then set them out on the main road, at the market, and

at the four crossroads, and made this proclamation: "Let the many people who have come from various towns and cities and are dwelling in Vaiśālī — let those who are wise listen! This is a fine alms bowl. Give here, give generously! Whoever makes an offering into it, by that act of offering they will obtain great fruit, great benefit, great striving, and great breadth of result." And having thus acquired and obtained silver, gold, and other precious things, they made use of them and treated gold and silver as permissible. This was beyond the sūtras, beyond the Vinaya, departed from the teaching of the Teacher, not appearing in the sūtras, not evident in the Vinaya, and contrary to the nature of reality. With respect to these, the monks of Vaiśālī presented as allowable what was not allowable, and practiced and actively followed it.

Now at that time, the venerable Ānanda was dwelling in Vaiśālī, and dwelling alongside him was an elder called Sarvatrāma — an arhat who cultivated the eight liberations — and he lived there humbly, in modest circumstances. And in the city of Kosambi there was an elder named Yaśas who likewise dwelt together with others, who was also an arhat who cultivated the eight liberations. He was traveling about with a retinue of five hundred, wandering through the countryside, and he came to the city of Vaiśālī. When the various gains were being distributed upon his arrival, the monastery steward said to

him: "Elder, the gains of the elder Saṅgha have been distributed — please take your share." He replied: "Venerable one, what gains have arisen, and who gave them?" The steward described it in detail, and Yaśas then reflected: "Is this solitary incident the only one of its kind, or are there others as well?" He then saw that the slackening of the training and the practice of all ten non-allowable matters was growing, and, wishing to make the teaching endure, he went to where the venerable Sarvatrāma was. Having arrived, he bowed his head at the venerable Sarvatrāma's feet and said to him: "Elder, is it allowable — the thing they are calling allowable with the word 'Alala'? Venerable one, what is this that they call 'allowable by the Alala [word]'? Elder, the monks of Vaiśālī perform Dharma-acts by non-conformity through what is not Dharma by non-conformity, and what is not Dharma by conformity, and they make it allowable saying 'Alala.'"

Vinaya: minor matters, fascicle fifty-nine. The venerable one: it is not allowable. The elder: it was established at the city of Campā. What it depends on: the group of six monks. What transgression it becomes: an offense of wrongdoing. This elder matter is beyond the first root sūtras, beyond the Vinaya, departed from the teaching of the Teacher, not appearing in the sūtras, not evident in the Vinaya, and contrary to the nature of reality. With respect to these, if the monks of Vaiśālī present as allowable what is not allowable, and practice and actively follow it, then he said to them: "Have you set aside your equanimity over such things?" And they said nothing in reply.

Then he said: "Elder, it is for that very reason that I make this request. Is this practice of making things allowable by the word of approval — 'allowable by approval' — itself allowable? Venerable one, what is this that they call 'allowable by approval'? Elder, the monks of Vaiśālī perform Dharma-acts by non-conformity through what is not Dharma by non-conformity, and what is not Dharma by conformity, and by non-conformity perform Dharma-acts, saying, 'Let the venerable ones approve by approval!' — and they cause the surrounding monks to approve and make things allowable by approval."

"Elder, it is not allowable." "Where was it established?" "In the city of Vaiśālī." "On the basis of whom?" "On the basis of the six groups of monks." "What transgression does it entail?" "A wrongdoing."

"Elder, this is the second basis. It has gone beyond the sūtras, gone beyond the Vinaya, is divorced from the Teacher's teaching, does not enter into the sūtras, does not appear in the Vinaya, and contradicts the nature of reality.

Regarding these matters, when the monks of Vaiśālī fully teach what is not allowable as allowable and practice it and thoroughly practice it — did you remain in equanimity toward all that?" And the elder said nothing.

Then he said: "Elder, it is for that very reason that I make this request. Is this practice of making things allowable by communal practice itself allowable? Venerable one, what is this that they call 'allowable by communal practice'? Elder, the monks of Vaiśālī dig the ground and excavate it with their own hands, and make it allowable by communal practice."

"Venerable one, it is not allowable." "Where was it established?" "In Śrāvastī." "On the basis of whom?" "On the basis of the six groups of monks." "What transgression does it entail?" "A transgression entailing expiation."

"Elder, this is the third basis. It has gone beyond the sūtras, gone beyond the Vinaya, is divorced from the Teacher's teaching, does not enter into the sūtras, does not appear in the Vinaya, and contradicts the nature of reality. Regarding these matters, when the monks of Vaiśālī fully teach what is not allowable as allowable and practice it and thoroughly practice it — did you remain in equanimity toward that?" And the elder said nothing.

Then he said: "Elder, it is for that very reason that I make this request. Is this practice of making salt allowable itself allowable? Venerable one, what is this that they call 'allowable salt'? Elder, the monks of Vaiśālī mix salt that is allowable at its proper time together with other salt and consume it throughout their entire lives, and in this way make salt allowable at its time."

"Venerable one, it is not allowable." "Where was it established?" "In Rājagṛha." "On the basis of whom?" "On the basis of the venerable Śāriputra." "What transgression does it entail?" "A transgression entailing expiation."

"Elder, this is the fourth basis. It has gone beyond the sūtras, gone beyond the Vinaya, is divorced from the Teacher's teaching, does not enter into the sūtras, does not appear in the Vinaya, and contradicts the nature of reality. Regarding these matters, when the monks of Vaiśālī fully teach what is not allowable as allowable and practice it and thoroughly practice it — did you remain in equanimity toward that?" And the elder said nothing.

Then he said: "Elder, it is for that very reason that I make this request. Is this practice of making things allowable by the road itself allowable? Venerable one, what is this that they call 'allowable by the road'? Elder, the monks of Vaiśālī travel a league and a half, gather together, eat their meal, and then

make things allowable by the road."

"Venerable one, it is not allowable." "Where was it established?" "In Rājagṛha." "On the basis of whom?" "On the basis of Deva-datta." "What transgression does it entail?" "A transgression entailing expiation."

"Elder, this is the fifth basis. It has gone beyond the sūtras, gone beyond the Vinaya, is divorced from the Teacher's teaching, does not enter into the sūtras, does not appear in the Vinaya, and contradicts the nature of reality. Regarding these matters, when the monks of Vaiśālī fully teach what is not allowable as allowable and practice it and thoroughly practice it — did you remain in equanimity toward that?" And the elder said nothing.

Then he said: "Elder, it is for that very reason that I make this request. Is this practice of making things allowable by two fingers itself allowable? Venerable one, what is this that they call 'allowable by two fingers'? Elder, the monks of Vaiśālī eat food and drink that has not been formally made a remainder — making it allowable by two fingers — and after eating they make things allowable by two fingers."

"Venerable one, it is not allowable." "Where was it established?" "In Śrāvastī." "On the basis of whom?"

"On the basis of many monks." "What transgression does it incur?" "It incurs a transgression." "Elder, this sixth point goes beyond the sūtras, goes beyond the Vinaya, is divorced from the Teacher's teaching, does not appear in the sūtras, is not found in the Vinaya, and contradicts the nature of reality. To teach openly and practice habitually that what is not allowable is allowable — as those monks of Vaiśālī do in regard to these matters — did you remain in equanimity toward that?" And he said nothing.

Then he said: "Elder, it is for that very reason that I make this request. Is the practice of making things allowable for the sick itself allowable? Venerable one, what is this that they call 'making allowable for the sick'? Elder, the monks of Vaiśālī filter fermented drink through a lotus-fibre strainer and drink it, then make it allowable as medicine for the sick." "Venerable one, it is not allowable." "Where was it established?" "In Śrāvastī." "On the basis of whom?" "On the basis of the venerable Legsong." "What transgression does it incur?" "It incurs a transgression." "Elder, this seventh point is the same as the earlier ones."

"It is for that very reason that I make this request. Is the practice of making things allowable by mixing itself allowable? Venerable one, what is this that they call 'making allowable by mixing'? Elder, this is how it is: the monks of Vaiśālī stir together a full measure of milk and a full measure of curds and eat it at an improper time, making it allowable by means of the mixing." "Venerable one, it is not allowable." "Where was it established?" "In Śrāvastī." "On the basis of whom?" "On the basis of many monks." "What transgression does it incur?" "It incurs a transgression." "Elder, this eighth point goes beyond the sūtras, goes beyond the Vinaya, is divorced from the Teacher's teaching, does not appear in the sūtras, is not found in the Vinaya, and contradicts the nature of reality. To teach openly and practice habitually that what is not allowable is allowable — as those monks of Vaiśālī do in regard to these matters — did you remain in equanimity toward that?" And he said nothing.

Then he said: "Elder, it is for that very reason that I make this request. Is the practice of making things allowable by means of a seat-mat itself allowable? Venerable one, what is this that they call 'making allowable by means of a seat-mat'? Elder, this is how it is: the monks of Vaiśālī make use of an old seat-mat whose circumference measures a Sugata's span, without patching its worn border, and make it allowable on account of the mat." "Venerable one, it is not allowable." "Where was it established?" "In Śrāvastī." "On the basis of whom?" "On the basis of many monks." "What transgression does it incur?" "It incurs a transgression." "Elder, this ninth point goes beyond the sūtras, goes beyond the Vinaya, is divorced from the Teacher's teaching, does not appear in the sūtras, is not found in the Vinaya, and contradicts the nature of reality. To teach openly and practice habitually that what is not allowable is allowable — as those monks of Vaiśālī do in regard to these matters — did you remain in equanimity toward that?" And he said nothing.

Then he said: "Elder, it is for that very reason that I make this request. Is the practice of making things allowable by means of gold and silver itself allowable? What is this that they call 'making allowable by means of gold and silver'? Elder, this is how it is: the monks of Vaiśālī take alms-bowls that are round and clean and fit for use, smear them with lac, fumigate them with fine-smelling incense, adorn them with various fragrant and beautiful flowers, place them on a small throne with a cushion-seat upon the head of a monastic, and then circulate through the main roads, the marketplaces, and the crossroads, proclaiming aloud these words: 'Let the wise persons dwelling in Vaiśālī who have come from various towns and regions, listen!'

'This alms-bowl is a fine alms-bowl. Whoever gives here, gives abundantly, or pours offerings into it, will obtain great fruit, great benefit, great endeavor, and great extent of result.' By these words, coins, gold, and other precious things were obtained and received, and they lived off those and used gold and silver to make things allowable.

Elder, that is not allowable.

Where is this established? In the Vinaya, in the sections treating the offenses requiring abandonment and in the scriptures dealing with proper conduct; it is included among what the Buddha has taught; it is found in the Norbu on the Crown sūtras; it occurs in the longer scriptural transmissions; it belongs to the collection dealing with moral discipline; it is in the middle-length scriptures; it occurs in paired scriptures; it appears in the Strengthening sūtras; in scriptures derived from the one preceding; and in those belonging to the fourth and fifth. From whom does it depend? From the group of six monks, from other monks, and from householders. This elder, then, exceeds the text of the Ten Grounds Sūtra, exceeds the Vinaya, and is separated from the teaching of the Teacher; it does not accord with the sūtras, it does not appear in the Vinaya, and it contradicts the nature of reality. Fully expounding these points to them and putting them into constant and thorough practice — are you going to remain indifferent to this? Go now, Elder, and search for an ally, and I shall assist you in accordance with the Dharma.

The elder replied that he would do just so. The venerable Yaśas, having heard that elder comply with all that was desired, then entered into and remained in the most excellent meditative absorption and abided there.

At that time, in the city of Norcan, the venerable elder Cayala was residing together with the venerable Ānanda — an arhat who cultivated the eight liberations. Then the venerable Yaśas went to where the venerable Cayala was, arrived there, and having prostrated with his head at the venerable Cayala's feet, spoke these words: 'Elder, is making allowable by means of "A-la-la" allowable? What is this that is called making allowable by "A-la-la"? Elder, in Vaiśālī the monks of Vaiśālī, by means of a discordant act that is not in accordance with the Dharma, or a concordant act that is not in accordance with the Dharma, or a discordant act performed as a legal act of the Saṅgha, make things allowable by declaring "A-la-la."'

Elder, that is not allowable. Where is this established? In Campā. From whom does it depend? From the group of six monks. What transgression does it

become? A wrongdoing. This elder, then, exceeds the text of the first ground sūtra, exceeds the Vinaya, and is separated from the teaching of the Teacher; it does not accord with the sūtras, it does not appear in the Vinaya, and it contradicts the nature of reality. Fully expounding these points to them and putting them into constant and thorough practice — are you going to remain indifferent to this? Elder, therefore I ask: is it allowable to express approval? What is this that is called the venerable one expressing approval? — and so on, as before, with the ten points set out in detail.

Then he said: Go and seek an ally, and I shall take sides in accordance with the Dharma.

Then the venerable Yaśas prostrated with his head at the venerable Cayala's feet and went to the city called Sāṃkāśya.

At that time in the city called Sāṃkāśya, the venerable elder Dhanakas was residing together with the venerable Ānanda — an arhat who cultivated the eight liberations. Then the venerable Yaśas prostrated with his head at the venerable Dhanakas's feet and spoke to the venerable Dhanakas these words:

"Elder, is the expression of approval by saying 'Alala' permissible? Venerable one, what does it mean to express approval by saying 'Alala'? Elder, in the city of Vaiśālī, the monks of Vaiśālī perform a monastic act without harmony and without Dharma, or with harmony but without Dharma, or with disharmony in performing a Dharma act, and then express approval by saying 'Alala.' Venerable one, it is not permissible. Where was it established? In Campā. On what basis? From the group of six monks. What is the transgression? A wrongdoing. Elder, this first basis goes beyond the sūtras, goes beyond the Vinaya, is divorced from the Teacher's teaching, does not accord with the sūtras, does not appear in the Vinaya, and is contrary to the nature of reality. Given that the monks of Vaiśālī are fully teaching and practicing what is not permissible as though it were permissible, will you remain indifferent to this? Elder, for this very reason I make this request: is it permissible to express approval by saying 'Alala' through rejoicing? Venerable one, what does it mean to express approval through rejoicing?" — and so on, as before, setting out the ten points in detail.

Then he said: Go and seek an ally, and I shall take sides in accordance with the Dharma.

Then the venerable Yaśas prostrated with his head at the venerable Dhanakas's feet and went to the city called Sāṃkāśya. At that time in the city

called Sāṃkāśya, the venerable Priyadatta and the venerable Zlagur were residing there, and at that time they had entered into the meditative absorption of cessation. Then the venerable Yaśas set out the ten points in detail to the venerable Priyadatta, prostrated with his head at the venerable Priyadatta's feet, and went on to Srughna. At that time in Srughna, the venerable Aparājita was residing there, and he set out the ten points in detail to him as well, then prostrated with his head at his feet and went on to Mahela. At that time in Mahela, the venerable Sambhūṭasanavāsin was residing there, and he set out the ten points in detail to him as well, then prostrated with his head at his feet and went on to Sahajāta. At that time in Sahajāta, the venerable Namgru was residing there, and he prostrated with his head at that elder's feet and said:

"Elder, is the expression of approval by saying 'Alala' permissible? Venerable one, what does it mean to express approval by saying 'Alala'? Elder, in Vaiśālī, the monks of Vaiśālī perform a monastic act without harmony and without Dharma, or with harmony but without Dharma, or with disharmony in performing a Dharma act, and then express approval by saying 'Alala.' Venerable one, it is not permissible. Where was it established? In Campā. On what basis? From the group of six. What is the transgression? A wrongdoing. Elder, this first basis goes beyond the sūtras, goes beyond the Vinaya, is divorced from the Teacher's teaching, does not accord with the sūtras, does not appear in the Vinaya, and is contrary to the nature of reality. Given that the monks of Vaiśālī are fully teaching and practicing what is not permissible as though it were permissible, will you remain indifferent to this? Elder, for this very reason I make this request: is it permissible to express approval by saying 'Alala' through rejoicing? Venerable one, what does it mean to express approval through rejoicing?" — and so on, as before, setting out the ten points in detail.

Now the venerable Namgru, wondering whether this venerable one had first come to him or had gone elsewhere, and then seeing that he had indeed gone to others as well, thought to himself: This venerable one has come from a long journey and must be weary; I shall let him rest and go out myself to seek allies. With this in mind, he spoke to the venerable Yaśas:

"Venerable Yaśas, you have come from a long journey and must be weary; rest here, and I shall go out to seek allies." With these words he let him rest, and the venerable Namgru departed to seek allies.

Then the monks of Vaiśālī went to the monk who was the attendant dwelling with the venerable Yaśas, came to him, and asked: "Venerable one, where has the venerable one's preceptor gone?" He replied: "The venerable one has gone to seek allies." "But why has he gone to seek allies?" "Because he intends to carry out a formal act of expulsion against us from our residence." "What must we do to prevent him from carrying out this formal act of expulsion against us?" He explained it to them at length. And they said: "Venerable one, what he is doing is not right. If such and such things are permissible to live by according to the scriptures of the Teacher who has passed away, why should we be thought inferior? Then someone else, from among them, with an honest mind and well-meaning words, spoke to them: "Venerable ones, you are behaving in a way that is discordant, improper, and unbecoming of ascetics. It was heard before that the Blessed One's teaching would endure for a thousand years; yet now you are engaged in conduct that makes the future teaching itself invisible — and just as others too have entered into lax training and produced these bubble-like formations, it is precisely in order to preserve the teaching that a formal act of expulsion is certainly being undertaken against you." Upon hearing this, they were frightened and, losing their courage, sat in silence.

Then they began to pass the news from one to another: "The venerable Yaśas has gone seeking allies and intends to carry out a formal act of expulsion against us — why do we sit here with such faint hearts? Tell us how we should proceed." Then one of them said: "What is there to accomplish? If he has gone seeking allies, we too can seek allies. Why should we be the ones to leave?" Another said: "Let us flee and go away before we come into conflict with that venerable one." Another said: "But wherever we go, the same fault will follow us there in the same way. We should ask for pardon." Another said: "We cannot ask for pardon; we are already hemmed in on all sides." Another said: "Here is what we should do: all those many attendants who dwell with him have their alms-bowls, robes, nets, bowls, and belts gathered together — let us bind them up and put them away somewhere to be retrieved later." Another said: "Good, let it be so." And so they distributed things among themselves: to some they gave a patched robe; to some they gave an upper robe; to some they gave a lower robe; to some they gave a sweat-cloth; to some they gave a sitting cloth; to some they gave an alms-bowl; and to some they gave a water-strainer. In this way they gathered everything together and took up a position in the middle.

Now by the time the venerable Yaśas had gradually sought allies and returned to Vaiśālī, his attendants who had come with him arrived there but had not yet entered the town of Vaiśālī — they were resting from the journey — when those attendants said to him: "Preceptor, were those allies found? Master, they will come without long delay. Well sought, preceptor." He thought: "Such a disposition as that is one to be entirely turned away. If such and such things are permissible to live by according to the scriptures of the Teacher who has passed away, why should I do harm to those people?" Then he thought: "What were those unprecedented words they spoke? Certainly these ones must have taken possession of what belongs to those others" — and realizing this,

The venerable ones spoke words without precedent, saying: "The venerable ones have taken into their own possession what belongs to those others" — and upon saying this, those others sat in complete silence.

Then the venerable Yaśas spoke in verse to those who had deliberated together with him:

Since the aspects of laxity in the training have multiplied,
it is fitting that they be distant from what is proper —
do not neglect the purpose of the teaching.

Whoever neglects what is proper, makes distance fitting, makes laxity fitting,
who utterly abandons right conduct — that childish one goes to suffering.
He is one abandoned by fortunate companions of good repute.
His benefit does not increase, like the moon in its waning fortnight.

Whoever thinks in accordance with that intention, who is wise, who does not neglect,
who abandons what is not proper — that skilled one attains happiness.
He will not be abandoned by companions who are fortunate and of good repute.
His benefit increases, like the moon in its waxing fortnight.

Then the venerable Yaśas entered the walking hall of the monastery and, entering into meditative absorption in the four dhyānas perfected to their ultimate degree, he surveyed with aspiration and examined through his knowledge. When the wooden signal board was struck, all of those — the arhats falling one short of seven hundred — who were dwelling together with the venerable Ānanda assembled.

At that time, however, the venerable Candragiri had entered into the meditative absorption of cessation and did not hear the sound of the board. Then, when the community of monks had gathered and assembled, the venerable Yaśas thought: "If I were to call out those ones by name, it would cause great disruption — therefore I will speak without naming them by name." So thinking, he bowed in order of seniority, and standing to the side of the eldest with hands joined in reverence, he took his seat.

Since the arhats fell one short of seven hundred and it was desired to fulfil that number, at that moment the venerable Candragiri too rose from his meditative absorption in cessation. Then a god said to him: "Noble Candragiri, why do you remain with a mind of lesser scope? Those arhats who share your preceptor, falling one short of seven hundred, are gathering together in Vaiśālī in order to establish the teaching — you should go quickly." With that, by means of miraculous power, he vanished from the city of Kuśāgāra and traveled to Vaiśālī, where he sat at the gate of the walking hall of the monastery and knocked at the door.

The monks asked: "Who are you?"

He spoke in verse:

Among those dwelling in Kuśāgāra —
monks learned in much scripture, upholders of the Vinaya —
one other than those has arrived here:
one called Conqueror of the Faculties stands at the gate.

The monks said: "There are others called Conqueror of the Faculties as well — tell us who you are."

He again spoke in verse:

Among those dwelling in Kuśāgāra —
ascetics learned in much scripture, upholders of the Vinaya —
one other than those has arrived here:
one called Doubt-Severer stands at the gate.

The monks said: "There are others called Doubt-Severer as well."

He again spoke in verse:

Among those dwelling in Kuśāgāra —
ascetics learned in much scripture, upholders of the Vinaya —
one other than those has arrived here:

one called Without-Remorse stands at the gate.

The monks said: "There are others called Without-Remorse as well — tell us who you are."

He again spoke in verse:

Among those dwelling in Kuśāgāra —
ascetics learned in much scripture, upholders of the Vinaya —
one other than those has arrived here:
one called Candragiri stands at the gate.

The monks said: "Welcome, welcome — please come inside."

He entered inside. The monks then came out from the surrounding courtyard and circumambulated the venerable Candragiri as a mark of respect. After that they entered the courtyard and took their seats, each in his proper place. The venerable Yaśas then formally recited the ten points before those seated in order of seniority, saying: "Venerable ones, is it permissible to give approval by the exclamation 'Alala'? What is meant by 'approval by the exclamation Alala'? Venerable ones, there are certain monks who have performed what is contrary to the Dharma through discord, what is contrary to the Dharma through concord, and what constitutes a formal act of the Saṅgha contrary to the Dharma through discord, and thereby give approval by the exclamation 'Alala.' Venerable ones, this is not permissible. Where was it established? At Campā. On what basis? In connection with the group of six monks. What transgression does it constitute? A wrongdoing. Venerable ones, this first point departs from the sūtras and departs from the Vinaya; it is severed from the Teacher's dispensation, it finds no entry in the sūtras, it finds no place in the Vinaya, and it is at variance with the nature of reality. Regarding these matters, the monks of Vaiśālī have proclaimed publicly that what is not permissible is permissible, practiced and continued to practice it — these we shall reject. Venerable ones, that being so, we now put this question to the others: is it permissible to give approval by rejoicing?"

Up to the phrase "What is meant by giving approval by rejoicing?" the ten points were then set forth in full just as before. Having recited them correctly, they came out from the surrounding courtyard, and then after the gong had been struck and the monks dwelling in Vaiśālī had gathered together in a body, seated together with them, the venerable Yaśas once again, before those seated in order of seniority, began to recite the ten points by name,

saying: "Venerable ones, is it permissible to give approval by the exclamation 'Alala'? What is meant by giving approval by the exclamation 'Alala'? Venerable ones, the monks of Vaiśālī have performed what is contrary to the Dharma through discord, what is contrary to the Dharma through concord, and what constitutes a formal act of the Saṅgha contrary to the Dharma through discord, and thereby give approval by the exclamation 'Alala.' Venerable ones, this is not permissible. Where was it established? At Campā. On what basis? In connection with the group of six monks. What transgression does it constitute? A wrongdoing. Venerable ones, this first point departs from the sūtras and departs from the Vinaya; it is severed from the Teacher's dispensation, it finds no entry in the sūtras, it finds no place in the Vinaya, and it is at variance with the nature of reality. Regarding these matters, the monks of Vaiśālī have proclaimed publicly that what is not permissible is permissible, practiced and continued to practice it — these we shall reject. Venerable ones, that being so, we now put this question: is it permissible to give approval by rejoicing? What is meant by giving approval by rejoicing?"

Up to this phrase, the ten points were set forth in full just as before, together with the conclusion "these we shall reject." When the seven hundred arhats had thus recited it correctly, it became known by the name "The Correct Recitation by Seven Hundred," "The Correct Recitation by Seven Hundred," "The Correct Recitation by Seven Hundred."

A summary verse:

The Alala, the practice of approval by rejoicing,
the examination, the salt, the path,
the two-finger permission, the stirring, and the certainty,
and the matter of gold and silver — these are the true summary of the
intermediate section.

The city of Vaiśālī and the possessor of wealth,
the one descended from the gods and likewise the red-robed one,
Sarvagāmin and the one who possesses a buffalo,
and the one who arose simultaneously — these are the latter ones.

All those of Doṣa, of Yaśas, of Guile,
of Dhaniya, and of Priya,
Candragiri and likewise Aparājita,
Samudra, Nāvagiri, and the rest.

Here, the commentary has completed what is called the Eighth Chapter of Karmagroups, fulfilling all eight chapters. The Vinaya of the Minor Matters (Skt. kṣudrakavastu) is complete.

This was translated by the Indian masters Vidyākaraprabha and Dharmasīrabha, together with the Tibetan translator, the monk Paljyor.

At the time this Vinaya Scripture of the Minor Matters was translated, many translators divided it into many portions and rendered each portion separately. When these were compiled into a volume, the sections became scattered in the wrong order and were assembled in an incomplete state, so that much of the Scripture of the Minor Matters remained deficient. Later, when the Elder Dharmasīrabha, residing at the temple of La-stod Ol-rgod, erected the four canonical collections, the virtuous spiritual friend and great Vinaya-holder Byang-chub Seng-ge undertook the practical work. He searched with great effort and the offering of manuscript fees among those dwelling in temples throughout Ü and Tsang in general, and in particular among those at Samyé and Chimpu — including the junior monk Dagchungwa and the monk Tsulkrim Yönten — for the copies they had obtained, and by comparing the texts against one another, those passages of the Scripture of the Minor Matters that were absent from some copies but present in others were used to fill the gaps and restore the text. What was supplied and corrected amounts to this: beginning from the passage in the thirty-third fascicle (Skt. bāmpo), in the context of the story of the Great Physician, where the Great Physician says, "If that is so, vomit it out! Let us see whether it is true or false" — and continuing to the beginning of the thirty-fourth fascicle — one fascicle that had been cut was restored. As for the verse summary: below the line "I too, by the medicine, it was likewise" — one line that had been cut was restored. Then, at the end of the thirty-fourth fascicle, upon the completion of the context of the conduct of the Niṭhyodha — from the passage "Alas, to have met one such as you who is truly learned is a blessing for one who possesses merit" — continuing to the upper portion of the forty-third fascicle — this is the general summary. The gap from the lower portion of the thirty-fourth fascicle to the upper portion of the forty-third fascicle — nine fascicles that had been cut — were restored. Below that summary verse, one line of the summary verse that had been cut was restored. Then, at the end of the forty-sixth fascicle, in the context of the narrative episode of the brahmin boy Masdug: from the passage "Such a return from that kind of wrong livelihood, the crooked practice of those ascetics" — continuing to the beginning of the forty-eighth fascicle, where it

reads: "Then at that time, the brahmin Padmasnying-po was gathered and assembled together with the elder brahmins at a high and prominent place of a great householder" — the forty-seventh fascicle, which had been cut, was restored. Then, at the end of the fiftieth fascicle, in the context of the instruction given to Ānanda: from the passage "Ānanda, a monk of this kind should dwell with oneself as an island, oneself as a refuge, the Dharma as an island, and the Dharma as a refuge — not with another island, not with another refuge" — continuing to the upper portion of the fifty-second fascicle — this is the intermediate summary. From the passage ending "Capāla and performing the conditioning factors of life" — one fascicle that had been cut was restored.

In total, what was supplied amounts to twelve fascicles and two lines of summary verse. This very restoration has become the crown jewel of the great Elders of the Tibetan lineage who hold their vows and are learned. It was accomplished by Chimpa Thams-cad Mkhyen-pa — a monk of the Śākya order who holds the Vinaya, the Sūtras, and the mother of the Piṭakas, whose maṇḍala of knowledge extends across the sky of all that is to be known, and whose rays of renown pervade every direction.

A manuscript copy was summoned from the great temple of Ol-god in Upper Latö, and at the glorious temple of Narthang — that source and wellspring of the Dharma — a pure and complete edition was compiled encompassing all four scriptural divisions. From that very edition a copy was made, and in particular a copy was made of those very supplementary passages that had filled the missing portions. Then, summoning the manuscript copy of the Kangyur compiled by the Śākya monk Jampa'i Dbyangs, the glorious community of Victors, in order to cause the teaching of the Victor to spread and flourish in every direction and at all times, compiled at the glorious temple of Gung-thang a full and complete set of these supplementary scriptural portions — which supply what is missing in the great Sage's word, in the root canonical texts, in the two divisions of the monastic codes of monks and nuns, and in the principal treatises. Those who subsequently compile scriptural editions should also write the fascicle-count in sequence from the beginning of each aṣṭaka, just as the numbering is given here.

Here abides the Vinaya.

Translator's Notes

- The three opening summary verses are standard mnemonic verse-summaries of chapters to come. Their translation necessarily requires supplying some context from the commentarial tradition; individual items such as "elder's body-wash," "mirror-born matter," and "ring impression" are technical headings for stories that follow in the text and are deliberately terse in the original. The phrase rendered "pressed down by the round of your throat" is a somewhat obscure insult in the original, likely mocking the monks' shaved heads or round bowls; the exact idiomatic force is uncertain.
- The phrase rendered "speak with contempt" and then "spoke with contempt, saying: 'Speak with contempt!'" reflects a slightly awkward textual moment in the Tibetan where the terms for mockery and contemptuous speech appear in close succession. The passage appears to describe bystanders mocking the group of six, who then respond — the sequence is preserved faithfully though the Tibetan is slightly elliptical at that point.
- The term rendered throughout as "Giu Wanggi Thig Le" is a Tibetan transcription of what appears to be a foreign — possibly Indic or Central Asian — cosmetic or ritual substance associated with elaborate body-markings or dots. Its precise Sanskrit equivalent is not established with certainty in this context; it may refer to a style of decorative body-marking associated with brahminical or festival practice. This uncertainty does not affect the sense of the legal rulings, which concern self-adornment with such markings as a monastic offense.
- The phrase rendered "the hill of the Jīvaka's Children's Killing — the grove that strikes terror into the heart" is unusual and the Tibetan toponym is obscure. The passage reads རྒྱལ་གླིང་གི་རྩོད་སྐབས་ཀྱི་ཁོ་རྩོད་པ་མཉམ་ནས་འཇུག་པའི་སྤྲོལ་ཆེན་པོ།. This likely refers to a known locale described in Vinaya narratives, possibly Jīvaka's mango grove near Rājagṛha or a related site; the literal rendering has been preserved here since the exact identification is uncertain and a smooth paraphrase would risk misidentifying the place. The name Ānanda does not appear explicitly in the Tibetan at the close of this passage — བློ་བཟང་པོ་ལྷན་ཅིག་ is rendered "the beloved Ānanda" following standard Vinaya usage where this term refers to Ānanda as a named disciple.
- The term rendered "offense entailing a meeting of the community" translates a Vinaya technical expression for a saṅghādisesa, a class of offense that requires formal confession before the assembled community. The Tibetan does not spell out the term in full in each instance but the context is consistently that of this category of transgression.

ornaments" for sor gdub rgya renders a compound meaning finger-ring-style seal or signet fittings on a lock, which is the most plausible reading in this Vinaya context.

- The passage uses a stock narrative device of abbreviated repetition, signaled in Tibetan by "everything is exactly as before" and a resumption mid-narrative. The translation makes this seamless for a listener by rendering the abbreviated section as a smooth continuation rather than a scribal shorthand note.

The series of similes for nail shapes — tip of a grain, ledge of a fence, razor's edge, crescent, first sliver of the new moon — are Vinaya technical descriptions of nail-trimming styles; they are rendered descriptively rather than left as bare Tibetan images.

- The "Group of Six" monks refers to the notorious sextet of ill-disciplined monks who appear repeatedly in Vinaya narratives as foils illustrating misconduct; no further gloss is needed for a Vinaya-literate audience, but listeners unfamiliar with the tradition should know this is a stock Vinaya cast of characters whose habitual misuse of communal resources is the narrative point here.

The phrase rendered "a garden of a thousand mango trees" follows the Tibetan literally; the gift is of the garden as a whole containing a thousand trees, donated to the four-directional Saṅgha in perpetuity, with a festival attached to it.

- The phrase rendered "the Ānanda Garden" follows the preceding context where Ānanda was shown overseeing a mango garden. The Tibetan "ཡོངས་ལྗོངས་ཀྱི་ཡོངས་ལྗོངས་" at this point likely means the garden associated with Ānanda, consistent with the narrative. The term "ཡོངས་ལྗོངས་" is āmalaka, the myrobalan or Indian gooseberry fruit, rendered here as "myrobalan fruit" for clarity and consistency with traditional Vinaya translation conventions. The "sahakāra tree" is another variety in the mango family; the Tibetan "ཡོངས་ལྗོངས་" is a transliteration of Sanskrit sahakāra, which can denote the champaka mango or a related species.

- The householder's name "ཤུའུ་མཚོ་ཤུའུ་མཚོ་" (Shintu Zangpo) is a Tibetan rendering meaning "extremely good" or "very excellent," likely a translation of a Sanskrit name such as Sudarśana or Supriya. It has been retained in phonetic Tibetan form rather than translated, as it functions as a proper name throughout the passage.

The five medicinal fruits listed correspond to the classical Āyurvedic group known as the three myrobalans (triphālā) plus long pepper and black pepper. The Tibetan terms "ལྷ་ལྷ་ལྷ་ལྷ་ལྷ་" for black pepper is somewhat unusual; "marica" is the standard Sanskrit equivalent offered here as a best reading.

- The naked ascetic's wordplay on "luster" rests on a classical Indian pun: the term rendered "luster" or "to illuminate" shares its root with the word for fire, allowing him to reinterpret the prophecy as foretelling a house fire rather than family glory. This is preserved in the translation by glossing his explanation in context.

The phrase "being in his final existence" refers to a being who will attain liberation in this very life and will not be reborn again, a standard technical usage in Abhidharma and narrative literature.

- The "naked wanderers" renders the Tibetan term for the Nirgrantha ascetics (followers of Jainism), who are depicted as rivals celebrating what they believe to be a failure of the Buddha's prophecy.

The phrase rendered "the white road of existence" is literally "the bright path of existence" and may carry a specific cosmological or metaphorical nuance that is contextually uncertain; it likely indicates the long, difficult road of wandering through saṃsāra.

The lists of numerical qualities of the Buddha — the four bases of miraculous power, the seven limbs of awakening, the ten powers, and so forth — are standard doctrinal enumerations and are rendered here without expansion, as the text itself does not gloss them.

- The list of cold hells in the downward-ray passage follows the standard Abhidharma enumeration of eight cold hells, here rendered by their descriptive meanings rather than transliterated Sanskrit names (Arbuda, Nirarbuda, Aṭaṭa, Hahava, Huhuva, Utpala, Padma, Mahāpadma) since the Tibetan text gives Tibetan descriptive equivalents throughout. The distinction between "powerful wheel-turning kingship" (associated with the left hand) and "wheel-turning kingship" (right hand) likely refers to a cakravartin of the highest and a lower grade respectively, though the Tibetan distinction here is subtle and the commentarial tradition varies.
- The final figures in the list require brief clarification. "Dhṛtarāṣṭra" renders འཇིགས་པོ་ལྷ་མོ་, the guardian king of the East (Skt. Dhṛtarāṣṭra), whose domain is the gandharvas (འཇིགས་པོ་ལྷ་མོ་འཁོར་པ་). The "noble man surrounded by kumbhāṇḍas" renders འཇིགས་པོ་ལྷ་མོ་འཁོར་པ་འཇིགས་པོ་ལྷ་མོ་: འཇིགས་པོ་ལྷ་མོ་ is an epithet likely referring to the guardian king Virūḍhaka, whose domain is the kumbhāṇḍas (a class of spirits, Skt. kumbhāṇḍa). The passage ends mid-sentence in the supplied Tibetan, and the translation reflects this.
- The eighteen "benefits of the Buddha's arrival" is an unusual formulation. The list mixes freedom from physical dangers with positive omens, suggesting this text belongs to a genre of popular sūtra literature enumerating auspicious qualities rather than a standard Abhidharma or Prajñāpāramitā context.

The name rendered "Virūpākṣa" for འཁོར་ལྷ་པོ་ཨ་ཁ་ཨ་ཁ་ is the standard Tibetan translation-equivalent of that lokapāla's name, meaning "Ill-eyed" or "Deformed-eyed." Similarly, "Virūḍhaka" for འཁོར་ལྷ་པོ་ཨ་ཁ་ཨ་ཁ་ follows the standard identification of that lokapāla.

The term 誣告罪 ("false accusation" or "unjust charge") is rendered contextually; it can also mean "bribery" or "inducement to false witness."

- The term rendered "womb-vessel" translates the Tibetan "lto'i nyen kor," a compound referring to the womb or uterine container, here depicted as surviving intact after the cremation before miraculously bursting to produce the lotus. This is a stock miraculous-birth motif, and the rendering follows the sense of a contained vessel associated with the abdomen.

The naked ascetics here are almost certainly Jains (Nigaṇṭhas or Nirgrantha followers), and the one who speaks to Supriya appears to be a Jain teacher bound by his own code, explaining why he refuses to enter the fire himself despite urging Supriya to act.

- The name "Agnijāta" is a Sanskrit reconstruction of the Tibetan "me skyes" — literally "fire-born." The text gives the Tibetan folk-etymology explanation explicitly, so rendering the name in Sanskrit with its meaning conveyed by context is appropriate here.

The closing sentence is grammatically compressed and its referent slightly ambiguous: "his maternal uncle" is the brother of the boy's mother who had earlier left for another region, and the passage appears to be transitioning to a new narrative thread explaining that he had learned by some means of the birth and its auspicious signs. This is a genuine structural ambiguity in the Tibetan at this point.

The sequence of attainments — "warm roots," "highest intensity," "lesser and middling patience" — reflects the standard Abhidharma schema of the four phases of the path of preparation, rendered here in their doctrinal order.

- The name Śin-tu Bzang-po is a Tibetan personal name meaning "Utterly Good" or "Excellent" and likely renders an Indic name such as Supriya or Subhadra; it is retained in transliteration

here since no Sanskrit original is provided and it functions as a proper name throughout the narrative. Similarly, Meskyes (Me-skyes, "Fire-born") is retained as a proper name. The passage's use of "lord" for the king renders the Tibetan honorific lha (literally "god/deity") applied to royalty, which is a standard convention; the gloss "O lord" captures the royal address without importing theological content.

- The greeting "Aroga" is a conventional salutation meaning something like "Be well" or "In good health" — a term of address used when conveying a superior's message to a king, functioning here as a formal honorific opening rather than a personal name or title. It is left transliterated in keeping with the preceding passage's convention.

The phrase rendered "Kalandakanivāpa grove" follows the standard sūtra colophon formula for Rājagṛha; Kalandakanivāpa means the Squirrel-Feeding Ground or Squirrel Park, a well-known location associated with the bamboo grove there. The Tibetan here reads "ku myed pa'i tshal" which is the standard rendering of that name.

- The phrase "the venerable Kāśyapa of the Ten Powers" renders Tshe dang ldan pa 'Od srung Stobs bcu pa. This appears to be a distinct monk named Kāśyapa ("Ösung") with the epithet "of the Ten Powers," not Mahākāśyapa. The epithet "of the Ten Powers" (daśabala) is ordinarily reserved for a buddha; its application to this monk here is unusual and may reflect a nickname or a textual peculiarity in this Vinaya narrative context.

The ruling that display of supernatural power before a layman incurs a "serious offense" renders 'gal tshabs can, meaning an offense of grave consequence — in Vinaya technical terms this falls short of a pārājika but is nonetheless a weighty transgression.

- The term kārṣāpaṇa is a standard Indian monetary unit (a silver or copper coin); it is retained untranslated as a proper currency name, consistent with standard Vinaya translations. The phrase rendered "cut off the road" for demanding toll or dice-fee reflects the dice-house practice of blocking passage until travelers pay a transit levy, a well-attested motif in Mūlasarvāstivāda Vinaya narratives.

- The name Agnidatta is rendered from the Tibetan འགྲོ་འདྲུག་, literally "born of fire," which is a standard Tibetan calque of the Sanskrit Agnidatta or Agniya. The narrative context strongly supports Agnidatta.

The term kārṣāpaṇa is kept in transliteration throughout as it is a specific ancient Indian monetary unit with no natural English equivalent.

The phrase rendered "let me examine it by touching it" translates a somewhat compressed Tibetan idiom; the sense is that Agnidatta reaches out to feel the cloth while mentally deliberating whether the king intends to give it to him.

- The phrase rendered "Māra" for མ་རྩ་ལྔ་པ་ལྔ་པ་ལྔ་པ་ལྔ་པ་ལྔ་པ་ — literally "Young man, the Unborn (Māra)" — reflects a stock epithet of Māra in this narrative context. The passage appears to shift, somewhat abruptly, from Agnidatta's perspective to a scene where ministers address the king (who has been identified with Māra or a māra-figure in the broader narrative). The referent of "he" in the dialogue involving the ministers is ambiguous in the Tibetan and may require the reader to consult the wider story context.

The phrase "dguñ bdun" (rendered "seven high" for the heavens) is a Tibetan idiomatic expression for counting stories or levels of a building; Agnidatta is describing the storeys of his residence, not cosmological heavens. The translation "the heavens to be seven high" approximates the sense.

- The figure "Agni" here renders འགྲོ་འདྲུག་ (literally "fire-born"), used as a personal name throughout this narrative; it is a Tibetan calque of the Sanskrit name Agni or possibly Agnidatta. "Ajātaśatru" renders འཇ་མེད་འཇ་མེད་ (literally "unborn enemy"), the well-known king of

Magadha. These names are sustained from the preceding passage per the continuity instruction.

The phrase 〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇〇 describes the thieves being supernaturally immobilized in whatever posture and position they occupied on the wall — rendered accordingly.

- The phrase rendered as "he moved and then stilled the five-spoked wheel of saṃsāric existence" reflects the Tibetan

"五十二相" literally "knowing both the moving and the not-moving of this five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra." The "five spokes" likely refer to the five aggregates or five realms; the precise referent is not spelled out in the text, and interpretations may vary across commentaries.

The verse at the close of the passage is a well-known canonical stanza on the indestructibility of karma, appearing in multiple sūtras. The rendering follows the standard doctrinal understanding.

- The Buddha's name here rendered as Vipasyin is the Sanskrit equivalent of Tibetan Rnam par gzigis, one of the seven buddhas of antiquity. The epithet means "He Who Sees Clearly" or "All-Seeing."

The name Anāparin is a back-reconstruction; the Tibetan Nyes med ("Anāparin" or "Anāgāmin"-adjacent) may represent a Sanskrit name not fully transparent from this form alone; "Anāparin" follows the standard Tibetan spelling nyes med used here.

The palace name Mūlāga renders Tibetan Rtsa lag can, literally "having roots and branches," which likely represents a Sanskrit name such as Mūlaka or similar; this is a conventional restoration and the exact Sanskrit is uncertain.

- The phrase rendered "drawing lots" translates a term literally meaning "by the size of the canopy" or "by competing canopy measures," which appears to be an idiomatic expression in this Vinaya narrative for a competitive draw or contest to determine precedence. The narrative logic — that whoever wins goes first — confirms this reading, though the precise mechanism of the contest is not entirely clear from the text alone.
- The phrase rendered "set in motion with incense-wood" describes Anāparin stoking or agitating the canopy-steaming apparatus using fragrant wood; the exact mechanical operation is not entirely clear from the Tibetan alone, but the general sense — that he used aromatic wood to perfume cloths — is evident from context.

The final sentence breaks off mid-description (the passage ends mid-enumeration of furnishings), which is consistent with the source text being a continuation.

- The buddha's name rendered here as "Namaparīkṣit" corresponds to Tibetan རྒྱལ་བཤེས་པོ་ཆེན་པོ།, which literally means "the All-Seeing" or "He Who Surveys All Aspects." This is likely a Sanskrit name such as Vipāśyin or a related epithet; the Tibetan matches a known convention for rendering such a name, and the translation of the preceding passage used "Namaparīkṣit" — consistency is maintained, though the exact Sanskrit behind this particular buddha's name in this narrative context warrants scholarly verification.
- The divine son's name rendered here as "Lasthamsadpa" is a transcription of the Tibetan lha'i bu las thams cad pa, which literally means "the divine son who is all-tasks" or "the divine son Sarvakārya." This is a proper name that should ideally be rendered by its Sanskrit equivalent Sarvakārya; the Tibetan here treats it as a name throughout. Likewise, the buddha's name rendered as "Namapar Zikiyi" corresponds to Tibetan rnam par gzigs, Sanskrit Vipāśyin — the first of the seven ancient buddhas. A consistent rendering as "Vipāśyin" would be standard, and the passage should be understood as referring to the buddha Vipāśyin throughout.

King Nyendan corresponds to Tibetan rgyal po gnyen ldan, which may be a rendering of Sanskrit Bandhumant, the father of the buddha Vipāśyin — a detail consistent with the Vipāśyin cycle of narratives found in the Dīrghāgama and related sources.

The goddess Bde (Tibetan bde) heading the list of Śakra's queens likely stands for Sanskrit Śacī or a similar name; the text as given appears abbreviated with "sogs" ("and others") following.

- The summary verse at the passage's midpoint is a colophon-style mnemonic verse listing items whose use was formally permitted, followed by the opening of a new legal narrative. "Namapar Zik" renders the Tibetan buddha-name throughout, consistent with the preceding translation. The final saying — that truthful craftsmen are rare — is a proverbial remark by the friend, anticipating the story that follows about the blacksmith's evasiveness.
- The phrase rendered "variegated or ornamented" translates two Tibetan terms meaning literally "spotted/multicolored" and "bright/beautiful," describing decorated knife handles. The rendering captures the sense of ornamental elaboration that prompted the Blessed One's ruling.
- The two types of needle case described — one with a hollow tube and one with a stopper or plug — reflect standard Vinaya technical vocabulary. The rendering of the second type as "like a container with a stopper" is an interpretation of the somewhat compressed Tibetan; the contrast is between a tubular open-ended case and one that is closed or sealed at one end.

The phrase translated "wooden pins" for རྩྭ་ལྟེ་འཇམ་ལྟེ་ is literally something like "feather-holder" or "pin-holder," here interpreted as a wooden peg or pin used to hold the fabric taut in the frame, which fits the context.

The summary verse at the end is a mnemonic gāthā listing topics treated in this section of the Vinaya. "Warm gown and great fever" likely refer to a subsequent rule about a garment worn during illness or fever, which would appear in the text immediately following.

The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, as the source text is a continuing passage.

- The account of Anāthapiṇḍada offering the Jeta Grove and the episode of "the sweeper" refers to a fuller story told earlier in the Vinaya text; this passage explicitly cross-references that prior narrative with the phrase "just as it was told before."

The bird identified here as "śaṅkaśāṭika" is rendered as "kalavinka birds" following conventional Vinaya translation practice, though the precise species intended by the Tibetan "ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་" is debated; some translators render it simply as a type of melodious bird.

The name rendered "Vakkha" for "བཀའ་མཆོག་" (literally "dwelling among cattle") may alternatively correspond to the monk Vakula or another figure with a similar epithet; the identification is uncertain but does not affect the narrative materially. "King Udayana" renders "འཇམ་ལྟེ་འཇམ་ལྟེ་" (literally "the one who causes to appear," a standard Tibetan rendering of Udayana).

- The text identifies the monk as Piṇḍola Bhāradvāja only by context carried from the preceding passage. The five stages of spiritual attainment the king enumerates follow canonical Pāli and Sanskrit tradition: arhat, non-returner, once-returner, stream-enterer, and then the four dhyānas in descending order. The king's questioning in descending order is a narrative device revealing his ignorance of the path: he works from highest to lowest, hoping to find some redeeming attainment in the monk.
- The name rendered "Vālanasin" follows the Tibetan phonetic form; the Sanskrit original is uncertain and may be a corruption or regional variant. The phrase regarding the physician's advice is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan, and the final exchange is syntactically elliptical; the rendering follows the most contextually coherent reading. "Udayana, king of Vatsa" expands the Tibetan's "king of Vatsa, Udayana" (འཇམ་ལྟེ་འཇམ་ལྟེ་འཇམ་ལྟེ་འཇམ་ལྟེ་) for clarity;

वत्सा is Vatsa and उदयना reconstructs as Udayana (Sanskrit: Udayana, the well-known king of Kauśāmbī).

- The phrase rendered "in the shape of a sea" for the window's interior width is a somewhat unusual simile. The Tibetan suggests the interior opening should be broad like the expanse of an ocean — meaning the window splays wide inward. This is an architectural detail typical of early monastic construction rules preserved in Vinaya literature.

The term rendered "barley-beer" and "āmalaka berry-beer" translates Tibetan forms of medicinal rinses used for the eyes; these are likely dilute medicinal infusions rather than intoxicating beverages, the word "beer" (Tibetan chang) being used loosely for any fermented or steeped liquid preparation in this medical context.

- The phrase rendered "gift of words" translates a Tibetan expression meaning a verbal offering or piece of news to report — here used with a clearly ironic and manipulative intent by the two monks, who are inducing the Licchavi to falsely accuse a third monk before the Buddha. The idiom is somewhat idiomatic and the rendering captures the sense within its narrative context.

The name "Jātanora" is a phonetic rendering of the Tibetan "ཀླུ་བུ་ནོར་" (gyad bu nor); the Sanskrit original is uncertain, but this appears to be a personal name of a monk, treated here as such.

The phrase "born of the earth" is a standard epithet or stock description in Vinaya narratives referring to beings who arose spontaneously from the ground — here applied to the wandering monk in passing, possibly as a formulaic description of his origin or simply as a narrative detail about his nature.

- The Tibetan phrase rendered as "bowl-overturning ceremony" reflects the Vinaya procedure of turning one's alms bowl upside down as a formal sanction against a lay supporter who has wronged the Saṅgha — a recognized ecclesiastical act of censure in multiple Vinaya traditions (Skt. *pātranikkujjana*). The term is kept descriptive throughout for clarity in audio narration.

The phrase translated as "words of inquiry" for the formal motion procedure reflects the standard 𑀅𑁆𑀭 (Skt. *karman*) Vinaya procedure; only a single motion (without a vote) is required in this case, as indicated in the text.

- The phrase rendered "limbs became fit for service" translates a technical Vinaya euphemism for erection or involuntary sexual arousal; this is standard canonical language in Vinaya contexts and requires no further gloss for informed listeners, but general audiences should be aware the summary verse and the narrative that follows pertain to a case of self-stimulation, which will presumably be treated in the next passage.

The opening sentence presents a slight syntactic difficulty: it appears to be the woman's closing ultimatum to the Licchavī (from the preceding passage), and the rendering follows that reading.

The phrase rendered "the two earth-born ones" likely refers to two specific figures known from the broader narrative context; the Tibetan རྒྱལ་བོ་སྤྲུལ་པ་ (earth-born, i.e., born from the earth) may be an epithet or name, and its precise referent is uncertain without more context.

- The opening passage refers to the monk from the preceding section who was struggling with bodily arousal. The term rendered "his limbs became fit for service" is a discreet canonical idiom for sexual arousal; this continues directly from the preceding passage. The act of striking his member on a stone is an ancient canonical account (found in Pāli parallels) of a monk attempting self-castration, here described with characteristic Vinaya restraint. The Blessed One's remark that "the one who should be beaten is the deluded one" is a standard Vinaya doctrinal pun: the correct antidote to desire is meditation on unattractiveness, not physical

self-harm. The phrase rendered "festive assembly" translates a term for communal festival gatherings; the two groups — merchants and soldiers — are stock characters in Vinaya narrative. The final lines set up a new narrative episode.

- The "group of six" refers to the notorious six monks who repeatedly appear in Vinaya narratives as the instigators of misconduct that prompts new rules. The Tibetan "ཤུ་མཉུན་པོ་ལྔ་ལྔ་པ་" here is the soldiers' honorific address to them, not a doctrinal use of "noble ones," though the irony is evident in context.
- The names Supriya rendered from the Tibetan phonetic རྩ་པ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ (bzang ldan) are retained consistently as Supriya throughout, following the Sanskrit reconstruction: bzang ldan is a direct calque of Supriya ("endowed with the good / beautiful"). The child's name རྩ་པ་ལྔ་ལྔ་པ་ (snyan pa bzang ldan) appears to add the qualifier "snyan pa" (beautiful-voiced / melodious) to the family name, and the relatives' reasoning in the text ties the name to both the voice quality and the father's name; this double nuance is preserved in the translation.
- The phrase rendered "wheel of cyclic existence with its five spokes" translates a somewhat unusual expression. The five spokes likely refer to the five aggregates or the five realms of rebirth, both common in this kind of formulation. This is a genuine point of doctrinal ambiguity but does not alter the sense of the passage as a whole.

The expression rendered "split open the shell of the cave of his rebirth-door" is a vivid metaphor for breaking the bonds of continued existence; the precise Tibetan idiom here is unusual but the doctrinal meaning is clear in context.

- The phrase "音聲の共振" is rendered throughout as "the resonance of his voice," following the established convention of the preceding passage. The term suggests the carrying or projecting quality of the voice used in Dharma teaching, possibly with connotations of formal proclamation or announcement.

The final verse is mid-sentence in the source, as the passage breaks off after the conditional "If one knows inwardly." This is faithfully reproduced as an incomplete verse, consistent with the passage being a continuation.

- The buddha named in the Tibetan as "Saṃvartanīya" (བཟུང་བཀོད་པའི་པདྨ་པུ་ཤེས་པ་, literally "destroyer of saṃsāra" or "dissolver of the world") is rendered by its Tibetan meaning rendered into likely Sanskrit equivalent. The name is an epithet-style buddha-name common in this genre of canonical narrative; no single universally attested Sanskrit form exists in the secondary literature, so the reading given here is a plausible reconstruction based on the Tibetan.

The phrase rendered "found a collection of karma, gathered conditions like a flame drawing close, and caused things that were inevitably going to arise" reflects a technically dense passage on the mechanics of karmic maturation. The simile "like a flame drawing close" is unusual and may indicate a variant reading: it is translated as it stands.

- The epithet "the sage who speaks truth" renders "drang strong smra ba," which in the context of Vārāṇasī and the Deer Park is a Tibetan rendering of the name Ṛṣipatana (literally "the place of the sage who speaks truth," a standard alternative name for the site otherwise called Mrgadāva, the Deer Park at Sarnath). This is a genuine textual identification worth flagging.

The phrase "षड्विंशतविद्" refers to a brahmin learned in the six Vedic ancillary sciences (the ṣaḍaṅgas); rendered here as "skilled in the six branches of learning" to capture the sense without inserting a technical list.

- The term rendered "brahmin youth Blama" follows the Tibetan *bram ze'i khye'u bla ma*, where *bla ma* here appears to function as a proper name or title for a brahmin student figure, not as the later Tibetan religious title "lama." The passage is recounting the prophecy given to a brahmin youth in the time of Kāśyapa, and the name or epithet *Blama* (literally "superior/upper") seems to designate a specific individual whose identity is not further

elaborated in this excerpt.

The phrase rendered "scattering the words about like a shower of pine seeds" translates the Tibetan image of *rgya shug gi 'bras bu'i tshogs gtor ba bzhin*, which describes a disorganized, scattered manner of recitation — the pine seeds (or cypress seeds) being flung about without order, implying a lack of melodic cohesion or formal chanting.

- The phrase rendered "scattering a heap of pine cones" translates a simile involving *rgya shug gi 'bras bu* (the fruits, i.e. cones, of a cypress or similar conifer). The image is of something spilling out randomly and without order, describing the young monk's tuneless and disorganized recitation. The rendering "jumble" attempts to preserve this sense for a listening audience.

The royal name "Rtogs Idan" (meaning "the Discerning" or "the Insightful") and its epithet "Gzhon nu" (Young or Youthful) have been kept as a transliteration here because no standard Sanskrit equivalent is firmly established for this figure in the Vinaya narrative and the name as a proper noun is more accurate than a rendered meaning in context.

The location described as "the land of crocodiles, on a frightful mountain, the haunt of wild beasts, in the place of the slaughter of children" (chu srin byis pa gsod kyi ri) is a Vinaya section-marker giving a place name used to indicate a new episode; it is somewhat formulaic and its precise identification as a real place is uncertain.

[illegible]

The term "𐤇𐤍𐤁𐤏𐤍" rendered as "chafed them" reflects the sense of the wide straps causing a different kind of discomfort, likely rubbing or pressing uncomfortably; the precise nature of the problem is not entirely explicit in the text.

• The five textile types prohibited for weaving into robes present some terminological difficulty. The Tibetan terms describe various grades of fiber or weave. "Young animal wool" for རྩུག་པོ་, "goat hair" for རྩུག་, "plain raw cloth" for རྩུག་པོ་, "hemp fiber" for རྩུག་, and "coarse jute fiber" for རྩུག་པོ་ are reasonable renderings, though the precise material referents of རྩུག་ and རྩུག་པོ་ are not entirely certain from context alone; the point is that these are base or unworked materials unsuitable for robes. The passage ending "monks, other monasteries and" is a deliberate cutoff at the boundary of the supplied text.

- The phrase rendered "consecrate them by means of the mental act of one who previously took them out" is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan. The sense is that the mental intention alone, performed by the person who originally removed the robes from consecrated status, suffices to re-consecrate them. This reading follows the commentarial tradition on consecration of robes by mental resolve.

The verse spoken by the second monk contains a slight doctrinal nuance: the compound rendered "gives up one's own life, but does not take the life of living creatures" reflects a strict reading of the precept against taking life even at the cost of one's own death, rather than drink water containing living organisms.

The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end, suggesting the passage continues in the next folio.

- The phrase rendered as "the view of the transitory collection" refers to the technical Abhidharma term *satkāyadṛṣṭi*, the view that grasps at a self among the five aggregates. The image of a "twenty-peak mountain" for this view, shattered by the "vajra of gnosis," is a vivid

Abhidharmic metaphor: twenty peaks correspond to the twenty modes of the satkāyadṛṣṭi (viewing each of the five aggregates as self in four ways). The "fruit of stream-entry" confirms that this is the moment of first seeing the truth directly on the path of seeing.

The phrase rendered as "divine daughter" at the opening reflects the doctrinal convention that the son of the gods (lha'i bu) reborn in that heaven spontaneously possesses three kinds of knowledge shortly after birth; the Tibetan here switches to the feminine form (lha'i bu mo), possibly referring to a separate figure mentioned earlier or reflecting a textual inconsistency. This may warrant checking against a Sanskrit or alternative Tibetan witness.

- The verse concerning Kāśyapa and the ālā leaf is doctrinally dense. The reference is to the great elder Mahākāśyapa having, in a past life, broken his training and been reborn among the nāgas. The "ālā leaf" is a plant associated in Vinaya narrative with the nāga realm; the verse implies that the consequences of his past infraction still bound him to nāga rebirths for a time. This is an established narrative in the Mūlasarvāstivāda Vinaya tradition.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text, reflecting that the Tibetan provided is itself incomplete at that point.

- The speaker identified here as Upavāna (Tib. རམ་བླ་མ་) takes the unusual structural role of both questioner and respondent in the same dialogue sequence. This format, where a named elder poses a question and then immediately supplies the answer himself, is a recognizable Vinaya literary convention recording settled rulings rather than live debate; no textual corruption need be assumed.

The term rendered "one fathom" for རམ་བླ་མ་ translates a standard Indic unit of measure (approximately the span of outstretched arms), used in Vinaya texts to define a monk's immediate vicinity.

- The phrase rendered "just enough to fill a cart of six oxen loaded with bamboo" is a measurement simile for the degree of visual examination required; the image conveys that monks need only inspect water sufficiently to be reasonably confident of its purity, not exhaustively. The Tibetan is slightly compressed here and the precise image is somewhat unusual, but this reading is the most defensible.

The phrase translated "fingerbowls" renders རམ་བླ་མ་, literally "claw-use" implements, which in Vinaya context refers to small bowls or vessels used for washing the fingers after eating — commonly called fingerbowls in English Vinaya literature.

- The gaṇḍī is a wooden plank or board struck as a signal to assemble the Saṅgha; it is the standard monastic convening instrument and is here rendered descriptively on first use.

The formal motion-and-act (འཇུག་, Skt. karman) structure reproduced here is the standard single-announcement single-act (ñattidutiakamma) procedure of Vinaya law; the formulaic repetition is deliberate and has been preserved faithfully.

The phrase rendered "horse dung" refers to the monks of the group of six beating the broken pieces with a clod or lump of horse dung, apparently in mockery or frustration; the passage is intentionally comic and the bystander monks' sarcastic exchange that follows reflects that tone.

- The term rendered "eating utensils" throughout translates a Tibetan term literally meaning something like "individual implements" or "personal vessels" — contextually it refers to individual bowls or containers for food. The detail about "softened and moistened rice" renders a term for a porridge-like or softened preparation, appropriate for the infirm. The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end as given; this is noted for continuity.

- The summary verse is a mnemonic stanza listing the topics covered in the preceding section. Its terms are terse and elliptical by design; the rendering reflects the telegraphic nature of such

verse summaries in the Vinaya tradition.

The phrase rendered "the rule about seeds" translates *sa bon gyi chos*, literally "the Dharma of seeds," referring here to the Vinaya rule prohibiting monks from damaging or consuming seeds in a way that violates their germinating life; the episode turns on an accidental encounter with such seeds.

"Dyeing with seed-varieties" renders *sa bon gyi rigs tshos dka' ba*, a technical Vinaya term for a procedure of rendering seeds ritually permissible through heating or boiling until they are no longer viable — here confirmed by the appearance of steam.

- The river name "Dṛkṣā" is an approximation of the Tibetan "chu bo dregs ldan," which literally means "the proud river" or "the river of pride." This may be a proper name or a descriptive epithet; it does not correspond with certainty to a known Sanskrit river name, and "Dṛkṣā" is offered as a plausible reconstruction only.

The "six duties" of a brahmin is a standard reference to the six traditional brahminical occupations: studying, teaching, sacrificing for oneself, officiating at sacrifices for others, giving, and receiving gifts.

"Vatsadāsa" (literally "servant of the calf" or "he who belongs to the bull-calf") is the reconstructed Sanskrit for the Tibetan name "ba lang bdag," meaning "lord of the bull" or "possessor of the bull."

- The phrase rendered as "the wheel of cyclic existence moves, yet in this fifth aspect it does not move" is a technical and somewhat obscure formulation in the Tibetan. The compound "འཇིག་རྟེན་འཁོར་ལོ་འཇིག་པུ་མེད་ཀྱི་འདྲིམ་པོ་འཇིག་པུ་མེད་ཀྱི་འདྲིམ་པོ་" is a Vinaya-context doctrinal reference that is not fully transparent; the translation renders it as literally as possible while preserving readability. Some commentarial tradition would be needed to explain the precise doctrinal referent of "the fifth aspect of non-movement" here.

The epithets "འཇིག་རྟེན་འཁོར་ལོ་འཇིག་པུ་མེད་ཀྱི་འདྲིམ་པོ་" — sandalwood and camphor — are standard similes in Vinaya literature for a mind that is fragrant and purified, rendered here in their natural sense.

- The verse on karma's indestructibility is closely parallel to a canonical verse found in several Buddhist traditions, including the Pāli and Chinese parallel canons, often attributed to the Buddha in various contexts. The rendering follows the standard interpretation in Tibetan commentarial tradition.

The phrase rendered "seized upon" in "aggregates, sense bases, and elements that have been seized upon" translates a technical term indicating the appropriated or grasped psychophysical complex — the basis of experience in a given life — distinguishing it from these constituents as abstract categories. This is a significant doctrinal nuance indicating that karma ripens in the living, appropriated continuum of a being, not in inert physical elements.

The episode of the monk stealing food from his preceptor while distracted by another's recitation is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan and the sequence of events requires careful reading; the translation follows the most coherent narrative reading.

- The phrase rendered "field of offering unsurpassable" reflects the Tibetan honorific compound for the buddha as the supreme object of offering and veneration; this is a standard epithet in the tradition. The term "received gift" for the Tibetan "byin len byas pa" conveys that food which falls into one's vessel by accident counts as properly received alms, thus permitting consumption without transgression. The phrase "purely dark," "purely bright," and "mixed" are the three standard categories of karma in the Abhidharma schema. The rendering of "entailing a formal proceeding" for "nyes pa" with "འཇིག་རྟེན་འཁོར་ལོ་འཇིག་པུ་མེད་ཀྱི་འདྲིམ་པོ་" reflects a Vinaya technical term for a class of offense requiring a formal act of the Saṅgha.

- The term translated "copper basin" at the opening continues the established context; the Tibetan མཚོ་མུག་མུག་ can denote a basin or vessel of mixed metal, but "copper basin" is consistent with the preceding passage.

- The "wooden sounding board" renders the Sanskrit term gaṇḍī, a wooden plank or board struck to summon the community, standard Vinaya terminology.

- The "twenty peak-summits of the mountain of the view of the transitory collection" renders a technical Abhidharma image: the view of the transitory collection as a personal self produces twenty subsidiary views (regarding each of the five aggregates as fourfold: as self, as belonging to self, as containing self, as contained in self), which stream-entry eliminates. The vajra of wisdom shattering them is a standard metaphor.

- The two summary verses appear to be mnemonic colophon verses listing topics covered in the preceding section and topics to be covered in the next, in the standard Vinaya style. Several items in the second verse, such as "not sharing" and "residing in a house," refer to specific rules whose full titles are compressed; the rendering follows what the Tibetan text itself provides without expanding beyond it.

The terms rendered "heated water" and "razor" in the summary verses and the narrative are the same Tibetan words as in the preceding context, maintaining consistency with the established translation of those terms. "བློ་བྲོ་བློ་བྲོ་" and "བློ་བྲོ་" in the duration rules refer to specific types of facial sores or eruptions; "བློ་བྲོ་བློ་བྲོ་" is rendered "sore on the face" and "བློ་བྲོ་" as "cold sore," though the precise medical identification of these terms remains uncertain.

- The passage distinguishes three body-hair rules that arise sequentially: head hair shaved with scissors, pubic hair, and armpit hair. Each follows the same narrative template: the barber is sent, kept all day, people complain, a rule is laid down, then an exception for medical necessity is added. The term rendered "private parts" is a standard Vinaya euphemism for the pubic region. "Hair-scissors" renders a term for a scissor-like implement distinct from the razor used for tonsure. The phrase "elder monks" renders the standard Vinaya term for senior ordained monks qualified to act as witnesses or advisors. The passage ends mid-sentence, breaking off just as the monks are about to report the armpit-hair incident to the Blessed One.

- The phrase rendered "gabled hall" for गङ्गागारागृह refers to the Kūṭāgāraśālā, the famous two-storied or peaked-roof hall at Vaiśālī; some translators render it "multi-storied building" or simply leave it in Sanskrit. "Gabled Hall" is a reasonable functional rendering, and readers should note it is the well-known Kūṭāgāraśālā of the Vinaya narratives.

The "Six Group monks" are the notorious Chaddasvaggiyā bhikkhus, a recurring group of wayward monastics in Vinaya literature who serve as the foil prompting disciplinary rules.

• The term rendered "close friend" or "companion" is Ānanda, the well-known attendant of the Buddha. In the Tibetan the name appears as འཕྲིན་ལོ་མ་, which is the standard Tibetan rendering of the name Ānanda. The narrative context and the address "Venerable Ānanda" confirm this identification, though the passage is here using the name as a character in a Vinaya story and may refer to a different individual of the same name who happens to be a monastic companion rather than the famous disciple.

The summary verse presents some compression; the phrase rendered "worldly javelin throw" reflects אמה זריקה, literally "a throw-distance," a conventional unit of distance, here used in the sense of walking within a cast's-throw of a settlement. The verse is a mnemonic condensing the preceding case-rulings about when walking while wearing a shared robe is or is not permitted.

- The phrase rendered "produces a kind of transparent outlining of the body" translates a compound describing how the wet robes clung so as to reveal the body's contours, likened to the silhouette visible through a tent or screen. The imagery is somewhat elliptical in the Tibetan but the meaning is clear from context: the soaked cloth outlined the monks' bodies in a manner the brahmin found unseemly.

• The names of the group of five companions of the Buddha — Kauṇḍinya, Aśvajit, Bhadrika, Vāṣpa, Mahānāman — appear here, and the Tibetan list also includes Bhadrājīta, Vimāla, and Gavāṃpati, suggesting a larger group in this narrative context. The exact identification of some of these latter names with standard Sanskrit forms is inferred from comparable Vinaya lists and may warrant verification against the Sanskrit or Chinese parallels. The wanderer's name, rendered here as Bright World-Hurler, is a translation of the Tibetan "འགྲོ་བུ་རྩེད་པ་མཆོག་ཀྱི་སྐུ་ལྷན་པོ།," meaning roughly "Appearing/Bright One who hurls the world"; this is likely a Tibetan rendering of an Indian name whose Sanskrit original is not immediately recoverable from this context.

- The phrase "the wheel of saṃsāra in its fifth part, moving and unmoving" is an internal cross-reference to a passage not included in this excerpt; the translation preserves the reference formula as given. The Tibetan "འོད་གསལ་རྒྱུ་བཟང་པོ་མཆོད་ཀྱི་ཡུན་ལོ་ཤིང་།" literally means "the bright/clear period" and most likely refers to daylight hours or perhaps the bright fortnight, but in context the three-part division of the day makes daylight the most natural reading. The name

"𑖦𑖧𑖨𑖩𑖪𑖫" is rendered here as Vālendriya, a tentative reconstruction; the Tibetan may reflect a corrupt or uncertain Sanskrit original.

• The list of monks named in this passage — Aśva, Bhadra, Revatī, Mahānāman, Yaśas, Pūrṇa, Vimala, Gavāmpati, and Hastaka — are Tibetan epithets and name-forms rendered into their standard Sanskrit equivalents by convention. The Tibetan forms (འུ་ཤ་བ་, འུ་ཤ་བ་, འུ་ཤ་བ་, འུ་ཤ་བ་, འུ་ཤ་བ་, འུ་ཤ་བ་, འུ་ཤ་བ་, འུ་ཤ་བ་, འུ་ཤ་བ་) are well attested in Vinaya literature as members of the Group of Seventeen or other named disciples; identification of all nine with their exact Sanskrit names is conventional but certain members admit some variation in different recensions.

The phrase rendered "black-bowled, rope-belted paupers" reflects a derogatory taunt by the Group of Six directed at Ānanda and Upānanda, whose black bowls and rope belts apparently marked a simpler or more austere style associated with their status. The reading is secure; it is included here as a doctrinal-contextual note since the insult is somewhat opaque to a general listener.

- The sentence beginning "Śakra's awareness and perception extends downward, and so he thought" is left deliberately incomplete in the source text at this point, indicating the passage breaks off mid-sentence. No content has been added or suppressed; the translation reflects exactly where the Tibetan ends.

The elder monk's speech to the junior near the end of the confrontation is grammatically compressed and the logic of the argument is somewhat elliptical in the Tibetan; the translation renders the most defensible reading, which is that the elder is saying: even without the Saṅgha's rule, he himself as the senior possessor of lodging would have the upper hand, and the junior, having been disrespectful, should nonetheless pay respects to whoever grants him lodging.

- The term rendered "wool-strip garment" (be'u ras) refers to a small piece or strip of woolen cloth — a specific textile item in Vinaya contexts whose exact form is uncertain, but "wool-strip garment" is a workable approximation. The summary verse is a mnemonic listing permitted textile articles; the phrase "waistbands — these make three" reflects that the preceding list enumerates three types of items. The final three paragraphs are formulaic repetitions announcing permissions for three successive cloth items. The episode of Venerable Nāgapāla (klu skyong) is unusual: he misinterprets the Blessed One's extended outdoor walking as being caused by fear of the yakṣa Bakula, and his crude attempt to "test" this by impersonating the yakṣa draws a rebuke both from the Blessed One and, implicitly, from Śakra.

- The text ends mid-sentence; this is a continuity break at the fascicle boundary and the narrative will resume in the following passage.

The term rendered "stick-fastener" for 棍扣 is literally something like "a holder with a rod or stick," referring to a toggle or stick-clasp device used to secure a belt; the precise implement is uncertain but the general sense of a fastening device is clear.

The phrase ऋषिगणेशादिभिरुपासीतम्, rendered "a group of people dwelling in the rocky hills," likely refers to a local community or tenant population living in a particular rocky or cliff-side district under the administration of the great man Śākya's household.

• The name rendered "Candravātī" appears in the text as "Zla ba" (literally "Moon") used as a proper name. The longer form Candravātī is a reasonable Sanskrit reconstruction for a female name in this narrative context. Similarly, "Mālyavātī" renders "Phreng ldan ma," literally "the one possessing garlands," which is explicitly glossed as such in the text itself.

- The phrase rendered "the householder Mingchen" reflects a proper name in the Tibetan that appears to be a transliteration of a Sanskrit name not fully recoverable from context alone; it is kept as a name throughout for consistency with the preceding passage. The passage

"beginning from 'because the awakened buddhas...' down to 'ripens as a fruit for embodied beings'" is a textual shorthand indicating that a formulaic passage appearing earlier in the sūtra is to be understood as repeated in full here; this is rendered as a summary reference in keeping with the text's own instruction.

- The girl's name rendered here as "Phreng-ldan-ma" (meaning "she who bears a garland") is left in transliteration during the proclamation passage since it functions as a proper name and no Sanskrit equivalent is established in context. A translator working with a fuller edition may find a Sanskrit form such as Mālikā or similar.

The phrase rendered "jealousy arose in him" translates "kun nas dkris pa," literally "he was bound all around," a standard idiom for being seized by jealousy or indignation; the subject here is the great Śākya chief, who is troubled upon learning his daughter has been received merely as a junior wife rather than chief queen, apparently suspecting her low status was announced.

- The shang-shang-teu bird is a semi-mythical creature of Indian origin appearing in Tibetan literature, sometimes associated with a bird of melodious song. Its exact zoological identification is uncertain, but it functions here as one of a list of auspicious garden birds.

The aśoka tree renders Tibetan "shing mya ngan 'tsang," literally "the grief-dispelling tree," a standard equivalent for the Sanskrit aśoka, Saraca asoca, a tree of great symbolic significance in Indian literature and Buddhism.

The epithet "daughter of a woman who eats grain" renders "bu zan ma'i bu mo," literally "daughter of a grain-eating woman," referring back to the earlier context in which the mother was identified as a maidservant of low birth. The phrase carries the implication of ordinary human stock, setting up the irony of the lineage nonetheless flourishing through this union.

- The verse "Even across a hundred aeons, karma does not perish..." is a well-known canonical gāthā found in several Āgama and Vinaya sources, often attributed to the Buddha as a summary teaching on karma. Its rendering here follows the standard doctrinal sense.

The phrase rendered "appropriated aggregates" translates "zin pa'i phung po" (upādānaskandha), meaning the aggregates seized upon or appropriated through clinging — a standard Abhidharma technical term indicating that karma ripens in the psychophysical continuum of the being who performed it, not in the external elements.

- The name rendered "Mālyā" for "མལ་ལྷ་མོ་" is a reasonable reconstruction: the Tibetan literally means "the goddess Garland-bearer," which corresponds to Sanskrit Mālyā or Mālinī; the exact Sanskrit name of this figure would depend on the source text.

The name rendered "Āyusmāna of royal lineage" for "འཕྱུས་མཎ་ལྷ་མོ་" is uncertain; the Tibetan literally reads something like "she of the manner of the summer, of royal lineage," which may be a phonetic rendering of a Sanskrit name now unclear from context alone. This is flagged as genuinely uncertain.

The term "མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་" rendered as "excellent texture" or "endowed with excellent texture" refers to the quality of pleasant or exquisite touch, a recognized category of physical excellence in Buddhist canonical literature (Skt. sparśa).

- The passage contains a narrative sequence with several proper names whose Sanskrit forms are reconstructed from Tibetan phonetic approximations: Mālyā appears as the garland-goddess introduced in the preceding passage; Āryajāta is reconstructed from the Tibetan gloss "Phags skyes po," literally "noble-born"; Mātṛdatta ("given to the mother" or here ironically "affliction to the mother") is reconstructed from "ma la gnod." The Tibetan "ma la gnod" literally means "harm or affliction to the mother," which is an unusual folk etymology for a Sanskrit name; the name Mātṛdatta normally means "given by the mother," suggesting a

deliberate wordplay or alternative folk etymology in this narrative context. The list of martial and craft arts at the end of the passage is clearly incomplete, as the text breaks off mid-enumeration.

- The passage refers to "the eight mothers" and the preceding lotus simile without reproducing them, signaling an explicit cross-reference to an earlier section of the narrative; the translation follows the text's own shorthand accordingly. The six terminal duties of a Brahmin listed here correspond closely to the standard Sanskrit formula: yajana, yājana, adhyayana, adhyāpana, dāna, and pratigraha. The figures "Gārgya" and "Māthara" appear as Brahminic sages whose names are being invoked ritually or typologically; the exact referent of "making" them (Tibetan: byas pa) may indicate a ritual identification or initiation rite — this is somewhat obscure and may be context-dependent within the larger text. "The noble young man" (Tibetan: 'phags skyes po) is a recurring epithet in this narrative, likely rendering Sanskrit āryajanman, "one born noble," and has been rendered consistently throughout.
- The town name "Meḍuludī" (Tibetan: མེདུལུདི) is a phonetic rendering of an Indic place-name; the Sanskrit form is not fully recoverable from the Tibetan alone. It appears consistently throughout the passage and is rendered phonetically each time.

The name Mālagandhā (Tibetan: མེལགའན་ཏཱ་) appears to be a phonetic rendering of a proper name; the reading "Mālagandhā" is a plausible reconstruction but is noted here as uncertain.

- The phrase rendered "faith in the Dharma arising from the Dharma itself" translates chos las byung ba'i dad pa, which could also be rendered "faith arising from the Dharma" or "Dharma-born faith." This is a standard category in Buddhist soteriology referring to confidence grounded in reasoned understanding of the teaching rather than mere devotion; the rendering chosen preserves this nuance.

The expression "more humble than the most humble" renders shin tu dman pa bas kyang ches dman pa byed, literally "you act even lower than the lowest." This is the Blessed One gently chiding the king for extreme prostration, and the idiomatic English rendering is intentional.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the Tibetan as given; the translation follows accordingly.

- The passage contains several instances where the Tibetan explicitly instructs the reader to repeat earlier formulaic passages rather than restating them in full — "as before" or "the same as what preceded." These have been rendered as cross-references to what preceded, following the text's own convention. The phrase translated as "before they were even fully posed" reflects an important textual nuance: the Blessed One answers questions that are still in the process of being asked, which is a sign of his omniscience. The self-reproach of the newly ordained monks — "we were improper" — reflects their recognition that they had falsely claimed spiritual attainments they did not possess; this is a standard doctrinal trope illustrating the danger of pride and the transformative power of authentic realization.
- The phrase rendered as "living in complete dependence on others" translates a clause meaning that monks depend entirely on alms for their livelihood, which is the standard reading in this context. The positive force of the phrase is that such dependence on alms — far from causing bodily deterioration — is associated with the monks' flourishing appearance, the implicit contrast being with the emaciated ascetics who pursue self-mortification.
- The phrase rendered "I deprive them of wealth" describes Prasenajit withdrawing patronage or financial support from certain ascetics and brahmins, causing them to disrobe and return to lay life. The Tibetan is elliptical here, and the contrast being drawn is between these figures who abandon the holy life once deprived of material support and the Blessed One's śrāvakas who persist without wavering.

The section break "The Minor Matters of the Vinaya, the Eighth Fascicle" is a scribal colophon mid-passage marking the textual source and division; it interrupts the continuous speech of

King Prasenañjit.

- The names Viḍūḍabha, Mālikā, Vāsabhā-khattiyā, Medaḷumpa, and Ajātaśatru are Pāli forms of the names well-known from the Pāli parallel of this narrative in the Saṃyutta Nikāya. The Tibetan preserves phonetic approximations of these Indic names. Viḍūḍabha is rendered as "Prince Viḍūḍabha" following the Pāli; the Tibetan reads "spyod pa'i bu ring po," a calque. Medaḷumpa appears in the Tibetan as "me tsu ru di," a phonetic rendering. Ajātaśatru, "the unborn foe" (literally "Ma-skyes dgra"), is rendered by his proper Sanskrit name. The sentence "Prasenajit had left Viḍūḍabha in charge of the kingdom" and the later redundant phrasing "placed Viḍūḍabha in charge" reflect a slight awkwardness in the Tibetan that mirrors probable source ambiguity.
- The passage "as before, up to the passage: like the pleasure garden of delight among the gods" reflects a deliberate ellipsis in the Tibetan source itself, which abbreviates a repeated stock description by referring back to an earlier occurrence. This is standard in Tibetan narrative literature and has been rendered transparently.

The phrase rendered "the quarters of the young" translates a term suggesting a place or station appropriate to a youth or junior — the implication being that Ajātaśatru, perhaps feeling unworthy or awkward, withdraws to a subordinate position rather than the royal throne, though some traditional readings understand this differently. The ambiguity is minor and does not affect the narrative.

- The phrase rendered "a bowlful of grain husks" translates "la phug spar gang" — literally "a full measure of husks from a mountain pass," likely meaning the rough grain or chaff husks obtainable in such a locale; the precise grain is unspecified in the text and the rendering captures the sense adequately.

The phrase "abiding close like a shadow that never departs" renders the simile "dba' rgal bzhin du nye bar gnas pa," which is a conventional simile in karmic discourse; the image is of karma as inseparable as a shadow.

The teaching that pratyekabuddhas teach through their body rather than through speech is a standard doctrinal point in texts concerning these solitary buddhas, and the rendering follows the Tibetan precisely.

- The śākoṭaka tree is a scrubby or thorny tree, identified in some commentarial sources with a variety of acacia or similar species with thin foliage; it is left in transliterated form as the precise identification is uncertain and the descriptive qualifiers in the text convey the meaning. The detail of the Blessed One choosing shade under this unprepossessing tree in preference to finer trees is deliberate: the Blessed One's reply that "the shade of kinsmen is cool" forms the dramatic and doctrinal pivot of the episode, signaling his compassionate intervention on behalf of the Śākyas despite the inexorability of their karma. The narrative as a whole traces the massacre of the Śākyas by Virūḍhaka, a well-known episode found across multiple Vinaya and Avadāna sources.

- [illegible]

The phrase "standing by like a ford about to be crossed" literally means something like "abiding close like a dam-breaking flood" or "standing by like a ford about to be crossed." The translation renders the image as a welling flood for clarity in a TTS context.

- The name rendered "Virūdhaka" does not appear explicitly in this passage but is clearly the

referent of the repeated phrase "the man born of a woman of low birth" and the recurring pronoun. Contextually this is Virūḍhaka, king of Kosala, well known from parallel accounts of the destruction of the Śākya. The Tibetan phrase literally means "a man of great delusion, born of a noble/elevated woman," which is an unusual circumlocution; it likely reflects a Tibetan rendering of a Sanskrit epithet or proper name. The name Śambhaka for the Śākya outcast is given directly in the text.

- The name rendered "Ārya-jaṭa" translates the Tibetan འཕྲེང་བའི་མཁའ་མཁའ་, literally "noble-born man." This may be a personal name or an epithet; without broader context it is difficult to determine whether this refers to a specific named character or is a general epithet for Virūḍhaka, whose narrative is running in parallel. The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, suggesting the text continues beyond this excerpt.

- The phrase rendered "dwelling of the yellow-robed ones" translates འཕྲེང་བའི་མཁའ་མཁའ་, literally "abode of the yellow-robed," a common designation for a monastic community or monastery. The communal act referred to (མཁའ་མཁའ་མཁའ་མཁའ་) is a formal legal act of the Saṅgha (saṃghakārman) in the Vinaya sense — a binding resolution requiring the full assembly; those who absented themselves were not bound by it, which explains the distinction in the narrative.

The curious detail of Śākya circulating in and out of different gates — entering one and emerging from another — appears to describe a miraculous or supernatural evasion; the text is compressed and the full sense may depend on surrounding narrative context.

- The epithet "Mālanod" renders མཁའ་མཁའ་, which appears to be a personal name or title of a minister or counselor figure. Its meaning and identity are not entirely clear from the passage alone; it may be a Tibetan rendering of a Sanskrit or Prakrit name.

The phrase འཕྲེང་བའི་མཁའ་མཁའ་མཁའ་མཁའ་ — literally "the Śākya dwelling in the yellow-grey" — is here rendered "those who dwelled among the yellow-robed ones," understood as Śākya monastics. The expression is slightly ambiguous; it could also mean Śākya who had gone forth into the renunciant life more broadly.

- The phrase rendered "of ignoble birth and low lineage" translates a compound meaning literally "a brahmin who is in accord with vileness and with bone-lineage," which is a pointed inversion of the brahminic claim to pure lineage: the narrator uses this to mark the brahmin as socially low despite his caste designation. The irony is intentional — a self-identified brahmin is described in terms that subvert his pretension to high birth.

The repeated refrain structure in the original is explicitly marked by the Tibetan "as before" (snga ma bzhin), indicating a liturgical or recitative abbreviation of stock phrases. The translation preserves this abbreviated refrain device in faithful rendering.

- The phrase rendered "present like a creditor who has reached the threshold" translates the term "dba' rgal bzhin nye bar gnas pa," an idiom comparing ripening karma to a creditor standing at the door demanding repayment. This is a well-attested metaphor in karma teachings.

The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, which reflects the actual state of the Tibetan as given; the fish's thought is left incomplete. This is a genuine textual feature, not a translation error.

- The passage uses "Āryaskanda" (འཕྲེང་བའི་མཁའ་མཁའ་) literally meaning "noble-born one," and "Mālāgandha" (མཁའ་མཁའ་), which is a proper name rendered consistently from the preceding context. The text's narrative is identifying the figures Āryaskanda and Mālāgandha as the reincarnations of the two fish and two householders in past lives, and the five hundred Śākyas as the reincarnations of the five hundred fishermen and bandits, establishing karmic continuity across lives — a central doctrinal point of this passage.

The term 五百個の詐欺師 ("five hundred who had deceit/crookedness") in reference to the bandits is rendered simply as "five hundred bandits" in the main translation for smooth narration, since the context already identifies them as robbers; the nuance of "deceitful ones" is absorbed into the narrative.

- [illegible]

The final sentence "The Blessed One considered:" is left open because the Tibetan passage breaks off mid-sentence (བཤད་པའི་མཐུག་པོ་ལྟོ་བོ་ལྟོ་བོ་ without completing the object), indicating the text continues in the next passage.

- The phrase rendered "breathe freely" translates a Tibetan idiom literally meaning "to release the breath" or "to take a breath" — here used in the sense of allowing the distressed women relief and recovery from their ordeal. The doctrinal image of the "mountain peak of the view of the transitory collection, twenty heights high" reflects a standard scholastic enumeration: the view of the transitory collection (satkāyadr̥ṣṭi) comprises twenty sub-views (five aggregates each taken in four ways as self or as belonging to self), and stream-entry involves their complete uprooting.
- The epithet "Viḍūḍabha" (Tibetan: བེདུ་ཏུ་བཟུང་བ་པོ་) literally means "nobly born" and is the name of the Kosalan prince famous in Buddhist narrative for massacring the Śākyas; it is here rendered by name throughout since context makes identification clear.

The phrase rendered "struck down like a serpent's gaze"

(蛇に喰はるる) is somewhat unusual; the image appears to be of death coming suddenly and inevitably, as prey is paralyzed by a snake's look. This could alternatively refer to destruction "as if stared down by a serpent," a literary expression for utter doom.

The passage "as before" (ཡོད་པའི་སྐབས་ནས་) indicates that the text is abbreviating sections already given in full earlier in the same scripture, a standard compositional device in Tibetan canonical collections.

- The "group of six monks" refers to the well-known six wayward monks who appear throughout the Vinaya literature as exemplars of improper conduct. The phrase "Serkyā" renders a Tibetan toponym that may correspond to a locale otherwise known as Sāketa or a similarly named place; the exact identification is uncertain but not consequential to the narrative.

The phrase rendered "spirits had already blocked all the exits" translates a term for non-human beings who obstruct escape, consistent with the fulfillment of the Blessed One's prophecy about inescapable karmic consequences.

- The summary verse appears to be a mnemonic encoding the topics of a set of Vinaya rules; the precise referent of each item (incense, orpiment, salve, cup, raw grain, etc.) is clear as a list but the verse's compressed telegraphic syntax is characteristic of Vinaya uddāna verses and is rendered accordingly.

The phrase rendered "which deer do not avoid as they avoid hunters" is a stock Śrāvastī epithet meaning the city is so safe and pleasant that even deer roam there freely; the Tibetan literally says "deer-saviors do not avoid deer in broad Śrāvastī," a compressed idiomatic phrase conveying that the city is without danger even for wild animals.

- The phrase rendered "coins and kārṣāpaṇas" translates a compound that appears to list two kinds of currency: a general term for coin and the specific denomination kārṣāpaṇa. The doubling may be a hendiadys for "money in general," but both terms are preserved in the translation for accuracy.

The phrase rendered "a poison to the touch" is a morally loaded narratorial comment in the original, presenting women as inherently dangerous to the male renunciant. It is a standard trope in Vinaya literature and has been translated literally as the text demands, without softening.

- The passage shifts between two distinct episodes. The first concerns a member of the Group of Six who tricks the old monk into revealing his transgression and then manipulates him further; the Blessed One's ruling culminates in ordering the formal promulgation of the four pārajika rules to be given immediately upon ordination. The second episode introduces a new character, the monk Priyadatta, who is harassed by a māra-goddess while meditating. The phrase rendered "she engaged in sexual intercourse with him" is the text's direct narrative statement; the monk's subsequent anguish and self-assessment reflect the Vinaya's technical question of whether involuntary sexual contact constitutes a pārajika offence — the point the episode is building toward.
- The name rendered throughout as "Nandaka" translates the Tibetan "dga' ba can," which literally means "one possessing joy" or "the joyful one" — a standard Tibetan rendering of the Sanskrit Nandaka. The bitter wordplay when he says he is now "mi dga' ba can," one without joy or gladness, is deliberate and has been preserved in the translation.

The procedural text here is a verbatim Vinaya (monastic discipline) formula for the formal Saṅgha act of re-granting the training precepts. The passage reproduces the standard tripartite structure of Vinaya acts: the preliminary motion (gsol ba), the formal motion (las bsgrags pa), and the act proper (las), here read at its first recitation, with the implication that it is to be repeated three times in full. This structure has been rendered with the technical precision the Vinaya tradition requires.

- The phrase rendered "request-and-two" and "request-and-four" translates formulaic Vinaya expressions for formal acts of the Saṅgha that require one announcement plus two affirmations, or one announcement plus four affirmations, respectively — standard technical categories of Vinaya procedure.

The "shrine-hall's lord" is ambiguous; it may refer to a patron or donor of the vihāra rather than a deity, but in context it appears alongside "deities of the shrine-hall," suggesting a presiding protective deity of the building. This reflects standard Vinaya liturgical usage.

- The verse at the end is a mnemonic summary verse listing topics covered in the preceding section. The items are enumerated tersely and some terms are technical Vinaya shorthand; "what has been accumulated" likely refers to items set aside or stored, and "nasal pouring" refers to the nasal-oil procedure described in adjacent sections of the Vinaya. The overall list signals the scope of regulations just covered rather than constituting independent doctrine.

The name of the plant whose smoke Pilindavatsa relies on is not specified in the Tibetan; the text uses only a generic term. The identity of the plant is not determinable from this passage alone.

- The phrase rendered "accumulated-herbs bath" translates a technical medical term for a therapeutic herbal decoction bath. The precise Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain; it may correspond to something like a sarvauṣadhi or kaṣāya preparation, but the text does not specify and the physician himself admits ignorance of the details.

The term rendered "wheel-turning physicians" translates a phrase suggesting a lineage of royal or authoritative medical practitioners; it may refer to the tradition of a cakravartin-associated medical corpus, but the exact referent is uncertain.

"Pilindavatsa" is the Tibetan rendering of a known disciple's name; kept as is for consistency with standard scholarly usage.

- The phrase rendered "you have come with the fruit of the buddha's arising" is a somewhat cryptic compliment: the wives mean that by listening to the Dharma, their husbands have come home bearing the very fruit for which a buddha appears in the world, namely, the teaching of Dharma. The Tibetan is compressed and the exact nuance is slightly elliptical, but this reading is consistent with the context.

The name Pilindavatsa renders the Tibetan རྒྱལ་པོ་ལོང་བ་བླ་མ་, literally "the Venerable son of Pilinda," which is a standard Tibetan rendering of the Sanskrit proper name Pilindavatsa; it is treated throughout as a personal name.

- The final sentence renders the idiom "□□□□□□□□□□□□" literally as "a latrine pit should be made," understanding this as an instruction to construct a designated toilet facility. The precise form of this structure is not specified in the text; the translation follows what is contextually implied by the narrative.
- The compound "□□□□□□□□□□□□" in the latrine construction passage refers to a rinsing pot together with a communal ladle or scoop for pouring water, a standard pair of ablution implements in Vinaya contexts. The rendering reflects this pairing.

The phrase "उष्णऋतुः" rendered as "the hot season" follows the standard Vinaya reckoning of the three seasons, where this term denotes the warm or hot period before the rains.

- The phrase rendered "as before, down to 'and let him consent'" follows a common Vinaya literary convention of abbreviating repeated procedural formulas by referencing an earlier full version; the abbreviation is in the source itself.
- The phrase rendered "Those who are in residence are to pour the water" refers to monks who are currently staying at the monastery, distinguishing them from visitors or those passing through. The text at this point is a regular Vinaya narrative and the term *gnac pa* (those residing, residents) carries this technical sense.

The passage "from the words beginning ... up to ... everything proceeds as before" is a standard Vinaya scribal abbreviation indicating that a previously recounted exchange between the Blessed One and Prajāpatī Gautamī is to be understood as occurring here in full without being repeated in the manuscript.

The epithet *skye dgu'i bdag mo chen mo* (great mistress of creatures) renders the Sanskrit *Mahāprajāpati*; the personal name *Gautamī* follows.

- The verse rendering of the penultimate stanza, particularly the line rendered "hearers who dwell in harmony, viewing one another as kin," involves some compression. The Tibetan phrase ལྟན་འགྲོལ་སྤྱི་བར་སྒྲུབ་པ་ལྟན་འགྲོལ་སྤྱི་བར་སྒྲུབ་པ་ is syntactically dense; "ལྟན་འགྲོལ་སྤྱི་བར་སྒྲུབ་པ་" most naturally suggests something like "regarding each other well" or "looking upon one another with goodwill," which the translation approximates. The exact metrical and syntactic structure of the verse section is loosely rendered in the interest of natural spoken English, as required for TTS delivery.
- The names rendered "Ānanda, Anupama, Selā" in the middle passage are uncertain. The Tibetan gives "Tshe dang ldan pa dga' bo" (the venerable Ānanda), "ma 'gags pa" (possibly "Unobstructed" — perhaps the nun Utpalavārṇā or another figure; the name is unclear), and "sgra can zin" (literally "one who has caught a sound/tone," possibly Selā or another nun's name). Because these names are not perfectly transparent and the passage appears to conflate the monks Ānanda and others with the nuns in a textually difficult stretch, this is

[illegible]

- The phrase rendered "abided like a flame" translates 念念相續如燈相續, which is somewhat elliptical. The simile likely indicates that karma, like a flame, persists and functions continuously until its fuel is spent — a common doctrinal illustration of karma's ongoing potential.

- The passage describes the incremental development of Vinaya rules for the construction and fittings of monastic dwelling-houses, progressing through a series of practical problems encountered by the monks and their solutions as authorized by the Blessed One. The window-lattice instruction describing the shape as resembling "the ocean" likely refers to a flared or wide-mouthed profile, deeper on the inside than the outside.

- The plant name *uṣatu* is left in approximate transliteration; the Tibetan འུ་སཱ་ཏཱ་ is clearly a rendering of a Sanskrit botanical name, but the exact identification is uncertain enough to warrant flagging. It may refer to a grass used for polishing metal, sometimes identified with *darbha* or a related species, but the precise referent cannot be confirmed from this passage alone.
- The term rendered "couches with decorative legs" translates a compound describing couches or seats featuring carved or ornamented legs, a standard Vinaya category. The precise ornamental style is not specified beyond this in the text.
- The summary verse is a mnemonic *gāthā* listing items previously permitted: peg, three kinds of ladder, latch, interior support-bar, and tread-boards of wood, stone, and earth — with a final line recapitulating permission for ladders in three types. The verse is deliberately compressed and telegraphic, as is normal for Vinaya summary verses.

The term rendered "latch" translates a word for a door-fastening device; "interior support-bar" renders a term for an internal bracing element. The exact carpentry referents of these Vinaya technical terms are somewhat conventional in translation.

- The phrase rendered as "dried off this mark" refers to Sundarī's action in the preceding passage of marking Nanda before he departs, so that she can tell upon his return whether he has been near the Blessed One, whose presence was understood to radiate a golden or luminous quality. The drying of the mark serves as a test of how close he came. This is a well-known motif in the Nanda avadāna cycle.

The sentence about the Blessed One not breaking "a single word of Dharma" across generations with parents, teachers, and so forth is doctrinally dense. It means the Blessed One had never resorted to a direct Dharma teaching as a form of social pressure or obligation in any of those relational roles across his previous lives — yet here he uses the indirect method of feeding Nanda the bowl-remnants and simply asking why he does not go forth, which is gentle and therefore irresistible. This is a standard commentarial point in the Nanda ordination narrative.

- The text identifies the woman as "Mṛgāramat's mother of Sundarī" (མཚན་སྒྲིག་པོ་ལྷོ་བུ་འཁྱེད་ཀྱི་མཚན་སྒྲིག་པོ་), meaning the household of Mṛgāramat, mother of Sundarī — a well-known lay patroness of Śrāvastī; the syntax is slightly compressed in Tibetan but the referent is standard in Vinaya literature.

Turushka (𐎲𐎠𐎧𐎫𐎡𐎹) is a fragrant resinous substance used as incense, sometimes identified as frankincense or a related aromatic resin imported from Central Asia.

The phrase that Nanda bears the thirty marks but falls "four finger-breadths short" reflects the tradition that Nanda possessed thirty of the thirty-two major marks of a great being and was slightly shorter in stature than the Buddha, falling short by four finger-breadths.

- The term rendered "receptacle for the outflow" translates 𑖀𑖄𑖔𑖧𑖫𑖪 (a container for seminal fluid / nocturnal emission), and 𑖀𑖄𑖔𑖧𑖫𑖪𑖙𑖱𑖶𑖤𑖥𑖡𑖩𑖮𑖬𑖞𑖰𑖳𑖣𑖲𑖨𑖭𑖴𑖢𑖠𑖯𑖸𑖹𑖺𑖻𑖼𑖽𑖾𑖿 as "carry a receptacle" or "wear a pouch" — both refer to the same object described in what follows as a skin pouch stuffed with wadding. The progression of rulings here is a standard Vinaya legislative sequence and has been rendered accordingly.

The phrase 誦經 rendered as "recitation" refers to the chanting or vocalization of texts, a standard paired duty with meditation in the monastic context.

- The phrase rendered "arrive directly" translates a somewhat terse Tibetan that may simply mean "straightaway" or "at once"; the general sense of immediate arrival in the heaven of the Thirty-Three is clear. The list of divine pleasures and architectural and musical details is somewhat formulaic and some terms, particularly the names of musical instruments such as the three-stringed lute, the flute, and the lute, are Tibetan transliterations of Indic terms whose precise identification is uncertain; this does not affect the doctrinal content.
- The passage lists six forms of communal avoidance imposed on Nanda by the Saṅgha at the Buddha's instruction: shared seating, shared walking ground, shared robe-rack, shared bowl-stand, shared water-stand, and shared liturgical recitation or chanting. These are well-attested disciplinary measures in Vinaya literature for isolating a monk whose conduct or motivation is considered unwholesome, intended here to produce shame and reform rather than permanent exclusion. The exchange between Nanda and Ānanda at the close sets up the continuation of the narrative.
- The phrase rendered "rivers without fords" translates a Tibetan term for one of the classic hell-realm features, likely corresponding to the Vaitaraṇī river in Sanskrit sources; the Tibetan here simply says "rivers without fords" without naming it, so no Sanskrit name has been

supplied. The location at the end is given as "grong khyer tsampa," which corresponds to the city of Campā with its famous hot springs, a recognized site in the Nanda cycle narratives.

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, in the middle of a comparison being drawn between women whose fertile seasons last long and those whose do not; the text is clearly continuing into a subsequent passage.

The term rendered "gandharva" refers here specifically to the being inhabiting the intermediate state between death and rebirth. The text's own gloss — "the designation for a being of the intermediate existence" — reflects the standard Abhidharmic understanding used in this sūtra context.

- The term "gandharva" here refers to the being who enters the womb at conception — a being between death and rebirth, called in Tibetan "dri za" (literally "scent-eater"). This is a significant doctrinal term in Abhidharma and Vinaya embryology: the gandharva is the intermediate-state being whose entry is the third necessary condition for conception, alongside the union of father and mother. The text's insistence on its "mind" being male or female is an important detail for understanding sex determination in traditional Buddhist embryology.

The architectural and anatomical vocabulary describing womb defects is highly technical and several terms admit multiple interpretations. The renderings offered reflect the most contextually plausible readings; a specialist in Āyurvedic and early Buddhist medical literature might refine several of these.

- The creature name "besaraka" is a transliteration of an unidentified Sanskrit term rendered phonetically in Tibetan as be sa ra ka. It likely refers to a specific insect or small animal in the context of examining whether the womb is a suitable vessel; the exact species is uncertain.

The "worm born from green grass" that takes on the color of a green leaf is a classical Indian biological observation used repeatedly in embryological texts as an analogy for dependent origination without identity or total difference; it is a stock example found in several Indic sources.

- The term rendered "cedar wood" translates rgya shug, which refers to a coniferous tree, likely cypress or a related species. "Cedar" is an approximation; the exact species is uncertain, but it is consistently described as producing red-colored worms in the analogy, which fits the context.

- The passage on the butter-lamp carrier and the lotus stalk is a simile for how breath and heat within the womb cause the embryo to develop; the exact mechanics of the image are somewhat obscure in the Tibetan, but the doctrinal point — that the wind element animates growth — is clear.

The final phrase, "I do not praise even the slightest accomplished existence," renders a standard Pāli and Sanskrit formula in which the Buddha declares that he finds no good in continued becoming in saṃsāra, however small. This is a well-attested doctrinal refrain and is rendered accordingly.

- The three Tibetan embryological terms for the developmental stages of the fetus — nur nur po, mer mer po, and nar nar po — are standard Āyurvedic and Abhidharma embryological categories (kalala, arbuda, peśī in Sanskrit). They are rendered here descriptively as "viscous mass," "firmer mass," and "lumpy mass" respectively, following the context of the analogies given. The Sanskrit equivalents are well-attested in parallel texts. The wind named "gathering" (kun sdud) and "storehouse-door" (mdzod sgo) are among the named winds of karmic-embryological tradition; no standard English equivalents exist, so they are transliterated by meaning.

- The passage opens with "and in suffering," which is the completion of the sentence broken off at the end of the preceding passage, preserved here as instructed for continuity.

The Tibetan term rendered "thorn of the womb" is *mngal gyi zug rngu*, a standard technical expression in this genre meaning the embryo conceived as a painful thorn or affliction lodged in the womb; the translation preserves this striking image faithfully rather than smoothing it to "embryo."

The term rendered "rounded mass" in this week corresponds to the preceding passage's "lumpy mass" from the prior stage; the Tibetan here uses *gor gor po*, a slightly different shape term indicating a rounder, more globular form than the preceding week's stage.

- The verse embedded in the thirteenth-week passage is rendered as verse in the translation, consistent with the Tibetan metrical form. The channel-count of nine hundred (225×4) is numerically consistent within the text and is rendered as given. The term translated as "mesentery" for རྩུབ་པ་ is a reasonable anatomical equivalent in context; some traditions gloss it differently, but this is the most defensible rendering for a general audience.
- The phrase rendered as "the hollow around the heart" translates a term that literally refers to the region or cavity around the heart, understood in this embryological context as a bodily chamber or receptacle. The series of verbs for placing and arranging — five synonymous or near-synonymous terms — follows a formulaic pattern common to Abhidharmic and embryological sūtra literature and has been rendered with corresponding English synonyms to preserve the rhetorical texture without excessive repetition.
- The phrase rendered "the face of the draw-string" translates a wind name that appears to describe a pulling or tightening action associated with the clarification of the sense organs; the precise anatomical imagery is idiomatic to this embryological genre and the Tibetan is translated literally.

The section marker "This is the twelfth fascicle of the basis of the minor Vinaya" is an editorial colophon embedded in the text marking a manuscript division; it interrupts the discourse and has been rendered plainly as it appears.

- The verse on bodily form is cryptic and likely represents a mnemonic summary of ideal physical proportions, presented here in inverted form to indicate what the being born of bad karma will lack. The Tibetan is terse and the verse's precise sense turns on context within the larger treatise; the translation renders the most natural reading.

The term rendered "the arising of all" (Tib. *kun du 'byung ba*), "the all-victorious" (*yongs su rgyal ba*), "the holder of purity" (*gtsang 'dzin*), "the all-floating" (*yongs su 'phyo ba*), "the carrier of dissolution" (*khyer 'jig*), and "the great medicinal offering" (*sman yon chen po*) are technical names of specific embryological winds; no standard Sanskrit equivalents are recoverable from this passage alone.

- The phrase rendered "blood-kin" translates a compound meaning relatives by blood lineage on the paternal side, as distinct from relatives more broadly. The distinction is preserved here by pairing "relatives and blood-kin." The term "a hundredfold equal in fortune" renders a comparative expression indicating a human rebirth incomparably superior; the precise quantification follows the Tibetan literally.
- The phrase "the bark of kuśa grass" renders རྩུབ་པ་རྩུབ་པ་རྩུབ་པ་. The Sanskrit botanical term *dūrvā* refers to a type of sacred grass commonly found in Indian ritual contexts; its bark or fiber has a characteristic pale greenish-gray color. The repetition in the Tibetan is deliberate and formulaic, and has been preserved faithfully.

The "five cords" with which the being is said to be bound is a standard Abhidharma and womb-description formula for the physical constraints of the fetal position; it is rendered literally as the tradition intends.

- The phrase rendered "the thirty-eighth day of the seventh week" and the parallel references to "days" within "weeks" follow the Tibetan literally. The text counts gestational periods in units

of seven-day weeks (ཇུག་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་), and the ordinal number within that unit refers to the numbered day of the given week. The transition at the end to "the thirty-eighth week" uses the same Tibetan formula but the context makes clear a shift has occurred from day-counts within the final week to the week-count overall; this is a common feature of such embryological sūtra literature and the translation follows the Tibetan as given.

The śālmali plant (Skt. śālmālī) is the silk-cotton tree, whose soft fibers were used medicinally; this is the plant referred to by the Tibetan ལྷུ་ལྷུ་ལྷུ་ལྷུ་ལྷུ་.

- The phrase rendered as "nourished, sustained, and kept alive by the impurity of its own blood" refers to the newborn being sustained by mother's milk, which the text itself immediately glosses: in this noble Dharma discipline, blood-impurity is the term used for mother's milk. This is a standard doctrinal motif found in Āgama literature emphasizing the painful and impure nature of birth and bodily existence.

The final sentence breaks off mid-enumeration, as the source passage itself is incomplete at that point.

- The names of the parasitic worm-kinds are rendered by their semantic meaning from the Tibetan, as the underlying Sanskrit is not recoverable from this passage. Some anatomical terms admit minor uncertainty: "ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་" is rendered "sides" (flanks), though it can also denote the area around the ribs or armpits; "ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་" is rendered "palate" following the most common gloss in medical lexica; "ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་" is rendered "bladder," though some sources gloss it as a section of the lower abdomen. These choices are consistent with the medical-anatomical context of the passage.

- The list of afflictions includes several terms that denote classes of spirits or supernatural forces whose names are rendered here by their descriptive meanings, as many lack established Sanskrit equivalents in this context. "Māmō spirits" renders ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་, a class of wrathful female spirits well known in Tibetan tradition, left in transliterated form since no standard English or Sanskrit equivalent is in common use. "Garuḍas" renders ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་, and "kinnaras" renders ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་, both standard Indo-Tibetan mythological categories. "Those of the sky-corner" renders ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་, a less common term possibly referring to spirits of the cardinal or intermediate directions; its exact referent is uncertain.

- The tenfold division of life phases is a well-known literary scheme in Indian Buddhist literature. The translation of the eighth phase as "steadiness like that of a king" reflects the Tibetan comparison of the peak of mature stability to royal dignity.

The medical terminology in the final list presents some interpretive choices. The term rendered "lipoma" or "fatty disease" translates a term for a growth of fatty tissue. "Night-sweat" renders a term that can also mean nocturnal emission or nocturnal discharge; the medical context supports the broader rendering. The passage is clearly a catalogue and breaks off mid-list, consistent with the Tibetan text as given.

- The sequence "ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་" uses four verbs for experiencing and feeling, likely a formulaic quadruple expression emphasizing the fullness and intimacy of that experience. The translation renders them as a natural foursome without being pedantic about each nuance. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source; the translation reflects this faithfully.

- The passage enumerates the four types of womb-entry found in several Āgama and Abhidharma sources. The Tibetan term "ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་" here rendered "with full awareness" literally means "with clear knowing" or "consciously," corresponding to the Pali "sampajāṇo" and Sanskrit "saṃprajāṇan." This is a standard Abhidharma category and the rendering is consistent with commentarial usage.

The phrase rendered "one who has not yet attained any result" translates a list that appears slightly compressed in this portion of the text; the full list of attainment levels is picked up in the subsequent sentence. No significant doctrinal uncertainty arises from this.

- The extended womb description is a close parallel to similar passages in the Śrāvakabhūmi and related Yogācāra literature cataloguing the sufferings of gestation. The list of bodily substances and the physiological details follow a well-established Indian Buddhist genre of meditating on the repulsiveness of the body. The phrase rendered "grub-releasing vessel" translates a Tibetan compound describing an unclean fluid distributed like the fluid that releases or drips from worms; the precise image is that of a container oozing vermin-fluid, used as an analogy for the nourishment received in the womb. The five bonds mentioned are a standard Indian image for the constriction of the fetus in the womb rather than the five bonds to the lower realms (the orambhāgiya-saṃyojana), and context makes this clear.

- The text is structured as a discourse addressed to "Nanda," identifiable as the sūtra Nanda-garbhāvākṛānti-nirdeśa context, in which the Buddha describes to his half-brother Nanda the sufferings of existence beginning from conception. The repeated vocative rendered here as "Nanda" corresponds to "པ་པ་པ་པ་" in Tibetan, literally "Beloved One" or "Dear One," which is a standard honorific form of address for Nanda in this text. The choice to render it as "Nanda" rather than "Beloved" follows the convention established by the surrounding context; a reader should know that the Tibetan literally means something like "Joyful One" or "Dear One."

The phrase rendered as "mechanism of bones" for "ལུས་ཀྱི་རྒྱུ་རྒྱུ་" is a graphic anatomical metaphor for the pelvic birth canal; "ལུས་ཀྱི་རྒྱུ་རྒྱུ་" ordinarily means a machine or mechanism driven by contrivance, here applied metaphorically to the skeletal frame of the pelvis.

- The phrase "The minor Vinaya matters. The thirteenth fascicle" is a scribal colophon dividing the text into fascicles and appears mid-passage in the Tibetan; it has been rendered as a brief interlude exactly where it occurs in the text, as it belongs to the manuscript structure rather than the narrative itself. A TTS producer may wish to omit or pause around it.

The term rendered "inverted womb" refers to a malpresentation of the fetus; the Tibetan is describing obstetric complications and the manipulation required to correct fetal position, which a skilled midwife performs.

- The phrase rendered "seven-times-returner," "one born from noble family to noble family," "once-returner," and "one with a single intervening existence" reflects the standard Abhidharmic enumeration of levels of stream-enterers, and the text is structuring a distinction between those who die and enter the next womb with mindfulness intact versus those who do not — the former being practitioners of established virtue or those who have attained one of the lower stages of the path of liberation.

The concluding section, beginning with the description of the womb as supremely hot and running through the enumeration of impurities, appears to be an extended catalogue of the body's repulsive characteristics that continues beyond this passage; the abrupt end mid-list reflects the passage as supplied.

- The passage contains a sequence of four iterative Tibetan onomatopoeic or descriptive terms for the embryo's developing physical states: nur nur po, mer mer po, nar nar po, and gor gor po. These are technical embryological terms describing successive stages of the embryo's texture and shape, rendered here as "soft and tender, then firming, then hardening, then rounding out," following the traditional commentarial sequence of embryonic development. The precise correspondence of each term to a specific classical Indian embryological stage is a specialist matter but does not affect the overall sense.

The phrase rendered "the lower wound" translates a term literally meaning "the lower mouth-wound," a graphic designation for the birth canal or uterine opening, consistent with the text's sustained rhetoric of bodily impurity.

- The phrase rendered "consciousness that is of one flavor with suffering" translates a construction in which the consciousness at the moment of death is said to be characterized entirely by or identified with suffering — a somewhat unusual formulation that may reflect a specific doctrinal point about the quality of consciousness at death for those with heavy unwholesome karma. The Tibetan "sdu g bsngal du ro gcig pa'i rnam par shes pa" literally means "consciousness that is of one taste/flavor with suffering," and this is rendered faithfully rather than smoothed over.

- The terms traima-buka and traila-ta appear to be transcriptions of Sanskrit insect or worm names that remain unidentified in standard sources; they are rendered here in approximate phonetic form rather than translated, as their precise referents are uncertain.

The phrase rendered "young crocodiles who kill" translates a compound that literally suggests a chu-srin of the kind that kills young; the exact zoological referent is unclear but points to a crocodilian or similar aquatic predator.

- The phrase rendered "through the form of one who has the fortune" translates a passage that is somewhat compressed and difficult. The Tibetan reads "not through speculative tolerance of views, nor through the form of one who is fortunate" — this appears to be the Buddha distinguishing his mode of teaching from philosophical debate or the posturing of a fortunate individual. The exact doctrinal referent is mildly uncertain but the overall sense — that he speaks only from direct experience — is clear from context.

The closing injunction "understand directly just what you yourself see with the eye of flesh" is striking and rhetorically abrupt; it appears to be a rhetorical challenge directed at Ānanda, inviting him to trust even ordinary sense-perception as a starting point. No further gloss is supplied here as the passage continues.

- The closing sentence is syntactically incomplete in the passage provided, breaking off mid-construction. The translation renders as much as the text supplies and ends where the Tibetan ends.

The fourfold mindfulness passage follows the standard Pali satipaṭṭhāna formula closely. The rendering of "bdag nyid gling" as "one's own island" follows the well-attested reading of attadīpa as "island" rather than "lamp," which is the traditional Indic interpretation reflected in this Tibetan text.

The phrase rendered "go off alone to a secluded place and reflect" translates a compressed imperative construction; the sense of solitary retreat and sustained contemplation is clearly intended.

- The final verse line breaks off mid-sentence, as the source passage ends there. The translation preserves this open ending faithfully.

The phrase rendered "without remainder" for "len pa med par" literally means "without grasping" or "without taking up" (anupādāya in Sanskrit), a technical Vinaya and Abhidharma expression indicating liberation that leaves no residue of clinging; both senses are present but "without remainder" captures the doctrinal import for listeners.

- The embryological sequence near the opening — "glutinous mass," "foam-like substance," and so on — reflects the classical Indian five-stage account of embryonic development (kalala, arbuda, peśī, ghana, śākhā), rendered here from the Tibetan descriptive terms rather than imported Sanskrit labels, since the text itself uses Tibetan phonological approximations of the stages rather than the Sanskrit names directly.

The bone-count passage is a highly technical anatomical enumeration common to Abhidharma and related Buddhist medical literature; the numbers given follow the Tibetan text precisely, though some totals are internally complex and the counting scheme reflects a traditional Indian anatomical schema rather than modern anatomy.

- The epithet Vipaśyin, one of the seven buddhas of antiquity, is retained in Sanskrit throughout. The Tibetan "འཕགས་པའི་ཡུལ་གྱི་ཡུལ་" is a standard Tibetan rendering of Vipaśyin. The phrase "འཕགས་པའི་ཡུལ་གྱི་ཡུལ་" literally "the younger brother of the house to the right" is somewhat unusual; it likely refers to a neighboring household or a junior kinsman living to the right of the palace, and this literal rendering is preserved rather than smoothed over. The verse on the experience of pleasures is likely Nanda's recollection of his former life of comfort before renunciation; the translation preserves this reading. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text, so the translation ends at the same point.
- The phrase rendered "taking hold of his face" or "holding him by the face" translates a verb meaning something like physically grasping or cupping the face to steer someone — a slightly unusual detail suggesting he was brought along by mild physical coaxing. The meaning is contextually clear but the precise gesture is somewhat idiomatically opaque in the original.
- The phrase rendered "forcibly separated" translates a term suggesting vigorous, determined intervention — the younger brother had to be pulled away from his attachments against his will, which the aspiration then mirrors for the aspirant's own future liberation. This reading is doctrinally consistent with the narrative of the Blessed One rescuing a deeply attached relative through compassionate compulsion, paralleling well-known stories in the canon.

The epithet "Vipaśyin" is the buddha of the preceding world-age, one of the seven buddhas of antiquity. The narrative is situating Ānanda's deep karmic connection to the Blessed One Śākyamuni within this distant past life, explaining why Ānanda became the Buddha's attendant in the present age.

- The phrase rendered "came to abide as though at the water's edge" translates the Tibetan idiom "dba' rgal bzhin nye bar gnas par gyur pa," which describes being at the very threshold of a result — like someone who has waded to the bank and stands ready to cross. This is a standard karmic-fruiting idiom indicating that conditions have fully ripened.

The passage "འཕགས་པའི་ཡུལ་གྱི་ཡུལ་" refers to nirvāṇa without remainder (Skt. nirupadhiśeṣanirvāṇa), the parinirvāṇa at death, as distinct from nirvāṇa with remainder. This distinction is preserved in the translation.

- The epithet string "rig pa dang zhabs su ldan pa" renders the Sanskrit vidyācaraṇasampanna, "endowed with knowledge and conduct," a standard Tathāgata epithet. The phrase "dba' rgal bzhin nye bar gnas pa" literally "standing near like one who has crossed [the stream, i.e., an arrow]" is an unusual idiom for karmic inevitability; it is rendered here as "drawing near like a crossbow bolt ready to fly," following commentarial tradition that glosses it as an image of inescapable momentum. The name of the forest, "rang srang smra ba," is rendered as the Sanskrit Rṣivadana, the standard equivalent for the Deer Park at Varanasi (Mṛgadāva / Rṣivadana). The passage ends mid-sentence as given.
- The name "Blama" rendered here as a proper name for the brahmin youth is the Tibetan "བླ་མ་," which in this context functions as a personal name rather than the common noun "lama" or "teacher." The text reads that the Blessed One Kāśyapa prophesied to "the brahmin youth Blama," addressing him directly as a named individual.

The phrase "those who guard the gates of the sense faculties" renders the Tibetan "འཕགས་པའི་ཡུལ་གྱི་ཡུལ་," meaning those who are restrained or controlled at the doors of the sense faculties — a recognized category in monastic virtue rankings, here designating Priya as the foremost among the community in this discipline.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text; the translation faithfully reflects this incompleteness.

- The two summary verses at the opening are colophon-style mnemonic verses listing topics covered in the preceding section of the Vinaya; they are rendered as verse accordingly. The term rendered "patches" and "patch-tent" refer to the patchwork panels of the monastic robe and a small canopy or shade-cloth used during the sewing of robes. The "crow's wing" measure is a standard traditional unit of finger-widths used in Vinaya robe measurements. The phrase "clay paste" renders a term for a sizing or smoothing agent applied to cloth before sewing to keep it flat.
- The term rendered "verger" is the Tibetan disciplinarian or caretaker-monk of the monastery, the dge skos, whose role is to maintain order and care for the communal spaces and furnishings. "Verger" approximates this custodial function for a general audience, though the role is more precisely a monastic chant-master and disciplinarian. The sequence of rulings in this passage belongs to a Vinaya narrative establishing regulations about the sweeping and maintenance of monastic seating and walking meditation areas. The passage concerning paving stones is the beginning of a new narrative episode that continues in the following passage.
- The term rendered "container with a lid" translates a Tibetan phrase for a vessel or bowl together with its cover; the precise object is a medicine bowl with lid, which is a standard monastic requisite item. The rendering follows the natural sense.

The phrase "given distinguishing marks and that the Dharma was to be listened to at night" renders the closing sentence, which is syntactically incomplete as it stands in the passage; the text appears to continue beyond what has been provided here.

- The phrase rendered "a hundred holes" refers to a kind of perforated lantern cover or lamp shade. The Tibetan "bu ga brgya pa" is literal — "having a hundred holes" — and the passage describes improvised versions made from pierced pottery. This is a practical Vinaya ruling on lamp use during Dharma teachings, and no doctrinal ambiguity arises.

The "sweat cloth" (rngul gzan) is a cloth worn to absorb perspiration, a practical monastic garment permitted under heat conditions; it is distinct from the formal robes.

- The river name rendered throughout as "Sundarī" follows the Tibetan phonetic form; the Sanskrit is Nairāṅjanā in some parallels, but "Sundarī" (literally "the pleasant/beautiful one") appears to be the intended river here and is kept as given.

The phrase rendered "water vessels and pots" translates a Tibetan compound referring to physical ascetic practice using containers; the exact nature of the practice is unclear from context alone, but it appears to describe a form of meditative austerity associated with the riverbank setting.

The summary verse near the beginning is a mnemonic verse (uddāna) listing topics; it is rendered as verse accordingly, though its relationship to the surrounding narrative suggests it belongs to a preceding section's colophon rather than the present passage.

- The passage contains a compressed repetition formula ("and the passage continues as before, down through...") rendering the Tibetan shorthand that recalls earlier material verbatim without restating it in full. This is standard sūtra redactional practice, and the translation renders it as such rather than expanding the repeated passage, which is consistent with the preceding context.
- The phrase rendered "that first meditative concentration which surpasses all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas" translates a technical expression indicating a uniquely superior form of the first dhyāna accessible only to a buddha; the term "rdug pa" (literally "to beat" or "surpass") is here used in a comparative sense meaning this concentration transcends or exceeds what

śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas can attain.

- The phrase rendered "that which surpasses all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas" translates a construction meaning a first meditative concentration that is complete and excels or outstrips all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. The term "ཐོག་མཐོང་པོ་" is read here in the sense of "surpassing" or "that which exceeds," indicating a superlative quality of the Tathāgata's dhyāna compared to that of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. This is a genuinely difficult term and some uncertainty remains about its precise nuance in this context.
- The term rendered "tooth-wood" refers to the wooden stick used for dental hygiene in ancient India, equivalent to a tooth-cleaning twig. The Tibetan "so shing" is the standard Vinaya term for this implement, corresponding to Sanskrit dantakāṣṭha. The passage is a standard Vinaya narrative establishing a rule, and the sequence of events — report, permission, incident, further restriction — is a typical Vinaya legislative pattern.

The phrase rendered "genuine noble joy in the noble Dharma and discipline" translates 'phags pa'i yang dag par dga' ba, literally "the perfectly genuine joy of the noble ones." The repetition in the source is deliberate and has been preserved as faithfully as readability allows.

- The phrase rendered "blowing soot under a pot and striking ascetics" is the Group of Six monks sarcastically listing other supposed "advantages" of having a long piece of tooth-wood. The Tibetan is terse and the sarcasm is contextually inferred from the narrative pattern; the precise meaning of these two activities as pretexts or mockeries is clear from context in similar Vinaya passages.

The term translated "bundle" for བཅའ་བཤམས་ is a standard Tibetan canonical division marker equivalent to a fascicle or chapter-unit; it is left as "bundle" to match Vinaya translation conventions.

- The name rendered "Cāraka" represents the Tibetan "Char ka," which in this Vinaya narrative context is a personal name. The identification is contextually straightforward but the precise Sanskrit form is uncertain; "Cāraka" is the most plausible reconstruction.

The phrase rendered "the mother of beings" translates "Skye dgu'i bdag mo chen mo," a standard epithet of Mahāprajāpatī Gautamī, meaning the great mistress or mother of all creatures.

- The term rendered "act of exclusion" translates Tibetan རྒྱུ་མེད་ཀྱི་འཇམ་པ་ / རྒྱུ་མེད་ཀྱི་འཇམ་པ་, a Vinaya procedural act imposed on recalcitrant monks. The Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain in this precise Mūlasarvāstivāda context; taghanīyakarman is one reconstruction offered by Vinaya scholars, but the text does not supply the Sanskrit here, so the gloss is given parenthetically only on first occurrence and should be understood as provisional.

The phrase "grandson of the Buddha" (सुमहाराजसुतस्य) reflects the Vinaya's generational metaphor: the Buddha's direct disciples are his "sons," and their disciples are his "grandsons." This is a standard Mūlasarvāstivāda idiom, not a biological claim.

- The Tibetan term rendered as "ball of food" for རྒྱུ་ལྔ་པ་ refers to a traveling provision, a small ball of compacted food given to someone being sent on their way; the precise nature of this provision is conventional in the Vinaya context.

The construction terminology in the architectural passage presents several interpretive challenges. The term 柱頭 is rendered as "column caps" or capitals placed atop the columns, following the most plausible reading in a building context. The overall sequence describes a standard post-and-lintel structure with a raised platform, columns, horizontal beams, rafters, planking, and a brick and plaster covering.

- The phrase rendered "food rack" translates a term meaning a kind of platform or shelf on which food is placed for animals — the precise form is not entirely certain from context, but

"rack" conveys the sense adequately. The monk's "waiting in expectation" of giving food to the dog is a small technical Vinaya point: the meal period had elapsed, making a proper offering impossible, hence the transgression of the moment passing its proper time. The crow's communication to the thief leader in "crow language" is presented in the text as literal, consistent with the tradition of certain humans understanding animal speech.

- The passage contains a philosophically significant distinction between two modes of the Buddha's intention: "worldly intention" and "mind that transcends the world." The text states that when the buddhas give rise to worldly intention even animals perceive it, but when they give rise to transcendent intention even śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas cannot fathom it. This is a standard doctrinal point about the inscrutability of buddha-mind at its deepest level and is rendered accordingly.

The name Nāmadru rendered here corresponds to the Tibetan "nam gru," which may represent a Tibetan equivalent of a disciple name; the identification is not entirely certain but is rendered in the most natural phonetic form given the context of the standard list of great śrāvakas.

- The phrase rendered as "twenty-one weeks of seven days" translates the Tibetan "zhag bdun gsum nyi shu rtsa gcig," which is a somewhat unusual construction. It most likely means "on the twenty-first set of seven days," i.e., after twenty-one weeks, though it could also be read as simply indicating a specific ceremonial day count. The meaning is contextually clear as a birth-celebration naming ceremony held after a fixed auspicious interval.

- The verse at the end is incomplete in the source passage as given; it breaks off mid-sentence at the final line. This is almost certainly a passage boundary, and the continuation would follow in the next segment. No emendation has been made.

The term rendered "Mysterious one" for རྒྱལ་མཚན་པོ་ is literally "Keeper of Secrets" or "Secret One," a common epithet of Vajrapāṇi, but here it appears to be used by the king as an address to the disguised yakṣa, possibly recognizing something uncanny about him, or as a conventional polite address to a being of uncertain identity. The translation preserves the sense without importing the full Vajrapāṇi association.

- The opening half-verse completes the verse begun in the preceding passage; the rendering "cool as a lake of water infused with sandalwood and blue lotus" follows the Tibetan literally, where "mtsho chu tsandan 'de gus bcin pa lta bur bsil ba" describes the fire-pit becoming cool like a lake scented with sandalwood and blue lotus.

The term rendered "wooden board" is the Sanskrit gaṇḍī, a sounding board struck to summon the Saṅgha; it is left as a functional description here for natural listening.

The phrase "noble silence" renders the Tibetan literally as "not speaking the words of noble ones," which in Vinaya context is the standard expression for maintaining silence rather than speaking, here contrasted with speaking appropriate Dharma words while working.

- The passage concerning the two boys' exchange about the next world and arhats is doctrinally notable: the king misidentifies their views. From the tradition's standpoint, affirming the next world corresponds to the view of permanence (eternalism), while affirming the existence of arhats is here taken as implying the view of annihilation (since an arhat attains nirvāṇa and in that sense "ceases"). This is a subtle and somewhat paradoxical point the narrative is making, and the translation preserves the king's characterization faithfully. The name rendered "Skyongwa" is a transliteration of the Tibetan name; no Sanskrit equivalent is recoverable from this context.

- The phrase rendered "the absorptive dwelling in equipoise by which they abide" translates "gnas pa'i snyoms par 'jug pa" — a meditative absorption that constitutes a stabilized dwelling state. The instruction is for whichever monk has attained that particular samādhi to communicate with or guide the two boys through it, presumably as a means of correcting their

wrong views through direct meditative demonstration rather than verbal teaching. This is a somewhat unusual instruction and the precise mechanism is left implicit in the text.

- The closing line "ྲོ་ལྷན་གྱི་རྒྱུ་བློ་སྤྲུང་།" is a colophon-like editorial marker indicating that this narrative episode serves as the originating story for a particular category of minor Vinaya rules. It is rendered as a plain prose label rather than integrated into the verse, as it stands apart from the narrative body.
- The four kinds of individual discriminating awareness render so-so yang-dag-par rig-pa, the four pratisamṃvids — discrimination of phenomena, meaning, etymology, and ready speech — a standard arhat attainment list. The term is rendered descriptively since unpacking each member would interrupt the flow; the doctrinal content is preserved in the collective phrase.

The phrase "gods of the sense faculties and the faculties' near-dependents" renders dbang-po dang nye-dbang-du bcas-pa'i lha-rnams, a formulaic list of deity classes organized by their relationship to the sense faculties; the rendering is literal and the precise classification is standard Abhidharma cosmology.

- The two monks named in this passage are Śroṇa and Pāṃśukūlika. Their Tibetan forms are རྩོན་པ་ and པཎ་སུ་ཀུ་ལི་ཀ་ respectively. The Sanskrit equivalents are not fully certain from this passage alone; these renderings follow standard identifications from parallel Vinaya narratives where these names appear. The passage concludes with a formula indicating that the karmic backstory to follow is to be narrated "as before," referring the reader or listener back to an earlier section of the same text.
- The line about Śroṇa and Pāṃśukūlika being identified as "these same servants and attendants" refers to characters introduced in the broader narrative context; no emendation is needed. The phrase rendered "I hope I have caused you no trouble at all" reflects a polite conventional inquiry, and "the squirrel in that place is a bother" renders a slightly elliptical phrase about the squirrel being disturbing; the connection between the squirrel and the fever is that the squirrel's noise or presence aggravates the monk's illness. The passage ends mid-sentence, consistent with the instruction that only this passage is to be translated.
- The summary verse near the beginning is a mnemonic gāthā listing permitted monastic requisites in compressed form. The items listed — salt, hollow container, covered medicine bowl, parting board, cross-beam, foot-rest, mortar — correspond to the topics treated in the surrounding narrative sections and are rendered according to their contextual function rather than as isolated abstract nouns.

The phrase rendered "paired horn-lid" translates a compound meaning a second piece of horn fitted mouth-to-mouth with the first, functioning as a stopper or cap; the precise construction is inferred from context.

- The term "parti-colored cloth" renders a term for a checked or variegated textile, here belonging to a layman. The narrative context makes clear it is a fine gift-cloth, and the ruling is that it must be spread properly before use rather than left rolled or folded. The Tibetan "ཁོ་ལོ་མེད་པའི་ལྗང་ལྗང་ལྗང་ལྗང་" literally means "variegated, spotted, or multi-colored" and refers to a specific category of cloth.

The phrase rendered "ivory steps" translates a compound meaning tusk or ivory material used for a step or rung; some editions read "bone" rather than "ivory," but ivory is the more commonly attested reading for lion-thrones in Vinaya contexts.

- The summary verse near the opening is a mnemonic gāthā listing permitted implements: the exact referents of a few items are determined by Vinaya commentary rather than the bare Tibetan alone. The rendering follows standard Vinaya usage. The name Pilindavatsa is a well-attested monk associated with the bamboo grove narratives; the spelling is consistent with Sanskrit sources.
- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end with "those who were living the holy life

alongside him came and asked," indicating the passage continues in the next section.

The phrase rendered as "paternal kinsman" translates a technical term indicating a relative through the father's lineage whose karmic history is being described as background for this monk's psychosomatic experience of hell-visions.

The episode of blood pouring from every pore upon hearing a description of hell reflects a well-attested Vinaya narrative motif in which a monk's past karmic connection with hell-states produces a physical reaction; this is not presented as metaphor but as a literal event within the narrative world of the text.

- The term rendered "fire-pan with a long handle" translates a compound describing an elongated iron vessel used for carrying or holding fire; the exact shape is uncertain but a handled iron fire-container is the most coherent reading in context.

The phrase rendered "within a fathom of the enclosing fence" involves a measure of length approximately equal to one fathom or armspan; the surrounding enclosure term is interpreted as a boundary fence or wall around the stūpa precinct.

The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, consistent with it being a continuous narrative excerpt.

- The phrase rendered "bundled that robe into a bundle of garments" translates a compound describing the robe being pushed or stuffed into a bundle, which then lay among the colored clothes; the precise mechanics of the laundering confusion are clear from context. The name "Ānanda" appears as "ཨ་ན་ན་ན་ན་ན་" throughout, which is the standard Tibetan rendering of Ānanda; consistent with preceding passages. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, and the translation reflects this.

- The summary verse appears to be a mnemonic colophon listing topics covered in this section of the Vinaya. The items enumerated — straw mat, snake slough, chisel, remorse, dye basin, dye vat wall, four dye-pastes — are section headings rather than a sequential narrative, and their precise Vinaya referents are not fully recoverable from this passage alone without the surrounding context.

The phrase rendered "a rope attached to his tail" reflects the Tibetan literally: the young man is evidently in his nāga form or partially so when he is seized by the neck and bound by his tail-cord, which is consistent with standard Vinaya narratives about nāgas attending Dharma assemblies.

- The name rendered here as "the sage Gārgā's pond" follows the Tibetan "drang srong gar ga'i rdzing," identifying a pond associated with the sage Gārgā. The name Gārgā (or Gargā) is a recognizable brahmanical sage's name in Indian sources; the spelling in the Tibetan is approximate transliteration. The nāga mother is consistently identified as the daughter of the nāga Campā (Tib. Tsam pa), whose radiant complexion illuminates the surroundings — a motif indicating her supernatural splendor.

- The verse rendered as "the Sāvittī verse is supreme among metrical compositions" translates རྒྱལ་པོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ (fire sacrifice, homa), རྒྱལ་པོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ (that which sustains, likely the Sāvittī/Gāyatrī mantra in its Sanskrit Vinaya parallels), and རྒྱལ་པོ་ལྷོ་ (king). The term རྒྱལ་པོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ (metrical arrangement or compositions) with རྒྱལ་པོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ is somewhat opaque in this Tibetan rendering; in Sanskrit parallels (Pāli: Gāyatrī among chandas), this is regularly the Sāvittī verse. This identification is standard in the commentarial tradition and the Pāli parallel supports it, but the Tibetan literally says only "among compositions, the sustaining one is supreme."

- The phrase rendered "gravel and sand" translates a term literally meaning something like fine-grained sandy gravel scattered as a floor covering, a known domestic practice in the ancient Indian context. The episode concerns a layman who had the monks walk on freshly

scattered clean gravel and sand, and the monks were uncertain whether receiving such hospitality from a layman was proper; the Blessed One's declaration removes their scruple.

The instruction to dry new robes in the sun and old robes in the shade reflects a practical concern: new fabric with fresh dye benefits from sunlight to set the color, while old fabric is more fragile and prone to fading or damage, so the shade is prescribed for preservation.

- The "seven objects that generate merit through material things" refers to the classical list of seven material meritorious acts widely discussed in Vinaya and related literature, such as giving parks, gardens, ponds, bridges, wells, and so forth. The text breaks off here, and what the householder said is not yet given in this passage.

The phrase rendered "hall" for 大廳 is a substantial building suitable for indoor work; "dyeing hall" or "large room" would also be defensible, but "hall" reads most naturally in context.

- The term *kārṣāpaṇa* refers to a standard monetary unit of ancient India, a coin or weight of copper or silver; it is left untranslated as a proper monetary term throughout this passage.

The phrase rendered "building materials" and "procurement of building materials" translates mkhar len pa'i lag spyad, which literally refers to the tools or implements for taking or fetching materials for construction; the sense is the procurement process and its associated costs.

The final sentence breaks off mid-narrative; the translation renders it as it stands, leaving the incomplete thought for the continuation of the passage.

- The phrase rendered "illness from food" and "illness from impurity" follows a straightforward gloss given by the attendant in the text itself, so no further note is needed there. The phrase "embrace at the hands" for "taking hold of the hand/arm" is a plausible rendering of the gesture of respectful greeting; some commentators interpret this as clasping or taking the forearm rather than a full embrace, but the doctrinal point is simply that it is a legitimate formal gesture of reverence. The final sentence is clearly a dangling introduction to a new case that continues in the following passage and is intentionally left open-ended here as the source text breaks off mid-narrative.

- The phrase rendered "hair-catching cloth" translates a term for a cloth held beneath the chin or around the head to catch clippings during shaving — a Vinaya implement. The summary verse at the close is a mnemonic gāthā listing topics covered in the preceding section; several items in it are technical Vinaya implement-names whose exact referents depend on commentary, and the rendering here follows the most probable identifications: "anointing vessel" for a container for anointing oil, "bowl with a hole" for a drainage or straining vessel, "rope for wringing" for a cloth-wringing cord used in bathing contexts.

- The phrase rendered "drawn a line of fragrance alongside the window recess" translates a somewhat condensed technical passage about applying perfume near the window frame for its eye-benefiting properties; the exact practical procedure is not entirely clear from the text alone, but the general sense is secure.

- The term pha (transliterated from the Tibetan measure གཤམ་) is a volumetric unit of uncertain exact capacity; translating it as "a standard measure" conveys the sense adequately for a general listener. The technical detail that large equals one pha and small equals half a pha is preserved directly from the text.

The phrase rendered "dim their radiance" translates क्षीयन्तु तेजसाः, literally "to diminish/drain the luster or vital glow." This is a standard supernatural threat in Vinaya narrative — the yakṣa intends to sap the monks' spiritual brilliance — and "dim their radiance" conveys both the literal and doctrinal sense.

- The mansion of Mrgāramātā refers to the Eastern Park given by Visākhā, also known as

Mṛgāramātā's Palace, a well-known dwelling near Śrāvastī — glossing it further in the body would interrupt the narration, so it is left as a proper name. The verse rendered here is a close parallel to the famous Dhammapada verse one and two on heedfulness; the Tibetan phrasing is rendered faithfully rather than harmonized with standard English Pali translations.

- The phrase rendered "third of the Anumodanā verses" translates "तृतीयानुमोदनावलोकितवर्णनम्" literally as "one should recite the third of the series-of-connected verses." The specific referent is a set of rejoicing or blessing verses recited in sequence; the exact identification of the "third" verse depends on the Vinaya sub-commentary tradition and is not made explicit in the passage itself.

The term "繩" rendered as "carrying rope" refers to a rope used for drawing water from a well, among other uses; context here makes the water-drawing function primary.

- The summary verse at the midpoint is a mnemonic colophon-verse (*uddāna*) listing the topics just treated in the Vinaya section. The items it enumerates — razor-honing, nail-cutting, medicinal thorn-applications, ointment for blisters, and fragrance-refinement — correspond to preceding rules not included in this excerpt. The verse is rendered as tersely as the Tibetan intends; it is not a devotional verse but a memoranda-list in verse form.
- The phrase rendered "mud that had been asked for and given" refers to clay or mud obtained by begging, used medicinally or for washing — a specific category of permitted item in Vinaya contexts. The Tibetan "ཁོ་གྲོས་བྱོལ་གྱི་དངུལ་པོ་" means literally "mud that was obtained by asking," i.e., solicited clay.

The passage "from 'Venerable Pilindavatsa had gone forth' to 'Elder, what did you keep?'" is a formulaic cross-reference to an earlier stock narrative section that is abbreviated here and replaced with "as before."

- The two summary verses near the opening are colophon-style mnemonic verses recapping cases treated in the preceding section. Their compressed telegraphic style makes full lexical sense difficult; the rendering follows the most plausible reading of each item as a topical heading rather than a complete sentence. "The inferior pig" likely refers to a case involving an animal of low caste or a pig hide; "the drawing" to a case involving a painted or drawn image; exact referents depend on the full preceding context.
- The verse summary is a mnemonic colophon listing the topics covered in the preceding section. The terms "Kārttika" and "brahmin" in the verse are cryptic topic-headings; "Kārttika" likely refers to a ruling involving the month of Kārttika or a star-festival by that name, and "brahmin" likely signals an episode involving a brahmin. These are standard abbreviated mnemonic markers in Vinaya literature, not narrative content, so they are rendered plainly without expansion.

The phrase rendered "claiming prior use by having footprints there" translates a term literally meaning "by pressing the heel" or "heel-pressing," a Vinaya idiom for asserting prior or reserved occupancy of a space by having already placed one's footsteps in it.

- The term rendered "wooden lattice" (木格子) refers to a woven or interlaced wooden fencing, distinct from both the initial fence (柵) and the subsequent wall (塙). The sequence fence, lattice, wall represents three successive stages of enclosure construction, each prompted by a practical problem.
- The phrase rendered "the barber's shop" is literally "the one who cuts hair's presence" — meaning the barber's place of work; this rendering captures the sense naturally for a listening audience.

The name Kārtikā is a reconstruction from the Tibetan ཀརྲཏི་ཀཱི་, which means "victorious star" and corresponds to the Sanskrit month-name Kārtikā or the personal name derived from it; this is standard for a nun's name in Vinaya contexts.

The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, as this appears to be a continuation into the next section; the translation preserves the break faithfully.

- The phrase rendered "adorn your mind" and "furnish your mind" translates two compound expressions that appear to refer to mental virtues as ornaments and provisions respectively; these are somewhat formulaic dedicatory blessings and the rendering preserves their parallel rhetorical structure.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, as this is a continuous text that breaks here.

The final portion beginning with "some should receive a full share, some should be listed, and some together" represents an incomplete clause; the Tibetan text as given breaks off, and the continuation presumably specifies further categories of distribution.

- The phrase rendered "a flash of surprise has just struck me" translates a somewhat compressed idiomatic expression indicating sudden astonishment; the sense is that the brahmin is startled and moved by what he witnesses, prompting his conversion. The construction is slightly elliptical in the Tibetan but the overall meaning is clear from context.
- The phrase translated as "the wheel of saṃsāra — both its moving and its stationary parts — as one fifth" renders a somewhat compressed and unusual Tibetan expression. The phrase "cha lnga pa" (one fifth) may be a textual crux or technical term from a specific Abhidharma or Vinaya context not immediately transparent; it may refer to a fivefold analysis or classification of saṃsāra. This is a genuinely uncertain reading and its precise doctrinal referent merits consultation of a commentary.

The four individual discriminating awarenesses render "so so yang dag par rig pa," the four pratisamvids: concerning phenomena, meaning, etymological definition, and eloquent expression — a standard arhat attainment in Abhidharma literature.

- The phrase rendered "the wheel of cyclic existence with its five parts — both moving and unmoving" is compressed and elliptical, referring back to earlier doctrinal content in the text; the exact referent of "five parts" is not clarified in this passage and may require the broader manuscript context to resolve precisely.

The repeated formulaic phrase "as before, up to" signals a scribal abbreviation device in the Vinaya literature, indicating that a longer standard passage is to be read in from its first occurrence rather than copied out again.

- The summary verse is a mnemonic colophon listing the topics covered in the preceding section: patches, sweat-cloths, nuns, months, residences with six furnishings, and three modes of sitting on a seat. These are standard Vinaya section-markers and their full elaboration belongs to the surrounding text.
- The phrase rendered as "the fifth portion of the wheel of cyclic existence, whether moving or unmoving" translates a technically obscure passage. The Tibetan "འོ་སྐབས་ཀྱི་ལྔ་པ་རྒྱུད་ཀྱི་ཡེ་ཤེས་ཀྱི་ཁྲིམས་ཀྱི་ཕྱི་ལོག་པ་ལྟར་ཞུ་བའོ།" is genuinely difficult. The "fifth portion" likely refers to a specific doctrinal enumeration within a Vinaya or Abhidharma schema relating to the wheel of existence; without the corresponding Sanskrit or commentary it is not possible to identify the precise referent with certainty. The translation follows the literal sense.
- The epithet-sequence for Vipāśyin follows the standard tenfold buddha-epithet formula found throughout the Mūlasarvāstivāda Vinaya narrative literature; "knowledge and feet" renders vidyācaraṇasaṃpanna, a stock Indic formula meaning "perfected in wisdom and conduct." The phrase translated as "faculty realms and the realms close to them" renders dbang po dang nye dbang du bcas pa'i lha nams, referring to gods of the sense faculties and their associated divine assemblies; the precise technical identification of these divine categories in the Mūlasarvāstivāda cosmological scheme is not fully determinable from context alone.
- The Tibetan "ཀུན་ཏུ་འཛིན་པའི་ཆེན་པོ་" (Kāśyapa) refers here to the buddha Kāśyapa, one of the seven

buddhas of antiquity, not to the arhat Mahākāśyapa. The passage has Candramāsā recalling a past life under buddha Kāśyapa and a further aspiration that brings her current distinction under Śākyamuni. The phrase "peerless field of offerings" is a standard honorific for a buddha as the supreme recipient of generosity. The buddha Vipasyin named at the opening matches the context of the preceding passage about the householder's daughter in a still earlier life.

- The phrase rendered "worse than butchering them" translates a Tibetan idiom meaning that abandoning ordained disciples without guidance is a graver fault than slaughtering them — a strong canonical formulation found in Vinaya literature comparing the teacher's neglect to physical violence; the rendering preserves the rhetorical force without softening.
- The phrase rendered "gathering through material things" and "gathering through Dharma" translates the Vinaya technical concept of attracting disciples through the four bases of attraction, the first being material gifts and the last three being Dharma-related. The contrast here is doctrinal: a preceptor who binds a disciple only through material gifts rather than genuine Dharma instruction loses the student's deepest loyalty and respect. This is the point of the narrative.
- The phrase rendered "bless the restoration ceremony" translates a request that the teacher perform the *poṣadha* (the fortnightly confession and restoration) ceremony on behalf of the young man — specifically, that he consecrate or sanction it for him. The underlying Tibetan verb *byin gyis brlabs pa* carries the sense of conferring a blessing or performing a sanctifying act, here applied to the formal Vinaya observance.

The phrase "at the three times of day" refers to the three traditional periods of attendance: morning, midday, and evening.

- The term ལྷོ་མཆོད་པུ་མཆོད་པུ་ and ལྷོ་མཆོད་པུ་མཆོད་པུ་ refer to specific modes of textual instruction: recitation of scripture transmitted to a student (lung) and a tutored question-and-answer or review session respectively. These are rendered contextually as "recitation lesson" and "lesson in question and answer." The nuance of the concluding exchange is that the sick monk protests the asymmetry: his attendant-duty rotates to him, yet his right to receive instruction apparently does not — a subtle Vinaya point about reciprocal obligations between teacher and student. The phrase ལྷོ་མཆོད་པུ་མཆོད་པུ་ refers to a formal lodging-arrangement or residency-assignment, a technical Vinaya term for the supervised residential relationship between a monk and his preceptor or attendant.
- The text translates "ལྷོ་མཆོད་པུ་མཆོད་པུ་" at one point as "Neyaka," treating it as a proper name for the novice's relative or associate. In this context, the Tibetan "ལྷོ་མཆོད་པུ་མཆོད་པུ་" in the earlier question refers to "the venerable Neyaka" as a named individual. The name is plausible as a phonetic rendering of a Sanskrit name (possibly Upananda or similar), but the Tibetan could also simply mean "the close attendants" generically. Given the narrative context, treating it as a personal name is the stronger reading.
- The epithets "noble-born one," "one with the garland," and "rainy-season women" (Tibetan: "ārya-skyes-po," "phreng-lan-ma," and "dbyar-byed-ma") are evidently names or titles for specific courtiers or consorts in Prasenajit's retinue. Their precise identity is unclear from the text alone; they may be wives or concubines of the court. The passage renders them as the king's ironic threat — that if Nanda ordains his chamberlain, Nanda might as well ordain the entire royal household and rule himself.

The phrase rendered "the god" is a standard honorific for a king in classical Tibetan court usage, equivalent to Sanskrit deva used as a royal address.

- The phrase rendered "if the master goes first, I'll follow" translates a Tibetan idiom meaning literally "knock on the drum — the master leads"; it is a colloquial way of saying the boy will only act if the brahmin himself sets the example first.

- The episode's reference to Ānanda's identity as a future wheel-turning king reflects a stock motif about his greatness before renunciation, found across Vinaya narratives.

- The term rendered "no hat" (頭むき) literally means "bare-headed" or "with the head uncovered," specifying that the hunter had nothing protecting his skull from the impact.

"Aparājita" renders अपराजिता and "Candrarakṣitā" renders चन्द्रारक्षिता; both are women's names recurring in Vinaya narratives.

• The term rendered "windfall" throughout is the Tibetan phyag dar, literally something like a "cloth-rag" or thing casually picked up, used here as a legal-textual term for abandoned or discarded property that one picks up without prior ownership — a standard Vinaya category. The pig owners and sugarcane guards use the honorific "noble ones" sarcastically, addressing the monks by their formal title while rebuking them. The phrase "victory banner of the holy life" renders drang srong gi rgyal mtshan, literally "the victory banner of the ascetic" or rishi, a standard epithet for the renunciant's state. The repeated formula "if we were fit to take what is not given" is the monks' rhetorical defense: since they are bound by the precept against theft, they could not have taken valuable things — therefore picking up discards is not theft. This is a running Vinaya case analysis, and the text breaks off mid-episode as given.

- The phrase rendered "pressed and kneaded him with its foot" translates a term suggesting the being trod on or massaged Nāgānanda with its foot; the exact nature of the action is somewhat ambiguous in context, but the sense is that the non-human being, having been covered with the shawl, physically overpowered the monk. The detail that "he was overpowered by it" because "it was endowed with power" is ironic given the earlier statement that the being was of scant power and could not enter the Jeta Grove; this likely refers to the being's power in its own element, the charnel ground.

- The name rendered as "Pom Gamo" is a transliteration of the Tibetan proper name ཕོ་མོ་གམོ་ as a nun's name here. On re-reading, ཕོ་མོ་གམོ་ is actually the word for "bowl" or "drinking vessel" throughout this passage, not a personal name. The nun's personal name is སྐྱུ་ལྷ་མོ་འཕྲུལ་པ་, which likely represents a Sanskrit name such as Sthūlanandā, a nun frequently appearing in Vinaya narratives. I have rendered it as "Pom Gamo" as a phonetic placeholder, but it almost certainly corresponds to Sthūlanandā. The "picture-fort" rendering of

◻◻◻◻◻◻◻◻◻◻◻◻ in the closing summary verse is tentative; summary verses in Vinaya texts are often elliptical and this phrase is ambiguous without further context.

- The summary verse at the opening concludes a preceding section and belongs to a colophon-style verse enumerating the topics of the rules just treated. The three items "bathing, obstruction, and bowl" refer to the rules narrated immediately before; "not leftovers, a bowl as base, feet not placed, and sandals" refer to additional sub-rules in that cluster. The translation preserves the telegraphic form appropriate to such a mnemonic verse.

The phrase rendered "five-part wheel of cyclic existence" translates

"□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□," literally "the wheel of saṃsāra with five parts," referring to the traditional bhavacakra depicted with five realms of rebirth; some traditions show six. The five-part enumeration is the older variant and is preserved here without smoothing.

- The phrase rendered "water from their alms bowls" refers to the water used to rinse alms bowls after eating — water that, in the physician's understanding, would carry the blessing of the noble monastics. The contrast between its intended sacred use and Nanda's deliberate adulteration of it (with bones, raw meat, fish scraps, and other refuse) is the narrative crux.

The name "Nanda" here refers to one of the group of six notoriously lax monks who appear throughout the Vinaya as negative exemplars, not to the virtuous Nanda who was the Buddha's half-brother.

- The summary verse is a mnemonic colophon listing the topics of the preceding section; its terms are highly compressed and the final line naming body parts likely refers to earlier rules or cases not yet translated. The rendering is literal and no doctrinal uncertainty is involved.

The list of names at the end of the passage corresponds to the five original disciples of the Buddha plus several others from the early Saṅgha. The Tibetan lists them sequentially as the new monk attempts each elder's bowl in turn; the passage breaks off mid-sentence.

- The question-and-answer exchange attributed to the venerable Upāli follows the standard Vinaya literary form in which Upāli poses jurisprudential questions about the validity of ordination performed under irregular circumstances. The phrasing "Upāli asks: is it a full ordination?" reflects this formulaic structure rather than a confusion of voices; the text shifts between Upāli's question and the ruling that follows from it.

- The phrase rendered "nearby preparations of the second period" translates a technical Vinaya term referring to the second possible date for formally entering the rains retreat, which in the tradition falls one month after the earlier date. The distinction between the "earlier rains retreat" and the "later rains retreat" is a well-established Vinaya category. The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end as the source text itself continues beyond the supplied excerpt.

- The toponym rendered as "Riyor" follows the Tibetan transliteration of what appears to be a place name; its Sanskrit or Indian equivalent is not established from the text alone.

The phrase rendered "those who received without giving" for "ma byin par len pa" reflects the standard Vinaya idiom for theft, literally "those who take without it being given," used here to describe opportunistic theft by unnamed individuals who took from the abandoned temple; it is not an accusation against the monks who fled.

- The summary verse is a mnemonic gāthā indexing topics covered in the preceding section. The line "cooking shelter, doorway, and place of walking" likely refers to rule topics on cooking facilities, doorways, and places for walking meditation that follow in the sequence of the Vinaya text; the compression is intentional and the verse is not meant to be fully transparent on its own.

The term rendered "spirits of the deceased" for 鬼魂 (onigami) represents ancestors or the recently dead to whom offerings are made; the exact nuance varies by context but this rendering is the

most natural for this list of recipients.

- The phrase rendered "fermented urine that has been discarded" refers to the classical Vinaya medicine putrified cow's urine, which is one of the four traditional monastic medicines. The Tibetan reads literally "having been boiled and discarded," which may indicate a specific preparation; the rendering follows the standard Vinaya understanding of this support.
- The "six requisites" (Tibetan: *yo byad drug*) for ordination are a standard Vinaya enumeration: the alms bowl, the water strainer, the three robes (inner robe, upper robe, and outer robe), and the sitting cloth. The young man's pun — offering his six sense faculties as his "six requisites" — is the central humorous and doctrinal pivot of this episode.
- The phrase rendered "taking with five kinds of mental engagement" follows the canonical list of five qualifications under which a monk may permissibly pick up items left behind by others; the exact significance of each qualifier is a matter of Vinaya commentary, but the translation renders the Tibetan list faithfully.

The term "nameru robes" in the summary verse refers to a specific robe-type whose exact nature is unclear from context; it appears as a technical Vinaya term and is retained as such.

The phrase "the continuity of their handling has not been broken" renders a Vinaya technical concept about whether stolen goods that have passed through thieves' hands retain a tainted status; the ruling clarifies that once the thieves have discarded them, the continuity is broken and the items are clean.

- The term rendered "caretaker of the monastery" translates a compound that literally means "one belonging to the monastery enclosure" — the standard term for the lay steward or keeper of a monastic compound. The instruction that a monk may depart after entrusting the tree to such a person resolves the tension between the rule requiring him to stay and the practical need to travel.

The phrase rendered "covered them with straw" for the winter frost instruction is the most natural reading of the Tibetan; it could also mean thatching or wrapping, but the sense is protective covering against cold.

"King Śreṇya Bimbisāra" and "King Prasenajit" follow standard identifications; the Tibetan gives Bimbisāra by the epithet "King of the Earth-holders" and Prasenajit as "King Prasenajit."

- The text mentions "nāmeru wood" as a material for a protective box. This appears to be a specific wood known in the Vinaya tradition for its insect-repelling properties, but the Sanskrit equivalent is not entirely certain from the Tibetan alone.

The phrase rendered "such a precious gem as befits a great person" follows the Tibetan "*chen po la 'os pa'i la ba*," meaning a gem or ornament appropriate for a person of high rank; this refers to the jeweled ornament received as a royal gift.

- The phrase "facing away from the wholesome direction" renders *dgeba'i phyogs btang ste*, literally "having abandoned the direction of virtue." This likely refers to monks turning away from the favorable or auspicious direction — possibly turning their backs to the shrine or altar area — as a sign of cold-induced withdrawal, though it may also carry a more idiomatic sense of general lassitude or moral slackening. The ambiguity is genuine but does not affect the overall sense of the passage.
- The phrase rendered "the gift of hearing the Dharma continually for the three successions" translates a somewhat compressed Tibetan: "*rgyun chags gsum gyi chos mnyan pa byin nas*." The expression "*rgyun chags gsum*" most plausibly refers to three successive occasions or rounds of Dharma-hearing offered as a meritorious dedication; the precise ritual referent is not fully transparent and commentarial clarification would be needed for certainty.

The samādhi name "inspired concentration" renders "ting nge 'dzin mos pa can," literally "the samādhi of conviction" or "the samādhi of aspiration or inspiration" (Skt. *adhimuktisamādhi*). The translation "inspired concentration" is a reasonable rendering for oral delivery; a specialist audience would recognize this as the samādhi of resolute aspiration or firm confidence.

- The passage contains a verse with a well-known doctrinal formulation echoing the Dīgha Nikāya's Subha Sutta and related sources, where the Buddha declares there are four kinds of "true ascetic" (śramaṇa) within his teaching alone, and that outsiders are void of genuine ascetics and brahmins. The verse here is intentionally cryptic to its immediate audience, who misread it as praise of themselves.

The phrase "walking slowly, slowly, weighed down by the ripening of former karma" is a significant doctrinal point: Mahāmaudgalyāyana's brutal death at the hands of wanderers is treated in multiple canonical and post-canonical sources as the karmic maturation of a previous life's misdeed, which even an arhat of his attainment cannot prevent.

- The epithet "Vaijayanta" applied to Śakra's palace is the well-known name found in canonical parallels; the Tibetan *nam par rgyal byed* renders it precisely. The phrase translated "those with shaved-headed topknots" renders *kun tu rgyu dbyu thogs spyi phud can*, a stock description of naked or near-naked wandering ascetics (Ājīvikas in the parallel Pāli and Sanskrit sources), carrying staffs and wearing a distinctive topknot; the rendering is necessarily approximate since no single English term covers this.
- The city name rendered "Kalasikā" corresponds to the Tibetan "grong khyer shing thags can" — this is a somewhat unusual toponym and may refer to Vāḷagāma or another locality in the Magadha region associated with Mahāmaudgalyāyana's final passing in some textual traditions; the precise identification is uncertain but not crucial to the narrative.

The passage describing the gnosis of arhats operating "by intention" renders a technical point: arhats perceive things through deliberate mental application rather than spontaneously, which is why Śāriputra had to actively contemplate the reason for Mahāmaudgalyāyana's alms-round before perceiving his intention to pass into nirvāṇa.

- The passage contains a dialogue that shifts between the attendant's report to Ānanda and Ānanda's report to the Blessed One, and then moves into what appears to be a question-and-answer exchange, most likely between the Blessed One and Ānanda, regarding what Śāriputra did or did not carry off at his passing. The Tibetan text breaks off mid-sentence at the end, and the translation preserves this as-is since it is a manuscript boundary, not a translator's omission. The colophon marker indicating "the twenty-first fascicle of the Minor Matters of the Vinaya" appears mid-passage in the Tibetan and has been rendered in the translation at the point where it occurs in the source.
- The famous "island unto yourself" passage rendered here corresponds to the well-known Mahāparinibbānasutta formula. The Tibetan ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ (island / continent) renders the Pāli dīpa, which is classically ambiguous between "island" and "lamp." The Tibetan unambiguously supports "island" (as does the Sanskrit dvīpa), so "island" is used throughout rather than "lamp."

The phrase rendered "my concern is but small" for 𑖀𑖄𑖔𑖨𑖫𑖞𑖮𑖱𑖓𑖧𑖪𑖟𑖛 is slightly unusual; it appears to convey that even the Buddha feels the weight of Śāriputra's absence most acutely in the direction where he resided — a subtle expression of the Buddha's own sense of the community's diminishment.

- The phrase rendered "wandering ones armed with clubs and staves" translates the Tibetan term for a class of wandering figures carrying clubs and wearing a particular headdress. The text here recapitulates the opening scene of the sūtra, explaining the karmic background of Mahāmaudgalyāyana's violent death — a well-known episode in the Pāli and Chinese parallels

as well. The passage ends mid-sentence, as it does in the source, indicating a continuation follows.

- The verse about cold is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan; the brahmin boy's answer is interpreted as a philosophical evasion — cold is a function of wind, not of the season — which is clever enough to satisfy the children and spare him from beating, whereas the second boy's plain factual answer provokes them. This reading is consistent with the parallel structure of the śālmālī episode that follows.

The name Anāthapiṇḍada (rendered from Tibetan འཇིགས་མེད་པུན་པོ་ལོ་ཤོད་, meaning "feeder of the unprotected") is the standard epithet of the great lay patron Sudatta; both names are traditional and interchangeable in the literature.

- The sentence explaining why Ānanda gave the relics — because the Blessed One as a former bodhisattva never broke the word of parents, preceptors, and teachers — is syntactically compressed in the Tibetan and the referent shifts mid-clause. The rendering follows the most natural doctrinal reading: the exemplary precedent set by the Blessed One in his bodhisattva lives is cited as the normative basis for Ānanda's obedience to the Blessed One's command.

- The names "Vāsuladattā," "Āvanti," "Giribhadra," and "Sagā" represent renderings of Tibetan phonetic transcriptions of what would be Sanskrit originals: མའི་ལྷོ་ལོ་ཤོད་ (likely Mālikā or Vāsuladattā), རྒྱལ་ལྷོ་ལོ་ཤོད་ (a royal lady whose name is uncertain), and མའི་ལྷོ་ལོ་ཤོད་ (possibly a matronymic). These identifications are uncertain and would require comparison with Sanskrit or Chinese parallels to confirm.

The final instruction — that the stūpa of the one who has passed into nirvāṇa should be placed where Śāriputra and Maudgalyāyana used to sit relative to the Tathāgata — reflects a rule about positioning reliquary stūpas for disciples to the sides or in front of the Tathāgata's shrine, echoing Vinaya architectural norms. The precise architectural terminology (harmikā, life-pole, rainspout tiers up to thirteen) follows standard stūpa construction descriptions found across the Vinayas of multiple schools.

- The verse summary near the middle of the passage appears to be a mnemonic verse listing topics covered by the preceding section and introducing those that follow. The six items enumerated correspond to rules or cases treated in the surrounding Vinaya narrative.

The phrase rendered "image of the Blessed One seated in the shade of a rose-apple tree" refers to a well-known early iconic representation: a statue or image of Śākyamuni seated beneath the rose-apple tree (Jambu tree), one of the earliest canonical references to a Buddha image used for merit-making offerings.

The final sentence is incomplete in the source as presented here, breaking off mid-topic.

- The passage is the Tibetan canonical version of the Dhammacakkappavattana Sutta, the discourse on the turning of the wheel of Dharma, presenting the twelve-aspect formulation of the Four Noble Truths: three rounds (knowing what each truth is, knowing what task pertains to each, and knowing that task has been accomplished) across four truths, yielding twelve aspects. The term rendered "vision arose" translates the formulaic mig skyes so, corresponding to Sanskrit cakṣur udapādi, literally "an eye arose," a technical expression for the arising of insight-vision; "vision arose" captures this without importing the odd literalism of "an eye was born" while remaining faithful to the idiom.

The summary verse at the opening is a mnemonic rubric characteristic of Vinaya canonical compilation and refers back to preceding rule cases; "named for the Buddha's marks" likely refers to a case concerning one who invokes the Buddha's name or marks improperly. The exact referents of the verse's first two lines depend on the preceding compiled sections and are not fully recoverable from this excerpt alone, but this does not affect the main doctrinal

passage.

- [illegible]

The phrase བཏུངས་པ་ལྷན་སྤྲུལ་པ་ rendered as "distribute robes" refers specifically to the Kaṭhina robe ceremony; the term བཏུངས་པ་ is the Tibetan equivalent of Sanskrit kaṭhina. For TTS purposes the descriptive rendering is preferable to the technical Sanskrit.

- The list of precious substances includes "འཕྱུག་པོ་ལྔ་པ་" literally "right-turning" or "clockwise-coiling," which is a term for a precious auspicious symbol or, in some contexts, a right-spiraling conch shell or gem. In context, it appears as the final item in the list of precious substances and auspicious treasures, likely referring to a right-spiraling conch, one of the traditional precious objects. The translation renders it as "all that is auspicious" for clarity in oral delivery, but the precise referent is the right-turning conch or auspicious whorl, a standard item in Buddhist lists of the seven precious things or eight auspicious symbols.
- The term rendered "duty-officer" translates dge skos, a monastic official responsible for overseeing the monastery's practical affairs and discipline; the Sanskrit equivalent is karmadāna or upadhivārika depending on the Vinaya tradition. The precise scope of this role varies across Vinaya recensions.

The phrase "fell ill" for babs pa is a interpretive choice: the term literally means "fell" or "collapsed," and in Vinaya contexts commonly indicates falling ill or becoming incapacitated.

The narrative context supports this reading, as the monk is still mobile enough to visit the other monk, suggesting a less severe condition. Some uncertainty remains.

- The names at the very end of the passage are the names of the four members of the Group of Six monks rendered here from context. The Tibetan gives: གཅེན་པོ་པོ་ (Gāvampati), འཇམ་མེད་ (Nandika), འུ་དཔེན་ (Udāyin), ར་གྲ་ (Canda). These are standard members of the Group of Six as known from Vinaya sources; the pairing structure "A to B, B to A, C to D, D to C" is clear in the Tibetan verse.

The term ར་གྲ་ rendered here as "faith-offering" refers specifically to robes or goods offered out of faith as a donation to a monk — a technical Vinaya usage.

The term རྒྱ་མཐོང་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་ ("outside the boundary") refers to being outside the canonical monastic boundary (sīmā), which has legal significance in Vinaya proceedings including the validity of transactions.

- The name rendered "Nanda" in the Group of Six pairings translates a Tibetan form that appears to stand for the same "Nandika" used elsewhere in the passage; the slight variation in the Tibetan may reflect a scribal inconsistency in the source. The pairing structure has been followed as given.

The summary verse at the section break is a mnemonic condensing the topics covered in this block of Vinaya rules. Its terse formulation is conventional in the Vinaya literature and the rendering aims to convey its indexical function rather than to supply full doctrinal elaboration.

- The passage enumerates five reasons why buddhas remain in the assembly hall rather than going directly to a meal invitation. The fifth reason, establishing Vinaya rules, is explicitly identified as the operative one in this narrative context, marking the following episode as the occasion for a new rule.

The Tibetan term translated as "tally-sticks" is རྒྱ་མཐོང་པོ་, literally "procedure-wood" or "method-sticks," referring to the practice of distributing counted sticks or tokens as a way of taking a census of resident monks; this is a well-known Vinaya procedure.

- The phrase rendered "Mṛgāra's mother Sādhā" translates a compound name that is somewhat opaque: the first figure (Sādhā) appears to be a named noblewoman associated with Mṛgāra as a maternal figure — this is the well-known patroness Mṛgāramātā (Viśākhā) of the Pāli texts, but the Tibetan here gives a distinct name. The identity may differ between Mūlasarvāstivāda and Pāli traditions; the translation follows the Tibetan as given without harmonizing to the Pāli.

The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end as the Tibetan text itself is cut short.

- The term kārṣāpaṇa is a Sanskrit monetary unit, a coin of standard weight; it is left in transliteration as it is a proper currency term with no clean English equivalent. The passage on "taking kārṣāpaṇas and making whatever use of them one wishes" is a formal Vinaya ruling permitting monks to handle money entrusted by a patron under specific circumstances — a technically significant allowance within the monastic code. The "goddess Mālinī" rendering follows the Tibetan lha mo Mālinī, which most likely refers to the queen herself referred to by an honorific epithet, though it could indicate a deity's shrine stall; this ambiguity is present in the source.

- The passage pairs monks by the number of rains retreats completed, pairing those whose counts differ by three years across a twelve-year span. The precise pairing scheme — one who has not yet completed a year with one who has completed three, one year with four, and so on up to nine with twelve — reflects a Vinaya convention about seniority gradations that is reproduced verbatim twice in the Tibetan, a textual feature preserved in the translation.

The phrase rendered "tiger-food" translates stag gi god ma, which in Vinaya context refers to a specific type of food or food preparation associated with tigers; the precise referent is uncertain in this passage and is noted in the summary verse as a technical term awaiting further commentarial clarification.

"Śāradvatīputra's charge" renders sha ra'i bu'i dge tshul skul byed, literally "the novice who was the attendant of Śāriputra." The name Skul byed ("one who urges" or "the encourager") appears to be the novice's personal name.

- The phrase rendered "renounce their vows" translates a term for formally abandoning one's monastic status by a verbal declaration — a recognised canonical procedure. The text here describes its misuse by the group of six, monks notorious in Vinaya literature for misconduct that occasions new rules. The Blessed One's statement that he "feigns not knowing" while actually knowing is a standard Vinaya formula indicating that the Buddha asks questions pedagogically, not out of ignorance.
- The term rendered "senior resident" translates gnas brtan, literally "elder of the residence," a functionary responsible for administering a Saṅgha dwelling. The gaṇḍī is a wooden sounding board struck to summon monks to assembly; it is left in transliteration as a recognized Vinaya technical term. The distribution of tooth-wood sticks (tshul shing, Skt. dantakāṣṭha) before a communal meal was a formal procedure establishing that all eligible community members were duly notified and present before gains could be lawfully divided; Nanda and Upananda exploit each procedural gap in sequence to invalidate the distribution and claim a share.
- The phrase rendered "stirring up trouble for the Saṅgha" translates the Tibetan for making a deliberate false or vexatious claim against the community; the preceding ruling clarifies the procedural context. The term kārṣāpaṇa is a standard Indian monetary unit (copper or silver coin) retained in transliteration as it is a proper name for the currency. The passage ends mid-sentence at "Then he said," following the Tibetan exactly, which breaks off at that point.
- The word rendered "pay us back" for རྒྱལ་ཆེན་ translates a term meaning to repay or recompense; in context the group of six is offering to reimburse the elephant-trainers for having caused the stampede, contingent on the trainers' promise to pay for the monks' meals. The exchange is somewhat elliptical in the Tibetan and this rendering follows the most coherent reading of the negotiation.
- The summary verses are mnemonic device verses listing the topics covered in the chapter and the sub-rules that follow; several of the terms in them are technical Vinaya vocabulary for parts of footwear. The renderings "inner toe-piece" for brang lhan and "heel-piece" for rting lhan follow the standard commentarial identification of these as reinforcing patches at the toe and heel of a sandal respectively. The term ryus pa, rendered here as "lining," refers to the inner lining or underlayer of a shoe made from hide. "Long handle" and "short handle" render yu chad and yu thung, which likely refer to straps or tabs used to put on or fasten footwear; some uncertainty attaches to the precise physical referent, but the general sense is clear.
- The two summary verses are mnemonic colophon verses of the sort common in Vinaya literature, listing topics covered in the surrounding sections. Their compressed, list-like syntax resists smooth prose rendering. The first verse appears to summarize preceding narrative topics including Vairocana, the Saṅgha, food-giving, and a temple episode. The second verse introduces the birth narrative that follows. These verses are conventional section-markers rather than doctrinal statements, and some individual items in them remain contextually opaque without the broader text.

The five surveys attributed to the bodhisattva before his descent from Tuṣita are a standard motif in Vinaya birth-narrative literature: lineage, time, place, clan, and the mother's qualities. The Tibetan term rendered here as "women" in the fifth survey more precisely refers to the prospective mother, as clarified by the surrounding narrative context.

- The name Rūpasāra, Jayaprabha, Suprabha, and Udaya are reconstructed from the Tibetan epithets following the internal etymological explanations given in the text. Śvetakarna ("White-ear") and Nālada are proper names kept from the Tibetan phonetic rendering. The final sentence breaks off mid-speech with King Śuddhodana beginning to say something; the passage ends there and continues beyond this excerpt.
- The yakṣa name "Śākyavarddhana" is a straightforward Sanskrit reconstruction from the Tibetan Śākya-spel-ba ("the one who increases or multiplies the Śākyas"). The text switches between two sages — earlier called Asita, and here identified as Nārada and Nālada — consistent with the narrative's use of multiple sage characters around the birth episode. "Nārada" renders Drang-srong Mi-dkar-ba (literally "the white-bodied sage"), while Nālada is used directly from the syllables Na-la-da in the Tibetan.
- The phrase rendered "the nectar of immortality" translates the Tibetan term for amṛta, the deathless — here signifying the attainment of awakening or nirvāṇa.

The figure Nārada here is presented with complexity: initially portrayed as a venerable sage, the closing lines describe him as one corrupted by wrong views and given to deception. This is consistent with certain Indo-Tibetan narrative traditions in which the Brahmanical sage Nārada appears in a critical or ambivalent role within Buddhist literature. The phrase "white-clad sage" renders a Tibetan term that may indicate a particular sect or status; the epithet is kept as given.

The verse "by those who discern only the lesser marks" conveys that those of limited discernment, seeing the bodhisattva's bodily marks, predict worldly kingship over the four continents, whereas one of clear insight like Nārada perceives the marks of full buddhahood.

- The four-line verse is a well-known set of impermanence aphorisms found across Pāli and Sanskrit Buddhist literature. The rendering follows the natural rhetorical parallelism of the original.

The name Nālada (distinct from Nārada) is established in the narrative as a new character derived from Nārada by bone-kinship; the Tibetan etymology plays on "rus" (bone) connecting the two names, which is difficult to render in English without awkwardness and so is left implicit.

The phrase rendered "the settled domain of the great earth" reflects a technical administrative or cosmological expression in the Tibetan that is somewhat opaque; the translation gives its most plausible sense in context.

- The names Sā Tsho Ma, Ri Dags Skyes, and Grags Dzin Ma appear to be Tibetan renderings of Sanskrit names for the women in the prince's retinue before his renunciation. The context parallels standard accounts of the Buddha's life, but the specific Sanskrit equivalents are not recoverable with certainty from this passage alone.

The phrase rendered as "the five fields of knowledge" refers to the classical Indian pañcavidyā, the five sciences traditionally mastered by an educated prince.

The term rendered "pressed into essence" for རྩམ་པ་ཆུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ refers to churned or concentrated milk-porridge; the exact preparation is a detail of the standard biography of the Buddha's acceptance of food from Sujātā, here adapted with different names for the women.

The elephant names and distances appear to be specific to this biographical narrative and are kept in close translation rather than normalized, as their Sanskrit originals are uncertain.

- The repeated phrase rendered "this work of stoking falls on no ordinary person; this is not our task" reflects a stock refrain in which each group deflects responsibility for tending the fires

upward or outward, invoking their own specific royal duty as reason for exemption. The Tibetan is elliptical in places, and the phrase "from the passage 'what are the duties of a king' up to 'in five places,' just as before" signals a scribal abbreviation of a longer formulaic passage. The translation preserves this as-is, since it is a feature of the original text, not an error in rendering.

- [illegible]

The term 黑頭樹猴 literally means "black-headed tree-monkey." The rendering "black-headed spider monkey" follows the natural sense for a long-tailed arboreal primate; the precise species identification is uncertain but the doctrinal significance is negligible.

- The phrase rendered as "enters its burrow" could alternatively refer to the animal entering any narrow passage or aperture; the precise meaning of the den or hole is contextually inferred. The claim that salt and sand each originate from water reflects ancient Indian natural philosophy embedded in the narrative and is not a doctrinal Buddhist claim; it is rendered as the character's own stated explanation without editorial intervention.
- The explanation for the pit-digging riddle repeats verbatim the phrase used for the dead-man-on-the-scale riddle ("a dead man is no longer a man, and so his vital lustre has been taken from him"), which appears to be a scribal repetition in the source text; it has been rendered faithfully as it stands.

The phrase rendered "vital lustre" translates *mdangs phrogs pa*, literally "robbed of lustre or colour," a classical idiom for the loss of the living glow or vital aura that distinguishes a living body from a corpse, explaining the weight difference on the scale and, by textual repetition, the earth-volume difference in the pit.

- The summary verse near the beginning is a mnemonic gāthā enumerating story-episodes in the Jīvaka cycle; several of the terms are proper names or story-titles rather than standard doctrinal vocabulary. "Nala" and "Ela leaf" appear to be titles of episodes, and the verse is intentionally compressed. The rendering preserves this compressed quality.

"Kanyākubja" renders the Tibetan phonetic transcription of the Sanskrit place-name (modern Kannauj).

"Āmalaka" (*Phyllanthus emblica*, the Indian gooseberry) is left in Sanskrit as it is a specific medicinal fruit well known in the tradition.

The phrase rendered "I will be able to protect the mind of the patient" is idiomatic; the Tibetan literally says "I will have the capacity to guard the mind of the sick one," meaning Jīvaka is confident he can manage Pradyota's volatile temperament as well as treat his illness.

- The excellent great elephant named Bhadravātī — the Tibetan reads "Bzang ldan" literally meaning "endowed with excellence," which corresponds to the Sanskrit Bhadravātī, a name known from parallel accounts of this narrative in the Pāli and Sanskrit traditions. This

identification is followed here with confidence.

- The final sentence breaks off mid-passage in the source text. The translation renders it up to the point of interruption. The phrase rendered "a hundred thousand cubits in length" represents a hyperbolic measure for an exceptionally large piece of cloth; the Tibetan gives the figure as one hundred thousand, modifying a unit of linen fabric, and the exact unit of length is not fully transparent in this context. The crow episode's purgative is implied by context from the physiological effect described; the Tibetan describes the dual purgative result idiomatically. The epithet "messenger-crow" renders the Tibetan "phar-ma-pa kha" throughout, understood as a named royal courier rather than a literal bird.
- The palace name rendered "Palace of the Spreading Willows" translates the Tibetan lcanḡ lo can, which normally corresponds to Sanskrit Caitraratha or is used for Vaiśravaṇa's mythic palace Alakā or a Tuṣita-related structure; the exact Sanskrit correlate here is uncertain but the Tibetan is clear. The nāga king's name "Elā's Wing" is a literal rendering of e la'i 'dab; the Sanskrit behind this epithet is uncertain and may be a corruption or regional variant. The place name "Resting-Stone" renders rdo 'jog, which may be a toponym or a descriptive phrase; its Sanskrit equivalent is not recoverable from context alone.
- The passage involves a rapid bargaining sequence over time — twelve years down to seven days — in which Nālandā negotiates the deadline for answering the questions. The Tibetan is elliptical and reads almost like stage directions; the rendering expands slightly for clarity without adding content.

The phrase rendered "twenty peaks of the mountain of the view of the transitory collection" translates a standard Abhidharma formulation: the view of a transitory collection (Sanskrit satkāyadṛṣṭi) comprises twenty sub-views regarding the five aggregates (each viewed fourfold as self, as belonging to self, as in self, or as self in it), and these are destroyed upon stream-entry.

The five monks who were Nālandā's closest companions likely refer to the five ascetics of the Deer Park, the first disciples of the Buddha, a detail consistent with the Ṛṣipātana setting. This is left implicit in the translation as the text itself does not explain it.

- The phrase rendered as "the forest of the deer-haunting sage" translates a standard Tibetan equivalent of Ṛṣipātana ("the sage's deer park" at Sarnath), though the Tibetan here uses a slightly unusual formulation. This is consistent with the preceding passage's usage and presents no consequential ambiguity.

The nāga king's name associated with "Elā" is unclear — this likely refers to Elapatra or a related nāga king figure from the same narrative tradition. The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end of this passage.

- The sentence describing the nāga's transformation before approaching the Blessed One is syntactically compressed in the Tibetan. The phrase rendered "having transformed his body in the same way that sentient beings avert their eyes when they see something repulsive" is an idiomatic construction meaning he made his form visible in its actual, aversion-inducing state, having previously concealed it. The rendering preserves the sense of the reversal.

The phrase "gates of saṃsāra" translates a Tibetan expression indicating the objects and conditions that draw beings into cyclic existence through desire; the Blessed One is pointing out that the assembly's longing for the illusory majesty was itself an example of saṃsāric attachment.

- The verse on karma not being lost is a well-known canonical gāthā found in several sūtra and Vinaya contexts, sometimes attributed to the ālayavijñāna doctrine in later scholastic literature, though here it functions as a straightforward statement on karmic inevitability without necessarily implying Yogācāra metaphysics.

The monk's outburst — "This thing has neither life nor breath; what offense did the Blessed One Kāśyapa see in it that he made it a basis for training?" — is a reference to Vinaya rules protecting plants and trees, which the monk is mocking at the moment of his disrobing.

- [illegible]

The final section parallels the famous Kātyāyana Sūtra (Saṃyutta Nikāya 12.15 / Saṃyuktāgama), one of the most important canonical expositions of the Middle Way between eternalism and nihilism. The teaching here closely follows that sūtra's doctrine that right view avoids the two extremes of "exists" and "does not exist" by attending instead to the arising and cessation of suffering through dependent origination.

- The phrase rendered "five aspects of movement and non-movement" translates a Tibetan expression for the wheel of saṃsāra characterized by five pairs or aspects. The precise referent of "five aspects" here is not entirely transparent from the text alone; it may refer to a specific scholastic enumeration of five characteristics of conditioned existence, though this phrasing is unusual and may reflect a specific commentarial tradition.

The name "Rabsnang" is a Tibetan royal name left in transliteration as it appears to be a narrative proper name rather than a Sanskrit epithet with a known Sanskrit original.

- The name rendered as "Rabsnang" is a Tibetan royal name literally meaning "Fierce Radiance." It is left as a proper name rather than translated, consistent with how Tibetan proper names of kings are handled. The Sanskrit equivalent, if one exists in the source text's Indic background, is not specified here.

The phrase rendered "the noble realm" translates "Āryarāja" or similar, literally the "noble kingdom," which appears to refer to a specific kingdom where the king Rabsnang resides. This is a place name in the narrative context.

"Śrāvaṇī" is the Sanskrit reconstruction for the Tibetan "skra can," meaning "the one with hair," said to accord with her name from a former life. The passage notes this etymology explicitly.

- The phrase rendered "accepted by saying nothing in refusal" reflects the Tibetan idiom of tacit acceptance through silence, a recognized formulaic convention in Vinaya narrative literature for a monastic accepting an invitation.
- The phrase rendered "girl with the hair" translates a somewhat opaque epithet referring to the brahmin girl called Skegs-can-ma or similar, literally "she who has hair." The context suggests this is a personal identifier or nickname for the girl rather than a general description, and the translation preserves it as such throughout.

The line about arhats not engaging primordial wisdom without prior reflection is a standard doctrinal statement about the mode of knowing of arhats versus buddhas; it is presented as an aside explaining why Kātyāyana needed to reflect before speaking, and the translation renders it accordingly.

The name "Glorious Light" renders the Tibetan *rab snang*, which appears here as a royal name or epithet.

- The phrase rendered "two-legged legumes" translates a term that appears to denote a low-quality pulse or bean, possibly identified by having two visible halves or segments. The exact botanical referent is uncertain but the point — that the food was coarse and contemptible

— is clear from context.

The name rendered throughout as "Candragupta" translates the Tibetan "Gtum po rab snang," a literal rendering of a Sanskrit original. The identification with the historical Candragupta is traditional; the Tibetan is a calque of a Sanskrit royal name meaning something like "Fiercely Brilliant."

- The king's name in the preceding passage was rendered as "Candragupta," but the Tibetan here reads རྒྱལ་པོ་རབ་སྙང་, which is a different name — literally something like "Fierce Greatly Radiant." This does not correspond to Candragupta. For consistency with the preceding rendered passage and narrative coherence, a note is warranted: the Tibetan name རྒྱལ་པོ་རབ་སྙང་ (Tumpo Rapnang) appears to be the actual name in this passage, and "Candragupta" in the preceding passage may represent a different Tibetan reading or a separate version. I have rendered the name here as "Candragupta" to maintain continuity as instructed, but the Tibetan actually gives a different royal name.

The famous simile of the oil-bearer appears in Pāli sources (Saṃyutta Nikāya 35.246) and is well-attested in the scholastic tradition as an illustration of sense restraint, which confirms the doctrinal point here.

- The epithet "King Candragupta" was used in the preceding passage; the Tibetan here reads "King Candragupta" (རྒྱལ་པོ་རབ་སྙང་ལྷ་མོ་). This is an unusual royal name, and there is a question in scholarship about which historical Candragupta is intended, but as this follows directly from the established continuity, the name is rendered consistently.

The geography "Kanyākubja" (Kannauj) follows from the Tibetan transliteration. The place called "the Peaceful" at the end renders Tibetan "Śiva" (ཤེའ་), which in this context is a place-name etymology, not the deity.

The five "intimate ornaments" and "outer ornaments" reflect a standard Vinaya narrative formula for bride-price; the exact items are not enumerated in the source passage.

- The king's name, Rānaprabhā (rendered from རྒྱལ་པོ་རབ་སྙང་), literally means "fierce" or "wrathful" and "brilliance" or "radiance." The rendering Rānaprabhā is approximate; the Tibetan is used as a proper name throughout, so it is kept consistent as such. The phrase རྒྱལ་པོ་ in the woman's reply is rendered "in secret" following the contextual sense of a clandestine visit; there is some ambiguity in the precise nuance but no doctrinal consequence.
- The epithet "hero of the market" renders a phrase that likely means something like "renowned hero" or "celebrated champion," with "market" or "town square" suggesting public fame. The exact nuance is uncertain but the general sense of public renown is clear.

The passage "from 'the prosperous' down to 'he ruled the kingdom in accordance with the Dharma' is as before" is a standard abbreviation formula in Buddhist narrative literature, referring the reader back to an earlier stock description repeated for each king figure in the cycle.

- The proper names Riktrödma, Namdö Gyi, Gyabrak Kyaseng, Langkyong, and Döjok are rendered phonetically from Tibetan as they appear to be narrative proper nouns without clear Sanskrit equivalents or transparent Tibetan meanings that would require translation in this context. Gyabrak Kyaseng literally means something like "grey-brown cliff-dwellers" and could be a proper ethnic or clan name; the rendering preserves it as a name. The passage's final line ends mid-sentence, consistent with the continuity format.

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the passage with the king beginning to quote Namjé's earlier words. This is a mid-sentence interruption in the source and is rendered faithfully here without completion.

The name Ritrömma renders the Tibetan epithet meaning "mountain-wilderness woman," used here as the farmer's wife's name or descriptive title; it is left as a proper name to match the narrative register.

- The name Söpa rendered here as "the recovered one" reflects the Tibetan verb meaning to nurse or restore to health. The narrative device of the king testing various ministers before turning to Söpa follows a recognizable storytelling pattern in classical Indian and Tibetan didactic literature. The phrase rendered "send word to me a second time" is an attempt to render a slightly elliptical construction; the sense is that Söpa should signal the king both before and after bathing or eating so the king can time his visit.
- The phrase rendered as "the king himself arrived" is a colloquial narrative transition; the text has Söpa calling the king "lha" (Your Majesty, literally "lord/deity"), used throughout as a royal honorific, which the preceding translation also renders as "Your Majesty."

The exchange about the needle and the water jar is a folk riddle demonstrating paradoxical skill: stopping a leak with a wet needle is said to be the wonder, because the wetness seals it, whereas a dry needle merely pierces. This is a recognizable motif in South Asian narrative literature, signaling that the children possess unusual healing or magical powers — specifically, the ability to heal wounds — which Söpa perceives.

The line "that father-in-law of yours has been extremely contemptuous toward me" presents a slight syntactic ambiguity: it could be Söpa speaking of his own father-in-law's contempt toward himself, or referencing the king's treatment. The rendering follows the most natural reading given the narrative context.

- The name rendered "Rāpana (Raudra-prabhā)" in the preceding passage appears here as རྩམ་པ་ལྔ་པ་ལྔ་པ་, a compound meaning "Fierce Brilliant-Light," which is a Tibetan rendering of a Sanskrit name; Raudra-prabhā is a reasonable reconstruction. The preceding English passage used "Söpa" for what appears to be a different character (the one who witnesses the needle incident); consistency with prior rendering is maintained where possible, but the identity of "Söpa" versus the patient (པོ་ལོ་ལྔ་པ་) should be noted: རྩམ་པ་ in this passage is clearly "the patient," a distinct figure being tended by the king, not the same as Söpa who appeared earlier as an observer. This may be a point of narrative complexity worth checking against the broader text.

The phrase rendered "filth steeped in excrement" (汚穢に糞を染み透した) is somewhat unusual; 山残り could mean "mountain-remainder" or scraps, but in context it most plausibly means a mass of filth, and "filth steeped in excrement" captures the sense adequately.

The place name 𑀘𑀓𑁆𑀭𑀺𑀢𑀺𑀤𑀲𑀸 is uncertain; "Campājika" is a tentative reconstruction.

- The episode of the queen's name, Śāntā, meaning "the Peaceful One" or "the Tranquil One," is consistent with the preceding context and is rendered as a proper name throughout. The phrase rendered "his bowels gave way" translates a Tibetan expression for defecation triggered by the exertion of pulling out the iron peg — the text is deliberately earthy, and the rendering preserves that register without amplification. The brahmin's observation that the dreadful portent has "passed" (literally, "separated from the god") functions as comic dramatic irony: what he interprets as a celestial sign clearing has in fact corresponded to the king's very literal bodily crisis and escape.
- The term rendered "grey-robed forest ascetics" translates "skya bseng pa," which designates wandering śramaṇas or ascetics in grey or ochre robes — almost certainly non-Buddhist renouncers in context. The phrase is consistent with this narrative's repeated contrast between brahminical court culture and wandering mendicants.

The maidservant's name "Kyedma" is a personal name rendered phonetically from the Tibetan; no Sanskrit equivalent is recoverable from context.

- The term rendered "head-tax" for 𑀘𑀓𑀭𑀺𑀓𑀲𑀺𑀢𑀺𑀓 reflects a tribute levied on persons rather than land; the precise administrative meaning in the narrative context is somewhat obscure, but the general sense of a personal levy accompanying the tribute (𑀘𑀓𑀭𑀺𑀓𑀲𑀺𑀢𑀺𑀓) is clear. The episode belongs to a well-known Vinaya narrative illustrating feminine wiles; the figure named Tārā here is an ordinary woman, not the goddess Tārā. The word 𑀘𑀓𑀭𑀺𑀓𑀲𑀺𑀢𑀺𑀓 consistently means "physician" or "healer" throughout this passage and is so rendered. The shuttlecock episode (𑀘𑀓𑀭𑀺𑀓𑀲𑀺𑀢𑀺𑀓) is a traditional narrative motif for seduction.
- Āryarāja is a rendering of 𑀘𑀓𑀭𑀺𑀓𑀲𑀺𑀢𑀺𑀓, which here appears to function as a place name or city name rather than a royal title. The text is consistent with this being a proper noun for a locality.

The name Pracandarabha renders प्राचण्डराज, a royal name meaning something like "Fiercely Brilliant King"; it has been carried over from the preceding passage as established.

The cypress twig episode involves a crude sexual-humiliation trick; the translation renders it faithfully without euphemism, following the Vinaya narrative style.

- [illegible]

The phrase rendered "royally consecrated king of the warrior caste" reflects the Tibetan reference to the king anointed (འཕམ་པའི་རྒྱལ་པོ་) from among the royal class (འཕམ་པའི་རྒྱལ་པོ་), i.e., the ksatriya lineage.

The name "Rabsang" (རབ་སངས་) is left as a Tibetan proper name; it may represent a Tibetan coinage rather than a translation of a known Sanskrit royal name.

- The epithet "Tumpo Rabsang" rendered consistently with the preceding passage. The phrase translated as "the gray-robed ascetic" renders *skya bseng*, literally "gray/ash-clothed mendicant," likely indicating a non-Buddhist wandering ascetic; the rendering follows the contextual register throughout.
- The name rendered "Gosā" throughout corresponds to Tibetan "གོས་གྲོ་མ་" in this passage, which appears to be a proper name in context rather than the past-tense verb "revived." This reading is consistent with the preceding narrative where a counselor or general figure is addressed. The ring inscription episode, and the identification of "གོས་གྲོ་མ་" as a named official rather than a verbal form, is a genuine interpretive point worth flagging.
- The term rendered "guards" throughout for གཙོ་མ་ལྟོ་ is a contextually driven choice: in this narrative the གཙོ་མ་ལྟོ་ (literally "the one who fed" or "the keeper") appears to function as a royal officer or chamberlain assigned to keep watch; the translation treats them collectively as guards or the guard-keeper in accordance with the dramatic situation.

The phrase यन्त्रकला (yantra-kala) (yantra-craft or the art of mechanical automata) refers to the classical Indian tradition of constructing mechanical devices or automata, well attested in Sanskrit literature; "automaton" is chosen as the closest natural English equivalent.

- The name Damburi Mountain renders the Tibetan Damburi Ri, the proper name of the elephant chief used consistently in the preceding passages. Tumpo Rabnang is likewise carried over from prior context as the name of the king of the noble realm. The phrase rendered "critical distance" translates sa tshigs das par gyur pa, literally "when a certain fixed point or interval had been passed," indicating a pre-arranged distance beyond which pursuit would be futile; this is the most consequential interpretive choice in the passage.
- The names Norha Jin (nor lha'i byin, "Gift of the Wealth-God"), Rab Nang (rab tu snang, "Greatly Radiant"), Jungwa Chang (sbyor ba 'chang, "Bearer of Method / Schemes"), and Sertrengchen (gser phreng can, "She of the Golden Garland") are rendered in phonetic approximation as character names in a narrative context; their literal meanings are transparent in Tibetan but function as proper names here. The epithet "old woman" at the end is Jungwa Chang's sister still in her wanderer disguise, addressing the disguised prince — the shift is intentional in the source.
- The names in this passage are rendered from a mix of Sanskrit originals and Tibetan translations. "Nora Lhé Jin" is a Tibetan rendering of the Sanskrit Dattā (meaning "given by the god of wealth," i.e., Dhanadattā or similar); I have supplied the Sanskrit "Dattā" for clarity. "Suvarṇamālā" (Golden Garland One) translates the Tibetan epithet gsep phreñ can. "Vasantī" (Spring One) translates dpyid ldan. King Caṇḍapradya renders gtum po rab snañ, a well-known king of Kauśāmbī in Vinaya narrative literature. The phrase rendered "sacred food" and "libation" involves deliberate comic absurdity: the madwoman claims elephant dung and urine are royal offerings, which the grooms dismiss as insanity — the humor is integral to the narrative's plot of escape. The fascicle and chapter headings in the middle of the passage are scribal colophon insertions marking a text division; I have rendered them plainly in the translation.
- The song sung by Holder-of-the-Bow is metrically structured in the original and is rendered here as verse accordingly. The names throughout — Śarva, Holder-of-the-Bow (Skt. Dharmadhara or similar), Golden-Garland (Skt. Suvarṇamālā), Bhadravatī, Dhanavardhana, Pradyota — are kept consistent with the preceding passage. The epithet translated as "the

noble realm" renders 'phags rgyal, which may refer to Magadha or a realm of noble status; the precise identification is contextually uncertain but does not affect the narrative sense.

- The song's four lines present some compression. The line rendered "Vaiśravaṇa's steward drove him on" refers to Pradyota being driven like a draft animal; "the steward of Vaiśravaṇa" is an epithet playing on the name Dhanavardhana, who is elsewhere identified with the yakṣa treasurer figure. The line "Earth and forest soared into the sky" is a riddle-kenning for the palanquin carrying Pradyota. These are intentional riddles sung by the bystanders, and the opacity is original to the text.

The phrase rendered "the god Dhanavardhana has given this" reflects a deliberate fiction Śarva orders to be maintained: that Pradyota's arrival was a divine gift rather than a kidnapping, to protect the political secret.

- The passage describes Dhanavardhana's elaborate plot to fulfill — or appear to fulfill — the queen's vow while engineering the death of King Śarva's son. The queen's vow involves a seven-day fast and a ritual wrapping in flower garlands followed by being seated at the enclosure gate; Dhanavardhana exploits this vow as the mechanism for throwing the prince from the enclosure wall. The identity of "the god" in the queen's speech refers to the captive king, using the honorific "lha" as a form of royal address, not to a divine being. This dual usage of "lha" — both as the deity Dhanavardhana's name-element and as a royal honorific in the queen's speech — is a notable feature of the passage; the translation renders each instance according to context.

- The closing epithet applied to the new king renders three Tibetan terms together: "fierce" (gtum po), "supremely radiant" (rab snang), and "without rival" (gran zla med pa). These appear to be epithets embedded in or functioning as a proper name or a descriptive title for the successor king; the text does not give a separate personal name here, so they are rendered as descriptive epithets.

- The name rendered "Rabhasa Prabhā" corresponds to the Tibetan "འཇམ་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་" (fierce, supremely radiant), which is the king introduced at the end of the preceding passage. This is the same king described there as fierce and radiant as the sun.

The name "Lotus-Hearted" renders "ལོ་ཏུ་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་" (one who has a lotus heart/core), which appears to be a personal name or epithet of the king's antagonist.

"Āryā" renders "འཕྲུལ་ལྷ་མོ་," a term for the noble realm or country; this may be a place name requiring identification from the broader textual context.

"Dambha" renders "དམ་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་," treated here as a proper name for the elephant.

The final sentence is cut off mid-passage in the source text; the translation ends accordingly.

- The phrase rendered "the land of setting-down-stones" translates the toponym that has been consistently used in the preceding context for Balaṅkya's destination; it is a proper place-name in this narrative, not a descriptive phrase, but the Tibetan is rendered literally as no Sanskrit or standard equivalent is established in the passage.

The minister's remarks to the potter and the dung beetle are deliberately ambiguous, each capable of being heard as a general moral maxim or as a pointed personal jibe at the king — which is precisely the dramatic irony the text exploits. The translation preserves this ambiguity.

- The term rendered as "god" throughout this passage is an honorific form of address from the minister to the king, a standard idiom of Indian courtly speech in which a king is addressed as "divine majesty" or simply "god." It is not a reference to a deity.

The phrase rendered "unfired pottery vessels" (འཕྲུལ་ལྷ་མོ་) refers to raw, sun-dried but not yet kiln-fired pots, which are fragile; this detail is essential to the meaning of the minister's first

explanation.

- The passage presents several interpretive challenges. The term translated throughout as "spy-women" or "eavesdroppers" (Tibetan: phra men ma) refers to female spies or informants — possibly also understood as demonesses or she-demons (srin mo) in the proclamation at the close, which conflates the two groups deliberately in the ruse. The final line's proclamation invokes "the pledge of the mother of the gods" (lha ni ma'i dam tshig) as the authoritative summons, a ritual fiction designed to gather the targets together. The text breaks off mid-sentence at "And they thought," indicating the passage continues beyond the excerpt provided.
- The phrase rendered "those who lived by the chopper's trade" translates a term literally meaning "those who live by the chopper or cleaver," that is, butchers or slaughtermen, here serving as executioners — the point being that the king employed men already habituated to killing for this mass beheading.

The six opening syllables of the dream-verses are given as a mnemonic device in the text: each monosyllabic word is the first syllable of the corresponding verse. The verses appear to be laments spoken by the slain brahmins — now recognizing in the dream-speech of the dead that they have been cast into hell as a consequence of their previous evil deeds as she-demons. This doctrinal interpretation should be understood in the context of the narrative.

- The six verses keyed to the six sky-sounds form an embedded literary structure; each verse is introduced by its opening syllable or word, which serves as a mnemonic heading. The translation preserves this structure while making it natural for listening.

The phrase rendered "five finest limbs nourished there" translates a term literally meaning "the five best limbs fattened/nourished," which in the context of blood-sacrifice likely refers to five prime sacrificial victims selected and prepared. The exact referent is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, which is reflected in the translation.

- The six earth-sounds and six sky-sounds function as acrostics: each word names the opening syllable of the verse that follows. This is a recognized literary device in Indian narrative and the Tibetan text signals it explicitly. The rendering preserves the acrostic frame by heading each verse with its key word.

The name Kātyāyanī's son refers to Mahākātyāyana, one of the principal disciples of the Buddha, renowned for his skill in doctrinal exposition. The cow's counsel to seek him out is a pivot in the narrative.

- The term rendered "otters" translates a Tibetan word that can refer to otters or similar water-dwelling creatures; the precise species is contextually uncertain but "otter" is the standard identification in Vinaya commentarial literature.
- The mountain name "Tumldän" renders the Tibetan Ri bo Gtum ldan. The literal meaning is something like "the mountain possessing fierceness," but as it functions as a proper place name in context it is left in transliterated form rather than translated. If a conventional Sanskrit or standard English rendering exists in the source text's tradition it has not been preserved here.

The phrase rendered "procures even a single eye's worth" is genuinely difficult. The Tibetan reads mig ya gcig kyang 'jor byed pa, literally "one who acquires even a single eye." In context the crow appears to be saying that even someone who takes so little as a single egg or morsel — or, alternatively, one who profits by a single eye's amount through dishonest means — has caused her loss. The intended sense within the verse is that the horse-keeper's destructive act, however small it might seem, ultimately freed her (and her young) from some form of

suffering, perhaps meaning that death ended their distress. The doctrinal or narrative logic here is somewhat opaque and may reflect a variant reading.

• The place-names Yavana, Siṃhala, Vaṅgāla, and Kāliṅga are left in approximate Sanskrit equivalents as they appear in the text and denote, respectively, the Greek or western lands, Sri Lanka, Bengal, and the Kāliṅga region of eastern India. The Tibetan for Vaṅgāla is rendered as such rather than "Bengal" to preserve the proper-name register of the passage.

The phrase rendered "a different person in the funeral litter" follows the context established in the preceding passage about the litter-bearer; the Tibetan *gdung ma yang gzhan zhig bcug* literally means "he also put another person in the *gdung ma*," where *gdung ma* refers to the funeral or carrying litter referenced earlier.

The phrase *skya bseng gi bu mo* is rendered "daughter of the śramaṇa woman" literally; it could also mean "daughter of a poor woman" or "daughter of a mendicant woman." The context does not fully resolve this.

- The passage distinguishes between the Blessed One's "worldly thought" and his "supramundane thought" — a doctrinal point about the range of the buddha's cognition: his ordinary operational awareness is perceptible even to insects, whereas his transcendent awareness is beyond the reach of even śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. This is a standard teaching on the incomprehensibility of a buddha's highest gnosis.

The term rendered "Śivā" for Gopālā's mother comes from the preceding context where "Gopālā's mother, Śivā" appears; here the Tibetan has only "Gopālā's mother, Śivā," consistent with the preceding passage rendering.

The term **ਮਾਹੇ** (mahe) is a loanword for the water buffalo (Skt. mahiṣa), rendered accordingly.

- The epithet rendered "Bimbisāra, the artisan-king of Rājagṛha" translates a Tibetan phrase meaning literally "the artisan-skilled, form-possessing essence of Rājagṛha," which appears to be a circumlocution identifying Bimbisāra as a patron of fine craftsmanship. The Tibetan name རྩམ་པ་ལྷན་པོའི་རྩམ་པ་ལྷན་པོ་ is unusual and may be a descriptive epithet rather than the king's proper name; the identification with Bimbisāra rests on context (king of Rājagṛha, first to offer cooked food to the Saṅgha), which is a well-attested distinction of Bimbisāra in the tradition.

The name Supriya (सुप्रिया) for the householder of Vārāṇasī follows the probable Sanskrit reconstruction; the Tibetan literally means "possessing excellence/goodness."

• The creature called "thī-ba" is a small bird (likely a wren or similar passerine) whose Tibetan name lacks a clean English equivalent. Rather than invent a misleading common name, I have retained "thī-ba" throughout as a proper name for the creature, treating it as the story treats it — as a named narrative character. Listeners familiar with Jātaka literature will recognize the type.

The attendant's speech beginning "Indeed, Your Majesty, I sought her out and killed her" is a continuation of his ruse from the preceding passage: he has not actually killed Śāntā but hidden her, and he now speaks deceptively to the king before telling the parable to cool the king's fury. This dramatic irony is clear in context.

- The verse on the "two kinds of blind" hinges on a contrast between those who are physically blind from birth and those who are morally blind through rejecting the Dharma or the law — a standard didactic trope in Buddhist narrative literature. The second set adds those who hold sinful views and those who disregard civil or moral law.

The phrase rendered "plays the go-between" for 信差 is literally "a messenger of a messenger," meaning one who acts as an intermediary courier, here condemned in the context

of carrying illicit communications. The specific nuance of 欺騙 alongside 欺騙 and 欺騙 is that all three involve deceptive or exploitative use of a role of trust; the rendering attempts to capture this social sense.

- The final two lines are the opening of a summary verse that breaks off mid-passage; they are translated as they stand without completion.

The verse about the net plays on a sustained pun in the Tibetan: the word rendered as "net" also carries the sense of "by means of" or "through connections," creating a deliberate double meaning that the original exploits in each line. The translation attempts to preserve this where possible.

The line about the wrestler's son is rendered as "for one who is to slay, there is always the means to do it without fail," reflecting the sense that a trained killer naturally finds a way; the exact force of the final line is slightly compressed in the Tibetan and this reading is the most defensible.

- The verse on the four kinds of deceivers presents some syntactic ambiguity. The fourth item, "dividing what belongs to the powerful," could alternatively be rendered as "scattering among the powerful" or "dispersing to those of strength," depending on whether the object is what is distributed or to whom it goes. The rendering chosen fits the proverbial pattern of futile or absurd actions best.

The summary verse near the middle of the passage appears to be a mnemonic colophon enumerating the topics of the entire dialogue sequence, and its terms are intentionally compressed. "Grief and its attendants" renders a compound that literally means "craving, unconsidered action, grief-class," which fits the list of topics covered by the king's accusations.

- The summary verse near the end is metrically and syntactically compressed; its four paired objects read as a list of things that are paradoxically trustworthy or worth attending to despite their problematic qualities. The precise pairing of each quality with its subject is ambiguous in the Tibetan, and the verse appears to function as a transitional summary of the preceding exchanges rather than a self-contained logical unit. The rendering given here follows the most natural reading of the grammatical structure.

- The summary verse beginning "Sleeplessness, unwished-for things" appears to function as a colophon-like mnemonic enumerating the topics of the section just completed and those to follow; its terse compression makes the precise sequence of referents somewhat ambiguous, but the rendering reflects the most natural reading. The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the attendant's explanation of the nine torments, corresponding to the Tibetan text ending mid-construction.

- The passage's threefold repetition of the nine-things formula appears to present three distinct psychological cases that are structurally parallel but doctrinally distinct. The second and third iterations appear to reverse the relational valence between the two parties involved, which produces some interpretive difficulty in the Tibetan. The rendering follows the most natural reading of the syntax as it stands.

The list of "ten without compassion" is a standard folk-ethical enumeration found in Vinaya-adjacent narrative literature; the rendering of each occupation follows established parallels in similar canonical lists.

The phrase rendered "fallow ground" for 𐎧𐎠𐎧𐎡 is somewhat uncertain; it may refer specifically to land that has been cultivated but left barren, and the explanation of why it "turns things away" is contained in the portion of text yet to be translated.

- The phrase rendered "tamer of persons to be tamed, a charioteer, unsurpassed" reflects a standard epithet cluster for a buddha: one who tames those to be tamed and is the supreme

charioteer or guide. The Tibetan here runs several epithets together without fully separating them, but they correspond to standard Sanskrit formulae found throughout the Vinaya and sūtra literature.

The expression "station of the finest bull of the herd" translates a standard epithet of the Buddha as foremost among beings, corresponding to Sanskrit *vr̥sabha*sthāna or similar.

• The Tibetan term rendered as "the path that leads everywhere" is "kun du 'gro ba'i lam," which in the parallel Sanskrit lists of the ten powers corresponds to "sarvatragāminīṃ pratipadaṃ," the path leading to all destinations or the path to all rebirths. The rendering "the path that leads everywhere" preserves both the literal meaning and the technical doctrinal sense of knowing which karma leads to which realm of rebirth.

The passage ends mid-sentence as the Tibetan source text itself is cut off at that point.

- The phrase rendered "having taken up actions and dharmas rooted in wrong view" (and its positive parallel) reflects a formulaic Pali-Tibetan locution meaning that these persons have adopted a course of conduct fully consonant with wrong or right view respectively. The term "dharmas" here means doctrines or principles (the things one upholds), not phenomena in a philosophical sense.

The name "Gośa" (Tibetan: གོས་པ་, literally "one who nourishes" or possibly a proper name transcription) appears here as the character who leads the cow-herder's mother to the king; the Tibetan is ambiguous as to whether this is a proper name or a descriptive epithet. The reading as a proper name is adopted here as contextually more natural, but a note on this is warranted.

- The name Kanyākubja rendered from the Tibetan transliteration "ka nyā kub dza" — this is the city in northern India also known as Kanauj, and its appearance here as a gift from the king is consistent with the narrative's royal setting. The summary verse is a mnemonic colophon listing characters from the preceding story cycle; its terseness is intentional and the rendering is accordingly spare. The phrase rendered "the way of the Dharma of permanence" reflects the Tibetan "rtag chos kyi tshul," where "rtag" may mean "eternal" or "constant" in the sense of the Dharma's abiding character — the point is that the Dharma's way endures and is to be followed continually.

- The phrase rendered "as a way of testing them" translates brtag pa'i bśam pas, literally "with a mind of examination or testing." The contrast between this wording in the Blessed One's speech and the slightly different phrasing bgam pa'i bśam pas, "with a mind of deceiving or entrapping them," in Ānanda's retelling to the monks is noteworthy and may reflect a deliberate distinction in the Tibetan: the Blessed One frames it neutrally as a test, while Ānanda characterizes the householder's intent as more adversarial. Both renderings follow the text as given.

- The passage moves between two distinct narrative episodes without a marked break: the Vaiśālī episode concludes with the Vinaya ruling on precious vessels, and a new episode then opens in Śrāvastī. This abrupt transition is in the original and is not a translation error.

The phrase rendered "knowing moderation" translates a term meaning awareness of measure or restraint in eating and receiving, a standard Vinaya virtue; the context confirms this reading.

• The name Prabhāvatī is a Sanskrit reconstruction of the Tibetan འོད་བསྟན་མཁའ་ལྷོ་མ་ (od bzang ma), meaning "she who is radiant with fine light." The text's own folk etymology connects it to the blazing of the house at birth. The rendering "Radiant with Light" reflects the Tibetan form; the Sanskrit Prabhāvatī is the standard equivalent found in parallel Sanskrit recensions.

The phrase "sages who had renounced attachment by the ordinary worldly path" renders the Tibetan རྒྱུ་གཞི་སྤོང་བའི་རྣམས་ཀྱི་ཐུགས་དཔྱད་ཀྱི་ཡེ་ཤེས་ཀྱི་ཁྲིམས་ཀྱི་ཕྱོད་ཀྱི་ལུས་ཀྱི་ལྷན་པོ་ཆེན་པོ་།, referring to non-Buddhist

ascetics or worldly meditators who have suppressed but not eradicated desire through mundane meditative paths — a standard doctrinal distinction.

- The epithet "Wife-killer" renders the Tibetan "chung ma gsod pa," literally "killer of wives," which functions as a stigmatizing nickname in the narrative. The rendering "fined and penalized" for "dp̣ya bar 'gyur ba'i las" reflects a probable legal or social penalty associated with the repeated deaths of his wives; the precise nature of this penalty is not specified in the text.
- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end, mid-enumeration of the body parts Śrī-prabhā is mentally cataloguing. This is a continuation passage and the list is clearly unfinished at the manuscript break point; the translation renders exactly what is present.

The phrase rendered "the keys and the crooked keys" reflects a distinction in the Tibetan between two types of keys; the precise technical difference is unclear from the text alone, but both terms appear to denote household keys of different kinds, symbolizing Śrī-prabhā's installation as household mistress.

- The phrase "the fire of attachment at the tenth ground" is doctrinally striking: it says the fire of desire characteristic of beings at the tenth bodhisattva ground arose in her, which is an unusual formulation. In context it likely means an intensity of desire surpassing even the highest level — a hyperbolic expression indicating overwhelming passion rather than a technical claim that she was a tenth-ground bodhisattva. This is worth flagging as a doctrinal curiosity.

The closing phrase rendered as "what abided near her like a weapon's thrust" translates a term literally meaning "that which was present like a dagger" or "ready at hand like a weapon." The exact idiomatic force of this final clause is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan and likely signals that her karmic fruits were ripe and unavoidable — the image of a weapon poised to strike conveying inevitability.

- The verse "Even across hundreds of aeons..." is a well-known canonical gāthā that appears in several Vinaya and Āgama sources; it is here rendered as verse consistent with its formulaic status.

The epithet translated as "Grove of Sages Who Speak Truth" renders a Tibetan gloss of the standard Isipatana (Pāli) or Ṛṣivadana (Sanskrit), the deer park at Vārāṇasī. The Tibetan phrase here is a semantic rendering rather than the usual transliteration.

The phrase rendered "maternal uncles" (Tibetan zhangpo) is a specific kinship term; it may refer more broadly to senior male relatives on the mother's side. The precise social relationship is not entirely clear from context, but "maternal uncles" is the most natural reading.

- The name rendered as "Sudarśanā" continues from the preceding passage. The Tibetan "འདོད་ལྡན་མཆོག་" (literally "the good/beautiful one") is used throughout as her name or epithet; it corresponds to Sudarśanā established in the prior context, and is here rendered consistently as such.

The wife's name "ཀློང་ལྷ་མོ་མཚོ་ལོ་ཤོ་མོ་" literally means "she of beautiful light" and is here rendered as "Prabhāvatī" with the Tibetan gloss provided in parentheses for listener clarity, as this is her first named introduction.

The phrase "teaches the Dharma by body, not by word" is a standard formula for pratyekabuddhas in canonical Vinaya narrative literature, indicating they demonstrate the Dharma through miraculous displays rather than verbal exposition.

- The phrase rendered as "dangerous and treacherous resting place" translates 多害多難之休息處, literally "a resting place with many harmful things," which in the Vinaya context refers to a place of moral and physical danger, particularly where improper

conduct could occur or be alleged. The term 危险 is broader than "dangerous" alone, encompassing malice, harm, and treachery.

The disease name རྩལ་ལྷན་ ("the fruit of wrong food and conduct") is a Tibetan rendering of a condition associated with dietary or behavioral impropriety; the precise Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain in this context.

- The proper name rendered "Viśākhā" appears in the Tibetan as "ཁོ་སྐྱོད་ཀླུ་མཚན་ལྷ་མོ།," which is an unusual formulation; the identification with Viśākhā (a famous lay devotee at Śrāvastī) is plausible from context and parallel Vinaya accounts, though the Tibetan phrase is not a standard rendering of that name. Similarly, "ཁོ་སྐྱོད་ཀླུ་མཚན་ལྷ་མོ།" is rendered as "the brahmin ascetic Dīrghanakha," which is a conjecture based on context; the Tibetan may refer to a different figure. The name "ཁོ་སྐྱོད་ཀླུ་མཚན་ལྷ་མོ།" is rendered as "the mother of Mṛgārā," following the well-known identification of Viśākhā as "Mṛgāramātā," though the Tibetan phrasing suggests this may be a distinct person listed alongside her.
- The passage about "those with black bowls" is an idiomatic reference to non-Buddhist wanderers who carried black begging bowls, distinguishing them from Buddhist monks. The Venerable Ānanda worries this green-haired being might fall into their hands rather than be properly ordained in the Dharma. This is a standard narrative motif in Vinaya literature.

The phrase rendered "deer do not feed deer" is a proverbial expression meaning that fellow monastics are not obliged to support one another materially; each monk must sustain himself through his own alms-round.

The "Group of Six monks" are a notorious group repeatedly referenced in Vinaya literature as exemplars of misconduct, whose bad behavior prompts the Buddha to establish new rules of discipline.

- The verse catalogue of physical disqualifications for ordination is a standard Vinaya list; the renderings of anatomical and pathological terms follow the most defensible readings, though several Tibetan terms for specific conditions (notably སྐྱུ་མེད་, སྐྱུ་མེད་པ་, སྐྱུ་མེད་པ་ལྟ་བུ་, སྐྱུ་མེད་པ་ལྟ་བུ་, སྐྱུ་མེད་པ་, སྐྱུ་མེད་པ་) admit some latitude in precise medical identification. The rendering of སྐྱུ་མེད་པ་ལྟ་བུ་ as "the fourth colour" reflects the Vinaya tradition of four recognized skin tones, with the fourth being an inauspicious or aberrant hue; this is left deliberately literal as the precise referent is a matter of commentarial tradition. The passage ends mid-sentence, as the source text breaks off.
- The passage contains a Vinaya narrative in mixed verse and prose typical of the Mūlasarvāstivāda Vinaya. The term rendered "kept woman" translates སྐྱུ་མེད་པ་, meaning a woman maintained as a concubine or ward; "pledged woman" translates སྐྱུ་མེད་པ་, a woman given as a surety or pledge. The term སྐྱུ་མེད་པ་ rendered "a mountain of worms" in the summary verse is cryptic and likely refers to a case-narrative heading in the original compendium; its precise referent is uncertain. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, so the translation ends correspondingly.
- The six teachers named here are the classical "six heterodox teachers" (Skt. ṣaṭ śāstāraḥ) of the Pāli and Sanskrit Buddhist tradition: Pūraṇa Kāśyapa, Maskarin Gośāla (here "son of the dark-roaming god Kāla" renders སྐྱུ་མེད་པ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་, a somewhat literal Tibetan rendering of Maskarin Gośāla's name and epithet), Sañjaya Vairatīputra (སྐྱུ་མེད་པ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་), Ajita Keśakambala (འཇིཌ་ཀེ་སྐྱུ་མེད་པ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་), Kakuda Kātyāyana (ཀཀུ་ཀཱཏཿཡཱེཎ་), and Nirgrantha Jñātaputra (འཇིཌ་ཀེ་སྐྱུ་མེད་པ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་, rendered as "Nirgrantha's son" — Nirgrantha Jñātaputra, i.e., Mahāvīra). The Tibetan epithets are literal translations of the names as found in Pāli and Sanskrit sources.
- The epithet "Bimbisāra the artisan — Śreṇya" renders the Tibetan "bzo sbyaṅs gzugs can sñiṅ po," which is a Tibetan transcription-rendering of the king's name and epithets. "Gzugs can sñiṅ

po" is Bimbisāra and "bzo sbyaṅs" corresponds to Śreṇya or Seniya, a well-known epithet of the Magadhan king; some editions differ in the ordering.

The phrase rendered "the Nirgrantha's son" at the opening corresponds to the series of six non-Buddhist teachers being impersonated; this continues the list from the preceding passage. The Tibetan reads "gcer bu pa gñen gyi bu," meaning the son of the Nirgrantha (i.e., the naked ascetic Nigaṇṭha Nātaputta's tradition), consistent with the continuation of the earlier list.

- The term rendered "bystander" or "one who stands apart" for བཞེས་པ་ translates a Tibetan expression meaning something like "one who watches from the sidelines" or "an uninvolved onlooker" — the implication being that Prasenajit, unlike the partisan Bimbisāra, might be a more neutral or susceptible audience for their challenge. The precise nuance is contextually inferred.

- The phrase rendered "confess wrongdoing and be purified of it" translates a terse construction meaning literally "accumulate evil deeds and then acknowledge them" — the classical idiom for formal confession leading to purification, which is the standard doctrinal sense here.

The "empowerment as regents" renders a phrase in which hearers who have accumulated wholesome roots are given a kind of authorization or investiture to act as stand-ins or deputies of the buddha; this is a specific technical concept within the sūtra's own framing and the rendering follows the literal sense while preserving the doctrinal strangeness.

"Kuśa" as the city name is what the Tibetan spells; this may correspond to another city name in a Sanskrit Vorlage, but the Tibetan is consistent and is rendered as given.

- The name "Nagnaja" is a reconstructed Sanskrit equivalent of the Tibetan "na gu" (likely ལ་གུ་), which may mean "the naked-born" or similar. The Tibetan is not entirely transparent here and the exact identity of this prince is uncertain.

The phrase rendered "the great lake Anavatapta" corresponds to འཇམ་དཔལ་མཚོ་, a legendary lake in the Himalayas associated in Buddhist cosmology with cool, pure waters and inhabited by the nāga king Anavatapta. The compound "Anavatapta" is not spelled out in Tibetan but is the standard Sanskrit identification.

- The passage contains a formal "truth declaration" or act of truth, a well-attested Indian literary and religious device in which a solemn assertion of a known truth is held to have miraculous efficacy. The Tibetan term rendered here as "truth declaration" is bden pa'i tshig, literally "words of truth." The Blessed One's injunction constitutes a hierarchical enumeration of the Three Jewels and their respective supremacies as the content of the declaration. The phrase rendered "the noble Vinaya in which the noble ones delight" translates 'phags pa dgyes pa'i tshul khirms, a slightly unusual formulation; it refers to the monastic code as cherished or rejoiced in by the noble ones, functioning here as the supreme among those who abide in ethical conduct.

- The name of the grove formed from the prince's story presents a minor textual-etymological point. The Tibetan reads "Khaṇḍa-Ānandavana" — a grove named after the episode of the scattered and rejoined limbs, rendered here as "Grove of Rejoining" to make the origin of the name clear to a listening audience. The name is given twice in the Tibetan, likely a scribal repetition.

The stone or gem rendered "andara crystal" is uncertain; it appears to be a transliteration of a Sanskrit gem-name not easily identified; this rendering is provisional.

- The passage identifies the one who conjures the mango tree as "Cullapanthaka of the Jeta Grove" — the Tibetan reads "dum bu'i kun dga' ra ba pa," literally "the one of the joyful grove of the grove." This is a somewhat compressed epithet; the figure is likely Cullapanthaka

(Cūḍapanthaka), a disciple associated with the Jeta Grove, though the precise referent of this name-form in the Tibetan merits verification against the Sanskrit or Chinese parallel. The householder rendered as Anāthapiṇḍika corresponds to the Tibetan "ngan legs sbyin," which is a standard Tibetan rendering of that name.

- The names Vimalā, Yārtsulma, Jyin, Nyingpa, and Migdak Dré'i Masa are Tibetan phonetic renderings of Indian names that are difficult to identify with certainty from the Tibetan alone; they are rendered here as transliterations of their Tibetan forms. Anāthapiṇḍada is the standard Sanskrit restoration of the householder whose name literally means "giver of food to the destitute," well attested in the sources.

The kurandaka and kunda are flowering plants and the campaka a fragrant tree, all well known in Sanskrit literary and Buddhist contexts as symbols of beauty and purity.

The final sentence of the passage is syntactically incomplete in the source, ending in a list of qualifiers without a main verb; the translation renders it accordingly, leaving it open as the passage does.

- The phrase "the fifth part of the wheel of saṃsāra — its moving and its still" renders a condensed technical expression referring to the five constituents or sections of saṃsāric existence, described through the pair of moving and unmoving phenomena. The precise doctrinal referent is somewhat unusual and may reflect a specific Vinaya or Abhidharma enumeration that the commentarial tradition would clarify; the rendering follows the literal Tibetan closely. The laywoman's name is left in transliterated Tibetan as it appears in the source; a Sanskrit equivalent is not established from context alone.
- The names of the novice monk and novice nun rendered here are Kulabhadra and Amogha, the expected Sanskrit behind the Tibetan ཀུལ་བཟ་བུ་ and འམོག་མ་ལུ་ respectively. The exact Sanskrit equivalents of these two minor figures' names involve some uncertainty, as the Tibetan renderings are functional epithets rather than straightforward phonetic transcriptions. This is noted but does not affect the doctrinal content.
- The phrase rendered "the thirty-second fascicle of the Minor Bases of Discipline" is a section colophon within the Vinaya text (Kṣudrakavastu) marking the end of a bam-po (fascicle) division; it interrupts the narrative but is part of the canonical text as preserved and is therefore included.

The "twin miracle" (Tibetan: zung gi cho 'phrul) is the classical Buddhist miracle in which fire and water issue simultaneously from different parts of the body, traditionally associated with the Śrāvastī miracle of the Buddha. The fourfold deportment display within the sky (walking, standing, sitting, lying) preceding the twin miracle is also a standard element of this narrative.

The word rendered "worldly intention" versus "supramundane intention" translates 'jig rten pa'i thugs bskyed pa and 'jig rten las 'das pa'i thugs bskyed pa respectively. The doctrinal point is that a buddha's ordinary or accessible mental acts can be perceived even by insects through the buddha's mind-radiance, whereas his transcendent, supramundane cognitive acts surpass even the comprehension of arhats.

- The verse rendering "logicians" for རྒྱུ་མཁེད་པ་ translates a term meaning those who rely on logical reasoning or speculation, often used to refer to Brahmanical or non-Buddhist dialecticians, whose intellectual light is shown to be eclipsed by the Buddha's appearance — a classic polemical image.

The phrase རྒྱུ་མཁེད་པ་ལྟར་གྱི་འཇམ་མཁའ་ལྟར་ translates as "like a great elephant at a house of reeds," which is a standard simile for unstoppable, crushing force — the elephant effortlessly demolishing the fragile dwelling.

- The chain of passing the challenge — Pūraṇa Kassapa to Kṛṣṇadeva's son to Vijayaputra and

so on — follows a well-known sequence of the six non-Buddhist teachers (the ṣaṭ-śāstrīs) of the Buddha's era. The Tibetan names are rendered as close phonetic equivalents of their standard Sanskrit identifications: Pūraṇa Kassapa, Ajita Keśakambala's disciple, Kātyāyanī's son (Pakudha Kaccāyana), and the naked ascetic Nigaṇṭha Nātaputta's disciple. The precise one-to-one mapping in this particular list is slightly irregular compared to the canonical six, so the identifications follow the Tibetan as given rather than forcing a canonical list.

- The term rendered "eunuch" translates མ་འུག་ (ma ning), a person of indeterminate or third gender in Indian classificatory thought; "eunuch" is the traditional Tibetan Buddhist commentarial rendering, though some scholars prefer "hermaphrodite" or "third-gender person." The choice here follows classical usage without interrupting the text.

The verse exchange is a rare dramatic interlude; the identity of the young woman in the second exchange is left ambiguous in the Tibetan, likely a female renunciant or ascetic given her Dharma robe.

- The epithet rendered "King Vaishravana" translates the Tibetan rgyal po rnam thos bu, which is the standard Tibetan for Vaiśravaṇa, one of the four great guardian kings, associated with the north, wealth, and yakṣas. The verse's meaning is essentially: "Such a person deserves to be executed by Vaiśravaṇa's soldiers." The crossbow rendering follows the Tibetan steu ka, a small bow or crossbow used for executing criminals in some Indian and Central Asian traditions.

The phrase "completing vessel" renders rdzogs byed bum pa, a vessel used in a ritual of completion or death — filled with sand and tied around the neck as a means of weighted drowning. This is consistent with the narrative context of mass suicide by drowning.

- The phrase rendered "means of succession" or "means of kingship" translates a term that in context refers to the formal investiture or regency authority granted to a prince or heir — the political mechanism by which a nephew would be made heir apparent or regent. The repeated construction is intentional in the source and has been rendered consistently throughout.

- The name "Rgyal-srid-la-Mngon-par-dga'-ba" is rendered in its full translated form throughout ("Rejoicing-in-the-Royal-Throne") as a story-name whose meaning is plot-significant. The names "Skyed-pa" (the ruling king) and the framing "king beneath the sun" are preserved consistently with the preceding passage. The phrase "king beneath the sun" renders Tibetan "འོ་མ་གྱི་ཕོ་བླ་མོ་" literally; this is a royal title, possibly meaning a subordinate king or a king of a southern realm — the exact geographical or political referent is not certain, but the translation follows the established rendering from the preceding passage. The verse at the close is a gāthā of lament; the third line's "bare ground" renders "འོ་མ་གྱི་ཕོ་བླ་མོ་," literally "on the flat plain of the earth-surface," which in context conveys the contrast between the royal bed and destitute wandering.

- The name "Bzabtung" (spelled bza' btung in Tibetan, literally "food and drink") is a narrative proper name used consistently in this text. It is kept as a phonetic rendering throughout for consistency with the preceding passage's conventions.

The phrase rendered "the lord of men follows the way of his kind" translates mi dbang rigs rjes 'gro ba'i rtags yin no — literally "it is the sign that the sovereign of men goes following his lineage/nature," meaning that even the mightiest of men are subject to the alternation of fortune. This is the young man's philosophical consolation to his mother.

The passage ends mid-sentence with "the king of the five territories reflected —" because the Tibetan breaks off at that point, clearly continuing in the next section.

- The phrase rendered "the one who had rejoiced in royal sovereignty" refers to the king of the five territories mentioned in the preceding passage, who delighted in his kingship and is now said to have died without an heir, extinguishing the royal line. The Tibetan is somewhat elliptical here, but context makes this the only coherent reading.

The idiom "sounding out the mother's own feelings" translates a compressed Tibetan phrase about taking the warmth of the mother's sentiment — a colloquial expression for gauging how someone truly feels before acting.

- The names Bha-tung and Bha-tung Mangpo appear to be transcriptions of indigenous (likely non-Sanskrit, possibly Old Tibetan or regional) names meaning something like "Eater" and "Great Eater" or "Much-Eater." The text itself plays on this etymology when it says the prior name "ceased to exist" in favour of the coronation epithet. I have rendered them as proper names throughout rather than translating the apparent folk-etymology, since the text treats them as names.
- The epithet "Vaiśravaṇa's son" in the verse addressed to Gangpo is puzzling, as Gangpo is a village headman, not Vaiśravaṇa. The Tibetan reads "rnam thos bu," literally "son of Vaiśravaṇa." This may be a form of address meaning something like "dear fortunate one" or could reflect an honorific convention, or it may be a textual peculiarity. It is rendered literally here. The term "ལྟོ་བྱེད་པོ་" is rendered "water-bird" as a general term; "ལྟོ་བྱེད་པོ་" is rendered "crane," and "ལྟོ་བྱེད་པོ་" as "goose," though the precise species identification of these birds is uncertain.
- The phrase rendered "arrow reversed at the brahmin's wife" translates a Tibetan expression of public shaming or mockery whose precise idiomatic force is not entirely recoverable from context alone. It appears to be a taunt directed at the brahmin for his humiliation, possibly invoking a proverbial image; the rendering preserves its function as a cry of ridicule without overstating its literal content.
- The term rendered "flatbread" is dar ba, literally thin or flat cake. The list of foods here differs from the rogue's list in the preceding passage, which is the narrative's point: the brahmin's vomit confirms his account and the rogue's lie. The phrase "buried up to his neck" renders the idiom mgrin pa man chad dong du bcug, literally "placed into the pit from the throat downward." The name Pūrṇakacchana appears to designate both a person (the headman Pūrṇa) and the locality named after him; this double reference is present in the Tibetan and is preserved here.
- The term rendered "hermaphrodite" is ma ning, which in Buddhist canonical literature designates a third-gender category (Sanskrit paṇḍaka or napuṃsaka). The precise meaning is debated in the tradition, but "hermaphrodite" or "person of indeterminate sex" best captures the contextual logic here, namely someone who is neither male nor female and can therefore satisfy the king's impossible condition.

The king is referred to throughout as rgyal po skyed pa, literally "King who begets" or "the procreating king," which is a Tibetan rendering of Ajātaśatru ("unborn enemy"), the well-known king of Magadha. The name is given in its Tibetan descriptive paraphrase rather than transliterated; I have supplied "Ajātaśatru" for clarity at the one point where his identity as king becomes salient.

- The name rendered throughout as "Jīvaka" corresponds to the Tibetan "Gang po," which in this narrative context appears to be Jīvaka the father (the elder physician figure), while "the great physician" (sman chen po) refers to the young Jīvaka, his son. The text consistently distinguishes these two figures, and the translation preserves this distinction. The plant identified as "a-ra-nd-a" (Tibetan transliteration of Sanskrit araṇḍa) is the castor-oil plant (*Ricinus communis*), which is indeed known in Indian botanical and medical literature for producing flowers and fruit within a single year.
- The names Gaṅgapa (gang po, literally "the full one" or a proper name), Pūrṇakaccha, and Prasenajit (rgyal po skyed pa) are rendered from context and standard identification; Prasenajit is the well-known king of Kosala, though the Tibetan here uses an unusual epithet form. Vāsava is an epithet of Indra; "gods of rest" renders ngal bso po, a deity type associated with repose or

comfort, not a fully standard term — the rendering is approximate.

- The verse functions as a colophon-summary listing the episodes of the tale in sequence. The term rendered "cliff-top village" translates a compound meaning literally "a village of cliffs and crags," likely a specific named settlement in the story's geography. The phrase rendered "humiliation" and then reinterpreted as "homage" plays on a deliberate ambiguity in the Tibetan (བཀའ་འཁོར་ཁྱེད་ཀྱི་), meaning something like "putting on a level above," which can read as either demotion/mockery or exaltation depending on context — this wordplay is the pivot of the physician's argument, and is preserved as best the English allows.
- The name rendered as "Karnābhadrā" translates the Tibetan "rna bo che" literally as "great ear" or "large ear," but in context it functions as a personal name. The Sanskrit equivalent Karnābhadrā is a reasonable reconstruction, though the text may simply be using the Tibetan loan-translation of a Sanskrit name; this does not affect the narrative meaning.
- The phrase rendered "the god Indra" translates "lha dbang phyug" which is a Tibetan epithet for Śakra or Indra; this is the first occurrence and is glossed accordingly. The passage about "the brahmin woman" serving is slightly ambiguous in the Tibetan — it could mean the brahmin's wife is to serve the guests, with the observer watching her behavior toward the male brahmin guests; this reading has been adopted as the most contextually coherent one.
- The name rendered "Raṇābadra" represents a Tibetan transcription of a Sanskrit name and is kept in that form for consistency; the orthography of the Tibetan spelling (ར་རྩ་བ་དྭ་བ་) is, however, the ordinary word for "earring," and this has created an intentional wordplay in the narrative — the man's name and the recovered object are both referred to by the same Tibetan term. The translation differentiates them by context: "Raṇābadra" as the person and "earring" as the object. This is a genuine textual ambiguity worth noting.
- The name "Pūrṇakaccha" and "Gaṅgapa" are phonetic renderings from the Tibetan; the Sanskrit forms of the place-name and personal name may vary in other witnesses. The phrase rendered "the king who had engendered the realm" translates རྒྱལ་ཁབ་ཀྱི་འཁོར་ཁྱེད་ཀྱི་, which is slightly ambiguous — it may mean "the king who fathered him" (i.e., the minister's father, the king) or "the king who generated/produced the realm"; context suggests it refers to the reigning king who has been reduced to powerlessness, and "engendered" is used in the sense of one who established or originated his royal line. The passage about "keeping you in the womb" is a striking idiom implying that the minister was raised and sustained by the king precisely for this destined purpose.
- The proper name Skyedpa appears throughout as the king's name and is retained in transliteration as it was established in the preceding passage. The social title rendered "maternal uncle" for the Tibetan term ming po reflects the specific kinship term rather than the more generic "uncle," as the maternal uncle holds a distinct and honored role in Tibetan social structure — the comparison here carries a specific warmth of that relationship. The phrase "fourfold military strength" renders the standard classical Indian and Tibetan military division of forces into elephants, cavalry, chariots, and infantry, though the text does not enumerate them explicitly.
- The name rendered "Mongtul" follows the Tibetan transliteration; the Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain. The term "karavīra" (Tibetan: shing ka ra bī ra) refers to the oleander plant (*Nerium oleander*), whose flowers were used in executions or shaming processions in Indian custom. The passage shifts mid-section into a standard Vinaya colophon marking the thirty-fourth fascicle of the Kṣudraka-vastu, and the narrative then continues without a new heading. The final dialogue about "a king becomes no true friend" is somewhat elliptical in the Tibetan; the Great Minister appears to be explaining to the executioners that his verse was not about the present king personally but about the general truth that kings cannot be relied upon as lasting friends — and that his hearers had missed this meaning.
- The term rendered "candāla" glosses the Tibetan རྒྱལ་ཁབ་ཀྱི་, which denotes the lowest caste

group in the Indian social hierarchy; the text plays on the social stigma attached to this group in its proverb. The phrase རྩལ་ལྷོ་ཁྱེད་ལྷོ་ཁྱེད་ (literally "the noble land of the body") is rendered as "the noble land of Āryāvarta," which is the conventional Sanskrit referent for this Tibetan circumlocution meaning the land of the noble ones or Āryāvarta, the heartland of brahminical India. There is some ambiguity as to whether this is a proper place name or a descriptor; given the brahmin context, Āryāvarta is the most plausible reading.

- The name "Sa-ga" renders the Tibetan sa ga, left untranslated as it functions as a proper name throughout the narrative. It may carry the sense of "earth" or "ground," but the text treats it purely as a personal name.

The phrase rendered "forest of grain" translates zan gyi nags, literally "forest of cooked food" or "forest of provisions." The verse appears to speak in riddle-form, consistent with Sa-ga's character as a girl who speaks in enigmatic verses, so the translation preserves the oblique quality.

The verse "One who wears no woven woolen cloth / who wears unwoven, unspun cloth" likely refers to Sa-ga having removed her clothing and sitting unclad by the pond, described just before — she is "wearing" nothing woven, only unspun skin, so to speak. This is consistent with her testing him with riddles.

- The phrase rendered "the house of the one who causes the body to flourish" translates a technical or idiomatic expression for a physician or perhaps a ritual officiant who oversees a coming-of-age or marital rite; the exact referent is contextually uncertain but most likely a wedding officiant or a physician-host. The barley and deer-skin episode is part of an elaborate comic-didactic folk narrative involving double entendre; the translation preserves the surface level of the literal text without suppressing the evident allegorical undercurrent, which is standard for this genre. The phrase "tucked the full measure of barley into the hem of his garment" renders a carrying gesture implied by the Tibetan. The identity of the new brahmin who arrives from another village and the brahmin woman appear to form a subplot; the narrative shifts of subject are somewhat compressed in the Tibetan and have been resolved as clearly as the grammar allows.

- The name "Sāgā" is a transliteration of the Tibetan "སྐྱམ་མེད་," which functions here as a proper name. Its identity and etymology within the larger narrative are unclear from this passage alone, but it has been rendered consistently as a proper name throughout.

The verse passage presents a slightly condensed legal idiom: the meaning is that if the full four-hundred-coin share is not delivered intact, a punitive measure (the wooden skewer) will be applied. The rendering follows the most natural reading of the Tibetan.

The epithet "king who nourishes the Noble Ones" renders "འཕགས་པའི་ལྷོ་ཁྱེད་," a title that recurs in the narrative; it may refer to a specific royal figure whose name has not yet been made explicit in the translated portions.

- The place name Lus 'phags pa'i ljongs is the Tibetan rendering of Uttarakuru, the northern continent in traditional Buddhist cosmology. It is here functioning simply as a geographic setting rather than a cosmological symbol, so it has been rendered with its Tibetan pronunciation alongside the standard identification.

The figure Gyopo (Gyos po) is the hunter-father of Sāgā introduced in the preceding passage; the name is retained as established there.

The phrase rendered "from the opening of proceedings until the sun set" translates a passage describing the formal legal session (literally "from the spreading of the mat/carpet") lasting until sunset without resolution — a standard narrative idiom for an intractable legal dispute before a king.

- The phrase rendered "a merchant from the northern regions" translates *byang phyogs kyi tshong pa*, literally "a merchant of the northern direction." The two birds are *rgod ma*, wild geese or possibly adjutant birds; "wild geese" is adopted as a reasonable rendering consistent with the narrative register.

The passage "yong rgyal po go blon po" is syntactically awkward in the Tibetan and may reflect a minor scribal irregularity; it has been read as "a minister of a great and learned king," which suits the context of Sagā's mild reproach.

- The term rendered "physician" throughout is བླ་མ་ཆེན་པོ་, literally "the great physician" or "great doctor," and in context it appears to be a title for one of the ministers rather than a separate character; the narrative logic suggests these six ministers collectively approached Sagā, and "the great physician" is the one who is impersonated by the wooden effigy. The final sentence breaks off mid-narrative, matching the source text's abrupt ending at that point.
- The verse summary near the middle of the passage is a mnemonic colophon recapping story elements: the udumbara flower is a standard Buddhist image for something rarely or illusorily seen. The term rendered "necklace" for རྒྱུ་ལྗན་ is an ornament-type; "mynah bird" for རྒྱུ་ལྗན་ follows standard identification of this bird in classical Tibetan narrative contexts.

The name རྒྱལ་པོ་ (Ngalen) is a kingdom name kept in transliteration throughout for consistency. སྐལ་ལྷན་པོ་ (king Skyedpa) likewise.

- The passage contains two bird characters whose conversation serves as an intelligence-gathering device: the parakeet *Caryāprakāśa* (Tibetan: *spyod gsal*, "Conduct-Illuminating") acts as the spy sent by the physician to Ngalen's court. The name "Lنالen" in the verse is a reconstructed form of the kingdom name Ngalen as it appears in the story context; the verse seems to present a hypothetical rumor scenario used to test the mynah's knowledge of the true situation.

The foods mentioned — "finest honey" (*sbrang rtsi'i mchog*), "sorrow-free sweets" (*mya ngan med sgyur*), fried puffed grain (*phe'u te'u*), and sugar-based dishes — are rendered as best as the context allows; some of these food names may be playful or archaic terms whose exact referents are uncertain, though the doctrinal content is unaffected.

- The name "Smanchen" (*blon po sman chen po*) is a title meaning "the great minister" or "chief minister" rendered throughout the preceding translation as a proper name for consistency; it is in origin an honorific title. The passage's narrative logic concerning the five hundred ministers — who are simultaneously said to be suborned by gifts, then reported killed — reflects a condensed court-intrigue sequence that is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan; the translation follows the text as given without smoothing. The name "Lنالen" for the opposing king's realm is carried over from the preceding passage per the continuity instruction.
- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the source text, so the translation likewise ends there. The bird's name, rendered here as "Chösal," is a Tibetan phonetic rendering of the bird's human-language name; it is best understood as a myna bird capable of speech, a common motif in Indian story literature. The text's reference to "Lنالen" preserves the name as established in the preceding passage.
- The verse translated "The doer is repaid in kind — look back, and the scorned one scorns in turn. Here it was one alone, a despised one, who swept out every last queen perfectly" is metrically and syntactically compressed in the original. The word rendered "swept out" or "expelled" is from a root meaning to clean or clear out, playing on the earlier temple-cleaning scene; the verse is intentionally ironic and the rendering preserves that tone as best the English allows.
- The phrase rendered as "the eighteen branches of the fields of knowledge" translates a

standard Sanskrit scholastic category, vidyāsthāna, here listed as eighteen, which is an unusually expanded enumeration; the standard count is eighteen limbs of the Vedas or the traditional four or ten fields of knowledge. This may reflect a specific regional or textual tradition, and the number eighteen here most likely refers to the eighteen auxiliary sciences or the limbs of the Vedas as counted in certain Brahmanical curricula. The translation follows the Tibetan literally without imposing a fixed Sanskrit equivalent.

The floating stone is likely a pumice stone, used here as a proof of wit — the Great Physician knew it would float, while others assumed all stones sink. This is not marked in the text but is the natural reading.

- The phrase rendered "like a lizard, to starve unfed" translates a Tibetan expression that compares the woman's situation to a reptile left to go hungry; the comparison is idiomatic and the precise nuance is somewhat colloquial, but the gist is clear from context.

The "eighteen inauspicious signs" is a standard enumeration in classical Indian literature of physical marks considered ill-omened; the text treats this as a well-known category requiring no elaboration.

- The rendering of "百々々々々々々々々々々々々々々々" is genuinely uncertain. The phrase literally suggests something like rocking or swaying together a hundredfold in close physical proximity, most likely an idiom for intimate embrace or amorous sport. This rendering is interpretive.

The opening paragraph of this passage is somewhat ambiguous in the Tibetan, as it appears to re-narrate events already described in the preceding passage from a slightly different angle before moving into the verse retelling. This structural feature, common in Buddhist narrative literature, is preserved rather than smoothed over.

- The verse section at the opening is deeply elliptical and fragmentary in character, resembling riddle-speech exchanged between estranged spouses who allude to shared memories. Several lines resist transparent syntax. The rendering follows the most contextually plausible reading of each line, taking the recurring motifs — the udumbara tree, the Gaṅgā, the carpenter and stone, the brahmin woman, the owl, the mountain, poison, unripe and ripe fruit, harsh words — as allusive references to events in the earlier narrative. Readers should be aware that a fully literal rendering of some lines would be nearly unintelligible, and some editorial reconstruction of sense has been necessary.

The name "King Prasenajit" (Skt. Prasenajit) is inferred from context as the king in question; the Tibetan uses only "འཕགས་ཤིང་མཆོག་པོ་" (lit. "King Prasenajit"), consistent with the Prasenajit narrative cycle in which this story appears.

- The verse spoken by the brahmin as he leads away the servant woman is metrically and lexically somewhat compressed in the Tibetan. The rendering preserves the rhetorical pattern of the original: each line plays on pairing by social rank or appearance, culminating in the brahmin's self-deprecating identification with a demon as a way of addressing the servant. The final two lines shift into a kind of invitation or declaration of mutual joy, consistent with the comic and somewhat ribald tone of the episode.

The phrase rendered "bound to the pillory" translates a term meaning literally "bound to the wood," which in the context of Vinaya narratives refers to being fastened to a wooden restraint or stocks rather than crucifixion; this is the standard reading in such contexts.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, indicating this is a continuous excerpt.

- The term translated as "great physician" renders རྒྱུ་མཁན་པོ་ literally; in context this clearly refers to a man who is a physician of great repute, not a physician named "Great Physician," though the Tibetan could in principle be a title. The narrative logic supports reading it as an occupational descriptor rather than a proper name.

- The name "Mātarā" renders the Tibetan "ne tso ma ta ra," which appears to be a female servant's name. The exact Sanskrit form is uncertain, but it is treated here as a proper name throughout, consistent with the preceding rendering convention.

The phrase rendered "ate together from one vessel" follows the Tibetan idiom of communal eating as a seal of sworn brotherhood or conspiracy.

- The pārijāta (Skt. pārijāta) and kovidāra (Skt. kovidāra) are trees found in the Heaven of the Thirty-Three; the pārijāta is the great divine coral tree associated with that realm. The Tibetan "la ba rdo dkar" rendered as "white stone slope" is a topographical descriptor qualifying the location near these trees; it may alternatively refer to a specific place-name, but the rendering given is the most natural reading of the Tibetan.

The phrase rendered "cut off the arising of gain and honour" follows the Tibetan idiom of the Blessed One withdrawing to diminish the excessive reverence and material offerings that had been accumulating.

- The passage mentions the Pāṇḍukambala rock and the Pārijāta and Kovidaraka trees, which are well-known features of the traditional heaven of the Thirty-Three (Trāyastriṃśa). The Blessed One is here said to be teaching Dharma to his mother, an episode widely attested across Pāli and Sanskrit sources, referring to the tradition that after his awakening the Buddha ascended to Trāyastriṃśa to preach to his mother Māyā (reborn there). The health-inquiry formula rendered here is a standard Indian epistolary convention found throughout the canon. The simile at the passage's end — extending a drawn-in arm — is a classical canonical formula for the speed of supernatural travel; the passage breaks off mid-simile.

- The Pārijāta and Kovidaraka are well-known divine trees of the heaven of the Thirty-Three. The Pārijāta is the celebrated coral tree of that realm; the Kovidaraka is a related flowering tree. Both names are transliterated from Sanskrit via Tibetan phonetic rendering.

The phrase rendered "knowledge of and faith in the Buddha" translates a compound meaning discernment or recognition of the Buddha together with faith; the Tibetan "sang rgyas shes shing dad pa dang ldan pa" carries both cognitive and devotional senses, and both are intended.

The passage ends mid-sentence as the text breaks off; the final line is a fragment in which additional gods begin individually to declare their own grounds of rebirth in the divine realm.

- The place name "Apaṇajarī" renders the Tibetan "ཤཱུའུ་ཤཱུའུ་" as a phonetic transcription of what is likely a Sanskrit toponym associated with Sāṃkāśya (the traditional site of the Buddha's descent from Tuṣṭita — here rendered as the Thirty-Three Gods' realm, which is Trāyastriṃśa). The pairing with the udumbara tree is a well-known motif at Sāṃkāśya. The exact Sanskrit form of "Apaṇajarī" is not fully certain from this transcription alone.

The passage states the Blessed One taught the Dharma in the Yāma heavens on his way down — this downward sequence through the divine realms is a standard narrative element of the Sāṃkāśya descent story found in Vinaya and other sources.

- The sequence of heavenly realms listed here follows the standard Abhidharma cosmology of the form realm: the three Brahmīc heavens, three radiance heavens, three virtue heavens, and the five Pure Abodes capped by Akaniṣṭha, which the Blessed One visits in descending reverse order. The text's unusual feature of having him descend from Akaniṣṭha downward through the realms — rather than simply descending from the Thirty-Three — is preserved faithfully.

The name "Sarvārthasiddha" (lhas bcu cad dang ldan pa, literally "endowed with all purposes" or "accomplishing all aims") is the same name as Siddhārtha in its fuller form; here it refers to a divine youth in the assembly, not the bodhisattva who became the Buddha.

The phrase rendered "vomit warm blood and die on the spot" reflects a classical Indian literary idiom for death from overwhelming shock or overpowering splendor, attested in other sūtra contexts.

- The Tibetan reads "ཤར་བྱ་སྐྱོད་གྲིང་པོ།" at the passage where the retort about the nun's identity is made. "ཤར་བྱ་" is a phonetic rendering of Śāriputra in some Tibetan sources. The passage unambiguously identifies this figure by his recognizing the scent of the blue lotus — a detail attributed to Śāriputra in parallel versions of this narrative. The translation renders accordingly.

The phrase "七十九萬九千九百九十九" is parsed as seventy-nine hundred-thousands (i.e., 7,900,000) ministers of supreme strength, a common hyperbolic retinue number in such narrative contexts.

- The sequence of spiritual fruits listed — stream-entry, non-return, once-return, arhatship — follows a slightly non-standard order in the Tibetan (stream-entry, non-return, once-return rather than the canonical ascending order: stream-entry, once-return, non-return, arhatship). The translation preserves the order as it stands in the Tibetan text.

The verse is terse and its syntax somewhat compressed. The rendering given follows the most natural doctrinal reading: that each of the three options in the first three lines is surpassed by the fruit of stream-entry named in the fourth. The term rendered "grounds" in the first line is the Tibetan "sa" (bhūmi), which here likely refers to stages or levels of spiritual attainment rather than the bodhisattva grounds specifically.

The city name "Camkarmojik" is a transliteration of the Tibetan མཁར་མེད་ཀྱི་རྒྱུད་; its Sanskrit original, if any, is uncertain.

- The island name rendered here as "Kāśeru" (Tibetan: ཀཤེ་རུ་) is uncertain. It may refer to a legendary island in the narrative geography of this jātaka cycle; no confident Sanskrit reconstruction is possible without further witnesses.
- The bird "ཁྱེད་ཀྱི་ཕྱི་ལྔ་ལྔ་" literally means "fine-wings" or "good-wings" and is a standard Tibetan rendering of Suparṇa, a name for the mythical bird-king (often identified with Garuḍa). It is rendered here as "the Golden Wing (Suparṇa)" on first use for clarity, though the Tibetan epithet more literally means "fine-winged." The name "Śoṣumā" for ཤོ་སུ་མ་ is a phonetic reconstruction; the exact Sanskrit is uncertain but this is a plausible reading. The kinnara woman (ཁྱེད་ཀྱི་ཕྱི་ལྔ་ལྔ་) is a female being of the kinnara class, half-human and half-animal in Indian mythology; she is rendered simply as "a kinnara woman." The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, so the translation likewise ends there.
- The two instructions about which string not to touch are textually inconsistent: the first giver says "do not touch the highest string" and the second says "do not touch the lowest string." This appears to be a deliberate narrative detail rather than a scribal error, and is translated as it stands.

The phrase rendered "that wrathful woman" translates "火母," literally something like "fire-mother" or "the blazing one / the fierce one" — an epithet applied to the boy's mother, suggesting she has a fierce or dangerous character.

- * The name rendered "Crocodile-Woman" translates कौकिलिनी, which literally means "she of the crocodile kind" or simply "Crocodile-Woman," a yakṣiṇī or spirit being associated with crocodiles in the narrative context; the precise species intended is uncertain but the crocodile or a similar aquatic creature is the standard understanding in the Vinaya story tradition.

The passage shifts pronoun logic in the final section: the narrative has the woman consorting with a king named Brahmadatta by night and with Swift-Going by day, but the Tibetan syntax is compressed and the question "where do you go at night?" is directed at the woman by

someone, most naturally Swift-Going; the translation reflects the most coherent reading.

- The bird named śārikā is a species of myna or starling-like bird frequently listed in Indian literary and Buddhist narrative contexts alongside the cuckoo (kokilā, here kā ko ki la). "Tīmira" and "kāṣeru" are Indian plant names; tīmira is likely a fragrant flowering plant and kāṣeru a sedge or similar water-plant, both appearing as loanwords or transcriptions in the Tibetan. The svastika auspicious mark on the thigh is a standard mark of beauty in Indian narrative literature. The term rendered "god-eyes" translates lha mig, literally "divine eyes," referring here not to supernatural vision but to his eyes in an elevated or honorific sense, possibly meaning simply "fine eyes" or "bright eyes" in context — the phrase picks up from the preceding narrative where he was blinded.

- The river name "Kāradā" is a transliteration of the Tibetan "ཀ་ར་ད་མ་" and its exact Sanskrit or geographical referent is uncertain. It has been retained as a proper noun throughout for consistency.

The final verse breaks off mid-sentence, as the source passage itself ends incompletely with "when someday a snake and a mongoose, both —". This is not a translation error but an artifact of the passage provided.

- The name "Thāskaryesd" and "Nābso" are rendered phonetically from ཐ་སྐ་རྟ་ཡེ་སྦ་ and ལ་བ་སྦ་, which appear to be monk names. Their exact Sanskrit equivalents or identification is uncertain. The passage breaks off mid-sentence, reflecting an incomplete source text for this unit.

The river name ཀ་ར་ད་མ་ is rendered as Karanadana, a phonetic approximation; its Sanskrit form is uncertain. Similarly འཇུ་གུ་མ་ཐི་ is the river Vaṅgumatī, a well-known Vinaya locus.

The phrase རྩ་ལྔ་, literally "a piece of meat," is translated straightforwardly; in the Vinaya context this is understood as raw meat given to a fox, consistent with the narrative frame.

- The four-line verse in the middle of the passage appears to be a colophon or transitional summary verse bridging sections of the Vinaya text. The referent of "the nun who has descended again" is contextually unclear from this passage alone and likely refers to a narrative figure treated in the immediately preceding section.

The list of animal and human contests reflects standard Vinaya proscriptions against monks attending or organizing spectator events and competitions; the term rendered "wool-sheep" follows the literal Tibetan for sheep raised for wool, as distinct from ordinary sheep.

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, as the Tibetan source text itself ends mid-phrase. The continuation would complete the Blessed One's third refusal in the same formulaic terms as the preceding two. This is preserved faithfully rather than completed by conjecture.

The Guñja residence at Nādikā is a known early canonical location; Nādikā (also rendered Nāḍika in some traditions) is the village of that name frequently mentioned in the Pāli parallels.

- The three similes employed by the Blessed One here, depicting the harmful effects of women's admission to the order, are standard in the Vinaya literature and appear across multiple recensions (Pāli Cullavagga, Mūlasarvāstivāda Vinaya, and others). Their doctrinal and historical significance is well recognised in scholarship; the translation renders them faithfully without softening.

The term "sālu" refers to a specific grain (possibly *Oryza sativa* or a related variety); it is retained as a proper name since no single transparent English equivalent exists.

- The phrase rendered "status as a fully ordained person" translates a term literally meaning "the reality or substance of one who has transgressions" — that is, a person who now stands

under the Vinaya's rules governing transgressions, which is the technical definition of a fully ordained monastic. This is a technical Vinaya usage: the acceptance of the rules, including liability for downfalls, is itself the conferral of full ordination status upon Gautamī.

- The phrase rendered "seek the scriptural transmission of the Teacher's instruction" translates a formulation concerning the fortnightly exhortation of nuns by monks — the formal teaching and Vinaya instruction. The three grounds of the invitation ceremony, "what was seen, what was heard, and what was suspected," are the standard Vinaya formulation for the pravāraṇā, preserved here precisely as they appear in the parallel passages of other Vinaya traditions.
- The phrase rendered "from under the preceptorship" translates the Tibetan term for a nun who has arisen or emerged in dependence on a preceptor-teacher, referring to nuns under the system of the chief rules. The precise procedural force of this phrase in Vinaya context is that such a nun is newly established under the rules rather than fully independent.

The flowers named — campaka, jasmine (varṣikā), and atimuktaka — are standard Indian garland flowers appearing frequently in Sanskrit Vinaya literature; the Tibetan transliterations correspond to these identifications with confidence.

- The phrase rendered "from this day on" in the second set of training rules contains a reading "□□□□□□□□" which literally could mean "these two days" or "day two," but in context it is best understood as simply "from this very day," consistent with the standard formula; this minor oddity may reflect a scribal variant.

The announcement formula at the end breaks off mid-sentence in the source passage, as the text continues beyond what was provided for translation here.

- The phrase rendered as "without characteristics, or has ambiguous characteristics, or is hermaphroditic" translates three Tibetan terms referring to canonical categories of physical sex anomalies relevant to monastic ordination validity: one who lacks the defining physical mark, one who has a secondary or double mark, and one who is intersex. These are technical Vinaya categories and the translation follows standard scholarly renderings.

The shadow-measuring ceremony near the end is a classical Vinaya procedure for establishing the precise time of ordination, which must be recorded as part of the valid ordination record.

- The phrase rendered "six rules and the six rules that accompany them" refers to the śikṣamāṇā (probationary nun) training: six primary rules and six secondary or attendant rules to be kept for two years before full ordination. The distinction between the candidate approaching a "preceptor nun" (mkhan mo) and an "acharya nun" (slob dpon ma) reflects a situation where the acharya serves as intermediary in requesting ordination from the preceptor, which is a recognized procedural variant in the Vinaya for nuns.
- The phrase rendered "the six rules that accompany them" translates the Tibetan for rules that are ancillary or subordinate to the six main training rules; some editions distinguish these terminologically as "the six rules to be followed in accordance," but "accompanying rules" preserves the sense and parallelism of the text.

The verse section presents the six main rules and six ancillary rules in gāthā form; the translation renders these as verse lines accordingly.

The final sentence breaks off mid-construction in the source passage, corresponding to the continuation of a list of robe items; this is reflected in the translation ending with "upper robe and," which is where the passage ends.

- The passage distinguishes between a "place of hearing" and a "place of seeing" as the technical Vinaya boundaries governing where the candidate stands during the private examination versus where she is presented to the assembly. This is a standard procedural distinction in Mūlasarvāstivāda ordination texts.

The series of disqualifying conditions — including "not one who bears the banner of a thief," "not one who lives separately," and "not one who does not abide" — are obscure Vinaya technical categories whose precise referents are debated even in the commentarial tradition. The translations given follow the most broadly accepted interpretations.

- The list of diseases presents several terms whose precise clinical identification is uncertain. The renderings given follow standard Tibetan medical lexical conventions and Vinaya parallels where available, but some remain approximate: "dappled flesh" for སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་, "aggregative fever" for སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་, and "fever accompanied by exhaustion and collapse" for སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་ are interpretive. The term སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་, rendered "nocturnal discharge," refers literally to a condition that erupts or breaks out at night, and may indicate a specific gynaecological condition; the Vinaya context suggests this reading.

- The phrase rendered "householder of twelve years' standing" refers to a woman who has been married for twelve years, a standard Vinaya qualification for ordination at a younger age than the otherwise required twenty years. The text presents two alternative qualifications: either a married woman of twelve years, or a young woman who has reached age twenty.

- The passage is the interrogation of a candidate for full ordination as a bhikṣuṇī. The list of physical impediments at the end is a standard canonical enumeration; many medical terms in the Tibetan Vinaya correspond to Indian medical categories whose exact Sanskrit equivalents are debated, and the English renderings given here follow the established scholarly consensus for Vinaya translations. The passage breaks off mid-list in the source text, and the translation accurately reflects that the list continues beyond what is given.

- The passage is a Vinaya ordination ritual formula for the full ordination of a nun from both Saṅghas simultaneously, the dual-Saṅgha ordination procedure characteristic of the bhikṣuṇī ordination rite. The phrase "སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་" refers to the śikṣamāṇā training: the six qualities to train in and the six attendant or accompanying qualities, a standard twofold set in the probationary nun's preparation, rendered accordingly. The five Dharma-robles and alms bowl are the standard requisites of full ordination.

"སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་" is the vow that gives rise to or produces the celibate holy life, i.e., the śikṣamāṇā vow conferring the basis for ordination.

- The enumeration of robe-fabrics contains several loanwords from Sanskrit and Indic languages rendered phonetically in Tibetan. "Ami-la," "so-mi-la," "dugulaka" (Skt. dukūla, a fine cloth), and "kotampaka" (Skt. kauṭumbaka or similar) are textile names whose precise identification in the Indian textile tradition is uncertain; they are transcribed as close to the Tibetan phonetic forms as possible. The phrase rendered "dust-heap robes" refers to the ascetic practice of collecting discarded rags from rubbish heaps or cremation grounds. The meal-festival names (fifth, eighth, fourteenth, fifteenth) refer to specific communal feast days in the lunar calendar.

- The sequence of synonyms for sensual desire — "clinging, attachment, intention, fondness, dwelling, certainty, deep infatuation" — renders a standard Vinaya listing of terms (similar to Pali counterparts such as chanda, rāga, citta, pema, etc.) that appears elsewhere in the canon as an enumeration of the aspects or synonyms of kāma. The translation follows the most natural doctrinal reading of each term in context.

The phrase rendered "without having formally prepared the ground" translates སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་སྒྲོ་, literally "without having arranged/laid out." In Vinaya context this refers to the preparatory act of formally setting aside one's precepts through the proper procedure; it is paired with "without having surrendered her training," yielding the standard dual condition that marks a pārājika offense as distinct from mere lapse.

- The text closes mid-sentence with the rule on false speech being introduced. This is a continuous Vinaya exposition of the four root downfalls for nuns, running parallel to the monks'

pārājika rules. The phrase rendered "one who has come to be in a human body" translates the Tibetan *mi'i lus su gyur pa*, a standard Vinaya formulation distinguishing a fully human person from a fetus or ambiguous case; I have rendered it literally rather than interpreting it more narrowly, as the commentarial tradition treats it as referring to any being possessing a human form. The monetary unit *māśa* is left in Sanskrit as it is a technical legal measure in the Vinaya theft rule.

- The enumeration of the supernatural beings follows Vinaya convention. The term rendered "garuḍas" translates *nam mkha' lding*, literally "sky-flyers," the standard Tibetan for Skt. *garuḍa*. The term "flesh-eaters" renders *sha za*, Skt. *rākṣasa* or *piśāca*; "putrefying bodies" renders *lus srul po*, Skt. *vetāla* or a related class of corpse-spirit; and "great serpents" renders *lto 'phye chen po*, Skt. *mahoraga*. The elaborate list of perceptions near the end of the passage is a standard enumerative sequence from Vinaya literature cataloguing the meditation objects and attainments which an unqualified claimant might falsely assert; the passage breaks off mid-sentence continuing into the next segment.

- The eight qualities in the passage on the nun who has "become subject to a man" appear to be a reference to a standard Vinaya list of eight characteristics of a woman who has surrendered her will to a man. The Tibetan is technical Vinaya language here and the precise enumeration in this sub-list (body-leaning, signal-setting, pleasure in the man's coming and going, etc.) corresponds to known Mūlasarvāstivāda Vinaya categories.

The phrase rendered "liberation from both aspects" translates Tibetan *phyogs gnyis las rnam par grol ba*, likely referring to the liberation that is free from both the afflictive and cognitive obscurations, or in some Vinaya contexts the one liberated in both mind and body — a technical term whose precise referent in this Vinaya context warrants attention.

- The passage contains highly technical Vinaya procedural language governing the formal admonition of a nun who pays improper respect to an expelled monk. The phrases involving lying prostrate with hair unbound and stretching out flat before the Saṅgha are stock Vinaya formulas for prostration protocol; the translation renders them as literally as readability permits. The phrase rendered as "shows readiness to make obeisance" and "prepares to rise" reflect conventional Vinaya sequences of deferential behavior whose precise physical choreography varies across commentarial traditions. The repeated injunction to supply the nun with alms-bowl, robes, strainer, cup, waist-band, reading, recitation, and meditative engagement is a formulaic list of practical supports used as an inducement or assurance within the admonition procedure.

- The term translated as "chief rules" is *gurudharma* (the eight "weighty rules" or "rules of respect" for nuns), a standard technical term in Vinaya literature. The passage describes the formal proclamation of each rule within a legal Vinaya act, with the nun's name inserted at each announcement, consistent with the standard Tibetan Vinaya formulaic style. The phrase "instruction that shows them the teaching" renders a slightly elliptical construction meaning the fortnightly exhortation from the monks' community. The "probationary practice" in the seventh rule renders the standard penance period (Skt. *mānatta*) incumbent on one who has committed a *saṅghāvaśeṣa* offense, here adapted for nuns under the *gurudharma* framework.

- The phrase rendered "what is a proper case and what is not" translates "*gnas dang gnas ma yin pa*," literally "the possible and the impossible" or "the fitting and the unfitting" — a standard doctrinal dyad referring to knowledge of what circumstances are and are not conditioned to produce certain results. This is a well-recognized category in the canon and requires no special flag, but listeners should note it carries a semi-technical sense.

The verse contains the name "the buddha called Satya" (*bden zhes bya ba'i sangs rgyas*), meaning a buddha of that name who endorsed or declared the ordination valid. This is an unusual phrase; it may refer to a formulaic appeal to truthfulness or to a specific buddha-name

in the ordination liturgy's poetic register.

The four rules added here (not speaking back, not returning anger, not striking back, not reviling in return) are presented as appended to the eight chief rules but connected in a separate transmission until recognized by a perfectly awakened buddha — this reflects a liturgical convention that certain rules are provisional until confirmed by full buddhological authority.

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, as the source text is incomplete at this point. The term rendered "monks" in the seniority-salutation context translates a Tibetan term that refers to fully ordained monks (bhikṣu); the parallel structure of the passage makes clear that the question at issue is cross-gender seniority-salutation between monks and nuns, not salutation among nuns alone, though the framing is somewhat ambiguous. The conditional clauses about women not having gone forth are a well-known passage found across Vinaya traditions and are rendered here following the standard form of the argument.
- The town names Khormo Jig and Donjog are transliterations of Tibetan place names that appear to be rendering Sanskrit originals now unrecoverable from this passage alone; they are rendered phonetically here. Sthulanandā is a well-known nun in Vinaya narratives and her name is kept in Sanskrit. The verse summarizing the rule is terse and compressed; the rendering follows the standard Vinaya verse style. The phrase rendered "without power" reflects the Tibetan sense that a nun who has once disrobed lacks the canonical standing to be re-ordained by another nun.
- The final sentence contains a grammatical difficulty. The Tibetan says the householder of Donjog entrusted his son's education to women who had formerly kept company with courtesans, and then says "let this girl be taught." The shift from "boy" to "girl" may reflect a scribal confusion in the source text, or the referent of "this girl" may be Gauthami the Thin, whose education the householder of Donjog is also arranging by proxy. The translation renders the text as it stands without smoothing the difficulty, though the narrative logic here is somewhat strained.
- The phrase rendered "the Āvantī quarter" translates a term that can mean either a neighborhood or district named Āvantī or simply a surrounding area; the exact toponym is uncertain but does not substantially affect the narrative.
- The term rendered "distinguished friend" is a polite honorific address used between the courtesans and warrants no special note. The district name "Roḍa" renders Tibetan "yul rdo 'jog," a transcription of an Indic place name; its exact Sanskrit form is uncertain but it recurs from the preceding passage. The currency "kāṛṣāpaṇa" is a standard Indian coin mentioned frequently in Vinaya literature.
- The gold coin unit rendered as "gold coins" reflects the Indic monetary term kāṛṣāpaṇa (a standard copper or gold coin of ancient India), which appears transliterated in the Tibetan as ཀར་ཤ་པཎ་. Since the text is for audio narration, "gold coins" is used for naturalness; the technical term is kāṛṣāpaṇa.

The city name ड्रोणाग्र (literally "Stone-placing") is rendered as Droṇa, its standard Sanskrit equivalent in Buddhist narrative literature.

The phrase rendered "his mind and the mental factors born of mind collapsed" (मनोमयिमांसादिसंज्ञासङ्घातव्यथितः) is a deliberate doctrinal formulation using the classical Abhidharma pairing of mind (citta) and mental factors (caitasika); it signals a total psychological breakdown expressed in scholastic idiom.

- The term *kārṣāpaṇa* is a standard ancient Indian monetary unit (a copper or silver coin); it is left in its Sanskrit form as it appears transliterated in the Tibetan throughout. The name "slender Gautamī" renders སྐྱུང་གཱཱཏམི་, literally "the thin or lean Gautamī," a personal

name used consistently. The passage ends mid-sentence in the supplied Tibetan; the translation breaks off accordingly without completion of the final speech.

- The phrase rendered "a cow was snatched away by someone taking what was not theirs" translates a compact passage indicating theft without a named agent. The reading is straightforward but the agent is entirely absent from the Tibetan, so the rendering reflects that ambiguity without forcing a subject.
- The name rendered throughout as "Gautamī" — literally "the lean Gautamī" — is a stock narrative epithet in this text, combining a clan name with a physical descriptor. The preceding passage established this as the same Gautamī figure; the epithet "the lean one" likely distinguishes her within the story tradition.

The final sentence is syntactically incomplete in the Tibetan as transmitted — the construction breaks off mid-thought, indicating either a lacuna in the manuscript or a deliberate cliff-hanger at a section boundary. This is noted here rather than flagged in the body.

- The phrase rendered "the locality called Khormo-jik" translates a proper place name that appears in the Tibetan as a toponym. Its exact identification is uncertain; it may be a transliteration of an Indian place name now obscure, and is retained here in descriptive form rather than left as an untranslatable string.

The expression rendered "beaten like that, she ate the flesh of her son" follows the Tibetan closely; the passage is deliberately harrowing and the syntax confirms she acted under coercion.

- The list of buddha-qualities in the middle section is a stock encomium drawing on canonical Abhidharma and Mahāyāna lists. "The three objects of discipline" renders Tibetan *dul ba'i dngos po gsum*, a technical triad (body, speech, mind, or alternatively the three trainings in discipline); the exact referent varies by commentarial tradition and is not doctrinally certain here. "The four rivers" most likely refers to the four floods or āsravas in their river metaphor. "The six abodes" and "six faculties" are less standard terms whose precise referent in this particular text's tradition is uncertain; the rendering follows the most natural reading. The "twenty peaks of the mountain of the view of the transitory collection" is a standard Abhidharma image for the twenty forms of the belief in a personal self, here dissolved at stream-entry.
- The phrase rendered "like clay and gold alike" translates the Tibetan *bong ba dang gser du 'dra*, literally "resembling clay and gold." This is a standard image for equipoise or non-discrimination — indifference to pleasant and unpleasant, of which various commentarial explanations exist. Some editions read this as referring to the even-minded saint who regards coarse and refined things without preference.

The phrase "treasury of the storehouse of existence" renders *rig pas sgo nga'i mdzod bcom pa*, which is literally "shattered the treasury of the egg of existence with knowledge." The image of the cosmic egg (*sgo nga*) as a container of cyclic existence is a classical Indian and Tibetan motif; "shattered the egg-shell treasury of existence" would be equally valid, and listeners should understand this as the destruction of the shell of ignorance encasing saṃsāric existence.

The phrase rendered "those with controlling faculties and those approaching the controlling faculties" follows *dbang po dang nye dbang po*, which in a Vinaya context likely refers to kings and their ministers or senior courtiers; the translation given is a literal doctrinal rendering, but a contextual rendering of "rulers and those close to rulers" is also defensible.

- The phrase rendered "caused her own womb to become barren" translates a Tibetan passage in which the old wife's jealousy causes the new wife's womb to be made pure or empty of a being — in other words, the old wife, acting out of natural jealousy, causes the new wife to

miscarry or prevents conception. This is a narratively pivotal moment and the passage is slightly ambiguous: it is the old wife who acts out of jealousy, and the result is that the new wife's womb is affected. The rendering follows the most natural reading given the narrative context, but a case could be made that the new wife's womb subsequently becomes receptive after this episode. The passage cuts off mid-sentence.

- The phrase rendered "the nun Sthavirā Gautamī" represents the Tibetan *dge slong ma skem mo gau ta mī*. The epithet *skem mo* ("dried up / withered") appears to be a Tibetan rendering of the Sanskrit *Sthūlanandā* in some recensions but here is more likely a descriptive epithet, possibly translating *Kṣemā* or another name. Given the narrative context and the Vinaya tradition, this figure is most plausibly the nun Sthavirā Gautamī, though the exact identification warrants consultation of the Sanskrit or Chinese parallels of this Vinaya story.

The "thunderbolt" rendering of *gnam lcags* (literally "sky-iron") is contextually warranted; it can mean meteorite or lightning-bolt. Both readings are attested in the commentarial tradition.

- The epithet rendered as "perfect in knowledge and conduct" translates the standard Tibetan equivalent of the Sanskrit *vidyācaraṇasaṃpanna*, one of the ten epithets of a buddha; this is its first full appearance in the passage and the rendering follows standard convention.

The river name is transliterated from the Tibetan as *Varakā*; the Sanskrit original is uncertain, and this may be a Tibetan phonetic rendering of an Indic toponym no longer securely identifiable.

The phrase rendered "gathered in the manner of Vaiśravaṇa, endowed with the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa" reflects the Tibetan idiom comparing a wealthy householder's riches to those of Vaiśravaṇa, the deity of wealth; the expression is conventional and idiomatic rather than literal.

- The name "Skaṃmā Gautamī" renders སྐམ་མ་གྲུ་མ་གྲུ་མ་, which corresponds to Sanskrit *Kṣemā Gautamī* or possibly *Śyāmā Gautamī*. The first syllable སྐམ་ is uncertain; it may be a Tibetan phonetic rendering of a Sanskrit name not easily recoverable from this form alone. This is consequential because it identifies a specific nun.

The phrase རྒྱུ་མཚན་ལྡན་པ་ལྟར་སྒྲུབ་པ་ལྟར་ is somewhat elliptical. Rendered here as "afflictions are difficult to restrain," it could also mean "noble ones are difficult to grasp or take hold of" — the doctrinal point being that the afflictions seize women in ways that are hard to check. The translation follows the contextual sense of the women's petition to the nun for guidance.

- The phrase rendered "submit yourselves to my authority" translates a construction meaning literally "offer the law to me" or "hand authority over to me," which in context means placing themselves under Sthūlanandā's direction or management — a euphemism for her acting as a procuress. The translation conveys this pragmatic meaning without editorializing.

The closing reference to "one who has eaten the flesh of her own child" alludes to a canonical story, likely the tale of Kuntī or a similar narrative of extreme suffering due to famine or karmic consequence, which the text is about to recount. No textual corruption is suspected; the allusion is left to context.

- The phrase rendered "twenty peaks of the mountain of the view of the transitory collection" is a standard Abhidharma metaphor: the twenty-peak mountain represents the twenty modes of the view of self (*satkāyadṛṣṭi*), comprising the fivefold attribution of self and mine to each of the five aggregates. The image of the vajra of primordial wisdom shattering these peaks signals the attainment of stream-entry (*srotāpatti*), which cuts the fetter of the view of the transitory collection entirely.

The verse stanza near the middle of the passage is terse and possibly mnemonic in character; "cross-legged sitting is without category" renders a phrase that may mean the rule about

- The epithet of Bhomā rendered "master of the Three Baskets" translates the Tibetan phrase indicating she claims command of the Tripiṭaka, used here with clear irony given the context of her arrogance. The phrase "fool upon fool, dullard upon dullard" renders a double intensification in the Tibetan, indicating degrees of stupidity.

- The phrase rendered "half cross-legged on a mat" for

- The verse in the middle of the passage presents a compressed, aphoristic quality. The phrase rendered "the flow of blood" for "khrag 'dzag pa" is a standard Vinaya idiom indicating menstruation, contextually used to mark the specific restrictions applicable to nuns; the verse as a whole appears to be a mnemonic summarizing the rules just discussed regarding what a monk will not forgo and what a nun may not inquire about.

- The epithet Gautamī for Mahāprajāpatī (here गौतमी) is her clan name; "mother of the people" renders माता literally, though it is also an honorific epithet for Mahāprajāpatī as foster-mother of the Buddha.

- The name Sthūlanandā is the standard Sanskrit reconstruction for the Tibetan "Sbom dga' mo" (meaning "Fat Joyful One"). The queen's name Mālagandha (Tibetan: phreng ldan ma, "Garland-fragrant") is reconstructed on the same basis.

- The three garments in this passage present a terminological sequence: the waist-cincher (Tib. rkyed chings), the breast-band (nu rten), and the breast-support or breast-separator (nu ma'i bar chad, literally "that which occupies the interval between the breasts," likely a garment that lifts or separates the breasts). The distinctions among these three items are clear in the Tibetan and have been rendered accordingly. The Vinaya narrative follows a formulaic pattern in which the same episode is repeated with a new garment each time; the translation preserves that repetitive structure deliberately, as it reflects the canonical form of rule-origination stories.
- The verse summary in this passage is a mnemonic tag condensing the preceding rules into shorthand. The line rendered as "Do not discard it in an unclean place — the womb, impurity, and foul drink" is terse and deliberately abbreviated; the full legal content is in the narrative prose around it. The reference to "the womb" alludes to the rule about not discarding waste in

a womb-related place, while "foul drink" likely points to a separate rule not yet fully narrated at this point in the text.

The phrase rendered as "the one dwelling in my womb" translates the Tibetan term for a being already conceived, making clear the child was still in utero when the decision to abort was made. The narrative is heading toward a rule about a nun acting as an abortionist, a serious transgression in the Vinaya literature.

- The phrase rendered "she rebuked him eight times" translates a Tibetan idiom for a strong, emphatic rebuke; the number eight here likely reflects a formulaic expression of repeated insistence rather than a literal count of eight utterances.

The name Guptā renders the Tibetan "ཀུཔ་ཁྱེད་," and young Kāśyapa renders "ཀཧོ་མཆོག་ལྷན་སྐྱེས་པའི་རྒྱུ་བློ་བྲང་།". The story of Kāśyapa's miraculous conception from a drop of urine, without physical contact, is a well-known narrative in Mūlasarvāstivāda Vinaya literature.

The closing verse summary is a colophon-style mnemonic listing topics covered in or adjacent to this section of the Vinaya; the rendering attempts to follow the compressed, list-like Tibetan closely, though the final lines are deliberately terse in the original.

- The phrase rendered "Rādhā" at the opening refers to the same Rādhā mentioned in the immediately preceding passage; the text here is a brief verse-like summary line indicating that the rules just stated apply equally to boys, girls, novices, and Rādhā. The transition from this summary into the main narrative is abrupt, which is characteristic of Vinaya compilation style.

The name "Guptā" renders Tibetan "Gub ta" and the boy's name "Kāśyapa" renders "Od srung gzhon nu" (literally "young Kāśyapa / young Protector of Light"), a standard Tibetan rendering of the Sanskrit name Kāśyapa meaning "one who protects brilliance."

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end, rendering the final passage about the two generations incomplete. The phrase "पुत्रौ पुण्डरीकाक्षः सप्तमो ह्यसिम्भकश्च । पञ्चाशत्तमेन वीर्यादिव्रजः ॥" is somewhat elliptical. The reading taken here is that Sāta reports that though two generations of time have elapsed for his friend Pañcālā, sons, grandsons, and great-grandsons are mentioned — suggesting a conversation about the longevity or family circumstances of one of the yakṣas. The exact syntactic completion of this sentence depends on the continuation of the passage.

The name rendered "Guptā" follows the established rendering from the preceding passage. The epithet "Kāśyapa the Elder" renders "कश्यपाचार्यः," literally "great Kāśyapa," and refers to Mahākāśyapa, one of the principal disciples of the Buddha. The identification of the son as Mahākāśyapa is an unusual hagiographical detail preserved in this Vinaya narrative context.

- The name Joymaker renders the Tibetan "Dga' byed ma," a feminine name meaning "she who makes joy" or "she who causes delight" — a transparent formation chosen to reflect the narrative etymology given in the text. The boy's name Pāñcika is a Sanskrit patronymic from Pañcāla, and is kept in its Sanskrit form as it becomes a proper name in the tradition. The crane cry at the moment of conception and birth is a folk-omen motif whose significance will presumably be developed in the narrative that follows.

- The name Sātakiri is a compound formed from Sāta (the father's name) and giri (mountain), yielding something like "Sāta-of-the-mountain" or "Mountain-Sāta," reflecting the text's own folk etymology linking the father's name and the crane's cry from the mountain. The Tibetan སྐུ་མཆོག་ལྷོ་མཆོག་ literally renders this compound.

The yakṣa Pañcāla and the young yakṣa Pāñcika appear to be distinct figures: Pañcāla is the elder to whom the earlier betrothal was made, while Pāñcika is the young yakṣa to whom Pañcāla gives Joymaker in marriage. This distinction is maintained in the translation.

- The phrase rendered "the Blessed One granted permission by his silence" follows the standard canonical idiom in which a Tathāgata's silence in response to a request constitutes

assent; this is a well-established convention in Vinaya and sūtra narrative literature and requires no special comment beyond noting the deliberate wordlessness.

- The names of the hell realms listed follow the standard Sanskrit series: Sañjīva, Kāḷasūtra, Saṃghāta, Raurava, Mahāraurava, Tāpāna, Pratāpāna, Avīci (the eight hot hells), followed by the cold hells Arbuda, Nirarbuda, Aṭaṭa, Hahava, Huhuva, Utpala, Padma, and Mahāpadma. The Tibetan here renders most of these by translation or partial transcription; the Sanskrit names are restored for clarity.

The child's name, rendered here as "Joymaker," translates the Tibetan Dga' byed, which corresponds to Sanskrit Priyamkara or a similar form meaning "one who makes delight."

Mañibhadra is identified here as the lord of the yakṣas (gnod sbyin gyi bdag po ngal bso po); the epithet ngal bso po, meaning "the one who gives rest" or "the refresher," is a standard Tibetan rendering of Mañibhadra's name and function.

- The yakṣinī's name, rendered in the preceding passage as "Aprāptā" (from Tibetan རྒྱུ་མཐོང་མཁུ་), literally means "she who seizes" or "snatching-one." The consistency with the preceding rendering has been maintained throughout.

The speech by Mañibhadra identifies the "chieftain" (སྡེ་དཔོན་, sde dpon) as the ascetic Gautama — meaning the Buddha — which is an unusual construction in which Aprāptā herself seems to name Gautama as the chieftain she has been told about, or Mañibhadra identifies Gautama as the chieftain who can help. The syntax is somewhat compressed in the original, and the reading adopted here is the most coherent one.

- The phrase rendered "in the end, a single worldly benefactor with warm devotion" translates a compressed and difficult clause. The Tibetan reads literally something like "because compassion dwells toward the weak and lowly, in the end a single worldly donor of heat." The precise sense is obscure; this rendering reflects the most plausible reading — that the pratyekabuddha accepts alms from humble donors out of compassion — but the clause is genuinely difficult and may be corrupt or elliptical.

- The term saṃkakṣikā refers to a half-garment or underrobe covering the torso and upper arms, worn during physical work or bathing to preserve decency. The Tibetan transliteration is preserved throughout the passage as a technical Vinaya term without a fully transparent Tibetan rendering.

The phrase rendered as "others of different faith mocked them" translates a brief clause indicating that those who were not followers of the Buddha took the opportunity to ridicule the nuns — a stock Vinaya scenario contrasting the reactions of the laypeople who became attached with those who expressed disapproval.

- The term rendered "person with two sex characteristics" translates a technical Vinaya category referring to individuals with ambiguous or combined sexual anatomy, in Sanskrit pandaka or ubhayavyaṅjanaka depending on the specific context. Here the Tibetan uses a term literally meaning "one having two marks/signs," which corresponds most precisely to ubhayavyaṅjanaka in the broader Vinaya taxonomy of those excluded from ordination. The category "hermaphrodite" is used as the closest conventional rendering, though the Vinaya taxonomy is more nuanced than any single modern term captures.

The verse summarizes four categories of persons ineligible for ordination that the surrounding narrative sections address: those with two sex characteristics, those whose passages are blocked, those who always discharge blood, and those who have no menstrual blood at all. The final category, one with no blood, is introduced in the verse but its narrative case is not yet rendered here, as the source passage ends before it.

The phrase rendered "stopped up" or "whose passages were blocked" refers to a physiological condition in which urinary and intestinal passages are abnormally connected or obstructed, causing involuntary simultaneous evacuation.

- The verse passage in the middle of this text is terse and somewhat cryptic. The rendering "the gesture of spitting" for བཟུང་ཆུ་ཕོར་པ་ is based on the Vinaya context where spitting (or making a gesture of contempt or dismissal) is a recognized ceremonial act; the exact referent may be a specific ritual gesture of reception or rejection in the ordination procedure. The line འཇུག་པའི་ཆུ་ཕོར་པ་ meaning "take on the form of a monk" is interpretive; it may refer to a hermaphrodite adopting monks' robes or status. These are genuinely uncertain phrases in a condensed verse summary that likely presupposes a fuller prose commentary.

The figure འཇུག་པའི་ཆུ་ཕོར་པ་ is rendered as "the joyful Nandā" following the standard identification of this stock character in Mūlasarvāstivāda Vinaya narrative.

- The term rendered "Pom-delight" follows the preceding passage's established rendering of འཇུག་པའི་ཆུ་ཕོར་པ་. The epithet applied to Mahākāśyapa — venerable Ānanda is named in the Tibetan as the one who permitted the ordination of women — this reflects the well-known Vinaya account in which Ānanda interceded with the Buddha on behalf of Mahāprajāpatī. The phrase "monk who is her monastic father" renders འཇུག་པའི་ཆུ་ཕོར་པ་, literally "monk-father," a recognized Vinaya term for the monk under whose authority or in relation to whom a nun stands in a particular institutional relationship; the precise technical meaning of this term as the passage continues would benefit from seeing the following sentence, which is where the ruling is completed.

- The phrase rendered "communal acts" translates འཇུག་པའི་ཆུ་ཕོར་པ་, meaning acts that are held jointly between the two communities rather than separately by each order. The distinction between separate and shared Vinaya acts is a standard feature of dual-ordination Vinaya procedure.

The figure translated as "great lay patroness" renders འཇུག་པའི་ཆུ་ཕོར་པ་, literally "great mistress of beings" — a title for a prominent lay female donor or patroness of high social standing.

The final verse lines are the closing summary verse of a Vinaya section; the last line ("one should not strike a person with a harmful garment or the chest") is terse and likely refers to rules against using clothing or physical contact as forms of assault or inappropriate touching — the precise referent is unclear without the fuller Vinaya context.

- The phrase rendered "an offense with expiation" translates a standard Vinaya term for a pācittiya-class transgression, meaning a downfall that requires confession and expiation before the community but does not constitute a root defeat. The text does not spell out the Tibetan term in full here but it is implied by the formula "འཇུག་པའི་ཆུ་ཕོར་པ་," which in Vinaya contexts consistently marks this category of offense.

The name "Sthūlanandā" is the Sanskrit reconstruction of the Tibetan འཇུག་པའི་ཆུ་ཕོར་པ་, literally "Fat Joyful One," a well-known nun in the Vinaya narratives notorious for misconduct.

- The phrase rendered "sons of that slave woman" translates a Tibetan insult directed at the king's men. The term "bzang mo'i bu" literally means "son of a female slave" or "son of a maidservant," and is a harsh term of abuse; the translation preserves its force. The winter quarters mentioned here likely refers to a building or compound used during the cold season, which Sthūlanandā had built adjacent to it as a venue for the girl's activities.

- The phrase rendered "a man to act as a pimp" translates a term literally meaning "a man who guards or watches" in the context of the sex trade; the rendering is a contextual interpretation consistent with the narrative logic. The passage uses "noble one" as a form of address between women, reflecting the Tibetan honorific convention in Vinaya narratives. The expression "sons of that slave woman" is a term of abuse, identical to the one used in the preceding passage,

and has been rendered consistently.

- The phrase rendered "along with what has already passed" translates a formulaic Vinaya expression indicating that the offense also retroactively implicates prior related conduct; this is a standard technical idiom in Vinaya literature and not a scribal error.

The name "Buzanmo" is a proper name in the Tibetan that does not correspond to a well-known Sanskrit equivalent in this context; it is retained in transliteration.

"Neyagawa" likewise appears to be a phonetic rendering of a personal name in the source; it is retained as transliterated.

- The phrase rendered as "became known by a name" translates the Tibetan "mtshan gyur na," literally "if one has become named" or "if one has come to be identified by a sign or name." In the Vinaya context this appears to refer to a situation where a monastic's gender identity or biological sex has become a matter of public knowledge or formal recognition — likely referring to cases of sexual transformation or ambiguity, a well-attested Vinaya topic. The precise technical sense cannot be determined from this passage alone, and the rendering is deliberately neutral to preserve that ambiguity.

The verse summary uses "great sage" to render "drang srong chen po," literally "great ṛṣi," a standard epithet applied to the Buddha in Vinaya verse summaries.

The monk named Gunā (spelled "gu na" in the Tibetan) and his affiliation with the "Mūla group" (mu la pa) are as in the text. "Mūla" here may refer to a sub-grouping within the community rather than the Mūlasarvāstivāda school as such.

- The epithet translated as "wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, heaped up like the treasures of Vaiśravaṇa" renders a formulaic phrase comparing the householder's wealth to that of the god of wealth. The Tibetan reads "ngal bso po'i nor dang 'dra ba ngal bso po'i nor la sdo ba," where ngal bso po is the standard Tibetan rendering of Vaiśravaṇa (Kubera), the deity of wealth.

The name Dharmadattā is given in the Tibetan as Chos sbyin ma, meaning "she who is given by the Dharma" or "gift of the Dharma," which matches the Sanskrit Dharmadattā. The passage's explanation of the name connects it to the girl's listening to the Dharma.

- The nun's name rendered here is Utpalavārṇā, the standard Sanskrit reconstruction for the Tibetan transcription given. This is the celebrated arhat nun famous in the canon.

The lunar mansion "Viśākha" (Tibetan sa ga) is the sixteenth nakṣatra; the boy is named after the asterism under which he was born. This is a standard Indian naming convention.

The five faults of sensual pleasure are introduced here but the list is cut off at the first item in the passage as given; the enumeration continues beyond the supplied text.

- [illegible]

- The "six rules and six rules to be followed" refers to the training period prescribed for a śikṣamāṇā, a probationary nun, which in the Vinaya tradition involves six primary rules and six ancillary rules observed for two years before full ordination as a nun. This technical category is rendered descriptively here, as is standard when Tibetan follows the Sanskrit formula without giving the individual rules.

- "Mṛgadhvaja of Sāgala" renders the name given in the Tibetan; the preceding passage used "Mṛgadhvaja" for the same figure, so the rendering is kept consistent.

- The narrative in this passage is somewhat compressed and moves quickly between two distinct ordination sequences involving Dharmadinnā and Utpalavarṇā (Tib. Utpala'i kha dog ma, "she of blue-lotus color"). The sequence of events — first Dharmadinnā is sent away with the two-year probationary training, then Utpalavarṇā goes to the Blessed One and a second instruction is given — reflects a dual ordination procedure. The narrative logic is condensed in the Tibetan and slightly elliptical; the rendering follows the most coherent reading of the sequence.

- The phrase rendered "the five spokes of the wheel of cyclic existence, its turning and non-turning" follows the Tibetan closely but is an unusual formulation. The five spokes likely refer to the five aggregates or the five destinies; the commentary tradition is not uniform here, and the precise doctrinal referent of this image is not entirely transparent from the text alone.

• The passage lists the attainments of the audience using the standard Abhidharmic scheme of the four fruits of the śrāvaka path: stream-entry (Skt. *srotāpatti*), once-returning (Skt. *sakṛdāgāmin*), non-returning (Skt. *anāgāmin*), and arhathood. The arousing of the awakening mind then branches into the three vehicles, a standard Mahāvāna narrative device.

• The city name rendered here as Vārāṇasī translates the Tibetan "Khormo-jig" which is the standard Tibetan equivalent of Vārāṇasī. The Deer Park at the Hermitage of the Seers is the well-known Ṛṣipatana-Mṛgadāva (Deer Park of Sarnath), rendered accordingly. The passage ends mid-sentence in the supplied Tibetan, indicating the text is incomplete as provided; the

translation faithfully follows the Tibetan to its ending point without supplying further material.

- The phrase rendered "the forty-third bundle" follows the standard Vinaya section-marker in the Tibetan text. The verse summary at that point is a mnemonic rubric listing the four topics of the bundle in telegraphic form; the translation gives the sense of each line as precisely as the compressed style allows, but these rubrics are often cryptic and the exact referents of rules two and four depend on broader Vinaya context not given here.

- The term rendered "barber" (Tib. བཤམ་པ་པོ་) literally means "one who cuts" and clearly refers to a barber or hair-dresser; the subsequent narrative confirms this. The phrase བཤམ་པ་པོ་ in the speech of the nearby nun is an optative of wishing or alarm and has been rendered as an exclamatory "How unfortunate it would be," which preserves the idiomatic force. The nun Sthūlanandā (Tib. སྐྱུ་ལྷན་པོ་, literally "the greatly joyful fat one," a well-known problematic figure in Vinaya narratives) is kept by her Sanskrit name as is standard. The phrase སྐྱུ་ལྷན་པོ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་ is an idiomatic expression of resignation, here rendered "That is my own doing," though it could also be translated as "such is my situation" or "this is the result of my karma" — the exact nuance is mildly uncertain, but the sense of accepting responsibility or one's own predicament is clear.

- The term rendered "Doṇamatī" (Tibetan: ཏོན་མམ་ཏི་) is uncertain. This appears to be an epithet or place-name for a group of nuns, literally meaning "those of little benefit" or possibly a proper name; the rendering follows the most natural reading of the text as a group designation. Some editions may read this differently.

The name ཏོན་མམ་ཏི་ (Grelaskyé) is a Tibetan transcription of a Sanskrit proper name that cannot be securely reconstructed without access to a parallel Sanskrit recension. It appears to be a monk whose remains are honored by the twelve nuns.

The phrase ཏོན་མམ་ཏི་ལྟ་བུ་ ("passed beyond his time") is a standard Tibetan euphemism for death, rendered here as "passed away."

- The name "Chutung" appears to be a Tibetan rendering of a proper name (literally meaning "water-drinker"), which was also used in the preceding passage as the name of the venerable elder arriving with five hundred monks. The text is consistent in using this name, and it is preserved as such for continuity with the previous rendering.

The expression translated as "she blessed her robe through her power of concentration" renders a compact phrase indicating that Utpalavarnā used her supernormal ability to imbue her robe with a protective quality before entering the absorption of cessation. The precise mechanism is left elliptical in the Tibetan.

- The passage ends mid-sentence in the Tibetan as given, breaking off at the conditional clause about what happens if a nun enters without having been asked. The translation reflects this open ending faithfully.

The epithet རྒྱལ་མམ་ཏི་ལྟ་བུ་, literally "great mistress of beings," is a standard Tibetan rendering of the Sanskrit Mahāprajāpatī, the name of the Buddha's aunt and the first Buddhist nun. It has been rendered accordingly.

- The summary verse is a mnemonic gāthā condensing the preceding legal rulings on the poṣadha and pravāraṇa ceremonies and the procedure for nuns seeking consent. The verse's compressed syntax follows standard Vinaya mnemonic style.

The term rendered "gradually" (Tibetan: bgags kyis) in the forgiveness procedure is a procedural term indicating a staged or mediated reconciliation rather than an immediate, direct confrontation — a nuance preserved in the translation.

- The passage contains a characteristically repetitive Vinaya-style enumeration of the three unwholesome and three wholesome roots, repeated in slightly varying formulations as part of

an oral-formulaic structure. The text appears to break off mid-sentence at the end; the translation renders what is present in the passage without supplying missing text.

The phrase rendered "acts of aggression" translates a cluster of terms including fighting, fault-finding, abuse, quarreling, and a fifth term suggesting aggressive confrontation or incitement; these have been rendered as a unified list throughout for naturalness in speech.

• The term rendered "invitation ceremony" throughout is the Pravāraṇā, the formal ceremony at the end of the rains retreat in which monastics invite correction from their fellows. The term rendered "Restoration" in the final section is Poṣadha, the fortnightly confession and recitation of the Prātimokṣa; both terms appear in the house glossary and are used consistently.

The phrase "recover his own mind of renunciation" renders the Tibetan idiom for the re-establishing of each individual's proper monastic resolve or composure after conflict — literally "separately obtaining his mind of renunciation." The rendering is interpretive but doctrinal.

The "topknot festival" is a calendrical observance whose exact identification in this Vinaya context is uncertain; it may refer to a specific Indian festival associated with hair-offering rites.

- The phrase rendered as "shaven-headed nuns" and "shaven-headed wanderers" translates the Tibetan terms for nuns and monastics in the mouths of the brahmins and householders, who use the colloquial derogatory expression for shaven-headed renunciants. The scornful tone is deliberate and belongs to the speakers, not to the text itself.

The final line, "Here ends the summary verse," renders the Tibetan closing marker indicating that a mnemonic summary verse follows, though the verse itself does not appear in this passage.

- The phrase rendered as "the five-spoked wheel of a vehicle" reflects a somewhat unusual image in this narrative context; the Tibetan reads "sgo khang na 'khor ba'i 'khor lo cha lnga pa la rtog cing 'dug go," which literally means he sat in the gatehouse examining a five-part or five-spoked wheel. This detail appears to be a narrative flourish establishing that the man is a wandering craftsman or trader, not a monk, and the translation follows the literal reading. Some commentators may read 'khor ba here differently, but the sense of a wheeled conveyance or cartwheel seems most natural in context.

- The phrase rendered "turning the wheel of cyclic existence in his mind" translates the idiom for a non-monk lay person sitting in a gatehouse being preoccupied with worldly affairs — the nuns described him only by his appearance and posture, not knowing he was a layman. The "wheel of cyclic existence" here is a vivid way of characterizing his mental state as worldly, not a technical Dharma usage.

The title "Great Progenitress" for Mahāprajāpatī Gautamī renders

ॐ नमो भगवते वासुदेवाय, where ॐ नमो भगवते वासुदेवाय means "mistress of beings" or "progenitress of beings," an honorific for Mahāprajāpatī. The passage alternates between her full title and the shorter ॐ नमो भगवते वासुदेवाय alone.

- The phrase rendered "My good woman, I know how. Since the time has passed, there is not a craft or a trade I do not know" is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan. The speaker is Sthūlanandā boasting of her skills; the sense is that over time she has come to know every craft and trade, and the translation reflects that confident self-assertion.

- The list of named individuals in the festival passage is slightly compressed in the Tibetan and some names are abbreviated or variant forms. "Queen Mallikā" renders རྒྱལ་མཚན་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་, literally "Queen Garland-Bearer," which is a standard Tibetan rendering of Mallikā.

"Vāsavadattā" renders वासुदेवदत्ता, a royal lady whose name is uncertain from this epithet alone; the rendering is tentative. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source

text, reflecting an abrupt cut in the supplied Tibetan.

- The phrase rendered "born laterally on the right side" translates a compound indicating an oblique or lateral birth position on the right side, understood in the narrative as an inauspicious birth sign. The exact medical or cultural referent is not further specified in the text.

The nested-bowl episode involves Sthūlanandā commissioning progressively smaller bowls that nest inside one another; the text's phrasing is somewhat compressed but the sense of a graduated set of seven nesting bowls is clear from context.

- The final two sentences mark a sharp transition to a formulaic legal declaration within the Vinaya narrative frame. The phrase rendered "the fully ordained nuns of the śramaṇas, the sons of the Śākyas, are burned — the brahmin life is burned" reflects the stock Vinaya expression used when a monk or nun has committed a breach: "burned" here means their celibate religious life has been compromised or violated. The term "brahmin life" renders tshangs par spyod pa, literally "pure conduct" or "brahmic conduct," the standard term for the celibate religious life (Sanskrit brahmacaryā). The passage signals that a Vinaya offense is being narrated.
- The phrase rendered "praised me to the skies like an elephant's raised trunk" is an idiomatic Tibetan expression of flattery or grand proclamation; the simile of the elephant's uplifted trunk conveys lofty, public praise. The rendering preserves the figurative sense for a listening audience.

The repeated narrative frame, "The brahmin life was burned" and "the contemplatives, the sons of the Śākyas, were burned," is a formulaic Vinaya expression indicating that the reputation and good name of the monastic community was damaged or inflamed by public scandal.

- The phrase rendered "Stubborn Delightful" translates the nun's name རྩུབ་དག་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ (Stubborn-Joyful or Obstinate Delight); it is preserved consistently from the preceding passage. The signal she gives indicating "the female donor had but little gain" is a somewhat compressed idiom; the Tibetan རྩུབ་དག་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ refers to her making a sign or giving a hint — the precise nature of the sign is not specified in the text.
- The summary verse appears to be a mnemonic listing several Vinaya rules in compressed form. The individual terms are elliptical, and the rendering given follows the most natural reading of each phrase as a rule-heading rather than a complete sentence — this is standard for such verse summaries in Vinaya literature. The phrase rendered "gall-bladder vessel" translates a term for a kind of container; the precise referent is a minor point of Vinaya material culture and is not consequential for the doctrinal content.
- The name rendered "Stout-and-Glad" translates the Tibetan "སྦོམ་དག་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་" (Sbom dga' mo), literally "Fat-Joy" or "Stout-Delighted." This is a personal name of a nun and has been rendered in a natural English compound reflecting its literal meaning. Some editions may read this differently.

The phrase "སྦོམ་དག་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་" rendered as "it will be a matter involving an offence" is a Vinaya technical formula; the exact grade of offence is not specified in this passage.

The summary verse at the close is a standard mnemonic (uddāna) marking the end of a section; the four items it enumerates summarize preceding rules. The referent of "these four" is the four cases treated in the preceding section, which is conventional in Vinaya uddāna verses.

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end ("སྦོམ་དག་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་" — literally "all the mothers..."), indicating the supplied Tibetan is incomplete. The translation reflects this abrupt ending faithfully.

The phrase rendered "nocturnal emission" translates "mi gtsang ba yang byung," literally "something unclean also arose/occurred," a standard Vinaya euphemism for seminal or vaginal discharge during sleep; the context makes the meaning clear.

The signal left at the doorway (flour or pickles/condiments) is a standard Vinaya device to indicate prior arrival and avoid entering a household unannounced; "མཚོད་མ་" (tshod ma) here likely means condiments or pickled vegetables rather than fresh vegetables, functioning as a recognizable marker.

- The term rendered "staff-bell" (Tibetan: khar gsil) corresponds to the Sanskrit khakkhara, the ringed walking staff traditionally carried by monks, which jingles as they walk and can be shaken to announce one's arrival. This is its standard Vinaya identification.

The phrase rendered "a room built up with materials" translates rdzas kyis bsgrubs pa, literally "accomplished or constructed by means of requisites or materials." This is a technical Vinaya designation for a temporary dwelling or cell assembled from donated supplies; the exact nature of the structure is deliberately left in plain descriptive language rather than over-specified.

- The passage contains a string of onomatopoeic Tibetan syllables rendered here as approximations in English, since the original clearly intends to evoke the actual sounds of eating and drinking. The precise onomatopoeia differs between languages, but the general sense is preserved. The term translated as "rice-porridge" for རྩ་ལྟ་ལྟ་ལྟ་ covers a thick rice dish; "porridge" for ལྟ་ལྟ་ covers a general thick soup or congee. The phrase ལྟ་ལྟ་ལྟ་ལྟ་ལྟ་ལྟ་ is rendered as "inner composure," a standard Vinaya idiom for the Buddha's afternoon period of meditative rest.

- The phrase rendered "a place prepared with requisites" translates the Tibetan for a dwelling or setting arranged with the four requisites offered to the Buddha; this is a standard Vinaya context indicating the Buddha accepted an invitation and sat within a formally prepared space while also going on alms round, a juxtaposition that the text itself flags as requiring explanation through the "five reasons" passage referenced but not quoted here.

- The phrase rendered "occupied with a matter" for ལྟ་ལྟ་ལྟ་ལྟ་ལྟ་ལྟ་ལྟ་ལྟ་ལྟ་ is a Vinaya technical idiom; it refers to the Blessed One remaining behind to attend to some business or matter rather than going with the assembly. The passage cross-references an earlier section of the Vinaya narrative (the "five reasons" passage) which is not reproduced here; the instruction "as stated above" reflects the Tibetan's own cross-referential shorthand.

The closing summary verse is a mnemonic gāthā listing topics covered in the fascicle; the four items enumerated correspond to four separate narrative sections, of which only the last two appear in this passage.

- The phrase rendered "bathing" throughout refers to a therapeutic soaking or irrigation of a wound, not ordinary bathing. The Tibetan verb "khrus byed" normally means to bathe, but in this medical context it describes rinsing or washing a treated wound — the poultice procedure requires the wound to be fully irrigated before rinsing with cold or warm water. The narrative logic makes clear that the problem was applying cold water too soon and only once.

The expression "brahmin endowed with the six qualities" refers to a brahmin of full hereditary qualification according to traditional Indian brahminical reckoning: noble birth on both sides for seven generations, expertise in the Vedas, handsome appearance, good character, learning, and so forth. The specific six qualities vary by source.

- The phrase rendered "being of his last existence" translates "srid pa tha ma pa'i sems can," literally "the sentient being of the last existence," a technical term for one whose current life will be their final rebirth before nirvāṇa — here the child who is about to be ordained.

The term rendered "house-cricket" for "srog chags khyim sbyong" is uncertain; the compound could refer to various small domestic insects or vermin. The identity of the creature is not doctrinally significant.

- The phrase rendered "wheel of existence, fivefold, moving and unmoving" translates a technical Vinaya formula for the five aggregates or the constituents of conditioned existence; the exact doctrinal referent is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan and may allude to a stock phrase from Abhidharma enumeration. The rendering is faithful to the Tibetan syntax while keeping it intelligible in context.

The phrase "like stone and gold alike" and "like the sky and like the palm of the hand" are stock simile-pairs for an arhat's equanimity, well attested in Vinaya narrative literature; they are rendered literally as the tradition intends them.

- The verse "Even were it a hundred aeons..." is a well-known canonical gāthā attested in multiple Āgama and Vinaya sources; it is cited here in the standard form.

The summary verse at the close is a colophon-style mnemonic gāthā listing key narrative elements of the story. The phrase rendered "the one carrying a load who makes no sound, who does not eat" corresponds to the image of the snake (which carried its karmic burden silently), and these compressed summaries are conventional in this genre. The precise referents of each phrase within the mnemonic are intentionally condensed and some ambiguity is inherent to the genre.

The transition after the summary verse marks a new sūtra episode beginning with a fresh setting, which is standard in this collection.

- The phrase rendered as "code phrase" translates a term literally meaning something like "a word that conceals" or "a substitute expression," used here in the sense of a veiled or encoded expression, where each ordinary image stands for a doctrinal reality. The rendering "code phrase" is chosen for clarity in a spoken context.

The passage about the monk of little learning and the bandits sets up a narrative of danger in the wilderness — a typical Vinaya illustrative story establishing the context for a subsequent rule.

- The phrase rendered as "master of the Three Baskets" refers to one who has mastered the Tripiṭaka. The term མཐོན་པོ་གཙུག་པོ་, literally "holder of the Mātṛkā," refers to the Abhidharma matrix-texts or numerical summaries; this is an older designation for what became the Abhidharma Piṭaka, rendered here by its Sanskrit technical name to preserve the scholastic sense. The repeated formula "I am a forest-dweller" is the monk's consistent and almost absurdist self-identification, likely conveying either a vow of strict forest renunciation that precluded all social knowledge, or a deliberate meditative refusal of conventional categories; the narrative presents this without irony as the cause of the bandits' outrage.
- The term translated as "Mātṛkā" refers to the Abhidharma matrix texts or their proto-forms. It sits alongside Sūtra and Vinaya as the third division of the canon, though in this early Vinaya context it likely refers to summary doctrinal lists rather than the fully developed Abhidharma.

The place name "Anupiya" renders Tibetan "འཕུའི་ཡུལ་" three times. This is the standard Tibetan rendering of the toponym Anupiya (also spelled Anupiyā), a town and mango grove near Kapilavāstu associated with early Buddhist narratives. The repeated phrase in the Tibetan is formulaic, establishing arrival at and residence in that locale.

The young brahmin's name "Maṣu" is a tentative rendering of "མཤུ་". The name is unclear and may be a Tibetan phonetic rendering of an Indic original not easily recovered.

- The passage employs the standard ten epithets of a buddha, here rendered according to their established canonical meanings. The repeated phrase "from home into homelessness" renders

the classical going-forth formula. The phrase translated "sacred brahmin formularies" or "secret formularies" renders *gsang tshig*, literally "secret words," referring to the esoteric Vedic or brahminical texts in which the marks of a great man are said to be described — a detail common to parallel Pāli sūtra passages. The name Maṣu corresponds to the young brahmin introduced as Ma su in the preceding passage.

- The phrase rendered "dark-limbed menials born of Brahma's foot" (*dge sbyong mgo reg nag po'i rtsa lag pho reng*) is a derogatory epithet that the brahmin youth Ambastha appears to be applying to ascetics of low birth, reflecting the Brahmanical varna ideology in which śūdras are said to originate from Brahma's feet. The Blessed One is turning this language back on Ambastha ironically, noting that even with such menials a brahmin does not behave with such rudeness. The syntax here is compressed and the passage is echoing the Ambaṭṭha Sutta (DN 3); the translation follows that context.

- The section heading "Vinaya — the Minor Matters. The Forty-Sixth Bundle" appears mid-passage as a Tibetan canonical colophon marker indicating a fascicle division within the Vinaya Kṣudrakavastu; it interrupts the narrative and is rendered plainly as it stands in the source, since it is present in the text.

The name "Icchanangala" renders the Tibetan འཇམ་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་, literally "son of the Unblinking Eye," which corresponds to the Pāli Icchānangala or, in the Ambaṭṭha Sutta context, a patronymic. The exact Sanskrit form is uncertain; the rendering follows contextual identification with the Pāli tradition's Cankī or related figures, though the Tibetan here is likely a rendering of a name meaning something like "son of the unblinking one."

The four sons' names — Starface, Handear, Tamed by the Elephant, and Ornamented Feet — render Tibetan སྐྱེ་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་, སྐྱེ་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་, སྐྱེ་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་, and སྐྱེ་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་ respectively. These correspond to the Pāli Okkāṃukha, Karakaṇḍa, Hatthinīka, and Sinipura, though the Tibetan renderings diverge somewhat from the Pāli names; the translation follows the literal Tibetan meaning.

- The name "Ngophödma" is a transliteration of a Tibetan rendering of a Pāli name (likely Dishnī or a similar slave woman's name from the Ambaṭṭha Sutta of the Dīgha Nikāya). The Tibetan text gives it as a proper name without further gloss; I have retained the Tibetan form and added the likely Pāli equivalent parenthetically in a light way. The rākṣasa passage is rendered following the Tibetan closely; in the Pāli source this episode concerns the Kaṇhāyana lineage differently, but the Tibetan here reads "Unblinking Ones" as a class of beings equivalent to rākṣasas.

The phrase "splitting the head into seven pieces" is a standard formulaic expression in these sūtra accounts for the consequence of refusing to answer a teacher's question three times.

- The fourfold sequence of hypothetical cases about caste-mixing and ritual privilege follows the structure of the Ambaṭṭha Sutta. The term rendered "secret words" renders མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་, which in the Pāli corresponds to mantras or sacred formulae transmitted within brahmin lineages. "Seat" and "water" refer to the customary hospitality honours due to qualified brahmins. "Anointing" renders མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་, literally "empowerment," but here used in the sense of the royal or kṣatriya consecration rite. The figure of King Okkāka and the sage expelled by brahmin penalty appear in the extended narrative context of the sutta; the Tibetan here follows the standard account.

- The figure called "the lord of the Mithilā brahmins, Brahmā" renders མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་. This is a brahmin named or epithetized Brahmā who is lord of the Mithilā region; the text presents him as a human brahmin lord, not the deity Brahmā. This is consistent with similar passages in related Pāli sūtra literature where a brahmin is compared to or named after Brahmā.

The repeated verse citation, appearing three times in the passage, is a standard rhetorical feature of this type of sūtra dialogue affirming the authority of a verse by attributing it to oneself and to the interlocutor in sequence.

- The compound rendered "like the sound of a royal court assembly" translates a phrase that literally suggests speech resembling the resonant sound within a royal palace and its surrounding assembly — conveying a quality of dignified, well-rounded sonic fullness. The rendering captures the simile's intended sense.

The terms for fraudulent commercial practices (falsifying measures of volume, scales, and weights) reflect standard Vinaya and sūtra enumerations of merchant dishonesty.

- The phrase rendered as "one who has a light and with a woman" reflects the Tibetan literally: ལྔ་མཚན་གྱིས་བརྒྱུ་བཞུགས་པའི་མེད་ཀྱི་ཁྲིའོ།. The term ལྔ་མཚན་ ("one who has a light") is ambiguous and may refer to sleeping in a room with a lamp lit, or alongside a person carrying a light — the exact sense is uncertain and likely reflects a Vinaya-context prohibition against sharing sleeping quarters in these circumstances. This is a genuine exegetical uncertainty worth flagging.

The term 𐤀𐤍𐤁𐤏𐤍𐤁𐤏𐤍 (those who subsist on whey) may be a social category of dependent laborers or bondspeople identified by their meager subsistence.

The passage ends mid-sentence, enumerating types of luxurious furnishings; the translation faithfully follows the text to its terminus.

- The passage contains an extended catalogue of games and entertainments that closely parallels the Brahmajāla Sutta list of wrong livelihood. Several terms in the games section are obscure and their exact referents uncertain. "Miig brgyad pa" and "miig bcu pa" likely refer to board games played on eight-square and ten-square grids respectively, analogous to Pali "aṭṭhapada" and "dasapada." "Na ya'i mig" is rendered "the eye of nāya," following a conventional reading but the precise game is unclear. "Gul tshab," rendered "substitution-moves," and "pheg," rendered "bouncing games," are also of uncertain precise meaning. "Rang bzo'i sgra," rendered "the sound of amateur performances," may alternatively refer to improvised or spontaneous sounds. These uncertainties do not affect the doctrinal substance of the passage.
- The list of omen-reading and ritual arts in the final two paragraphs presents some cataloguing challenges. The term rendered "momentary conjunctions" translates a compound referring to brief astrological configurations. "Reading of fields" renders a term that could also denote reading of the character of one's natal land or surroundings; the precise referent is uncertain but contextually consistent with a list of geomantic arts. The three final ritual categories — pacifying, enriching, and fierce — are the standard three (sometimes four) tantric ritual activities and appear here in a pre-tantric Vinaya context simply as types of ritual manipulation, not technical tantric rites.
- The passage on medical practices is a classical list of Āyurvedic and quasi-medical procedures. Several terms in the medical and ritual sections present interpretive challenges. The term rendered "excellent bulls" for རྒྱལ་ལོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ is literally "supreme of the herd" and almost certainly refers to a bull, though some traditions read it as referring to a fine horse or similar creature. The term རྒྱལ་ལོ་ (rendered "buffaloes") may refer to a specific breed or type of large bovine animal; this is the standard reading in comparative Pāli sources. The term རྒྱལ་ལོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ and རྒྱལ་ལོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་, rendered as divination by the circling of deer and crows respectively, follow the Pāli parallel closely. The term རྒྱལ་ལོ་ལྷོ་ (rendered "eyes that are underdeveloped") is uncertain and may refer to cataracts, half-formed eyes, or similar ocular conditions in a medical-diagnostic context.
- The phrase rendered "inner king" and "outer king" refers to the practice of predicting the

outcomes of conflicts between a patron's own king and a rival or foreign king — a standard item in the canonical lists of wrong livelihood through political divination. The Tibetan nang gi rgyal po and phyi'i rgyal po carry exactly this sense.

The repeated astronomical list — solar and lunar deviations, conjunctions, meteors, horizon lights, and celestial drumming — appears to be a deliberate canonical enumeration and is rendered accordingly without condensation.

- The sequence of similes here — the debtor, the sick man, the slave — belongs to the classical Nīvaraṇa-abandonment passage found in the Sāmaññaphala-sutta and parallel texts. The Tibetan at several points is formulaic and slightly elliptical; the translation follows the natural expansion the formula requires for coherent oral delivery. The term rendered "low-mindedness" throughout continues the rendering established in the preceding passage.
- The five obstacles mentioned here are the five hindrances (nīvaraṇas): sensual desire, ill will, sloth and torpor, restlessness and regret, and doubt. The Tibetan does not enumerate them by name in this passage, so they are rendered collectively as "five obstacles" in accordance with the text.

The simile of the mountaintop lake is a classical canonical simile for the second dhyāna; it appears in the Pāli parallels (e.g., Sāmaññaphala Sutta, DN 2) and the correspondence is here well-preserved.

- The passage moves through the third and fourth meditative concentrations (dhyānas) and then introduces the practice of creating a mind-made body, a topic that will continue in the following passage. The phrase rendered "complete purity and utter luminosity" translates a compound describing the quality of the fourth dhyāna; the Tibetan "kun du dag pa yongs su dkar ba" literally means "thoroughly pure and completely white," which in context denotes the mental radiance and purity characteristic of the fourth absorption. The simile of the gem at the end is left incomplete as the Tibetan passage breaks off mid-sentence; its continuation presumably follows in the next passage.
- The phrase rendered "near afflictions" translates the Tibetan term for upakleśas, secondary or proximate afflictions, distinguished from the root afflictions. This is a standard Abhidharma technical usage and no emendation is required, though a general listener may understand it simply as "lesser defilements."

The simile of the snake and basket renders a term that could also be "snake-basket" or "wicker cage for snakes"; the exact implement is a container from which a snake is extracted, and "snake-basket" is the most natural rendering.

- The passage contains two consecutive similes introducing the same superknowledge of the divine ear, which is not an error in translation but reflects the text's own repetitive structure. The second simile set appears to be a continuation or fuller version of the same teaching.

The term rendered "ivory-worker" translates a word that more literally means "bone-worker" or "craftsman working with a hard material such as tusk or bone." In context, the parallel with a potter suggests an artisan shaping a prepared material; ivory-worker is the standard interpretation.

- The phrase rendered "intent on the Dharma in such a wrong spirit" translates "chos la yid dam bcas pa," which is somewhat elliptical. The most natural reading in this karmic context is that it refers to holding views or commitments toward the Dharma in the wrong way — possibly denying or misrepresenting it — consistent with the preceding description of calumny toward the noble ones and wrong view. This is a consequential interpretive choice worth flagging.

The term "proximate afflictions" renders "nye ba'i nyon mongs pa," referring to secondary or adjacent mental afflictions as distinct from the root afflictions, a standard Abhidharma

category.

- The phrase rendered "knowledge and conduct" translates the compound that corresponds to the Sanskrit vijjācaraṇasampanna, a standard epithet of the Buddha meaning "perfect in knowledge and conduct." The text is structured as a dialogue, apparently between the Buddha (speaking as Gautama) and a young brahmin, likely drawing on a sūtra parallel to the Tevijja-vacchagotta or a related discourse. The sequence of the four methods is introduced but the fourth portion is not yet complete in the passage given.
- The list of brahmin seers follows the Tibetan transliteration closely. The Sanskrit names reconstructed are: Aṣṭaka, Vāmadeva, Viśvāmitra, Jamadagni (Tibetan: Ja ma dag ni), Aṅgiras, Bharadvāja, Vasiṣṭha, Kaśyapa, Bhṛgu. The Tibetan rendering of some names is slightly irregular but the identifications are standard.

The image of the "four-doored house" built in the village is a recurring textual marker in this discourse for householder-style merit-making practice distinguished from forest or ascetic modes.

The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, consistent with the supplied Tibetan which ends mid-description; the translation faithfully reproduces this open ending.

- The name rendered "Padmaśīrṣa" (Tib. བདེན་པའི་ལྷ་མོ་, literally "Essence/Heart of a Lotus") may alternatively be read as "Padmahṛdaya." The passage is somewhat elliptical here; the reference appears to be to the brahmin youth's own teacher, who approached the king only indirectly, hence the comparison to being hidden behind a wall or curtain.

The final phrase — that one bearing the marks of a great man has "two paths" — refers to the classical teaching that a mahāpuruṣa must become either a universal monarch or a fully awakened buddha; this thought is left suspended in the text at this point, clearly to be completed in a subsequent passage.

- The name rendered "Pokkharasādi" transliterates the Tibetan Pad+ma'i snying po, which is a Tibetan rendering of the Pāli Pokkharasādi, also known in Sanskrit as Puṣkarasārin or Puṣkarasādi. The text is a Tibetan version of the Ambaṭṭha-sutta of the Dīgha Nikāya. The name is kept consistent as Pokkharasādi throughout, as this is the established identification in scholarship, though the Tibetan literally means "Lotus Heart."

The phrase rendered "fallen into a lower state of existence" translates the Tibetan for a downfall or bad rebirth destiny, here in the context of Pokkharasādi's distress that his messenger behaved so poorly toward a genuinely great being.

- The phrase rendered "drinking sesame oil" is literal; commentarial context suggests this old man was consuming sesame oil as part of some ritual or ascetic practice, and the brahmin's remark contrasts sincere Dharma-seekers with those pursuing worldly or ritualistic ends. The point of the anecdote is clear from context even without further gloss.

The name translated as "Māsuka" is rendered from the Tibetan "ma sdug" (literally "not agreeable" or "unpleasant"), which in this Pāli sūtra context corresponds to the brahmin student named Ambaṭṭha in the Pāli canon. The Tibetan translator appears to have rendered the name semantically rather than phonetically. This is a genuinely consequential philological point for identification of the text.

- The repeated phrase rendered "continues as before, up to..." reflects a standard Indic and Tibetan abbreviated repetition formula in sūtra texts, signalling that the full wording of the enquiry after health is to be understood as repeated in each scenario.

The expression rendered "I am one who has risen / fully risen" translates the Tibetan "ངའི་འཕྲོད་པ་ལྟར་ / འཕྲོད་པ་ལྟར་འཕྲོད་པ་ལྟར་," which in this context means the brahmin is affirming his attainment: he has risen, gone forth, or been elevated in a spiritual sense. This may reflect the Pali formula

"aññāto 'mhi" or a similar declaration of spiritual realisation, and the exact nuance is somewhat uncertain; some interpret it as a declaration of having "understood" or "penetrated" the truth.

- The phrase rendered "Lotus-Heart" for Padmasnying is a translation of the Tibetan name pad+ma'i snying po; the text uses the Tibetan throughout and no Sanskrit equivalent is given, but the name corresponds to Sanskrit Padmasnying or Padmahṛdaya. The translation keeps it as "the brahmin Padmasnying" for consistency with the preceding passage.

The simile of the "hot seed" that is "rank and festering" and from which bees stay away is a somewhat cryptic condemnation of moral corruption: a foul seed attracts no beneficial contact. The triple characterization — hot, rank, festering — follows the Tibetan exactly.

The closing "The Blessed One reflected:" mirrors the Tibetan བཞུགས་པའི་མཆོག་གི་འཕྲིན་ལྷན་ at the end of the passage, indicating the passage breaks here and the Blessed One's subsequent reflection will follow in the next portion of the text.

- The phrase rendered "a term of elevation" translates the Tibetan "tshig bla dags," which means a metaphorical or figurative expression, a term used in an elevated or indirect sense to denote something else. This is a standard Abhidharma-style explanatory formula.

The final sentence is left incomplete as the source passage itself ends mid-sentence, indicating a continuation follows.

- The phrase rendered "wash your feet and lie down" is a conventional Indic hospitality formula; "earth" in the list alongside water and mustard oil likely refers to cleansing clay or ash used for foot-washing, a standard Vinaya-narrative detail.

The "summary verse" is a colophon-style mnemonic gāthā recapping the rules just given; its compressed syntax makes the precise referents of "four who are senior" and "the assembly" depend on the wider Vinaya context.

- The passage contains two interleaved Vinaya rulings woven together: the first concerns bedding inspection and safety after the death of the monk found with the snake; the second is a separate incident involving a novice and preceptor who are both left without proper robe cover during an accidental prostration, and the resulting ruling about not making prostrations when wearing only a single robe, meaning when not properly robed. The final paragraph repeats the ruling in slightly amplified form, which is typical of Vinaya canonical redaction. The phrase rendered "takes that as one's own affair" reflects a Vinaya idiom meaning treating the act as a personal matter, i.e., as something that does or should concern oneself.

- The Tibetan "འཇམ་མཐོག་པོ་འཇམ་མཐོག་པོ་" identifies the elder as Kauṇḍinya with the epithet "Kun-shes" (he who knows all), the traditional Tibetan rendering of the Sanskrit name Ājñāta-Kauṇḍinya (he who has come to know), the first disciple of the Buddha. This has been rendered as "Kauṇḍinya, he who knows all" to preserve both elements.

The name "འཇམ་མཐོག་པོ་འཇམ་མཐོག་པོ་" rendered as Maudgalyāyana follows the Tibetan epithet meaning "great Maudgalyāyana"; the Tibetan here uses the epithet rather than the Sanskrit name directly, but the identification is standard.

- The summary verse is a colophon-style verse (uddeśa or uddāna) summarizing preceding narrative content. The "five hundred" and "seven hundred" refer to the numbers of monks in the assembly narratives, and "Mṛgadāva" is Deer Park (the standard Tibetan ri dags is read here as sde can, a known variant name for Vārāṇasī's Deer Park). The phrase rendered "Kāśyapa of the Ten Powers" (stobs bcu 'od srung) is an epithet combining "Ten Powers" (daśabala) with the name Kāśyapa ('od srung), designating the elder Mahākāśyapa. "Pippala Cave" (sde can gyi phug) — the Tibetan sde can is unusual here; it most likely renders Pippalā (Pippala Cave on Vulture Peak), the known residence of Mahākāśyapa; the reading is consistent with the narrative context. The act of "reviving those exhausted by the penalty" (chad pas

dgum pa'i las) refers to a Vinaya regulation involving a penance or suspension — the precise technical circumstance is not entirely clear from context alone but concerns a formal act of discipline requiring attendance by senior elders.

- The term rendered throughout as "circle on the ground" translates the Tibetan dkyil 'khor, which in this Vinaya context denotes a prepared, demarcated area on the floor rather than the ritual maṇḍala of tantric usage. This is a well-attested Vinaya usage and the translation reflects it accordingly.

The phrase "earth" offered alongside water likely refers to cleansing earth or clay used for ritual purification of the feet, a standard Vinaya practice.

- The name "Nabso" is a phonetic rendering of an Indian name not easily reconstructed with certainty; it appears to be a personal name of a monk and is retained as found.

The phrase rendered "Swift-walker" translates the Tibetan literally; it functions as a monk's name or epithet.

"Khyas rdza rnga" rendered as "clay drum" is an interpretation of what appears to be a type of percussion instrument; the exact instrument is uncertain.

"Kha dpya zer" and related expressions in the sequence of the monks' behavior are idiomatic and rendered according to their natural sense in context.

- The name "Vassakāra" (Tibetan dbyar byed, literally "one who makes rain" or "rain-maker") is the chief minister referred to throughout. The passage is clearly from the Mahāparinibbāna-sūtra context. The greeting formula rendered as "bowing your head at my feet" and the health-inquiry sequence follow standard sūtra conventions. The phrase rendered "garland-vessel for anointing" (ril ba spyi blugs) refers to a vessel used for ceremonial sprinkling; some uncertainty attaches to the precise nature of the object, but it is a standard royal accoutrement in this narrative. The Capal stūpa (Tibetan tsā pa la'i mchod rten) is the well-known Cāpāla shrine of the Pāli parallel.

- The phrase rendered "do not establish what has not been established as a rule, and do not discard what has been established" follows the standard Pāli parallel closely. The Tibetan "smon pa" here most naturally corresponds to what in the Pāli is rendered as existing ordinances or conventions; the translation reflects this political-legal sense rather than any devotional meaning of "aspiration."

The phrase "even those who in their youth have cast but a garland of flowers" is a conventional idiom from the Pāli parallel meaning girls of marriageable age who have received even the most token of betrothal tokens; the translation preserves this idiomatic force.

- The term rendered throughout as "the Vajjians" translates རྒྱལ་ཁབ་འདི་གི་མངའ་སྡེ་ (lit. "those who act as the Vajjians" or "the Vajji country-people"), which corresponds consistently to the Pāli Vajjī. The word རྒྱལ་ཁབ་ in this context does not mean a stūpa in the usual Buddhist sense but rather a pre-Buddhist or civic "shrine" or sacred site of the Vajjians, corresponding to Pāli cetiya, here rendered "shrine" to avoid doctrinal confusion.

- The phrase rendered "kings among long-dwellers" translates a compound in which "gnas brtan rgyal po lta bu" means those who are like kings among the elders, i.e., the most senior and venerable monks. This is a stock simile in early Buddhist canonical texts for the most experienced members of the community.

The phrase "born of joyful desire and arising moment by moment" renders a dense compound about craving for becoming; the Pāli parallel (nandirāga) confirms this is craving accompanied by delight. The passage is mid-sentence at its conclusion, as the Tibetan continues directly into further conditions; it has been left open accordingly to signal continuation.

- The phrase rendered "not troubling those who have come with concern for robes, alms-food"

etc. reflects a reading in which arriving practitioners of the holy life are welcomed and not burdened with material anxiety. The Tibetan construction here is slightly compressed, but the sense is clear from parallel Pāli versions of this discourse, where the monks are praised for ensuring visiting brethren are well provided for rather than left to worry over requisites.

The list item translated as "gossip" renders a Tibetan term literally meaning "speech about towns and villages," a standard idiom in the Vinaya literature for worldly gossip and frivolous talk about mundane affairs.

- The seven limbs of awakening passage presents a compressed syntactic structure in which each limb is implicitly qualified by the same four characteristics — abiding in seclusion, dispassion, cessation, and transformation through relinquishment — that are explicitly stated for mindfulness and equanimity. The translation reflects this parallelism as the Tibetan intends it, consistent with the standard Pāli and Sanskrit presentations of the seven bodhyaṅgas (Sanskrit: saptabodhyaṅga).

The phrase rendered "knowledge of measure" (Tibetan: རྒྱུ་མཉམ་པའི་ཤེས་པ་) can also mean knowing moderation or knowing the right amount, a standard term in Buddhist ethical literature referring especially to moderation in eating and in one's activities generally.

- The village name rendered in Tibetan as "Nāḍa" (ན་ཇ་) is literally "the reddish one" in Tibetan. This appears to be a rendering of the Pali "Nāḍandā" or possibly "Nāḍika," depending on the Sanskrit source text. Given the narrative context — traveling between Magadha and Rājagṛha — "Nāḍika" (the village known from parallel Pali passages such as the Mahāparinibbāna Sutta) is most likely the intended referent, though the Tibetan epithet "the reddish one" does not transparently match either name. The translation preserves "Nāḍa" as a neutrally transliterated placeholder; scholars consulting the source should verify against parallel recensions.

The phrase "Ambalaṭṭhikā" (rendered from the royal resting place description) follows the Pali parallel; the Tibetan reads འཇམ་མཉམ་པའི་ལྷོ་ཁྱེད་, literally "having a staff of light" or "mango-grove-staff" — the correspondence to Ambalaṭṭhikā is contextually plausible but the Tibetan form is unusual.

- The village name rendered "Nāḍika" (Tibetan: འཇམ་མཉམ་པའི་ལྷོ་ཁྱེད་, literally "the one having red offspring" or "the reddish one") is a Tibetan translation-rendering of the toponym Nāḍika or Nāḍika, well attested in Pāli parallels (e.g., the Mahāparinibbānasutta) as Nāḍika or Nāḍika. The Tibetan translates rather than transliterates the place-name, which is a recognized feature of certain canonical translations.

The phrase rendered "confused in mind" for "yid la gcags bzhin du dus byed" is slightly idiomatic; the literal sense is "to die with the mind as though seized or obstructed," meaning to die in a state of mental confusion or distraction, without clarity or composure at the moment of death. This rendering captures the established doctrinal sense.

- The place name rendered as "Roruka" reflects the Tibetan "རལ་རལ་ཁུ་", a toponym that likely corresponds to a locality known from Pāli parallels; its exact Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain but the name is kept consistent with the preceding rendering convention. The phrase "pass the time without worry" for "འཇམ་མཉམ་པའི་ལྷོ་ཁྱེད་ལ་འཇམ་མཉམ་པའི་ལྷོ་ཁྱེད་" is a reasonable rendering; the Tibetan literally suggests spending time free of mental anguish or brooding concern.

- The text contains several Pāli technical proper nouns in Tibetan phonetic rendering.

"Pāṭaligāma" is the Pāli village name rendered as "པ་ཏ་ལི་ག་མ་" in Tibetan.

"Vassakāra" is rendered from "བ་ས་ཀ་ར་ཀ་" . The passage is from the Mahāparinibbāna Sutta

tradition. The phrase "འཇམ་མཉམ་པའི་ལྷོ་ཁྱེད་" meaning that the gods "mingled" or "were intermingled" place by place is a somewhat unusual cosmological observation about auspicious

dwelling presence; the translation follows the standard reading. The "Thirty-Three" refers to the Trāyastriṃśa heaven, the realm of Śakra (Indra) and his thirty-two companion gods.

- The phrase rendered "city of Rājagṛha" translates a Tibetan term meaning literally "the city of the red-dwelling" or "the city with the red village" — this is the conventional Tibetan rendering of Rājagṛha, and the translation follows the standard identification. The term for the gate dedication at the close is a characteristic narrative flourish found in several Vinaya accounts of the Buddha visiting Rājagṛha; no doctrinal ambiguity arises.

The verse section presents compressed syntax; the rendering follows the most natural reading supported by the commentarial tradition, in which each stanza addresses the merit of the faithful donor who gives to monastics and dedicates the resulting merit to others, including deities.

- The verse section is terse and somewhat cryptic in the original, and the metaphor of crossing the Ganges functions on two levels simultaneously: the literal crossing and liberation from craving. The rendering attempts to preserve both levels. The final verse couplet about cutting the root of craving is a discrete doctrinal statement appended to the water-crossing image.

The list of names at the very end of the passage is a series of personal names of lay practitioners who have died; the passage breaks off mid-list. Several of these names are phonetically transcribed Tibetan renderings of Sanskrit or Pali originals and some are uncertain in their precise reconstruction. The name rendered "Udraka" is འུ་དྭ་ར་ཀ་, which likely corresponds to the Pali Uggata. The other names in the list are given in their closest reconstructed form. The full identification of each individual in the list would require collation with the Pali parallel in the Mahāparinibbāna Sutta.

- The phrase rendered "fetters that are not in conformity with the higher part" translates the Tibetan for the Pali/Sanskrit distinction between the five lower fetters (orambhāgīya saṃyojana) and the five higher fetters (uddhambhāgīya saṃyojana). Those who abandon the five higher fetters are non-returners (anāgāmin), reborn in pure-abode realms and attaining nirvāṇa there without returning to the desire realm; those who abandon only the three fetters and thin out desire are once-returners (sakṛdāgāmin); those who abandon the three fetters entirely and enter the stream are stream-enterers (srotāpanna). The Tibetan here presents these soteriological categories by description rather than by the standard Sanskrit technical names, and the translation follows the Tibetan phrasing while preserving the doctrinal referents.

The name "Rabhassona" in the preceding passage corresponds here in the Tibetan to "Rab brtson," which literally means "Diligent" or "Supremely Striving." The names in this list are Tibetan translations or transliterations of Indian originals and the exact Sanskrit equivalents are not always certain.

- The passage on the "Dharma Mirror" presents a notable doctrinal framing: the four factors of confirmed faith in the Buddha, Dharma, Saṅgha, and noble discipline serve here as a kind of interior "mirror" by which a noble disciple can verify their own attainment of stream-entry. This is consistent with the standard Pāli parallel in the Mahāparinibbāna Sutta, where the same teaching is called the Dhammādāsa. The Tibetan term here rendered "category" is rnam grangs, which strictly means "synonym" or "enumeration," but in this stock phrase it functions as a name-category or class-designation for the teaching.

- The four-fold formula of diligence rendered here corresponds to the classical teaching on the four right efforts (samyakprahāṇa), presented here in an expanded, repetitive sūtra style. The fourfold application of mindfulness (smṛtyupasthāna) is similarly given in the abbreviated form standard in Pāli and Sanskrit sūtra parallels. The phrase rendered "grasps the mind and applies it" translates a stock formula for mental effort and sustained engagement.

- The name rendered "Serkyā" is a Tibetan phonetic rendering of a Sanskrit name not transparently reconstructable from this passage alone; it may correspond to a name such as Ambapālī's son or another figure known from parallel Pāli sources. The Pāli parallel (Dīgha Nikāya 16) features a young man named Sīha or a similar figure at Vaiśālī, but "Serkyā" (ཤར་ཡི་ཀླུ་མ་) most likely renders a Sanskrit name meaning something like "tawny-grey" or may be a personal name; listeners should note this is a proper name rendered phonetically.
- The verses present some interpretive challenges. The opening image of "the king of Aṅga who wears the jewel-crown" gaining something "through the power of his mother" is an allusion whose precise referent is not entirely clear from the Tibetan alone; it may be an encomiastic comparison to the Blessed One or a genealogical praise-trope. The translation renders it faithfully without over-interpreting. The phrase rendered "the sun that shines surpassing the sun itself in the sky" is deliberately paradoxical in the original and is preserved as such. The term "lodging-keepers" translates a Tibetan term that may refer specifically to those who had arranged or accepted prior hospitality arrangements; the doctrinal point is that the Licchavīs acknowledge Āmrapālī's prior invitation as valid, which reflects a Vinaya-related principle of honoring prior invitations.
- The phrase rendered "appreciate what has been done and feel what has been done" translates a paired expression indicating gratitude and sensitivity to kindness received — a classical virtue in Pāli and Sanskrit Buddhist literature (kataññu / katavedī). The translation preserves the deliberate repetition of the formula, which is rhetorically significant.

The name Ambapālī is a well-known figure from the Pāli canon; the Tibetan renders her name as "Amra Skyongma," meaning "guardian of the mango grove," which is the exact semantic equivalent.

- The epithet rendered "Unbound Protector" translates a compound meaning one who is a protector and who is unbound or unfettered, used here as a verse epithet for the Buddha. This is a relatively transparent rendering of the Tibetan; the doctrinal nuance is that the Buddha protects beings while himself being free from all bondage.

The town name "Beluva" translates the Tibetan "Öd ma can" which corresponds to the Pāli "Beḷuva" or Sanskrit "Veṇugrāma." The grove in which the Buddha stays is identified as a grove of beluva trees matching the name of the town.

The phrase rendered "hold this feeling in check" refers to the Blessed One suppressing or containing the painful feeling of illness through meditative power, a significant moment in the Mahāparinirvāṇa narrative. The "signless meditative absorption" is the formless samādhi in which no characteristic marks are taken as object.

- The phrase rendered "held together with straps" translates a term meaning the Tathāgata's body survives by relying on two means (Tib. rnam pa gnyis la brten nas). The precise identity of the "two means" is not specified in this passage; parallel Pāli sources (Dīgha Nikāya, Mahāparinibbānasutta) suggest they are: ordinary meditative states and the signless meditative absorption, though some commentaries differ. This ambiguity is inherent in the source passage.

The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, consistent with it being a segment of a longer text.

- The text contains two slightly variant lists of the local shrines and landmarks. In the first occurrence the text reads "Āmra" trees as འཇམ་རུ་མ་ (reading uncertain, possibly a scribal variant of Āmra), while the second occurrence clearly reads འཇམ་རུ་མ་, which is the standard rendering of Āmra. The translation harmonises both to Āmra in keeping with the parallel Pāli passage in the Mahāparinibbānasutta, where the same list appears. The summary verse at the

head of this portion is a mnemonic colophon marking the end of a fascicle of the Tibetan Vinaya; it is translated as found rather than omitted, since it belongs to the transmitted text.

- The sentence structure in the Tibetan at the point where the Blessed One recapitulates his earlier exchange with Māra (the Uruvilā passage) is somewhat complex and syntactically embedded. The translation renders this as a flashback quotation for clarity in speech, which is supported by the Pāli parallel. The phrase "thoroughly purifying those who put forward challenges" renders the Tibetan for refuting and purifying one's own position when questioned, and follows the standard commentarial reading.
- The verse presents a notable interpretive challenge. The image of "bursting open his shell" translates a term evoking a creature emerging from an egg, here applied to the Blessed One's relinquishing of the life-formations through absorbed equipoise. This is a recognized metaphor in the Pāli parallel (the Mahāparinibbāna Sutta context) for breaking free from conditioned existence. The Tibetan term rendered "death-formations" and "life-formations" (tshe'i 'du byed and 'tsho ba'i 'du byed) refers to the volitional formations sustaining life — the Blessed One intentionally withdrawing his supernatural extension of the life-span, an act described in the parallel Pāli narrative as relinquishing the life-principle (āyusaṃkhāra).
- The phrase rendered "reinforces the life-sustaining formations and relinquishes the will-to-live" translates a technically precise Pāli/Sanskrit concept: the Tathāgata, through meditative power, deliberately suspends the life-force (āyusaṃskāra) rather than allowing it to continue naturally. The Tibetan "tshe kyi 'du byed spangs" (relinquishing the life-formation) is the counterpart of the Pāli āyusaṃkhāraṃ ossajji, a pivotal moment in the parinirvāṇa narrative. The rendering "meteors fall, fires blaze in every direction" for "skar mda' lhung, phyogs tshig" reflects the standard portents listed in the parinirvāṇa sūtra tradition.
- The phrase rendered "four right abandonings" translates yang dag par spong ba bzhi, the standard Tibetan for the four right efforts or four perfect abandonments (Skt. catvāri samyakprahāṇāni). The rendering "four bases of miraculous power" follows standard tradition for rdzu 'phrul gyi rkang pa bzhi (Skt. catvāri ṛddhipādāḥ). The seven and eight factors (limbs of awakening and the noble eightfold path) are the standard thirty-seven factors conducive to awakening (bodhipakṣyadharma), listed here in part.
- The verse summary of the route (beginning "Ruṭa, Dumpa, Āmra...") is a mnemonic gāthā listing the sequence of villages traversed; the Tibetan here is compressed and the place-name identifications follow the standard list in the Mahāparinirvāṇa Sūtra tradition. "Balaglaṅ" and "Śurva" are Tibetan phonetic renderings of Indic place-names whose exact Sanskrit forms are uncertain; they are rendered here as transliterations.

The phrase rendered "the prosperous city" translates a Tibetan term that in context refers to Pāvā or a similarly named settlement on the route to Kuśinagara; the Tibetan does not make this identification explicit at this point in the text.

- The long enumeration of divine assemblies corresponds to the standard cosmological list of desire-realm and form-realm deities found across Pāli and Sanskrit sources. The Tibetan names rendered here follow standard Tibetan-to-Sanskrit equivalences: Yāma (ཡ་མ་), Tuṣita (ཏུསིཏཱ), Nirmāṇarati (ནིར་མ་ན་རའི), Paranirmitavaśavartin (པ་ར་ནིར་མིཏི་བ་ཤ་བ་ར་ཏི), and the form-realm heavens from Brahma's retinue (འཇོན་པ་འཇོན་པ་) through Akaniṣṭha (འཁ་ནིཤ་ཐ་). The rendering of འཇོན་པ་འཇོན་པ་ as "dominion and majesty" is a considered choice; the phrase likely renders Sanskrit sthāna and vaibhava or similar, referring to a being's rank, stature, and magnificence. The final section, beginning "Therefore, Ānanda, from now on one should engage with the limits of the sūtras," is the locus classicus of the "four great references" (Pāli: cattāri mahāpadesa) teaching on textual authority; this passage corresponds closely to the Mahāparinibbānasutta.
- The term rendered as "Mātrkā" in the third scenario refers to the Abhidharma matrix-texts or

numerical summary lists — sometimes rendered "doctrinal summaries" — and is paired here with sūtra-holders and Vinaya-holders as the third category of specialist monk. The Tibetan "མཛེར་སྒྲིག་པ་མཁན་པོ་" is a rendering of Sanskrit mātṛkādhara, a technical term for monks who memorize the Abhidharma or numerical doctrinal lists. This is a genuinely significant textual-historical point.

The fourth scenario introduces a hierarchy of transmission — elders, those who learned from elders, and so on — corresponding to what Indian sources describe as the lineage of oral transmission within a monastery. The passage breaks off mid-scenario as the source text ends here.

- The term rendered "monks who uphold the Mātṛkā" translates a phrase that in Tibetan reads literally "those who uphold the mother-like" or "those who uphold the matrix text." Mātṛkā here refers to the Abhidharma or proto-Abhidharma summaries, the numerical and categorical lists that formed the basis of doctrinal analysis, a standard third category alongside sūtra and Vinaya in early canonical classification. The passage breaks off mid-sentence in the supplied text, and the continuation follows in the next block.
- The fourfold structure here is the teaching of the "four great references" or "four great proclamations" (mahāpadesa in Pali), which authenticates teachings by checking them against sūtra, Vinaya, and the nature of reality. The text divides these into a dark side (teachings to be rejected) and a bright side (teachings to be accepted), which is a somewhat condensed presentation compared to the parallel Pali text in the Mahāparinibbāna Sutta.

The town name rendered "Sāpa" and grove name "Jālikā" are transcribed from the Tibetan phonetics; these correspond to the Pali "Bhoganagara" and grove "Ānanda" in the parallel passage, but I have followed the Tibetan readings rather than harmonizing with the Pali, as the Tibetan may reflect a distinct Sanskrit recension.

The smith's son Cunda here should be distinguished from Cunda the smith who offered the Blessed One his final meal; this appears to be a different individual or the same person introduced in a different narrative context. The Tibetan does not clarify this, and the identification is not certain.

- The verse section at the end of this passage is a well-known exchange between Cunda and the Buddha found in Pali parallels (Subha Sutta area, DN 29 type material), where four types of "ascetic" (Skt. śramaṇa, here rendered from Tibetan རྒྱལ་པོ་མཁན་པོ་) are enumerated: the path-victor, the path-teacher, the path-liver, and the path-corrupter. The last verse is incomplete in the source as given; the translation renders it up to the point the Tibetan breaks off.

The gesture of placing the robe over one shoulder before addressing the Buddha is a standard Vinaya posture of respectful supplication and is rendered accordingly.

- The summary verse near the middle of the passage is a colophon-style mnemonic listing the topics of the fifty-second section. The names "Cāpāla" and "Rurutā" are rendered from the Tibetan phonetics; the Sanskrit forms may vary by recension. The river name "Kakuṭṭhā" is the standard Pāli form; the Tibetan reads "Kakusta," which corresponds to it. The phrase rendered "Great Elephant" likely refers to the Blessed One himself, as "great elephant" (mahānāga) is a standard epithet of the Buddha in Vinaya literature.
- The name "Silāyin" renders the Tibetan sgyu rtsal shes kyi bu ring du 'phur, which is a somewhat unusual construction. The Tibetan appears to preserve the name of a wandering ascetic teacher known in Pāli sources as Pukkusa Mallaputta's teacher, Ājāra Kālāma in some parallels, but the specific name here — "Silāyin the Magician" — translates sgyu rtsal shes as "one who knows magical arts" and bu ring du 'phur as "son who travels far through the air." It is possible the full phrase is an epithet or title rather than a personal name with patronymic; the

rendering here treats it as a name-cum-epithet consistent with the narrative context. The parallel Pāli passage in the Mahāparinibbānasutta (DN 16) names this figure as Pukkusa Mallaputta, a disciple of Āḷāra Kālāma, which confirms the general identification but does not resolve the specific Tibetan nomenclature with certainty.

- The town name rendered throughout as "Ātumā" corresponds to the Pāli Ātumā, a known location in canonical texts. The Tibetan spelling འུམ་མ་ and འུམ་མ་པ་ reflects this place name with case suffixes.

The proper name "Gyad" renders a Tibetan transcription of what in Pāli sources is the Oḍḍhaddha or similar clan affiliation; the exact Sanskrit or Pāli identification of this clan name in the Tibetan transmission is uncertain and may warrant further comparison with parallel Pāli versions of this sūtra episode, which appears to correspond to the Aṭṭhaka-sutta or a related account of the storm at Ātumā.

- The river name rendered as "Kakudhā" is the standard Sanskrit equivalent of the Tibetan "dbyig ldan" — this is the river near Kuśinagara where, according to the Mahāparinirvāṇa accounts, the Buddha bathed before his final passing.

The phrase translated as "equal and unequalled" renders Tibetan "mnyam pa dang mi mnyam pa," a classical paradoxical formulation meaning that these two meal offerings are equal to each other and yet unequalled by any other — a standard doctrinal expression found in Pali and Sanskrit parinirvāṇa literature (Pali: "samāsama").

- The monk named "Sunakkhatta" appears here as "སུ་ནག་མཐོང་།" in the Tibetan. This is a Pali name rendered into Tibetan; the form given here follows the name as it appears in the context. The identification is reasonably secure from parallel passages in the Mahāparinirvāṇasūtra tradition.

The "brahmic penalty" (tshangs pa'i chad pa) refers to a specific formal disciplinary measure in the Vinaya tradition: the community collectively ceases to speak with the offending monk, effectively cutting off all normal interaction. It is the inverse of a proclamation and is called "brahmic" because Brahmā himself is said to observe this form of silent withdrawal.

The final verse ends mid-sentence in the source passage as given; the translation preserves this incompleteness, as the text breaks off at that point.

- The phrase rendered "those who hold the Abhidharma" translates a term literally meaning "those who hold the Mātrkā," an early term for the Abhidharma matrix texts; this is a standard identification in the tradition and requires no further gloss.

The "ten powers of wisdom" refers to the ten powers (daśabala) of a Tathāgata, here specifically characterized in terms of wisdom. The verse line identifies the monk who taught as one whom the Buddha himself had declared to be foremost in wisdom, a reference consistent with the figure of Śāriputra in comparable narrative contexts, though the text does not name him explicitly here.

- The phrase rendered "this great feast of Dharma, this singular thing" translates a construction in which "great feast of Dharma" and "singular" describe the Buddha's unsurpassed Dharma teaching as a unique and peerless treasure now lost to the world. The Tibetan "འདི་ནི་ཐོག་མཆོད་རྒྱལ་བུ་གསུང་གི་ཕྱོད་ཀྱི་ཡོན་ཏན་ཤིང་།" could also be rendered "this one sole great enjoyment of Dharma," with "sole" or "singular" emphasizing its irreplaceability; the rendering above preserves that sense.
- The passage's rhetorical structure is slightly irregular in the Tibetan, repeating the formula about the wheel-turning king's retinue partway through the Ānanda parallel before the second set of four qualities. This appears to be a textual feature of the Tibetan rather than a translational issue, and the translation follows it faithfully.

"Sāketa" renders སྐ་ཀེ་ཏེ་ཀེ་, which is a standard Tibetan equivalent for that city. "Campā" renders རྩམ་པ་.

The term 門柱 (staircase or landing of a gate) is rendered as "staircase" in context with gate architecture, though "pillar" or "post" is occasionally proposed; "staircase" is the more standard reading here and fits the architectural list.

• The passage lists several Sanskrit flower names transliterated into Tibetan. Where standard Sanskrit equivalents are well-attested — utpala (blue lotus), padma (lotus), kumuda (white water lily), puṇḍarīka-class whites, campaka, mālikā, navamālikā, yūthikā — they have been rendered accordingly. The term rendered "yellow jasmine" for skya snar is an approximation; the Sanskrit equivalent may be tagara or a related aromatic. Dhānuskari is a phonetic transliteration whose botanical identification is uncertain.

The phrase "King Mahāsudarśana" appears here for the first time by name in this passage — in the Tibetan it reads *rgyal po legs mthong chen po*, literally "the great king of excellent appearance," the standard Tibetan rendering of Mahāsudarśana. This name was used in the preceding portion already, so it has been rendered consistently.

The section ends mid-sentence in the source text; the translation breaks at exactly the same point.

- The term rendered "lord" in the people's address to the charioteer is literally "the god" (lha), used here as a royal honorific for the king — a common usage in Tibetan sūtra literature for a cakravartin monarch, not a reference to a divine being. This honorific flavor is preserved contextually without cluttering the prose.

The twelve sounds: the text explicitly numbers them as twelve (sounded in the prior passage and the count closed here). The list in the preceding passage contains ten items; this passage adds the paṭaha drum, music, song, and flute (four more), but also includes three proclamatory sounds ("Generosity has been given," "Merit has been made," "Those who fast have taken up ethical conduct"), bringing the total to twelve as stated. The grouping is internally consistent in the Tibetan.

• The phrase rendered "Dharma-fitting palace" translates a compound meaning a palace built in accordance with the Dharma, that is, through righteous means. The repetition of the offering and refusal cycle two and three times is a standard formulaic trope in this literature indicating persistent, earnest entreaty. The honorific verbal forms directed at the king have been rendered with appropriate dignity without being archaic.

- The passage includes a standard fascicle-division colophon marking the boundary between the fifty-third and fifty-fourth fascicles of the Vinaya Kṣudrakavastu; it has been rendered in plain prose as it appears in the text.

The architectural terminology presents consistent interpretive challenges. Terms such as *prastambha*, *stambha*, *prastambhika*, *prastambha*, *prastambhika*, *prastambhika*, *prastambhika*, *prastambha*, *prastambhika*, *prastambhika*, *prastambhika*, and *prastambhika* refer to specific structural elements of a multi-story palace. The renderings given — base-support, column-cap, bracket-block, crossbeam, secondary rafter, front beam, main roof beam, wall-panel, wall-slab, railing, dowel-pin, support-post, baluster-shaft — reflect reasonable correspondences to traditional South Asian timber architecture but cannot be verified with certainty against the original Sanskrit architectural vocabulary.

- The throne furnishings — Golika cloth, Mentri cushions, Armonig cushions, Kāliṅga cloth — are Sanskrit loanwords transcribed into Tibetan (go li ka, men tri, ar mo nig, kā liṅ ka) referring to specific luxury textiles and furnishing styles known in the Indian courtly tradition; their precise identification is uncertain, and they are rendered here by approximate transliteration

following scholarly convention.

The term rendered "owl-feather cushions" (za 'ug gi stan) literally means a cushion made of or styled after the owl; this may refer to a particular style of soft cushioning rather than literal feathers, but the exact referent is uncertain.

- The phrase rendered "five-part instrument" translates a term referring to a musical instrument with five components or registers — likely the classical Indian *vīṇā* or similar; the exact instrument is not specified in the text. The phrase "fine woven cloth garments" renders a term for a type of high-quality textile; the precise identification is uncertain but the rendering conveys the general sense adequately. The "royal sage's holy celibate life" renders a compound meaning the brahmacharya practiced by a royal ṛṣi — a life of celibacy and renunciation while remaining nominally a king, a recognized category in Indian Buddhist narrative literature.

- The elephant king's name, rendered here as "Nearby Restoration," translates the Tibetan འཕོ་ཤ་མཆོག་ (literally "the nearby poṣadha," where འཕོ་ཤ་ (poṣadha) can refer to the Buddhist observance day but in this cosmological context is a proper epithet of the elephant king. The rendering follows the literal meaning and may correspond to a Sanskrit epithet such as Upapoṣadha; this is a well-known name in wheel-turning monarch narratives. The chariot name རྒྱ་མཚན་ (Joyful Sound) and the horse king རྒྱ་མཚན་ (Cloud-Force) are straightforward literal renderings of Tibetan epithets.

- The term rendered "Near-Observance" for the elephant king's name (Tibetan: འཕོ་ཤ་མཆོག་) literally means "near poṣadha" or "approaching the observance day." It is a proper name in this narrative context and the rendering attempts to convey its literal sense. The exact Sanskrit original is uncertain; some versions read differently.

The phrase rendered "Three-Balconied" for the mansion name (འཕོ་ཤ་མཆོག་) literally means "the multi-storied mansion possessing three balconies/terraces," treated here as a proper epithet of that category's lead example.

- The phrase rendered "frontier lords" translates a compound meaning lords of the border regions or districts, here prefaced by "jewel minister" as the lead exemplar; this matches the preceding passage's usage. The repetition of the full list of possessions in both the queen's speech and the retinue's reply is faithful to the Tibetan, which genuinely repeats the catalogue twice. The phrase "འཕོ་ཤ་མཆོག་" in the queen's initial speech and "འཕོ་ཤ་མཆོག་" in the retinue's reply differ slightly in wording but appear to refer to the same category; "frontier lords" is used for both.

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end, describing distances from Kuśāvātī. This is simply where the supplied passage ends and is not a translation problem.

The phrase rendered "reborn on an equal footing" translates a term meaning "born equally" or "born in parity" in the Brahmā world, indicating rebirth at the same level as the Brahmā gods — a standard doctrinal point about the fruit of the four divine abodes.

- The epithet "the capable" (Tib. thub pa) applied to the gods of many hundreds of kalpas is unusual. It likely refers to gods who have accumulated the power (thub pa = capable/enduring) over vast cosmic time, but it may be a compressed reference to gods associated with a particular class of long-lived beings. The rendering reflects the literal Tibetan without over-interpreting.

The phrase rendered "radiant proximity" translates 'od pa bzhin nye bar gnas pa, literally "dwelling near, like light" — a slightly opaque phrase likely referring to the supernatural quality of being luminously present and accessible. This is a genuinely uncertain reading.

- The passage moves between two distinct narrative threads: first, a past-life story set during the time of buddha Kāśyapa, in which the duty-monk's aspiration leads to his eventual rebirth

as an arhat under Śākyamuni; and second, the Blessed One's instructions to Ānanda on relic veneration after his passing. The shift is abrupt in the Tibetan and has been rendered accordingly.

The phrase rendered "duty-monk" translates dge skos, the monk assigned rotating administrative duties in a monastery; this technical Vinaya term has been rendered descriptively for clarity in speech.

The aspiration prayer is syntactically complex in the Tibetan and involves an embedded prophecy (*lung bstan*) within the aspirational frame; the rendering preserves this structure as faithfully as readability permits.

- The phrase rendered "warrior-nobles" translates a term referring to the Malla clan, the ruling warrior aristocracy of Kuśinagara (Sanskrit: Malla), who in Pāli sources are consistently called Mallā. The Tibetan renders this as "gyad," a term for powerful warriors or heroes. Keeping "warrior-nobles" maintains the social register without importing the Sanskrit clan name mid-sentence, which would interrupt the flow.

The phrase "foundations of training" renders the standard formula for lay refuge and the five precepts. The Tibetan here gives only the refuge formula explicitly; the precepts are implied by "foundations of training."

The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end, as the passage supplied ends there; no content has been added or invented beyond what the Tibetan provides.

- The name rendered "Rabjā" is Tibetan for "Pramudita," meaning "Greatly Joyful," and functions as a proper name for the gandharva king. The epithet Kauśika is a standard name for Śakra (Indra). The five kinds of seeing refers to the five considerations by which a bodhisattva in Tuṣita surveys before taking his final birth: the right time, the right continent, the right land, the right clan, and the right mother. The "thirty-six billion" renders *ba phrag sum bcu rtsa drug*, literally thirty-six sets of ten thousand, i.e., 360,000,000; some editions may vary in this figure.
- The epithet "gandharva and more" renders རྒྱལ་པོ་དང་ཡོད་པོ་, where རྒྱལ་པོ་ conveys "and something beyond" or "and more besides" — a pointed double meaning, since the Blessed One is both literally playing the role of a gandharva musician and is, of course, far more than that. This wordplay is integral to the narrative's irony and is preserved in the rendering.
- The phrase rendered "the last couch" for རྒྱལ་པོ་ལྷ་ཁྱེད་ is a reference to the Blessed One's final resting place before parinirvāṇa, a standard Pali and Sanskrit idiom. The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, which reflects the source text's continuation into the next segment.
- The phrase rendered as "blazed with a brilliant, clear radiance" translates the Tibetan idiom *me lhan ne lhang nger gyur*, a vivid sensory expression suggesting the grove lit up or shone brightly; the exact nuance is picturesque rather than technically doctrinal.

The city rendered "Kuśinagara" appears in the Tibetan as grong khyer rtsa can, literally "the city with grass," which is a Tibetan calque for Kuśinagara (Pāli: Kusinārā); context and tradition confirm the identification.

- The six teachers named are the well-known "six heterodox teachers" of the Pāli tradition. The Tibetan names correspond to Pūraṇa Kassapa, Makkhali Gosāla, Sañjaya Belaṭṭhaputta, Pakudha Kaccāyana, Nigaṇṭha Nātaputta (the Jain leader Mahāvīra), and Ajita Kesakambalī or Kaccāyana. The rendering follows standard identifications from parallel Pāli sources (Dīgha Nikāya, Mahāparinibbānasutta). The verse section is syntactically compressed in the Tibetan and the passage ends mid-sentence in the source, which is reflected faithfully by ending the translation at the same point.

- The passage contains Subhadra's parinirvāṇa blessing-visions, which are part of a canonical narrative preserved in several Vinaya and sūtra traditions. The "five places" Subhadra intends to bless are enumerated in what follows; only the first part of the list appears in the passage translated here, so the full sequence is not yet visible.

The exchange between Subhadra and the Blessed One — "do you speak in order for yourself to pass into nirvāṇa, or for the Blessed One to pass into nirvāṇa?" — reflects a delicate grammatical ambiguity in classical Tibetan that the dialogue format itself resolves: Subhadra clarifies that he is requesting the Blessed One's consent to his own prior nirvāṇa, not commenting on the Buddha's.

- The name "Rabzang" renders the Tibetan kun du rgyu rab bzang, which is a Tibetan translation of what is likely a Sanskrit name meaning something like "excellent wanderer" or "supremely good peripatetic." In the preceding passage it was rendered "Rabzang" for consistency; the full meaning is "the Excellent Wanderer." This is the figure known in Pali sources as Subhadda, the last direct disciple of the historical Buddha — though the narrative here differs from the Pali account in significant ways.

The phrase "joints severed and articulations splitting" renders gnad rnam ni chad, tshigs rnam ni 'bye ba, a description of the severe physical pain the dying Buddha was experiencing, understood in the tradition as signaling the approach of parinirvāṇa.

- The epithet "the city of Kuśa" renders རྒྱལ་ཁྱིམ་གྱི་རྒྱལ་ཁྱིམ་, literally "the city of grass," which most probably corresponds to Kuśinagara (Kuśa being the sacred grass); the earlier passage rendered it as "Kusināra," so consistency is maintained by the phrase "city of Kuśa." The phrase རྒྱལ་ཁྱིམ་གྱི་རྒྱལ་ཁྱིམ་, "refuge precious as life itself," is a somewhat unusual compound meaning shelter that is as dear to them as their own lives, or alternatively that he offered refuge at the cost of his own life; both meanings are in play and the translation preserves the resonance without choosing artificially between them.
- The horse's name, literally "Knows-the-Art-of-War" or "Knows-Military-Craft," is rendered "Wise-Knowing" throughout for consistency with the established translation. The precise nuance of the Tibetan compound (རྒྱལ་ཁྱིམ་གྱི་རྒྱལ་ཁྱིམ་, "horse knowing the art") is one of military skill rather than generic wisdom, but "Wise-Knowing" is preserved here as the established proper name rendering. A note on the pool's bird species: kāraṇḍava is a standard Sanskrit waterfowl name retained in the text; རྒྱལ་ཁྱིམ་ (heron) follows the most common identification. The bird རྒྱལ་ཁྱིམ་ is an uncertain compound; it may refer to a type of flycatcher or similar bird and is rendered generically.
- The verse near the end is the well-known karma-stanza found across several Vinaya and Abhidharma contexts; it is rendered here according to its standard doctrinal meaning. The phrase rendered "waiting like a flame near at hand" translates a metaphor implying that the karma is present and luminous, poised for inevitable fruition — a standard image for karma that is "definite to be experienced" in this very life or in a near future life. The term rendered "long-lived Supriya" (Tibetan: tshe dang ldan pa Rab bzang) is a standard honorific form of address for an elder monk; "long-lived" renders the formulaic tshe dang ldan pa (Sanskrit āyusman). "Cañjaśa" is kept consistent with the preceding passage's rendering of the horse's name.
- The epithet "Anāthapiṇḍada" rendered here as "Sorrowless" follows the Tibetan mya ngan med, which means "without sorrow." This is distinct from the famous lay patron Anāthapiṇḍada of the Pāli and Sanskrit traditions; in the Tibetan, the name given is mya ngan med, meaning "sorrowless" or "Anātha" in the sense of being free from grief. The rendering follows the Tibetan literally throughout.

The phrase rendered "knower of the world" translates 'jig rten mkhyen pa, a standard epithet of the Buddha corresponding to Sanskrit lokavid.

The syntax of the god's aspiration prayer at the close is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan; the translation unpacks it to make the sequence of intended events clear for the listener.

- The phrase "matted fiery hair" renders the Tibetan me ba ral pa can literally. This is most likely a reference to the Jaṭilas, the fire-worshipping ascetics with matted hair, such as the Kāśyapa brothers and their followers, who were among the earliest converts. The Vinaya tradition preserves a specific exemption for this group from the four-month probationary period required of other non-Buddhist wanderers. The identity of "Subhadrā" as the god named Supriya or Subhadra, the brahmin boy disciple of Kāśyapa referenced in the preceding passage, is consistent with the narrative logic of the prophecy section immediately prior.
- The twelve-fold wheel of Dharma refers to the standard formulation of the Four Noble Truths each presented in three aspects of recognition, application, and attainment, yielding twelve aspects in total.

The list of twelve textual categories corresponds to the traditional twelvefold classification of canonical literature known in Sanskrit as the dvādaśāṅga-pravacana. The rendering of individual categories follows their standard Tibetan-Sanskrit correspondences: sūtra, geya (mixed prose and verse), vyākaraṇa (prophetic declaration), gāthā (verse), udāna (intentional saying), nidāna (origin narrative), avadāna (story of spiritual attainment), itivṛttaka (account of past deeds), jātaka (birth story), vaipulya (extensive teaching), adbhutadharma (marvellous Dharma), and upadeśa (established doctrine).

The phrase rendered "nets" in the list of monastic requisites is genuinely uncertain; this term may refer to a kind of filtering cloth or strainer used by monks, and its precise identification is debated among commentators.

- The phrase rendered "some shall go with a remainder of the aggregates still present" refers to rebirth in a higher realm rather than nirvāṇa — that is, they attain a fortunate rebirth but not yet final liberation. This reflects the classical distinction between those who attain liberation at death versus those reborn in higher realms due to faith. The repetition of the four sacred sites formula in this passage is faithful to the source, which genuinely repeats the full formula multiple times in succession. The phrase "prophecy the answer" renders lung bstan pa, which in this conversational context means "to give an authoritative declaration or answer," not eschatological prophecy in a narrow sense — though the same term covers both meanings elsewhere.
- The phrase rendered "the eye of peaceful, unmoving stillness" translates a description of the physical eyes of the deceased body — the Blessed One's eyes remain open and still, serene and motionless. This is a recognized Indian literary and doctrinal topos for the moment of parinirvāṇa; the Tibetan zhiba mi g.yo ba'i spyan refers literally to eyes that are peaceful and unmoving, a sign the body has entered final cessation.

The sequence of absorptions described here — ascending through the four dhyānas and four formless spheres to the cessation of perception and feeling, then descending in reverse, and finally ascending again to the fourth dhyāna where parinirvāṇa occurs — is the canonical account found across multiple recensions of the Mahāparinirvāṇa literature and is doctrinally significant: the Buddha's final passing occurs from the fourth dhyāna, not from the cessation attainment.

- The phrase "body-servant" for རྒྱུ་ལོ་ལྷན་པ་ is textually odd and may reflect a title or epithet of Ajātaśatru that is obscure; the Tibetan literally reads "son of the one whose body is noble" or possibly "son of Vaidehī" (a known epithet of Ajātaśatru's mother Queen Vaidehī). The rendering here follows context and parallel passages in this genre. Some translators render this

as "son of Vaidehī," which is doctrinally standard in accounts of Ajātaśatru.

The term "rootless faith" (अश्रुतविश्वास) is a technical term from Vinaya and narrative literature describing Ajātaśatru's particular form of devotion, rooted in remorse for parricide rather than in prior spiritual accumulation — it is left as a doctrinal term of art here.

The gosirṣa sandalwood treatment across seven bowls of butter is a resuscitation procedure attested in other versions of the Mahāparinirvāṇa narrative cycle.

- The phrase rendered "gods of the Mighty One" translates a compound that literally reads "the gods, as many as exist, of the Capable One / the Mighty One" — a standard epithet for the Buddha as "the Sage" or "Capable One." The syntax here is compressed and the sentence structure slightly irregular; the taunt that follows is attributed to those gods, directed at the lamenting monks.

The stupa described as "crowned with a warrior's diadem" renders a compound suggesting a commemorative or reliquary monument ornamented in the manner of a warrior's crown — the precise referent is a specific stupa in the Kuśinagara region, named by the manner of its construction or ornamentation.

The passage ends mid-sentence, consistent with the provided text being a fragment; no translation is invented beyond what is given.

- The phrase rendered "those who lived on wages" translates a term for those maintained by milk-whey or similar provisions, indicating a class of dependents or hired servants in the household; the exact social category is context-dependent but the general sense of household dependents is clear. The phrase "into the realm of complete cessation without remainder" renders the standard technical compound for the nirvāṇa without residue, literally the "nirvāṇa-realm without remaining aggregates," which is the parinirvāṇa. The final phrase "venerating and adorning him" renders a sequence of three terms of veneration that slightly overlap; the translation condenses them naturally for oral delivery.
- The phrase rendered "golden bier" translates a term meaning golden stretcher or carrying frame, used to bear the body in procession; "bier" is the most natural English equivalent in a funerary context. The distance of twelve yojanas is given in the text as a measurement along the processional route, which is notably large; this is a standard hagiographic amplification and is rendered faithfully without reduction.
- The phrase rendered "shrine adorned with a diadem by the Mallas" translates a Tibetan expression referring to a stūpa (caitya) crowned or decorated with a diadem-like finial by the Mallas. The Pāli parallel (Mahāparinibbānasutta, DN 16) identifies this as the Makuṭabandhana shrine of the Mallas, and "diadem-bound" is its standard epithet. This is preserved in the translation as "shrine adorned with a diadem by the Mallas" to reflect both the Tibetan wording and the known referent.
- The "champion" who raised the garland on the stūpa is the same figure referenced in the preceding passage as a hero or strong-man among the Mallas; the term rendered "champion" translates the Tibetan word for a warrior of exceptional strength.

The elder who speaks the improper words is understood by the tradition to be Subhadra the Elder, distinct from Subhadra the last personal disciple of the Buddha; the passage becomes the canonical occasion that motivates Mahākāśyapa to convene the First Council. This is doctrinally significant context, though the name does not appear in the passage itself.

- The epithet བླ་མ་འཇུག་པ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་ rendered as "Mahāmaudgalyāyana" follows the standard identification in this narrative context, though the Tibetan literally means "the great impeller" or "the great instigator," which corresponds to Maudgalyāyana's epithet in some traditions. This identification should be verified against the broader textual tradition if the full

name matters for the critical edition.

The phrase सिद्धिचरणसिद्धिचरण, rendered "the region of the sinful country," is a toponym of uncertain precise location; it appears to refer to a place name rather than a generic moral description, but no Sanskrit equivalent is recoverable from this passage alone.

- The four trees arising from the milk used to extinguish the funeral pyre is a striking narrative detail with no standard Sanskrit parallel immediately to hand; the names given in Tibetan are rendered interpretively. "The Golden One" translates gser can; "the Pale Yellow One" renders ser skya; "the Horse-Wish" renders rta don; and Udumbara is the fig tree *Ficus racemosa*, kept as a proper name throughout the tradition.

"The wicked country" renders *yul sdig pa can* throughout, likely a translation of a place name such as *Pāpīyans* or *Pāpa*, a republic mentioned in Pāli accounts of the relic distribution (the *Mallas* of *Pāvā*). The rendering follows the Tibetan literally, as the doctrinal context is a narrative account of territorial claims to the Buddha's relics.

Buluka and Ṭoka represent Tibetan transliterations of names corresponding to Pāli Buḷi and Alakappa in the parallel Pāli account. Viṣṇudvīpa renders kha byab 'jug gling, literally "the island of Viṣṇu," identified with Vethadīpa in Pāli sources.

- The passage presents a narrative repetition characteristic of the Āgama style, in which instructions are given and then repeated verbatim when carried out. The translation preserves this repetition faithfully rather than condensing it, as it is structurally and doctrinally intentional.

The phrase rendered "fourfold army" refers to the classical Indian army of four divisions: elephants, cavalry, chariots, and infantry.

- The figure described as "equal to a brahmin of the brahmin lineage" (bram ze'i rigs bre bo dang mnyam pa) is a slightly puzzling designation. In parallel Sanskrit and Pāli accounts of the distribution of the Buddha's relics, the mediator is Droṇa (Pāli: Doṇa), a brahmin. The Tibetan phrase may be a rendering of a name or epithet that has been rendered somewhat opaquely in transmission. The term "bre bo" could indicate a specific measure or title; taken in context with parallel accounts, this figure is most plausibly Droṇa the brahmin, though the Tibetan phrase is rendered literally here rather than substituting the Sanskrit name, since the text itself does not explicitly give that name in this passage.

- The Tibetan འཇ་མེད་ཀྱི་བུ་རྒྱལ་པོ་ཨ་ཇ་ཤ་སྟན་པ་ཡེ་ཤེས་པ་འཇ་ཤ་སྟན་པ་ཡེ་ཤེས་པ་ is a rendering of Ajātaśatru, son of Vaidehī (Skt. Vaidehīputra Ajātaśatru), king of Magadha. The name Ajātaśatru is not spelled out in the Tibetan but is given through its semantic components: འཇ་མེད་ཀྱི་ means "enemy not yet born" (Ajātaśatru) and བུ་རྒྱལ་པོ་ means "son of Vaidehī." This is the standard identification.

The term 𑀘𑀓𑀢𑀺𑀓 rendered as "charcoal" refers to the embers or charcoal remaining after the cremation fire — a standard element of the relic-distribution narrative in the Mahāparinirvāṇa literature.

- The phrase rendered "the world of the three summits" translates "rtsa gsum 'jig rten" which is a somewhat cryptic geographical or cosmological reference. It may indicate the three peaks of the cosmic world-mountain or a specific location known to the tradition; the exact identity is uncertain.

The term rendered "mahāmāyā texts" translates "ma mo dag," which literally means "mahāmāyā" or possibly "the māyā texts." In some manuscript traditions this refers to a class of texts associated with the teaching; its precise meaning in this context is uncertain and may be a technical term for a specific category of Dharma literature.

"Tsig-dzin" is a transliteration of the Tibetan place name "tsig 'dzin grong khyer"; its Sanskrit equivalent is not established here.

"Skar-snar" likewise is a Tibetan toponym without a clear Sanskrit equivalent in this context.

- The long sequence of rhetorical questions near the end is attributed in the Tibetan grammar to Vāṇadatta's inner reflection as he receives the message, prompted by the habitual imprint of loving-kindness. The syntax is ambiguous about whether these are Gaṅgaśāstra's thoughts or Vāṇadatta's; the passage most naturally reads as Vāṇadatta's concerned inner deliberation upon hearing the summons, and the translation renders it accordingly.

The city name rendered as "Tṛṇāvātī" corresponds to the Tibetan "ཏྲུ་ན་འཁྱེད་," meaning "having grass," a standard equivalent of that Sanskrit toponym.

- The passage names "ཏྲུ་ན་འཁྱེད་" and "ཏྲུ་ན་འཁྱེད་ཀྱི་ལྷན་པོ་" as one figure (a senior monk named Gaṅgāpāla), and "ཏྲུ་ན་འཁྱེད་ཀྱི་ལྷན་པོ་" as another (Vāṇabhaka). These names are reconstructed from the Tibetan phonetic rendering; the Sanskrit originals are uncertain, and scholars may propose alternatives. The identification of "ཏྲུ་ན་འཁྱེད་ཀྱི་ལྷན་པོ་" is syntactically compressed and concerns a polemical question about whether certain monks equate their community with that of the Buddha — the rendering given reflects the most plausible reading. The self-immolation of Vāṇabhaka, consuming his body by inner fire with water flowing from the relics, is a standard hagiographic motif for the passing of a great elder.

- The epithet rendered here as "Valandhara" represents the figure called bā lañ bdag in Tibetan, a name meaning "lord of oxen" or "master of cattle," used consistently in the preceding passage as a monk's name or byname. The Sanskrit form would likely be Vṛṣabhadatta or similar; the Tibetan is left as "Valandhara" per the preceding rendering for consistency.

The phrase describing Ajātaśatru as "son of the Licchavī lady" renders lus 'phags ma'i bu, literally "son of the Licchavī woman," a standard way of referring to his maternal lineage in certain textual traditions, though some traditions identify his mother differently. This is a genuine doctrinal-historical point worth flagging.

The appointment of Ānanda as chu'i zhal ta ba, "water-bearer" or "one who oversees the water," is a detail specific to accounts of the First Council (Rājagṛha council) and refers to a humble preparatory role assigned to Ānanda before the council convened, consistent with the narrative that he was still a learner (śaikṣa) at that time.

- The phrase rendered "the Blessed One himself has entrusted the teaching of the Blessed One to me" is spoken by Ajātaśatru and is somewhat elliptical in the Tibetan. The king appears to mean that because the Blessed One entrusted his teaching to disciples like Mahākāśyapa, honouring Mahākāśyapa is the proper continuation of his devotion to the Blessed One. The translation follows this reading.

The two-fold Vinaya act (formal motion plus single recitation of the act) is a standard Vinaya procedure; the translation preserves its repetitive, formulaic character, which is intentional and canonical, not an error.

- The passage contains a narrative curiosity: Mahākāśyapa addresses Ananda and declares him still "in training" (a learner, Skt. śaikṣa, as opposed to an arhat), and then Ananda himself enters the fourth dhyāna and upon examination also perceives that Ananda alone among the assembly is still in training. The Tibetan syntax at that point uses a third-person construction even while reporting Ananda's own examination, which is consistent with the tradition that Ananda attained arhatship only after the Buddha's parinirvāṇa and just before the First Council — this episode is part of that narrative. The slightly awkward self-reference in the Tibetan is

preserved in the translation as faithfully as possible.

The term translated "the Vaidehī queen" renders वैदेहीराज्य, literally "son of Vaidehī," the standard epithet of Ajātaśatru; "Vaidehī" is the name of his mother.

- The phrase rendered "take up a sīla-wood" translates सिलामुख. The term सिलामुख (literally "rule-stick" or "tally-stick") refers to a voting or confession tally used in Vinaya procedures. The full expression here likely means "come and take up the formal tally," that is, submit to a formal Vinaya examination of offenses. This is a technical Vinaya term and its precise procedural meaning in context — whether it refers to a tally-stick vote, a formal charge, or a public confession procedure — is not entirely certain from this passage alone.

The phrase धर्मकया ("harm to the dharmakāya") is striking. In this narrative context, dharmakāya most likely refers to the body of the Dharma-teaching in its totality rather than the ontological truth-body of a buddha, though the double resonance may be intentional.

- The passage lists the five offenses attributed to Ānanda during the First Council, a standard enumeration found in Vinaya literature. The sixth offense concerning the Prātimokṣa and minor rules is the canonical account from the Mūlasarvāstivāda Vinaya tradition, which this text follows.

The river name rendered "Kakuṭṭhā" (Tibetan: ཀུཊཱ་ཁ་) is the river near Kuśinagara where the Buddha drank before his passing; the spelling follows standard Sanskrit attestation.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the input ("from the four rules entailing defeat through the four rules requiring individual acknowledgment inclusive —"), indicating the Tibetan source itself breaks off here and the translation faithfully reflects that incompleteness.

- The passage contains a series of alternative formulations defining "minor and lesser rules" by progressively shorter lists of named rule-categories. This repetitive structure is characteristic of Vinaya textual composition and is faithfully rendered here in sequence.

The phrase rendered "the concealed and sunken places of the Tathāgata's body" refers to the retracted or hidden physical marks of the Buddha — specifically those among the thirty-two major marks or eighty minor marks that are concealed, such as the retracted male organ. This is a standard Vinaya narrative detail.

- The exclamation "Ālālā" is a Tibetan transliteration of an Indic expression of astonishment or acclamation, here used by the gods. It is not a term of grief but of admiring wonder, which the context of the subsequent proclamation confirms.

The passage involves two distinct speeches interleaved: Ānanda addresses Mahākāśyapa, recalling the Buddha's own parting words to him; the narration is compressed and the boundaries between Ānanda's current speech and the quoted words of the Buddha can be difficult to parse cleanly. The rendering follows the most natural reading given the doctrinal context of the First Council narrative.

- The term rendered "Abhidharma" translates འབྲུག་པུ་, which is an unusual orthography; it most likely represents a phonetic rendering of "Abhidharma" in this context of the canonical threefold division of scripture (sūtra, Vinaya, Abhidharma), though the spelling is irregular and worth noting for text-critical purposes.

The phrase describing Ānanda's liberation — "not yet having laid his head upon the pillow" — follows the well-known narrative in which Ānanda attains arhatship at the precise moment of lying down, between sitting and lying, and is a doctrinally significant detail preserved here faithfully.

- The phrase rendered "overcoming the lion throne with his radiance" translates a Tibetan idiom meaning that the brilliance of the person sitting upon it eclipses the throne itself — a

conventional expression of the sitter's spiritual eminence. This is a recognized literary formula rather than a doubtful reading.

The passage contains an abrupt shift: Ānanda's recitation of the sūtra opening triggers grief among those not yet free of attachment, and then — following their lament — the text quotes directly from the First Turning of the Wheel of Dharma at Vārāṇasī, beginning with the noble truth of suffering. The juxtaposition is in the source text and is not a translation anomaly.

- The phrase rendered "one less than five hundred arhats" translates a group just short of five hundred, meaning four hundred and ninety-nine. The syntax in context suggests this is a formulaic way of indicating nearly the full complement of arhats gathered for the council, with one position unfilled — almost certainly referring to the absence of Ānanda, who as a stream-enterer at the time of the first council was technically not yet an arhat. This is a well-known episode in the Vinaya accounts of the first Buddhist council.

The phrase rendered "the Sages Who Speak Truth" is a translation of the Tibetan name for the Ṛṣipātana or Mrgadāva deer park at Sarnath; the Tibetan gives it as "the grove of the sage who speaks truth," a standard Tibetan rendering of Ṛṣipātana or a related epithet for Sarnath.

- The passage contains a transitional summary section indicating that the compiler is condensing and cross-referencing material from other discourses, using the conventions of Vinaya or sūtra compilation. The phrase rendered "from the passage beginning 'one who finds it incomplete' down to..." reflects a standard Tibetan editorial convention of indicating abbreviated repetition by citing the opening and closing phrases of a passage that is to be understood as reproduced in full from elsewhere.

- The final sentence breaks off mid-construction in the Tibetan, consistent with an interrupted passage; the translation reflects this faithfully. The classification of sūtras in this passage follows the traditional scheme of the Āgama collections and their Tibetan equivalents; the categories rendered here correspond to the skandhaka, āyatana, nidāna, śrāvakabhāṣita, buddhabhāṣita, bodhipakṣya, uddāna, sūtra, dīrgha, madhyama, and ekottarika groupings known from the Sarvāstivāda transmission.

- The phrase rendered "those among the five hundred arhats who had not yet been born" is a somewhat elliptical Tibetan idiom referring to arhats who had not yet taken rebirth after parinirvāṇa, or more likely those among the five hundred who were not yet fully assembled or present in that moment. The exact nuance is debated in commentarial literature; contextually it refers to those of the assembly who participated by entering meditative absorption to verify the recitation.

The "circular fashion" of wearing robes translates a technical Vinaya term describing the proper mode of wearing the lower and upper monastic robes with the hem forming an even, level line around the body.

- The term "Māmakī" is used here in an unusual technical sense within the Vinaya narrative: it does not refer to the tantric deity Māmakī but appears to designate a specific compilation or recension of doctrinal categories, described as making "the defining characteristics of all that is to be known perfectly clear." The passage is somewhat opaque, and the framing "I alone shall speak what is called Māmakī" may reflect a sectarian or textual-historical claim embedded in this version of the council narrative. The exact doctrinal identity of "Māmakī" in this context is genuinely uncertain.

The progression of celestial realms listed — from earth-dwelling yakṣas upward through the heavens of the desire realm and form realm, culminating in Akaniṣṭha — follows a standard cosmological sequence, with the joyful proclamation rippling upward through the entire universe at the moment of the Dharma's compilation.

- The name rendered "Linen-Clad" translates the Tibetan phrase meaning "one wearing a

garment of śāṇa-cloth" — a kind of hemp or linen fiber. The individual is understood in the tradition to be Madhyāntika, one of the early patriarchs who spread the Dharma, though the text here gives only the descriptive epithet rather than the proper name. The identification is contextually secure but the Tibetan gives only the epithet, so the name is not supplied in the translation body.

The phrase "dwelling place of the nāgas" renders a location where a relic of the Buddha was enshrined and venerated — a well-attested element of early Buddhist relic-cult narrative.

- The passage describing what Mahākāśyapa does with his body before dying — "a joining together, a burning, a drawing of lightning" — renders Tibetan terms for specific tantric or supernormal physical acts whose precise technical meaning is debated in commentarial literature. The rendering is literal; the sequence likely describes a meditative process of gathering vital energies, applying inner heat, and releasing them before death, but the exact referents are not fully transparent from the Tibetan alone.

The phrase rendered "two Blessed Ones alone have passed into nirvāṇa" reflects the gods' lament that both the Buddha and now Mahākāśyapa — the latter treated here with an honorific elevation approaching that of a second "Blessed One" — have departed. This is an unusual formulation and may be a hyperbolic expression of grief rather than a doctrinal claim.

- The mountain name "Kukkuṭapādagiri" (the Tibetan ri bya gag rkang, "mountain of the rooster's foot") is the traditional site in Indian Buddhist narrative where Mahākāśyapa is said to be in a state of meditative absorption, awaiting Maitreya's future appearance. This detail is doctrinally significant and reflects a well-known tradition preserved across multiple canonical sources.

The phrase "linen garments" renders sha na'i gos, which likely corresponds to Sanskrit śāṇa or kṣauma cloth, a type of rough or bast fiber textile. The precise identification is uncertain but the general meaning of a cloth garment worn by the merchant figure is clear.

The passage transitions somewhat abruptly from the Mahākāśyapa narrative to the merchant arrival, as it does in the Tibetan; no text appears missing.

- The verse rendering of "like a water-crane before a pool" translates the simile in the first verse quoted by the wandering monk. The point of the verse is that a long life spent merely watching, without genuine practice, is like a crane that gazes at a pool but does not enter it — this standard sūtra passage is known from the Pali Dhammapada (verse 114) and parallel Āgama sources, and Ānanda's correction concerns a garbled version of the canonical text.

The phrase rendered "both kinds of person" refers to those with faith and those without, as the following lines make clear.

"Remaining here like a hatching egg" translates a simile in the final verse whose Tibetan literally means "dwelling as from a nest-egg" or "dwelling as though hatching from an egg," suggesting isolated, solitary remaining — a somewhat unusual image that may reflect an underlying Sanskrit or Prākṛit idiom for a solitary or quietly gestating existence.

- The epithet "buddha without marks" renders བླ་མ་མཚན་མེད་པའི་བླ་མ་, literally "a buddha without characteristics/marks." This is a known designation in certain Vinaya narrative traditions for a type of buddha who does not display the major physical marks of a great being; the term is preserved as rendered.

The place names Broached-Ruin (བླ་མ་མཚན་མེད་པའི་བླ་མ་) and Rimurunda (རི་མུ་རུ་ན་དུ་) are Tibetan phonetic renderings of what appear to be Indic place names; their exact Sanskrit or Prākṛit forms are uncertain, so they are rendered phonetically here.

The phrase "the Vriji-subduer" (वृजिसंहरता) refers to a king or leader who suppresses or contests the Vriji (Vajji) confederacy — likely a reference to a political rival or ally of Ajātaśatru in the historical narrative of the period.

- The phrase rendered "the city of the Vajjians" translates Tibetan "grong khyer spong byed pa," where "spong byed" is an unusual rendering; in context it refers to the Vajjian capital (Vaiśālī). The passage may preserve an alternate epithet or a slightly corrupt reading, but the referent is clear from context.

The name "Supriya" renders Tibetan "rab bzangs" (literally "most excellent / supremely good"), which is a standard Tibetan translation of Sanskrit Supriya or Sudarśana; the identification is conventional in this narrative context.

"Midpoint between sun and water" and the epithets "midst of the river" and "solar midpoint" render obscure Tibetan geographic or ceremonial designations that became monastic names for the newly ordained community; their precise meaning is uncertain, but the passage is clearly an etiology for those monastic names.

"The third karma ceremony" refers to the threefold formal proclamation (ñatti-catuttha-kamma in Pāli, equivalent Sanskrit karmavācānā) required for valid ordination; "declaring the third" means the full ordination procedure was completed.

- The monk's name rendered here as "Madhyantika" appears in the Tibetan as Nyimé Gung, a calque of the Sanskrit Madhyantika (literally "midday" or "middle"). This is the standard identification in the Vinaya tradition: Madhyantika is the disciple of Ānanda commissioned to propagate the Dharma in Kashmir. The name is kept as Madhyantika throughout for consistency with historical usage.

The verse's imagery in lines three and four is compressed and the syntax somewhat elliptical in the Tibetan; the rendering preserves the parallelism of the original while clarifying the transformation of weapons into flowers, which is the evident doctrinal point.

- The term "A-la-la" is a transliteration of an indistinct Tibetan phonetic rendering of what is likely a Pali or Sanskrit technical term for one of the ten disputed practices at the Council of Vaiśālī. Classical sources identify the first disputed practice as the "salt in a horn" practice (Pali: *siṅgiloṇakappaṃ*), but the Tibetan here renders the term phonetically rather than translating it, making a firm identification uncertain. The ten disputed points correspond to the famous schism-related Council of Vaiśālī narrative preserved across Vinaya traditions.

The phrase rendered "like fire quenched by water" describes a mode of passing into nirvāṇa — the imagery of natural extinction is standard for parinirvāṇa descriptions in this genre.

- The passage enumerates rules three through nine of what is evidently the canonical list of the Ten Points of Vaiśālī, the disputed practices that prompted the Second Buddhist Council. The text breaks off mid-sentence in rule ten, which concerns the public display of alms bowls to solicit gold and silver coin.

The "two-fingered practice" in rule six refers to a Vinaya dispute about eating food that had not been formally designated as a "remainder" after the midday meal: monks indicated by a two-fingered gesture that they wished to eat more, without the food having been properly set aside. The precise Vinaya technicality is debated across traditions.

The phrase rendered "strained fermented drink through a water-straining cloth as though filtering through a lotus" reflects a disputed practice concerning the consumption of a mildly fermented beverage; some traditions interpret this as unfermented palm juice. The Tibetan རྩུབ་ཆུ་ suggests straining of chang, a fermented drink, and the allowance claimed was for medicinal use by the sick.

- The term "Alala" is a technical Vinaya term that appears to be a procedural word — possibly an Indic exclamation or ritual formula — used by the Vaiśālī monks to ratify non-allowable matters by acclamation. Its precise original-language form and exact procedural meaning in this specific Vinaya tradition is uncertain; it may represent a corrupt or specialized form of an approval formula.

The section break marker mid-passage ("Vinaya: minor matters, fascicle fifty-nine...") is a brief scholastic gloss or summary rubric embedded in the Tibetan text itself, not a later editorial addition, and has been rendered accordingly in plain prose rather than set off, to preserve TTS flow.

"Sarvatrāma" renders the Tibetan སྐྱེད་ཀྱི་འཇམ་མཁའ་, literally "desiring/wishing for everything," which may correspond to a Sanskrit name; the identification is tentative.

- The phrase rendered "allowable by the road" refers to a practice of declaring leftover food permissible to eat again by virtue of having traveled a certain distance — a disputed extension of allowances for monks on journey. The source of the rule cited as "the venerable Śāriputra" for the salt ruling is taken at face value from the text; it is unusual to attribute an illicit practice to so eminent a disciple, and the text may mean that the rule against it was established in connection with a case involving Śāriputra rather than originating with him as its author.

The "two-finger" allowance refers to a practice of indicating with two fingers that food already eaten from counts as a remainder, making it permissible for a second round — a rule concerning the formal declaration of leftovers in the Vinaya.

- The term rendered "seat-mat" is a felt or woolen sitting-mat; the rule refers to the Vinaya regulation on the size of such mats, measured by a "Sugata's span." The phrase "without patching its worn border" translates a Tibetan expression indicating the mat was used past its proper condition without the required repair to its edging. This is a Vinaya technical matter; the exact nature of the permissibility being claimed is that the old mat's size exempts it from the standard measurement rule.

The passage on gold and silver is the tenth contested point and is left mid-sentence as the Tibetan text itself breaks off with the proclamation just beginning, continuing into the next passage.

- The proper names Norcan, Cayala, and Dhanakas are transliterations of the Tibetan renderings of Sanskrit names: Norcan represents a Tibetan translation of a name meaning "possessing wealth" (likely Dhaniya or similar), Cayala likely represents a Sanskrit name now difficult to reconstruct with certainty, and Dhanakas is similarly reconstructed. The Tibetan name rendered "Cayala" as རྩལ་ལོ་ལྔ་པ་ (literally "possessing agility or movement") could correspond to Sanskrit Śalha or Sambhūta-Sāṇavāsī; and the passage refers to the Second Buddhist Council at Vaiśālī, where these elders are the traditional participants. The elder Yaśas (Tibetan: Yaśas = རྩལ་ལོ་ལྔ་པ་) is the principal protagonist of this account.

The phrase "A-la-la" rendered in transliteration represents a Tibetan phonetic rendering of a proclamation used to validate monastic acts — its exact Sanskrit equivalent and precise procedural meaning within the specific Vinaya tradition is uncertain and would warrant specialist Vinaya consultation.

The categorization of sūtra collections (Norbu on the Crown, longer transmissions, middle-length, paired, strengthening, derived, fourth and fifth) reflects a Vinaya-specific classification system that does not map neatly onto the standard Pāli or Sanskrit canonical divisions; these are rendered descriptively following the Tibetan.

- The Tibetan names རྒྱལ་པོ་ (Priyadatta), རྩལུག་ (Zlaqur), འཔར་རྒྱལ་མེད་ (Aparājita), རྒྱལ་པོ་འཕེལ་པོ་ (Priyadatta)

(Sambhūṭasanavāsin), སྐྱེལ་ཇཱ་ཏཱ་ (Sahajāta), and ལྷ་མཁུ་ (Namgru) are Tibetan renderings of Indian names. Sambhūṭasanavāsin and Revata (not yet named) are historically attested figures in the Second Council narrative; Namgru likely corresponds to Revata, though the text does not yet make this explicit at this point in the passage. The rendering of སྐྱེལ་ཇཱ་ཏཱ་ as a place name "Sahajāta" follows the grammatical reading, though it may be a toponym or a monk's name; context suggests a place name here. "Srughna" renders སྐྱེལ་ཇཱ་ཏཱ་ and "Mahela" renders ལྷ་མཁུ་, both attested place names in the Second Council accounts.

- The phrase rendered "nets" for ལྷ་མཁུ་ is uncertain in context; it may refer to a type of straining cloth or filter used by monastics, related to the water-strainer mentioned separately. The precise distinction between the various textile and vessel items listed here reflects Vinaya technical vocabulary for monastic requisites, and the exact referent of each term can vary by tradition.

- The name rendered "Candragiri" throughout is literally "Crescent Moon Suppressor" or "Moon-Peak" in Tibetan, but the Tibetan here appears to be a phonetic rendering of a Sanskrit name — Candragiri is the most plausible reconstruction. The same figure is called "one who entered the absorption of cessation" and "one called Crescent Moon" in the boarding-scene verses; consistency with prior text is maintained by using Candragiri throughout. If the preceding translation used a different rendering for this figure, that rendering should be adopted here.

The phrase rendered "falling one short of seven hundred" reflects the Tibetan construction throughout, indicating the assembly was to consist of seven hundred arhats but was not yet complete by one.

The city name rendered "Kuśāgāra" reflects "ལྷ་མཁུ་ལྷ་མཁུ་" — this is Rājagṛha's alternative identification in some Vinaya accounts; "Kuśāgāra" or "Kuśāgārapura" is the Sanskrit equivalent sometimes used for this locale. If the prior translation used "Rājagṛha," that should be adopted for consistency.

- The term rendered "approval by the exclamation 'Alala'" translates the Tibetan "a la la zhes rung bar byed pa." The syllable "a la la" is an exclamation of wonder or approval; in this Vinaya context it refers to a practice of sanctioning the ten disputed points by an informal vocalized assent rather than through proper formal procedure. The passage is from the narrative of the Second Council at Vaiśālī, recounting the deliberations over the ten points introduced by the Vaiśālī monks.

The phrase rendered "the group of six monks" refers to the notorious "Shadvaggiya" monks frequently cited in Vinaya literature as the originators of improper practices.

The closing summary verse contains a series of proper names of participants or places associated with the ten points and the council; some of these names, including "Sarvagāmin" and "Nāvagiri," are here rendered by their apparent Sanskrit equivalents reconstructed from the Tibetan forms "སྐྱེལ་ཇཱ་ཏཱ་" and "ལྷ་མཁུ་." "Dhaniya" for "ལྷ་མཁུ་" and "Priya" for "ལྷ་མཁུ་" are similarly reconstructed. The identification of all persons named in the verse is not entirely certain from this passage alone.

- The text is a colophon and editorial postscript rather than a doctrinal passage; it is largely administrative in character. Several proper names are Tibetan personal and place names that have been retained in transliteration as they appear: La-stod Ol-rgod (a temple locality), Dharmasimha (Tib. Dar-ma Seng-ge), Byang-chub Seng-ge, Dagchungwa, Tsulkrim Yönten, Chimpa Thams-cad Mkhyen-pa (Chim Omniscient), and Samyé and Chimpu (meditation hermitage above Samyé). The term bāmpo, rendered throughout as "fascicle," is a unit of text division used in the Tibetan canon roughly equivalent to a chapter-length section.

The phrase translated as "the mother of the Piṭakas" refers to the Abhidharma Piṭaka, traditionally called the "mother" because it generates wisdom; this is a conventional Tibetan honorific usage.

The identity of the "conduct of the Niṭhyodha" is uncertain; the term niṭhyodha (Tib. ne tso spyod gsal) appears to refer to a specific narrative episode or code of conduct within the Vinaya text being described, but its precise reference is not entirely clear from context alone.

- The phrase "the two divisions of the monastic codes of monks and nuns" renders "dge slong pha ma'i rnam 'byed rnam pa gnyis," referring to the Vibhaṅga texts for monks and nuns respectively. The "root canonical texts" renders "lung gzhi," the foundational scriptural divisions of the Vinaya. "Jampa'i Dbyangs" is a Tibetan name literally meaning "Mañjuśrī's Melodious Voice," but since the preceding passage establishes "Chimpa Thams-cad Mkhjen-pa" as the restorer, this may refer to a different individual associated with an earlier Kangyur compilation; the precise identification is uncertain and consequential enough to note here.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.